

Encyclopedia of
BLACK STUDIES

MOLEFI KETE ASANTE
AMA MAZAMA
EDITORS



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BLACK STUDIES

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EDITORS



FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:21 PM Page i

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:21 PM Page iii

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1

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Acquiring Editor:

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Editorial Assistant:

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Developmental Editor:

Yvette Pollastrini

Project Editor:

Claudia A. Hoffman

Typesetter:

C&M Digital (P) Ltd.

Indexer:

Will Ragsdale

Cover Designer:

Ravi Balasuriya

FM-Asante.qxd 11/3/2004 3:17 PM Page v **Contents**

List of Entries, *vi*

Reader's Guide, *ix*

Editorial Board, *xiii*

Contributors, *xv*

Preface, *xix*

About the Editors, *xxiii*

Introduction, *xxv*

Entries A-Z, *1–482*

Appendix I: Chronology of the Most Notable Books, Scholars, and Events
in Black Studies, *483*

Appendix II: Advanced Degree–Granting Programs, *487*

Appendix III: Major Journals in Black Studies, *489*

Suggested Resources, *491*

Index, *507*

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page vi **List of Entries**

Accommodationism

Afrocentric Schools

Black Feminist Thought

Affirmative Action

Afrocentric Social Work

The Black Jacobins

Africa World Press

Afrocentricity

The Black Manifesto

African Aesthetic

Afrocultural Theory

Black Nationalism

African Americans

Afronography

Black Panther Party for

African Americans and American

All African People's

Self-Defense

Communism

Revolutionary Party

Black Philosophy

African American Oratory

American Anti-Slavery Society

Black Politics

African American Studies,

American Civil War

Black Power Conference of

Temple University

American Colonization Society

Newark, New Jersey

African American Studies: The

American Negro Academy

Black Power Movement

First Doctoral Program

Amistad Research Center

The Black Scholar

African American Studies:

Amsterdam News

Black Skin, White Masks

Graduate Studies for the 21st

An Appeal to the Colored Citizens Black Studies

Century

of the World

Black Studies, City College of

African American Studies: The

Ancestor Veneration

New York

Indian Perspective

Ancient Egyptian Studies

Black Studies, Kent State

African Burial Ground Project

Movement

University

African Cosmology

Antilynching Campaign

Black Studies, Names

African Dance in the United

Antiracist Philosophy

Controversy

States

Apollo Theatre

Black Studies, Wellesley College

African Demographics

Associated Publishers

Black Theology

African Epistemology

Association of Black

Blaxploitation Films

African Ethnic Groups

Psychologists

Blues

African Liberation Day

Ausar Auset Society

Broadside Press

African Philosophy

The Autobiography of Malcolm X

Brown v. Board of Education of

African Renaissance

Axum Empire

Topeka

African Studies Association

Bureau of Refugees, Freedmen,

African Worldview Theory

Back-to-Africa Movement

and Abandoned Lands

Africana Womanism

Before the Mayflower

Africological Enterprise

The Birth of a Nation

Capoeira

Africology

Black Anglo-Saxons

Caribbean

Africology: Opposition

Black Arts Movement

Charles L. Blockson

Afrocentric Creed

Black Athena

Afro-American Collection

Afrocentric Criticism

The Black Atlantic

Cheikh Anta Diop International

Afrocentric Education

Black Church

Conference

The Afrocentric Idea

Black Codes

Christianity

The Afrocentric Paradigm

Black Consciousness Movement

Class and Caste

The Afrocentric Scholar

Black Existentialism

Class Struggle

vi

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page vii **List of Entries**——vii

Code Noir

Imperialism

Moynihan Report

Compromise of 1850

Indigeniste Movement

Multicultural Education

Congress of African Peoples

Institute of Positive Education

Congress of Racial Equality

Institute of the Black World

Narratives of the Enslaved

Congressional Black Caucus

Introduction to Black Studies

Nat Turner's Rebellion

Consciencism

Invisible Man

Nation of Islam

Consciousness

Islam

National Association for the

Council of Independent Black

Advancement of Colored

Institutions

Jazz

People

Creole

Jim Crow

National Black Political

Creolization

Johnson Publishing Company

Convention, Gary, Indiana

The Crisis

Joint Center for Political and

National Black United Fund

The Crisis of the Negro

Economic Studies

National Council for Black Studies

Intellectual

Journal of African Civilizations National Negro Congress

Cultural Genocide

Journal of Black Studies

National Urban League

Curse of the Door of No Return

Journal of Negro History

Négritude

Negro

Dark Ghetto

The Karamu House

Negro Convention Movement

The Destruction of Black

Kawaida

Neocolonialism

Civilization

Kemet, Afrocentricity and

New Deal

Diaspora

Knowledge

The New Negro

Diopian Historiography

Kiswahili Movement

Nguzo Saba

Dislocation

Ku Klux Klan

Nommo

Dream Team

Kush

North Star

Kwanzaa

Nubia

Ebonics

Education and Black Studies

Last Poets

Obeah

Elder Scholars

Letter From the

Odu Ifa

Emancipation Proclamation

Birmingham Jail

Opportunity: A Journal

Enslavement Resistance

“Lift Every Voice and Sing”

of Negro Life

Ethiopianism

Lucumi Tradition

Oral Tradition

Ethnic Notions

Lynching

Organization of Afro-American

Eurocentrism

Unity

European Slave Trade

Maat

Oyo Empire

Exodusters

Mali Empire

March on Washington

Patriarchy

Family

Marie Laveau

The Philadelphia Negro

Fanonian Concept of Violence

Maroon Societies

The Pittsburgh Courier

Festivals

Mdw Ntr

Plessy v. Ferguson

Fisk Jubilee Singers

Melanin Theory

Popular Traditional African

Forty Acres and a Mule

Messianism

Religions Everywhere

Freedom Songs

Middle Passage

Protest Pressure

Freedom Summer

The Mis-Education of

The Psychopathic Racial

Gabriel Prosser's Revolt

the Negro

Personality

Ghana Empire

Mississippi Freedom

PUSH

Democratic Party

Haitian Revolution

Montgomery Bus Boycott

Rastafarianism

Highlander Folk School

Moorish Science Temple of

Reconstruction

Hip-Hop

America

Red Summer

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page viii viii———**Encyclopedia of
Black Studies** Reggae

Spirituals

U.S. Constitution, Fourteenth

Reparations

Stolen Legacy

Amendment

Republic of New Afrika

Stono Rebellion

U.S. Constitution, Fifteenth

Revolutionary Action Movement

Amendment

Ring Shout

Talented Tenth

Root Doctor

Temple Circle

Vesey's Conspiracy

Their Eyes Were Watching God

Vodu

Sankofa

They Came Before Columbus

Santería

Third World Press

Watts Prophets

Schomburg Center for Research

Two Cradle Theory

Watts Rebellion of 1965

in Black Culture

Westernization

Scottsboro Case

Umfundalai

The World Conference Against

Slave Route

Underground Railroad

Racism, Racial Discrimination,

Songhay Empire

Universal Negro Improvement

Xenophobia and Related

Soul

Association

Intolerance

The Souls of Black Folk

Us

The Wretched of the Earth

Southern Christian Leadership

U.S. Constitution, Thirteenth

Conference

Amendment

Yoruba Tradition

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page ix **Reader's Guide**

This list is provided to assist readers in locating entries Institutions, Intellectual Schools, Journals, Legal on related topics. It classifies entries into 30

Issues, Movements, Newspapers, Political Issues, categories: African American Studies Afrocentricity, Professional Organizations, Publishers, Racism, Annual Conferences, Anti-Racism, Arts, Associations Religion, Reparations, Research Centers, Resistance, and Organizations, Books, Campus Politics, Civil Theories, United States Constitution. Some entries Rights, Classical Africa, Concepts, Culture, Films, may appear in more than one category.

AFRICAN AMERICAN STUDIES

Council of Independent Black

Jazz

Institutions

The Karamu House

African American Studies,

National Council for Black

Last Poets

Temple University

Studies

Oral Tradition

African American Studies:

Reggae

The First Doctoral Program

Ring Shout

African American Studies:

ANTI-RACISM

Spirituals

Graduate Studies for the

American Anti-slavery Society

Umfundalai

21st Century

Antilynching Campaign

Watts Prophets

African American Studies:

Antiracist Philosophy

The Indian Perspective

Black Consciousness Movement

ASSOCIATIONS AND

Freedom Summer

ORGANIZATIONS

AFROCENTRICITY

Highlander Folk School

March on Washington

American Colonization Society

Afrocentric Creed

Protest Pressure

American Negro Academy

Afrocentric Criticism

Association of Black

Afrocentric Education

Psychologists

The Afrocentric Idea

ARTS

Ausar Auset Society

The Afrocentric Paradigm

African Aesthetic

Black Panther Party for

The Afrocentric Scholar

African American Oratory

Self-Defense

Afrocentric Schools

African Dance in the

Institute of Positive Education

Afrocentric Social Work

United States

Institute of the Black World

Afrocentricity

Apollo Theatre

National Association

Afrocultural Theory

Black Arts Movement

for the Advancement

Afronography

Blaxploitation Films

of Colored People

Blues

National Black United Fund

Capoeira

National Urban League

ANNUAL CONFERENCES

Fisk Jubilee Singers

Organization of Afro-American

Cheikh Anta Diop International

Freedom Songs

Unity

Conference

Hip-Hop

PUSH

ix

Black Studies, Kent State

Talented Tenth

Leadership Conference

University

Westernization

Universal Negro

Black Studies, Names

Improvement Association

Controversy

CULTURE

Us

Black Studies, Wellesley

African Americans

College

African Burial Ground Project

BOOKS

Ancestor Veneration

CIVIL RIGHTS

Ebonics

The Afrocentric Idea

Festivals

The Afrocentric Paradigm

Congress of Racial Equality

Fisk Jubilee Singers

Afrocentricity

Congressional Black Caucus

Freedom Songs

An Appeal to the Colored Citizens National Association

Hip-Hop

of the World

for the Advancement

Jazz

The Autobiography of Malcolm X

of Colored People

Kwanzaa

Before the Mayflower

National Negro Congress

Last Poets

Black Athena

National Urban League

Nommo

The Black Atlantic

Nguzo Saba

Black Feminist Thought

CLASSICAL AFRICA

“Lift Every Voice and Sing”

The Black Jacobins

Reggae

Black Skin, White Masks

Diopian Historiography

Spirituals

Code Noir

Ghana

Watts Prophets

The Crisis of the Negro

Kush

Intellectual

Mdw Ntr

Dark Ghetto

Two Cradle Theory

FILMS

The Destruction of Black

The Birth of a Nation

Civilization

Ethnic Notions

CONCEPTS

Introduction to Black Studies

Sankofa

Invisible Man

Affirmative Action

Kemet, Afrocentricity and

African Americans

INSTITUTIONS

Knowledge

and American Communism

Letter From the Birmingham Jail

African Cosmology

Black Church

The Mis-Education of the

African Epistemology

Family

Negro

African Philosophy

Kwanzaa

The New Negro

Africological Enterprise

Patriarchy

Odu Ifa

Class and Caste

The Philadelphia Negro

Consciousness

INTELLECTUAL SCHOOLS

The Psychopathic Racial

Creolization

Accommodationism

Personality

Diaspora

Dream Team

The Souls of Black Folk

Dislocation

Elder Scholars

Stolen Legacy

Ethiopianism

Kawaida

Their Eyes Were Watching God

Eurocentrism

Temple Circle

They Came Before Columbus

Fanonian Concept of Violence

The Wretched of the Earth

Imperialism

JOURNALS

Maat

Messianism

The Black Scholar

CAMPUS POLITICS

Multicultural Education

The Crisis

African American Studies,

Nommo

Journal of African Civilizations Temple University

Protest Pressure

Journal of Black Studies

Black Studies, City College

Rastafarianism

Journal of Negro History

of New York

Soul

Opportunity

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xi **Reader's Guide**——xi

LEGAL ISSUES

African Ethnic Groups

Marie Laveau

Axum Empire

Moorish Science Temple

Black Codes

Black Anglo-Saxons

of America

Brown v. Board of Education

Caribbean

Nation of Islam

Bureau of Refugees, Freedmen,

Creole

Obeah

and Abandoned Lands

Diaspora

Popular Traditional African

Forty Acres and a Mule

Ghana Empire

Religion Everywhere

Plessy v. Ferguson

Kush

Root Doctor

Scottsboro Case

Mali Empire

Santería

Maroon Societies

Vodu

MOVEMENTS

Negro

Yoruba Tradition

African Liberation Day

Nubia

All African People's

Oyo Empire

REPARATIONS

Revolutionary Party

Songhay Empire

Ancient Egyptian Studies

Black Manifesto

Movement

PROFESSIONAL

European Slave Trade

Back-to-Africa Movement

ORGANIZATIONS

Middle Passage

Black Consciousness Movement

Reconstruction

Black Power Conference of

African Studies Association

Reparations

Newark, New Jersey

National Council for

Slave Route

Black Power Movement

Black Studies

Congress of African Peoples

RESEARCH CENTERS

Haitian Revolution

PUBLISHERS

Indigeniste Movement

Amistad Research Center

Kiswahili Movement

Africa World Press

Charles L. Blockson

Mississippi Freedom

Associated Publishers

Afro-American Collection

Democratic Party

Broadside Press

Joint Center for Political and

Negro Convention Movement

Johnson Publishing Company

Economic Studies

Organization of
Third World Press
Schomburg Center for Research
Afro-American Unity
in Black Culture
Republic of New Afrika

RACISM

Revolutionary Action Movement
Code Noir

RESISTANCE

Cultural Genocide

NEWSPAPERS

Class Struggle
Freedom Summer
Curse of the Door of No Return
Amsterdam News
Jim Crow
Enslavement Resistance
North Star
Ku Klux Klan

Exodusters

The Pittsburgh Courier

Lynching

Gabriel Prosser's Revolt

Red Summer

Nat Turner's Rebellion

POLITICAL ISSUES

World Conference

Stono Rebellion

Against Racism, Racial

American Civil War

Underground Railroad

Discrimination, Xenophobia

Compromise of 1850

Vesey's Conspiracy

and Related Intolerance

Emancipation Proclamation

Watts Rebellion of 1965

Neocolonialism

New Deal

RELIGION

THEORIES

Ausar Auset Society

African Worldview Theory

POPULATIONS

Christianity

Africana Womanism

African Americans

Islam

Africology

African Demographics

Lucumi Tradition

Black Existentialism

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xii xii———**Encyclopedia of
Black Studies** Black Nationalism

Kawaida

U.S. Constitution, Fourteenth

Black Philosophy

Melanin Theory

Amendment

Black Politics

U.S. Constitution, Fifteenth

Black Studies

Amendment

U.S. CONSTITUTION

Black Theology

Consciencism

U.S. Constitution, Thirteenth

Education and Black Studies

Amendment

FM-Asante.qxd 11/3/2004 3:21 PM Page xiii **Editors**

Molefi Kete Asante and Ama Mazama

Temple University

Editorial Board

Dr. Troy Allen

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Department of History

Department of African American Studies Southern University, Baton
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Department of Afro-American Studies

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Institute

Brown University, Providence, Rhode Island Cornell University, Ithaca,
New York Dr. Clenora Hudson-Weems

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Department of English

Department of Africology

University of Missouri–Columbia

University of Wisconsin, Milwaukee

xiii

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xv **Contributors**

Adjua Barbara E. Adams

Katherine Olukemi Bankole

The College of New

West Virginia University–Morgantown Rochelle–Rosa Parks Campus

James A. Banks

David Shachia Agum

University of Washington

Temple University

Kismet Beckman

Makungu M. Akinyela

University of Chicago

Georgia State University

Aslaku Berhanu

Akua Nson Akoto

Temple University

NationHouse Watoto Shule/Sankofa Fie **William Boone**

Kwame Agyei Akoto

Temple University

NationHouse Watoto Shule/Sankofa Fie **Kwame Botwe-Asamoah**

University of Pittsburgh

Akin Alao

University of Texas at Austin

George Brandon

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Southern University

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Chicago State University

Harry Amana

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Molefi Kete Asante

Temple University

Dawn L. Cannon

Howard University College of Medicine **Molefi Khumalo Asante**

University of California, Los Angeles **Willie L. Cannon Brown**

Pierce College

Deborah F. Atwater

Pennsylvania State University

Ibo Changa

University Park Campus

Temple University

Mario J. Azevedo

Mark A. Christian

University of North Carolina at Charlotte Miami University of Ohio

xv

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xvi xvi———**Encyclopedia of
Black Studies Talmon Chvaicer**

Peter Gratton

University of Haifa, Israel

DePaul University

Adeniyi A. Coker

Fatima Hafiz

University of Alabama at Birmingham Temple University

Edward R. Crosby

Rebecca Hankins

Kent State University

University of Arizona Library

George Sefa Dei

Deonte Hollowell

Ontario Institute for Studies in Temple University

Education, University of Toronto **Kristy Holmes**

Robert Douglas

Temple University

Louisville University

Thomas Houessou-Adin

Nah Dove

University of Toledo

University of Ghana

Rosalyn Howard

Zetla K. Elvi

University of Central Florida

Temple University

Regina Jennings

Andrew Michael Fearnley

Rutgers University

University of Cambridge

Christopher K. Johnson

Ana Monteiro Ferreira

Temple University

Universidade Aberta, Lisboa

Ilona V. Johnson

Rita S. Fierro

Penn State University

Temple University

Zainabu Jones

Tiffeni Fontno

Temple University

Temple University

Myra Julian

Kiera Hope Foster

Temple University

Temple University

Maulana Karenga

Aisha Francis

California State University, Long Beach Vanderbilt University

Tiamoyo Karenga

Justin Gammage

California State University, Long Beach Temple University

Maghan Keita

Mohamed Garba

Villanova University

Abdou Moumouni University of Niamey **Leophus S. Tarharka King**

Fikru Gebrekidan

Millersville University

St. Thomas University

Geoffrey “Jahwara” Giddings

William M. King

Antioch College

University of Colorado at Boulder **Aimee Glocke**

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Temple University

Temple University

Lewis R. Gordon

Kwasi Konadu

Brown University

Akan Institute

Mekada Graham

Deborah LaNier

California State University, Fresno *Temple University*

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xvii **Contributors**——xvii

Cynthia Lehman

Levi A. Nwachuku

*University of Maryland at Eastern Shore Lincoln University of the
Commonwealth of Pennsylvania*

Natalie Lewis

Temple University

Imari A. Obadele

Prairie View A and M University

William Little

José-Vittorio Pimienta-Bey

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Commonwealth of Pennsylvania

Wellesley College

Darrianna M. Proctor

Temple University

Ama Mazama

Temple University

Reiland Rabaka

California State University, Long Beach **Charlton D. McIlwain**

New York University

Sudhi Rajiv

Jai Narayan Vyas University, Jodhpur **Bart McSwine**

Pamela Yaa Asantewaa Reed

Chicago State University

College of New Rochelle

Judylynn Mitchell

Patricia Reid-Merritt

West Salisbury Elementary School in Maryland Richard Stockton College

Miriam Ma'at-Ka-Re Monges

Rico X

California State University, Chico Temple University

Del-Zola Moore

Michelle Rief

Temple University

College of Manhattan

Clyde Alafiju Morgan

Gloria Grant Roberson

State University of New York College Adelphi University

at Brockport

Mario Root

Suzuko Morikawa

Bishop Dunn Catholic School in Dallas Chicago State University

William R. Scott

Christopher Murray

Lehigh University

Temple University

Jorge Serrano

Gwinyai Muzorewa

Temple University

Temple University

Thysha M. Shabazz

H. V. Nelson

Temple University

University of California, Los Angeles **Mwalimu J. Shujaa**

Mutombo Nkulu-N'Sengha

Fort Valley State University

California State University, Northridge **Mawusi Renee Simmons**

Vera DeMoultrie Nobles

Temple University

San Francisco State University

Mark Solomon

Wade W. Nobles (Nana Kwaku

Boston College

Berko I, Ifagbemi Sangodare)

Catherine Squires

San Francisco State University

University of Michigan

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Black Studies Robert Ssengonzi**

Selase N. Williams

Research Triangle Institute

California State University, Dominguez Hills **Ronald J. Stephens**

York Williams

Grand Valley State University

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Douglas E. Thomas

A. J. Williams-Myers

Adelphi University

State University of New York at New Paltz **Griselda Thomas**

Khonsura J. Wilson

Temple University

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Ivory Achebe Toldson

Raymond A. Winbush

Southern University

Morgan State University

Wendy Carmen Trott

Gail Hilson Woldu

Delaware Technical College, Wilmington Trinity College

Winston A. Van Horne

Tyrene Wright

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee City University of New York

Kheli R. Willetts

Stephanie Yarbough

Syracuse University

Temple University

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xix **Preface**

Black Studies emerged as both an intellectual field person a white person in thought, attitude, and and a critical ideology during the 1960s. It has behavior, to leave the person nothing but a black shell.

remained close to its roots and also made a broad and Therefore, the creators of Black Studies understood deep impact on scholarship in general by creating a that one of their key demands had to be control over the fundamental shift in the way scholars pursue research process of education.

and view human societies: Black Studies has made Within a university structure, all power resides in possible an awareness of the great contributions that departments and faculty members, not in programs Africans and those of African descent have made to and adjuncts or research assistants. The first objective the discourse of knowledge.

of the movement was to secure departments of Black Studies. This was a major task because there had not been any such departments at major or minor univer-THE DIMENSIONS IN BLACK STUDIES

sities. The best to emerge from decades of education, There are three dimensions in the evolution of Black even in the black colleges and universities, were Studies during the last few decades: (1) the organiza-departments of history where individual historians—

tion of departments and programs, (2) the academic such as Chancellor Williams, Carter G. Woodson, and administrative instruments dealing with the nature William Leo Hansberry, John Henrik Clarke, John of the discipline, and (3) the preparation of scholars Jackson, Benjamin Quarles, and others—sought to in graduate programs. Those who sought to create demonstrate the role of Africans in world history. But Black Studies were concerned with the obstacles that some of them were often under severe pressure, criti-would be advanced to prevent the self-definition, self-cized, ostracized, and hounded out of colleges seeking determination, and intellectual liberation of those of to express themselves as enclaves of whiteness in a African descent living in the Americas. This was a sea of black students.

substantive issue because the history of American All of this history was available to the students of education had been against the extension of certain the sixties who understood that to avoid the mistakes intellectual freedoms for Africans. Furthermore, of the black colleges they had to demand a Black before 1865 people of African descent living in the Studies

department where the courses would be taught United States were not citizens and consequently were from *a black perspective*. This was the operative term not African Americans but Africans. Since the 1990s, at the very beginning of the movement. It was trans-many people of African descent have used *African* later erroneously by some to mean that only blacks to designate their cultural origin. This use of the term could teach in the departments, but the initial impetus is not a reference to citizenship. The term *African* is was not racist or racial but ideological. Those who being used here in a special sense to mean those taught in the departments of Black Studies had to who were enslaved and their descendants. Carter G.

understand and appreciate the black perspective.

Woodson referred to this difficulty in his 1933 book Black Studies departments were established in *The Mis-Education of the Negro*. It was Woodson's several major colleges and universities, such as Ohio State, where the black person had been afforded State, Louisville, San Jose State, Temple, Cornell, the right to education, the process was often meant to Pittsburgh, Wisconsin, San Francisco State, Harvard, further isolate the person from his or her cultural and SUNY Buffalo, and UC Berkeley. Other schools, such historical background. The idea was to make the black as UCLA, the University of Pennsylvania, Princeton, xix

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xx xx———**Encyclopedia of Black Studies** Yale, Michigan, Wayne State, Michigan State, the Americas. In recent years, the tendency to define Michigan, and Illinois, chose the weaker program some areas of research as Diaspora Studies has gained model and did not create such departments.

momentum. The idea in the centers and some depart-Consequently, there has been a long debate over the merits where this term is employed is that such stud-field in these institutions that did not immediately ies must explore and expose the character of the move to organize Black Studies as a department. They experiences of African people in the Caribbean and have remained on the periphery of the discipline, South America. One could comfortably say, however, often attracting high-powered intellectuals in the tra-that there has never been a time in Black Studies when ditional disciplines and suggesting that they are Black there was a prohibition of this

sort of transcontinental Studies professors. Occasionally these professors understanding of the African experience. The field repudiate both Black Studies and those who suggest was at its very origin a pan-African enterprise.

that they are anything other than sociologists, historians, or literary critics. Immersed in their old disciplines and wedded to their old career paths, these Black Studies. For the first time since the emergence professors have often used Black Studies departments of the field 20 years earlier there would be the possibility as means for advancement in their original disciplines bility of Black Studies conferring the terminal degree but not as professional arenas for their own work.

on a candidate. The doctoral program was greeted The academic and administrative instruments with tremendous anticipation by the scores of young meant to secure the field include the establishment of scholars who would benefit from it in ways that could research centers, journals, seminars, conferences, and not even be imagined. The first master's and Ph.D.

a professional organization. Over the years, these class at Temple University, during the autumn of instruments of the discipline have been articulated in 1988, was comprised of 37 students. At this time, more discreet ways. For example, instead of the there have been more than 125 doctoral graduates at *Journal of Black Studies*, *Black Scholar*, and *Western* Temple University. They occupy positions in depart-Journal of Black Studies, the three most prominent ments and programs in the United States as well as in journals that emerged out of the sixties and early sev-other nations. The first student to receive the doctor-enties, scores of departments and centers have their ate in African American Studies was a Nigerian, own journals and newsletters. Black Studies is no Adeniyi Coker; the first African American student to longer a small affair in the American academy. The receive the doctorate in African American Studies field is implicated in many national and international was Mark Hyman; the first white student to receive a issues, and scholars from every corner of the globe doctorate in African American Studies was Cynthia publish in the journals. The *Journal*

of *Black Studies*, Lehman; the first Chinese student to receive a doctorate from a refereed journal that has set the standard for scholarship in African American Studies was Yuan Ji; and scholarship in the field, has more than 3,000 subscribers.

the first Japanese student to receive a doctorate in More than half of the professors who have received African American Studies was Suzuko Morikawa.

tenure in the field of Black Studies have published in These Black Studies scholars and those who follow the *Journal of Black Studies*. In addition, over 75% of them will be building on the work of those of us who all Black Studies professors who are tenured have had to train in other disciplines because Black Studies published in at least one of the three journals established did not yet exist. Therefore, the objective of each listed concurrently with the field—the *Journal of* graduate program in Black Studies must be to prepare *Black Studies*, *Black Scholar*, and *Western Journal of* its students to apply their greater conceptual and *Black Studies*.

disciplinary education to enriching the discipline. At Major research centers have been established at the present time, there are departmental doctoral Columbia, the University of Michigan, and UCLA, as programs at Temple, UC Berkeley, and the University well as at other universities, with the aim of conferring of Massachusetts Amherst; there are interdepartmental contributing to the evolution of scholarship in Black doctoral degree programs at Harvard and Studies. Grants have been made to scholars for the Michigan State.

exploration of public policy, education, social welfare, The *Encyclopedia of Black Studies* has brought and economic aspects of the lives of Africans living in together the work of nearly 200 scholars with the

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xxi **Preface**——xxi

objective of securing a baseline for the establishment reversed so that many departments claimed that the of a canon of the field. Our intention has been to confer name African American or Afro-American was too very a sense of the research activity, conceptualization, limiting. Some sought to use the term

Africana to and pedagogy of Black Studies scholars. Thus, we represent black people in the Americas, Africa, and have created an encyclopedia that is conceptually the Caribbean. The term has gained acceptability driven rather than personality driven; that is, the ideas through its use by the Cornell University Institute for and concepts of the field are thrust into the forefront *Africana* Studies and the *International Journal of* and create the context within which individuals'

Africana Studies, which is published under the auspices of the National Council for Black Studies. The *Encyclopedia of Black Studies* fills a serious term *Africana* was also taken up by the *Encarta* need for professionals in the field, but it also has value *Africana* encyclopedia of African culture.

for those who are interested in the cultural production of the black community apart from the general public **THE ORGANIZATION OF THE ENCYCLOPEDIA** output in popular journals and magazines. The intent of the encyclopedia is to provide more than a state-of-the-art account of the field—it is to give the reader betically. They are cross-referenced to aid the reader substantial information that might be used to develop in making associations between entries. Furthermore, state-of-the-art accounts in the field. Thus, we were we have prepared a Reader's Guide in which the eager to make sure that scholars, researchers, and entries are grouped according to a series of key topics, students could refer to the encyclopedia for trustworthy allowing the reader to read all of the entries on a accounts, common definitions in the field, and disci-particular theme, such as Organizations, Culture, or plinary protocols. Students in many fields, including Resistance.

but not limited to African American Studies, history, sociology, and anthropology, will find the encyclope-ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

dia of use in their researches. Serving as a source for the most used ideas and concepts in the field of Black We would like to acknowledge the people who have Studies is a principal goal of this encyclopedia. Often worked

and concepts in the field of Black We would like to acknowledge the people who have Studies is a principal goal of this encyclopedia. Often worked

hard to help us bring this encyclopedia to individuals have used concepts such as *Afrocentricity*, *fruition*. Rolf Janke and Vince Burns were our first *Africology*, *double consciousness*, *patriarchy*, and contacts at Sage on this project. Throughout every-Kawaida without knowing what the average user of thing, even the departure of the senior development such terms in Black Studies means by them. We hope editor, Vince Burns, Rolf Janke has been consistent that the *Encyclopedia of Black Studies* will be a guide and on target. We greatly appreciate his confidence in from which to have meaningful discourse.

our work and in our project. Claudia Hoffman came aboard at the right time, just as the work was intensifying, and the fact that this encyclopedia is being read **THE VIEW OF BLACK STUDIES**

by scholars the world over is due to her diligence in We take a broad view of Black Studies. This is only working with us. We are grateful to her for the work natural because the originators of the field took a that she did in guiding this project.

broad view. More important, however, is the fact We could not have achieved this monumental proj-that the position the early scholars took is absolutely ect without the thinking of our colleagues and our correct in terms of how most people in the field view graduate students. Many of them helped us with entry the work that we do as professionals. Black Studies development and gave us much encouragement when implies in its name the idea that the study is concerned academic and organizational obstacles seemed insur-with people who are identified as or define themselves mountable. We never underestimated the amount of as black people. This identification transcends national work that would be needed to secure contributors who and continental boundaries. African American Studies were knowledgeable on the subjects of the entries we reduced the reach of the term *Black Studies* and made thought it necessary to include. We probably underes-it more American. This was the trend during the 1980s.

timated the amount of time it would take to pull all of However, by the early 1990s the trend was once again the entries together on time. Nevertheless, we are

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xxii xxii———**Encyclopedia of Black Studies** happy to say that the *Encyclopedia of Black Studies* have external or university funding. Yet the editorial was produced within the time frame given by the pub-board members gave us their support, believing that if lishers. This was due in large part to our able assistant, this project could be done, we could do it. So for us Sekhmet McCallister. She was extraordinary in her they are the real keepers of the field of Black Studies ability to use all electronic means to assist us. We and we greatly appreciate them.

could not have done this job without her steadfastness.

Both of us thank our families profusely for their She is a remarkable person and we are very grateful understanding, generosity, and patience. We therefore for her assistance.

express our gratitude to Dr. Garvey Lundy and Ana We especially want to recognize the members of Yenenga, the most important people in the world to us, the editorial board who lent their names and reputa-for their ability to listen to our complaints about dead-tions to this project and gave their input generously lines and difficulties. They endured and we endured.

when necessary. Some of them worried that we would not be able to pull this project off because we did not

—*Molefi Kete Asante and Ama Mazama*

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xxiii **About the Editors**

Molefi Kete Asante is considered one of the most important professors in Black Studies. She is the author distinguished contemporary scholars in Black Studies.

of five books, including *L'Imperatif Afrocentrique* and He is the author of 55 books and more than 300 articles *The Afrocentric Paradigm*. Her articles and essays in 25 different journals.

have appeared in many scholarly journals nationally Dr. Asante was the first director of UCLA's Center and internationally, and she has been cited by African for Afro-American Studies, from 1969 to 1973, where American Studies professional organizations for he was responsible for developing the research and curriculum programs. During the past 30 years, he has consultant for educational institutions, she has co-edited the *Journal of Black Studies*, making it one of the needed in the area of making scholarship relevant to most prestigious journals in the field of Black Studies.

the African community.

Dr. Asante has been recognized as one of the 10

Dr. Mazama has taught at the University of Texas most widely cited African Americans. He has taught at Austin, Pennsylvania State University, and Temple at several universities, including UCLA, Purdue, University. She has trained outstanding graduate Florida State, Howard, SUNY Buffalo, and Temple.

students and has been the most prolific teacher of At Temple University he created the first Ph.D. program in African American Studies. He has directed Temple. A teacher of remarkable talent, Dr. Mazama more than 100 doctoral dissertations. In 2001, has also been an academic leader in Black Studies.

Transition Magazine said, "Asante may be the most Her work has focused on language, linguistics, and important professor in Black America." Dr. Asante theory. She has been particularly skillful in defending has received scores of awards and recognitions, the Afrocentric paradigm as a legitimate framework including the distinguished Douglas Ehninger Award for analyzing events and texts. Her work has been for Rhetorical Scholarship from the National Communication Association in 2002.

Cheikh Anta Diop Conference's committee for outstanding research and academic excellence, **Ama Mazama** is one of the leading theorists of the Dr. Mazama has won both the Ankh Award and the Afrocentric school. With

a doctorate from La Diop Award, becoming the only person ever to win Sorbonne in Paris, Dr. Mazama is one of the most both of these distinguished awards.

xxiii

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xxv **Introduction**

THE ORIGINS OF BLACK STUDIES

not because the field should be codified or concretized but because scholars and students should have some. Nearly 40 years ago, African American students at clear conception of the evolutionary processes that San Francisco State College engaged in protests created and maintain the discipline. Black Studies has that led to the creation of the first bachelor's limited the wanton spread of imperialistic curricula to degree-granting departments of Black Studies in the the degree that it has presented an exceptionally brilliant United States. Nathan Hare was made the first chair-liant collection of articles and books demonstrating person of the department. This was 1967. A year the validity of a multiplicity of perspectives on facts.

later, Martin Luther King, Jr., was assassinated in Education is no longer, as it was, lily-white. One only Memphis, Tennessee, leading to the most widespread has to consider the linguistic and symbolic transformations and urban disturbances in the history nations that have occurred in the academy to see the of the United States. However, with the death of King impact of the discipline of Black Studies on sociology came a renewed commitment on the part of the ogy, history, social work, psychology, and political American nation to bring about educational reform, science. Those fields that have not been influenced by and Black Studies was one of the beneficiaries of this the innovations in Black Studies remain intractable new mood.

but also remain outside of the new thinking about. Since that time, scholars have undertaken the task race, culture, gender, and ethnicity.

of fleshing out Black Studies with theoretical works, No longer are most academicians comfortable research studies, methodological discourses,

social using terms and phrases such as *African slaves*, responsibilities, and institution building. The success *Columbus's discovery of America*, *African primitives*, of these efforts, against the enduring intransigence of *Universal Man*, and *Black Africa*, without appending the academy toward Black Studies, has been phenom-some explanation to them. The ideas these words rep-enal and sustaining. The fact that the *Encyclopedia of* resent call for studied reflection on the nature of his-Black Studies can now be written attests to the matu-torical and cultural reality. Clearly, Europe is no rity of the field.

longer the standard nor the model by which Africa, Africans, and those of African descent must be judged. Numerous arguments for white exclusivity

THE FIELD AND THE ENCYCLOPEDIA

have been shown to be myths maintained by a racist This is not merely an encyclopedia of black culture or educational system. Thus, the names of ancient an encyclopedia of black people—it is a specific, pre-African philosophers such as Ptahhotep, Imhotep, cise encyclopedia dealing with the emergence and Akhenaten, Amenemhat, Amenemope, Duauf, and maturity of an intellectual field that was begun as a Amenhotep, son of Hapu, have been heard in the corrective to generations of hegemonic curricula classrooms of America's most prestigious universities meant to support the theories and practices of white because of the transformation brought about by Black racial domination. Increasingly there are encyclope-Studies. Indeed, it is not simply that the names have dias dealing with many topics and themes, including been heard but that the philosophies have been trans-distinguished African scholars, the African world, lated, read, and discussed in many venues. Maulana African nations, and African culture.

Karenga's monumental work *Maat: The Ethics of* Few disciplines or areas of study have needed an *Social Justice* (2004, Routledge) is just the latest in a encyclopedia as much as Black Studies does. This is long line of outstanding publications in Black Studies xxv

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xxvi xxvi———**Encyclopedia of Black Studies** scholarship on ancient Africa. It has taken Black much more capability and much more enlightenment Studies scholars to rescue the study of ancient African about African American and African realities than

we ethics and culture from the static archaeological had in the past. The reason for this is researchers'

works of many Egyptologists.

intense search for as much information as possible to Our aim in this encyclopedia is to extend the disbe able to write the whole black story. This search led course on intellectual ideas, not merely to enumerate scholars to Ahmad Baba, the last chancellor of the the cultural artifacts that exist in the black world.

University at Sankore in Mali, who may have been the Indeed, culture is important and we see our work as most published African writer of his generation.

adding to the serious treatment of the concepts and During the 15th century, he wrote more than 42 books ideas that are employed in Black Studies. In effect, in on various subjects, including law, ethics, mathemat-order to approach the study of Africans in the ics, and religion. Another writer, Amadou Bamba, the Americas and Caribbean, it was necessary for the early 19th-century cleric of Senegal, authored more African and African American scholars who practiced than 1500 treatises on many subjects during his time Black Studies to see it as more than politics, and more as spiritual and cultural leader of the Mourrides of than the enumeration of artifacts; they had to under-Touba. Without the aggressive research of African stand the field in its own right as disciplinary arena.

American Studies scholars, however, information This was the first task of achieving an academic full-such as this probably would not have been brought to ness in the field. Without this type of framework, all the attention of students and the lay audience.

else dangled in the air and often appeared irrational, The fact that we know so much about the condition bizarre, or strange. For example, it was impossible to of the African diaspora in Brazil, Venezuela, properly study the funeral behaviors of African Colombia, Belize, Guatamala, Costa Rica, Martinique, Americans in the South, Jamaicans, or Haitians with-Guadeloupe, Haiti, Jamaica, Mexico, Peru, Uruguay, out some appreciation

of the context in which these and many other countries is directly related to the behaviors developed. Catherine Godboldt (2002) scholarly interest in comparative African societies, addressed this issue in a telling way when she noted religions, and acts of resistance to oppression. Much that although it is well known that black people in the of this information was available before Black South have always enjoyed the porch as an extension Studies, without registering as serious points of inter-of the family dwelling, it is necessary to have a broad est in the academy until Black Studies scholars began view of village life in Africa to see the connection to refer to new categories of information.

between enslaved Africans building porches on Black Studies as a discipline also has a political Southern homes and the public spaces for socializing aspect because it was born of the desire to see a more in Africa. European houses did not have porches, and equitable world. It is a subject that introduces the it was not until Africans introduced porches that this student and scholar to the fact of Africa's betrayal.

new idea was born. What has happened too often in The question is not "Has Africa been betrayed?" but education is that the white, Western European per-

"By whom and for what reasons has Africa been spective has been taken as universal, and therefore betrayed?" Set in motion by enslavement, colonial-people have no idea of what constitutes continuities or ism, and globalization, the betrayal of Africa sought to correspondences from one culture to the next. This disinherit Africans in the Americas as well as through-perspective collapses almost everything into its sphere out the world. The ultimate function of this is to and what is actually an African achievement is seen as dislocate Africans in the context of human history.

European. Thus one of the central tendencies of Black Dislocation is at the root of many of the theoretical Studies is to consciously cultivate a discourse on iden-problems in studying African phenomena. It is the tity that speaks to the diversity and commonalities quality of being outside of one's own psychological or found in the pan-African world.

cultural reality, which has been the experience of What we have discovered in the course of editing Africans worldwide. The fact that Africans have often this encyclopedia is the extent to which Black Studies taken as their reality the experiences of Europeans and has revolutionized the information pool. Just the fact have participated in the general Eurocentric under-that the field has brought many new professors into standing of history has further distanced many people the arena for thinking and acting has affected infor-from their own historical realities. Thus, the intent of mation in both quantity and quality. We now have the Afrocentric revolution, including its cultural and

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xxvii **Introduction**——xxvii

political forms, is to relocate Africans everywhere assured him a place in history. Clarke articulated the within their own centered context for analysis and views of many African American scholars that interpretation, enabling them to produce more authen-Africanists, who were usually white, were disinter-tic and genuine responses to phenomena.

ested in the quality of African development and were in many ways merely arms of the colonizing impulse in the Western world. Although Clarke would later **The Afrocentric Point of Departure** criticize the Afrocentric theory, in 1974 he published Afrocentricity, therefore, was posited not as an an article in the *The Afrocentric World Review* in anti-European view but as a way for Africans the which he strongly affirmed the need to reshape the world over to proactively seek to explain phenomena study of history.

from their own points of view. This perspective cre-The experience in Montreal had been a watershed.

ated, inter alia, difficulties with the many scholars When the African American scholars walked out of who hold imperializing and hegemonizing attitudes the conference, they were joined by a group of revo-and have insisted on a dominating ideological per-lutionary African scholars who vowed to work for the spective where only Europe is correct, only Euopean creation of an African Heritage Studies Association.

ideas are valid, and Europe becomes the universal. This movement and the association it created predated model for all thought and behavior.

the National Council of Black Studies, which was The transformation brought about by Afrocentricity founded in 1974. Since that time, the two organiza- had been presaged in the writings and actions of tions have worked in tandem to examine, investigate, numerous scholars. Perhaps, as both Daryl Zizwe Poe interpret, and promote African culture transcontinen-

(2004) and Kwame Botwe-Asamoah (2004) have tally and transgenerationally.

claimed, Kwame Nkrumah was the first African to call The publication of *Afrocentricity* in 1980 by Molefi for an Afrocentric response to the political, economic, Kete Asante, 8 years before the creation of the first and cultural realities of Africa. As Ghana's first presi-Ph.D. program in African American Studies, and 6

dent and the spiritual leader of the modern pan-African years after the founding of the National Council of movement, Nkrumah propounded the view that Africa Black Studies, had an energizing effect on African had to examine the world with an eye to its interests as American Studies scholarship. Among the first disser-determined by its culture rather than Europe's culture.

tations to be written using Afrocentric ideas was that of Ghana was to be the prime model of African *conscien-Francis Dorsey, who received a doctorate from Kent cism, which is what Nkrumah named his philosophical State University's Department of Communication in perspective.*

1983. Dorsey had received a master's degree in com-Variou seeds of an Afrocentric orientation can be munication from the State University of New York in found in the works of Willie Abraham, Frantz Fanon, Buffalo under the direction of Molefi Asante in 1979.

and others, but their works are often compromised by He had been among the first students to be exposed to their training in the West (Abraham, 1966; Fanon, the new thinking regarding African agency. Thus, his 1968).

While this is not the time for a discourse on the dissertation on Marcus Garvey at Kent State was a misorientations that exist in their works, let it suffice revolutionary turn in the communication field and it to say that the incipient ideas in their intellectual con-anticipated many dissertations that were to be written tributions were useful to the maturity of the concept of in African American Studies.

Afrocentricity.

A Disciplinary or Multidisciplinary Field?

A Call to Change Scholars' Views of Africans Various scholars, such as Linda James Myers, It was the dramatic walkout of the 1969 African Marimba Ani, and Wade Nobles, emerged in the 1980s Studies Association Convention in Montreal by and 1990s to add to the discourse on the nature of African American scholars that led directly to a call Black Studies. One of the earliest to undertake a dis-for renewal in the way Africans were approached by cussion of the scope of the field was James Stewart scholars from the West. This may have been the event (1997), who pioneered work on the philosophical side that made John Henrik Clarke, leader of the walkout, of the discipline. He was committed to a multidimen-a household name in the pan-African community and sional, multidisciplinary view of the field and in several

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xxviii xxviii——***Encyclopedia of Black Studies*** highly useful essays laid out an intellectual idea that research articles that constitute foundational work in generated debate and discussion. Maulana Karenga the discipline.

(1993) at first reinforced Stewart's multidisciplinary One cannot simply write the history of Black view of the field. Later, however, he stated that the Studies as a history of Temple University's department Afrocentrists had made an important distinction of African American Studies, although many of the between discipline and interests: There is only one intellectual battles for the discipline have been fought discipline, and there are many interests, not many dis-at Temple. A plethora of issues have confronted the ciplines (Karenga, 1993). Nevertheless, this issue has field at other universities and have been met by equally continued to be debated in the National Council

for committed scholars. One of the first issues that schol-Black Studies conferences, as befits any serious disars had to deal with was the relationship of African course around concepts grounded in the search for American Studies to African Studies. A second issue theoretical and professional advancement.

was the role of Marxist analyses in the construction On the other hand, the Temple Circle, a group of of responses to the continuing crisis in the lives of Temple University professors and graduate students African Americans. A third issue was the cultural war led by Ama Mazama and Molefi Asante, took a radi-debate that was generated by the strong Afrocentric cally different perspective by arguing that Black thrust in the early 1980s. Finally, the idea of gender Studies was a discipline that could be applied to sev-and its relationship to culture had to be configured in eral different thematic and subject interests. Thus, one the evolving discourse around the collective African could have an interest in social institutions, music, experience. Each issue had its corollaries, subthemes, human experiences in chronological time, or the psy-and extenuations; each had its arguments, and some chic states of humans, and study these interests from were accompanied by conclusions before arguments an Afrocentric perspective. This became the most were made, but all the issues have been addressed in dominant perspective among students seeking the the general development of Black Studies.

highest degree since it freed them from being locked into defending a multidisciplinary field that could not Black Studies and African Studies be put back in the box. Black Studies had come of age because now there were not just competing paradigms African Studies developed during the late 1950s but different ways to view reality.

and early 1960s in the United States as a response to Faculty at other departments joined the fray on the rising tide of independent nations on the continent one side or the other. At Harvard, Yale, Brown, and of Africa. Most of the early support came from the Cornell, four key Ivy League institutions, Black Ford and Rockefeller Foundations. Their interests and Studies was seen literally as the study of black people those of the United States government coincided inas-from many different disciplines. There

was only much as they both sought ways to influence the newly one boundary—you had to be studying black people.

independent nations. Furthermore, the American This meant that there was almost no boundary, government wanted to have a highly trained cadre of because African people had been studied for hundreds civil servants who had knowledge of the languages of years; yet it would have been too much of a stretch and cultures of Africa. This was particularly useful to to claim that this activity was Black Studies. What the the information agencies.

Temple Circle understood was that the mere study of Consequently, many of the early Africanists were black people was not Black Studies.

also government employees and consultants. There has always been a close association between the Africanist tradition and the information services.

The Theoretical Evolution and

American officials interested in diplomacy and com-Development of Black Studies

merce in Africa frequently turned to the new Cecil Gray (2001) wrote an interesting and contro-Africanists for advice and assistance. Many of them versial book on the evolution of Afrocentricity. In his were scholars who had limited appreciation of book, he points out the inadequacy of a system that America's own role in the enslavement of Africans must rely on definitions from outside the group.

and therefore disconnected their research and work Therefore, to discuss Afrocentricity one must always from the ongoing problems of the Africans in the return to the intellectual source, that is, the books and diaspora.

*FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xxix **Introduction**——xxix*

Thus, when the Black Studies movement began in African descent in the industrial, heterogeneous the late 1960s, nearly 10 years after the Africanist societies of the West has not been adequately movement, there was little contact between the two answered by the Marxists; it remains one

of the con-interests. Indeed, Africanists tended to be largely tinuing issues in Black Studies. Nevertheless, a social-white, and Black Studies scholars were largely ist ethic seems to underlie much of the literature in the African Americans. However, the fact that African field, although it could be argued that it is not a con-Americans cast their research interests in pan-African sciously socialist attitude that governs the writings of terms meant that they would have a different perspec-African American Studies professors. It is as though tive than that of the Africanists. Bridging the gulf the humanist element in the analysis and synthesis of between the continents became a new desire in the political energies is directed toward creating societies academy.

where domination is critiqued as a matter of course and where human oppression based on race, culture, class, or gender is obliterated.

Black Studies and Marxist Sociologists Most of the leading sociologists in Black Studies Black Studies and the Cultural Wars departments viewed themselves as political sociologists and always framed their discussions in terms of The cultural wars of the 1990s were initiated not what it was that they had to offer to the vision of by Black Studies scholars but by white Eurocentric autonomy. It was clear that the African American con-scholars in response to some of their black protégées'

dition was one that demonstrated the class question in Afrocentric contention that it was necessary to its strictest sense. It was not clear whether there was develop a paradigm that spoke to the specific and para Marxist solution to the condition of Africans in the ticular condition of African people in the world. This United States. Many of the leading scholars in this was a thrust for agency, a movement to reinterpret tradition —Gerald McWorter (aka Abdul Alkalimat), reality from the standpoint of African people and for Ronald Bailey, and William Sales, for example—

the interest of African people. This was seen, inter believed strongly in the necessity of a general analy-alia, as an attack on white people, which it was not, sis of African American history based on the conflict and as an assault on Europe's hegemony, which it was.

model (Alkalimat, 1986). The fact of the matter is that Black Studies, in using the Afrocentric paradigm when one looks at the Southern experience of African (Mazama, 2003), was expressing its commitment to Americans, Africans were workers and whites were demonstrating that African phenomena can be studied capitalists in the classic caste sense. One could argue, from the perspective of African people. The goal was as some have, that this was only an aberration because for Africans the world over to be centered, that is, white workers were also being crushed by the cap-to be placed in an active role as agents with the possi-italist state. With radical democratic and socialist bility of seeing, conceiving, and acting in their own thinkers, such as William Sales, Manning Marable, best interest. Thus, scholars rushed to show that one and Cornel West, one often sees the duality of class can examine anything from an Afrocentric point of and race in their Black Studies writings. Manning view and arrive at conclusions different from those of Marable, who teaches political sociology at Columbia Eurocentrists. The difference was that Eurocentrists University, is the author of many books, including had identified their particularity as universal and How Capitalism Underdeveloped Black America could not see that others had different views and per-

(1983) and Black Liberation in a Conservative spectives that were valid for them. The Eurocentrists America (1997). Cornel West, who teaches religion at were so used to universalizing their experiences that Princeton University, is best known for the popular they believed that Black Studies scholars were, work Race Matters (1992). William Sales, who indeed, committing the highest academic crime—they teaches Black Studies at Seton Hall University, is the were assaulting the taboo of Eurocentric hegemony author of From Civil Rights to Black Liberation: itself. This is the origin of what white scholars Malcolm X and the Organization of Afro-American describe as cultural wars and what Black Studies Unity (1994).

scholars, such as Perry Hall and Terry Kershaw, The question of which factor is most responsible describe as the necessary reexamination of the proto-for the economic and cultural condition of people of cols of researching African phenomena.

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xxx xxx—**Encyclopedia of Black Studies** Afrocentrists claimed that it was not legitimate for productions of the society are more impressive than white scholars to attack other cultures or peoples and Greece and Rome combined. This meant, in Diop's then to claim that Europe was protected from criticism conception, that Europe, in its racist attitude, would because it was a chosen, special, unique culture above have to find ways to disinherit Africans of their the rest. Creating and researching from a centered per-classical civilization. He wrote many books, mainly spective, Afrocentrists rejected the idea that Europe in French, but some of them were published in was a model for humanity, because everywhere English, including the majestic work, Civilization or Europe seemed to be separating itself from the rest Barbarism. In each work Diop sought to advance his of humanity (Chinweizu, 1975). Indeed, geographer idea that the African was the mother of human civi-J. M. Blaut (1999) argued from a position similar to lization. A devoted researcher, Diop studied linguis-that of the Afrocentrists by claiming that the major tics, physics, architecture, history, art, mathematics, European historians were racists.

and did melanin experiments on mummies, in order to This new Afrocentric approach led scholars such as prove his point that the ancient Egyptians were black Innocent Onyewuenyi (1993), Miriam Monges Africans. In response to Diop, numerous Black (1997), Katherine Bankole (1996), and others to Studies scholars took up the call to link the study of advance novel ideas about different eras of African African people to the classical African structures of history. Onyewuenyi claimed a legacy that had been the past to advance a more meaningful interpretation left by Cheikh Anta Diop and continued researching of philosophy, ethics, religion, and culture.

the African origin of Greek philosophy in order to Detractors sought to minimize the achievements of demonstrate the antiquity of Nile Valley philosophical science, whether biological, archaeological, linguis-concepts. Monges undertook a new look at the civi-tic, or physical, when such achievements turned up as lization of Kush and established the plinth that would evidence against the position of a white Egypt or the later yield her work on the "shebanization" of knowl-position that Greece learned nothing from Africa. Of edge, which is the critical recentering of ancient course,

this could not be supported in the end, because knowledge on the activities and achievements of the overwhelming evidence to the contrary silenced women. Bankole demonstrated that the medical care everyone except the most foolhardy. Mary Lefkowitz, of the enslaved Africans in Louisiana was not only a classicist, wrote a book called Not Out of Africa brutally crude but also based on a Eurocentric notion (1996) to answer what she deemed the most signifi-of the inferiority of Africans and the superiority of cant arguments of the Afrocentrists. She singled out Europeans.

Martin Bernal, author of Black Athena (1987), who Perhaps the most provocative element in the cul-had created quite a stir with his thesis that ancient tural wars was the Afrocentrists' objective of carrying Athens owed a lot to the African and Asian civiliza-out the work of Cheikh Anta Diop, the late Senegalese tions that predated it, and attacked him with a historian, Egyptologist, and linguist. Diop had con-vengeance, believing that he had somehow under-tended that the ancient Egyptians who built the mined the dominant position of Greece in the ancient pyramids and the Pharaonic civilization were black-world. But Bernal's position was supported by enor-skinned Africans. This had upset much of the common mous evidence as well as plausible theories of African lore among whites that the ancient Egyptians were contributions to Greece. Indeed, in the 1950s George whites and had established the great civilization in G. M. James had written in Stolen Legacy (1956/2002) North Africa without any African influence. Diop's that there was no Greek philosophy, only stolen arguments in The African Origin of Civilization African philosophy. Bernal outdistanced both James (1974) were intended to answer all of the questions and Diop in his massive Black Athena project. What raised by European scholars about the cultures and was clear in the cultural war discussions was that civilizations of Africa as well as to show emphatically the hegemonists were outclassed by scholarship.

that ancient Egypt was the creation of black people.

Afrocentric scholars, many of them with knowledge Thus, Diop took the lead in defending Africa's own of Greek, Hebrew, Latin, and the ancient Pharaonic agency as a continent of cultural expression apart language Mdw Ntr, delved into the works of Plutarch, from European influence.

Pharaonic Egypt, or Kemet, Herodotus, and Aristotle, among others, to ferret out as it was called by the early Africans, was the most the distinction between the ancient record and the monumental civilization of antiquity. The creative modern Aryan record. It was necessary for Black

FM-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page xxxi **Introduction**———xxxix

Studies scholars, particularly the Afrocentrists, to Patricia Dixon (2001), Nah Dove (1997), and others.

reformulate historical periods based on a new reading Gender is necessarily a factor to be raised in any of the texts. This was done, and it was published in critical, political, economic, behavioral, or cultural and disseminated through articles in the Journal of discussion, but it is not the core of Black Studies.

Black Studies, the Journal of Negro History, Western Definitionally, Black Studies must deal with black Journal of Black Studies, and Black Scholar.

people, with no regard to gender.

Yet it is understood that in the context of Black Studies as elsewhere men and women cannot be seen Black Studies and Gender

as being the same. Indeed, Patricia Dixon (2001) has The issue of gender in the context of Black Studies boldly argued that it might be necessary for black has always been a complicated one. There had been an women in the United States, given the large numbers of early movement to separate female-centered interests single women, to reconsider the Western opposition to from Afrocentric ideas, thus creating two perspec-polygamy. Of course such a proposal is provocative, but tives, one female and the other African. This separatist it is one idea found in an analysis of the economic and idea was rejected by the major leaders of the field social plight of African American families. Gendered because it overlooked the idea that Afrocentricity was understandings of different phenomena are definitely a theoretical perspective, indeed, a paradigm, that was possible within the purview of Black Studies.

initiated without regard to gender. The idea of a sepa-Black Studies cannot be isolated from the world rate female-centered paradigm would essentially and therefore it cannot be isolated within the academy.

leave Afrocentricity as a male-centered paradigm. It The modern college or university, to be taken seri-was neither conceived as a male-centered idea nor ously as a place of major intellectual discourse, must sustained in any active way as a one-gender concept.

have Black Studies. Africans and those of African The Afrocentric idea was to view both females and descent are preeminently modern people in thinking males of African heritage as benefiting from a general and attitude, and whether one is at Harvard or Arizona orientation to phenomena, reality, concepts, and State, it is almost impossible to understand the modern events that were African centered.

world apart from understanding the role of African One cannot divest oneself of one's cultural per-people in this era. Furthermore, African American spective. When a person is making an analysis, it must people are so much a part of the political culture, the be from one cultural perspective or another. This was religious context, and the economic life of America the fundamental issue facing those who wanted to that it would be impossible to be considered well edu-construct a gender-based analysis of African phenom-cated without knowing something of the myriad ways ena. It was in this light that Clenora Hudson-Weems blacks have created space in America. Given the issues (1998) established the idea of "Africana womanism."

that have been articulated over the past 40 years, and Hudson-Weems meant to disengage the study of anticipating what is likely to occur in the future, we African womanism from feminism. The discourse believe that the Encyclopedia of Black Studies will around feminism was, to her, a discourse originated serve as a much-needed guide for those who are seek-by white women who had limited understanding of ing clarity in the ever more complex world we live in.

the place African women had played in American or While our encyclopedia does not purport to provide African life. Indeed, she

contended that white women all that is known about African people the world over, could get their liberation and still remain essentially we are confident that you will find in this work a full racist against black women.

measure of the state of Black Studies.

Thus, race always trumped gender in the discussion of transformation. Furthermore, Hudson-Weems led **REFERENCES**

the charge to disengage the struggle for women's rights from the antimale discourse of many feminists. This Abraham, Willie. (1966). The Mind of Africa. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.

became a leading ideological position for many women Alkalimat, Abdul. (1986). Introduction to Afro-American in Black Studies. It was by no measure the only posi-Studies: A Peoples College Primer. Chicago: Twenty First tion taken by women and men in the field, but there Century Books.

were few who could assert successfully a position in Asante, Molefi Kete. (1980). Afrocentricity. Buffalo: Amulefi opposition to the one held by Hudson-Weems (1998), Publishing.

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Theory. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press.

Editors' Note: The majority of our contributors provide brief descriptions of the resources they recommend in the Further Reading sections that appear at the end of the individual entries. We invite you to learn more about the subjects presented in the Encyclopedia of Black Studies by following up on these suggested resources.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 1

A

and educational philosophy is commonly contrasted

ACCOMMODATIONISM

with the social and political philosophy of other turn of the 20th-century African American leaders and Accommodationism generally refers to a public pol-intellectuals. Most often Washington's accommoda-icy in which African Americans are advised to accept tionism and conservatism are compared with W.E.B.

current racial domination and discrimination in order Du Bois's much mangled theory of the "talented to be gradually granted full citizenship and integration tenth" of blacks capable of leading the rest, critique into American society at some future time. As a major of cultural nationalism, and democratic socialism. How-turn in 20th-century African American social and ever, Du Bois was merely one of many critics who political philosophy, accommodationism is usually took issue with Washington's "Tuskegee Machine," an associated with Booker T. Washington's thought and informal group of individuals led by Washington who practices. Washington's philosophy of accommoda-were the principal opinion makers in the African tionism is best characterized by its emphasis on American community. In fact, a short list of some African American vocational training and industrial of Washington's other—albeit often omitted—critics education, procapitalist and antiunionist stances, reads like an all-star roll call of 20th-century African public acceptance of the dialectic of white supremacy American social and political thinkers and radical and black inferiority, black collaboration with influ-journalists: Francis Grimke, William Monroe Trotter, ential and wealthy whites so as to paternally critique George W. Forbes, Thomas T. Fortune, A. Philip and correct "backward" and "childlike" blacks, and Randolph, Oliver C. Cox, Kelly Miller, and J. Max euphemization of the importance of electoral politics Barber. What perplexed Washington's critics—many and the struggle for civil rights and social justice.

of whom were at one time Washington supporters, Du Bois included—was his double-dealing with regard to politics, economics, and education.

BOOKER T. WASHINGTON'S

PHILOSOPHY OF ACCOMMODATIONISM

Washington's Political Philosophy Where many of the most noted 19th-century African American leaders were distinguished by their emancipatory efforts to free blacks from bondage and bring counseled blacks not to seek immediate "social equal-into being an authentic multicultural America, ity" but to be "patient, faithful, law-abiding, and unre-Washington's words and deeds stand in stark relief.

sentful" in the face of white racial domination and He has been hailed as the archetypal African discrimination. In his famous 1895 address at the American conservative, because he urged blacks to Cotton States Exposition in Atlanta (commonly acquiesce to rather than radically oppose the racism of referred to as the "Atlanta Compromise" address), the established order. Washington's economic strategy Washington, in his customary fashion, catered to the 1

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 2

2——Accommodationism

whims and wishes of whites when he stated, "The artificial forcing." Politics and economics went wisest among my race understand that the agitation hand in hand in Washington's ideology, but greater of questions of social equality is the extremest folly."

emphasis was placed on economics. In his assessment Washington wanted to assure whites that his ideology of blacks' situation at the turn of the 20th century, was one of conservative black economic and educa-Washington opined that a firm economic foundation tional development, a brand of thought that did not would enable blacks to achieve their freedom faster demand redress for past or present white wrongdoing than a purely political or agitative approach would.

and anti-African activity—for example, the African He quickly befriended wealthy whites, such as Holocaust, enslavement of Africans, and segregation Andrew Carnegie and John D. Rockefeller, and liter-of blacks in U.S. society.

ally became the darling of turn of the 20th-century However, many of Washington's critics were quick philanthropy circles. It is in this setting that to point to the fact that although he publicly advocated Washington mugged and masked most, telling "darky an apolitical or, as some have asserted, an anti political jokes" and deprecating and diminishing black philosophy for black development, he was nonethe-dignity. According to his biographer Louis Harlan, less privately involved in the search for solutions to Washington's comfort with belittling black dignity both black and white political problems. Despite his before wealthy whites, evidenced by his constant nonpolitical public stance, Washington served as a reiteration of his favorite "coon stories" and quips sort of unofficial African American advisor to four such as "there seems to be a sort of sympathy between U.S. presidents: Grover Cleveland, William McKinley, the Negro and the mule," helped to exacerbate and Theodore Roosevelt, and William Taft. Behind the perpetuate racist myths and stereotypes about black scenes and in clandestine black political circles, inferiority.

Washington used his Tuskegee Machine and international influence to fight for civil rights and social jus-Washington's Philosophy of Education tice. For example, in 1900 he covertly lobbied against racist election provisions in Louisiana's state constitu-What might be called Washington's philosophy of tion. Further, it was reported that in 1903 Washington education was essentially an extension of his political personally spent over \$4,000 opposing Alabama's and economic thought. In fact, although much has segregation laws in federal courts. Washington's crit-been made of Washington's emphasis on vocational ics, however, in both the past and the present, have training and industrial education, records show that maintained that no matter what he did privately, his both Hampton, where Washington went to school, and stated public position and approach to racist policies Tuskegee Institute, where he was president, produced gave whites the impression that blacks were not more black teachers at the turn of the 20th century as devoted to democracy as they were interested in than

manual or skilled laborers. One reason for this earning a dollar. Washington went so far as to assert, was the covert ideological character of Washington's

"The opportunity to earn a dollar in a factory just educational program, which promised manual labor-now is worth infinitely more than the opportunity to ers but delivered college-educated blacks.

spend a dollar in an opera-house." In other words, Washington's educational thought was based on he asked African Americans to accept segregation pro-that of his "tutor and idol," General Samuel Chapman vided they would have every opportunity to advance Armstrong, who developed a pedagogy that was economically.

designed specifically to coerce blacks to accept post-Reconstruction white racial rule. Armstrong argued that blacks should be encouraged to take up industrial **Washington's Economic Theory**

education as a way to subordinate and hold them Washington believed that with economic advance-as second-class citizens in the white-ruled, post-ment, blacks would be in a position to gain and main-Reconstruction South. According to Armstrong, blacks tain power in U.S. society, which is to say that he were "not capable of self-government," and should be foresaw blacks becoming a political force. He said, "It banned from the American political arena. He eagerly is important and right that all privileges of the law advertised himself as a "friend of the Negro," urging be ours," and he added that such "privileges" would be African Americans to "let politics alone," claiming that gained by "severe and constant struggle rather than black votes during Reconstruction enabled "some of

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 3

Affirmative Action———3

the worst men" to become involved in politics, primary source of Washington's philosophy, as they creating a situation that "no white race on this earth represent public expressions of his private reflections on ought to

endure or will endure.” Clearly Washington’s the conditions of African American people.

*aversion to public politics stemmed from Armstrong’s influence on him. Throughout his public life, Washington asserted that African Americans’ first **AFFIRMATIVE ACTION***

priority “was to get a foundation in education, industry and property.” In order to build this foundation, Washington urged African Americans to forego open The concept of affirmative action as a governmental agitation against segregation and for political fran-policy to redress past and current acts of racial (and chise. This public policy had severe and long-term later sexual) discrimination first entered the public consequences for African Americans: educational and lexicon on March 6, 1961 when President John economic underdevelopment; continued and increased F. Kennedy issued Executive Order 10925. Facing antiblack violence, especially lynching; temporary mounting pressures from African Americans, liberals, throttling of black social and political theory and civil rights activists, and other humanitarian groups, praxis; and censure and erasure of black intellectual Kennedy called upon employers to engage in “affir-independence.

mative action” to address, forthrightly, the race issue in America, particularly as it related to the federal

— Reiland Rabaka

government’s role in supporting racial inequities in employment opportunities. Although calling it affir-FURTHER READING

mative action was new, public demands for a nondis-Bush, Rod. (1999). The Washington–Du Bois Conflict: criminatory form of government can be traced as far African American Social Movements in the “Age of back as the U.S. Constitution.

Imperialism,” 1890–World War I. In We Are Not What From its very inception, affirmative action was We Seem: Black Nationalism and Class Struggle in the intended to support a policy of fairness and equal American Century. New York: New York University Press.

opportunity in federal employment practices, with the This is a fine critique of the early 20th-century debates regarding African American social theory and movements.

initial efforts focused on businesses and organizations Childs, John Brown. (1989). Constituting the Vanguard: that received federal support through governmental Washington and Du Bois Imagine Leading Groups, Each in contracts. On September 26, 1965, President Lyndon His Own Image. In Leadership, Conflict, and Cooperation Johnson provided the cornerstone of affirmative in Afro-American Social Thought. Philadelphia: Temple action policy when he reaffirmed the government’s University Press. Childs’s essay situates the debate position in Executive Order 11246. The order prohib-between Du Bois and Washington as an ongoing issue of ited discrimination on the basis of race, creed, color, political and social leadership within the African American and national origin, but not sex. In 1973, President community.

Cox, Oliver C. (1951). The Leadership of Booker T.

Richard Nixon amended Executive Order 11246 with Washington. Social Forces, 30, 91–97. This remains one of Executive Order 11375 in order to include sex as a the most insightful pieces ever written on the leadership protected class, thereby concluding the presidential philosophy of Booker T. Washington.

initiatives that launched affirmative action policy.

Harlan, Louis R. (1972). Booker T. Washington: The Making of Responsibility for oversight of policy implementation a Black Leader, 1856–1901. New York: Oxford University rested with the Department of Labor.

*Press. Harlan's work is largely responsible for establishing a framework for examining Booker T. Washington in light of the complex issues that faced black leadership in the **THE EVOLUTION OF AFFIRMATIVE ACTION***

American South.

Marable, Manning. (1997). Booker T. Washington and the During the first decade of the policy's existence, affir-Political Economy of Black Accommodation. In Black mative action's evolutionary process was marked by Leadership. New York: Columbia University Press. This is a the passage of various legislative and regulatory acts, brilliant examination of Washington's philosophy in the con-laws, executive orders, and Supreme Court deci-text of the overall political economy of the black community.

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sions—and supported by legal mandates of the U.S.

Washington. E. Davidson Washington, ed. Garden City, Constitution, the Fourteenth Amendment, and civil NY: Doubleday, Doran. These speeches are the best rights acts. It was an important aspect of the nation's

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 4

4——Affirmative Action

overall civil rights initiative. As the concept continued and university efforts to include members of diverse to evolve, the principles of fairness and the expectation of equal opportunity for all were applied to business-many acknowledged the devastating effects of past practices, corporations, institutions of higher education, discrimination on African Americans and other and other societal organizations. Many institutions, groups, they posited that a "color blind" approach although not mandated to do so by the federal government-was the only legitimate way to end centuries of social inequity, voluntarily created and implemented affirmative discrimination and social injustice.

action programs as they attempted to find ways to The 1978 Supreme Court decision in the Regents of the University of California v. Bakke marked the beginning of a decline in affirmative action. Bakke, a white male,

36-year-old white male engineer, had been denied admission to the University of California's Medical School at Davis. He sued on the basis that the school's affirmative action program, by specifying the number of racial minorities to be included in each class, constituted a quota system and violated his constitutional rights as an individual applying to the school. Affirmative action's basic premise was to overcome the effects of systemic forms of institutionalized racism, discrimination but that the utilization of race as a factor in admissions was not. The decision set in motion a national debate about what was acceptable during the initial stages of policy implementation, under the government's affirmative action policy.

*affirmative action received much support from politicians, academics, and public intellectuals, who **AFFIRMATIVE ACTION***

*applauded the government's efforts to diversify the **AND POLITICAL DISARRAY***

workforce. Affirmative action rules and regulations were vigorously applied to the Philadelphia Plan, In the 1980s, the Reagan Administration's open which established the goal of hiring those who were opposition to civil rights and race-sensitive solutions discriminated against to work on publicly funded to the nation's social problems did not bode well for projects in an effort to diversify the building trade affirmative action. The Reagan Administration's unions and expand opportunities for blue-collar desire to jettison affirmative action as soon as it workers. However, as the premise of equal opportu-was politically possible was well known. In addition, nity spread and eventually made its way to institutions repeated legal challenges and growing ambiguity of higher education, strong opposition to the policy about what constituted a constitutionally sound pro-emerged, resulting in the higher education arena serv-gram made it difficult for institutions committed to ing as the central battleground of affirmative action.

racial diversity to continue their affirmative action By the mid 1970s, affirmative action had emerged efforts. While the social inequities in the distribution as one of the nation's most contentious and controver-of America's social resources was a jarring public sial social policies. Proponents argued that affirmative reality, governmental support for affirmative action action is a morally justified approach to redressing the continued to dissipate.

nation's historic practices of racial and sexual dis-Jimmy Carter's administration was supportive of crimination. They insisted that to create a more equal affirmative action policy; George Bush's administration society, aggressive equal opportunity strategies must was not. Bill Clinton's administration offered hope that be applied to every segment of American society, par-affirmative action initiatives would be strengthened, ticularly higher education, which serves as a door of particularly as they related to the appointment opportunity to improved social standing. Opponents of

federal justices who were repeatedly entrusted advanced the concept of reverse discrimination, con-with the responsibility of interpreting the legality of tending that whites were being victimized by college the nation's affirmative action efforts. Early in his

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 5

Africa World Press———5

administration, George W. Bush indicated that he would not be supportive of affirmative action policies.

AFRICA WORLD PRESS

However, the legal challenge to the University of Michigan's affirmative action program that finally Africa World Press, Inc., based in Lawrenceville, New made its way to the Supreme Court in 2003 was the Jersey, was launched in 1983 with the publication of most anticipated affirmative action ruling in the Ngugu wa Thiong'o's Barrel of a Pen: Resistance to 21st century.

Repression in Neo-Colonial Kenya. Since then, Africa Conservative activists sued the University of World Press has published over 400 titles, including Michigan hoping to strike down the school's race-nonfiction, poetry, and photographs. The founder of sensitive admission programs at both the under-the press, Kassahun Checole, was a graduate student graduate college and the law school. Although the in political science at the State University of activists' support was broad based, colleges, universi-New York in Binghamton when he decided to start a ties, Fortune 500 companies, and retired military per-press that would allow African writers to write for the sonnel from throughout the nation filed amici (friends American audience. One of the most successful books of the court) briefs in support of Michigan's program.

published during the early days of the press was the In a 5–4 vote, the Supreme Court affirmed the Bakke book Afrocentricity by Molefi Kete Asante. It had decision, noting, "It is necessary that the path to lead-been published first by Amulefi Publishing of Buffalo, ership be visibly open to

talented and qualified individuals of every race and ethnicity.” However, in a related decision, the Supreme Court invalidated the popularity.

school’s undergraduate policy that utilized a point Initially the press published works by African system to help diversify its student body.

writers who were well known, but in the 1990s the Affirmative action is a viable, morally justified, press had started to publish works by new authors, civil rights initiative that forces the nation to engage in expanding its reach in the American public and to redistributive justice. It is, in the words of the late the African continent. By the early 21st century Africa Justice Thurgood Marshall, absolutely “necessary that World Press had evolved to become the leading we continue using racial classifications to remedy the publisher of books on African, African American, historic discrimination against African Americans.”

Caribbean, and Latin American issues.

For many in the African American community, affir-Discovering a need to expand to serve the new native action is the unfinished business of the civil African nations, the press sought to find partners in rights movement, the black power movement, Africa who could assist in launching operations on Reconstruction, and the Freedmen’s Bureau, leaving the African continent. The publisher was especially most to ask the question, if not affirmative action, then eager to have the government of Eritrea, his home what?

nation, involved in the distribution of books for the

— Patricia Reid-Merritt

public and the school systems of the African nations.

*This became a major part of the operation of the press for many years. Africa World Press developed **FURTHER READING***

Red Sea Press as an imprint to deal with strictly Hanmer, Trudy. (1993). Affirmative Action: Opportunity for African books, works that explicate uniquely African All? Berkeley Heights, NJ: Enslow. This is a good introduction issues, while Africa World Press continues to publish duccion for those new to the topic.

books by African American and Caribbean writers Ramphele, Mamphela. (2000). The Affirmative Action Book: who write on subjects that affect the pan-African Towards an Equity Environment. Capetown: IDASA Public world, such as The Afrocentric Paradigm by Ama Information Centre. This book demonstrates that the con-Mazama. Africa World Press, with offices in London, cept of affirmative action is applicable to any society where there is inequity.

Eritrea, Ethiopia, and Ghana, is a diligent publisher Woods, Geraldine. (1989). Affirmative Action. Edmonton, and distributor of books pertaining to the pan-African Alberta, Canada: Franklin Watts. Woods's book introduces world.

a young adult audience to the history of mistreatment and discrimination.

— Molefi K. Asante, Jr.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 6

6——African Aesthetic

*portion of Africa, there are at least 100,000 sites. The **AFRICAN AESTHETIC***

oldest among the different sites date back to between 26,000 and 30,000 B.C.E. Anthropologist Mary An explication of an African aesthetic requires an Leaky discovered prehistoric art in Kenya and operative definition of aesthetic. Admittedly, the term Tanzania that she assigned dates back to at least evolved out of the Greek word aesthetikos, which 15,000 B.C.E.; the finds at Tassili date back to at least means merely “perceptive,” but the term aesthetic is 30,000 years. All of the investigators of prehistoric widely held to connote a philosophy of beauty. We African art have expressed their

amazement at its normally speak of an aesthetic as representing the variety and distinctiveness. The Paleolithic art of dif-standards by which a society assigns value to their ferent areas in Africa, whether carved into rocks and cultural productions, especially their expressive art caves' walls or painted on them, reveals depictions of forms, such as music, dance, theater, and the visual realistic images as well as abstracted versions. Such a arts (e.g., painting and sculpture). Although many variety of early expressions of art portends the multi-African ethnic groups do not have a specific word or plicity of traditional and present-day African art.

term similar to the word aesthetic, the value that they place on their artistic productions—music, dance, **THE SIGNIFICANT ELEMENTS**

sculpture, and masked spiritual entities—is equal to the value that other societies place on similar art An examination of African art from this early period forms, and thus an African aesthetic exists in practice down through the ages reveals the embodiment of if not in name.

three significant elements: craftedness, originality, and spirituality. The fact that at different sites different types of images are identifiable reveals that certain **THE EXPRESSIVE**

stylistic norms were being practiced even during the **NATURE OF THE AESTHETIC**

Paleolithic period. Such adherence to an acceptable Melodic speech that comes down to us as song is prob-mode of creating images or scenes is a communicable ably as old as speech itself, and movement to music—

craftedness. Within the various identifiable types, dance—may well be synchronous in inception with subtle variations appear to have been permissible, speech and song. Visual expression reaches at least as allowing for a certain amount of originality. While far back as the Paleolithic age, and it is through this specific religious intentions cannot be proven or cor-early recorded art form that one can plausibly point to roborated, most paleontologists and art historians ritual dance scenes that would also, no doubt, involve agree that some, if not most, of the human images incantations or song. Furthermore, Africa's expressive with symbols

connoting natural or celestial concepts arts can be identified because their character is distinct-represent some form of spirituality or spiritual ritual.

tive from that of other cultures' artistic modalities.

Thus the ability to craft the images to meet specific Although no exact formal philosophy of African art group criteria, but with individual variation, and yet exists, when the practice of African art is scrutinized have the image exude or suggest a certain spiritual over time and space, it speaks volumes. Black Studies aura follows African art's evolution and metamorpho-scholars have investigated ways of developing an aes-sis down through the ages. A close study of Paleolithic thetic construct that encompasses one African art form African art therefore establishes that even in this early and can also be applied to other African art forms.

age a predilection for particular expression, a predis-What follows is an examination of African artistic proposition for specific icons, a propensity for symbolic ductions and how the many artistic practices, from the images with religious implications, an "aesthetic" is Paleolithic period on, express, represent, or signify a indisputable.

predilection for the unique and valued multiplicity of Like the prehistoric cave and rock art, traditional what is commonly held as African art.

African art has a socioreligious function. Whereas the The magnitude and diversity of prehistoric rock prehistoric depiction of animals had a function related and cave art in Africa are staggering and almost to hunting ritual, and scenes involving humans and beyond belief. The sites in North Africa, which include celestial icons had some divine or propitiation cere-the Tassili Plateau, the Atlas Mountains, and others, monial function, anthropological field research has number in the tens of thousands. In the southern shown that traditional African art's function is related

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 7

***African Aesthetic*————7**

to one or more of life's passages—birth, initiation, as gestator, nourisher, and giver of life symbolizes the marriage, eldership, death, rebirth. This need to create earth as mother and the African woman as the visual art for a ritual or ceremony to celebrate the rites of prototype. A Paleolithic rock painting of this madonna passage is a sociological behavior shared by most of motif and a sculpture of the earliest portrayal of Auset Africa's indigenous groups. It is through an examina-and Heru leave no question about the Africanness of tion of certain images, icons, and symbols, as well as either of these mother-and-child figures symbolizing an unprecedented use of mixed media to create the birth, regeneration, and nourishment.

unique concepts of African art, that one can discern a The unique variations of masked figures among plausible connectedness of African art across time and most African groups—such as Nimba of the Baga, space. This diachronic and synchronic inquiry also Kponiugo of the Senufu, Banda of the Nulu, and so reveals that African art is often spiritually based, even on—have their counterparts in early rock and cave art, when such art serves a cultural function rather than as well as in the Kemetian panoply of sacred images having been created for or used in a specific religious that are part human and part animal (e.g., Sphinx, ceremony. That African art has continued to have a Anubis, Sekhmet, etc.). Many African scholars agree cultural function when many other cultures ceased to that a primal reason for African people art from use art in such a fashion is indicative that there is a prehistoric times forward is that it serves a survival shared African aesthetic.

function that involves giving physical form to spiritual meaning. African artists create a synthesis of visual **THE COMMEMORATIVE FUNCTIONS**

elements that exemplify the special attributes of the spiritual entity being represented.

Examples of this continued use of art with a cultural function are the commemorative sculptures of African **THE TYPE MOTIFS**

rulers—earlier on the monumental Pharaohs of ancient Kemet and Nubia, and more recently the There are many type-motifs that symbolize various

Ndop of the Bakuba. Just as the Kemetians and the aspects of culture. These type-motifs may be the exag-Nubians felt that their rulers were god-kings (i.e., geration of content-loaded concepts, such as enlarged rulers endowed with godlike qualities), the Bakuba breasts, oversized genitals, the pregnant stomach, or symbolize Ndop's significance as Chemba Kunji. Each the expanded protruding navel, suggesting nourish-sculptural image is a commemorative work of art ment, procreation, or continuity of life. Such aesthetic paying homage to a beloved and respected ruler by the standards become visual canons, general formulas, portrayal of his physical likeness or by indicating by artistic conventions that must be followed by the symbolic embellishment his attributes and contribu-artists or artisans of each ethnic group; otherwise tions that enhanced his people during his reign. As the viewers from outside of the particular cultural groups ruler, he is revered unquestionably because his ordi-would not be able to recognize Yoruba art as being nation began with a divine ritual giving him the sacred distinct from Asante art, Bakuba art as distinct from abilities of the supreme creator. The same can be said Dan art, Senufu art as distinct from Bayaka art, and of the images of the Oni of Ile Ife, of the Oba of Benin, so on. While the art of each group is distinct from the and of the Bangwa of the Bamaleke.

art of every other group, each discernible practice Other examples of how different African ethnic is nonetheless one of multiple expressions of similar groups share an aesthetic of a spiritually based art cultures sharing a common origin of interconnected-are the mother-and-child figures of the Asante, the ness flowing from earlier rock and cave art. It is clear Yoruba, the Senufu, the Bamana, the Bakongo, the that this vast interconnected African art shared a Chokwe, and the Makonde, to name just a few. All of beginning from which flowed similar content con-these mother-and-child images serve the same pur-cerns with spiritual and religious ramifications.

pose as the earlier image of Auset holding Heru. A Through an examination of the form—medium selec-comparison of the religious practices of Kemetians tion, decorative motifs, design patterns—an African (ancient Egyptians) and those of the Nubians and aesthetic becomes even more incontrovertible.

other indigenous Nilotic peoples reveals similarities.

African artistic expression is older and more The religious practices one finds in Egypt and Sudan, numerous than any other group's artistic achievement one also finds in Congo and Benin. The mother figure the world over. From thousands of Paleolithic rock

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 8

8——African Americans

and cave paintings to the monumental art of the Nile African dancer; and when looking at African fabrics Valley civilizations to traditional and contemporary with their multiple use of color and patterns, African expressions throughout Africa and the pan-African masks with their colorful and mixed media fabri-world, a multitude of African groups have shared cation, and African sculptures with their intricately unique and distinct artistic idioms.

ornamented surfaces. Simply stated, the concept of There is no separation between form and content in multidominant cultural elements is a useful construct African art. A broad analysis of the form of Africa's by which to measure, analyze, or describe African cul-art, from its masked spiritual representations to its ture, especially its expressive art forms such as music, expressive sculptural statues to its textiles and tapes-dance, and textile design (printed or woven), and tries, reveals cultural productions that are complex—

probably their multilayered folk literature as well. The brightly colored with multifarious patterns and/or predisposition to apply colors in layers; the proclivity embellished with intricate designs. This type of to use high-key sharply contrasting colors; and the expressive elegance is also exhibited in Africa's other predilection for use of multiple textures, mixed media, expressive art forms, such as music, dance, and theand complex design patterns and shapes is fundamen-ater, as well as in different religious rituals. The tal to African material culture and its visual art.

richness of African music and dance has long been

— Robert Douglas

accepted and documented as a viable contribution to world culture.

FURTHER READING

*Asante, Kariamu Welsh. (1994). African Aesthetics. Trenton, **THE AESTHETIC IN MUSIC***

NJ: Africa World Press. This is an examination of the African music is distinguished from the music of other polydimensionality of African art forms.

Garlake, Peter. (1987). The Painted Caves. Harare, Zimbabwe: world traditions by the superimpositions of several Modus. This book concludes that there are as many as lines of meter. Broadly speaking, the difference 30,000 different rock painting sites in Zimbabwe alone.

between African and European rhythms is that whereas Lewis-Williams, David. (1983). The Rock Art of Southern any piece of European music has at any one moment Africa. New York: Cambridge University Press. This book one rhythm in command, a piece of African music has lists thousands of rock art sites by area in different always two or three and sometimes as many as four countries throughout Southern Africa.

*rhythms. A similar correlation can be made between European and African dance, whether or not it is being performed in a particular religious ceremony or secular presentation. Take the wedding ceremony dance of the **AFRICAN AMERICANS***

Tiv people of Nigeria. A Western researcher had to be taught to dance the dance of the Tiv to understand it. It African Americans are an African ethnic group whose was not as simple as she thought it would be. Having members are citizens of the United States of America.

learned the dance steps, she was then taught to move They remain one of the most biologically diverse her hips and shoulders in particular ways. “My hands groups in the United States because of the historical and my feet

were to keep time with the gongs, my hips intermingling of scores of African ethnic groups, with the first drum, my back and shoulders with the Native Americans, and Europeans. The term African second.” The Tiv wedding dance was not unlike most American is something of a misnomer, as the many African dance in that good dancers are expected to people of African descent in Canada, Mexico, Brazil, move one or more parts of their bodies to one or more Cuba, Venezuela, Peru, Colombia, the Antilles, Costa of the different rhythms being played by different Rica, Nicaragua, and Uruguay, which like the United instruments of different drums.

States are part of the Americas, are not included in the All of Africa’s significant expressive cultural term African American. Nevertheless, the term has modes use many dominant or simultaneously signifi-been used to designate people of African descent who cant elements. This multidominance or simultaneity are domiciled in the United States since 1865. Prior to can be experienced when listening to the multirhythmic—that year, blacks were not Americans, and therefore mic, polymetric African music; when observing the most saw themselves only as Africans. There were, multimovements of different parts of the body of an however, a few free blacks who called themselves

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 9

African Americans——9

“colored citizens” when, in fact, they did not possess imagination as places of high style, fashion, culture, the rights of American citizens.

and business. The evolution of African American communities from Southern and rural to Northern and urban has occurred since 1945. According to the 2000

SIZE AND COMPOSITION

census, the largest African American populations are African Americans constitute the second largest racial found in these cities: New York, Chicago, Detroit, group in the United States of America. Africans came Philadelphia, Los Angeles, Houston, Baltimore, New with the Spaniards in

the 16th century to the area that Orleans, Memphis, and Washington, D.C. In terms of became the United States. However, the first appear-the percentage of the population of a city that African ance of groups of Africans in the English colonies Americans represent, the following cities are the five of America occurred in 1619, when 20 Africans leaders among cities with populations over 300,000: were brought as indentured servants to Jamestown, Washington, D.C. (70%), Atlanta (67%), Detroit Virginia. Subsequent importations of Africans over a (65%), New Orleans (55%), and Memphis (49%). East period of 200 years from western Africa, stretching St. Louis, Illinois, is 96% African American, but its from Morocco on the north to Angola on the south, population is less than 100,000. The cities with the greatly increased the African population in the United largest African American populations are New York, States. By the time of the Emancipation Proclamation with 2.1 million African Americans, Chicago with in 1863, the population of Africans in the United 1.4 million, Detroit with over 800,000, Philadelphia States had reached 4½ million.

with close to 700,000, and Los Angeles with more African Americans are a composite people com-than 600,000.

prised of numerous African ethnic groups—Yoruba, In 2002, the population of African Americans was Wolof, Mandingo, Hausa, Asante, Fante, Edo, Fulani, estimated to be 37 million. In addition to the African Serere, Luba, Angola, Congo, Ibo, Ibibio, Ijaw, and American population in the United States, there are Sherbro—with a common origin in Africa and a com-approximately a million African Americans abroad, mon struggle in the United States against racial mainly in Africa, Europe, and South America. African oppression. Many African Americans show evidence Americans constitute about 12% of the U.S. popula-of racial mixture with Native Americans, particularly tion. This is roughly equal to the percentages of Muskogee, Choctaw, Cherokee, and Pawnee, as well Africans in the populations of the South American as with Europeans from various ethnic backgrounds.

nations of Venezuela and Colombia. The United African Americans were predominantly a rural and States has the second largest population of Africans Southern people until the great urban migration of outside of the

continent of Africa. The following the World War II era. Thousands of Africans moved to countries have the largest population of African-the major urban centers of the North to find better jobs descended people in the world: Nigeria, Brazil, Egypt, and more equitable living conditions. Cities such as Ethiopia, Congo, and the United States.

Chicago, New York, Philadelphia, and Detroit became magnets for entire Southern communities of African **CULTURAL AND LINGUISTIC ORIENTATION**

Americans. The lure of economic prosperity, political enfranchisement, and social mobility attracted many African Americans are now avid speakers of English.

young men and frequently women, and the elderly During the 17th century, most Africans in the were left on the farms of the South. Men would send Americas spoke West African languages as their first for their families and men and women would send for language. In the United States, the African population their aging parents once they were established in their developed a highly sophisticated pidgin, usually new homes in the North.

referred to by linguists in its creolized form as Residential segregation became a pattern in the Ebonics. This language is the prototype for the speech North, as it had been in the South. Some segregated of the vast majority of African Americans. It is com-communities in the North gained prominence and prised of African syntactical elements and English became centers for culture and commerce. Harlem lexical items. Use of this language made it possible in New York, North Philadelphia in Philadelphia, for Africans from various ethnic and linguistic groups Woodlawn in Detroit, Southside in Chicago, and Hough (e.g., Yoruba, Ibo, Hausa, Akan, Wolof, Mande, etc.) in Cleveland were written into the African American's to communicate with each other as well as with the

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 10

Europeans with whom they came in contact. The position with a once a day break for exercise. Many impact of the African American language on American died or went insane.

society is thorough and all embracing. From the The North made the shipping of Africans its ubiquitous “O.K.,” a Wolof expression from Senegal, business; the South made the working of Africans its to the transformations of words like “bad” and “awe-business. By 1860, the census counted 4½ million some” into expressions of something entirely original, Africans in the United States. The number of Africans one sees the imprint of African American styles increased rapidly from the 18th century on—from derived from the African heritage. There are more 757,208 in 1790 to 4,441,830 in 1860. The African than 3,000 words, place names, and concepts with American population grew both by increased birth African origins found in the English language of the rates and by importation of new Africans. But by United States of America. Indeed, popular speakers of 1860, slavery had been virtually eliminated in the the African American idiom are the source of the most North and West. And by the end of the Civil War in dynamic additions to the language—from the words 1865, it was over for every state. After the Civil War, of jazz musicians and rappers to street slang, all of 14% of the population of the United States was which have given American English its own authentic African. The 4½ million Africans who made up the color. The proverbs, poems, songs, and hollers, which black population in 1865 are the ancestors of the overcome with the historical saga of a people whose whelming majority of Africans living in the United only epic is in the great songs known as the spirituals, States today.

provide a rich texture to the ever-evolving language of the African American people.

WHEN FREEDOM CAME

During the Reconstruction period after the Civil War, A CAPTURED PEOPLE

African American politicians introduced legislation African Americans did not freely come to America.

that provided for public elementary and secondary. Theirs is not the history of a people seeking to escape education, something that was rarely present before political oppression, economic exploitation, religious the campaign by African American legislators. This intolerance, or social injustice in their homeland.

public act of creating a radical policy for the benefit of. Rather, the ancestors of the present African Americans the masses remains one of the great legacies of the were stolen from the continent of Africa, placed on African American involvement in the legislative ships against their will, and transported across the process of the 19th century. Education has always Atlantic. While most of the enslaved Africans went been seen as a major instrument in changing society to Brazil and the Caribbean, a great portion landed in and bettering the life chances of African American the Southern states of the United States. At the height people. Lincoln University and Cheyney University in of the European slave trade, almost every nation in Pennsylvania, Hampton University in Virginia, and Europe was involved in some aspect of the enterprise.

Howard University are some of the oldest institutions As the slave trade grew more profitable and the of learning for the African American community.

European captains became more ambitious, larger Other universities, such as Tuskegee, Fisk, Morehouse, ships with specially built "slave galleries" were com-Spelman, and Atlanta, are now a part of the American missioned. These galleries between the decks were no educational story of success and excellence.

more than 18 inches high. Each African was allotted a The great civil rights movement of the 1950s and space no more than 16 inches wide and 5½ feet long 1960s ushered in a whole new generation of African for the many weeks or months of the Atlantic cross-Americans committed to advancing the cause of jus-ing. Here the Africans were forced to lie down shack-tice and equality. Rosa Parks refused to give her seat led together in chains and fastened to staples in the to a white man on a Montgomery city bus and created deck. Needless to say, many Africans perished under a stir that did not end until the most visible signs of such conditions. Where the space was

2 feet high, racism were overthrown. Martin Luther King, Jr., Africans were often allowed to sit with their legs over emerged as the leading spokesperson and chief symbol each other's legs like riders on a crowded sled. Africans of a people tired of racism and segregation and pre-were transported from Africa to America seated in this pained to fight and die if necessary to obtain legal and

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 11

African Americans——11

human rights. Malcolm X took the battle one step employment in communities where their professional further, insisting that African Americans were psycho-services were needed, therefore, the above-mentioned logically lost and therefore had to find historical and professions and others that cater to the African cultural validity in the reclamation of their connection American population have provided professionals to Africa.

with numerous opportunities for employment.

Thus, out of the crucible of the 1960s came a During the past 20 years the number of businesses vigorous movement toward full recognition of the opened by African Americans has begun to increase, African past and legacy. African Americans' relation-after decreasing in the final decades of the 20th century.

ships with other groups depended more and more on During the period of segregation, many businesses run mutual respect rather than on African Americans act-by and solely for the convenience of the African ing like clients to other groups. African Americans American population flourished. When the civil rights expressed their concern that the Jewish community movement ended most of the petty discriminations had not supported affirmative action, although there and it was possible for African Americans to trade and was a long history of Jewish support for African shop at other stores and businesses, the businesses American causes. Accepting the role of vanguard located in the African American community suffered.

in the struggle to extend the protection of the U.S.

There is now an awareness in the African American Constitution to oppressed people, African Americans community of the need to see businesses as connected made serious demands on municipal and federal offi-with and dependent on the greater American society.

cials during the civil rights movement. Voting rights In addition, a greater role, a role closer to equal that of were guaranteed and protected, educational segrega-men, is played by African American women than by tion was made illegal, and petty discriminations American women in other ethnic groups. Indeed, against African Americans in hotels and public facili-many of the chief leaders in the economic develop-ties were eradicated as a result of the sustained ment of the African American community are and protests and demonstrations of the era.

*have been women. Both men and women have always worked in the majority of African American homes and during the enslavement, work was the principal **NATIONAL INVOLVEMENT***

activity of both men and women.

IN VARIOUS SECTORS

The existence of a growing economy does not guaran-CULTURAL PATTERNS AND CUSTOMS

tee that African Americans will be served by that growth. The labor of African Americans has been a African American marriage and kinship patterns are key component in the economic system of the United varied, although most now conform to the marriage States since its inception. However, the initial rela-and kinship style of the majority of Americans. Mon-tionship of those of African descent to the economy ogamy is the overwhelming choice of most married was based on the position of Africans as enslaved people. Because of the rise of Islam in the African labor. Africans were instrumental in establishing the American community, there is also a growing com-industrial and agrarian power of the United States.

munity of persons who practice polygamy. Lack of Railroads, factories, residencies, and places of busi-marriageable males is putting intense pressure on ness were often built by enslaved Africans. Currently African American females to find new ways of main-African Americans are engaged in every sector of the taining traditions and parenting children. Within the American economy, though there is less integration in African American population, various arrangements some sectors than in others. A considerable portion of constitute family. Thus, people may speak of family, the African American population works in the indus-aunts, uncles, fathers, mothers, and children without trial or service occupations. Others are found in the necessarily meaning that there is a genetic kinship professions, holding positions such as teacher, lawyer, between them and those about whom they are speak-doctor, and manager, more often than in small busi-ing. African Americans often say "brother" or "sister"

nesses. These patterns are based on previous condi-as a way to indicate the possibility of that being the tions of discrimination in businesses throughout actual fact. In the period of the enslavement, individ-the South. Most African Americans could find uals from the same family were often sold to different

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 12

12——**African Americans**

plantation masters and given the names of those and sometimes female socialization clubs. Church owners, creating the possibility that brothers or groups and community center organizations seek to sisters would have different surnames. Most African channel the energies of these groups into positive Americans' names are derived from the enslavement socialization experiences. They are joined by the period and are not African names but, rather, English, numerous Afrocentric workshops and seminars that German, French, and Irish names, for the most part.

train young people in traditional African behaviors Few African Americans can trace their ancestry back and customs.

before the enslavement. Those who can do so have African Americans can be found in every stratum normally found records in the homes of the plantation of the American population. However, it remains a owners or in the local archives of the South. African fact that the vast majority of African Americans are Americans love children and believe that those who outside of the social culture of the dominant society have many children are fortunate. Thus it is not in the United States. In just under 140 years, African uncommon for African American families to have Americans who were emancipated with neither wealth more than four children.

nor good prospects for wealth have been able to African American children are socialized in the advance in American society against all odds. Con-home, but the church often plays an important role sidered determined and doggedly competitive in in socialization. Parents depend on other family situations that threaten survival, African Americans members to chastise, instruct, and discipline their have had to outrun economic disaster in every era.

children, particularly if the family members live in Discrimination against African Americans remains in close proximity to the parents and the children know private clubs, country clubs, social functions, and them well. Socialization also takes place through rites some organizations. Nevertheless, African Americans and celebrations that grow out of either religious or have challenged hundreds of rules and regulations that cultural observances. There has been a growing inter-have tried to limit their choices.

*est in African child socialization patterns with the emergence of the Afrocentric movement. Parents are **THE STRUGGLE FOR EQUALITY***

introducing African rites of passage at an early age to provide their children with historical referents.

Among the major players in the battle for equal rights Increasingly, such rites are challenging traditional have been the National Association for the Advance-religious rites for children in the African American ment of Colored People (NAACP) and the National community by becoming the preferred form of transi-Urban League (NUL). These two organizations

have tion ritual around puberty. For some time, churches advanced the social integration of the African and schools have done rites in which children have American population on the legal and social welfare been expected to recite certain details about heroines fronts. The NAACP is the major civil rights organiza-and heroes or about various aspects of African tion as well as the oldest. Its history in the struggle for American history and culture to be considered mature equality and justice is legendary. Thurgood Marshall, in the culture.

the first African American to sit on the Supreme Many independent schools have been formed to Court, was one of the organization's most famous law-gain control over the cultural and psychological edu-yers. He argued 24 cases before the Supreme Court as cation of African American children. A distrust of the a lawyer and is credited with winning 23 of them.

public schools has emerged during the past 25 years Although there is no official organization of the because African Americans believe that it is difficult entire African American population and no truly mass for African American children to gain the self-confi-movement that speaks to the interests of the majority dence they need from teachers who do not understand of the people, the NAACP comes closet to being a or are insensitive to their culture. Youth clubs estab-conscience for the nation and an organized response lished along the lines of the African age-set groups are to oppression, discrimination, and racism.

popular as drill teams and formal youth social organi-At the local level, many communities have orga-zations. On the other hand, neighborhood street gangs nized committees of elders who are responsible for are often associated with delinquent behavior and various activities within the communities. These com-should not be confused with the new, more culturally mittees are usually informal and are set up to assist aware youth groups that are generally healthy male the communities in determining the best strategies to

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 13

follow in political and legal situations. Growing out of The predominant faith of African Americans is an Afrocentric emphasis on community and cohesive-Christianity, the second largest group of believers ness, the committees are usually comprised of older accept the ancestral religions of Africa—Vodu, men and women who have made special contributions Santería, Myal, and a third group of followers practice to the community through achievement or philanthropy.

Islam. Judaism and Buddhism are also practiced by some people in the African American community.

*Without understanding the complexity of religion in **POLITICAL PARTICIPATION***

the African American community, it is not possible African Americans participate freely as members of to venture too deeply into the nature of the culture.

the two dominant political parties in the nation, the While African American involvement in the religions Democrats and the Republicans. Most African of Christianity and Islam attracts attention, the Americans are Democrats, a legacy left by the era African religions are present everywhere, even in the of Franklin Delano Roosevelt and the New Deal minds of black Christians and Muslims. Thus, tradi-Democrats who brought about a measure of social jus-tional practitioners have introduced certain rites that tice and respect for the common people. There are have become a part of the practices of the Christians more than 6,000 African Americans who have been and Muslims. African greetings and libations to the elected officials in the United States, including the ancestors are heard in black Christian and Muslim governor of Virginia and the mayors of New York, gatherings. African Americans are spiritually oriented—

Los Angeles, Philadelphia, Detroit and Chicago.

they weave religion into everything they do so that Concentrated in the central cities, the African there is no separation between religion and life. They American population has a strong impact on the have also given American society the master songs political processes of the older cities.

The national known as spirituals. Many of the practitioners of Democratic Party chairperson is of African American the African religions use the founding of Egypt as heritage and some of the most prominent persons in the starting date for the calendar, thus 6302 A.F.K.

the party are also African Americans. The Republican (After the Founding of Kemet) is equivalent to 2002.

Party also has its share of African American politi-This is particularly true among followers of Ausar cians, though not as large a share as that of the Auset, a neo-Kemetetic religious group. Yet there is no Democrats. There is no independent political party in single set of beliefs to which all African Americans the African American community, although it has subscribe.

remained one of the dreams of leading African Martin Luther King, Jr.'s birthday, January 15, and American political strategists.

Malcolm X's birthday, May 19, are the two most Conflict is normally resolved in the African important days in the African American calendar.

American community through the legal system, Kwanzaa, a celebration of first fruits, which was although there is a strong impetus to attempt consen-initiated by the philosopher Maulana Karenga, is the sus first. The idea of discussing an issue with other most joyous occasion in the African American year.

members of the community who might share similar Kwanzaa is observed from December 26 to January 1, values is a prevalent one in African American society.

and each day is named after an important virtue.

The first recourse when problems arise is another There is no wide acceptance of cremation in the person. This is true whether it is an individual, social, African American culture. The majority of African or familial problem. Rather than calling a lawyer first, Americans choose burial over cremation. Funerals an African American is most likely to call a friend and are often occasions of sadness followed by festivities seek advice.

To some extent, the traditional African and joyousness. “When the Saints Go Marching In”

notion of retaining and maintaining harmony is at the was made famous as the song played by African heart of the matter. Conflicts should be resolved by American musicians in New Orleans to convey people, not by law is an African adage.

*African Americans to the other world. Sung and played with gusto and great vigor, the song summed up the victorious attitude of a people long used to **THE PRACTICE OF RELIGION***

suffering on earth.

African Americans practice the three main monotheistic religions as well as Eastern and African religions.

— Molefi Kete Asante

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 14

14——African Americans and American Communism FURTHER READING

THE CRUSADER

Asante, Molefi Kete. (2002). African American History: A In 1917, Cyril Briggs, a native of Nevis and St. Kitts, Journey of Liberation. Saddle Brook, NJ: Peoples Pub-founded the journal The Crusader, which advanced a lishing Group. This is a comprehensive history of African militant racial “catechism” of the greatness of African Americans.

peoples. Inspired by Woodrow Wilson’s stated aim of Asante, Molefi Kete, and Mattson, Mark. (1998). African freedom for oppressed nations and colonies, Briggs American Atlas. New York: Scribner’s. This is the first historical atlas detailing the experiences of African Americans promoted African liberation while calling for struggle spatially. It presents historical,

social, economic, and and agitation against racial injustice in the United educational data.

States. In 1919, Briggs formed the semisecret African Drake, St. Clair. (1987). Black Folk: Here and There. Los Blood Brotherhood (ABB), which advocated armed Angeles: UCLA Center for Afro American Studies. This resistance to lynching, the right of blacks in the South book is a compelling odyssey of the African people.

to vote, the right of black workers to unionize, and Frazier, Thomas R. (1988). Afro American History: Primary defiance of Jim Crow laws. By then he had become Sources. Chicago: Dorsey Press. This is a key source for documents relating to African American history.

disillusioned with Wilson and drew closer to the first Redkey, Edwin. (1969). Black Exodus: Black Nationalism and black recruits to the Communist Party, such as Otto Back-to-Africa Movements, 1890–1910. New Haven, CT: Huiswoud, Claude McKay, and others. Inspired by the Yale University Press. This book remains a useful exami-Third Internationale's call for revolutionary unity nation of the role of black nationalism in African American between colonial peoples and labor in the metropoli-history.

tan states, Briggs was increasingly drawn to Marxism and to Lenin's view of the struggles of blacks against national oppression as inherently antiimperialist.

*In 1919, the Communist Party's founders had **AFRICAN AMERICANS***

*barely moved beyond the view of Eugene Debs and **AND AMERICAN COMMUNISM***

the Socialist Party that socialists had "nothing special to offer the Negro" and that blacks would only rise as the working class rose. For Briggs, however, the road Of the many radical and socialist political movements to freedom for Africa and for people of African of the 20th century, the Communist Party (CP) USA, descent was through the world "socialist common-more than any other, placed black liberation at the wealth." An

Afrocentric outlook came to rest on the top of its agenda. The Party won some critical victory notion that communism was endemic to the African races for that cause and achieved a small but significant communal experience. The unfolding world movement following among black workers and intellectuals, ment led by the fledgling socialist Russia would especially during the 1930s and 1940s. The first conclusion indeed have something special to offer the Negro. Its tact between blacks and communists was the result would lift the imperial yoke from Africa, assist the of a convergence of seminal events in the second struggles of blacks all over, and consequently honor decade of the 20th century. The Great War engendered the aspirations of black people as indispensable to the irreparable splits in socialist parties over support or revolutionary process. Briggs was among the first to opposition to a war that opponents viewed as imperiled revolutionary socialism to a radical nationalist. The Bolshevik Revolution in Russia followed vision that demanded freedom for Africa and for by the formation of V. I. Lenin's Third Internationale African Americans.

(Comintern) spurred anticolonialist currents, as Lenin declared that struggles of non-European colonial and dependent peoples for self-determination was essential—THE AFRICAN BLOOD BROTHERHOOD

tial to the fortunes of working-class movements in developed states. Those events, in turn, stimulated While the African Blood Brotherhood most likely movement toward the communist orbit by a segment never exceeded 3,000 members, it attracted militant of a new urban black intelligentsia drawn largely but intellectuals such as Richard B. Moore, Otto not exclusively from West Indian immigrants already Huiswoud, W. A. Domingo, and Grace Campbell, as schooled in anticolonialism.

well as clusters of war veterans, principally in

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 15

African Americans and American Communism——15

New York and Chicago. Briggs's increasing stress on to the Comintern to assist in toning down the open an alliance between peoples of African descent and role and direction of the Communist Party in the organization

international communist movement soon became nization. Hobbled by its own narrowness, by a party a source of antagonism between the ABB and Marcus whose ethnic federations often sought insularity Garvey's far larger Universal Negro Improvement through the exclusion of blacks, and by the country's Association (UNIA). In some measure, Briggs had conservative climate, the ANLC could never over-anticipated the first extensive discussion of the come its small following and ineffectiveness.

"Negro question" at the Fourth Comintern Congress in 1922, which concluded that the struggles of blacks against oppression were inherently antiimperialist.

THE NATIONAL QUESTION

Nationalist organizations like Garvey's UNIA carried By 1928, the CP's "Negro work" remained in crisis the seeds of revolutionary battle against imperialism, and was placed for discussion and debate on the so Briggs repeatedly sought to influence Garvey to agenda at the Sixth Comintern Congress. Harry accept an alliance with the communists. Garvey, Haywood (also known as Heywood Hall), a young however, held to his fervent belief in racial solidarity black recruit to the Communist Party who was study-as the exclusive agency of social transformation.

ing at the Communist University of the Toilers of the Neither Briggs nor the communists were able to budge East (KUTV) in Moscow, received support from the Garvey, and the conflict between Briggs and the Soviets to lead a drive to characterize the Negro ques-Jamaican leader became increasingly personal and tion in the United States as a national question.

was finally sundered beyond repair.

Haywood argued that in 215 contiguous Southern counties, running from the Tidewater to East Texas, the black majorities constituted an oppressed "nation ***THE AFTERMATH OF WORLD WAR I***

within a nation" that had been blocked from the larger By the mid-1920s, revolutions had been defeated nation by the residue of slavery and the betrayal of in Europe, the postwar U.S. labor upsurge had been

Reconstruction. Thus, in the South, the goal of blacks crushed, and the red scare had led to the deportation was self-determination (i.e., not necessarily separa-of thousands of radical alien immigrants. The radical tion of the races, but the right of choice by the black tide dissipated and a conservative antilabor trend majority); in the North, their goal was political, became dominant. The revolutionary nationalist per-economic, and social equality.

spective of black communists was superceded (with The concept of national self-determination for the the Comintern's support) by an effort to get black pro-black majority in the South was fatally flawed. Even letarians emigrating from the South to join organized V. I. Lenin, who generally promoted self-determination, labor. The African Blood Brotherhood waned and died had pointed out in his Statistics and Sociology that the as communists organized the American Negro Labor dynamic development of industrial capitalism in the Congress (ANLC) in 1925 to batter down the doors of United States rapidly shrunk national differences and the American Federation of Labor (AFL) and advance undermined the special claims of various groups interracial unionism.

while solidifying the country into a single national The ANLC registered some accomplishments. It entity. However, defining the Negro question as a organized a militant strike of black women laundry national question bared the depth of a special oppres-workers in Chicago, it vigorously defended black sea-sion that transcended race and class. It underscored men charged with cowardice aboard a sinking ship a brutally repressed nationality—an assault on basic bound for the Caribbean, it supported striking black human identity itself.

coal miners, it played a leading role in the strike of Thus the black freedom movement was elevated to motion picture projectionists in Harlem in the late the highest status in the Leninist lexicon; black life 1920s—insisting that there could be no hegemonic constituted a revolutionary force in its own right, one black culture in Harlem unless there was a struggle to absolutely indispensable to the fortunes of the work-uplift the economic conditions of African Americans.

ing class. Lenin believed that the working class would But the ANLC suffered from chronic and ultimately never achieve its own goals without

the Negro people fatal sectarianism, despite pleas from black organizers and their movement for self-determination. It was

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 16

*16——**African Americans and American Communism** therefore the “sacred duty” of white labor to respect juries. The nine defendants were ultimately spared the aspirations of blacks and to prove through relent-the electric chair, although some of them spent long, less struggle against all forms of racism and discrimi-arduous years in prison. Concurrent with the nation the worthiness of interracial radical alliances.*

Scottsboro case was a broadly based campaign to free Blacks would only overcome generations of distrust Angelo Herndon, a young black communist convicted of radical whites if those whites unreservedly under an archaic pre-Civil War sedition statute in respected blacks’ national consciousness and right Georgia. There were also scores of other cases involv-of political choice. Thus, education, cleansing of the ing African Americans ensnared by a racist legal heart, mawkishness, and sentimentality were rejected system.

as a basis for commitment to black liberation and were At the same time, in their own ranks the commu-replaced by the concept of revolutionary necessity.

nists were faced with resistance to racial equality, That new ideological framework, combined with especially in the social sphere. After complaints from the onset of the Great Depression, unleashed a frenzy black members about racist treatment within the CP, of activity rivaled only in history by the abolitionist a series of publicized “white chauvinism” trials were movement. In 1929, the Communist Party dissolved staged to confront white communists charged with the ANLC and formed the League of Struggle for racism, which the CP viewed as rooted in capitalist Negro Rights (LSNR). The LSNR used its paper, The exploitation but having taken on a life of its own in Liberator, which was edited by Cyril Briggs, to stress white working-class consciousness. Before large audi-traditional black resistance to oppression, and its ences, “the stench of the slave market” was decried as attacks on lynching and racist violence mirrored the those charged were

forced to choose between political militant timbre of the Sixth Comintern Congress. In purgatory or confession and renewal. Despite the con-the 1930s, the poet Langston Hughes was president of trivances, the trials often provoked questions in the the congress. March 6, 1930, a day of mass demon-black press and black community about whether strations for unemployment insurance, marked the blacks could follow the injunctions of the larger polity beginning of significant black involvement in to hate a movement that was willing to purge its ranks communist-led actions. In 1930, the Party established of members whose "crimes" constituted little more a beachhead in Alabama and began the painful task of than standard social practices.

building the Share Croppers' Union under brutally Throughout the sectarian early 1930s, when the repressive circumstances that cost the lives of perhaps communists repeatedly castigated middle-class "enea score or more of black croppers. The union laid the mies" in the black community, the Party nevertheless groundwork for the labor and civil rights movements won respect for its militant antieviction, antilynching, in Alabama.

welfare rights, labor organizing, and other struggles in The Scottsboro case followed soon thereafter in streets and courtrooms, at unemployment and welfare March of 1931. It constituted a herculean global effort offices, on picket lines, in cotton fields, and in class-to save the lives of nine boys framed on a rape charge.

rooms. This impressive record ultimately could not A battle between the communist-led International stem the doubts of African Americans about the Labor Defense (ILD) and the National Association for fidelity of white labor in general to black liberation or the Advancement of Colored People (NAACP) about the ability of the Party to overcome its own erupted over control of the case, baring important pariah status. Thus the seeds of a black labor alliance underlying disagreement about which social class, were planted.

bourgeois or labor, would lead the black liberation With the coming of the antifascist Popular Front in movement. It also revealed sensitive issues about the the mid-1930s, the communists adopted a far broader conjunction of race and class when the communists and more inclusive relationship with

the black often revealed a deeper affinity and respect for the community—jettisoning ideological division in favor impoverished Scottsboro parents than did the middle-of stress on common ground and cooperation in build-class leaders of the NAACP. The Scottsboro case ing interracial unions, advancing civil rights, and com-followed a long and tortured trajectory through three bating the worldwide fascist danger. The founding of trials and numerous appeals—along the way estab-the National Negro Congress (NNC) in 1936 in pursuit lishing important precedents that established the right of those aims marked a high point in communist influ-to adequate counsel and the inclusion of blacks on ence on blacks. The congress coalesced scores of

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 17

African Americans and American Communism———17

black church groups, civic organizations, and unions.

fascism. Some African Americans felt disappointed and The NNC aimed to cultivate a cadre of black labor abandoned as a result of this apparent downgrading of organizers to help build powerful industrial unions in the battle for equality. However, antiracism was by then the auto, steel, meat packing, and electrical industries.

deep in the bones of black and white communists and The Southern Negro Youth Congress (SNYC), liberal allies and could not be fully placed on the back which was founded in 1937, mobilized Southern burner. Campaigns went on during the war for full youth and students to fight segregation, demand vot-implementation of Fair Employment Practices in ing rights for blacks, work for equality in education burgeoning defense industries, for desegregation of the and health care, and assist in building unions, espe-armed forces, and for an end to discriminatory policies cially in the tobacco and food processing industries.

against the black community.

The SNYC also trained a new generation of young In 1944, CP general secretary Earl Browder dis-black radicals and communists, among them

James solved the Party, jettisoning the last vestiges of and Esther Jackson, Edward Strong, and Louis Lenin's concept of an organization of dedicated revo-Burnham, who would go on to leadership positions in lutionaries. It was replaced by the Communist Political the Communist Party and in the postwar progressive Association, a loosely organized educational and civic movement around Henry Wallace's 1948 presidential action group. The concept of national self-determination candidacy. In 1938, communists joined Southern lib-for the Black Belt was interred as Browder declared erals to form the Southern Conference for Human that Southern blacks had "self-determined" assimila-Welfare to advocate economic justice and equality.

tion into the larger society. Less than 2 years later, By the mid-1930s, communists were embracing Browder was ousted, the Party reconstituted, and the and promoting black culture as the quintessence of a self-determination doctrine resurrected.

national people's culture. Black writers and artists like Through these upheavals, the Negro National Richard Wright, Paul and Eslanda Robeson, Langston Congress and SNYC had become moribund. Then, in Hughes, Jacob Lawrence, and many others were 1946, the communists helped found the Civil Rights drawn to a vibrant radical interracial cultural commu-Congress (CRC), led by communist lawyer William nity within the communist orbit where their poetry, L. Patterson, a veteran of the International Labor graphics, and works for the theater were promoted by Defense and the Scottsboro battles. The CRC gained Communist Party publications and by Party-influenced notoriety when it placed before the United Nations a organizations. The antifascist spirit drew about 80

petition, "We Charge Genocide," which documented African American men and a woman nurse into the a long list of government-sanctioned assaults on international brigades to fight Franco's insurgency in African Americans that in the organization's view Spain, while scores of black artists, like Cab Calloway constituted genocide.

and Count Basie, performed at benefit concerts for the The CRC also fought scores of cases in the courts Spanish loyalist cause.

and in the streets involving African Americans While the communists' defense of the Nazi-Soviet ensnared by the legal system. Among the most well Pact of 1939 crippled the support for communism in known were the cases of Rosa Lee Ingram in Georgia, some areas, the communists' standing in black com-Willie McGee in Mississippi, and the "Trenton Six" in munities was largely undamaged. Communists and New Jersey. Rosa Lee Ingram, a widowed tenant their allies in this period organized an extensive farmer and mother of 12, had, along with two of campaign to end Jim Crow in major league baseball, her sons, been convicted and sentenced to death for continued to provide vehicles for expression and killing a white neighbor. The jury had ignored strong development of African American music and art, and evidence that the killing was clear-cut self-defense organized boycotts of segregated public facilities against the neighbor's attacking the Ingrams with a and the film *Gone With the Wind*. After the Nazis rifle butt, and they proceeded to a speedy trial and invaded Soviet Russia in June of 1941 and the United sentencing. An international campaign combined with States entered the war against the axis powers, the Party legal appeals ultimately spared the lives of Ingram and leadership expressed reservations about a "Double V"

her sons. The CRC fought in vain to save Willie campaign for victory against racism at home and fas-McGee, who was executed in 1951 for rape of a white cism abroad. Rather, the leadership stressed the need woman in Laurel, Mississippi, despite overwhelming for national all-class unity in the struggle to defeat evidence that the charges were motivated by the

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 18

18——**African Americans and American Communism** woman's rage after McGee ended an affair with her.

had to be lifted. The historic Supreme Court decision The six black defendants known as the "Trenton Six"

in May of 1954 ending segregated schools noted the were freed in 1951 on appeals entered by the CRC

negative effect of unequal education on the battle after they had been sentenced to death in the killing of against communism being conducted by Washington.

a white shopkeeper, despite witnesses who identified The 1955 bus boycott in Montgomery, Alabama, the killers as “two or three white or light-skinned that was led by Martin Luther King, Jr., ushered in the black teenagers.”

modern civil rights revolution, which in significant The 1948 campaign of Henry Wallace for presi-measure, with all its faults and missteps, echoed the dent, in which communists played a prominent role, long and neglected history of the left’s struggles for was marked by a powerful commitment to civil rights racial equality. A vibrant link between past and present and by the refusal of Wallace and his running mate, was forged when veterans of the old Share Croppers’

Senator Glen Taylor, to appear in the South before Union like Hosea Hudson and Ned Cobb joined the segregated audiences. Defying physical threats and new battles of the 1950s. Yet, the Communist Party, barrages of rotten eggs and tomatoes, the Wallace buffeted by the Cold War, McCarthyism, and the campaign rallied Southern liberalism in the first major revelations by Nikita Khrushchev in 1956 of the postwar assault on segregation and was a factor in crimes of Stalin, was now in decline. However, Party pressuring Wallace’s rival, Harry S. Truman, to accept members and many who had left the Party continued a strong civil rights plank in his successful campaign to work for desegregated schools and voting rights for the presidency.

while the left-wing Southern Conference Education Yet, the Cold War was deepening and was having a Fund (successor to the Southern Conference for complex and contradictory effect on the relationship Human Welfare) extended valuable experience to the of communists, blacks, and the struggle for equality.

rising Southern movement.

In an increasingly repressive environment, the old The upsurge in the antiwar and civil rights move-adage that it was “tough enough being black

without merits in the 1960s brought a modest spike in the also being red” appeared to be borne out by the Party’s young African American membership, Angela Davis’ early harsh demands on radical and communist Davis the most prominent among the new members.

African Americans to march in lockstep with growing The doctrine of national self-determination had again anticommunism and to abandon their criticisms of the been interred in 1958, but elements within the Party larger society’s racial injustice. Communist leaders defied national policies against nationalism, respond-such as New York City councilman Benjamin J. Davis ing sympathetically to the black power movement and and Henry Winston were sentenced with 11 white col-even establishing an unprecedented all-black youth leagues to federal prison for “teaching and advocating club in Los Angeles.

overthrow of the government”; Paul Robeson’s con-The collapse of the U.S.S.R. and the states of cert career was destroyed and his passport confiscated; W.E.B. Du Bois was indicted in 1951 for the Communist Party. Long-time Party leader Gus

“failure to register as a foreign agent” due to his spon-Hall was accused of abandoning the traditional Party sorship of the Stockholm Peace Appeal to ban nuclear position on the centrality of the struggle against weapons (but the charges were later thrown out).

racism and for black liberation. Prominent black Baseball star Jackie Robinson was forced to testify activists like Angela Davis, Charlene Mitchell, and against Robeson before the House Un-American James Jackson, as well as a number of local African Activities Committee, and leaders of the major main-American leaders left the Party to form the democratic stream civil rights organizations were repeatedly socialist Committees of Correspondence. But despite called upon to denounce the left and to affirm their its often heavy-handed relationship with the African support of the U.S. conflict with the U.S.S.R.

American community, the Communist Party estab-At the same time, the U.S. government’s Cold War lished an important and influential record in the

long with world communism had a positive effect on the and continuing struggle for fulfillment of the promise ongoing battle for equality in the United States. With to African Americans of equality, justice, and interra-a contest for hearts and minds in Africa, Asia, and cial unity.

Latin America raging, segregation and racism in the United States was becoming a heavy albatross that

— Mark Solomon

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 19

African American Oratory———19

FURTHER READING

involving U.S. laws, justification of the institution of slavery, public lynching, Jim Crow segregation, Dudziak, Mary L. (2000). Cold War Civil Rights: Race and the Image of American Democracy. Princeton, NJ: Princeton inadequate education, poverty, discriminatory hous-University Press. This is an exhaustive study of the efforts ing, and unfair employment practices. War and peace, of the U.S. State Department and other government agen-human rights, political rights, civil rights, and ecocies to pressure the civil rights movement to support U.S.

onomic power issues have raised and called to step foreign policies and to convince foreign nations that the forth to the platform various black spokespersons, United States was making progress on civil rights.

including religious, diplomatic, and protest leaders Foner, Philip S., and Allen, James S. (Eds.). (1987). American and revolutionaries, to report various wrongs of the Communism and Black Americans: A Documentary nation. Also within this rich oratorical tradition are History, 1919–1929. Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This is a compilation of primary documents from the oratorical talents of black comedians, poets, rap communist and African American sources on the black-red artists, pimps, and con artists. What follows is a brief relationship.

chronological survey exploring African Americans'

Foner, Philip S., and Shapiro, Herbert (Eds.). (1991).

historical experiences, their oratorical skills' unique American Communism and Black Americans: A

characteristics, and their rhetorical choices over the Documentary History, 1930–1934. Philadelphia: Temple course of the past 4 centuries, which should shed more University Press. This continues the documentation of the light on this subject.

first volume noted above.

The African American community endured vio-Kelley, Robin D. G. (1990). Hammer and Hoe: Alabama Communists During the Great Depression. Chapel Hill: lence, discrimination, and segregation. To free them- University of North Carolina Press. This is the most com-selves from these shackles, African American men prehensive work to date on the Share Croppers' Union and and women have served in the armed forces from the communist activities in the Deep South during the Revolutionary War through the Vietnam War and 1930s.

beyond, fighting for freedom, equality, justice, and the Naison, Mark. (1983). Communists in Harlem During the preservation of cultural identity. They have adapted to, Depression. Champaign: University of Illinois Press. This integrated into, or resisted the strength of the white-covers the work of communists in Harlem during the tumultuous 1930s.

dominated and racist system of governance in the Solomon, Mark. (1998). The Cry Was Unity: Communists and country. Yearning for their human dignity and basic African Americans, 1919–1937. Jackson: University Press equality, African Americans with oratorical skills have of Mississippi. This book conveys the story of African responded to white violence and abuse through more Americans and communists from its beginning in 1917

radical and revolutionary means by articulating radi-until its apex in 1937.

*cal integrationist, pan-Africanist, black nationalist, and Marxist themes. Many of them made both sacred and secular appeals calling for national peace, harmony, love and nonviolence, religious fellowship, **AFRICAN AMERICAN ORATORY***

militancy, nationalism, black power, and/or repatriation. These orators delivered messages in an attempt Rhetoric, in its broadest sense, is the theory and practice to persuade the nation to give blacks equal citizenship rights of persuasive eloquence, whether spoken or written status with whites.

ten. Spoken rhetoric is oratory, and oratory is shaped There were rampages against oppression in the by the historical experiences and cultural worldview late 19th- and early-20th-century accommodationist of a people. The oratory of African Americans, which appeals of the Tuskegee Institute's Booker T.

is unique from the oratory of other cultural groups, is Washington and his political machine, as well as in intricately tied to all African American experiences.

the late 19th- and 20th-century black nationalist and Thus the study of African American oratory examines pan-Africanist oratory tradition of Martin Delaney, the historical experiences, political situation, identity-Edward Blyden, Alexander Crummell, Bishop Henry ties, and ideological positions of a variety of black McNeal Turner, Marcus Garvey, W.E.B. Du Bois, speakers, as well as their oratorical abilities and skills.

Paul Robeson, Kwame Toure, and Malcolm X. From The history of African American oratory reveals the the mid-19th century to the present, there have been strategies and themes orators employed when confrontational, agitational, radical integrationist fronting 19th- and 20th-century historical topics addresses against oppression by orators such as David

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 20

20———African American Studies, Temple University Walker, Charles Remond, Henry Highland Garnet, Hamer, and the oratorical giants before

them such as Maria Stewart, Frederick Douglass, Ida B. Wells-Marcus Garvey and A. Philip Randolph—relied on Barnett, Sojourner Truth, Adam Clayton Powell, Nommo for force, majesty, and an oratorical style Adam Clayton Powell, Jr., Fannie Lou Hamer, Martin steeped in the perennial traditions of art to bring about Luther King, Jr., Malcolm X, Robert F. Williams, a comprehensive and passionate statement on justice.

Angela Davis, Stokely Carmichael (also known as Following these rhetorical conventions, a number of Kwame Toure), Maulana Karenga, Huey P. Newton, contemporary rappers, comedians, and other orators—

Louis Farrakhan, Jesse Jackson, and Al Sharpton. A from Langston Hughes to The Last Poets, Melle Mel, persistent theme in this African American oratory was Chuck D, KRS One, Queen Latifah, Will Smith, Ice T, and is the issue of race and slavery. Men and women Common, and Sister Souljah—have continued the orators before and after the abolition of slavery rich oratorical tradition of African Americans.

expressed their concerns, feelings, attitudes, and aspi-

— Adisa Alkebulan

*rations about ending white supremacy and racial and ethnic discrimination and replaced these issues in their **FURTHER READING***

speeches with the themes of black pride and freedom.

An important dimension of African American Illo, John. (1972). The Rhetoric of Malcolm X. In Molefi Kete oratorical history involves the principal spokesper-Asante (Ed.), Language, Communication, and Rhetoric in sons' ability to create articulate and effective speech Black America (pp. 158–175). New York: Harper and Row.

This is the classic essay on the style and eloquence of behavior on the platform. Early on, Africans in Malcolm X.

America cultivated an appreciation for Nommo, the Smith, Arthur (aka Molefi Kete Asante), and Robb, Stephen generative power of the spoken

word, since reading (Eds.). (1971). The Voice of Black Rhetoric. Boston: Allyn and writing by Africans was outlawed. African and Bacon. This is an introduction to rhetoric and a collec-Americans' communicative uniqueness in using tion of speeches by African American orators.

Nommo for sacred and secular purposes became for Smitherman, Geneva. (1986). Talkin' and Testifyin': The these orators a transforming power of vocal expres-Language of Black America. Detroit, MI: Wayne State University. In this major work on the creation of the African sion and eloquence. Out of an African heritage American language, Smitherman presents arguments for the steeped in the oral tradition, African American orators uniqueness of the African American language.

developed, consciously and unconsciously, unique communication patterns and skills in work songs, sermons, and spirituals with two meanings, one for the body and one for the soul. Nommo also created an **AFRICAN AMERICAN**

atmosphere in which the calls of black speakers and the responses of black audiences in sacred and secular **STUDIES, TEMPLE UNIVERSITY**

contexts constituted one act of communication. This is apparent in most African American Baptist church set-For 4 years, from 1997 to 2001, an ideological strug-tings when the preacher states something and the con-gle was waged over the philosophical direction of the gregation responds, "Take yo' time, take yo'time,"

Department of African American Studies (DAAS) at

"Fix it up, Reb," "Preach it, Reb," and when contem-Temple University (TU) in Philadelphia. The depart-porary rap music artists say, "Somebody scream," and ment had gained national and international fame in the members of their audience scream.

late 1980s for its Afrocentric orientation, as well as Other rhetorical qualities of Nommo on which for being the first program in the country to grant African American orators rely in sacred and secular a Ph.D. in African American Studies (AAS), under situations involve the use of proverbial

statements, the leadership of Molefi Kete Asante, the founder of spontaneity, indirection, and image making. Indeed, the Afrocentric paradigm. However, the department the oratory of African Americans is predicated upon started drawing negative attention in 1996 when a the power of the spoken word. The oratory of serious effort was made by a group of white and black Malcolm X, to a greater extent than the oratory of professors and administrators to have Molefi Asante's many of his contemporaries of the latter half of the tenure at Temple terminated. They had charged 20th century, was stunning in cadence and logic.

Asante with abuse of power, but the real issue, as Malcolm X—like Martin Luther King, Fannie Lou was later revealed, was the widespread discussion on

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 21

African American Studies, Temple University——21

campus about the Afrocentric orientation of the prerogative to recommend a particular candidate to department.

the dean, who may reject or accept the nomination.

The Ford Foundation refused to grant funding However, Adams disregarded the contract altogether, to the department, claiming that it was too political.

and thus violated the DAAS faculty's rights by insist-Those who attacked Asante wanted to find a more ing that the DAAS faculty could only nominate either agreeable black person to run the department.

Joyce Joyce or Ronald Bailey.

Although their efforts to railroad Asante out of office In June of 1997, 8 out of 12 faculty members failed, this was only the first open attack on the responded by filing a class action grievance against department from the Temple administration, to be the dean for violating their right to nominate their own followed by many more. Asante, whose term was chair. The Union (TAUP) sided with Adams and dis-expiring on June 30, 1997,

announced during the fall missed the grievance as moot. In July of 1997, Adams of 1996 that, for personal reasons, he would not seek organized an “election” of her own, out of her office, reelection as chair of the DAAS. The dean, Carolyn with only two names on the ballots. She was greatly Adams, quickly seized this opportunity to attempt assisted in this by her African American assistant, to implement a drastic philosophical change in the Mary Middlebrook, as well as Ella Forbes, a junior DAAS. This change, it seems, was to be part of DAAS professor about to be reviewed for tenure. In a broad revamping of Temple University’s public fact, Forbes was one of two people (the other one image, with a serious commitment to luring students being Nathaniel Norment) who voted for Joyce. Two from the suburbs. A highly visible DAAS, whose other ballots were cast—one faxed by C. T. Keto, a philosophical orientation was perceived as hostile to professor on leave in South Africa who favored white supremacy, could have seriously undermined Bailey, and one from Peterson-Lewis who elected the success of the plan.

both candidates, thus disqualifying her ballot. The rest of the faculty decided to boycott what they considered to be an illegal election. On July 18, 1997, Adams **AN ARRAY OF FORCES**

announced the result of her election: Joyce had been From the very beginning, Adams engaged in ques-elected with two votes and would therefore become tionable tactics in order to ensure that the next DAAS

the chair of the DAAS for the next 5 years. Indeed, chair would develop a vision that was appealing to she was offered the position by President Liacouras the rest of the university. She took it upon herself and accepted it on August 29, 1997, just in time for to appoint a search committee, made up of Sonia the fall semester.

Sanchez (Women’s Studies), Sonya Peterson-Lewis (AAS), Trevor Sewell (School of Education), **FOUR DIFFICULT YEARS**

Thaddeus Mathis (Social Work), Nathaniel Norment (AAS), Abu Abarry (AAS), and Kariamuwelsh-The new era that opened with the appointment of Asante (AAS), who was later replaced, at her own Joyce—over the wishes of the overwhelming majority request, by Ama Mazama. Originally

chaired by of the faculty and the students, who had selected Sanchez, the committee was eventually cochaired Mwalimu Shujaa and Mary Hoover as their top candi-by Peterson-Lewis and Sewell. The students also dates—proved to be quite disruptive and destructive.

insisted on having a representative and elected Joyce, a professor who had spent turbulent years at Fabanwo Aduana. The latter was only reluctantly previous institutions, was quite aware of the dispute accepted by Adams, who proceeded to unilaterally that opposed the dean to the faculty over her appoint-appoint a student who was not elected, Edi Becton.

ment. While granting numerous favors to those who The search committee appointed by Adams was had supported her, Joyce chose to display what was charged with identifying potential candidates for the perceived as sheer vindictiveness, hostility, and con-position and bringing them to campus. Five candi-tempt toward those faculty and students who had not dates were invited in May and June of 1997: Joyce supported her candidacy. One of her first moves, for Joyce, Ronald Bailey, Geneva Smitherman, Mary example, was to make up an *a posteriori* requirement Hoover, and Mwalimu Shujaa. The Union Contract's for qualifying for a teaching assistantship, and to try Article 14, which defines and protects the rights of the to fire the teaching assistants on that capricious and Temple faculty, stipulates that it is the faculty's illegal basis. When this failed, she denied the teaching



A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 22

22———**African American Studies, Temple University** assistants access to an office, thus forcing them to African experience is fundamentally subordinate to hold conferences with their students in hallways. It was the European experience and is therefore ultimately widely reported that she asked one student and one best understood within a Eurocentric cultural and faculty, Jason Neuenschwander and Nathaniel Norment, historical context. Indeed, the European experience is to remove the pictures of African ancestors that had allegedly universal and “others,” including Africans, been on the walls of the department for many years. At are defined by their encounters with Europeans. Thus any rate, they were seen removing the pictures from the Africans have been defined as less than Europeans, walls and this further enraged other students. This

“uncivilized,” “primitive,” and “illiterate,” as well as, move was perceived by many as the symbolic violation more recently, “underdeveloped,” “developing,” and the destruction of a sacred African space, a true declaration. By dictating the concepts that must be used in relation of war. In addition, Joyce created extremely difficult order to apprehend the African experience, Eurocentric difficult working conditions for those under and opposed thought effectively maintains Africans in a state of to her. For example, she restricted their access to a mental incarceration. Totally alien to the Eurocentric copy machine for several years by having the machine perspective, on the other hand, is the idea that there locked up in a closet. Furthermore, she did not consult could exist a culture and history developed by with those who had not supported her candidacy. Joyce Africans independently of and even prior to Europe.

held only one faculty meeting during her first year, even Afrocentricity argues against such ethnocentric reduction though the by-laws required monthly meetings, and she tionism and presses instead for an epistemological and her allies ruled the department.

centeredness—an understanding of the African culture—However, in addition to and more important than cultural and historical reality based on African-generated Joyce’s tyranny and pettiness was her dangerous criteria. Afrocentricity also insists that unless African agenda of dismantling the program and replacing it American Studies scholars embrace such epistemic—with a watered-down version of the program, one in logical relevance, they can only hope to conduct which students in AAS would have two advisors—one Eurocentric studies of Africa and her people, not from AAS and one from a European studies department—genuine African Studies.

ment such as history, English, women’s studies, By articulating the Afrocentric paradigm, Molefi anthropology, or another department. This, it was Asante set in motion a true revolution, one that would claimed, was necessary, in order to ensure quality.

definitively challenge Eurocentric scholars’ false This requirement served as reminder of Joyce’s belief claims of the universalism and superiority of in African intellectual inferiority, as no other department—Eurocentric thought, as well as show the path to ment had any such requirement. It also aimed at

bringing the DAAS back in line with the European intellectual tradition, from which it had strayed for too long. In addition, and quite unsurprisingly, the few new DAAS faculty who were temporarily hired under Joyce and Adams had no understanding of or sympathy for the Afrocentric paradigm. Consistent with Joyce's agenda of reforming the philosophy in the DAAS was her withdrawal of all departmental support from the annual Cheikh Anta Diop Conference, which is dedicated to the advancement of Afrocentric scholarship. Similarly, the celebration of Kwanzaa was no longer organized nor endorsed by the department.

THE PHILOSOPHICAL STAKES

Most graduate and undergraduate programs in African American Studies embrace the Eurocentric perspective. Dr. Adisa Alkebulan, African American Studies professor, San Diego State University, a graduate of Temple University DAAS

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 23

African American Studies, Temple University——23

African empowerment through African self-knowledge, of office several times. However, the administration self-definition, and self-naming. Over the years, refused to honor their vote. Instead, it recommended hundreds of people from several continents came to Joyce for tenure after only one semester, against the Temple seeking to be part of this unique and liberating wish of the DAAS senior faculty and against Temple's learning experience. European studies were seen as their own requirement that a faculty member not be recommended as a kind of intellectual plantation from which recommended for tenure until a full year had elapsed. Joyce Africans genuinely interested in African liberation was also publicly and strongly backed by the Women's could now escape thanks to Afrocentricity. The real Studies program, which was cochaired by Sonia nature of the attacks launched against the pro-African Sanchez. Sanchez was the subject of a book Joyce had orientation of the DAAS by white and black administrators published shortly prior to coming to Temple, and she traitors at Temple University was certainly not missed supported Joyce's appointment and tenure. In addition, by those who resolved to exercise their African agency, one of Joyce's

first moves as chair was to appoint and consequently stood up and fought to defend Sanchez's friend Jimmy Garret as visiting faculty and Afrocentricity.

to give Sanchez's son a job as a receptionist. The tension at Temple escalated and was brought to a head on May 22, 1998, when pro-Joyce student Gregory **THE FIGHT FOR AFROCENTRICITY**

Carr physically assaulted anti-Joyce professor Ama The fight for Afrocentricity involved its supporters in Mazama.

a fight against Joyce and Adams. Joyce's ruthlessness The community was made aware of the attacks on and negative agenda were met with fierce resistance the DAAS Afrocentric orientation by local newspaper from the very beginning by students such as Fabanwo articles, radio interviews, a rally, flyers, demonstra-Aduana, Adisa Alkebulan, Erin Moore, Zainabu tions at Temple-sponsored events, and so on. On the Jones, Pamela Yaa Asantewaa Reed, Geoffrey intellectual front, to counter the Eurocentric discourse Giddings, and Buashie Amatokwe; staff such as Sekai promoted by the new administration, Afrocentricity Zankel; and faculty such as Molefi Asante and Ama was publicly nurtured within the DAAS by Nommo, Mazama. Those who supported Afrocentricity which was organized by Ama Mazama and many adopted three main strategies: confronting the depart-students as a round table where Afrocentric forums ment and the university on all issues viewed as racist were held. Nommo also became responsible for or harmful to students and the discipline, making celebrating Kwanzaa.

appeals to the administration, and making appeals to When it finally became clear that Temple the community. As far as the first strategy is con- University had no intention of addressing the issues cerned, every effort was made to prevent the Joyce raised by DAAS students and faculty over Joyce's administration from implementing any radical appointment and actions, legal action was taken. This changes. Thus Joyce was bombarded with letters action was in the form of a lawsuit, filed in civil court about her vision and goals. Student leaders found on February 4, 1999, by Ama Mazama against the ways to broadcast their anti-Joyce, anti-Adams, and Union (TAUP) and Temple University, in the name of anti-Sonia Sanchez sentiments with statements that the ancestors. The lawsuit filed by Mazama

alleged appeared everywhere—on walls, doors, and elevators (1) that Temple University had violated the rights of on campus—forcing everyone to notice that a gross the faculty under the collective bargaining agreement, injustice was being committed. Underground newslet-and (2) that TAUP had acted in bad faith and breached ters were also widely circulated on campus. In response, its duty to Mazama of fair representation. The lawsuit Temple dispatched undercover agents and had video-consequently sought to force TAUP to proceed to arbi-cameras installed in the department.

tration. Mazama hired Leon Williams, an African As far as the appeals to the administration are American attorney well-known in the Philadelphia concerned, letters were written on a weekly basis by area for his pro-community activism. In response, outraged students and faculty. This was done in part Temple hired the largest law firm in Philadelphia, to alert the administration to the abuses suffered by Ballard & Co., to defend it. This, however, would the faculty and students but also to make it clear that prove futile, as TAUP and the university lost the law-Joyce did not have the situation under control. The suit. In 2000, after hearing the facts during a 2-day faculty, following the Union Contract, voted Joyce out trial on January 10 and 11, the judge agreed with

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 24

24———**African American Studies: The First Doctoral Program**

Mazama's allegations and ordered TAUP to proceed American community, a new resonating insight into to arbitration. TU and TAUP appealed the verdict political, economic, and cultural issues. The program twice, all the way to the Pennsylvania Superior Court, initially designated the Afro-Asian Institute soon only to again and finally lose the case in September of changed its name and purpose, becoming the Depart-2000. Shortly afterward, Joyce announced her resig-ment of Pan African Studies. The name was changed nation and transfer into the Women's Studies program once more when in 1984 it became the Department of on July 1, 2001. Joyce was replaced by Nathaniel African American Studies.

Norment, one of Joyce's former and now disgruntled The Afro-Asian Institute, heavily influenced by supporters, who made several public statements reaf-Muslim students, was a program, whereas Pan African

firming the Afrocentric orientation of the Department Studies took the form of a department when it estab-of African American Studies at Temple University.

lished a reporting mechanism comparable to that in The struggle to maintain Afrocentricity at Temple had other academic departments and an undergraduate been won.

degree program. There had been a struggle for acknowledgment of the legitimacy of an African

— *Ama Mazama*

American program from the very start of the Afro-Asian Institute. Faculty members at Temple regularly **FURTHER READING**

called for the abolition of the program. Its students Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). *Erasing Racism: The Survival of* were constantly harassed, and some of the faculty who *the American Nation*. Amherst, NY: Prometheus Books.

participated were intimidated by colleagues who won-This is a scathing attack on racism in education, housing, dered how they could squander their time and career employment, and other sectors of American society.

on something as ephemeral as Black Studies.

Butler, Johnnella. (1981). *Black Studies: Pedagogy and Revolution*. Washington, DC: University Press of America.

Numerous African and African American faculty Butler's book is one of the original works on racism, members paid for their involvement in the department-discrimination, and prejudice in the academy.

ment's battles with collegial and university commit-Henry, Annette. (1998). *Taking Back Control: African* tees by being refused tenure. Yosef ben-Jochannan, *Canadian Women Teachers' Lives and Practice*. Albany: the popular Egyptologist, had a public battle with the State University of New

York Press. This is an excellent university over his credentials.
Nevertheless, by 1978

examination of the struggle of black women to maintain the department had grown to 13 faculty members. It control of their lives and careers in the midst of racist was at this time that the dean of the College of Arts practices.

Rodriguez, Roberto. (1997). *Justice: A Question of Race*.

and Sciences offered faculty members in the depart-Tempe, AZ: Bilingual Press. This is one of the best books ment the option of leaving the department for more on fighting racism in every sphere of American life, partic-traditional ones. Several of these individuals accepted ularly in education and media.

to go to other departments, including Wilbert Roget to the French department and Sonia Sanchez to the English department. One professor was placed in the **AFRICAN AMERICAN STUDIES:**

Office of the Dean. Some left the university altogether. The net result was the dismantling of a large **THE FIRST DOCTORAL PROGRAM**

activist group of African scholars.

Nevertheless, the department persisted to assert its The history of the first Ph.D. program in African academic rights and succeeded in gaining a mass fol-American Studies at Temple University must be seen lowing in the community. By the late 1970s, the issues in the light of the department's evolution in terms of were public and the department was under pressure its scope and function. African American Studies at to change its emphasis and shape. Professor Odeyo Temple was first constituted as the Afro-Asian Ayaga was the chair of the department, and he imme-Institute in 1971, making it one of the first programs diately began to establish contacts in the university during the stormy birthing of the field in the great and the city and state governments. Ayaga was a wave of department and program creations that remarkable leader at a time that demanded steadfast-occurred from 1969 to 1972. It was the most dynamic ness, integrity, and

commitment to the intellectual intellectual program in the Philadelphia area, bringing project of African American Studies. He shared his to Temple, which is located in a heavily African contacts, ideas, and impressions of the university, as

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 25

African American Studies: The First Doctoral Program——25

well as insights into the political nature of the Temple members over the following 2 years and introducing a campus, with Molefi Kete Asante, the new chair.

master's degree program. The provost gave the green Ayaga graciously passed on to Asante his contacts and light on the hiring but did not commit to the graduate sources from the various government and civic bodies.

program proposal because it had to go through the university committees.

THE CREATIVE CONTEXT

THE INITIAL PROPOSAL:

When Molefi Kete Asante arrived at Temple from **THE MASTER'S PROGRAM**

State University of New York (SUNY) at Buffalo, where he had served as chair of the Department of Using the model for programs he had written for Communication and the Department of Black Studies, UCLA (University of California, Los Angeles) and there were only three professors in African American SUNY, Asante drafted a graduate program in African Studies: Odeyo Ayaga, Alfred Moleah, and Tran Van American Studies to be submitted to the Graduate Dinh. All the other departmental faculty members had Committee of the College of Arts and Sciences at been chased away, humiliated, denied tenure, or oth-Temple. There already existed master's programs in erwise forced to change departments. Professor Dinh Black Studies at Cornell University, Ohio State took early retirement in the fall of 1984 and that left University, UCLA, Yale, SUNY at Albany, and three

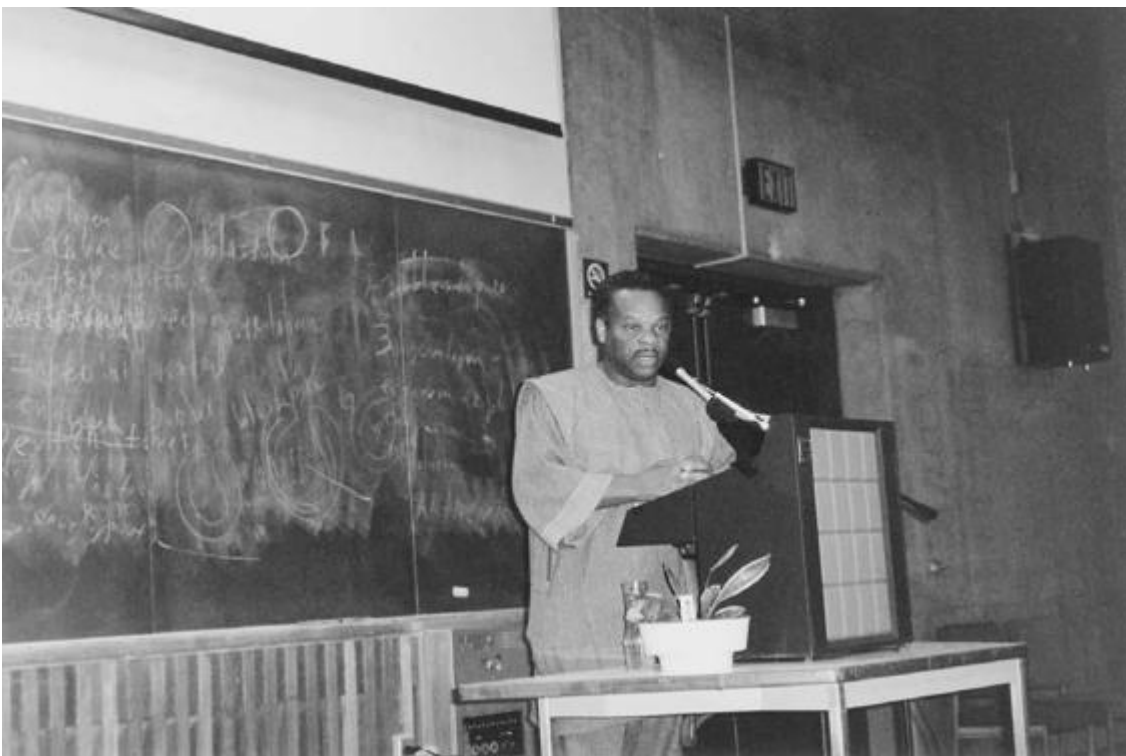
department members. There was an air of optimism at Atlanta University. However, from the beginning, tension on the campus because a new administration Asante believed that most of the departments had not had taken over the university and a new dean would clear philosophical or conceptual basis to the aggregate likely be coming aboard. The community sensed the gap of courses that existed in their programs. What possibilities inherent in such a situation and demanded was different about Asante's conception was that it to see a rebirth in the department. The highly valued made the Afrocentric paradigm the instrument guiding Community Education Program had been left in program development.

guishing and a community leader, Maisha Ongonza, The faculty proposed that the master's program be was leading the remnants of that program and essentially split into two natural divisions: cultural aesthetic and socially running the day to day affairs of the department-social behavioral. Courses were created and grouped in that office.

according to these concentrations. For example, the Professors Ayaga and Moleah were exhausted by social behavioral track or concentration included some of the constant battles with the administration. They had in their courses on Malcolm X, Martin Luther King, Jr., become experts at writing memoranda to defend the Cheikh Anta Diop, W.E.B. Du Bois, and Zora Neale Hurston. Some other department and their understanding of the mission of the department. Some other courses were proposed but not the undergraduate program. They had put up as good as approved. The cultural aesthetic track or concentration a fight as possible given the fact that Ayaga was included courses such as African Aesthetics, Kenyan and Moleah was South African, and the white Ebonics, African American Drama, African American professors kept them on the defensive. Both had been Art, Négritude, and African literature. Students were radicalized by their involvement with the department required initially to take three core courses regardless because the type of racism they confronted at Temple of the track that they chose as their principal area was different from what they knew at home and quite of concentration. These courses included Proseminar unexpected; they vowed to save the department but in Graduate Studies in African American Studies, knew that they had to save themselves first. Stress African Civilization, and Research Methods in took its toll on them.

African American Studies.

Asante informed them that even with only three faculty members, they had to propose a revitalized vision. The initial reading of the proposal by the Graduate Committee of the College produced considerable discussion of the department and fight for it. They essentially cushioned and academic scramble. Some professors felt asked Asante to take the lead in defining the new direction of the department. With swiftness, and because African American Studies as a department was going to have a graduate program there was some hoopla around the change in the program. They did not believe in it as a field or as a department, Asante took advantage of the momentary discipline. Some conservative professors even claimed goodwill by proposing to hire three new faculty that African American Studies represented a catering



A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 26

26———**African American Studies: The First Doctoral Program** to the notion of “relevance” in education. Others initial proposal for a master’s degree to the department believed that such a graduate program would have

for additional documentation, Asante decided to a deleterious effect on the graduate programs in research the possibility of initiating a doctoral degree English, history, and sociology, bringing unnecessary program, since the major assessment work had competition for a decreasing pool of students. Still already been done for the master's. Examining about others said that no students would enroll in the program 200 programs at various universities, he discovered because students want traditional degrees. Perhaps the that there were at least 20 doctorate-granting programs harshest criticism came from Emma Lapzansky, a in the nation with less faculty than African American black history professor who was also an assistant dean.

Studies at Temple had at the time. Soon he added Lapzansky wrote that the program "would ghettoize"

Kariamuwelsh, Sonja Peterson-Lewis, and C. T. Keto education. Asante's response was that the aim was to to the department. Professors Odeyo Ayaga and Tran correct the ghettoization of education inasmuch as Van Dinh had taken early retirement. Professor Alfred Temple's curriculum and departments without African Moleah was the senior professor, having been in the American Studies were ghettos of whiteness in curricu-department the longest and having achieved the rank of lum, departmental theories, methods, and faculty repre-full professor. However, he did not participate in the sentation. His response was followed by silence from creation of the graduate program. His interests were the dean's office, and soon thereafter Lapzansky left the external to the department at the time, as his preoccu-university.

pation with the South African struggle kept him busy No other opposition to the program surfaced in with international responsibilities.

letters; those who objected to the proposal were care-Asante attempted to add a social policy component ful not to write their objections. They whispered that to the proposal as a third concentration, to answer there were limited materials to teach at the graduate the need for a track for students interested in trans-level in African American Studies. But they spoke out forming the way the areas of social welfare, health, of ignorance and did not have to be confronted head-transportation needs, and other delivery mechanisms on except as the objections were dealt with in several in the

African American community were studied and revisions of the proposal. Relying on the expertise of researched. The inclusion of this social policy compo-a wide range of scholars in the field, Asante was able to answer most of the objections quite easily.

both the master's and the doctoral programs. By the time the new faculty members, Welsh, Peterson-Lewis, and Keto, had taken on the vision and mission **THE POSSIBILITY OF**

of the department, there was a new turn of events.

A DOCTORAL PROGRAM

A new dean, Lois Cronholm, was appointed to the When the Graduate Committee of the College of Arts and Sciences. Lois Cronholm and Arts and Sciences had made its decision to return the her assistant dean, Jayne Kribbs, along with provost Barbara Brownstein and executive vice president H.

Patrick Swygert, became the doctoral program's strongest supporters, even in the face of faculty opposition. President Peter Liacouras played a major role in articulating the vision that was to give Temple the best department of its kind in the nation, but he could not force the faculty to act on the proposal.

The approval of the master's and doctoral programs by the Graduate Committee of the College of Arts and Sciences created euphoria in the National Council of Black Studies. It was a national triumph, indeed, an international achievement for Temple University.

Asante and the department had achieved a great victory, and all of the arguments, setbacks, delays, and threats of obliteration were reduced to memories, *Dr. Molefi Kete Asante, Afrocentric theorist and activist* recorded memories but memories nevertheless. The



A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 27

African American Studies: The First Doctoral Program——27

reviewers who had visited the campus to offer advice terminal degree was written and proposed entirely and suggestions included Professor James

Turner of by an African intellectual and then accepted and Cornell University, Professor William Nelson of approved by a predominantly white institution. The Ohio State University, Professor Delores P. Aldridge construction of a new way to approach and interrogate of Emory University, Professor Marimba Ani of phenomena of the African experience created, inter Hunter College, and Professor Maulana Karenga of alia, space for radically new interpretations of data.

California State University, Long Beach. In addition, By introducing the idea of studying phenomena Howard Dodson of the Schomburg Center came to from the standpoint of African agency, that is, as support the department's movement for a doctoral subjects acting and not simply acted upon, the program. These reviewers' advice and suggestions Afrocentric perspective opened up an entirely fresh were incorporated into the final report.

field of research. For example, the U.S. constitutional In an attempt to forestall any objection to the conventions could suddenly be examined from the admission standards of the new programs, the depart-perspective of the Africans who cooked for the dele-ment introduced the highest grade point average gates or who drove their carriages. One could ask, (GPA) requirement in the College of Arts and

“What were these enslaved black folks thinking while Sciences at the time. A student had to have a 3.0 GPA the colonial white folks were thinking?” Perhaps to enter the program and a 3.6 GPA to apply for the national independence was a gift of Europe, but teaching assistantship. A year or so later, the depart-through years of struggle, freedom was truly to be ment elevated the admission requirement to a 3.2 GPA ultimately a gift of Africa.

for admission. One of the reasons for this was that The introduction of the doctoral program in African the department had experienced an unusually high American Studies shattered the idea that blacks could number of applicants, contrary to the speculation of not propose any intellectual program from which those who believed that there would be only a few whites could learn. Before this development, the idea students interested in the graduate program. Initially the department received hundreds of applications.

APPROVAL AND RECOGNITION

The Temple University Board of Trustees approved the proposal for a doctoral program in African American Studies in 1987. This represented one of the most critical historical developments in American higher education for the following reasons: (1) it represented a major breach in the structure of white supremacy, (2) it introduced a new paradigm, and (3) it minimized the significance of race in theoretical and conceptual innovation.

The proposal to create a new doctoral program in a major white institution in the United States was a bold act. The power to grant terminal degrees had always been held by whites; even at predominantly black institutions where the doctoral degree was offered, it was usually based on some model of a white doctoral program. Thus a history doctorate at Atlanta University was based on the history doctorate at Georgia, Emory, or some other university. In other words, there were no doctoral programs in the United States not created by white people.

The doctoral program in African American Studies *Dr. Miriam Ma'at-Ka-Re Monges, recipient of one of the first* at Temple represented the first time that a new *doctorates in African American Studies from Temple University*

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 28

28———**African American Studies: Graduate Studies for the 21st Century** that whites created and everyone else participated in master's degree and 6 also offer a doctoral degree.

their creation had been the common educational prac-Given that AAS departments and programs have been tice, but the doctoral program at Temple was a radical in existence since the late 1960s, universities have change in that equation. It served to minimize race in been quite slow in creating and maintaining graduate the construction of concept and theory, and thereby programs in AAS. Ohio State University and Cornell struck a blow for equality in theorizing about any University were the first institutions to implement a phenomenon related to the African experience.

master's degree program in AAS in the early 1970s.

It was almost 20 years later, in 1988, that the first doctoral program in AAS was created at Temple **NEW DOCTORAL PROGRAMS**

University, under the leadership of Molefi Kete As of 2004, 15 years after the establishment of Asante. Several years later, other universities—such as Temple University’s doctoral degree in African as the University of Massachusetts at Amherst, American Studies, five additional universities offer the Harvard University, Yale University, Michigan degree: Yale University, University of Massachusetts State University, and the University of California, (U Mass) at Amherst, Michigan State University, Berkeley—followed Temple’s lead and created their Harvard University, and University of California, own doctoral programs in AAS. However, these Berkeley. However, Harvard, Yale, and Michigan universities did not espouse the same philosophy that State offer interdepartmental degrees, with the bulk informed the first doctoral program in AAS. Indeed, of their graduate courses coming from traditional there is a major difference between the Temple doc-university departments. Indeed, only Temple, U Mass, toral program and the others, in that the AAS depart-and Berkeley offer the degree from a departmental ment at Temple consciously rejects the European structure, and only Temple has a disciplinary metaparadigm and espouses the Afrocentric paradigm approach.

developed by Molefi Kete Asante.

— *Ama Mazama*

AN INTELLECTUAL DEPARTURE

FURTHER READING

What defines *Afrocentricity*, the philosophy upon Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). *Kemet, Afrocentricity and* which the Afrocentric paradigm is based, is the crucial *Knowledge*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is role it attributes to the African social and cultural expe-Asante’s dialogue with the issues he confronted in creating rience as the ultimate reference point. Afrocentricity the doctoral program at Temple.

fully acknowledges the negative impact that Europe Asante, Molefi Kete, and Vandi, Abdulai. (1980). *Contemporary* has had on the lives of African people, and it suggests *Black Thought: Alternative Analyses in Social and the restoration of a sense of historical and cultural Behavioral Science*. Newbury Park, CA: Sage. The editors of this volume organized a number of key scholars in a continuity as the first and indispensable step for collective of alternative voices. This is a good introduction Africans' recovery. Quite naturally, the Afrocentric to a new way of approaching phenomena.

historiography assumes ancient African civilizations Cruse, Harold. (1967). *The Crisis of the Negro Intellectual*.

as the most relevant historical and cultural source for New York: William Morrow. This is a classic work on the African people, wherever they may find themselves cultural and intellectual conflict confronting the African today. Afrocentricity also contends that it is Africans'

American intellectual who seeks to overcome structural acceptance of ideas foreign to their cultural reality and racism in the symbols of the society.

ethos, ideas imposed on them by Europeans as "universal" and superior, that has caused the state of great confusion in which Africans currently find themselves.

AFRICAN AMERICAN

It is this confusion that has created the imperative **STUDIES: GRADUATE**

need for Africans everywhere to find in their own cultural references the concepts and practices that **STUDIES FOR THE 21ST CENTURY**

will benefit them.

The organizing principle of the Afrocentric para-Of the 175 African American Studies (AAS) programs digm is the centrality of the African experience for and departments currently in existence, 15 offer a African people. The position taken by the department



A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 29

African American Studies: Graduate Studies for the 21st Century
———29

of AAS at Temple is that what defines African Studies as African Studies (and not something else) is its focus on the African experience from an African perspective (i.e., Afrocentricity). Much of what passes for AAS is nothing but European studies of Africa and her people. Such confusion is made possible by the unquestioned, yet highly problematic, acceptance of the European perspective as universal.

THE TEMPLE UNIVERSITY MODEL

AAS at Temple concerns itself with different topics, and this does not contradict the unidisciplinary status of African Studies but is very much to be expected, since African Studies endeavors to cover the African experience's multiple dimensions. As a result, it covers all aspects of African lives. The purpose of Afrocentrically generated knowledge is to empower African people and give them the means to ultimately *Dr. Adeniyi Coker, Director of African American Studies at the* put an end to their current predicament. The strong *University of Alabama, Birmingham, who in 1991 became the first* commitment to Afrocentricity in the Temple AAS

student to receive a Ph.D. from a department of African American department is demonstrated by its sponsorship for *Studies*

many years of the Annual International Cheikh Anta Diop Conference, a major platform for Afrocentric have had two advisors, one in AAS and one from scholarship, and especially by the courses it offers.

another department or program (such as history, For example, students are taught, among other things, English, anthropology, sociology, or women's studies), ancient African history and civilizations, as well as a formula that had never been employed in any other to decipher the ancient Egyptian language mdw ntr.

department at Temple University.

Although the period of Africans' enslavement in However, the university's plans were resisted by America is understandably mentioned in several some faculty and students, who, through public classes, emphasis in AAS is placed on Africans' past, protests and a lawsuit, were eventually able to

obtain current, and possible victories. Thus a new name, the removal of the chair and the resignation of the *Africology*, meaning the study of African phenomena dean. Thus, although the department greatly suffered from the standpoint of African people, has been from the fighting and lost considerable intellectual suggested for AAS.

ground, it nonetheless managed to maintain its The Temple program was from the start an impor-Afrocentric orientation. Other graduate programs in tant voice for Africans, and it instantly became highly AAS have not been subjected to the severe attack successful in attracting hundreds of Africans from all leveled at Temple, and this is in large part attributable over the world, as well as non-Africans from North to such programs posing no threat to the tradition of America, Europe, and Asia. These students came to Eurocentric academics. Indeed, those departments do the AAS department eager to be a part of a liberating not fundamentally challenge the implicit assumptions educational experience. However, existing as it did in about Europe and Africa found in most American a white supremacist context, its very success worked universities. These assumptions can be briefly sum-against the Temple program. Indeed, in 1997 Temple's marized as follows: (1) all human beings evolve along administration hired Joyce A. Joyce as the new chair the same line, (2) the European experience is univer-for the department of AAS. In a number of prosal, (3) Europeans are superior, and (4) "others" are posals, Joyce defined her mission—to dismantle the defined by their experiences with Europeans. As a Afrocentric program and place it under the intellectual result of such assumptions, the history of all women, tutelage of various European studies departments.

men, and children in the world is said to naturally Under this new plan, AAS doctoral students would coincide with that of Europeans. Thus Europeans are

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 30

30———**African American Studies: Graduate Studies for the 21st Century** implicitly or explicitly held to be the universal norm In addition, the categories used are, unsurprisingly, by which Africans' intellectual, cultural, and social Eurocentric. The University of California, Berkeley, for

“progress” or, rather, lack of progress will be evaluated. This is ethnocentrism par excellence, as it claims societies, like those in Africa, defined as less than and that there is only one way of being human, and it is needing to emulate European societies).

white. What it also suggests is that for Africans to put The second major consequence of most graduate an end to their inferior condition, they must emulate programs applying the European paradigm to African Europeans. In addition, this ethnocentrism implies experience is that they then define themselves as that Africans could not have had a meaningful exis-

“interdisciplinary” or “multidisciplinary.” Indeed, all tence before their contact with Europeans, hence the graduate programs, with the exception of those at creation of a Eurocentric historiography that places Temple University and the University of Wisconsin at the brutal European intervention into African lives as Milwaukee, define African Studies as interdisciplinary, the defining starting point of Africans’ existence.

that is, as a field of study that is dependent on so-called Thus, the history of Africa is divided into precolo-traditional, established disciplines (i.e., European dis-nial, colonial, and postcolonial periods, during the ciplines). In other words, in order to exist, African latter of which, it is said, Africans started “develop-Studies must be tied to European studies.

ing.” In a similar fashion, diasporic Africans are made The clearest example of that line of thinking is proto believe that their history started in the 17th century, vided by Yale, which offers a joint doctoral degree in when their immediate ancestors were dragged in a European discipline and AAS. Furthermore, in that chains to American shores. In that context, the bulk of strange arrangement, there is no claim to equality, diasporic Africans’ existential experience would have since the department of AAS considers the European been as “slaves” to Europeans. In the best and most discipline chosen by a student to be “his or her primary generous case, enslaved Africans are depicted as field of study.” Thus, the AAS department readily

“resisting” their mean white “masters”; in the worst admits to its being secondary to the “traditional” dis-case, they are depicted as acquiescing to

their servile discipline chosen by the students. All the faculty who status and happily participating in their own oppres-supposedly teach in that department have joint sion. However, whatever the case, the fundamental appointments or no appointment at all in AAS. At and racist assumptions of this Eurocentric historiogra-Harvard, where the degree awarded is a “Ph.D. in phy are not questioned: Africans are always defined *in* Afro-American Studies,” a similar model prevails, *relation to* Europeans.

since half of the courses taken by the students who seek a Ph.D. in Afro-American Studies must be from a “traditional” discipline, such as anthropology, soci-DISTINGUISHING

ology, or English. Quite consistently, all the faculty of **FACTORS IN GRADUATE PROGRAMS**

the Department of Afro-American Studies at Harvard Unfortunately, most graduate programs in AAS

have joint appointments. In fact, Harvard University, display an unquestioned acceptance of applying the which has claimed to have the premier department of European paradigm to the African experience. This has AAS in the country, attempted to garner credibility for two major consequences. The first one is that most its Afro-American program by hiring Henry Louis graduate programs are informed by a Eurocentric his-Gates in 1990, who in the midst of much media hype toriography. At the University of Massachusetts at embarked on assembling a loose group of highly Amherst, for example, only one course, African Origins visible black intellectuals, the “Dream Team,” who of the Afro-American Community, seems to suggest remained fully committed to their respective an awareness that the so-called Afro-Americans had a European disciplines and departments. This strategy, life before their enslavement by Europeans, while at however, resulted in a precarious arrangement for Harvard University such a course is not even available.

Harvard’s Afro-American Studies department, which In fact, in programs other than that at Temple started to crumble away a few years later with the University, Africans are referred to either as “Blacks”

departure of some of its most visible half members, or as “Afro-Americans,” but never as “African such as Cornel West and Anthony Appiah, who both Americans,” let alone “Africans,” in course titles.

were attracted to programs other than African

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 31

African American Studies: The Indian Perspective——31

American Studies elsewhere, shortly followed by **FURTHER READING**

Gates’s own leave of absence. In fact, Harvard does Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). *Afrocentricity*. Chicago: African not even claim disciplinary status for Afro-American American Images. This book provides an excellent discuss-Studies but, rather, defines it as a “field,” with a focus sion of the intellectual and political context within which on African people as the defining criterion and its AAS emerged. It puts particular emphasis on intellectual tools of intellectual investigation drawn from the confusion in AAS and makes a compelling case for the European disciplines that are defined as primary.

embracing of the Afrocentric paradigm by AAS scholars There is the same emphasis on the multidisciplinary and students.

or interdisciplinary aspect of AAS elsewhere, of course.

Karenga, Maulana. (1993). *Introduction to Black Studies*. Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This book is indis-AAS departments have focused on doctoral programs pensable reading on AAS birth and growth.

rather than master’s programs due to spatial constraints.

Mazama, Ama. (2003). *The Afrocentric Paradigm*. Trenton, Master’s programs tend to define African Studies as a NJ: Africa World Press. This book provides a useful and field focusing on the black experience rather than as comprehensive overview of the principles, theories, and a discipline.

For example, the Department of AAS at concepts developed by Afrocentric scholars.

Ohio State University, which has the largest number of Mazama, Ama. (2004). Graduate Programs in African Studies.

faculty of any AAS department, espouses the definition In Jacob Gordon (Ed.), *African Studies for the 21st Century*. New York: Cambridge University Press. Mazama of AAS as multidisciplinary, with students having to discuss at length the problems facing AAS graduate programs in literature, music, history, psychology, and makes recommendations for strengthening sociology, political science, economics, community existing programs.

development, and so on. The Africana Studies and Research Center at Cornell University, on the other hand, advocates a “transdisciplinary” approach.”

There are at least two interrelated reasons why those **AFRICAN AMERICAN STUDIES**:

who teach in African Studies programs are quite com-**THE INDIAN PERSPECTIVE**

comfortable with a definition of African Studies as multidisciplinary, interdisciplinary, or some similar concept.

Indian scholars believe that African American Studies, Having been trained, for the most part, in a European especially African American literature, poses an discipline, they simply continue applying the skills important challenge to white American literature.

acquired while being trained as sociologists, psychol-Since much of white American literature, which has ogists, literary critics, linguists, historians, and so on, taken root in India, militates against the ideals of while focusing on some aspect of the African experi-liberty and equality for all peoples, Indian scholars ence. They have generally not questioned the premises welcome African American literature as an alternative upon which the

European intellectual discourse rests, to it, an alternative that fosters the genuine values nor have they seriously questioned the relevance of proclaimed in American documents. This exciting such discourse to African lives. This is indicative of the body of African American literature is filled with the pervasive confusion among black scholars about the spirit of self-examination and questioning, challeng-academic and intellectual standing of AAS. This state ing the very basis of almost all major institutions of affairs is not a new development—it has character-America. This literature is thus of unique interest to ized AAS since its inception because AAS was created Dalit Indians (i.e., the oppressed Indians formerly out of a strong political spirit rather than a clear intel-called untouchables), who are similarly engaged in lectual vision. It is most likely, therefore, that as long as articulating, questioning, and challenging the contra-AAS is conceived as a mere appendage to European dictions in Indian society.

studies, it will fail to entrench itself further in the academy. In order to grow stronger at the graduate level, AAS must attain disciplinary status, which can happen **AFRICAN AMERICAN**

only if scholars involved in AAS accept Afrocentricity **STUDIES AND DALIT STUDIES**

as their defining paradigm.

Although throughout the world the history of those

— *Ama Mazama*

oppressed in the name of color, caste, or religion has

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 32

32———**African American Studies: The Indian Perspective** not run the same course, the broad framework of the autobiographies, which are closer to factual reality struggle of the oppressed for liberation has been more and are the most revealing modes of expression for or less the same. The context of the production of underprivileged selves—the movement is from aware-Dalit Indian and African American literary discourses ness of the

false image imposed upon them to reject the suffering, marginalization, and oppression of it and, finally, to an affirmation of self. But these groups by the supremacist ruling classes and writings do not end in any kind of final resolution. The discrimination. Oppressed African American scholars questions remain unanswered. The analysis of their have seen similarities between their predicament and predicament and the system is done very competently, that of the suffering masses in other parts of the world.

but an alternative vision does not emerge. It is here, They have thus provided a perspective for the study of in this context, that African American Studies has a oppression and resistance and inspired Dalit Indians great contribution to make. African American auto-to see through the designs of the nexus between the biographers not only show the movement from the white *savarna* (meaning “upper class” in Hindi) and consciousness of their predicament to an analysis of the oppressor or ruling capitalistic classes. Like their America’s racism but also point a way out of the exist-African American counterparts, the writings of the ing race relations. They point to an alternative to a Dalit record the search for identity and selfhood in the materialistic civilization that is satisfied with the context of their respective cultures and the struggle acquisition of trinkets and trash. African American of their community to survive whole, forcing their writers, following Richard Wright, have provided a oppressors to revise their literary imagination and critique of white society as well as an alternative affirm the legitimacy of their voices. In this regard, the vision of a new society based on equality and justice.

Dalits relate much of their assertion of literary and The role of the black creative writers and the liter-cultural ideals to those of the practitioners of African ary scholars who serve as intermediaries is to explain American Studies.

the relationship between black people and those In their writings the Dalit have closely examined who attempt to subdue them. These writers have dis-the sociocultural religious framework that has limited covered that they are treated differently not only their horizons and sought the possibility of reforming because of their skin color but also because of the the way they

live. In doing so, they reject the existing entire attitude with which white Americans interpret religious order. Yet they find it difficult to collectively the world. The responsibility of such writers is to not revolt against the system. As in the case of some be limited to the racial question and to move beyond African Americans, some Dalits have compromised such concerns. In doing so, writers have been able to and given up their past. One reason for the Dalits' lack discover the universal significance of blacks' position.

of response to issues of history is that education came These writers thus are not confined to the limitations late to them and, with the exception of Bhim Rao of protest literature and can focus on defining the Ambedkar, they have lacked strong leaders. In addi-nature of reality and finding appropriate forms for tion, there were the middle-class Dalits who estranged conveying it.

themselves from their caste and got entangled in the The Dalit writer can learn from the African socioreligious complexities and microinterests of the American experience how to seek and redefine a com-society. However, they still inspired their brothers and mon culture. The Dalits' dream of a secular Indian sisters to change their ways and also to do something nation that brings communities together and empha-to change the "touchable" Hindu. At the same time, the sizes unity in diversity comes into conflict with the Dalits gave a wake-up call to the *savarana* Hindus to existing, hierarchical social order in which birth still remove the contradictions in the society or else the suf-determines worth. The resolution of this conflict is ferers would blow up the structure of their democracy.

not in sight and this dream of an alternative order has The Dalits have not had organized strategies, such been temporarily sidelined. This is not to say that the as Afrocentricity, to counter their exploitation by Dalits need to imitate black writings. Some Dalit others, but they have beguiled others by adopting writings analyze the existing system very compe-quasipersonas, however uncomfortable and conscious tently, and each writer deals with it in her or his own they themselves have been of the deception. Such way. Although the stages and process of liberation are personas are transitory and have been adopted by the same, the conditions of existence are different, the Dalits only until they are able to live without so the experience and its

treatment will have to be them. In the Dalits' writings—especially in their different. Black literature can provide a platform on

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 33

African Burial Ground Project——33

which Dalit writers can test their plan of action for from Congo, Ghana, and Benin. Their lives in New equality, reassess key issues in intellectual history and York had been quite harsh, as they clearly had expressive culture, dissolve boundaries, and write a frequently suffered from severe malnutrition and nontraditional version of literature. The blueprint pro-serious diseases. Children had died in great numbers, vided by African American writers for such a change and as a whole, the birth rate was lower than the can help the Dalits to triumph over the trivialities that mortality rate.

divide their world.

On October 4, 2003, the excavated remains of the 17th- and 18th-century Africans were reinterred dur-

— *Sudhi Rajiv*

ing a ceremony called the Rites of Ancestral Return, at the very site where they had been discovered almost **FURTHER READING**

13 years earlier. The ceremony involved many cities, starting with an evening departure ceremony at Howard Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). *Afrocentricity: The Theory of University in Washington, D.C., proceeding to Social Change*. Chicago: African American Images. This Baltimore, Philadelphia, Newark, and finally reaching book is a classic wake-up call for oppressed people.

New York City. Over 3,000 people participated in Asante's book was popularized in India in the 1990s.

Bennett, Lerone. (1968). *The Challenge of Blackness*.

what was to be, by all accounts, an emotional event, Chicago: Johnson. Bennett's book demonstrates that for the excavation and burial of those enslaved oppressed people can choose their own path to liberation Africans brought the horror and evil of slavery to the through identifying with their own sense of history.

fore once again, a most sensitive issue for many Rajiv, Sudhi. (1992). *Forms of Black Consciousness*.

Africans who feel a special reverence for and grati-New York: Advent Books. This is one of the best tude to their ancestors. By the same token, it also works done by an Indian scholar on the nature of black raised the issue of the quite significant contributions consciousness.

Africans have made to the economic development of America, thus reinforcing the legitimacy and timeliness of the claim for reparations made by an increasing number of African Americans.

AFRICAN BURIAL

Above all, maybe, the African Burial Ground **GROUND PROJECT**

Project forced American society in general and African Americans in particular to deal with a painful The African Burial Ground Project began in 1991

chapter of history, Africans' enslavement in America, with the discovery of an African cemetery during the a chapter that has often been ignored or distorted, and building of the Foley Square Project Federal Building whose scope and significance have therefore often in lower Manhattan in New York. The cemetery was been belittled. The African Burial Ground Project the home of the remains of over 400 Africans. This compelled Africans to revisit their identity, their finding, the largest bioarchaeological site identified in relationship with the past, and their ancestors who the Americas, immediately raised awareness as well suffered terribly not so long ago. As a result, as the as many questions about the colonial past of Northern public became aware of the African Burial Ground states, especially New York, which had more enslaved Project, many became

committed and contributed to Africans than had been realized. These questions were the proper and dignified handling and burial of the able to be answered in the years that followed, as a remains of their African ancestors. This was no easy result of the close study of the remains at Howard battle in the face of federal indifference, if not resis-University by a team of 70 to 80 researchers operating tance, to the right of African people to bury and treat under the supervision of physical anthropologist their dead with the respect due them.

Michael Blakey, the scientific director of the African

— *Ama Mazama*

Burial Ground Project.

The researchers combined information yielded by DNA with the study of skulls and historical data **FURTHER READING**

to tell the story of those whose skeletons they were There has not been any scholarly report yet on the African examining—for example, their place of birth, age at Burial Ground Project. The interested reader will, however, death, cause of death, and general life conditions.

benefit from reading the following essays on slavery in the They found that the Africans had come primarily Northern states.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 34

34———**African Cosmology**

Blassingame, John. (1972). *The Slave Community*. London: **SPIRIT AS THE PARENT REALITY**

Oxford University Press. This work documents and surveys the institution of slavery and demonstrates the effect of Spirit is a tremendously complex and stupendously slavery on the creation of community among Africans of dynamic construct. The ancients understood spiritual-various backgrounds.

ity as the parent of reality. In the framework of African Blatt, Martin H., and Roediger, David R. (Eds.). (1998). *The cosmology, human beings are the union of spirit and Meaning of Slavery in the North*. New York: Garland. This physical being within a physical realm of existence.

book focuses more particularly on the economic aspect of While humanity is confined in large measure to the 19th-century slavery in the North.

temporal dimension, human beings continuously engage in conscious and unconscious interactions with the spirit. *Spirit* is the word used to describe the intuitive through supranational connectedness that many **AFRICAN COSMOLOGY**

people feel with the entirety of creation. In its broadest usage, *spirit* refers to both the totality of existence and A *cosmology* is a body or system of thought arising the multiplicity of its manifestations.

out of a people's history and culture that addresses It is clear from the interviews with and experiences issues of reality and creation, truth and value, mean-of many adherents of indigenous African cultures and ing, process, and that people's place within creation.

from the work of various researchers that the termi-It can be differentiated from the more general term, nology and understanding of designated elements of *cosmogony*, which is a people's mythohistorical the spirit differ and often conflict within the same description of the creation of the universe or, put village. Each of the indigenous cultural systems more simply, their creation story. Although indigenous nonetheless provides for a single creator who is a African cosmologies appear to differ according to singularity and a multiplicity simultaneously. The geography and regional histories, the degree to which creator has mandated order and balance. The deities or they coincide in fundamental principles and function children of the creator are the ministers and emissaries defines them as multiple expressions of a single of the creator. As aspects of the creator, they maintain cultural and cosmological construct.

that mandated balance and order. These ministers In the cosmologies of traditional Africa, the of the creator are the *Abosom* (Akan), the *Orisha*

physical existence of human beings is a limited (Yoruba), the *Neteru* (Kemet), the *Nommo* (Dogon), but representative (complementary or synchronistic) the *Vodu* (Ewe), to name but a few examples. They are expression of the cosmic order mandated by the the intermediaries between humanity and the ances-creator of the universe. Human physical existence is tors and creator (*Odumankoma*, *Oyankopon*, *Ngala*, the consequence of the actions and determinations of *iNkosi*, *Olodumare*, *Kalunga*). The ancestors are vari-deities and ancestors and is being continually influ-ously referred to as, for example, *Nsamanfo* (Akan), enced by them. The character and existence of human *Egungun* (Yoruba), and *Nkukunkulu* (Zulu). These physical existence are determined and shaped by the children of the creator are the first expression of the greater and parent spiritual reality. Each human being differentiation or generativity of the creator. In several exists because of the ancestral line of which she or he African cosmogonies, the number 8 has a prominent is a part. The ancestral line extends from the creator, place in reference to the original number of deities or the deities, and the clan ancestors. No human being families of deities.

exists apart from that lineage or continuum. Each In African cosmology there are provisions for one human being has a personal mission. It is the discov-or more components of the spirit that issue directly ery and actualization of that personal mission that from the creator and are the source of physical life, positions the individual to make the maximal contri-such as the *Kra* (Akan), *Ka* (Kemet), *Emi* (Yoruba), bution to the efforts of the collective. It is the inability and *Kla* (Ga). Each cosmology provides for a compo-or unwillingness of the person to identify with his or nent of personal destiny that may be acquired in a her personal mission and apply himself or herself to variety of fashions. Among the Akan it is referred to that mission that compromises the possibility of suc-as the *Nkrabea* or *Hyebea*. Among the Yoruba, it is the cess in matters of family development and sustained *Ipin-Ori*. There are also provisions for the element and productive relations or strategic actions in his or of character, such as the *Sunsum* of the Akan. The her endeavors.

elements of both character and mission are derived

ultimately from the creator. In each system there are physical environment. The Dogon, for instance, make concepts of the spiritual double or complement that abundant references to various seeds and the condition exists synchronously with the physical. Also in each of particular grains. There are also references to other system, the differentiated components of the spirit are features of their environment, including jackals and seen first as extensions of *Odumankoma*, *Oludumare*, caves or burrows. These are prominent features of *Amma*, *iNkosi*, as the creator is variously named, and their physical space; thus it is natural for the Dogon then as expressions of the *Abosom*, the *Orisha*, the to assume that their spiritual reality parallels their *Neteru*, and other deities. What emerges is a picture temporal experience. These temporal parallels and of the spirit as an incomprehensibly complex and reference points facilitate an understanding of the dynamic reality of which the physical reality is but a operation of the spirit as it relates to their material and small component.

mundane concerns. The conceptions of the cosmos, its beginnings and the place and dynamics of humanity in its relations with the spirit, present a picture not **THE FUNCTION OF**

only of abundant diversity but also of true cultural **RITUALS AND MYTHS**

unity. Each cultural system uses scenarios analogous to people's experience in their respective environ-Throughout Africa, various traditional societies have ments to explain the origins and nature of the cosmos employed rituals to facilitate interaction with the or creation. It can be said that this is the multiplicity spiritual. They have also employed myths to foster within the singularity that is the expression of the an understanding of the spiritual reality as the parent creator.

reality that is incapable of being comprehended Each regional expression mimicks the complexity within the realm of materialist rationality. Thus, spirit of the cosmos as the people perceive it. Through a represents the lack of name for the reality that is the set of rituals as complex as their cosmology, each greater reality. As different names exist for different

people has sought to facilitate, enhance, and main-aspects of all things, different names also exist for tain the connectedness of the material and the spiri-different aspects of the spirit because it cannot be tual. Part of the seemingly bewildering complexity described in just one way. Different terminology has can be explained through an understanding that the therefore been used to describe various components, spiritual is so interwoven in the material concerns attributes, and manifestations of the spirit. The *Kra*, and functions of the culture that the material and *Sunsum*, *Ntoro*, and *Mogya* are different manifesta-spiritual are indistinguishable. The underlying value tions of the spirit in the Akan people's cosmology as and principle of African cosmology is that in it the it relates to the human person.

expressions and manifestations of the creator are Similar manifestations in the Dogon people's infinite, and it is thus not the purview of one person cosmology include the *Gozu*, *Kikin Bummone*, and or group of persons to judge the worth or value of *Nyama*. For the Bambara people, the *Ni* and the *Dya* those expressions.

are two prominent manifestations of the spirit. The Zulu people call these manifestations the *Isithunzi* and

— *Kwame Agyei Akoto and Akua Nson Akoto the Ithongo*. In the cosmology of Kemet, the concepts of *Ka*, *Ba*, *Khaba*, *Akhu*, *Seb*, *Putah*, and *Amu* are

FURTHER READING

manifestations of the spririt in the human being.

Ackah, Christian Abraham. (1988). *Akan Ethics*. Accra: Ghana Parallel conceptions in the Yoruba cosmology include University Press. This book presents a detailed and useful the *Emi*, *Ori*, *Ipin*, and *Enikeji*. Similar conceptions account of Akan spiritual beliefs.

exist among the Manding and throughout West, East, Agyei, K., and Akoto, Akua Nson. (1999/2000). *The Sankofa Central*, and Southern Africa. These conceptions of *Movement: ReAfrikanization and the Reality of War*.

the manifestations of the spirit in the makeup of the Washington, DC: Oyoko InfoCom. This is a clearly articulated human being are further compounded in their interrelated analysis of fundamental African spiritual principles, actions with other manifestations of the spirit whose and it makes the case for the need for African people to re-embrace those principles.

terminology and character encompass altogether Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1991). *Civilization or Barbarism: An* different dynamics.

Authentic Anthropology. New York: Lawrence Hill. Diop Traditional mythology was fashioned to facilitate outlines the profound cultural unity that binds African people's understanding of the operation of the people.



36———**African Dance in the United States** T'Shaka, Oba. (1995). *Return to the African Mother Principle of Male and Female Equality*. Oakland, CA: Pan African Publishers. This book explores the cultural meaning of gender complementarity throughout Africa.

AFRICAN DANCE

IN THE UNITED STATES

African dance in the United States is a movement form that has entered the country at the university level from the continent of Africa since the 1950s.

African dance, the oldest form of dance in the world, had its academic beginning in American universities in the mid-20th century as a result of the following distinct circumstances:

1. the rise in African consciousness due to the Négritude movement, African nationalism, and pan-Africanism, as expressed in the 1950s *Dr. J. Kwabena Nketia, philosopher of music* and 1960s by heads of African states such as Kwame Nkrumah, Léopold Sédar Senghor, and companies to appear. Alvin Ailey was the representative Julius Nyerere

of the United States to the first international African 2. the development in Africa of government-festival of arts in Dakar, Senegal in 1965.

Subsequently, sponsored cultural and educational institutions Ailey's dance company toured the African continent, for the purpose of disseminating and preserving dancing from Ghana to Ethiopia. However, two African culture

professors—Albert Mawere Opoku and Kwabena Nketia of the University of Ghana, Legon—had the 3. the desire of African American educators and greatest impact on the transfer of African dance ideas scholars to advance the scholarship in African to the United States. They were the chief promoters of and African American Studies beyond European West African dance in the United States. Both Opoku paradigms, which meant that they sought to and Nketia worked in universities in America before extend the understanding of African cultural retiring in Ghana in the 1980s. It was the relationship traits and values to all of the Americas and the between them that brought new dances, royal court Caribbean

music, and new African American adherents into 4. the civil rights movement of the 1960s, when the realm of African dance. Subsequently, there were emergent voices on university campuses were many African masters, such as Olatunji, who came to calling for and insisting upon coursework and the United States from Nigeria to teach African dance.

disciplines that acknowledged the need for valid In the African context, dance is always performed scholarship not predicated on colonialist models to music, so when we speak of African dance it must be understood to include music. African dance has 5. the launching of cultural initiatives such as become a feature in many university, civic, and private touring national dance companies that had an events, such as homecoming parades and celebrations; impact on the American panorama from Broad-convocations and special ceremonies; banquets, arts way to the university campuses.

openings, weddings, birthdays, and fashion shows; opening for featured artists; Black History Month Given the environment created by these circum-events; Kwanzaa celebrations; Juneteenth Day cele-stances, there was a new awareness around African brations; African American arts festivals; liturgical dance that made it possible for innovative dance dance dialogue groups and forums; as well as in

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 37

African Demographics——37

interactions with the Hispanic community, including multidimensionality of space and body movements of Santería, Lukumi, and Palos Montes celebrations.

African dance to the complexities of life.

Actually, most American colleges and universities Welsh-Asante, Kariamu. (1996). *African Dance*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is one of the key contributions to have neither Black Studies nor African dance as a part the understanding of African dance in the modern context.

of the curriculum. It is rare to find a department of Welsh-Asante seeks to demonstrate that African dance is a Black Studies in which dance is a major component.

dance not merely of the past but also of the future.

Yet it is clear that African dance is a major art form in the African world. African dance is also connected to the presence in the United States of Gamelan orchestras, Caribbean clubs, drum circles, and pow-wows.

AFRICAN DEMOGRAPHICS

This is not to say that African dance and music set this precedent but to suggest a simultaneous cultural and To date, most research that has been done on human academic awakening of international involvement descent points to evidence that all humans originated on several American college campuses (e.g., State in Africa. Thus Africa has a long history, over the University of New York College at Brockport, Ohio course of which it has undergone numerous experi-State University, California Arts, Temple University, ences that have affected its demographic size, compo-and the University of California, Los Angeles).

sition, and distribution. Around the turn of the Three great African dance companies, Les Ballets millennium, it was estimated that Africa is home to Africains of Guinea, National Ballet of Senegal, and almost 900 million people, which is about 14% of the The National Dance Ensemble of Ghana, have consis-world's population. About one third of this population tently brought amazing entertainment, drama, move-lives in urban centers, which are typically communi-ment, and spectacle to world audiences. Traditional ties of 2,000 to 10,000 inhabitants. This is a recent and classical African dance has been studied in the phenomenon, however; for most of history, the Americas by Henry Drewal, Kariamu Welsh-Asante, African population has lived a rural lifestyle and John Mason, and Robert Ferris Thompson in the United depended on agriculture and hunting for survival.

States and by Juanita Elbine Dos Santos in Brazil, as Although human beings have lived in Africa for well as by hundreds of other scholar-choreographers.

thousands of years, little information is available on the actual number of inhabitants for most of Africa's

— *Clyde Alafiju Morgan*

history. It is estimated that around the beginning of the 16th century, sub-Saharan Africa had 20% of the **FURTHER READING**

world's 600 million people at that time. However, European and Arab infiltration of the African continent—Asante, Molefi Kete, and Welsh-Asante, Kariamu (Eds.).

(1990). *African Culture: The Rhythms of Unity*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This book brings together some of the dances, violence, and slavery that accompanied it. It is the most critical thinkers in the field of African aesthetics estimated that the European slave trade alone led to an attempt to discuss the nature of the unity of African dance, art, and enormous forced movement of between 15 and 50

cultural expressions. It is a daring intellectual work that millions of Africans to the Western Hemisphere between includes pieces by Wole Soyinka, Maulana Karenga, the mid-1400s and the mid-1800s. Given the number of Africans presently in the Americas and the others.

Barber, Karin (Ed.). (1997). *Readings in Popular Culture*.

Caribbean, some scholars believe that the number of Africans taken from the African continent is considerably higher than 15 million. However, despite these and includes a way to assess the newest forms of African circumstances and epidemics that have plagued the cultural expressions.

continent, the population in Africa continues to grow. Kubik, Gerhard. (1978). *Dance, Art, and Ritual of Africa*.

at a rate of 2.4%, one of the highest population growth New York: Random House. This book deals with the rates in the world.

perceptions, actions, and symbols of dance in African Population change results from the interaction of communities.

Opoku, Albert M., and Bell, Willis. (1965). *African Dances: A three variables: birth, death, and migration. A Ghanaian Profile*. Legon: University of Ghana, Institute of society's population can increase through natural African Studies. In this work, Opoku and Bell connect the increase, when more births than deaths occur in a

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 38

38———**African Demographics**

given period of time, or through net migration, when Demographers have described the phenomenon of more people move into the geographical area than countries and regions moving from a state of high move out in a given period of time. At the regional birth and death rates to a state of low birth and death level, most population change in Africa is due to nat-rates as a *demographic transition*. This process tends ural increase, in the sense that more people are born to occur in three stages. In the first stage, birth and than die in any given year. The current total fertility death rates are high and, as a result, little population rate for Africa is 5.2. That is, on average, a woman growth occurs. In the second stage, death rates fall due living in Africa would have more than five children if to improved living conditions, while birth rates she were to go through her reproductive lifetime bear-remain high. During this period, population grows ing children at the current rate of women in the vari-rapidly as more people are born and fewer die. The ous age groups. This means that women in Africa on third stage of the transition is reached when fertility average bear two or more children than women in falls and closes the gap between birth and death rates, other parts of the world, in which total fertility rates resulting again in a slower pace of population growth.

are lower than 3. But the average age at death for This pattern has been observed in a number of people in Africa is younger than that of people in

most European societies, many of which are now in the other parts of the world by about 10 years. There are third stage of the transition. In most parts of Africa, significant differences within the continent on most of birth and death rates remained high until after World these indicators, however.

War II. When death rates began to fall in Africa, they Although migration plays a limited role in chang-fell more rapidly than they had in Europe, primarily ing the size of the African population at the regional through the introduction of medical and public health level, it does greatly influence the composition of technology to control infectious diseases rather than various societies on the continent. Seasonal migrant from economic development within the African labor to mines, long-distance trading, truck driving, countries. In addition, because of better health, birth and serving in the military are some of the occupa-rates in Africa increased and the population continued tional factors that lead to migration in the region.

to grow at a high rate. In the past 30 years, birth rates Generally, such occupations are filled with young have fallen but death rates have fallen even faster, men ages 20 to 35, who often establish semiperma-hence leading to continued population growth on the nent homes and new relationships in the places of continent.

work but also maintain regular contact with their Aside from the total size of a population and the spouses in the country. Consequently, spatial mobil-three demographic variables of birth, death, and ity is one of the major factors contributing to the migration, another important demographic character-spread of the HIV/AIDS epidemic in Africa. Civil istic of any society is its *age and sex structure*, or the strife also frequently leads to massive movements of proportion of people at each age, by sex. A popula-refugees within the continent.

tion's age-sex structure determines its potential for There normally are a number of other socioeco-future growth as well as the patterns of growth among nomic factors that influence changes in each of the age groups. Generally, a population with 35% of its three major demographic variables under discussion.

people under the age of 15 is considered young, and For instance, although the biological ability of women this offers some indication of the likely burden that to bear children is similar across most population these people will place on various resources as they groups, the actual number of children born varies sig-grow older. In addition, a large population of young nificantly from one social setting to another. This is women produces a substantial number of births, mainly due to differences in the social factors that which influences future population growth. Recent influence the opportunities and motivations for child-data indicate that more than 40% of the African bearing in the various African societies. Some of the population is under the age of 15.

reasons noted to affect fertility in Africa are low Rapid population growth is linked to many social access to contraceptive services, the desire to have problems, including hunger, high infant mortality, many children as old-age security, the poor education inadequate social and health services, and a poor and low status of women, early age at marriage, a infrastructure, including such services as transporta-preference for sons over daughters, and high infant tion and communication. Population growth does and child mortality rates.

not necessarily cause these problems, but there is

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 39

African Epistemology——39

evidence that rapid population growth could make it likely be slow. Given the number of young people in more difficult to ease social problems such as those the region, there is already an inbuilt momentum that listed above, primarily because of the pressure that will lead to continued population growth in Africa, increasing numbers of people put on the economy and even in the wake of the HIV/AIDS epidemic, for the infrastructure of already resource-stricken societies.

coming 30 years.

With one of the most rapidly growing populations in

— Robert Ssengonzi

the world, Africa ranks below almost all world regions on several social, economic, and health indicators, such as maternal and child mortality rates, crude death **FURTHER READING**

rate, life expectancy, immunization rates, and average Gould, P. R. (1993). *The Slow Plague: A Geography of the personal income.*

AIDS Pandemic. Malden, MA: Blackwell. This is a good Many countries in Africa are also now facing a source of information on the AIDS pandemic and its effect crisis caused by the HIV/AIDS epidemic, which is on the population of Africa.

undermining the development and human resources of Population Reference Bureau. (2002). *World Population Data* the region at an alarming rate. Research and projec-Sheet. Washington, DC: Population Reference Bureau.

tions have shown that in some countries, the epidemic This is very useful statistical data on population in Africa.

Thomas, H. (1997). *The Slave Trade: The Story of the Atlantic* has or will slow developmental growth and reduce life *Slave Trade: 1440–1870*. New York: Simon and Schuster.

expectancy at birth by more than 10 years. Since the There is excellent material in this book, although Thomas bubonic plague in the 14th century that killed an esti-gives a conservative estimate of the number of Africans mated 35 million people, mostly in Europe, no other uprooted from the continent of Africa.

epidemic has had such a strong impact on human population as the HIV/AIDS epidemic. According to the United Nations, it has been estimated that in 2001, of **AFRICAN EPISTEMOLOGY**

the world's 40 million people living with HIV/AIDS, 29 million were living in Africa. Yet, these numbers only partially depict the magnitude of the

epidemic African epistemology is the African theory of knowl-that since the late 1980s has claimed more than 3 mil-edge, which includes the African conception of the lion people and orphaned millions of children, mainly nature of knowledge, the means used to gain knowl-in Africa. It is estimated that about 9% of adults edge, the criteria for the assessment of the validity of between 15 and 49 years of age in Africa are currently knowledge, the purpose of the pursuit of knowledge, infected with HIV. The range in prevalence varies and the role that knowledge plays in human existence.

greatly, however, from 2% to 30%, with some south-The adjective *African* applied to a people implies that ern African countries being the most affected. South that people, given the specificity of their location in Africa is the country with the largest number of the world and their experience in human history, have HIV-infected persons, at 5.0 million.

as African people a specific way of understanding It is not possible to tell exactly what the future size and explaining the world and the complexity of the of Africa's population will be. However, given past human condition. At the same time, given that Africans trends and existing circumstances in regard to the are members of the unique human family of Homo components of population—birth, death, and migra-sapiens, African epistemology naturally exhibits tion—some estimates can be made. If the population similarities with and differences from epistemologies in Africa were to continue to grow annually at the cur-developed by people living in other parts of the world.

rent estimated rate of 2.4%, the population would In Africa, as elsewhere, the philosophizing process double in just 28 years. However, there is evidence begins with an epistemological quest, that is, the quest that contraceptive use is increasing in most parts of for a solid foundation of human knowledge. This epis-Africa. Also, other social and cultural changes that temology or theory of knowledge deals with ways of influence a change in fertility—such as increased age knowing and criteria for the evaluation of the validity at marriage and increased education of females—are of knowledge. In so doing, it raises the fundamental taking place. Birth

rates are falling in many nations, questions of how and why knowledge is created.

such that the rate at which the population grows will be confronted with the thorniest questions about human decline. Yet, this decline in population growth will be destiny in the midst of a mysterious universe, Africans

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 40

40———**African Epistemology**

have developed since time immemorial a complex to challenge this invention of Africa by deconstructing epistemology that enabled them to find satisfactory knowledge about African people built especially by answers to the numerous questions pertaining to the anthropologists and other social scientists. In other human condition. Their creation myths articulated an words, the critique of Western and Westernized epis-answer to the enigma of the origin of humankind and temologies constitutes an important part of African the meaning of life in this world and the hereafter.

epistemology. Moreover, in the postcolonial era Thus the first questions to be addressed are how world, where the limitations of the dominant Western Africans articulate and evaluate knowledge and what concepts, theories, and paradigms have become obvi-constitute the specific characteristics of Africans' cog-ous, it is imperative, especially with the development native modes and their general conception of the of Black Studies in the United States, to decolonize nature and role of knowledge in human existence. The knowledge by exploring different ways of knowing.

African approach to knowledge can be grasped from Naturally, Africans have turned toward their ancestral the wisdom of oral tradition, especially the various intellectual heritage to articulate the new vision of creation myths, folktales, and proverbs; the way of African epistemology. In the United States, Afro-seeking truth in social, political, and religious institu-centricity emerged in the 1980s as the most influential tions; the work of healers; the avenues for finding epistemological paradigm inspired by the African guilty parties in traditional justice systems; and the tradition.

ways of solving family disputes and other social conflicts. However, the earliest written documents that **AFRICAN WAYS OF**

give us a hint about African epistemology are from **KNOWING AND COGNITIVE FACULTIES**

Kemet, especially in the definition of the philosopher from the Antef inscription (12th Dynasty, 2000–1768

For the sake of clarity, it may be argued that African B.C.E.), the Instruction of Ptahhotep (25th century epistemology comprises four basic African ways of B.C.E.), the Instruction of Nebmare-Nakt (Papyrus knowing that can be separated into three categories, Lansing, 12th century B.C.E.), the anonymous the supernatural, the natural, and the paranormal paths Instruction recorded on papyrus by Chester Beatty IV

to knowledge. First, there is a supernatural path of (12th century B.C.E.), and the ethical teaching of knowledge in which human beings gain knowledge Amenemope. These texts articulate the fundamental through the help of supernatural powers. This cogni-African path to knowledge that is also expressed in tive mode includes divination (*lubuko*, in the Kiluba Zera Yacob's *Hatata*, the current Bwino epistemology language of the Congo) and revelation (i.e., messages of Bantu philosophy, and the Ofamfa-Matemasie epis-revealed in dreams and visions). These two cognitive temology of the Akan, to name but a few examples.

modes are characterized by the intervention of super-But what exactly is this African theory of knowl-natural beings—spirits, ancestors, dead relatives, edge? How do Africans access and process knowledge?

gods, goddesses—who impart knowledge to humans Why do Africans conduct this quest for knowledge? By directly through a dream or vision or indirectly which means do people gain knowledge, and how are through mediums, diviners, animals, extraordinary people expected to use knowledge? As these questions life events, or natural phenomena that require a spe-indicate, African epistemology deals with the faculties cial kind of interpretation.

by which people gain knowledge, and the debate over Another epistemological path is that of natural the credibility of such means. Hence, it addresses the cognitive modes. In this way of knowing, human critical issue of truth. How can people be sure that beings gain knowledge by using their natural faculties they know the truth and that they can adequately or abilities, including intuition (*mucima* in Kiluba), express it in their languages?

which consists of the work of the human heart (i.e., Africans' unique history of enslavement, colonial-feeling and insight), and reason, which consists of a ism, neocolonialism, and racism has created an natural investigation of reality through the human African epistemology with a specific focus on the intellect and logical thought process. Given that in relationship between knowledge and political and Africa, intuition and reason are not mutually exclu-economic power. In a world where for centuries sive, the phrase *African rationality* has its peculiarity.

Africans have been studied and defined by their colo-Between these two poles of African epistemology, the nial or slave masters, African epistemology has come natural and supernatural ways of knowing, stands a

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 41

African Epistemology——41

third category of paranormal cognition or extrasensory **African Rationality**

perception (ESP), which includes such modes as clairvoyance and telepathy. The focus here is limited The concept of African rationality has been disto divination and African rationality, which play a torted, obscured, and discarded by centuries of epis-crucial role in African people's everyday life.

temic violence produced by colonial and neocolonial scholarship. In countless scholarly works shaped by Darwinian evolutionism, Hegel's philosophy of world **Divination**

history, and Lévy-Bruhl's grand dichotomy, the Because of the nature of its success, divination African mind has been defined in binary terms as the plays a crucial role in African life as a trusted means opposite not only of the Western mind but also of of decision making and a basic source of vital the mind of the rest of humankind. According to knowledge. It also plays a role in the enactment and these philosophies, the African mind is irrational, validation of legal and political decisions in various emotional, and superstitious, and by nature anti-parts of Africa. Intellectuals and peasants, politicians thetical to philosophical and scientific rationality.

and technicians, professors and students, even However, as postcolonial scholarship, especially the Christians and Muslims, consult the diviner, espe-Afrocentric paradigm in the United States, has shown, cially when they face critical existential problems African epistemology is far from the hocus-pocus of and have to make tough decisions. Long regarded as witch doctors promoted by outside scholars during the primitive hocus-pocus, divination has come to be last 5 centuries.

acknowledged by more careful scholarship as an For thousands of years Africans have domesticated important cognitive mode not only in Africa but also cattle, developed agriculture, created astronomical elsewhere in the world, including in the intellectual calendars, mastered medicinal plants, educated their heritage of the West. Through a healthy decolo-children, and survived various mortal dangers because nization of knowledge, postcolonial scholarship has they gained an efficient knowledge that opened the shown that divination is not an irrational practice by secrets of nature and unlocked the enigma of human some charlatan or obtuse superstitious mystificators, existence. The science and architecture of Egypt, but rather, a powerful epistemological approach by astronomy of the Dogon, architecture of Zimbabwe, men and women of exceptional wisdom and high art of Benin, and many other religious, philosophical, personal character.

and scientific achievements still visible today bear Divination stands at the core of African episte-witness to Africans' passion for genuine knowledge.

mology as a valid cognitive mode. It exemplifies African languages indicate that Africans have used well the way African epistemology integrates scien-the power of reason to carefully analyze nature and tific and religious

knowledge, natural cognitive faculties—the human condition in the world. The Shona languages and supernatural powers. Divination emerges gradually, for instance, has more than 200 different words as a dynamic, complex, and sophisticated cognitive tool to describe the action of walking. The adjective *big* is method that skillfully combines logical-analytical rendered by 183 words in the Nupe language and 311

and intuitive-synthetical modes of thinking that in words in Hausa. Many languages have 10 or 20 words Western tradition are rigidly separated. Moreover, to describe an object according to changes in its form, divination is not solely a belief grounded in religious weight, volume, or color, and as many words to characterize an action depending on whether it is single or superstitious paraphernalia hides the diviner's pro-multiple, weak or strong, beginning or ending.

found knowledge, which is obtained through difficult This African epistemology is based on careful techniques and a long and hard training of intellect observation of natural phenomena, an analytical and character. Divination is not mere faith. It is an assessment of the understanding of the phenomena, learned discipline based on an extensive body of and a logical explanation of reality, and it is well knowledge, which involves at once natural and super-articulated in the *Ofamfa-Matemasie* epistemology natural phenomena, the material and immaterial, and expressed in the Adinkra symbols of Ghana, *Ofamfa* visible and invisible dimensions of reality. As such, and *Matemasie*. The Adinkra symbol *Ofamfa*, which divination constitutes an important component of is also called *Pempan Hwemu Dua*, literally means African epistemology.

“search rod” or “measuring rod” and is the symbol for

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 42

42———African Epistemology

critical examination and excellence. It defines the thought. The African thinks not only with the head but African concept of critical thinking. *Matemasie* is the also with the heart. This means that African people

symbol of wisdom and insight. It adds an ethical reject the cold Cartesian dualistic logic. African reason dimension to the epistemology by establishing the dialogues with intuition and other cognitive faculties.

connection of knowledge and goodness, harmony, and Moreover, this relationship between head and heart balance. Thus the purpose of knowledge is to ensure introduces a human factor into African epistemology.

a good life for oneself and the community.

Knowledge has to be humane. Such is the fundamen-This notion of critical thinking expressed by the tal characteristic of African epistemology.

Ofamfa symbol also is articulated in the *Hatata* epistemology of the Ethiopian philosopher Zera Yacob **THE MAIN CHARACTERISTICS**

(1592–1685), a contemporary of René Descartes. Zera **OF AFRICAN EPISTEMOLOGY**

began his journey toward knowledge by identifying the obstacles that hinder the effort to know the truth.

Every epistemology is shaped by its theorists’

Zera observed that because the knowing process is a conception of the object of study. African ontology difficult labor, people “shy from any critical examina-involves the interconnectedness of all reality, thus tion” and “hastily accept what they have heard from African epistemology is grounded in a holistic vision.

their fathers.” Thus Zera adopted criticism as the African epistemology has eight major characteristics: initial step toward knowledge and included other (1) the principle of intellectual humility and non-steps such as analysis (*Hatata* in Kiluba), inquiry, and dogmatism; (2) cosmotheandricity (i.e., the intercon-the light of reason and the goodness of the created nectedness of the human realm with the cosmic and things as the basis of the cognitive method. The the spiritual worlds); (3) an ethical dimension

with a Baluba tradition in the Congo agrees with this *Hatata* focus on wisdom; (4) rejection of the notions of epistemology.

“knowledge for knowledge’s sake” and “art for art’s sake” The *Bwino* epistemology of the Baluba is grounded in these two principles; (5) a holistic perspective focused on the interin the proverb *Mwana wihangula ye unvwaâ*, meaning connectedness and balance of reality; (6) rejection of

“the child who raises questions is the one who will the compartmentalization of knowledge, an integra-gain knowledge,” which stipulates the centrality of the tion of various disciplines, and a rejection of the question in the path toward knowledge. For the Bantu, opposition of reason and other cognitive faculties; knowledge does not stem from a blind repetition of (7) rejection of the opposition of the sacred and the ancestral ways. The Baluba state that in order to know, profane, religion and science, knowledge and faith; one has to begin with the “art of unknowing,” being (8) rejection of the opposition of the individual and carefully aware that everything that shines may not be the community as cognitive agent.

a “genuine knowledge” (*Bwino ke bwino*). This means These characteristics of African epistemology are that knowledge is not knowledge until it is critically well exemplified by, among others, the *Bwino* episte-examined and its validity enshrined. It is precisely this mology of the Bantu people of Central Africa and power of critical thinking that has made African tradi-the *Ofamfa-Matemasie* epistemology of the Akans.

tion so dynamic, vibrant, and flexible, constantly The *Bwino* epistemology is defined by the Luba adapting to new challenges. The very survival of proverb, *Bwino bonso ke bwino, bwino I kwikala biya* African people throughout history is due to this kind *ne Bantu*, “knowledge is not knowledge, true knowl-of epistemology, which allowed people to assess the edge is to know how to live in harmony with our fel-meaning of new realities in the light of old canons and low human beings.” The fundamental point made by to assess ancestral wisdom and customs in the light of this proverb is that, in African epistemology, genuine new circumstances and wisdom.

knowledge is not divorced from wisdom. Indeed, for It should be emphasized here that the specificity of the Baluba, the superior level of knowledge is the African rationality is to be found in the concept of the *Bwino*, that is, “knowledge-wisdom.” This type of thinking heart. In most Bantu languages, the word knowledge can be generated only by a person who has *heart* (*Mucima* in Kiluba, for example) also stands for *mucima muyampe*, “good or pure heart.” Goodness of thought. A *Muntu wa mucima muyampe* is not only a heart produces knowledge-wisdom, which in turn person with a good heart in the sense of being kind, enables the character development of the knower.

compassionate, and generous but also a person of good Thus, harmonious and peaceful coexistence with all

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 43

African Epistemology——43

human beings (*Bantu*) and all things (*Bintu*) stands The healer uses intellect in the selection of as the fundamental characteristic and criterion of the adequate medicinal plants and in the diagnosis of dis-credibility of knowledge. In this African scheme of ease. In addition, the healer relies on divination, intu-things, epistemology (*Bwino*) and ontology (*Bumuntu*) itive psychological skills, and a religious worldview are inseparable. To know is to foster the victory of that considers disease the result of a combination of goodness over bad character; it is to foster human factors, including unbalanced ethical conduct and flourishing and respect for nature. This is possible broken relationships with nature, the ancestors, spir-only through an act of modesty.

its, and fellow human beings. African epistemology Thus, the African journey to knowledge begins with is grounded in the fundamental belief that reality is an epistemological humility, which is the fundamental one, that is, everything is interconnected in a web belief in the inability of a single individual to know of relationships. There is a fundamental connection the whole truth. As an Akan proverb puts it, “wisdom between the male and female, the living and dead, the is like a baobab tree, a single person’s hand cannot visible and invisible realms, the spiritual and material

embrace it.” More explicitly, an Akan proverb, *Nyansa* spheres, the human and divine realms, humanity and *nni onipa baako ti mu*, states that “wisdom is not in the the natural world, and so on. In this worldview, to head of one person.” This same attitude is found in understand or to know is to grasp the interconnected-Kemet, where the definition of the philosopher, the ness of all things.

Antef Inscription, recalled that the philosopher is not a Thus African epistemology rejects all forms of philosopher merely because he is clear-sighted, but dualism, with the primary dualism being that of the also because he constantly seeks advice from others.

subject and object of study. Rather than separating More specifically, Ptahhotep taught in the 25th century themselves from the object of study, Africans B.C.E. that the sage must consult not only the wise but communicate with what they wish to know. The also the ignorant and the maids at the grindstones, for African becomes tree with the tree, rock with rock, no one reaches the limits of every art and no one water with water, and wind with wind. It is a major should be proud of his or her knowledge. This profes-article of African epistemological faith that compart-sion of ignorance that is the beginning of wisdom mentalization of knowledge and methods generates stems from the acknowledgement of the immensity of intellectual schizophrenia and obscurity—albeit *docta* the cosmos and the limitations of the human mind.

ignorantia. Africans believe that such compartmental-As Birago Diop’s classical poem “Souffles” cap-ization generates partial and disconnected knowledge tures well, the essence of African ontology, the African rather that sound knowledge. Thus they hold that the view of reality, is cosmotheandric—it expresses the best way to know is to use a variety of tools or human interconnectedness of the human and spiritual worlds.

faculties and a variety of methods. Interdisciplinarity To paraphrase the 16th-century Abyssinian philoso-or epistemological dialogue stands at the core of the pher Walda Heywat, the idea is that the distortion of African holistic approach.

any part automatically affects the other parts of the In African societies, the sage is not a person of one whole since the whole universe is interconnected.

wisdom or one knowledge. The sage is sage precisely Likewise, the Yoruba Ifa divination is based on the because of his or her ability to be a psychologist, a assumption that human beings are part of the cosmic teacher, a spiritual master, an artist, an architect, a body, which includes every life form and energy in the thinker, and a good practitioner at the same time. The universe, the balance and harmony of which is indis-wise person is a whole person because of his or her pensable for the health and happiness of every human holistic knowledge and holistic approach to knowl-being. This is why African epistemology rejects the edge. The ontological and cosmological dimensions opposition of the sacred and the profane, as well as the of African knowledge imply also that knowledge is related opposition of spiritual and empirical methods not a mere language game or a pure dialectical enterin the acquisition of knowledge. For Africans, there is tainment. Knowledge is active. Indeed, it is action!

no duality of matter and spirit or of faith and knowl-Because knowledge has an impact on the knower and edge, and no opposition of science and religion. This on reality around the knower, all knowledge is poten-is well illustrated by the African healer, who always tially dangerous and needs to be handled with combines various cognitive modes to achieve a extreme care and precaution. Hence, African episte-successful result.

mology involves an ethical requirement. The pursuit

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 44

44———**African Ethnic Groups**

of knowledge is inseparable from the pursuit of wisdom, for in the African understanding of things, a **AFRICAN ETHNIC GROUPS**

genuine knowledge necessarily involves wisdom. The unwise knower is referred to as a witch.

The continent of Africa contains nearly 2,000 ethnic For Africans, the focus is on not knowledge for groups. This is the largest number of diverse ethnic knowledge's sake but knowledge for humanity's sake.

groups of any continent. Many of the ethnic groups of The purpose of knowledge is to enhance human flour-Africa are larger than European nations. For example, ishing and preserve and promote all other forms of life the Hausa population of Northern Nigeria is larger in the universe. This is why initiation is fundamental.

than the population of the Netherlands, Denmark, It is critical to train human character so that people Sweden, Switzerland, Portugal, or Norway.

can handle knowledge for the benefit of humankind.

Each ethnic group traces its origin to a single In the African worldview, knowledge is not merely a female or male ancestor. Some groups are related to right. With knowledge comes responsibility. The one others through lineage. The Akan group of Ghana and who knows more has more responsibility to care for the Ivory Coast, for instance, is connected to seven others and for the world. Knowledge, in African epis-founding sisters. Each group of Akan has the same set temology, is the path to becoming fully human and of *abusua* as all the others. Some African people trace humane. It is a sine qua non of *Bumuntu*, "authentic their ancestry to only one ancestor. For example, an personhood." A person without knowledge-wisdom is ethnic group such as the Ijaw of Nigeria traces its referred to as *Mufu unanga*, "dead man walking." The ancestry to Woyengi, a female deity.

act of knowing is a process of becoming humane.

Of the hundreds of ethnic groups on the African Where knowledge leads to violence, oppression, and continent, less than 20 can be considered major destruction, Africans speak of *Butchi*, "witchcraft,"

groups in terms of population. Thus, the Yoruba, Ibo, rather than *Bwino*, "knowledge-wisdom."

Hausa, Wolof, Mandinka, Congo, Chokwe, Akan, Kikuyu, Hutu, Oromo, Zulu, Xhosa, and Shona are

— *Mutombo Nkulu-N'Sengha*

among the ethnic groups that are considered significant in their countries. In some modern states, how **FURTHER READING**

these groups are treated and how they treat others determines the fate of national politics.

Asante, Molefi Kete. (1992). *Kemet, Afrocentricity, and A major source of internal political conflict in Knowledge*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This book Africa has been the rivalry between ethnic groups, raises the critical issue of perspective on the African such as the war between the Hutu and Tutsi in East experience and argues that such experience must be apprehended through an African epistemological lens, as Africa. The Hutu and Tutsi populations share the opposed to through the Eurocentric biases that have so same language and the same ancestors, but they have often misrepresented Africa.

had devastating wars. One reason for the animosity Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1981). *Civilisation ou Barbarie*. Paris: might be that the colonial era European powers, *Présence Africaine*. In this book, Diop makes a compelling mainly the Germans and the French, created distinc-case for the reassessment of African early contributions to tions between groups of East Africans in order to human civilization, thus shedding light on the issue of have a buffer population devoted to the colonial African epistemology since ancient times.

Eze, Chukwudi. (1998). *African Philosophy: An Anthology*.

masters.

Oxford, UK: Blackwell. This is a useful reader on major African ethnic groups are no different from ethnic African philosophical issues.

groups on other continents in their relatedness to Gyekye, Kwame. (1995). *An Essay on African Philosophical ancestry*. Just as there are Irish, Scottish, Welsh, and *Thought: The Akan Conceptual Scheme*. Philadelphia: English ethnic groups in the United Kingdom, there Temple University Press. This is an enlightening and are various ethnic groups in African countries. These systematic approach to Akan philosophy, including Akan groups must never be referred to as *tribes*, as this is epistemology.

a pejorative term related to a notion of Africans as Mudimbe, V. Y. (1988). *The Invention of Africa*. Bloomington: Indiana University Press. This is an important book on the uncivilized, primitive, and backward. African ethnic issue of the epistemic violence involved in the construction groups represent culture, customs, and traditions.

of an Africa that never was through the use of Eurocentric and racist categories.

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 45

African Philosophy——45

FURTHER READING

of the day, continue the progress of the liberation movement, and symbolize the determination of the Agyei-Mensah, Samuel. (Ed.). (2003).

Reproduction and Social Context in Sub-Saharan Africa: A Collection of people of Africa to free themselves from foreign Micro-Demographic Studies. Westport, CT: Greenwood domination, exploitation, and all forms of oppression Press. The authors in this volume discuss the role of diver- resulting from colonization and white supremacy.

sity in reproductive behavior in Africa.

African Liberation Day was influential in the defeat of Oheneba-Sakyi, Yaw, and Awusabo-Asare, Kofi. (1999). *Female colonialism and apartheid in South Africa and has Autonomy, Family Decision-Making, and*

Demographic helped to expose imperialism imposed by the United States. Currently the supporters and coordinators of penetrating analysis of the way female autonomy operates in the commemoration of African Liberation Day fight the process of reproduction in Africa.

against dictatorial and corrupt governments, ethnic cleansing, AIDS, exploitation, and various forms of subjugation imposed on people of African descent.

AFRICAN LIBERATION DAY

— *Deborah LaNier*

FURTHER READING

On April 15, 1958, in the city of Accra, Ghana, Hakata, Michelle. (2001). African Liberation Day Marked in African leaders and political activists gathered at Style. *New African*, 398(18), 12–17. This article celebrates the first pan-African conference held in Africa. This the 43rd commemoration of African Liberation Day, in conference, under the auspices of Osagyefo Kwame which the keynote speaker Vivene Younger, a member of the Nkrumah, was attended by representatives of the central committee of the All Africa People's Revolutionary governments of Liberia, Morocco, Libya, Sudan, Party (AAPRP), addressed the continuing political strug-Tunisia, Ethiopia, Ghana, and the United Arab gles of Africans throughout the world. *New African* follows Republic, as well as by representatives of the National selected commemorations of ALD annually.

Liberation Front of Algeria and the Union of the
www.blacknet.com.uk/aaprp BlackNet.com This Web site provides historical information on the origins of African Cameroonian Peoples. In celebration of the first Liberation Day and highlights the main objectives of the collective presence and call for action of this nature on movement.

African soil, April 15 was celebrated as African www.thetalkingdrum.com
This Web site is a resource for Freedom Day for 5 years. Then, on May 25, 1963, the obtaining historical information surrounding the founding leaders of 32 independent African states met in Addis of African Liberation Day. It also contains updates on Ababa, Ethiopia, and at this historic and significant the current political debates and issues for people of meeting, the Organization of African Unity (OAU), African descent and information on

the key leaders and currently known as the African Union, was formed by freedom fighters who have contributed to African struggle for liberation.

and chartered, and the independence of two-thirds of the continent from colonial rule was celebrated. Since that meeting, May 25 has been celebrated everywhere as African Liberation Day (ALD).

AFRICAN PHILOSOPHY

The idea of African Liberation Day was initially born to combat colonialism and the oppression of The Google search engine indicates a strong African African people, and its meaning has since broadened presence in the world of philosophy. Indeed, while to embrace the fight against all of the injustices there is no category for white philosophy in cyber-imposed on people of African descent throughout the space, statistics from February of 2004 indicate world. The spirit of this day is to promote awareness 3,050,000 hits for black philosophy, 1,620,000 hits for and encourage organization worldwide to fight against African philosophy, and 1,220,000 hits for African inherently racist foreign and domestic policies and American philosophy. African philosophy received socioeconomic conditions facing people of African many more hits than Indian philosophy (1,340,000), descent.

Japanese philosophy (1,320,000), Jewish philosophy African Liberation Day was born to honor the (1,300,000), Arab philosophy (367,000), Islamic legacy and continue the struggle of the ancestors, philosophy (644,000), and Spanish philosophy celebrate annually the initial plight of the founders (6,180). African philosophy comes closest in number

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 46

46——African Philosophy

of hits received to Chinese philosophy (1,650,000) What is meant by African philosophy, then, is the and Greek philosophy (1,770,000). Although the pres-specific African way of understanding and explaining ence of African philosophy in cyberspace comes after the world and the drama of the human condition. It is that of major European traditions, the

presence of the systematic effort of the African mind to understand black philosophy surpasses that of British philosophy and stands the world as a meaningful cosmos and to understand-

(2,090,000) and German philosophy (2,610,000) and stand the place and role of human beings and other is equal to the presence of French philosophy creatures in the universe. It is thus a rigorous pursuit (3,050,000). The presence of American philosophy, of truth and a rational search for the meaning of with 5,130,000 hits, reigns supreme in cyberspace.

human existence. African philosophy is at once an Although merely indicative, this presence of philosophical activity of the mind, a way of expression, and a way of philosophical literature in cyberspace points in its own of life based on genuine knowledge and wisdom.

limited way to the presence and influence of African Indeed, it is a way of thinking, speaking, being, and philosophy in today's world. Nowadays, African living wisely. Such an enterprise entails the use of philosophy is part of the regular curriculum in philosophical thinking not to achieve skepticism and philosophy departments in Africa and around the world. And cynicism but to enhance human flourishing. Since yet, just three decades ago, the very notion of the existence-time immemorial, Africa has praised wisdom over time of African philosophy was controversial, and age and titles and maintained that the unexamined many in philosophy departments believed that the life is not worth living. Thus the Baluba, like many rational enterprise of philosophy was incompatible other African people, established a clear distinction with African cultures, if not antithetical to the structure-between *kunena* ("to speak eloquently and wisely") of the African mind itself. Furthermore, in some and *kunenakanya* ("to speak incoherently and corners of the world community, some philosophers unwisely") and between *kulanga* ("to think well") and remain skeptical and suspicious of African rationality, *kulangakanya* ("to think with confusion or to have despite the presence of numerous books, journals, and evil thought"). In fact, the person with a lack of associations of African philosophy. Considerations of knowledge and unwise conduct was regarded in traditional African history, especially of the slave trade and colonial Africa as *kivila*,

kidingidingi, that is, an “empty nihilism, have since 1945 put the following questions well” or a worthless being. Thus according to African at the center of the debate about African philosophy: philosophy, the goal of life is to become humane by What is African philosophy? Who qualifies as an pursuing wisdom.

African philosopher? What makes specific African Throughout the ages, African philosophy has been thought philosophical? What makes a philosophy expressed orally and in written texts, in both African African? However, the history of African philosophy and foreign languages, notably in Latin, Arabic, and its object of study are broader and deeper than this French, English, German, Italian, Portuguese, and preoccupation with relatively recent African history Spanish. Over the last 5,000 years, African philosophy suggests.

has trodden many paths, constantly adapting its method The notion of African philosophy refers simply to and language to the evolution of its object of inquiry, the African love for wisdom, that relentless passion of which constantly changes according to ecological, the African mind to know and to know the truth about economic, political, and cultural circumstances.

human existence and the world. African philosophy is In ancient times, African societies produced their indeed a careful examination of life and of living own philosophers, the sages who articulated their beings. As such, it involves a rational meditation thought in creation myths, proverbs, sapiential folk-on love, suffering, mortality, and immortality. It is a tales, and the ethical vision that governed political, reflection on ways of living a good life and a constant religious, and other social institutions. At that time, questioning of the credibility of institutions created people philosophized entirely in African languages.

for the purpose of achieving such a good life. It It was a philosophy of Africans, by Africans, and for proceeds by way of a methodic, systematic analysis of Africans. It produced African cosmologies such as knowledge and known phenomena, a study of the fun-those of the Yoruba and the Dogon, a vision of human damental questions of human existence, articulated in nature, and a theory of human dignity and human an explicit,

critical, autocritical, and systematic dis-rights; it also produced ethical norms and the wisdom course that is sometimes symbolic and proverbial but of a good life. African investiture speeches embodied very often discursive.

an entire political philosophy, the African vision of the

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 47

African Philosophy——47

meaning and aim of political power, the distinction Written by an obscure Belgian missionary, Placide between a bad ruler (like Kilopwe) and a sage king Tempels, working among the Baluba people of (like Mulopwe), the centrality of the welfare Katanga (now the Democratic Republic of the Congo), of the people in the art of government. In addition, the book articulated the metaphysical and ethical ancient philosophers meditated on metaphysical ques-vision of Baluba wisdom. It was warmly embraced by tions regarding the spiritual world, immortality, and Léopold Sédar Senghor and other prominent figures in the afterlife.

the Négritude movement and adopted by the newly created publishing house Présence Africaine. Writing to approve or disprove the philosophical ideas of the **AFRICAN PHILOSOPHY**

Baluba proposed in the book, which radically chal-IN THE WESTERN MIND

lenged the Western dogmatic monopoly on reason, In modern times, however, colonialism and enslave-armies of philosophers in Europe and Africa engaged ment introduced a rupture with the past, a rupture so into a heated debate that, from 1945 to 1975, produced deep that the very notion of the existence of an the fundamental literature of the contemporary African African philosophy was put into question. The new philosophical discourse.

schools created by the colonial masters and slave-This contemporary African philosophy was largely holders in the 19th and 20th centuries aim

to destroy produced in Western languages by thinkers trained African historical consciousness. Both in Africa and in schools established by Europeans. In response, the in the Americas, Africans and those descended from pan-African and Négritude movements stressed the Africans were taught to regard their past as aphilo-need to decolonize the mind by articulating a way of sophical, irrational, and worthless. Since the tragic philosophizing in tune with ancestral African tradi-encounter between Africa and Europe in the 15th cen-tions and contemporary African concerns. Many ques-tury, almost all the prominent Western philosophers tions emerged in this early period of defining African vigorously denied Africans' ability to think properly.

philosophy, which stretched from 1940 to 1980. First Following in the footsteps of renowned Western and foremost, Africans were asked to prove the philo-philosophers—Hume, Montesquieu, and Voltaire—

sophical quality of African thought to a skeptical Kant, who is celebrated as a paragon of critical think-Western establishment, which controlled publishing ing, denied philosophy to Africans on somatic grounds.

policies and even continued to run the educational Despite the presence of Amo Afer, an African professor system and faculties of philosophy in postcolonial of philosophy, in Germany during his own time, Kant Africa until the 1980s. In this context dominated by wrote of the African man that he “was black from head the hermeneutics of suspicion, whether there could be to toe, a clear proof that what he said was stupid.”

an African philosophy became a focal topic for many After Kant, Hegel, in his *Philosophy of World* articles and books over several years. It was still an *History* (1827), proclaimed ex cathedra that Africans important topic in the 1990s, as publications by were not only outside the kingdom of reason but also Kwame Gyekye in Ghana and Lucius Outlaw in the outside history and outside humanity itself. After United States indicate. In wrestling with this question, Hegel, Lévy-Bruhl, applying Darwin's theory of evolu-African philosophy gained an expertise in the scrutiny tion to the human mind, declared the African mind of the pitfalls and dissonance of Western philosophi-

“prelogic” and radically antithetic to the Western mind.

cal traditions, as well as in the vast semantic field of This epistemic violence, which served as the rational-the concept of philosophy.

ization of the necessity of colonialism, soon provoked a reaction that led to the rise of African contemporary **THE BREADTH OF AFRICAN**

philosophy. Initiated as a literary movement by **PHILOSOPHICAL DISCOURSE**

Africans and those of African descent in the Americas and Europe, this movement was to turn into a powerful Moreover, African philosophers turned to a serious laboratory for new philosophical ideas, which crystal-study of the history of philosophy in Africa, which lized mainly in the Négritude and pan-African move-culminated in the articulation of a comprehensive ments at the beginning of the 20th century.

history of African philosophy going back to pharaonic However, it was the publication of *Bantu Philo-Egypt. The result of the superb research done by sophy in 1945 that generated the most consistent and Cheikh Anta Diop and Theophile Obenga in this field explicit philosophical tradition of modern Africa.*

led to the overthrow of the “Greek miracle” dogma

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 48

48———***African Philosophy***

and the articulation of a fundamental paradigm shift African politics; Martin Bernal, whose work, like that in the history of world philosophy. The question of the of Cheikh Anta Diop and Theophile Obenga, chal-conditions for the possibility of a specific philosophy lenges the Greek miracle ideology; Johannes Fabian, was turned on the West, which had to justify its own who like V. Y. Mudimbe has deconstructed anthropol-originality and rationality in view of new historical ogy and colonial epistemic violence; Jean-Paul Sartre, evidence proving that the founders of Western whose

solidarity with the colonized people and his philosophy—including thinkers like Pythagoras and sophisticated analysis of colonialism and racism has Plato and many other scientists and philosophers—

prompted Mudimbe and some other scholars to had been trained by Egyptian philosophers in Nile welcome him among “African philosophers”; and the Valley schools for many years. The new findings British philosopher Robert Bernasconi, who has done made clear that Western cultural arrogance and Lévy-an analysis of racism in Western philosophy that is Bruhlism were baseless, founded as they were on enlightening and can usefully be read along with myths of Western primacy. As a result, a confident Lucius Outlaw, Cornel West, or Lewis Gordon. Since African philosophy emerged and directed its energy Western philosophers are insiders who have the abil-to productive preoccupation: to think the human ity to better understand the passion of the Western condition in Africa.

mind, those who have for years contributed to While most of the contemporary African philoso-Africans’ struggle for full humanity through a denun-phers are trained professionals, with master’s and/or ciation of colonialism, neocolonialism, imperialism, doctoral degrees in philosophy, and very often profes-and racism or through a genuine study of African sors in departments of philosophy and Black Studies, languages, culture, and wisdom bring a valuable the field of contemporary philosophical discourse is contribution to African philosophy.

*broader than the circle of academics. If what makes a thought philosophical is its substance, then rational **THE AFRICAN***

*and rigorous thinkers are also found outside the often **PHILOSOPHICAL TRADITION***

narrow circle of academic philosophers. Thus significant philosophies are also found among novelists, With regard to the means of expression, Africa has poets, and dramatists, such as Léopold Sédar Senghor, both the tradition of oral philosophy and that of writ-Wole Soyinka, Chinua Achebe, Ngugi wa Th’iongo, ten texts. Although most of the traditional philosophy Sembene Ousmane, Mongo Beti, and many feminist was done orally, there

is also a long tradition of writ-novelists, to name but a few. Philosophy is also found ten texts that goes back to ancient Egypt, where there in the writings of professional theologians whose existed, long before the rise of philosophy in ancient training generally includes many years of philosophi-Greece in the 6th century B.C.E., one of the most cal studies, as well as in the works of professional ancient philosophies in the world. This Kemetic anthropologists, political activists, lawyers, and philosophical tradition flourished from around the artists. Thus, African philosophy exists in a multitude 27th century B.C.E. (in shortest chronology) to the of literary genres. In many libraries, important philo-4th century C.E. Then, during the era of the Roman sophical texts can be found in the sections of religion, Empire, a new tradition flourished in North Africa, anthropology, art, and literature in addition to on the led by thinkers converted to Christianity, such as shelves in the philosophy section or in philosophical Saint Augustine. The Islamic University of Sankore in journals. Likewise, the question of authorship is not Timbuktu flourished from the Middle Ages into the limited by birth certificate or somatic complexion. As 17th century and produced powerful thinkers like recent anthologies of African philosophy edited by professor Ahmed Baba (1556–1627), who wrote more Emmanuel Chukwudi Eze and other Africans attest, than 40 books on subjects as diverse as philosophy, the African philosophers include thinkers of African theology, astronomy, and biography.

descent in Europe and the Americas, as well as the Among the many scholars at the University of white, Western coalition of those willing to write on Sankore during the 15th and 16th centuries were the subject.

Mohammed el-Mrili (a professor of law), Ahmed ben Indeed, this latter category includes scholars such Said (a professor of logic), and Ben Mohammed Aquit as the British Africanist Basil Davidson, who has (a professor of logic). As a jurist, philosopher, and written about the African philosophy of history and theologian, Ahmed Baba confronted the issue of

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 49

slavery in the Islamic context. He challenged the legal **THE PHILOSOPHY'S**

and theological arguments used at the time to justify **RENDEZVOUS WITH THE WEST**

the practice of enslavement. Unlike the Moroccan jurist al-Wansharisi, Ahmad Baba placed the burden in the century of the Enlightenment, African philosophy of proof not on the slave but on the slavedealer, who was still in the process of discovering its correct must prove his lawful right of ownership of the slave path. The Western world had a rendezvous with African he offers for sale. To the question "Can one take the philosophy with Amos Guinea Afer (1703–after 1753), word of an enslaved person?" that many Arabic jurists Edward Wilmot Blyden (1832–1912), and Olaudah answered "No," Ahmad Baba replied with a firm and Equiano (1745–1797). These African authors grew up documented "Yes." With regard to theological arguin the Western world and used their knowledge of the ments, he dismissed the story that the black person Western languages and writing system to articulate a could not create philosophy. Ahmad Baba was an systematic view of the African conception of freedom avowed believer in the capabilities of all humans, and and human rights by denouncing theories and prac-as a black man himself, he thoroughly understood the tices they considered to be harmful to human dignity issues of his day. Despite the limitations imposed by and human aspiration to happiness. While Baba his condition as a Muslim, Baba contributed in his struggled for African dignity in the Islamic world, own way to the articulation of an African philosophy Afer, who became known as Anthony William Amo, of human rights.

had to face the question of the enslavement of Africans in the Western Christian world. Coming from a Christian perspective, Amo used his studies of **The Ethiopian Tradition**

Western philosophy to articulate a doctrine on the In the 16th and 17th centuries, a rationalistic philo-rights of black people in Europe. With two doctorates, sophical tradition flourished in Ethiopia with authors in philosophy and law, and in 1738 having authored such as Zär'a Yacob or Zera Yagob (1592–1685), a *Tractatus de Arte Sobrie et Accurate*

Philosophandi, a contemporary of René Descartes (1596–1650) whose book on logic and epistemology, Amo was the first book Hatata (meaning “Analysis” or “Treatise”) African philosopher of modern times. In the very era clearly deals with a rationalistic philosophy. Zera of the Enlightenment, this contemporary of Kant began his journey toward knowledge by identifying the studied and thought philosophy in Europe.

obstacles that hinder humans’ effort to know the truth.

Amo was born in Axim, in the region of Ghana, Zera observed that because the knowing process is a and arrived in 1707 in the Netherlands, where he was difficult labor, people “shy from any critical examina-baptized a year later in the Lutheran church at tion” and “hastily accept what they have heard from Brunswich-Wolffenbüttel. In his dissertation for his their fathers.” Thus Zera adopted criticism as the initial doctorate of law, which he defended in 1729 at the step toward knowledge, followed by steps such as University of Halle in the Netherlands, Amo already analysis (Hatata), inquiry, and the light of reason and revealed his concern for the human rights of Africans.

the goodness of the created things, as the basis of his The title of his dissertation, Dissertatio Inauguralis de cognitive method. The Baluba Bwino epistemology Jure Maurorum in Europa, makes this clear. After law, agrees with this Zera’s Hatata epistemology, as does he studied philosophy, first at the University of Halle the Ofamfa-Matemasie epistemology of the Akan. The and then at the University of Wittenberg in Germany, Akan people used the artistic Adinkra symbol to where in 1734 he defended his dissertation, De express their love for the wisdom of critical thinking.

Humanae Mentis Apatheia, written under Martin They used the symbol called Ofamfa or Pempan Löscher. Amo’s philosophy of liberty can best be Hwemu Dua, which literally means “search rod” or appreciated by juxtaposing it with the philosophy

“measuring rod” and stands for “critical examination during that same period of another African, Jacobus and excellence.” Aware of the pitfalls of cold logic and Capitein, who wrote and publicly defended at Leiden excessive rationalism, they added to Ofamfa another University in the

Netherlands a thesis affirming that epistemological dimension called Matemasie, the sym-there is no opposition between slavery and Christian bol of “wisdom and insight,” thus making it clear that freedom.

the purpose of knowledge is to ensure a good life for In England in the late 1780s, the brilliant writer oneself and the community.

Olaudah Equiano (1745–1797), who was originally

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 50

50——African Philosophy

from West Africa, used his familiarity with the wealth of traditional wisdom, which constitutes a English language and culture to write a book public-precious source of information for younger genera-cizing the evils of the slave trade and strongly con-tions of philosophers.

demning the system of slavery. Contrary to Hegel’s Historians of African philosophy have attempted conception of slavery, Equiano argued for the African various classifications of dominant trends, from traditional sense of human dignity and moral values.

ethnophilosophy to hermeneutical philosophy. Others Decades later, in the 19th century, the philosophical have spoken of African humanism, Négritude, pan-scene was occupied by a brilliant elite from the Africanism, nationalism, political philosophy, critical Americas, people like Edward Wilmot Blyden philosophy, sagacity, and many more. These are all (1832–1912), Marcus Garvey (1887–1940), and facets of an epistemic tradition that carries the strug-W.E.B. Du Bois (1868–1963).

gle of Africans for full humanity. These ways of think-After World War II, a new elite emerged in Africa ing often overlap and can even be found in the work to carry on the articulation of African philosophy.

of a single author. Because of the mortal danger to While Kwame Nkrumah’s pan-Africanism stimulated Africans of Western domination and local tyrannical thought in English-speaking countries, in Francophone

regimes, contemporary African philosophy has Africa, the creation of Présence Africaine in 1947 and focused on themes pertaining to political philosophy, the Société Africaine de Culture spread the impact of ethics, and the philosophy of history. It thus wrestles, the Négritude movement, and with it Bantu philosophy—among other things, with the issues of personhood, philosophy. Kwame Nkrumah's book Towards Colonial cultural alienation, and the search for an authentically Freedom (1947), Aimé Césaire's Discours sur le African mode of being and becoming humane. It Colonialisme (1950), and Frantz Fanon's Peau Noire, denounces human rights violations, racism, colonial-Masques Blancs (1952) played a crucial role in the ism, neocolonialism, dictatorship, and sexism, and its articulation of an African philosophy of human rights.

struggles to articulate a path for African renaissance Nigeria, Ghana, Senegal, Cameroon, Kenya, and for African survival and global peace in a world Uganda, and the Democratic Republic of the Congo where machines and a heartless global market tend to become major centers of philosophical production overcome genuine humanism.

between 1969 and 1990. It is worth noting that in the Although a small number of agnostics, such as postcolonial era, beginning in the 1970s, the critique Okot p'Bitek and V. Y. Mudimbe, have emerged in of colonialism, neocolonialism, imperialism, and contemporary African philosophy, religion remains racism turned progressively into a critique of African generally inseparable from the African philosophical sources of estrangement, notably postcolonial tyranni-tradition because of the central role that it plays in cal regimes. At the same time, the struggle for intel-African lives. However, in a land where Africans have lectual and spiritual decolonization of the African been religiously abused, a critical evaluation of reli-mind continued. This early trend, which was inaugu-gious practice has become indispensable to the credi-rated by Stefano Kaoze, well before Placide Tempels, bility of faith itself. Thus a rich philosophy of produced vigorous thinkers like Alexis Kagame, religion—articulated by Fabien Eboussi Boulaga, Vincent Mulago, and John Mbiti, who turned toward V. Y. Mudimbe, John Mbiti, Jean Marc Ela, Bimwenyi the traditional wisdom contained in proverbs, folk-Kweshi, Engelbert Mveng, Chinua Achebe, Cheikh tales, and other traditional institutions to articulate a Hamidou

Kane, and Mongo Beti—has largely con-typically African perspective on the world. Although a tributed to the Africanization of Christianity, as well younger postmodernist and postcolonial generation, as to the purification of both African traditional reli-which includes such thinkers as Paul Hountondji and gions and the bourgeois and colonialist Christianity Marcien Towa, has mockingly referred to this trend supported by Western governments and their missionas “ethnophilosophy,” contemporary philosophers’

ary agents. The fact that the wealthy continent of reconciliation of modern thought with African tradi-Africa, blessed with all kinds of natural resources, has tional wisdom has enabled them to productively move one of the poorest populations in the world, while beyond a mere repetition of Western philosophical African wealth languishes in Western banks, consti-theories. Thus, in their writings, Alexis Kagame, tutes one of the most dramatic challenges to Western Vincent Mulago, Léopold Senghor, Hampate Ba, and Christian solidarity with Africa. It clearly appears that Birago Diop have brought back to academic life a Africa needs justice and not charity. Here the global

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 51

African Philosophy——51

religious charity rhetoric has become too problematic others. In addition, the recent phenomenon of for a continent where people have become beggars, nonviolent political struggle through a broad national nationalists without nations and capitalists without dialogue, popularized under the concept of the capital.

national conference, is already generating a new trend The fundamental philosophical question raised referred to as Bumuntu philosophy or humanism of here is whether faith and reason can be reconciled in the third millennium.

a land so fond of harmony and balance. It seems that The peculiarity of the African mode of philoso-a sine qua non condition for the credibility of faith in phizing consists in the focus on balance, harmony, and Africa requires a

careful scrutiny of the relationship a holistic vision of the world. Thus African philosophy does not reject religious worldviews, nor does it of nations. On the other hand, the poet Birago Diop privilege a narrow rationalism. In Africa, philosophy introduced to the world the nobility of African tradition is not an art for art's sake, but rather, a serious reflection on how to enhance human flourishing. This is

“Souffles” that most essential notion of cosmopolitanism—why the governing principles of African philosophy, which characterizes the African spiritual are *Bumi* (life), *Bumuntu* (a genuine way of being worldview and constitutes the metaphysical foundation humane), hospitality, and solidarity. In the 21st century, of those noble African virtues of solidarity and unity—the dangers constituted by globalization and the rise of universal hospitality. Honoring these values requires a of terrorism and counterterrorism are likely to generate philosophical critique of some obscurantist aspects of a new trend in African philosophy, a trend that African social life, from tribalism to blind nationalism will enlarge the concept of terrorism to include the and from crass materialism to sexism.

violence of global marketers and the Machiavellian warlords of world politics. Although contemporary philosophical discourse

is still overwhelmingly dominated by male thinkers, the traditional dialectical challenge to patriarchy and **AFRICAN PHILOSOPHY AND RELIGION**

sexism has been taken up by a progressively growing generation of feminist philosophers. Creative thinkers In the field of the philosophy of religion, there is a need like Tanella Boni (from the Ivory Coast), Awa Thiam to articulate an African critique of “just war” ideologies (from Senegal), Sophie Oluwole (from Nigeria), and to formulate a vision of African self-defense in the Marie Pauline Eboh (from Nigeria), and Mercy Amba Oduyoye (from Nigeria) are proudly carrying the torch of women's liberation inspired by traditional African polemiology. Its challenge will be to find African values.

an alternative to the Machiavellian ethos of modern The study of traditional culture has enhanced real politik and to the war ethic of Pax Romana aesthetics. The environmental crisis of the planet, the related in the famous militarist dogma of Flavius looting of African minerals and forests, the pollution Vegetius Renatus: *Qui desiderat pacem, praeparet* of African air and water by modern industries, and the *bellum*. The notion that war is a necessary tool for dumping in Africa of nuclear and other toxic waste by bringing peace, and that in war violence itself foreign corporations has led to the rise of an ecologi-becomes the highest form of love, was characteristic cal philosophical discourse. Although still in the mak-of Hitler's philosophers, as Kurt Flasch reminds us in ing, this thinking has already generated a profound his enlightening *Die Geistige Mobilmachung; Die critique of science and technology and a reflection Deutschen Intellektuellen und der Erste Weltkrieg*. But on traditional sciences and technologies. Such critical Africa, the cradle of humanity, has other philosophi-thinking is likely to produce a vigorous African phical commitments. And rightly so. In this highly com-losophy of science. Likewise, in light of the deepening petitive global village, in this era of perpetual human crisis generated by the global market and arms war for perpetual peace, African survival itself is at industries, African thinkers are now turning toward stake, and so is the credibility of African modes of the ancestral notion of personhood and creating a philosophizing.

powerful African humanism based on the notion of In this era of global economic and political turbu-Bumuntu. This notion inspired the South African lences, in this world where nations come together to Peace and Reconciliation commissions, among ensure their economic and political survival, the early

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 52

52———African Philosophy

philosophical dream of African unity articulated its prophetic gadfly role, remains and will continue to by pan-Africanist thinkers acquires a greater signifi-be disseminating the noblest expressions of African cance. Cesaire's *Discourse on Colonialism* (1950), love of wisdom, for humans continue to

philosophize Patrice Lumumba's political thought, and Nkrumah's to know how to live carefully and meaningfully.

conscientism and critique of imperialism are of great Finally, it should be noted that the contribution value, as this is an imperial era. The vision of a new of African philosophy to the world is already felt, political order envisaged by Nyerere's Ujamaa and the especially in the field of philosophy of history. The African humanism of Kaunda are also worthy of con-rediscovery of Kemetic philosophy, and the acknowl-sideration. For it is self-evident that no real salvation edgment that Pythagoras, Plato, and some early Greek can come from Western ideologies of communism, philosophers studied in Egypt, has revolutionized our Marxism, or selfish capitalism. The African tradi-understanding of the global history of philosophy and tional virtues of hospitality and solidarity call for the challenged the dualistic view articulated by thinkers creation of a new world order. And in this context, the such as Lévy-Bruhl, Kant, Hegel, Gobineau, and ideology of pan-Africanism needs to be reshaped. It Voltaire regarding Africans' ability for philosophical is worth recalling that African philosophy has been reasoning. Thus, African philosophy has challenged pan-African since its very inception in the modern many of the Western assumptions regarding non-era. Both the pan-Africanism of Nkrumah and the European people, and in so doing, it has contributed Négritude of Senghor drew from the vitality of to the decolonization of knowledge in general and thinkers from the Americas. Since the 1990s, Asante's philosophical knowledge in particular. The challenge Afrocentricity—the vigorous philosophical move-for Africa, as for many people around the world, is ment that originated in the United States and has now how to build a peaceful global village. African now globally popularized the vision of Cheikh Anta suffering; the genius of African languages (which are Diop—has followed in the footsteps of pan-Africanism.

gender inclusive); the traditional values of commu-Afrocentricity has contributed to the dismantling of the nity, interdependence, interconnectedness, solidarity, Greek miracle ideology and the decolonization of the and hospitality; the respect for nature and for spiritual history of philosophy.

values; the respect for life; and the wisdom of African proverbs constitute an important asset for a new way of philosophizing so needed at the present time.

AFRICAN PHILOSOPHY

IN THE AMERICAN CONTEXT

— *Mutombo Nkulu-N'Sengha*

Today, the United States constitutes one of the major centers, perhaps the most significant center, of African **FURTHER READING**

philosophical production. This intellectual relation-Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1991). *Civilization or Barbarism: An ship among Africa, Europe, and America*, which con-Authentic Anthropology. New York: Lawrence Hill Books.

tributed to the dismantling of the system of the slave Published toward the end of his life, this book contains the trade as well as the defeat of colonialism, is perhaps refined synthesis of Diop's philosophy of world history, the only chance to face the dangers of this new era which is radically antithetical to Hegel's philosophy of history.

of global empires. To reread Du Bois, Nkrumah, Hountondji, Paulin J. (1996). *African Philosophy: Myth or Lumumba*, Cabral, and Fanon in the light of current *Reality?* Bloomington: Indiana University Press. A bril-state of world affairs implies a reexamination of some liantly controversial thinker, Hountondji joined the French of the premises of the current trend of postmodernism, establishment in rejecting the philosophical value of for it is too obvious that in this imperial era, where African traditional thought. His vitriolic attack against the 18th- and 19th-century rhetoric has come back to the founding fathers of African philosophy (i.e., the generation fore, there is nothing "post" in the dominant postcolo-of Alexis Kagame) left many wondering whether African philosophy was facing a "colonial backlash" disguised as nial discourse of our time, especially when we recall postcolonialism.

that postcolonies are to a certain extent none other Mudimbe, V. Y. (1988). *The Invention of Africa: Gnosis, than an Africanization of Western colonies. In other Philosophy, and the Order of Knowledge*. Bloomington: words, the fundamental deconstructionist task of Indiana University Press. This book articulates a radical African philosophy and its hermeneutics of suspicion, deconstruction of the pitfalls of modern anthropology and

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 53

African Renaissance——53

the social sciences, which have largely contributed to the idea of creating the foundation for a renaissance in invention of the idea of a primitive and prelogical Africa.

African thinking. Over time, they attracted hundreds Tempels, Placide. (1969). *Bantu Philosophy*. Paris: Présence of students to their seminars and published many Africaine. This book contains the confession of a mission-books in support of the African Renaissance move-ary who went to Africa with a mindset shaped by colonial ment. Among the activities of the African Renaissance theories of evolution and the ethnological mythology of Lévy-Bruhl, and who was surprised that the image of group is the publication of the journal *ANKH*, the Africa that was inculcated in him in Europe was totally leading journal in the study of Kemet in the African false. Tempels's acknowledgment of the existence of world. *ANKH* has defended the positions outlined by African rationality and a sophisticated sense of morality Cheikh Anta Diop in his earlier works on the African challenged the very foundation of the colonial regime origin of civilization and advanced a pan-African which was based on the civilizing mission ideology.

study of the connectedness of African languages to the Although still shaped by the colonial Hegelian paradigm, Nile Valley civilizations.

this book contributed to African philosophical discourse by challenging the distortion of knowledge by “scholars of African Renaissance promoter Salomon Mezepo, colonial empires.”

an architect and the publisher of Menaibuc Editions, emerged as a leading personality in the promotion of the work of the African Renaissance movement.

Menaibuc published the writings and scholarship of the **AFRICAN RENAISSANCE**

major African Renaissance scholars, such as Theophile Obenga, Jean Philippe Omotunde, Ama Mazama, African Renaissance is the name of an intellectual Nzue Paulin Carlos Mozer, Gregoire Biyogo, and movement with the purpose of expanding and pro-others. A principal scholar and teacher in the African moting the ideas of Cheikh Anta Diop. The movement Renaissance school is Jean Philippe Omotunde, who was founded in the early 1990s in Paris by professor embarked on a campaign to reeducate the French Theophile Obenga and nuclear physicist Cheikh public about the African origin of civilization. Like M'Backe Diop, the son of Cheikh Anta Diop. In Obenga, his major teacher, Omotunde gathered many 1948, Cheikh Anta Diop had called for an African facts of African history and culture and presented them Renaissance based on the values and constructs of in powerful analytical and critical works.

African reality. The African Renaissance movement African Renaissance is linked with the Afrocentricity is thus related to the Afrocentricity movement in intellectual movement, the Temple Circle, and other its determination to define African ideas and ideals groups and scholars interested in classical civilizations, from an African perspective. Furthermore, like African advancement, and the general rise of humanity.

Afrocentricity, the African Renaissance movement Each year members of the African Renaissance join in views ancient Kemet as the starting place for all dis-the academic conference held in Philadelphia that is cussions of culture and language in the African world.

dedicated to Cheikh Anta Diop.

Under the direction and tutelage of Theophile

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

Obenga, the African Renaissance group in Paris organized themselves into a school devoted to teaching and publishing Afrocentric scholarship. Cheikh M'Backe **FURTHER READING**

Diop used his scientific background to advance the Asante, Molefi Kete. (1998). *The Painful Demise of work of the group*. The combination of the efforts and *Eurocentrism*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is a talents of African linguist, historian, and philosopher response to the critics of Afrocentricity, as well as an Theophile Obenga and nuclear physicist Cheikh advancement of the idea that Europe refuses to see that its M'Backe Diop contributed to African Renaissance hegemony is unnatural and unsustainable. Asante responds becoming a major instrument in the dissemination of to Stephen Howe, Mary Lefkowitz, and other anti-African scholars.

Afrocentric ideas in the Francophone world.

Diop, Cheikh M'Backe. (2003). *Cheikh Anta Diop: L'Homme* In the beginning, a core group of 8 to 12 intellectu-et l'Oeuvre. Paris: Présence Africaine. This is the definitive als, professionals in such fields as education, science, work on the greatest African intellectual of the 20th century.

communication, and computer science, started meet-Written by the nuclear physicist Cheikh M'Backe Diop, the ing twice a month in Paris at the Sorbonne with the son of Cheikh Anta Diop, this book is not a sentimental

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 54

54———**African Studies Association**

work, but one that deals concretely with the entire corpus
HERSKOVITS'S VISION

of this outstanding African scholar.

Obenga, Theophile. (2001). *Le Sens de la lutte contre* However, Herskovits's vision of the association as *l'africanisme eurocentriste*. Paris:

L'Harmattan and Gif sur Yvette, France: Khepera. This is a powerful discussion of scholars for scholarly purposes did not have the racism that emerges in the writings of several leading support of the entire membership of the association.

French scholars when they approach the study of ancient The African and African American membership, in Egypt. Obenga responds to the attacks on Afrocentricity particular, disagreed with Herskovits. Their major and African Renaissance scholarship by Fauvelle-Aymar, argument was that their scholarly production ought to Chretien, Perrot, Walker, and other anti-Afrocentric authors.

have some form of connection to the larger society in which the African Studies Association exists. Indeed, Herskovits's preference was to engage the world in his **AFRICAN STUDIES ASSOCIATION**

writings rather than through the association. He has done this eloquently by using his research on the African kingdom of Dahomey and African roots of The African Studies Association (ASA) was formed African American culture to engage racial ideas about at a conference in New York in March of 1957 as a Africa and an orchestrated mainstream erroneous nonprofit organization open to all individuals and projection of Africans and African Americans.

institutions interested in African affairs. There were Herskovits's actions as the president of the African 35 Africanists who attended the conference, including Studies Association were, however, contradictory to the association founder Melville F. Herskovits. The major ideas in his scholarly works. The climax of this contra-objectives of the conference were to bring together diction was his role in helping to deny funding to pan-people with a scholarly and professional interest in Africanist W.E.B. Du Bois's *Encyclopedia Africana* Africa, to improve communication among Africanists, project, while offering the association's full assistance to collect and disseminate information on Africa, and to the CIA's Allen Dulles in his projects in Africa.

to stimulate research on Africa. The majority of the Scholars were critical of his actions as the greatest ASA membership is in the United States, with

smaller affront to the institutionalization of African Studies numbers in Canada, Asia, Europe, and Africa. Most since the birth of ASA in the 1950s and the 1960s.

members are teachers and researchers associated with Herskovits's actions were interpreted by African institutions of higher learning. The membership Americans as an attempt at eliminating competing includes individuals with careers in international forms of scholarship on Africa, in this case, the pan-development and health, foreign affairs, government Africanist element. Thus, it has been speculated that service, K-12 education, and church and social work.

perhaps Herskovits used his position as the African The African Studies Association held its first Studies Association president to undermine Du Bois's annual meeting at Northwestern University in *Encyclopedia Africana* project because of his concern Evanston, Illinois, in September of 1958. The regis-that pan-African scholarship would generate racial ten-tered fellows of the association, as they were then sion and increase his marginality as a white Africanist.

called, numbered 90. Among these association members were 24 women and several African and African American scholars. The others were predom-CONTROVERSY AND TURMOIL

inantly white Africanists. As the first president of the association, Herskovits explained its creation as an Since the 1950s and the 1960s, there have been opportunity to enhance communication among schol-debates and discussions about how the African ars who had a sustained interest in Africa. In the over Studies Association should be run. At the heart of the 4 decades of its existence, Herskovits's ideas about events that shook the 1969 annual meeting of the asso-the purpose of the African Studies Association have ciation in Montreal, Canada, was the question of who been realized through the spreading of an association within African Studies should have the power to that every year brings together scholars to exchange define the content of the new directions for the field.

ideas about their research findings and analyses and to Herskovits's contradictory extremes led to an engag-rekindle their sense of kinship with

those with whom ing debate about who should define the scholarly stan-
they share an interest in Africa.

dards of African Studies, and how those who held

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 55

African Studies Association——55

power within the association were using their positions **EFFORTS AT
RECOVERY**

to limit and control the activities of individual scholars within the
association.

In the mid-1990s, the African Studies Association At the climax of the crisis
in the African Studies decided to grapple with the concerns and issues that
Association, a group within the ASA known as the had dogged it since the
1960s, so the association Black Caucus urged the association to depart from
began a self-conscious evaluation of its program and Herskovits's
formulation charter, which defined the individual scholars. At the fore of the
criticism of association as a marketplace of intellectual ideas set the ASA
was its lack of relevance to Africanist schol-apart from the political
atmosphere of the existing ars on the African continent. The Africanist
scholar-environment. The group also responded to the fact ship on Africa
reflected in the work of ASA's that in 1969 only one black person was
holding a members seemed to distance itself from African decision-making
position in an association whose continental realities. The inability of the
Africanist dealings were predominantly about black people, their scholars
to work in harmony with their African countries, and their societies. Thus
the Black Caucus colleagues in an atmosphere of mutual respect
specifically implored the association to promptly resulted in the
association's failure to achieve one of broaden the participation of black
people in all phases its major goals of building bridges between its of its
modus operandi.

research communities.

The crisis in the African Studies Association, The African Studies Association sponsors an which had been intense, reached its peak when the annual meeting, which provides an occasion for proceedings were interrupted by African and African panels, plenary sessions, discussion groups, exhibits, American scholars who staged a walkout from the and films. The meeting is held in different regions of meeting. The entire Montreal meeting was given over North America in cooperation with major colleges, to arguments regarding the loyalties and priorities that universities, museums, and other institutions, and Africanist scholars should adopt. The fallout from participants attend from America, Africa, Asia, and these discussions resulted in the formation of a new Europe. With an average attendance of 1,300, the organization by those who were not content with the association's annual meeting has become one of the priorities of the African Studies Association. Led by largest annual gatherings of Africanists in the world.

John Henrik Clarke, the pan-Africanist Black Caucus Today, the association represents a diverse group of of the African Studies Association moved to form the people interested in Africa and the African people.

African Heritage Studies Association (AHSA). PanThe association also provides information and support Africanist scholars formed the AHSA specifically to services to the Africanist community. Four ASA peri-further build on and expand the previous tradition of odicals are currently produced annually: *African* African scholarship and research, a major component *Issues* (formerly *Issue: A Journal of Opinion*), *ASA* of African Studies that had been ignored by the *News*, *African Studies Review*, and *History in Africa*.

association.

The African Studies Association continues to The precarious nature of the ASA membership's search for better ways to respond to the issues, ques-discussions and the split that continued for many tions, and concerns that emerged in the late 1960s and months after the Montreal conference are indicative were later revisited and readdressed in the late 1990s.

of the volatility of the debate about how the African Such issues include the initiation of specific steps to Studies Association should operate. As challenging as engage African Americans in the association, as indi-those times were, they actually forced the association cated in its resolution of 1970, and the adjustment of to examine difficult but necessary questions that its operative structures to establish collaboration and required collective intellectual engagement. In the cooperation as a means to bridge the divide between 1970s and early 1980s, the association moved to initi-American scholars of Africa in the United States and ate the dawn of a new era of activism. The ASA's their African colleagues in Africa. The resolve to cast board of directors passed several resolutions that away the negative legacies of the past and initiate a reflected the association's sensitivity to diverse issues, new course for the association is being pursued and with the need to promote greater interest in African sustained in the overall interest of African Studies Studies among African Americans as a top priority of and Black Studies. This resolve is capable of meeting their new agenda.

the needs of current dynamic trends because it is

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 56

56———**African Worldview Theory**

rooted in pan-Africanism—the only perspective that can promote the broad, self-consciously inclusive **AFRICAN WORLDVIEW THEORY**

approach to the association that is required to put it on the right course.

The African worldview theory is essentially a combi-One of the major objectives of the African Studies nation of the classical and contemporary, continental Association has been to promote the teaching of and diasporic African overarching outlook on human African Studies as an academic discipline. This has experience and the natural and phenomenal world.

been achieved to a large extent. The number of It is distinguished from the worldviews of other African Studies programs in U.S. institutions has peoples in so far as it is grounded in and grows out of increased dramatically since the founding of the African history and culture. African

peoples' beliefs African Studies Association, and many of the institu- about God, nature, and major life rituals—such as tions have been carrying out extensive research on birth, puberty, adulthood, marriage, elderhood, and Africa. African Studies will continue to grow more death—exhibit enough commonalities to warrant rapidly as African nations increasingly strive to exert being called an African worldview. These commonal-their influence on the world. ASA is hosted by ities in many areas of the life-worlds and lived Rutgers, the State University of New Jersey in New experiences of African peoples render interminable Brunswick, New Jersey. ASA is currently a member philosophical disputes and semantic discussions as to of three organizations: the American Council of whether there exists a general or universal African Learned Societies (ACLSA), the National Humanities worldview utterly unnecessary and unrewarding. One Alliance, and the National Council of Area Studies can know the African worldview by knowing what Association (NCASA). In addition, the association tasks are performed by a discussion of it.

has a close relationship with the Association of The key tasks in any discussion of the African African Studies Programs.

worldview are to bring to the fore what African worldview theorists mean by commonalities in African cul-

— *David Shachia Agum*

tures and societies and to lay bare, in a critical and culturally grounded fashion, what many of these the-FURTHER READING

orists are pointing to in their discussions of differences in and among the various African cultures and Clarke, John Henrik. (1969). "Confrontation at Montreal."

African Studies Newsletter, 2/6(7), 7–13. This article exten-societies.

sively discusses the crisis that rocked the African Studies Association and the proceedings at its 1969 annual meeting **CONTENTIONS OF COMMONALITIES**

in Montreal.

Fraser, Gerald C. (1969). Black Caucus Deliberations at Worldview theory is at work in all other cultures and Montreal: Who Should Control African Studies and For societies, as a people cannot survive, and certainly What Ends? *Africa Report*, 1, 20–21. Fraser discusses the cannot flourish, without creating and transgenera-contentious issues raised about Black Studies at the African tionally passing on systems and traditions of thinking Studies Association Meeting in Montreal.

(philosophy), belief (spirituality and/or religion), and Greene, Sandra E. (1999). Symbols and Social Activism: An values (axiology) that enable them to cope with the Agenda for African Studies and the ASA for the 21st specific sociohistorical and cultural challenges of Century. *African Studies Review*, 42(2), 1–14. This essay examines the history of the African Studies Association and their milieu. In the classical world, African people laid its engagement with the debates, concerns, and issues that the foundation for human culture and civilization and, have generated both tensions and creative energy within the throughout the continent, developed societies that association since its beginning.

rested on and revolved around similar systems of Robinson, David. (1994). The African Studies Association at thought, belief, and values.

Age 35: Presidential Address to the 1993 African Studies In the contemporary African world, which includes Association Annual Meeting. *African Studies Review*, both continental and diasporic African peoples and 37(2), 1–11. This essay is a critical review of the history of cultures, major challenges and common experiences the African Studies Association and its various attempts to address the controversial issues confronting it.

have emanated from, among other issues, African www.africanstudies.org This is the official Web site of the enslavement, the African Holocaust (*maangamiz* in African Studies Association.

Kiswahili), and the subsequent colonization of

African peoples both on and off of the African is clear to all that enslavement, holocaust, and continent. The similarities—though, to be sure, not colonization have had an indelible impact on the way identical nature—of the various thought, belief, and contemporary theorists and laypersons alike approach value systems of continental and diasporic African and interpret classical and contemporary, continental peoples have led many theorists to argue that there is and diasporic Africa. African worldview theory accen-indeed an African worldview. This worldview consti-tuates the challenges of theorizing modern Africa.

tutes a combined continental and diasporic African What it means to be African in the modern moment perspective on life that sums up what Africans know is inextricably bound up with classical and contem-about the world; how Africans evaluate the world, porary, continental and diasporic African history and both rationally and emotionally; and how Africans culture, as well as philosophical, spiritual, and axio-respond to the world volitionally.

logical African traditions.

— *Reiland Rabaka*

DISCOURSE ON DIFFERENCES

FURTHER READING

Also important in terms of discussing the African worldview is the discourse on differences within Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1974). *The African Origin of Civilization: African cultures and societies. This discourse, which Myth or Reality*. Chicago: Lawrence Hill Books. This book generally compares and contrasts classical continental outlines in an authoritative way the contributions of Africans to human civilizations.

with contemporary diasporic African experiences, Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1978). *The Cultural Unity of Black* often argues that too much attention is paid to the *Africa*. Chicago: Third World Press. In this book, Diop

commonalities of African peoples and cultures, with-makes a compelling case for the fundamental underlying out serious, substantiated social scientific investiga-cultural unity of African people.

tions of the differences among these diverse groups.

Du Bois, W.E.B. (1986). *Du Bois: Writings* ((Nathan Irvin It is often argued that the phenomenal diversity of Huggins, Ed.). New York: Library of America Press. This African life experiences, both before and after the book outlines Du Bois's seminal thinking on the meaning of blackness for Africans in the diaspora.

African enslavement, holocaust, and colonization, did Gyekye, Kwame. (1996). *African Cultural Values: An* not simply problematize the unification of Africans *Introduction*. Elkins Park, PA: Sankofa. Gyekye presents but also made assertions of a collective worldview an insightful overview of African cultural commonalities.

among African peoples seem utterly untenable.

Mbiti, John S. (1989). *African Religions and Philosophy*.

However, the African worldview theorists argue London: Heinemann. This remains the authoritative text of that their assertions are indeed sound and not any dif-African religions and philosophy. Mbiti compares and conferent from those of the many Western European trasts a great number of African cultural groups and cogently worldview theorists who, for example, utilize ancient identifies African religious and spiritual universals.

Soyinka, Wole. (1985). The African World and the Greco-Roman culture and civilization as the model Ethnocultural Debate. In Molefi Kete Asante and Kariamu and mean by which to measure European modern cul-Welsh-Asante (Eds.), *African Culture: The Rhythms of* ture and civilization. Why is it, the African worldview *Unity*. Westport, CT: Greenwood Press. Soyinka discusses theorists ask, that persons of European descent born the complexities of African identity as a result of slavery and bred as far away from Europe as the United States and colonization.

can look to ancient Greece and Rome as their cosmological and cultural foundation, but persons of African descent who turn to ancient Egypt, Ethiopia, or Nubia **AFRICANA WOMANISM**

are accused of myth making and made a mockery of?

Africana womanism is a theory developed by scholar Clenora Hudson-Weems in the late 1980s to deal with **THE CLASSICAL AND**

African women's issues from an Afrocentric perspective-**CONTEMPORARY, CONTINENTAL**

tive. Indeed, at the heart of the Africana womanist **AND DIASPORIC AFRICAN WORLDVIEW**

theory lies the assertion that a true understanding of Although some scholars agree and others disagree the nature of the relationship between African men with the basic premise of African worldview theory, it and women requires a thorough understanding of and

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 58

58———**Africological Enterprise**

grounding in African culture and history. In fact, Hudson-Weems asserts that the cooperation of Hudson-Weems coined the term *Africana womanism* African men and women against white supremacy is in 1987 out of the realization of the total inadequacy in fact necessary for the survival and well-being of of feminism, and like theories (e.g., black feminism, African people as a whole. In place of feminism, then, African womanism, or womanism), to grasp the real-Hudson-Weems proposes a theory that stems from ity of African women, let alone give them the means African culture and focuses on the very unique expe-to change that reality.

riences and needs of African women, a theory she According to Hudson-Weems, there are two prob-calls Africana womanism. Furthermore, the first lems with the adoption of feminism by African step toward true liberation, as Hudson-Weems sees it, women. First, she argues, feminism is

fundamentally entails the freedom and power to name oneself. In that a European phenomenon. As such, it is loaded with respect, the term *Africana womanism*, which seeks to European metaphysical principles, such as the prob-give African women the means to name their own lematic, conflictual relationship between the genders, reality and to define an agenda for themselves and the with men seen as the primary enemies of women.

entire race, is a first and necessary step toward defining Such an antagonistic view of men is understandable what it means to be an African woman setting goals in the context of white male hegemony and the that are consistent with African culture and history. In subsequent relegation of white females to inferior and other words, it is the first step toward existing delib-subordinate status in their own societies. Second, erately and consciously on African terms—certainly feminism as it developed in the 1880s was blatantly a most profound and revolutionary act in a world racist. The feminist movement, which started as the dominated by Eurocentrism. It is precisely this new, women's suffrage movement, was initially concerned revolutionary aspect that is the appeal of the refresh-with the abolition of slavery and social equality for ing theory of Africana womanism.

all, irrespective of race, class, or gender. However, it

— *Ama Mazama*

eventually became quite conservative at the time of the ratification of the Fifteenth Amendment, which **FURTHER READING**

granted voting rights to African American males but not to white females. For these reasons, Hudson-Husdon-Weems, Clenora. (1993). *Africana Womanism*: Weems argues, feminism does not and cannot reflect *Reclaiming Ourselves*. Troy, MI: Bedford. This is the reference text on Africana womanism, in which Hudson-Weems the beliefs or interests of African women. She points lays out the rationale and major tenets of her theory.

out in particular how, historically and culturally, African women do not apprehend African men as their enemy.

Hudson-Weems insists on the necessary comple-**AFRICOLOGICAL** ENTERPRISE

mentarity of males and females always posited by African culture as an imperative for the continuation Winston Van Horne coined the term *Africology* of life itself. In addition, she asserts that it would not after *Afrology*, the term coined by Molefi Asante in be in the best interest of Africans as a people to allow *Afrocentricity* (1980). In discourse and by agreement, themselves to be divided along gender lines, as Van Horne and Asante decided to use the term African women and men both face the same evil of *Africology* to refer to the Afrocentric study of African white supremacy. Hudson-Weems recognizes that phenomena (as opposed to any other way of examining there are issues plaguing the relationship between phenomena). Discussions of African agency happen in African women and men, and she addresses this in the the field of Area Studies and in the field known as both following two remarks: On one hand, such issues have Black Studies and African Studies. When that discus-often been the result of living in a racist and highly sion centers inquiry on Africa and Africans and seeks patriarchal society, creating at times unhealthy behav-to improve the life chances of all Africans, Afrocentric iors and attitudes in African women and men; on the theories arise. While Afrocentric scholars are guided by other hand, due to their lack of institutional power in the same paradigm, the fields within which they work a highly racialized and racist society, African men influence their inquiry and theory construction.

have never been in the position to oppress African Scholars who use the Afrocentric paradigm have women to the same extent that white people have.

given rise to the discipline of Africology within the

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 59

Africology———59

field of African Studies. While this field addresses Eurocentric impositions by virtue of the fact that the a global African cultural experience, it has focused black and the white defenders of European hegemony

geographically on Africans in the Americas. In con-sought to undermine the Africological enterprise.

trast, the field of Area Studies focuses on the exclusive

— *Daryl Zizwe Poe*

examination of life in contemporary Africa. In each field, Afrocentric scholars seek to conceptually unite the African transatlantic experience.

When a bold group of African American students **FURTHER READING**

and faculty at universities such as the University of Asante, Molefi Kete. (1998). *The Painful Demise of California*, Berkeley, San Francisco State, North-Eurocentrism. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is just western, Cornell, and the University of California, one of the many works that Asante has written to explain Los Angeles made their demands for Black Studies, the nature of the Africological project.

they broke the back of the repressive intellectual Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). *Afrocentricity*. Chicago: tradition and opened up an entirely different avenue African American Images. (Original work published for African agency. Wherever Africology expresses 1980) This is a later edition of Asante's first book on Afrocentricity.

itself in the African world, it is because of the inspira-Mazama, Ama (Ed.). (2003). *The Afrocentric Paradigm*.

tion first articulated in the call for agency by African Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This book has become American students in the late 1960s. Criticized by the one of the standards for Afrocentric discourse. Mazama Marxists and radical Democrats as a bourgeois inven-brings together the major voices in the field.

tion, Africology had to be defended on several fronts.

Using the rhetoric of the Chicago School of Sociology led by Robert E. Park, William Ogburn, and Ellsworth Faris, several African American

AFRICOLOGY

Marxists were the first to criticize the assertion of African agency, because to them it was counterpro-Africology is the Afrocentric examination of phenomena and would prevent assimilation of ideas, concepts related to African people. It conflates subject concepts, and people. They falsely believed that the matter discipline and institutional discipline. As a objective of the Black Studies movement was to subject matter discipline, it is the oldest of all disempower a black bourgeoisie at the expense of the disciplines, given the origins of *Homo sapiens* in Africa; masses. The Marxists reacted to the Black Studies as an institutional discipline, it is of more recent movement in this way even though the movement was vintage, generally related to the rise in the 1960s of the first authentically masses-led action in the academy. Black Studies departments and programs in the academy. On the other hand, the black reactionary conservative-American academy and elsewhere around the world.

Marxists criticized the Black Studies movement As a subject matter discipline, Africology entails not-because they saw it as a threat to social assimilation.

Marxist and empirical inquiry and discourse concern-Both fears were false and simply masked the real fear of the life histories and life prospects of peoples of intellectual autonomy. Both the Marxists and the primary African origin and their descent transgenerational reactionaries conservatives misunderstood or seem to notionally, transhistorically, and universally. Given they have understood too well the meaning of agency for enormous scope of its subject matter, and the wide-spread those supporting Africology.

spread absence of institutional structures through Africologists challenged the idea that Africans which the subject matter of Africology could be could not create concepts, constructs, and theories in scrutinized in the form of an institutional discipline the interest of human liberation. Interpreting liberation (i.e., a discipline that disseminates knowledge and as being free of impermissible intervention in the cultural-establishes reputations in the academy), many have cultural, economic, or intellectual sphere, Africologists claimed, erroneously, that Africology is not an academy-created a new arena of disciplinary knowledge. When micro discipline. This error, both of

commission and Afrocentricity was conceived as a theoretical option omission, has been, and continues to be, grounded for the liberation of African people, it was seen not as largely in a failure to recognize that Africology does an opposition to Europe but as an assertion of African not require a one-to-one correspondence between agency. However, it quickly became an opposition to subject matter discipline and institutional discipline.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 60

60———Africology

Fortunately, at the outset of the 21st century the behaviors that constitute the subject matter of subject matter of Africology is increasingly spread Africology is now livelier than it has ever been. The around the globe through institutional structures, flourishing of paradigmatic competition in Africology which serve six basic purposes: (1) to educate and is particularly healthy regarding the discipline; for train scholars who will discover, recover, construct, only the paradigms that are able to withstand the most deconstruct, and reconstruct knowledge pertaining to stringent intersubjective testing and corroboration will Africology's subject matter; (2) to reposition Africa endure, since such competition generally has the and its significance in the evolution and development effect of weeding out weak and unsound claimants to of human life, societies, and civilizations; (3) to open the status of paradigm.

new paths in the advancement of societies and civi-Among the candidates now competing for the status lizations; (4) to provide a rigorous and substantively of paradigm in Africology are Afrocentricity, Kawaidea rich education, both at the undergraduate and graduate theory, cultural nationalism, pan-Africanism, Africana levels, for those who desire to pursue careers and womanism, and Négritude, to mention but a few. Of establish reputations outside of the discipline; (5) to these, Afrocentricity is perhaps preeminent at present.

command the respect of competing disciplines It has had to withstand a considerable number of through the conceptual rigor and empirical soundness broadsides, which is a commonplace for any paradigm of

Africological scholarship; and (6) to bring distinct—that is ascendant in a given cross-section of historical time to their institutions through the research, instruction. Should Afrocentricity be superseded by one or more, and service of scholars, the broad value of more of its competitors, it will not cease to be of value Africological scholarship, and the work of the students and influence in Africological scholarship, though its that is produced.

status will have changed.

All academic disciplines are grounded in values—

which may be articulated and recognized openly or **THE AFRICOLOGICAL PARADIGM**

hidden and suppressed in claims of value neutrality—

and serve a range of interests and purposes. Since there Paradigmatic competition fosters intellectual stringency, is no value-neutral or value-free interest or purpose, the though it is often accompanied by rancor and acrimony.

question arises, what sorts of interests and purposes do Intellectual stringency inclines Africologists toward given disciplines serve? And more specifically, how do a continuous expansion, sharpening, and refinement of the interests and purposes served by other disciplines the contents of their discipline, as each generation of compare to those fostered by Africology?

scholars transmits its knowledge, wisdom, and under-Most fundamental in regard to Africology is the standing to the next. There is in such intellectual stringency discovery and recovery of laws, and the positing of agency a striving purpose, which impels Africologists empirical generalizations, pertaining to congeries of to engage in instruction and research in the interest historical processes that Africans and their descendants of serving peoples of African origin worldwide as dants globally can put to use to advance and sustain they strive to (1) recenter Africa in regard to the rise, their well-being, good, and interests. Tough-minded growth, and development of societies and civilizations; critical inquiry and discourse concerning seven crucial (2)

reposition Africans and their descendants as defining attributes of culture—species life, species subjects rather than mere objects in the evolution and being, language, religion, literature-art-science-revolution in ideas and societal structures from the technology,

institutions,

and transgenerational

agrarian age through the beginning of the postinforma-memory—and the complexities as well as laws and tion age; and (3) redirect the consciousness of those empirical generalizations of political economy are who have by commission or omission acted to margin-thus essential to Africological scholarship. Such alize Africa and her progeny in the diaspora.

scholarship requires this grounding in order to serve As a subject matter and institutional discipline, well the interests and purposes that animate it, and out Africology necessitates clear-sightedness, levelheaded-of which the paradigms of Africology emerge and ness, fearlessness, self-confidence, and composure by contest for primacy.

those who would advance the discipline. Africologists Competition among paradigms to offer sound cannot evade the problem of Egypt or any other intel-descriptions, explanations, evaluations, predictions, lectual, cultural, or moral issue. Their moral arithmetic and justifications concerning the phenomena and must be sound and moral compass set correctly, for

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 61

Africology: Opposition——61

Africology does not countenance moral flaccidity.

discredit Africology in three strikes: (1) political The moral and ethical categories of Africology afford association, (2) false attribution, and (3) intellectual no justification for behaviors that wrongfully diminish dismissal. If they could get three strikes against the self-respect, self-

esteem, dignity, integrity, free-Africology, then they could put Africologists out of dom, and well-being of the individual qua individual.

the field. Strike one was to avoid a discussion of The imperatives of moral clarity and intellectual strin-Africology or Afrocentricity, the theory that supports gency necessitate that scholars of Africology take the discipline, by focusing instead on naive and risks in advancing the interests and purposes of the extreme black nationalist spokespeople at the height discipline—risks that could be personally costly in of their popularity and calling them, as well as other regard to their institutional standing.

blacks who articulated strictly antiwhite positions, The matter of risks notwithstanding, Africology has Afrocentrists. The objective was to make those who begun to come into its own as an institutional disci-challenged the dominance of white racial ideologies pline, and it will grow and flower in this century just as in the academy appear to be irrational.

sociology did in the previous century. Accordingly, it is Africology did not guarantee the racial character-obligatory that Africologists become the very best that istics, religious choices, or sexual leanings of its they can be in regard to the subject matter of their dis-practitioners and adherents any more than sociology, cipline, so that they are positioned to execute well the literary criticism, or philosophy guaranteed theirs.

transgenerational responsibilities of their roles in schol-The claim that any antiestablishment person who arship, instruction, and service.

speaks against anti-Africanism is an Africologist or Afrocentrist was thought by Black Studies scholars

— *Winston A. Van Horne*

to show intellectual ignorance at worst and intellectual dishonesty at best.
An orator may be pro-African **FURTHER READING**

American, but being pro-African American does not make the orator an Afrocentrist. If it did, then all Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). *Kemet*,

Afrocentricity, and Knowledge. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is a members of the NAACP's board would be Afrocentrists.

standard work in methodological philosophy in Black Since Africology is a discipline, it demands rigor-Studies. In this work, the author suggests major intellectual ous training and severe critiques. A person cannot currents, offers innovative approaches to data, and states the assume that he or she is an Africologist by virtue of case for using the Kemetic classical model in African Studies.

expressing a willingness to support Afrocentric Asante, Molefi Kete. (1999). *The Afrocentric Idea* (2nd ed.).

approaches to phenomena. It is necessary to master Philadelphia: Temple University Press. Asante provides a the language, orientation, techniques, research methods, new approach to phenomena based on recentering African thought to a subject position and away from an object posi-and concepts of the field of Africology in order to tion. The book is important for graduate students in Black declare competence in the discipline.

Studies.

A second strike against Africology was false attri-Mazama, Ama (Ed.). (2003). *The Afrocentric Paradigm*.

bution, that is, claiming something to be Africology Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. Mazama's excellent book that was not. For instance, claiming that melanin brings together the best works of the Afrocentrists as stan-theory (which espouses the essentialist value of biol-dards in the field of Black Studies. She identifies the prin-ogy) and Africology are the same is false attribution.

cipal attributes of the paradigm in the introductory chapter.

The melanists believe in some special or particular chemical or spiritual power that is inherited through the genes and glands and that affects African people differently than it affects others. The Africologist, **AFRICOLOGY: OPPOSITION**

who is a person looking at phenomena from an Afrocentric point of view, would admit that people Africology as a discipline contended with several have inherited different combinations of chemicals common oppositions during the last decade of the but would argue against attributing any special advan-20th century. In some ways it was to be expected that targe to individuals because of biological essential-a new discipline would confront numerous challenges ism. Africologists believe that the power equation in as other disciplines sought to assert their orthodoxy.

society relates to the aggregates of human political However, the opponents of the discipline sought to and economic relations over a period of time.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 62

62———**Afrocentric Creed**

Nevertheless, in addition to linking Africology to melanin theory, the opposition has made other false The Afrocentric Creed

accusations against Africology whose principal purpose was to undermine the discipline.

I have faith in myself

The third strike against Africology was meant to be I have faith in my teachers

its intellectual dismissal. This was the tactic chosen I will accept my duties and responsibilities by the English writer Stephen Howe, the American I respect others and seek their respect writer Mary Lefkowitz, and the half-English and I have self-respect

half-Ghanaian writer Anthony Appiah. But those of I have self-control

the intellectual dismissal school have found it difficult I can learn if I study hard

to simply dismiss the Afrocentric study of African I will learn because I will study hard phenomena, because the theory finds its source and I love

myself, and loving myself, I will be strength in the historical and cultural realities of myself and know myself

African people. Africologists generally seek to create I am the one who is talking

opportunities for solid scientific advances by basing ideas on sound social principles. Thus Africology, as El Credo Afrocentrico

a relatively new discipline, has retained the energy of its founders and has become an increasingly powerful Creo en mi capacidad

tool for analysis.

Tengo confianza en mis maestros

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

Acepto mis responsabilidades y tareas

Tengo auto-respeto

FURTHER READING

Si, puedo controlar mis emociones

Si, puedo aprender si estudio mucho

Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). *Kemet, Afrocentricity and Aprendare* porque me dedico a mis estudios *Knowledge*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is the Me quiero y en mi amor para mi mismo, me book in which Asante proposed the idea of Black Studies realizo y me conosco

as a discipline.

Marable, Manning. (2002). *The Great Wells of Democracy*: Hablo yo en esta oracion

Reconstructing Race and Politics in the Twenty First Century.

New York: Basic Books. Marable's book is a pioneering effort to understand how we can reconstruct race and politics.

West, Cornel. (1992). *Race Matters*. Boston: Beacon Press.

West provides an ethical argument, rooted in Christianity,

AFROCENTRIC CRITICISM

against racism and white privilege.

Afrocentric criticism is an evaluative field that uses the position of African agency to determine the location of a text or situation. For the Afrocentrist,

AFROCENTRIC CREED

criticism—whether of a literary, cultural, ceremonial, presentational, or personal narrative—relates wholly

“The Afrocentric Creed” is a document created by Molefi Kete Asante in 1994 as a part of a general project to infuse Afrocentric content into the public schools. If the African person project to infuse Afrocentric content into the public is not centered, the Afrocentric critic applies all the schools. “The Afrocentric Creed” has been adopted by elements of Afrocentric criticism to the narrative.

scores of urban schools and become identified as one There are two dimensions to consider in determining the centrality of the Asante Afrocentric Curriculum in a text: (1) the writing, that is, what is Infusion model. Some elementary school students written about, and (2) the writer, who is doing the are asked by their principals to memorize “The writing. It is only in capturing both the writing and the Afrocentric Creed” at the beginning of the school year.

writer that Afrocentric criticism can discover the total The creed is then used subsequently by the teachers centrality of a text. Thus this is different from a post-and principal as a way to discipline students. Students’

modern reading, for example, where only what is behaviors are evaluated by examining the actions in written matters. Since the goals of Afrocentric

critique the prism of "The Afrocentric Creed."

cism are different from the goals of postmodern and

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 63

Afrocentric Education——63

other types of criticism, the acts of criticism are also **AFROCENTRICITY AS FOUNDATIONAL**

different. The Afrocentric critic's objective is to obtain Afrocentric education is grounded in and proceeds a holistic reading by precisely locating a text that from the Afrocentric worldview, which includes emanated from a person who is writing in the context beliefs regarding the fundamental questions on the of oppression, colonialism, racism, persecution, and existence and organization of the universe and denial of freedom.

societies. These questions are central to education.

For the Afrocentric critic, all legitimate criticism J. A. Sofola, in *African Culture and The African* must engage the writing and the writer, the signature *Personality*, advanced several ideas about the opti-and the signer. Determining what the signer intended is much attributes of formal and informal Afrocentric often impossible, but by examining both the signature education, including the following:

and the signer, the critic is able to come closer to this intention than by simply concentrating on the text.

1. the family as the epicenter of African social Various writers have used the text as a cover for per-existence, giving the individual family member sonal grudges, prejudices, lies, and political chicanery.

his or her identity and frame of reference How is the critic to have some ability to make a judgment about the nature of literature if not by juxta-2. a

support system of love, care, responsibility, posing the signature and the signer with each other?

and justice for each individual from the rest of While it is possible to make some suggestion about the his or her family and the community at large meaning of a text without knowing anything about the 3. wholesome human relations providing each writer, clearly the task is much easier if the critic knows individual a stake in the community and balance-both the signature and something about the signer.

ing the individual's development with the devel-Using the principal components of the Afrocentric idea, opment of the community

particularly the notions of agency and centeredness, 4. community land tenure and ownership, provid-the Afrocentric critic is able to ascertain the role of a ing everyone access to land

text within the political or social environment of its creation.

5. the peaceful coexistence of different peoples through the philosophy of live and let live

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

6. respect for elders and the old as a common feature of governance

FURTHER READING

7. generosity and hospitality toward the “stranger,”

Blackshire-Belay, Aisha C. (Ed.). (1992). *Language and the “visitor,” the “foreigner”*

Literature in the Black Experience. Westport, CT: Greenwood Press. The articles in this book are useful for 8. an optimistic disposition to life's mission understanding the way critical theory is developed within the framework of language and culture.

It can be said that restoration of the Afrocentric Mazama, Ama (Ed.). (2003). *The Afrocentric Paradigm*.

worldview exists as a project because African culture Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This book provides the has been the target of systematic acts of destruction by most comprehensive collection of methodological and critical essays in Afrocentricity.

proponents of Western European cultural imperialism and white nationalist supremacy. It must be added that national consciousness arises out of a people's culture.

AFROCENTRIC EDUCATION

AFROCENTRIC

PERSONAL TRANSFORMATION

AND WORLDVIEW RESTORATION

Afrocentricity is the interpretation and/or reinterpretation of reality from an African perspective. Thus Afrocentric education proactively addresses the impo-Afrocentric education is the process through which sition of cultural alienation and the transformation African culture and the knowledge and skills needed processes associated with restoring African people to maintain and perpetuate it are developed and to the center of their own story by means of the advanced in present generations and transmitted to Afrocentric worldview. While the Afrocentric world-future generations.

view has existed since antiquity, Afrocentrism has

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 64

64———Afrocentric Education

not. Afrocentrism is a concept that was constructed Schools are among the institutions through which to enable Africans to use the strengths of enduring the process of cultural assault upon Africans has been cultural unity as weapons for liberation and tools for facilitated. African students are

taught to think in non-building a new world order. The need for such a African ways using Western orientations to knowledge concept was created by African experiences with inva-as the foundation for learning. Afrocentric education is sion, conquest, enslavement, colonization, and neo-therefore part of the same process of cultural restora-colonization. Concomitant with these acts of aggression tion and promulgation that is inherent to Afrocentricity.

and violence against African people, there have been Thus, when it is perceived as a part of the body of systematic efforts to destroy African culture through human sciences, some of the major assumptions under-the imposition of European culture on Africans every-lying Afrocentric education are as follows: where. The three examples below illustrate how the methodology of Afrocentric worldview restoration as a

- it acknowledges African spirituality as an process of personal transformation has been treated by essential aspect of Africans' uniqueness as a contemporary scholars.

people and makes education an instrument of Afrocentricity is a transforming agent for the Africans' liberation

restoration of the Afrocentric worldview. The process

- it prepares Africans for self-reliance, nation main-by which this transformation is to be effected is tenance, and nation management in every regard guided by *Afrology*, a term coined by Asante to refer
- it provides support for re-Africanization, to to a comprehensive Afrocentric philosophical state-counter the cultural alienation imposed through ment with attendant possibilities for a new logic, conquest, colonization, and enslavement science, and rhetoric. It is precisely this possibility of
- it aims to build commitment and competence in individual transformation that makes an Afrocentric present and future generations to support the collective consciousness viable.

struggle for liberation and nationhood The ideological function of Eurocentric culture

- it facilitates participating in the affairs of can be understood through the systematic analysis of nations and defining (or redefining) reality on Western culture's deep structure and the uses of its Africans' own terms, in their own time, and in logic. This essentially means learning how to demystify their own interests

tify the universalistic claims of Western cultural imperialism

- it emphasizes the fundamental relationship by treating them as manifestations of ideology.

between the strength of African families and the When Western culture is made visible in this way, it is strength of African nationhood

possible for Africans to transcend the Europeanization

- it ensures that the historic role and function of thought and redefine their thinking in African—the customs, traditions, rituals and ceremonies—

centered terms. Deconstruction and reconstruction which have protected and preserved Africans'

must thus occur in tandem. Given the extent of Western culture, facilitated their spiritual expression, encroachment on African understandings, the employment-ensured harmony in their social relations, pre-empt of constructionist approaches is necessarily pared their people to meet their responsibilities anteceded by deconstruction and reconstruction—a as adult members of the culture, and sustained relationship between the three approaches that Daudi the continuity of African life over successive Azibo deems ideal in his work on African Psychology.

generations—are understood and made relevant to the challenges that confront Africans now

- it emphasizes that African identity is embedded **AFROCENTRIC EDUCATION**

in the continuity of African cultural history and **AND THE AFRICAN WORLDVIEW**

that African cultural history represents a distinct What sets Afrocentricity apart from other theories is its reality continually evolving from the experiences intrinsic embodiment of an ongoing process of recovery of all African people wherever they are and have recovery and restoration of the African worldview as a means been on the planet across time and generations of locating and centering present conceptions of reality

- it builds commitment to the struggle for liberation and analysis of phenomena within the African world and to the nation-building process through view continuum. Afrocentric education, as a corollary the exercise of each individual's thought of Afrocentricity, must necessarily share these qualities.

processes

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 65

The Afrocentric Idea———65

- it embraces the traditional wisdom that independent African-centered schools that embody a

“children are the reward of life” and is an commitment to reclaiming the African worldview and expression of Africans’ unconditional love for restoring sovereignty for African people. From the children, thus it uses educational methods that mid-1990s into the early 21st century, the academic best serve African children by reflecting the best successes of the cultural focus of the African-centered current understandings of how they develop and independent schools have led to attempts by some learn biologically, spiritually, and culturally public, private, and charter schools, particularly in urban areas, to emulate their model. These efforts Afrocentric education, then, is, at one and the same have focused on the cultural

symbolism and rituals time, complex and straightforward. It facilitates developed by the independent African-centered preparation for African life; self-determination; a link schools. Their reliance on public funds and the differ-between spirituality, liberation, and nation building; a ing ideological commitments of these schools, how-bond connecting family and nation; and intergenera-ever, do not lend themselves to the emphases on tional transmission of culture. Moreover, Afrocentric the self-reliant, institution-building strategies and cul-education facilitates recognition of the continuity of tural nationalist goals that characterize independent African cultural history and commitments to personal African-centered schools of the type represented by transformation.

the Council of Independent Black Institutions.

— *Mwalimu J. Shujaa*

AFROCENTRIC SCHOOLS

FURTHER READING

Afrocentric education is clearly dependent upon human perception and interpretation. Thus education Akoto, K. A. (1992). *Nationbuilding: Theory and Practice in* can be Afrocentric only to the extent that the persons *Afrikan-centered Education*. Washington, DC: Pan-African responsible for the curriculum and instruction in World Institute. This is a key work by one of the major thinkers in the field, especially with regard to the need for schools consistently apply Afrocentric interpretative African-controlled schools for the proper education of frameworks and methodologies to facilitate and eval-African Americans.

uate teaching and learning. These persons must be Ani, Marimba. (1994). *Yurugu: An African-centered Critique* consciously engaged in Afrocentric personal transfor-of European Cultural Thought and Behavior. Trenton, NJ: mation themselves. It follows then that a curriculum or Africa World Press. This is a solidly developed analysis of any other artifact of schooling cannot be Afrocentric what is wrong with the Eurocentric conception of knowledge.

independent of the human capacity to perceive and Asante, Molefi Kete. (1994). *The Afrocentric Project in Education*. In M. J. Shujaa (Ed.), *Too Much Schooling, Too* interpret it in an Afrocentric manner.

Little Education: A Paradox of Black Life In White The black power movement in the United States *Societies* (pp. 395–398). Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press.

from the mid-1960s through the early 1970s produced This book discusses some of the most important assumption-perhaps 50 to 75 independent schools in African communities behind the Afrocentric movement in education.

communities across the country. Although independent Shujaa, Mwalimu J. (1992). *Afrocentric Transformation and schools controlled and operated by Africans had Parental Choice in African American Independent Schools*.

existed in the United States since the 1790s, the *The Journal of Negro Education*, 61(2), 148–159. This schools that came out of late 20th-century progressive essay analyzes some common motivations and thoughts of African American parents about schooling issues.

politics were radically different from the other schools.

Sofola, J. A. (1973). *African Culture and the African* This difference was the result of the movement that *Personality*. Ibadan, Nigeria: Oyo Books. This book produced them having learned critical lessons about provides a useful analysis of common and basic African the politics of education and the role of schools in cultural features.

imposing the ideology and worldview of the politically dominant Eurocentric culture in the United States on African people. The planners and organizers of these schools referred to them as “Independent Black

THE AFROCENTRIC IDEA

Institutions” and laid out clear objectives for them.

The Council of Independent Black Institutions, *The Afrocentric Idea* is Molefi Kete Asante's second founded in 1972, is an umbrella organization of salvo in a trilogy of books that includes *Afrocentricity*

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 66

66——— *The Afrocentric Idea*

(1980) and *Kemet, Afrocentricity, and Knowledge* write and speak of changes in science and scientific (1990). In *The Afrocentric Idea* Asante articulates his culture without considering the sociohistorical reality simultaneously critically acclaimed and vigorously of their perspectives, which are based on race, gender, contested concept of Afrocentricity. *Afrocentricity* is, and class.

essentially, a critical theoretical framework that advo-According to Asante, human beings' *historicity*, cates analysis of African history and culture and, more their consciousness of their own and their ancestors'

generally, world history and culture from an African lived experiences and life struggles, is never neatly perspective. Afrocentrists assert that knowledge of checked at the door like an overcoat at a dinner classical and contemporary, continental and diasporic party, but it more often than not has a deep and African history and culture is inextricable from and abiding impact and influence on their thought and indispensable to any analysis or proper interpretation behavior (i.e., their concepts and categories of of Africa and Africans.

culture and their life practices). Because of the pro-In a later book, *The Afrocentric Idea* (1987), tracted and often hidden nature of European hege-Asante further develops the theory of Afrocentricity mony in modern life, that is, what scholars such that he initiated in *Afrocentricity* (1980) by bringing as Maulana Karenga and Molefi Kete Asante have it into critical dialogue with the Eurocentric tradition.

called the progressive Europeanization of human This tradition extends from Greco-Roman civilization consciousness, many European and European-and culture through to contemporary thinkers such as trained

theorists are conceptually incarcerated. To Karl Popper, Edmund Husserl, Claude Lévi-Strauss, combat conceptual incarceration and the internalization and Thomas Kuhn. It is characterized, albeit often, by the belief that the European way of sexism, capitalism, and colonialism, among others), of viewing phenomena is not only the correct way Asante advances *centeredness* and *agency* as the two to engage history and culture but also somehow central categories of the Afrocentric idea as a con-universal, neutral, and normal. Asante asserts that conceptual system and method.

Afrocentricity does not question the value and validity of the Eurocentric tradition within its context, within the life-worlds and limits of European culture **AFRICA AS SOURCE AND CENTER**

and civilization. However, what Afrocentricity does take issue with is what European imperial expansion. For Asante and the Afrocentrists, Africa is as much efforts have historically done and currently continue a cultural paradigm and crucial point of departure to do—obliterate and erase, censor and systematically as a continent. For diasporic and continental African deny African (and other non-European peoples') people to center themselves in Africa is, first and humanity and history, their culture and contributions foremost, to dialogue with African history and culture, to civilization. At the heart of the Afrocentric idea, to be conversant with its spiritual, philosophical, and then, is a radical rejection and constant critique of the axiological systems and traditions. Centering entails established European imperial order. It is a view that asking Africa crucial questions and seeking critical critically assesses the past and present monocultural answers; it involves utilizing Africa's contributions to reality with the intent, literally, of creating a new, mul-culture and civilization in a current and ongoing effort ticultural, multiperspectival, and multidimensional to address the crisis, conflicts, and contradictions of reality.

the contemporary moment. Malcolm X, among others, *The Afrocentric Idea* opens with a gentle nudging believed that a psychological, cultural, and philosoph-by Asante for his readers to come to terms with the ical migration back to Africa would solve the problems fact that there are a multiplicity of views from which of African loss of centeredness. This idea resonates to

analyze and experience phenomena, not only the deeply within and reverberates sonically throughout European view, and certainly not the European *impe-The Afrocentric Idea* and Asante's other works. In *The rial* point of view. According to the nature of para-Afrocentric Idea, the notion of centering includes digm shifts pointed out by Popper and Kuhn, among placing African ideals at the center of any analysis others, Asante argues that the next great paradigm that involves African culture and behavior, as well as shift will involve the issues of cultural specificity and asking crucial cultural questions in categories such as positionality. The Eurocentric paradigm theorists location, place, and stance.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 67

The Afrocentric Paradigm———67

LANGUAGE AND LOCATION THEORY

history and epistemology by offering new and alternative paths for interpretation of African and An Afrocentrist locates a text by studying its language, human experience. It simultaneously challenges attitude, and direction. Language is the cornerstone of and points to the hegemonic character of Eurocentric location theory because it most easily manifests its interpretations of African history and culture by high-author's conceptual incarceration or conceptual libera-lighting and accenting Africans' self-assertions and tion. For example, a writer who calls Africans "primi-life struggles to demand their long-denied human tives" or "pygmies" or a text that refers to an African dignity. *The Afrocentric Idea* is concerned, perhaps or Native American nation or cultural group as "a more than anything else, with widening our under-tribe," "bushmen," or any other pejorative term demon-standing of what it means to be both African and strates that the writer and her or his text are caught human in the fullest and most expansive sense.

within the confines of European imperial culture and philosophy.

— *Reiland Rabaka*

The writer's attitude toward African history and culture also is an important indicator of the writer's **FURTHER READING**

perspective. For instance, how does the writer Asante, Molefi Kete. (1980). *Afrocentricity*. Buffalo, NY: describe and explain decolonization? Which is to say, Amulefi. This was Asante's first book on the subject of how does the writer theorize African anticolonial Afrocentricity, the third edition of which was published in social and political practice? Does the writer theorize 2003. It was meant for a popular audience and therefore is from a European colonial vantage point, which written in a passionate, engaging style.

employs all manner of imperial euphemisms and pejorative-Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). *Kemet, Afrocentricity, and natives?* Or, does the writer theorize from a point of *Knowledge*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. Written with view internal to African history, culture, and struggle, the purpose of laying a foundation for actual Afrocentric research, this work is the major essay on the methodology-which displays an in-depth understanding of African cultural issues surrounding the Afrocentric enterprise.

epistemology, sensitivity to the subject, and under-Asante, Molefi Kete. (1998). *The Afrocentric Idea* (rev. ed.).

standing of Africans' right to live self-determined and Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This is Asante's dignified lives? In addition, the Afrocentricist asks to principal statement on the theoretical idea of African whom the text is directed or, put another way, who is agency in textual, intertextual, and phenomenal approaches the intended audience? Is the text affirming of African to research.

and universal human dignity, or does it deny, denude, Asante, Molefi Kete. (1999). *The Painful Demise of Eurocentrism: An Afrocentric Response to Critics*. Trenton, and degrade the humanity of Africans or others? In NJ: Africa World Press. Attacking the arguments of those this sense, the Afrocentricist is also a radical human-who claim that Egypt is not a part of Africa, this work is and is critically and constantly concerned about the asserts the Africanism of ancient Egypt, the primacy of aim of the text—who it is intended for and what it African chronology, and the fact that

Egypt is to Africa is intended to do. At the core of these questions, then, what Greece is to Europe.

is the Afrocentric concern with the overarching perspective of the writer and purpose of the text he or she has produced.

THE AFROCENTRIC PARADIGM

AGENCY AND LIBERATION THEORY

The Afrocentric Paradigm (2003), edited by Ama In Afrocentric theory, the concept of agency is given Mazama, a Temple University professor of African pride of place. Nowhere, perhaps, is this more appar-American Studies, has become the most significant text ent than in *The Afrocentric Idea*. According to Asante, in Afrocentric discourse since the publication of Molefi *agency* entails Africans' self-conscious action. Further, Kete Asante's second edition of *The Afrocentric Idea* it is one of the aspects of Afrocentricity that dis-

(1998). Indeed, *The Afrocentric Paradigm* has quickly tinguishes it most from the Négritude theorists' con-become the most definitive theoretical collection in the cept of Africanity, which is primarily concerned brief history of Afrocentric research or Afrocentricity.

with African identity and ontology (i.e., being). The What makes *The Afrocentric Paradigm* particularly Afrocentric concept of agency extends and expands valuable is that it details the evolution of the



A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 68

68——— *The Afrocentric Paradigm*

various areas of specialization. The book is divided into two sections: the Metaphysical Foundations and the Sociological Dimension. The Sociological Dimension includes three categories: (1) Africology as the Afrocentric Disciplinary Matrix; (2) Afrocentric Epistemology, Concepts, and Methodology; and (3) Afrocentric Theories.

The first section of the book, the Metaphysical Foundations, begins with the article “The Afrocentric Idea” by none other than Molefi Kete Asante, who articulates the idea with clarity and purpose. Maulana Karenga, another

giant in the field, concludes the section with his essay “Afrocentricity and Multicultural Education: Concept Challenge and Contribution.”

Also included in this section is Danjuma Sinue Modupe’s “The Afrocentric Philosophical Perspective: A Narrative Outline.”

In the second section of the book, the Sociological Dimension, Asante’s article “African American Studies: The Future of the Discipline” stands alone in the first category, Africology as the Afrocentric Disciplinary Matrix. In Asante’s article, he explores *Dr. Ama Mazama, Afrocentric theorist and scholar* the need for further development of the discipline. The second category, Afrocentric Epistemology, Concepts, Afrocentric idea. In her introduction, Mazama points and Methodology, includes the work of Asante in addition that Afrocentricity was not produced in a vacuum in relation to articles by Norman Harris, Linda James Myers, and has several important antecedents. She credits and Na’im Akbar. Each article provides a solid frame-Marcus Garvey, Cheikh Anta Diop, Frantz Fanon, work with which to engage Afrocentric research by Aimé Césaire, Maulana Karenga, Léopold Sédar providing the proper methods and methodologies.

Senghor, Négritude, black nationalism, pan-Africanism, These scholars understand that a cohesive and coherent and Kawaïda with providing Asante with a theoretical set of philosophical assumptions is necessary in foundation to develop the Afrocentric idea. What also developing an Afrocentric frame of reference.

makes *The Afrocentric Paradigm* brilliantly unique is The final category, Afrocentric Theories, explores Mazama’s clarity in defining Afrocentricity.

several such theories that further our understanding of In her introduction, the editor indeed convincingly African phenomena. This category opens with two argues that Afrocentricity is the foundational and articles, one by Clenora Hudson-Weems and one by necessary paradigm for the discipline of Black Nah Dove. These articles are crucial because they Studies. She then proceeds to analyze thoroughly its address the significant role of Africana women in the metaphysical dimension (with its affective, cognitive, overall struggle for liberation and identity for African and conative aspects), as well as its structural and people. The category also

includes Jerome H. Schiele's functional dimensions. Her emphasis is clearly on ideas on Afrocentricity and social work, Ama Mazama's the metaphysical dimension, however, as the book Afrocentric approach to language planning, and addresses itself to an academic audience. Thus Mazama Kariamu Welsh-Asante's articulation of African aes-deals with Afrocentric epistemology, methodology, and thetics, as well as Molefi Kete Asante's position on methods and reviews many Afrocentric theories.

examining texts through an Afrocentric lens, Mwalimu Mazama has pulled together a collection of scholars Shujaa's examination of the role of Afrocentricity in who represent the core of Afrocentric scholarship.

the education of African children, and Asa Hilliard's These major scholars in the field of Africology/

review of pedagogy in ancient Kemet.

Africana/African American/Black Studies have also This edited volume is a must read for anyone inter-contributed to the Afrocentric idea and are coming from ested in the discipline of Africology, as well as for

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 69

Afrocentric Schools——69

those interested in understanding the Afrocentric idea.

approaches and to publish articles relevant to the field Ama Mazama has provided a text that effectively dis-and to African people's lived experience. The journal pels all misrepresentations and preconceived notions therefore supports the intellectual growth of the disci-of Afrocentricity. Her choice of scholars to assist in pline by publishing scholarly articles that provide further establishing the idea is part of the genius of teaching and learning materials for Black Studies this monumental work.

courses.

The journal solicits articles on relevant issues

— Adisa A. Alkebulan

confronting African world societies and written from the perspective of African people's experience. The **FURTHER READING**

journal's emphasis is on generating and promoting new ideas regarding the nature of the challenges Asante, Molefi Kete. (1998). *The Afrocentric Idea* (rev. ed.).

Philadelphia: Temple University Press. (Original work confronting African world societies, as well as the published 1987). This was the first major work to define causes of and solutions to those challenges. The journal's guiding philosophy is the principle of respect with special reference to the area of public discourse and and appreciation for African world indigenous and communications.

contemporary knowledge systems.

Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). *Kemet Afrocentricity and The journal was published as The Afrocentric Knowledge*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. In this work, *Scholar* until 1996, when its name was changed to the Asante further defines Afrocentricity as an intellectual idea *International Journal of Africana Studies*. The change within the academy in general. This text also helped shape the scope of the discipline of Africology.

of name reflected the controversy within NCBS

Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). *Afrocentricity: The Theory of regarding whether Afrocentricity was the defining par-Social Change*. Chicago: Third World Press. This book was adigm for African American Studies. In 1999, Loyola originally published in 1980 under the title *Afrocentricity: Marymount University became the institutional spon-The Theory of Social Change*. Asante's aim was to intro-sor of the journal. The *International Journal of duce the general public to the idea of Afrocentricity*, thus *Africana Studies* publishes articles by major African this book is valuable in the practical application of leaders and thinkers in the African world.

Afrocentricity to Africans' daily lives rather than as a guide for conducting Afrocentric research.

— *William Little*

FURTHER READING

THE AFROCENTRIC SCHOLAR

Karenga, Maulana. (2002). *Introduction to Black Studies*. Los Angeles: Sankore University Press. This work discusses at *The Afrocentric Scholar*, which was later renamed the length the emergence of Black Studies.

Mazama, Ama (Ed.). (2003). *The Afrocentric Paradigm*.

International Journal of Africana Studies, is the pri-Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. The essays in this book mary journal of the National Council for Black provide a solid understanding of the paradigmatic role of Studies (NCBS). It was first published in 1992 by the Afrocentricity for Black Studies.

Center for Black Culture and Research at West Virginia University under the editorship of William A.

Little. The mission of the journal has from its inception been to encourage scholarly research that explores and analyzes the history of African people in **AFROCENTRIC SCHOOLS**

Africa and the diaspora from an Afrocentric perspective. The overall goal of the journal is to provide an Afrocentric schools were developed during the 1980s alternative and relevant framework for the study of as African American educators demanded that schools African world people, their history and culture. The center children within their own cultural context.

journal supports the mission of NCBS to promote aca-There had been a strong independent school tradition demic excellence and social responsibility; it also pro-in the African American community prior to this time, vides Black Studies (also called Africana Studies and but in the 1980s

the movement gained momentum African Studies) scholars with their own space for from the articulation of the Afrocentric philosophy by intellectual debates about content and pedagogical leading intellectuals. Many of those persons became

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 70

70——**Afrocentric Schools**

consultants for the new schools being designed on the and centered to reflect the student population. It basis of the transformative ideas generated by the is filled with color images, posters, and slogans Afrocentrists. There are now over 300 of these schools of achievement. There may be also proverbs.

devoted to the proper education of African children.

Each classroom is an invitation to learning.

One of the first Afrocentric schools was started 5. A centered classroom is a laboratory for creative by Freya Rivers in Lansing, Michigan. This school, discussion, discourse, debate, and critical think-Sankofa Charter School, was a model during the time ing. The idea is to make every significant con- of Rivers's leadership. The school based its content cept live by discussion. The classroom teacher and form on the principles in the works of Maulana corrects false information and irrational views Karenga, Harriet McAdoo, Asa Hilliard, and Molefi with sensitivity. This means that the centered Kete Asante. Consequently, the school flourished and classroom is one where discussion is embraced.

the students demonstrated outstanding academic leadership. Children were learning four foreign languages 6. A centered school's discipline is based on respect in elementary school and mastering mathematics by for knowledge in both the bringer and the seeker the fourth grade. Other schools across the nation of knowledge. The principles of Maat (order, followed the Sankofa model, and although many of balance, harmony, justice, righteousness, truth, the administrators were hampered by a Byzantine and reciprocity) are uppermost in the classroom.

system of rules and regulations, they were able to Teachers may also employ the Nguzo Saba, seven make progress.

principles of community, for maintaining disci-Most Afrocentric schools adhere to the following pline. This means that the students are taught to ten basic tenets of the centered school, which devel-respect themselves, the search for knowledge, and oped out of the movement to attach children to the the teacher and other students. Discipline is based subject matter being taught to them in urban schools.

on knowledge and thus on the willingness of the teacher to listen to and accept questions.

1. A centered school takes each student's culture 7. A centered school celebrates the culture of its into account in every subject and at every grade students. Teachers feel comfortable wearing the level. Where there are many cultures, the teacher fashions of the students' cultures, present speak-must seek to demonstrate during the school term ers and performers from the culture, and use illus-that she or he has an interest in centering these trations and lessons from the culture. A student in students of many cultures in the subject.

such a school understands the historical role his 2. A centered school seeks to create lessons, or her people have played in world events.

strategies, and goals that reflect the concept of 8. A centered school involves the parents in the authentic voice, which means that the material process of centering the students. However, it in the classroom must reflect the cultural expe-may be necessary for the school to first center the riences of the children. Centering is the center-students' parents, so that the parents understand piece of the classroom process, and it is pursued how to center their children in the culture.

by the teacher's seeking all the ways to attach Therefore, at public meetings held at the school, the student to history, concepts, mythology, the principal or designee reviews the ideas science, mathematics, nature, motifs, and the behind the centered school, providing the parents personalities that pervade the lessons.

with a brief history of the Afrocentric school concept. A centered school operates on the principle of centrality and its applicability to centered schools.

scientific generation, where the school principal is a generator for the building and the teacher is where the principal, teachers, and students meet a generator for the classroom. A generator is one who regularly repledges themselves to academic excellence. Thus, the principal energizes the professional faculty and the faculty energizes the students.

always has an academic and cultural goal. The 4. A centered school is a positive school, in which academic goal is to succeed in being the best the environment reflects the centeredness of the school possible on the basis of the credentials of students. The school is clean, brightly painted, the students as demonstrated by their learning.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 71

Afrocentric Social Work———71

10. A centered school asks the question, Who are my self-determination for all as an integral part of its students? In answering this question each day, the professional ethos. The general purpose of social centered school applies the principles of learning work operations and practices has been subject to styles, relational attributes, oral presentation, per-numerous and profound changes over time. One of sonality, aesthetics, and cultural symbols to the these changes is the addition of specifically Afrocentric issues of environment and achievement.

social work, which seeks social change through empowering blacks to address their own needs and the The teachers and administrators who establish center-pressing needs of their communities.

tered schools use these principles as departure points Recent developments in critical theory, which in developing the schools. Thus centered schools have identified the various ways in which Western reflect the unique

characteristics of the best quality forms of knowledge dominate social work models and education possible within a given school community.

approaches, have clarified the necessity of Afrocentric social work. These understandings strengthen the

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

need to examine the knowledge base of social work to locate its intellectual hegemony as the source of its **FURTHER READING**

explanatory theories and therapeutic ideas about Akoto, K. A. (1992). *Nationbuilding Theory and Practice in human behavior*. It is in this way that scholars and *Afrikan Centered Education*. Washington, DC: Pan African researchers challenge hidden sources of oppression World Institute. This is a powerful pan-African statement within social work knowledge and create new models of the need for independent African institutions.

for practice.

Kambon, Kobi. (1998). *African/Black Psychology in the* Thus a new generation of black scholars and *American Context: An African-Centered Approach*.

researchers is engaged in developing theoretical and Tallahassee, FL: Nubian Nation. From a theoretical point practice models that encompass the values and cul-of view, this is one of the best works to date on the educational, cultural, and economics issues confronting the tural heritage of black people as action-oriented African American population.

strategies for social change. This heritage includes Lomotey, Kofi (Ed.). (1990). *Going to School: The African* belief in the interconnectedness of all things; the spir-American Experience. Albany: State University of itual nature of human beings; the interdependence of New York Press. This is an excellent collection of articles collective and individual identity; the inclusive nature by outstanding scholars that covers the entire school expe- of family structure; the oneness of mind, body, and rience of African Americans.

spirit; and the value of interpersonal relationships as Shujaa, Mwalimu (Ed.). (1994). *Too Much Schooling, Too the source of interpretative frameworks of human Little Education: A Paradox of Black Life in White Societies*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. Shujaa's book behavior.

is a dynamic work that speaks to the contradictions inher-Afrocentricity as a theory of social change is in ent in the way black children are educated in America. It is accord with social work's mission to promote human-a very sobering work.

itarian values and empower oppressed communities.

Afrocentric social work gives voice to the cultural values, philosophies, experiences, and interpretations of black communities regarding the causes and reso-AFROCENTRIC SOCIAL WORK

lutions of social problems. These cultural elements and themes become the source of knowledge and Afrocentric social work is a culturally specific para-interpretative frameworks used to design social work digm that embraces an African-centered worldview interventions as a means of black empowerment, com-as the basis for theories and models of practice.

munity regeneration, and spiritual renewal.

Afrocentric social work draws on the principles, val-Historically, social welfare activities in black ues, and local knowledge for models of practice. The communities have been closely connected to social, hallmark of the social work profession has been its religious, and political organizations, which have emphasis on promoting humanitarian values. These been major sources of support for black families and core values of social work are firmly grounded in individuals in the struggle for survival and resistance a historical foundation of social justice, as demon-to deep-seated racism and oppression. These unique strated in the profession's commitment to equality and historical experiences provide the background and

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 72

context in which contemporary black led organizations Graham, M. (2002). *Social Work and African-centred* have asserted black rights through which the needs *Worldviews*. Birmingham, UK: Venture Press/BASW. This of black people have been addressed. One of the first is the first work written on the nature of Afrocentric social work. It deals with the cultural-specific issues surrounding black groups to call upon black social workers was the welfare of African people in the United Kingdom.

Marcus Garvey's organization during the early part of Schiele, J. (2000). *Human Services and the Afrocentric* the 20th century.

Paradigm. Binghamton, NY: Haworth Press. This award-Social welfare activities have been shaped and winning book has become the standard by which many defined by forms of solidarity, mutuality, and reci-other social welfare works are judged.

procity grounded in the cultural antecedents of African personhood and community. Thus black communities, scholars, and professionals have been engaged in reconnecting with an African cultural

AFROCENTRICITY

matrix in their quest for community regeneration and revitalization and cultural renewal. Cultural knowl-Afrocentricity: The Theory of Social Change, the first edge provides an important resource base for black edition of which was published in 1980, was Molefi individuals and families engaged in affirming their Kete Asante's initial thrust toward a critical theoretical spiritual, emotional, and intellectual experiences and framework that advocates analysis of African history potential and in creating new visions and futures in and culture and, more generally, world history the diaspora.

and culture from an African perspective. Such an Community-based rights of passage programs have Afrocentric critique situates the analysis of phenom-become an established framework for social work ena in the cultural agency of African people. The practice in black communities. There are various Afrocentrist asserts that knowledge of classical and forms of rites of passage that support major transi-contemporary, continental and

diasporic African tional relationships in families and facilitate the history and culture is inextricable from and indispensable-regeneration of communities. Life-cycle development able to any analysis or proper interpretation of Africa (i.e., rites of passage) programs use cultural values and Africans.

as the central feature in guiding social work interven-Though the theory of Afrocentricity has tions. This action-oriented approach is an effective antecedents and borrows from several social and tool in responding to the needs of many young black political theories, it was not until the publication of people. An African-centered worldview is articulated *Afrocentricity* that the theory received its first sophis-within the program through the value system repre-ticated and systematic treatment. This book became sented by the seven pan-African principles known as the signature work in the field. It signaled a new the Nguzo Saba. Each principle of the Nguzo Saba adventure in intellectual activity and lifted the work provides the focus for program objectives and activi-of scholars in African American Studies (also called ties. These social work interventions have made Black Studies) to a more theoretical plane and important inroads in serving the growth needs of provided a basis for an Afrocentric critique of young black people and their families and communi-Western culture. A second, revised and expanded ties. Codifying African cultural values in explanations edition of *Afrocentricity: The Theory of Social Change* of human behavior enables Africans' empowerment was published in 2003 by African American Images to be realized through a culturally centered approach of Chicago. Asante has observed that although to social realities.

Afrocentrists often harbor varying intellectual agendas and interests, which reflect their training in

— *Mekada Graham*

diverse academic disciplines and their radically different political persuasions, what makes them **FURTHER READING**

Afrocentrists is their conscious utilization of a historically and culturally grounded African approach Graham, Mekada. (1999). The African-centred Worldview: to and analysis of knowledge and experience.

Developing a Paradigm for Social Work. *British Journal of Social Work*, 29(2), 252–67. This was one of the first arti-The book *Afrocentricity* builds on the thought and cles to apply the Afrocentric concepts developed by Asante practice of many activist-intellectuals and highlights to the social problems of Britain.

key areas for developing Afrocentric critique. Thus the

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 73

Afrocentricity——73

central tasks of a serious discussion of Afrocentricity, time and circumstance. A short list of ancestors would as both a critical theory of contemporary society surely have to include W.E.B. Du Bois, Cheikh Anta and a cultural consciousness-raising movement, are Diop, Frantz Fanon, Anna Julia Cooper, Edward (1) explaining its core characteristics, concepts, and Wilmot Blyden, Martin Delany, Ida B. Wells, Mary basic categories of analysis; (2) bringing to the fore the Church Terrell, Marcus and Amy Jacques Garvey, major moments and the often shrouded meaning of its Carter G. Woodson, Mary McLeod Bethune, Léopold discourse and debates; and (3) seriously and soberly Sédar Senghor, Aimé Césaire, Ella Baker, Malcolm X, delineating the criticisms of *Afrocentricity*.

Fannie Lou Hamer, Kwame Ture, and Walter Rodney.

Afrocentricity sought to provide a coherent concep-Afrocentricity demonstrates that after 500 years of tual framework. This framework in Asante's view the progressive Europeanization of human conscious-takes culture to be simultaneously crucial and critical ness, it is not only European imperial thought and with regard to efforts aimed at the mental and physical texts that stand in need of Afrocentric analysis but also emancipation of Africans in particular and humanity African history itself. African peoples have been sys-in general. Asante argues in *Afrocentricity* that culture tematically taught to view and value the world, and to is precisely what enables one to locate a theorist think and behave, from a European imperial frame of and his or her text, deciphering whether the language, reference. This means that many contemporary attitude, and

direction, among other aspects of the Africans have internalized not just imperial but also text, are anti-African and therefore anti-human. Upon anti-African thought and practices. It is in this sense locating an anti-African text, the Afrocentrist critiques that Asante positions his work, *Afrocentricity*, as both the text by radically rereading it, that is, locating it in a critique and a corrective.

light of African historical and cultural experience.

Afrocentricity considers the historical fact that the

AFROCENTRICITY AS

European imperial impulse has led to Native American **CRITIQUE AND CORRECTIVE**

holocaust and almost absolute physical and cultural decimation of Native Americans; African Holocaust *Afrocentricity* allows dislocated Africans, that is, (*maangamizi* in Kiswahili), enslavement, and colo-Africans moved off of their cultural territory and who nization; and the domination and colonization of vari-have an imperial relationship with African cultural ous Asian peoples. Therefore, *Afrocentricity* argues, theory and traditions, to relocate, return to, and reclaim Africans should cease imitating Europe and its mores their long denied humanity, history, and heritage.

and offer ethical and egalitarian alternatives to the As critique, *Afrocentricity* locates the anti-African and established imperial order by asking Africa questions other antihuman elements of a particular thought and and seeking from African history and culture answers practice—whether rendered under the guise of reli-to the major issues of the modern epoch.

gion, science, art, or even long-held tradition—and by This line of thinking, that Africa and African reading these elements against the backdrop of African peoples have a powerful message for humanity, and historical and cultural experience, offers an ethical and that all methods of fighting white supremacy must be egalitarian alternative to the imperial impulse. Further, embraced at the dawn of the 21st century, resonates as a corrective,

Afrocentricity radically relocates and deeply with many of the most radical theorists and recenters, providing both its adherents and the subjects activists of the Afrocentric movement. Some of the (as opposed to objects) in question with mutual ground central figures in this intellectual movement are Molefi upon which to engage and exchange with one another.

Kete Asante, Maulana Karenga, Ama Mazama, In this book, Asante poses a major challenge to the Marimba Ani, Tony Martin, Leonard Jeffries, Linda crude classical Western scientific dichotomies.

James Myers, Theophile Obenga, Oba T'Shaka, Wade Although Asante has sometimes been criticized as Nobles, Chinweizu, Ngugi wa Thiong'o, Danjuma essentialist, there is nothing in *Afrocentricity* that Modupe, Runoko Rashidi, Clenora Hudson-Weems, argues biology alone.

Afrocentricity has nothing what-Bobby Wright, Amos Wilson, Na'im Akbar, and Kobi soever to do with general discussions, by persons of Kambo. This type of thought also put a premium on African descent or others, of Africa and African the Afrocentric pantheon of intellectual ancestors, peoples' history, culture, societies, religions, political usually intellectual activists who consciously asserted organizations, and so forth. And, further, it should not African agency and self-determination in their specific be confused with melanin theory, which is biologically

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 74

74———**Afrocentric Theory**

determined and extremely reactionary and, therefore, Hudson-Weems, Clenora. (1995). *Africana Womanism*: harmful to both Africans and humanity as a whole.

Reclaiming Ourselves. Boston: Bedford. This is the first Afrocentricity revolves on an axis of African work on Africana womanism by the leading proponent of the concept.

agency and asks questions concerning historical and Karenga, Maulana. (1995). Afrocentricity and Multicultural cultural accuracy and interpretation based on its four Education: Concept, Challenge, and Contribution. In basic

categories of analysis: cosmology, epistemology, Benjamin P. Bowser, Terry Jones, and Gale Auletta Young axiology, and aesthetics. Asante is therefore against (Eds.), *Toward the Multicultural University*. Westport, CT: not European thought and culture but European *impe-Praeger*. *This is the key essay on the relationship between rial thought and culture. In addition, it is a monstrous Afrocentricity and multiculturalism.*

misinterpretation to claim that Afrocentricity is Mazama, Ama (Ed.). (2003). The Afrocentric Paradigm.

Eurocentricism in blackface or reverse racism, because Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is a classic collection of original and published articles by the most creative Afrocentricity is not a biologically determined ideol-researchers and theorists in Afrocentricity.

ogy but a radical sociotheoretical framework, as Van Dyk, Sandra. (1998). Molefi Kete Asante's Theory of evidenced by its epistemic openness and inherently Afrocentricity: The Development of a Theory of Cultural humanist posture, a posture Asante has illustrated in Location. Unpublished doctoral dissertation, Temple many articles and essays.

University, Philadelphia. This is first dissertation to take on Afrocentricity continues to be widely read and the idea of Afrocentricity as a theory of cultural location.

understood by the masses of African people, and it demonstrates how an idea can become theory, political practice, and social movement. This is true because the book is part and parcel of a larger and

AFROCULTURAL THEORY

long-standing effort by people of African descent and others to liberate themselves, both physically and Afrocultural theory aims to explain the various phe-mentally, and bring into existence new human beings nomena associated with African cultural practices and and a new world.

behavior. Thus Afrocultural theory is dedicated to understanding how the behaviors, traditions, customs,

— Reiland Rabaka

*and rituals of African societies affect the development of **FURTHER READING***

consciousness in the African person. It seeks to explain cultural consciousness in terms of certain events or Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). Kemet, Afrocentricity, and processes the African person has adapted from his or her Knowledge. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is Asante's cultural reality. When a person has internalized the discourse on method and language in Afrocentricity.

phenomena of the African cultural world, there is the Asante, Molefi Kete. (1998). The Afrocentric Idea.

possibility of consciousness, more than awareness in a Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This is the main theoretical work on Afrocentricity.

popular sense, of the phenomena, meaning essentially Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). Afrocentricity. Chicago: African that the person views the phenomena from inside what American Images. This is a later edition of the 1980 book is happening. A person who is raised within the context that established the discourse on Afrocentricity and proof an African cultural world where there is a ritual asso-vided the language for the discussion.

ciated with puberty, for instance, will normally have a Dove, Nah. (1998). Afrikan Mothers: Bearers of Culture, different reaction to additional ritualized situations than Makers of Social Change. Albany: State University of a person who has never experienced the situation. This New York Press. This book is an Afrocentric exploration of mothers in the African context.

is to be expected in the course of activities that involve Gray, Cecil C. (2001). Afrocentric Thought and Praxis: An what is often referred to as Africanity. This is the Intellectual History. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press.

process of participating in the activities that are usually Gray's work, based on that of his teacher, Molefi Asante, analyzable by Afro-cultural theory.

is a useful restatement of some of the key principles of In The Afrocentric Idea, Molefi Kete Asante applies the theory, although it includes clear variances with the Afro-cultural theory to an analysis of African oratorical original conception.

and rhetorical behavior. Asante contends that the idea Henderson, Errol A. (1995). Afrocentrism and World Politics: of an African cultural reality that locates oratory in the Towards a New Paradigm. Westport, CT: Praeger. This is one of the best examples of the extensions of the cultural traditional values of the African world—where oral tra-arguments used in Afrocentricity to establish a geopolitical dition, speech, and the generative power of the spoken perspective based on African ideas.

word had value in themselves—is fundamental to

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 75

Afronography——75

appreciating the privileging of oratory in the African As a method of ascertaining the condition or state of community. Other scholars apply the concepts of an event, person, or text related to African people, Afro-cultural theory to language, call-and-response Afronography projects both an ethical and an evalua-activities, and rituals. Afro-cultural theory suggests that tive dimension. In its ethical dimension, it is con-the use of African traditions, customs, and rituals might cerned with the nature of what is in the best interest help to explain the contemporary behaviors and atti-of the African community specifically and the world tudes of people of African descent. This is to suggest community generally. The evaluative dimension not that there are no other influences on contemporary allows the Afronographer to discern the usefulness of Africans but that one cannot forget the cultural origins an event, person, or text in the search for truth. In both of African activities when examining African lives.

dimensions, Afronography seeks to understand the What Asante and other scholars have attempted to characteristics that accompany certain positions, do with Afrocentric theory is to open the door to a new hence, positionalities. The idea is that all positions way of assessing the multiple experiences of Africans.

carry with them certain obvious and not so obvious Like the metatheoretical idea of Afrocentricity, characteristics that allow a viewer, reader, locator to Afrocentric theory places a considerable weight on the determine the extent of the influence of those charac-issue of location. Thus, an Afrocentric analysis seeks teristics on the position. In one sense this is a utilitar-to discover where the parties being analyzed are located ian function. Utility in an epistemological sense is culturally. This is a feature of determining conscious-related to the character of the proof discovered in the ness, as it is easy to see whether a person is coming qualitative environment.

from the inside of a process or from the outside in an Establishing the nature and extent of social, criti-interpretation or an expression. The researcher there-cal, and cultural positionalities by employing such fore places the various parties in an investigation in terms as dislocations, distortions, simplifications, order to obtain an adequate assessment. In Afrocentric blurs, distances, omissions, and misidentifications theory, the researcher also realizes that the parties to be within the context of ethics and evaluation creates investigated have automatically placed themselves by opportunities for stating more clearly and precisely their own activities. Thus it is possible for a person to the role of Africans in a given situation. Each move-look black phenotypically but to be devoid of any hint ment away from Afrocentricity is considered a way of of Africanity, that is, affiliation with custom, traditions, being out of location, and the Afronographer grapples or rituals of the African culture in any form. Or, a with this in the writing of any particular experience.

person may not look black phenotypically yet may be Afronography seeks to determine what it is to deeply involved in the African cultural world. Thus, the know something. There are four approaches used Afrocentric theory

adjusts for the infinite variations of by Afronography: historical, experiential, textual, and the African cultural world.

social. The aim of these approaches is to engage phenomena in such a way that it becomes possible to

— Molefi Kete Asante

*determine the location of the agent, creator, operator, or subject. Thus, examples from history, science, art, **FURTHER READING***

and various other disciplines compete to mark the location of a phenomenon.

Asante, Molefi Kete. (1998). The Afrocentric Idea.

Among the questions being raised by Afronography Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This is one of the are what forms of legitimation are necessary for this key works in the Afrocultural theoretical field.

Mazama, Ama. (2002). Langue et Identité en Guadeloupe.

new method of viewing reality and what the nature is Pointe-à-Pitre: Jasor. This is a stellar example of how a of any legitimacy that does not privilege the people researcher uses the Afrocultural foundation to investigate who are being studied. Thus the questions naturally a contemporary issue.

arise as to how to expand the work being done by Afronographers gratis, and what types of institutional structures would ensure the legitimation of this perspective. Clearly the established institutional fields do
AFRONOGRAPHY

not support granting legitimacy to a methodological form that questions their lack of diversity. What then Afronography is a method of recording and writing is the task of the Afronographer? The Afronographer the African experience from an Afrocentric perspective.

says that it is to demonstrate that the African narrative

76——*Afronography*

*can be understood within the context of any given **QUALITATIVE METHODS AND***

*situation so long as the African is not deprived **ORIENTATION IN AFRONOGRAPHY***

as subject.

The Afronographer seeks to discover, argue, In many ways, Afronography is akin to what in sociol-analyze, prove, challenge, describe, justify, or clarify ogy is called ethnography or case studies, but some situation. This is done within the context of seek-Afronography begins from a different place and has ing what is true, describing human actions and prod-objectives that are often at variance with those of ucts, and being respectful of all human situations.

ethnography. While ethnography was developed as Respect is demonstrated in the Afronographer's accu-a Eurocentric way of acquiring information about rate depictions, direct quotations, and highlighting people other than Europeans, Afronography is a contradictions. In Afronography, all analysis is based method of gaining access to information about on the idea that explicit abstraction and generalization Africans from the standpoint of African culture itself.

of data should concentrate on the issue of location.

This trend in scholarship must be seen as research in As the Afronographer is interested in understanding the its proper context, where researchers have a reasonable role of the analyzed, the goal of Afronographic analysis handle on the issues confronting students in the disci-is not antihumanist as it is in most purely statistical pline of Africology.

analyses (which seek to establish reliable frequencies A key factor in being a researcher in the and generalize from them to predict behavior).

contemporary world has to do with appreciating the Afronography is important because of the value of the centrality of human agency. No researcher understands places on knowing. It is a method that seeks to dispel this more than the adequately trained Africological myths, construct valid identity, and readjust typified-researcher who seeks to explore the best ways to know. Inasmuch as the myths and stereotypes surround something and then to be able to explain what he or rounding African positionalities have been negative she knows. The Africologist, however, wants to know and have sustained the marginality of African people, about things from the standpoint of Africans as Afronography, using a centered perspective on situa-agents. This means that all things are not within the tions, seeks to recenter the discussion about African purview of the Afronographer, just as the economist people by allowing for the subject place of Africans does not seek to apply her methods to physics. Using to reveal all varieties of opinions. Afronography is Afronography, the Africologist wants to be able to dis-therefore not a system designed to replace Eurocentric cover, through direct methods over a period of time, analysis for the sake of replacement, but rather, a some particular answers to human problems. The aim method that seeks to elicit the positionalities, ideas, of Afronography has to be to cope with the persistent themes, and information that have always escaped distortion of the African presence in the world.

Eurocentric analysis in which Africans are marginal-There are always more possibilities, potentialities, ized. Thus the aim is for scholars to have better and problems of agency than researchers expect.

judgment by using methods that include face-to-face However, it is by directly knowing some of the issues approaches, total awareness, surrogacy, and empathy that researchers are able to properly explain them. A to arrive at conclusions. The value of surrogacy is researcher might ask, is there an illusion of conscious in its nonreflectivity, its immediacy, and its reality.

will? The answer to this question throws light on the If the researcher cannot know all Jamaicans, what question of what it is a person actually does when that should he or she do to learn something about person does something. All action is created by the Jamaicans? Of course, the first thing the researcher mind, and will itself is a creation of the mind. Thus it should

do is to look for reasonable stand-ins or surro-is difficult to speak of anything other than the feeling gates for all Jamaicans, such as individual Jamaican of free will. What constitutes agency on the part of a filmmakers, novelists, reporters, tourists, and so forth.

researcher? Is it the actual conscious will to do someWhat Afronography allows the researcher to do is to thing or the process of doing it? Whatever answers to discover in time, place, religion, environment, myths, these questions the research discovers, it is clear that taboos, customs, habits, and behaviors a measure of the Afrocentrist working in Africology must be what is true, from the standpoint of the African as attuned to finding ways to make sense out of unexam-subject, in a given situation. Ultimately, this is the ined types, stereotypes, and repetitive actions and value of Afronography.

forms in ordinary life.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 77

All-African People's Revolutionary Party———77

THE MOST RADICAL EMPIRICISM

Marxist scholars to the discussion of the fundamental problems of method.

The Afrocentrist accepts personal knowledge as the Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). Kemet, Afrocentricity and most radical form of knowing. Personal knowledge Knowledge. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This was is divided into two parts: (1) intense self-knowledge the first book to establish the methodological ideals for and (2) outside knowledge. In the first instance, researchers.

people are interested in what they know about them-Asante, Molefi Kete. (1998). The Afrocentric Idea.

selves. This is usually seen as identity types of Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This is a key theoretical work in the field of Afrocentricity. Used by knowledge, that is, who people are in terms of their numerous

scholars to examine the critical dimensions of origin, birth, education, parents, domicility, and culture.

texts, situations, and phenomena, this work is especially Outside knowledge refers to what people know when useful to researchers.

they are face to face with objects, events, and other Mazama, Ama (Ed.). (2003). The Afrocentric Paradigm.

people. This is the purview of Afronography.

Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. Mazama's book extends In the contemporary world, it is necessary for the Afrocentric methodology by organizing essays that people to know about much more than themselves.

speak to the need to interpret and explain from an Afrocentric perspective.

*People's personal knowledge must include information about those they cannot possibly get to know and events that they will not be able to see, thus Afrocentrists must create ways to approach this **ALL-AFRICAN PEOPLE'S***

*quandary. Afrocentrists do this by establishing a **REVOLUTIONARY PARTY***

methodology that has nonreflectivity and immediacy.

Afronography helps researchers to make sense out The All-African People's Revolutionary Party of the complex, multilevel, urban and rural environ-

(A-APRP) is the brainchild of Ghana's first president, Nkrumah where human interactions occur in a heteroge-Kwame Nkrumah (1909–1972). The first published neous nation where African people have historically call for an A-APRP was in Nkrumah's Handbook of been marginalized. It is one of the ways that humans Revolutionary Warfare (1968). This call was a clear can reorient knowledge and create conditions for indication of the shift in focus of African freedom fight-effective human interactions within the context of ers from nonviolent positive action campaigns and heterogeneity.

regional approaches to all out continent-wide armed To be an Afropolitan, then, is to be aware of the revolution and pan-African nationalism. This evolved multifaceted nature of human existence in the world, posture was necessitated by the increased repression of not merely the existence of mind, or social institutions, colonial regimes and their internal neocolonialist allies.

or economic processes. But since any researcher is In an effort to reduce his influence, Nkrumah was really only one individual who neither can be in every overthrown in 1966 by the collaborative forces of the place nor represent every human condition, researchers Ghanaian military and police in cahoots with foreign must depend upon reasonable surrogates for their intelligence forces. Nkrumah's original handbook was radical empiricism. The value of knowing is that it confiscated in that coup d'état. He rewrote the book dispels myths, helps to construct valid identity, read-while serving as co-president with Sékou Touré in just types, and helps people to make better decisions.

Conakry, Guinea. As co-president, Nkrumah's respon-In the final analysis, real (i.e., concrete) usable knowl-sibility was mentoring and managing the African edge helps with face-to-face, empathic, holistic, and freedom fighters in the Guinea. Freed, albeit forcibly, surrogate consciousness.

from the day-to-day responsibilities of running the

— Molefi Kete Asante

*civil government of Ghana, Nkrumah immersed himself in creating the strategy for what he viewed as the **FURTHER READING***

inevitable all-African war for liberation, unity, and socialism. He believed that this goal would only be Alkalimat, Abdul (Ed.). (1990). Paradigms in Black Studies: successfully accomplished through the scientific Intellectual History, Cultural Meaning and Political Ideology. Chicago: Twenty-First Century Books. This organization of human forces on a global scale.

book, which clarifies theoretical issues in Black Studies Included in Nkrumah's plan was a provisional research, contains the contributions of

several leading government made up of liberated zones and liberation

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 78

78——*All-African People's Revolutionary Party* organizations. This provisional government would of Africa under scientific socialism. The A-APRP

be known as the All-African Committee for Political views its ideology as the necessary path to the objec-Coordination (A-ACPC) and would have a parallel tive of pan-Africanism. The ideology of the A-APRP

military component, the All-African People's Revolu-was originally Nkrumahism and later amended to tionary Army (A-APRA). Both configurations, how-Nkrumahism-Turéism. This ideology was derived ever, were to be preceded by a political organization from a scientific analysis of conditions in the African that would do the groundwork, the All-African world, as well as from the revolutionary principles People's Revolutionary Party (A-APRP). The A-APRP's found in the works of Kwame Nkrumah and Séku tasks were (1) to organize a cadre into a monolithic Turé, two of the foremost advocates of pan-group committed to carrying through the remainder Africanism.

of the strategy, (2) to link all liberated territories The A-APRP's program consisted of the following and struggling parties under a common ideology to points:

smooth the way for continental unity, and (3) to assist in the execution of an all-African people's war against

- recruiting and training cadres from among the colonialism and neocolonialism.*

ranks of the African intelligentsia, especially There has been debate as to whether the A-APRP

students and women

and A-ACPC were expected to coexist or the A-APRP

- *consolidating principled relations with revolutionary organizations around the world Nkrumah wrote more about the A-ACPC than he did*

tionary organizations around the world Nkrumah wrote more about the A-ACPC than he did

- *building coalitions to smash bourgeois political parties and the military-industrial-police-state from the start been the more formal of the two groups, intelligence complex*

comprised as it was of the central committees of

- *smashing Zionism by working to build a world-organization as coalescing members. This member-wide anti-Zionist front*

ship approach was different than that of the A-APRP,

- *building the African United Front and the which was to be catalytic and thus was comprised of All-African Committee for Political Coordination dedicated working-class cadres.*

- *organizing and institutionalizing African Liberation Day worldwide*

KWAME TURÉ'S LEADERSHIP

The A-APRP is organized along the general lines After Kwame Nkrumah, Kwame Turé (1941–1998) of a socialist political party. The organization uses a was the most memorable advocate and recruiter for the democratic centralist model with regional and chapter A-APRP. He and a relatively small group of commit-structures. It currently has two internal wings: the All-African members kept Nkrumah's plan alive and recruited African Women's Revolutionary Union (A-AWRU) thousands of college students to study Nkrumah's and the Young Pioneers Institute (YPI), which like ideology and plan for the all-African people's war.

Nkrumah's earlier party, the Convention People's Party (CPP), was well known for his work in the Student Party (CPP), caters to the children of the organiza-

Non-Violent Coordinating Committee and the Black tion's members and initiates. Full members are Panther Party and as coauthor, with Charles Hamilton, known as cadres and membership usually requires a of the book Black Power (1969). With the assistance rigorous process of political education and propa-of Shirley Graham-Du Bois (1896–1977), Turé met ganda work.

Kwame Nkrumah and Séku Turé (1921–1984) and was invited to work with Nkrumah and the Democratic **THE MEMBERSHIP OF THE PARTY**

Party of Guinea (PDG). Turé went on to become a major propagandist and central committee member for The nature of the A-APRP makes reliable data on both the PDG and the A-APRP.

membership numbers scant. Its membership has increased and decreased in line with the developments of pan-Africanism in world affairs. When the African **THE OBJECTIVE OF THE PARTY**

Liberation Movement was at its height in southern The objective of the A-APRP is pan-Africanism, Africa in the 1960s, so too was the membership in which it defines as the total liberation and unification the A-APRP. Since that time, its membership has

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 79

American Anti-Slavery Society———79

grown across Africa, Europe, and South America. The Stockwell, John. (1978). In Search of Enemies: A CIA Story.

A-APRP's membership in the United States has either New York: W.W. Norton. This is considered the authorita-held constant or decreased since then. Though the tive book on the role of the CIA in Africa, particularly in the overthrow of African leaders such as Kwame Nkrumah.

A-APRP admits that currently its membership is in the hundreds, it is clear that many thousands of college students of African descent have trained, at

least temporarily, in the organization's political education **AMERICAN ANTI-SLAVERY SOCIETY**

process. This process often takes place on college campuses. The prime activity of the political education program is referred to as a work-study process, The American Anti-Slavery Society (AASS) was the which involves small circle discussions, with 5 to 13

most prominent organization in the fight against persons, around a uniform reading list, discussion of enslavement in the history of the United States. When geopolitical topics, and affairs of the organization.

the U.S. Constitution was written in the late 18th cen-Since the passing of Nkrumah, the A-APRP has tury, a debate over congressional representation been successful at keeping the concepts of African resulted in a clause designating enslaved Africans as identity and African union in the discussions of the three fifths of a white person. Thus out of every 100

African intelligentsia. The organization has also blacks, only about 60 would be counted for the purpose developed forums for anti-imperialist organizations to of congressional representation.

speak to the African intelligentsia. These forums were Free individuals, black and white, registered traditionally organized during the A-APRP's African their opposition to the institution of slavery from the Liberation Days (ALDs). In this way, the A-APRP has nation's founding. Quakers were in the forefront of sought to internationalize the consciousness of the this early antislavery struggle, which generally advo-African intelligentsia and youth.

cated the gradual emancipation of enslaved persons.

The personification of the A-APRP as "Kwame This approach is distinguished from the later abolition Turé's organization" brought significant challenges for movement, whose adherents emerged in the mid-19th the organization after his passing. Turé's lifelong century and insisted on immediate emancipation.

struggle for blacks brought him fame, fame he used for The abolition movement surfaced in part in response the A-APRP's benefit. No one else in the organization to an organization called the American Colonization had the public familiarity that Turé had earned as a Society (ACS) that was founded in 1816. This organi-leader in the civil rights, black power, and pan-African zation was led by wealthy Southern planters who movements, so it was not possible to replace him in the believed that free Africans jeopardized the institution organization. Thus the organization Turé helped to of slavery. They claimed, however, to support gradual build continues to exist and is organizing with new emancipation and insisted that the colonization of tactics that reflect the post-Turé era. Chapters are still manumitted slaves would ultimately encourage slav-being built and relations with other pan-African and ery's dissolution.

liberation organizations are being consolidated.

Some white antislavery supporters initially endorsed the American Colonization Society because

— Daryl Zizwe Poe

*they believed in its mission. Free African Americans in the North were not duped by the ACS and pleaded **FURTHER READING***

with white abolitionists to abandon colonization. They Agyeman, Opoku. (1992). Nkrumah's Ghana and East Africa: persuaded prominent abolitionists like William Lloyd Pan Africanism and Interstate Relations. Rutherford, NJ: Garrison to denounce the group. Although whites who Fairleigh Dickinson University Press. Agyeman seeks to opposed the institution of slavery did not necessarily demonstrate how Nkrumah's theory of pan-African unity believe in equality of the races, when the antislavery affected the states of East Africa. This is a useful study of activists withdrew their support from the ACS, some the role of government politics and ideology.

began calling for immediate emancipation. The orga-Poe, Daryl Zizwe. (2004). Kwame Nkrumah's Contribution to nized movement for abolition began in local commu-Pan African Agency. New York: Routledge. This

book provides information on Nkrumah's philosophical search for nities where groups of individuals formed antislavery his ideological home and the difficulty of translating that societies. These groups distributed pamphlets, hosted search into practical agency politics.

speakers, raised funds, and aided fugitives. They were

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 80

80———**American Anti-Slavery Society** often interracial, but they remained segregated by Constitution to be a proslavery document, publicly gender until 1840.

burning a copy of it in 1840. It was in this year that the In 1833, 62 male abolitionists representing local AASS elected a woman, Abby Kelley, to serve on the antislavery societies in 11 states met in Philadelphia organization's business committee at its annual con-and organized the first national association dedicated vention. A few delegates led by Lewis Tappan walked to abolition. Among the African American men in out in protest. They were frustrated by Garrison's rad-attendance at this meeting were James Forten and ical tactics and opposed coupling abolition with other Robert Purvis. The American Anti-Slavery Society reform efforts, such as women's rights. The men went endorsed the Declaration of Sentiments, written by on to form a rival abolition association called the leading abolitionist William Lloyd Garrison, which American and Foreign Anti-Slavery Society. This attacked enslavement as immoral, blamed Northerners group placed greater emphasis on internationalizing as well as Southerners for its perpetuation, proposed the abolition movement, but it failed to gain significant a strategy of nonviolent resistance, and condemned support. In general, black abolitionists held Garrison in the emigration schemes of the American Colonization high regard, but they were annoyed with white aboli-Society. Garrison was to become the leading figure in tionists' squabbling and believed it harmed the cause.

the AASS and serve as president of the organization Black abolitionists came together during this from 1843 to 1865.

period in national and state conventions to formulate Garrison was born in 1805 in Massachusetts, their own autonomous agenda. For Africans, abolition where he was indentured to a newspaper owner at was more than just a charitable cause. Many had the age of 14. He became an expert printer and joined family or friends who were enslaved, and abolition forces with Benjamin Lundy in 1829 to publish an was intricately linked to the improvement of living antislavery newspaper known as *The Genius of Un-conditions for free Africans*. African women also versal Emancipation. Like many antislavery agitators played a significant role in the abolition movement at the time, Lundy favored gradual emancipation, but and the ensuing struggle for women's rights. Some Garrison grew increasingly impatient with this notable figures among them were Sojourner Truth, approach. He soon parted ways with Lundy and Frances Ellen Watkins Harper, and Sarah Parker launched his own newspaper, *The Liberator*, in 1831.

Remond. Black women abolitionists were able to The Liberator became one of the most influential draw special attention to the unique suffering that the means of attracting support for abolition and was institution of slavery imposed on black women.

published until the close of the Civil War.

Over time, blacks grew disillusioned with the The abolition movement spread its message not AASS and Garrison's refusal to support political agita-only through the emerging abolitionist press but also tion. This became especially poignant after the passage by sponsoring lecture tours. Free-born Charles Lenox of the Fugitive Slave Law of 1850 that threatened the Remond was among the earliest African American freedom of all blacks in America. Douglass and other speakers on the abolitionist lecture circuit. Eventually black abolitionists promoted the election of Abraham abolitionists found that fugitives, like Frederick Lincoln, which sparked the outbreak of the Civil War.

Douglass, were the most effective public speakers for In the end, the Republican North was victorious and abolition. Douglass escaped enslavement in 1838, enslavement was abolished with the Thirteenth published a narrative of his life in 1845, and eventu-Amendment to the U.S.

Constitution in 1865. Garrison ally became the most well-known black abolitionist.

asserted that the American Anti-Slavery Society had African Americans were strong supporters of Garrison achieved its mission, and the organization was disintegrated in the 1830s and 1840s. Garrison attended a number banded. However, others believed that the struggle for of the period's national black conventions, which blacks' civil rights was far from over.

endorsed his work and influenced his ideas.

— Michelle Rief

*Garrison was a strict pacifist who believed that enslavement must be abolished through a strategy of moral persuasion (this later became known as **FURTHER READING***

Garrisonianism). He criticized the Christian clergy for Aptheker, Herbert. (1989). Abolitionism: A Revolutionary their failure to condemn slavery, and he was a strong Movement. Boston: Twayne Publishers. Aptheker provides proponent of women's rights. He opposed involve-a strong class analysis of the movement to overturn the ment in politics and eventually proclaimed the U.S.

principal social institution of the American nation.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 81

American Civil War———81

Benjamin, Quarles. (1969). Black Abolitionists. New York: Northwest territories of Ohio, Michigan, Indiana, Oxford University Press. One of the major African American Illinois, Wisconsin, and Minnesota.

historians examines the often neglected role blacks played As the United States began to expand thanks to in the struggle to end the enslavement. This is a brilliant both the Mexican War and the Louisiana Purchase, examination of the role of key black spokespersons.

the question of slavery in the newly acquired territories-Ripley, C. Peter (Ed.). (1985–1992). *The Black Abolitionist Papers* (5 vols.). Chapel Hill: University of North Carolina Press. This is the standard collection of the African American abolitionist papers produced a firestorm of controversy. In 1818, Congress passed the Missouri Compromise, which

allowed Missouri to be admitted into the union as a free state, so long as slavery was not included in the new territories and above the line 36°30'N latitude. Yee demonstrates in this volume how black women activists contributed to the movement for the elimination of slavery until 1850, when Congress voted to admit enslavement.

California as a state, but in the Compromise of 1850

stipulated that people in the territories seized during the Mexican War be allowed to decide for themselves **AMERICAN CIVIL WAR**

whether or not they would allow slavery. When Congress decided to organize the territories in Kansas and Nebraska, it passed the Kansas-Nebraska Act, which allowed settlers to extend slavery into the new territories. The American Civil War began in 1861 when a Confederate general fired on the Union outpost at newly acquired territories. The passage of this act at Fort Sumter, South Carolina. The war ended in 1865

plunged the Kansas territory into a 4-year cycle of violence with the Confederate surrender at the Appomattox. It was the bloodiest and most as “Bloody Kansas.” Although the antislavery proponents eventually won their fight to keep slavery out of American soil. More than 600,000 men and women in the territory, it added to an already embittered rivalry were killed or mortally wounded while the country between the North and the South.

sustained billions of dollars in property losses.

However, the most notable event to result from the Civil War was the abolition of slavery and the freeing **The Dred Scott Case and**

of those who had been enslaved. Between the 1600s **John Brown's Raid on Harper's Ferry** and 1865, there had been more than 4 million Africans. In 1857, an enslaved African, Dred Scott, sued for held in bondage in America.

his freedom when his master took him to a free territory. Scott argued that his presence in a free territory meant that he was no longer a slave. However, the **CAUSES**

Supreme Court argued that Scott had no right to file. At the center of the controversy was the issue of slavery suit in a state or federal court because he was a slave and its expansion into the Northern and Western territories and considered property. Thus, he was not a citizen of territories that were acquired as a result of the Mexican War from 1846 to 1848. In addition, the Missouri Compromise along with other legislative 11 Southern states that would ultimately make up the limits on slavery unconstitutional.

Confederacy felt that the enslavement of Africans was. In 1859, John Brown and a band of his followers, a vital part of their economy and especially essential some of whom were Africans, attacked and seized a in the growth and exportation of cotton. Northern economic interests, which mostly depended on manufacturing in what is now West Virginia. Brown's plan was to liberate the slaves by using force and did not require slave labor, were affected. Brown and his followers were eventually executed because the South, which had to import its own products. A large number of Northerners, mostly abolitionists from abroad, favored lower tariffs on imported goods, regarded Brown as a martyr and considered his attempt to liberate the slaves as a noble act. The opposition to cheap foreign imports. Moreover, those tariffs North's praise of Brown fueled Southern suspicions helped pay for the improvement of roads and the expansion of Northern abolitionists, who they felt were threatened by expansion of railroads, as well as for expansion of their way of life in the South.

The Southern Secession

THE EMANCIPATION PROCLAMATION

and the Beginning of the War

On January 1, 1963, President Lincoln, at the urging When Abraham Lincoln was elected the 16th pres-of abolitionists like Frederick Douglass, and buoyed ident of the United States in 1860, the South was fear-by the Union Army victory at Antietam 4 months ful that it would mean the end of slavery and thus earlier, signed the Emancipation Proclamation that decided to secede from the Union. In a special session, freed all slaves in all the states that had seceded from the South Carolina Legislature unanimously voted to the union. Although Lincoln's decree did not immedi-leave the union in December of 1860. Other Southern ately free enslaved Africans, it did make the Civil War states followed South Carolina's lead in 1861, and in into a war not only to save the Union but also to end February of that year the states formed the Confederate slavery. In the court of international public opinion, States of America. Jefferson Davis was elected presi-sympathy with the Confederacy meant identifying dent of the Confederacy by the Confederate congress with slavery, thus there was no foreign international and held that position until the eventual defeat of intervention on behalf of the South in the Civil War.

*the South by the Union Army in 1865. Meanwhile, President Lincoln, concerned with preserving the Union, pleaded for the Southern states to rejoin the **African Soldiers in the Union Army** Union. But Lincoln also vowed to protect federal A very important outcome of the Emancipation properties seized by the South and sent a relief vessel Proclamation was that it enabled African males, both to resupply a Union Army outpost at Fort Sumter; free and runaway slaves, the opportunity to join the South Carolina on April 6. Five days later, Fort Union Army. Frederick Douglass gave a speech in Sumter was fired upon and eventually surrendered to*

support of blacks joining the Union cause. In all, the Confederate Army, thus beginning the Civil War.

*approximately 186,000 blacks, in 163 units under white commanding officers, served in the Union Army during the Civil War. By all historical accounts, **THE WAR AND UNION VICTORY***

black soldiers fought bravely and helped to win some. Despite early Confederate victories at Bull Run and key battles during the war, dispelling white notions of on the western front in Missouri in 1861, the Union black inferiority on the battlefield.

Army's vast resources—of leadership, military might, Among the black units that performed well for the and economic power—would ultimately overwhelm Union Army during the Civil War was the 1st Kansas the Confederate Army and spell defeat for the South, Colored Volunteers, which turned back an attack by which surrendered to Union forces in 1865. President the Confederate Army at the battle of Island Mound, Lincoln's signing of the Emancipation Proclamation Missouri. The most well-known battle that black ended Confederate hopes for foreign intervention, soldiers fought was the assault on Fort Wagner by because countries like Great Britain and France had the 54th Massachusetts in July of 1863. During the abolished slavery years earlier and did not want to campaigns of 1864 to 1865, black soldiers partici-become embroiled in a conflict that defended the pated in every major battle except for Sherman's institution of slavery.

March through Georgia. But despite proving their President Lincoln was assassinated shortly after worthiness as soldiers, black soldiers faced discrimi-the war ended in 1865. The war itself cost the nation in pay and other areas. Black soldiers received U.S. government over \$6 billion. It devastated the \$7.00 per month, plus a clothing allowance of \$3.50, economy of the South. The Confederate states lost while whites were paid \$13.00 per month. Some regi-two thirds of their wealth, with the most devastating ments refused pay blacks at all until Congress passed loss coming with the end of slavery. For the enslaved, legislation that granted equal pay to all soldiers.

the end of the Civil War meant freedom. As a result Near the end of the war, when the South found of the Union victory, both houses of Congress passed itself losing battle after battle, the Confederate Army the Thirteenth Amendment, which outlawed slavery.

attempted to raise a regiment of black soldiers. With The Thirteenth Amendment was ratified by three the promise of freedom, a few black Confederate fourths of the states and came into effect in December companies were raised, but the war ended before they of 1865.

could be deployed in battle.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 83

American Colonization Society——83

For blacks, the Civil War and the period of insisted that colonization would put an end to enslave-Reconstruction provided freedom from enslavement, ment. However, there were others who wanted to but it did not provide equality with whites. Despite the maintain enslavement, as well as eliminate the free Fourteenth and Fifteenth Amendments guaranteeing Africans they believed threatened the institution of blacks' rights, and the elections of black public officials slavery and could potentially encourage insurrections to political office, blacks were relegated to second-class among enslaved Africans.

citizenship. That this was the intention of many As early as 1714, a New Jersey man had suggested became clear when in 1877 the federal troops protect-sending Africans back to Africa. Soon after the ing blacks were ordered out of the South and Southern Revolutionary War, a Virginia legislative committee states instituted Jim Crow laws to legally establish the led by Thomas Jefferson devised a plan of gradual color line.

emancipation and deportation. Other organizations also pursued the idea of colonization. Paul Cuffee, a

— Christopher Murray

free African and accomplished businessman and sea-farer, was the first to actually succeed in relocating **FURTHER READING**

Africans from the United States to Africa. In 1815, Blight, David. (2001). Race and Reunion: The Civil War in using his own resources, he transported 38 Africans.

American Memory. Cambridge, MA: Harvard University The philanthropists, abolitionists, and clergy Press. In this book, Blight explores the deeper meaning of wanted to free enslaved Africans and their descen- the Civil War in American memory.

dants, and give them the opportunity to emigrate back Randall, J. G., and Donald, David. (1969). The Civil War and Reconstruction. Lexington, MA: Heath. This work seeks to to Africa, whereas the slaveowners and their sympa-demonstrate that Reconstruction must be seen as an exten-thizers, fearing that free Africans threatened the insti-sion of the national will.

tution of enslavement, wanted to rid the nation of these Vorenburg, Michael. (2001). Final Freedom: The Civil War,

“troublemakers.” It was difficult for the latter group to The Abolition of Slavery, and the Thirteenth Amendment.

imagine a society in which whites were integrated with Cambridge, UK: Cambridge University Press. This is a blacks. Nevertheless, the ACS included both of these very good book on the causes and effects of the Civil War.

groups. Many whites believed that Africans were inferior and maintained that the African presence was an obstacle to American progress and development.

AMERICAN

For these reasons, they supported colonization.

*In December 1816, Finley traveled to Washington, **COLONIZATION SOCIETY***

D.C., where he secured the support for the ACS from prominent white Americans. Among the early founders The American Colonization Society (ACS), which were Finley's brother-in-law, Elias B. Caldwell, clerk was originally called the American Society for of the Supreme Court; attorney Francis Scott Key Colonizing the Free People of Color in the United (author of "The Star Spangled Banner"); Supreme States, was founded in 1816 in Washington, D.C. The Court Justice Bushrod Washington, the nephew of society was started by Robert Finley, a white George Washington; Henry Clay, the Speaker of the Presbyterian minister from Basking Ridge, New House; and Charles Fenton Mercer, a member of the Jersey, who like many white Americans of his time House of Representatives. Soon after adopting a con-believed that the African presence in the United States stitution, the group spent several years fundraising for threatened the welfare of the nation and the quality of the society. To that end, the society lobbied Congress life for white people. Therefore, the primary aim of and James Monroe, the president of the United States.

the ACS was to assist all free Africans in the United In 1819, Congress granted the ACS \$100,000 in fund-States in emigrating to a colony established in Africa.

ing. Some white-owned companies believed that they Liberia was created for that purpose, and Sierra Leone could profit from the ACS venture. To raise funds for was created by Great Britain for similar reasons.

the enterprise, the ACS dispersed agents. Thousands of Some within the ACS thought that emigration was dollars were collected to purchase and charter ships.

a viable alternative to emancipation. However, the By 1832, several legislatures had given the ACS offi-members of the ACS varied considerably in their cial approval. Even slave-holding states had coloniza-beliefs. Some sincerely supported free Africans. They tion organizations. The ACS was the largest of such

84—*American Negro Academy*

organization but was by no means the only organiza-referred to colonization as “the twin sister to slavery.”

tion committed to colonization. Southern newspapers He was adamantly opposed to state or national also contributed to the cause of colonization of free resources being used to support such a venture. Other Africans.

prominent Africans who opposed colonization were In January of 1820, the ACS sailed its inaugural Samuel Cornish, David Walker, Maria Stewart, voyage with 88 Africans and 3 whites. However, Richard Allen, and James Forten. Two of the most 22 Africans and all 3 whites died of yellow fever famous white abolitionists, William Lloyd Garrison within 3 weeks. In spite of several conflicts between and Albion Tourgee, also opposed the aims of the ACS

emigrants and the local populations, within 10 years, and argued bitterly against colonization.

more than 1,400 Africans emigrated to Liberia with By the mid 1820s, most African abolitionists the assistance of the ACS. By 1838, approximately believed that the ACS was a proslavery effort to rid the 2,500 Africans had made the journey from the United United States of free Africans. Many in the African States to Liberia. The society hired mostly whites to community were loud and passionate about their oppo-govern the colony. In 1847, the capital of Liberia was sition to colonization. In 1817, in Philadelphia alone, established and named Monrovia after President Richard Allen and James Forten led 3,000 African James Monroe. In all, the ACS settled more than voices in opposing colonization. The ACS was not 12,000 Africans in Liberia.

an abolitionist organization, they maintained, but a The response of Africans in the United States to proslavery organization with the sole purpose of forc-colonization and the ACS varied. The ACS membering free Africans to choose between reenslavement and ship began to decline in the

mid 1800s, but the colo-banishment. These Africans said they felt entitled to nization movement did not. Prominent Africans in the everything it meant to be American, regardless of the United States who supported the idea of colonization reality of their day. Many of them believed that included Paul Cuffee, Alexander Crummell, John America was their homeland and asserted they knew Russwurm, Martin R. Delany, Edward Blyden, and nothing of Africa. By far, there were many more Bishop Henry McNeal Turner. These advocates Africans who rejected colonization than there were believed that full equality in a racist America could Africans who embraced it.

never be achieved and that colonization was the best

— Adisa A. Alkebulan

*alternative. Thus Delany advocated colonization, but he denounced the ACS and Liberia as a “mockery of a **FURTHER READING***

government” because of its close relationship with the ACS.

Franklin, John H., and Moss, Alfred R. (2000). From Slavery Many factors militated in favor of colonization, to Freedom: A History of African Americans (8th ed.).

including Christian nationalism and trade, the New York: McGraw-Hill. This text offers a critical look at the early emigration movement in the United States.

Christian mission to “civilize” Africa, the acknowl-McCartney, John T. (1992). Black Power Ideologies: An Essay edgement of Africa as a land of riches and black in African-American Political Thought. Philadelphia: regeneration, and the economic depression in the Temple University Press. McCartney describes advocates United States. Only Blyden, a Christian himself, and critics of the colonization movement, as well as the rejected the notion of Christian nationalism and civi-philosophies that guided the opposing views.

lization. He respected the indigenous traditions of African people and recognized the damage that Western “civilization” and Christianity had done to Africa and Africans. Many Africans were rightly sus-AMERICAN NEGRO ACADEMY

picious of the ACS. Cuffee was skeptical of the ACS, but he continued to support it despite his reservations.

The American Negro Academy (ANA) was founded on The ACS and the idea of colonization were not March 8, 1897 in Washington, D.C. The academy was without their critics. Many abolitionists, black and the brainchild of the Reverend Alexander Crummell white, opposed the goals of the ACS and questioned (1819–1898), who was the son of an African prince, as its motives. Chief among them was Frederick well as an intellectual and an Episcopal priest.

Douglass, who believed that colonization supported Crummell had met with four men on December 18 of the false notion that Africans were inferior. He the previous year to discuss his idea of an association of

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 85

Amistad Research Center———85

the most eminent African men with the purpose of did not quite reach the masses of black people the raising the consciousness of African people. The four way it had hoped, because many black people were so men were John Wesley Cromwell (1846–1927) and preoccupied with the daily battles of life that they Walter B. Hayson (1822–1905), two Washington public hardly took notice of the academy.

school teachers; Paul Laurence Dunbar (1872–1906), In 1924, Crummell’s ANA ceased to exist. Decades a poet; and Kelly Miller (1863–1939), a mathemat-later, in 1968, poets, historians, artists, and scholars ics professor at Howard University. Subsequently, took up the banner of the ANA—including Julian Crummell increased his effort to put together a group

“Cannonball” Adderley, Margaret Walker, James to protect, promote, and advance the African people Baldwin, Harry Belafonte, John Hope Franklin, Ossie by calling together 18 of the greatest African minds of and Ruby D. Davis, Nina Simone, and Lerone his day to meet at Lincoln Memorial Church.

Bennett, Jr. In March of 1969, after a series of meet-By the end of the first meeting, the men had set ings, these dedicated individuals founded the Black the organization into motion. The membership was to Academy of Arts and Letters (BAAL) to carry on the be 40 elected men who had distinguished themselves work of the American Negro Academy.

as college graduates, professors, artists, or writers.

— Del-Zola Moore

*The group, under the leadership of Crummell, adopted and signed a constitution and named the first national **FURTHER READING***

scholarly organization dedicated to the advancement of African culture the American Negro Academy.

Moss, Alfred, Jr. (1981). The American Negro Academy: Voice The number of elected men was soon increased to 50.

of the Talented Tenth. Baton Rouge: Louisiana State Their mission was to defend Africans against vicious University. This is the best work on the development of the American Negro Academy.

assaults, foster higher education, publish scholarly works, and help cultivate intellectual taste by promoting original literature, art, and science.

The American Negro Academy was the first organi-AMISTAD RESEARCH CENTER

zation, and the only organization in America at that time, to gather black scholars and artists from all over the world. It was the first learned society created by Amistad is a manuscripts library and archival reposi-black

Americans. During its lifetime, the academy published more than 20 scholarly papers written by some of America's many populations, Africa, and the African of the finest minds of the black community, such as diaspora. Founded in 1966, the center takes its name Alexander Crummell's "Civilization: The Primal Need from a significant incident in American history, the of the Race and Attitude of the American Mind Toward Amistad Schooner Revolt of 1839. Singbe Pieh (later Negro Intellect," J. L. Lowe's "Disfranchisement of the called Cinque) led Africans illegally taken from their Negro," and William Pickens's "The Status of the Free land and destined for slave plantations in Havana, Negro from 1860-1970."

Cuba, in a revolt on a Spanish schooner called La The contributors to the American Negro Academy Amistad. While attempting to return home, the included W.E.B. Du Bois, Carter G. Woodson, Alain Africans were tricked instead into steering toward the Locke, John Mercer Langston, and Francis J. Grimke.

United States, where they were captured and put on These scholars were interested in advancing the work trial. A group of Christian abolitionists took up their of the race in such a way as to defy the racist category-cause and paid their legal costs. The Africans' case rization leveled against African people. The academy wound its way through the U.S. court system, but it worked hard to strengthen the intellectual life of the was not until former U.S. president John Quincy black community, improve the quality of black lead-Adams argued on their behalf before the Supreme ership, and protect the black community from the Court that the Africans finally won their freedom.

effects of racism. The American Negro Academy lasted into the 1920s. By the end of its lifetime, the **THE AMERICAN MISSIONARY ASSOCIATION**

academy had reached most of its goals by educating African Americans and providing an outlet for the This same group of abolitionists later formed an inter-black intelligentsia to publish their works. However, it racial organization called the American Missionary

86—***Amistad Research Center***

Association (AMA). The AMA founded hundreds of of Greater New Orleans; the Southern civil rights churches and schools for African Americans, Native litigation records; Mississippi businesswoman and Americans, Puerto Ricans, Appalachian whites, Asian activist Clarie Collins Harvey; and the Anti-Americans, and Hispanics. Distinguished colleges and Defamation League of B'nai B'rith.

universities that emerged from these efforts include Amistad's literary and musical collections are Atlanta, Berea, Dillard, Hampton, Houston-Tillotson, unprecedented in size and scope. Researchers come LeMoyne-Owen, Piedmont, Talladega, Tougaloo, and from around the world to examine the papers of poet Fisk, where the Amistad Research Center was estab-Countee Cullen, writer Chester Himes, scholar and lished under the guidance of Clifton H. Johnson.

activist W.E.B. Du Bois, poet and human rights Johnson, after completing the arrangement of activist Frank S. Horne, playwright Tom Dent, and AMA papers, recognized the need for an institution musicians Harold Battiste, Anne Wiggins Brown, that would document the lives and activities of those Harold Swanson, William Warfield, and Camilla ethnic groups with which the AMA had historically Williams. Amistad's holdings on Africa are also worked, specifically African Americans and other impressive in their breath and scope. They include the ethnic communities. Initially under auspices of the papers of the first organization to report on the inhu-AMA's Race Relations Department at Fisk, the center man apartheid system in South Africa, the American was later incorporated as an independent institution Committee on Africa. Established in 1948, this orga-with a permanent board of directors. The Amistad nization went on to document political struggles all began with its core collection—the AMA papers, over the continent of Africa. The center's other hold-which include over 350,000 documents—and then ings include the papers of Operations Crossroads went on to collect other important records.

Africa, an organization used as a model for the Peace During the turbulent years after World War II, the Corps; sociologist Victor Du Bois; and U.N. Press AMA established their Race Relations Department to Corps journalist Marguerite Cartwright.

address racism and pluralism in American society.

In 1994, under the direction of Clyde Robertson, The Race Relations Department records, incorporated director of Africana Studies for the New Orleans into the Amistad Research Center's holdings, were Public Schools, Amistad collaborated in the develop-among the first documents to address the issues of ment of the first Afrocentric Archives in this country.

civil and human rights. These records give Amistad Housed at the Amistad Research Center, these manu-the distinction of being one of the first institutions to script collections represent the leading scholars within actively document the modern civil rights movement.

*the Afrocentric paradigm. They include the work of Molefi Kete Asante, considered the father of the Afrocentric movement, lecturer and writer Runoko **THE AMISTAD'S HOLDINGS***

Rashidi, and sociologist James L. Conyers, Jr.

Amistad arguably has the nation's premiere holdings Amistad also has an art collection universally on those participants and organizations that helped accepted as the finest collection of art in the Deep shape its progress. The collections encompass the South. The collection consists of 19th-and 20th-activities of attorneys, politicians, artists, writers, and century artists such as Edward Mitchell Bannister, others who often placed their lives on the line. Some Richmond Barthe, Selma Burke, Elizabeth Catlett, notable collections include the papers of New Orleans's Claude Clark, Aaron Douglas, Vivian Ellis, Palmer first black mayor, Ernest "Dutch" Morial; Mississippi Hayden, Malvin Gray Johnson, William H. Johnson, activist Fannie Lou Hamer; the Race Relations Lois Mailou Jones, Martin Payne, William Pajaud, Information Center; U.S. Congressman William William E. Scott, Henry O. Tanner, Hale Woodruff, Jefferson; Michigan Senator Carl Levin; the National and Frank Wyley.

The most celebrated pieces in the Committee Against Discrimination in Housing; the collection are Funeral Procession of 1940 by Ellis National Association for the Advancement of Colored People and the 41 paintings in the Toussaint People (NAACP) of New Orleans and Memphis; the L'Ouverture series by Jacob Lawrence. Of these original Montgomery Bus Boycott participant inter-individuals, Amistad also holds the personal papers views; NAACP attorney A. P. Tureaud; former NAACP

of Catlett, Ellis, Pajaud, Barthe, Woodruff, and executive director Benjamin Hooks; the Urban League Wyley.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 87

***Amsterdam News*——87**

The center also houses an excellent collection of African textiles made during the late 19th and early

AMSTERDAM NEWS

20th centuries by artisans from the Kuba kingdom in Zaire. Other African objects at Amistad are from The Amsterdam News is one of the oldest and most West, Central, and East Africa and include masks, well known African American-owned newspapers in carved figures and posts, musical instruments, calabash the United States; and perhaps the most well known art, utilitarian and sacred containers and vessels, African American newspaper in the world. The basketry, ceremonial clothing, cast metal objects and Amsterdam News was established by James H.

figures, and iron currency.

Anderson on December 4, 1909. Anderson settled in This is only a cursory description of the treasures Harlem, New York, and decided to embark on creat-housed at the Amistad Research Center. Currently ing a newspaper that would reflect the lives of those in residing on the campus of Tulane University in New the Harlem community. The Amsterdam News, named Orleans, Louisiana, the center continues to collect, after Amsterdam Avenue, the street that Anderson preserve, and make accessible its holdings

through lived on, served as a forum where members of the onsite research, public forums, publications, audio-Harlem community could give voice to their thoughts, and videotaped personal histories, digital online fears, hopes, and aspirations. The African Americans exhibits, and collaborative projects. With over 10 mil-in Harlem saw the 2-cent, 6-page newspaper as a lion primary source documents dating from 1780 to place where their community was the focal point, as the present, more than 20,000 books, 1,000 runs of the Amsterdam News covered local events such as periodicals, 30,000 pamphlets, 1½ million news clip-black community organizations and the local political pings, 74,000 reels of microfilm, over 300 works of and social issues of the time. In less than a year art, over 600 pieces of African art, and more than 400

the Amsterdam News had become a success. As audio- and videotapes, Amistad can truly say it docu-a result, Anderson decided to expand his newspaper ments America's diversity.

and partnered with Edward A. Warren, an African American businessman. Some years later, in 1921,

— Rebecca Hankins

when Warren died, Anderson sold his share of the newspaper to Warren's relatives and turned to satisfy-FURTHER READING

ing other goals. Anderson became a civic leader, served as a Boy Scout commissioner, and ran for Johnson, Clifton H. (1969). A New History: An Essential alderman, while the paper he had founded continued Alternative to Narrow White Mythology. Journal of Current Social Issues, 7, 8 – 11. Johnson presents an argu-to prosper.

ment in this essay for the founding of the Amistad Research In 1930, the Amsterdam News became the first Center and the development of its mission.

African American newspaper to join the Audit Bureau Johnson, Clifton H. (1989). A Legacy of La Amistad: Some of Circulation. Even when the Great Depression cre-Twentieth Century Black Leaders. The International ated

many financial challenges for the newspaper, the *Review of African American Art*, VIII(2), 4 – 23. This essay *Amsterdam News* made history and became the first looks at the production of black leaders, educators, and African American–owned newspaper to have a fully activists through the American Missionary Association unionized African American staff. However, as the educational institutions.

Johnson, Clifton H. (1990). *The Amistad Case and Its Great Depression continued to wreak havoc on the Consequences in U.S. History. Journal of the New Haven world economy, the Warrens' financial difficulties Colony Historical Society*, XXXVI, 113–143. Johnson's compelled them to sell the *Amsterdam News* for essay examines the historical and legal impact the case had \$5,000 to C. B. Powell and Philip M. H. Savory.

on American society and the issues surrounding slavery Powell and Savory recreated the *Amsterdam News*, and emancipation. It is also available online at <http://www.changing.it> from a community-based newspaper that .tulane.edu/~amistad

mostly dealt with local issues in Harlem into a news-Morris, Robert C. (1981). *Reading, 'Riting, and Reconstruc-paper that represented the collective voice of African tion: The Education of Freedmen in the South, 1861–1870.*

Chicago: University of Chicago Press. This is a history of America. Thus the *Amsterdam News* began to deal the early freedmen schools and their impact on the educa-with national politics that affected the African tion of blacks in the South.

American community.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 88

88——— *An Appeal to the Colored Citizens of the World*

During the 1960s, the *Amsterdam News* was the institution of slavery. Definitely no one prior to him premier newspaper for the civil rights and

black had ever distributed a pamphlet as incendiary as An nationalist movements. The Amsterdam News gave a Appeal to the Colored Citizens of the World.

platform to both the Judeo-Christian nonviolence of It is believed that Walker was born in North the civil rights movement, which was under the lead-Carolina in 1785 of a free mother. At an early age, he ership of Martin Luther King, Jr., and the black nation-left North Carolina and settled in Boston, where he alist movement of Elijah Muhammad and Malcolm X.

became a barber. The discussions Walker had with Malcolm X even wrote a column in the newspaper clients in his barber's chair fueled his opposition to titled "God's Angry Man." Despite this prosperity, in the system of enslavement that had trapped Africans 1971 the Amsterdam News was once again sold, this in perpetual bondage. Walker became increasingly time for \$2.3 million to a group of African American angered by the system that defined Africans as infe-businessmen that included Wilbert Tatum, who was to rior to whites—and especially by the hypocrisy of become important at the paper. With the leadership of white Christian Americans, whom he said were the this group, the Amsterdam News went through another most brutal people on the face of the earth.

transformation, moving away from its radical and mil-In the 1820s, most African people were not as itant stance and becoming a more liberal newspaper.

convinced as David Walker was that the only way As the result of a strike in 1984, Tatum became not Africans would be free was for Africans to free them—simply an investor but also the publisher and editor of selves. This belief, which was the beginning of the the Amsterdam News. Under the guidance of Tatum, school of thought that has been called nationalism, the Amsterdam News returned to a more militant and influenced the thought of the most electrifying intel-progressive position. In 1997, Tatum's daughter, Elinor lectuals and political activists in African American Tatum, became editor-in-chief of the newspaper, and history. Walker predated Henry Highland Garnet, under her supervision the Amsterdam News continues Bishop Henry McNeal Turner, Martin Delany, to be an avenue where the issues, concerns, and voices Alexander Crummell, and Marcus Garvey.

of African America are expressed.

Walker was fed up with the fact that the abject conditions of the African community did not cause more

— *Kiera Hope Foster*

*revolution. He was familiar with Thomas Jefferson's Notes on the State of Virginia (1785), as well as with the **FURTHER READING***

revolution in Haiti, Gabriel Prosser's 1800 conspiracy, Pride, Armistead S., & Wilson, Clint C. (1997). The History and Denmark Vesey's 1822 attempted revolt. Walker's of the Black Press. Washington, DC: Howard University education and passion enabled him to produce the most Press. This text gives a comprehensive history of the challenging document written by an African in America African American Press in the United States.

until that time. An Appeal to the Colored Citizens of the
www.amsterdamnews.org This is the official Web site of the Amsterdam News, which provides the history of the news-World consisted of a direct call to the enslaved Africans paper, full text articles, and other relevant information.

to rise up against their masters in a violent revolt.

In addition to being a barber, Walker had a small tailoring business in Boston. His shop was very likely

AN APPEAL TO THE COLORED

a gathering place for those who engaged in antislavery activities, as his pamphlet was distributed as far as the

CITIZENS OF THE WORLD

Carolinas by black Bostonian seamen. Walker was a member of the Massachusetts General Colored David Walker, a free black man, published a militant Association that was organized in 1826 to petition the antislavery pamphlet, David Walker's Appeal in Four Massachusetts government in the

interests of African Articles; Together with a Preamble to the Coloured Americans. In addition, Walker was a representative Citizens of the World, But Particularly and Very for Freedom's Journal from 1827 to 1829.

Expressly to Those of the United States, which Walker's speech to the 1828 convention of the became known as An Appeal to the Colored Citizens Massachusetts General Colored Association was a of the World and was distributed widely throughout preview of his pamphlet. In the speech, he admon-the Eastern seaboard of the United States. Walker may ished the Africans in his audience to work toward have been the first black militant to write against the self-determination and self-help. It was clear that

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 89

Ancestor Veneration——89

*Walker did not believe that dependency on whites was the solution to the problems of Africans in **ANCESTOR VENERATION***

Massachusetts. It would be seen later in An Appeal to the Colored Citizens of the World that what he Africans have long believed that the ritualized propitia-believed about Africans in Massachusetts he also tion and invocation of dead kin could influence the fate believed about the masses of Africans everywhere.

of the living. This is not exclusively an African practice, Walker stressed that only Africans' active efforts in but it has probably been brought to its most complex and their own interest would change their situation.

elaborate levels by Africans. The Chinese, Melanesians, When Walker's appeal came out in September of and Japanese also have constructed system of ancestral 1829, it was one of the most politically explosive veneration. In Africa, the relationship between the living works ever written in America. Walker's appeal was and the dead is a manifestation of the continuity of pointed, historical, biblical, and prophetic. It was a community in a specific familial way. When a society call for action and an argument for the humanity of passes concepts, art forms, and myths from generation African people. According to Walker, only the self-to generation, those ideas

are enshrined in the society's determination and self-definition of Africans them-memory as worthy of emulation.

selves could raise African people from slavery and the Everything must be approached through the ances-inequality handed out by whites. Walker believed that tors. This means that in classical African religion if to achieve Africans' freedom there must be vio-

(CAR) there is always ancestral priority, presence, lence, then there must be violence, as God could not and power. The ancestral spirits are the most intimate want Africans to be enslaved against their wills.

divinities and must be consulted on important occa-It is no wonder that the legislatures of several sions. Africans regard the ancestors as the keepers of Southern states offered a reward for Walker's head.

morality. One of the ways descendants of the ances-South Carolina and Georgia wanted Walker so intensely tors maintain a balanced society is by avoiding the that they were willing to offer \$10,000 if he were deliv-activities that were considered immoral by the ances-ered alive, or \$1,000 if dead. In the North, white aboli-tors. Sudden deaths are often thought to be attributed tionists who were nonviolent in their philosophies, such to punishments inflicted by ancestors. Therefore, the as William Lloyd Garrison and Benjamin Lundy, criti-living must do everything they can to avoid crossing cized Walker for being too forceful in his rhetoric. Nine the moral path laid down by the departed ancestors.

months after the publication of An Appeal to the The social fabric of African communities is woven Colored Citizens of the World, Walker was found dead together by ancestor reverence. It is the source of under unknown circumstances. Many historians have many domestic and institutional relationships. It is conjectured that he was assassinated, although it has not not a reflection of any supernatural world, but rather, been possible to prove this theory conclusively.

a part of the world in which Africans who practice CAR live. Thus the manner of reverence of African

— Molefi Kete Asante

people is relatively similar, making it possible to **FURTHER READING**

speaking of the commonalities of ancestor reverence among Africans.

Aptheker, Herbert. (1987). *American Negro Slave Revolts*.

New York: International. Aptheker's study remains one of the significant works on the lives and actions of black **THE LINE OF DESCENT**

activists and revolutionaries.

Asante, Molefi Kete. (2001). *African American History: A The descent line is the basic structural component for Journey of Liberation*. Saddle Brook, NJ: Peoples all groups that practice ancestor reverence. Africans Publishing Group. This book gives a historical context to know who to revere by knowing to whom they belong.

the struggle for liberation in African American history from Constant ritualizing reverence of the First Ancestors an Afrocentric perspective.

helps to reinforce the appreciation for a particular Walker, David. (1995). *David Walker's Appeal in Four descent group*. Sometimes the main descent group Articles; Together with a Preamble to the Coloured can be augmented by other ethnic or clan groups. For Citizens of the World, But Particularly and Very Expressly to Those of the United States. New York: Hill and Wang.

instance, the Ndebele people of Zimbabwe were origi-

(Original work published 1829). This is the complete text nally a royal clan of the Zulu of South Africa, but of Walker's very powerful pamphlet.

during their migration and conquest northward out of

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 90

South Africa they acquired new clans and ethnic groups because the calling of the names of the ancestors who now appropriate some of the same ancestors.

makes clear the lineage of groups and individuals.

For many African people, the descent is through CAR ancestor reverence or worship should not be the mother, that is, matrilineal. Thus the ancestor to be confused with cults of the dead. In and of itself, death revered would come from the mother's side of the has no divine qualities in CAR. African people wor-family. The father would be a part of this family line ship something far more significant than merely the by virtue of his marriage to the direct descendant. In dead. Practitioners of CAR believe that in actual fact some cases, the father would also revere the ancestors those who have lived among us affect our lives after of his father. The idea is that the ancestor revered death. The deification of the ancestral spirit is essen-must be within the family structure. If the structure is tial to the religion, and death must occur for the patrilineal, then the ancestors are from the father's process of deification to take place. Ancestor reverside and the mother may participate in the reverence ence, therefore, is not the same as practices dealing as a member of the family.

with ghosts and spirits and hobgoblins. The ancient Greeks believed in such ghost and shade cults but did not have ancestor reverence.

A RELIGION OF THE ANCESTORS

There is a widespread practice of ancestor rever-CAR is preeminently a religion of the ancestors. Thus ence on the continent of Africa; therefore the practices the Swazi king appeals to the ancestors on behalf of are varied. The Ga of Ghana and the Nuer of the the nation, showing himself to be the chief priest. This Sudan, two of the several groups without an elaborate pattern of royal intercession is followed by many system of ancestor reverence, still have a strong belief other African groups, though it is not universal. What in the veneration of ancestors on special occasions.

is common and extensively practiced is sacrifice. For The Ga have ritualized libations in the name of the the Swazi this means that each year

an animal must be honored dead during naming ceremonies, marriages, dedicated to a specific royal ancestor and may only be and the Homowo Festival. Their practice, and that of eaten by the direct descendants of that ancestor.

the Nuer, may be somewhat like the practices of the While it is true that ancestors are revered, it is also Jews and Catholics, both of whom name ancestors on true that not all ancestors are revered in the same way.

special occasions. The Jews name ancestors on the A congregation, that is, a kinship group, so to speak, New Year and Day of Atonement, and the Catholics does not provide ritual service or respect to every have masses in the names of the ancestor saints. The ancestor in all situations of worship. The ancestors Ibo of Nigeria believe that the ancestors profoundly who are accorded respect in a given situation are pri-influence all actions in society. Rather than kings rul-marily those who are exclusive to the worshipping ing their towns, the Ibo have a group of elders who group. This helps Africans to distinguish between col-govern the community. The Ibo venerate ancestors in lateral groups, perhaps in the same ethnic group. On a very significant, elaborate way, which has a farthe other hand, some ancestors are more than family, reaching importance in their society. The Ibo people they are national, that is, all families in the ethnic offer sacrifices regularly, and no one eats or drinks group are derived from them.

without giving a portion to the ancestors.

The complexity of the practice of ancestor reverThe spirits of the dead are the ancestors, and the ence varies among ethnic groups. However, in most forces of nature represent their activities. The powers groups the connections between the religion and prop-behind the storms, rain, rivers, seas, lakes, hills, and erty, marriage, birth, death, and titles to membership rocks are the spirits of the ancestors. They are not and leadership of the group are clearly tied to just the rocks or water but the spiritual powers capa-geneonymy, the commemoration of the ancestors by ble of manifesting anywhere. There is no separation name. Everyone who calls the name of the ancestors between religious activity and other activities. The must use the accepted sequence, because that is the relationship between the living, the dead, and the way the group establishes itself as a congregation.

Supreme God is one of mutuality and connectedness.

Geneonymy is also important for its establishment of Humans are intertwined with the divine; there is no a focus on the ancestors. Every member of the con-seam in the relationship. The spiritual world is inter-gregation knows exactly to whom he or she belongs.

related with the natural world. Thus, according to the There is no confusion about this in the ethnic group, Shona of Zimbabwe, the Supreme God, Mwari, is

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 91

Ancestor Veneration——91

connected through the ancestors and spirit mediums such as a stool that represents the validation of the to the living. The natural world, the world of trees, proper ancestral lineage. For the Akan, ancestor ven-rocks, rivers, and so forth, has a direct connection to eration is more than a filial relationship to the father the spiritual world by way of moral geography. When or mother; it is a kinship event rooted in their political all people look at the natural world, they can identify and philosophical system. Those members of the lin-forest, birds, mountains, rivers, hills, and insects; eage who are heads of households or holders of office this is a biological or ecological system. But when may become enshrined as venerated ancestors. What practitioners of CAR view the natural world through is true for the Akan matrilineal system is also true for the lens of moral geography, they see sacred mountains, the patrilineal system in terms of the rules of selection sacred trees, sacred hills, and sacred rivers.

and veneration.

THE IDENTIFICATION OF ANCESTORS

ETERNAL LIFE

To become an ancestor, death is necessary, but it is not As ancestors, people are able to prolong their legal enough. Most practitioners of CAR make a

distinction existence through their heirs. Those who become between the dead and the ancestors. The Tallensi ancestors may have been people with bad tempers or people believe that those who die without offspring poor judgment, but it becomes the inescapable duty of live a ghostly existence because they have no one to their heirs to venerate them because the ancestors con-provide reverence for them. The Fon of Dahomey say tinue to live effectively in the world. Accordingly, it that the dead (*chio*) are not the same as the ancestors does not matter what a person's relationship has been (*tovodu*). Dahomey, which is now called Benin, is the with the ancestors, once these people have become African nation with the largest proportion of its popu-ancestors, it is necessary for that person to venerate lation practicing CAR, and thus it also has the most them regardless of their successes or failures as complex ritual system for deifying the dead and turn-people. All ancestors have equal standing, as they ing them into ancestors.

have all been ritualized into ancestorhood and this car-Clearly Africans' practice of ancestor veneration ries with it the power to influence lives and intervene involves a pantheon of deities, but although such a in activities of their descendants.

pantheon exists in all of these congregations, it is most The Tallensi people believe, along with many other often a judicious and limited one. Africans do not have Africans, that if a man has no sons, he cannot become thousands of deities, as the Hindus do, or even scores of an ancestor, regardless of his virtue and success in deities, as the ancient Greeks did; they have only the life. Without an heir to venerate him, he is in danger robust ancestral spirits that have been properly called of a grievous travesty. What holds for the ancestor, into service by ritual. These spirits have been brought holds for the descendants. The eldest son must offici-home again and have manifested themselves in the ate regardless of his moral condition or his intellectual service of the community. Through prayers, rituals, capacity. No one can take away from him his right to sacrifices, and incest prohibition and other taboo injunc-lead the veneration of the ancestors of his parents. He tions, the community acknowledges the dead person as alone has the lifelong responsibility to carry out the joining the cosmography of the ancestral world.

functions of libation and sacrifices for the ancestor. If The Akan of Ghana have developed an ancestor he fails to do so, he will be in grave peril. Should reverence based on kinship. The matrilineal forbears others try to take away his right to fulfill his responsibilities can become ancestors and receive veneration. The bility, they will be in peril.

Akan people's system is connected to their philosophy. Similarly, all of the ancestors behave the same way that every person is comprised of the *ntoro*, the *sun-toward their descendants, irrespective of the ances-sum*, the *mogya*, and the *abusua*. The father transmits tors' characters in life. Ancestors who had been good the *ntoro*, personality, to the child, but the *ntoro* does people behave just like those who had been bad not survive death. The *sunsum* is the spirit of the child people. In addition, they intervene in the lives of their that exists always. The mother transmits the *mogya*, heirs regardless of the character of those heirs. An heir the blood, and the *abusua*, the family lineage. What could be trifling or upright and thrifty, and yet the survives and is transmuted to become the ancestor is ancestral intervention will make no distinction based the spirit, a name attached to certain ritualized relics on this difference. The ancestors exact ritual service

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 92

92———Ancestor Veneration

and veneration in accordance with the rules of 80 days so that the flesh decomposed, and then charms intervention, which are the same for all heirs.

were fastened onto the skeleton. The Swazi specialists squeezed the fluids from the body to prevent rapid decay. The Swazi king, divine in life, was apotheosized **ANCESTOR VENERATION**

in death and entered the ranks of the ancestors.

HOLDS BACK CHAOS

CAR believers accept that ancestors are ever living.

None of this is a matter of good or evil; it is a matter of This is not worship in the Christian sense. Ancestors holding back chaos in the world. In fact, the ancestors do not replace the supreme deity. Ancestors have do not punish or persecute their descendants for powers that the living do not have, and to obtain their wickedness or reward them for goodness. However, blessings the living must avert their anger and win the ancestors may harass or trouble the descendants their favor. Since humans are in the midst of primal for their failure to provide religious submission or ser-struggle between good and evil, they need all the vice. The ancestors are not punishing authorities but assistance they can gather. Who better to provide judges who are concerned with the prosperity of the people with assistance in this struggle than their own lineage. They are attuned to the needs of the people ancestors who have a stake in their survival? Every and provide corrective intervention when necessary.

person is involved in the struggle for continuity, not Thus to the practitioner of CAR, ancestor veneration just political heroes. There are different approaches or reverence is a body of religious beliefs that are to this among African people.

aligned with rules of conduct for designated authori-It was a common practice for the Asante army to ties in the social system of most African societies.

call upon famous Asante warriors during battle. The Attending to the rites of ancestors is one way to con-names would be spoken, shouted, and sung as the tinue to bind the people together in one community, army went into battle. The Yoruba called upon a myth-because ancestors show the continuity of the society ical god of war. With war comes death. The general and compel communal action when it is necessary.

attitude of Africans toward the dead is one of respect.

Death represents a separation, but always a sepa-There are specific taboos about death in some African rartion that is provoked or brought about by some-ethnic groups. Some groups do not even speak the thing. Death does not happen for no reason. The word *death*. However, most African taboos are not Swazis believe that no one dies without some sort of about death

but, rather, involve prohibitions against sorcery, that people do not die from sickness or old sexual relations with certain people and under certain age and no one dies a natural death. The Lovedu circumstances. The incest taboos apply to a larger belief that the life of the Rain-Queen does not end range of people in Africa than in Europe. In Africa, with her death because she becomes divine by taking the taboos apply not only to members of the same her own life. She takes poison, which contains the family but also to members of the same clan or lin-brain and spinal cord of a crocodile, among other eage. Taboos against marriage tend to be stronger and things. The queen is then buried in a deep grave stand-stricter than those against copulation. The rules of ing upright and facing north from whence came her exogamy (i.e., marriage outside of a specific group), ancestors. The body is wrapped in cloth and ox skin.

which are the direct result of these taboos, influence It is buried with beads, water, a firebrand, a mat, and, the social structure of African societies. The rules reg-in the ancient days, a male corpse. The grave is grad-ulate the exchange of women and marriage compen-ually filled up and is only completely covered after sation and maintain the society's cohesion. There has, 6 months, when the head has decomposed. A year however, been ceremonial violation of incest taboos later the fires are put out and then ritually relit and a by some of the royal families of Central Africa.

new queen is installed. Like the language of death in The taboos concerning death vary. The Akan other African ethnic groups, the Lovedu's references people of Ghana have taboos against speaking of to death are indirect. They say "the house is broken,"

death at all and would never say that the king is dead.

"the king is busy," "the mountain has fallen," "the These taboos are so serious that people who violate mighty tree is uprooted," or "the queen is elsewhere."

them have to make restitution in some ritual propitia-In the past, when an Asante king died, he was laid tion. Although in all societies there are those who are out and the seven openings of his body filled with gold terrified of ghosts and those who have *thanatophobia* dust. The body was put in a

coffin over an open pit for (the fear of death), in Africa taboos regarding death

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 93

Ancient Egyptian Studies Movement——93

involve a different sort of fear. The taboo and the fear conception of reincarnation is world affirming, not concern the community, not just the individual person, world renouncing. Souls that are reborn in children may and a person who breaks such a taboo actually vio-be grandparents returned. The ancestors do not create later the fabric of the society. It is like tearing a the child, God does. The ancestral name is renewed in hole in a beautiful blanket. It must be repaired or else the family, revitalizing the people. Ancestors may be everyone suffers.

born in different children at the same time. Humans can Respect for the dead is a given among CAR believ-return millions and millions of times.

ers. The Asante have ceremonies every 3 weeks for the ancestors. The ancestors are given water to wash

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

their hands and soul food, that is, food for their souls.

The Gikuyu elders put a little food on the ground for **FURTHER READING**

the departed spirits. Africans do not pray to ancestors; Abraham, Willie. (1962). *The Mind of Africa*. Chicago, IL: they pray to gods, but they ask ancestors for interces-University of Chicago Press. This book continues to enjoy sion. Africans would no more pray to an ancestor than wide readership and citation. It was one of the first to state to a living parent, as prayer is reserved for the gods. A the African's position on values and ancestors.

person may pour libations to the ancestors to ask the Achebe, Chinua. (1958). *Things Fall Apart*. London: Heinemann. This is the most popular novel in Africa asked favors, ancestors may also be scolded, “You so history. In it, Achebe, one of Africa’s principal novelists, speaks to cultural conflicts.

and so, why do you treat us like this? Why did you Marariki, Claude. (1999). *Survival Strategies for Rural* give us this problem? What must we do to appease *Zimbabwe*. Harare: University of Zimbabwe. This is one of you?” This scolding does not consist of insults so the best studies of African traditional and classical much as of conversation that people hold with the responses to nature, agriculture, and society. Marariki spirits to express their disappointment over failures.

provides a detailed essay on the use of traditional values for As the African world is continuous, united, connational development.

scious of no distinction in quality between its members Mbiti, John. (1969). *African Religions and Philosophy*.

on earth and its ancestors, then this may look like London: Heinemann. Mbiti’s book is the standard work on African religions and philosophy, which has been criticized worship. The Catholics have solved this problem by by some scholars but remains the classic statement on the providing specialized levels of respect, consisting subject.

of *latria*—worship of God, *dulia*—reverence for the Mutwa, Credo. (1969). *My People*. London: Anthony Blond.

saints, and *hyperdulia*—special homage to Virgin This is a southern African look at the nature of society, the Mary. Africans do not debate whether or not the ances-living and the dead, human values, rituals, and myths in tors are gods; they know that they are ancestors and community.

that this involves a particular type of belief. While the Okpewho, Isidore. (1983). *Myth in Africa: A Study of Its Aesthetics and Cultural Relevance*. Cambridge, UK: Catholics have appropriated some of the ideas of the Cambridge University Press. This remains the best work on African people

the religion conquered, Catholics do African values and myths and their relationship to the past not see ancestors in the way that Africans see them.

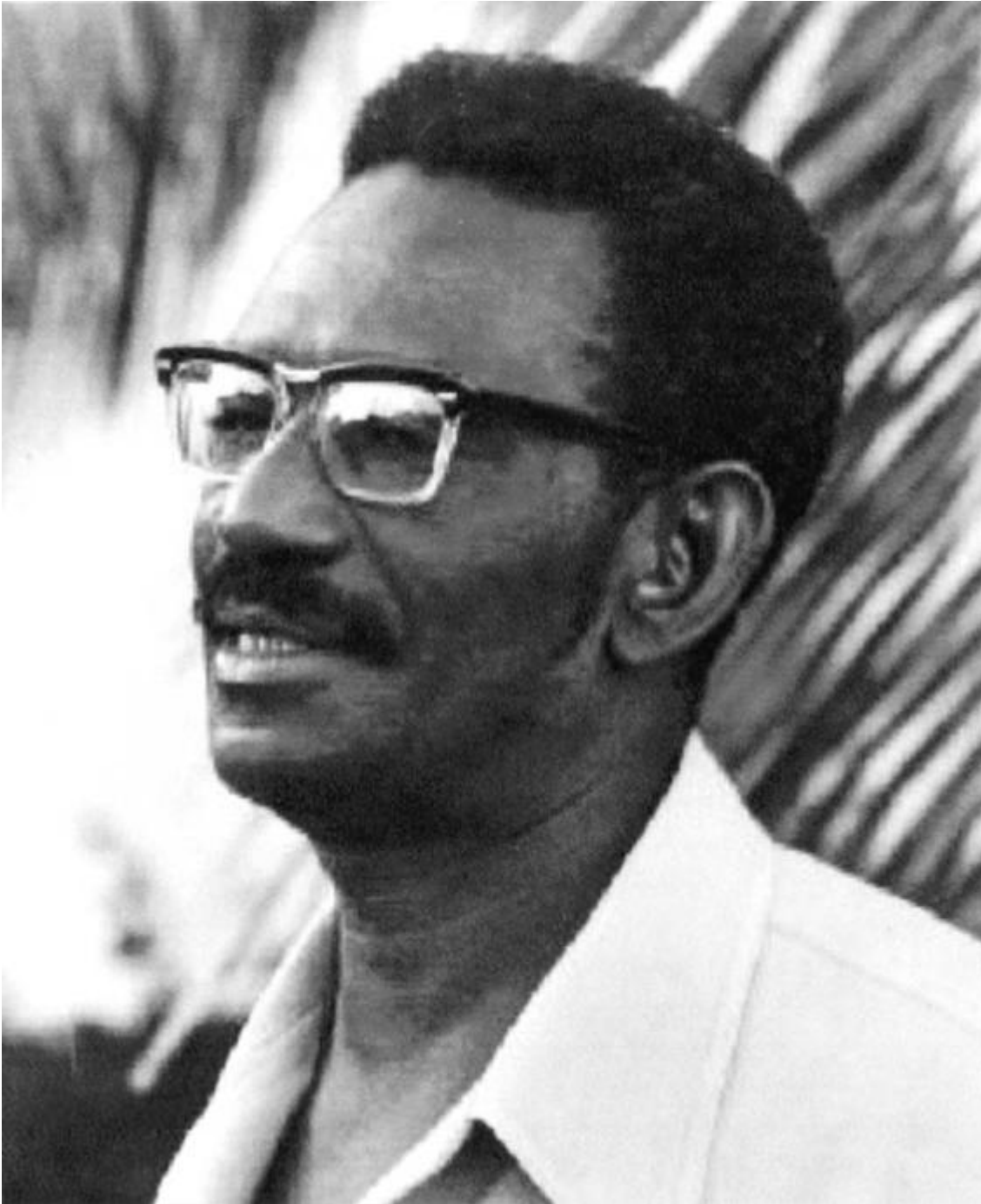
and the future.

Africans believe in reincarnation as strongly as do some other religions, especially Buddhism and Jainism. African reincarnation is based in the religion of ancient Egypt in which the priest says that people **ANCIENT EGYPTIAN**

shall come back millions and millions of times.

However, although reincarnation is a firmly held belief **STUDIES MOVEMENT**

in most of Africa, the African conception of reincarnation differs from the Indian conception. Unlike The call to research, recover, and bring forth the Africans, Indians believe in rounds of existence, the legacy of ancient Egypt as a paradigm of achievement cycles of rebirth from which people can escape only and possibility has a long history among African through nirvana, or enlightenment; in reward or pun-Americans. An early interest in Egypt as a classical ishment by rebirth into a higher or lower state (which African civilization is evident in the 19th-century is also found in Plato); and that the nature of the works of African American activists and writers such present world is suffering and illusion. The African as David Walker, Hosea Easton, Martin Delaney, and



A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 94

94———**Ancient Egyptian Studies Movement** Henry Highland Garnet.
References to Egypt as a **THE AFROCENTRIC INITIATIVE**

model of African achievement appear continuously. Also important to the development of the ancient and in varied sources in the early and mid-20th cen-Egyptian studies movement was the emergence of tury. However, the flowering of interests and activities the Afrocentric initiative put forth by Molefi Kete in classical African Studies that resulted in an ancient Asante. Asante outlines his intellectual thrust first in Egyptian studies movement in the mid-1980s had its *Afrocentricity: The Theory of Social Change* (1980), roots in the black power movement of the 1960s and then in *The Afrocentric Idea* (1987), and finally in the Afrocentric initiative that began in the 1980s. *The Kemet, Afrocentricity and Knowledge* (1990). In these ancient Egyptian studies movement, in its academic and subsequent works, Asante argues that Africans and community dimensions, borrows from and builds must be understood and approached as the subjects of on the ongoing cultural nationalist project of the their own history, that African ideals must be placed recovery and reconstruction of African culture. This at the center of any analysis that involves Africa, cultural movement is often called by the Akan word and that these ideals must be gleaned from African cul-sankofa, meaning “to return and fetch it,” and it is a ture—starting with classical African culture, especially project of continuous research of the past in search of but not limited to ancient Egypt, or Kemet. This philo-paradigms of thought and practice useful in under-sophical initiative, offered as a methodology and theo-standing and improving the present and enhancing the retical framework for critical research, evaluation, and future. It thus became a central aspect of the Africana exchange, created a national and international dialogue Studies project, which stresses the interrelatedness in the academy, community, and society. Moreover, of knowledge and practice, intellectual and political Asante evolved as a major Diopian scholar and adher-emancipation, and the ongoing need for grounding in ent, and thus contributed not only to the discourse on African culture in all projects of depth and value.

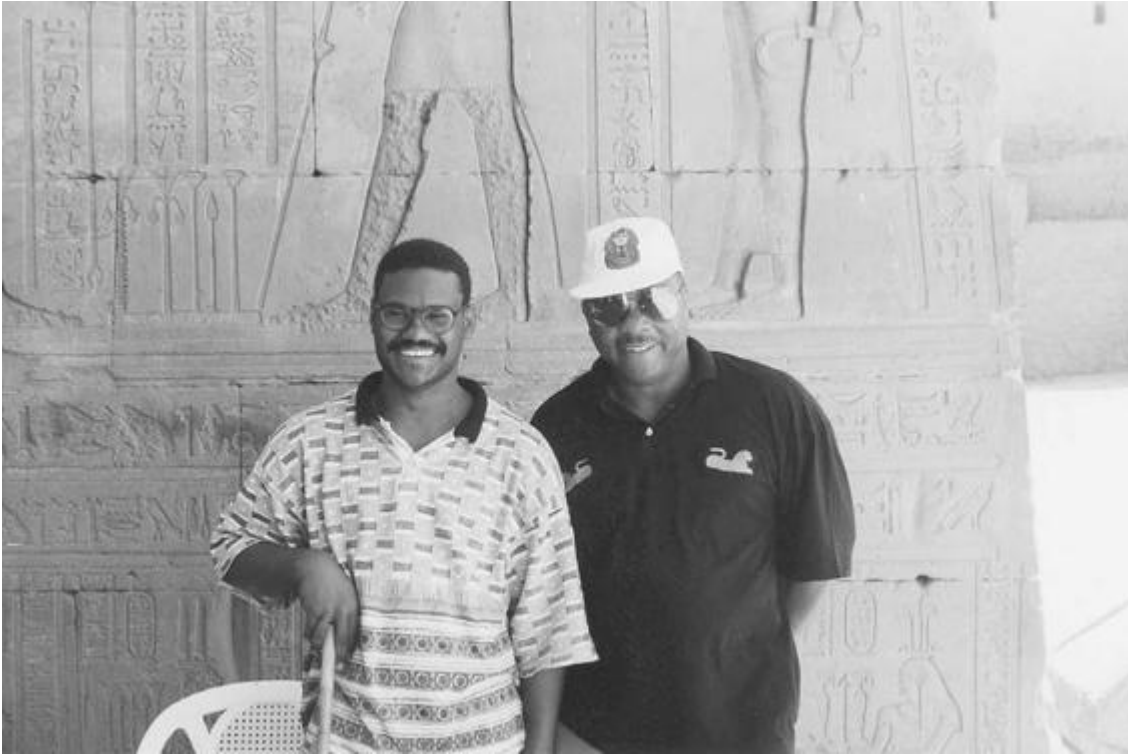
ancient Egypt but also to the embrace and critical understanding of Diop’s work and its emphasis on **WHY EGYPT?**

Kemet as Africa’s major paradigmatic civilization.

The stress on the study of ancient Egypt in particular, and classical African Studies in general, then, grew out of several processes within the Black Studies or Africana Studies movement. Since the 1960s this movement has emphasized a return to the source, that is, to African culture, to extract and engage paradigms of excellence and possibilities and use them to enhance African understanding and assertion in the world. This focus on the study of ancient Egypt and related activities evolved as a movement as a result of several factors. First, it evolved from the intensification of the study of works focused on classical African Studies in the late 1970s and early 1980s. Part of being both educated and informed was to be conversant with works such as George James's *Stolen Legacy* (1976), John Jackson's *Introduction to African Civilizations* (1980), Yosef ben-Jochannon's *Africa: Mother of "Western Civilization"* (1971), Chancellor Williams's *The Destruction of African Civilization* Cheikh Anta Diop

(1974), and Cheikh Anta Diop's *The African Origins of Civilization: Myth or Reality* (1974). The study of Another major factor in the flourishing of ancient such works was conducted in both the academy and Egyptian studies was the increasing reception and the community and reflected an increased interest in study of the works of the premier African ancient Egypt and in classical African civilization Egyptian studies scholar Cheikh Anta Diop. At first, generally.

English-speaking Africans did not have ready access



A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 95

Ancient Egyptian Studies Movement——95

Africa (1992), which he wrote in English, has also contributed to the discourse on ancient Egypt.

Diop inspired the ancient Egyptian studies movement to flourish and spread in both the academy and the community. In his major works, the *African Origin of Civilization* and *Civilization or Barbarism*, he outlined the basic arguments for the African character of ancient Egypt and its importance to African and world history and civilization. His detailed proofs include cultural, linguistic, anthropological, artistic, and contemporary eyewitness evidence. He concluded that it is a conscious and concerted falsification of history rooted in the rationale and practice of European imperialism that has denied and obscured *Mohammed Gabre (on left), an Egyptian Egyptologist, with an* the African character of ancient Egyptian civilization.

unidentified African American

In *Civilization or Barbarism*, Diop argued for the value of ancient Egyptian studies in achieving the following three purposes: (1) reconciling African to Diop's works, which were originally written in French with history (i.e., ending the great falsification of African and human history), (2) enabling available, they became a central focus of discourse on Africans to build a body of modern human sciences, ancient Egypt and greatly influenced African scholars and (3) renewing African culture.

and lay persons in the United States and the diaspora Diop understood that far from being a diversion to in general as well as on the African continent. Diop the past, a look back toward ancient Egypt is the best pioneered the African scholarly focus on Egypt as a way to conceive and build the African cultural future.

classical African civilization that not only Diop imagined a recovered Egypt playing the same stratified African genius in the world but also provided a role in a reconceived and renewed African culture that source of paradigms for African renewal and continued the Greco-Latin ancient past plays in Western culture.

contribution to world civilization.

It is this conception of the role of ancient Egypt in Diop's major works translated into English include African history and culture and in civilization that has *The African Origin of Civilization: Myth or Reality* informed and guided the flowering of interest in and (1974), *Black Africa: The Economic and Cultural* activity around the project of Egypt's recovery, as well *Basis for a Federated State* (1980), *Precolonial Black* as the founding of professional associations and *Africa* (1987), and his last work, *Civilization or* processes to contribute to this project.

Barbarism: An Authentic Anthropology (1991). His major works that are currently available only in French **INTELLECTUAL INITIATIVES**

are *Nations Nègres et Culture* (1954) and *Anteriorité* **Kawaida Institute of Pan-African**

des Civilisations Nègres (1967). These works have **Studies and Kemetic Institute**

made their way into the discourse, however, through the conversations and literature of diasporic scholars. The increasing interest in and activities involving who read French. Diop's student and colleague, ancient Egypt began in the early 1980s, when a variety of Theophile Obenga, contributed to this discourse when of intellectual initiatives around ancient Egyptian studies he was invited to the United States in 1992 by Molefi Kete Asante. These efforts began to take concrete forms and coalesce. Central to these efforts was the work of the Kawaiida Institute of African American Studies at Temple University.

of Pan-African Studies (KIPAS) in Los Angeles, which Obenga's major works are at present available only in its part of the organization in the U.S., and the Kemetic French and include *L'Afrique dans l'Antiquité: Egypte Ancienne—Afrique Noire* (1980) and *La Philosophie Africaine de la Période Pharaonique, 2780–330 Avant Notre Ère* (1978). His *Ancient Egypt and Black University* in Chicago, and had dedicated itself to the

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 96

96———**Ancient Egyptian Studies Movement** recovery of ancient Egypt's legacy mainly by teaching KIPAS in the project; and (5) to create a permanent the Kemetic language, history, and philosophy in the organization of scholars and laypersons committed to Chicago community. The institute also has developed the Diopian project of recovery and reconstruction.

a ritual service and a priesthood to conduct it. The Kawaiida Institute of Pan-African Studies is led by **Association for the Study**

Maulana Karenga, who is a professor of Black Studies **of Classical African Civilizations** at California State University, Long Beach, and it serves as the educational and research arm of the Having planned and organized this project, KIPAS

organization Us. Us played a vanguard role in the black and Us reached out to the Kemetic Institute to join the freedom movement and continues to have national conference. Out of this conference, the Association for and international influence through its philosophy of the Study of Classical African Civilizations (ASCAC) Kawaida, its continued organizing activities, the was founded. KIPAS gave the ASCAC its organiza-pan-African holiday Kwanzaa that Karenga created, and tional origins, its name, and its logo and the University Karenga's writings, lectures, and teaching.

of Sankore Press published its first literature—

In the early 1980s, KIPAS began teaching courses Maulana Karenga's *Selections From the Husia* on ancient Egyptian history and ethical thought, as well (1984); Jacob Carruthers's *Essays in Ancient Egyptian* as on the works of Diop and later ancient Egyptian *Studies* (1984); Karenga and Carruthers's edited hieroglyphs. In addition, Karenga collected, translated, volume, *Kemet and the African Worldview* (1980); and and wrote commentaries on Kemetic sacred texts and Karenga's edited volume, *Reconstructing Kemetic* held discussions within KIPAS and the organization Us *Culture* (1990). In its first 3 years, the ASCAC was on these texts. The texts are called the *Husia*, and they instrumental in creating an international dialogue have become a standard reference on ancient Egyptian and a flurry of activity involving ancient Egyptian spirituality and ethics. Moreover, it was then that it was studies. It set up a national and international chapter first proposed that *Maat* be used as the name of the structure; registered 1,000 members by 1987, whom ancient Egyptian spiritual and ethical tradition, that it took to Egypt for its annual conference; began to Seven Cardinal Virtues (truth, justice, propriety, har-penetrated the academy and urge Black Studies depart-mony, balance, reciprocity, and order) be posed as cen-ments and programs to include courses on ancient tral to the practice of Maat, and that a *Sebanate*, a body Egyptian studies as essential to their curriculum; and of moral teachers, *Seba Maat* or simply *Seba*, students established study groups in the community to expand of Maat, be trained to teach ancient Egyptian ethics and the discourse.

spirituality grounded in the *Husia*.

However, due to differences concerning research In this period of development, Us decided to call a focus and policy direction, KIPAS and its members conference to identify and engage other scholars and left the ASCAC in 1989. KIPAS had established its laypersons in the Diopian project of the critical recov-own program of ancient Egyptian recovery and recon-ery and concrete and creative use of ancient Egyptian struction before its initiative to found the ASCAC, culture. Having been assigned the task, KIPAS

which KIPAS had expanded during its work with the planned and organized the First Annual Ancient ASCAC, so it continued this work in the areas of Egyptian Studies Conference, which was held in research, education, writing and publication, and February of 1984 at Southwest College in Los institution building. Eventually, the ASCAC began to Angeles. Within the framework of the general Diopian shift from an exclusive focus on ancient Egypt to project of recovery, the purposes of the conference as inclusion of West Africa, especially Ghana.

outlined by KIPAS and Us were (1) to identify and build exchanges with other scholars and laypersons **Other Groups**

interested in the critical study of ancient Egypt; (2) to provide space for presentation of research to fellow Another factor shaping the development of ancient scholars, students, and the larger community; (3) to Egyptian studies at the time was the activities of the introduce the *Husia* and ideas related to spiritual and Nile Valley civilization group led by Ivan van Sertima.

ethical recovery and reconstruction; (4) to offer publi-The group held a major conference on Nile Valley cation possibilities for research on ancient Egypt civilization in September of 1984, 7 months after the through the University of Sankore Press, which joined founding of the ASCAC, calling together scholars and

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 97

ancient Egyptian enthusiasts. But unlike the ASCAC, Karenga, Maulana. (Ed.). (1990). *Reconstructing Kemet* the group formed no professional organization. How-Culture. Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press.

ever, Ivan van Sertima, who founded the *Journal of Karenga, Maulana. (2004). Maat, The Moral Ideal in Ancient Egypt: A Study in Classical African Ethics*. New York: *African Civilization*, built the journal into a major Routledge. This work discusses the ethical and moral source for publication of critical research on Nile dimensions of the concept of Maat as a matter of African Valley and other classical African civilizations and classical philosophy.

African presence in civilizations around the world.

Karenga, Maulana, and Carruthers, Jacob. (Eds.). (1986).

Central also to the continuous work on ancient *Kemet and the African Worldview*. Los Angeles: University Egyptian studies is the annual International Cheikh of Sankore Press.

Anta Diop Conference organized by Molefi Kete Asante and Ana Yenenga. The conference brings together African scholars and other Africanists from throughout the world who are committed to the preser-ANTILYNCHING CAMPAIGN

vation and continuance of Diop's work, as well as to the overall Afrocentric study of classical African African American women played a key role in the civilization, especially Kemet.

fight to stop lynchings in the United States. In 1892, following the lynchings of three of her friends, Ida B.

Wells became a leader in the antilynching movement.

THE FUTURE

Wells's friends—Thomas Moss, Calvin McDowell, and Henry Steward—were lynched in Memphis, As a result of the work of the Kawaida Institute

of Pan-Tennessee, after protecting their grocery store from an African Studies, the Kemetic Institute, the ASCAC, the angry white mob who believed that blacks should not International Cheikh Anta Diop Conference, and allied own a store. The store had been targeted by whites scholars and activities, the ancient Egyptian studies because it was successful and thus deemed threaten-movement remains vibrant and productive. Classes in ing by some whites in the community. Wells's anger ancient Egyptian studies in departments and programs over this incident fueled her desire to push for federal of Black Studies and Africana Studies have increased antilynching legislation.

and include history, culture, art, language, religion, Wells used her newspaper, *Free Speech*, to speak out and ethical philosophy. In addition, major confer-on the continuous lynchings of African Americans in ences and smaller symposia, seminars, and other the United States. She noted that although allegations forums with this intellectual focus are held regularly.

of rape were usually cited as the cause of particular In addition, universities and museums have increased lynchings, it was in fact typically economic competi-discourse and exhibitions to address a heightened tion or outright racism that provoked the lynching.

interest in ancient Egypt caused by the Afrocentric She also condemned lynchings as a sign of the initiative in ancient Egyptian studies. And finally, perverted, sick mind of white America. Wells made African scholars have produced in English and French enemies with her assertions, and in 1895 when she numerous works to advance research and increase and published a statistical analysis of lynchings in the sustain interest in the project.

South called the *Red Record*, an angry white mob took

— *Maulana Karenga*

action and destroyed her newspaper office. Wells then moved to Illinois and continued her activism there.

Beginning in 1898, Wells worked tirelessly to try and **FURTHER READING**

persuade the federal government to pass antilynching Asante, Molefi Kete, and Mazama, Ama (Eds.). (2002). *Egypt* legislation. While this legislation was never passed, v. *Greece and the American Academy*. Chicago: African Wells did successfully pressure Illinois Governor American Images. This is a collection of works by some of Charles Deneen into not rehiring a white sheriff who the key Afrocentric scholars.

presided over the lynchings of two blacks during the Carruthers, Jacob. (1995). *Mdw Ntr: Divine Speech—A race riot in 1908 in Springfield, Illinois*.

Historiographical Reflection of African Deep Thought from the Times of the Pharaohs to the Present. Chicago: Center Another key figure in the antilynching movement for Inner City Studies. This is an important contribution on was Mary Church Terrell. Terrell chose to use the African philosophy from ancient times.

political route to protest lynching. She was the

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 98

98——Antiracist Philosophy

founder and first president of the National Association race matters, both on its own terms and as an integral of Colored Women (NACW), an organization designed part of any critical theoretical discourse about human-to help African American women socially, economy and social relations. Antiracism involves searching cally, and politically. Using the NACW platform of for knowledge, producing texts, and disseminating self-help and protest, Terrell encouraged black women information as political action in the service of to provide a strong moral example in their families and humanity. It is therefore imperative for antiracist work communities and to use that example on the world to challenge the glee of the political Right concerning stage to combat racism and prejudice. Her own writ-the so-called irrelevance of race, the gloom of the Left ings and public speeches garnered her respect from about the possibilities of race discourse in progressive women in both the United States and Europe. Terrell's politics,

and the postmodern despair about the politics activism as president of NACW focused on providing of essentializing race.

information on lynchings and pressuring the U.S.

The entry point of antiracist work is within the government to enact legislation against lynching. Mary subject's (i.e., the individual's) personal experience, Church Terrell also fought against segregation and, history, and social practice. The subject is a creative in fact, one of her last acts was to protest segregation agent with an active and resistant voice. Thus, minori-in restaurants in Washington, D.C. In 1950, she suc-tized groups have discursive power. Critical antiracism cessfully cofiled a case against discrimination that must work with the understanding that the subaltern ultimately ended with a court decision favoring deseg-think, speak, and desire. Both the privileged and regation of eating facilities in the nation's capital.

minoritized have working and embodied knowledge.

Although their efforts to obtain federal antilynching And for members of both groups, the act of under-legislation were not successful, Ida B. Wells and standing the self results in an affirmation of a Mary Church Terrell provided a shining example of politics of community responsibility. The power of the activism of African American women after Recon-the "I" (as the lone subject), the product of liberal struction. Their activism inspired later generations to individualism, is insidiously harmful to developing continue the fight against racism and prejudice and to community. To enact a politics of responsibility, the improve life conditions for the African American individual needs to be fully grounded in how the family in the 21st century.

self becomes conscious of its existence within a collective. The initial process in the exercise of self-

— *Cynthia Lehman*

consciousness and the politics of affirmation involves acknowledging the powerful synergy of body, mind, **FURTHER READING**

and spirit. In antiracist work this means seeing equity Harris, Trudier. (Ed.). (1991). *Selected Works of Ida B. Wells-work as a form of spirituality. As such, equity work is Barnett*. New York: Oxford University Press. *This is the not forced but, rather, flows through individuals'*

best collection of works by Ida B. Wells-Barnett. It is well actions and thoughts. It is marked by genuineness and organized and presented in a scholarly manner.

sincerity.

Riggs, Marcia. (Ed.). (1985). Can I Get a Witness? Prophetic Antiracism is more than a theory and a discourse.

Religious Voices of African American Women: An It also involves action and allowing knowledge to Anthology. Maryknoll, NY: Orbis Books. This book con-induce political work. Given the interconnections of tains essays by African American women on the issues of lynching and racism.

soul and body, the worth of a social theory must be Wells, Ida B. (1899). Lynch Law in Georgia. Chicago: Chicago measured in terms of both the theory's philosophical Colored Citizens. This is Wells's report on the cruelty and grounding and its ability to offer a social and political viciousness of lynch law in the state of Georgia.

corrective. Thus a key principle of antiracism is overcoming the theory/practice dichotomy, resulting in a praxis that both guides and insists on political action. Antiracism must be understood, theorized, and

ANTIRACIST PHILOSOPHY

acted upon.

Unfortunately, many people's hearts are not open Antiracist philosophy is not a formal philosophical to envisaging and acting for change. Many have not movement but a philosophical stance against discrim-taken seriously the fact that to make change calls ination based on race. This perspective stresses that for enormous personal and collective sacrifice,

Antiracist Philosophy——99

commitment, and resources. There are risks and school implicate youth engagement and disengagement consequences in pursuing antiracist work. These risks from school. Antiracism inquires into and uncovers involve the emotional toll and resulting spirit wounds how race, ethnicity, class, gender, sexuality, physical of coming to grips with stories of pain and anger, as ability, power, and difference influence and are influ-well as the stress of having to deal with attacks on enced by schooling processes. This inquiry includes one's credibility. Antiracist work occupies itself with how the processes of teaching, learning, and educa-assisting minoritized communities to become empow-tional administration combine to produce schooling ered and empowering, to be spiritually affirmed and success and failures for different students. Antiracism affirming, and to heal spirit injuries. The key question, opines that addressing questions of power, equity, and then, is not who can do antiracist work, but rather, social difference is essential to enhancing learning whether one is prepared to face the risks and conse-outcomes and the provision of social opportunities for quences that come with such work. Antiracism is all youth.

about the search for equitable human conversation—a Antiracist educators start with what students respectful dialogue among social groups. Antiracism already know and then search for ways to situate the holds that community is about relationships with local cultural resource knowledge into the official others, about how to negotiate with and relate to each curriculum. Such educators have a unique place in other, and about how the community is a collective.

*the current climate of school advocacy because of the power that critical antiracism education offers to imagine schools afresh. The shape the future itself **ANTIRACISM, EDUCATION, AND***

*should take is being hotly contested in schools, union **SCHOOLING: ASKING NEW QUESTIONS***

halls, and community forums, and clearly antiracism. There are emerging questions that those who hold an has to be part of that debate. Antiracist educators have antiracist philosophy must deal with. Antiracist education—unprecedented opportunities to influence many minds—must address the public disquiet and scepticism and to share and engage different—dominant, privileged—about antiracist practice and its efficacy in bringing leged, subjugated, subordinated, and minoritized—

about changes in schooling. For example, our schools perspectives. The environments in which educators are being called “communities of difference.” How, work offer advantages and opportunities that depend then, do antiracist educators ensure that schools on their subject positions and politics. Educators can respond to the multiple needs and concerns of a diverse work, even with the differential allocation of space body politic? How do such educators create schools and resources, to further the cause of youth education.

where all students are valued, feel a sense of belong—It all comes down to a question of whether an ing, and have access to instruction that is responsive to antiracist educator wants to see current challenges as the needs of diverse learners? To ensure that all obstacles or as opportunities and openings to make students develop a sense of entitlement and connected-change happen. The failures and resistances of the ness to their schools, there must be a proactive attempt 1990s provide a springboard and impetus to rethink by educators to respond to the needs of all students.

antiracist education in the 21st century.

Educators must understand that the needs of students. Educators with an antiracist philosophy view extend beyond the material realm to emotional, social, antiracist education broadly, as more than just what and psychological concerns. Schools have a responsibility to help students make sense of their identities, to learning. Antiracist education involves the varied build the confidence of all students, and to minimize options, strategies, and ways through which individu—the effects of social constraints that would have also come to know their world and act in it. Learning students confirm low educational expectations based happens in many places, including schools,

families, on their identities. Thus, the contemporary challenge workplaces, neighborhoods, broadcast and independent-for antiracist education is to incorporate such diverse media, the legal system, museums, religious needs into critical educational practice.

institutions, theatres, and galleries, among other sites.

For those in education, holding an antiracist Within these multiple spheres of learning, antiracist philosophy therefore means learning about the experience of education entails drawing on the intersections of social experience of living with a racialized identity and understanding difference in order to understand the complexities of students' lived experiences in and out of social inequality.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 100

100——Antiracist Philosophy

Antiracist thinking poses broad questions Critical antiracist work requires a broad redefinition of the social organization of learning, such as the definition of antiracism, which means looking at racism in as those concerning what it is to be a person in contemporary society and the relation of this curriculum, forms of oppression. This practice involves taking a stance from the many sites of learning, to the reproductive critical stance, which helps antiracists to also address the production of the knowledge that shapes and transforms the saliency of specific forms of oppression. History the social and political world. Antiracism must investigate and context are significant concepts in teaching about the harmonies and contradictions with respect race and racism. Educators must equip students to to what is learned across these multiple sites, and understand the historical genesis and political trajectory—consider the far-reaching implications of these for theories of race and difference—the historical specificity—the fundamental issues of identity formation, human ties of racist practices as well as how racism has been possible, equity, and the pursuit of social justice and become institutionalized and normalized in different societies. For example, antiracists understand that societies.

excellence and equity are complementary, not opposi-The classroom teacher's personal experience, tional, terms and that the quality of learning environ-history, and understanding of teaching practice serves ments and the scholarship produced therein increase as an entry point for antiracist work. The antiracist tremendously with the recognition that equity measures teacher is an example of the synergy of body, mind, are excellence measures.

and spirit that allows a person to see equity work as a Antiracism critiques conventional schooling by form of spirituality. Such a teacher recognizes that interrogating the way schools produce, validate, and because individuals, and thus students, are creative privilege certain forms of knowledge while devaluing agents with active and resistant voice, educators must and delegitimizing other knowledge, history, and engage with antiracist knowledge in ways that allow experience. Critical antiracist practice challenges the society to move forward in new and creative ways dominant interests involved in processes of producing reflective of students' local knowledge, subject posi-knowledge and exposes and opposes how such knowl-tion, history, and experience.

edge becomes hegemonic and is disseminated nation-The antiracist educator, and particularly the white ally and globally. However, hegemony is not limited antiracist educator, must work with the knowledge that to the frame of Western knowledges and epistemolo-society treats people differently based on race and that gies. The notion of hegemony is therefore useful for the society's racialized common sense can be exposed understanding the relationship between multiple to dominant groups in ways that do not require the use social values and complex realities. Looking through of the label "racist." It is not helpful for antiracists to an antiracist prism makes it possible to undertake a indict all whites as racists. However, there needs to be rigorous examination of the (in)adequacy of dominant a recognition of how individuals are helped or hin-discourses and epistemologies for understanding the dered by a racist system. Starting with the self means realities of diverse people, positioned as they are in that the white antiracist educator must acknowledge oppressive and oppressed positions in the contexts of his or her dominance and privilege and assist other the asymmetrical power relations among social whites to see the

privilege that accrues to them by groups. Thus, given the current incompleteness of virtue of their white identities in white racist societies.

discourse and political practice, antiracism involves

— George Dei

a search for epistemological diversity in the understanding of the complexity of oppressions.

FURTHER READING

To the degree that anti-racist practices seek to create the context for more complete discourse around Bhavnani, R. (2001). Rethinking Interventions in Racism.

humanity and human interests, they are in line with London: Trentham Books. This volume argues that the the broadest and most humane methods of Afrocentric meanings of many words and terminology applied in racist discourse, such as black, white, racial, ethnic minorities, scholars engaged in the practice of defining all human culture, and cultural difference, are not easily agreed upon.

beings as centered within culture. Individuals cannot Guttman, A. (Ed.). (1994). Multiculturalism: Examining The divest themselves of some form of culture, but those Politics of Recognition. Princeton, NJ: Princeton University who consciously operate out of their culture may be Press. This is a comprehensive collection exploring the said to exercise the discourse of greater humanity.

many aspects of multiculturalism.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 101

***Apollo Theatre*———101**

Henry, Frances, and Tator, Carol. (1994). The Ideology of the Apollo; for example, Pearl Bailey, Ella Fitzgerald, Racism—Democratic Racism. Canadian Ethnic Studies, Sarah Vaughn, James Brown, and Gladys Knight

were 26(2), 32–45. This important article makes it possible for all winners. The Jackson 5 and Stevie Wonder would an antiracist to ask how some whites perpetuate racism and also enjoy their first major exposure at the Apollo. It employ a powerful racist ideology without ever feeling that became famous as the place where unknown perform-they have abandoned liberal democratic ideals of social justice for all.

ers had their talents assessed by raucous Harlem audiences. By the late 1950s, the theater was the country's top stage for established black artists and the launching point for numerous musical careers. However, the **APOLLO THEATRE**

Apollo steadily lost money during the 1970s due to the demands of big acts commanding enormous The Apollo Theatre of New York is one of the classic increases in salary. In 1977 the Apollo was forced to venues for African American cultural performance.

close its doors. Several years later, in 1985, the Inner The Apollo Theatre has been a presence in Harlem for City Theater Group rescued the decaying landmark, 89 years and the epicenter of black American culture.

refurbished it, and reopened it. The Apollo Theatre Originally known as an Irish Music Hall, the Jack was then declared a national historic landmark, which Davenport's family enterprise took over the theater secured the building's survival, but the efforts to in 1919, renamed it the Hurtig and Seamon's New restore the viable performance house largely failed.

Burlesque Theater, and on its stage offered vaudeville, The theater was a financial disaster when in 2001, striptease, and burlesque acts to predominantly white Derek Johnson, a former AOL Time Warner executive, audiences. In 1933 the theater was renamed the replaced Representative Charles Rangel, a New York Apollo, after the Greek god of music and poetry. In Democrat, as chairman of the Apollo Foundation and 1934, the new management team of Frank Schiffman began turning it around. It is to be expected that the and Leo Brecher began presenting black entertainers Apollo, because of its central location in Harlem, will to racially mixed audiences.

continue to attract outstanding performances and large Through good business management, Schiffman's audiences. It remains an icon of the African American sense of responsibility to the community, and a respect contribution to stage performances in New York.

for show business tradition, the Apollo became known

— Adjua Barbara E. Adams

as the best showcase in Harlem. Schiffman created an atmosphere that made all black performers want to **FURTHER READING**

play at the Apollo Theatre at least once. For his efforts, Cooper, Ralph. (1990). Amateur Night at the Apollo: Ralph he gained respect and affection from patrons all over Carter Presents Five Decades of Great Entertainment.

the country who visited the theater. Black talent flour-New York: HarperCollins. This is an accessible history of ished in Harlem like nowhere else in the city. Harlem the Amateur Night concept at the Apollo and provides was the place to be, because it was the one place in the insight into the Apollo's great history.

entire country where black men and black women Dolkart, Andrew S., and Sorin, Gretchen S. (1977). Touring could creatively express themselves. Harlem became Historic Harlem: Four Walks in Northern Manhattan.

an oasis where millions of people flocked. As Harlem's New York: New York Landmarks Conservancy. This book contains a general spatial representation of Harlem commu-racial makeup began to change with the addition of nities, as well as many historical anecdotes about Harlem life.

blacks from the South, the first entertainment to grace Fox, Ted. (1983). Showtime at the Apollo. New York: Holt, the Apollo stage were the big bands of Duke Ellington, Rinehart and Winston. In one of the best books written on Benny Carter, Louis Armstrong, Cab Calloway, and the subject of entertainment at the Apollo, Fox reveals the Count Basie, to name a few.

Jazz a la Carte, featuring pressures and tensions behind the scenes at the Apollo.

Benny Carter's big band, helped to garner the theater's Schiffman, Jack. (1984). Harlem Heyday—A History of Modern new role as the city's premier location for African Black Show Business and the Apollo Story. New York: Prometheus Books. Schiffman's book is one of the best American performance.

works on modern black show business. He writes about the Throughout the 1930s and 1940s, the Apollo was a general history of show business, making the Apollo a big mecca for legendary entertainers such as Bessie part of the story.

Smith, Billie Holiday, and Dinah Washington. Many www.newyork.com/visit/attractions.apollo_theater.html This careers began as a result of winning Amateur Night at Web site has some interesting information on the Apollo.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 102

102——Associated Publishers

*Woodson had an unyielding spirit and will, which **ASSOCIATED PUBLISHERS***

caused him to quit university teaching and to devote his life to the dissemination of African cultural and Associated Publishers is the oldest African American historical information. In 1920, he organized the publishing company in the United States. In 1920, Associated Publishers to serve as a means for African Carter Godwin Woodson, a professor at Howard American authors to have their writings published. In University, organized the publishing company to con-1926, to bring further attention to the beauty, richness, duct research, document, and disseminate scholarly and diversity of African American culture, Woodson writings on the life and culture of African Americans.

created the celebration Negro History Week. In 1976, Woodson recognized the need for the world to gain the Association for the Study of African American a greater appreciation for African Americans and Life and History changed the name of the celebration wanted to unmask some of the distortions and misrep-to Black History Month.

resentations about the history of African people. His One of the principal difficulties Carter Woodson aim was to give the African community an instrument experienced was getting his works published by the for publishing the best scholarly documents on major white publishing houses. In response, he used African and African American history. Since its inception, Associated Publishers has published nationally ing house and was thus able to fund and distribute the known and recognized authors who have written many books and monographs he wrote. In many ways, numerous articles, monographs, and books that give his work became the model for such contemporary an accurate account of outstanding contributions publisher-scholars as Jawanza Kunjufu and Haki African Americans have made to world society.

Madhubuti. Once Associated Publishers was estab-Woodson was born December 19, 1875 in New lished, having published 30 books authored by Carter Canton, Virginia. He was the son of James Henry and G. Woodson, it was also capable of publishing other Anne Eliza Riddle Woodson, who had survived the authors. Some of Woodson's books include The horrors of enslavement. As a young boy, Woodson Education of the Negro Prior to 1861 (1915), A worked in the coal mines of West Virginia. His formal Century of Negro Migration (1918), The History of education began at Douglass High School in the Negro Church (1927), The Rural Negro (1930), Huntington, Virginia. After high school, he attended and The Negro Professional Man and the Community Berra College in Kentucky, Lincoln University in (1934). Woodson, the renowned historian and scholar Pennsylvania, and the Sorbonne in Paris. In 1908, he recognized as "the father of black history," died on received his bachelor's and master's degrees from the April 3, 1950. His internationally acclaimed book The University of Chicago. In 1912, Woodson became the Mis-Education of the Negro (1933) continues to be a second African American to receive a

doctoral degree standard by which educational authors of his generation from Harvard University.

tion are judged. Associated Publishers published The Woodson spoke French fluently and mastered Negro History Journal and the Negro History Bulletin several other languages. He served as a principal and in addition to books. Noteworthy scholars such as high school teacher in Washington, D.C., a supervisor Charles H. Wesley, John Hope Franklin, Samuel of schools in the Philippines, and as the dean of Banks, and Edgar Allen Toppin chose to publish some Liberal Arts at Howard University and West Virginia of their best research with the publishing house, and Collegiate Institute. On September 9, 1915, Woodson they have thus been major contributors to the rich founded the Association for the Study of Negro Life heritage of Associated Publishers.

and History. As a visionary, he saw the need to

— Judylynn Mitchell

research and document the many outstanding contributions of African Americans and to pass knowledge **FURTHER READING**

and truth to future generations. In 1916, Woodson Asante, Molefi Kete. (2002). 100 Greatest African Americans.

began publishing the Journal of Negro History. The Amherst, MA: Prometheus Books. This book presents journal, which is still being published, features writ-information about outstanding African Americans and their ings on African American life and culture. The publi-contributions, including Carter G. Woodson.

cation is widely distributed throughout the United Association for the Study of African American Life and States, Africa, Europe, Asia, and Latin America.

History (ASALH). (2002, January). Black History Bulletin,

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 103

65(1). Washington, DC: Author. This is a historical update O'Bradovich, David Tarrell, Charles Thomas, and Mike on the work of Woodson and on the ASALH.

Ward. Guided by the principles of self-determination, Association for the Study of African American Life and agency, and mutual self-interest, these women and History (ASALH). (2002, June). *Black History Bulletin*, men set about building a professional organization 65(2). Washington, DC: Author. This issue continues the through which they could address the long neglected historical update on Woodson's work and the ASALH

begun in the previous issue.

needs of black people and black psychologists. The association's founders pledged to see themselves as black people first and psychologists second.

The members of the association recognized that **ASSOCIATION OF**

Western (i.e., white) psychology failed to provide a full and accurate understanding of the psychological **BLACK PSYCHOLOGISTS**

experience, essence, and integrity of black people.

Since Western psychology's theories and therapeutic The Association of Black Psychologists (ABPsi) practices clearly were not uncritically applicable to was founded in San Francisco in 1968 by black black people, the association decided to develop a psychologists and psychology students from across culturally grounded discipline and field of black the country looking for a way to use their skills to ben-psychology. As an African-centered discipline, black efite the black community. The association was formed psychology not only would include the study of the to address the significant social problems affecting the behavior of black people but also would seek to black community and to have a positive impact on the transform black people into self-conscious agents of mental health of the national black community their own mental and political liberation. In

addition, through planning, programs, services, training, and the work of the radical black psychologists in the advocacy.

association helped to clarify the intellectual justification and application of African-centered thought and success of mental health services for the black community—the co-emerging field of Black Studies.

munity depends on the ability of black psychologists. From its inception, this liberatory black psychology to (1) act as free and independent agents in the interwas created by (1) engaging in severe critique and rejection of black people; (2) resist and/or inoculate them from white psychology's methodology, conclusions, selves against the degradation and dehumanization and ideological promise; (2) providing Afrocentric resulting from the effects of white supremacy; and models of study, theory, and therapy; and (3) self-con-

(3) advance and increase the utilization of their under-consciously intervening in the struggle for a more standing and application of the experience, essence, humane and just society and environment. The development, integrity, and vitalism of black people. The association of contemporary black psychology was then recognized that if the practice of black psychology grounded in the recognition that what was needed was gifts, including theorizing, did not respect and reflect a theoretical and therapeutic practice that was centered in the essence, experience, and integrity of black people, then everything black psychologists provided (therapeutic people. Thus the association through its African approach, service, treatment, and theorizing) would only Psychology Institute defined African-centered psychology disserve, dehumanize, and further debilitate black psychology as “the self-conscious ‘centering’ of psychology people.

logical analysis and application in African reality, The founders of the Association of Black culture and epistemology. African Psychology examines Psychologists were Calvin Atkinson, Ronald Brown, in the process that allows for the illumination and Ed Davis, Jim DeShields, George Franklin, Reginald liberation of the spirit. African Centered Psychology Jones, Roy Jones, Robert L. Green, George Jackson, is ultimately concerned with

*understanding the sys-Mary Howard, De Lorise Minot, Leon Nicks, Lonnie
tems of the meaning of human beingness, the features Mitchell, Bill Pierce,
Joseph White, Shirley Thomas, of human functioning, and the restoration of
normal/*

*Samuel Winslow, Joseph Akward, J. Don Barnes, natural order to human
development.”*

*Harold Dent, Russ Evans, Bill Harvey, Al Goines, The stated purpose of the
ABPsi was and continues Luther Kindall, Thomas Hilliard, Mel King,
Walter to be to have a positive impact on the mental health of Jacobs, Jane
Fort Morrison, Wade W. Nobles, Sylvia the national black community by
means of planning,*

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 104

104——Ausar Auset Society

*programs, services, training, and advocacy. The Akbar, Ph.D. (1987–1988),
Dennis E. Chestnut, Ph.D.*

*association’s objective is to ensure that the skills (1988–1989), Suzanne
Randolph, Ph.D. (1989–1990), and abilities of black psychologists are
being used to Linda James Myers, Ph.D. (1990–1991), Timothy R.*

*influence necessary change and address significant Moragne, Psy.D.
(1991–1992), Maisha Hamilton social problems affecting the black
community.*

Bennett, Ph.D. (1992–1993), Anna M. Jackson, Ph.D.

*Specifically, the formal organizational goals of the (1993–1994), Wade
Nobles, Ph.D. (1994–1995), association are to (1) enhance the
psychological well-Thomas A. Parham, Ph.D. (1995–1996), Frederick B.*

*being of African (i.e., black) people in the United Phillips, Psy.D. (1996–
1997), Kamau Dana Dennard, States and throughout the diaspora; (2)
promote con-Ph.D. (1997–1998), Afi Samella B. Abdullah, Ph.D.*

structive understanding of African people through (1998–1999), Mawiya Kambon, Ph.D. (1999–2000), positive approaches to research; (3) develop an Anthony Young, Ph.D. (2000–2001), Mary Hargrow, approach to psychology that is consistent with the Ph.D. (2001–2002), Harvette Grey, Ph.D. (2002–2003), experience of African people; (4) define mental health and Willie S. Williams, Ph.D. (2003–2004).

in consonance with newly established psychological The organization has grown over the years and has concepts and standards regarding African people; an exciting future because of the many new psycholo-

(5) develop international support systems for African gists who are entering the field with an eye toward link-psychologists and students of psychology; (6) develop ing African concepts with contemporary African lives.

policies for local, state, and national decision making

— Wade W. Nobles (Nana Kwaku

that influence the mental health of the African com-Berko I, Ifagbemi Sangodare)

munity; (7) promote values and lifestyles that support the survival and well-being of the black race; and (8) support established African organizations and aid in the development of new independent African institutions to enhance Africans' psychological, **AUSAR AUSET SOCIETY**

educational, cultural, and economic situation.

The Association of Black Psychologists has grown The Ausar Auset Society is an African- and Kemetite-from a small group of concerned professionals into an centered spiritual group founded by Ra Un Nefer independent, autonomous organization of over 1,400

Amen I (formerly Rogelio Straughn) in New York in members who see their collective mission and destiny 1973. The members, initiates, students, and commu-as the liberation of the African mind, empowerment of nity participants study and implement spiritual the African character, and

illumination of the African practices that Africans developed in ancient Kemet spirit. ABPsi has been guided for over 35 years by a and in the Indus Kush civilization. Ausar Auset has member-elected board of directors, regional represen-28 chapters and study groups across America and tatives, and national staff. The chronology of ABPsi abroad in Toronto, Trinidad, Bermuda, St. Thomas, presidential leadership is as follows: and England. The branches replicate the structural Charles W. Thomas, Ph.D. (1968–1969), Robert archetype established by Ra Un Nefer Amen I, Green, Ph.D. (1968–1969), Henry Tomes, Ph.D.

Shekem Ur Shekem of the Ausar Auset Society in (1969–1970), Robert L. Williams, Ph.D. (1969–1970), New York. The title Shekem Ur Shekem is Egyptian Stanley Crockett, Ph.D. (1970–1971), Reginald L.

and is taken to mean “king of kings,” and there are Jones, Ph.D. (1971–1972), James S. Jackson, Ph.D.

kings (Ur Aua) and queen mothers (Ur-t Aua-t) who (1972–1973), Thomas O. Hilliard, Ph.D. (1973–1974), reign in other regions.

George D. Jackson, Ph.D. (1974–1975), William In the New York Het Neter, free weekly classes are Hayes, Ph.D. (1975–1976), Ruth E. G. King, Ed.D.

held in spirituality, meditation, qigong, vegetarian (1976–1977), Maisha Bennett, Ph.D. (1978–1979), cooking, homeopathy, medicine, family relationships, Joseph Awkard, Ph.D. (1979–1980), Daniel Williams, health, nutrition, and business ventures. A store sell-Ph.D. (1980–1981), David Terrell, Ph.D. (1981–1982), ing products for inner development, a vegetarian Joseph A. Baldwin, Ph.D. (1982–1983), William K.

restaurant, and a school comprise the multilevel com-Lyles, Ph.D. (1983–1984), W. Monty Whitney, Ph.D.

plex. Ausar Auset is an independent and functional (1984–1985), Melvin Rogers, Ph.D. (1985–1986), African spiritual organization that offers, primarily to Halford H. Fairchild, Ph.D. (1986–1987), Na'im people of African descent, a way of life.

The Autobiography of Malcolm X——105

The philosophy of Ausar Auset is to awaken the schools teach standard academic subjects, spiritual sacred potentiality in men and women. Through the culture, and meditation. Men and women in Ausar initiation system and the oracle, adherents of Ausar Auset are entrepreneurs, priests, priestesses, queen Auset experience a connection to and interaction with mothers, and skilled laborers. Through the guidance divine instructions specific to them individually.

of the oracle, they have the choice to participate or not Through the oracle that Ra Un Nefer Amen I is said to participate in polygamous or monogamous rela-to have received, the participants obtain metaphysical tionships. All of the children are treated like extended guidance for life situations and problem solving.

family. Mothers are called *Mut* (pronounced moot), In his text, *Tree of Life Meditation System* (1996), from ancient Kemet, meaning “Mother” and Amen presents the 11 realms of African and Kemetic

“Goddess.” Fathers are called *Atef*, meaning “Father”

conceptions that respond to the subconscious and and “Crown.” Ausar Auset combines the names of the conscious states.

ancient Ausar (Osiris) and Auset (Isis).

Ra Un Nefer Amen I was born Rogelio Straughn in Panama on January 6, 1944 and raised by his mother

— *Regina Jennings*

and stepfather, Guricku and Bertram Straughn. He attended the Conservatory of Music, where at age 6 he **FURTHER READING**

studied piano and music theory. As a child, he also Amen, Ra Un Nefer. (1990). *Metu Neter, Vol. 1: The Great* read periodicals and texts to his

grandfather, Panama's *Oracle of Tehuti and the Egyptian System of Spiritual* first dental surgeon, who had become nearly blind. He *Cultivation*. Bronx, NY: Khamit Corporation. This is the read to his grandfather *Times Magazine*, *Newsweek*, major statement of the philosophy and approach of the newspapers equivalent to the *New York Times*, and Ausar Auset society. This work is Amen's most important philosophy texts such as Plato's *Republic*. In a philosophical statement.

9:00 a.m. third grade class, his history teacher told Amen, Ra Un Nefer. (1994). *Metu Neter, Vol. 2*. Bronx, NY: Khamit Corporation. This is volume two of Amen's the students that civilization started in Egypt. Amen philosophy.

saw stars and awoke at 7:00 p.m. at home in bed.

Neither the family nor the school would discuss what happened in those lost hours. At 14, he read Thomas

THE AUTOBIOGRAPHY

à Kempis's *Imitation of Christ* and *The Spiritual Exercises of St. Ignatius of Loyola*. Soon afterward, he

OF MALCOLM X

began secretly practicing the spiritual exercises that influenced ascetic theology and monasticism.

The Autobiography of Malcolm X tells the life of Straughn attended a high school that produced Malcolm Little in a dramatic fashion that resonates Panama's presidents, where he studied history, political with many members of the African American commu-science, music, and literature. He read the works of nity. His life was lived with intensity and purpose, and Che Guevara, Pablo Neruda, and Jose Marti. As the in this book he describes the path that he took in a way youngest member of the Federation of Panamanian that makes his story accessible to all. Malcolm Little Students (FPS), he protested with the peasants who was born in Omaha, Nebraska, and grew up in Detroit, fought against Panama ceding land to

Costa Rica. After Boston, and New York. He was a young man whose coming to America with his parents in 1960, he father had been killed by white racists and whose protested against the Vietnam War with Students for a mother had experienced a nervous breakdown. He Democratic Society. He also continued his spiritual was a naive student in school, a hip small time hustler search. In 1962, he completely changed his diet after called "Detroit Red," and a petty criminal who learning about the effects of vitamins and minerals on became a Muslim and joined the Nation of Islam health. He concluded that divine spiritual potency com-while in prison in New York.

bined with healthy living could solve the world's prob-When he came out of prison, he changed his name lems. During the 1960s, he participated in various black to Malcolm X in conformity with the discipline of the power organizations until he established his own group Nation of Islam. Malcolm X then devoted his life to based on achieving higher realms of consciousness.

the Nation of Islam, which had transformed him and Ausar Auset members attempt to live according given him a new understanding of his condition and to divine laws from ancient theologies. Ausar Auset that of all Africans in American society. He dictated

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 106

106——Axum Empire

his story, which became *The Autobiography of* cultural hero and explains how he became a symbol of *Malcolm X*, to Alex Haley during hundreds of sessions.

African creative genius.

By the time the book was published, however, its Breitman, George. (1965). *Malcolm X Speaks*. New York: Grove Press. This is the first collection of speeches by subject had been gunned down at a Harlem meeting as Malcolm X.

he was about to give a speech on February 5, 1965.

Malcolm X. (1989). *The Last Speeches*. New York: Pathfinder.

The accused gunman was associated with the Nation This book brings together speeches that were given by of Islam.

Malcolm X after he severed relations with the Nation of *The Autobiography* received high praise when it Islam.

was released in 1965, and it has remained one of the major works in African American letters, biography, and Black Studies ever since. The book won the Anisfield-Wolf Book Award in 1966 and was made **AXUM EMPIRE**

into a film by Spike Lee in 1992. *The Autobiography* shows Malcolm X as a person who was able to con-Axum is located in north central Ethiopia near the front danger, to face the white man, and to speak his border of Eritrea, a country bordering Ethiopia and mind without compromising his principles and values.

the Red Sea. It is the capital of the Abyssinian This is what made him such an attractive figure to province of Tigrè. Axum was once the center of a vital the African American community. In many ways, trade route connecting the rest of Africa with India, Malcolm X lived as a fully cultured African American Arabia, and the Far East. Axum is famous as the site and became in his living the embodiment of courage, of tall steles, which were carved from single granite straightforwardness, and principle.

blocks that date to the 3rd or 4th century B.C.E. The The story of Malcolm X is historical, literary, socio-most prominent of the remaining steles is about 85

logical, psychological, political, and biographical. It is feet tall. Axum is most famous for being the most a treasure trove of complex information about one of sacred city of Ethiopia and the last home of the Ark of the most beloved leaders ever produced in the African the Covenant.

American community. In his book, Malcolm X outlines the pattern of his political growth from the time of his homemade education, to the insights into the nature of **RELIGIOUS TRADITIONS**

the American society given him by Elijah Muhammad, the leader of the Nation of Islam, to his appearances at Axum is rich in religious traditions. The original reli-top universities and colleges explaining the realities of gion practiced there was a traditional African one in the African world. Unlike Martin Luther King, Jr., who which the primary deity was associated with the sun spoke often in favor of integration and nonviolent and moon. Later, traders and sages from India and confrontation, Malcolm X articulated a philosophy of Asia brought religions such as Buddhism and Jainism self-respect, equality, and self-defense.

to Axum. During the 4th century, Christianity was In the field of Black Studies, *The Autobiography of* declared the national religion. By the 6th century, *Malcolm X* remains a classic work chronicling the life Jewish traders had introduced Judaism in Axum.

of a great person, but it is also a riveting story told with There is evidence that in 627 to 628 C.E. the Prophet authority, literary flare, and rich personal testimonies.

Muhammad sent a letter to the Axumite king, Ella What we see in this book is one man in a spiritual Saham, seeking to convert him to Islam. King Saham struggle to overcome the personal obstacles that con-replied by saying that he had definitely accepted Islam front him but also a man who metamorphoses into a as his faith and that he was sending his son to the representative of the collective journey for liberation.

prophet. Afterward, a small group of Muslims who were seeking asylum fled to Axum where they found

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

refuge and an abundance of the means of living.

Axum was one of the earliest places where followers **FURTHER READING**

of Muhammad could freely practice their religion Asante, Molefi Kete. (1992). *Malcolm X as Cultural Hero and without fear of persecution. Traditional African, Other Afrocentric Essays*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press.

Judaic, and Islamic influences can still be seen in the This book of essays discusses the role of Malcolm X as a architecture and cultural customs of Axum.

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 107

Axum Empire———107

Axum is also thought to be Ethiopia's most sacred the senior priests are admitted there. The middle place, because it is the site of the first St. Mary Church, section of the church is called the *kiddiest*. Priests and which was built in 372 C.E. to hold the Ark of the those receiving communion use this area. The outside Covenant. In the early 1530s, just before the Muslim area is called the *kine mahlet* and is where *debterra* armies attacked, the Ark was moved; however, it was (cantors) sing sacred hymns and the congregation returned to Axum in the early 1600s and installed in worships. This three-part system is believed to be the second St. Mary's Church. The Ark remained there based on the Temple of Solomon, which itself has until 1965 when Emperor Haile Selassie moved it to antecedents in the Temple of Amen at Karnak.

a new chapel, where it remains today.

In the sacred text of the Ethiopian Orthodox In addition to Axum's rich religious tradition, it is Church, *Kebrä Nagast, or The Book of the Glory of* renowned in Ethiopian tradition as the home of *the Kings* of Ethiopia, it is written that the Ark was Makeda, Queen of Sheba. The queen left from Axum taken from the Jewish people and given to Ethiopians when she visited King Solomon's court in Jerusalem to because they were true to

God's words. Its sacredness discuss commerce, religion, and politics with him. The is elevated by its mysteriousness.

Queen of Sheba's sacred quest for wisdom resulted in the Ethiopians' possessing the Ark of the Covenant.

How the Ethiopians Carried Away Zion The writers of the *Kebra Nagast* chronicle that the **Arks in Kemet**

relationship between Makeda, Queen of Sheba, and Arks are very ancient spiritual commodities that King Solomon resulted in a love relationship and the have been part of African culture since the time of birth of a child, Menelik. The Ark of the Covenant and Kemet (i.e., ancient Egypt). Ethiopian and Jewish how it came to rest in Axum is a crucial element in the traditions maintain that the Ark of the Covenant love story of Queen Makeda and King Solomon.

houses the Ten Commandments, which are believed to According to *Kebra Nagast*, Queen Makeda raised be laws given to Moses by God and represents the Menelik in Ethiopia. When he became an adult, he and energy of God. The Ark is said to emit a dazzling a group of priests visited his father, King Solomon.

mystical aura.

One night, while the group was in Jerusalem, an angel According to the Bible, Moses was raised in of the Lord appeared to Azaryas, one of the priests who Kemet; its influence on him can be seen in the bibli-accompanied Menelik, and stood over him like a pillar cal description of the Ark of the Covenant and the of fire. The angel told him to awaken his brothers (i.e., rituals that the Jewish people followed when they his fellow priests) and ask them to join him in taking used it in religious ceremonies. It was custom for the wooden pieces to where the Ark was kept. The angel people of Kemet to hold an Apet festival, where there told Azaryas to pull open the doors of the temple was a procession in which arks were carried between where they kept Zion, the "Tabernacle of the Law of the temples of Luxor and Karnak. The Kemetic arks God," and they would be able to take it away with no were originally shaped like boats but eventually problem.

Azaryas arose and woke up three of his became shaped more like chests. The Ark of the brethren. They went to the temple, which held Zion, Covenant was originally described as a rectangular, and found the doors open. An angel was in there to fur-gold-plated hardwood box, about 4 feet long, 2 feet, ther direct them. They took Zion and replaced the spot 3 inches wide, and 2 feet, 6 inches deep. It was over-where it had been with the pieces of wood that the laid in pure gold within and without and round about.

angel had told them to bring. They covered the wood It rested on a mercy seat of pure gold. It had one with “coverings of Zion,” then shut the doors and went golden cherub with outspread wings on one end and back to their houses. Then the priests sacrificed a another similar one on the other end.

sheep, burned incense, and set Zion in a secret place for 7 days and 7 nights.

When Menelik was ready to return to Axum, he **THE ETHIOPIAN CHURCH**

asked his father, King Solomon, to bless him, which According to Ethiopian tradition, the Ark of the he did. Menelik was not immediately aware that his Covenant rests in the most private part of the group was in possession of Zion, but when he was Ethiopian church, which is called the *mekedes*. Only told, he rejoiced. The group put Zion on a wagon piled

A-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:24 PM Page 108

108———**Axum Empire**

with a “mass of worthless stuff, and dirty clothes, and

- Menelik, the son of King Solomon and Makeda, stores of every sort” and departed from Jerusalem.

Queen of Sheba, brought the Ark from Jerusalem Even though the people of Israel were not consciously to Axum, the sacred and political capital of aware that Zion was on the wagon, they knew intu-Ethiopia

itively and “old men, children, virgins and widows

- the God of Israel transferred his residence on wailed and wept.” The Archangel Michael spread out earth from Jerusalem to Axum, the ecclesiasti-his wings in front of them and, with his protection, cal and political capital of Ethiopia they were able to march across the ocean with the same ease as they were able to move across the land.

The Emperor Haile Ras Tafari Selassie was the When Menelik and his party arrived in Ethiopia, 225th direct line descendent of a dynasty that ruled they told the people that they were the custodians of from Axum and began with Menelik, the son of Zion. According to legend, when warring groups Makeda and Solomon. In 1974, there was a revolution attacked, many of the Ethiopians’ statues were in Ethiopia and he was removed from the throne. The destroyed and the monoliths that represented the tra-emperor died in obscure circumstances a year later. In ditional religion fell and broke into pieces. The Queen spite of numerous wars and upheavals, Axum remains of Sheba then stepped down and her son, Menelik, a site of commitment to sacred passion and opulent ruled as the Ethiopian emperor from Axum. The text festivals.

of *Kebra Nagast* says, “For ZION shone like the sun . . . they spread out purple beneath her, and they

— *Miriam Ma’at-Ka-Re Monges*

draped her with draperies of purple, and they sang songs before and behind her . . . for they saw Zion moving in the heavens like the sun, and they all ran **FURTHER READING**

with the wagon of Zion, some in front of her and some in back of her.” This is the Timkat, Ceremony of the Budge, E.A. Wallis. (1992). *The Queen of Sheba and Her Epiphany*, that the Ethiopian people do today in *Only Son Menyelek I: Being the Book of the Glory of Kings (Kebra Nagast)*. Oxford, UK: Oxford University Axum. During this joyous ceremony, a replica of the Press. (Original work published 1932). This is an English Ark is taken out wrapped in rich purple brocade and translation of the famous Ethiopian *Kebra Nagast*.

marched in a procession of priests and laypeople. On There are many other translations, but this remains a rare occasions, some privileged pilgrims are given useful text.

water to drink that has been washed over Zion. Axum Kobishchanov, Y. (1966). *Axum*. University Park: The continues to be the holiest city in Ethiopia.

Pennsylvania State University Press. The Axum Empire is discussed from its origin to its eclipse. The author traces its beginnings as a commercial powerhouse and **The Church Today**

demonstrates how it maintained control over the sea and land.

The Ethiopian Orthodox Church believes that *The Original African Heritage Study Bible*. (1993). (Cain Hope Felder, Ed.). Washington, DC: Winston. This refer-

- the lawful kings of Ethiopia were descended once work was edited by African-heritage conscious from Solomon, King of Israel

theologians.

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 109

B

and although there settlers were initially greeted **BACK-TO-AFRICA MOVEMENT**

with hostility, they soon established relations with the indigenous people and created a home among The Back-to-Africa movement is a physical and them. This movement led to the creation of the country psychological project that emerged from the desire of of Liberia.

African people to return to their native land. Several A second movement was that led by Marcus major campaigns related to the Back-to-Africa move-Garvey (1887–1940), who preached, among other ment have been launched in North America. They things, a Back-to-Africa doctrine. Perhaps

no individual stem from the sense of loss Africans experienced upon influencing African American thinking on going when they landed on foreign soil. How to return to the back to Africa as much as Garvey did. When he came land they had left was the all-encompassing passion of to New York in 1916, Garvey had already seen the the people who found themselves as strangers in an condition of blacks in the Caribbean and Central alien society. This would become the passion of some America and was certain that the only way for African of their descendants as well, and when they could people to have peace was to leave the Americas. He not imagine the possibility of the freedom to travel was convinced that white racism would never cease to Africa, they would sing about it or write poetry and that only on the African continent would Africans depicting it. Thus Africa became the eternal symbol of experience harmony, progress, and development.

the drive of the black population toward physical and Among the instruments Garvey used to disseminate psychological redemption.

nate his ideas was *The Negro World* newspaper. In *The* The first American movement to send Africans *Negro World*, he advanced the need for economic back to Africa did not originate with Africans, how-independence, pride of race, and a return to Africa.

ever. It came out of the intense debate among white Garvey organized a steamship company, the Black politicians about the future of the nation. Some aboli-Star Line, to provide commercial and transport links tionists had proposed sending Africans out of the between black people; however, his method of selling country in order to lessen the possibility of racial stock led to his conviction in 1923 for mail fraud in conflict. This plan was supported by the most promi-relationship to the Back-to-Africa project. When he went Americans of the early 19th century. In 1816, the came out of prison in 1927, he was an international American colonization movement was started with figure in the African world. His organization, the the purpose of sending blacks back to Africa. The first Universal Negro Improvement Association and African group of Africans left for Africa in 1820, but the Communities League, had more than 10 million project failed because it was poorly planned and the members, and Garvey, its leader and

guide, was the people could not find a desirable place to settle. Soon, most electric and charismatic speaker produced by the however, the land later known as Liberia was settled, African world. Back-to-Africa remains a powerful 109

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 110

110——— *Before the Mayflower*

concept into the 21st century, although it has evolved (4) “Behind the Cotton Curtain,” (5) “Blood on the from referring to a strictly physical return to Africa Leaves: Revolts and Conspiracies,” (6) “The Generation to the psychological idea of going back to Africa of Crisis,” (7) “The Jubilee War,” (8) “Black Power in mentally.

the Old South,” (9) “The Life and Times of Jim Crow,”

(10) “Red, White and Black: Race and Sex,” (11) “From

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

Booker T. Washington to Martin Luther King, Jr.,” and (12) “The Time of the Whale.”

FURTHER READING

In the first chapter, “The African Past,” Bennett Garvey, Amy. (1986). *Marcus Garvey: Opinions and Writings*.

reveals to the reader that human civilization began in Wellesley, MA: Majority Press. (Original work published Africa, and that Ethiopia and Egypt were two of the 1923). This is the classic compilation of Garvey’s papers greatest civilizations of antiquity. He also documents and speeches and remains the most important source of the power and prestige of the empires of Ghana, Mali, information about Garvey’s principal ideas. Tony Martin, the major authority on Garvey, provides an insightful and Songhay during the golden age of West Africa.

introduction.

The second chapter, “Before the Mayflower,” docu-Martin, Tony. (1976). *Race First*. Wellesley, MA: Majority. This is currently the best analysis of the Garvey colonies at Jamestown in 1619, as well as the legal movement and its political implications.

and political process that transformed them from indentured servants, similar to others in the colony, into enslaved beings throughout the colonies.

The next two chapters, “The Founding of Black

BEFORE THE MAYFLOWER

America” and “Behind the Cotton Curtain,” highlight how free Africans helped shape the United States. First published more than 40 years ago, Lerone Bennett’s *Before the Mayflower* (1962), now in its sixth printing, stands as one of the most important texts exploring the African experience in the United

“Blood on the Leaves: Revolts and Conspiracies,”

States. Bennett’s classic work begins in antiquity with draws attention to the most well-known plots and Ethiopia and Egypt. The author traces the origins of rebellions formed by Africans resisting the evil of Africans from West Africa through the horrors of the enslavement. The next chapter, “The Generation of Middle Passage to the Americas, and then through Crisis,” revisits the activities of free Africans and their the enslavement, Reconstruction, Jim Crow, and civil opposition to racism and enslavement. It highlights rights eras.

important individuals, organizations, and events in Bennett’s narrative of the African experience is in a U.S. history that directly affected the institution of poetic voice, which adds to the value of this monu-enslavement—in particular, both African and white mental text. Indeed, the author’s writing style creates abolitionists, the Compromise of 1850, and

the Dred an enjoyable reading experience. Bennett turns this Scott case. In the seventh chapter, “The Jubilee War,”

history into an epic journey that is neither a story of Bennett charts the path to the Civil War and Africans’

victimization nor an exaggeratedly triumphant docu-support of and participation in it. He also reveals mentary. It is a superb synthesis of the challenges Abraham Lincoln’s reluctance to challenge the insti-Africans faced, their mistakes, their victories, their tutition of slavery and to allow Africans to fight for successes, and their failures. *Before the Mayflower* their own liberation.

is a book about both tragedy and victory. While not In chapters 8 through 12—“Black Power in the Old romanticizing African resistance and resilience, South,” “The Life and Times of Jim Crow,” “Red, Bennett most certainly displays a consciousness of White and Black: Race and Sex,” “From Booker T.

Africans’ victories and perseverance in the face of the Washington to Martin Luther King, Jr.,” and “The Time failed and broken promises of a society that enslaved of the Whale”—Bennett documents Reconstruction, and oppressed their people for centuries.

the brief period of democracy in the South, and the The book is comprised of the following twelve black politicians who emerged during this era, the end chapters: (1) “The African Past,” (2) “Before the of Reconstruction, and the subsequent era of Jim Mayflower,” (3) “The Founding of Black America,”

Crow and legal segregation and disenfranchisement

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 111

The Birth of a Nation———111

that eradicated black political power and human rights such as the close-up, the iris shot, the split screen, and for nearly 100 years.

rapid-fire editing. The grandeur of the film swept *Before the Mayflower* is a landmark work that is still audiences off their feet. At a private White House used in many universities across the country. Because it screening, President Woodrow Wilson exclaimed, "It was published more than 40 years ago, it is obviously is like writing history with lightning!" However, the limited in its scope and most useful for study of African film also succeeded in perpetuating on a massive scale American life prior to the 20th century. The book also the cultural myths and misrepresentations of African precedes the Afrocentric movement; therefore some Americans that had originally been constructed during of its language does not reflect the cultural location the era of enslavement in the United States. In the tra-of many contemporary scholars. Nevertheless, *Before* dition of the popular minstrel show, the prominent *the Mayflower* continues to be a valuable resource for black characters of the Mammy, Uncle Tom, the bru-anyone interested in the African experience in the tal black buck, and the tragic mulatto were played by United States.

white actors in blackface.

The Birth of a Nation debuted during a period of

— *Adisa A. Alkebulan*

tremendous social and political change in the country.

Released during the era of Jim Crowism, the film **FURTHER READING**

functioned to aid in the oppression of blacks by just-Bennett, Lerone. (1964). *The Negro Mood*. Chicago: Johnson fying the need to keep them under the control of a Publishing Company. Bennett provides the reader with an white racist social, economic, and political system.

accurate assessment of the political and social climate The constant articulation of this racist agenda in pop-that made revolts and violence predictable in the urban ular culture was a thorn in the side of the body politic.

communities of America.

The great migration of African Americans from the South to the urban centers of the North threatened the fragile social fabric as blacks aggressively challenged the role of Martin Luther King, Jr. Chicago: Johnson Publishing Company. This is one of the earliest biographies of Martin Luther King, who according to the author, was cast in the role of spiritual and moral teacher.

ment, education, and housing. At the same time, the arrival of nearly 25 million European immigrants into the United States posed a unique challenge to the white power structure. As economically and politically disempowered groups came into contact in depressed areas for the liberation struggles of the African American community.

urban communities, the possibility of collective organization and action across racial and ethnic lines *White Dream*. Chicago: Johnson Publishing Company.

became a cause for concern. In order to maintain the system of white supremacy, the white ruling class tried to save the Union, although he did not believe needed to divest immigrants of their various ethnic identities that blacks and whites could live together in America.

identities and instill in them new identities based primarily on race. Film, with its gross caricatures of African people, became the perfect vehicle to acculturate the largely illiterate population into a racist

THE BIRTH OF A NATION

society as immigrants aligned themselves with white supremacist ideology.

American cinema was in its infancy when David Wark Griffith's epic saga was released in 1915. Based on the **EARLY PROTEST AGAINST THE**

FILM

novel *The Clansman* by Thomas Dixon, the film *The Birth of a Nation* continues to be hailed as a techno-The African American community vigorously logical masterpiece as well as a triumph of white protested the release of *The Birth of a Nation*. Several supremacist ideology. *The Birth of a Nation* is con-civil rights and religious groups denounced the film's sidered by scholars and critics to be the antecedent racist propaganda. The NAACP (National Association of contemporary Hollywood feature films, as Griffith for the Advancement of Colored People) was instru-made masterful use of innovative formal strategies mental in organizing black boycotts of the film all

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 112

112——— *The Birth of a Nation*

over the country. The organization picketed the theater seen cheating at the ballot box and illegally denying at the film's New York premiere, and the Chicago whites the right to vote. And during a meeting of the and Boston branches also led massive demonstrations South Carolina legislature, black representatives make against it. Black-owned newspapers condemned the a mockery of the political process by removing their film in lengthy editorials. And race rebellions broke shoes, drinking liquor, and eating fried chicken while out in a number of cities. However, the film still the proceedings take place. Finally, white legislators enjoyed critical success, and this success is believed are appalled as their black counterparts proceed to to have contributed to the rise in Ku Klux Klan mem-pass a series of laws that permit marriage between bership and increase in lynchings of blacks during blacks and whites.

this period.

Sex and Race

THE STORY

The danger of unrestrained black sexuality is introduced through two mulatto characters—Lydia Brown, era of American history. The story centers around Congressman Stoneman's housekeeper, and the ambitious white, upper-class families, the Camerons and tious Silas Lynch. The behavior of these two figures is the Stonemans. The Camerons of Piedmont, South constantly juxtaposed against that of the film's white Carolina, represent the wealthy, slave-holding, planter characters, particularly the white female characters, class of the Southern aristocracy. They symbolize whose sexuality is always presented as innocent and the gentility and tradition of the Confederacy. The restrained. In an early scene, Lydia is shown fantasizing—Stonemans are wealthy Northern industrialists who long for the privileged life she believes will be hers are ambivalent on the issue of slavery. The film opens when the Confederacy is defeated. When a white colonel with a visit from the Stonemans to the Cameron league of Stoneman rejects her sexual advances, Lydia, home. As the Stonemans tour the Cameron home—as a result of her black blood, goes into an orgasmic fit instead, plantation life in the antebellum South is displaying an innate animalistic sexuality. Silas Lynch depicted as a utopian environment where rigid racial later displays this same uncontrollable nature in his codes are strictly observed. Enslaved Africans are desired to possess Elsie Stoneman, the congressman's depicted as passive supporters of the system, and the daughter. Although the mulattoes are able to assume Camerons are shown to be virtuous and benevolent some degree of civility because of their mixed-race slaveowners. However, several scenes later, the Civil War begins and the idyllic life the Camerons have the surface waiting to erupt at the slightest provocation—enjoyed abruptly comes to a halt.

tion. But perhaps the infamous scene depicting the There are two dominant themes that run throughout black renegade soldier Gus lustfully pursuing the “pet the film: the threat of black social and political agency sister” Cameron most clearly establishes the danger and the threat of black sexuality. The destructive of black sexuality in the film. Rather than accept the potential of blacks is foregrounded in the scene concerning marriage proposal of the savage brute, the young girl merely referred to as “the Raid on Piedmont.” Lydia chooses to protect her virtue by throwing herself off a cliff by a

“white, scalawag” captain, black Union soldiers cliff and plunging to her death.

maraud through the town terrorizing whites and looting their homes. The blacks are shown as uncivilized **Birth of the Klan**

brutes with no regard for human life, and they are juxtaposed against the civilized regiment of white The formation of the Ku Klux Klan dominates the Confederate soldiers who race to the besieged town to third act of the film. As destruction reigns throughout rescue the white citizens and restore peace and order.

the South, Ben Cameron comes up with an idea that The scene functions to emphasize the inherent inferi-will avenge the death of his sister and save the South ority of black intelligence as well as blacks’ depen-from black rule. The introduction of the Klan at this dence on white leadership.

narrative juncture functions to legitimize the need for The futility of black political advancement is violent aggression against blacks as the only method demonstrated as newly freed blacks attempt to usurp for maintaining white privilege. In the climatic final political power from the white ruling class. Blacks are scene, its members are shown riding to the rescue of

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 113

Black Anglo-Saxons———113

the besieged Cameron family and their faithful black servants who have taken refuge from black marauders **BLACK ANGLO-SAXONS**

in a remote area outside the city. Hence, the Klan provides the clearest articulation of white supremacist *Black Anglo-Saxons* is a term most commonly used ideology by acting as the repository of truth, peace, to denote people of African descent who historically and order.

have been miseducated and as a result experience problems with identity formation. Those referred to as Black Anglo-Saxons have a fundamental

disorder **SCHOLARLY DISCOURSE ON THE FILM**

stemming from racism and global white supremacy.

Since its premiere, two distinct modes of discourse have This disorder affects African people, predominantly developed around *The Birth of a Nation*. Mainstream in North America and Great Britain, who experience film scholars often foreground the film's aesthetic and demonstrate inordinate difficulties or maladaptive accomplishments, giving the sociopolitical meanings behaviors regarding their African heritage and ances-imbedded in the narrative only a cursory analysis, while try. The term has also been used in discussing the scholars based in the humanities and social sciences behaviors of blacks on the continent of Africa who, as usually focus on the representation of race without a a result of their colonial and neocolonial experience, clear understanding of how the film's artistic qualities strive to become Westernized and to emulate white inform the narrative. However, in recent years a number European and American culture at the expense of of scholars have sought to close the discursive space other Africans. The term has been analyzed in many by examining how the formal strategies or aesthetics areas of study beyond psychology and clinical per-of the film function to reinforce an ideology of white sonality assessments, such as history, education, soci-supremacy. For instance, Griffith's intertitles or title ology, and Africology. The term *Black Anglo-Saxons* cards, as they are more commonly known, not only pro-has also been used to critique the historic role of the vide information and clarify the plot, they also convey black elite and middle class and their relationship to a sense of historical accuracy to subsequent scenes. In the masses of poor blacks. Other, more creative terms the scene involving the newly elected black legislators, that have been used include *Afropeans* and *Afrosaxons*.

a title card preceding the visual image of the vulgar, The most significant written analysis of Black uncivilized politicians informs viewers that the scene is Anglo-Saxons comes from sociologist and Africana a reenactment of an 1871 session of the South Carolina Studies scholar Nathan Hare. Hare's book *Black legislature*. The purpose of the intertitles (like voiceover *Anglo-Saxons* has been widely discussed and cited narration in the sound

era) is to act as the authoritative since its publication in 1965. With respect to its voice of history. By making reference to actual his-impact, this text has been compared to Carter G.

torical events, their strategic placement within the film Woodson's *The Mis-Education of the Negro* (1933), lends credibility to the ensuing fictionalized narrative E. Franklin Frazier's *Black Bourgeoisie* (1948), and that discredits the history and culture of African people.

Frantz Fanon's *Black Skin, White Masks* (1967).

Thus, it was necessary that the role of African American Nathan Hare defined the term *Black Anglo Saxon* as scholars include correcting the images and the impres-characterizing "those members of the Black middle sions given by negative portrayals of blacks in the class who have lost all sense of identity and responsi-movies. It is no different in this era.

bility for the Black masses." This phenomenon is the result of the racial and cultural oppression of African

— *Stephanie Yarbough*

people, and its outcome is self-hate and the conscious or unconscious desire to cause harm to other members **FURTHER READING**

of African society. Author, educator, and Africana Bogle, D. (1998). *Toms, Coons, Mulattoes, Mammies, and Studes* scholar Julia Hare has lectured widely on the *Bucks*. New York: Continuum. This is the standard work on miseducation of the Black Anglo-Saxon. According to the portrayal of Africans in American cinema.

Julia Hare, in the most extreme behavioral examples Taylor, C. (1996). *The Re-Birth of the Aesthetic in Cinema*. In of Black Anglo-Saxons, individuals deny any and all D. Bernardi (Ed.), *The Birth of Whiteness, Race and the Emergence of U.S. Cinema*. New Brunswick, NJ: Rutgers aspects of Africanity and make a concerted effort to University Press. This is one of the most insightful discus-distance themselves from the larger group of blacks.

sions of the relationship between race and cinema.

Julia Hare also notes that some of the behaviors are a

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 114

114——**Black Arts Movement**

defense mechanism rooted in racial demoralization racism and journalism, pointing to the fact that many media and the fear of the established order. Hare comments institutions hire blacks who will not even go into their own on how Black Anglo-Saxons fail to appreciate the communities.

Hare, Nathan. (1965). *Black Anglo-Saxons*. London: Collier-impact of their attitudes on the rest of the African Macmillan. This is the classic work on African Americans American community.

who have abandoned their own culture.

Since Nathan Hare established the conceptual basis Hilliard, Asa G., III. (1998). *Sba: The Reawakening of the* for the dialogue on Black Anglo-Saxons, other writers *African Mind*. Gainesville, FL: Makare. Hilliard's work and scholars have also addressed the issue. George is brilliant in its conceptualization of the problem and E. Curry, syndicated columnist and former editor-in-solution to the crisis in African American consciousness.

chief of *Emerge* magazine, discussed the concept with Vontress, Clemmont E. (1966). The Negro Personality respect to the recruitment and inculcation of young Reconsidered. *Journal of Negro Education*, 35(3), 210–217.

This is one of the early accounts of black personality as black journalists from colleges and universities.

developed under duress.

Citing Hare's work, Curry noted, for example, how Wilson, Amos N. (1998). *Blueprint for Black Power*.

few African American journalists actually cultivate New York: Afrikan World Infosystems. Wilson's book is a any ties with their community and are willing to massive work detailing the manner in which African people search on their own for any story related to African in the United States have been kept from power over their Americans. There are scholars who in related analyses own lives. This study is one of the best in the field.

have offered methods for addressing the problem.

These include but are not limited to Frances Cress Welsing's examination of aspects of the behavior in *The Isis Papers* (1991), Amos Wilson's systematic **BLACK ARTS MOVEMENT**

study in *Blueprint for Black Power* (1998), Asa G.

Hilliard's cultural response in *Sba: The Reawakening* The black arts movement (BAM) was an intense, *of the African Mind* (1998), and Katherine Bankole's vocal, provocative, and serious intellectual movement observations in *You Left Your Mind in Africa* (2000).

devoted to exploring all and every aspect of African The concept of the Black Anglo-Saxon has been life—without reference to the culture imposed by both vigorously challenged and praised for providing Europe. Often referred to as the artistic sister of the one of the most thorough critiques of the emergence black power movement, the black arts movement is and maintenance of the black middle class since highly regarded among African American intellectu-E. Franklin Frazier. It remains a viable construct in the als. The movement changed the function and meaning analysis of how and why persons of African descent of literature, as well as the place of culture in main-actively participate in the disassociation and exploita-stream America, by insisting on the right of the artists tion of other Africans.

to redefine the roles and characterizations given them by white Americans.

— *Katherine Olukemi Bankole*

BAM sought to challenge some of the long-standing assumptions of literary critics and historians. Thus, its **FURTHER READING**

writers wanted to interrogate the role of the text, art and temporality, the responsibility of artists to their Bankole, Katherine. (2000). *You Left Your Mind in Africa: communities, and oral forms*. BAM was essentially *Journal Observations and Essays on Racism and African American Self-Hatred*. Morgantown, WV: Nation House.

critical, but it did produce some outstanding art, such This is a very insightful work on the nature of racism and as the work by Charles Fuller, Haki Madhubuti, Amiri African American self-hatred, as well as an observation Baraka (formerly LeRoi Jones), Ed Bullins, Nikki and critical commentary useful for understanding black Giovanni, Harold Cruse, Adrienne Kennedy, and cultural disorientation.

Larry Neal.

Cress Welsing, Frances. (1991). *The Isis Papers*. Chicago: There were a number of central points made by Third World Press. This book is provocative and highly the BAM artists. They were concerned about black critical of the racist structures in the American society.

identity, ethnicity, dignity, timeliness, aesthetic, Curry, George E. (2001, August 16). Looking for Black Journalists in the Wrong Places: The Last Word. *Black cultural nationalism, and self-determination. Some Issues in Higher Education*, pp. 21–25. In this article, a of the main philosophical writers included Larry major African American journalist speaks on the issues of Neal, Amiri Baraka, Maulana Karenga, and Charles

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 115

***Black Athena*———115**

Fuller—all of whom wrote detailed discussions of Bernal’s work is subtitled “The Afroasiatic Roots their approaches to artistic contribution. BAM was a of Classical Civilization,” emphasizing his belief that dominant paradigm while it lasted, and it has shaped the foundation of Greek civilization was Africa and the way we respond to art.

Asia. He establishes his arguments on the basis of historical inquiry and linguistic analyses. There is a

— *Daryl Zizwe Poe*

strong appreciation in Bernal's books for the work done by early African scholars such as George G. M.

FUTHER READING

James and Cheikh Anta Diop. Although Bernal cannot Baker, Houston A. (1984). *Blues, Ideology, and Afro-American* be called an Afrocentrist, he is clearly one of the *Literature: A Vernacular Theory*. Chicago: University of scholars who has assisted the Afrocentric project of Chicago Press. Baker's book is one of the best works on critiquing the hegemonic ideas of the European world.

the blues; it is crisply written and speaks volumes about The first volume is his most famous work, *Black* the need to understand it.

Bambara, Toni Cade. (1970). *Black Woman: An Anthology*.

Athena, is organized into 10 chapters and a conclusion.

New York: New American Library. This book remains a Each chapter is created to build toward the conclusion valuable anthology.

that the "miracle" of Greek culture is a misnomer and Cruse, Harold. (1967). *The Crisis of the Negro Intellectual*.

a fabrication of the Aryan model of antiquity. The New York: William Morrow. This monumental work development of Greek civilization from its earliest chronicles the lives of blacks who experience the double times with the appearance of the Pelasgians and struggle of trying to please whites and their social being.

Ionians was indebted to outside influences and it was Gayle, Addison. (1971). *The Black Aesthetic*. Garden City, most likely, Bernal argues, that these sources were NY: Doubleday. This book is beautifully written and

argued by a person who was one of the key figures in the Africa and Asia. In the case of Africa, Egypt supplied BAM.

Greece with a considerable cultural trove of ideas, concepts, ceremonies, names, and material artifacts. Using

See also [www. blackartsmovement.com](http://www.blackartsmovement.com) This is an important the works of Greek writers, Bernal demonstrates that Web site on the movement managed by Molefi K. Asante, Jr., the early historians and geographers were clear on the and edited by Amiri Baraka and Ed Bullins.

debt Greece owed to Africa. Thucydides, Isocrates, Plato, and Aristotle were beneficiaries of the work of those who lived in Asia and Africa before them. To Bernal, it is clear that the ancient model of antiquity is

BLACK ATHENA

much more plausible than the Aryan model that was created to aid the idea of white superiority. Indeed, the *Black Athena* is a three-volume project by Martin goddess Athena was black, which is why Bernal titled Bernal. It is mainly concerned with ancient Egyptian his work *Black Athena*.

and Phoenician roles in the formation of Greek civiliza-Delving into the controversy over the color of tion. While Greek is without question an Indo-European the ancient Egyptians, Bernal distances himself from language, more than half of its basic vocabulary cannot those who argue that the ancient Africans were white.

be explained in terms of Indo-European. The linguistic Perhaps this is the position that creates tension argument is thus central to Bernal's hypothesis that between him and the classicists who cannot accept Egypt and the Levant (East or Syro-Palestine) had a that the ancient Egyptians were black skinned with massive cultural, scientific, and religious impact on the wooly hair, as suggested in the 5th-century book, *The formation of ancient Greek civilization*. Classical and *Histories*, written by Herodotus. Nevertheless, Bernal Hellenistic Greeks (500–50 B.C.E.) emphasized the shows how the fate of Egypt and its relationship to importance of Egypt in the creation of their culture Greece rise and fall with different emphases on the and

civilization. However, modern Euro-American part of European scholars. It is the work of the defenders of the Eurocentric disciplines of classics and Afrocentric scholars that has maintained the strength Egyptology generally marginalize ancient Egyptian and of the argument that Egypt is the great contributor to Phoenician cultural influences on Greece. Moreover, early Greek civilization.

due to racial and ideological biases, Eurocentric schol-Another point in *Black Athena* that has created ars were unwilling to trace ancient African sources of controversy is Bernal's view on the Egyptian Vulture fundamental Greek words.

Glyph. Scholars' recognition of the original / sound of

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 116

116———**Black Atlantic**

the Egyptian Vulture Glyph is crucial in tracing the could not have existed without the presence and correct Egyptian and African sources of Greek words influence of Egypt makes it all the more important to that cannot be fully explained in terms of Indo-teach Black Studies courses to those who study the European. The Egyptian Vulture Glyph is convention-classics.

ally represented as 3. It is an original / sound with

— *Mohamed Garba*

an *r* variant in Egyptian and other African languages.

The monoconsonantal Egyptian form / (3) stands for **FURTHER READING**

“vulture,” and for the more general category of birds.

It corresponds to the Hausa (Chadic) *lalo* for “type of Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). *Kemet, Afrocentricity and bird*,” the Maba (Chadic) *ara* for “vulture,” the Logo *Knowledge*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This work (east Sudanic) *ala* for “vulture,” the Ge' ez (classical examines various

aspects of ancient Egyptian civilization as a way to build theoretical foundations in Black Studies.

Ethiopic) *lilo*, *lolo* for “vulture,” the Tigrinya or Asante, Molefi Kete, and Mazama, Ama (Eds.). (2002). *Egypt* Amharic *lila*, *lilo* for “vulture,” and the Tigre *lilo* for vs. *Greece and the American Academy: The Debate Over* “vulture.”

the Birth of Civilization. Chicago: African American Images. Unfortunately, this Vulture Glyph was erroneously. This book is notable because it brings together the presumed by earlier Egyptologists to be a glottal stop.

central theorists and historians who have taken on the chal-This has misled a lot of scholars. Lost in such confusions of the neo-Aryan school of thought about antiquity.

sion, some Indo-Europeanists have not only accused Bernal, Martin. (2001). *Black Athena Writes Back: Martin Bernal Responds to His Critics* (David C. Moore, Ed.).

Bernal of inconsistencies or lack of rigor in proposing Durham, NC: Duke University Press. In this series of different values for the letter 3 but also denied the evi-essays, Bernal demonstrates *Black Athena's* critics' adherence. The derivation of Greek *l* or *r* from Egyptian 3

ence to the Aryanist model of ancient history.

is, according to some Indo-Europeanists, unsupported Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1991). *Civilization or Barbarism: An* by any reliable example. Thus, Bernal's derivation of *Authentic Anthropology* (Yaa-Lengi Meema Ngemi, the Greek *kar* or *ker* for “soul” from the Egyptian *k-l* Trans.). Chicago: Laurence Hill. (Original work published or *k-3* for “soul” was rejected by certain Eurocentric 1981). This is Diop's major work on the nature of ancient scholars who proposed instead the Proto-Indo-civilizations.

Obenga, T. (1995). *La Géométrie Égyptienne: Contribution de* European form *ker*, related to *keiro*, meaning “cut.” It *l' Afrique Antique à la*

Mathématique Mondiale. Paris: is an instance where the adapted Egyptian loan word Editions l' Harmattan and Khepera. In this work, Obenga had been completely disguised in Greek as a regular confronts the issue of the origin of ancient science and Indo-European form with the necessary affixes and shows that Africa made a major contribution to the ancient dialectal variants (*kar* or *ker*).

world in mathematics.

Within an Afrocentric orientation to data, the origin of the Egyptian conception of the soul, *k-l* or *k-3*, can be located in Africa. The Egyptian *k-l* or *k-3* for “soul”

corresponds to the Hausa (Chadic) *kur(wa)* for “soul,”

BLACK ATLANTIC

spirit,” the Mofu-Gudur (Chadic) *kul(ey)* for “ancestral spirit,” the Teda (Nilo-Saharan) *(a)gal/ (a)kal* for “spirit, Over the past decade, there has been a growing thought,” the Ga (Kwa, Niger-Congo) *kla* for “soul,”

academic interest in the notion of the Black Atlantic.

the Ewe (Kwa, Niger-Congo) *(e)kla* for “soul, the Akan Indeed, it is a term that is both provocative and (Kwa, Niger-Congo) *(o)kra* for “soul,” and the Wolof complex, involving the ebb and flow of millions of (west Atlantic) *hel* for “spirit,” among others.

African descended peoples between three continents Bernal’s linguistic background has enabled him to (Africa, Europe, and America) for over 500 years.

show relationships between African and Greek lanIn this time period, African-derived peoples have guages that had not been shown before. *Black Athena* endured enslavement, colonialism, segregation, and is a monumental work and its achievements in history second-class citizenship, concomitant with various and linguistics are equaled by its contribution to the forms of resistance to these oppressions. Moreover, field of Black

Studies. Bernal once and for all time ingrained in this experience has been the development demolishes the notion of a pure, miraculous Greece, of white supremacy and its overt and covert attempts entering the world without assistance, and particularly to dehumanize, delimit, or deny African humanity.

without help from Africa. The fact that we now know Scholars who theorize the Black Atlantic offer varied that it is reasonably plausible that Greek civilization analyses ranging from historical to contemporary,

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 117

Black Atlantic——117

literary to political, parochial to pan-African positions.

Africans in America as having common ground for Presently there are two main schools of thought that organizing themselves against white supremacy is overlap—the contemporary academic areas of post-naive and akin to promoting ethnic absolutism.

modernism and Afrocentrism.

In fairness to the postmodern perspective on the Paul Gilroy's *The Black Atlantic: Modernity and Black Atlantic*, it is not possible to seriously deny that *Double Consciousness* (1993) exemplifies the post-there has been a cross-fertilization of cultures. However, modern school of thought and has been highly an African-centered perspective would, while acknowl-acclaimed in mainstream academic circles. However, edging the heterogeneity of African transnational from an African-centered perspective, his critical experiences, focus on both specificity and commonality.

insight is suspect on a number of basic levels. For In *Black Atlantic Politics: Dilemmas of Political* example, Gilroy wrestled with the idea that being both *Empowerment in Boston and Liverpool* (2000), William European and black required some special form of Nelson offers an ideal example of a contemporary double consciousness. The fact that he puts

European African-centered study of Black Atlantic politics. His before black is informative, as it signals that he viewed analysis of Boston and Liverpool gives clear evidence being European as primary and being black as sec-that in these cities, separated by the Atlantic Ocean, ondary as he established his Black Atlantic thesis.

there is a common experience of institutionalized racism African-centered scholars find this problematic, as it that has marginalized African-descended people's effectively marginalizes the African aspect and thus chances of full citizenship in both places. Boston and fails to enhance African agency in any meaningful way.

Liverpool are seaport cities, have a strong Irish heritage, Another key theme that emerges from postmodern and have endured antiblack riots. Nelson found the sim-perspectives is the hybridity within the Black Atlantic ilarities between Liverpool and Boston quite startling, cultural experience. Through the course of European and more research is emerging to substantiate the notion modernity, Gilroy maintains, individuals born within of commonality in the global African-descended world.

the Black Atlantic region have remained "locked sym-Whether the situation being analyzed is historical or biotically in an antagonistic relationship marked out contemporary, there is little doubt that heterogeneity is by the symbolism of colours which adds to the con-an aspect of African global experience. However, this spicuous cultural power of their central Manichean viewpoint should not be confined to the postmodern dynamic—black and white." Again, the African-definition, as it simply splinters, divides, and misappro-centered school of thought finds Gilroy's Manichean priates African phenomena. In addition, the postmodern dualism problematic because it sets up a framework of perspective amounts to a trivialization of the varied good and evil. It seems that Gilroy accepts a paradigm historical black struggles for liberation and, more in which white is linked with good and black is linked important, renders future struggles largely impotent.

with evil. Framing the Black Atlantic in Manichean The Black Atlantic as a site for the analysis of the thinking is thus detrimental to African descended African diaspora will no doubt continue to enrich intel-peoples. That is,

unless one attempts to turn the tradi-lectual thought and research for the foreseeable future.

tional Manichean logic on its head by making black Contentions between postmodern and African-centered good and white evil. But this merely leads to a reac-perspectives will also reflect the reality of how impor-tionary posture, and African-centered scholars prefer tant the interpretation of black history and culture is instead to stand firm within an African-centered ori-and who actually benefits from such analyses. At bot-entation to data interpretation that fosters independent tom, the Black Atlantic offers much scope, and the pos-analysis free from Eurocentric conceptualization.

sibilities for further research are infinite. This augurs Fragmentation of all cultural and social phenomena well for both the neophyte and seasoned scholar, wher-is the bedrock of the postmodernist pick-and-mix ever they are located within the Black Atlantic region.

analyses of the Black Atlantic experience. And because

— *Mark A. Christian*

there has been fluidity in this transnational cross-cultural reality, to think of commonality among black **FURTHER READING**

peoples is to pander to essentialism. In short, there is no Christian, Mark. (2001). African Centered Knowledge: A way back to Africa for Africans caught up in the Black British Perspective. In *Western Journal of Black Studies*, Atlantic—they have become new people as they have 25(1), 12–20. This is a penetrating account of the status been integrated or assimilated into Western culture. To of Afrocentric understanding in the British Isles by an regard, for example, Africans in the Caribbean and Afro-Britisher.



B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 118

118——**Black Church**

Gilroy, Paul. (1993). *The Black Atlantic: Modernity and Africans* were in fact overwhelmed with recited *Double Consciousness*. London: Verso. This is the original Christian text and rhetoric that confirmed, justified, statement of the Black Atlantic thesis by one of the leading and made hallowed their inferior station in American sociologists of Britain, which has been widely cited and life. Any faith-based beliefs that were potentially sub-criticized in African American Studies.

versive and would connote racial equity, such as “love Nelson, William E., Jr. (2000). *Black Atlantic Politics: Dilemmas of Political Empowerment in Boston and thy neighbor as thy brother*” or “all Christians are cre- Liverpool. New York: State University of New York Press.

ated in the image of God,” were not shared with the This is a powerful comparative analysis of the condition of black population for fear of

insurrection. Whites knew two black communities on both sides of the Atlantic.

that there could be no justification for their white Walvin, James. (2000). *Making the Black Atlantic: Britain and* supremacist practices and that the structure of domi-the African Diaspora. London: Cassell. Walvin's book nation that was enslavement could potentially be com-deals with the construction of the African diaspora in polit-promised if they shared such sentiments with blacks.

ical and cultural terms.

From its inception, the Black Church provided communal respite from forceful white dominance, a sanctuary away from white enslavers' controlling and **BLACK CHURCH**

abusive behaviors. Africans in the Black Church practiced such African customs as extended family gathering and spiritual call-and-response practices during The *Black Church* is a comprehensive term that refers religious ceremonies. The Black Church was also a to African American Christian institutions dating back forum for discussing and planning resistance during to the 18th century. The Black Church is a faith-based enslavement. Nat Turner's organized coup in South community structure, which is characterized by spiri-Hampton, Virginia in 1831 is one example of such an tual, social, and communicative patterns specific to event. He was a deacon in an African Baptist Church African culture that set it apart from European and who used that structure to coordinate and lead the Western Christian churches of the same denomination.

participants in the famed insurrection.

A mere 10% to 15% of Africans enslaved in America actually adopted Christianity during the period of bondage, with the majority of African Americans drawn to the dominant European religions after that period. Blacks on plantations throughout America secretly practiced the highly structured religious customs and faith ethics of the African tradition.

Plantation owners, however, systematically and forcefully attempted to remove these traditions from the culture of the enslaved. African religious practices were forbidden and African traditions were dismissed as heathen rituals that lacked any religious function.

Africans were bombarded with oppressive white rhetoric, which consistently deemed traditional African religion inferior and not worthy of the recognition of God.

Eddie Glaude, former graduate student and author of several papers and a book on the Black Church, consulting Sekai Zankel, graduate secretary at Temple University, 1990

HOW CHRISTIANITY

JUSTIFIED THE RACIAL ORDER

The first recorded organized Christian churches Christianity, on the other hand, served as a tool for founded by African Americans were formed in South maintaining the relationship and roles of the master Carolina in 1773 and Virginia in 1776. The number of and the enslaved, the oppressor and the oppressed.

institutions of this type grew slowly, especially in the If enslaved Africans were permitted to practice a South, until Africans emerged from the legal con-religion, it was European Christianity only. Enslaved straits of enslavement in 1865. These initial churches

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 119

Black Church——119

were offshoots of Methodist and Baptist establishments, for African Americans, often providing food, clothing, which mirrored the denominations and practices of and other primary necessities—and even the first most plantation owners. As the Black Church evolved, formal education for many in the black community.

however, most African Americans became increasingly dissatisfied with the tendencies of white churches. They very seriously, so they created academic centers inside were expected to worship according to European of their churches.

guidelines that were unnatural for the black members In addition, African American leaders concerned of the congregations. Often African Americans were with social justice, political participation, and educa-abused, were taunted, and experienced limited partic-tional equity for black people traditionally began their ipation rights in white churches. In the majority of activism in the Black Church, a pattern that snow-cases, Jim Crow laws and other oppressive practices balled in the 1950s with the start of the civil rights were just as prominent in the white churches as in the movement. Of the historical African American resis-larger American society. For example, blacks were tance revolutions, the civil rights movement was the forced to sit in the back of the church, barred from largest that was based in Christianity. Most of the communion rituals, and so forth.

leaders and organizations responsible for the move-However, rather than engaging in a critical assessment were associated with a Christian denomination.

ment of the role of Christianity in fostering white Carefully planned boycotts, sit-ins, marches, and the supremacy, and abandoning the acquired Christian like were orchestrated in Black Churches, often by faith for this reason, blacks established a number of Christian black ministers such as Reverend Dr. Martin independent sects. Other than the African Baptists, Luther King, Jr., Reverend Wyatt Tee Walker, and some of the new sects reflected the race or nationality Reverend Jesse Jackson. The primary organization of church leadership and congregation in the title. The associated with this movement was the Southern African Methodist Episcopal (AME) Church, founded Christian Leadership Conference (SCLC).

in 1816 by Methodist deacon Richard Allen, and Black congregations of the past filled Black Church the Colored Methodist Episcopal (CME) Church, services with emotional and spiritual interaction, and founded in 1870, are two that followed this pattern.

congregations of today carry on that tradition. Most of With such churches, African Americans began to them have been consistent in incorporating drumming, interpret the Christian word of God with some degree dancing, and spirituals, or hymns providing response of independence and were free to worship in their own to oppression, into the Christian service. These aspects manner, based on the culture of their ancestors. The distinguish the Black Church as a unique institution. In new style of worship combined the traditional reli-The Souls of Black Folks, W.E.B. Du Bois attributes the gious and cultural practices with adopted Western need for those denied the protections of a society to practices.

seek a “social center,” and that center for Africans was With the period of Reconstruction, the passing of the and remains the Black Church. Influenced by African Fourteenth and Fifteenth Amendments guaranteeing religion and spirituality, the desire for freedom from blacks’ rights, and the many social and professional oppression, and a somewhat modified perspective on gains of blacks in the 20th century, came a surge in lit-Christian religions, African Americans have created eracy and a will to define African American culture.

a unique construct within the European model. As a Social and political leaders of the time guided African result, Black Church services are interactive, full of Americans through this process. Many leaders, like cultural rituals, and responsive to the social condition Booker T. Washington, W.E.B. Du Bois, and Marcus of African Americans.

Garvey, who did not hold the same social, political, and

— *Myra Julian*

educational opinions, were practicing Christians. Even their individual establishments promoted the doctrines of Christianity. By 1913, there were some 40,000 Black **FURTHER READING**

Churches in America. Support for the physical, social, Lincoln, C. Eric, and Mamiya, Lawrence H. (1990). *The Black* political, and educational well-being of the black com-Church in the African American Experience. Durham, NC: munity became a standard and pinnacle function of the Duke

University Press. This is a useful account of the Black Church that lasted beyond enslavement. The history of social activism and social service associated with Black Church became the sole social services resource the Black Church.

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 120

120——**Black Codes**

Wilmore, Gayraud. (1998). *Black Religions and Black Radicalism* (3rd ed.). Maryknoll, NY: Orbis Books. This while we ought to do our best to bring them up to our work is one of the classics in black theology. Wilmore, per-present level, that, in doing so, we should, at the same haps the most dominant black theologian of his generation, time raise our own intellectual status so that the rela-provides a strong analysis of the interplay between religion tive position of the two races would be the same.”

and radicalism.

Woodson, Carter G. (1945). *The History of the Black Church*.

Nevertheless, radical Republicans were able to get Washington, DC: Associated Publishers. This book docu-the civil rights bill and the Reconstruction acts passed ments the critical role of the Black Church in African in 1867 and 1868. White control in Southern state American life.

legislatures made the passage of these laws almost useless, however, because the Ku Klux Klan and other racist organizations used terror and violence to prevent blacks from voting.

BLACK CODES

What occurred in Texas provides a telling example of how the Black Codes came into existence and were The Black Codes were a series of laws passed by the used to restrict the black population. It was the state legislatures of the South between 1865 and 1866.

Eleventh Legislature that produced the Texas Black Codes were patterned after the antebellum Codes in 1866. The Texas laws were meant to define Slave Codes, and their express purpose was to restrict

“the rights of persons lately known as slaves, and African American freedom. Indeed, the codes were free persons of color.” The Texas Black Codes made created in response to the fact that more than 4 million discrimination legal, and barred black people from formerly enslaved Africans had recently gained their voting, holding office, serving on juries, and testifying freedom, and they served to keep these African people in court (except in cases involving other blacks).

from full participation in the political, economic, and Supplemental legislation required railroads to provide social life of the South. In fact, the Black Codes separate accommodations for blacks and whites, sought to define the legal place of African people as establishing the basis for segregated facilities in other permanently inferior to whites, and thus reaffirmed services. An education law prevented blacks from the white Southerners’ attitude that black people were sharing in the public school fund, while the state’s meant to serve the interests of the white population.

homestead law prohibited blacks from participating in Thus, the Black Codes enacted during the the distribution of public land.

presidency of Andrew Johnson prevented blacks Like similar laws in other Southern states, the from sitting on juries, prohibited blacks’ from voting, Texas Black Codes intended to regulate black labor by limited blacks’ testimony against whites, denied forcing or coercing blacks to work for whites. Indeed, blacks the right to work in certain occupations, and they gave local authorities the right to use coercive legislated against blacks carrying weapons. In effect, force, with the threat of prison, to get blacks to work.

the Southern legislatures were trying to reinvent the The apprentice law made it possible for minors, with enslavement of Africans.

parental consent or with court orders, to be forced into On the national level, the radical Republicans in labor. The law required the employer to

provide the Congress advocated the passing of a civil rights bill to apprentice with food, clothing, medical attention, protect the newly freed Africans in the South from the humane treatment, and education for some trade, Black Codes. However, in April of 1866, President which would include farm labor. In return, the Johnson vetoed the civil rights bill, telling Governor employer could use the apprentice's labor and be per-Thomas C. Fletcher of Missouri, "This is a country for mitted, where necessary, to use corporal punishment white men, and by God, as long as I am President, to ensure that the apprentice worked. The employer it shall be a government for white men." Obviously, could pursue an apprentice who ran away from the Johnson saw his role not as the protector of the farm, and any person who interfered with the appren-oppressed, downtrodden, formerly enslaved, but tice's work could be fined. The jurisdiction for the rather, as the guardian of white privilege. He wrote in enforcement of this law was with the local courts.

a letter to Benjamin B. French, the commissioner of To further strip African Americans of their rights, public buildings, "Everyone would, and must admit, Texas, like other states, instituted a contract law that

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 121

Black Consciousness Movement——121

allowed all labor agreements that involved work for more than a month to be filed with the court. Workers **BLACK CONSCIOUSNESS**

had to be given a lien on half a crop to ensure the **MOVEMENT**

payment of wages. This was almost never done. On the other hand, employers had strong guarantees for The black consciousness movement was a political, the delivery of labor. They could deduct wages for cultural, and social movement that originated in South contract violations, disobedience, waste of time, Africa during the same time as the rise of Black destruction of property, debt, and absenteeism.

Studies in the United States, in the late 1960s and Under the Black Codes, vagrancy was a serious early 1970s. The leader of the black consciousness

violation, and a black person arrested for vagrancy movement was Bantu Stephen Biko, a charismatic who was unable to pay the fine could be apprenticed.

man of enormous intellectual abilities. Biko became Local courts had the power to assign convicts to any an international symbol of the resistance against type of labor until the fine was paid. Furthermore, the white racial domination in the late 1960s, and then he local authorities could put to work in any capacity a launched a conceptually clear definition of black con- person who had been sent to the county jail for a mis-sciousness for the youth movement of South Africa.

demeanor or petty offense. By stealing the time and Biko's understanding of the black consciousness wages of black people in this way, the white farmers movement began with defining those who were legally, were able to greatly increase their wealth.

politically, economically, and socially discriminated In the end, the Black Codes failed to fully bring against as a group in South African society. For Biko, about the reenslavement they were intended to create.

people had to identify themselves as supporting the This is in part because the laws galvanized the oppo-liberation struggle in order to be a part of the black sition in Congress and throughout the nation to the consciousness movement. Since the black conscious-racist policies of the Southern legislatures. Although ness movement was political, Biko argued, black con-segregation remained for many years, the most oner-sciousness was not a matter of pigmentation but a ous parts of the Black Codes only stayed in effect for reflection of a mental attitude. This argument of the a brief time. African Americans protested both the black power advocates in the United States resonated Black Codes and racial segregation, and many of the with the black consciousness movement in South laws that legalized the racist treatment of African Africa. Moreover, what Biko saw was that if he could people were rewritten as a result of the persistent get the masses simply to describe themselves as black, pressure placed on the South.

they would be on the road toward emancipation. Thus

— Molefi Kete Asante

using blackness as an identifier meant that people had committed themselves to fight against the forces that **FURTHER READING**

sought to use their blackness as a stamp of inferiority and subservience. For individuals to say “I am black”

Asante, Molefi Kete. (2002). *African American History: was to state a positive position about how they saw A Journey of Liberation*. Saddle Brook, NJ: Peoples themselves. This was a revolutionary concept in a Publishing Group. This is an Afrocentric analysis of African American history as primarily a struggle for free-society where it was commonly assumed that black-dom, and it includes an insightful discussion of the African ness was something negative.

resistance to the Black Codes that sought to disenfranchise black people in the United States.

OVERCOMING UNCONSCIOUSNESS

Franklin, John Hope. (1974). *From Slavery to Freedom*.

New York: Alfred A. Knopf. This book provides indispensable information for a thorough understanding of the history of the black consciousness movement cannot be fully understood without the understanding that South African context and political significance of the Black Codes.

African people who were not white did not necessarily Harding, Vincent. (1974). *There Is a River*. New York: see themselves as black. Biko and others in the move-Harcourt Brace Javonovich. Harding, one of the veterans of the movement recognized that there were people in South Africa the black power era and a brilliant historian, provides a clear and concise history of blacks' struggle and the search who had a nonwhite identity that would always frustrate for freedom in the midst of their deep despair in the time because the aspiration of the nonwhite is often to American society.

be white, which is really impossible. Nonwhites were

122———**Black Consciousness Movement** those who sought to serve the interests of white racial United States in many instances, in which whites had domination by serving in the police force or by calling the been deliberately made haves and blacks made have-whites by honorific titles. This was madness, according to nots, had inspired a confrontation between the races.

the black consciousness movement.

The movement asserted that these people should stop being nonwhite, stop being people who hated **Contradictions of Workers**

blackness and who despised their own culture. Black What Biko wanted to point out was that in South people were capable of standing with their heads high Africa there was no worker in the classical sense who in defiance of oppression rather than surrendering was white, for even the most downtrodden white their souls to white people. These proud people were worker was invested in the apartheid system. The the new people that the black consciousness move-whites were protected by laws preventing them from ment wanted to create. Therefore, it was possible having to compete with blacks. The only real workers to define black consciousness as the realization by in apartheid South Africa were black, and yet they Africans of the need to rally together around the cause were the lowest on the economic ladder. The black of liberation from oppression and to operate as a consciousness movement challenged the socialist group to rid themselves of the shackles that bound theory that the workers would unite.

them to perpetual servitude. Furthermore, it was a cor-The most violent antiblacks in South Africa were the rective and sought to demonstrate that blackness was lowest class of whites. The class analysis did not seem not an aberration and whiteness was not normal. The to hold in this case because color was far more impor-aim was to get whites off of the backs of blacks. This tant in the apartheid system than anything else, and new realization was meant to infuse the black com-white workers did not see anything that allowed them munity with new pride in the African values, culture, to identify their lot with blacks. White racial domina-religion, and general

outlook on life. But the critical thing was the one force that had to be destroyed because the element that made this new vision a movement was it infected everything. So long as Africans' vision the relationship between the consciousness of the self remained clear and they conceived of themselves as and the emancipatory program.

free, freedom was inevitable. But it was important that they avoid losing themselves in an amorphous work of **OVERHAULING A RACIST SYSTEM**

colorlessness. The black consciousness movement was not just a means to an end but a process meant to influence. Biko and his allies came to realize that they could not encourage black people to regard themselves as central rather seek reformation of the system because that would then be as appendages of white people. In this respect, simply accepting the major premises of the racist black consciousness as conceptualized by Biko was an irony itself. The society had to be completely over-antecedent to Afrocentricity.

hailed. Blacks were out to completely transform the The black consciousness movement delineated its system. The black consciousness movement wanted to basic beliefs in order to enable blacks to increase their ensure that Africans were convinced of the truth understanding of how the system of white privilege of their position. It was impossible for people to be worked in South Africa. The movement addressed conscious of themselves and yet remain in bondage.

these beliefs to the black community as follows: The envisioned self had to be a free self.

The black consciousness movement recognized that 1. We are all oppressed by the same system.

it was not just the liberation of Africans that was at stake but the liberation of the oppressed peoples of the 2. That we are oppressed to varying degrees is a world from the aggressive and exploitative activities of deliberate design to stratify us not only socially white culture. It must be acknowledged, however, that but also in terms of the enemy's aspirations.

in countries where whites exploited each other, they 3. We are committed to emancipation and it is our never reached the level of brutality they reached in duty to bring to the black people the deliberate-exploiting blacks. This was clearly not a coincidence ness of the enemy's subjugation scheme.

but a deliberate plan to completely eliminate any attempt at freedom on the part of blacks. The unjust 4. We must have committed people who will go on racial structure of South Africa, so similar to that of the and continue our program.

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 123

Black Existentialism——123

Stephen Biko's vision was so complete that he Although human beings evolved in Africa and then saw implications for correcting false images of blacks spread across the globe and eventually adapted in in the culture, education, religion, and economics. He ways that transformed them into groups from dark to was most aware of the terrible role played by religion, light, the notion of *black people* is uniquely a function education, and the media in creating a false under-of constructions that have been premised upon how standing of Africans by blacks as well as by whites.

lighter-skinned peoples have looked at darker-skinned Although there were many organizations that used his ones over, at least, the past 2,000 years. Black existen-concept of black consciousness, Biko remained the tialism emerges from the lived reality of such people.

principal interpreter of the movement—until he was In pre-colonial Africa, the African's struggle with bludgeoned to death by white police on September 12, the problems of existence primarily involved the self 1977, at the age of 30. At that time he became a that emerged from theologies, ontology, and ethics, martyr to the South African liberation struggle.

which was premised on a cosmological paradox of predestination and an unfolding future. The idea of

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

destiny or predestination required individuals to seek out their unique calling in life. This view located **FURTHER READING**

much agency or responsibility in individuals, who Biko, Steve. (1979). *Black Consciousness in South Africa*.

were linked to a broad community of elders, ances-New York: Random House. This may be the authoritative tors, deities, and an ultimate being. A form of human-work on the beliefs and opinions of the leader of the black ism resulted in which there was always something consciousness movement; it is certainly one of the best people could do about their situation. In most African works about Biko's thoughts and philosophy.

Biko, Steve. (2002). *I Write What I Like: Selected Writings* systems, the past has greater ontological weight than (A. Stubbs, Ed.). Chicago: University of Chicago Press.

the present, and the future has none since it has not yet This is a collection of the works of Steve Biko, which the occurred. This philosophical stance with regard to reader will find an accessible introduction to his writings.

history is existential because it relies on individuals Mandela, Nelson. (1995). *Long Walk to Freedom: The* to invent or make the future.

Autobiography of Nelson Mandela. New York: Little, In addition to these traditional existential beliefs Brown. This is a comprehensive autobiography of the most were the developments of Judaism and Christianity respected leader of the South African liberation struggle.

in antiquity in the Eastern regions of Africa and the Mandela spent 27 years in prison, and while he was in prison many people fought to bring about his release and Middle East, the subsequent development of Islam in liberation for the nation.

the Middle Ages, and the many mixtures of those reli-Sparks, Allister. (1986). *Tomorrow is Another Country: The* gions and other African religions as various empires *Inside Story of South Africa's Road to Change*. Chicago: under their rubric spread across Africa. By the time of University

of Chicago Press. A well-known journalist gives the Arabic, East Indian, and European slave trades, the his account of the changes in South Africa, which makes it questions of existence faced by African individuals clear that overcoming the history of brutality and death, and non-Africans included their relationship to the including that of Steve Biko, will remain a challenge to the rationalizations of slavery advanced by non-African country for years to come.

religions. The focus here, however, is on the black existentialism that emerged in the Americas.

The problems of existence for black peoples in the **BLACK EXISTENTIALISM**

Americas stem from racialized slavery and antiblack racism. Slavery and racism created the problem of Black existentialism explores the problems of exis-black suffering and the sustained black concern with tence generated by the complex history of black liberation and freedom and what it means to be peoples. The word *existence* comes from the Latin human. Such responses emerged not only in the many expression *ex sistere*, which means “to stand out.”

struggles fought by black people in the modern world When one exists, one literally emerges from indistinc-but also through black thought, literature, and music.

tion or insignificance. The word today is associated All existentialisms negotiate the relationship of with simply being, but its etymology suggests “to thought to experience. Experience is lived and prelive” and “to be.” To exist in this sense is to become cedes thought, but thought is what brings meaning and fully aware of being alive and what that signifies.

understanding to experience. The first, most influential

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 124

wave of black existentialism was in music and then Like all existentialists, Wright is able to criticize a literature. The quintessential black existential system for what it does to people, while recognizing response in music is the blues. The blues focus on the importance of responsibility even in an unjust life's difficulties and brings reality to the world of system as necessary for human dignity and maturation.

feeling or black suffering and joy. As an art form, In *The Outsiders* (1953), he expands his application the blues defy predictability and human closure. The of this question from North America to the modern blues welcome improvisation, which makes blues world, which, he argues, makes demonic those who songs and their offspring—jazz, rhythm and blues, live on its underside. Wright's outsider, Cross Damon, soul, funk, reggae, samba, salsa, and some forms of finds himself incapable of experiencing responsibility hip-hop—exemplars of the existential credo of exis-because he lives in a world that inhibits his develop-tence preceding essence and its connection to the ques-ment into a man. The paradox of the novel is that tion of freedom. What is more, the unique way in Damon's greatest fear is realized when he dies feeling which the blues bring to life the reality of and para-innocent after killing several people.

doxically joyful insight into suffering—by facing it Other literary examples of black existentialism can instead of avoiding it—points to an anthropology of be found in the writings of Ralph Ellison and James black adulthood as a struggle against despair. This Baldwin, both of whom explored problems of black makes the blues an important adversary of antiblack invisibility as a function of hypervisibility. Ellison racism. Racism attempts to force black people to the laments the madness faced by educated blacks—who developmental level of children, freeze them there, and expected their achievements to entail their inclusion denigrate black self-value. Blues songs, by contrast, (visibility) instead of heightened exclusion (invisibil-encourage maturation and growth and are life affirm-ity) in U.S. society—for they live in a social world in ing. The impact of the blues is broad—it permeates which they exemplify the impossible. Baldwin brings nearly all black aesthetic productions. It can be found his insights to interracial and bisexual settings and in paintings and sculptures, dramas and dance.

looks at the question of suffering as a struggle to Black existential literature dates from the 1930s.

defend the possibility of genuine human relationships.

Although existential insights can be found in the 18th-century poetry of Phillis Wheatley and the various as well, in the novels of Toni Morrison, particularly her early narratives and novels by former slaves and freed first novel, *Bluest Eye* (1970). There, Morrison brings blacks in the 19th century, the first explicitly exist-out the peculiarity of notions such as ugliness and tial set of literary writings are those of Richard Wright beauty that dominate women's lives in general but black from the 1930s to the late 1950s. Wright articulates women's in a profound way through expectations of black experience at the level of what existentialists mimesis. The expectation that black women copy white call a *situation*, where human beings' encounters with females' appearance subordinates their lives because all each other create meanings that they do not necessar-imitations are ultimately inauthentic. They live by a ily intend. In *Native Son* (1940), the protagonist, standard that they can never meet. This theme of inau-Bigger Thomas, finds himself "in a situation" when he thenticity is taken to another level when she writes of helps his employer's drunken white daughter to her bad mixtures—those that result from a world that bedroom after chauffeuring her and her boyfriend bridges the gaps between adults and children with the around town and realizes that they were at risk of consequence of molestation and incest—mixtures that being discovered. Wright provides reflections on the produce madness. More recently, in *Freedom in the* relationship between choice and options for the mar-Dismal (1998), Monifa Love brings many of these exis-ginalized of the modern world, who find themselves tential themes together through a provocative explo-constantly thrown into situations they would prefer to ration of the meaning of freedom in the midst of very have avoided, and he outlines many of the classic limited options. In the Caribbean, the most influential existential problems of freedom and responsibility existential novel is George Lamming's *In the Castle of* that follow. Why is it, he asks us, that U.S. society *My Skin* (1970), where the characters fight against the forces Bigger Thomases, people who in attempting to torrents of history and the

congealing force of slime that assert their humanity become its troublemakers, back leeches on projects of humanistic struggle.

“into their place” while holding them responsible for Black theoretical reflections on existence can be their actions?

found as early as the writings of Frederick Douglass,

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 125

Black Existentialism———125

most of which constitute a constant meditation on The leader of existential pragmatism is Cornel West, freedom and the meaning of being human. The four whose “prophetic pragmatism” takes on such themes most influential black existential texts are, however, as dread, despair, death, disease, and, in his most W.E.B. Du Bois’s *Souls of Black Folk* (1903) and popular work, *Race Matters*, nihilism in black com-Darkwater (1920) and Frantz Fanon’s *Black Skin*, munities. The most well-known black existential *White Masks* (1952) and *The Wretched of the Earth* phenomenologists are William R. Jones, Lucius T.

(1961). Du Bois advanced the concepts of what it Outlaw, Paget Henry, and Lewis Gordon. In *Is God* means to blacks to be seen as a problem and the double *a White Racist?* (1973), Jones argued that black suffer-experience of blacks, who are forced to live publicly by ing cannot be addressed theologically without collap-what the white world believes is true while knowing the ing into theodicy (i.e., thought on God’s ultimate truth lived by blacks as a contradiction of white society.

justness) rationalizing antiblack racism. He advanced He also raised the existential and theodicean problem a humanistic appeal in which people are responsible for of the meaning of black suffering, and he outlined the history. Outlaw focused on struggles against racism, the importance of black music as life affirming.

need for black-affirming environments, and the devel-The reflections of Douglass and Du Bois converge opment of an antiracist philosophy. Paget

Henry, in his in the works of Frantz Fanon. In *Black Skin, White Masks* (2000), Fanon advanced a sociogenetic approach to the self of the Afro-Caribbean and the poetic and study of antiblack racism while defending human historical responses developed for its emancipation.

agency. He echoed Du Bois by pointing out that truly Lewis Gordon is the most explicitly phenomenological-critical investigation requires identifying racism even if of the new wave of black existentialists, and he, at the level of method. This requires, paradoxically, a Lucius T. Outlaw, and Paget Henry have argued for methodology of not presuming a *method*, which, in Africana thought as an antidote to epistemological existential language, is the essence presumed before the colonialism where blacks are expected to depend on existence. Thus Fanon showed how every effort to white thinkers for philosophical reflection on black escape blackness fails because escape is in itself a form experience. Africana phenomenological work has of failure. For instance, although all people articulate examined the relationship between consciousness and meaning and identity through language, the black con-the world of meaning, and, following Fanon, asserts that change of language does not entail that colonizing processes must be fought against at change of being. In addition, a black person's choosing the level of method. The result is an Africana post-a white lover as part of denying his or her blackness has colonial existential phenomenology linked to the lived-the same consequence; denial is, in the end, a false real-experience of black folk in the modern age. This, and its result would be, presaging Toni Morrison, existential philosophy leads to a variety of explorations an affirmation of whites as the standard of value.

of the contemporary human condition, such as theorizing-Although in most of his writings Fanon attacks oppression as an attempt to eliminate a genuinely the blues in favor of written poetry, his reflections in human world and asserting the need for values *Black Skin, White Masks* have an unmistakable blues premised upon ancestral obligation in the fight against structure. He goes through processes of repetition nihilism and human denigration through understanding that lead to tears through which he is able to face how the ancestors struggled against worse odds.

the pathologies of reality, and the truth here is that Other themes of Africana postcolonial existential Eurocentric society cannot see black adults and does phenomenology have been black existential thought not know what it means for black people to be normal.

as the question of black humanity, especially in race Blacks seek to become men and women, but they find theory and theories of oppression; the importance of themselves locked at a level below that status in the developing a livable mode of everyday existence; the white world. In his final work, *The Wretched of the Earth*, Fanon explores what it means for blacks to be of rigorous ways of studying and understanding black

“the damned” (*les damnés*), for every generation to people; the symbiotic relationship of identity and lib-find its mission, and for every generation to be respon-eration; and crises of knowledge and their impact on sible for humanity’s future.

the formation of people in each epoch. Like West in More recently, black existentialism has taken a *Race Matters*, Gordon in *Existentialia Africana* (2000) turn to pragmatism and existential phenomenology.

saw nihilism as a fundamental problem of our time, but

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 126

126——— *Black Feminist Thought*

he added that it is symptomatic of a process of social *Empowerment*, first published in 1990 by Routledge, decay. He rejected West’s claim that many blacks are explores the work and ideas of black women and their nihilists because they lack faith in the United States conscious pursuit of knowledge and empowerment out-and argued that it is healthier to suspend serious side a white patriarchal epistemology. Collins creates attachment to a decaying society and transcend it a common space for scholarly and everyday dialogue through what he calls “teleological suspensions,”

about the various paradigms, movements, and aesthetic-where liberation requires a constant commitment to issues concerning race, class, and gender oppression as freedom and humanity and the virtues required for they relate overall to the liberation of black women and such devotion.

black people. She addresses how black women support, Today there is a rich array of intellectuals who critique, and reject mainstream feminist concerns and can be called black existentialists. These include objectives. Collins acknowledges the voices and experiences-Stephen Haymes, who has built upon black existential experiences of black women who are traditionally over-phenomenology in his study of the pedagogical practice-looked, as well as the work done by prominent and very voices of slaves; Clevis Headley, who has produced an vocal activists, intellectuals, and artists.

impressive array of essays on black aesthetics and race *Black Feminist Thought* is divided into three parts: theory; and Tsenay Serequeberhan, who is perhaps the The Social Construction of Black Feminist Thought, chief proponent of black hermeneutical existential philosophy-Core Themes in Black Feminist Thought, and Black philosophy. Other theorists have contributed essays to *Feminist Knowledge and Power*. In the first part, *The Existence in Black: An Anthology of Black Existential Social Construction of Black Feminist Thought, Philosophy* (1997). Thus many philosophers are developing- Collins evokes black women's strong tradition of opening new areas of reflection on black existentialism.

resistance to race, sex, and class oppression with the words of Maria W. Stewart, one of the earliest known

— *Lewis R. Gordon*

African American women to address these issues in a public forum. She then posits six distinguishing **FURTHER READING**

features of black feminist thought as a model of Gordon, Lewis R. (Ed.). (1997). *Existence in Black: An convergence for the diverse experiences and bodies Anthology of Black Existential Philosophy*. New York: of knowledge of black women in America. Collins Routledge. This may be the best

anthology on the question applies the distinguishing features to the informal of existentialism and the black community.

work of black women whose work is simply an aspect Gordon, Lewis R. (Ed.). (2000). *Existentialia Africana: of their survival, and to the formal work of black Understanding Africana Existential Thought*. New York: women activists and academics who make conscious Routledge. This book explores the conceptual basis of efforts to empower black women and black people in Africana existential thought in the continuing drama of black literature and politics.

white hegemonic power structures.

Gyekye, Kwame. (1995). *An Essay on African Philosophy: In the second part, Core Themes in Black Feminist The Akan Conceptual Scheme*. Philadelphia: Temple Thought, Collins posits work and family, objectified University Press. This work represents one of the clearest images, self-definition, sexual politics, love relation-examinations of African philosophy from one of the fore-ships, motherhood, and activism as major areas most contemporary African philosophers.

for investigation of black women. Collins also uses Henry, Paget. (1997). African and Afro-Caribbean Existential these themes as sites to interpret black women's resis-Philosophies. In Lewis Gordon (Ed.), *Existence in Black: An Anthology of Black Existential Philosophy* (pp. 11–36).

tance to oppression. The third part, Black Feminist New York: Routledge. This is a penetrating article that Knowledge and Power, engages readers in more acad-goes to the root of existential philosophies in the Afro-emic dialogue about how mainstream politics and Caribbean world.

epistemologies are affected by the political and intellectual work of black women. Collins discusses how the collective ideology of black women challenges a political system that ignores them as black and female

BLACK FEMINIST THOUGHT

worldwide, and she argues for a black feminist epistemology that questions any system of knowledge that Patricia Hill Collins's *Black Feminist Thought*: does not take into consideration the collective experience of race, gender, and class oppression. In addition,

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 127

***The Black Jacobins*———127**

Collins proposes a model for empowerment based on later became a political philosopher and activist. His black women's responses to various domains of power.

activism is reflected in his seminal work, *The Black Black Feminist Thought* is very useful as an intro-Jacobins, which is a call to arms for the oppressed duetion to the study of black women's oppression and people of African descent to fight for what they believe resistance to oppression in America. With the term in. The book predates the liberation of African states *black feminist thought*, Collins establishes an umbrella and was to serve as an outline for Africans' rebellion under which the common themes and opposing against oppressive European rule. *The Black Jacobins* ideologies of black feminism, womanism, Africana contributed to the inspiration of a generation of uprising womanism, and unnamed forms of knowledge can be and agency for the cause of sovereignty and freedom.

addressed. However, Collins does not have the empir-This historical text records the struggles, confrontation, ical content and theoretical grounding necessary for and successful resistance against better armed enslavers a deep structural Afrocentric analysis and advanced and as their collaborators.

scholarship on black women. Though Collins makes *The Black Jacobins* is written from a Marxist available historical and literary examples, she fails to paradigm, thus James chronicles the relentless day-to-include statistical information from research studies day struggle of the people of Haiti to overcome the to support these observations about black women's European oppression. *The Black Jacobins* primarily work. Collins's six distinguishing features are a set depicts the prolonged revolution of blacks in Haiti, of

principles to evaluate the diverse work of black from 1791 to 1803, and the legacy of its leader, women, but they do not take into serious consideration Toussaint L' Overture. The text also delves into the the theoretical work that exists. Overall, however, conditions endured by the enslaved people during *Black Feminist Thought* remains a very good overview their capture in Africa, the Middle Passage, and life on of the collective intellectual, aesthetic, and activist the island. James reports the tactics used by European work by black women for self-empowerment.

enslavers in their hunt for human prey that was the basis of European economic control and hegemony.

— *Griselda Thomas*

He goes further to expose the collaborative role of certain classes of Africans. James cites the events that shaped the island country, the destiny of enslaved **FURTHER READING**

people on Saint-Dominique, as well as the struggle Guy-Sheftall, Beverly (Ed.). (1995). *Words of Fire: Anthology* that made Toussaint L' Overture a leader.

of African American Feminist Thought. New York: New Francois Dominique Toussaint L' Overture was a Press. This is a compilation of some of the most significant Haitian of African descent who was born in 1744 and intellectual work produced by black women since the early died in 1803 in a French dungeon. L' Overture was 19th century.

Hudson-Weems, Clenora. (1993). *Africana Womanism*: self-educated and bought his freedom in 1789. It is not *Reclaiming Ourselves*. Troy, MI Bedford. This book pre-clear where L' Overture obtained his extensive skills sends the theoretical explanation and literary application of in stratagem, organization, and politics, but they were Africana womanism, which is an Afrocentric paradigm that all masterfully perfected. The French name the leader challenges the ideologies of mainstream feminism, black adopted, L' Overture, means “the opening” and was feminism, and womanism.

taken from the swift campaigns that were conducted Wing, Adrien Katherine (Ed.). (1997). *Critical Race* on coastal towns of Haiti that dislocated English con-Feminism: A Reader. New York: New York University trol. L' Ouverture, the opening, was used to describe Press. This is an anthology of scholarship by black women legal scholars concerned with issues of race and sex.

this phase of the revolution.

L' Ouverture's generals, Jean-Jacque Dessalines and Henri Christophe, were invaluable in the capture and extraction of coastal towns from British control.

They secured the removal of British influence in

THE BLACK JACOBINS

1798. Dessalines was renowned as a determined, confident, and aggressive fighter against the mulatto *The Black Jacobins* was written by Cyril Lionel Robert forces. He would later have to battle the mulatto James, a Trinidadian, in 1938 and revised in 1962.

forces, which were under the direction of General James was an educator and school administrator who André Rigaud. When L' Ouverture was captured in

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 128

128———**The Black Manifesto**

1802, Dessalines became his successor as the leader the French bourgeois, petite bourgeois, and proletariat of the revolution. Dessalines then went on to become caused these groups to align themselves for military the chief of state, and governor general for life, until action. The majority of French bourgeois, mulattoes, his death in 1806.

and enslaved Africans closed ranks with the French The name Haiti was originally used by the aborig-armed forces in order to suppress the Haitian

majority in reference to the island. Then the Spanish that had been Napoleon's cash cow. Their cause was renamed the island Santo Domingo, and when in to maintain colonial control and to continue to profit 1697 there was a division of the island and the from trading the enslaved. The economics of the situ-French gained control of one third of it, they named ation determined the actions of the French. In 1789

their claimed lands Saint-Dominique. The territory of Saint-Dominique was the single most profitable slave Saint-Dominique was later deposed and renamed enterprise in the world. The plantations that produced Haiti after the revolution on January 1, 1804.

sugar cane—which was used to make rum and *The Black Jacobins* is a chronicle of the first molasses, among other things—relied on the unpaid Caribbean independent state. Haiti is in fact distin-labor of the enslaved for their huge profits. This slave guishable as the site of the only fully successful trade and slavery were the cornerstones of Napoleon's African revolt against enslavement, a revolt that was ambitions of domination because France's economic followed by independence and sovereignty in the wealth depended upon what was produced on the Americas. The insurrection began in August of 1791

plantations. Thus the Haitian revolution was a major and continued until November 18, 1803 at the famed turning point for the French offensive in the world. The battle of Vertières. After the revolution, it was on French faced declining income from the Haitians and the battlefield in Vertières that the government of were forced to enact the Louisiana Purchase, which President Jean-Bertrand Aristide erected a powerful forfeited French claims in what is now the United memorial to the heroes of the revolution. The adver-States. News of Napoleon's defeat by Haitians may series of the revolution included the white planters, have had a divisive impact on the trade of enslaved mulattoes, royal commanders, and some enslaved people, as the 80 years following the liberation of Haiti Africans. They opposed the revolting Haitians of saw the emancipation of the enslaved in the Americas.

African descent along with periodic alliances they

— *Gwinyai Muzorewa*

established with sympathetic groups, which included the Spanish Santo Domingo. In 1793 the rebels and **FURTHER READING**

the Spanish briefly joined forces in a quick-moving series of raids on the French settlements on the coast.

Amin, Samir. (1997). *Capitalism in an Age of Globalization*.

The racial perspective taken by the people in Haiti London: ZED Books. This is a Marxist account of the global was markedly different from that of North Americans.

experience of capitalism and its influence on various nations.

Bellegarde-Smith, Patrick. (1990). *The Breached Citadel*.

Class, not race, was the emphasis in the Saint-Boulder, CO: Westview Press. This is a fine introduction Domingue colony. The European proletariat was to the people and history of Haiti. Bellegarde-Smith, a sympathetic to the enslaved people, as they were also Haitian, investigates the culture and values that grew out of seeking opportunities for underclass advancement, the tremendous achievement of the heroes of Haiti in liber-civil liberties, and sovereignty. Class therefore was a ating themselves.

major motivation for choosing sides during the revo-Rodney, Walter. (1974). *How Europe Undeveloped Africa*.

lution. The elite Europeans remained loyal to French Washington, DC: Howard University Press. This is Rodney's magnum opus in scholarship and interpretation rule, while groups within the white bourgeoisie and of the dispossession of African resources.

proletariat sympathetic to the ideals of the revolution of 1791 sided with L' Ouverture. France in the years preceding 1791 was already experiencing a revolution because the enslaved were seeking their freedom.

THE BLACK MANIFESTO

Therefore, there was an atmosphere of rebellion against oppression among some French bourgeoisie, The Black Manifesto was a moral declaration for petite bourgeoisie, proletariat, and African Haitians.

reparations read at the Riverside Church in New York This atmosphere resulted in the emanation of liberty.

in 1969. It was the product of an effort led by James The color line was blurred, and the economic and Forman, who drafted a statement demanding reparations social barriers to freedom for Africans and some of in the amount of \$500 million (a dollar value of

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 129

The Black Manifesto———129

\$15 per black man, woman, and child) as compensation protect the rights of black workers and their for the past mistreatments and capitalist exploitation families

of 30,000,000 African people. The Black Manifesto 8. to establish the International Black Appeal outlined significant reasons why white Christian (IBA) to help produce additional capital for the churches and Jewish synagogues should support the establishment of cooperative businesses in the manifesto presented to and adopted by the National United States and in Africa, with a \$20 million Black Economic Development Conference (NBEDC) start-up fund

in Detroit, Michigan, on April 26, 1969. Forman presented these demands to the general board meeting of 9. to establish a black university in the South with the National Council of Churches (NCC) in New York \$130 million

City on Friday, May 2, 1969, and again by disrupting 10. to ensure that the Interreligious Foundation for services at New York's Riverside Church on May 4, Community Organization (IFCO) allocate all 1969. Using the NBEDC, Forman called for NCC

unused funds to implement the demands of the financial support, claiming the church was part of the Black Manifesto.

vast system of controls over black people and their minds and should pay reparations. Forman's presenta-Forman, who linked the history of black enslave-tion outlined and designated how the \$500 million ment to the history of white supremacy in religious from the NCC would be spent to meet the following institutions and the U.S. government, felt that The demands:

Black Manifesto represented the black community's collective response to years of white exploitation, 1. to use \$200 million to establish a Southern Land degradation, and brutalization of African people Bank to aid black farmers evicted from their worldwide. Forman and other NBEDC leaders desig-homes because they dared to defy white racist nated the following as The Black Manifesto slogan: practices in this country

2. to establish four major publishing and printing **All roads must lead to revolution** industries in the United States to be funded with *United with whomever you can unite* \$10 million each. These publishing houses will *Neutralize wherever possible*

be located in Detroit, Atlanta, Los Angeles, and New York to help generate capital for further *Fight our enemies relentlessly*

cooperative investments in the black commu-Victory to the people

nity, to provide jobs, and to alter the white-Life and good health to mankind

dominated control of the printing industry **Resistance to domination by the white** 3. to establish four of the most advanced scientific **Christian churches**

and futuristic television networks as an alternative *And the Jewish synagogues*

to racist propaganda and to locate them in Detroit, Chicago, Cleveland, and Washington, D.C. They **Revolutionary Black power**

will need to be funded by \$10 million each *We shall win without a doubt*

4. to establish a research center to provide reliable research on the problems faced by African The NBEDC, which included organizers John people. This center will require no less than Watson, Mike Hamlin, Ken Cochran, John Williams, \$30 million to be operational

and 20 others, called for the mass mobilization of 5. to establish a training center for teaching black black people nationwide to support the manifesto. The community stakeholders skills in community NBEDC elected a 24-member steering committee, development, with a \$10 million start-up fund consisting of former Revolutionary Action Movement (RAM) members, and members of the Detroit 6. to use \$10 million to develop a national welfare chapter of the Black Panther Party, the League of center to work with welfare recipients and Revolutionary Black Workers, and the Republic of workers

New Afrika (RNA), to provide leadership for the 7. to use \$20 million to establish the National campaign. RNA's leadership rejected the manifesto, Black Labor and Strike and Defense Fund to however, to concentrate on its own work in

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 130

130——**Black Nationalism**

Mississippi—reparations, acquisition of land in five Schuchter, Arnold. (1970). *Reparations: The Black Manifesto* Southern states, and establishment of an autonomous *and Its Challenge to White America*. Philadelphia: J.B.

black nation—claiming that the manifesto had failed Lippincott. This is one of the best accounts of the history of The Black Manifesto.

them in not giving adequate consideration to acquisition and ownership of land and the large amount of start-up capital it required.

The Black Manifesto, one of the first collective **BLACK NATIONALISM**

demands for reparations, represented an important call for social change. It was the first such call proposed to the NCC that demanded it pay large sums of money to Nationalism is the expression of a people's commitment to self-compensate millions of African Americans. Although ment to self-determination in all its scope and dimensions the manifesto's demands were not sustainable and sions. The nationalism of Africans in America is a lacked the support of the SNCC, The Black Manifesto conscious expression of the self-determination of a raised \$500,000 for African American projects.

people who have been forcibly abducted from their Ironically, very little of the money went to the NBEDC, homeland without the choice and/or means to return which was under investigation by the FBI and the on their own terms. The historical development of Department of Justice. With the money it did receive, Africans and Europeans in America has involved a the NBEDC established the publishing house Black symbiotic relationship in which Africans have been Star Publications in Detroit and published *The Political* exploited in the economic and political system of the *Thought of James Forman* in 1970. The demands of U.S. social order. The nationalism of Africans in The Black Manifesto were not met and there are still America can be described as the belief in and vision of ongoing political discussions about reparations for independence from this exploitative relationship, and African American enslavement and oppression. The as a conscious political and sociopsychological move text of The Black Manifesto can be found in Arnold outside this sphere of influence. Thus, the ideas and Schuchter's *Reparations: The Black Manifesto and Its* praxis of African Americans that can be characterized *Challenge to White America* (1970), electronically for as nationalist, and perhaps pan-African nationalist, are subscribers of *The New York Review of Books*, and inextricably linked to the hegemonic context that gave through formal requests made to the archives of Union rise to the pursuit of sovereignty and the idea that Theological Seminary, Harvard University, and the Africans in America constitute a cultural nation.

State Historical Society of Wisconsin.

— *Ronald J. Stephens*

CONCEPTUALIZATIONS AND PROPONENTS

Several historians have described the convergence of **FURTHER READING**

distinct African peoples on plantations in the South into Agular, Marian. Black Manifesto. *Microsoft Encarta* a common culture, which flowed from an essentially *Reference Library 2002*. This is an entry on the develop-autonomous value system anchored in indigenous ment, purpose, and ideas behind The Black Manifesto.

Africa and created a pan-Africanism that provided an Forman, James. (1969). *Black Manifesto to the White* identity and an ideology. It has been demonstrated that, *Christian Churches and the Jewish Synagogues in the* at the time of emancipation, enslaved Africans still *United States of America and All Other Racist Institutions*.

San Marino, CA: TACT. This is the rationale, purpose, and remained essentially African in culture. Similarly, an objectives of The Black Manifesto in the words of its major examination of the religious orientation, artistry, music, creator.

and statements of Africans in America also revealed Lecky, Robert S., and Wright, Elliott (Eds.). (1969). *The Black* that the core values of the great number of Africans *Manifesto: Religion, Racism, and Reparations*. New York: in America have always been self-determination, free-Sheed and Ward. This is one of the first works to bring dom, and resistance to assimilation. The idea here is together authors to discuss the nature of The Black that slave ships and the plantation system of the South Manifesto.

served not only as natural incubators of revolts but also Myers, Aaron. Republic of New Africa. *Microsoft Encarta Reference Library 2002*. This is a related work on the to create a nascent pan-African nationalism that grew Republic of New Africa, a group with its own ideas about and assumed different forms as it was articulated by reparations.

numerous proponents over the last two centuries.

Historically, the dual themes of integration or Walker, viewed black nationalism as not simply a assimilation and black nationalism, at times recog-means to freedom but an eternal principle to struggle nized by their respective nonviolence and self-defense toward. The years 1840 to 1865 were Garnet's great-connotations, have been represented by proponents est period of activity and accomplishment. Garnet seemingly at odds in their ideological position relative defended the notion of African humanity and linked to liberation for African people. The accommodation-the fate of Africans within and outside the United ist nature of proponents of integration has been essen-States together, asserting that it was the responsibility tially defeatist and has not been a viable option for of the oppressed to liberate themselves. He later sovereignty in the United States or elsewhere. Despite moved toward the idea of emigration to Liberia and the historical shifts from nationalism to accommoda-cooperated with the New York State Colonization tionism, or visa versa, as a result of the bankruptcy of Society, but he remained opposed to the notion of one movement or the ability of the other to advance its involuntary emigration as a condition of liberation cause, black nationalism has always had a significant in the United States. Garnet studied much and was constituency in the African community in America, a precursor to W.E.B. Du Bois, Paul Robeson, and which tends to expand during periods of crisis and the scholastic tradition embodied by Cheikh Anta contract under overtly oppressive conditions.

Diop of Senegal. In an 1848 speech delivered in The black nationalist movement has also embodied Troy, New York, Garnet noted the contributions of an internal contraction (i.e., accommodation) or Africans to ancient civilization while Anglo-Saxons expansion (i.e., pan-African nationalism) in terms of were living in caves, and he called for ideological pushing either for full rights for blacks as citizens unity of Africans in America.

of the United States and/or for a physical space Between 1830 and 1860, the forces of accommo-that blacks would govern. Historical representatives dationism (i.e., integrationists) were countered by of the dual forces of

nationalist accommodation or nationalists who articulated means by which genuine pan-African nationalism include Martin R. Delany sovereignty might be attained. The integrationist and Frederick Douglass in the 19th century, Marcus movement contracted and the nationalist movement Garvey and W.E.B. Du Bois in the early 20th century, expanded during this period. The voices of 19th-and Malcolm X and Martin Luther King, Jr., in the century nationalists, such as Martin R. Delany, Edward latter half of the 20th century.

Wilmot Blyden, Alexander Crummell, Bishop Henry In the late 18th century and early 19th century, McNeil Turner, and George Washington Williams, Daniel Coker, Elijah Johnson, and Paul Cuffee acted reflected pan-African nationalist sentiments while on pan-African ideas in advocating emigration to holding at the same time ideas that underpinned the Africa, and Paul Cuffee used his own money to repa-accommodationist outlook. For example, due to their triate 38 Africans to Sierra Leone in 1815. The ambivalence on the question of identity, Crummell, so-called club movement (of self-help institutions) of Turner, and Delany combined a strong affection for African women in the early 1800s and the national Africa with an equally strong, if not stronger, com-convention movement sought to address nationalist mitment to becoming fully American. Thus Alexander concerns in their debates over how they should iden-Crummell attempted to Christianize Africans and tify themselves culturally. Yet, it was the appearance introduce them to Western ideas, Edward Wilmot of David Walker's *An Appeal to the Colored Citizens* Blyden pioneered the concept of the African personal-of the World in 1829 that engendered a more con-ity, and Henry McNeal Turner taught black national-frontational and pan-African nationalist stance against ism and pan-Africanism, advocated the view that God enslavement, an institution that Walker believed was black, and extended his message of black pride in affected African people worldwide. Walker's *Appeal* Africa. Martin R. Delany, a proponent of pan-African contained a severe criticism of the system of enslave-nationalism, originated and used the phrase, "Africa ment, a call for revolt by the enslaved Africans, and a for the Africans" in 1859, the same year he visited nationalist position to accommodationist perspectives Liberia. Delany called attention to the African charac-

(within the national convention movement) on how far of Africans in the North and South of the United States should culturally identify themselves.

States and held that the strength of African culture. Henry Highland Garnet published his 1847 address was essential to ending black ambivalence on the one hand and Walker's *Appeal* together. Garnet, like David, questioned of identity.

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 132

132———**Black Nationalism**

Frederick Douglass and Martin Delany, who led the largest ever black nationalist organization, the coedited *The North Star* publication, personified the Universal Negro Improvement Association (UNIA), duality in African American nationality building from Kingston, Jamaica, to Harlem, New York.

between the integrationist and nationalist ideologies. Garvey, a brilliant man, articulated for the first as well as within the integrationist and nationalist time the major tenets of black nationalism, and his movements. For instance, when Delany was calling is considered by most the father of modern black for blacks' political independence in Africa, Douglass nationalism.

was demanding full citizenship for blacks in the Garvey represented the sentiments of pan-African United States; later, Douglass briefly contemplated nationalism in the early 20th century, whereas W.E.B.

political independence and Delany momentarily. Du Bois, a supposed rival of Garvey, discovered the tested the path of U.S. citizenship through his pan-black nationalist tradition in the 1890s through intense participation in the Civil War and the politics of study and believed that nationalism was an effective Reconstruction. With the betrayal of the promise of means in the liberation struggles of Africans in Reconstruction and Jim Crowism, the nationalist America. Du Bois and Henry Sylvester Williams were spirit found expression in movements in the United States the pioneers who founded the pan-African congress in States to establish all-African towns and Oklahoma as London in July of 1900.

an all-African state.

Du Bois viewed Africans in the United States as a In 1879, Benjamin “Pap” Singleton’s migration permanent and distinct group, with specific nonnegro-crusade out of the South, from Tennessee, toward the tiable values, and as a nation filled with great possi-West mobilized thousands of Africans in America. The bilities of culture and an original destiny based on 19th century also saw the emigration of thousands of African ideals. Du Bois’s work marked a new devel-Africans from the United States to Haiti.

Africans opment in the nationalist tradition by virtue of his entered the 20th century poised for a new political, cul-ability to move easily among his people and take part tural, institutional direction that was not being pro-in the sacred settings of their lives. Though Du Bois vided by personalities such as Booker T. Washington, might be considered by some to be a pan-Africanist who himself opposed going back to Africa but spon-and an accommodationist, for him, black nationalism sored programs and opportunities for Africans in and socialism, which he considered to have deep America to return to the African continent. It was roots in African communalism, were actually recon-Booker T. Washington who inspired Marcus Garvey to cilable.

come to the United States and whom Garvey wanted to In the 1930s and 1940s, Du Bois contemplated meet, but Washington died before Garvey arrived.

the feasibility of spreading black nationalism in The pan-African nationalism of the Garvey move-America through programs. He established connec-ment and the accommodationist nationalism repre-tions between African culture and black nationalism sented by the communist-oriented African Blood and drew on indigenous values found in West African Brotherhood (ABB) directly and indirectly influenced societies so that Africans in America might organize the Harlem Renaissance of the early 20th century.

their lives in cooperative communities—a spiritual The African Blood Brotherhood was founded by unity. These efforts derived from his vision of cooper-Cyril V. Briggs in 1919 after his split from A. Philip ative societies as the primary vehicles for the transfor-Randolph’s group over their

different definitions of nation, through trained leadership, of the majority of radicalism. In the beginning, the ABB leaned toward Africans in the United States into leaders. For Du Bois, nationalism rather than the socialism that was as well as for Paul Robeson, African liberation was one advanced by the communist movement. Members of that was worldwide in scope. Robeson believed that the ABB included notables such as Richard B. Moore African peoples should seek out and build on their and Hubert Harrison; it was Hubert Harrison who common qualities with the object of developing a more originated the Harlem street corner orator tradition expansive and unified African culture. The relationship that Malcolm X later embraced, fashioned the slogan of culture, identity, and sovereignty was also recog-

“Race First,” and provided a platform for Marcus nized by pan-African nationalists, such as Carlos Cook Garvey when he arrived in Harlem in 1917. Shortly and those who came after the civil rights and black after his arrival in the United States, Garvey trans-power era. At a convention in Harlem in 1959, Carlos ferred the headquarters of what would soon become Cook, the founder of the Garvey-oriented African

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 133

Black Nationalism———133

nationalist pioneer movement, called for the abrogation history and culture, thus to such nationalists, a cultural of the term *negro*; this term went out of use in the revolution precedes or is a form of political revolution.

1960s as a result of the efforts of the pan-African According to some, cultural nationalism has reached nationalist movements of the black power era. In hind-essentially the same impasse reached by assimilation-sight, the ultimate concerns of the civil rights and ism and black neoconservatism, due to what is per-black power movements were similar, and the latter ceived as reactionary obsessions with demonstrating was the logical extension of the former.

the equality of African humanity and the primal and extraordinary qualities of African history and culture.

The point is that the various groups of nationalists, **SIMILARITIES AND** particularly, after the civil rights era, have approached **DISSIMILARITIES OF PROPONENTS**

black nationalism from their particular level of experience. Though integrationists and nationalists shared the experience and expertise, and their projected approach to same experiences of enslavement and European black nationalism has been more a matter of strategy hegemony, the proponents of these ideological tenets and tactics more a goal. Indeed, while most nationalists tendencies responded differently to the U.S. social order.

share the goal of liberation, the incoherency of black nationalist thought is due, in part, to often irreconcilable, themes represented by these tendencies have historically embodied with their own particular strategy or tactics and considered elements of each other, and within rather than with the goal; it is also due to a lack of the nationalist tradition there have been proponents clarity about history and culture.

who have thought about and acted upon accommodationist (i.e., integrationist) ideas. Liberalism, communism, and trade unionism, it can be argued, became the main ideological rivals of black nationalist thought, the 1960s nationalism in the 20th century. There was a proliferation of black nationalism in the urban centers of the of disengaged organizations, of various strands of late 20th century, and the dynamics and ascendance of nationalist thought that vied for ascendancy as the of black cultural nationalism in the broader context most correct approach or ideological path toward of nationality formation are observable. The historical liberation.

Komozi Woodard lists five phases of black nationality formation. It is in this context that the black nationalist typology of cultural, territorial, religious, economic, and (2) black nationalism before the Civil War inspired by revolutionary nationalism can be found. The idea principles of the American and Haitian revolutions; here, in a very simplistic way, is that cultural nation-

(3) the development of the subjected nation in the nationalists focus on the values and views of Africans in Black Belt areas of the South; (4) the great migration America, territorial nationalists focus on land (as the of 1.5 million Africans to urban industrial centers; basis of an independent cultural nation), religious and (5) the migration of 4 million Africans from the nationalists approach liberation from a religious per-South between 1940 and 1970, heralded by the black spectre, economic nationalists operate as nationalists power movement and the politics of black cultural within the capitalist system, and revolutionary nation-nationalism.

alism is premised on the international dismantling of In the final analysis, nationalism proves heteroge-capitalism and on armed resistance. Some scholars neous, even though no pure nationalist ideology can contend that revolutionary nationalism and reac-be identified with certainty. However, whether it be tionary nationalism are ultimately and fundamentally 19th-century personalities such as Maria Stewart, the only two types of black nationalism, in which the David Walker, and Henry Garnet, the words and former believe in the potential of the masses to deter-works of whom reveal that language was used to mine the course of liberation, while the latter fix on establish cultural identity in ways that would advance developing a capitalist and exploitative state in Africa.

liberation; or the Nation of Islam, which served pri-The distant forms of black nationalism, such as marily as a means for poor urban Africans to attain a cultural or religious nationalism, reflect a difference national identity and a sense of ethnic consciousness, in emphasis rather than a mutually exclusive belief it can be asserted that the black nationalist movement, system. Cultural nationalists seek to restore African at its core, has always been concerned with liberation people's knowledge and practice of their authentic and national cultural identity.

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 134

134———**Black Nationalism**

THE CURRENT STATE

that there is something more fundamental to the **OF BLACK NATIONALISM**

advancement of black nationalism than mass movements and a committed group of people. At the time Throughout its evolution, the ideology of black of emancipation, enslaved Africans still remained nationalism in the United States has lacked coherence essentially African in culture, and the core values of and adequate theoretical clarity. As a result, the black the great number of Africans in America have always consciousness and black power movements were been self-determination, freedom, and resistance to weakened from within by opportunism, ideological assimilation.

conflicts, paranoia, ineffectual leadership, lack of The greater and more substantive expression of managerial skills, and a weak financial base. Harold black nationalism has been pan-African nationalism Cruse's observation in the 1960s that black national-throughout the history of Africans in America. It is ism was fragmented into sects, factions, and cliques accurate to say that although the cultural identity of that resembled a morass of self-inflicted immobility Africans in America continues to be affected by the and frustration still holds true today. Amos Wilson U.S. social order, the African cultural orientation in also observed that black nationalists and nationalistic America is still very much linked to the African histor-organizations exist and function without a consensually ical-cultural continuum that informs that orientation.

clarified set of goals and a working well-coordinated Thus, it is not difficult to find many illustrations of system of interdependent nationalist organizations, Africanisms in the thought, speech, social relation-and this makes impossible the conversion of ambigu-ships, spiritual outlook, and general lives of many ously defined nationalist sentiments into a powerful Africans in America today. Many are convinced that the movement.

liberation of Africans in America ultimately lies in their Wilson advocated the formation of a black nation-understanding, appreciation, and assertion of their cul-alist political party to serve as the primary and legiti-tural heritage. Black nationalism is inherently a mate leader on behalf of the African community. He cultural-ideological statement, and perhaps by drawing envisioned the party as providing viable and workable on pan-

African nationalist conceptions unambiguously plans and training and organizing know-how and serv-linked to culture, identity, and liberation, black nation-ing as the community's primary political arm, chief alists will forge a coherent framework by which to negotiator, and principal agency for forming coali-achieve and sustain sovereignty in the African world.

tions with others. Some black nationalists argue that the United States and/or its revolutionary potential is

— *Kwasi Konadu*

where efforts should be focused, while others argue that the African continent is the African's only true land base. Black nationalists of the latter persuasion **FURTHER READING**

claim five states in the South on the premise of an Akoto, Kwame A. (1992). *Nationbuilding: Theory and African land-owning majority*. Yet, Africans on the *Practice in Afrikan Centered Education*. Washington, DC: African continent and in the Caribbean are over-Pan-Afrikan World Institute. This book addresses issues whelming majorities on their land but still are not sov-related to the applications of pan-African nationalist philos-ereign in that they remain conceptually and physically ophy to nation building in the context of African historical and cultural continuity. The author applies a pan-African dependent on external thinking and goods. The black nationalist paradigm to African-centered education as well nationalists who seek to organize the masses have as connecting the concept of nation building to his discus-failed to realize that mass movements have not shown sion of education.

to be sustainable or a viable strategy toward libera-Lewis, Rupert, and Bryan, Patrick (Eds.). (1991). *Garvey: His tion*. Certainly the idea of fighting for compensations *Work and Impact*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. These through legal means is not new, and the African repa-essays, written by an international panel at a conference rations campaign is a strategy that may yield some on Garvey, evaluate pan-Africanism and other aspects of interesting outcomes.

Garvey's ideological perspectives and practices, in addition to women in the movement, the influence of Garveyism on If black nationalism is ideally a mass or people's Jamaican culture and peoples of the Caribbean, and race movement, why is its greatest failing the lack of a and economic development.

clearly defined creed propagated by an organized Stuckey, Sterling. (1987). *Slave Culture: Nationalist Theory* group of dedicated advocates and activists? It appears *and the Foundations of Black America*. New York: Oxford

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 135

Black Panther Party for Self-Defense———135

University Press. Stuckey explains how different African Chicago, Los Angeles, San Diego, Brooklyn, Denver, peoples interacted on the plantations of the South to Newark, Baltimore, and New York. By the end of 1968, achieve a common culture, which flowed from an essen-the BPP had grown to 5,000 members in 45 chapters tially autonomous value system rooted in the African past and branches. Meanwhile, *The Black Panther* news-and that created a pan-Africanism that provided an identity paper had grown to a circulation of 250,000.

and ideology.

Van Deburg, William L. (Ed.). (1997). *Modern Black Nationalism: From Marcus Garvey to Louis Farrakhan*. New York: New York University Press. The text is a collection of **THE 10-POINT PROGRAM**

what the editor considers the most influential speeches, **AND COMMUNITY SERVICE PROGRAMS**

pamphlets, and articles that trace the development of black nationalism in the 20th century. It begins with Marcus The BPP established its agenda for black self-Garvey as the father of the 20th-century movement, and determination through its program calling for political then proceeds to

black nationalism in the black power era and economic justice for African Americans. The and black nationalism and contemporary society.

10-Point Program included demands for the following: 1. freedom and the power to control institutions within the black community

BLACK PANTHER

PARTY FOR SELF-DEFENSE

2. full employment for African Americans 3. an end to capitalist exploitation of the African The Black Panther Party for Self-Defense was American community

founded in 1966 in Oakland, California, by Huey 4. decent housing

P. Newton and Bobby Seale. The party's founding 5. black community control of education members also included Elbert "Big Man" Howard, Sherman Forte, Reggie Forte, and Bobby Hutton. One 6. free health care for blacks and all poor people of its early members and one of its eventual leaders 7. an end to police brutality against African was Eldridge Cleaver. Some of the party's most Americans and all poor people

prominent members and leaders, at one time or the 8. an end to all wars of aggression

other, included Kwame Ture (Stokely Carmichael), Kathleen Cleaver, Eldridge Cleaver, Angela Davis, 9. freedom for all African Americans being held in David Hilliard, Elaine Brown, Audrea Jones, H. Rap state, federal, and military prisons, as well as free Brown, and Mumia Abu-Jamal.

trials for all black people charged with crimes The organization, whose named was shortened to 10. land, bread, justice, peace, and control of modern the Black Panther Party (BPP), was formed to con-technology for the black community

front rampant acts of police brutality against blacks and to empower the black community to combat the In 1969, the Black Panther Party initiated

its first social, political, and economic ills facing the commu-Free Breakfast Program at St. Augustine's Church. By nity in Oakland and throughout the United States. One the end of that year, Black Panther chapters throughout of its first missions was to be a watchdog against acts the United States had set up breakfast programs that fed of police brutality. Thus armed members of the Black over 10,000 children. The BPP also organized commu-Panthers would follow police officers with cameras to nity programs and services such as free health clinics, make sure that the officers were not beating and abus-as well as campaigns for community control of schools ing African Americans.

and police. In addition, the Panthers led rent strikes and In 1967, fully armed members of the BPP, led by organized what were called "liberation schools" for Bobby Seale, marched on the California state house in school-age children. The BPP found housing for people Sacramento to protest the state's attempt to outlaw without homes and donated food and clothing to people carrying loaded weapons in public. During the same in need. In cities like Chicago, the Black Panthers, year, the party's newspaper, *The Black Panther*, was under the leadership of Fred Hampton, ran five differ-founded. By 1968, the party had begun expanding to ent breakfast programs, created a free medical center, other U.S cities, and BPP branches were formed in and conducted blood drives and door-to-door tests for

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 136

136———**Black Panther Party for Self-Defense** sickle cell anemia. The Chicago branch also reached sentenced to 2 to 15 years in prison. In 1970 Newton's out to local street gangs and orchestrated truces conviction was overturned on procedural errors.

between warring factions. Eventually, the federal In April of 1968, the Panthers became embroiled in government implemented free lunch programs and a gun battle with Oakland police in which 17-year-old expanded Medicare and daycare programs.

Panther Bobby Hutton was killed and Cleaver was wounded. Hutton, who was unarmed at the time of his death, was shot 10 times by the police after his house **POLITICAL PHILOSOPHY**

was set on fire. In the aftermath of the incident, Cleaver **AND MAJOR PUBLICATIONS**

was arrested and after his release fled to Algeria.

The Black Panthers espoused the political views of In Chicago, two Panthers, 21-year-old Fred Malcolm X (also known as el Hajj Malik el Shabazz) Hampton and 17-year-old Mark Clark, were gunned and the principles of Marxist-Leninist socialism that down during an early morning raid by police who had called for an end to capitalist exploitation of the black been tipped off to their whereabouts by an FBI infor-masses and a redistribution of wealth. The Panthers mant. Both Hampton and Clark were shot while they thought that they would win their battle for the were sleeping, Hampton in his bedroom and Clark in masses by armed struggle. They believed in inter-the living room. Hampton's wife, who was 8 months national working class unity across racial and gender pregnant at the time, was also wounded in the police lines, so they created alliances with other radical raid but survived. Four other BPP members were organizations, such as the Student Non-Violent Coor-wounded as well. A federal grand jury found that the dinating Committee (SNCC), the American Indian police had fired 90 shots into the building and that only Movement, and Cesar Chavez's farm workers' move-one shot came from the building—from Clark. The ment. The BPP's political philosophy also included Party members who survived the raid were arrested empowering women to move into nonsubordinate and charged with attempted murder of police officers.

roles. The Panthers advocated the need for all work-None of the law enforcement officials involved in the ers to seize the means of production from capitalist shooting were arrested for killing the two Panthers. In exploitation.

1969, Bobby Seale, along with seven codefendants, The Black Panthers put their political and ideological was indicted for his participation in the protests at the views into a variety of books. Eldridge Cleaver's *Soul* 1968 Democratic National Convention in Chicago. In *on Ice* was released after Cleaver left the country in what became known as the Chicago 7 Trial, Seale was 1968. Bobby Seale's book, *Seize the Time*, which denied the right to serve as his own lawyer by Judge chronicled the rise of Newton and the

Panthers, was Julius Hoffman, who also ordered Seale bound and published in 1970 during Seale's stint in prison. Huey gagged during the courtroom proceedings. Seale was Newton's *Revolutionary Suicide* was published in 1973.

convicted of 16 counts of contempt and sentenced to Years later, in 1989, when Newton received his Ph.D. in 4 years in prison. During his stint in prison, he was social philosophy from the University of California, charged, but not convicted of another murder. By the Santa Cruz, his dissertation was titled, "War Against the early 1970s, Panthers throughout the country had been Panthers: A Study of Repression in America."

charged and/or convicted of a variety of offenses. In some cases, the charges were false.

POLICE HARASSMENT

THE FBI COUNTERINTELLIGENCE PROGRAM

As the Black Panther Party increased its local and (COINTELPRO) AND THE PANTHERS' DEMISE

national presence, the police and other law enforcement agencies started their crackdown on the Panthers In 1968, the FBI, under the leadership of J. Edgar and their activities. Party founder and leader Huey P.

Hoover, began infiltrating the Black Panthers in an Newton was arrested and jailed for allegedly killing effort to disrupt and neutralize the Party. An FBI an Oakland police officer. Newton's imprisonment informant provided information to the police and the sparked the Free Huey campaign, which was organized FBI that enabled them to set up the assassination of by Eldridge Cleaver, the party's minister of informa-Fred Hampton. In the 1970s, the FBI used a carefully tion, in an effort to help fund Newton's legal defense.

orchestrated program of psychological warfare and Newton was eventually convicted of manslaughter and disinformation to create dissension within the ranks

Black Philosophy——137

of the BPP. Some of those activities included forging **FURTHER READING**

letters to the Panther membership criticizing Foner, Philip S. (Ed.). (2002). *The Black Panthers Speak*, with Newton's leadership and questioning the loyalty of a new foreword by Clayborne Carson. New York: Da Capo other members. The external meddling on the part Press. This book presents the Black Panthers in their own of the government that led to divisions within the words.

Party also led to disagreements between Newton and Jones, Charles E. (Ed.). (1998). *The Black Panther Party* Cleaver. In a telephone interview on a local television (*Reconsidered*). Baltimore, MD: Black Classic Press. This talk show, Cleaver, who was in exile in Algeria, criti-volume is now considered by insiders to be an authoritative sized Newton's leadership of the Party and attacked work on the Black Panthers, because many of the articles are written by scholars who were formerly with the the Party's programs. As a result of this interview, Panthers.

Cleaver was expelled from the Party. In response, he Newton, Huey P., with the assistance of J. Herman Blake.

formed his own black nationalist organization.

(1995). *Revolutionary Suicide*. New York: Writers and The strife within the BPP eventually led disillu-Readers. This book is useful for an insight into the thoughts sioned Party members to leave the Party and pursue of Black Panther leader Huey P. Newton.

their own interests. Before his resignation in 1975, Seale, Bobby. (1970). *Seize the Time*. New York: Random Bobby Seale ran for mayor of Oakland and lost, House. As the cofounder of the Black Panthers, Bobby Seale established himself as one of the clearest thinkers in despite receiving 40% of the vote. Huey Newton, the movement. His book discusses Huey P.

Newton and the shaken by the divisions within the party, became origins of the Party.

heavily dependent on drugs. In August of 1989,
<http://www.blackpanther.org/> This is the official Web site of Newton was killed in a drug dispute in Oakland.

the Black Panther Party.

Eldridge Cleaver and his wife Kathleen returned from
<http://www.bobbyseale.com/> This Web site provides information on Bobby Seale, one of the founders of the Black Panthers. In 1975 and became born again Christians. In 1979, Eldridge Cleaver entered into a plea bargain with the state of California in which all charges against him from the 1968 shoot-out with Oakland police were dropped. He pled guilty to assault and was placed on 5 years probation. Cleaver went on to **BLACK** Panthers.

with the state of California in which all charges against him from the 1968 shoot-out with Oakland police were dropped. He pled guilty to assault and was placed on 5 years probation. Cleaver went on to **BLACK PHILOSOPHY**

become a Republican and an anticommunist, and he ran for the Republican nomination for the U.S. Senate Black philosophy is a body of intellectual reflection in 1986 but was defeated. He had various run-ins with on and explication of the nature of African existence.

the law, was convicted for cocaine possession and bur-Black philosophy makes primary use of the black glary in 1988, and died at 62 in May of 1998. As the epistemic and presents an understanding of diasporic BPP gradually faded out, there were still Panther African and continental African phenomena. Black members—such as, among others, Geronimo Pratt philosophy is necessarily distinct, as it cannot be inte-and Mumia Abu-Jamal—who were being arrested, in graded into a generic American philosophy by includ-many cases on trumped up charges, and imprisoned.

ing black American intellectual thinkers under the subcategorized areas of American transcendentalism or pragmatism, for example. There is a need to recog-THE BLACK PANTHERS' LEGACY

nize under black philosophy particularities and schools of thought such as the Africana existentialism The Black Panther Party left an indelible mark on the of William R. Jones, Paget Henry, and Lewis Gordon; African American struggle for freedom and self-respect.

the black pragmatism of Cornel West; and the The BPP's community service programs, such as the Afrocentrism of Molefi Kete Asante.

Free Breakfast Program and free sickle cell anemia Black philosophy cannot be categorized under screenings, were eventually adopted by state and federal the general field of philosophy, which is currently social service agencies. The Black Panthers' attempts to constructed with Western derived paradigms and the combat police brutality led to better public scrutiny, dichotomization of Western and Eastern intellectual through police review boards, of the way police officers realms. John Mbiti and Kwame Gyekye have offered carry out their jobs in communities of color.

the key justification for a distinct African philosophy as

— *Christopher Murray*

one that in supplying discourse on wisdom, morality,

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 138

138——**Black Philosophy**

and community maintains black and African inclusion there is reluctance to accept Greek philosophy as and does not exclude dialectics on oral traditions, stemming from African precursors. Black philosophy proverb wisdom, spirituals, and the Luo concept of fairly considers all that Kemet had offered to such time, which are all black phenomena.

prime Western philosophers as Thales and Pythagoras, The case against African philosophy has been for example, two very important and pioneering intel-made by Kwame Anthony Appiah, Kwasi Wiredu, and lectual thinkers of the field. Black philosophy notes Paulin Hountondji, who have argued that the black how philosophical primers make little use of the

composite cannot be considered because doing so Kemetic writings of Ptah-hotep, Amenemope, and only helps to buttress an abused homogenized entity, Wen-Amon, which existed hundreds of years before and such an action is ironically anchored on a racial-such Greek thinkers as Anaxamander, Heraclitus, and ism that has been prompted by white construction.

Anaxagoras. Thus, black philosophy is an imperative Thus intellectualizing under a black identifier only in the 21st century to ensure the inclusion in world continues to falsify and deny the multiplicity of an philosophy of African thinkers whose work dates back expansive people. Other philosophers, such as Kwame thousands of years and adds to the body of world Gyekye, point out that despite the variety of African philosophical and historical knowledge. Black philos-languages and cultures, there are common features ophy exists not only to add to the black epistemic but intrinsic to African cultures, so it is unnecessary to also to appropriately reveal the long philosophical break them up into separate philosophies for the Akan, tradition and continuum based in Africa.

Yoruba, Kikuyu, Bantu, Mende, and so on. In the As in most other disciplines, there are multiple midst of the various African cultures that persist, there particularities and many schools of thought within are common features that more rightly manifest them-black philosophy revealing interpretations of black selves in every African culture and can be seen as existence. The purpose of black philosophy is to make the underlying common thread that runs throughout inclusive the black epistemic and to appropriate fairly African cultures. A definable inherent and pervasive aspects of black phenomena. Some theorists believe it substantiality appears and can be construed as essen-would be better to exclude the concept of race and not tially being a refraction of African life and thought.

continue to see people in that harmful guise, which Moreover, the African personality is revealed and can only validates white racialization of what it means to be related. Black philosophy encompasses a human-be black. Essentially, black philosophy adheres to the ism that regards African values and patterns of thought commonality of societal existence of oppressed and

that relate to the African nature of things. Black philosophy-enfranchised African peoples throughout the world rather philosophy makes use of traditional Westernism, but it works than just the unification of one race.

at a usage that always includes the sublimated African Some of the modern great thinkers in black philosophy-condition of existence.

philosophy who have displayed philosophical ingenuity and Mzee Lasana Okpara and Jonathan Scott Lee point maintained dialectics about the condition of enslaved out in their perceptive introduction to the book *I Am* and oppressed African people throughout the world *Because We Are: Readings in Black Philosophy* are Frederick Douglass, Martin Delany, Edward W.

(1995), a title borrowed from John Mbiti, that tradi-Blyden, Alexander Crummell, Booker T. Washington, tional Eurocentric Western claims of a whole human-W.E.B. Du Bois, Marcus Garvey, Anna Julia Cooper, ity have always excluded Africa. Okpara and Lee Alain Locke, C.L.R. James, Richard Wright, Frantz point out that there is no generic philosophy because Fanon, Léopold Sédar Senghor, Kwame Nkrumah, Western philosophy is the product of dominant Julius K. Nyerere, Amilcar Cabral, Wole Soyinka, European cultural intellectualism in which oral tradi-Malcolm X, Martin Luther King, Jr., Maulana tions and the misappropriation of the African as lack-Karenga, Imari Baraka, Haki Madhubuti, Angela Y.

ing wisdom and morality seemed fair.

Davis, Marimba Ani, Toni Morrison, bell hooks, The standard notion of philosophy (i.e., Western Kwame Anthony Appiah, Lucius Outlaw, William R.

philosophy) begins with Plato and thus excludes the Jones, Lewis Gordon, Leonard Harris, Cornel West, ancient African philosophers who preceded the Molefi Kete Asante, Ama Mazama, and Wade Nobles.

Greeks. Aristotle's *Metaphysics* attributes the found-This list is not exhaustive, but it is suggestive of the ing of philosophy to Greek knowledge of the world enormous role played over time by African intellec-and

originality. A generic philosophy cannot exist if it fails in formulating concepts and ideas of a black

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 139

Black Politics——139

philosophy that seeks to alleviate the burden of near future. Accordingly, three primary areas are the oppression and redefine a people.

focus here—representation and political participation, ideological and public policy shifts among African

— *Jorge Serrano*

Americans, and black electoral politics.

FURTHER READING

REPRESENTATION, VOTING

Asante, Molefi Kete. (1987). *The Afrocentric Idea*.

Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This is the noted **RIGHTS, AND POLITICAL PARTICIPATION**

book on African agency that helped to create a discourse The essence of democracy is representation. Commonly around the metaphors of location and dislocation.

identified democratic principles, such as fair and open Asante, Molefi Kete. (2000). *The Egyptian Philosophers*.

Chicago: African American Images. This is an introduction elections, full adult suffrage, and officials who are to the earliest philosophers in human history.

responsive to the citizenry, all rest on the assumption Asante, Molefi Kete, and Abarry, Abu S. (Eds.). (1996). *African* that a small group of elected

leaders represents the *Intellectual Heritage*. Philadelphia, PA: Temple University Press. A comprehensive sourcebook for African ideas and African American participation winds its way through concepts, this work remains the standard in the field.

250 years of legalized slavery, another 100 years of Gyekye, Kwame. (1987). *An Essay on African Philosophical legal oppression and segregation, and a continuing Thought: The Akan Conceptual Scheme*. New York: struggle for equal opportunity and dismantlement of Cambridge University Press. This is the most contemporary statement of the Akan philosophy by one of the great racist stereotypes and attitudes. Within this context, philosophers of contemporary Africa.

black Americans have benefitted from increased Lewis, Gordon. (2000). *Existential Africana: Understanding representation in federal, state, and local public offices Africana Existential Thought*. New York: Routledge.

but have been hindered by the still disproportionately Gordon's book is one of the best works on the existential low levels of representation of black interests.

quality of the African's experience.

The number of black members of Congress has increased dramatically since 1980, and more striking gains in numbers of blacks holding political office have been made at the state and local levels. The gains **BLACK POLITICS**

at the federal level are partly a result of race-conscious districting. Because of the constitutional requirements Black politics includes the myriad ways in which mandating a decennial census and several Supreme blacks work to gain influence and power in the system Court decisions mandating congressional districts to of government said to represent their interests. Black be equally proportioned, the process of reapportionment-politics is both the philosophies held by blacks about ment and redistricting of boundaries for congressional how a representative government should work to seats is necessary. Some activists for minority interests satisfy their best interests

and the strategies espoused have claimed that the creation of so-called majority-for accomplishing this. It has been said that the more minority districts is the answer to minority representa-things change, the more things remain the same. This tion in Congress. Others disagree.

is certainly the case regarding recent political issues Majority-minority districts virtually guarantee that within contemporary African American communities.

nonwhite candidates will be elected to Congress. In A host of new political issues confront African fact, there have been only a few black members of Americans across the United States, while they con-Congress who have represented majority-white dis-tinue to grapple with the political issues that faced tricts or states. But the creation of majority-minority previous generations. It goes without saying that the districts means the decreased presence of racial general rubric of African American politics is too minorities in all other districts. Some have argued broad to enable in-depth treatment of every issue that this creates a situation where white members of here. Thus the focus here is on particular aspects of Congress no longer need to be responsive to minority black politics that have become increasingly relevant interests. Others argue that reliance on race-conscious in recent years, highlighting issues regarding new districting limits the potential influence of minority problems, new perspectives on solving old problems, leaders, since the practice makes it quite difficult for and where black constituencies may be headed in the a minority candidate to be elected in a majority-white

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 140

140———**Black Politics**

district, essentially placing a limit on the number of as more than number of votes. Participation includes minority members of Congress at any given point a variety of activities, such as community organization in time.

and outreach, protests, boycotts, and interpersonal Blacks have made their greatest inroads into elected communication, that are common forms of political offices at the state and local levels. The number of activity in many

black communities. Participation in black elected officials at these levels has increased most prominently by the psychological construct called political efficacy (i.e., the belief that one can make a difference). The greatest increase occurred in areas of the country where there are one can make a difference). The most efficacious large African American populations. While redistricting strategies account for much of the increase at them in the middle or upper class and those who are the federal level, other factors factor significantly college educated. On the whole, whites do participate into increases at the state and local levels. Whites at a higher level than blacks, but once demographic are increasingly willing to vote for black candidates at indicators such as income and education are consistent with these levels, especially when the ideological beliefs trolled, whites and blacks participate at virtually the same and party affiliations of blacks and whites are strongly same rates.

correlated. Increasing numbers of nonblack minority populations have also contributed to this phenomenon.

IDEOLOGY AND PUBLIC POLICY

The increased level of black elected officials in state and local offices has led, and will likely continue Black politics is characterized and driven by the “just to lead, to increased influence. Blacks have succeeded permanent interests” that former U.S. Representative in shaping state public policy to their benefit. In addition, William Clay, and a variety of academic researchers, this increase at the state level will likely translate have shown dominated the political landscape of the into greater numbers of blacks vying for seats in federal offices in the 1960s, 1970s, and 1980s. However, the terrain of such office as lower officeholders continue moving up interests, as well as the most available and appropriate the electoral ladder.

means of attaining them, has changed and continues to While increasing levels of inclusion of blacks in change within African American populations. Further-federal, state, and local offices generally signals a positive trend in terms of meeting our country’s ideal of state and federal bodies, there is simultaneously a significant equal representation, another factor—discrimination

nificant trend of divergence among African Americans regarding voting rights—has recently revealed a series of political party affiliation, ideological stances, and hindrance to this ideal. The controversial outcome and public policy attitudes, levels of racial-group identity of the 2000 election raised significant questions about participation, and belief in a strategy of black political solidarity.

through free and fair election and voting processes.

Research shows that blacks still overwhelmingly Academic research, and that sponsored by official federal-affiliate with the Democratic Party and largely support external bodies, shows that for blacks and other minorities, Democratic candidates; however, the nature of the there are significant barriers to voting, to having their affiliations and the degree of support have significant votes counted, and to having them counted accurately.

significantly waned. While there have been marginal but significant inquiries into these problems have demonstrated that significant increases in the number of blacks registering some of these barriers have been deliberately concealed. As Republicans, there has been a sizable increase in structured to exert and maintain political power within the number of blacks registering as Independents and the white community. Prior to the 2000 election, many with parties other than the Democratic Party. The effects of these problems were not identified or highlighted, presence of blacks like Colin Powell, J. C. Watts, largely because of the acceptance of the myth that Condoleezza Rice, and others in high-ranking positions blacks and other minorities choose not to participate in politics in the Bush administration has had a measurable effect on the political process as much as whites do.

impact on blacks' considerations of the Republican Party. Contrary to popular understanding, however, black Party as a viable space for participation by black Americans have not generally been found to participate politicians and black constituencies in general.

in political activities less than their white counterparts.

This movement of blacks away from the Republican Party is especially the case when participation is defined Democratic Party, which traditionally supports

black

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 141

Black Politics——141

causes, also results from the fact that blacks are voters who may have rejected the message if it were increasingly expressing nonracial policy concerns more explicitly racist.

that converge with those of whites. These factors have It is unlikely that we will see many explicitly racist translated into decreased opportunities for specific messages in political advertising in the future. But black communities, and the black population as a racial messages take a variety of forms and come from whole, to pursue a political strategy based on some a variety of sources. It is important to understand modicum of solidarity—especially as the racial group these new campaign dynamics to fully comprehend identification of African Americans is increasingly the complexity of racial politics in the 21st century.

divided along the lines of economic well-being, residential situation, and levels of education. These diverg-THE NEW FACE OF

ing aspects of contemporary black political realities **ELECTORAL CAMPAIGN POLITICS**

have also spilled over into the increasingly changing As the number of African American candidates rises, nature of black electoral politics, specifically the so does the potential for black candidates to compete manner in which race has been used by black and against one another in election contests—contests that white political candidates in the electoral process.

have been heretofore largely uncompetitive, as many elected officials have held office for long periods **RACIAL MESSAGES**

of time and then hand picked a successor. Although **IN POLITICAL CAMPAIGNS**

African American candidates are not likely to espouse racist attitudes, this does not preclude the use of race in campaign advertisements, their campaigns. The increase in the ideological divergence even when there are no black candidates running for city of black Americans inevitably translates into election office. Although blacks' comparatively low levels of political participation where black candidates are forced to differentiate themselves from their black opponents. One result of risk of white candidates using racial messages that this is black politicians' using claims to racial authenticity might alienate black constituents, racist messages continue as a communication strategy in their campaigns.

continue to exist. Even in an era that attaches social stigma Candidates involved in this debate argue, in to overt racial prejudice, some messages still rely on essence, who is "really black," and which of them negative stereotypes of racial minorities. In some is "keeping it real," as opposed to "selling out" (i.e., cases, the messages are explicit, but in most cases, they mimicking or assimilating into the white hegemonic are implicit. Research in this area demonstrates that norm). Perhaps the most fitting and recent example of implicit messages are likely to be more effective than this was found in the 2002 Democratic primary in explicit messages, because the latter violate our cultural norm of racial equality and are thus generally rejected. Incumbent Earl Hilliard ran against Arthur Davis in a contest that rejected by voters. Implicit messages, however, work the press noted pivoted on the race issue, with Hilliard on racial predispositions that exist in the subconscious claiming that "his lighter-skinned opponent [was]

minds of Americans, even those who outwardly reject not really black at all." Both candidates' discussions such stereotypes in their day-to-day lives.

about black authenticity foreshadowed what will The now-infamous Willie Horton ad is a prime likely become an increasingly common theme in election example of such a message. Vice President George H.W. Bush's campaign within majority-minority districts.

H.W. Bush ran an attack ad against Michael Dukakis It is clear that changes in the larger U.S. political in the 1988 presidential race on the issue of

crime.

climate have made the issue of equal representation The ad accused Dukakis of being soft on crime the prized political goal of African Americans. Blacks because of a prison furlough program that was in are increasingly moving away from monolithic forms place while Dukakis was governor of Massachusetts.

of political thought and strategizing, which will con-The ad featured the story—and accompanying mug tribute to their attaining this goal. Yet new challenges shot—of Willie Horton, a black man who committed will likely be posed as blacks continue to compete for a rape and assault while on furlough. The existence of power and a voice in American politics.

Horton's picture, which revealed his race, was unnecessary to convey the intended message, but it likely

— *Charlton D. McIlwain*

primed negative racial stereotypes in the minds of *and Stephen M. Caliendo*

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 142

142———**Black Power Conference of Newark, New Jersey FURTHER READING**

Prior to the black power movement, which was accompanied by pounding fists, the traditional civil Clay, W. L. (1996). *Just Permanent Interests: Black Americans in Congress, 1870–1991*. New York: Amistad Press. This rights struggle favored coalitions and integration with book outlines the history of black American members of whites. Black power, on the other hand, carried for-the U.S. House and Senate and the interests and strategies ward the ideology and nationalism of 19th-century driving their careers as elected representatives.

writer and activist David Walker; the doctor, essayist, Guinier, Lani. (1994). *The Tyranny of the Majority*: author Martin Delany; and the fighter journalist, Ida *Fundamental Fairness in Representative Democracy*.

B. Wells. In the 20th century its essence was reflected New York: Free Press. In this book, Guinier provides arguin the political philosophy of Marcus Garvey and later ments about redistricting policies and appropriate attempts Elijah Muhammad. The omnipotence of black power to ensure equal representation for minorities.

Kinder, D. R., and Winter, N. (2001). Exploring the Racial traveled internationally. In South Africa, the activist Divide: Blacks, Whites, and Opinion on National Policy.

and nationalist Stephen Biko coined the term *black American Journal of Political Science*, 45, 234–245. This *consciousness* to describe this ideology. In America, essay discusses the ideological and public policy differ-the salute of pounding raised fists and the chanting ences of blacks and whites in the United States.

of “black power” gave the adherents an experience of Mendelberg, Tali. (2001). *The Race Card: Campaign Strategy*, their potential previously lacking in American political *Implicit Messages, and the Norm of Equality*. Princeton, struggles. The spirit of black power was a grassroots NJ: Princeton University Press. Mendelberg looks at the powder keg and ideology. Unlike the Communist changing ways that negative attitudes about blacks have been used by white political candidates and responded to Party, USA, and later the radical progressive left, by white voters throughout history.

black power proponents spoke specifically to black Reeves, Keith. (1997). *Voting Hopes or Fears? White Voters*, people, insisting on intraracial solutions to eradicate *Black Candidates and Racial Politics in America*.

white supremacy.

New York: Oxford University Press. This book analyzes The Black Power Conference of Newark, New the responses of whites to black political candidates, as Jersey, engendered this essence, potency, and direc-well as the general ways in which black politicians are tion, as well as continuing the tradition of antebellum evaluated by white voters.

Negro conventions and early 20th-century pan-African congresses. The conference had 1,000 delegates representing 286 organizations and institutions **BLACK POWER CONFERENCE**

from 126 cities in 26 states, plus Bermuda and Nigeria. It took place in 1967, from July 20 to 23, in **OF NEWARK, NEW JERSEY**

Newark, New Jersey, which was still recovering from the black rebellion that occurred there from July 11

The 1967 Black Power Conference of Newark, New through 17, leaving 26 dead and 1,004 injured. Martin Jersey, established an unprecedented shift in blacks'

Luther King said of Newark that it had “a short fuse ideas for and practices in their nonviolent struggle for and a long train of abuses.” At the time of the rebel-civil rights. The name of the conference, the important lion, black people constituted 52% of the city’s slogan and mantra—black power—popularized by 400,000 people, and over half of the black adults had Stokely Carmichael (also known as Kwame Ture), no more than an eighth grade education. High unem-exposed the weakness in protesting solely for inte-ployment, broken families, and crime strained the gration. On May 29, 1966, Adam Clayton Powell, black community and ultimately led to the rebellion.

who was then chairman of the Education and Labor Committee, declared in his baccalaureate address at **THE WORK OF AMIRI BARAKA**

Howard University that “Civil Rights are man-made and Human Rights are God-made. To demand our Leroi Jones (later known as Amiri Baraka) attempted God-given rights is to see *black power*—the power to avoid just such a disaster when he established Spirit to build black institutions of splendid achievement.”

House in 1965 as a center for black art and community A week later, Stokely Carmichael marched through activities. In 1967, however, activists at Spirit House Greenville, Mississippi, leading the marchers in the challenged the mayor for his refusal to hire a black call-and-response chant,

“We want black power,” “We man to a post on the board of education, despite the want black power.”

fact that at the time 70% of Newark’s schoolchildren

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 143

Black Power Conference of Newark, New Jersey———143

were black. There was also tension among blacks over At the 14 workshops, delegates presented papers authorities’ decision to relocate blacks from 150 acres and discussed youth organizing, politics, nationalism of city land in order to build a medical school there.

and internationalism, economic development, social This mounting tension catapulted when police brutal-change, and intellectual and black power. The main ity was added to the long-standing indignities assault-purpose of the delegates was to decide how to capture ing black people, thus the rebellion. Nathan Hare, the momentum of black power and mobilize it into chair of the Black Power Conference, refused to constructive programs and empowerment for the capitulate to the city officials who wanted the confer-masses. The delegates believed that black power ence postponed or held in another city. Recognizing represented the future, despite the dissension and that systemic white supremacy caused the black disagreements of the many groups and organizations rebellions, Hare and the Continuations Committee in the movement. They charted a course for black members decided that to cancel the conference was people for the next 100 years. This was the first con-tantamount to yielding to the same system that caused fference of its kind in the 20th century and it contrasted the rebellion. The Continuations Committee members with, broadened, and challenged the traditional civil were Omar A. Ahmed of the Bronx, New York; Ron rights movement and its leadership. Nobody missed Maulana Karenga of Los Angeles, California; Isaiah Martin Luther King, Whitney Young, or Roy Wilkins; Robinson of New York; and Chuck Stone and Jewel however, Adam Clayton Powell, who had been sched-Mazique of Washington, D.C. Adam Clayton Powell uled to speak, was noticeably mourned. Powell had to appointed this original committee on September 3, cancel his appearance

when he learned that he could 1966, following the 1-day Black Power Planning not enter New York because of legal difficulties.

Conference that Powell had convened at the Rayburn More than 80 resolutions emerged out of the 14

House office building. That committee formulated workshops. All were read and considered by a vote at plans for the first National Conference on Black the conference's final plenary session. Only one reso-Power in 1967.

lution was officially passed by the conference and that was The Black Power Manifesto, a small section of which reads,

THE PURPOSE OF THE CONFERENCE

The purpose of the Black Power Conference in Black people have consistently expanded a Newark was to discuss the most pressing issues of the large part of our energy and resources reacting day. In the Episcopal diocese of Newark, the delegates to white definition. It is imperative that we held workshops, presented papers, and developed begin to develop the organizational and techni-more than 80 resolutions calling for specific programs cal competence to initiate and enact our own of action in political, economic, and cultural affairs.

programs. . . . Control of African communities The following is a small sampling of the 286 organi-in America and other black communities and zations and institutions represented at the National nations throughout the world still remains in the Conference on Black Power: Abyssinian Baptist hands of white supremacist oppressors.

Church of New York, *Amsterdam News*, Association of Black Social Workers, A. Philip Randolph Institute, It was therefore resolved that the National Better Business Investors, Black Liberation Center, Conference on Black Power sponsor the creation of Black Muslims, Business and Industrial Co-ordinat-an International Black Congress, to be organized out ing Council, Catholic Inter-racial Council, Committee of the soulful roots of black peoples and to reflect the to Save Negro Lives on Foreign and Domestic new sense of power and revolution that was blossom-Battlefields,

Committee to Seat a Negro Congressman in black communities in America and black in Brooklyn, Congress of Racial Equality (CORE), nations throughout the world.

Delta Ministry, Detroit's Inner City Organizing

— *Regina Jennings*

Committee, Democratic Liberation Party of San Francisco, Fisk University Poverty Research Group, Greater Hartford Council of Churches, Jazz-Art
FURTHER READING

Society for Social Research, Mau Maus, and Yale University Child Development Center.
(1974). *Black Activism: Racial Revolution*

in the United States 1954–1970. Valley Forge, PA: Judson

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 144

144——**Black Power Movement**

Press. This is a very fine history of the roots of social and philosophy, and the promotion of an overall positive political activism in the United States during the critical black consciousness, highly influenced black youth period of the civil rights revolution.

and student activists. By the mid-1960s, the notion of Salzman, Jack, Smith, David, and West, Cornel (Eds.). (1996).

black power had emerged as the rallying call of mainly *Encyclopedia of African-American Culture and History* disenchanted members of the Student Non-Violent (Vol. 1). New York: Simon and Schuster/Macmillan. This encyclopedia has a good entry on the subject of the Black Coordinating Committee (SNCC). Kwame Ture Power Conference in Newark.

(1941–1998; also known as Stokely Carmichael) was Stone, Chuck. (1968). The National Conference on Black elected to chair SNCC in 1966 after

members had Power. In Floyd B. Barbour (Ed.), *The Black Power* become increasingly impatient with the slow pace of *Revolt* (pp. 189–198). Boston: Extending Horizons the integrationist tactics of their previous leader, John Books. Stone, the former chief of staff for Congressman Lewis (who later became a congressman). Ture left the Adam Clayton Powell and a well-known intellectual SNCC in 1967 (to be replaced by H. Rap Brown, who himself, examines the significance of the Black Power Conference in terms of the political institutions in the was later known as Jamil Abdullah Al-Amin) and soon American society.

after joined the Black Panther Party, established by Huey P. Newton and Bobby Seale in 1966, as the group's honorary prime minister.

BLACK POWER MOVEMENT

THE BLACK POWER CONCEPT

The black power movement was a political, social, Kwame Ture also collaborated with Charles V.

cultural, and economic movement for black self-Hamilton to pen the now classic *Black Power: The determination*. The movement, which brought forth a *Politics of Liberation in America* (1967). The authors generation of black activists committed to the struggle argued that it was incumbent upon black people in the for and practical realities of black agency, began in the United States to politically control their communities United States in the mid-1960s and lasted until the for the good of the majority. They also emphasized early 1970s. The legacy of this era has still not been how important it was not to imitate the structures of fully accounted for, as this movement for black politi-power that had oppressed black people by seeking cal, social, economic, and cultural power not only political pluralism instead. They asserted that “the transformed American society, but, also infused ultimate values and goals [of black power] are not peoples of African descent all over the globe with the domination or exploitation of other groups, but rather desire to accentuate and positively identify with black an effective share in the total power of the society.”

pride and black consciousness. This was a time that In the late 1960s, *black power* as a slogan was recalled the black nationalist legacy of Marcus Garvey and the United Negro College Fund (UNCF), as well as elements of the Harlem Renaissance era of the 1920s, which can be deemed activists and artists. In response to the growing popularity of black power, U.S. mainstream society set 1960s. As Walter Rodney, author of *How Europe Underdeveloped Africa* (1981), maintained in a speech. The Black Panther Party and the Us organization in Philadelphia in 1969, “Black Power as a slogan is a term were groups that endured infiltration into their new, but it is really an ideology and a movement of ranks by undercover police officers; surveillance of historical depth.”

black groups was also employed by the FBI’s counterintelligence program (COINTELPRO). Indeed, at 21, 1965, there was an ideological shift in the very outset, the black power movement and its black power movement away from the focus on various organizational groups were deemed subversive nonviolent integrationist strategies of Martin Luther King Jr. by American law enforcement agencies, led by King and other leaders of the civil rights movement.

J. Edgar Hoover of the FBI, and considered a threat to Malcolm X’s emphasis on human rights over civil American life. Interestingly, before he was forced to resign, and his assertions of black self-determination, a resignation from office in 1974 due to the Watergate scandal, need for knowledge of African heritage, pan-African President Richard Nixon endorsed the idea of black

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 145

Black Power Movement——145

power as it related to economic development within direction in the United States and emigrated to Guinea black communities.

in West Africa.

The fact that a rather right wing Republican However, the cultural nationalists emphasized president endorsed the notion actually highlights primarily the reality of white racism and only after-the ambiguities in the theories and practice of black ward capitalist economics. What black people needed power during this time period. Although not all was a cultural base that authenticated their experi-advocates in the black power movement were social-ence. The cultural nationalists believed that without ists, the majority of the key leaders espoused an such a culture, American blacks could not expect anticapitalist, antiexploitation agenda. However, it to become free from the politics of white racism.

was the Black Panthers who advocated an openly Maulana Karenga, one of the leading interpreters of Marxist-Leninist approach to the black liberation the national question, often says in his public lectures struggle. In 1968, Bobby Seale published *Seize the* that the international issue is racism, not economics, *Time: The Story of the Black Panthers*, in which he so white people are racists not just capitalists; that clearly locates the Black Panthers' manifesto within race rules out economics, and minimizes it when it an antiracist and anticapitalist frame of reference.

doesn't wipe it out completely; and that therefore we Seale wrote,

conceive of the problem today not as a class struggle but a global struggle against racism.

We, the Black Panther Party, see ourselves as a Karenga did not rule out the economic aspect of nation within a nation, but not for any racist rea-black liberation; however, he emphasized that in order sons. We see it as a necessity for us to progress to have authentic black power, there was a need as human beings and live on the face of this for cooperative economics (*Ujamaa* in Kiswahili) earth along with other people. We do not fight grounded in cultural nationalist philosophy (e.g., racism with racism. We fight racism with soli-buying in the black community). At bottom, the main darity. We do not fight exploitative capitalism difference between the cultural nationalist perspective with black capitalism. We fight capitalism with and the Black Panthers, in terms of black power socialism. And we do

not fight imperialism economic strategy for liberation, appears to have been with more imperialism. We fight imperialism in regard to the cultural nationalists not particularly with proletarian internationalism. These principles emphasizing or critically evaluating the inherent principles are very functional for the Party. They're inequality within the capitalist system.

very practical, humanistic, and necessary. They A number of critics have examined the 1960s black should be understood by the masses of the power movement and endeavored to put the era into people.

historical context. Among these critics is Harold Cruse, who in *The Crisis of the Negro Intellectual* (1984) wrote,

THE POLITICAL CLEAVAGES

In essence, Black Power represents nothing The black power movement was not a monolithic more than a strategic retreat for a purpose. It group of black activists sharing the same ideology and proposes to change, not the white world outside, methods for black liberation. There were differences but the black world inside, by reforming it into in thought and action among activists in the move-something else politically and economically. In ment. There has yet to be written an in-depth study of, its own way and for other purposes the Nation for example, the friction between the cultural nation-of Islam has already achieved this in a limited alists and the Black Panthers. The Black Panthers way, substituting religion for politics.

were grounded in the principles of socialism and the enemy was, according to Seale, "the ruling class, the Cruse understood that Africa could not be romanti-very small minority, the few avaricious, demagogic cized, but he was adamant that Africans in America hogs and rats who control and infest the government."

faced particular complex social problems when it But because the Black Panthers were prepared to came to their liberation struggle in the United States.

work in alliance with white, left wing liberals, Kwame Black power advocates in the 1960s often failed to Ture resigned from the party in July

of 1969. He learn from lessons of the past, particularly from the was disillusioned with the black power movement's 1920s Harlem Renaissance and Garveyism era.

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 146

146——— *The Black Scholar*

Nevertheless, in hindsight, the black power **FURTHER READING**

movement of the 1960s was still able to gain certain Allen, Robert L. (1970). *A Guide to Black Power in America: concessions from an overtly racist society. The found-An Historical Analysis*. London: Victor Gollanz. This is ing of Black Studies departments and programs is part one of the earliest works to describe the black power of this legacy, even though many of these departments movement.

and programs do not espouse a philosophy and social Ani, Marimba. (1994). *Yurugu: An African-Centered Critique* practice that empower African-centered perspectives.

of European Cultural Thought and Behavior. Trenton, NJ: The rise in black consciousness that accompanied African World Press. Ani has written a penetrating work the movement created a space for people of African explaining the behavior of whites who have embraced the European notion of white supremacy.

descent to endorse their heritage. Thus the age of the Carmichael, Stokely, and Hamilton, Charles V. (1967). *Black Afro* hairstyle and the saying "black is beautiful" ush-Power: The Politics of Liberation in America. New York: ered in a limited, but cultural, sense of African agency.

Random House. This is the classic work on black power.

Moreover, this era inspired young black intellectuals Written by Kwame Ture, who had been called Stokely to create motifs, symbols, and concepts with authentic Carmichael, and the Columbia professor Charles Hamilton, meaning for African diaspora cultures. For example, this book was a key

document in the black power Maulana Karenga developed Kwanzaa, the African-movement.

Christian, Mark (Ed.). (2002). *Black Identity in the 20th* centered cultural holiday that was at first meant for *Century: Expressions of the U.S. and U.K. African* Africans in America but now is celebrated in many *Diaspora*. London: Hansib. This is an original contribution parts of the African diaspora. In addition, Molefi Kete by several authors to expressions of identity in the United Asante used his philosophy of Afrocentricity to help States and the United Kingdom.

him develop the first Ph.D. program in African Cruse, Harold. (1984). *The Crisis of the Negro Intellectual*.

American Studies. Black women intellectuals who New York: William Morrow. (Original work published emerged from the legacy of the black power move-1967). This is an authoritative work on the mind of the ment include Marimba Ani, Miriam Maat Ka Re African American intellectual during the civil rights era.

Rodney, Walter. (1975). *The Groundings With My Brothers*.

Monges, Katherine Bankole, Christel Temple, Patricia London: Bogle-L' Overture. Rodney's book is one of the Dixon, Shirley Weber, Vivian Gordon, Charshee most authentic statements of black cultural, political, and McIntyre, Barbara Wheeler, and Clenora Hudson-social self-determination.

Weems, among many others. Each sought to advance Seale, Bobby. (1970). *Seize the Time: The Story of the Black* an authentic insight into African-centered scholarship.

Panther Party. London: Arrow Books. This is Seale's major There is no doubt that the black power movement work outlining the philosophy and policies of the Black inspired a generation of scholars and activists to Panther Party.

endorse and promote African heritage as it related to the African diaspora experience. However, little credit is given to it for inspiring other oppressed

communities to fight for their rights in an oppressive society. For

THE BLACK SCHOLAR

example, the white women's movement and the gay and lesbian movement both imitated the black power *The Black Scholar* was founded by Robert Chrisman movement in order to gain concessions in U.S. society.

and Robert Allen in 1969 in Oakland, California. It And the proliferation of Women's Studies and Ethnic has become one of the most important intellectual Studies programs in the academy is directly related to journals in the black world by virtue of its high the vanguard position of the Black Studies movement.

standards. Almost all of the major contemporary Finally, African diaspora communities continue to African American intellectuals have published in its grapple with the reality of white racism and white priv-pages. The journal has regularly featured such authors ilege. In hindsight, what the black power movement as Audre Lorde, Toni Morrison, Maulana Karenga, fought for in the 1960s should be the basic right of every Cornel West, Molefi Kete Asante, Henry Louis human group—dignity, self-respect, first class citizen-Gates, Amiri Baraka, Manning Marable, and Haki ship, and freedom from all forms of discrimination.

Madhubuti.

— *Mark A. Christian*

The purpose of *The Black Scholar* was from the start to provide an instrument for the dissemination of

See also Black Arts Movement the current social, political, economic, and cultural

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 147

Black Skin, White Masks———147

ideas of the black intelligentsia. Over the course of According to Fanon, in order to justify and maintain its lifetime, the journal has shown a remarkable flexi-their colonial supremacy over Africans, Europeans bility in themes and subjects. Thus, it has provided conveniently constructed two social categories, blacka much needed outlet for black intellectuals' essays ness and whiteness. The first one was equated with detailing their political and ideological perspectives.

fundamental inferiority and animality. The second Over the past 20 years, the journal has struggled one conferred a monopoly over humanity. Thus, for to support itself with funding from private sources.

Fanon, blackness and whiteness are purely social In 2004, the journal was acquired by the University constructs, with no basis in reality. What does of Nebraska Press. Robert Chrisman, who is chair of exist, however, is the human. The human's determin-Black Studies at the University of Nebraska at Omaha, ing characteristic, wrote Fanon, who was heavily is the editor of the internationally acclaimed journal.

influenced by the French existentialist philosopher The journal has firmly established itself as one of the Jean-Paul Sartre, is to be free. Colonialism, by creat-leading journals of black cultural and political thought ing racial categories from which no one may escape, in the United States. Among its recent contributors gravely interferes with freedom and must be have been Amiri Baraka, Angela Davis, Julian Bond, destroyed.

Shirley Chisholm, Nelson Mandela, and Maya In *Black Skin, White Masks*, Fanon described in Angelou. *The Black Scholar* remains a strong and particular the reification of African people in vibrant journal after nearly 40 years of publication.

Martinique and its terrible consequences. Defined by the colonizers as cannibals, backward, rapists,

— *Daryl Zizwe Poe*

fetishists, inferior, and so on, it became impossible for blacks to avoid white people's definition and perception **FURTHER READING**

of them. Thus, racism literally, and in the most fundamental way, Ama (Ed.). (2003). *The Afrocentric Paradigm*.

mental way, ascribed an inferior, subhuman status. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This book provides a clear message to blacks. As a result of having internalized this negative conception of the role of Afrocentricity in intellectual discourse, many black people became convinced that

that they could only achieve human status if they imitated Thiong'o, Ngugi wa. (1986). *Decolonising the Mind: The Politics of Language in African Literature*. London: James Currey. The book is a good illustration of the type of ideas that those who claimed to define humanity (i.e., white people). Thus, what followed were tragic and pathetic ideas that are found in the pages of *The Black Scholar*. Although attempts on the part of some blacks to appropriate this book takes an African point of view, it concentrates on whiteness in an effort to redeem their humanity.

the socialist aspects of the mental bondage rather than the *Black Skin, White Masks* focused particularly on dislocation caused by a fundamentally different philosophy—the issue of the prestige associated with speaking a colonial system being imposed on Africans.

European language and having a white lover. After having noted how language plays a vital part in life, Fanon explained how the rejection of Creole, the mother tongue of African people in Martinique, and the

BLACK SKIN, WHITE MASKS

worship of French was a case of linguistic alienation caused by blacks' attempt to escape blackness and be white. *Black Skin, White Masks* was written in French by Frantz Fanon and first published in France in 1952.

engaged in love or sexual affairs with whites did this to It has been translated into many languages, including English, to prove their human worth. In other words, the colonized English, as it has become a classic reference text on the subjects, victims of the psychological violence inflicted by the issue of European colonization and subsequent blackness by the colonizers, aped the

colonizers, thus wearing alienation. Fanon was born in 1925 in Martinique, a

“white masks.” All of this, Fanon claimed, was quite Caribbean country colonized by the French since 1635.

unhealthy. His recommendation therefore included In 1947, Fanon left Martinique to study psychiatry in destroying blackness and whiteness alike, through the France. *Black Skin, White Masks* was originally written destruction of colonialism, to redirect our focus on the as part of Fanon’s medical thesis.

cultivation and nurturing of the human that is within Fanon was primarily concerned with the devaluing each person, regardless of skin color. Fanon rejected stating impact of colonial racism on African people.

Négritude, that is, the belief that there exist specific

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 148

148———**Black Studies**

black cultural values. Similarly, he thought of the past critical social space in society and the academy, and as an unnecessary and false burden that could only an expanded sense of social and human possibility.

compromise the realization of that individual freedom And it is from the critical concerns and the struggles so dear to him at the time of his writing.

that gave practice and social expression to them that Black Studies developed its self-understanding as

— *Ama Mazama*

both an area of critical intellectual study and an instrument of social change in the interest of African **FURTHER READING**

and human good.

Fanon, Frantz. (1963). *The Wretched of the Earth*. New York: Grove Press. This is Fanon's most famous book, and his most penetrating analysis of the condition of the oppressed **THE INITIAL DEVELOPMENT**

in the African world.

Black Studies developed in the context of the intellectual-Fanon, Frantz. (1965). *Black Skin, White Masks: A Dying Colonialism*. New York: Grove Press. In this work, Fanon, racial and social struggles of the 1960s, but it of necessity—as a psychologist, unmasks the mental problems brought on society draws upon the rich resources of the African by a constant barrage of Eurocentric views and attitudes past—continental and diasporic, ancient and modern.

toward Africans.

Classical civilization, especially ancient Egypt, is Fanon, Frantz. (1967). *Toward the African Revolution*.

studied critically for the intellectual and social para-New York: Penguin Books. This book was published after digests, possibilities, and understanding it provides.

Fanon's death and is a collection of his journal articles, Also of interest in Black Studies is the similarity in popular accounts of what he saw as he traveled in Africa the insights expressed by ancient peoples and by the and his prophetic call for a new revolution on the African continent.

men, women, thought, and issues of the 19th and 20th Hansen, William W. (1996). *A Frantz Fanon Study Guide*.

centuries.

New York: Grove Press. This useful book provides an Black Studies is rooted in and builds on the ancient insightful overview of Fanon's philosophy, as well as an and ongoing activist intellectual tradition of African extensive list of the numerous books and articles that have culture. This tradition extends back to Egypt and its been written on Fanon.

model of social consciousness and activist intellectuals (*seshu* in the ancient Egyptian language Mdw Ntr) who understood their purpose as moral and social as well as intellectual. Thus, they constantly expressed a **BLACK STUDIES**

commitment to searching after that which was good for the people, and to serving the people through the Black Studies, which is also called Africana Studies, pursuit of justice, caring for the vulnerable and the is the critical and systematic study of the thought environment, respecting persons as bearers of dignity and practice of African people in their current and and divinity, speaking the truth, and working for historical unfolding. As an area of inquiry, Black future generations. A similar emphasis is found in the Studies may be conceived in a broad or narrow sense.

Ifa intellectual tradition of the Yoruba, in which the More broadly conceived, it is an inquiry that begins sage and teacher Orunmila taught that the fundamen-with ancient societies, such as ancient Egypt, Mali, tal criterion for a good world and the key instrument and Songhai, which established an intellectual tradi-in creating that world is effective knowledge of tion of studying themselves and the world in which things—a moral wisdom that enables humans to come they lived. More narrowly conceived, Black Studies together for the purpose of creating, increasing, and is a self-conscious and organized university-based sustaining good in the world.

discipline with origins in the 1960s and a modern intellectual practice rooted in and expressive of the **AN ACTIVIST TRADITION**

social visions and social struggles of this period.

Reflected in the vision, values, and practice of Black This activist tradition that is so central to Black Studies are the critical concerns expressed in African Studies' self-conception and methodology has been struggles for freedom, justice, equality, power, maintained and further developed in more modern political and cultural self-determination, educational times by such black activist intellectuals as W.E.B.

relevance, meaningful African presence in areas of Du Bois, Anna Julia Cooper, Ida B. Wells, Mary

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 149

Black Studies——149

McLeod Bethune, Malcolm X, Martin Luther King, BLACK POWER AND BLACK STUDIES

and many others who have used their knowledge It was in the black power period of the student and skills to address the critical issues of their times movement, however, that Black Studies emerged and in both discourse and social practice. Thus com-took root. In 1965, the black power movement evolved mitment to the pursuit and use of knowledge in in the wake of the exhaustion of the civil rights the service of community, society, and humanity movement and with the emergence of urban revolts is deeply rooted in African intellectual practice as a political signature of the times. The black power and serves as a foundation for the Black Studies movement ushered in a new dialogue about relations of activist scholar and activist intellectual. And it power and the place of blacks in society and the uni-is reaffirmed in the self-defining triple mission versity, racism as a defining feature of society, and the of Black Studies—cultural grounding, academic need to struggle to overthrow the established order and excellence, and social responsibility.

create a more just society. In addition, the movement Like the activist-intellectual tradition that preceded argued for self-determination, cultural grounding, it and contributed to its development, Black Studies relevant education, and cultural and student activism began as a political demand, rooted in both the general for blacks. It was out of this political consciousness student movement on campuses and the social strug-and activist context that Black Studies developed as gles of the 1960s out of which the student movement both a movement and a discipline.

evolved. The social struggles of the time served as a The first Black Studies initiative was put in context for and contribution to the emerging student motion in 1966 by black students at San Francisco movement, which self-

consciously linked itself to State College (now known as San Francisco State these larger struggles for social change on and off University). The movement began as a project with campus. Interacting to create a climate of struggle on academic and social dimensions, an experimental campus that was linked to larger social struggles were offering of courses and links with tutorial programs four basic movements. These movements—the civil and other service activities for the surrounding com-rights movement, the free speech movement, the munity. The black students realized the importance of anti-Vietnam War movement, and the black power departmental status and began to demand a depart-movement—contributed to the emergence of Black ment of Black Studies. Nathan Hare was called in Studies as a discipline.

to develop the department and did in fact develop The civil rights movement's fight for freedom, jus-the first Black Studies department, but the board tice, and equality was essential to the political and of trustees continued to delay action on the project.

educational mobilization and organization of black Confronted with the administration's resistance, the students and other students for the struggle on campus black students formed the Third World Liberation and in society. The free speech movement affected Front of students of color and in 1968 launched a Black Studies by focusing on free speech as a student strike, which they won. From this point of departure, right, which expanded space for a dialogue to emerge Black Studies ultimately expanded to hundreds of from assertions by Black Studies activists of their colleges throughout the country.

right to speak their own cultural truth and their right to a relevant education. The anti-Vietnam War move

ment brought together people of color and progressive whites in a coalition to oppose the war in Vietnam; As Black Studies advocates, scholars, and students they demanded that the U.S. government remove with diverse interests and emphases sought to define armed forces from Vietnam and their representatives and develop the discipline, a broad sense of mission from campus, that the university stop its complicity in evolved. These activists and intellectuals sought to the war effort, and that Americans take

up the struggle create a project that would link their two areas of against racism at home and abroad. The antiwar concern and struggle—community and campus—in movement helped build alliances among people of mutually beneficial ways. This is what Nathan Hare color, linked the struggle for change in the society to meant when he told black activists, “we must take the the struggle for change in the university, and further campus to the community and bring the community revealed the university’s vulnerability to student to the campus.” To achieve this, the founders of the power and activism.

discipline crafted a triple mission whose interlocking

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 150

150———**Black Studies**

elements served as a foundation and guideline for understood itself as not only a source of intellectual their work. First, they moved to critically study, bring production and exchange but also an agency of social forth, and teach the best of African culture and social change. It has therefore linked intellectual emancipation practice and pose it as a model of human excellence with political emancipation and committed itself to both and human achievement. Second, they sought to in a single interrelated project. This is logically linked to extend the struggle for social freedom and justice in Black Studies’ commitment to being both critique and society to include a struggle for academic freedom corrective, which assigns a social activist emancipatory and justice in the university. And finally, they linked role to both education and the educated.

education and the obligation to serve by connecting The discipline of Black Studies has, of necessity, student learning with student activism directed toward undergone a series of significant changes since its achieving the good in and for the community, the inception. These changes, as might be anticipated, are society, and the world. Thus, stated concisely, the triple the result of the internal developmental dynamics of mission of Black Studies—to provide and inspire the discipline itself and its responding to challenges black cultural grounding, academic excellence, and posed by a changing academy, society, and world.

social responsibility—took root.

Some of the most important developments are (1) pro-Black Studies scholars began with the understanding of the discipline, (2) the idea that African culture was and must be the foundation of Afrocentricity, (3) black women's history and framework for their intellectual and social studies, (4) multicultural studies, and (5) classical practice. Moreover, they saw it as a source of valuable African studies. The National Council for Black Studies, the preeminent professional organization of the discipline, has been instrumental in providing grounding in African culture, they could not produce forums, models, advisors, and scholars for development of an authentic, accurate, or dignity-affirming understanding of curriculum, programs of assessment, service to African people or their initiative and experience, links to the community, and international relations in the world. This was the requirement of an exchange. These initiatives have brought scholars black framework for intellectual thought and social together in mutually beneficial exchanges and helped practice that would later be called an Afrocentric or to expand the discipline and move it toward a flexible African-centered approach.

standardization in vital areas. The African Heritage In addition, Black Studies evolved with the central Studies Association has played a similar role in the understanding that black life and culture are worthy of development of the discipline.

the most careful and detailed study for their models of human excellence, achievement, and possibility, and **INTELLECTUAL ADVANCES**

that black scholars must produce research and engage **IN THE PROFESSION**

in teaching practices that are of the highest quality.

This is a commitment to the highest level of teaching Another significant development for the discipline and intellectual production as Black Studies scholars is the annual International Cheikh Anta Diop and students, with the

focus not simply on amassing Conference organized by Molefi Kete Asante, founder data but on below-the-surface thinking and the devel-of Afrocentricity and professor of African American opment of an interpretive capacity to understand and Studies at Temple University. As the preeminent translate the African initiative and experience in the Afrocentric professional forum of the discipline, it has world in varied, deep, and dignity-affirming ways.

created important space for a community of junior and senior Black Studies scholars dedicated to pursuing the kind and area of inquiry suggested by the schol-ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE

arly legacy of Africa's premiere Egyptologist and **AND SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY**

classical African studies scholar, Dr. Cheikh Anta In Black Studies, the emphasis on social responsibility Diop. Bringing together Black Studies scholars from is affirmation of the discipline's commitment to using throughout the world, it offers an important paradigm knowledge to improve the human condition and enhance of Afrocentric scholarship and intellectual exchange the human prospect. From its inception, Black Studies in diverse and productive forms.

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 151

Black Studies, City College of New York——151

Clearly, one of the most important developments Karenga, Maulana. (2001). *Introduction to Black Studies*. Los in Black Studies is the emergence of Afrocentricity Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This is the most as a major conceptual framework within the disci-widely used introductory text in Black Studies.

Mazama, Ama (Ed.). (2003). *The Afrocentric Paradigm*.

pline. A methodological initiative put forth by Molefi Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This book brings together Asante, founder of the first doctoral program in most of the theoretical articles around the development of

African Studies, Afrocentricity quickly became a disciplinary perspective in Black Studies.

major focus and framework for discourse in the discipline, the academy, and society. It has invigorated academic and public discourse by posing chal-
BLACK STUDIES, CITY

lenges of methodology, pedagogy, and research to the discipline itself and the academy as a whole.

COLLEGE OF NEW YORK

Black women's studies has also been indispensable to the discipline's continued development and the main-
On June 28, 1969, after consideration of the tenance of its self-understanding as a liberatory pro-student and community protests and agitation for ject that offers moral critique of and corrective for more relevant education for African and other ethnic constraints on human freedom and human flourish-communities, the City College administration sub-ing. The development of black women's studies as mitted a proposal to the Board of Higher Education an integral and indispensable part of Black Studies of the City of New York for the establishment of an affirms this position, enriches and expands Black Urban and Ethnic Studies Program. An ad hoc com-Studies discourse and research, and reflects the disci-mittee appointed by the acting president had drafted pline's capacity to constantly rethink its scope and the recommendation for the program in accordance content and reconstruct itself in ever more valuable with the recommendation of the faculty senate.

and vital ways.

The country was filled with political activism, Multicultural studies, with its critique of and and other university campuses were exploding with demand for an end to a monocultural and Eurocentric protests and demonstrations, seizures of administra-education, actually was initiated with and through the tion buildings, and teach-ins. City College sought to struggles for Black Studies. The contention, then and avoid such disturbances to its normal academic life by now, was and is that a quality education is, of neces-insisting that it was keeping up with the changes in the sity, a multicultural

education and that comparative society. Thus the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences engagement in analysis and understanding can only on the campus planned to apply the department's stan-enrich our learning and teaching experience. Classical dard of excellence to providing instruction, research, African studies, which includes ancient Egyptian, and specialization in urban and ethnic studies. These Nubian, Yoruba, Ashanti, and other cultures of antiq-new courses were approved by the administration at uity, has brought an expanded and enriched under-the college.

standing and exchange to the Black Studies project.

Soon it became clear that the department would not It has provided an ancient and instructive point of be able to maintain an ethnic studies emphasis, which departure for framing and pursuing critical issues, had included almost every ethnic group of importance affirming the centrality of African history to the in New York, as well as an emphasis on urban studies.

history of humanity and human civilization and pro-Thus in 1972, when Leonard Jeffries came to City viding useful and expansive paradigms of human College, he found ethnic studies in disarray. Jeffries, excellence and human possibility.

who since graduating from Columbia University with a degree in political science had been in the thick of

— *Maulana Karenga*

Black Studies developments in New York, and who had been one of the founders of the Black Studies **FURTHER READING**

department at San Jose State University in California, had a clear objective. He wanted to make the Black Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). *Kemet, Afrocentricity, and Knowledge*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is the Studies courses in ethnic studies the basis for a sepa-first book written specifically for graduate training in rate department, and for that department to become African American Studies.

one of the leaders in the nascent field of Black Studies.

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 152

152———**Black Studies, City College of New York** The department needed to respond to two aspects of gave students the opportunity to study abroad. The the African world—the African and the diasporic. This department had to defend its right to exist.

was consistent with what was going on intellectually Nevertheless, the department developed a Master and academically in the nation, as other colleges that of Arts degree program in defiance of what seemed had instituted Black Studies departments were taking like impossible odds. This program was created a pan-African approach.

because African American Studies had become an Therefore, by the fall of 1972, the newly consti-established part of higher education and there was an tuted Black Studies department was seen as being urgent need to make available curriculums and facili-designed to articulate in intellectual and constructive ties to prepare teachers and scholars to do research terms the crucial life experiences of people of African in this field. The Master of Arts program was to be descent on the continent and in the diaspora. To that jointly administered not just by City College but by end, the department began the process of seeking all of the colleges of the City University of New York faculty who could produce the courses necessary to (CUNY). The department came increasingly under achieve such an objective. In the process of securing fire as it became known that James Smalls, an adjunct the faculty for the program, the department found it professor and employee of the college, was holding was able to attract some of the most visible professors community meetings to inform the public about the in the nation. The names of the professors—Kiteme, African origin of civilization, Afrocentricity, and Scobbie, Sanchez, Bain, Wheeler, Amoda, Laraquem, African politics. In addition, a speech given in Albany Cartey, Mathias, and Bambara—represented the entire by Leonard Jeffries was widely criticized by state African world, as scholars from the United States, politicians as being inflammatory. Some elements Africa, the Caribbean, and Central America were in the state moved to have Jeffries fired from City employed by City College.

College, but because he had been a professor for The department experienced enormous growth in nearly 30 years and had tenure, there was nothing its student population and in the number of courses it that could be done legally to remove him from his offered, but it was always threatened by changes in post. However, CUNY did remove him as chair of administration at the levels of the deans and presi-the department, although there had never been any dents, as well as by outside political pressures, usually complaints with his work. Jeffries went to court to brought on by those who did not want to see the Black secure his freedom of speech. The court determined Studies program advance. Convinced that New York that CUNY could not remove a professor for speak-needed the program to be responsive to the interests of ing his mind, even if it disagreed with the professor.

the community, the leadership of the department made The case was appealed by CUNY. Jeffries denied the a liaison with the African and Caribbean communities charges lodged against him and became an instant in New York in order to widen its own political and celebrity among African American Studies communi-community base. This proved to be a wise strategy ties, which saw him as being persecuted.

because the forces on campus that sought to derail the In the meantime, the Department of Black Studies department saw that community support for the at City College suffered severely as a result of the department was strong. John Henrik Clarke and Yosef political pressures surrounding it and was unable to ben-Jochannon became patrons of the department adequately fend off its enemies. Many faculty and sought to give advice to its leadership. Thus, the members left the program and student interest in it department gained an international reputation. It was waned. Although some of the professors were redis-the place where African academics from all over the tributed into other departments, the objectives of the world came to see what was going on in the field of program have not been extinguished, and a small core Black Studies. In the 1990s, however, the political of faculty still seeks to create a truly international, climate changed and the new conservative atmosphere pan-African department at City College.

in the nation was affecting the campus. There were

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

constant verbal attacks against the department, as well as academic politics meant to keep the department from hiring new permanent faculty, offering

FURTHER READING

new courses, and responding to the various needs of Clarke, John Henrik. (1990). *The African World Revolution*.

the students, such as by offering programming that Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This book is one of the

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 153

Black Studies, Kent State University———153

classic statements of the problems confronting African and set up a “university in exile” in the neighboring scholarship and political transformation. Clarke’s work is a community of Akron or simply went home to pan-African thrust into the belly of anti-Africanism.

Cleveland. The students remained out until they Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1991). *Civilization or Barbarism*.

were convinced they should return by the adminis-New York: Lawrence Hill. This is one of the principal tration’s willingness to address their demands. The works for rethinking and rewriting the history of the African world.

students made five demands. First, in May of that Fanon, Frantz. (1963). *The Wretched of the Earth*. New York: year, black students had argued for and were granted Grove Press. This book explains the conditions that an office that would be responsible for dealing with Africans in the Americas, Africa, and the Caribbean must the educational and social factors they felt were struggle against to overcome all forms of mental oppres-obstructing

their ability to achieve. The students' situation, of which the education deficit is but one.

wanted this office to be administered by an African American with the rank of dean. Second, BUS pressed for the establishment of an office of minority affairs, **BLACK STUDIES**,

a learning development program, and a fund to assist black student programming activities. Third, **KENT STATE UNIVERSITY**

the students demanded they be granted amnesty for violating university regulations by walking out. The On April 4, 1968, African Americans throughout students' fourth and fifth demands, which were not the United States rose up in strident and oftentimes met until May of 1969, called for the establishment of violent protest over the assassination of the Reverend an autonomous Black Studies institute that would not Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. Three years before be attached to one of the university's constituent King's murder, Malcolm X (who is also known by his colleges, as well as a facility to house a black cultural Muslim name, el Hajj Malik el Shabazz) was gunned center.

down in Harlem while speaking at the Audubon Ballroom.

KENT STATE ENTERS

The murders of these two warriors in the struggle **THE CIVIL RIGHTS ERA**

for civil and human rights, and liberation from America's institutionalized racism, resulted in wide-The 1964 Civil Rights Act required all public and spread urban protest and violence in black communi-private higher educational institutions that were ties everywhere. Protests also erupted in the nation's receiving federal funds to demonstrate how they were high schools and universities, and Kent State working in good faith toward removing all vestiges of University in Ohio was no exception. The on-campus race and color discrimination. Kent State, therefore, appearance in November of 1967 of the Deacons for needed African American students as much as those Defense and Justice (which originated in 1965 in students

needed Kent State University. Consequently, Jonesboro, Louisiana) had inspired students to orga-Kent State granted the students amnesty, stating that nize the Black United Students (BUS) in the spring of the university had insufficient evidence to suspend 1968. BUS members then began to assert their dissator deregister them. The university selected from its isfaction with white America and with Kent State African American faculty Milton E. Wilson, who University. To make matters worse, recruiters for the worked with BUS during its walkout, as dean of the Oakland Police Department appeared on campus, newly established Human Relations Center. This cen-further inciting black students to react. These events ter was to administer the Office of Minority Affairs precipitated BUS's walkout in May of 1968 from a and create and staff a learning development program.

campaign rally held for Democratic presidential However, its primary emphasis, as its name suggested, candidate Hubert Humphrey.

was to effect better relations between the races. With These incidents, along with the deaths of Martin these acts, the university met three of the students'

Luther King, Malcolm X, and Medgar Evers, spurred demands.

the students into more dramatic actions. Consequ-In May of 1969, Kent State began a national search ently, they organized a student walkout in November for a director of the institute. One of the three persons of 1968, "a day of absence" during which 58% or interviewed was Edward W. Crosby, who had earned more of the 600 black students on campus walked off both his bachelor's and master's degrees at the

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 154

154———**Black Studies, Kent State University** university, in 1957 and 1959; he earned his doctorate The institute was intended to be a *full-service* at the University of Kansas in 1965. From 1965 to academic program, and the university was made 1969, he was the educational director of the aware of this programmatic imperative from the out-Experiment in Higher Education, a federally funded set. It was for this reason that the provost,

Louis higher education program sponsored by Southern Harris, drafted a policy statement, stating in his cover Illinois University (SIU) and based in East St. Louis, letter to President White that he would “harness” the Illinois, a community that was 90% black. The institute’s director. The institute’s program, as stipu-program, a Black Studies precursor, offered a stan-lated in the policy statement, was to be guided by a dard curriculum with emphasis on African, African committee composed of the deans of the university’s American, and World Culture Studies and enrolled four constituent colleges and others. A professor from 100 students (10 of whom were white).

the College of Education was chosen as its chair. This From a survey of the faculty and from Crosby’s harnessing committee was calculated to obstruct all interview, the university assumed he might prove to be programmatic attempts to respond affirmatively and a problem. At issue were his emphasis on program-reasonably to the desires of black students; it was also matic holism and his apparent tendency to align with to ensure that the institute was shackled financially black students. The university’s president, Robert I.

and operationally. Nevertheless, after two or three White, therefore tried to dissuade him from taking the meetings, the director allowed the committee to die.

position by offering him the same salary he was earn-The students’ choice of Crosby to direct the institute ing at SIU. Crosby had anticipated this ploy; he didn’ t was made to the consternation of university officials, like it, but he was smart enough not to react negatively.

who knew that Crosby agreed with the students’

Instead, he wrote White declaring that he was “not demands (1) for an institute that would be credit grant-interested in the position for the sake of money; he was ing and autonomous of all constituent colleges and rather interested in it for the sake of the work students schools; (2) for a program designed not in accordance were asking him to do.” With this statement made, he with a “studies model” and thus not required to rely accepted the position, began his time at the university primarily on already hired faculty

(most of whom on August 15, 1969, and changed the title of the nascent were, of course, white); and (3) for a program that Afro-American Studies Institute to the Institute for would be able to draft its own operational imperatives African American Affairs (IAAA). As students enjoy and design and staff its own curriculum. The last two doing, they later shortened the title to “the Institute” or points were critical, as the provost, the administrative

“the ‘Tute.” Both names rapidly caught on.

officer to whom the institute would report, had already assigned his assistant to survey all university departments and ascertain how many courses taught could be **THE INSTITUTE FOR**

used as Black Studies courses. The provost wanted to **AFRICAN AMERICAN AFFAIRS**

saddle the institute with courses and faculty that would The word affairs in the official title was chosen harness (i.e., curtail) its freedom to determine its specifically because the director’s experience at the development. Moreover, Kent State wanted to saddle Experiment in Higher Education had taught him the institute with a “rush into blackness” that would that any meaningful educational program for under-result in something the students would soon tire of, fail graduates had to be holistic in design. Its operational to garner a supportive student constituency, and within organization and curriculum should not be compart-1 to 3 years collapse of its own inertia.

mentalized and broken down into fiefdoms, as is the The institute’s start up budget was a paltry case on university campuses. The students, moreover, \$62,000. Its director knew that other start-up Black must not be bi- or trifurcated as they are at most uni-Studies programs had received much larger budgets, versities. The word *affairs* also allowed the institute to such as the \$500,000 with which the University of handle all of the affairs (i.e., related educational areas) Pittsburgh’s Black Studies program was begun. Not that African American students would be engaged only were Ohio State and Cornell better funded, they in—academic affairs, student affairs, financial affairs, also were granted graduate program status. The insti-sociocultural affairs, and so on; as much as possible, tute’s budget was

without doubt dispensed to induce students would not be shuffled off to other campus failure. During the institute's first year, Crosby's entities for service.

salary was over \$20,000—a third of the budget; the

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 155

Black Studies, Kent State University——155

salary of his assistant, Wiley Smith III, was \$14,000; the particulars for televising courses and came away and the secretary's salary was \$7,500. Thus \$19,500

from that meeting knowing they could proceed with had to suffice for office supplies, telephones, in- and their plans to offer an academic program that would out-of-state travel, if any, and wages for student assis-not overtax their budget.

tants. Faculty hires were not even contemplated.

The institute's decision not to use already hired THE COURSE OF STUDY

faculty, of course, made staffing a quality course sequence difficult, if not impossible. To overcome this A three-course sequence was drafted that consisted difficulty, the institute pledged its funds, its willing-of fifteen 2-hour lectures per week per quarter. These ness to struggle, and its creative talents; it would not lectures would be canned and used for course offer-allow its limited budget to deter its ability to build ings in subsequent quarters. They would also be aired an institution. In August of 1969, the institute was over the university's closed-circuit television system housed in a small office divided into two sections in in the dormitories. Discussion leaders would show the 111 Kent Hall. Later, in 1970, it was allocated addi-lectures during class periods, and students could then tional office space in Lowry Hall. Coordinating pro-view the lectures for study or review purposes in their grammatic activities in two places was logistically dorm rooms. To avoid the problem of having visiting problematic, but institution-

building efforts proceeded lecturers relating to nothing other than the camera, according to plan nevertheless. By 1971, the institute the lectures would be televised live in the television occupied an entire wing of Lowry Hall's second floor.

studio. Thus, the individual lecturers would in fact In 1972, the director petitioned the university to move be relating to students just like in a regular class. The the institute to the ground floor of the recently vacated series of lectures, titled "Symposium on the Black Old Student Union building, and his petition was Experience," was divided into three quarter segments: approved. Ultimately, the institute's successor, the

"Towards a Black Cosmology and Aesthetic: The Department of Pan-African Studies, would program Way of Life of Peoples of African Descent," "Towards the entire three-story building.

a Black Perspective in the Social Sciences," and The institute had committed itself to offer one or

"Towards a Black Community Development Science."

two courses for spring quarter 1970. A student recruit-The segment titles announced the curricular direction ment regime was drafted that involved meeting with the institute would take throughout its development.

groups of black and white students in 30 dormitories.

Moreover, each course segment firmly established At the same time, the institute's two-member admin-the institute's commitment to curricular holism and istrative team busied themselves with solving their instructional innovation.

major problem (1) by eliciting the academic support This curricular plan was presented to the provost of the few African American faculty teaching in vari-for his advice and consent and circulated to all those ous departments; (2) by creating a list of potential selected to serve as advisors, seminar leaders, and/or external lecturers and discussion leaders who could lecturers. In the fall of 1969, a conference was con-be called on, if needed;

and (3) by studying several vened to which were invited all the potential lecturers published brochures and catalogues to discover the and consultants, the administrators of the Tele-academic support services the university offered. The Productions Unit, several undergraduate and graduate black academic community on campus was informed students, and, of course, the provost. The first course of the institute's programmatic intentions. Their list of was offered in March of 1970 to 51 students—one potential lecturers employed at other universities, of whom was a white female. The institute's first heads of local community-based public service agen-academic offering was aborted on May 4, when anticies, and discussion leaders grew very quickly. In Vietnam War protests on campus unfortunately addition, the administrative team discovered that the resulted in the Ohio National Guard shooting 13 white university had a policy that made their Tele-students, four of whom were killed. The university Productions Unit available for developing televised was shut down, classes were cancelled, dormitories courses without cost to the requesting department.

were closed, and students, faculty, and administrative This was the answer to the institute's curriculum-and clerical staff were barred from the campus.

building problems. The director and his assistant Fortunately, a number of lectures for the first segment immediately visited the Tele-Productions Unit to learn were already in the can. When classes resumed for fall

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 156

156———**Black Studies, Kent State University** quarter, the institute had a larger budget and was able workshops, and so on. This combination of academic to pick up where it had left off, make preparations to and sociocultural attributes placed the institute and televise its second series of lectures, and continue to BUS in the forefront of black educational program-pursue its institution-building mission.

ming in Ohio.

From 1968 on, the university reluctantly allowed This union of BUS and the institute also led to the Black Cultural Center to exist. Indeed, its exis-

the disruption of the university's plans to scuttle their tence soon came under attack. The university and the existence. When the institute, the CP-AC, and BUS

dean of human relations objected to the Black United entered the Old Student Union building, the university Students' use of the cultural center, which they had in league with the dean of the human relations center named Kuumba House. The center had been placed in established what they considered a competing center—

a small two-story wooden frame house. BUS and the The Center for Human Understanding. This center institute developed several programs for the house, lasted less than 2 years. It was given an old army bar-one of which was an art exhibit. In spite of their joint rack behind the CP-AC. Later this barrack was found to efforts, they did not program the center to the dean's be infested with termites. Dean Wilson was told by the satisfaction. One of his complaints was that too many university's architects to evacuate the facility within long distance calls were made from the center. Simply 24 hours. The Center for Human Understanding then disabling the phone would have resolved this issue.

moved into vacant but inadequate space in a converted A list of equally specious complaints was also lodged.

dormitory. Before its second year was out, it closed its It was clear that the problem was that the facility doors for good.

was not conducive to cultural center programming.

The university's attempts to stymie the development—Moreover, the university's central administration had ment of a viable African American academic institution—not been forthright with BUS and had offered them tion united with a black student–operated sociocultural a facility the university knew would be torn down enterprise were unsuccessful. The longer the institute within a year. Kuumba House sat on land earmarked and BUS survived, the stronger and more effective for the construction of a business administration their programming efforts became.

building. The institute joined BUS, therefore, in their In 1973 the institute discontinued using the three struggle with the administration over securing an sets of symposium tapes as its primary course offer-alternative site—until 1972, when the institute and ings. The economic reasons predisposing the use of BUS both moved to the ground floor of the Old available electronic technology were still at work; Student Union building.

however, the original symposium series was converted This move energized the institute, BUS, and the into three standard courses under the IAAA rubric Black Culture Center. All three elements now had a with different titles. Five qualified full-time but non-respectable facility within which they could thrive.

tenurable teaching faculty were employed to teach The three organizations seized the opportunity and sections of these courses. In 1974 five additional fac-became a force the university had to contend with ulty and sections of Kiswahili and Yoruba were added.

during its years of controversy and the instability In 1975, to reach a larger audience, the institute caused by the National Guard's murder of four student established a relationship with the Public Broadcasting protesters on the university's campus.

Service (PBS) and two of its affiliated channels—

The combination of the three organizations led to WNEO and WEAO. These channels were based in changing the cultural center's name to the Center Kent, Akron, and Youngstown and programmed in of Pan-African Culture (CP-AC). The move also fur-Kent. This connection allowed the institute to incor-thered the institute's ability to concretize its goal: to porate into WNEO's and WEAO's programming build a holistic African-oriented educational institu-schedules a recently produced PBS program—The tion on a state university campus. The institute envi-Black Experience, a comprehensive series of 60 half-sioned and endeavored to create an institution that had hour TV programs produced by WTTW in Chicago a ready-made student constituency; offered academic and written and narrated by Charles P. Branham. The studies in African and African American history, liter-series begins with "African Beginnings" and ends ature, education, politics, and sociology; incorporated with "Towards a New Community: The Search for social and cultural programs; and augmented its Alternatives." The consulting historian for the series curricular efforts using theatre productions, confer-was John Hope Franklin. The institute divided The ences, lectures, artistic performances, art exhibits, Black Experience series into three quarter-length

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 157

Black Studies, Kent State University———157

courses and assigned two faculty members to draft 1994, DPAS's curriculum expanded from a series three manuals composed of reading materials and of 45 televised lectures by several discussion leaders study guides for the series. They selected Franklin's into full-fledged major and minor sequences taught by *From Slavery to Freedom* as one of the primary texts tenured faculty supported by graduated assistants and for the three 5-hour credit courses. The institute went a cadre of dedicated undergraduates. The DPAS not a step further, however, and had the complete series only offered a creditable range of courses, it also aired in Akron and Youngstown and every other formed the Black Faculty and Staff Association on surrounding community able to view programs. The campus, worked to form the Black Studies Consortium institute thus fulfilled two of its programmatic objec-of Northeastern Ohio, and participated in the

formatives, in that it simultaneously diversified its course tion of the National Council for Black Studies. Other offerings and reached out to urban and rural commu-than the aforementioned textbooks and manuals, the nities within the 50-mile radius that comprised its institute and later the Department of Pan-African catchment area. Black Studies programming at Kent Studies published during this period KITABU, a State University was on the move. The institute had monthly newsletter that was distributed nationally; the demonstrated its value to itself, the university, and the quarterly *African American Affairs Monograph Series*; community at large.

and the short-lived *electronic Journal of African* In 1976, the institute petitioned the College of Arts *Studies* (eJAS). Successive DPAS administrations and Sciences for full departmental status. In response, chose not to maintain these publications.

the university offered the institute departmental status In its early years, the institute made itself into with a ready-made curriculum and teaching faculty, a full-service academic enterprise. That is, it literally which the institute's director agreed with BUS they became a holistic educational institution, handling should reject. However, after the institute had been in students' academic needs, financial needs (at one operation for 7 years and established a curriculum and point, Kent State's business office commissioned a faculty to teach it, the institute was ready and strong the institute to handle the financial problems of all enough in all the requisite particulars to hold its own university students), and social and cultural needs. In as a *bona fide* academic department. The institute 1972, for instance, the institute responded to students again petitioned for full departmental status and its who were having unnecessary difficulties with college petition was approved, with major and minor course English as it was taught in the English Department.

sequences, by the relevant committees of the Faculty The institute proposed to the English Department that Senate and the State's Board of Regents. The institute it allow the institute to offer the same English classes then metamorphosed into a research and program in DPAS under the English Department's rubric and development institute and the Department of Pan-taught by English Department teachers but selected African Studies (DPAS)

was born. Its faculty were and administered by IAAA/DPAS. This English pro-tenured and a two-volume introductory textbook was gram was endorsed by a senior English Department written by Edward Crosby— *The African Experience* faculty, approved by the English Department's chair, in *Community Development: The Continuing Struggle* and has remained in operation for 33 years.

in Africa and The Americas. After two preliminary To cement the universality of its mission, DPAS

editions, Simon and Schuster published the text in had its minor programs offered in the College of 1984, along with a companion text by Crosby, *Your Education* and the College of Fine and Professional *History: A Chronology of Notable Events in the Arts*. On Honors Day DPAS conferred three awards *History of Africans in Africa and the Diaspora, 1600*

on African American students with various majors: *BCE to 1980*.

The Fela Sowande Award of Creativity, The Mary The institute had thus evolved from a one-room Mcleod Bethune Award for Scholarship, and the program with three hired staff into the Department W.E.B. Du Bois Award for Service. DPAS also estab-of Pan-African Studies with a faculty and staff of 42

lished other honors and recognitions, such as the persons. The department had administrative control of Mu Mu Chapter of Alpha Kappa Mu, a national an entire building, the Old Student Union, which was academic honor society for all students with a GPA officially renamed Oscar W. Ritchie Hall, dedicated of 3.5 or higher. For many years the IAAA/DPAS, by in memory of the first African American to teach in establishing meaningful relationships with students a majority white state university in Ohio. During 25

in general, enrolled over 60% of the black student constructive years, from August of 1969 to January of body and a number of white students as well.

158———**Black Studies, Names Controversy** In 1970 the institute began staging amateur role. The university therefore reintroduced its old theatrical productions. These productions continued arguments to have DPAS turn itself into a “tradi-until 1972, when the institute moved into the Old tional” department and divorce itself from black Student Union building and the theatrical perfor-students. Kent State wanted the DPAS, as an academic mances became more professional. With the assis-department, to cease advocating for redress of issues tance of the director and other staff from Cleveland’s relating specifically to students of color. The chair of famed Karamu House, the productions became the DPAS has resisted this argument for 25 years. Only nucleus of a full-blown theatre program. In 1978 a time will tell how his successors will continue to wage doctoral candidate in speech communications, Fran E.

the struggle and maintain the mission and program Dorsey, joined the staff of DPAS. His acumen and modalities initiated by the Institute for African skills resulted not only in his being named the CP-American Affairs and advanced by the Department of AC’s director but also in the establishment of the Pan-African Studies into the 21st century.

African Community Theatre (ACT). Dorsey also had

— *Edward R. Crosby*

the work ethic and inspirational drive that the cultural complex with growth potential needed. The theatre **FURTHER READING**

program was originally in Ritchie Hall; however, because of its growing size, ACT had to acquire space Asante, Molefi Kete. (2002). *Afrocentricity*. Chicago: African on another side of campus in Franklin Hall, where American Image. This is one of the first volumes to deal Dorsey and the chair alone renovated two theatres—

with the question of culture as a way to reconstruct the consciousness of African Americans.

Mbárí Mbáyò Theatres I and II. ACT then began to Karenga, Maulana. (2002). *Introduction to Black Studies*. Los stage performances on campus

and in surrounding Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This book remains communities. The Association for the Study of Afro-the classic introduction to the field of Black Studies.

American Life and History invited ACT to perform at its annual conference in Philadelphia. ACT's director also managed to have constructed on the second floor **BLACK STUDIES**,

of the CP-AC a fully outfitted theatre, and its repertory company—the Mbáí Mbáyò Players—performed on **NAMES CONTROVERSY**

and off campus and out of state until 1998.

The approach of IAAA/DPAS/CP-AC to academic Black Studies, as it emerged on university and college and sociocultural programming was to keep it live, campuses across the United States in the late 1960s that is, to make it dynamic and powerful as well as reland early 1970s, was fundamentally the product of the evant. This approach had already resulted in students'

many sacrifices of countless black students. Much of registering for IAAA and DPAS courses in excess the early philosophical confusion surrounding the of what they would have to take to constitute a major field was reflected in the lack of clarity the students or minor. IAAA/DPAS wondered what was causing found in the naming process itself, thus Black Studies students to enroll for these extra credit hours.

is referred to by a thicket of names.

IAAA/DPAS reasoned that the operant element was These black students—with the support of the small their welcoming attitude and willingness to meet cadre of black faculty and staff who joined them (there students where they were and not where they were were very few black faculty and staff at most predom-imagined to be. The IAAA/DPAS desired to serve inantly white universities and colleges at that time), as students and become not only their mentors but also well as with sympathetic white students, faculty, and their surrogate parents, their home away from home.

staff—sought to establish institutional structures that This served to attract black and white students, who would enable them to study systematically, and from a were also captured by DPAS's openness.

black perspective, the lives and works of black people in the United States, Africa, and the Caribbean. They did not seek to simply infuse existing courses in, say, **CHANGES AND**

history, political science, sociology, psychology, **PROSPECTS FOR THE FUTURE**

anthropology, economics, philosophy, and English When the DPAS chair retired, the university reignited with some black-related materials or to graft onto the its effort to change the department's student advocacy curricula of these disciplines courses with "Black,"

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 159

Black Studies, Names Controversy——159

"Afro-American," "African American," or "African" in *black*, *Afro*, and *African* to be a triad of terms that their titles. They sought to break away from the white-formed one unified whole, where each was subordinated content of virtually all of the classes to tutable for the other. From this perspective, Black which they were exposed and reorient their education Studies and Afro-American Studies entailed African in a direction that gave them a sounder social and psy-Studies, and vice versa. And so, in the early years, chological mooring in regard to the lives and works of there were departments, divisions, programs, and black people. At the very outset, then, Black Studies certificates in Black Studies that emphasized past and was seen as a corrective to the extant curricula of just present links between black people in Africa and in the about every college and university in the American United States. The initial emphasis on the United academy.

States was soon to expand to cover all of the Americas.

Black students, who made untold selfless sacrifices (Incidentally, the term *Africana Studies* was coined to lay the institutional foundations of Black Studies, distinguish the version of Black Studies articulated in held very strong views and opinions about what they this paragraph from the traditional white-dominated wanted, though they generally lacked the knowledge African Studies that had been institutionalized at and experience necessary to achieve what they envi-leading universities in the American academy.) sioned. Furthermore, they usually did not receive support from their black professors, as of the few blacks **THE TWO SEPARATE**

who filled faculty and staff roles at predominantly **CURRENTS IN BLACK STUDIES**

white colleges and universities, many did not subscribe to the creation of Black Studies departments, At the very outset of its institutionalized form, then, divisions, programs, and so on. Given the small cadre there were two separate and distinct, though related, of black faculty and staff who shared the sentiments of intellectual currents in Black Studies—one nationalist the students concerning the institutionalization of and the other universalist in culture and politics. The Black Studies, it was the desires, demands, and pres-cultural nationalists saw the scholarship of Black sure of black students that were foremost in impelling Studies as a means to the national empowerment of largely white administrators and faculty to establish black people in the United States. The cultural inter-Black Studies on their campuses.

nationalists perceived in the scholarship of Black Studies possibilities for the empowerment of black people worldwide. Among the cultural international-THE SOURCE OF THE NAME ISSUE

ists were the pan-Africanists, who discerned in Black At a time when black students routinely called one Studies paths for the rebirth, growth, development, another brother and sister, the Afro hairstyle was very and grandeur of continental Africa, which, they prof-popular, the saying “black is beautiful” was a com-fered, would be advantageous to black people wher-monplace, and the concept of black power was highly ever on the planet they lived and in whatever society evocative for blacks as well as whites, there were they participated. Pan-Africanist themes were not those

who saw Black Studies as fundamentally a eschewed by the cultural nationalists, but they played study of U.S. history and society designed to a supporting rather than a leading role in the cultural empower black people individually and black com-nationalists' construction of Black Studies.

munities generally. Black Studies was thus study and The intellectual and social ferment from which action in regard to black people in the United States.

Black Studies arose was manifested in the broad array It was at once a movement, an ideology, an academic of names used to designate the substance of the disci-initiative, and a form of community action. Black pline, which in addition to Black Studies include Studies sought to end the neglect and correct distor-Afro-American Studies, African American Studies, tions in the study of black Americans.

African and African American Studies, Africana But very early on, there were university students, Studies, and Pan-African Studies, among others. The faculty, and staff, who constructed the terms *black* and many names associated with Black Studies reflect the *Afro* to transcend the boundaries of the United States.

rich, and sometimes countervailing, array of values, For them, both terms were linked inextricably with the interests, and purposes that attend it, at times with continent of Africa and could not be separated from regrettable consequences. Some view Black Studies it. They perceived intuitively, and also experientially, as grounded in the activity of pure scholarship, others

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 160

160———**Black Studies, Wellesley College** see Black Studies as a vehicle for transformative social activism, and still others perceive Black Studies **BLACK STUDIES,**

as an institutional home for the scholar-activist.

WELLESLEY COLLEGE

AFRICOLOGY AS A

Wellesley College was started in 1875 for rich and **LEGITIMATE NAME FOR THE FIELD**

bright white women who were excluded at the time from elite white men's colleges. It has traditionally It is against this backdrop, drawn over almost two been one of the "Seven Sisters" colleges, a kind of Ivy generations, that the term *Africology* formally entered League for women, comprised of Radcliffe, Barnard, the lexicon of the American academy in the 1993–1994

Smith, Mt. Holyoke, Bryn Mawr, Vassar, and academic year at the University of Wisconsin-Wellesley. Most African American colleges were Milwaukee. *Africology*—the normative and empirical founded in the same period and for a similar reason, inquiry into the life histories and life prospects of namely, as an alternative for students who were mostly Africans and their descent transgenerationally, trans-unwelcome at mainstream institutions of higher learn-millennially, and universally—subsumes all of the ing. In the 1970s, some of the Seven Sisters colleges names that attend Black Studies and make them all became either completely coeducational or partially redundant intellectually and pragmatically. But contro-coeducational (e.g., in their graduate school only).

versies attending the name Black Studies have not Wellesley has remained steadfastly committed to its ended with the introduction of the more comprehensive status as an all women's college.

and precise disciplinary name Africology. Questions W.E.B. Du Bois in his 1902 *College Bred Negro* pertaining to whether Black Studies (or Africology, for reported two black graduates of Wellesley since its that matter) is an academic discipline persist, despite inception. This was enough to qualify Wellesley as a the work of individuals who have claimed all along liberal institution at a time when most white schools that it is a discipline. Moreover, there are those who totally rejected black students. Ella Smith Elbert, class have posited that Black Studies itself is not a discrete of 1888, was Wellesley's second black graduate and discipline but an interdisciplinary discipline, and there became one of African America's

pioneer professional are still others who simply see Black Studies as one of historians when she obtained her master's degree in many area studies. And so, controversies pertaining to economics and history from Wellesley in 1892. She the name Black Studies and its cognates are likely to taught at Howard University, the legendary "capstone persist for yet another generation, even though increas-of Negro education," for 11 years.

ingly Black Studies is disappearing from the formal names of departments, programs, and certificates in the **THE REVOLUTION COMES TO WELLESLEY**

American academy—to be supplanted by Africology in due course.

By the eve of the Black Studies revolution of the late

— *Winston A. Van Horne*

1960s, about 100 black women had graduated from Wellesley. These included women who went on to dis-FURTHER READING

tinguish themselves in a variety of professions. Several, like Jane Matilda Bolin, who became African America's Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). *Kemet, Afrocentricity, and first woman judge in 1939*, were the first blacks in *Knowledge*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. Asante surveys the entire field of Black Studies with an eye toward the their fields. Some were daughters of famous black men, maturing of the discipline. This work is useful for a general such as Clarissa Scott Delaney, daughter of Emmett J.

treatment of the controversies surrounding the discipline.

Scott, Washington's secretary at Tuskegee Institute in Cruse, Harold. (1967). *The Crisis of the Negro Intellectual*.

Alabama and special assistant to the Secretary of War New York: William Morrow. Cruse shows how the black during World War I. Some black women, like Portia intellectual in America has had to struggle for definition by Washington, daughter of Booker T. Washington, attended overcoming

the imposed names, definitions, and interpret-but did not graduate from Wellesley.

tations of a racist society.

Early on, in the absence of Black Studies, black Karenga, Maulana. (2001). *Introduction to Black Studies*. Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This book remains students at Wellesley, as elsewhere, sometimes con-the most comprehensive introduction to the field of Black structured their own informal black studies in any way Studies.

they could. Elbert, for example, did her master's thesis

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 161

Black Studies, Wellesley College——161

on Reconstruction after the War of the Slaveholders'

support personnel. If their demands were not met Rebellion. She later became an important black forthwith, they warned, they would go on a hunger bibliophile and ultimately donated her extensive strike and call in the national media. All 24 students collection of rare Afro-Americana to Amherst College, joined Ethos and supported its demands. One initial her son's alma mater, and to Wellesley College, where hold-out was eventually won over to the cause.

her acquisitions are now housed in a special collection.

Intense negotiations ensued. The faculty was split, and the white student government leaders accused Ethos of racism for categorically rejecting white **FIGHTING FOR CIVIL RIGHTS**

student input into a negotiation committee. The college **AND EDUCATIONAL CHANGE**

president, Ruth Adams, managed to maintain a cool Change came to Wellesley, as it did to the entire head and eventually acceded to the requests of the nation, in the wake of the civil rights and black power black students.

She understood that the popularity of a movement. By the mid-1960s, the nonviolent, inter-hunger strike, outside pressure, and vigorous agitation of the civil rights movement had given way to its more militant, nationalist black power counterpart.

committed Wellesley to immediate efforts to increase Black empowerment and racial pride replaced desegregation as the major objectives of black struggle. She agreed to the establishment of an Afro-American Studies program. It would initially be an independent major, cobbled together from courses relevant to the black experience that were whatever willing faculty members could extract from taught by black professors. There was a close connection between campus activism and Black Studies.

professor headed this interim arrangement. The school Members of the militant Black Panther Party for Self-Defense claimed to have introduced the first such program at Merritt College in California. Wellesley Waddell Fund was utilized to finance student projects not touched by these currents. Black power movement requiring travel to Africa and the Caribbean. Between leaders Stokely Carmichael (later known as Kwame Ture) and Malcolm X were among those who in 1973, Wellesley College saw its first Black Studies department on Wellesley's campus in the 1960s. White college black faculty. One of these was the writer Alice Walker, in response to the worsening racial situation, who served briefly in the English department began admitting black students, either for the first time or in larger numbers than before.

tered at the college. (About three decades later, she The period from 1965 to 1968 saw the most intense was still sufficiently upset by her experience to refuse to be commencement speaker.) 1969, culminating in the nationwide riots triggered by For the 1972 to 1973 school year, Wellesley

initiated the assassination in April of 1968 of civil rights icon, created an official Black Studies program, with one full-time professor, a historian. His charge was to recruit a the proximate event leading to the introduction of full complement of professors for the Black Studies Black Studies at Wellesley. At the time of King's death, there were 24 black students at Wellesley, the year. Wellesley's new Black Studies Department began largest number at one time in the college's history.

in 1973 with a full complement of five professors. It was some days after this tragic event, a few of them (legally a fully fledged department (as opposed to a pre-end has it, in a taxi) founded Ethos, the Black Student group) with the curricular autonomy and financial support. In the tradition of the time, they announced ability that normally emanate from departmental status.

a number of nonnegotiable demands. They wanted the Students could and did major in Black Studies from introduction of a Black Studies program run by black the very beginning. The major was interdisciplinary professors. They wanted an immediate increase in the and pan-African in scope, with professors encouraged number of black students admitted to Wellesley. They to cover more than one area of the African diaspora.

demanded the immediate hiring of someone in the Several years later a minor was added. In the early school's admissions department whose task would be 1990s the department's name was changed from Black to recruit black students. They demanded other black Studies to Africana Studies. This reflected a nationwide

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 162

162———**Black Studies, Wellesley College** trend at the time. It was also an affirmation of the evaluated for tenure in his second year. His qualifications pan-African scope of the department's offerings.

were strong and his chances for tenure seemed very good. The first five professors in the Black Studies good. However, the events that followed his becoming department came from various disciplines—two from eligible for tenure

made clear that the prospect of a history, one from English, one from drama, and one tenured black colleague unnerved some white professors from sociology. Two of the five were full-time Black professors, who had probably not sufficiently thought through Black Studies professors. One was a joint history and this implication of a Black Studies department. First the Black Studies hire. One was jointly in English and history department, where he had a joint appointment, Black Studies. The sociologist had an unusual joint appointment abruptly terminated the joint arrangement. They simply appointment at Wellesley College and Brandeis stopped inviting him to department meetings, but never University. By this time, thanks to the energetic formally informed him of their decision. Then the dean recruitment that resulted in large black classes of 1972

of the college wrote him a note saying that the college and 1973, there was a critical mass of black students had decided in its wisdom that the tenure quota for Black on campus. Black students supported the new department. Studies would be capped at one for all time. This meant, meant and have continued to do so from then to now.

she explained, that if the current candidate came up for Blacks as well as students of other races elected the tenure as mandated by college legislation, he might well Black Studies classes in fair numbers.

be successful and then no other Black Studies professor would ever have a chance to be tenured. In order to level the playing field, she curiously argued, she would **KEEPING FAITH**

advance the next person in line, who would have been The new black faculty and administrators moved eligible for evaluation the following year. Thus, she reacted quickly to consolidate their position on campus. They soned, two (black) people would have a chance to slug it set up structures that were able to sustain the community while the rest of the college would presumably enjoy unity through the good years and the rough ones that lay the spectacle.

ahead. One of these was the Black Task Force (BTF), comprised of black faculty and staff. The BTF sought **CONFRONTING**

and obtained guarantees of black representation on **DIFFICULTIES AND PERSEVERING**

all college committees. They argued that most blacks would never get elected to committees through a In reply, the associate professor thanked the dean for normal majority vote. This has proved an invaluable her thoughtfulness, but he said that he did not wish to device over the years. Several attempts were made in be drawn into a fight with another black professor that ensuing years to strike it down, but it has survived.

would result in the inevitable loss of a job for one of Since much of the governance of Wellesley College them. He suggested that the dean simply give tenure to takes place in committees, black folk have thus been the candidate who was being prematurely advanced and assured a voice, albeit a minority one. Another endur-said that he would leave the college without a fight.

ing institution founded early on was Harambee House, When word of the dean's grotesque maneuver reached a building that had conveniently become vacant at the black students, they called an emergency meeting at the time of the 1968 demand by black students that Harambee House. In a single night, almost the whole a special place on campus be provided for them.

black student body signed a petition expressing their Harambee House has always had a black director, abhorrence of what the dean had attempted. They pres-who has usually played a crucial role in coordinating sured the artificially advanced candidate to withdraw students' concerns and being a liaison with faculty and from the arrangement, but he refused. The students then staff. Harambee House over the years has provided a suggested that the dean should go ahead and evaluate black haven on campus for the social, educational, and both professors, but that the stipulation of only one slot political activity of all sectors of the black community.

should be withdrawn. If both candidates qualified, they The rapid consolidation of the black community said, then tenure them both. If neither qualified, then so was tested in 1975 when black Wellesley faced its first be

it. But they did not want two professors being forced post-1973 crisis, that of the tenuring of the first black to fight for a preordained single slot.

faculty. One of the historians had come in as an associ- To make matters worse, the administration chose a professor and, according to college rules, would be this very time to inform the most popular black staff

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 163

Black Studies, Wellesley College———163

member on campus, a psychological counselor, that The members of the department proved to be his job was being reduced from full time to half time.

serious scholars. Their publication record was as good Now the students had two reasons to be upset. In as that of the faculty of any other department at response, they held a sit-in at the president's office on Wellesley. In fact, it was better than that of many, one day, and later thoroughly disrupted Wellesley's perhaps most, faculty at the school, which despite showcase centenary convocation. As the president of its prestige did not in the 1970s have a particularly the college rose to speak before the assembled presi-outstanding publication record. The department also dents of all the Seven Sisters colleges, other digni-turned out some outstanding majors. One finished her taries, and the press, the president and members of first 3 years of coursework at Wellesley in 2 years, Ethos, together with some white allies, marched into was Phi Beta Kappa, and was accepted into Harvard the chapel, grabbed the president's microphone, and Medical School at the end of her junior year. She took over the meeting. When an organist tried to never had a chance to finish her Black Studies major.

drown out the Ethos president's speech with loud Another had her 1978 bachelor's honors thesis chords, a student pulled the plug on his instrument.

accepted for publication by the publisher G.K. Hall Ethos rained on Wellesley's 100th birthday parade.

(which is now a division of Macmillan). Both of The upshot was that the school restored the coun- these are probably records that have not been equaled selor's job to full time and ended up having to tenure or surpassed by students in any other department two black professors rather than one. For the profes- at Wellesley. While these achievements were sor who chose to go along with the dean's scheme acknowledged by the wider community, they were not and have himself prematurely tenured, this proved a sufficient to relieve the sense of siege and presumed big mistake. Students thereafter refused to take his inferiority under which Black Studies operated for courses. With no one to teach, he was made associate much of the time.

dean, a post invented especially to give him something A significant part of the problem seemed to be to do. He left the college shortly thereafter.

caused by the attempt by successive administrations The new department greatly enriched college life at to destabilize the department. As in the case of the Wellesley. Its first drama professor, Danny Scarbor-1975 artificially advanced tenure candidate, the ough, was able to fill the largest auditorium on campus administrations had an uncanny knack for identifying for 3 nights at a time with his annual Broadway-type those black faculty and staff who could be enlisted shows, featuring his student-comprised Wellesley in this work of self-destruction. In addition, as in all College Black Total Theatrical Experience Repertory Black Studies departments, in the department at Theatre company. The Ethos Fashion Show, begun in Wellesley student issues were never totally divorced 1983 as a major fundraiser, has remained the most from wider community issues. The campus was not largely attended student production on campus.

insulated from the events affecting black people in the In the early 1970s, Wellesley's Black Studies depart-outside world, thus, for example, for many years the ment faculty were founding members of a Boston-area issue of divestment from corporations collaborating Black Studies consortium that brought together faculty with apartheid South Africa was a source of recurring from Harvard, Brandeis, and Brown Universities, unease. When in 1995 the Rodney King beating ver-Salem State College, Boston State College, and other dict provoked riots in California, Wellesley's black nearby schools. The consortium later joined the students were just as

enraged and frustrated as the rest National Council for Black Studies (NCBS) and hosted of African America. A large body of students left a both regional NCBS meetings and a joint national campus rally and marched on the president's house in meeting of the NCBS and the African Heritage Studies the middle of the night to vent their rage.

Association. Out of this activity came the *New England* In the early 1990s, strained Black-Jewish relations *Journal of Black Studies*. Members of the consortium began to loom as a major recurring problem. African presented guest lectures at one another's campuses and American Egyptologist and professor Yosef ben-taught occasional courses for other departments and Jochannon spoke at Wellesley and was heckled by programs as the need arose. Sometimes they collab-Greek and Latin professor Mary Lefkowitz, provok-orated with a Boston community organization, the ing an angry response from the students and commu-African Heritage Institute, to bring such speakers as nity members present. Al Sharpton's visit to campus Kwame Ture and Robert Williams to Boston.

was preceded by charges of anti-Semitism from

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 164

164———**Black Studies, Wellesley College** Jewish students. One of them made the outlandish Martin countered with a book of his own, *The Jewish* suggestion that Sharpton was an advocate of genocide.

Onslaught: Despatches From the Wellesley Battlefield, When the film *Cleopatra* starring Elizabeth Taylor in which he placed the Wellesley hysteria into was screened on campus by the Greek and Latin club, the context of the history of relations between blacks a black student wrote an op-ed piece in the newspaper and Jews.

on the historical inaccuracy of the film. She was About half a year into the controversy, Wellesley consequently summoned to Lefkowitz's office and hired a new president. Her first major pronouncement harangued for a considerable period. This student left was a statement denouncing Martin and *The Jewish* the college shortly thereafter. By the 1990s, Lefkowitz *Onslaught*. An astounding 40,000 to 60,000 copies of had begun to carve

out a career of sorts in Black Studies this statement were reportedly sent out to all students, bashing. Major publications such as the *Chronicle of parents, alumnae, faculty, staff, the media, and pre-Higher Education and the Wall Street Journal* seemed sumably whoever else the school could think of.

to have an insatiable appetite for her fulminations on When merit pay for full professors came around, what she considered the “irrational” development Martin was awarded zero, despite his 13 publications represented by Black Studies in academia. All of this in the 3-year review period and strong teaching and reached its culmination in what some blacks called the service performance. Professors who had published

“Jewish onslaught,” which began in 1993.

nothing in as many as 20 years received merit pay.

The trouble began when Professor Tony Martin The history department, where Martin’s courses had included portions of *The Secret Relationship Between* been cross listed for 20 years, suddenly decided that *Blacks and Jews*, authored by the Historical Research the courses were no longer worthy of history credit.

Department of the Nation of Islam, on his African Cudjoe and Andrews, blacks who sided with the Jews, American history survey syllabus. The book was received temporary endowed chairs, the first and still based overwhelmingly on material culled from the only black professors in Wellesley’s history to Jewish sources and illuminated the Jewish role in be awarded chairs of any kind. When the revolving the slave trade, a subject that was insufficiently department chairpersonship rotated back around to known. Wellesley’s Jews considered the exploration Martin, the administration stepped in and imposed a of this aspect of African history to be a “hateful”

chair from another institution. This person continued exercise. The Wellesley chapter of the national to teach at Brandeis University while commuting peri-Jewish student organization, Hillel, initiated a odically to Wellesley to chair its Africana Studies protest. They were quickly joined by national Jewish department.

organizations and the college administration, most Rumors were also circulated of an intention to of whom were Jews.

close down Africana Studies altogether. This appeared A joint call for the revocation of Martin's tenure imminent when the administration announced the was made by four major Jewish organizations, namely establishment of a visiting committee to review the the Anti-Defamation League, American Jewish Africana Studies department. The three-member Committee, American Jewish Congress, and the Jewish panel was composed of respected but moderate Community Relations Council. The powers that be professors from institutions of comparable prestige.

were able to enlist the support of some black folk. The Their report, which some in the black community chair of Africana Studies, Selwyn Cudjoe, practically feared might be a pretext for closing down the depart-placed himself at the head of the protest and initiated ment, was actually constructive and mildly censured the attacks on Martin in academic council. From rela-the school for some of its indiscretions. The administive obscurity, Cudjoe was suddenly lifted into national tration proclaimed itself not bound either by the prominence, and his op-eds condemning *The Secret* criticisms leveled against it or by the suggestions *Relationship* appeared in many major newspapers.

for ending their subversion of the department's He was ably assisted by Marcellus Andrews, a black operations.

economics professor, who was allowed to opine in Jews and blacks again came into conflict in 2002

the campus newspaper that Wellesley's black students when black students invited New Jersey poet laureate were "intellectually weak and morally lazy." This was Amiri Baraka to speak. He had spoken on campus his response to black students' standing fast against twice before without incident, but this time his visit the protest against Martin and solidly supporting him.

coincided with a strident attack on him from Jewish

Black Theology——165

spokespeople and organizations. He had expressed in poetry the view that there might have been possible **BLACK THEOLOGY**

Israeli foreknowledge of the Twin Towers disaster of September 11, 2001. Jewish organizations protested Black theology is an approach to understanding the this insinuation and the college president issued state-supreme deity that is rooted in African culture. It ments decrying Baraka's anti-Semitism.

emerged in the 1960s as a viable alternative to white Africana Studies at Wellesley continues as always Christian theology. Black theology was principally to provide a quality education while existing within a articulated by African American preachers and theolo-constant aura of siege. The effort to protect the depart-gians led by James Cone, a professor at the Union ment from encroachment by others trying to offer Theological Seminary. Cone reached into the past of parallel courses and from attrition by deans wanting black America's rich theological and spiritual heritage to reduce its size is a constant reality. Throughout to highlight the role of religion in the life of black its history, the department has nevertheless enjoyed folk, and he laid the groundwork for those who have steady support from black students and fair to strong followed his steps to systematically record the history support from all others. Successive administrations of theology in black America.

seem not to have come to terms with the reality of With the assistance of Gayraud Wilmore and black scholars with a perspective of their own. Rather others, Cone reached back to Africa to study how than try to find a principled solution to tensions, the Africans had understood the concept of God.

tendency has often been to subvert the department by Wilmore's theological writing, particularly in his encouraging disruptive elements within it to keep it book *Black Religion and Black Radicalism* (1983), off balance. In many

ways, the story of Black Studies connected the present plight of black suffering with may simply be the story of being black in America—

the African past. Wilmore and Charles Long encour-writ small.

aged Cone and other black radical theologians to read the writings of Africans. Cone read these writings and

— *Tony Martin*

came to see Africa as the critical source for the development of a black theology based on black religion.

FURTHER READING

The radical theologians became even more deter-Adams, Ruth M. (1978). From the College President. *Black* mined to look to Africa as the source of African *Studies at Wellesley*, 2. This is a full and frank recounting American theology when South African theologians of the events that ultimately led to the introduction of Black started contrasting their theology with black theology.

Studies at Wellesley College, which was written contempo-What Cone and other radical clergy and theologians raneous with the events, originally appearing in the July were doing was systematically developing a theology 1968 issue of the *Wellesley Alumnae Magazine*.

Ball, Wendy, and Martin, Tony. (1981). *Rare Afro-Americana*: of empowerment based on the African experience.

A Reconstruction of the Adger Library. Boston: G.K. Hall.

According to Wilmore, this was the first time since This is an outgrowth of Ball's Wellesley B.A. thesis exam-Garveyism that black Christianity distinguished itself as ining rare books donated to Wellesley's library by Ella something unique and different from white Christianity.

Smith Elbert, class of 1888.

Black theology further displayed its flexibility by *Black Studies at Wellesley* (later *Africana Studies at Wellesley*).

searching its religious past in Africa, which was not This is the occasional newsletter of the Africana Studies rooted in Christianity. Moreover, because it looked to Department at Wellesley College from 1976 to the present.

Martin, Tony. (1993). *The Jewish Onslaught: Despatches Africa as the place to pattern black theology in America, From the Wellesley Battlefield*. Dover, MA: The Majority it freed itself from the orthodox dogmatism of Scripture Press. This is a historical analysis of Black-Jewish relations alone. Thus Black theology continues as a designator, in the United States and elsewhere, written in the midst of which distinguishes it from Euro-American theology.

the greatest challenge to Black Studies at Wellesley According to black theology, it is necessary to go College.

beyond the church experience to discover the source Miranda, Elizabeth. (2002). *Black Women Pioneers in Higher of theology*. Thus, it can be found in black folklore, *Education: A Biographical History of Wellesley College* spirituals, and the blues. It is the function of the clergy *Black Alumnae From 1887–1940*. Unpublished B.A. honors thesis, Africana Studies Department, Wellesley College.

and theologians to glean insight from these rich This is a unique and invaluable record of Wellesley's black sources, findings that eventually will aid in the libera-history.

tion of all oppressed people.

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 166

166——Blaxploitation Films

In the 1960s, a distinct consciousness of black Cone's scholarly focus and ministry have been theology began to emerge when nontraditional black devoted to fighting battles for black people. Developing clergy began to

assess Christianity in relation to the a theology of black empowerment, for Cone, did not struggle unique to black America. When black clergy take place in a vacuum. What directed him to evaluate began to evaluate Christianity in light of their strug-the relationship between Christianity and black gle, they found Anglo racism at its core. Hence, many empowerment was his experiences and those of mil-started to associate racism with the Antichrist. Cone lions of black people suffering throughout America.

critically analyzed the plight of African people in his Cone takes pride in the knowledge that black theol-first book, *Black Theology and Black Power* (1969) .

ogy, unlike Euro-American Christianity, does not have This was the work that laid the groundwork for black its mooring in academia. Black theology has its roots theology. In the book, he connected theology with in the community of suffering, and it is rooted in the the philosophy of black power, a decision clergy and community of outcast and not among Constantine's theologians challenged. After all, this was the white conquerors. The ministry of Jesus started not with the man's religion, so what could it say to blacks? How-elite members of society but among the illiterate and ever, Cone took no time to address his critics, as he downtrodden.

believed he was on a divine mission and therefore So if the Black Church endeavors to recapture the refused to be distracted from it.

ancient spirit of Christianity and embrace its pre-Civil During Cone's early theorizing, he was primarily War zeal, black theology must adopt its 1960s posture centered on white racism. Later he balanced this one-or become a haven of rhetoric much like the theology dimensional perspective by focusing on other factors Cone condemns. If the fervor and zeal that heralded that contributed to suffering and inhumanity, including the Black Church's pre-Civil War and 1960s stances is sexism and economic exploitation. Yet his boldest not reignited, then Cone will find himself fighting stance was an attempt to show that a positive relation-against his own creation.

ship existed between black power and the Gospel. His

— Douglas E. Thomas

decision to link Jesus with black empowerment was not some frenzied notion based on emotionalism or **FURTHER READING**

anger. His rationale was rooted in the biblical perspective and based on the ministry of Jesus. For Cone, “if Cone, James H. (1993). *A Black Theology of Liberation*.

Christ is present among the oppressed, he could only Maryknoll, NY: Orbis Books. This is Cone’s fundamental be working through the activity of black power.” The statement of the conditions and promises of a theology that is based on the experiences of the oppressed.

rise of black power in America brought to the forefront Cone, James H. (2000). *Risks of Faith: The Emergence of a* what was taking place in the hearts and minds of many *Black Theology of Liberation 1968–1998*. Boston: Beacon African Americans. Because Martin Luther King was Press. Here Cone traces the emergence of the most radical such a beloved prophet in the black community, few movement in African American religious history in order to organizations could successfully challenge his nonvio-establish the grounds of a black theology.

lent philosophy. However, the gravitation toward black Wilmore, Gayraud. (1998). *Black Religion and Black power* by many who were disenchanted with society *Radicalism*. Maryknoll, NY: Orbis Books. (Original work published 1983). This is one of the key treatments of black signified a rejection of King’s vision of black and religion and its relationship to radical social and political white fellowship. Because of this important philosoph-transformation. Wilmore is one of the leading theologians ical change in the black community, Cone made no of his time.

apology for linking black empowerment with the Gospel of Christ. In fact, the Gospel from Cone’s perspective is not authentic unless it empowers the weak and outcast members in an oppressive society. A theol-
BLAXPLOITATION FILMS

ogy that does not reach out to the poor and oppressed but remains confined in abstraction is an inadequate The term *blaxploitation films* refers to a series of films theology. Cone quoted Malcolm X as having said, “I released between 1969 and 1974 that featured a pri-believe in a religion that believes in freedom. Anytime marily black cast and whose narratives focused on the I have to accept a religion that won’ t let me fight a contemporary black urban experience. Grounded in battle for my people, I say to hell with that religion.”

the action-adventure genre, these films were usually

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 167

Blaxploitation Films——167

low-budget Hollywood productions geared toward collapse. The advent of television and the expansion the black youth market.

of the foreign film market after World War II steadily The blaxploitation period was preceded by several cut into the studios’ profit margin. At the same time, shifts in America’s sociopolitical landscape. In the middle-class whites were vacating urban areas for context of World War II, the United States felt vulner-the developing suburbs, leaving cities to their black able to charges that the country’s racist practices citizens. Though blacks made up only 11% of the were similar to the extreme nationalism exhibited population in 1970, they accounted for 30% of movie by Germany and Japan. This started a thrust toward audiences in the urban areas where theaters were inclusion that resulted, among other things, in an traditionally located. Studio executives had begun to agreement in 1942 between the NAACP (National notice this shift in racial demographics several years Association for the Advancement of Colored People) earlier, and they came to believe that the key to their and heads of the major studios to increase the partici-financial solvency was the production and distribution pation of blacks in the film industry. Hollywood of a film product specifically geared to the black responded to the charges with an attempt to improve community.

the representation of blacks on screen. The 1950s became known as the era of integration in American **THE NEW BLACK DIRECTORS**

cinema and led to the rise of actors such as Sidney Poitier, Dorothy Dandridge, and Harry Belafonte.

Melvin Van Peebles, a black director with several film Poitier in particular came to symbolize the integra-credits to his name, is generally credited with popular-tionist hero by starring in vehicles that cast him as izing the genre that eventually became known as a conservative, intelligent, sexually neutral, culturally blaxploitation. He directed *Story of a Three-Day Pass* ambiguous figure who posed no threat to the white (1967), a foreign film based on his novel, and establishment. He was the model of black respectabil-Watermelon Man (1970), a low-budget Hollywood ity for white audiences as well as for a certain segment feature. Then 39-year-old Van Peebles decided to of the black community. Blacks who desired assimila-channel his resources into independently writing, pro-tion into the dominant culture generally embraced ducing, and directing *Sweet Sweetback's Baadasssss* Poitier, but others rejected him because of his charac-Song (1971), the story of a black man who triumphs ters' unwillingness to articulate their oppression over a corrupt white establishment. The protagonist of and rage.

the film works as a sexual performer in a South Central Los Angeles bordello where he was abandoned as a boy. He received the name Sweetback at the age of **THE BLACK PERSONA OF THE 1960s**

9 from a female prostitute who forced him to engage By the late 1960s, Hollywood had begun to respond to in sexual intercourse with her. At the beginning of the desire of black audiences for a more assertive the film, Sweetback appears to be a passive character, black film star, and Jim Brown, a former all-star foot-emotionally alienated from the people and events ball player with an appealing personality and arrest-around him. As the narrative unfolds, two police offi-ing physical presence, proved to be exactly what cers request that the bordello owner allow Sweetback Hollywood was looking for. Though black audiences to act as a temporary suspect in a local murder case in initially welcomed Brown's aggressive film persona, an effort to calm public fears. While he is in custody, they

grew increasingly weary of the way in which his Sweetback becomes a witness to the brutal beating characters' emerging militancy was continually under-of a young black revolutionary by the two cops. He mined by their support of the white power structure.

becomes enraged by the beating and physically attacks Eventually, it became clear that Hollywood's typecast-the officers. Sweetback then becomes caught in a ing of Brown in roles that required physical strength series of misadventures as he attempts to elude police.

rather than emotional depth merely signaled a return to Van Peebles employed a number of technical the caricature of the black buck popularized in early devices (such as multiple exposures, jump cuts, and American cinema.

long montages) to differentiate his film from the stan-Hollywood's increasing interest in black-oriented dard Hollywood product, and the innovative musical films in the 1970s was the result of a financial crisis arrangements of the 1970s soul group Earth, Wind, that left the industry on the verge of economic and Fire as well as the director's own poetry were

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 168

168———**Blaxploitation Films**

used to enhance the narrative. Van Peebles produced remorse for the negative impact his illegal activities his film for \$500,000, yet it had grossed \$10 million have had on his community. He simply wants out of by the end of its run.

the drug business and is looking for the most advanta-Sweetback was particularly popular with young, geous way to achieve his goal.

black males; however, it did not fare as well with other members of the community. Blacks who were fans of **THE BLACK FEMALE STARS**

the integrationist hero did not care for this new style of protagonist. Though Huey P. Newton, one of the Several vehicles starring female protagonists

were founders and leaders of the Black Panther Party, also released during this period. Actresses Pam Grier called *Sweetback* “the first truly revolutionary Black and Tamara Dobson launched their careers in the film made,” Lerone Bennett of *Ebony* magazine stated *Coffy* (1973, Hill) and *Cleopatra Jones* (1973, that “Sweetback is neither revolutionary nor black.”

Starrett), respectively. And like their male counter-Black intellectuals and critics generally agreed with parts, these characters also elicited a storm of contro-Bennett’s criticism of the film. Though Van Peebles versy. Though many black moviegoers considered the stated that his aim was to reappropriate the image of sexually assertive heroines to be mere reformulations the bad, black buck, many felt that his emphasis on of the black jezebel, others applauded these aggres-Sweetback’s sexual prowess undermined any attempt sive, gun-wielding defenders of the black community.

to provide audiences with a conscious, liberated character. Especially problematic was Van Peebles’s treat-THE NATURE AND

ment of the women in his film, who functioned mainly **LIMITATIONS OF THE GENRE**

as objects for Sweetback’s sexual gratification.

However, the representation of an overtly sexual, defi-The blaxploitation genre is generally credited with ant hero who challenges the white power structure articulating to a certain degree the social and political and wins was a refreshing change for many black upheaval experienced by America, and particularly its moviegoers.

black community, in the 1960s and early 1970s. The The success of *Sweet, Sweetback’s Baadasssss* Vietnam War, political scandals such as Watergate, *Song* launched a host of imitators, the most notable government social policies that led to the increased being *Shaft* (1971), directed by Gordon Parks, Sr., the ghettoization of the black underclass, the rapid rise of first black to work as a photographer for *Life* maga-drug use within the culture and its insidious infiltra-zine, and *Superfly* (1972) directed by Gordon

Parks, tion into the black community, as well as the backlash Jr. *Shaft* was originally conceived as a standard detec-on civil rights gains, resulted in increased feelings of tive tale with a white protagonist, but studio execu-cynicism among many. In films like *Sweetback*, *Shaft*, tives refashioned the script to capitalize on tensions and *Superfly*, the stark, realistic cinematography in the black community. The central character, John depicted the decay of urban black communities, and Shaft, is a smooth-talking, butt-kicking, leather-the soulful lyrics of respected musical artists such as coat-wearing New York City detective who espouses Isaac Hayes and Curtis Mayfield reflected the com-black nationalist ideology through his rhetoric and munity's feelings of disenfranchisement. However, demeanor. However, unlike *Sweetback*, who harbors as blaxploitation films continued to draw a sizable no alliances with the white establishment, Shaft is audience, Hollywood became even more conservative able to successfully negotiate that world without jeop-in its presentation of progressive black characters.

ardizing his position of authority within the Harlem By appropriating the discourse of black nationalism neighborhood he polices.

in its characterization of individualistic, material-Critics had less trouble with Shaft than with driven, pseudomilitants, Hollywood ultimately sought Priest, the Harlem cocaine dealer who is the hero of to undermine black social and political agency and *Superfly*. Though the plot of *Superfly* centers around the idea of black collective empowerment.

the hustler's attempts to abandon the drug trade, the By the mid-1970s, Hollywood had emerged from products of his corrupt lifestyle—the expensive its fiscal crisis. Amid increased public condemnation wardrobe, apartment, and car and the beautiful, of the one-dimensional characters, rehashed plots, and alluring women—are glamorized throughout the film.

poor technical quality of most of the blaxploitation Especially problematic is Priest's apparent lack of films, studio executives no longer felt it necessary to

invest in black-oriented material and the blaxploitation forms of the blues. The blues musician maintains the era soon came to an end.

role of cultural historian and social commentator that is so vital to the *djeli* tradition.

— *Stephanie Yarbough*

Other early African American musical forms rooted in African tradition also contributed to the develop-FURTHER READING

ment of the blues as a genre. The early blues singers Bogle, Donald. (2000). *Toms, Coons, Mulattoes, Mammies, incorporated the vocal potentiality and musical and Bucks*. New York: Continuum. In this book, Bogle resourcefulness of the cries, calls, and hollers of field identifies the main racist characters that pervaded workers and street vendors. Blues musicians continued American cinema for a long time.

the rhythmic elements and call-and-response patterns Guerrero, Ed. (1993). *Framing Blackness: The African American Image in Film*. Philadelphia: Temple University of the work songs. In addition, many blues composi-Press. This is an insightful analysis of how devastating tions are indistinguishable from spirituals.

images have effectively undermined black agency.

The blues are central to the creative and ingenious Martinez, Gerald. (1998). *What It Is . . . What It Was: The communicative dynamics in African American culture*.

Black Film Explosion of the '70s in Words and Pictures.

The blues engage in a search for truth in the African New York: Hyperion. This book identifies major themes American experience, thus blues songs communicate and trends in black cinema in the 1970s.

the performers' responses to the realities of life. The song texts cover a wide range of subject areas and convey an underlying theme of hope and optimism regarding the survival and progress of African Americans **BLUES**

despite their social conditions. This message of the blues is proliferated through proverbial wisdom, The *blues* are an African American musical genre philosophy, humor, satire, imagery, self-affirmation, created as the personal expression of the collective political commentary, and protest. Some common emotive response to the cultural and social experience topics found in blues texts include emotional concerns of Africans living in America. The blues are not only like love, loneliness, frustration, and grief, as well as musical compositions and styles of performing but social concerns like oppression, injustice, poverty, and also a conscious state of being. The music encom-homelessness.

passes a wide range of styles from meditative solo per-Itinerant musicians who sang at social functions, formances to barrelhouse piano to sizzling dance railroad stations, street corners, and restaurants per-music. Characteristic features of the blues include formed the earlier forms of the blues. They accompa-

“blue notes”—altered pitches in a diatonic scale; spe-nied themselves on the banjo or fiddle, and their blues cial vocal effects—hums, grunts, growls, and falsetto; songs were improvisatory in nature. The banjo was AAB form—a three-line stanza with statement, restate-eventually replaced by the guitar, which became the ment, and concluding commentary; and a standardized preferred accompanying musical instrument of the chord progression in the instrumental accompaniment.

blues singer. The blues singer could adapt the guitar Based in oral tradition, the blues are directly linked to produce sounds expressing a “blues” feeling by to African musical precedents in structure and tonal-sliding a knife or bottleneck against the strings.

ity, style of delivery, choice of accompanying instru-The blues as a distinct musical form was stabilized ment, and the role of the musician. Distinctive in the 1920s by the recording and publishing industries.

elements in the music performed by the *djelis*, praise W. C. Handy is credited as one of the first musicians singers, of Senegambia are so prevalent in the blues to notate his blues compositions, and he established that the blues can be seen as a transformation of this a music publishing company in 1907 in partnership with African musical heritage to accommodate the experi-singer Harry Pace. Handy's composition *St. Louis ences of Africans in America*. The use of the penta-Blues, published in 1914, gained worldwide recognition tonic scale, call-and-response patterns, and special and resulted in the dissemination of the blues sound to vocal effects are common in both the music performed a wide-ranging audience. Beginning in the 1920s, talent by the *djelis* and the blues. The *koni* and *xalam* played scouts from recording companies searched the United by the *djelis* are the prototypes of the banjo that was States for blues performers to record, concentrating used as an accompanying instrument in the early first on female singers and by the mid-1920s on male

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 170

170———Broadside Press

singers. The blues are most often described in four Woods, Clyde. (1998). *Development Arrested: The Blues and general categories—the country blues, the classic blues, Plantation Power in the Mississippi Delta*. New York: piano blues, and the urban blues.

Verso Books. This is a relatively new look at the relationship of the blues to plantation life in Mississippi.

The country blues, or down-home blues, are associated primarily with regional styles, including the delta blues from the Mississippi Delta, the Carolina Piedmont blues from the Southeast, and the Texas **BROADSIDE PRESS**

blues. The performers were primarily solo male singers who were accompanied by guitar, banjo, or The Broadside Press was founded in Detroit, Michigan, harmonica. Performers of country blues—like Blind in 1965 and lasted until 1977, effectively encompassing Lemon Jefferson,

Huddie Ledbetter, Charlie Patton, the early phase of the Black Studies movement. The Brownie McGhee, Sonny Terry, and Son House—

objective of the press was to publish the writings, par-became known for their personal style and creativity.

ticularly the poetry, of new black writers. Founded with The blues performed by female singers accompa-only \$12 by celebrated African-American poet, librar-nied by piano or small instrumental ensembles, and ian, and publisher Dudley Felker Randall (1914–2000), with a more standardized musical formula, are catego-the Broadside Press was a medium for the publication rized as city blues or classic blues. Classic blues singers of poems and other writings of black writers, thus giv-were mostly from the Southern states and were well ing voice to an entire generation of African American versed in the songs sung by the country blues singers.

authors. It published books at affordable prices, as well Bessie Smith, Ma Rainey, Ida Cox, and Alberta Hunter as the individual poems printed on a single sheet of are among those referred to as classic blues singers.

paper that are known as broadsides. One such broad-Piano blues developed from the banjo and guitar side is “Ballad of Birmingham” (1969), a poem Randall accompaniments of the country blues, with the specific wrote on the 1963 bombing of a church in Birmingham, styles created known as barrelhouse, honky-tonk, and Alabama. He published it on a broadside sheet and boogie-woogie. Leading blues pianists included called it a Broadside Press publication to protect his Albert Ammons, Meaude Lux Lewis, Jimmy Young, copyright. Indeed, during the 12 year span of its exis-Clarence “Pine Top” Smith, and Jelly Roll Morton.

tence, the Broadside Press published 90 titles of poetry The urban blues, or electric blues, are typified by the and had 500,000 books in print, making it one of the big band accompaniment of electric guitars, amplified most prolific black commercial book publishing harmonicas, saxophones, drums, and piano. Features of companies in the United States.

earlier blues are maintained in these blues, although the Unfortunately, late in 1975 the firm experienced music is notated and arranged. This style is

expressed some financial problems, as a result of which it in the music of B. B. King, Muddy Waters, Howlin'

stopped publishing books. In 1977 Randall sold the Wolf, Bobby Blue Bland, and T-Bone Walker.

press to an Episcopal Church, the Alexander Crummell The blues have served as the basis for the early Memorial Center, to pay his debts. Even though development of jazz and greatly influenced American Randall had to sell the press, he still managed to hold popular music forms such as rhythm and blues, soul onto much of his vision, and he remained with the music, and rock-n-roll. The study of the blues is company as an editorial consultant.

important because the blues are a synthesis of ideolo-Although Broadside Press published books in gies and sensibilities that provide critical insight into various categories—literary criticism, plays, autobi-the African American psyche.

ographies, collective biographies, picture books, and story books—the primary objective of the company

— *Mawusi Renee Simmons*

was to publish black poetry, as Randall had contended **FURTHER READING**

from the beginning. Randall did not lock himself into any rigid ideology as manager of the Broadside Press, Barlow, William. (1989). *Looking Up at Down: The Emergence* but he did have certain proclivities. He wanted to pub-of Blues Culture. Philadelphia: Temple University Press.

lish poetry, and he did. Among the many books of This is one of the best books written on blues to date.

Keil, Charles. (1991). *Urban Blues*. Chicago: University of poetry published by Broadside Press were *Poem* Chicago Press. Keil is an original

student of the blues, and *Counterpoem* (1966) by Dudley Randall and Margaret this is his best book on the subject.

Danner; *Cities Burning* (1968) by Dudley Randall;

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 171

***Brown V. Board of Education of Topeka*———171**

Think Black (1967), *Black Pride* (1968), and *Don't United States*. Indeed, in this 1954 ruling, a unanimous *Cry, Scream* (1970) by Haki R. Madhubuti; *Black Supreme Court*, under chief Justice Earl Warren, *Judgement* (1968), *Black Feeling, Black Talk* (1970), struck down the “separate but equal” doctrine that had and *Re-Creation* (1970) by Nikki Giovanni; *We A* legalized segregation. The ruling provided hope that *BaddDDD People* (1970) by Sonia Sanchez; and *The discrimination against blacks was finally coming to Last Ride of Wild Bill* (1974) by Sterling Brown.

an end.

Other black authors whose works—adult nonfiction, This discrimination has a long history. After the juvenile nonfiction, and juvenile fiction—were pub-Civil War, Reconstruction substantially improved the lished by Broadside Press include, inter alia, James conditions of blacks, economically and politically, in Andrew Randall, Jr., John Clayton Randall, Gwendolyn the Southern states. For example, blacks served in leg-Elizabeth Brooks, Claude McKay, Countee Cullen, islatures of Southern states and even served as sena-Addison Gayle, Margaret Walker, Imamu Amiri Baraka, tors in the U.S. Congress. This progress, however, Langston Hughes, Frenchy Jolene Hodges, Mae quickly dissipated as the North abdicated responsibil-Jackson, Etheridge Knight, Gwendolyn Thompson, ity and the South reverted to conditions that in cases Habte Wolde, Audre Lorde, George Barlow, Henry were worse than the conditions blacks experienced Blakely, Juddy Simmons, Regina O' Neal, Lyn Levy, prior to the Civil War. During this period, the rise Leonead Pack Bailey, Arna Wendell Bontemps, and of the Ku Klux Klan and other white supremacist Nicolas Guillen. The press best represented the period societies, the withdrawal of federal troops from the of the black arts movement by

publishing the revolution-South, and legislation that disenfranchised and denied
tionary artists whose work often would not be published blacks access to
education and public facilities, all by the major American publishers.
Broadside Press created conditions of extreme terror for blacks in the
inspired young authors to write, contributing perhaps South. This
culminated in the *Plessy v. Ferguson* case more than any Black-owned and
Black-operated pub-in 1896, in which the Supreme Court established
lishing firm of its time to the literary development of the “separate but
equal” doctrine that upheld segrega-African American talents.

tion as long as the separate facilities available to the races were equal. For
all practical purposes, very

— *Thomas Houessou-Adin*

little attention was paid to the “equal” part of this ruling, while great
emphasis was placed on the “sep-FURTHER READING

arate” part.

Bailey, L. Pack. (Ed.). (1974) . *Broadside Authors and Artists: Beginning in*
the 1930s, several efforts were made *An Illustrated Biographical Directory*.
Detroit, MI: to chip away at the *Plessy* ruling, most of which were
Broadside Press. Bailey gives a good overview here of the attempts to force
states to provide equal facilities writers for Broadside Press.

to blacks. However, the legality or the morality of Josey, E. J., and
Shockley, Ann Allen (Eds.). (1977). *Handbook of Black Librarianship*.
Littleton, CO: Libraries Unlimited.

separation was never questioned. With the onset of This handbook is an
excellent source of materials on World War II, the challenge to legal
segregation began African American artists and poets.

to build momentum. Several executive orders by Joyce, Donald Franklin.
(1983). *Gatekeepers of Black Culture: President Franklin Delano Roosevelt*
and President *Black-owned Book Publishing in the United States*, Harry
Truman eliminated segregation in the armed 1817–1981. Westport, CT:

Greenwood Press. This is one forces and related agencies. The *Brown v. Board of Education* decision is considered the culmination of the black press.

these efforts.

Thurgood Marshall served as the principle lawyer of the NAACP (National Association for

BROWN V. BOARD

the Advancement of Colored People) defense fund that argued the case in front of the Supreme Court.

OF EDUCATION OF TOPEKA

Aided by notable lawyers such as James M. Nabrit, Jr., Robert Carter, Jack Greenberg, and William T.

Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka was an Coleman, Jr., and assisted by the pioneering research extremely important court ruling aimed at the disman-of psychologist Kenneth B. Clark, the Court asserted tling of legal segregation and discrimination in the that separate schools could not be equal because

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 172

172———**Bureau of Refugees, Freedmen, and Abandoned Lands** segregating children on the basis of race “generates a March 3, 1865, nearly a year before the end of the feeling of inferiority as to their status in the commu-Civil War. The bureau supervised all relief and educa-nity that may affect their hearts and minds in a way tional activities relating to refugees and freedmen, unlikely to ever be undone.”

including issuing rations, clothing, and medicine. The It is argued, however, that the *Brown* decision alone Freedmen’s Bureau also assumed custody of confis-had little impact on ending segregation, for it failed to cated lands or property in the former Confederate define what constitutes segregation and

to provide a states, border states, District of Columbia, and Indian timeline for dismantling it. Although the *Brown* decision is important and symbolic, the 1964 Civil Rights Act of the Johnson Administration, which barred discrimination in all schools and other institutions and reports on the programs and conditions through receiving federal funding, is believed to have played a part in the South.

more significant legal role in ending segregation.

When the Civil War started, the issue of what to do. However, since the 1964 Civil Rights Act, the with the African population in the South was upper-Supreme Court has meticulously worked to dismantle most in the minds of the Northerners who prosecuted the ideals espoused by the *Brown* decision. Beginning the war. The Africans were simply interested in freedom with the Nixon Administration and culminating in the 1960s. However, with the liberation of areas of the Reagan-Bush years, the conservative Rehnquist Court South, millions of African people became refugees. It has issued rulings meant to return to the era of *Plessy* was out of concern over what would become of these *v. Ferguson*— a ruling for which Rehnquist has expressed his deep support. Three key decisions stand with the situation in the South. The Freedmen's Bureau as important in the Supreme Court desegregation Bureau operated from 1865 to 1872, a mere 7 years, agenda: *Board of Education of Oklahoma City v.*

but it might be argued that it was in effect more informed by *Dowell*, *Freeman v. Pitts*, and *Missouri v. Jenkins*.

Initially from the beginning of the war, as the Union Army With these three decisions, the Supreme Court stated, Army had to do something about the Africans who in effect, that a school district could send students were liberated during the war.

back to de facto segregated neighborhood schools, Thus as soon as the Union Army defeated after the latter had obeyed their court orders for

deseg-Confederate forces in Virginia and Tennessee, escaped reintegration for several years.

and freed Africans came into the Union lines. Men, women, and children who were frightened, hungry,

— *Garvey F. Lundy*

and tired—a cadre of starving folk, homeless and often unhealthy—came into the camps of the Union **FURTHER READING**

soldiers to volunteer their services, to seek protection, and to serve as spies. Many white soldiers responded Kluger, Richard. (1976). *Simple Justice: The History of Brown v. Board of Education and Black America's Struggle for* to the pitiful condition of the refugees; some even *Equality*. New York: Alfred A. Knopf. Kluger's book is a started Freedmen's Aid societies and appealed to detailed chronology of the *Brown v. Board* decision.

philanthropists for relief. The American Missionary Orfield, Gary, and Eaton, Susan E. (1996). *Dismantling* Association, which had been active in the defense of *Desegregation: The Quiet Reversal of Brown v. Board of the* black rebels onboard the *Amistad*, sprung into Education. New York: New Press. This is a biting analysis action as well.

of how the courts have systematically dismantled the Soon the number of freed Africans and forfeited *Brown v. Board* decision.

estates was overwhelming, so the government sought to regulate the situation by proposing half-hearted measures overseen by the U.S. Treasury. The officials **BUREAU OF REFUGEES, FREEDMEN,**

of the Treasury were asked to take charge of the abandoned lands and sell them or lease them for 1-year **AND ABANDONED LANDS**

periods, as well as to provide for the welfare of the Africans who once served on those lands.

The Freedmen's Bureau, as it was often called, was Congress had passed a bill, by the thin majority of established in the U.S. War Department by an act of two, to establish a bureau for freedmen, but Senator

B-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:01 PM Page 173

Bureau of Refugees, Freedmen, and Abandoned Lands——173

Charles Sumner of New York argued that freedmen and alleviated a vast amount of pain and suffering, built abandoned lands belonged under the same department, some schools, opened some health facilities, taught and he therefore substituted a bill that attached it to the more than 100,000 people to read, and transferred Treasury in an attempt to strengthen the Treasury's many people back to farms where they could earn a influence in the matter. This bill passed the Senate but living.

was not taken up by the House. Finally, after several

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

months, a conference of the House and Senate came up with a compromise that made the new department independent of the Treasury and the war officials. This **FURTHER READING**

bill was defeated when it was put to the full Senate, and Asante, Molefi Kete, and Mattson, Mark. (1998). *African* a new bill was drawn, the Act of 1865, which passed, *American Atlas*. New York: Scribner. This work deals resulting in the Freedmen's Bureau. Although the importantly with the construction of African American bureau only existed until 1872, its influence lasted until history as a movement for freedom.

the Union Army left the South in 1877. This might be Bennett, Lerone. (1988). *Before the Mayflower*. New York: called the end of the Reconstruction era, which had Penguin. Bennett's book is one of the most popular histories every written. Its influence is significant in the lasted for a total of 12 years.

African American community.

The Freedmen's Bureau took charge of abandoned Franklin, John Hope, and Moss, Alfred, Jr. (1988). *From* lands and at one time held 800,000 acres. These *Slavery to Freedom* (6th ed.). New York: McGraw-Hill.

lands disappeared when Congress ended the appropri-This remains a classic work on the advancement of the ations for the bureau. The Freedmen's Bureau had African from an enslaved person to a free person.

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 175

C

capoeira Regional, purports to be modern and **CAPOEIRA**

innovative in that it incorporates elements from East Asian combat sports into the traditional movements.

Part of Brazilian folklore, capoeira is a battle dance, Fans of *capoeira Regional* believe that it was invented a martial art, and a national sport. In past decades, it in the Reconcavo plantations in North-Eastern Brazil.

has been taught in Brazilian schools, universities, and private health clubs. Today, it is popular all over the **CAPOEIRA'S ORIGIN**

globe, and interest in this fast-spreading battle dance has yielded a great number of historical, anthropolog-The origin of capoeira is still a principal subject of ical, and sociological studies that examine its various research and debate among scholars. Some trace its facets and manifestations.

origins from West Central African combat games, Capoeira includes a variety of components: musi-while others emphasize that it came about as a result cal instruments, dancing, and singing. Because it is of creolization.

also a social event conducted in a circle, it is some-The earliest written sources found on capoeira are times defined as a dance. But it also includes combat from the late 17th century, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. At maneuvers, jumping and kicking, which complies that time, studies and documents,

were written mainly more or less with the definition of a martial art. Those by whites and obviously reflect their outlook on life.

who participate are called capoeiras.

Some of them viewed Africa as a backward continent, deprived of the developed European cultures. These attitudes—together with the needs of plantation own-TWO STYLES OF CAPOEIRA

ers—translated into policies designed to prevent and There are two major known capoeira styles today. The annihilate any black cultural expression, including first, *capoeira Angola*, purports, as its name indicates, capoeira.

to preserve the pure, authentic dance brought from From the white authorities' standpoint, capoeira Angola by enslaved Africans who practiced a rite of had two aspects, both odious. On one hand, it was a passage called “*Zebra Dance*,” the *N’golo*, in which game played by enslaved Africans, and that game the winner would get to marry his chosen bride with-might become aggressive and dangerous. On the other out having to pay her dowry. The Angoleiros (those hand, it was a means capoeiras used to undermine the who practice *capoeira Angola*) believe that, due to the public peace and threaten the lives of peaceful citi-circumstances of Brazilian slavery, the ritualistic zens. In either case, capoeiras were severely punished aspect of N’golo was lost while the combative ele-when caught.

ments gained prominence. Thus, *capoeira* emerged In the early 1800s, authorities and tourists as a means of resistance and survival. The second, described capoeira “as slaves’ plays,” “dances,” and 175

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 176

176———**Capoeira**

“battles.” The inconsistency in definitions was the **Changing Attitudes**

result of their attempt to define an activity that was In the 1870s, there was a noticeable growth in the irreconcilable with their experience. Dancing does not amount of capoeiras’ activities and an improvement in go hand in

hand with boxing—at least from the white their social status, followed by a change in the attitude man's point of view. Moreover, the movements of of the authorities toward them. In this period, capoeira presented a specific kind of a martial art—

capoeiras began to team up into two major groups: without the physical contact—thereby lending the air the Nagoas and the Goaiamus. They competed against of a game to the entire activity. The confusing defini-each other to gain supremacy over the various city tions stem from the significant differences between regions. Historians have characterized this rivalry as a the life experiences of the various cultures.

struggle for control over the urban space and a political conflict between social classes.

Social Expression

The major capoeira characteristic in the third quar-For the African enslaved in the early 1800s in ter of the 19th century, at least from the authorities'

Brazil, capoeira was a social expression that inher-perspective, was their entrance into the field of poli-ently incorporated all the basic elements of African tics. The other characteristics—well-organized and dances: the circle, the dance, the music, and the spec-loyal groups, physical skills, the use of arms, the per-tators, as well as rituals, symbols, and other compo-petration of heinous acts of violence, disturbances nents that served the capoeiras in the course of the of the peace, and rioting—instilled fear in the public.

activity. As with many other activities, it contained Politicians, well aware of the power of the capoeira elements that combined the sacred and the secular; gangs, of their command of the streets, and of their hence the gods or the dead or both were active partic-intimidating effect on the citizens, took advantage ipants in the event. It was necessary to appease them; of this power to further their personal political aspira-there were ways to secure their help; and there were tions. As bodyguards, capoeiras wielded their influ-customs, various garments, accessories, gestures, ence, especially

during elections. They guarded the songs, and sounds that assured the desired results.

polls and encouraged or deterred the voters, depending There are reports about capoeiras who participated in on their connections with their patrons. Opponents public festivals and mass celebrations, dancing, leap-were beaten up savagely, whereas supporters were ing, and hopping in front of military parades and reli-provided with armed escorts as they made their way to gious processions, supposedly disturbing the peace the polling stations.

and exhibiting the kind of behavior expected of them.

The records report that they used amulets and partici-The Fall of the Monarchy

pated in rituals that were supposed to protect their bodies against injuries. They put on special acces-Once the Brazilian monarchy fell on November 15, sories and played music to connect with arcane worlds 1889, the Republicans retaliated against the capoeiras and with their gods and forefathers to secure their they detested by launching a relentless war. The leader protection against evil spirits.

of this unyielding campaign was Police Commissioner While the authorities tried to label them as danger-João Batista Sampaio Ferraz, a sworn Republican, ous and violent hoodlums, the people admired who was determined to root out violence and crime capoeiras and their deeds. The lower classes, which from the city and considered the capoeiras his main mainly consisted of blacks, held on to their ancient target. Capoeira was no longer only a black perfor-traditions, gods, ceremonies, and symbols. Yet, with mance but had become an activity in which various the changing reality, they did not remain isolated and other people engaged, including many mulattos and segregated. Various influences infiltrated the patterns whites, most of whom had definite occupations and of their customs and rituals. Their direct connection to a regular income. Still, because they participated in their countries of origin was cut off when the transat-capoeira, these people were stigmatized as drifters and lantic slave trade

was stopped in 1850, and the tradidlers whose source of livelihood was theft, extortion, tions that were transmitted from generation to and murder.

generation depended on memory and on oral teach-The policy of suppression eventually expressed ings, which were influenced by external factors.

itself in the penal code signed October 11, 1890 that

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 177

Capoeira——177

outlawed capoeira. Capoeira groups lost their power creating *capoeira Regional*, the most famous and and political influence and dismantled. But as numer-popular style today. From a spontaneous street and ous records of their arrests in the last decade of the beach activity, from public celebrations and proces-19th century and the early 20th century prove, the sions, capoeira turned into a sport, a martial art, pre-phenomenon did not vanish altogether.

sented as superior to all others. Bimba's greatness lies in his realization that capoeira must be institutionalized, severed from its "playful" context as a pastime, **The Mestico**

and ushered in as an integral part of physical education In the 1930s, researchers led by Gilberto Freyre and self-defense. Bimba did it by adding elements began stressing the beneficial influence of the African from other martial arts—especially from the Far East, and Indian cultures on the creation of Brazilian such as karate, judo, and jujitsu—and by introducing society. There began an intensive preoccupation with its systematic and consistent teaching into the syllabus the creation of a national Brazilian identity with an of special schools.

emphasis on homogeneity. The new mixed identity was called *mestico*. Getulio Vargas's "Estado Novo"

Vicente Ferreira Pastinha (Mestre Pastinha) (new state) Policy in 1937-1945 advocated the image of Brazilian unity where whites, blacks, mulattos, Many capoeiras, led by Vicente Ferreira Pastinha mesticos, and others live in harmony and with no (Mestre Pastinha), who wished to preserve the spirit racial strife. Capoeira, like other popular manifesta-of what he considered the “pure” capoeira, demon-tions such as samba, carnival, and African-Brazilian stratively refused to accept the regimentation of religions, gained legitimacy as part of the national Mestre Bimba’s version. Their style, which they identity and increased in stature. Because sports were claimed represented the real capoeira brought over also encouraged, capoeira was recognized as the from Angola, presumed to keep alive the values, Brazilian martial art, as the national sport, and as a movements, rituals, and esthetic language prevalent in Brazilian product worthy of the public’s admiration.

African cultures.

Destigmatizing Capoeira

CAPOEIRA TODAY

To cleanse the capoeira of the negative connota-As Brazil’s military regime weakened in the early tions associated with it, it became necessary to refash-1980s and as a result of similar processes taking place ion and show capoeira in a new light. The Rio de in the United States, radical social changes revived Janeiro version of capoeira stood for everything the interest in the traditions, customs, and values of authorities rejected and abhorred, so the first action African cultures. Brazilians returned to the “sources”

was to sever ties with this version. “The negative” Rio and attempted to connect once again with the tradi-de Janeiro brand of capoeira was totally ignored, and tions of the “motherland.” Protest groups demon-all eyes turned to the second capoeira center, to Bahia, strated against the government, claiming that the which henceforth became the symbol of Brazilian hitherto pursued policy of encouraging the recogni-authenticity, the pure source of social and cultural tion of a uniform Brazilian identity and image embod-expressions.

ied in a common national type was meant to conceal Engraved in the collective memory are two great the deep chasm between whites and blacks and teachers of capoeira from Bahia: Mestre Bimba and between rich and poor, thereby perpetuating veiled Mestre Pastinha, who respectively started the two and camouflaged discrimination and racism. New prevailing capoeira styles, *capoeira Regional* and groups of capoeira Angola were founded, stressing *capoeira Angola*.

more than ever the African elements. These processes rekindled the embers of interest in this almost-defunct version, and new students enrolled in these schools *Manoel dos Reis Machado (Mestre Bimba)* first in Brazil and later in the United States and The most significant turnabout in capoeira was Europe.

introduced by Manoel dos Reis Machado, known as Some scholars as well as *capoeiras* believe that, Mestre Bimba, who made capoeira a profession by nowadays, there is a new type of *capoeira* called

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 178

178———**Caribbean**

capoeira atual (actual *capoeira*) created by Bimba's **PEOPLE OF THE CARIBBEAN**

students who felt the loss of African traditions known **Indigenous People**

in *capoeira Angola*. These students tried to combine the traditions and adapt them to our times. When Until the end of the fifteenth century, three differ-people adopt what they like from the two capoeira ent people lived in the Caribbean: the Ciboneys, the styles, they create countless hybrids, depending Taino Arawaks, and the Karibs. It is to the latter that mostly on the masters' predilections. In Brazil, the the region owes its name. Estimates concerning the further invention of new styles, such as *capurate* size of the original population vary from 300,000 to (capoeira with karate) or *capugitso* (capoeira and jio 6,000,000. The Arawaks were located primarily in the jitso), points to an intricate process in constant flux, Greater Antilles, the Bahamas, and some of the Lesser the encounter, collision, and fusion of

different cultures, traditions, world outlooks, values, and customs, Antilles; the Ciboney had settled in the western part all of which find their expression in contemporary of Cuba and Haiti. The word *Antilles* itself derives from Capoeira.

from “Antillia,” the name of an imaginary island that started appearing on maps as early as 1424.

— *Maya Talmon-Chvaicer*

See also Creolization **The Arrival of Europeans**

FURTHER READING

The first Europeans, led by Christopher Columbus, set foot in the Caribbean on October 12, 1492, in the Desch-Obi, T. J. (2000). *Engolo: Combat Traditions in African Bahamas*, on the island of Guanahani, known today as *and African Diaspora History*. Unpublished doctoral dissertation, University of California, Los Angeles. Desch-San Salvador. Columbus was then searching for a new Obi analyzes Capoeira’s African cultural roots.

route to Asia and incorrectly believed that he had Downey, Gregory John. (1998). *Incorporating Capoeira*: reached its western shores. This mistake led him to *Phenomenology of a Movement Discipline*. Unpublished call the Caribbean islands the “West Indies,” a name doctoral dissertation, University of Chicago. This work that is still commonly used. Columbus’s first voyage takes a look at relatively recent developments in was followed by many, and each time he stumbled Capoeira.

upon an island, he claimed it as a Spanish possession Lowell, Lewis. (1992). *Ring of Liberation: Deceptive* and renamed it accordingly. Thus, original indigenous *Discourse in Brazilian Capoeira*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press. In this book, Lowell reviews the history of names were replaced by Europeans ones, such as the attitudes toward Capoeira.

Karukera losing its Karib name of “the island with beautiful waters” to become Guadeloupe and Ayiti becoming Hispaniola (literally, “Little Spain”).

The arrival of the Europeans in the Caribbean **CARIBBEAN**

opened an era of great physical and social violence. It was particularly disastrous for the indigenous people, Traditionally, the term *Caribbean* refers to the thou-and almost all of them disappeared in a short period of sands of islands that run parallel to Central and South time. The reasons for their elimination are multiple America, stretching almost 2,500 miles. The term, and range from warfare, European diseases, slavery however, also often includes Belize in Central and overwork to brutal murder and unspeakable cruel-America, as well as Guyana, Suriname, and Guyane ties. The Karibs in particular put up a fierce resistance on the South American mainland. The Caribbean against European assaults, and this caused them to be islands are further divided into three major groups: described by Eurocentric historians as “warlike” and the Bahamas archipelago, made up of 700 islands dangerous, with some even tracing the root of the and 2,000 rocks; the Greater Antilles (that is, the four word *cannibal* to their name, Karib. Of course, the larger islands of Cuba, Hispaniola, Puerto Rico, and Karibs were simply and quite naturally defending Jamaica; as well as the Caiman Islands); and, finally, themselves. Many, less biased, historians recognize the Lesser Antilles, which run from the Virgin Islands that the extermination of these indigenous people rep-in the north to Aruba in the south, off the coast of resents one of the largest genocides of modern history.

Venezuela.

Today, only in Dominica has a small community of

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 179

Caribbean———179

Karibs managed to survive on a reservation where such as tobacco. This predilection for sugar cane was they weave baskets for tourist consumption.

pervasive, and it is generally admitted that, in the sev-The Spanish claim over the Caribbean was quickly enteenth century, the Caribbean underwent what is challenged by other Europeans, in particular the known as the Sugar

Revolution, with sugar being held French, British, and Dutch, each one wanting to seize as “King.” The cultivation of sugar cane requires large Caribbean land. As early as 1538, Spanish ships had areas, as well as an important labor force, and this led to travel under protection due to the constant attacks to the massive introduction of enslaved Africans in the Caribbean launched by other Europeans. In 1621, a war broke out between the Dutch and the Spanish, which the white indentured servants for whom there were no latter lost. The Dutch victory led to the creation of more plots available. The result was a drastic alter-the Dutch West India Company that same year, and a change of the Caribbean’s demographics and racial between 1630 and 1640, the Dutch claimed Curaçao, structure, with the Africans often making up over 90%

St. Eustatius, St. Martin, and Saba. The Spanish defeat of the total population.

also facilitated French and British incursions and Most Caribbean people today are descended from settlements in the Caribbean, and by the end of the those Africans who were brought primarily from West seventeenth century, both European countries had suc-Africa in the dreadful and fetid holds of slave ships.

ceeded in firmly entrenching themselves in the region: The Caribbean, as a whole, received over 50% of the the British had seized Barbados in 1627, Nevis in Africans taken out of Africa during the European 1628, Antigua and Montserrat in 1632, St. Lucia slave trade. This represented, by all accounts, the in 1638, Jamaica in 1655, and the Cayman Islands in largest forced migration in history. Unsurprisingly, the 1670, while the French had occupied Guadeloupe and increase in the African population closely paralleled Martinique in 1635 and the western part of Hispaniola the increase in sugar production. For example, in (now Haiti) in 1665. In 1671, Denmark claimed the Jamaica, the sugar production was 4,782 tons in 1703, Virgin Islands. European conflicts over the control of with an enslaved African population of 45,000. In the Caribbean were constant, and it was not uncom-1754, Jamaica’s sugar production had jumped to mon for a given island to change hands in a short 23,396 tons, obviously produced

by 130,000 enslaved amount of time. Thus, Dominica, for example, Africans.

changed European hands no less than 17 times.

Life as an enslaved African was horrific. The The first years of the European occupation were mortality rate was extremely high due to overwork, a period of social experimentation, with rather small depression, disease, malnutrition, and mental and production units devoted to several crops such as physical torture. On the other hand, the natural repro-cotton, coffee, and more particularly tobacco. In addition rate was low, thus causing the constant arrival tion, parallel to the vanishing of the indigenous people of new captives from Africa to replenish the labor was the introduction of small numbers of Africans, as force of European-owned plantations. From a social well as of Europeans. The former were introduced in standpoint, plantation societies were divided along the Caribbean as early as 1493, primarily to help the caste lines. Each caste had its own subdivisions.

Spanish approach the Karibs; while the latter came as Generally speaking, there were two major castes: the indentured servants. These were socially disenfranchised white caste and the caste of the enslaved Africans.

chised Europeans, some of them even criminals and With the passage of time, a third significant caste prostitutes, in search of a better life. At the end of their emerged: free people of color, made up of black and indentured service, they often received a plot of land, mulatto free individuals. Over all, one's race and color which they could cultivate, that is, if they were still determined rather rigidly one's social rank, with alive or around. Indeed, many died or chose to return darker Africans at the bottom of the social hierarchy, home, due to difficult life conditions.

and whites at its top.

Conscripted Africans

RESISTANCE TO SLAVERY

Starting in the 1660s, however, the cultivation of Resistance to slavery and white supremacy was a con-sugar cane began dominating the Caribbean landscape stant feature of Caribbean societies otherwise ruled when cane proved more profitable than other plants by terror. In fact, resistance was as old as slavery

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 180

180———Caribbean

itself. It took several forms, such as revolts, maroon had been abolished, for the most part, the *haves* communities, poisoning cattle, breaking up equip-remained the whites and the *have-nots*, black. Many ment, abortions, and slow work. Although maroon Africans engaged in small subsistence farming. With communities existed everywhere that slavery pre-few Africans choosing to continue working on sugar vailed, those in Jamaica and Surinam remained the plantations, the white colonists relied on indentured most famous in the Caribbean. On the other hand, it is servants from many parts of the world, especially Asia in Haiti that the most successful revolt took place and including Africa, to replace their lost labor force.

between 1791 and 1803. It eventually ended with This marked the beginning of the Indian and, to a enslaved Africans' victory over French colonists who lesser degree, Chinese migration to the Caribbean in were backed by the most powerful army at the time, the second half of the nineteenth century. Between that of Napoleon Bonaparte. Haiti became the first 1838 and 1917, it is estimated that nearly half a mil-black republic in 1804.

lion Indians settled in the Caribbean, with Guyana and The African victory in Haiti, then the wealthiest Trinidad being the two major destinations followed by Caribbean colony, dealt a serious blow to slavery in Guadeloupe and Surinam. Thanks to Asian labor, the the Caribbean, as well as elsewhere, raising serious sugar industry managed to survive. After 1850, how-doubts about the viability and future of plantation ever, the Caribbean sugar industry declined steadily societies. Inspired and ignited by the Haitian example, and has become quite limited on many islands today.

Africans everywhere in the Caribbean became. In the meantime, except in Haiti, the African masses increasingly and openly adamant about instant free-remained excluded from meaningful political participation. In addition, developments in Europe, in particular in their new societies well up to the middle of the 19th century, a growing industrialization, made labor-intensive the 20th century. This was to change to a certain industries increasingly obsolete.

degree, however, with the achievement of political There was also in Europe a growing anti-slavery independence or autonomy in many Caribbean movement. Slave trade was banned in 1808 by the countries.

British and in 1814 by the French. A few decades later came the abolition of slavery itself: in 1834 in British **THE EMERGENCE OF**

colonies, in 1848 in French and Danish colonies, in **THE CARIBBEAN NATIONS**

1863 in Dutch colonies, in 1873 in Puerto Rico, and, at last, in 1886 in Cuba. The abolition of slavery in It was in the 1960s that most Caribbean nations Cuba marked the end of legal slavery in the region.

emerged, for the most part without much bloodshed.

Caribbean countries, however, remained colonial As far as British colonies are concerned, Jamaica and properties of Europe. In addition to the traditional Trinidad gained independence in 1962, Barbados and European colonial powers, the end of the 19th century Guyana in 1966, the Bahamas in 1973, Grenada in marked the beginning of a visible U.S. imperialistic 1974, Dominica in 1978, St. Lucia and St. Vincent presence in the Caribbean. Invoking the Monroe in 1979, Antigua-Barbuda in 1981, and St. Kitts-Nevis Doctrine and Manifest Destiny, the U.S. gained con-in 1983. We must note, however, that many of these four major islands of the Greater Antilles, countries still recognized the queen of England as namely Haiti, Cuba, Puerto Rico, and the Dominican their titular head of state. For Puerto Rico, Cuba, and Republic. This was done through wars, military inter-the Virgin Islands, the situation was different. Cuba, ventions, and occupations, as well as the imposition through a socialist revolution led by

Fidel Castro, of dictators, such as Batista in Cuba or Trujillo in Haiti, broke away from international capitalism and succeeded the Dominican Republic. The United States also successfully put an end to U.S. rule. Puerto Rico became a free state in 1952, while the Virgin Islands from Denmark in an associated free state in 1952, while the Virgin Islands in 1917 for \$25 million.

Islands remained under complete American tutelage.

At the abolition of slavery, payments and reparations. Similarly, France turned its colonies of Guadeloupe and Martinique into “overseas departments” in 1946, who had toiled for free for hundreds of years but to the making them an administrative and geographical colonies, whom, it was felt at the time, had lost value-extension of France.

able property and commerce opportunities. To the While changes in political status may have engaged Africans, nothing was granted. And although slavery derived a new vision and a sense of hope for a brighter

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 181

Caribbean——181

future, as well as facilitating the emergence of a black 26% of the region's GDP and employment to about middle class, it is nonetheless fair to say that, for the 400,000 people. It is the only industry that has shown most part, Caribbean nations still find themselves steady growth over the past 30 years. Because it is economically controlled by outside forces. This is due largely foreign-controlled and owned, however, in part to the fact that, shortly after independence, tourism has a limited impact on local economies. On Caribbean nations had to face a difficult set of economic circumstances, such as rising interest rates, significant environmental degradation, as well as cultural sinking prices for exports, shrinking markets, increasing and psychological damage. It also suffers from serious rising costs of oil and other imports—all of which fluctuations in visitor volume and spending. Offshore precluded sustained industrialization and led to quasi-financial services represent a significant sector in endemic trade deficits, increased unemployment, debt,

Caribbean countries, in particular, Antigua and Barbuda and poverty. The external debt (primarily to the Barbuda, Barbados, and the Bahamas. In recent years, IMF, World Bank, and Inter-American Development Bank), for example, increased by 100% between 1981

fact, footwear, sewn leather products, apparel, and and 1991. Servicing the debt is taking a serious toll textiles represent nearly half of all U.S. imports from on Caribbean economies and people. In the 1980s, the region.

countries like Guyana and Jamaica spent nearly 50%

of their revenues on foreign debt service payments.

Thus, while life expectancy and literacy have generally **A UNITED CARIBBEAN**

improved, poverty and suffering are widespread due to **The Caribbean Community and Common Market** structural adjustment reforms. Unemployment rates of from 15% to 25% are common.

In the face of a common legacy of slavery, colonialism, and shared culture, and a present of economic difficulties, the Caribbean countries attempted to unite.

Economy

The Caribbean Community and Common Market It is largely bleak economic prospects that have (CARICOM) came into existence on July 4, 1973 and led large numbers of Caribbean people to leave into effect on August 1, 1973. It was signed by the their native land in search of greater opportunities, prime ministers of Barbados, Guyana, Jamaica, primarily in Europe, the United States, and Canada, Trinidad, and Tobago at Chaguaramas, Trinidad. Some contributing to the emergence of a sizable African-of the goals of CARICOM were to improve standards Caribbean diaspora. The largest migration wave to the of living and work, facilitate full employment, and United States began in 1966, with the passage in 1965

expand trade and economic relations with third states.

of the McCarran-Walter Act that eliminated the previously established national quota system. Since then, **Caribbean Free Trade Association**

thousands of Caribbean men and women have made the United States their home, in particular New York. Another effort at unity is the Caribbean Free Trade Association (CARIFTA). CARIFTA came into existence as a result of the signing of the Treaty of Montserrat in July, 1965 by Antigua, Barbados, and Guyana, and often supporting Caribbean economies through capital Guyana. Additional countries joined CARIFTA, and, inflows.

eventually, CARIFTA countries Belize, Dominica, Grenada, St. Lucia, St. Vincent and the Grenadines, and Guyana have been able to rely on some earnings from oil and/or mining (primarily bauxite), for most Suriname in 1995 and Haiti in 1997.

Caribbean countries, tourism, bananas, and sugar are their major foreign-exchange earners. Nonetheless, **The Caribbean Basin Initiative**

due to high costs of production, bananas and sugar depend on preferential marketing arrangements. Unfortunately, instead of fostering significant intra-Caribbean cooperation, Caribbean leaders increased their reliance—and thus, dependency—on the

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 182

182———**Charles L. Blockson Afro-American Collection** European Union and the United States, as well as their corporations, as their major commercial partners. This **CHARLES L. BLOCKSON**

dependency became further entrenched and institutionalized—AFRO-AMERICAN COLLECTION

tionalized with the Caribbean Basin Initiative (CBI) developed under the Reagan administration in 1984.

The Charles L. Blockson Afro-American Collection is Its purpose was to provide tariff exemptions or reduce a unique repository of major and minor documents from 24 participating representing African and African American history countries in Central America and the Caribbean. In and culture. The collection was founded by Charles L.

In addition to its great economic influence, the U.S. has Blockson, who began collecting African books when increased its military presence in the Caribbean with he was 14 years old. After his teacher told him that several military bases, the two largest ones being in history showed there was only a handful of notable Puerto Rico. The U.S. penetration into the Caribbean, black Americans, young Blockson decided to prove however, has also been cultural, with American television wrong. He began to gather books about people of African descent and their history by going to thrift stores, thus disrupting further the local way of life.

shops, used book stores, and church bazaars, as well as the Salvation Army and Goodwill stores; Blockson **THE CARIBBEAN TODAY**

found that “even trash cans in alleyways” would occasionally have treasures.

Despite this, the Caribbean remains culturally fertile. Collecting books and artifacts that document and creative. It continues, for example, to produce African American culture and history became important musical genres—reggae, calypso, ska, zouk.

Blockson’s lifelong passion. In 1984, he donated his On the intellectual and ideological front, the Caribbean collection of over 20,000 books and documents to has had the distinction of making a major contribution Temple University in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania to Pan-Africanism and Black Nationalism, with native to form the Charles L. Blockson Afro-American Collection. Today the Blockson Collection contains Padmore, Frantz Fanon, Kwame

Ture (a.k.a. Stokely over 100,000 books, journals, pamphlets, manu- Carmichael), and Eric Williams. The Caribbean has scripts, photographs and prints, drawings, sheet also produced important literary figures such as Aimé music, broadsides, posters, and artifacts. In addition, Césaire, V. S. Naipaul, and George Lamming, to information contained in brochures, flyers, newspa-mention only a few.

pers and magazine clippings, and ephemera is avail-

— *Ama Mazama*

able in the Collection's Vertical Files. A catalogue of the Blockson Collection was published in 1990.

See also Maroon Societies, the Haitian Revolution The Blockson Collection covers all phases of Afro-Americana from 1600 to present, including

FURTHER READING

materials on black people of countries other than the United States. Among the numerous resources in the Barry, Tom, Wood, Beth, and Preusch, Deb. (1984). *The Other Collection* are the following groups of materials: *Side of Paradise: Foreign Control in the Caribbean*.

New York: Grove Press. This is a very insightful study of U.S. and European imperialism in the Caribbean.

The Slave Narrative Collection. Included here are Bryan, Anthony (Ed.). (1995). *The Caribbean: New Dynamics* narratives of black former slaves such as Olaudah in *Trade and Political Economy*. New Brunswick, NJ: Equiano, Ignatius Sancho, Prince Lee Boo, Sojourner Transaction. This is a useful survey of the major contem-Truth, and Frederick Douglass.

porary economic and political challenges facing Caribbean countries.

James, C. L. R. (1963). *The Black Jacobins*. New York: *The Photographs and Prints Collection*. Features Vintage Books. This book is the classic study of African images of African American Civil rights leaders, resistance in the Caribbean during slavery.

gious leaders, artists, entertainers, educators, and Knight, Franklin. (1990). *The Caribbean: The Genesis of a Fragmented Nationalism*. New York: Oxford University Press. Knight's book remains the most comprehensive and history. The John W. Mosley Photograph Collection, authoritative source on Caribbean history.

which provides images of notable black entertainers,

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 183

Cheikh Anta Diop International Conference———183

the old Negro League players, social and political One of Blockson's many achievements is that, in personalities, and the general black social and cultural 1989, he initiated and launched The Philadelphia life in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, is a distinctive part African-American State Historical Marker Project.

of the photographs and prints collection.

Sixty-five markers were built and installed honoring the contributions of African Americans to the city of *The Paul Robeson Collection*. Contains concert clip-Philadelphia. He also published a guide book to accompnings, recitals, performance programs, photographs, pany this project, *Philadelphia's Guide: African-posters, and sheet music pertaining to Robeson's life American State Historical Markers*.

and career.

The Blockson Collection attracts visitors from throughout the world. It is located in Sullivan Hall on Sheet Music Collection. Represents popular music, the main campus of Temple University in Philadelphia.

jazz, and folk music.

— Aslaku Berhanu

*Other important research materials in the Blockson Collection are letters, papers, correspondence, and **FURTHER READING***

memorabilia. Outstanding among these are related to Basbanes,

Nicholas A. (1995). A Gentle Madness: Bishop Richard R. Wright, William Still, Frederick Bibliophiles, Bibliomanes, and the Eternal Passion for Douglass, Langston Hughes, and James Baldwin. Of Books. New York: Henry Holt. This is an excellent book on special significance are Haitian presidential papers the passion of bibliophiles.

from Henri Christophe to the Duvaliers.

Blockson, Charles L. (Ed.). (1990). Catalogue of the Charles L.

Among the treasured items at the Blockson Blockson Afro-American collection, a Unit of the Temple Collection are many rare and out-of-print books.

University Libraries. Philadelphia: Temple University Some of these volumes include Corippus Africani Press. This is the authoritative catalogue for the Blockson Grammaticus, a description of Africa (1581); collection.

Blockson, Charles L. (1998). "Damn Rare": The Memoirs of Anthology of the Poems of Phillis Wheatley (1773); an African-American Bibliophile. Tracy, CA: Quantum Confessions of Nat Turner, describing his role in the Leap. Blockson traces his interest in African and African 1831 slave uprising; The Bible in Defense of Slavery, American books from his earliest period.

*an 1851 publication that uses biblical passages to justify slavery; and a novel, Clotel; or, the President's Daughter (1853). The Collection also offers readers first editions of works by George Washington **CHEIKH ANTA DIOP***

Williams, Frances Ellen Watkins Harper, Paul Lawrence Dunbar, W.E.B. Du Bois, Carter G.

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE

Woodson, and others.

The Blockson Collection is unique in that it is The Cheikh Anta Diop International Conference was directly run and supervised by the dedicated historian initiated by Molefi Kete Asante to coincide with the and bibliophile Charles L. Blockson. Peter J.

introduction of the first doctoral program in African Liacouras, former president of Temple University, American Studies at Temple University. The confer-said, "The most important element in the Charles ence was called in October, 1988, and featured many Blockson Collection is Charles Blockson himself."

of the new students who had enrolled in the Blockson's work has been published in numerous Department of African American Studies at Temple.

journals and anthologies, and his ten books include The Cheikh Anta Diop Conference had three objec-his autobiography, "Damn Rare": the memoirs of an tives: (1) introduction of the new discipline, (2) pro-African-American bibliophile; African Americans in fessional and collegial networking among students Pennsylvania Above Ground and Underground; and faculty in Black Studies, and (3) advancement of Hippocrene Guide to the Underground Railroad; disciplinary knowledge around the Afrocentric idea.

Black Genealogy; and Pennsylvania's Black History.

Named for the brilliant Senegalese scholar, Cheikh He is also the author of a cover story on the Anta Diop, who single-handedly revised the text on Underground Railroad that appeared in the July 1984

African antiquity by writing several books exposing issue of the *National Geographic Magazine*.

the methods Europeans had employed to falsify



C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 184

and Australia. A committee evaluates papers presented in abstract form and selects the best ones for presentation at the conference. Because it is always the intention of the conference to have the papers published, papers selected for the conference must be written out in full.

By 2004 there had been sixteen conferences, all held in Philadelphia. The Cheikh Anta Diop International Conference was affiliated with Temple University until 1996, when it became affiliated with the Association for Kemetic Nubian Heritage (ANKH).

ANKH underwrites the conference and is responsible for the organization, personnel, and programming.

The papers are usually published in full form in the *Journal of Black Studies* or as abstracts by ANKH.

Considered by professionals in the field of Black Studies as one of the key conferences each year, the Cheikh Anta Diop International Conference has achieved the singular status of most preferred professional conference in African American Studies.

— Garvey F. Lundy

FURTHER READING

Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1974). *The African Origin of Civilization* (Mercer Cook, Trans.). Westport, CT: Lawrence Hill. In this book, which is perhaps the most popular work in English by the great Senegalese scholar, Diop takes on the European historians and Egyptologists over the race of the ancient Egyptians.

Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1978). *The Cultural Unity of Black Africa*. Chicago: Third World Press. Here Diop discusses *Dr. Doreen Loury and Dr. Segun Shabaka, recipients of doctoral* the cultural unity of African people and the relationship *degrees in African American Studies, discussing the future of* of culture, environment, and politics.

Black Studies at the conference

Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1991). *Civilization or Barbarism: An Authentic Anthropology* (H. J. Salemson and M. de Jager, Eds., Yaa-Lengi Meema Ngemi, Trans.). Westport, CT: African history, the conference assumed a leadership Lawrence Hill. This is a profound study of the nature of role in the projection of Afrocentric consciousness.

civilization, its origin in Africa, and its development From the beginning, the CAD Conference was defined throughout history.

as an instrument where space for intellectual growth could be created and sustained in an environment of free discourse. Diop had been the inspiration for the conference because, in his two important works trans-
CHRISTIANITY

lated into English— *The African Origin of Civilization* and *Civilization or Barbarism*—he had demonstrated Christianity is a set of religious beliefs anchored by the advantages of sound scholarship over shoddy a belief in the existence of Jesus Christ, whom work. His research methods were multidimensional Christians accept as Lord and Savior. Christianity and his expertise was sharp, always projecting a mea-originally developed from Judaism. Jesus Christ was a sure of African intellectual integrity in pursuit of truth.

Jew who lived from about 3 BC to 30 AD. He lived The conference has attracted participants from and taught in Palestine, primarily (although not exclu-Africa, Asia, North America, South America, Europe, sively) among fellow Jews. Christianity separated

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 185

Class and Caste———185

from Judaism when followers came to regard Jesus as Although Christianity has had many reforms in an the son of God and as God's presence in human form.

effort to transform the nature of the religion's history, While it is true that Christianity has its own values it remains central to many African people.

and beliefs, it shares a number of beliefs and practices

— *Cynthia Lehman*

with other religions, particularly Judaism and Islam.

For example, all these religions believe in one Creator

See also European Slave Trade God. They also believe that God is active in the personal lives of individuals, and that God teaches people.

FURTHER READING

African people first encountered Christianity during the European Slave Trade. The first Christians that Cleage, Albert. (1969). *The Black Messiah*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is one of the first books to deal came to Africa during the period of enslavement were with black power Christianity.

Catholics who had been led to believe that the whole Hilliard, Asa G. (1998). *SBA: The Reawakening of the African* world belonged to them. Although there had been *Mind*. Gainesville, FL: Makare. This book provides critical African Christians in earlier centuries, particularly insight into the moral and ethical position of education.

in Egypt, Ethiopia, and Sudan, it was not until the Karenga, Maulana. (2004). *Maat: The Moral Ideal in Ancient* 15th century when Portuguese explorers encountered *Egypt*. New York: Routledge. This is a major study of the Africans on the west coast of the continent that role of classical African ethics in the ancient world.

Africans felt the negative aspects of the Christian doctrine. The Portuguese kidnapped Africans and took them to Lisbon, where they were held against their wills and made to serve the king of Portugal. This **CLASS AND CASTE**

opened the road to the European Slave Trade and the dehumanization of African people.

A *class* is a group that is ranked according to its place. This action is often said to be against the Christian in a social hierarchy based on inequality in terms of doctrine, but the character of Christianity then and wealth, education, and/or income. A *caste* is a more now has remained essentially the same. Christians rigid form of social stratification whereby a member argue for three aspects to their religion, which they of a particular caste, as determined by birth and social base on the experiences and teachings of Jesus of mobility, has a fixed ethnicity and is rigidly confined Nazareth, who is also known as Jesus Christ or simply to the status of the group. The intersection of class the Christ. First, Christians accept the idea that human and caste as it relates to the global black experience beings have sinned against God and, second, are has led to a provocative debate. To explain the social therefore in need of salvation. Third, they practice an stratification in the “New World” experience of exclusionary form of salvific religion where only the blacks, some scholars offer mainly a Marxist account Christians shall be saved.

that incorporates race into the paradigm. Other writ-Christianity is also a world system. It was first ers recognize that class and caste are an integral introduced into Africa as a world system by mission-aspect of black life, yet they prefer an analytical aries, who entered the continent with the idea that approach centered on social action and interpretive their God was better for the Africans than the sociology to an approach centered on race. The prob-Africans’ own Gods. Africans considered this arrogant lem for African-centered scholars is that in regard to and hegemonic, but the missionaries, often accompa-class and caste analyses, Marxist and related schools nied by the gun, imposed their will on the African of thought lay fundamentally within the framework people, creating in the continent an alien body of of Eurocentric-derived concepts and sociological believers who no longer respected their own tradi-discourse. Thus a Black Studies scholar seeking to tions. When the African first saw the white man, the understand the plight of African Americans within white man had the bible and the gun and the Africans a class and economic structure may find a Marxist or had their land. Soon the white man had the land and Weberian class and status analysis too narrow and the gun, and the African had the bible. This pattern Eurocentric to be of any real value. The African-was repeated. The Catholic Church sanctioned the centered scholar’s problem therefore lies in what can

taking of African lands, and the pope blessed the decision deemed not having conceptual agency and an action to split the world between Portugal and Spain.

authentic black perspective.

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 186

186——Class and Caste

Unlike traditional Marxist accounts of white Gunnar Myrdal's macro analysis of U.S. society, European class exploitation, the accounts of black *An American Dilemma: The Negro Problem* and scholars—such as Eric Williams's *Capitalism and Modern Democracy* (1944), a social study of African *Slavery* (1964), Oliver Cromwell Cox's *Caste, Class Americans*, concludes that they are a “caste” group *and Race* (1970), Robert Staples's *Introduction to Black* and that their collective treatment has fallen short of *Sociology* (1976), and William Julius Wilson's *The* what the United States stands for—democracy and liberal—Declining Significance of Race: Blacks and Changing identity for all its people. For Myrdal, African Americans *American Institutions* (1980)—all put a primacy on the constitute “an American dilemma” for the nation that economic basis of the exploitation and discrimination of could be remedied by bringing them in line with the black people in Western societies. In addition, regard-ethos of American ideals and away from the experience-less of their theoretical differences, the scholars who enforces of enslavement, segregation, and second-class wrote these works have understood the place of race in citizenship that have made African Americans, unlike Western societies and have each explained it by including-whites, a distinct and stigmatized caste. Yet this idea of including the racial dimension in their discussions of the

“fixed” status of African Americans is problematic, as oppression and discrimination of black peoples. The many blacks, by virtue of their light skin or European common denominator in the accounts of these economic-phenotype, have been able to “pass” into white society.

economic reductionist scholars is the placement of economic—Therefore, Myrdal's research is not a valid application economics alongside race and racism as a

primary factor of the concept of caste to African Americans, whose exploitation. For these scholars, capitalism as a system experience has often blurred racial boundaries, despite creates racist exploitation of blacks by upper-class the historical attempt by the established order to segregate whites, and it also uses race as a mechanism for divide the community from full citizenship.

ing the white and black working classes. Therefore, Oliver Cromwell Cox heavily criticizes Myrdal's racism is seen as part of an analysis of a racist-study in his book *Caste, Class and Race* (1970), main-capitalist-caste society in which more than mere class taining that it is an "idealist" analysis of the African exploitation is involved in the process of social inequality-American experience. Instead, Cox adopts a basic but ity. The debate involving class being more significant not thorough Marxist perspective and maintains that than caste (i.e., race) intensified in the late 1970s and American racism is merely a tool of the ruling class to 1980s with the work of William Julius Wilson.

keep the working classes divided. Cox rejects the idea *Class* and *caste* are certainly slippery terms when that African Americans are a caste, explaining that in analyzed from a black perspective, as they are com-India the caste system was ordained by consensus, but plex and interconnected variables, as well as mutually in the United States a caste system would be fundamental yet interrelated terms when they are associ-mentally antithetical to the egalitarian principles of ated with societies that are structured in racialized democracy, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness. Thus hierarchies. Indeed, class alone does not explain the while enslavement and segregation stigmatized all social inequality of black people in Western and African Americans, this economic process deeply Westernized societies, and neither does caste in isola-contradicted the nation's avowal of social justice and tion explain the inequality. Each variable plays into freedom for all.

the other and together they can be useful in analyzing From an African-centered perspective, class and the structural position of black people, particularly in caste are concepts that provide insight into social nations that can be deemed capitalist in terms of economic inequality, particularly in societies

such as India and economic and social organization. In his *Introduction to Black Studies* (2002), Maulana Karenga writes that explain the experience of African-descended people in

“it is clear that racism cannot be reductively translated societies such as those in the United States and the as a function of class or class struggle. Such a position United Kingdom. Although class is an important factor obscures the complexity and variousness of their in determining economic disparity, African Americans interplay and their separate relevance as factors in and black Britons could more logically be recognized a racist-capitalist society” (p. 305). The relevance of as historically outcast social groups than as groups class is separate from that of race, although the connection with a specific caste status. Moreover, even though concepts are often connected in discussions of racialized these social groups are genetically heterogeneous, they or caste-like oppression.

have endured homogeneity in the collective experience

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 187

Class Struggle——187

of racialized oppression, in varied forms, since they and/or owns the means of production (the technology arrived on Western soil. At bottom, the traditional definition and resources used to produce the goods and services initiation of caste does not appropriately fit the social in the society). Black people in the African diaspora experience of the many African-descended communities most often do not have control over the key resources ties throughout the world. However, caste coupled that maintain the societies in which they live. These with the concept of class provides a way to consider resources are fundamentally in the control of the the various forms of racialized hierarchies that exist white-led governmental, banking, business, and cultural sectors, but not entirely, in capitalist nations.

tural sectors of these societies.

The key European thinker to have analyzed class

— Mark A. Christian

struggle in relation to capitalist societies is Karl Marx **FURTHER READING**

(1818–1883). Along with his colleague, Friedrich Engels (1820–1895), Marx defined *class struggle* as Berghe, Pierre L. van den. (1981). *The Ethnic Phenomenon*.

fundamentally pertaining to the conflict between the New York: Elsevier. This is a complete discussion of the ruling class (the bourgeoisie) and the working class ethnic dimension of society.

(the proletariat), or the oppressor and the oppressed.

Cox, Oliver C. (1970). *Caste, Class and Race*. New York: In their classic work, *The Communist Manifesto*, Monthly Review Press. (Original work published 1948).

This book remains one of the classics in urban sociology.

Marx and Engels maintained that capitalism is an Karenga, Maulana. (2002). *Introduction to Black Studies* (3rd avaricious economic system. They mainly focused in ed.). Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This is an that book on explaining the exploitation inherent excellent introductory work on race and ethnicity.

in capitalist systems of socioeconomic organization.

Myrdal, Gunnar. (1944). *An American Dilemma: The Negro* Moreover, they primarily examined the oppression of *Problem and Modern Democracy*. New York: Harper and those in the white working class, who were seen as Row. Myrdal's book remains the standard for its time.

nothing more than an exploited commodity in the Staples, Robert. (1976). *Introduction to Black Sociology*.

New York: McGraw-Hill. This is a key work in black capitalist system.

sociology.

A key point in the African-centered critique of Williams, Eric. (1964). *Capitalism and Slavery*. London: Marxism is that Marx and Engels make no mention Andre Deutsch. (Original work published 1944). This book of the overt oppression and exploitation of those of by a leading Caribbean intellectual is a masterpiece of African descent. Indeed, they say nothing about the interpretation of the development of capitalism and slavery.

millions of Africans in the diaspora who, at the time Wilson, William J. (1980). *The Declining Significance of they were writing, were oppressed under European Race: Blacks and Changing American Institutions* (2nd colonial and imperial dominance in the Caribbean ed.). Chicago: University of Chicago Press. Wilson's book is one of the most provocative works of the 1980s.

region and on the continent of Africa. In their analysis of capitalism, then, Marx and Engels failed to deal with the oppression of the millions of unpaid laborers who were not only exploited through the use of their **CLASS STRUGGLE**

labor but also systematically brutalized and dehumanized via racialized oppression.

Historically, global patterns of structured socioeco-Some black scholars have used the class struggle nomic inequality have varied in societies. Class strug-paradigm of Marxism to explain the socioeconomic gle is a central tenet of Marxist analyses. Some foundation of exploitation ingrained in capitalism. Yet scholars examine social stratification as it relates to the majority of black Marxists employ a racialized as the experience of African-descended people. They well as economic analysis of exploitation in relation consider class struggle to be a central component in to class struggle. In *How Capitalism Underdeveloped* the fight against the social inequalities in modern *Black America* (1983), Manning Marable suggests that societies such as those in the United States and the capitalism is more of a problem than communism for United Kingdom. In such societies, which use capital-black Americans. The Marxist panacea for race ism and free market enterprise as a socioeconomic oppression is tied in with that for

class oppression. For organizing principle, the population is stratified and black Marxists, the root cause of racialized discrimination—the distribution of wealth in society is primarily nation is the unequal distribution of wealth and power.

skewed toward benefitting the group that controls Discrimination based on race is merely employed by

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 188

188——— *Code Noir*

the ruling class to fragment the working class and inequality if they endeavor to locate themselves inside to set white workers against black workers. This tactic an intellectual paradigm designed not for others but keeps at distance the possibility of unity or class specifically for black liberation.

consciousness among the exploited masses. Black

— *Mark A. Christian*

Marxists believe that the issue of race is secondary to that of class, and that if the class struggle is won by the **FURTHER READING**

working classes, then race will no longer be relevant.

There are a number of problems with the black Alkalimat, Abdul. (1986). *Introduction to Afro-American Marxist perspective on class struggle*, and one of them *Studies: A Peoples College Primer*. Chicago: Twenty-First is that it fails to consider that the white ruling class Century Books. This book has a strong chapter on the idea of class struggle within the Marxist context.

and the white working class have historically joined Asante, Molefi Kete. (2002). *Afrocentricity and the Decline of forces to oppress the black worker*. Even the white-Western Hegemonic Thought: A Critique of Eurocentric led trade unions, which are supposedly grounded in Theory and Practice. In Mark Christian (Ed.), *Black socialist principles*, have

historically barred blacks *Identity in the 20th Century: Expressions of the U.S. and* from joining their organizations as fellow workers.

U.K. African Diaspora. London: Hansib. This essay deals The white working class has usually viewed blacks with the nature of social and cultural analysis.

collectively as wage-earning rivals and discriminated Cox, Oliver C. (1970). *Caste, Class and Race*. New York: Monthly Review Press. (Original work published 1948).

against them at will. Indeed, there has been little evi-This remains one of the best studies of class and race in the dence of solidarity among black and white workers literature.

throughout the modern industrial and postindustrial Karenga, Maulana. (2002). *Introduction to Black Studies* (3rd eras in Europe and North America. Interestingly, in ed.). Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press. A classic *Introduction to Black Studies* (2002), Karenga sug-textbook in African American Studies, Karenga's book is a gests that race and class are parts of the same issue.

grand survey of the intellectual ideas of modern Africans Thus, Karenga believes that it is unrealistic to imagine and includes a chapter dealing with the class struggle.

a utopia in which the entire working class unites, Marable, Manning. (1983). *How Capitalism Underdeveloped Black America*. London: Pluto. This is the best work on especially given the aggression white working class capitalism's response to the African American community.

communities have historically meted out to black Marx, Karl, and Engels, Friedrich. (1987). *The Communist communities*. This aggression cannot simply be *Manifesto*. New York: Pathfinder. (Original work published regarded as false consciousness, as many enlightened 1948). This is the complete text of the original *The* and socialist-orientated trade union organizations *Communist Manifesto*.

actively maintained a color bar in regard to their membership criteria.

Maybe Marxism can explain the mechanism of the capitalist system. Thus Abdul Alkalimat may be

CODE NOIR

correct when he examines the black struggle in the United States within a Marxist framework where The *Code Noir*, meaning “Black Code,” is the corpus workers are urged to join the union movement.

of French laws that defined and governed the lives However, Alkalimat may be idealistic in his vision, of enslaved and free African people who inhabited given the historical reality of white trade union behav-French colonial territories, primarily in the Americas ior toward black workers. In short, the class struggle but also in the islands in the Indian Ocean. The code envisioned by black Marxists has never materialized, was drawn up by Jean Baptiste Colbert in 1683 and and in examining why, scholars have yet to fully con-first promulgated by Louis XIV in March of 1685.

sider both the origins of Marxism in mid-19th century From the time of its inception until the definitive abo-Europe and whom it was designed to liberate. The lition of slavery in French colonies in 1848, no other class struggle was designed to free the white working piece of legislation would affect people of African class from its exploitation at the hands of the owners descent to the extent that this document did.

of the means of production; it was *not* designed to free The objective behind its enactment was to safe-black enslaved workers and their descendents. In the guard France’s economic and other interests in colo-21st century, Black Studies scholars may envision nial territories. France benefitted tremendously from more creative solutions to the problem of social the wealth generated by its colonies. Of the numerous

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 189

products sought after and cultivated, sugar was enslaved Africans could no longer serve as domestics the most coveted. Already by 1700, Haiti (then and were allowed to go to France only for the purpose St. Domingue) had earned the title of *île de sucre par* of religious instruction or to learn a skill or trade.

excellence, and by 1790 it had become the richest Marriages between enslaved Africans were not per-colony in the world, generating an annual revenue of mitted, even with the consent of the planter, and 180 million livres and supplying three fourths of the planters were no longer allowed to emancipate world with sugar.

enslaved Africans. Failure to observe any of these The 1685 Code Noir consisted of 60 articles that laws resulted in the African's being remanded to the addressed every imaginable aspect of enslaved king. The 1763 law forbade any person of color, Africans' lives, from birth to death. Article 44 aptly whether enslaved or free, to embark for France; the captures the spirit: "Let us declare slaves as moveable 1777 law completely forbade any person of African property," thus reducing them to nothing more than descent to enter France, citing rampant miscegenation objects. The other 59 articles, among other things, and "corrupting the good and natural order of the required that enslaved Africans be baptized in the Kingdom" as the reasons. Finally, the 1778 law pro-Catholic faith within a week of their arrival in the hibited interracial marriages between blacks, mulat-colony; stipulated their food and clothing allowances, tos, and other persons of color with whites—upon medical care, and work days; and included guidelines penalty and immediate expulsion to the colonies.

regarding their family life and marriage, burial rights, The existence of the Code Noir is proof that the punishment for things such as striking one's master universal principles of liberty and tolerance that (or any member of his family) as well as for escaping, were embraced during the Enlightenment were not and civil conduct in court proceedings. As the French extended to persons of African ancestry. The fact that monarchy would come to regret some 50 years later, the code was revised regularly throughout the 18th Article 26 even provided enslaved Africans legal century, in response to the influx of enslaved and free recourse in the form

of a *mémoire* for infractions persons of color in metropolitan France, refutes the committed against them.

historical claim that slavery did not exist in France.

Unlike the 1685 Code Noir, which was concerned In fact, the historical record suggests that France primarily with regulating the colonial workforce, sub-reinvented slavery, and it raises new questions about sequent revisions in 1716, 1738, 1763, 1777, and 1778

France's critical role in the slave trade. Many histori-were preoccupied with the conduct of enslaved ans have argued in defense of the code, citing it as a Africans not only in the colonies but also in metropol-document designed to protect the rights of enslaved itan France, especially with regard to issues of race.

Africans. However, close examination reveals just the The 1716 edict came about as the result of planters opposite, for it was the colonial planter and not the requesting—on the pretext of Africans' needing reli-enslaved African who was privileged by the code.

gious instruction or to acquire a skill required in the One of the unforeseen but interesting consequences colonies—that some of the enslaved Africans be sent of the legal protection afforded enslaved Africans in to France. Other Africans simply accompanied the Article 26 of the Code Noir, however, is its evolution planters on extended visits as domestics. With each into the deposition of liberation, a special form of the succeeding edict, the few existing rights of enslaved legal brief whose express purpose was to reclaim the Africans diminished (i.e., all but their civil status).

enslaved African's liberty. The deposition of liberation Fearful that after setting foot in France, enslaved was the most viable form of African resistance on Africans might consider themselves free, which was metropolitan soil, and it is the only record we have customary, planters implored the monarchy to intro-from 18th-century France of the African's voice. And, duce changes in the law. The new edict stipulated that unlike other forms of African resistance, barring insur-enslaved persons' status

remained unchanged in spite of the fact that, it is the one that most caught planters off guard by the arrival in France, thus contradicting the 1571

decree by the Bordeaux Parliament that proclaimed: to challenge their authority by means of the same sys-

“France, the mother of liberty, allows no slaves.”

tem used to oppress them. The first of these cases on The length of an enslaved African's stay in France record was that of Jean Boucaux from Saint-Domingue, who was no longer left up to the discretion of the planter Domingue, who sued his planter for his liberty in and was restricted to no more than 3 years. In addition, 1738, 10 years after he came to live in France. His case

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 190

190———**Compromise of 1850**

established a precedent for other enslaved Africans created American nation. Slaves swelled the population who followed suit, and without exception, every of the South, and if they were counted as humans and enslaved African who made such an appeal won his or not as property, they would give the Southern states her liberty in addition to back wages. The evolution of more representation in Congress. In addition, population—the deposition of liberation challenged the legitimacy of the tax appropriation from the states.

of the slave laws and called into question one of the To create a balance between the interests of states with fundamental laws of nature—that of natural liberty.

slaves and states with no slaves, Congress agreed on a three-fifths compromise that allowed the slave popula-

— *Ilona V. Johnson*

tion to count for three-fifths of the white population.

In 1820, the slavery issue led to another com-FURTHER READING

promise—the Missouri Compromise. In 1819, the Abanime, Emeka P. (1972). The Anti-Negro French Law of people of the territory of Missouri applied for state-1777. *Journal of Negro History*, 64(1), 21–29. This is an hood. At the time, the nation had 22 states, of which insightful analysis of the anti-African laws developed by half were states with slaves and half were states with France in an attempt to protect itself from “racial impurity.”

no slaves. States with slaves preferred that Missouri Futch, Innocent. (1994). The Black Code. *The UNESCO*

Courier, 19, p. 2. Futch provides useful information about be admitted into the union as a slave state, so that the purpose of the Black Code.

such states would have a numerical advantage in the Hesse, Philippe. (1985). *Le Code Noir: De L’Homme et de Senate*. To prevent this from happening, New York L’Esclavage. In Serge Daget and François Isambert (Eds.), representative James Talmadge, Jr., introduced a *Receuil Général des Anciennes Lois Françaises: Vol. 2*.

resolution prohibiting the introduction of slavery in

“*Le Code Noir*.” *De la Traite à L’Esclavage*. Paris: Belin-Missouri. The resolution engendered heated discus-Le Prieur. This is a thorough discussion of the nature of the sion in the House of Representatives, but it passed.

Black Code, as it describes the treatment and situation of The Senate, however, rejected the resolution. The the African in the context of French official and unofficial behavior.

application of the territory of Maine for admission Midlo-Hall, Gwendolyn. (1971). *Social Control in Slave* into the union brought a solution to the Talmadge *Plantation Societies*. Baltimore, MD: Johns Hopkins resolution. Maine was admitted into the union as a University Press. Midlo-Hall examines the laws that were free state and Missouri was admitted into the

union as developed by European colonists to protect and reinforce a slave state with a proviso that slavery be excluded white supremacy during slavery days.

from the rest of the Louisiana Purchase north of Missouri's southern border.

Controversy over slavery did not end with the Missouri Compromise but continued as new states **COMPROMISE OF 1850**

were added to the union. Following its war with Mexico and the subsequent signing of the treaty The Compromise of 1850 was a political maneuver of Guadalupe Hidalgo in 1848, the United States that allowed the enslavement of Africans to continue acquired territories from Mexico at a cost of \$15

in some areas of the United States, while in other million. These territories included Arizona, California, states and territories Africans were free. The New Mexico, Texas (at the Rio Grande boundary), American political landscape from 1787 into the Nevada, and Utah. To prevent the institution of 1860s was constructed with infusions of compro-slavery in the territories acquired from Mexico, mises. The continuation of the institution of slavery in Representative David Wilmot from Pennsylvania postcolonial America created ideological conflict attached a rider to a war appropriation bill, declaring between those who were for slavery and those who that slavery be forbidden in any lands taken from opposed it. Slavery was more prevalent in the South, Mexico. The rider sailed through the House but col-where the plantation economy thrived as a result of lapsed in the Senate. Senator John Calhoun of South the free labor provided by the institution of slavery, Carolina led the fight against Wilmot's proviso, argu-than it was in the North, where there were no planta-ing that the Constitution guaranteed to the citizens of tions and the need for slaves was minimal.

all states who immigrated to the territories the same The presence of slaves had implications for the rights they enjoyed in their home states. Since the population and the economic development of the newly citizens of some states had the legal right to own

slaves, these citizens should have the right to take **FURTHER READING**

their slaves with them to wherever they migrated.

Franklin, John Hope, and Moss, Alfred A., Jr., (1998). *From Slavery to Freedom*. New York: McGraw-Hill. This book discusses the territories acquired from Mexico applied for statehood of the key books on the significance of Africans to and again when California applied for admission into American history. It has a good discussion of the compromise of 1850. The Wilmot proviso had ignited a crisis, and that white legislators entered into to preserve slavery.

and a compromise seemed to be a viable solution. The Hamilton, Holman. (1964). *Prologue to Conflict: The Crisis and the Compromise of 1850*. Lexington: University of Kentucky. This book demonstrates his political and Compromise of 1850. ical dexterity in crafting the Compromise of 1850.

Kentucky. This is a good basic reference book on the crisis of 1850.

The goal of the compromise was to find a solution to Holt, Michael F. (1978). *The Political Crisis of the 1850s*.

all the controversies involving slavery in the nation.

New York: W. W. Norton. Holt's book contains one of the best analyses of the political players and their objectives (2) arguments for and against slavery in the new during the crisis of 1850.

states; (3) invocation of the doctrine of popular sovereignty. Stamp, Kenneth. (1990). *America in 1857: A Nation on the Brink*. New York: Oxford University Press. This treatment of slavery should or should not be introduced in of the American nation on the brink of war has a sound account of the Compromise of 1850.

their territory; and (4) the constitutional legality of slavery. The compromise, which resulted from Clay's

"omnibus" bill, called for the following: 1. California would enter the union as a free state.

CONGRESS OF AFRICAN PEOPLES

2. Utah, Nevada, New Mexico, and Arizona would be organized without mention of slavery.

The Congress of African Peoples (CAP) was first convened in Atlanta, Georgia, in September of 1970.

3. Texas would cede certain lands to New Mexico Organized primarily by CAP cochairs Hayward and be compensated by Congress, which would Henry and Amiri Baraka, its stated objective was to pay the large debt of the former Republic of formulate a methodology that would unite the various Texas.

theoretical persuasions within the pan-Africanist 4. A strong fugitive slave law would better protect movement. This first CAP was attended by more than slaveowners. Special federal commissioners 2,700 delegates representing 220 national and interna-would be allowed to circumvent local courts, tional organizations. During the 4-day founding ses-arrest fugitive slaves in the North, and return sion of the congress, 11 workshops were conducted, them to their owners.

which covered political liberation, education, history, social organization, religious systems, communica-5. Slave trade would be allowed in the District of tions, law and justice, black technology, creativity, Columbia, the nation's capital.

economics, and community organization.

Participants represented a wide range of ideologi-Henry Clay's omnibus bill passed due largely to cal and political positions, from those who promul-Stephen Douglass's political astuteness, but the com-gated integrating into

the American governmental promise was never a comfortable one for either the system to those who supported the revolutionary over-South or the North. Many in the North were repulsed throw of the U.S. government. All the constituencies that slave auctions were being held in the nation's cap-united around the theme "unity without uniformity,"

ital at a time when the slave trade had been abolished which the CAP had adopted as its slogan and which in many European nations. The different sectors were captured the sentiment that the various factions within simply not willing to sacrifice their respective desires the black freedom movement could work together on the altar of compromise. The compromise survived without compromising or surrendering their auton-for only about 7 years. In 1857, the Kansas-Nebraska omy. At that time, the prevailing ideological position Act divided the new territories into two types—slave within the CAP, which was also held by key move-and free.

ment organizers, was cultural nationalism, the belief

— *Levi A. Nwachuku*

that African Americans must reclaim African culture

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 192

192———**Congress of Racial Equality** and develop African consciousness to wage a successful League (RCL). In 1978, the RCL united with two struggle for political power.

other revolutionary organizations, the Chicano August At the outset, the CAP expressed its ideology as Twenty-Ninth Movement and the Asian American *pan-African nationalism*, which is the global expresI Wor Kuen, to build a single organization, the U.S.

sion of black nationalism, and stressed institution League for Revolutionary Struggle.

building. It sought to operationalize the term *black*

— *Storm Foreman*

power, and in doing so identified its four constituent tenets: self-defense, self-sufficiency, self-determina-FURTHER READING

tion, and self-respect. Work councils were created within the 11 workshops and charged with the task Baraka, Amiri (Ed.). (1972). *African Congress*. New York: of creating programs that could concretize the CAP

William Morrow. This book contains transcriptions of ideology. Professionals and specialists presented speeches made at the 1970 conference, as well as a collection of the resource papers presented and the resolutions resource papers, and resolutions were passed in each passed.

workshop based on the information given. In the area Bush, Rod. (1999). *We Are Not What We Seem: Black* of education, it was resolved that Black Studies schol-Nationalism and Class Struggle in the American Century.

ars would initiate a process linking independent black New York: New York University Press. Bush provides a brief institutions, Black Studies programs, and educational chronology of the CAP, including its later development.

programs within black communities into a single unit Marable, Manning. (1984). *Race, Reform and Rebellion: The* titled the Comprehensive Black Educational System.

Second Reconstruction in Black America 1945–1982.

Jackson: University Press of Mississippi. This book pro-In addition, resolutions were passed for the establish-vides an analysis of the ideological shift from cultural ment of a worldwide black political party, which nationalism to revolutionary nationalism within the black would seek to gain power both within and indepen-power movement in general, with some reference to the dent of electoral politics, and for the decentralization shift in the CAP.

of U.S. law enforcement and creation of community Pinkney, Alphonso. (1976). *Red, Black, and Green: Black security forces inside African American communities*.

Nationalism in the United States. New York: Cambridge By 1971, 10 CAP chapters were operating in major University Press. Pinkney's book includes a chapter on cities around the United States. The CAP was a major rural nationalism that contains a history of the CAP to 1976.

force behind the historic National Black Political Convention held in March of 1972 in Gary, Indiana. In San Diego, California, in September of 1972, the CAP

held its second national meeting. There was a decline **CONGRESS OF RACIAL EQUALITY**

in attendance of delegates, primarily as a result of the CAP's focus on building a separate, independent The Congress of Racial Equality (CORE) was founded black political party in the months following the in 1942 in Chicago. Among the students who created founding congress. Among those that withdrew sup-the organization were James Farmer, Bayard Rustin, port were the NAACP (National Association for the Anna Murray, and George Houser. They had come to Advancement of Colored People) and members of the the conclusion that pacifism was the best way to Congressional Black Caucus. Still, the CAP remained approach the racial issues confronting the black com-effective and continued to wield influence over the munity. The students were influenced by Henry David political landscape both inside and outside of African Thoreau and Mahatma Gandhi, and they practiced American communities.

nonviolence and civil disobedience because these As the CAP continued to operate, the organiza-strategies had been used so successfully by people in tion's ideology began to shift. Whereas cultural India to end British colonial rule of their country.

nationalism was initially championed by a majority In 1947, CORE announced plans to send a team of CAP members, this position was later revised to of eight white men and eight black men into the incorporate

certain concepts attributable to Marxism-deep South to test the ruling that interstate transporta-Leninism. By 1974, the CAP openly embraced revolution had to be segregated. It was called the Journey lutionary nationalist ideology. Eventually, as a result of Reconciliation and was to last for 2 weeks of the influence of Maoism, the Congress of African through North Carolina, Tennessee, Virginia, and Peoples was renamed the Revolutionary Communist Kentucky. The NAACP (National Association for the

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 193

Congressional Black Caucus———193

Advancement of Colored People) did not like the existed in the political arena and to support the right direct action proposed by CORE and thought that of blacks to vote. CORE was considered one of the such a movement of disobedience would bring about major civil rights organizations in the country.

wholesale slaughter in the South. The Journey of

— *Mario Root*

Reconciliation left Chicago on April 9, 1947. The team included George Houser, Bayard Rustin, James Peck,

See also Freedom Summer Igal Roodenko, Nathan Wright, Conrad Lynn, Wallace Nelson, Andrew Johnson, Eugene Stanley, Dennis Banks, William Worthy, James Farmer, Louis Adams, **FURTHER READING**

Joseph Felmet, Worth Randle, and Homer Jack.

The Journey of Reconciliation team ran into trouble Franklin, John Hope, and Moss, Alfred A. (1994). *From Slavery to Freedom: A History of African Americans*.

in several states. At one point, two African Americans New York: McGraw-Hill. This has been the authoritative were found guilty of violating South Carolina's Jim history of African Americans for many years.

Crow bus statute and were sentenced to 30 days on a Frazier, Thomas. (1988). *Afro-American History*. New York: chain gang. However, the judge said he found the atti-Harcourt Brace. This is a book of primary sources about the tude of the white men even more objectionable, so African American struggle for freedom.

although he sentenced the black men, Bayard Rustin Nalty, Bernard C. (1986). *Strength for the Fight: A History of* and Andrew Johnson, to 30 days, he sentenced the *Black Americans in the Military*. New York: Free Press.

white men, Jewish students Igal Roodenko and Joseph This book seeks to show the role played by African American military professionals in building an integrated Felmet, to 90 days on a chain gang as punishment for armed services despite racism.

coming to the South with blacks. This event galvanized the members of the Congress of Racial Equality.

In February of 1948, the Council Against Intolerance in America gave George Houser and Bayard Rustin the Thomas Jefferson Award for the Advancement of **CONGRESSIONAL BLACK CAUCUS**

Democracy for seeking an end to segregation.

The leader of the group who would make the most The Congressional Black Caucus emerged as a result important contribution to ending segregation was of centuries of African Americans' determination and James Farmer, who became National Director of the perseverance to obtain their freedom from enslavement Congress of Racial Equality in 1953 and helped orga-and their right to enfranchisement. The United States nize student sit-ins during 1961. The sit-ins against was founded by people who sought to create a country segregation were held in public parks, churches, ruled by a constitution rather than a king and who libraries, museums swimming pools, and theaters.

believed in the principle of freedom from governmen-Within 6 months, these sit-ins had ended restaurant tal tyranny. However, the founding fathers

continuation and lunch-counter segregation in 26 Southern cities.

ously professed but rarely practiced the doctrine of Later, the Congress of Racial Equality organized freedom, liberty, and justice for all. These rights were Freedom Rides through the South. In Birmingham, largely absent from the lives of the majority of the Alabama, one of the buses was firebombed and its population; when the constitution was ratified, only passengers were beaten by a white mob.

white property-owning men, 3% of the population, By 1961, CORE had 53 chapters throughout the were granted the right to vote in state and federal elec-United States. Two years later, the organization helped tions. At that time, African Americans were enslaved.

organize the famous March on Washington. On The Constitution neglected other groups and prevented August, 28, 1963, more than 200,000 people marched nonproperty-owning white men, white women, Native peacefully to the Lincoln Memorial to demand equal Americans, free African Americans, and other racial justice for all citizens under the law. In 1963, Floyd groups from experiencing the power of voting for an McKissick replaced James Farmer as the national elected official; it also neglected to abolish the institu-director. The following year, CORE, the SNCC

tion of enslavement. Due to this reality, African (Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee), and Americans had to actively and continuously fight to the NAACP organized their Freedom Summer campaign not only their freedom from enslavement but pain. The idea was to put an end to the fear that also their right of enfranchisement.

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 194

194—Congressional Black Caucus

African American men fought bravely in the Civil War, sworn into office, and he remained in the House of Representatives until March 3, 1879. Although both hope of obtaining their freedom and equal citizenship.

Revels and Rainey were the first African Americans. However, both the Union and the Confederacy used to serve in the U.S. Congress, years of grandfather African American soldiers in their political plan clauses, segregation, and racism prevented masses of to control the United States, without any intention of African Americans from voting in the Southern states granting them anything in return. In addition, on and from running for office. Despite this reality, August 5, 1862, President Lincoln was quoted in the African Americans continued to demand equal citizen-New York Times as having said that if he could unify ship and the opportunity to participate in the democratic the country without freeing Africans from enslave-process. The history of African Americans' determina-ment, he would. Despite Lincoln's racism and reluc-tion is the legacy that the Congressional Black Caucus tance to end the institution of slavery, on January 1, (CBC) embodies.

1863, all slaves in states that were in rebellion against On January 2, 1969, a group of African American the Union were freed, and 2 years later, on December 6, members of Congress united under the name the 1865, the Thirteenth Amendment was ratified and Democratic Select Committee. Those in attendance enslavement was abolished.

were Adam Clayton Powell, Jr., and Shirley Chisholm of New York; Charles Diggs and John Conyers, Jr., of **THE LEGAL EMPOWERMENT OF BLACKS**

Detroit; Louis Stokes of Ohio; Bill Clay of Missouri; William Dawson of Chicago; Robert Nix of Philadel-The Thirteenth Amendment was followed by more phia; and Augustus Hawkins of Los Angeles. This important constitutional legislation. On July 9, 1868, meeting was followed in 1971 by another meeting, Congress ratified the Fourhteeth Amendment, which which four more African American members of made all persons born in the United States national-Congress attended: George Collins of Illinois; Parren ized citizens. This was followed in 1870 by the Mitchell of Maryland; Charles Rangel of New York; Fifteenth Amendment, which prohibited denying and Walter E. Fautroy of the District of Columbia.

any citizen the right to vote and gave Congress the After this meeting, on February 2, 1971, the power to enforce this prohibition. After enslaved

Democratic Select Committee changed its name to the Africans obtained their freedom, they began during Congressional Black Caucus.

Reconstruction to realize their hopes of enfranchisement. Many African Americans sought and won polit-IN DEFENSE OF THE DEFENSELESS

ical office, especially in locations where African Americans were the majority of the population. The From its inception, the purpose of the Congressional first African American to become a senator in the Black Caucus was to create a place in the federal gov-United States was Reverend Rhoades Hiram Revels.

ernment where the issues that face African Americans Revels was born to free African American parents in and other marginal Americans could be heard and Fayetteville, North Carolina on September 27, 1827.

addressed by government. The Congressional Black He was educated at Knox College in Galesburg, Caucus was formed during a time when the gains Illinois, and he became a minister in the African made by African Americans and other marginalized Methodist Episcopal Church. After Jefferson Davis Americans were being attacked by white conserva-abandoned his position as a senator from Mississippi tives in the federal government, under the leadership to become the president of the Confederate States of of the Republicans and former president Richard America, Revels replaced him and served as a senator Nixon. During this period, white America grew intol-from February 23, 1870 to March 3, 1871. While in erant of the civil rights movement and integration, and office, Revels served on numerous committees, includ-as a result, white mobs attacked and killed many ing the Education and Labor Committee and the African Americans and the federal and state govern-Committee on the District of Columbia.

ments failed to protect African Americans' civil rights.

Unlike Revels, Joseph H. Rainey, the first African To combat this situation, the Congressional Black American in the House of Representatives, was born Caucus emerged to become a presence in Congress into enslavement in Georgetown, South Carolina on that served the African American population and June 21, 1832. On December 12, 1870, Rainey was aided in creating a more democratic America.

The Congressional Black Caucus assumed radical **FURTHER READING**

objectives that included every person in the United States. Allen, Robert. (1969). *Black Awakening in Capitalist America*: States being able to afford fair and equal justice under the law, every businessperson be able to have equal work remains one of the best on the development of share of public funds, and every community in the economic and political power in America.

United States able to have equal share in deciding how taxes are to be allocated. Bositis, David A. (1994). *The Congressional Black Caucus in the 103rd Congress*. Lanham, MD: University Press of America. The CBC also opposed the unfair international policies that are seen in this era of America. In this book, Bositis provides a comprehensive globalization, as well as unfair political campaign history of the formation of the Congressional Black Caucus and its founders.

fundraising in the state and federal government. In Singh, Robert, Sinclair, Barbara, and Niemi, Richard G.

addition, the organization put together coalitions com-

(Eds.). (1997). *The Congressional Black Caucus: Racial politics of black congresspeople and other nonwhite Politics in the U.S. Congress*. Thousand Oaks, CA: Sage.

elected officials. The CBC's efforts to create a unified text gives inclusive documentation of policies and ing and separate caucus within the U.S. government politics of the Congressional Black Caucus.

have met with much discontent. However, despite the Wolfenstein, Eugene. (1989). *The Victims of Democracy*: CBC's critics' accusation that the group engages in *Malcolm X and the Black Revolution*. London: Free Association. This book demonstrates how African reverse discrimination and separatism, the caucus has Americans become victims of the idea of democracy, and continued to prosper and remain a force in Congress how Malcolm X

showed what a possible future could be in that is devoted to exposing, examining, and address-a society based on justice.

ing the issues that African Americans confront in <http://www.cbconline.org>
This is the official website of the American society.

Congressional Black Caucus. The site has links to the many Today the Congressional Black Caucus is com-programs that CBC developed, the history of CBC, as well prised of all the African American congresspeople as national news and historical facts concerning the African and is revered as a voice to be reckoned with in American community.

Congress. The influence of the CBC is seen not only in Congress but also in the numerous programs the caucus has created to aid African Americans. In **CONSCIENCISM**

1976 the CBC created the Congressional Black Caucus Foundation, Inc. (CBCF), an institute whose purpose is to promote a coalition of members of Consciencism is a philosophy based on a set of the community of African Americans—legislators, philosophical statements penned by Kwame Nkrumah businesses, community organizations—as well as (1909–1972). According to Nkrumah, Africans every-of African Americans and organizations that serve where share historical bonds, cultural bonds, and people of color and labor unions, so as to foster pos-common aspirations for unity, but colonialism and itive change in the African American community.

enslavement interrupted the expression of this shared This foundation also creates forums where these heritage and generated a cultural confusion rectifi-constituencies can discuss their concerns and objec-able only by the ethical imposition of conscience.

tives for the future. CBCF programs, such as Nkrumah therefore presented consciencism as a way the Congressional Black Caucus Spouses (CBC

of beginning to resolve what he saw as the crisis of the Spouses), the Educational Scholarship Fund, the African conscience. The statements that detail the phi-Fellowship Program, and internship programs, losophy were intended as a theoretical basis for an promote education and political

involvement in ideology that synthesizes the African experience. The the African American community. Finally, the CBCF

elements of this synthesis are (1) traditional African recently created the With Ownership, Wealth society, which is understood as the base of the African (WOW) program, which employs education, coun-experience and is used to filter other experiences seling, and funding to help African Americans and through; (2) Islam's effect on the worldwide African other people of color buy, maintain, and keep their community; and (3) the Euro-Christian impact on homes.

that community. Nkrumah sought to use this ideological formula to engender a harmonious development

— *Kiera Hope Foster*

of African society.

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 196

196———**Consciencism**

Pan-Africanism was described by Nkrumah as functional unity, and better life circumstances for the the total liberation and unification of Africa under multitude of Africans everywhere.

a socialist union government. He envisioned this The text *Consciencism* contrasted the philosophi-objective as the only sure way of achieving the rapid cal views of traditional African societies with alien transformation of African society that would ensure views. Nkrumah insisted that the critical study of past a better chance in life for Africans everywhere. The philosophies leads to modern theories that can imbue process of emancipating and unifying the African contemporary struggles with militancy and vitality. In world required a pan-African ideology for guidance his book, Nkrumah thus fine-tuned the analytical tools and support. The most impressive models of rapid of dialectical and historical materialism by adding two transformation at the time were the Soviet Union tools—the concepts of categorical conversion and and China. Each of those

societies had chosen a cosmic contrast. These concepts help to explain the socialist form of governance in opposition to the vitality of the cosmic raw material—matter—and are capitalist culture of the Western European colonial necessary to resolve the outside-inside contradiction powers. Nkrumah thus added socialism to the defin-prevalent in Euro-Christian and Islamic philosophies.

ition of pan-Africanism and attributed this addition Consciencism asserts that traditional societies to what he called the African personality. He rejected transcendentalism by synthesizing the con-explained socialism as evolutionary in African cepts of outside and inside and eliminated the contra-societies rather than revolutionary, as such societies dictory relationship between them by making them had already experienced similar principles of human continuous.

relations in their communalistic organization and Furthermore, consciencism advocates a qualita-ways of life.

tively different explanation for behavioral motivation Nkrumah described the African personality as an in two ways. First, it removes the notion of nonhu-expression of a reawakened consciousness among man deterministic control over social reality. Second, Africans and African descendants that could only it replaces the social determining force of the reach its full potential when Africa reached pan-mode of production advocated by Marxists with the Africanism. The African personality was seen as an determining power of the condition of the con-essential characteristic of the African nation rather sciousness. In the text, Nkrumah explained that the than as a particular state, language, religion, political philosophy advocates ideological training as the only system, or skin color. Furthermore, Nkrumah asserted safeguard for the establishment of a socialist mode of that the African personality would be projected in the production.

international community after the liberation and unity The philosophy of consciencism, Nkrumah's of Africa was completed.

self-proclaimed materialist philosophy, adds an explanation of the existence of immaterial phenomena and their interconnection with matter to the

IDEOLOGY AND PHILOSOPHY

analytic tool shed of African revolutionaries. The In effect , consciencism is the philosophical premise of cosmic raw material is declared to be matter, which Nkrumahism, the ideology expounded by Kwame is described as a plenum of forces in tension Nkrumah. It is a philosophy that brings moral respon-and capable of self-motion. Nkrumah explained that sibility to the work of the pan-African revolution.

the answer to the cosmic raw material question Nkrumah's 1970 text, *Consciencism: Philosophy and* requires the synthesis of matter and its internal self-Ideology for De-colonization, suggested this philo-motion, nature and ideas, and practice and theory.

sophical idea as the ideology for decolonization.

Nkrumah agreed with Marx on the ordinal primacy In his text, Nkrumah warned the non-Western of matter, but he also asserted the exigent primacy students to find their philosophical tools within their of ideology. Spirit is expressed as a surrogate of own indigenous culture and social milieu. Nkrumah critically organized matter. The connection between explained how this approach enables other cultures spirit and matter and between theory and practice is and their philosophical outlooks to be known and used explained through categorial conversion. The accep-to improve the plight of African people. He insisted tance of the vitality of matter—often called, pejora-that any revolutionary African ideology has to address tively, animism, was prevalent in traditional African issues capable of quickening the pace of liberation, societies.

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 197

Consciousness———197

CARDINAL ETHICAL PRINCIPLES

FURTHER READING

Consciencism's cardinal principles are humanism, Nkrumah, Kwame. (1970). *Consciencism: Philosophy and* egalitarianism, and collectivism,

which are related to *Ideology for De-colonization*. New York: Modern Reader.

the concept of unity through matter's characteristic This is the philosophical statement for consciencism by the first president of Ghana and the classic work on the subject.

oneness. They represent core values in Nkrumahist Poe, Daryl Zizwe. (2004). *Kwame Nkrumah*. New York: ideology and are described as follows: Routledge. This was one of the first books to deal compre-

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hensively with Nkrumah as an Afrocentric thinker.

Humanism is the recognition of each human being as an end within himself or herself, not *merely* a means to an end.

- *Egalitarianism* is the equal and fair opportunity **CONSCIOUSNESS**

for all and each in society to develop to their fullest capacity.

- *Collectivism* is the assertion of the paramount In defining the term *consciousness* for African people, interest of the collective over the alien individ-the immediate task is to free African thinking from ual. The alien individual is typified as a person the meanings and constraints imposed by training in who remains self-absorbed and has chosen him-Western thought and techniques, and especially by the self or herself in contradistinction to the collec-Western episteme and paradigms inherited and used tive. The individual who chooses the collective for thinking itself. The African heritage of black also chooses herself or himself.

people is replete with elegant, elaborate, and extraordinary conceptualizations of human knowing and **CONSCIENCISM'S STATEMENTS**

awareness. The following explication is a brief and partial composite of African-centered understanding What follows is a summation of

consciencism's of consciousness.

statements:

In regard to the notion of consciousness, it is fairly well documented that Africa conceives of reality and 1. Revolutionary African ideology requires the all that is within reality as a mental expression of the synthesis of the traditional base culture with the divine. Ancient Nile Valley metaphysics, for instance, Islamic and Euro-Christian impact.

believes that Djehuti (whom the Greeks call Hermes) 2. When a foreign philosophy is studied, it should be the mind and will of the creative demiurge and that be seen in the context of the intellectual history from this personified divine mind emerges the word to which it belongs and the context of the milieu that brings all things into being. Similarly, Dogon in which it was born.

metaphysics states that the universe is a thought in the mind of Amma, the creator. In terms of consciousness, 3. Most African traditional societies see humans as the philosophical thinking of the Akan makes a dis-essentially spiritual beings.

inction between *Adwen* ("realms of knowing"), *Nea* 4. Positive action leads to liberated territories, *Wonhu* ("thought" or "that which can not be perceived"), *Nea edtra Adwen* ("that which transcends foreign domination.

thought") and *Anidho* ("levels of awareness"), *Anidahoso* ("awareness of self"), and *Oben* ("perception beyond the ordinary"). 5. In order for a country to apply socialism, it

be liberated, be unified, and embrace philosophy-In Kikongo Lingala, the word for *conscious* is *cal* materialism. It also needs a philosophical *conzealeli*, which means the way you are in life, your consciencism to enable it to hold to its general nature essence. The Bantu-Congo believe that there are while allowing for its individuality in the family diverse forces and waves of energy that govern life of nations. It does this through its response to the surrounding humans. This fire-force, which is called material conditions of

the territory, its generation *Kalunga*, is complete in and of itself and emerges of dialectical moments, and its employment of within the emptiness or nothingness and becomes the positive action through a mass party.

source of life on earth. This *Kalunga* is a force in

— *Daryl Zizwe Poe*

motion that can be considered consciousness. The

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 198

198———**Consciousness**

Bantu-Congo believe that the heated force of Kalunga mind and heart. Every knowable and perceivable blew up and down as a huge storm of projectiles, object in the natural universe is a hieroglyph of divine *Kimbwandende*, producing a huge mass in fusion. As consciousness (i.e., comprehension and imagination).

Fu-Kiau puts it in *Tying the Spiritual Knot: African Divine consciousness is more than thinking, feeling, Cosmology of the Bantu-Konko* (2001), in the process and awareness: Everything vibrates in a divinely gov-of cooling, the mass was in fusion and then solidifica-erned universe. The entire universe, which is poten-tion occurred, giving birth to the earth. In a very real tiality contained in itself, is a neverending totality of way, the world as a physical reality, floating in possibilities—consciousness.

Kalunga, emerges as an act of consciousness.

Consciousness is thus the intelligent energy of the The term *consciousness* as African people apply it divine. The spectrum of consciousness includes is therefore a construct that represents their ability to numerous levels, which differ in degree of frequency know, perceive, understand, and be aware of self in and density. In fact, the level of consciousness deter-relation to self and all else. All that is consciousness mines the configuration of matter.

Level is indicated is, in fact, revealed in and determined by relationships by vibration. Consciousness is inscribed in and deter-

(i.e., energy in motion). At the most fundamental mines the nature of every organism. Each animal, level, consciousness is found in the pulse that gives us each species of plant, each mineral, and each of their life. A heart cell, for example, is unique in that it pro-respective components represents conscious energy duces a strong electromagnetic signal that radiates (or vibrating at different speeds. In terms of human relates) out beyond itself. The electromagnetic (EM) beings, one vibratory level becomes heart. Another field produced by the heart radiates outward some level of vibration becomes liver; another will become 12 to 15 feet beyond the human body. In effect, every lung; another will become the synergetic being known human being is in constant contact or relationship as the human being. The varieties of so-called races of with other human beings and energy-vibrating life humanity, which are biologically organized in essen-forms at all times. Indeed, in *The Biology of* tially the same way, are also made distinct by the *Transcendence: A Bluerprint of the Human Spirit* degree of differential organic vibration. Consciousness (2002), J. C. Pearce writes that if two live heart cells is, however, more than potentiality contained in itself.

are kept apart, and then when they begin to die (as eviAs a knowing and knowable vibration, motion, or denced by fibrillation) are brought into close proxim-energy, consciousness is simultaneously potentiality ity with each other, they will resume their regular and intentionality contained in the pulse of life.

life-producing pulsation. This indicates not only a cel-At the level of the human being, consciousness is lular relationship but also the awareness and under-always a collective experience and passes from one standing (consciousness) of each cell to every other collective generation (or being) to the next. Like the cell, which is evidence of and critical to life. What is energy or vibration indicative of it, consciousness most important here is that what is seen as the elec-is never destroyed. In fact, it is the reincarnation of tromagnetic (EM) energy of the cells is in fact the consciousness, as psyche, that constitutes the reincar-consciousness of each

cell, which carries information nation of a person. A reincarnated person is a new or awareness. It is the vibration of each cell that person only in the carnal sense. The collective con-results in the awareness of self (one cell) and other sciousness, or what some call racial consciousness, is (another cell). Consciousness is, in effect, the intelli-constantly renewed in each succeeding generation.

gent energy of the divine.

The reincarnated are different from the preceding What the ancient Africans of the Nile Valley (the generation only to the extent that their consciousness Kemites) called the “intelligence of the heart” is in vibrates at a new (i.e., different) speed. African people, scientific terms an intricate dialogue between the elec-as a particular vibratory phenomenon, reincarnate tromagnetic fields generated by the knowing cells in consciousness from one generation to the next irre-human beings’ hearts, minds, and bodies and the elec-spective of geographical location. Many of the great tromagnetic energy fields in the world at large and spe-deep thinkers throughout the African world have spo-cific energy fields found in our particular experience ken through this sense of consciousness, this force with time, place, and space. The African is distin-in motion, a consciousness that is inborn. Chester guished by a particular consciousness that is reflected Higgins claimed in *Feeling the Spirit: Searching the* in a special capacity for having intelligence of the *World for the People of Africa* (1994) that Africa was

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 199

Consciousness———199

born in African people even if they were not born in that is reflected in the Book of Knowing the Africa. The Africa born in African people everywhere Evolutions of Ra where the god Neb-er-tcher records is that inborn sense of consciousness, that vibratory the creation and birth of the gods: “I am he who fire force in motion that is complete in and of itself yet evolved himself under the form of the God Khepera.

continually emerging to become the source and the I, the evolver of the evolutions and developments consequence of living.

which came forth from my mouth. . . . I laid the Consciousness is thus the essence, energy, expres-foundations of all things by my will and all things sion, and experience of the black spirit (or being) in evolved themselves there from.” The same conscious-the form of awareness, knowing, comprehension, and ness—the sense of essence, energy, and experience—

existing. It is that which allows African people to is symbolized further in the ancient Nile Valley text reflect, respond, project, and create from, before, and by the words *Kheper-i*, *Kheper Kheperu*, *Kheper-kuy*, beyond the time of their individual experience.

M Keperu, which mean “When I Became, the Consciousness is intricately merged with spirit.

Becoming Became, I have Become in Becoming.” This It is the knowing of what a knowing and knowable consciousness of evolving the evolutions, of vibrating spirit knows. The hermeneutics of consciousness in a knowable and knowing energy, of the pulse that gives sense determines or allows African people to conceive human beings life, is continually reincarnated in black of and understand themselves as fundamentally spirit.

awareness (i.e., consciousness). It is found in the word Having an awareness of themselves as spirit, in turn, *advancement* in the National Association for the allows African people to access realms of knowing Advancement of Colored People, in the word *improve-that are not limited to just cognition or perception*.

ment in the Universal Negro Improvement Association, It also allows them to be accessible to spirits in the and in the word lift in the Negro national anthem, “Lift realm of the spirit. It connects knowing and awareness Every Voice and Sing.” In addition, W.E.B. Du Bois to both the perceivable (visible) and the unperceivable speaks directly to the complexity of the vibratory (invisible).

radiance (or energy) that he immortalized when he Hence, consciousness as (or driven by) an eternal coined the term double consciousness.

living spirit is not bound by time, space, or place. It Consciousness as defined here allows blacks to connects knowing, awareness, and comprehension draw upon a meaning of being that is antithetical to to the universal and the divine. Consciousness is thus the constructions of blacks by the dominant culture, that which gives congruity to the supra, inter, and which include objectifications of negation, nullifica-inner realms of being. It allows for the retention of the tion, and dehumanization. This consciousness serves ancestral sensibilities that interpret and give meaning as the source of both the potential for liberation and to contemporary experience. It is consciousness—as the intention to be free. It is the inner thought or men-awareness, knowing, and comprehension—and its tal vibration that guides the awareness that a person's subsequent meaning that give particular content, con-actions are or should be in deliberate accord with that text, and contour to black character and style. The person's destiny. Consciousness also allows a person desire to always function at a higher level (i.e., the to be aware of the possibility of the fulfillment of that sense of excellence) is characteristic of the conscious-destiny. Accordingly, without understanding the ness of African people from time immemorial.

vibratory energy that configured itself into being, Consciousness functions as both retentive and resid-becoming, and belonging to African people, a black ual knowing and awareness. As retentive energy, con-person may be incapable, for instance, of fully com-sciuousness allows for the remembering or retention prehending why Harriet Tubman, Nat Turner, of all previous information, experience, and ideas. As Sojourner Truth, W.E.B. Du Bois, Marcus Garvey, and residual energy, consciousness provides a conduit or other black leaders and lay people alike react to and circuit for tapping into the residue of human knowing determine reality in a unique and special way.

and awareness and thereby creates or inspires new An African-centered understanding of conscious-knowing and awareness.

ness requires black people to meet the challenge of The vibratory spiraling of African people toward awareness, knowing, comprehension, and existing higher level functioning, or ascension, is best under-through the realms of knowing and levels of aware-stood as self-generating consciousness (i.e., energy). In ness that are the very same aspect of being that each the ancient Nile Valley, it is this sense of consciousness black person is attempting to define. Consciousness is

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 200

200———**Council of Independent Black Institutions** the knowing and knowable vibratory fire-force that **HISTORICAL CONTEXT**

is the neverending totality of possibilities emerging CIBI's history is linked to the community control from itself and shaping and being shaped in relation to schools movement that emerged in the United States both perceivable and unperceivable reality.

in the 1960s. Demands for community control repre-Unfortunately, it is this African sense of conscious-sented an ideological departure from the integrationist ness that was deformed and derailed as the direct and strategies employed during the period leading up to indirect intent and consequence of Arab conquest, and following the Supreme Court's 1954 *Brown v.*

international enslavement, and European colonization.

Board of Education decision in favor of desegrega-The de-Africanization and dehumanization of African tion. School desegregation efforts provided African-people required the distortion of African conscious-descended people with information about the school ness. The contemporary disconnection of Africans decision-making process. The basic realization that from an African sense of consciousness remains the the same authorities who managed public school seg-intent and consequence of Eurocentric intellectual regation also managed public school desegregation (i.e., conceptual) hegemony and worldwide white led activists in cities such as New York City; Chicago; political and philosophical supremacy. It is clear that Los Angeles; Boston; East Palo Alto, California; and

remembering and reexperiencing an African meaning Washington, D.C. to initiate organized efforts to gain of consciousness is essential to the liberation of the power over the public schools in their communities.

African mind and the development, empowerment, The community control of public schools movement and revitalization of African people worldwide.

further sharpened understandings of the politics of

— Wade W. Nobles

education and the dynamics of power. Beginning in (Nana Kwaku Berko I, Ifagbemi Sangodare) the mid-1960s and continuing though the mid-1970s, during the height of the black power movement, inde-FURTHER READING

pendent black schools were organized in cities across the United States.

Fu-Kiau, Kimbwandende Kia Bunseki. (2001). Tying the Spiritual Knot: African Cosmology of the Bantu-Konko (2nd ed.). Toronto: Athelia Henrietta Press. This is a work of scholarship, insight, and spiritual achievement.

THE FOUNDING OF CIBI

Fu-Kiau's understanding of the world is based on an Five black power conferences were held between African conception of consciousness.

Higgins, Chester, Jr. (1994). Feeling the Spirit: Searching the 1966 and 1970. The concept black power defined the World for the People of Africa. New York: Bantam Books.

spirit of the developing independent black school This is among the books that best describe and illustrate the movement. In 1967, following the Second National search for a common consciousness.

Conference on Black Power held in Newark, New Pearce, J. C. (2002). The Biology of Transcendence: A Jersey, Jitu Weusi (formerly known as Leslie Blueprint of the Human Spirit. Rochester, VT: Park Street Campbell), one of CIBI's founders, argued that Press. This is a major work on the

development of African Americans had to determine their own destiny transcendence.

in education. In 1970, the California Association for Afro-American Education and Nairobi College in East Palo Alto jointly sponsored a conference to set up cri-COUNCIL OF INDEPENDENT

*teria for the evaluation of independent black schools and to facilitate communications between such **BLACK INSTITUTIONS***

schools. It may be that the first formal reference to these schools as Independent Black Institutions (IBIs) The Council of Independent Black Institutions (CIBI) occurred during this conference. IBIs were seen as is an umbrella organization of African-centered self-reliant organizations. This conference also pro-schools and home schooling, as well as individuals duced some of the fundamental concepts that charac-who are advocates of African-centered education. It terized an IBI. The participants' leanings toward was founded in 1972 to unify a rapidly developing cultural nationalism are clearly underscored by the movement of pan-Africanist oriented independent attention given to the role of culture in power relation-schools in the United States.

ship. The Nguzo Saba (Seven Principles), developed

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 201

Council of Independent Black Institutions———201

by Maulana Karenga in 1965, headed the list of national Council of Independent Black Institutions defining characteristics identified for a proposed (CIBI) began to take form and function. The original nationwide system of IBIs.

statement of purpose provided that CIBI must be the Shortly after the California meeting, the first political vehicle through which a qualitatively differ-Congress of African People was convened in Atlanta, ent people is produced. The idea was to produce a Georgia, in the first week of

September in 1970. This people committed to truth—in practice as well as in meeting was actually the fifth black power conference.

principle—and dedicated to excellence and the will to The Education and Black Students Workshop chaired struggle uncompromisingly for the liberation of all by Preston Wilcox was one of 11 workshops convened African people everywhere.

*at the congress. The charge given this working session was to develop plans for establishing a parallel school **THE SIGNIFICANCE OF CIBI***

system incorporating all legally, physically, and psychologically independent schools at every educational The formation of independent schools by people of level into a national pan-African school system. Within African descent in the United States was not a new this workshop there were 10 working sessions; one of phenomenon. African people have been creating their these was called Independent Black Educational own schools in the United States since the 1790s.

Institutions. Two schools of thought surfaced regard-However, the founding of CIBI and the movement it ing the most appropriate strategy. One was to continue characterizes are historically significant for at least to pursue community control of public schools serving two reasons. The first reason is the employment of large populations of children of African descent. These institution building as a strategy for cultural libera-schools, once under the control of the African commu-tion. CIBI focused on institution building for the indenity, would be converted to IBIs. The second strategy pendent education of African people at a time when so was to either establish new independent institutions or many other institutions were caught in the maelstrom strengthen existing ones. It was the latter strategy that of school desegregation. For CIBI's members, institu-received the most attention. Two reports on the work-tion building was a clearly organized act of resistance ing session were published. The first report was edited against the European-centered cultural hegemony and by Preston Wilcox and titled Workshop on Education intellectual control that shrouded school desegrega-and Black Students, Congress of African People, tion. Further, while undertaken to lay a foundation for Summary Report (1970). The second report was edited national liberation and self-determination,

institution by Frank J. Satterwhite and titled *Planning an* building became a means of establishing liberated *Independent Black Educational Institution* (1971).

zones or free spaces where the process of education In 1972, from April 21 to 23, the New York African would be insulated from the cultural assault of American Teachers Association convened a meeting Western hegemony.

of 28 persons, representing 14 independent schools The second reason that CIBI is historically signifi-across the United States. John Churchville, Jitu cant is that the organization's schools sought to Weusi, and others already involved in building deconstruct European-centered views of the world independent institutions brought up their frustration and reclaim, recover, and reconstruct an African over the inability of the group to develop a consensus worldview—and, most important, to codify this around a plan of action. A caucus of the independent process in their curriculums. CIBI helped to lay a path school representatives was thus convened during the that had been pursued earlier by the Universal Negro meeting to discuss what should be done and come up Improvement Association and the Nation of Islam.

with a mandate.

This attention to the cultural context of schooling was Two months later, from June 29 to July 3, a largely missing in the school desegregation move-national work meeting was held in Frogmore, South ment. In fact, Du Bois noted that many people of Carolina, to act on the mandate from the independent African descent feared that the study of African cul-school caucus at the African American Teachers tural history as distinct from European cultural history Association conference. The participants in this meet-would set back school desegregation.

ing determined the principles, policies, and programs Since CIBI's founding, its member schools have of the organization and set up a national structure to continued to incorporate a pan-African philosophy of carry out its objectives. It was at this point that the education based on a cultural value system (e.g., the

Nguzo Saba). In addition, CIBI schools represent children in CIBI schools. However, parents who organized partnerships of parents, educators, and withdrew their children from CIBI schools to enroll community residents who are collectively engaged in them in charter schools often found those schools building and maintaining institutions of learning. As a unsuitable and returned their children to CIBI schools.

united front serving as an umbrella organization for The 21st century is also a period in which the independent African-centered educational institutions, vision of intergenerational leadership of CIBI institu-CIBI members have collectively produced instructions is being realized. The institution building tional resources for classroom and home use. Notable approach developed by CIBI schools in the 1960s and among these is *Positive Afrikan Images for Children*: 1970s enabled the transfer of leadership from the *The CIBI Social Studies Curriculum*. This book is the founding generation to successor generations. As an product of the cumulative classroom experiences with organization, CIBI also took steps to prepare its future African-centered education of some of CIBI's most leaders by changing its leadership structure to ensure accomplished instructors. Another example is CIBI's representation of younger adults and instituting male annual Science EXPO. Held every April since 1977, and female co-executive officers.

the Science EXPO showcases the application of

—Mwalimu J. Shujaa

students' knowledge of science and technology applied to the resolution of challenges facing the African **FURTHER READING**

world.

CIBI has maintained standards of self-governance Afrik, Hannibal T. (1981). *Education for Self-reliance*, and self-reliance and addresses education as a cultural *Idealism to Reality: An Analysis of the Independent*

Black imperative that cannot be divorced from family, community, and national contexts. In 1995, CIBI produced a document of the role of the black independent institution.

a definition of African-centered education that makes Campbell, L. (1970). *The Black Teacher and Black Power*. In it inseparable from nation building: *African-centered* Nathan Wright, Jr. (Ed.), *What Black Educators Are Saying* education is the means by which African culture—

(pp. 23–24). New York: Hawthorn Books. This is one of including the knowledge, attitudes, values, and skills the major works dealing with the nature of education as needed to maintain and perpetuate it throughout the seen by black educators.

nation building process—is developed and advanced Council of Independent Black Institutions. (1972, June 30).

Summary of First Work Meeting, Frogmore, SC. This document is a delineation of the work that was achieved by the commitment and competency within present and future CIBI during the first year.

generations to support the struggle for liberation and Council of Independent Black Institutions. (1990). *Positive nationhood. Nation building* is the conscious and *Afrikan Images for Children*. Trenton, NJ: Red Sea Press.

focused application of black people's collective This is the authoritative work on the philosophy behind the resources, energies, and knowledge to the task of liberating independent school movement.

erating and developing the psychic and physical space Ratteray, J. D., and Shujaa, M. J. (1988). Defining a Tradition: that they identify as theirs. This definition is intended Parental Choice in Independent Neighborhood Schools. In D. T. Slaughter and D. J. Johnson (Eds.), *Visible Now: to set independent African-centered educational institutions Blacks in Private Schools*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press.

tutions apart from public schools, charter schools, and This is a very useful work on the development of indepen-private schools that have emulated the CIBI model dent neighborhood schools.

without its commitment to self-determination and sovereignty for African people.

In the early 21st century, CIBI's major challenges include economic stability for its member institutions.

CREOLE

Publicly funded charter schools patterned after CIBI schools initially attracted families who were unable or The term *Creole* originally referred to any person, unwilling to pay the tuition that CIBI schools require black or white, born in Caribbean or South American in order to remain independent. The charter schools colonies during the European colonization of those attracted not only families dissatisfied with poor qual-areas. These Creole people were believed to form ity public schools that earlier might have enrolled unique Creole societies, with a distinct culture in terms their children in CIBI schools but also families with of food, language, values, and so on. Most often now,

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 203

Creole——203

however, the term refers to languages created as a and between local people. At this stage, it expands in result of contact between two or more peoples, as hap-only one way, from the user's mother tongues. This pened between Africans and Europeans on American phase helps to account for the indigenous lexical soil. Creole languages, however, are not exclusive to items and the numerous direct translations found in all the Americas. Creole languages emerged in Africa, as Creole languages where English was the language well as in other parts of the non-African world.

spoken by the Europeans. As interracial contact While the social and historical circumstances lead-increases, the third phase occurs. During this

phase, leading to the development of a Creole language are rather borrowing lexical items from the European language. Clearly, the process through which such a language extends vocabularies. The fourth phase is limited and emerges remains rather mysterious. Several theories to areas where the European language continues to have been put forth to account for the development of the official national language. When the contact of Creole languages in the Americas. One of the first between the European language and the Creole language-theories, the baby talk theory, was quite racist. It argues that language is sustained, and as education in the so-called pidgin argued that Africans, because of their alleged intellectual inferiority, had to be taught an impoverished form of the European language. As this form spread, a process called decreolization occurs. The influence of a European language that resulted in a Creole language (which in this context was perceived as a pathological form of the European language) then increases considerably.

pathological form of the European language).

However, the notion of a pidgin is problematic. Some later scholars have argued that the extent to which it assumes that there was linguistic discontinuity between Africans developed a pidgin as a language of communication between continental Africans and Africans in the Americas. The idea of a pidgin implies that they used to communicate with Europeans enslaved in the Americas. The idea of a pidgin implies that they used to communicate with one another, because captives were linguistically diverse. When they arrived in their new homes, they gave up African languages and abandoned the African linguistic tradition. Africans who were enslaved were bilingual and in for the use of a pidgin that was primarily a European language. Many cases multilingual. However, they were then given an invention or simplified version of European language and denied the opportunity to speak their African languages. Many studies on Creole languages in the Caribbean fail to acknowledge the role of African languages, and as more Africans arrived, African languages in the creation of these languages. Although languages were used less and less frequently, while the researches have identified Africanisms, they have increasingly relied on pidgin. Over generations, placed more emphasis on finding European grammatical sources. In doing this, the pidgin gradually developed into a Creole language. This evolution involved the substitution of

West adequate and unbiased analysis of relevant African African words with European words (English, French, languages.

Portuguese, Spanish, Dutch, and others). However, this The distinctiveness of Creole languages is clear substitution of vocabulary took place within the struc-when we consider their patterns of grammar and tures that characterized West African languages. Thus pronunciation, several of which mirror West African a so-called Creole can develop from a pidgin when the linguistic patterns. For example, in many West African pidgin is the result of its speakers being unable com-languages, the English *th* sounds are not present, and municate by using their native language or being in a in Creole languages *th* is replaced with sounds such multilingual area where another language is essential as a *d*, *t*, or *f*. There are also verbal rituals that are for progress and survival.

reflected in the oral tradition. Furthermore, there is the Four main phases in the expansion process from continued importance of the spoken word. It may thus a pidgin to a pan-African language have often been be useful to think of Creole languages as pan-African posited. The first phase involves casual and unsus-languages (i.e., as multilanguage systems that have an tained contact between European language speakers African base) and, although the speakers of these lan-and the local people. From this contact, a marginal guages may be able to understand English or French, pidgin evolves that is capable, with the help of ges-for example, the languages they speak are still not tures, of communicating needs, numbers, trading English or French. The Creole languages, which are arrangements, and so on. The second phase begins as spoken in the Americas (i.e., the Caribbean and North soon as the pidgin English, for example, is used by and South America), express the common historical

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 204

204———**Creolization**

and cultural-linguistic experience of Africans in Creole language spoken seen as a dialect of that the Western Hemisphere. Africans in the Americas European language. The reasons given for this theo-persevered in maintaining a language and culture of rized simplification varied from the

African inepti-African origin that include a unique structure of grammar and gross physical traits that made learning a matter, vocabulary, pronunciation, and cultural style.

European language impossible to its use as a learning strategy. The racist baby talk theory illustrates such an

— *Adisa A. Alkebulan*

approach, and so does the polygenetic theory. Such theories share the assumption that African languages **FURTHER READING**

played no role, or a very minimal one, in the creolization process. Alleyne, Mervyn. (1988). *Roots of Jamaican Culture*. London: Pluto Press.

Although specific to Jamaica, this text demonstrates the African cultural continuity in the second approach to the creolization process, namely, the universalist communities.

approach, which posits the activation of some innate Mazama, Ama. (1999). The Nature of Linguistic Contacts in language bioprogramme, rather than simplification, as Guadeloupe: Historical and Sociological Evidence. In Pauline Christie et al. (Eds.), *Caribbean Linguistic Studies* the major force at work within creolization. The activation (pp. 36–54). Port of Spain, Trinidad: University of the West Indies Press. This is a fascinating case study in the necessary by the situation of extreme linguistic deprivation of a particular Creole language, with an activation in which Africans found themselves as a result emphasis on the African linguistic base of the language.

of their (1) not being able to transmit their ancestral Mufwene, Salikoko S. (Ed.). (1993). *Africanisms in Afro-languages to their offspring and (2) not having access, American Language Varieties*. Athens: University of Georgia Press. This is one of the most comprehensive texts on the plantation. As a result, creolization is believed on African Creole languages.

Smitherman, Geneva. (2000). *Talkin That Talk: Language, to shed light on universal language processes and Culture and Education in African America*. New York: structures, and these structures are believed to be Routledge. This text discusses many aspects of the lan-reflected in Creole languages. Again, a major assump-guage of Africans in the United States.

tion of this approach is that African languages were socially irrelevant and, therefore, do not need to be considered when examining creolization.

It is precisely this assumption that is disputed by **CREOLIZATION**

the proponents of the third approach, the substratist approach. The substratist approach presumes that Creolization is a term used in linguistics to refer to the creolization entails the modification not of European process of language creation in societies where speak-languages but of African languages. Indeed, African ers from widely different linguistic backgrounds have languages, this approach argues, continued to play a felt the need to communicate. Such a situation obvi-significant role in the lives of enslaved Africans and ously prevailed in the Americas during the enslave-must therefore be taken into full consideration where ment period when Africans, indigenous people, and creolization is concerned. This approach highlights Europeans found themselves forced to communicate and questions the arrogant bias of scholars who have although they spoke languages that varied greatly. The dismissed, many times without much care, African outcome of creolization is Creole languages.

languages and their possible contribution to Creole Although creolization is a concept that has become languages, although similarities between these lan-quite widespread, it is nonetheless plagued by great guages and Creole languages are often obvious. What ambiguity. In fact, there is no general consensus as to the substratist approach asserts most clearly is the what exactly creolization entails. There have been need for thorough and careful examination of the three general, and at times not necessarily exclusive, sociohistorical context in which creolization occurred, approaches to creolization in the American context, be rather than the a priori yet unjustifiable dismissal of it North America or the Caribbean. The first approach, African languages as irrelevant to creolization.

which is Eurocentric, has defined creolization as pri-Over time, creolization has been used to describe marily a process of linguistic simplification in which areas of cultural change and creativity other than lan-Africans have adapted a European language, with the guage, such as a cuisine, music, and so on. In the end,

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 205

The Crisis———205

creolization is believed to produce a new culture, mainstream press. Never pulling its punches, The a new identity. Generally speaking, creolization is Crisis has done far more than merely draw attention associated with rapid cultural change, although more to racial discrimination—it has also disparaged the questions than answers have been formulated about rationale of such beliefs, pillorying prejudice and the process, since a lack of conceptual clarity contin-providing an alternative view of black Americans.

ues. Recently, some scholars have suggested that Founded in the summer of 1910 by W.E.B. Du creolization is occurring on a worldwide scale as a Bois, the publication took its name, at the insistence result of globalization (i.e., Westernization), espe-of Mary White Ovington and William English cially in urban areas. Some have even praised this Walling, from a James Russell Lowell poem titled development as enriching and necessary. Interestingly

“The Present Crisis.” Still, there is no question that Du enough, though, what is suggested here is that while Bois was very much the inspiration and driving force Europeans retain their culture intact, other peoples behind the journal. Du Bois had been keenly aware of undergo a process of cultural change and identity that the need to establish what he called “a Negro journal”

brings them closer to the European model. Once since 1905, and he had already gone some way to again, Europe is assumed to be the ideal target of achieving this as editor of Moon Illustrated Weekly cultural change—a most Eurocentric stance that, (1906) and Horizon (1907–1910). Nevertheless,

The unfortunately, continues to inform, and probably Crisis started a new genre in black journalism, appeal-obscure, much of the literature on creolization.

ing to a national audience and functioning as a forum for black intellectuals. The first issue, in November of

— Ama Mazama

*1910, declared that the publication was to be a newspaper and a review of opinion and literature, while it **FURTHER READING***

would also print a few short articles and provide an Alleyne, Mervin. (1981). Afro-American Language Varieties.

editorial column to comment on topical issues. For a Ann Arbor, MI: Karoma Press. This remains an excellent number of decades, its full title was The Crisis: A discussion of the shortcomings of Eurocentric theories, Record of the Darker Races, and its contents through-while making a compelling case for the significance of the out time have reflected its historical importance as the input of African languages during the creolization process.

Alleyne, Mervin. (1988). The Roots of Jamaican Culture.

chronicler of and commentator on black history, London: Pluto Press. This extends the discussion about thought, and culture across the globe.

creolization to cultural spheres such as religion.

For the NAACP, an organization that has over-Christie, Pauline et al. (Eds.). (1999). Caribbean Linguistics whelmingly fought discrimination through litigation, Studies II. Port of Spain: University of the West Indies the entertaining and enlightening The Crisis has pro-Press. This is an interesting compilation of case studies of vided a useful counterpoint. The editorial freedom different Creole languages.

and critical analysis that the journal has provided has Hymes, Dell (Ed.). (1971). Pidginization and Creolization.

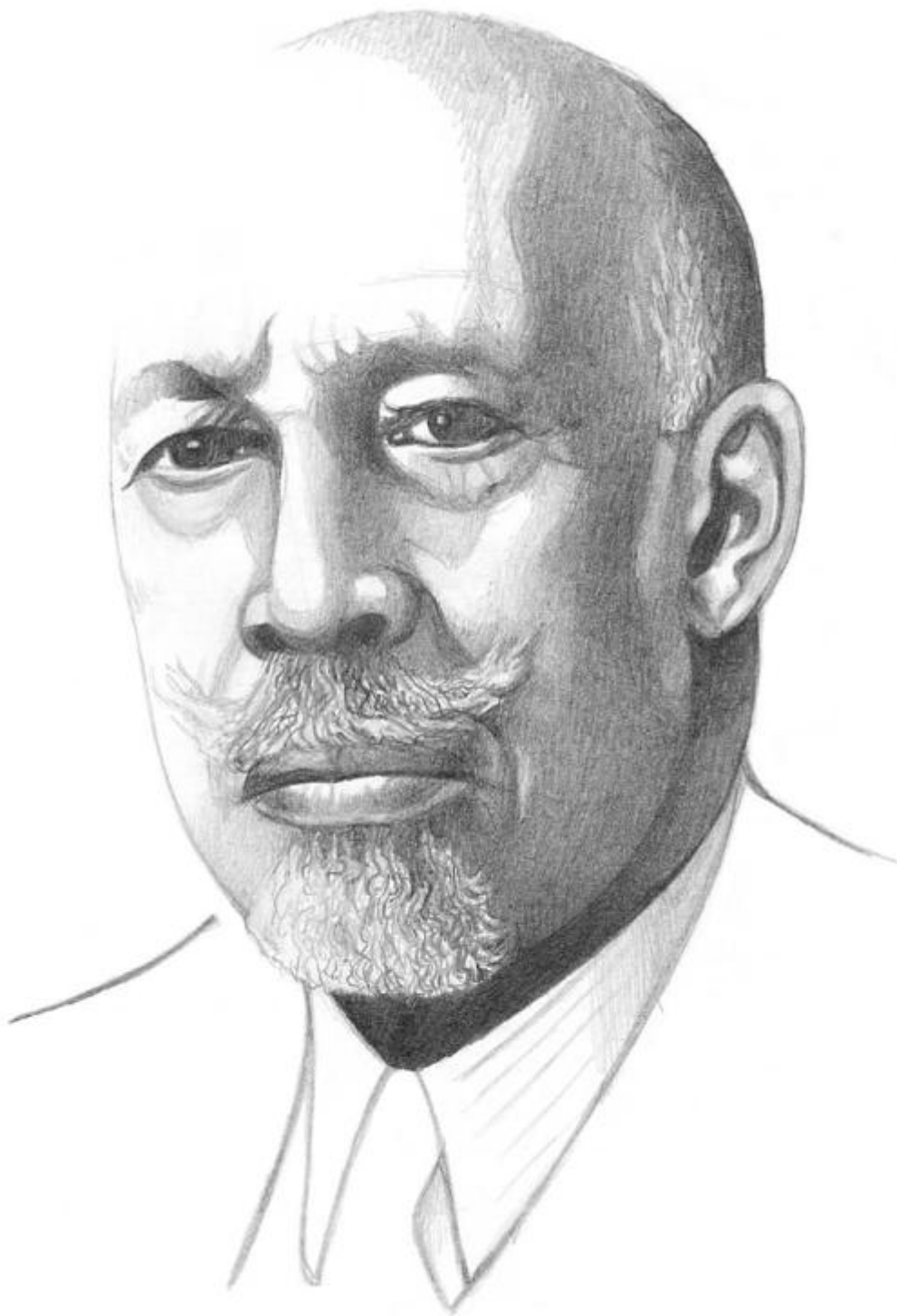
been its principal attraction, though. Along with the New York: Cambridge University Press. This text remains a classic reference text on the early issues raised by linguists rigorous technical and professional layout that busion the creolization process.

ness manager Augustus Dill provided during the early years, such attributes easily made The Crisis the premier black periodical in the first half of the 20th century. All 1,000 copies of the first issue quickly

THE CRISIS

sold out; within a year, its monthly circulation was 9,000; by 1917, that figure had risen to 50,000.

The Crisis is the publication of the National Association for the Advancement of Colored People and despite increased competition after World War II (NAACP), and it has provided one of the most impor-from journals such as Ebony (1945), Jet (1951), tant and influential forums in which the black experi-and Sepia (1952), The Crisis has continued to play ence has been documented and debated. From the a central role in discussions of issues from a black outset, the publication sought to repudiate the typically perspective. Its articles cover myriad subjects, from negative image that the media have provided of black celebrations of black achievement and success to Americans, while at the same time challenging the denunciations of the indignities suffered through political and cultural hegemony of the white-controlled racism.



C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 206

W.E.B. DU BOIS'S

CONTROVERSIAL EDITORIALS

As a journal of opinion, the most important feature of The Crisis is its editorial columns. Pertinent, provocative, and persuasive, each editorial takes one current affairs issue and discusses its significance for African Americans. In September of 1911 and January of 1913, W.E.B. Du Bois penned two of his most vitriolic attacks on what he termed "Anglo-Saxon Civilization." Du Bois was a polemicist without contemporary, and his editorials were characteristic of the deeply sardonic way in which he lampooned the pretense of American racial etiquette.

In 1919, Du Bois wrote some of his most acidulous criticisms of discrimination in the article "The Black Man in the Great War," as well as in his oft-cited editorial "Returning Soldiers." Du Bois was a master rhetorician who used his appealing aphoristic style well, as illustrated particularly in the editorial: "We return. We return from fighting. We return fighting."

Here Du Bois was not just castigating discrimination but actually laying down a bold agenda on which protest could continue. In response, the U.S. Post Office delayed the mailing of certain copies of The Crisis, and Attorney General A. Mitchell Palmer charged that the publication was denigrating and racist against white society. In Congress, Representative James F. Brynes cited the articles as the type Dr. W.E.B. Du Bois, historian, philosopher, writer, activist of journalism that had fanned the flames of racial violence.

The reaction that Du Bois's articles provoked provoked personality from its offices, but it did not reduce nevertheless confirmed that The Crisis, by showing the publication's aggressive journalistic style. Roy African Americans as historical agents, presented an Wilkins's 1935 interview with Senator Huey Long, image that subverted the stereotype. With its emphasis

"Dictator of the State of Louisiana," illustrated this on identifying the most important issues of the day point when the editor made no attempt to replace and commenting on them as they relate to African the senator's

offensive language with more anodyne Americans, *The Crisis* has always covered a broad range of topics. Likewise, as school desegregation began in the late 1950s, and the promise of desegregation wore thin, *The Crisis*, with characteristic irony, issues affect African Americans. Still, denunciations recalled the slogan "truly free in '63" from the 19th-century Jim Crow laws remained paramount until all such century movement for the abolition of slavery.

laws were abolished.

Throughout its existence the journal has bristled with indignation, partly as an attempt to stimulate debate among its readers. "Do not hesitate to criticize us. We **THE WIDE-RANGING OPINIONS**

want ideas," wrote Du Bois in 1911 in an early issue of **AND IMPORTANCE OF THE JOURNAL**

The Crisis. Even today, *The Crisis* seeks a diversity of Du Bois's resignation from *The Crisis* in June of opinions rather than a single definitive opinion, insist-1934 may have removed the journal's most prickly ing there is more than one way to tackle discrimination.

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 207

***The Crisis*———207**

Even though *The Crisis* never became synonymous as being equally important in showcasing examples with the Harlem Renaissance in the way that the of black achievement. The practice of printing the Urban League's *Opportunity* magazine did, it is photographs of black college and high school gradu-important to recognize the type of coverage that the ates similarly provided examples to be emulated.

publication has provided for black artists. It is not just Although *The Crisis* has eschewed any kind of that *The Crisis* has actively encouraged black litera-political affiliation, its columns have nevertheless pro-ture and art; for it has also played a significant role in vided continuous analysis of

political events as they helping to define such work. During the 1920s, the relate to black Americans. In 1912, for example, Du journal was unquestionably a passionate promoter of Bois declared his support for Democratic candidate the work of black artists. Through the influence of Woodrow Wilson, on the premise that Wilson was the literary editor Jessie Redmon Fauset, the journal's candidate most likely to challenge racism in America.

front covers were regularly adorned with the illustra-Political coverage of the 1924 presidential election tions of artists such as Hale Woodruff, Aaron Douglas, focused on the voting records of each of the three and Charles Alston, while its columns were filled with main candidates. During the course of this campaign, the writings of Langston Hughes, Gwendolyn Bennett, the journal lambasted Robert LaFollette for not Jean Toomer, and Wallace Thurman. Likewise, The openly condemning the Ku Klux Klan and, at the Crisis was one of the first journals to organize literary same time, cautioned its readers that both main parties and artistic competitions for black artists, a practice supported white supremacy. During the presidential that it continued until 1933.

campaign of 1932, The Crisis was equally careful Still, the most important role that The Crisis played to avoid openly endorsing any candidate, although was that of ascribing meaning and direction to literary this did not prevent its editor from listing the reasons and artistic works. And it was this that made the pub-why black Americans should not support Herbert lication an early advocate of Black Studies. In an arti-Hoover. This type of coverage was less concerned cle in its June 1921 issue, and in an entire issue in with aligning the publication with a particular candi-October 1926, The Crisis averred that artistic portray-date or party than with exploring the possibilities for als of African Americans should celebrate and glorify African American voters.

African Americans. Such sentiments undoubtedly In recent years, the political endorsements of The reflected its editor's support for the "black is beauti-Crisis have become more explicit, as evidenced by ful" doctrine. But they also underline the role the jour-current editor Victoria Valentine's support, in the nal played in shaping African Americans' opinions autumn

of 2002, for New Jersey politician and advocate about themselves and their world. The publication of cate for school vouchers Cory Booker. In response *Brownies Book*, a magazine for “children of the sun,”

to Valentine’s taking a political stand, publications between January of 1920 and December of 1921, similar to the *Black Commentator* have been swift to note and have attempted to instill pride in younger generations how such endorsements contravene NAACP policy of African Americans. Finally, the list of works by and the best interests of African Americans.

black authors that Arthur B. Spingarn compiled, and that were printed in *The Crisis* between 1937 and

THE CRISIS IN A GLOBAL ERA 1968, represent an essential bibliographic resource for anyone interested in Black Studies.

Even though some have insisted that Du Bois wrote The annual special editions of *The Crisis* have according to the shibboleths of European thinking, it served as an important means by which the experience should be noted that the focus and perspective of *The Crisis* of black Americans have been debated. Every *Crisis* has never exclusively centered on the plight of June, from 1914 on, an entire issue was devoted to the black Americans and their struggle against discrimination; in October, the focus shifted to nation in the Western world. The Chinese Revolution children. Both editions were required reading for and changes in British Imperial rule in India, both anyone connected with the raising of children or the of which took place in 1912, evoked an enthusiastic instruction of students, and the circulation of each response from Du Bois, whose comments reflected moved well beyond regular subscribers. Such editions a sympathy for all who suffered racial discrimination provided a practical means of making significant contribution. Moreover, in an editorial in January of 1933 in improvements in the realm of black pedagogy, as well response to Japan’s attack on China, Du Bois wrote

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 208

of the need for all peoples suffering discrimination **FURTHER READING**

to unite and face their oppressors together. In short, Daniel, Walter. (1982). *Black Journals of the United States*.

he drew many parallels between those suffering Westport, CT: Greenwood Press. This book provides a racial discrimination in Asia and the struggle of basic but important introduction to black publications in African Americans against Jim Crow, thus exhibiting America. Its treatment of *The Crisis* covers the period from what some have termed his transracial view of the 1910 to the late 1970s.

world.

Fraser, C. Gerald. (1980). *The Crisis 1910–1980: A Record of With* polylingual editor James W. Ivy taking over the *Darker Races*. *The Crisis*, 87(10). This is a trim account in 1950, and with the onslaught of the Cold War, *The* of the publication's early life that considers the role of *The Crisis* in wider events like the Harlem Renaissance. It also *Crisis* published an increasing number of articles that attempts to define the publication's role in the post–civil dealt with discrimination in other areas of the world.

rights era.

The journal documented anti-Dutch independence Lewis, David Levering. (1993). *W.E.B. Du Bois: Biography of movements in Indonesia*, as well as mounting racial *a Race, 1868–1919*. New York: Owl Books. This is the tensions in Cuba, Brazil, and Martinique. Of greater most comprehensive study of the genesis and impact of Du importance, though, were the articles that Ivy com-Bois's thinking. It provides an important discussion of the missioned to be written by Africans about the condi-relationship between the publication and the NAACP.

Rudwick, Elliot M. (1958). *W.E.B. Du Bois in the Role of tions in their own colonially administered countries*.

Crisis Editor. *Journal of Negro History*, 43(3), 123–142.

In 1961 alone, *The Crisis* printed two such articles, Rudwick argues that Du Bois was a theorist whose editor-

“Angola Office” and “The National Front for the ship of the publication encouraged him to develop an Liberation of Angola.” Articles such as these reflect inflated sense of his own powers, which contributed to the how *The Crisis* has continually sought to create a financial and political problems between the publication sense of common purpose among African Americans and the NAACP.

and those living under colonial rule in Africa. This view has been presented most clearly in the publication’s coverage of the fight against apartheid in South Africa in the 1980s, as well as in recent articles on

THE CRISIS OF THE

racism in the global era. The unifying theme of such

NEGRO INTELLECTUAL

coverage has been the idea that all who have suffered discrimination because of their race share a common experience.

The Crisis of the Negro Intellectual is Harold Cruse’s Since its foundation, *The Crisis* has been a tremen-exploration of what black intellectuals from the mid dously important journal of black culture and think-1940s up until the mid 1960s were not doing, followed ing. By devotedly recording the events and issues that by what he thought they ideally should be doing. As have faced African Americans, *The Crisis* has contin-Cruse was on a mission to analyze and critique the ually helped to define what it means to be black in realm of historical and contemporary black intellec-America. Its broad focus on all aspects of life for tual leadership, virtually every intellectual, activist, African Americans marked an important departure scholar, and writer was subject to his pen. Among the from media that only provided stereotypically nega-people that he took it upon himself to criticize was tive coverage of minority groups. Similarly, by show-Marcus Garvey. He claimed that Garvey did not fulfill ing the deleterious nature of all forms of prejudice and his mission of repatriation to Africa and the proof

of discrimination all over the world, *The Crisis* has this was the fact that there were no Garvey settlements helped to reconceptualize issues of race in to the con-on the continent of Africa. He also challenged the text of the modern world. The columns in *The Crisis* political unity of Garvey and his movement, the have been one of the most significant sources of opin- Universal Negro Improvement Association (UNIA). In ion within black America, with its journalists provid-addition, Cruse claimed that there was no place in the ing broad coverage of the black struggle for freedom black community for black or white Communists. He and its editorials helping to flesh out a framework for even blamed Communism for the fall of one of the black intellectuals.

greatest leadership organizations, The African Blood Brotherhood (ABB), saying that Communism caused a

— *Andrew Michael Fearnley*

rift among the organization's members.

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 209

Cultural Genocide——209

Cruse's focus was on creating a new approach to *Intellectual* was able to do was to transcend its own time resolve the issues left behind by other black intellec-and find relevance in another generation.

tuals by synthesizing their works. He recommended

— *Deonte Hollowell*

that the following four tasks be taken up by all black intellectuals:

FURTHER READING

1. knowing their own intellectual ancestors and Cruse, Harold. (1967). *The Crisis of the Negro Intellectual: the movements in which those ancestors were A Historic Analysis of the Failure of Black Leadership*.

involved

New York: Quill Press. This is Cruse's major work.

Du Bois, W. E. B. (1996). *The Souls of Black Folk*. New York: 2. synthesizing integration and black nationalism Penguin Books. (Original work published 1903). It was on into a single and consistent analysis publication of this groundbreaking book that Du Bois 3. identifying and prioritizing political, economic, prophesied that the major problem in 20th-century America and cultural needs for the advancement of would be that of the color line.

Woodson, Carter G. (1977). *The Mis-Education of the Negro*.

the race

Washington, DC: Associated Publishers. (Original work 4. understanding that American conditions are published 1933). In this book, Woodson asserted that black unique when analyzing the American race issue men and women were not being properly educated because their education caused them to attempt to assimilate into Cruse structured his text to include social com-white American culture.

mentary, biography, historical essays, and political commentary. He concentrated on certain issues affecting the black community, such as the rift between black political radicals and black political conserva-
CULTURAL GENOCIDE

tives. What Cruse observed as problematic was that intellectuals often had disputes over strategies of Cultural genocide is the deliberate and systematic protesting and the idea of accommodation. He insisted annihilation of a people's culture by another group of that black history was a history of conflict between people. Cultural genocide's weapons of choice are integrationist and nationalist forces in politics, eco-physical terror and violence, psychological torture, and nomics, and culture. Politics, economics, and culture seduction. Indeed, cultural genocide always entails the were arguably Cruse's greatest ideological concerns.

negation of the worth of the culture to be suppressed, He maintained that these three issues (and blacks'

and it often seeks to enlist the acquiescence and active coming to terms with a synthesis of them) were of cooperation of those whose culture is to be destroyed.

major importance to black progress. Cruse asserted This is done primarily through intense propaganda and that, of these three, culture is the most important, bribery, making cultural genocide at times quite subtle because blacks must understand themselves before and all the more effective.

they will be able to make any meaningful political or As far as Africans are concerned, cultural genocide economic gains as a whole.

can only be understood within the context of white Cruse's book, though written in the 1960s, is still supremacy. Most destruction of African culture widely read and appreciated by Black Studies scholars occurred due to the pervasive myth of European and students. Many of the historical truths outlined by absolute, God-granted cultural superiority and conse-Cruse then still hold true today; also, Cruse's analyses of quent burden to civilize the world (i.e., to mold it in these truths are currently accepted in many intellectual Europe's image). The destruction of inferior cultural circles. For example, he spoke extensively about the forms was to be undertaken with ardor, with a major manner in which the American mass media controls conversion to European culture as the expected and society, and particularly black life. He also focused on desired outcome.

the importance of black artistic expression, and how it Africans first experienced a widespread and sys-was virtually owned and operated by white publishing tematic attack on their culture during the period of companies. He cited the collapse of the American Negro their enslavement on American soil. African culture Theatre, which was due to white involvement. Thus, one was described by Europeans as primitive and barbaric.

of the most important things that *The Crisis of the Negro* Physically and forcefully uprooted from their original

210———**Cultural Genocide**

land, millions of Africans were pressured to abandon *development*, which are both euphemisms for the their African cultural ways and adopt European cul-Western way of life.

ture. This was particularly true in the area of religion At times, cultural genocide may become so effec-and spirituality, where the acceptance of a blond, tively implemented by the oppressive group that many blue-eyed Jesus Christ was literally beaten into “hea-of the oppressed internalize the racist rationale for the then” Africans, while the worship of African deities contempt in which their culture is held. As a result, and ancestral spirits was conveniently equated with they start identifying with their oppressors’ culture as satanic practices and severely and harshly punished.

if, or wishing, it were theirs, while disassociating from Africans on the continent of Africa had similar their own culture. Africans with this perspective show experiences during European colonization in the 19th no interest nor competence in their own cultural and century and later. Indeed, during that period, numer-historical traditions. Having been thoroughly brain-ous Christian missionary schools were established to washed, and having accepted the European myth of impose the adoption of European culture and aban-African inferiority and European superiority, they take donment of African culture. In these schools, Africans pride in perpetuating an alien culture. These Africans were forced to at least publicly accept Christianity and are culturally dislocated. This dislocation may be so reject their own beliefs and rituals. Failure to do so extreme that it leads them to destroy their own culture.

resulted in brutal floggings and traumatic humilia-Such was the case, for example, in Haiti, when many tions. At other times, Africans could receive medical Africans actively participated in the many anti-Vodu care in clinics set up by Christian missionaries only campaigns organized by the Vatican and destroyed after they had publicly renounced their religion and African sacred ritual objects such as drums, all in the recognized the Christian god as the only true god.

name of Jesus Christ. This dislocation is also observ-Along with the imposition of Christianity came able on the aesthetic level, with many Africans on the the imposition of European, Christian names on continent and in the diaspora applying dangerous Africans. Naming had always been held as of the chemicals to their skin and hair, or subjecting them-utmost importance in African culture. Indeed, the selves to painful and costly operations, in a futile and name reflects the essence of the person named.

painful attempt to look white, or at least less black.

Therefore, when Europeans imposed European names However, many Africans have resisted cultural on Africans, they dealt a severe blow to African cul-genocide and remained the faithful keepers of African ture by inscribing Africans in a European-dominated cultural traditions, often at the risk of being greatly historical and cultural space. In a similar vein, African ostracized. African history is replete with examples of languages were described as inadequate, worthy not Africans refusing to accept African culture as obsolete even of being called languages but only of being and to participate in its destruction. Haiti again pro-called dialects. Unsurprisingly, Africans were vides a good example of this, with African spirits fully, expected to stop using them and embrace European consciously, and successfully being called upon by languages. Again, failure to do so automatically trans-enslaved Africans to overthrow slavery, white racism, lated into physical and psychological abuse. African and white supremacy in the 19th century. In the United children caught speaking their mother tongue in States, many Africans publicly rejected assimilation, school had to wear signs such as “I am a donkey” or the expected result of a successful cultural genocide,

“I am stupid,” pay a fine, and/or wear some symbol while encouraging Africans to return to Africa as the that identified them as sinners.

cultural source of their being. Such was the message The most effective weapon Europeans used against of Marcus Garvey in the 1920s and of Malcom X and African languages, though, was bribery, since the other black cultural nationalists in the 1960s. More scholarships and better paying jobs during the colo-recently, this is the message of Afrocentricity.

nial period were reserved for those who demonstrated

— *Ama Mazama*

fluency in a European language. This, unfortunately, remains true to this day, and it is a clear indication that cultural genocide continues unabated. Although brutal **FURTHER READING**

punishments may not be common anymore, Africans Asante, Molefi Kete. (1987). *The Afrocentric Idea*.

nevertheless remain under tremendous pressure to Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This is Asante's emulate Europeans, in the name of *modernization* and theoretical work on Afrocentricity.

C-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:03 PM Page 211

Curse of the Door of No Return———211

Asante, Molefi Kete. (2001). *Afrocentricity. The Theory of Before a Ship Would Come. Given Two Containers, Social Change*. Chicago: African American Images. This is One For Easing Themselves and One For Food, Many the third edition of Asante's first book on Afrocentricity, Became so Sick and Weak That They Eased which was published in 1980 by Amulefi Publishing of Themselves Where They Slept. On the Floor of This Buffalo, New York.

Dungeon the Blood of Menses Combined With Urine Asante, Molefi Kete. (1992). *Kemet, Afrocentricity, and Knowledge*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is an and Feces to Make This One Hell-Hole of Evil.

important work on the African cultural location and dislo-You, the Door of No Return, Was a Silent Witness cation issue.

to Human Brutality. You Saw the Faces of Evil in Fanon, Frantz. (1967). *Black Skin, White Masks*. New York: Those Who Whipped Our Backs as We Passed Grove Press. Fanon discusses in a very insightful manner Through.

the devastating impact of slavery and colonization on the You Thought We Would Not Return. You Stood By African and European psyche.

as We Slipped Through Your Portals to the Americas.

Gerima, Haile. (Producer/Director). (1994). *Sankofa* [Film].

Washington, DC: Gerima Films. This film does a superb You Made History and Became History as We Wept, job of illustrating enslaved Africans' refusal to abandon as We Cried, Where Is God?! Where Is God?!

their culture and the perverse tactics used during slavery by With Shackles and Leg Irons We Left Here, Europeans trying to destroy African culture and replace it Uncertain About Our Destiny.

with their own.

They Called You the Door of No Return. We Vowed Memmi, Albert. (1991). *The Colonizer and the Colonized*.

as We Left Through This Door, as We Saw This Boston: Beacon Press. This is a well-known, essential text Beautiful Land for the Last Time, That Our Children on the dichotomization of the colonial world.

Would Return.

Mudimbe, Valentin Y. (1988). *The Invention of Africa*.

Bloomington: Indiana University Press. Mudimbe's book There are Things That You Did Not See: On The is an excellent study of the conversion process that lies at Thousands of Ships That Took 60 Days to Find the the heart of the attempted destruction of African culture by Americas, We Tasted Agony Often and Gloried When Europeans in Africa.

Someone Died Saying, Gone She to Her Mother's Country or Gone He to His Friend's Home.

You Cannot See From This Beautiful Coast the Cotton Fields of Georgia or the Sugar Cane Fields of **CURSE OF THE**

Jamaica. You Do Not See the Banana Plantations of **DOOR OF NO RETURN**

Costa Rica or Brazil.

Hear Me! Hear Me Now!

The curse below is one of the most popular of the Have We Not Returned?! Are We Not Africa's curses that were uttered for nearly 20 years at each Children? Is This Not Our Ancestors' Land?

“door of no return,” as the various doors along the The Dismemberment of Our Cultures, Our coast of Africa were called. These were the doors Religions, and Our Traditions Often Left Us Broken through which Africans were led to the waiting ships and Broken-Hearted.

to be transported to the Americas and Caribbean to be Tortured, Beaten, Lynched, Raped, and Worked to enslaved.

Death in the Americas, We Have Dreamed Pre-Enslavement Dreams and Walked the Nights of This Land With Our Memories, Asking What Evil Befell **THE CURSE OF THE ARROGANT DOOR**

Us?

Through You, and a Thousand Doors Like You, Doors Now Who Have You Seen Here? Have We Not of No Return, Millions of Africans Passed.

Returned? Have I Not Brought Here the Pebbles Captured, Held Here in Bondage, Men and Women From the Beaches of the Lands to Which We Were and Children, Few Older Than Thirty, Suffered in Scattered? And You Are No More the Door of Intolerable Conditions.

No-Return!

In This Place, Women, 200 Strong, Would Be Kept This curse was read by Molefi Kete Asante at Here in This Dungeon, Sometimes For 6 Months Elmina Castle in Ghana during the 1980s and 1990s.

D

tended to reject the dark-skinned dolls as “dirty”

DARK GHETTO

or “bad.” Further, when asked which doll resembled them, many of the children ran away in tears.

Dark Ghetto: Dilemmas of Social Power (1965) is Ironically, Clark exhibited a similar aversion to his Kenneth Bancroft Clark’s seminal sociological and own ancestry by declaring that the American Negro is psychological treatise, in which he likened the no more African that he is Danish, Indian, or Irish.

American ghetto, with Harlem as the prototype, to What these tests revealed is that by the age of 7, an urban colony in which the almost exclusively most black children are painfully aware of the negative black inhabitants are emotionally and psychologically connotations associated with their dark skin. Society, damaged and scarred as a result of the perpetual racism, primarily through the mass media, has taught them the greed, insensitivity, discrimination, and fear of a white unavoidable lesson of their so-called inferiority. This ruling class that rationalizes racial segregation on the sets in motion a cycle of self-hatred and group-hatred basis of the alleged inherent inferiority, subhumanity, that is intergenerational and generally lifelong. The and brutality of the “Negro.” Written in the wake of National Association for the Advancement of Colored two 1964 events—the Harlem riot and the passage of People (NAACP) used the doll-test findings as a major the Civil Rights Bill of 1964, *Dark Ghetto* was Clark’s part of the landmark 1954 Supreme Court case *Brown* self-proclaimed “anguished cry.”

v. Board of Education, which ruled that school segregation is unconstitutional . Although born in the Panama Canal Zone, Clark was

raised by his mother in Harlem. Thus, he approached his Clark identified several strategies that have histori-boyhood home as an “involved observer.” Eschewing cally been used by blacks in America to effect social the notion of objectivity as unrealistic and unattain-change: prayer, isolation, accommodation, despair, able, he sought the truth behind the Harlem “pathol-alienation, law and maneuver, direct encounter, and ogy”: the staggering rates of juvenile delinquency, truth. He also named two racial fantasies employed in family instability, drug addiction, infant mortality, and America by blacks and whites alike—accommodation homicide. What he found was a “devouring” ghetto and acceptance, as well as a third fantasy used exclu-filled with bars, churches, and fortune-tellers—and sively by blacks—militancy. Ultimately, he posited that funeral homes. The only constant he reported is inade-the ghetto is, in simplest terms, the result of a struggle quacy, with its ever-present attendants: fantasy, decay, for power between the victims, who want change, and abandonment, and defeat.

the victors, who resist change. Clark asserted that any Perhaps the most widely reported finding in *Dark* real change in the American racial quagmire will *Ghetto* is that of the “doll tests,” which consisted of require a joint effort of blacks and whites, who share a showing four identical dolls, two black and two white, common destiny.

to black children across the country, some as young as 3 years old. These children, when given a choice,

— *Pamela Yaa Asantewaa Reed*

213

D-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:44 PM Page 214

214——— *The Destruction of Black Civilization*

FURTHER READING

His profound work recovered a lost and destroyed history, and he intended it to make known the wholly Clark, Kenneth Bancroft. (1964). *Youth in the*

Ghetto: A Study of the Consequences of Powerlessness and a Blueprint unified guiding ontological system that had persevered *for Change*. New York: Harlem Youth Opportunities from a black past to a black present over several Unlimited. It was this study that would later be expanded thousands of years. An important aspect of his work and published as *Dark Ghetto*.

involves the utilitarian directive of an African ethos that Clark, Kenneth Bancroft. (1986). *Prejudice and Your Child* can guide all black people onward. The search for a (2nd ed.). Middletown, CT: Wesleyan University Press.

black heritage was a major concern for Chancellor (Original edition published 1955). This is an extremely Williams, for he believed that only when African useful sourcebook, as it summarizes the results of the descendants learn about their past as a people can they doll tests and other related research. It was this book that brought Clark's work to the attention of the NAACP

find their true identity, and he perceptively acknowl-when they were preparing to challenge legal segregation in edged that otherwise black people will be gliding in America's public schools.

the swales and currents of the heritages of other people.

Karenga, Maulana. (2002). *Introduction to Black Studies* (3rd Williams's admonitions to black people can be ed.). Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press. Karenga described as sobering, and his imperative is prophetic gives a concise yet comprehensive summary of *Dark* given that he conducted his research in the tumultuous *Ghetto*, in addition to contextualizing it within the overall times of the late 1950s through the 1960s. His work is Black Studies movement.

a concise summarization of an intended two-volume review of African history, and it contributed to the revision of history that has sought to make things right

THE DESTRUCTION

and truthful. The belief that African descendants need

OF BLACK CIVILIZATION

to know the truth of black history, which remained unacknowledged in the West for centuries, drove Chancellor Williams's *The Destruction of Black* Williams's research.

Civilization: Great Issues of a Race from 4500 B.C.

to 2000 A.D. is a book of enduring power that has **THE MIXED RACE QUESTION**

retained its ability to provoke from the time of its first publication by Third World Press in the 1970s. In it, Williams made a distinction between black ancient Williams begins telling of the destruction of black civ-Egyptians and mixed-race ancient Egyptians, who are ilization with his own story, the story of an inquisitive also known as Afro-Asians. It is the mixed-race ancient young boy who grew up in South Carolina and wanted Egyptians who predominate later on in history and who to know why it was that white folks had all the power primarily reside in northern ancient Egypt. The ancient and control. Thus it could be said that when he was Afro-Asians unfortunately sold out the ancient black very young, Chancellor Williams began the monu-race, and they even tried to conquer the blacks and deny mental task of striving to reveal a vital evidenced them their true place in history. The ancient Afro-history of black people. As an adult, Williams worked Asians were the result of miscegenation between male 16 years to accomplish this task because, as he Asians from the northern region of ancient Egypt and explains it in his book, he needed to make it an female Africans from the southern region of ancient unhurried summary of history. His research worked at Egypt, specifically from Nubia, which is also known as specifically answering several important questions: ancient Ethiopia. When the Afro-Asians seized control (1) How did all-black Egypt become all-white Egypt?

of ancient Egypt, Europeans assumed them to be white, (2) What were some of the details of that process which helped to exclude any connection

between them that assisted in erasing the feats of the African race and what has been called Black Africa.

from recorded history? (3) How was it that the black According to Williams, at certain times these inventors of writing came to lose this art? (4) Are the mixed-race people were seen as being black, but they African people one race? (5) If so, how do we explain were actually half Africans who were fighting for con-the multiple languages and cultural varieties? (6) Is trol of Black Africa. Black Africa in this instance there some historical explanation for black disunity should be construed as stemming from Nubia, which and black self-hatred? (7) How do we explain black is seen as the heartland of the ancient blacks. Nubia desire for white and Asian rulership?

began in the Sudd Swamplands, included southern

D-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:44 PM Page 215

***The Destruction of Black Civilization*———215**

parts of Sudan, and extended up to what is commonly people was not an enlightened American or European referred to as the first cataract on the Nile River but is invention but an African reality early on in ancient actually the last when you are going down the river.

African civilizations. He wanted them to understand Ancient Egypt (or Kemet) is insightfully described as that passed down through the ages was the African the land of the black people instead of the black lands, value that the rights of the individual never come and ancient Egypt is described as the oldest daughter before the rights of the whole or the community: of ancient Ethiopia (or Nubia). Williams also noted Although invading Europeans and Arabs destroyed that ancient Ethiopia should not be confused with the African self-governing and harmonious social modern Ethiopia, as ancient Ethiopia was in southern existence, the memory of such ancient unity needs Egypt past the first cataract and Sudan.

to be maintained by present African descendants.

Williams asserted the importance of understanding that certain disruptions and critical societal situations **WILLIAMS'S EXPLANATION OF BLACKNESS**

resulted in Africans' interminable struggle to survive The explanation Williams found for the children of the and are the prime cause of African disunity.

sun is construed as one key element in understanding blackness or black skin tone, which is seen as a bless-THE PURPOSE OF

ing from the Sun God himself. Black skin is a shield **STUDYING BLACKS' HISTORY**

from the rays of the sun and therefore a strong, valued human attribute, and this, of course, is the opposite of Williams believed it was imperative to study the what traditional European rationalism would have past and understand the historical determinants that black people believe. Williams also mentioned the precipitated Africans' social disruption and disarray courage of Queen Candace, who stood tall with a black as a first step in working toward a necessary change.

army before the Macedonian leader Alexander made Williams pointed out the inevitable—that African his way through Egypt (which was heavily populated descendants have to exist with whites in an ultimate by this time, in 332 B.C.E., with Afro-Asians). Of cooperative society. Thus he instructed blacks to course, Alexander had great appreciation for the mili-reformulate and reject the need for white adulation, to tary might of Nubia, and rather than settling there, he strike out pretenses about integrationism that particu-moved on to conquer ancient Egypt just up to the first larly await the beneficence of whites, and to mandate cataract, where most of the Afro-Asians resided. He respect on their own terms as Africans. Williams pre-did not venture into Nubia. Williams urged his readers sented a solution and guidelines for adhering to a mas-to remember not only historical figures like Candace ter plan that would enable global reorganization of but also Piankhi, Shabaka, Shaka, Shyaam, Nzinga, African people toward an ideal unity that all African and Mutota, as well as African towns and cities like descendants could abide by. The resolve would not Makuria, Alwa,

Ethiopia, Meroe, Axum, and Kush, only eternally liberate black minds that are white con-Ghana, Mali, Songhay, and Kuba.

trolled but also set out to rebuild the black greatness Thus Williams made a meaningful history known.

that once was. The proffered itinerary would reemerge In his exploration of antiquity, he noted Thebes and the genius that always had been an inherent part of Thebald, Napata, Elephantine, Nekheb, and places African people throughout the world. Affirmation of throughout Nubia-Cush in ancient Ethiopia, and Williams's concept of the destruction of an all-white maintained their historical significance. Also, and sole standing civilization is the key primordial Williams encouraged his readers to learn about step in constructing a better humanity.

Musawarat, Nuri, Paopolis, Kerma, Assuan, Soleb,

— *Jorge Serrano*

Abu Simbel, Kurusku, Samnah, Philae, Kawa, Dongola, and so on. He stressed that African descen-FURTHER READING

dants need to know black history, as it is part of the Hansberry, William Leo. (1977). *Africa and Africans: As Seen* legacy that was wiped out and that requires continu-by Classical Writers. Washington, DC: Howard University ous acknowledgement. Williams wanted African Press. These are the lecture notes of one of the first schol-descendants to know that African constitution, educa-ars to suggest the African origin of civilization.

tion, democracy, and justice were real, and also to Jackson, John A. (1972). *Man, God, and Civilization*. New recognize that the original concept of power to the Hyde Park, NY: University Books. This book has been used

D-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:44 PM Page 216

to bring hundreds of African American students to Edward Blyden from the Danish West Indies (now the consciousness about the role of Africans in history.

Virgin Islands); T.E.S. Scholes, J.A. Rogers, Robert James, George J. (1954). *Stolen Legacy*. New York: Lowe, Marcus Garvey, Leonard Barret, Erna Brodber, Philosophical Library. This is probably one of the most Lorna Goodison, and Mutabaruka from Jamaica; discussed books ever written by an African scholar. It has Molefi Kete Asante, Sheila Walker, and Wade Nobles been supported, defended, maligned, and criticized, yet it remains one of the most useful works for understanding from the United States; Arthur Schomberg from Puerto ancient history.

Rico; Jean Price-Mars from Haiti; John Jacob Thomas, George Padmore, C.L.R. James, Chalkdust, Bob Marley, Burning Spear, and Peter Stalin from Jamaica; George James, Norman Cameron, Ivan Van Sertima, **DIASPORA**

and Walter Rodney from Guyana; Aime Césaire, Joseph Zobel, and René Maran from Martinique; *Diaspora* is a word derived from the Greek word George Lamming and Kamau Brathwaite from *diaspeirein*, meaning “dispersion.” It was applied first Barbados; Maryse Condé, Ama Mazama, and Simone to the Greeks in the Hellenic world, and later to the Schwartz-Bart from Guadeloupe; and Nicolas Guillen Jews after the fall of Jerusalem. With the emergence from Cuba. The Rastafarian movement, calypso, reg-of the Zionist movement in Europe during the 19th gae, and *negritude* have all, in one way or the other, and early 20th centuries, the term *diaspora* was contributed to the acceptance of *diaspora* as a collec-almost exclusively applied to the Jews, encompassing tive term referencing the experience and culture of their experience under genocidal circumstances (as people of African descent.

in Nazi Germany) and adverse conditions throughout In today’s usage, the concept of the diaspora has the Middle East and Europe, as they longed to return two meanings and purposes. First, as a layperson’s term, to Palestine or Israel, which they claimed to be their it has been applied to all peoples of African descent homeland, as “God’s chosen people.”

who are scattered around the globe in countries such as France, Great Britain, Brazil, Belize, Mexico, the United States of America, and virtually every Caribbean **THE AFRICAN DIASPORA**

island. Interestingly, some experts have recently. Scholars began adopting the term *diaspora* as a tool included a segment of the Indian population, the Dalits to analyze the experience of people of African descent (formerly known as the untouchables), as a black dias-during the 20th century, especially during the 1950s pora, and many Dalits now claim to be of African and 1960s. Africans in the diaspora in the United States ancestry and identify their struggle with that of the of America during slavery implicitly expressed the African Americans from whom they take inspiration.

ideas of dispersion and a desire to return to the home-These and others make up part of what some scholars land when they invoked the idea of “Ethiopia,” using have called the Afro-Asian diaspora, whose constitutive biblical imagery, as they pondered the reasons for their element was the Indian Ocean slave trade carried out suffering. Marcus Garvey’s Back to Africa movement mainly by the Arabs and Middle Eastern traders and during the first two decades of the 20th century had merchants. The third layer of the black diaspora is embedded in it the concept of a homeland to which made up of voluntary migrants who have left their diasporic black men and women were encouraged to African homeland and are now found in other parts of return. However, diaspora as a concept never succeeded the world, especially France, Great Britain, and the in becoming a political tool capable of galvanizing United States. Therefore, viewed from this vantage black people and providing a common identity and pur-point, the African diaspora is a set of communities, not pose for those living in the Americas, Asia, and Europe.

a sovereign state with its own language, and connotes The concept of the diaspora has, however, been used simultaneously a process and a condition.

implicitly and explicitly by both intellectuals and non-intellectuals, and it has been the focus of and inspira-The Memory of and Desire for Return to Africa tion to many cultural movements and practices in the black world designed to advance black people’s agen-The constituent elements of the

diaspora, which das. For the sake of completeness, the following is a list become the focus and subject of scientific inquiry of the contributors to the concept noted by scholars: through the diaspora analytical model, include the

D-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:44 PM Page 217

Diaspora——217

following: memory of and desire or longing to return designation. Many noteworthy black scholars have to the homeland, commitment and some sense of extolled the virtues of the new paradigm as opposed responsibility to the well-being of that motherland, to the traditionally prevailing model. Indeed, the pro-and solidarity with other communities that claim the ponents emphasize that, as a concept, diaspora has a same original home. The most readily identifiable built-in comparative perspective of black people out-characteristics of diasporic African people are race side and within Africa, and it thus allows scholars and skin color (black or shades of black pigmentation, to have a comprehensive understanding of the black contingent upon how blackness is defined in a specific world at one point in time. From the perspective of national context); a history of suffering from slavery, a diaspora, one learns about the similarities that bind colonialism, and/or discrimination based on racism; and dissimilarities that separate the discrete experi-and a continuous struggle to reconquer their dignity ences of black people scattered across the globe.

and earn fair treatment from the international commu-Instead of using concepts based on political relanity, particularly the more technologically advanced tionships of hegemony—such as slavery, race, and and hegemonic Western world. Unfortunately, viewed colonialism—as the model to study black people, the from this perspective, the concept has the connotation diaspora paradigm makes black people the focus and of victimization rather than of agency on the part of the subject of the study. This is a recent accomplish-people of African origins, whose numbers are increas-ment, as up until the last few decades, the most ing rapidly on the world map.

common paradigm in the study of the experience of Indeed, when the number of Africans on the continent was the national or nation-state model, it is added to that of Africans in the diaspora, the undergirded by an analysis of race, slavery, freedom size of the black world is very large. Africa's population or liberation, legal status, and perhaps cultural manifestation is estimated at over 850 million. In Brazil alone, populations within the confines of national boundaries, people of African descent number at least 100 million, which prevented scholars from capturing the totality the largest black population of any country outside of the experience of Africans on the continent and of Africa; the U.S. black population is 33 million in the diaspora. Indeed, many now consider this (accounting for 13% of the U.S. population); and the approach to be anachronistic, one that is based on Caribbean has some 40 million black people. Mexico the models created and imposed by an academic community said to be the home of over 150,000 black people, community whose perspective has essentially remained mostly African Americans and their descendants.

Eurocentric, always carrying with it the subtext of Other countries, in Europe and elsewhere—such as domination and quite often relegating Africans and Great Britain, France, Portugal, Belgium, Italy, Spain, their descendants to a secondary role.

and even Russia—have also been home to Africans, The old paradigm has further overlooked the especially following the colonial period, and in all international dimensions of the diaspora, namely, the these countries combined, the number of Africans is impact of the capitalism, socialism, Marxism, global-approximately 100,000. Thus, when all people of African descent, and rapid technological changes that have African descent are put together, including those who have benefitted the Western world at the expense of people of African descent in the Middle East and Southeast Asia, Africans of African descent and their communities—those who in the world number almost one billion.

are now attempting to become and remain agents of their own destiny. In contrast, the new paradigm provides a comparative perspective of people of African descent and their experiences over the millennia According to the academy, the most useful and innovative, and, therefore, empowers them to move away

SCHOLARLY USE OF THE DIASPORA CONCEPT

from vative paradigm or tool of analysis of the experience European-based paradigms by bringing center stage of these people of African descent scattered across the the black world in its most intricate, relevant, and globe is the concept of the diaspora. The trend toward interlocking global connections.

this use of the concept, as noted earlier, began during Politically, the concept of the diaspora implies the the 1950s and 1960s, but accelerated during the idea of separation, but it also implies the unity of 1990s, becoming the paradigm that has compelled a people who are geographically scattered and dis-several African American and African Studies programs persed. In addition, it carries the notion or desire of to change not only their focus and scope but their very eventual unification in a homeland. It stands to reason

D-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:44 PM Page 218

218——Diaspora

then that a diaspora is not static but conditioned by except perhaps diasporic Africans' sharing of traditional local and international realities, making for the exis-cultural forms like call-and-response in music, *vodu*, tence of unique identities (creoles, mulattoes, coloreds, *candomble*, *s anteria*, and mutual societies? Indeed, the blacks, *pardos*) and cultural mixes and resulting in understanding of slavery, race, gender, and class, as what some have characterized as *overlapping diaspo-well as the remembrance of freedom, were at that point ras shaped by globalization, ethnicity, gender, and in time too dissimilar among these groups to allow for class. It is worth noting that scholars who are using comparison. To mitigate this problem, some scholars the diaspora paradigm are searching for similarities advocate a periodization of longer intervals, such as and dissimilarities in experience and response and centuries, as freezing short periods of time leads to dis-presuppose that the similarities will be greater in tortion and often to findings of more dissimilarities quality and quantity than the differences—if the dis-than similarities, thus rendering the diaspora paradigm similarities are greater, the comparative model is not meaningless. As a result, the difficulties inherent in the useful. In addition, the diaspora model should ideally concept of the diaspora as a tool for the*

acquisition and go beyond simply uncovering cultural similarities (in analysis of knowledge have forced some scholars to music, art, idioms, and African resilience) and dissect advocate its abandonment altogether in favor of a the plethora of black people's political, social, and black globality model that would focus on Europe, economic experiences, correlating them with those Africa, and the New World.

of other diasporas and communities.

Finally, there is the question of the place of pan-Africanism in the new academic discourse and how this concept differs from the diaspora paradigm as a tool **USES OF THE ANALYTICAL IDEA**

of analysis applied to the unveiling of the secrets of However, in any academic enterprise involving the black world. Pan-Africanism is a movement that the social sciences, the humanities, and the fine arts, the emerged within the diaspora, an organizing political tools of analysis are never perfect. People and societies tool that was designed to bring people of African change and new circumstances and evidence force descent together to fight for their rights, whether under members of the academy to adjust, abandon, and colonialism in Africa and the Caribbean or under dis-sharpen the old paradigms or find new ones. This prob-crimination in the United States, and to promote the lem applies to be the diaspora as well. Indeed, the dias-unification of black people, especially those living on pora seems to be the best tool currently available for the the continent of Africa. Indeed, beyond the motherland, analysis of the experiences of the black world, even it was unrealistic to expect that the Caribbean nations though scholars see some shortcomings inherent in it.

alone, for example, could form a United States of Black For example, they ask, how can we assume that we ben-People. Furthermore, a major segment of the black efrit quintessentially from a comparative perspective of world, the African American population, could never the experiences of black people situated in totally dif-belong to that union, given that it owns no soil on which ferent environments and political settings that, at least to claim its sovereignty and its national identity.

on the surface, have nothing to do with each other?

In conclusion, the concept of the diaspora allows us Beyond this paradox, scholars have also noted the prob-to follow new vignettes of academic inquiry and grasp lem of periodization in comparative diaspora studies.

the totality of the experiences of the black world.

How legitimate is it, for example, for one to compare It is through the study of the diaspora as a paradigm Brazil in 1888 with African America in 1863, Haiti in that one can properly illuminate the unique political 1890, and Ghana in 1875 regarding their response to and economic impact of black people on the world slavery and the quest of diasporic Africans for freedom scene and realize that without them Europe and the and determination?

Americas would not be the “peacock” nations that Indeed, whereas diasporic Africans in Haiti were they are today. All in all, therefore, and despite its independent by 1804, those in Brazil were only virtu-shortcomings, most African and African American ally free in the early 1880s (de jure freedom did not scholars today agree that the concept of diaspora is the come until 1886), and those in America were still best academic tool of analysis we have discovered or enslaved in 1863. Further, in the late 19th century recovered over the past few decades.

Ghana did not even exist as the nation we know today.

What would be the common thread in such a study,

— Mario J. Azevedo

D-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:44 PM Page 219

Diopian Historiography——219

FURTHER READING

of young Senegalese men who were devoted to revolutionary change in their condition. Blyden may Byfield, Judith. (Ed.). (2000). [Special issue on the diaspora].

African Studies Review, 43(1). This is a recent and com-have met Babacar Sy, Lamine Gueye, Ngalandou prehensive treatment of the concept of the diaspora as a Diouf, Mar Diop, Cekuta Diop, Raoul Lonis, Lamine tool of analysis, in which a group of scholars deal with Senghor, Emile Faure, Adolphe Mathurin, Kojo the subject in all of its subtleties—history, definitions, Tuwalu, and Kouyate Garang. There is no indication implications, shortcomings, and future trends. Particularly that Diop met with Blyden, but the environment of significant is the article by Tiffany Ruby Patterson and St. Louis at that time makes it possible. Here was the Robin D.G . Kelley.

leading pan-Africanist of the continent, who, after Hines, Darlene Clack, and McLeod, Jacqueline (Eds.). (2000).

having been in Liberia for a long time, had come Crossing Boundaries: A Comparative History of Black People in Diaspora. Bloomington: Indiana University to the French colonial capital to talk to the young Press. The essays in this volume provide a basic theoretical African intellectuals. It is certainly not out of the ques-framework for the use of the concept of the diaspora as a tion that Diop may have met with him in the company tool of analysis and illustrate the complexity of the experi-of all the other young men of the day. And Diop was ences of diaspora communities in the Americas, parts of the almost certainly exposed to the work of Marcus Middle East, and Europe.

Garvey in St. Louis. A Senegalese named Sar Djim Okpewho, Isidore, Davies, Carole Boyce, and Mazrui, Ali Ndiaye, who knew Diop, gave an interview a few (Eds.). (1999). African Diaspora: African Origins and New months after Diop's death in 1986 in which he said that World Identities. Bloomington: Indiana University Press.

This compilation of 33 articles contains a broad range of he had distributed Garvey information in St. Louis in material on the phenomenon of the African diaspora.

the 1920s and 1930s, and his friend Sama Lam Sar recalled that the influence of Marcus Garvey was very strong in St. Louis in the period of 1930 to 1940.

*Diop's importance resides in his pivotal position as **DIOPIAN HISTORIOGRAPHY***

the African intellectual who confronted the most powerful myth the Europeans had created about African Diopian historiography is the name assigned to the history. It is the structure and process of his writing of revolutionary turn in the writing of African history African history that at once made history and made introduced by the late Senegalese scholar, Cheikh a new interpretation of Africa. This is the meaning of Anta Diop. Diop was born in 1923 in Caytu (near Diopian historiography. He thrust Africa to the center Diourbel) in Senegal, and he spent considerable time of its own story and made all other issues subsidiary.

learning from the learned men of the Mourides order This was the first time that Africa had been written in of Islam. One of these men was a relative of his, the central position in its own story since the occupa-Cheikh Mbacke, who was impressed by the brilliance, tion of the European powers. Diop is in a class alone eagerness to learn, and discipline of the young Cheikh by virtue of his intellectual struggles and victories.

Anta, who asked him many questions and demon-There are three distinct aspects to his historiogra-strated very early the type of inquisitiveness that was phy: (1) battling the culture of disbelief, (2) the asser-necessary for superior scholarship. Mbacke believed tion of an Africa independent of Europe, and (3) the that the capacity of the young Cheikh Anta to master unity of Africa. It was necessary for Diop to fight the the wisdom of the elders and the knowledge of the culture of disbelief in the capability of African people imams indicated a bright destiny for the young man.

to create civilizations of majesty and monumentality.

He encouraged him to study diligently and to apply Diop also had to demonstrate that Africa before colo-himself wisely. Thus, Cheikh Anta attended the nialism was fully capable of running its own affairs.

French school at Diourbel until the 1940s, when he And, finally, he asserted the unity of Africa, despite went to the Lycée Faidherbe in St. Louis, on the

Island the fact that there were different local and regional of Sor, where Mbacke was living at the time.

histories. In addition to these three major aspects of There were many influences on Diop. He was the logic of Diop's historiography, there are two main formed in the crucible of the St. Louis of 1940 to 1955.

theses that helped to make him the most quoted Among the pan-Africanists who visited the city was African historian. One of Diop's theses is that world one of the most powerful black intellectuals of his culture was divided into a two-cradle structure, with day, Edward Wilmot Blyden. He found a community one cradle patrilineal and European and the other

D-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:44 PM Page 220

220———Dislocation

*African and matrilineal. Therefore, African culture **THE IMPACT OF DISLOCATION***

and values were equal to but different from those of all Dislocation has become a concern for many Black the other cultures in the world.

Studies scholars, as it is undeniable that African people The other thesis for which Diop is well known is have experienced severe dislocation for the past that ancient Egypt was a black civilization and that 500 years under white supremacy. African dislocation this would have always remained an accepted fact had can be apprehended in a great variety of areas. It not the European historians falsified history. The new is easily observable, for example, in the adoption historiography of Africa, the Diopian historiography, of European aesthetics, with Africans attempting to thus meant a rewriting of the ancient record to show modify their original physical appearance in order to the ancient Egyptians as the black people they were conform to the European model. Michael Jackson's and to defend African culture from those who were tragic example immediately comes to mind. However, invested in the falsified records. Diop was convinced although the singer may represent the most extreme that it was important for the African scholar to revi-example of such an attempt at physical

distortion, he sion Africa without the lens of Europe in order to is in no way alone. Countless African people, all over write a correct version of the continent's history.

the world, continue to rely on surgery and dangerous Indeed, Egypt had to be reconnected to the rest of chemicals in order to alter the texture of their hair and Africa so that African historians would be able to the color of their skin.

write a logical story.

In addition, dislocation is responsible for the

— Molefi Kete Asante

*adoption of the individualistic and materialistic ethos that is characteristic of the dominant European **FURTHER READING***

culture. Dislocation is also quite evident in the adoption of European theories and other intellectual con-Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1974). The African Origin of Civilization.

structs by African scholars and writers. Many African New York: Lawrence Hill. This is the major historical work of Diop.

intellectuals, for example, continue to refer to Africa Keita, Meghan. (2000). Race and the Writing of History.

as “underdeveloped” and to African languages as New York: Oxford University Press. This is an excellent

“dialects,” while others adamantly argue that there are introduction to the works of Cheikh Anta Diop in history.

*no philosophers in Africa. Such a discourse obviously reflects an uncritical and probably unconscious adoption by Africans of the European discourse on Africa. In other cases, some black fiction writers go **DISLOCATION***

so far as to make their black characters blush, thus holding whiteness as the implicit norm that informs The concept of dislocation was first advanced by their writing.

Molefi Asante as a critical conceptual component of The result of dislocation has been massive confu-the Afrocentric Theory in the 1980s, and it was further sion, disorientation, and self-destruction. Indeed, developed in the 1990s. According to the Afrocentric dislocated Africans tend to dissociate themselves from Theory, each ethnic group occupies a particular space, their own history, culture, and biology and may thus based on its history, culture, and biology. That space engage in actions that run contrary to the best interest represents the group's center or location. However, of the African people. Such individuals are often it is possible for a given group to develop a sense of negatively referred to by self-conscious Africans as location that is not congruent with its history, culture,

“negroes.” It is important to realize that, given the and biology. This often happens when the group iden-racism that has been endemic to most of European tifies, consciously or not, with another group, which it thought, African dislocation has meant not simply perceives as dominant, and loses sight of itself, thus total or partial acculturation but also, quite often, causing dislocation to occur. The identification with self-hatred. Thus, dissociation from the African com-another group may occur at two related levels: It may munity has often been seen as necessary by many dis-involve the adoption of the dominant group's attitudes located Africans, not simply for the purpose of social and/or the partial or total adoption of the dominant and economic advancement but also to advance and group's culture.

prove their humanity to Europeans.

D-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:44 PM Page 221

Dream Team———221

THE DISLOCATION

*history, and physical appearance in order to move **CONCEPT AS AN ANALYTICAL TOOL***

from a state of chaos to one where harmony and peace may prevail.

Such dislocated Africans were referred to by Ama Mazama, in public and academic settings in the late

— Ama Mazama

*1990s, as malevolent negroes. There are two types of malevolent negroes: malevolent negroes with a **FURTHER READING***

European aesthetic and malevolent negroes with an Asante, Molefi Kete. (1990). Kemet, Afrocentricity and African aesthetic. The former, generally speaking, Knowledge. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This book lays are individuals who have fully and openly committed the theoretical foundations for the concept of dislocation.

themselves to the defense of white supremacy, at the Asante, Molefi Kete. (1998). The Afrocentric Idea. Philadelphia: expense of African people, if necessary. Clarence Temple University Press. In this original work, the author Thomas, an African American who was appointed seeks to explain the validity of being centered in one's to the Supreme Court by George H. Bush, Sr., and historical and cultural place.

who supported the dismantling of affirmative action, Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). Afrocentricity. Chicago: African American Images. This is the classic book referred to as the may be the best example of a malevolent negro with first introduction to the concept of Afrocentricity. In this a European aesthetic. Malevolent negroes with an work, Asante demonstrates the numerous ways Africans African aesthetic, on the other hand, are a rather have been decentered conceptually, politically, economi-recent phenomenon and are all the more dangerous in cally, and definitionally and provides an alternative, that they present themselves as "Africans." They will African-centered perspective.

not publicly and openly support white supremacy.

Mazama, Ama. (Ed.). (2003). *The Afrocentric Paradigm*.

However, behind the scenes, they will be observed Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This book contains addi-consistently and systematically betraying and under-tional discussions and examples of the concept of dislocation within the context of Afrocentricity.

mining African agency. Obviously, the actions of malevolent negroes have been a most serious problem for African people for hundreds of years and have repeatedly caused attempts by Africans to free themselves to abort. Such malevolent negroes are often **DREAM TEAM**

generously rewarded and hailed by Europeans.

In addition to the malevolent negroes, however, Beginning in the mid 1990s and continuing until there exists another category: the benevolent negroes.

2001, the Harvard Dream Team was a gathering of These are Africans with good intentions toward their very well-established scholars at Harvard University's own community. However, because of their disloca-W.E.B. Du Bois Institute for Afro-American Research tion, they analyze the African experience through a and Department of Afro American Studies. Henry European lens and embark on projects that are funda-Louis Gates, Jr., a major literary figure, spearheaded mentally Eurocentric and not necessarily in the best the idea of bringing together a "dream team" of interest of African people. Many Africans from the scholars, which included Cornel West, William Julius diaspora, for example, look at Africa as a place that Wilson, Evelyn Higginbotham, and Kwame Anthony needs to be "civilized" and "developed," and as a Appiah. Seeking to create an opportunity to jumpstart result, they create programs to do just that, while fail-Black Studies at Harvard, Gates hoped that this group ing to realize that what they are really advocating for of scholars would be the new intellectual wave of the Africa is Westernization. In the same vein, some field. The Dream Team had several successes in the

"black" schools, in order to get black students "ready public arena, spreading liberal educational views, to compete," may simply further the

cultural and intel-highlighting the importance of African Americans lectual dislocation of African children.

in the American academy, and producing useful The remedy for dislocation suggested by the documents for the field, including the Encarta Afrocentric Theory is relocation. While many debate Encyclopedia. The Dream Team, under intense public what it means to be African (i.e., what relocation scrutiny, had several personal and professional cir-would entail), there is a general consensus that cumstances that resulted in diminishing their number Africans must accept and embrace their own culture, and influence at Harvard. However, it is generally

D-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:44 PM Page 222

*222——**Dream Team***

believed that irreconcilable differences with the coeditor with Darlene Clark Hine and Leon Litwack administration at the university led to the ultimate of the Harvard Guide to African American History breakup of the group. By 2003, of the entire Dream (2001). William Julius Wilson arrived at Harvard in Team, only Gates, Higginbotham, and Wilson 1996, after teaching sociology at the University of remained at Harvard.

Massachusetts at Amherst and University of Chicago All of the major players in the Dream Team had for 24 years. Wilson's major works— The Declining their own individual achievements. Henry Louis Gates Significance of Race (1978), The Truly Disadvantaged was featured on Time magazine's "25 Most Influential (1990), and When Work Disappears: The World of the Americans" list in 1997, received a National New Urban Poor (1997)—are noted for contending that Humanities Medal in 1998, and was elected to the the economic plight of blacks in America is the result American Academy of Arts and Letters in 1999. Gates of poverty from joblessness rather than race. Kwame is coeditor of the encyclopedia Encarta Africana Anthony Appiah grew up in Ghana and England.

(1999) published on CD-ROM by Microsoft and in Among his books are Assertion and Conditionals book form by Basic Civitas Books under the title (1985), For Truth in Semantics (1986), In My Father's Africana: The

Encyclopedia of the African and House: Africa in the Philosophy of Culture (1992), and, *African American Experience* (2000). He is also the with Amy Gutmann, *Color Conscious: The Political author of Wonders of the African World* (1999), the *Morality of Race* (1998). Appiah is also coeditor with book companion to the 6-hour BBC/PBS television *Henry Louis Gates of Africana: The Encyclopedia of series of the same name*. Gates's most popular works the *African and African American Experience* (2000).

include the *Norton Anthology of African American* He joined the faculty at Princeton along with his fellow *Literature* that he edited in 1996, which features the former *Dream Team* associate Cornel West in 2002.

writings of Frederick Douglass, Phillis Wheatley,

— Deonte Hollowell

W.E.B. Du Bois, Paul Laurence Dunbar, and others and *The Signifying Monkey: Towards A Theory of Afro-American Literary Criticism* (1988), which **FURTHER READING**

focuses on African American vernacular.

Appiah, Kwame. (1992). *A. In My Father's House: Africa in Cornel West* taught primarily in the field of African the *Philosophy of Culture*. New York: Oxford University American philosophy of divinity while he was at Press. Appiah discusses theories of traditional religions in Harvard University. Prior to his tenure at Harvard, a postmodern context, where he argues that there are limits which began in 1994, West taught at Yale University, of symbolist interpretation of religion.

Union Theological Seminary, and Princeton University, Gates, Henry Louis, Jr. (1988). *The Signifying Monkey: where he was chair of the program in Afro-American Toward a Theory on Afro-American Literary Criticism*.

Studies. He is the author of numerous books, includ-New York: Oxford University Press. The purpose of ing his most famous book, *Race Matters*

(1993), *Jews* Gates's book is to present a theoretical stance on black literary works from a black perspective.

and *Blacks: Let the Healing Begin* (1995), *The Cornel Higginbotham, Evelyn. (1993). Righteous Discontent: The West Reader* (1999), *The African-American Century Women's Movement in the Black Baptist Church, 1880–1920*.

(2002), and *Democracy Matters* (2004). He has also Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press. Higginbotham recorded a jazz/hip-hop CD called *Sketches of My* provides an account of the crucial role of black women in *Culture* (2001). West's visibility outside the academy making the black church a powerful institution for change created friction between him and Harvard's adminis-in the black community.

tration, and West eventually left Harvard in 2002 and West, Cornel. (1993). *Race Matters*. Boston: Beacon Press.

This is West's analysis of America's racial dilemmas.

returned to Princeton.

Wilson, William Julius. (1978). The Declining Significance Evelyn Brooks Higginbotham began teaching at of Race: Blacks and Changing American Institutions.

Harvard in 1998. Higginbotham is the author of Chicago: University of Chicago Press. At the heart of Righteous Discontent: The Women's Movement in the Wilson's argument in this text is the notion that race replaced Black Baptist Church, 1880–1920 (1993). She also is class as the most important issue in American relations.

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 223

E

*African Americans. There is neither a white nor a black **EBONICS***

English, there is only English and the varieties of English called dialects that exist in Australian and The term Ebonics, a combination of ebony and phonics, American English. There are also regional accents, such refers to “black sounds.” The term was introduced as Brooklyn, Boston, Atlanta, Los Angeles, and Dallas in the early 1970s, at the Cognitive and Language accents. Understanding a few of the important terms Development of the Black Child Conference in in language is useful in any analysis of Ebonics. For St. Louis, by a group of African American linguists example, the terms dialect, accent, regionalism, slang, led by psychologist Robert Williams. The group had semantics, phoneme, morpheme, and lexicon should be held a caucus to come up with a term for black people’s understood in order to appreciate the Africological, that language that would not have the negative connotations is, Black Studies, orientation to language.

of Black English—a term that had caused considerable confusion, as people kept thinking of the language Dialect: a form of speech spoken by a community spoken by African Americans as a negative form that does not yet have the power to define itself as of English.

standard.

Ebonics is the language spoken by a majority of Accent: a dimension of speech pronunciation that Africans in the United States. Like other languages, varies from the commonly used form

Ebonics is a regularized code with specific and constant grammatical, phonological, and lexical princi-Regionalism: phonological and lexical characteris-ples. Robert Williams, called by some the dean of tics of a language spoken in a given region African American psychologists, led the debate to Slang: a colloquial use of certain terms and words define African American cultural experience from the that might be used in a language and abandoned after standpoint of African people with agency as actors a while or words that are used by a certain group in in the history of language. When the psychologists society as an indication of group membership.

and linguists emerged from the St. Louis caucus, the African American attendees at the conference had Semantics: the study of the meaning of

words adopted the use of the word *Ebonics* to refer to all *Phoneme*: a unit of sound

of the characteristics of the language of African *Morpheme*: a unit of meaning Americans. The word *Ebonics* was seen in print for the first time in the 1975 book *Ebonics: The True Lexicon*: the totality of the words, terms, proverbs, *Language of Black Folks*, which was produced by the folk notions, verbal and nonverbal cues that constitute Washington University Institute of Black Studies and constitute a language.

published by Robert Williams and Associates.

To say “Black English” is to misunderstand the The Black Studies scholar is interested in Ebonics nature of the language spoken and understood by not as a dialect or as slang, but as a language itself.

223

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 224

224———**Ebonics**

This is the central difference between those who are an English speaker in the United States who does not locate the discussion of Ebonics from a centered use the expression “O.K.,” which is an African term perspective and those who make their analysis from that David Dalby, in his article “African Element in the periphery of African culture.

Black English,” traces back to the Wolof-Mande region of West Africa. In addition, many other Americanisms originated in Africanisms. Many words—such as **EVOLUTION OF EBONICS**

boogie woogie, jazz, jamboree, jive, mumbo-jumbo, One does not call English spoken by Mexican *big mouth, gumbo, juke, gorilla, goober, elephant*, Americans “Brown English” or that spoken by Asian *cola, banjo, banana, okra, bogus, bug, fuzz, phoney*, Americans “Yellow English,” because we recognize *yam*, and *rap*—are directly related to West and Central that those groups have legitimate languages of their African

terminology. Ebonics contains the remnants of many African languages. Other Americans may speak Spanish, Chinese, or many African terms that have changed over the years. For example, the Ebonics expression “to kick language described by a color adjective. Thus, when the bucket,” meaning that someone has died, is traced linguists determined that the language spoken by a to two sources, the Ga *kekere*, meaning “dry, stiff” and majority of African Americans had developed along-bu, meaning “end,” and the Sierra Leonean Krio side English and used many vocabulary items that *kekerebu*, meaning “dead.”

were English, they recognized the possible confusion. Pioneering linguist and scholar of African of the language with English and knew that a name American language Geneva Smitherman has argued had to be given to it to disassociate it from the English that Ebonics is African in nuance, gesture, and tone, as language. This was an act of African agency quite well as in the derivation of its structure and lexicon.

in line with the movement in the 1960s for African Because of the numerous ethnic communities that self-determination and self-definition. The linguists were mixed in American society, the resulting language named the language spoken and understood by the majority was a distillation of an intercultural linguistic majority of African Americans “Black English.”

heritage. There were nuances of Yoruba, Congo, Actually, when Africans were first brought to the United States, and Ga in every large gathering of Africans in English colony of Virginia in 1619, they did not speak the United States. Sometimes words from those English. They came to America with African languages entered Ebonics.

languages. In fact, over the following 200 years, Africans The culture inherent in a language is directly from ethnic groups such as Angola, Congo, Yoruba, related to a people’s history. That is why, like other Ewe, Akan, Wolof, Hausa, and Mandinka were languages, Ebonics has its own identifiable phonology-brought to America with their own languages intact.

ology, syntax, and lexicon. These are three of the But since all of these languages are different, it was most important characteristics of a language. Although difficult for Africans to speak with each other. Neither it is well

known that humans create communicative could they speak to the whites who dominated them.

forms and explore ways to transmit the most intimate Thus, using the commonalities of their own languages ideas in conversation, what is not well known and as well as some English, they were able to create a lan-not often appreciated is the genius of the Africans in guage, what is now called Ebonics, that would allow the United States in their creation of the language them to communicate with each other and with the Ebonics.

whites. In many respects, this language was the most

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

creative early achievement of African Americans.

Among the traits of Ebonics is its phonology, **FURTHER READING**

which includes a structured grammar and idiomatic expressions that are understood by its speakers. While Blackshire-Belay, Aisha. (Ed.). *Language and Literature in the* it is true that some of the features of Ebonics are *African American Imagination*. Westport, CT: Greenwood Press. This work analyzes the various ways African shared with English dialects, other features occur only Americans have imagined language.

in Ebonics. It is the systematic differences that occur Christian, Mark. (Ed.). (2002). *Black Identity in the 20th* only in Ebonics that show its relationship to *West Century*. London: Hansib. The essays in this book deal with African languages. Through Ebonics, many English many aspects of African culture in the Western world. This speakers are influenced by Africanisms. There is not is a good source of material on identity.

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 225

Education and Black Studies———225

Dillard, J. L. (1973). *Black English*. New York: Random have similar markers, including the commencement House. This is the authoritative

work on Black English exercises.

by a long-time expert on the language of Africans in the In the African traditions, preparations for such rites Americas. This book has been referred to by many of the tended to start at a very early age. The community linguists who came after Dillard.

accepted the fact that the child would one day end the Mufwene, Salikoko, Rickford, John R., Bailey, Guy, and Baugh, John (Eds.). (1998). *African American English*.

training period, and so they started preparing for it London: Routledge. This is a comprehensive work on the when the child was quite young. Testimony regarding nature of African American speech. It deals with some of the high level of integration that the educational the key issues surrounding the language of Africans in the process had with day-to-day life is seen in the fact that Americas.

during infancy, lullabies were sung to the African child and served to communicate the whole history of the family to the child. When the child started to learn how to speak, the mother was careful to teach the

EDUCATION AND BLACK STUDIES

child the correct manner of speaking, and later on in the child's development, she taught the child the cor-Education is the process of acquiring knowledge and rect manner of walking. The children heard questions developing the mind and character through formal such as "What is your father's name?" "What is your and/or informal learning. Black Studies represents a grandfather's name?" and "What is your great-grand-radical departure in the formal educational process father's name?" All the questions were designed to by bringing into the academy a perspective that is connect the child to family history and cultural mem-Afrocentric. In various explorations into the lives of ory. Age-group sets were a key part of this system, and African people on the continent and in the diaspora, the character and memory of more mature children the discipline of Black Studies has sought to provide were developed through the use of fables, myths, and students with in-depth discourses on African systems a complex process of training that resulted in the of knowledge. There are many

varieties of African memorization and identification of hundreds of family education, but most of them have the same basic characteristics. In ancient African societies, there were no characteristics. Based on the ideas from Black Studies, most uneducated children.

scholars now agree that African education involves By the time Ghana became independent in 1957, colonialism had almost completely destroyed the

- teaching the unity of humans and nature, an fabric of African culture and African people. From the ecological idea

early 1400s, the European system of education and

- teaching social responsibility, a social idea the work of Christian missionaries had been imple-

- teaching the importance of character, an ethical mented to instill in Africans a sense of inferiority idea

about everything that was African. Everything in the

- teaching the importance of humility, a spiritual education of African children was presented to sub-idea

stantiate the view that they were backward, primitive, and heathen. The primary purpose of this system of In previous eras in Africa, rites-of-passage initiation-education was social control, to make Africans political positions were central to all education; vocational skill training and economically valuable to and dependent training was not a major part of the educational on European societies. Over time, this system became process. This meant that those with the ability to train in varying forms a worldwide educational system the young used their talents to provide the proper designed to support and maintain the continued dominance measures for the young to experience and achieve the influence of the Western world over all others. It is this desired results. These rites constitute the pragmatic system that demanded the establishment of a more manifestation of the core values of a society. When a democratic movement in education.

person was on the road to becoming a man or woman, Black Studies is linked to this development the initiators would provide the necessary steps and because it was born out of the context of the 1960s procedures to bring the person to the goal. Then, as in student movement for Black Studies. With their pro-most situations of this type, there would be a celebra-fessor, Nathan Hare, as their advisor, students at San tion. Modern education systems in the West tend to Francisco State University in 1968 demanded courses

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 226

226———**Elder Scholars**

relevant to their experiences—courses that would be **CHANCELLOR WILLIAMS**

taught from a black perspective. Today, Black Studies programs exist in colleges and universities through-Chancellor Williams (1902–1996), the grandson of out the country, including doctoral degree programs slaves, was born in Bennettsville, South Carolina. He such as those at Temple University, the University of earned his master's degree from Howard University Massachusetts at Amherst, the University of California and doctoral degree from American University. He at Berkeley, Harvard University, and Michigan State was an astute educator and prolific writer. His early University. These programs have begun in varying questions were social and historical interrogations degrees to lay the foundation for a significant para-derived from his observations of the social relations in digm shift in the education of blacks throughout the his community. He frequently questioned the disparity world.

in opportunity between blacks and whites. This became his most constant compass in the intellectual

— *Bart McSwine*

work that he was to do during his lifetime. Williams believed that it was impossible for whites to dominate **FURTHER READING**

African people for so long and with such ferocity unless there was something in whites or in blacks that Carnoy, Martin. (1974). *Education as Cultural Imperialism*.

made these cruelties possible. He wanted to search for New York: David McKay. This book gives a comprehensive view of how education has been used as a tool of impe-the answer to what that something was.

rial domination.

In his search for the truth about the black race, Hilliard, Asa. (1995). *The Maroon Within Us*. Baltimore, MD: Williams conducted field studies in African history in Black Classic Press. These essays focus on self-determination, Ghana, West Africa, with the main objective of deter-cultural identity, African educational methodologies, and mining the independent achievements of the African socialization patterns.

race and the nature of black civilization before either Kenyatta, Jomo. (1965). *Facing Mt. Kenya*. New York: Asian or European influence penetrated the continent.

Random House. Kenyatta gives an in-depth anthropological His study spanned over 10 years, during which time account of the sophistication of Gikuyu cultural systems of government and education.

he surveyed 26 countries and centered on 105 tradi-Wilson, Amos N. (1993). *The Falsification of Afrikan tional African culture language groups*.

Consciousness. New York: Afrikan World InfoSystems.

Chancellor Williams succeeded Leo William This book describes the role that racist historiography Hansberry, his former professor and mentor at Howard played in the destruction of African consciousness.

University, and became the History Department's specialist in African History. He held the position until his retirement in 1972. In recognition of his work as a historian, and for his contributions to African education

ELDER SCHOLARS

and black history during the critical transitional era when colonies became independent nations, Howard The Elder Scholars were a group of academicians, University's History Club changed its name to the writers, activists, and lay historians who lived primarily Chancellor Williams Historical Society.

on the East Coast of the United States during the 20th The empirical research for Williams's doctoral dis- century. They wrote and debated the ideas of African sertation, an unusual portrayal of the life of black store-cultures and civilization in many forums. Some of the front churches as viewed from inside, was published most prolific and best known of these scholars were as his first novel, *Have You Been to the River?* He Chancellor Williams, John Henrik Clarke, Edward V.

authored the essay "And If I Were White" and eight Scobie, and Yosef ben-Johannan. They became legends books, among them *The Rebirth of African Civilization*, in the African American communities of the East Coast *The Raven*, *The Second Agreement with Hell*, and *The* largely because of their activist stance on political and *Destruction of Black Civilization: Great Issues of a* intellectual issues. Collectively, their lives were *Race From 4500 B.C. to 2000 A.D. The Destruction of* devoted to the quest for the truth about the history of *Black Civilization*, which challenged Eurocentric views African people, and they made an important contribu-of African history, offered theories on black American tion to this quest by serving as sources for the first gen-empowerment based on African models, and proposed eration of Black Studies scholars.

a master plan for black unification and development.

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 227

Elder Scholars——227

The work spans 6,000 years of African history, manhood in Columbus, Georgia, where black boys revealing common social patterns within the continent's were not allowed to imagine themselves as conduits cultures. *The Destruction of Black Civilization* contin-of social and political change. Beginning in his early ues to be a top seller in the black community.

youth, Clarke began to search for African people in the Bible because he saw no image of “his people” in God’s book. He studied the history of the world, and **EDWARD V. SCOBIE**

the history of African people in particular, and queried Edward V. Scobie (1918–1996) was born on the island the color of Christ and the angels, as well as the of Dominica, where he excelled as a student and an athlete-absence of blacks in pages of his Sunday school letter. He was the island’s top swimmer and table tennis lessons.

player. In 1941, he joined the British Royal Air Force, Clarke was an ardent student, but he couldn’t spend and as a navigator in a bomber command he completed much time on formal education because he was often many missions over Germany during World War II.

taken out to work to help supplement his father’s meager income. He was still enlisted when he returned to England for income. Nevertheless, the foundation for his early in 1945, which was the site of the Fifth Pan African education was the public school libraries in Columbus, Congress. By attending sessions at this meeting, Scobie Georgia, where he borrowed books by signing his name and talked with some of the notable black scholars employed’s name to the notes he composed. He con- and African patriots in attendance: Kwame Nkrumah, continued to borrow five books a week through the Jomo Kenyatta, W.E.B. Du Bois, George Padmore, and method he devised until he left Columbus at the age of C.L.R. James. The content of these sessions was the 18. Although Clarke left school in the seventh grade, compelling force that shaped Scobie’s worldview and he remained an avid reader throughout his life. A read-his subsequent academic and literary careers.

ing of Arthur Schomburg’s essay “The Negro Digs Up Returning to Dominica after the war, Scobie became His Past” made him determined to go to New York editor for the *Dominican Herald*, published two works, City to meet Schomburg and learn the true history of *Flamingo* and *Tropic*, and served two terms as mayor of African people. When Clarke was 18, he and a friend Roseau, the capital of Dominica. He was also one of the left Georgia by freight train headed for the North.

founding members and vice president of the Dominican Clarke arrived in New York in 1933, with the Freedom Party. Scobie moved to the United States ambition of pursuing a career as a writer. On his to take an appointment as Associate Professor at arrival he decided to take the necessary steps to build Livingston College. Later, positions at Rutgers and a life of scholarship and activism in New York. He Princeton followed. He was Professor Emeritus in the traveled to the Harlem Branch of the New York Public Department of Black Studies of the City University of Library (now The Schomburg Center for Research New York for 25 years. His were the largest and most in Black Culture) and introduced himself to Arthur popular classes in the department.

Schomburg. Clarke demanded to learn the history of Scobie was the author of *Global Afrikan Presence* African people within the hour—Schomburg's lunch (1994); however, it was his stellar work *Black Britannia* hour. Schomburg directed him to first read the history (1972) that brought him international acclaim. The book of Europe to understand how black history was stolen.

provides a broad but comprehensive outline of the role From that first meeting they became close friends, of blacks in the Spanish, Italian, Portuguese, Dutch, with Schomburg mentoring Clarke and suggesting French, and British worlds, and it remains an important specific books on world history for him to read. The history of blacks in the British Isles. Scobie was consid-sudden death of Schomburg in 1937 was a devastating ered the best specialist on the life of Africans, particu-blow to Clarke. However, he was surrounded by many larly those from the Caribbean in Britain. He was the of the literary giants of the time, and he proceeded dean of the subject of blacks in Britain.

to join the Harlem History Club, to become a member of the Harlem History Workshop, and to study with Leo William Hansberry, John Killens, Williams N.

JOHN HENRIK CLARKE

Huggins, and John Jackson. They in turn mentored John Henrik Clarke (1915–1998), the grandson of him in a similar manner to Arthur

Schomburg, and slaves and son of sharecroppers, was born John Henry these men became the major forces that helped to Clark in Union Springs, Alabama. He matured to shape the life of John Henrik Clarke. He changed his



E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 228

228——Elder Scholars

name from Henry to Henrik because he admired the 1985 with the distinguished title of Professor Scandinavian rebel playwright Henrik Ibsen, who Emeritus.

addressed social issues in his work, and he added the Clarke shared his life with many luminary world letter “e” to Clark.

figures: Kwame Nkrumah, Paul Robeson, Betty A self-proclaimed nationalist and pan-Africanist, Shabazz, Malcolm X, Zora Neale Hurston, James Clarke was a largely self-taught historian who took Baldwin, Martin Luther King, Jr., Richard Wright, undergraduate classes in history and

world literature Julian Mayfield, John G. Jackson, Cheikh Anta Diop, at New York and Columbia Universities and the New John O. Killens, Hoyt Fuller, Chancellor Williams, School for Social Research. His long search for the Drucella Dundee Houston, Marcus Garvey, Jr., Leonard true history of African people took him to libraries, Jeffries, and Yosef ben-Johannan, whom he embraced as museums, and archives in Africa, Asia, the Caribbean, his brother. Clarke will be remembered for his many Europe, and Latin America.

contributions to society and to his people, as well as for Clarke was also a writer, with a book of poetry, saying, "History is not everything, it is the starting *Rhyme and Rebellion* (1948), to his credit, as well as point. History is a clock that people use to tell their over 50 short stories that were published in the United time of day. It is a compass they use to find themselves States and abroad. His best-known short story, "The on the map of human geography. It tells them where Boy Who Painted Christ Black," has been translated they are, what they are, but more importantly, what they into more than a dozen languages. His publications in must be."

the form of edited books, major essays, and book introductions are many. Among the major texts by **YOSEF BEN-JOCHANNAN**

Clarke used in the disciplines of history and African American Studies at colleges and universities are Yosef ben-Jochannan (1918–present), a noted scholar *Africa, Lost and Found* with Richard Moore and Keith and lecturer, is affectionately called "Dr. Ben." He Baird, *Africans at the Crossroads: Notes on an* was born in Ethiopia and grew up in the Caribbean, *African World Revolution, Introduction to African* and traveled extensively with his parents through *Civilizations* with introduction by John G. Jackson, Cuba, Puerto Rico, and South America. He attended *Marcus Garvey and the Vision of Africa*, and *Malcolm* the University of Puerto Rico and then Cambridge, *X: The Man and His Time*. His articles and conference initially with the intention of becoming a civil engi-papers on African and African American history and neer. Instead, he studied law before deciding on a culture have been published in leading journals career in cultural anthropology. Ben-Jochannon throughout the world. In 1986 the Cornell University migrated to the United States in 1945, where he Library was

renamed the John Henrik Clarke Africana continues to maintain a home in Harlem.

Studies Library, and in 1993 Clark University Woodruff Library Center in Atlanta, to which he donated thousands of books, dedicated a wing of the library in his honor. His lesson plans and course outlines, known for their thoroughness and meticulous structure, were donated to the Schomburg Center for Research in Black Culture.

Clarke was the recipient of honorary degrees from the University of Denver, the University of the District of Columbia, and the Medgar Evers College of the City University of New York (which was awarded posthumously). However, in 1995 he completed his dissertation and earned a doctoral degree from Pacific Western University in California. He was a professor in Cornell University's Africana Studies and Research Center and for 20 years in the Department of Black *Dr. Yosef ben-Jochannon, one of the Elder Scholars who brought* and Puerto Rican Studies at Hunter College of the *awareness of the Nile Valley civilizations to the African American* City University of New York, from which he retired in *community*

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 229

Emancipation Proclamation———229

Ben-Jochannon has an exemplary command of Boyd, Herb. (1996, November 23). Scobie Dies at 78.

ancient and contemporary history and is respected for *Amsterdam News*, p. 1. This article on the life of Edward his meticulous research into the roots of African Scobie is the portrayal of a man who was a giant among African intellectuals.

history. For decades, his argument has been that the Clarke, John Henrik. (1994). *My Life in Search of Africa*.

educational system has attempted to perpetuate the Ithaca, NY: Cornell University Americana Studies and myths that Europeans are the sole contributors to civ-Research Center. This is Clarke's memoir of his search

for civilization and that Egypt was originally European. He Africa. He reminisces on his life, career, obstacles, and dis-has conducted research in Africa, India, and Europe, coveries, and he muses about what still remains to be done.

and he was a UNESCO specialist in cultural anthro-Toure, Yemi. (1991, March 3). Elder Statesmen. *Los Angeles* pology of East Africa. Ben-Jochannon has written *Times*, p. 23. This a fine article on the role of the elder many books about the black presence in Egypt, among statespersons of African American history.

which are voluminous history books. The most well known of his books are *Africa: Mother of Western Civilization* and *Black Man of the Nile and His EMANCIPATION PROCLAMATION*

Family, which was originally published in 1972 and rereleased in 1989.

Ben-Jochannon uses his work to challenge and On January 1, 1863, U.S. President Abraham Lincoln expose Europeanized African history and to reveal the declared free all enslaved Africans residing in territory distortions made concerning African contributors to in rebellion against the federal government. This world civilization. He work has been called a correc-Emancipation Proclamation actually freed few people, tive lesson in “ourstory.” Ben-Jochannon is a retired because it did not apply to enslaved Africans in border Adjunct Professor of History and Egyptology at states fighting on the Union side, nor did it affect Cornell University’s Africana Studies Research enslaved Africans in Southern areas already under Center and Senior Lecturer, Faculty of Languages, Union control. Of course, the states in rebellion did not Al Azhar University, Egypt. He has also taught at act on Lincoln’s order to free the enslaved Africans.

Malcolm-King College, Marymount College, Temple However, the Emancipation Proclamation did suggest University, and Hunter College of the City University that the Civil War would be fought to end slavery.

of New York. He is multilingual and speaks Hebrew, Lincoln had been reluctant to write a proclamation Spanish, Portuguese, Agu (an ancient Ethiopian lan-freeing the Africans. He had articulated his view of guage),

Arabic, and Greek and has a reading knowl-the African on several occasions, and he was a firm edge of Italian and classical Arabic.

believer in the doctrine of white supremacy. Lincoln, therefore, initially viewed the war only in terms of preserving the Union. But when the political and moral **IN CONCLUSION**

pressure kept mounting in the country, the President The Elder Scholars are often acclaimed as the genera-became more sympathetic to the idea that blacks should tion that laid the foundation for the more scientific be free in those states in rebellion. On September 22, Afrocentric work that was done by the scholars of the 1862, he issued a preliminary proclamation announc-1980s and 1990s.

ing that emancipation would become effective in those states still in rebellion on January 1, 1863. The

— *Adjua Barbara E. Adams*

proclamation did not end slavery in America, which was not achieved until the passage of the Thirteenth **FURTHER READING**

Amendment to the Constitution on December 18, 1865, but the Emancipation Proclamation did make that Adams, Barbara E. (2000). *John Henrik Clarke: Master Teacher*. Chicago: A&B Press. This is the first full-length accomplishment a virtual certainty after the war.

treatment of the life of John Henrik Clarke, and it places

— *Daryl Zizwe Poe*

Clarke in historical perspective.

ben-Jochannan, Yosef, and Clarke, John Henrik. (1991). *From* **FURTHER READING**

the Nile Valley to the New World, Science, Invention & Technology: New Dimensions in African History. Trenton, Commager, Henry Steele. (1960). *The Great Proclamation*.

NJ: Africa World Press. This is a portrait of African history Indianapolis, IN: Bobbs-Merrill. This was one of the first from the combined minds of two of the Elder Scholars.

books that attempts to dissect the Emancipation Proclamation.

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 230

230——Enslavement Resistance

Donovan, Frank. (1964). *Mr. Lincoln's Proclamation*.

narratives attest to such small personal insurrections, New York: Dodd, Mead. This book provides a political some of which were visited directly upon the slave-overview of how Lincoln accepted the challenge of this owner or members of his household, and some of proclamation.

which were directed toward the self of the enslaved Franklin, John Hope. (Ed.) (1963). *The Emancipation* person—who as property possessed, if nothing else in *Proclamation*. Garden City, NJ: Doubleday. These essays on the proclamation were selected by one of the most the world, a will of his or her own.

distinguished scholars of the century.

An enslaved person seeking personal retribution or reprisal on behalf of the collective might attempt to poison or otherwise sicken the master, the mistress, or other members of the household; pregnancies were
ENSLAVEMENT RESISTANCE

aborted (though it was just as often likely that the fertility of enslaved women was diminished because Resistance to enslavement started in Africa and of sheer overwork, gross malnutrition, and violent continued in the Americas. Most enslaved Africans physical treatment); newborn infants were murdered resisted, in small and large ways, day in and day out.

outright to prevent them from being enslaved and/or This resistance to enslavement took several forms.

eventually sold away from their parents. It is also clear from existing enslaved African narratives that the image of the stereotypical “shiftless, lazy negro”

DAY-TO-DAY RESISTANCE

stemmed as much from blacks being worked beyond A small resistance on the part of an enslaved African exhaustion as it did from resistant slaves working suggested to others that there was more than one way more slowly and dully than their true capabilities to survive the monstrosity of enslavement, and more would allow. While these small acts of resistance, than one way to escape it. It may be argued that an more often than not, permitted black people to survive African’s nurturing another enslaved African, be it a physically and psychologically, sometimes the gam-child or a mate, was itself an act of resistance in a ble was lost and punishment would be as swift and context that held that African life was worthless. And fatal as it was for (real and imagined) conspirators practicing African culture, which was often done at the who chose to participate in rebellion on a larger scale.

risk of loss of life, was also clearly an act of resistance.

Retribution for small acts of rebellion sometimes The choice between rebellion and survival, when precipitated group revolt. A case in point is that of available, was often shaped by general prevailing Margaret Bradley, an enslaved woman who was events, such as living with the global antiblack violence convicted in 1803 in York, Pennsylvania, of attempting that generally arose in the wake of a prior rebellion or to poison two whites. Over the subsequent 3 weeks, conspiracy to rebel, or by very personal circumstances, blacks burned 11 buildings in protest of the verdict.

such as an African’s child being sold while she was Another factor that has been documented to have away on an errand for the owner of the house. Individual precipitated numerous rebellions in diverse locations acts of open defiance were often assumed to have their was the suspicion of enslaved Africans that they had origin in the personal vendetta; an enslaved African who been freed, but that the white plantation owners had was humiliated by an especially cruel public punish-refused to inform them and

act on it. In one such ment (and they were all cruel and often public—the instance, in 1734, near Somerville in what was then slaveholders made sure not to lose the deterrent effect called East Jersey, the conspirators (as the insurrec-the discipline would have on other enslaved Africans) tion was not executed) were arrested, beaten, and might attempt escape or set valuable property afire.

mutilated, and two were condemned to be hanged, In order to avoid, even temporarily, what were although one escaped that fate.

often body- and mind-numbingly severe workloads, an enslaved African might cut off the last three fingers **ARMED RESISTANCE**

of one hand, pretend not to understand a set of work instructions, “accidentally” break a necessary and In addition to numerous mutinies on the ships during expensive tool, or simply hide out in the woods with the Middle Passage, there were also many instances the intention of not returning until a particular demand of armed rebellions on the plantations. While insur-was met. Volume upon volume of enslaved African rection was predictable in the slaving environment,

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 231

Enslavement Resistance——231

claims of the docile, happy, and well-cared-for before being brought to Charleston, South Carolina, enslaved African notwithstanding, there were environ-as the property of Captain Joseph Vesey. In creating mental and human factors that tended to support his rebel alliances, Denmark Vesey capitalized on his uprising or to increase the chances of its success. A facility with language—he could speak French, higher proportion of enslaved Africans born in Africa; Creole, and English—and on his connections with the a black populace, including the enslaved and the free, African Methodist Episcopal (AME) and Presbyterian that exceeded the white population in size; and the churches and with enslaved and free blacks (although very presence of free blacks as an example of black all of his coconspirators were enslaved). Each of liberty all tended encourage insurrection. Even during Vesey’s generals kept a separate list of his

personal periods when the white population was temporarily recruits, and the lists were not shared. The group decreased—for example, during the summer, when acquired swords, firearms, and ammunition, which rich whites often vacationed further north—successful they had strategically hidden throughout the city.

rebellion was seen as more possible. Vesey, Prosser, They decided on a summer Sunday for the revolt, as and Turner all planned their revolts—the most famous blacks could legally congregate on Sundays and many cases of armed resistance in the United States—for white citizens would be summering elsewhere.

dates in July or August.

Although they were betrayed months before the scheduled revolt, authorities scoffed at the story and took few early protective measures. Two weeks after **The Gabriel Prosser Revolt**

the betrayal, spies were dispersed to gather informa-Of the three insurrectionists at the time of the tion; Vesey was named, and again authorities scoffed.

planned revolt—Prosser, Vesey, and Turner—Gabriel It took 2 additional weeks to accomplish his capture.

Prosser was the youngest, born into slavery just outside of Richmond in 1776. Growing up in the years **The Nat Turner Rebellion**

of the American, French, and Haitian Revolutions, young Prosser must have been exposed to talk of The best-known executed rebellion of enslaved resistance, freedom, and equality.

Africans within the United States was the insurrection Prosser was a powerful, physically imposing black led by Nat Turner, a black man in Southampton man (6 foot, 2 inches tall and muscular from years of County, Virginia. Turner was born into slavery on blacksmithing) who could read and write. As a black-October 2, 1800 (the year of the Gabriel Prosser smith, Prosser had an extremely useful trade, exten-Revolt), and was

believed by many to possess second sive knowledge of the terrain in and around the state sight. Convinced that it was his divine mission to fight capital, and the acquaintance of many from all social against slavery, on August 20, 1831, Nat Turner and strata, making him well suited for his chosen work of his coconspirators began a bloody coup, sparing no insurrection.

white person, irrespective of age or gender.

During the summer of 1800, Prosser and his gener-Turner's original small group of men swelled to 50

als (his brothers, Solomon and Martin, and three other or 60 as they went from house to house, killing the enslaved Africans) added recruits and constructed an white inhabitants with axes, guns, swords, and clubs.

ambitious plan. Prosser's well-constructed plan, howIn all, they were reported to have taken the lives of ever, was never executed. It was betrayed, in advance, 55 plantation-owning men, women, and children in to Governor Monroe, who promptly called in 600

48 hours. Through sheer resourcefulness and survival militiamen. If that weren't enough, torrential rains instinct, Turner managed to elude the hastily assem-kept the rebels—said to number several hundred to a bled militia by living in the woods for 6 weeks before thousand—from the rendezvous point, and they were he was captured.

forced to disperse.

Aftermath of the

Vesey's Conspiracy

Rebellions of Prosser, Vesey, and Turner Denmark Vesey, who was born in either Africa or Following the arrest and "trials" of Prosser, Vesey, the Virgin Islands, was enslaved for several months on and Turner, each was convicted and hanged. Only the island of St. Domingue (which is now Haiti), Turner's confession was dictated in full before his

232——Enslavement Resistance

execution by hanging. In each instance, most if not all where he opened a used clothing store and became an of the leaders' coconspirators were executed; and the activist, contributing frequently to *Freedom's Journal*, rank and file followers were largely convicted and the first newspaper in the nation owned and operated hanged, or convicted and sold farther South; literally by blacks. In 1829, he wrote an "Appeal," a radical hundreds of blacks, both enslaved and free, were document that encouraged blood for blood in defense whipped, otherwise maimed, or outright slaughtered of black life and railed against the return of blacks to because of their connection, or imagined connection, Africa. Walker published and distributed it through to the insurrections. Although the scope and impact of seamen who traveled to Southern ports; even more the insurrections were largely minimized by whites, creatively, Walker sewed copies of his document into panic related to the revolts was widespread. The the lining of the clothes he sold, decreasing the chance resulting fear following the Turner rebellion drove of detection. Because of the seditious nature of the Southern legislatures to tighten restrictions on

"Appeal" in the slaveholding South, Walker's life was enslaved Africans and pushed the fight for abolition threatened and a reward was offered for delivering almost wholly into the North.

him to the South.

Other Rebellions

CONCLUSION

Another important form of armed resistance was Resistance to enslavement was quite widespread. It the constitution of Maroon communities and the wag-took many forms, but each time, what African people ing of guerrilla warfare by their members against asserted was their humanity, in a most inhumane, plantations. Maroon communities existed everywhere white-created, context. What inspired Africans was enslavement prevailed. In the

United States, such the insurmountable will that most of them had to be communities were found in Virginia, North Carolina, free to determine the modalities of their own exis-South Carolina,

Louisiana, Alabama,

Florida,

tence. This remains a valuable lesson for present Mississippi, and Georgia. The most famous Maroon generations.

communities, however, were located outside of the United States, in Brazil, Jamaica, and Surinam. The

— *Dawn L. Cannon*

Maroons often duplicated African models of social organization and engaged in African cultural prac-FURTHER READING

tices. The successful war fought to overthrow slavery Aptheker, Herbert. (1943). *American Negro Slave Revolts*.

in Haiti, which was waged by Africans against their New York: Columbia University Press. This is a minutely French enslavers, also needs be mentioned here, as researched treatment of the mechanics of slavery and the it was the only fully successful military victory of forces supporting and thwarting rebellion. Numerous inci-enslaved Africans over their white oppressors.

dences of rebellion support the author's conclusion that insurrection was the rule rather than the exception.

Genovese, Eugene D. (1979). *From Rebellion to Revolution*:
ABOLITIONISM

Afro-American Slave Revolts in the Making of the Modern World. Baton Rouge: Louisiana State University Press.

In the latter decades of slavery in the United States, This text provides a global treatment of the psychology, while insurrection and armed revolt persisted, resis-sociology, and science of black rebellion against slavery.

tance also took an alternate path. Freed blacks such as Higginson, Thomas Wentworth. (1969). *Black Rebellion: Five Frederick Douglass and Sojourner Truth, who were Slave Revolts*. New York: Arno Press. This is a well-both literate and passionate, began to express their researched, dramatic treatment of the stories behind the plea for the abolition of slavery in written venues and maroons of Jamaica and Surinam, as well as the Prosser, in public forums. Of the freed blacks advocating for Vesey, and Turner insurrections.

James, C. L. R. (1963). *The Black Jacobins*. New York: the end of slavery, David Walker was considered by Random House. This book undertakes a critical analysis many as one of the most militant.

of the Haitian Revolution, as it details class and race Born in Wilmington, North Carolina, just before dynamics in the Haitian fight for freedom and ties together the start of the 19th century, Walker was free because forces within the slave trade within the United States and his mother had been freed. He settled in Boston, internationally.

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 233

Ethiopianism———233

increasingly widespread use of the term, as did sacred **ETHIOPIANISM**

scripture, most notably, “Princes shall come out of Egypt; Ethiopia shall stretch forth its hands unto God”

Ethiopianism is the name scholars have given to the (Psalms 68:31–32). This prophecy, which African race redemption ideas that black theologians and converts to Christianity first adopted during the 18th theorists in different parts of the English-colonized century’s great religious revival, referred to spiritual world derived from biblical Ethiopia. The term was submission to the Hebrews’ God. However, black originally used in the

1890s in South Africa to clergy such as Peter Williams, Jr., of the St. Philip's describe secessionist black churches, which were African Church in New York, interpreted the passage called Ethiopian denominations after the perennially as a salvation-liberation text. Williams and other free black nation of Ethiopia. The expression was black clerics—Absolom Jones, Daniel Coker, and not used to describe Ethiopian elements in black J. W. C. Pennington—evolved from the verse the American thought until the 1970s, when scholars of vision of a resplendent African past and future.

black nationalism first discerned signs of an Ethiopian In the antebellum era, protest pamphleteers such ideological tradition in America.

as David Walker and Alexander Young used various From the late 18th to the late 20th century, the Hebraic and Hellenic sources to identify the Nile Valley ancient African country Ethiopia symbolized an ideal—as the origin of all Africans. This theorized common ized mythical space, an African Zion, for people of Nilotic identity made Africans collectively, whatever African descent globally. The peculiar mystique their provenance and predicament, inheritors of a Ethiopia has held among Africans worldwide stems shared and acclaimed ancestry. Black publicists also from its recognition as a major biblical civilization, its crafted from biblical Egypt and Ethiopia a cyclical history of uninterrupted independence, and its having view of black history, one in which the inception, a longer Christian heritage than most of Europe can regression, and renewal of African ascendancy was claim. As a distinctive emblem of black precocity, predestined. These beliefs—an esteemed black iden-power, and promise, esteemed Ethiopia gave sup-tity, history, and destiny—constitute the core of a pressed Africans during slavery, colonialism, and seg-salvation ideology that is in direct opposition to racist regation a particularly strong sense of racial pride and denigration and racial despair.

inspiration. Its significance even surpassed that of The Exodus motif dominated the dialogue of dynastic Egypt, an African state that black Bible read-enslaved blacks. That of Ethiopian deliverance domi-ers greatly respected for its might and majesty but nated free black discourse. After the Civil War, the generally viewed as a slave society.

rhetoric of black redemption was nationalized. The An attachment to Ethiopia among African Ethiopian prophecy appeared as a motto for the black Americans began before the American Revolution.

race in Southern newspapers like the *Black* Starting in the 1760s, some enslaved Africans who *Republican* of New Orleans and in speeches of mass had converted to Christianity and conformed to leaders such as Benjamin “Pap” Singleton of Kansas.

English culture, like the authors Phillis Wheatley and In the Reconstruction era, the gospel of Ethiopian Jupiter Hammon, occasionally used the term *Ethiopia* salvation was also prominently reflected abroad in to mean all

Africans everywhere. The Ethiopian the race manifestos of the eminent black scholars nomenclature or some related cognomen also appeared Alexander Crummell and Edward Blyden, noted in the names of early black religious congregations, advocates of Liberian emigration. The Ethiopian such as the Ethiopian Anabaptist Church in Georgia ideology and contemporary Ethiopia gained added and the Abyssinian Baptist Church in New York. By significance worldwide with the Ethiopians' stunning the 1800s, an emergent black American intelligentsia defeat in 1896 of an Italian army sent to colonize the that included the influential Methodist bishop Richard country. The victory verified modern Ethiopia as Allen had begun to employ religious rhetoric that God's chosen instrument of global black redemption.

proclaimed the Ethiopian's worldwide deliverance, At the end of the 19th century, Ethiopian renaissance spiritually and secularly.

was a conspicuous theme in black drama, poetry, and Thus the literary custom in the West of using history, as evidenced in works of the noted writer *Ethiopia* as a generic term for all Africans stimulated W.E.B. Du Bois. African redemption was also a

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 234

234——— *Ethnic Notions*

marked feature of educated West African thought.

descent everywhere can draw inspiration from sovereign It was the critical theme, for instance, in the classic nations throughout the ancestral homeland instead of *Ethiopia Unbound*, which the pioneer Gold Coast only within the Nile Valley.

nationalist J. E. Casely Hayford authored in 1911.

— *William R. Scott*

The ideas that comprise the Ethiopian tradition constitute a myth of African redemption. According to **FURTHER READING**

St. Clair Drake, it is a “retrospective myth of a glorious past and prospective myth of divine deliverance.”

Drake, St. Clair. (1970). *The Redemption of Africa and Black* The Ethiopian mode of thought addresses the prob-Religion. Chicago: Third World Press. This work contains a lematic present of African peoples through the por-seminal reflection on the neglected subject of Ethiopianism.

Mainly an examination of Edward W. Blyden as an “intel-trayal of a utopian African past and projection of lectual Ethiopianist,” the study remains, despite its brevity, an optimistic future. The myth of race resurgence an indispensable introduction to the topic.

attained its apex between the two world wars. The Moses, Wilson J. (1998). *Afrotopia: The Roots of African* theme of black redemption permeated the era’s *American Popular History*.

New York:

Cambridge

major “New Negro” movement, the Universal Negro University Press. Moses provides important perspectives Improvement Association. The ideology of race on the ideology and history of Ethiopianism as part of a salvation Marcus Garvey preached was steeped in critical analysis of the evolution of Afrocentric thought in the United States.

Ethiopian millennialism. So was the massive reaction Scott, William R. (1993). *The Sons of Sheba’s Race: African* of Africans globally to the second Italian invasion *Americans and the Italo-Ethiopian War*. Bloomington: of Ethiopia in 1935. Leaders of the worldwide Indiana University Press. This book examines the protest, such as Willis N. Huggins of Harlem, liberally Ethiopian tradition in black thought as a critical factor in invoked the Ethiopian mythos to rally the black the identification of African people worldwide with the masses against fascist imperialism.

defense in the 1930s of Ethiopia against fascist aggression.

The Ethiopian thought style is associated presently with Rastafarianism, the well-known Caribbean religious movement that emerged in Jamaica in about 1930. The religion, which takes its name from

ETHNIC NOTIONS

Ethiopian Emperor Haile Selassie's precoronation appellation, Ras Tafari, traditionally regarded the *Ethnic Notions* was the first major work of now-deceased monarch as God. Because of broad acclaimed African American filmmaker Marlon Riggs public awareness of Rastafarianism, generated by (1957–1994). Narrated by actress Esther Rolle and popular reggae music suffused with Rastafarian sym-featuring commentary by noted scholar Barbara bolism, views have arisen that Ethiopianism origi-Christian, legendary filmmaker Carlton Moss, and nated in the Caribbean instead of North America, others, the documentary explores the origins and where the myth began and from which it extended to evolution of black stereotypes in America.

elsewhere in the Atlantic world. The belief's diffusion Riggs traces the development of the loyal Tom and always proceeded from African American Protestants faithful Mammy, the carefree Sambo and childlike who spoke Ebonics rather than from Afro-Catholics.

Coon, the savage Brute and animal-like Pickaninny in Although the Ethiopian ethos was the first and popular media such as songs, cartoons, films, adver-longest ideological formulation of Africans in the tising, and common household artifacts. As he locates diaspora, it ultimately declined as a force in black each figure within its proper historical context, it American thought between 1940 and 1960. A critical becomes evident that they were not simply arbitrary factor in its decline was the final collapse of products created for mass entertainment. To the white Garveyism. Italy's defeat of Abyssinia in 1936 also ruling class, these caricatures functioned as important adversely affected visions of Ethiopian redemption.

elements of social control.

Modern society's growing secularization undermined In particular, Riggs's insightful analysis of the spiritualist ideas such as that of a divinely driven

Sambo figure demonstrates how racial myths were revival of African glory. And, paradoxically, Africa's constructed according to the shifting politics of white decolonization diminished Ethiopia's significance.

supremacy. During enslavement, it was necessary for With the continent's independence, people of African white slaveowners to maintain support for the system

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 235

Eurocentrism——235

by presenting slavery as a benign institution in which and contemporary blacks in the media must accept enslaved Africans were content with their oppressed some responsibility for the present-day manifestation condition. In accordance with this theory, Sambo was of racial myths. However, with increased representa-characterized as ignorant, shiftless, and unable to tion in major media outlets, black creative artists as function outside the confines of the slave system.

well as audiences are now in the best political and By the mid-1800s, impersonations of Sambo by economic position to challenge and eventually eradi-white minstrel performers had become a mainstay in cate stereotypes with more conscious, authentic popular stage productions throughout the North. As images of black history and culture. *Ethnic Notions* the abolitionist movement grew, the illusion of the handles the complex subject of American race rela-docile figure helped ease white fears of black resis-tions with great clarity and insight, and the Emmy-tance. And as Riggs notes, the fact that Sambo was so winning documentary has become required viewing in popular with Northern audiences during this period many high school and university classrooms.

dispels the myth of an utterly benevolent North sym-

— *Stephanie Yarbough*

pathetic to the antislavery cause. After enslavement, Sambo was transformed into several manifestations of **FURTHER READING**

the Coon, a figure whose unsuccessful efforts to adopt white speech and mannerisms presumably confirmed Bogle, Donald. (2000). *Toms, Coons, Mulattoes, Mammies, and Bucks*. New York: Continuum. Bogle identifies the assimilate into the dominant culture. The emergence main racist characters that pervaded American cinema for a long time.

of the Zip Coon was a thinly veiled attempt by the Guerrero, E. (1993). *Framing Blackness: The African white ruling class to undermine black political agency American Image in Film*. Philadelphia: Temple University during Reconstruction.

Press. This book provides an insightful analysis of how In the early 1900s, white anxiety over an expand-devastating images have effectively undermined black ing black labor force in the North gave birth to the agency.

Urban Coon, whose carefree lifestyle revolved around Ross, K. (1996). *Black and White Media: Black Images in liquor, gambling, and raucous behavior*. This more *Popular Film and Television*. Cambridge, UK: Polity Press.

Ross surveys and contrasts the portrayal of black and white dangerous version of the Zip Coon served to legit-people on television and in films.

imize increased violence against blacks and the suppression of black advocacy for quality employment, housing, and education. These caricatures permeated American popular culture, despite the fact that neither **EUROCENTRISM**

the slave system nor the urban industrial economy could have succeeded with the existence of such indo-Eurocentrism is a political, cultural, social, and ecolent characters as Sambo and Coon.

onomic world system that emerged with the expansion The psychological damage suffered by blacks of Europe during the voyages of conquest from 1492

because of these dehumanizing stereotypes is explored to 1600. When Europe expanded into Africa, Asia, in *Ethnic Notions* through actor Leni Sloan's dramatization of America, and the Pacific regions after Christopher Columbus's voyages to the Americas, it brought to Williams. In a tragicomic monologue, Williams articulates those regions the religion, language, customs, traditions, and symbol systems of Europe.

blackface in order to secure employment in the mainIn one sense Eurocentrism may be seen as the stream theater industry. His poignant statement, "It's advancement of the European ideal, but in another no disgrace being black, but sometimes it's terribly sense it may be seen as imperialism, exploitation, and inconvenient," reveals the internal conflict suffered by the promotion of greed. These two senses of the same many black performers whose exploitation of black phenomenon have created tension between Europeans cultural norms ultimately negated the reality of the and other peoples, particularly when Eurocentrism, as black experience.

an intellectual tendency, has been imposed upon those *Ethnic Notions* concludes that any system of peoples.

oppression is successful once the oppressed group During the period of the colonization of Africa, willingly perpetuates negative stereotypes of itself, beginning with the 15th century and ending with the

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 236

236———**European Slave Trade**

independence of many nations in the 1950s and 1960s, Europe sought to make the Africans Europeans in their **EUROPEAN SLAVE TRADE**

names, desires, opinions, fashion, religion, and tastes.

Those who rejected such imposition assumed the role What is referred to as the "European slave trade"

of militants, belligerents, and alternative thinkers. The created the division of the black and white races in colonizers thought that because they were imposing world history. The capture, exploitation, and dispersal what was “best” for the Africans, the Africans would of Africans by European nations, for the purpose of accept Eurocentrism without conflict or protest. In free labor, created a distorted image of Africans that many instances, this was the case, but in many others continues to affect the African-European relationship.

it was not the case.

The European institution of slavery took on a harsh, Eurocentrism is thus, in the words of Samir Amin, brutal, and dehumanizing form. However, the enslave-

“the great taboo,” because it is the accepted reality. A ment of Africans predates European contact with West person from the colonized world who speaks against Africa. From the 10th to the 14th century, Arab Eurocentrism is labeled radical, as the Eurocentric nations bought and sold African captives in Islamic system is all inclusive, encompassing education, law, markets. A large number of those enslaved were science, and knowledge. To challenge Eurocentrism is African women, who were purchased to work as ser-thus to challenge what is widely assumed to be the vants or concubines. The captives were relocated way things are.

north across the deserts of northwest Africa to the It is this issue that has thrown light on the way the Mediterranean coast. There, in markets such as Ceuta Afrocentrists have articulated their arguments in (which is now Morocco), Africans were purchased to Black Studies. Afrocentrists are the first challengers work as servants or laborers in Spain, Portugal, and of the notion that any group or culture should impose other countries. This marked the start of what is its will on the rest of humanity. Afrocentrists have referred to as the European slave trade.

contended that if Eurocentrism was just the expres-The inception of the European slave trade occurred sion of European ideas, values, literature, and so forth, when the Portuguese and Spanish developed a rela-ther would be no problem. However, the imposition tionship with North Africa

after the Moorish invasion of Eurocentrism as the only way to view reality of the Iberian Peninsula. Although Spain and Portugal amounts to ideological slavery and therefore must be had access to the natural and human resources of rejected. Thus, a pluralism without hierarchy is the Africa along the northern coast, they were not content best approach to dealing with imposing ideologies.

with this trade and moved further south along the western coast of Africa. Between 1420 and 1441,

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

Spain and Portugal were the first European nations to trade for natural resources with indigenous Africans.

In 1442, the Portuguese explorers returned from **FURTHER READING**

the western coast of Africa with gold dust and Amin, Samir. (1989). *Eurocentrism*. New York: Monthly 10 Africans. This essentially began the enslavement of Review Press. This book discusses the intellectual con-Africans by European nations.

struction of Eurocentrism as an idea in the promotion of Although Portugal was the first European nation to imperialism.

establish a permanent relationship with indigenous Blaut, J. M. (2000). *Eight Eurocentric Historians*. New York: Guilford Press. This is the best book to date on the way Africans, the Spaniards followed in 1562. Soon after-Eurocentric historians organized their support for ward, the British made their appearance in the trade Eurocentrism.

of Africans. Then the Dutch became involved in Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1990). *Civilization or Barbarism*.

human trade in about 1620, followed by the French New York: Lawrence Hill. This is Diop's masterpiece in about 1640. The Swedes, Danes, and Prussians examining how Europe engaged the questions of African attained the full extent of their involvement in the history and civilization.

18th century.

Madhubuti, Haki. (1995). *Claiming Earth: Race, Rage, Rape*. In 1482, the Portuguese forced their way onto the *Redemption*. Chicago: Third World Press. In this book, one of the greatest African American essayists and poets examines the role of globalization and the new world order on the West African coast in present day Ghana to control trading in the role of Africans. This location was referred to by the condition of African people.

Portuguese as *Elmina* (which means “the mine”)

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 237

Exodusters——237

because of the productivity of the nearby gold mines.

The human traffic to the United States, mainly Although originally built for trade in gold, ivory, and centered in Rhode Island, ended in 1807, the first other resources, this trading post was the first of year Congress addressed the question of abolition, as many trading posts built by Europeans along Africa’s agreed to by the compromise between Northern and western coast that was used to export Africans.

Southern states writing the Constitution in 1787. The From its outset, the relationship between Europe French enslavement of Africans ended 1848. After the and Africa was economic. Portuguese merchants Napoleonic Wars ended in 1814 and 1815, the British used the trading posts to trade with Africans. They decided to end their trade. The Dutch trade, which exchanged items such as brass and copper for such largely ended during the war with France in the late products as pepper, cloth, beads, and Africans.

1700s, was abolished in 1814. However, although the Europeans did not have the power to overcome trade of Africans ended in the early 1900s, slavery African states before the late 19th century, and gold continued to exist through to the end of the 1900s—

production, centered in Akan gold fields in the back-and its effect still continues to negatively affect the country of present-day Ghana, remained in African African world community.

hands.

— *Justin Gammage*

However, after the voyages of exploration, European nations began a frenzied scramble for the human resources of Africa they needed to clear the **FURTHER READING**

lands and build the cities of the Americas. Thus, Chinweizu. (1987). *The West and the Rest of Us: White before the start of the 1500s, nearly 200,000 Africans Predators, Black Slavers and the African Elite*. Lagos, had been relocated against their wills to Europe and Nigeria: Pero Press. Chinweizu begins this book with the the Americas. By the mid 1500s, the colonial powers history of Europe's arrival in Africa, goes on to discuss of the Caribbean islands and Brazil had begun to the beginning of the European slave trade, and explores in-depth Europe's invasion of African and other countries.

invest in cultivating sugar, a crop that demanded Davidson, Basil. (1961). *The African Slave Trade*. Boston: constant attention and strenuous labor.

Atlantic-Little. This is one of the best introductions to the By 1619, over 150 years after the Portuguese first history of the slave trade.

traded humans from Africa, European explorers had brought more than a million Africans to European-controlled plantations in the Americas to be enslaved and used as free labor. This relationship continued for nearly 300 years. It is estimated that Europeans made **EXODUSTERS**

more than 54,000 voyages for the purpose of trade in human beings. As a result, a conservative estimate The Exodusters movement, which was officially of 10 to 12 million Africans were transported to the called the Kansas Fever Exodus, was a largely spon-Americas. Some estimates put the number at 50 mil-taneous, mass movement in the spring of 1879 of lion. In

a span of 20 years, from 1680 to 1700, the some 20,000 black people from the border states of British alone were responsible for exporting over Kentucky and Missouri; from the former slaveholding 300,000 Africans and relocating them in the West states of Tennessee, Mississippi, and Louisiana; and Indies and the North American continent. By the mid-1700s from Texas to Kansas. The blacks' motivation for 1700s, the British had become the largest slave leaving when Reconstruction collapsed was the per-traders.

sistent threat of violence from whites. Henry Adams, By the early 1700s, tobacco, sugar, indigo, and rice a formerly enslaved man and army veteran, speaking plantations had switched from European indentured primarily of his experiences in Louisiana, testified labor to enslaved African labor. By the mid-1700s, before a U.S. Senate committee investigating the Brazil, Saint-Domingue, and Jamaica were the three Exodusters that the freed people were endangered largest colonies in the Americas receiving Africans. In daily by white violence. Indeed, they were subjected the 1830s, Cuba emerged as the main Caribbean plan-to murder, rape, and arson, as former plantation owntation colony. Throughout the history of human trade, ers sought to intimidate them into a kind of passivity however, more Africans were brought to Brazil than to that would make them easier to manage. Added to any other colony.

this were debt peonage, the convict lease system, the

E-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:50 PM Page 238

238———**Exodusters**

abuse of black women, inadequate to nonexistent its agencies—the fabled 40 acres and a mule—were school facilities, and the absence of health care, all eroded in the face of white terrorism intended to return of which had the effect of remanding black people things to the way they were in the social world of the to the days when the enslavement and its attendant antebellum South. Benjamin “Pap” Singleton played processes ruled the land.

a major role in this. Little is known of Singleton before In actuality, three factors set the stage for the his involvement with the Exoduster movement. What is movement: The first was the Homestead Act of 1862; known is that

he was born into slavery in Nashville, the second was the panic of 1873; and the third, which Tennessee; escaped to Canada as an adult; relocated resulted from the first two, involved the search for to Detroit, where he ran a boarding house that was a a more suitable and hospitable environment. The station on the Underground Railroad; and returned to Homestead Act, especially when applied to the vast Tennessee after the war was over. During the late 1860s open spaces of the trans-Mississippi West, made the and early 1870s, his experience working as a coffin acquisition of land relatively uncomplicated and maker persuaded him that black people would be better unambiguous. According to the original legislation, off if as many of them as possible could either increase the only thing that any potential settler, regardless of their independence or move out of the former states of race or class, needed to do was pay a filing fee, live on the Confederacy to places where they might find more and improve the property for a period of 5 years, and and better opportunities. Westward migration, then, then take title to 160 acres of free land. Pointedly, the seemed like the best of all possible options at the time, objective here was to populate the open space; and black people hoped that Kansas, because of its develop its previously untapped resources; and better history and because it had been the birthplace of John preserve, protect, and defend the founding concepts Brown, might just fill their needs.

of the envisioned American nation—freedom, liberty, Therefore, early in the 1870s, Singleton and equality, and justice.

several of his associates journeyed to Kansas. Upon However, with the country in dire financial straits, their return, they convinced several families that they some cutting of public expenditures was mandatory.

had less to lose by choosing to go west than by stay-And one of the more expensive costs for the federal ing where they were. By 1874, Singleton had begun to government at the time was the expense of troops sta-post fliers encouraging black people to relocate and, tioned in the South during Reconstruction to protect between 1877 and 1879, his group assisted a few hun-the lives of black people, as well as their newly dred families to settle in the state, develop colonies, acquired property and limited access to social and and prepare the way for those who were to follow.

democratic rights. Thus, the Economic Panic of 1873, Singleton also made additional trips to the state, in which gradually, and then with increasing haste, the including one in 1877, at which time Singleton aided troops were withdrawn, signaled to the traditionalists in the development of a colony in Cherokee County.

that obstacles to their desire—namely, the redemption Unfortunatly, what was not expected was that of the Southern way of life—were being removed. By the response to the fliers would be so massive, thus the time of the Hayes-Tilden Compromise of 1876, quickly overwhelming the modest infrastructure that Reconstruction existed more in name than in fact.

had been put in place. Many of those who arrived that The consequences of the soldiers' removal as attitudes spring of 1879 in St. Louis, and in other communities changed, priorities shifted, and the search for a new along both the Mississippi and Missouri rivers, order was initiated, are found in the testimony of were destitute, in questionable health, without skills, Henry Adams mentioned above. And though Frederick illiterate, and full of anxieties generated by changed Douglass in his speeches and writings sought to dis-circumstances in the places they had left. All they suade blacks who wanted to leave the South, at the really brought with them was the hope that they might same time, Richard T. Greener and others were find a new life on the prairie.

encouraging them to leave, and the prospective As might have been expected, white Southerners did migrants easily understood that increased mobility what they could to redirect or halt the movement alto-might bring increased opportunity.

gether, as at first small groups, and then much larger The third factor was the early investigation and congregations, gathered by the riverside to begin their exploration of other places that might be more journey to what they believed was a "promised land."

hospitable, as the gains promised by the government and Once they arrived in Missouri, however, these people

quickly came to be perceived as refugees whom no one **FURTHER READING**

really wanted and who presented problems that both Athearn, Robert. (1978). *In Search of Canaan: Black black and white citizens in St. Louis, Kansas City, Migration to Kansas, 1879–80*. Lawrence: Regents Press Topeka, and other communities along the way were of Kansas. This is a close examination of the experiences woefully unprepared to address. But address them they of black migrants to Kansas after Reconstruction.

did, relocating people to outlying areas, and eventually Painter, Nell Irwin. (1976). *Exodusters: Black Migration to on to Kansas itself*, although some of these people did *Kansas After Reconstruction*. Topeka: University Press of return to their former homes in succeeding years, as they Kansas. An overview of the migration of black people out were disappointed by the conditions they encountered.

of the South following the fall of Reconstruction, especially its millenarian aspects.

— *William M. King*

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 241

F

siblings to each other. While conjugal relationships **FAMILY**

between husbands and wives were important for defining smaller family groupings or households into The family is the basic relational unit of most societies which children were born, uncles or aunts often were and cultures. In the African cultural context both on referred to as “father” or “mother” and had the social the continent and in the diaspora, family is defined and cultural responsibility for the children of their primarily by blood relationships connecting kinship brothers and sisters that parents have for their children networks across many households. These primarily in

Westernized nuclear families. This system, based blood or *consanguineous* relationships are also defined on blood relationship through lineages and well-by marriage, adoption (both formal and informal), and structured lines of responsibility and inheritance, appropriation of *para* or *play* kin defined by social provided both fluidity and security for members of the function rather than by either blood or conjugal rela-extended African family. In addition to these structural tions. While some family members within Africana parameters, African families were defined spiritually diaspora cultures may occupy a single dwelling, the by the recognition of all members of a lineage across family is defined not by where its members reside but generations, including the unborn and the dead or by the various forms of relationship that make up the ancestors. This meant that much day-to-day living kin network across households. This kin network con-included rituals of inclusion and acknowledgment of necting several households is often referred to as the ancestors as active family members. This also meant extended family.

that both elders and small children were valued, cared for, and provided an important place in the family and wider social structure of the African community.

THE FAMILY IN AFRICA

In traditional West African societies, the cultural **THE FAMILY IN AMERICA**

origin of most black families in the United States, families were defined by their extended, multigenera-In the diaspora, particularly in the United States, the tional network character and blood relations patriline-experiences of enslavement and Africans' social, eally (i.e., along a male line), as seen among the cultural, and spiritual resistance to enslavement have Yoruba of Nigeria; matrilineally (i.e., along a female been critical elements in determining both the struc-line), as seen among the Ashanti of Ghana; or in some ture and function of black families. While the cruelties instances twineally (i.e., along dual lines of inheri-and dehumanizing methods of chattel servitude made tance), as seen among the Ibo of Nigeria. Family size it impossible for Africans enslaved in North America and kin networks were extended by marriage between to maintain the complex family

systems of the tradi-members of different lineages, since marriage to a tional African societies, Africans were able to hold blood relative was prohibited. Within a lineage group, on to the value for blood relations, the valuing of children within the same age cohort were considered the extended kin network, reverence and respect for 241

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 242

242——**Family**

elders, and the centrality of children to the family families, how have they been able to survive and structure. The continued focus on the primacy of con-exhibit such resilience in the face of overwhelming sanguineous or blood relations in defining family odds?”

engendered a strong sense of responsibility and obliga-From the middle of the 20th century through the tion between blood kin across the extended network.

early years of the 21st century, the pathological deficit After the Civil War, though Africans were legally view championed by Frazier and Moynihan has held

“freed people,” black families continued to be sub-sway in shaping governmental policy as well as the jected to the social, cultural, political, and economic public discourse about the family in African America.

policies of their former enslavers. In the decades This view and the scholarship behind it have provided following, and into the 20th century, these policies the rationale for the economic policies of every designed to maintain racist control through Jim Crow U.S. president from Lyndon B. Johnson to George laws had a tremendous debilitating effect on gender W. Bush. Despite this reality, however, and despite relations, relations between parents and children, and repeated predictions of the eventual dissolution of the extended family relations, while at the same time black family, the cultural values retained from family creating increasing class stratification and tensions life in West Africa, the maintenance of extended kin between family groups.

networks, as well as the resilience learned through Throughout the 20th century, scholarship on the resistance to enslavement and racism have ensured the African family in America was largely shaped by a ongoing adaptability and longevity of the African two-pronged debate between the pathological deficit family in the United States.

view and the cultural relativity or African cultural

— *Makungu M. Akinyela*

retentions view. Largely influenced by the work of the renowned black E. Franklin Frazier, and later that of Daniel P. Moynihan, the *pathological deficit* view **FURTHER READING**

argues that as a result of the destruction of traditional Billingsley, Andrew. (1994). *Climbing Jacob's Ladder: African values, customs, and cultural norms in slavery The Enduring Legacy of African-American Families*.

and to some extent because of ongoing racist policies, New York: Simon and Schuster. This book, by one of the black families after the Civil War had no cultural basis premier scholars on the black family, challenges many of for building healthy kinship patterns. This view often the myths and misconceptions that influence black presents black people as perpetual victims with family research.

neither a past nor a future of any relevance outside Franklin , Donna L. (1997). *Ensuring Inequality: The Structural Transformation of the African-American Family*.

of the context established by European American New York: Oxford University Press. This work examines cultural and institutional norms. The *cultural relativ-current stresses in black family life by reviewing the ity or African retentions view emerges out of the work historical dynamic between family development and of W.E.B. Du Bois, Melville Herskovits, and later American political and economic policy*.

Robert Hill, Andrew Billingsley, Wade Nobles, and Hill , Robert B. (1999). The Strengths of African American others. This view, rather than assuming

that black Families: Twenty-five years later. Lanham, MD: University families are only deficient reflections of European Press of America. This is a revised version of the argument American norms, argues that there are Africanisms in made by Hill in defense of the black family, with important new research and models for creating a solutions frame-black family relationship styles that explain the differ-work for understanding black families.

ences between black and white families. From the T'Shaka, Oba. (1995). Return to the African Mother Principle start, researchers with these different views of of Male and Female Equality. San Francisco: Pan black and white families in America ask radically Afrikan. T'Shaka reviews 14 traditional African societies different questions in their research and scholarship.

and, using these societies as models, poses an African-Researchers with the pathological deficit view are pri-centered, nonsexist paradigm for black male-female marily concerned with the question, "Why are black relationships.

Willie, Charles Vert, and Reddick, Richard J. (Eds.). (2003).

families not able to achieve the success experienced A New Look at Black Families (5th ed.). Thousand Oaks, by white families in America?" On the other hand, CA: AltaMira Press. This work brings together the those with the cultural relativity or African retention research of several sociologists who use a case study view are curious to know, "Despite the historical, approach to examine black families from different class social, political, and cultural barriers set before black backgrounds.

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 243

Fanonian Concept of Violence———243

*they are accused of attempted theft. In both instances, **FANONIAN CONCEPT OF VIOLENCE***

there is, in other words, a situation of perceived theft.

*Fanon challenged the nonviolent resolution of this *Les damnés de la terre*, which is literally translated face-off—decolonization. The colonized paying for*

“the damned of the earth,” was originally published the land would, in effect, be like their paying robbers under its French title in 1961, shortly before the death to return the goods the robbers stole from them.

of its author, Frantz Fanon, on December 6, 1961.

What’s more, colonizing groups also bring a set of Fanon had written the work over a 10-week period of values that present their actions as rightful and just, astonishing labor after learning that he had leukemia.

and they bring along their military forces to support The philosopher-psychiatrist was one of the most them. These values usually ascribe greater worth to infamous revolutionaries in the French-speaking the lives of colonizers than to the lives of the colo-world, having formally joined the Front nationale nized. Since the decolonization process requires libération (FLN), the group that led the fight for retrieving the land, standing up to the military, and Algerian independence. Although there was a price denying the superiority of the colonizing group, an on his head, Fanon managed to evade capture and analytic of violence emerges. When the colonized met with Jean-Paul Sartre, the most celebrated living are asked to be nonviolent, it means that they are philosopher of the time, and persuaded him to write asked to request change in a form that is acceptable the preface to the work. The work had an immediate to the colonizers. In some cases, that means so-called great influence on the French-speaking world. Two change without the colonizers losing anything.

*years later, in 1963, it was translated into English and published as *The Wretched of the Earth*.*

TYPES OF VIOLENCE

*There are few books that have had as much impact on contemporary thought as *The Wretched of the Fanon* asserted that violence creates many shifts. First, it *Earth*. It was described by the Black Panthers as “the is an*

act of seizing freedom. Second, it creates a situation in which innocents suffer, which strengthens the book as essential reading for all left-wing intellectual opposition to the colonial relationship. Third, it stimulates. The right wing attacked it viciously as a war-late new sets of values by toppling the colonizers from their thrones, and members of the more orthodox the status of gods. Fourth, it cannot be maintained, left attacked it as “unscientific.” Yet its impact has been such that new resolutions must occur. And fifth, it has been such that its readership ranges from college and perhaps most controversial to left-wing thinkers, to students reading “canonical texts” in universities to argue that the logic of colonialism is such that its best high school dropouts trying to figure out their situation are those that are a contradiction of the entire system as they live in the midst of poverty, squalor, and system and are most willing to take on its instruments of violence. Even a quick read of this classic, controversy—namely, the police and soldiers. These are the same text will explain these responses.

lumpenproletariat, the criminals and outsiders. Added to this are the peasants, since colonized countries often lack an industrial base. His response to first world intel-

THE CENTRAL ARGUMENT

lectuals who demand a period of “development” before taking action. The main thesis of the book is that freedom must be taken, never given. Because of this, the English title response in King, Jr.’s taken, never given. Because of this, the English title response in his “Letter from Birmingham Jail”: If they misrepresents the text, since Fanon did not consider were in the position of the colonized, they, too, would colonized people and those subject to international see why they cannot wait.

racist policies to be “wretched.” They lived as Fanon then took on third world mainstream leader-

“damned” people because they all, even the innocent ship by arguing that after decolonization, the new guard among them, suffer the same plight. The colonizers of elites would prop themselves up as mediators structure their relationship to the colonized as one of between the old colonizing forces and the new regime.

legitimate possession. This means that they see them-We know this today as neocolonialism. The money serves as having a right to the conquered people's stolen by these elites in former Zaire and other parts of land. Thus, when the conquered and colonized fight to Africa come to mind. Money is borrowed to build the regain what they, too, consider to be rightfully theirs, nation, then stolen by these elites and placed in foreign

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 244

244——Festivals

banks while the people continue to incur debts on the social, cultural, and historical legacies. The origins of interest. Fanon's message is summed up in the phrase, some of the earliest festival—or carnival—events in

“Every generation has its mission.” The mission after the African diaspora have frequently been attributed independence is to build up the infrastructure of the to European celebrations such as Roman Saturnalia nation. The individuals who inherit the nation after and Catholic Shrovetide or pre-Lenten festivities. The independence are often a weak national bourgeoisie, etymology of the word carnival, in fact, reflects the people whose power is linked not to material capital—

religious association with the prohibition of meat which would affect the infrastructure of the nation—

eating during the Lenten season (deriving from two but to cultural and service work. In other words, they Latin words: carne meaning “meat” and vale meaning often depend on their status as race representatives

“goodbye”). While the word itself may originate in mediating between the old regime and the new. The new the language of Europeans, carnival traditions among struggle, then, becomes fighting this bourgeoisie in the people of African descent in the diaspora can be hope of achieving a genuinely postcolonial society.

traced to celebrations of the fertility of women and Fanon closed the book by asking for a material and mother earth that originated thousands of

years ago conceptual struggle. The material struggle is to build up in Egypt. A critical examination of carnival traditions the nation's infrastructure—that is, roads, hospitals, reveals a strong African cultural aesthetic, combining sanitation, schools, and so on. The conceptual struggle sacred and secular rituals. This African aesthetic has involves new ways of knowing and understanding our-persisted in attenuated fashion in the diaspora.

selves as human beings. He described this as “shedding Masking (also known as masquerade, or playing our skins and setting afoot a new humanity.”

mas) is an integral element of carnival, and it reflects The Wretched of the Earth has proven to be a very the masking traditions of African cultures that prescient book. Many of the problems about which employed these in various rituals. The mask is Fanon warned have come to fruition, and the third inspired in large part by the reverence for ancestors, a millennium has been greeted by struggles for the dig-common theme in many African cultures. The Yoruba, nity of humankind in a very regressive era. The image for example, link the mask to the power and presence of Fanon has been rewritten many times, as the spate of the dead; the mask creates a threshold of protection of books and articles on him attest. In the end, the man against the penetration of the profane and maintains makes the most sense in the context of an appreciation distinctions between the worlds of the living and the of the revolutionary force of his ideas. He called upon dead. Masking various parts of the body is accom-us in that influential work to question the interpreta-plished with diverse materials, such as feathers, raffia, tion of the world that has been offered to us so that we cloth beads, and sequins. These materials are widely can, in another voice whose echo resounds from a employed by participants in the festivals of the century and a half past, change it.

African diaspora, from the black Indians of New Orleans to Bahians in Rio de Janeiro, to Trinidadians

— Lewis Gordon

in Carnival, to West Indians in Toronto's Caribana.

Carnival revelers “playing mas” in Trinidadian and **FURTHER READING**

Bahamian carnivals, for example, parade in costumes Fanon, Frantz. (1963). The Wretched of the Earth. New York: designed with bright strips of multilayered fabric that Grove Press. This is Fanon’s major work on the question of resemble Egungun costumes worn in the festivals of violence in relationship to oppression.

Benin and Nigeria; netted face coverings represent Gordon, Lewis. (2000). Existential Africa. New York: a boundary between the worlds of the living and the Routledge. Gordon provides a thorough discussion of existence from an African point of view. This is a serious work ancestral spirits that is to be breached only at one’s for the person interested in African philosophy.

personal peril; white-chalked faces evince ancestral spirit worship; feathers, considered among the Yoruba to be powerful in invoking positive life force energy (ase) and wealth, are also important elements in
FESTIVALS

costume decoration.

Africa-inspired drumming, outlawed during slavery, The diverse traditions of festivals among Africans and plays a central role in carnival music traditions, their descendants in the diaspora derive from complex although the earliest reports of carnival music included



F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 245

Festivals——245

Africans in the diaspora was characterized by periods of segregation (from European and free black celebrants), periods of suppression (due to laws enacted against them), periods of violence (from police actions), and periods of integration (with European celebrants and traditions).

Some of the most well known carnivals are found in the Caribbean region. Carnival celebration dates there vary; many occur around the Christian Lenten holiday, others occur during the summer months.

Many of the events that were originally celebrated during the pre-Lenten season changed their timing to avoid conflicting with the popular Trinidadian carnival. The Trinidadian carnival also exerts a substantial African Ohum Festival, Ghana

influence upon the conduct of festivals held in North America and Europe.

European-style minstrel bands and court music, Characterized as raucous and wild events in the sometimes performed in mockery of the colonizers.

early period, carnivals have transposed into well-Caribbean calypso and steel pan music evolved from organized and often well-financed events. In many chac-chac, drum sounds, and rhythms from Africa.

areas, they have evolved into tourist attractions—

Carnival performances have launched many regional commodified cultural events that draw large crowds musicians into the international music scene.

and can generate substantial personal and national While enslaved, Africans were sometimes called income. Carnivals also became highly politicized upon to perform for the entertainment of slave own-sources of nation building for Caribbean elites immigrants, but they were only permitted to assemble for diately following independence, forums for airing their own celebratory purposes during certain occasions on social and political issues, and win-sions, most notably the Christmas holiday season.

dows of visibility for those aspiring to political office During these limited occasions, they would celebrate or promoting a particular cause.

*by donning costumes, dancing, and drumming (where permissible). After Emancipation, however, freed **CARNIVAL IN THE CARIBBEAN***

Africans elaborated the tradition of carnivals throughout the diaspora, incorporating costumes, music, and Trinidad has one of the oldest and largest carnivals dances that reflected those found in African as well as in the African diaspora. Their carnival reflects the in the European and Asian cultures to which Africans callaloo culture created by the diverse groups who were exposed in the “New World.” The aesthetic came into contact there. Historically, Trinidad was fusion of such diverse cultures created multivalent tra-the province of Arawak and Carib Amerindians, and ditions that, nonetheless, are woven with some similar it later became home to the French, Spanish, British, threads throughout the African diaspora. Originally Africans, and East Indians. Trinidad’s carnival incor-centered in the colonies of the New World, the porates elements from all of these

cultures. One early carnival tradition has spread to Europe, as well as carnival tradition was called Canboulay, a term to Canada and the entire United States. Enclaves of thought to originate from cannes brulées, which is Caribbean immigrants in these regions inspired many French for “burning cane” and signified enslaved of these new carnival traditions.

Africans’ practice of using sticks to extinguish acci-Some of the earliest carnivals in the African dias-dental and premeditated fires on sugar cane planta-pora were occasions for expressions and characterizations. Canboulay incorporated the stick-fighting tions of class struggles. Carnivals represented one of traditions of East Indians and West Africans, and until the few venues where those of different classes and it was banned in the 1880s, it was a vital part of the statuses mixed, and where it was possible, at least for carnival. One of the most important ongoing features a brief interval, for their statuses to be reversed. The of Trinidadian carnival is the competition between development of festival or carnival traditions among bands, singers, and dancers for cash prizes. And every

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 246

246——Festivals

year, kings and queens are chosen the day preceding influences of many cultures—African, Caribbean, the carnival marches or processions. It has been said Amerindian, North American, and European. The that carnival in some countries is celebrated as a diver-antebellum Catholic influences of French and Spanish sion from the cares of everyday life, but in Trinidad, residents inspired the pre-Lenten festivals, which everyday life is seen as a diversion from carnival.

began after Christmas and lasted until Shrove Tuesday Most residents begin preparation for the next year’s or Mardi (French for “Tuesday”) Gras, while the carnival immediately after the conclusion of the enslaved Africans were allowed to assemble for song present event.

and dance only on Sundays. New Orleans has a dual The 1960s and 1970s witnessed a revival of the tradition that initially held one event that was exclu-carnival traditions in the smaller islands of the sive, for invited gentry

only, and another for the Caribbean. Festivals there occur around Christmas or masses. Postbellum, the excluded masses of freed in late July or early August, often marking the August blacks created their own pre-Lenten festival that com-Emancipation Day or independence throughout many bined the African and Amerindian cultural traditions former British colonies. Notable among these are of many residents whose historical contact led to the carnivals on the islands of Anguilla, Antigua, mixed ethnicities. The black Indians (also known Barbados (called “Crop Over” festival), Grenada, as tribes of Mardi Gras Indians) are well known for British Virgin Islands, and Jamaica (in late July or their elaborately plumed costumes that resemble early August), St. Vincent’s Vincy Mas, and St. Lucia those of both Plains Indian and African cultures. These (in June or July). Most mark the carnival date with

“tribes” are separated into downtown and uptown fac-various festivities including boat races, parades, fire-tions whose styles are distinguished by their costume works, music and band competitions, and dancing.

designs and materials.

Dominica’s Mas Dominik and Guyana’s Mashrami The over a half million Caribbean immigrants in (or Mash) occur annually in February. Junkanoo in New York City inspired the annual celebration of the Bahamas, Jonkonnu in Jamaica, and carnivals in carnival in Brooklyn. Organized during the civil rights St. Kitts-Nevis and Montserrat are staged annually and black power and black pride era of the 1960s, between Christmas and New Year’s Day.

the Brooklyn Labor Day Carnival (which was later Rara is a ritualized carnival celebrated in Haiti.

renamed the West Indian-American Day Carnival, Inc) This festival occurs during the 6-week period preced-displays costumes that reflect pan-Caribbean influences.

ing Easter. It is rooted in the culture of Vodou, an In addition to local talent, the Brooklyn carnival attracts African-derived religion, and is punctuated with some of its best performers—musicians, dancers, and African cultural

traditions, particularly from the singers—from Caribbean countries; they travel to Congo and Angolan regions. There is a hierarchical Brooklyn to participate in various carnival competitions.

order in the Rara bands that “make rara” in the streets Events commence on the Thursday preceding Labor (rather than at a specific site), and participants, “major Day, with each succeeding day’s music dedicated to joncs,” are elaborately costumed in garments created a specific Caribbean musical genre (Thursday, calypso; from paper, mirrors, cloth, and sequins. Rara music is Friday, reggae; Saturday, steel pan). Sunday, or performed with vaccines (bamboo tubes), Petro and Dimanche Gras, climaxes with costume competitions Congo drums, lambi (conch shells), and tin horns.

in preparation for the march in Monday’s Labor Day Rara serves both unifying and competitive functions event. While ostensibly promoting pan-African solidar-in Haitian communities, and it also acts as a mecha-ity, the Brooklyn carnival, ironically, serves as a means nism of social control. Carnivals are critical in the to differentiate the Afro Caribbean from other people of construction of pan-Caribbean identity and the asser-African descent in the United States.

tion of solidarity among Caribbean immigrants in Toronto’s Caribana is held annually on the first North America and in Europe.

weekend of August and is sponsored by several expa-triate West Indian groups. In addition to the function of identity construction and pride elevation, Caribana **CARNIVAL IN NORTH AMERICA**

generates substantial tourist revenues for the city, New Orleans boasts one of the oldest carnival tradi-drawing well over a half-million visitors. In line with tions in North America. The pre-Lenten festival Mardi the carnival tradition of the Caribbean, the competi-Gras, like Trinidad’s carnival, reflects the diverse tive spirit is alive with king and queen competitions,

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 247

Fisk Jubilee Singers———247

and thousands of participants play mas in elaborate diaspora serve many functions. They are the occasions costumes and invite the crowds who watch to join for commemorative celebrations, social maneuverabil-in the festivities. Smaller carnivals have emerged in ity, and the informal transmission of culture.

other North American cities including Hartford,

— Rosalyn Howard

Boston, and Miami.

FURTHER READING

CARNIVAL IN EUROPE

Beier, Ulli. (1959). A Year of Sacred Festivals in One Yoruba Like New York City and Toronto, London is home to Town. Lagos: Nigeria Magazine Press. This is a good intro-a large number of Caribbean immigrants, primarily duction to the sacred festivals of Yoruba.

from the former British colonies. West Indian immi-Burton, Richard, E. (1997). Afro-Creole: Power, Opposition and Play in the Caribbean. Ithaca, NY: Cornell University grants brought their cultural traditions with them, and Press. In this book, Burton discusses the concept of play in they created carnival in their new home as a vehicle to the Caribbean, particularly as it is highlighted by issues of promote cultural solidarity and identity. The Notting power, opposition, and masquerade.

Hill Gate Carnival is held on the British Bank Holiday Cowley, John. (1996). Carnival, Canboulay and Calypso: and features the cultural traditions of many Caribbean Traditions in the Making. Cambridge, UK: Cambridge countries, as well as creolized traditions that resulted University Press. This is a good book on the tradition of from cultural contact. Just as the people are transna-carnival in the African diaspora, which cites examples tional, so are the variegated cultural traditions that from various African cultures in the Americas and Caribbean.

emerge in this festival.

*Crahan, Margaret E., and Knight, Franklin W. (1979). Africa and the Caribbean: Legacies of a Link. Baltimore, MD: **CARNIVAL IN SOUTH AMERICA***

Johns Hopkins University Press. This is a fine work that establishes the connection between Africa and the Rio de Janeiro's pre-Lenten carnival (carnaval in Caribbean as seen in the cultural artifacts of the diaspora.

Portuguese) and its Afro-Brazilian music and dance, Tselos, Susan E. (1996, Spring). Threads of Reflection: particularly the samba, have been important symbols Costumes of Haitian Rara. African Arts, pp. 58-65. This article by Tselos is one of the best descriptions of Haitian of Brazilian identity since the 1930s. Bahia, the site of Rara costumes.

*the largest population of people of African descent outside the African continent, was the center of the Luso-Brazilian slave trade, and Afro-Bahians' influence is significant in the Rio carnival. The Rio carnival really radiates all over that country. It is organized by two **FISK JUBILEE SINGERS***

categories: the street and the club. The street aspect is generally organized by neighborhoods or blocos. The The Fisk Jubilee Singers are the premier choral clubs are middle-class organizations whose walls ensemble of African American musicians, who gar-become permeable during carnival. The Salvador car-nered international acclaim performing concert-nival has become competitive with the Rio carnival, arranged versions of the spirituals—the great sacred and African-derived musical forms such as axe songs of their ancestors—while raising funds to support predominate in both. Carnival is the occasion for Fisk University.

temporary social maneuverability; persons of lower In January of 1866, only 6 months after the socioeconomic status have opportunities to mix with American Civil War ended, Fisk University was the middle and upper social classes during various club founded in an abandoned army hospital barracks in balls. Critical actors in the carnival are the samba Nashville, Tennessee. The university was established schools whose members are the

poor and black, mar-under the auspices of the American Missionary ginalized members of Brazilian society. Their social Association with the purpose of training former position is inverted, however, as they demonstrate a enslaved Africans to be teachers. With hundreds of superiority as teachers of the samba dancing that is so eager students, Fisk struggled financially in its early integral to the carnival. However, not all aspects of years, and by 1868, it was on the brink of collapse.

racial and class-based segregation disappear during Recognizing the musical talents of many of the young the carnival. Thus festivals or carnivals in the African students, music teacher and treasurer George White

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 248

248——Fisk Jubilee Singers

organized a chorus of Fisk students and appointed an the purchase of 25 acres of land on which Fisk 18-year-old student named Ella Sheppard assistant University is located. The self-determination and choral director.

*self-reliance of the group did indeed ensure the future of their school, and their bold confrontation with Northern racism triggered some significant social **BUILDING A CONSTITUENCY***

changes. After they were refused accommodations The chorus began singing in neighboring towns for on the Pullman cars, George Pullman integrated the donations for their school—despite the dangers they cars—and they stayed integrated for another quarter faced from local whites, who were threatening and century. Schools were opened to black children for the assaulting Fisk students for teaching at rural schools.

first time in New Jersey by the embarrassed Board of In October of 1871, White took the first group of nine Education when a New Jersey hotel manager put the singers on a fund-raising tour of the Northern states.

group out after learning that they were not minstrel Despite the reluctance of the students' parents and the singers. And, they set an example for other black opposition of other teachers at Fisk, and with no sup-schools, such as

Hampton Institute, which began their part from the American Missionary Association, the own choral ensembles.

group started in Cincinnati and followed the network With only 2 weeks of rest after their first tour, the of abolitionist homes and churches that had previously Fisk Jubilee Singers (who had begun to call them-assisted enslaved Africans in escaping to Canada.

selves the Jubilee Singers) reorganized, and in April They sang in churches, at private parties and teas, and of 1873 the group of 11 singers launched their first in busy streets. They endured filthy boarding houses, tour abroad when they traveled to the British Isles.

were treated badly at hotels and on railways, and suf-With a full and difficult schedule, their concerts, fered ill health from the lack of adequate clothing portraits, and songbooks were sold out, and books in the cold weather, as they remained dedicated to and newspapers were chronicling their history and acquiring funds to keep Fisk alive.

success. In the spring of 1874, the Jubilee Singers Initially, the group sang the popular songs of the returned home with \$50,000 for the construction of day in their performances, and they only sang the spir-Jubilee Hall. Despite all of the singers' sacrifice, ituals privately. They had not thought of singing the Jubilee Hall remained only a hole in the ground spirituals in public because the songs were, as Ella because the American Missionary Association had Sheppard said, "sacred" to their parents. But with the been borrowing heavily from what the singers earned prompting of their musical director, they began to use to stave off its own bankruptcy. Thus the exhausted the spirituals for their encores. Ella Sheppard later Jubilee Singers were asked to go on yet a third tour.

related, "It was only after many months that gradually With only 3 of the original 11 singers remaining, the our hearts were opened to the wonderful beauty and group set out for an extensive tour in America and power of our songs." Their singing of the spirituals was Europe. They traveled to Great Britain, Switzerland, so well received that they began to incorporate more of the Netherlands, France, and Sweden, as well as to them into their repertoire. Ella Sheppard began teach-Germany, where they did an

astonishing tour of singing and providing musical arrangements of the family-68 concerts in 41 towns in 98 days, not including earlier spirituals and new melodies as the group drilled and impromptu performances in churches, trains, and rehearsed while on tour. The highlights of their first private homes.

tour included a performance at Oberlin College in Returning to Nashville, the Jubilee Singers were Ohio for a national convention of ministers, sold-out honored by Fisk for raising over \$160,000 to complete performances in Connecticut with hundreds being Jubilee Hall and save their school. Jubilee Hall turned away in New Haven and Hartford, and remains today as one of the oldest structures in use a performance before President Ulysses S. Grant in a at Fisk University, and it was designated a National concert hall full of congressmen and diplomats.

*Historic Landmark by the U.S. Department of the Interior. In 1884, the Jubilee Singers began a 6-year world tour, and the Jubilee Singers tradition became **POPULARITY AND ACCLAIM***

a permanent institution at Fisk University. Today, the From this first tour of 6 months, they were able not ensemble is made up of students from various discionly to pay Fisk's debts but also to donate \$20,000 for plines at Fisk and from all over the United States, and



F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 249

***Forty Acres and a Mule*———249**

the singers continue to perform for audiences throughout the world. In 2000, the Fisk Jubilee Singers were inducted into the Gospel Music Hall of

Fame.

Thus the contributions of the Jubilee Singers extend far beyond Fisk University. They not only introduced the spiritual to the world but also helped preserve the music of African American ancestors for posterity.

— Mawusi Renee Simmons

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Ward, Andrew. (2000). Dark Midnight When I Rise: The Story Dr. John Hope Franklin, historian, intellectual, organizer of the Jubilee Singers Who Introduced the World to the Music of Black America. New York: Farrar, Straus and Special Field Orders No. 15 designated 40-acre Giroux. This is one of the most important works on the story of the Jubilee Singers.

*sections of “tillable land” in Florida, Georgia, and South Carolina to be used exclusively by African people in the United States. African people were the only ones allowed to reside in these 40-acre sections **FORTY ACRES AND A MULE***

and were under no rule except that of the U.S.

Congress and military. Under Special Field Orders

“Forty acres and a mule” was the refrain heard and No.15, African people could not be conscripted into repeated during and after the Civil War when Africans the military, even though African men were highly were expecting

a redistribution of land. This came encouraged to enlist “as soldiers in the service of the about because on January 15, 1865, the American United States, to contribute their share towards main-government passed Special Field Orders No. 15, taining their own freedom.” Sherman appointed which when they were executed immediately there-General R. Saxton the Inspector of Settlements and after allowed General W. T. Sherman to give aban- Plantations to oversee the division and acquisitions of doned land in Charleston, Beaufort, Hilton Head, the designated land and land titles. Due to the large Savannah, Fernandina, St. Augustine, and Jacksonville job at hand, T. W. Osborne and Davis Tilson were to African people in the United States. These orders also recruited a few months later to help Saxton in dis- were passed 5 months before the end of the Civil War.

tributing the confiscated land. Although there was Then, on May 26, 1865, when the fighting between no specific mention of the allocation of mules, with the North and the South ceased, all legislation passed Sherman’s permission, the army was to loan out mules during the war, including these orders, were declared and horses seized during the war to those who settled null and void. The land that Sherman, with the coop-in these designated areas. It is said that over 40,000

eration of the Freedman’s Bureau, had been able to African men and women had been given an accumu-allocate to African people was taken back and redislation of 400,000 acres of land under these orders (at tributed to Southern plantation owners by President 10 acres a person), opening the door for the debate on Andrew Johnson. Thus the idea of 40 acres and a mule whether 40 acres and a mule was to be per family, per became one of many empty and broken promises person, or for African men only. Regardless of the made by the American government to African people logistics, these numbers were really representative of in America.

the collaborative efforts of the Freedman’s Bureau and

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 250

Sherman, as Sherman alone was never able Moses, Wilson Jeremiah. (1988). The Golden Age of Black to execute these orders in the way he wanted to Nationalism 1850–1925. New York: Oxford University because when the Civil War ended he lost some of Press. Moses examines the key ideas that created the African American desire for black determination and his power.

self-definition.

*On March 3, 1865, Congress created The Bureau of Refugees, Freedmen, and Abandoned Lands, also known as the Freedman's Bureau, to follow Sherman's lead and rent out 40-acre plots of land to African people. This land came with the promise that **FREEDOM SONGS***

it could eventually be bought. The Freedman's Bureau controlled over 800,000 acres of abandoned and con-Freedom songs are a corpus of songs that were used fiscated land throughout the Southern confederate during the civil rights movement of the 1960s and states, the states bordering the confederate states, the afterward as a unifying force in the African American District of Columbia, and territory occupied by Native struggle for freedom and human rights. The use of Americans. On May 25, 1865, a month after Lincoln's music in the fight for freedom was evidenced through-assassination, Johnson stated that these plots of land out the history of Africans in the Americas, particu-needed to be taken back and redistributed to the larly in the songs known as spirituals. But as a specific whites who owned them before the war. The former group of songs, freedom songs refer to the songs that plantation owners knew that owning land enabled were sung at sit-ins, mass meetings, prayer vigils, economic power and stability, and they therefore pres-protest marches, boycotts, rallies, freedom rides, sured Johnson to take back the land from African picket lines, courthouses, and jails. The first docu-people as quickly as possible. Many African people mented and identified body of freedom songs came who rented and owned these lands violently resisted from the student sit-in organizers in North Carolina, because they knew that this land belonged to them and South Carolina, and Tennessee.

that they were entitled to it. Despite their efforts, the Freedom songs are songs of protest and self-land was still stolen back by the government.

assertion, inspiration and encouragement. Through the The dream of “40 acres and a mule” continues to freedom songs, disenfranchised African Americans be a prominent issue for African people in America have been able to respond courageously to injustices today, especially with the current lawsuits filed for and comment boldly on events in their struggle for reparations. Those in support of reparations have cal-civil rights. In essence, the freedom songs were tools culated that 40 acres and a mule is worth around for survival that drew together people of differing \$43,000 in today’s society, and they assert that it backgrounds and experiences in a centralized struggle should be repaid in a way that economically benefits for human rights.

all African people in America. Whether or not repara-The majority of the freedom songs were adapted tions are ultimately made, 40 acres and a mule has from the wellspring of African American musical become part of the many hypocritical moves by the styles that were rooted in African cultural traditions.

American government promising African people in Most of the songs and styles of singing were based on America something that never became a true reality.

spirituals, gospel songs, and hymns. The original meanings of the older spirituals, messages of justice

— Aimee Glocke

and liberation, were relevant to the latest circumstances. In many of the older texts, pronouns were **FURTHER READING**

changed from first-person singular to first-person Asante, Molefi Kete. (2002). *African American History: A plural, fostering the sense of community and group Journey of Liberation*. Saddleback, NJ: Peoples Publishing solidarity. The repertoire of songs was expanded to Group. This book, which recounts the history of African include many popular African American musical Americans, has major sections that treat the aftermath of forms and singing techniques of the 1960s (e.g., the Civil War.

rhythm and blues). Melodies were retained, song texts Franklin, John Hope. (1980). From Slavery to Freedom: A History of Negro Americans (5th ed.). New York: Alfred were modified, and old and new styles were blended to A. Knopf. Franklin's book is a classic on the period after create the freedom songs that captured the verve and enslavement.

potency of the movement.

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 251

Freedom Songs——251

THE MEANING AND

Freedom Singers, and the CORE (Congress of **HISTORY OF SONGS OF PROTEST**

Racial Equality) Singers. The performances of these ensembles brought attention to the movement, and the The singing of a particular freedom song usually freedom songs gained increased importance as a means lasted for extended periods during sit-ins and of conveying the nature and intensity of the struggle to marches. As a result, new verses were composed not audiences outside of the setting of civil rights move-only to fill up the time but also to express the comment activity. Some of these groups used money raised plexity of the dissent and protest against oppression.

from their performances to pay the bail for the release At some times, individuals inspired by an event or a of imprisoned freedom fighters throughout the South.

testimony composed new verses, and at other times, Other song leaders, such as Fannie Lou Hamer from verses evolved spontaneously out of the group experi-Ruleville, Mississippi, individually carried the freedom ence. The counteractions of song and protest resulted song tradition to mass meetings and marches across the in a new energy that propelled the group into further state of Mississippi, and later throughout the South and committed resistance. The freedom songs that sur-the nation.

faced in the midst of protest can be divided into Some of the freedom songs of the civil rights two basic categories: group participation songs and movement have a long history of being used as professionally composed songs.

African American protest songs. The song Old The group participation songs were often versions Freedom dates back to the enslavement period and, of existing songs that were improvised, with the help with changes in the song text, was used as a marching of a song leader, by groups engaged in civil rights song by protesters in the 1906 Atlanta race rebellions.

activities. As the civil rights movement gained It was again used in the 1930s by organizers of the momentum in a community, local song leaders would Southern Tenant Farmers' Union; found its way to the join in the crusade. The song leaders performed in a sit-ins, mass meetings, and freedom rides of the civil variety of styles as they learned the songs of the orga-rights movement; and was sung frequently at SNCC

nizers, added to them, and sorted through songs in the conferences.

traditional repertoire to find songs that encapsulated We Shall Overcome is one of the most popular of the feelings of the current struggle and the local senti-the freedom songs, and it became the theme song for ment. At mass meetings in rural counties of Southwest the nonviolent constituency of the civil rights move-Georgia, for example, song leaders used the lining-out ment. Adapted from a combination of the melody of hymns and call-and-response songs of that area as the an older hymn called I'll Be Alright and the text of I'll basic repertoire. Sometimes the older songs were sung Overcome Some Day, an older gospel song composed without change, and sometimes words were changed by Charles Tindley, We Shall Overcome was first to identify and authenticate a specific local incident or used by the Food and Tobacco Workers Union in event. An ideal mass meeting would combine songs Charleston, South Carolina in the 1940s. During that from the standard freedom song repertoire, unchanged period, Zilphia Horton, Director of the Highlander in song form and text, with songs modified and Folk School in Tennessee, introduced it to union updated by recent events.

gatherings all across the South. We Shall Overcome Strong song leaders in different regions would band has been sung at great mass rallies by thousands of together to develop “freedom choirs.” These groups of voices around the world and in many languages.

musicians not only led the group participation songs at Four major collections of freedom songs have been mass meetings and other activities but also performed published: The SNCC songbook, We Shall Overcome their professionally composed songs as they traveled (1963); Freedom is a Constant Struggle (1968); Songs across the country in support of civil rights issues.

of the Spirit Movement (1968); and the NAACP song-Freedom choirs included the Montgomery Gospel Trio, book, Lift Ev’ry Voice (1972).

the Selma Freedom Choir, the Nashville Quartet (the The freedom songs played a vital role in the civil American Baptist Theological Seminar Quartet), the rights struggle and gave people renewed courage and Birmingham Choir (Carlton Reese’s Gospel Freedom a sense of unity. The serious study of the freedom Choir of the Alabama Christian Movement for Civil songs provides a historical account of events, the Rights), Guy Carawan and the Freedom Singers, the various responses to oppression, the array of protest SNCC (Student Non-violent Coordinating Committee) strategies, and personal reflections and testimonials of

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 252

252——Freedom Summer

the civil rights movement, an important epoch in the risking their lives and, consequently, only 6% of history of African American people.

all African American people in Mississippi were registered to vote. Because this was the lowest per-

— Mawusi Renee Simmons

centage of registered voters in the country, Mississippi became the new battleground in the fight for African **FURTHER READING**

people to be able to exercise their right to vote in the Carawan, Guy. (1990). *Sing for Freedom: The Story of the United States*.

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ORGANIZING FREEDOM SUMMER

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Freedom Summer was organized by a coalition of Written by one of the great performers of civil rights songs, some of the most well known civil rights organiza- this booklet contains important information on the voices tions of the time: the National Association for the of the movement.

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organizations made up what was known as the New York: Garland. This is a good study of the way songs Mississippi Council of Federated Organizations.

were used in the movement.

Spencer, Jon Michael. (1990). *Protest and Praise: Sacred Because the white community protested African Music of Black Religion. Minneapolis, MN: Fortress Press.*

people's right to vote in Mississippi and other Spencer's work is an exploration of sacred music used for Southern states, volunteers leaving for

the South had secular purposes.

to be prepared for the strong possibility of encounter-ing violence. College students were trained by SNCC

*workers in nonviolent protest methods at Western College for Women in Oxford, Ohio. Most of the **FREEDOM SUMMER***

students were around 21 years old, white, and from wealthy families. The students were asked to bring Freedom Summer was a massive outpouring of money for bail, expenses, and medical costs, as well political activism during the summer of 1964 when as money for transportation home at the end of the hundreds of black and white college students traveled summer. After about a week of training, the volunteers to Southern states like Mississippi to recruit African were sent to Mississippi. Their goals for the summer people in America to vote. The recruitment efforts were to build freedom schools, open community included not only registering African people to vote centers where African people could obtain both legal but also educating African people on voting rights.

advice and medical services, register African voters, Although civil rights organizers had been working and establish and organize the Mississippi Freedom on the Freedom Vote campaign in Mississippi since Democratic Party.

1961, Freedom Summer was to be much more intense College students who participated in Freedom because it was a presidential election year and recruit-Summer knew that they might encounter violence, ing African people to vote was essential to winning harassment, and even death. Many local governmental the campaign for civil rights.

officials in Mississippi anticipated the arrival of the Although the right to vote was received by men volunteers by increasing their police force, reinforc-with the passage of the Fifteenth Amendment in 1870

ing their weaponry, and preparing their jails and pris-and by women with the Nineteenth Amendment in ons. Many political leaders passed laws that would 1920, disenfranchisement inhibited African men and inhibit

disruptive activities they thought might occur women from truly exercising their right to vote. This over the course of the summer. Violence did erupt—

disenfranchisement occurred in such legal sanctions when white supremacist groups, community members, as poll taxes and literacy tests, as well as outright and police attacked the Freedom Summer workers physical attacks of terror, intimidation, brutality, and numerous times over the duration of the summer.

even murder. For African Americans, registering to African American homes, churches, and Freedom vote in places such as Mississippi literally meant schools were burned down. Over 1,000 Freedom

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 253

Freedom Summer———253

Summer volunteers were arrested, and many were believed that it was because two of the three murdered deliberately beaten while in police custody.

men where white. Had they all been black, the media Despite the threat of violence, the Freedom most likely would not have covered the story at all, as Summer workers were able to accomplish many of in the search for the bodies of the three civil rights their goals. Freedom schools were established workers, the bodies of three missing African Americans throughout Mississippi to teach African American were found, and their murders did not receive any news history, leadership, reading, writing, and mathematics coverage.

*to African men, women, and children. Many Southern schools at this time were insufficiently funded and did not have the appropriate supplies, suitable textbooks, **THE POLITICS OF FREEDOM SUMMER***

or the educated faculty to properly teach the children.

The Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party (MFDP) The Freedom schools challenged these inequalities was also established during the Freedom

Summer and drew about 3,000 students to the 30 schools to challenge the historically racist Democratic party.

throughout the South. Although these Freedom Although many African Americans at this time were schools were deemed illegal by southern lawmakers, Democrats, the Southern Democratic party excluded both teachers and students still participated in them both African voters and African representatives. This is despite the danger involved. Those who attended the why African people were not only recruited to register schools risked intimidation and violence, while those to vote but also to join the MFDP, which more than who taught in the schools risked imprisonment, as 80,000 did. Although the MFDP won much national teaching in a Freedom school was punishable by up to support in places like California, President Lyndon 6 months in prison.

*Johnson refused to support the new party. When the MFDP was not included at the Democratic National **CREATING SPACE AND***

*Convention, delegates from five states threatened to **OPPORTUNITY FOR PARTICIPATION***

walk out of the convention if the MFDP was not seated. President Johnson was forced to intervene and Freedom clinics were also established, attracting doc-allowed the MFDP representatives into the convention tors from all over the country to provide basic health as at-large delegates. However, the delegates were care at no charge to African people in Mississippi.

soon thrown out of the convention after refusing to And legal clinics were created to educate African swear full allegiance to the Democratic party. Fannie people in their legal rights, as well as to oversee the Lou Hamer went before the Credentials Committee Freedom Summer activities to ensure that no constitu-and the media to discuss how difficult it was for tional rights were violated. Lawyers from the National African people in Mississippi to vote and how impor-Lawyers Guild, the NAACP Legal Defense Fund, and tant the MFDP was for African people. Although the the American Jewish Committee, as well as many law MFDP was not able to accomplish all that it had school students, traveled to Mississippi to take

part in intended, the party did show the country that political the legal aspect of the summer's protests.

power could be seized and utilized in the advancement Although the possibility of violence came with of civil rights.

the job, the most well-known case of brutality in Although the risks were high for all those who the summer of 1964 was the murder of the three civil participated in Freedom Summer, the achievements rights workers James Chaney, Andrew Goodman, and made it all worth the risk and effort. Freedom Summer Michael Schwerner. Chaney, Goodman, and Schwerner had a huge impact not only on Mississippi but on the were arrested for a traffic violation while investigating entire country. Freedom Summer laid the groundwork a church bombing and physical attack on church for the passage of the Voting Rights Act of 1965, and members in Philadelphia, Mississippi. No one knows Freedom schools became the blueprint for future what actually happened after they were released from programs such as Head Start. The main idea was if jail, but a few weeks later, the bodies of the men were Mississippi's overt racism and discrimination could be found in a nearby dam. The black man, Chaney, had conquered, then anything was possible in the struggle been beaten to death, and the two white men, Goodman to advance civil rights.

and Schwerner, had both been shot. These murders received extensive coverage in the media, and many

— Aimee Glocke

F-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:57 PM Page 254

254——Freedom Summer

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Group. This is a comprehensive African American history book that covers the civil rights movement as well as the student protests and campaigns in the South.

G-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:59 PM Page 255

G

*the revolt strategically, holding numerous meetings **GABRIEL PROSSER'S REVOLT***

that included his wife Nanny, his brothers Martin and Solomon, and Jack Bowler. Prosser's team of insur-Gabriel Prosser was an enslaved African who was gents planned to collect various weapons and strike born in approximately 1775 in Henrico County, at harvest time to ensure a good food supply. They Virginia, and belonged to Thomas Henry Prosser, established guidelines for approaching the enemy and owner of the Brookfield Plantation on which Gabriel reducing the number of civilian casualties. The guide-Prosser lived. Gabriel Prosser has been described as lines instructed the rebelling slaves not to kill elderly literate and religious; he was also a skilled black-women, children, the poor, or religious persons who smith, which allowed him to leave the plantation more were deemed friends of the antislavery cause.

frequently than unskilled Africans could. His status Gabriel Prosser's plan for the rebellion had three among other enslaved Africans notwithstanding, areas of offensive action. First, the group would confis-Gabriel Prosser had no tolerance for the slave system, cate the munitions in the city; second, they would seize and he took every opportunity to vigorously challenge the powder houses; and third, they would advance into it—especially for routinely meting out capital punish-town in two flanks opposite of the city and kill all white ment for the least infraction. Thus Prosser and his males except those supportive of their actions. They brother Solomon were brought to trial for threatening would then capture and hold Governor James Monroe, the life and property of a white man, who then brought and

after the city of Richmond was taken, they would suit against the brothers' owner. While Gabriel Prosser seize other cities and free all slaves. After control was received a rare judgment in that he was not hanged, he established over the state of Virginia, Prosser would was branded on his left hand and held in jail. Still, he become its leader. If the plot called for an immediate continued his defiance against the slave system, and at adjustment to their plans, the group decided that they the age of 24 he planned one of the largest and most would conduct guerrilla warfare and live as maroons highly organized slave revolts in North America.

until freedom could be established.

Prosser, inspired by the Haitian Revolution, devel-Prosser anticipated that vast numbers of Africans oped the plans for a systematic uprising that was would participate in the revolt. Some sources suggest ultimately to include over 1,000 enslaved Africans in that Prosser's group was approximately 1,100 strong; the area of Richmond, Virginia. He selected this area other sources suggest that thousands of Africans came because of the large numbers of enslaved Africans to carry out the attack on Richmond, Virginia, on there who would be available to join the insurrection.

August 30, 1800. The rebelling slaves met at Old Prosser assessed the enslaved African population as Brook Swamp, 6 miles from Richmond. As they many times larger than the white community (esti-headed toward the city, they encountered a violent mated at 32,000 and 8,000, respectively). He planned storm with torrential rains that washed out roads and 255

G-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:59 PM Page 256

256——Ghana Empire

bridges. That same night the revolt was betrayed by of the desert as farmers. The Soninke formed a two house slaves from the Meadow Farm plantation confederation and defended themselves against the who feared that their owner would be killed.

nomads and eventually formed the kingdom of Ghana.

Governor James Monroe called for martial law and During the 3rd century C.E., the Mande-speaking ordered troops and militias to occupy the area. Many Soninke people were united by a great king who led Africans merely suspected of participating in the insur-them to conquer the city of Kumbi Saleh in what is gency were captured and summarily hanged. Thirty-now western Mali. Kumbi Saleh was an important city five members of Prosser's group were executed—all along an important north-south trade route. The king went to their deaths refusing to divulge any informa-of the Soninke was known as the Kaya maghan, "king tion about the plan. Prosser managed to escape down of the gold," and as Ghana, "war chief." He belonged the swampy lowlands of the Chickahominy River. A to the royal clan of Ouagadou, and the Soninke first bounty of \$300 was immediately established to help in named their kingdom after this royal family. In time, the capture of Prosser. A few weeks later, Prosser was the land of the Ouagadou (or Wagadu) became known caught aboard a ship, the Mary, which was docked as Ghana. It was a kingdom associated with gold, and in Norfolk, Virginia. On October 7, 1800, after being it lasted about 600 years before being conquered from interrogated by the governor, and after refusing to the east by Mali.

reveal any of the details of the complex plan, Prosser Ghana was well placed to take advantage of trade was hanged. The American slaveholding society used between the north and south. Located between the salt the Gabriel Prosser rebellion to directly influence more mines and the goldfields, Ghana was a great source of harsh slave laws in the North and the South. The commerce and trade talk. Camel caravans crossing the Gabriel Prosser Revolt served as an important model Sahara brought goods such as copper, fruits, and salt for other revolutionary plans, including the Louisiana from the major mines as well as from Taghaza. The Slave Revolt of 1811, the Denmark Vesey Conspiracy caravans also brought clothing and other manufac-in 1822, the Nat Turner Revolt in 1831, and the tured goods, which they exchanged for kola nuts, Christiana Revolt in 1851.

hides, leather goods, gold, and ivory. Taxes collected on every trade item entering the kingdom were used to

— Katherine Olukemi Bankole

pay for the government and huge army that protected the kingdom's borders; the city of Kumbi Saleh, with **FURTHER READING**

its political control and economic prosperity, was Aptheker, Herbert. (1974). *American Negro Slave Revolts*.

considered the hub of the universe.

New York: International Publishers. This book, which The location of the goldfields was kept strictly is perhaps the best-known work on slave revolts, surveys secret by the Soninke. By the 10th century, Ghana American history for examples of slave insurrections and was the size of Texas or Nigeria, including parts revolts.

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Islamic states of North Africa for minting into coins.

Mutersbaugh, Bert M. (1983). *The Background of Gabriel's As the trans-Saharan trade in gold expanded, so did Insurrection. Journal of Negro History, 68(2) 209–211.*

the state of Ghana. The trans-Saharan trade also This is one of the best articles written on the background of the insurrection.

brought Islam to the empire, initially to the rulers and then to the masses.

Locally obtained iron ore was used to make tools and weapons, which made agriculture easier and more **GHANA EMPIRE**

efficient; made possible the use of iron-tipped spearheads, lances, knives, and swords; and gave ancient Around the 3rd century B.C.E., nomadic groups herd-Soninke soldiers technological superiority over their ing animals in West Africa on the fringes of the Sahara neighbors who used bone and wood. The Soninke became a threat to the Soninke people who lived south were thus able to capture more farming and grazing

G-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 12:59 PM Page 257

Ghana Empire———257

land from their weaker, less-organized neighbors. The to the mighty king of Mali, Sundiata, who defeated Soninke were also able to obtain horses from the Ghana at the battle of Kirina.

Saharan nomads with whom they were in contact.

— Mario Root

*In 1076, shortly after Ghana reached its zenith, the city of Kumbi Saleh fell to the Berber Almoravids, who swept across the desert from what is now Mauritania in an effort to control the gold trade and **FURTHER READING***

purify the Islam practiced in Ghana. The invaders sub-Asante, Molefi Kete. (1996). Classical Africa. Saddle Brook, sequently withdrew, but the kingdom of Ghana was NJ: Peoples Publishing Group. This is an introduction to weakened. Sub-kingdoms, which had previously paid the six classical civilizations of Africa.

tribute to the Ghanaian king, gradually made the trade Fage, J. D. (Ed.). (1978). Cambridge History of Africa.

routes through Ghana dangerous. In addition, in the Cambridge, UK: Cambridge University Press. This is a comprehensive examination of African civilizations by 11th and 12th centuries, the Bure goldfields were some of the most well-known scholars on the subject.

opened up to the south, drawing traders further east, Phillipson, David. (1985). *African Archaeology*. Cambridge, and a terrible drought accelerated the deterioration of UK: Cambridge University Press. Phillipson's book is an the environment through overgrazing, adding to the authoritative account of African archaeology and early suffering in Ghana. In 1242, the once great empire fell civilizations.

H-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:27 PM Page 259

H

ceded the western third of the island of Santo **HAITIAN REVOLUTION**

Domingo (as the Spanish referred to the island).

In the ensuing years, immigrants from France The Haitian Revolution, in the eyes of many, re-pre-populated Saint-Domingue, for they saw that great sends the most thorough case study of revolutionary profits could be made in the production and exporta-change anywhere in the history of the modern world.

tion of sugar, indigo, coffee, and cocoa from the Indeed, it can be argued that it was the force behind island. Saint-Domingue attracted those who wanted to the abolition of slavery in the Caribbean. After over make a quick profit, as well as those, like ex-convicts, 10 years of battle, enslaved Africans were able to who were looking to start a new life. These people overturn the colonial status of Haiti by successfully gladly settled there, but the same could certainly not defeating the great military powers of the world and be said about the hundreds of thousands of Africans establishing a new political state led by formerly who were imported and enslaved to provide free labor enslaved Africans in the Western Hemisphere. As a so that French planters could achieve their grand French colony for less than a century, Saint-Domingue dreams of wealth. By 1791, Saint-Domingue had (as Haiti was known during colonial times) become become the wealthiest of France's territorial posses-the center of a historical drama that has effectively sions, accounting for 40% of its foreign trade. As reshaped and challenged the ideals of freedom and such, it was often referred to as "the pearl of the liberty that were being played out in the French and Antilles."

The astonishing wealth accumulated by American Revolutions. The Haitian Revolution struck French planters became renowned, and the expression a blow to the racist European and North American

“wealthy as a Creole” became common in France.

view of a hierarchical world forever dominated by white people.

EXPLOITATION OF

*Stumbled upon by Christopher Columbus in 1492, **AFRICANS FOR PROFIT***

and renamed by him Hispaniola, meaning “Little Spain,” the territory of Saint-Domingue was a favorite The commercial success of Saint-Domingue came at a target for raids by English, Dutch, and French bucca-very high price, however, for it prepared the founda-neers whose base was an island off the northwest tion of a revolutionary revolt from which France has coast of Saint-Domingue called Tortuga (which takes never truly recovered. The enormous wealth generated its name from La Tortue, meaning “The Turtle”). As from Saint-Domingue was achieved on the backs of incursions increased, and as the French began to out-enslaved Africans. By all accounts, the system of slav-number the other pirates, a battle ensued for territorial ery was horrific: Africans working from dusk to dawn control. The battle came to an end in 1697 with the were regularly tortured with ruthless cruelty and left Treaty of Ryswich that concluded the War of Grand to die after white planters had sufficiently extracted a Alliance. In the treaty, France claimed and Spain life’s worth of labor in the briefest time imaginable.

259

H-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:27 PM Page 260

260——Haitian Revolution

Out of the mix of white planters and Africans came Saint-Domingue in the newly revived State Assembly three classes of people who fought for control

and in Paris; second, they drew up a list of grievances status. The three groups were known as the *grands* (*Cahier des Doléances*) that effectively sought *blancs*, *petits blancs*, and *gens de couleur*. The *grands* permission for white planters to govern the colony *blancs* consisted of important whites, owners of large without interference from France.

plantations, wealthy merchants, and high officials of These actions caught the attention of Léger Félicité the state. The *petits blancs* were all other whites, such Sonthonax, a radical Jacobin closely associated with as shopkeepers, artisans, and small planters with only *Les Noirs* (The Friends of Blacks). The Jacobins were a few enslaved Africans. Finally, the *gens de couleur* determined to eradicate all traces of counterrevolution or free colored people, those with African blood in and royalism, which they identified with the whites of their veins, usually as a consequence of the union of Saint-Domingue. In the ensuing debate between the white planters and African women who were often Jacobins and the royalists, the National Assembly ultimately raped and kept as concubines. By 1790, they num-mately passed an ambiguous resolution, which while bered about 28,000.

granting political rights to the *gens de couleur*, still The *gens de couleur* were an ambitious lot, who left open the interpretation of colonial authority. As owned land, endeavored in commercial enterprises, the whites were not inclined to extend freedoms to the and enslaved Africans themselves. They were social *gens de couleur* on the island, they were determined climbers who sought status equal to that of the *grands* to take the island by force, if necessary. Bloody *skir-blancs*, thereby posing a threat to the *petits blancs*, mishes thus grew between the *gens de couleur* and the who felt indignant that someone with African blood whites, but all designs for control of Saint-Domingue could be above them on the social scale. The growing were completely derailed when the Africans revolted.

presence of the *gens de couleur* was largely due to the Black Code (*Code Noir*) of Louis XIV, which **AFRICANS' INSURRECTION**

permitted an African to gain his or her liberty either by purchasing it or by receiving it as a gift from his or On the night of August 14, 1791, at Bois Caiman in her master.

the northern part of Haiti, Vodun priest Boukman As the *petits blancs* became more and more Houngan and priestess Marie Saint-Dede Bazile held a threatened by the social gains of the *gens de couleur*, service that laid the plans for a general slave uprising.

discriminatory laws were enacted that increasingly Six days later, blacks began to slaughter every white curtailed the *gens de couleur*'s freedom and that were man, woman, and child they could lay their hands designed to humiliate them.

on. Whites, for their part, retaliated and did the same, Back in France, the French Revolution had begun, slaughtering all the blacks they could. Spain and and between the years 1788 to 1793, the affairs of England sent troops into Saint-Domingue on the Saint-Domingue became inextricably tied to the pretext of trying to put an end to the insurrection events of the revolution. Indeed, word of the revolu-and to prevent it from spreading to their neighboring tion in France served as an inspiration for the *gens* colonies. The *gens de couleur*, although they were *de couleur* as well as the whites, although to different known to be quite cruel to enslaved Africans at times, ends. The *gens de couleur*, inspired by the words of escaped the wrath of the Africans. They thus sought to the *Declaration of Human Rights*, sought to regain the use the African uprising to their advantage in wresting freedoms that were increasingly being denied to them control of Saint-Domingue from the whites. Out of this and, ultimately, to declare an independent Saint-maelstrom rose the major players of the revolution: Domingue with their class as rulers. The whites, on Henry Christophe, Jean-Jacques Dessalines, André the other hand, were seeking, through independence, Rigaud, Alexandre Pétion, and, above all, Toussaint greater commercial possibilities outside the restrictive Louverture. Indeed, it is often said that the leadership colonial boundaries imposed by France and, insti-responsible for this unique historical event was almost gated by the *petits blancs*, the firm and permanent entirely the work of one individual: Toussaint establishment of whites as the dominant group on the Louverture.

island. In this endeavor, the *grands blancs*, who con-The French general in charge of the colony was trolled colonial affairs, took two miscalculated mea-Laveaux; the leader of the *gens de couleur* was André sures that would

spark the fire of revolution: First, Rigaud. Overwhelmed by the Spanish and British they sent a delegation of 37 deputies to represent invaders, Laveaux sought the help of Toussaint, who

H-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:27 PM Page 261

Haitian Revolution———261

was reputed to be a brave and brilliant military strategist.

Napoléon sent his brother-in-law, Charles Leclerc, Toussaint agreed to help, and on his journey to Saint-Domingue with a formidable army to capture and remove Domingue managed to defeat several Spanish regiments. Toussaint as governor, reestablish slavery, and return to France. Soon afterwards, Toussaint returned to Saint-Domingue to France. In January of 1802, all the territory Spain had recently won from her. To Leclerc arrived in Cap François (currently named Cap-Haïtien), but he was repelled by Henry Christophe, from public sight as he prepared his troops for the who rallied the Haitians against the French army. On February 5, Christophe set fire to the city and withdrew to the neighboring hills. By some accounts, the Haitian Revolution, which decisively defeated the British war of independence is said to have begun with these and completely removed them from the island. By events. For 3 months, Toussaint vigorously fought 1796, Toussaint was an undisputed hero. He was back the invading French army. On April 26, 1802, feared and respected by his soldiers and loved by Christophe surrendered. On June 10, Toussaint the Africans who had been given their freedom in accepted an invitation to dine and discuss matters of 1793 by the French Commissioners (Sonthonax, the colony that resulted in his being captured and Polvèrel, and Ailhaud) who were attempting to gain taken aboard a ship soon bound for France. He died on their support against the armies of Spain and England.

April 7, 1803, in the Jura Mountains of southeastern France. Moreover, the whites respected him, and Laveaux was France.

indebted to him. Only the *gens de couleur* were sus-However, although Toussaint was now out of the picious of him. They gave their allegiance to Rigaud, way, Leclerc's plans to reestablish slavery and return not to Toussaint.

Saint-Domingue to France were never carried out.

Then, in a series of brilliant tactical maneuvers, Leclerc and his army were decimated by yellow fever.

Toussaint sought to consolidate his powers. He The black generals, who had been captured by assigned to potential white rivals administrative posts Leclerc, were once again fighting against the French.

that effectively sent them to France (and away from As Leclerc's army was systematically being annihi-Saint-Domingue) to carry out their "duties." All that lated by yellow fever, his letters to Napoléon pleading remained was the battle for supreme leadership for reinforcement became frantic. On November 1, between Toussaint and Rigaud. Rigaud, however, was 1802, Leclerc himself succumbed to yellow fever.

no match for Toussaint, who easily defeated Rigaud's The cost of the Saint-Domingue campaign army, following which Rigaud fled to France never to be was increasing. In a futile attempt to save face, heard from again. After 1799, as nominal governor of Napoléon named Rochambeau as Leclerc's successor.

Saint-Domingue, Toussaint revived prosperity in Saint-Rochambeau, however, was incompetent and, more-Domingue. Historians have called Saint-Domingue's over, Napoléon was not prepared to fully support him.

return to prosperity between 1799 and 1802 amazing.

In May of 1803, the Amiens Peace Treaty was broken, It was also during this period that Toussaint gained and France found itself at war with England. With the cooperation of the president of the United States, Saint-Domingue slipping from his hands, and in des-John Adams; negotiated an advantageous treaty with perate need of capital, Napoléon abandoned his

plan England; gave his people a new constitution that gave for a New World empire. In April of 1803, Napoléon him not only all political power for life but also the sold the territory of Louisiana to President Thomas authority to name his successor. In effect, Toussaint Jefferson, doubling the size of the United States at that had been able to achieve many of the feats that time. Meanwhile, Rochambeau, in a desperate attempt another important figure in this drama—Napoléon to control Saint-Domingue, waged desultory warfare Bonaparte—had failed to achieve.

by hunting Africans with 1,500 bloodhounds bought from Jamaica and hanging, shooting, drowning, or burning all the Africans he could catch.
Christophe **FRANCE'S ATTEMPT**

and Jean-Jacques Dessalines responded by mas-TO RECAPTURE THE ISLAND

sacring every white person within their reach. On Napoléon was determined to recapture Saint-November 16, 1803, at Vertières, the final battle took Domingue. As the richest of France's former colonies, place—Rochambeau was defeated. Three days later, Saint-Domingue played a major role in Napoléon's Rochambeau and his few remaining men capitulated plan for a New World empire. On December 14, 1801, to the English in Jamaica.

H-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:27 PM Page 262

262———**Highlander Folk School**

INDEPENDENCE

Leyburn, James G. (1941). *The Haitian People*. New Haven, CT: Yale University Press. This book provides an excellent Dessalines proclaimed the independence of Haiti abridged version of the Haitian Revolution. Outlining the on January 1, 1804, in Gonaïves. He chose to call the major events and players, it clearly depicts Haiti after island Haiti, an aboriginal word meaning “mountain-the revolution up until the point of the U.S. occupation, ous,” rather than the French name Saint-Domingue.

closing with an analysis of Haitian society.

Haiti, the Caribbean, and the rest of the Americas Madiou, Thomas. (1987–1989). *Histoire d’Haiti* (Vols. 1–7).

would never be the same again.

Port-au-Prince, Haiti: Editions H. Deschamps. (Original work published 1847). This is a monumental work that The Haitian Revolution immediately sparked covers Haitian history from 1492 to 1843 and is considered unrest throughout the region of the Caribbean, espe-the standard work on the Haitian Revolution.

cially in communities of Maroons in Jamaica and Nicholls, David. (1996). *From Dessalines to Duvalier: Race, among blacks in St. Kitts*. Also, immigrants fleeing *Colour and National Independence in Haiti*. New an independent Haiti had a profound effect wherever Brunswick, NJ: Rutgers University Press. Nicholls presents they went. In the Spanish-colonized Caribbean, for a color-based analysis of the Haitian Revolution and example, Haitians are credited for revitalizing agricul-Haitian politics since 1804.

tural production in Cuba and Puerto Rico. In North America, Haitians influenced language, religion, politics, culture, cuisine, architecture, medicine, and **HIGHLANDER FOLK SCHOOL**

the conflict over slavery, especially in Louisiana.

The Haitian Revolution sent a wave of fear through The Highlander Folk School was founded by Myles whites throughout the world. In Great Britain, anti-Horton in Monteagle, Tennessee, with the purpose slavery movements gained strength and colonial of training people to organize against big business. It Africans themselves became more restless such that in was intended as a union training center. When Horton 1808, Britain abolished its transatlantic slave trade founded the school in 1932, the condition of the work-and dismantled the slave system between 1834 and ing class in the United States was quite dreadful. The 1838. As for the French, their slave trade was abol-nation was still in the throes of the Great Depression, ished in 1818, although slavery survived as an institu-millions of people were out of work, and those who tion in Martinique and

Guadeloupe until 1848. Above were working often put up with abuse from their all, however, the Haitian Revolution, as the only employers because of the scarcity of work. Often men instance of complete African victory over the evil of and women would be fired from their jobs because slavery, served and continues to serve as a great they complained about the working conditions. The source of inspiration and pride for Africans engaged situation in the South was far worse than the situation in the fight against white supremacy worldwide.

in the North. Consequently, the Highlander Folk

— *Garvey F. Lundy*

School became known as a place for the dispossessed to learn how to control their own lives and to speak **FURTHER READING**

out of their own interests. This was the image of the school until the 1950s.

Fick, Carolyn E. (1990). *The Making of Haiti: The Saint During the 1950s*, the activities of the school *Domingue Revolution From Below*. Knoxville: University became increasingly connected to the civil rights of Tennessee Press. This book, in addition to focusing on the great historical figures of the revolution, also considers movement. In some respects, the worker and civil the impact of the Maroons and of blacks' everyday acts of rights movements merged at the Highlander Folk resistance on the revolution.

School. It was the only place in the South where James, C. L. R. (1963). *The Black Jacobins: Toussaint blacks and whites could meet as equals and plan L'Ouverture and the San Domingo Revolution*. New York: social activism. Because of this, the school earned Random House. (Original work published 1938). This is a negative reputation with the local authorities, a historical account of the Haitian Revolution and its members of the Ku Klux Klan (KKK), and judges in relationship with the French Revolution, stressing the rev-the South. Those who attended the Highlander Folk olutionary potential of proletarian masses. Although not denying the importance of race conflict, James places School to learn about civil disobedience, union orga-greater emphasis on class antagonism and how it

provided nizing, or voters' rights were often criticized, abused, the socioeconomic impetus for revolution.

and attacked. The Highlander Folk School was called

H-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:27 PM Page 263

Hip-Hop——263

“communist” by some who wanted to discredit it in As hip-hop was muscling its way into the the eyes of the public. Monteagle public officials marketplace of ideas, some observed that it was the revoked the school’s charter in 1960, but the resource-hip-hop DJ whose skills as a musical technician and ful Myles Horton responded by relocating the school, genius represented the first transition of hip-hop from first to Knoxville and then to New Market. In the the streets to professional performance outlets. Later, 1980s, the school’s focus shifted to balancing envi-these legendary DJs were often backstage during ronmental concerns with the struggle for economic public performances, as it was the rap artists’ duty to recovery in the South. Black Studies sees the please the crowds on stage. DJ Love Bug Starsky, for Highlander Folk School as important because it was example, was known in the community for chanting the venue for some of the important training of

“hippity-hop, don’t stop, keep on the body rock.”

African American activists during the 1950s.

Other MCs, including DJs Kool Herc, Hollywood, Kurtis Blow, Grandmaster Flash, and the legendary

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

Afrika Bambaataa contributed to elevating the culture in other ways. Herc helped to increase hip-hop’s **FURTHER READING**

visibility in the neighborhoods and the professional arena by hosting shows all over New York and by Cleaver, Eldridge. (1968). *Soul on Ice*. New

York: McGraw-Hill. This is a controversial book because in it Cleaver encouraging the competitive break dancers he called appears to have lost sight of his own cultural and social

“B-boys.” Bambaataa was at the same time moving center, but the book is useful for understanding how the his Zulu Dancers and B-boys into the clubs, a cultural fight for civil rights merged into the black revolutionary site where B-boys, most of whom were recognized movement.

gang members, could settle their disputes in more Colaiaco, James A. (1993). *Martin Luther King, Jr.: Apostle of positive ways*. Bambaataa, which in Zulu means *Militant Nonviolence*. New York: St. Martin’s Press. This

“affectionate leader,” became a hip-hop legend. And is one of the best books on King’s strategies for gaining freedom for African Americans.

with the commercialization of the culture, the artistry Forman, James. (1985). *The Making of Black Revolutionaries*.

of hip-hop and rap music rose to become a multibil-Washington, DC: Open Hand. This is Forman’s principal lion dollar enterprise in both the domestic and inter-contribution to our understanding of the nature of American national marketplace.

society’s response to the black demand for justice.

RAPPIN’ AND STYLIN’ OUT: RAPPERS AS

CONTEMPORARY GRIOTS AND TRICKSTERS

HIP-HOP

Rap music began in the South Bronx of New York City in the early 1970s. With the rap music explosion came Hip-hop is one of the most misunderstood cultural Sugar Hill Gang’s “Rapper’s Delight” and Kurtis expressions of the second half of the 20th century.

Blow's "The Breaks," which were followed in the late 1970s by Grandmaster Flash and the Furious Five's culture, the hip-hop explosion included hip-hop

"The Message," a song that graphically depicted hard deejaying, break dancing, rap music, and graffiti art times and desperation in urban America. In 1980, it performances, mirroring life in marginalized black was Soulsonic Force's "Planet Rock" that took center neighborhoods. The term *hip-hop* was used at various stage. However, with the huge commercial success of stages of its development as old school hip-hop DJ-Run-D.M.C.'s "Walk This Way" and the Beastie Boys, MCs and their fans expressed their feelings about the the heart of rap turned toward consumerism. At the emerging generation of youth. Similar to responses same time, many popular rap songs spoke in opposi-to the black cultural thrusts of the 1940s, 1950s, and tion to the ideology of the dominant culture, the greed early 1960s, hip-hop was described in the 1980s and of independent and major record companies, and the 1990s by its critics as a passing fad, an offhand cul-partying needs of hip-hop's practitioners.

tural statement, and a rebellious art form. Despite Still, a number of celebrated rap stars and group these public criticisms, the artistry of multitalented acts—Run-D.M.C., Chuck D and Professor Griff of hip-hop artists, producers, and practitioners burst Public Enemy, Ice-T, Niggas Wit Attitudes, Ice Cube, loudly and proudly onto the American cultural scene.

The 2 Live Crew, Sister Souljah, the Geto Boys,

H-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:27 PM Page 264

264——**Hip-Hop**

Dr. Dre, Snoop Doggy Dogg, and Tupac Shakur—at goods; the increase in cable viewership of *Yo! MTV*

one time or another were accused of glorifying *Rap*, *Video Jukebox*, and Black Entertainment Tele-violence, chanting racist and anti-Semitic remarks, vision's *Rapcity*; and the regular appearance of hip-or spouting sexually explicit, offensive, and obscene hop DJs on cable television shows

such as Russell lyrics. These rap artists defied and opposed the censorship of Simons's *Def Jam Comedy* on HBO, which employed sorship attempts of Tipper Gore and Susan Baker of former New York DJ Kid Capri; as well as the appeal Parents Music Resource Center, C. Delores Tucker of in rap to crossover from the recording studios to the the National Political Congress of Black Women, and soundstage.

the Reverend Calvin Butts of the Abyssinian Baptist As a result of some of the choices made by rap Church.

artists such as Ice Cube, Queen Latifah, MC Lyte, During rap music's evolutionary development, Ice-T, Tupac Shakur, Run-D.M.C., the Fat Boys, Tone rappers employed a number of themes in their lyrics, Loc, Big Daddy Kane, L.L. Cool J, Kid-N-Play, Will including racism, discrimination, oppression, unem-Smith, and Salt N Pepa, some critics have concluded ployment, equal rights, women's rights, free speech that commercialization killed the social and political rights, racial unity, black-on-black crime, sexism, thrust of hip-hop.

abandonment, love, decay, despair, and violence. Rap However, rap remains socially, politically, philo-music quickly became a very complex, persuasive, sophically, culturally, and rhetorically significant. It and powerful rhetorical device and communication has deep roots in the African American oral tradition.

medium for the fans and critics of many rappers. A Rap belongs to the work songs; the blues; the black skillful rapper was widely known as a cultural hero radio DJ tradition; the soul and funk music traditions and wizard of words, capable of bringing to life fictive of James Brown and George Clinton; the rhetorical images mirroring real life events and situations. Rap traditions of black comedians such as Rudy Ray artists from coast to coast were not only able to Moore, Redd Foxx, and Richard Pryor; the lyrics of skillfully play the role of contemporary tricksters and poets such as Langston Hughes; the boasting of griots by appropriating the personas of players, gang-Muhammad Ali; and the oral traditions of playing the sters, preachers, teachers, feminists, revolutionaries, dozens and signifying.

and entertainers, but they were also able to make Rap represents not only a combination of con-those portrayals, through the backing of marketing scious poetry and musical genius but also a continua-experts, serve as popular fantasy tales and illusions tion of African and Caribbean oral traditions with that somehow had the power and influence to chal-roots that stretch to West and Central Africa. Like lence their peers, authority figures, their friends, their ancestors, African American male and female themselves, and strangers. Rappers sought to make a rappers—who are essentially contemporary griots, profit from offering commentary on pressing social, praise singers, and poets—draw their energy from the political, ethical, and economic issues.

combination of personal style, an innovative story, the Television ratings increased in the 1980s, due in skillful use of words, and a reading of the nation.

part to the recruiting of rap artists to promote con-Rappers create and invent stories using multiple social sumer products. MC Hammer sipped Pepsi, Kid-N-texts. Rap is the heir of the blues, soul, R&B, jazz, Play courted Sprite, and Young MC gave Taco Bell funk, and other African-originated musical and rhetor-a soft-sell pitch. On prime-time television, Heavy D

ical traditions and also has its own personality. Like made guest appearances on *Roc*, while Will Smith's traditional African epic narratives, rap explains *Fresh Prince of Bel Air*, Queen Latifah's *Living African American* interpretations of why the world *Single*, and L.L. Cool J's *In the House* appealed to exists as it does. Like newscasters such as Ted Koppel, young white, black, Latino, and Asian teen and adult Bryant Jennings, Sam Donaldson, and Cokie Roberts, viewers. Rap artists were also featured in cartoons rap's messengers are able to set an agenda by creating targeting children, including Street Frogs, Kid-N-Play, and sharing provocative news stories about a variety and the notorious Hammertime, all of which were of local, national, and global events, as well as by out-broadcast on Saturday mornings. Almost from its lining vicarious details pertaining to positive and neg-inception, then, hip-hop developed an often ambigui-ative realities, events, and activities in the rural ous relationship to consumerism, as seen

in the ram-communities and urban neighborhoods of African pant purchasing of various hip-hop-related consumer Americans.

H-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:27 PM Page 265

Hip-Hop——265

Rap may also function as a farce, to the extent that

“punch phrasing,” which Hebdige describes as “where it enables young black male and female rappers to the DJ hits a particular break while the record on the employ trickery and deception in the telling of histor-other deck is still playing.” Grand Wizard Theodore ical tales about African American realities and possi-invented the technique called “scratching,” and bilities. By employing such trickery, rappers school Bambaataa, whose parents were from the Caribbean, the community and the nation. Rappers use very mixed funk beats with percolating synthesizer and elaborate braggadocio tales to insinuate themselves rhythms. Bam, as he prefers to be called, demon-into the personas of cultural, political, and religious strated incredible range in alternating between white nationalists, Afrocentrists, black feminists, gangstas, pop and black funk to keep white, black, and Puerto Africana womanists, players/pimps, humanitarians, Rican couples dancing. With a rap group he helped preachers, and teachers. The rapper’s narratives to form, and which was called Soulsonic Force, Bam communicate the hopes, dreams, values, fantasies, produced one of the first hip-hop singles, “Planet aspirations, fears, frustrations, and sufferings of Rock.” As hip-hop expanded into the mainstream, working-class people living below the poverty line.

Bambaataa’s reputation rose.

Mastering the poor man’s technology back in the 1980s, hip-hop DJs such as Herc, Hollywood, Flash, **The Wizardry of the Hip-Hop DJ**

Bambaataa, Terminator X, and Dr. Dre played a The wizardry of the hip-hop DJ represents an significant part in the evolution and development of important manifestation of the culture. Hip-hop DJs the black deejaying

tradition by becoming experts have invented a variety of hip-hop and rap formats—

in reconfiguring eclectic sounds, techniques, styles, house, hip-house, techno-house, and hip-hop music—

profiles, African-originated orality, and recyclable for live performances, prime-time television shows, African-American musical beats. By the 1980s, others and cable programs. These progenitors of hip-hop were creating and experimenting with polyrhythmic gave rap its edge. With the aid of two turntables and sounds, repetitions, and break beats with their turntable—a repository of old records, as well as the creative bles, digital samplers, computers, drum machines, ability to master techniques like scratching, cutting, multirecords, and hyperinstruments. Old school studio mixing, punch phrasing, and looping—and a creative DJs such as Hank Shocklee and Daddy-O combined imagination and good MC rapping voice—the early samples with complex sounds to manipulate musical hip-hop DJ brilliantly introduced innovative styles beats, while others used Macintosh computers to rein-and recyclable sounds from a trilateral pan-African vent unique sounds from the bass and the keyboard.

aesthetic tradition. Herc, Flash, and Bambaataa were These DJs carefully blended musical beats, rhyming widely recognized as bearers of contemporary African stories, and exciting sounds by relying heavily on cultural traditions.

improvisation, wit, and intellect.

The hip-hop experiment began shortly after Herc emigrated from Jamaica to New York in 1967. Herc **HIP-HOP DANCING AND AFRICAN**

purchased and named his own sound system, the **AMERICAN AND AFRICAN DANCE QUALITIES**

Herculords, and patterned his deejaying style after the Jamaican tradition of “toasting.” Herc’s smooth talk-Hip-hop dancing, known initially as break dancing, ing over instrumental and dubbed versions of 1960s first became popular through local performances hit records was intermixed with “shout-

outs” and in parks and clubs in New York. Then it attracted screams of “Rock the House” to keep the crowds attention at local dance contests and competitions in dancing. Besides creating his own style of playing the New York, New Jersey, and Philadelphia. The hip-same sound repeatedly, Herc was known for “cutting hop dance craze soon spread to the West Coast and from one record deck to the other as he talked through the motion picture industry through both Hollywood the microphone,” as Dick Hebdige put it.

and independent feature films such as *Flash Dance*, Herc was the first hip-hop DJ to make the transi-Wild Style, *Beat Street*, *Breaking’*, *Breakin’ 2: Electric* tion from the parks to the professional arena, but *Boogaloo*, *House Party*, *House Party II*, *Class Act*, *Flash*, Theodore, Bambaataa, and others were creating and others. The dance patterns gained mass appeal their own DJ sounds as well. The Grandmaster, whose in the 1980s and 1990s through the performances of parents came from Barbados, became an expert at dancers in music videos and on comedy shows aired

H-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:27 PM Page 266

266———**Hip-Hop**

on cable television. Like rap, the dance patterns in *Style*, where they were characterized as prolific break dancing, popping, locking, moon-walking, the writings belonging to crews. In the early days, these Electric Slide, the Pee-Wee Herman, the Smurf, the crews used graffiti as a symbolic gesture to identify Cabbage Patch, the Running Man, the Kid-N-territorial space. Graffiti was also used to celebrate Play, the Heavy D Shake, the Flavor Flav, and the culture, and eventually to replace violence with M.C. Hammer’s Chinese Typewriter on MTV all nonviolence. However, the mass media characterized evolved from the same pan-African aesthetic matrix.

graffiti artists, as they did rappers and break dancers, Essentially, these dance movement patterns resembled as a menace.

similar dance qualities and traits characteristic of Campaigns spearheaded by local law enforcement African and Afro-Diasporic dancing. Their roots can agencies, politicians, and taxpayers tagged these be easily found in earlier dance patterns and styles, visual artists as social deviants and

outcasts with ranging from the ceremonial and polyrhythmic nothing to do. Like other cultural manifestations of stomps performed in traditional African societies to hip-hop, graffiti artists made the transition from the various movement patterns performed in Brazil, community to professional art galleries in the early Cuba, Haiti, Jamaica, and on and off plantations in the 1980s. Like any new and bold fashion statement, United States.

graffiti-originated fashion designs, whether they orig-After break dancing arrived on the cultural scene in inated on the East or West Coast, were tagged as the mid-1970s, the B-boys who were in groove with

“bizarre and weird.” In addition to this descriptive

“the break points in the DJ’s performance” created characterization, the styles and profiles of some of down and upright movements of play-fighting in the practitioners who invented and promoted the which they robotically scuffle their feet, hands, heads, culture’s material aspects continue to appropriate and bodies back and forth. However, with the spread the collective hip-hop imagination and attitude.

of the break-dancing fever uptown, newer movement The fake gold chains called “dope-ropes,” oversized exchanges and patterns evolved between the East casual pants, the X Cap, and high-top fade haircut and West Coasts. With its mimelike movements, worn by fans of hip-hop, as well as other hip-hop the Electric Boogaloo reached New York via Los manifestations—including graffiti-originated expres-Angeles, Cleveland, South Carolina, and other medi-sions from spraypainted images on the walls of build-ating points. Since the 1990s, newer dances have ings to airbrushed images on clothes, picture books, surfaced. “Freaky style” dance patterns, limited to hip posters, magazine covers, cartoons, and canvases dis-and pelvic thrust motions, also played a significant played in art galleries—have generated much capital.

role in the 2 Live Crew’s “As Nasty As They Wanna Fans intrigued by video images of rappers in fancy Be” freedom of speech controversy, which included cars, wearing gold chains and baggy clothes, associate some very public defenses by Henry Louis Gates of these artifacts with success in hip-hop.

the use of profanity. With the popularity of Daisy-Besides Def Jam Records, Def Jam Comedy, and Duke Shorts, freaky dance styles, including the Butt, the more recent Phat Farm clothing line, Russell the Butterfly, and the Tootsie Roll, have spread in Simmons, one of the most successful black entrepre-dance clubs all across America.

neurs in the hip-hop business, has made a significant mark in the fashion industry. He invested in a profitable industry, and he has helped others—such as **GRAFFITI ART AND FASHION:**

April Walker of Walker Wear, Chuck D of PE mail-VANDALISM AND CONSUMERISM

order clothing, and Naughty By Nature (NBN) of Graffiti, which has been characterized as a Naughty Wear—do the same. Now that hip-hop has display of symbolic writings and disturbing images penetrated the marketplace of ideas as well, well-on public surfaces, first appeared in New York in established white designers have increasingly invested the mid-1960s. By the 1970s, graffiti writings had in one way or another in the hip-hop clothing indus-gained widespread visibility as a form of folk art try, including Tommy Hilfiger, Polo, Guess, Girbaud, and as an important communication channel for gang Nautica, Versace, and Marc Buchanan. In addition, cultures. Graffiti emerged as part of hip-hop after advertisers representing a number of major multina-appearing on subway walls and trains in the first tional corporations have jumped on the bandwagon.

independently produced hip-hop documentary, *Wild* Many use rappers in advertisements and promotions

H-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:27 PM Page 267

Hip-Hop——267

to market leather jackets, jeans, food service chains, Hebdige, Dick. (1987). *Cut 'n' Mix: Culture, Identity and* and sportswear from various manufacturers, including *Caribbean Music*. London: Methuen. This a sourcebook Timberland, Rockport, and Nike. *The Source*, the for the styles and attitudes of DJs.

Henderson, Errol Anthony. (1996). Black Nationalism and most widely read hip-hop magazine, has also tapped, Rap. *Journal of Black Studies*, 26, 308–339. Henderson has promoted, and profited from the lucrative business in written an important essay on the significance of black hip-hop fashions that can be said to have saturated the nationalism to rap music.

market.

Rose, Tricia. (1994). *Black Noise: Rap Music and Black Culture in Contemporary America*. Hanover, CT: Wesleyan

— *Ronald J. Stephens*

University Press. Rose's book remains the major work in **FURTHER READING**

the field of rap music and African American culture. It is an important and useful book for those interested in seeing the Bennett, Eric. (n.d.). Hip-Hop. *Microsoft Encarta Reference* interrelationship of the music and American culture.

Library 2002 [Computer software]. This essay offers Stephens, Ronald J. (1991). The Three Waves of Contemporary immediate access to the hip-hop phenomenon.

Rap Music. *Black Sacred Music: A Journal of Theomu-George, Nelson*. (1993). *Hip-Hop's Founding Fathers Speak sicology*, 5, 25–40. This is one of the best contemporary the Truth. *The Source*, November, 44–50. This is a solid essays on the various waves of rap music.

piece on the founding fathers of the hip-hop nation.

Stephens, Ronald J. (1998). Rappin' n Stylin' Out: Images of Haylin, Lucy. (1993). Moguls With Attitude: Hip-Hop Titans Rap Artists as Contemporary Griots and Tricksters in the Russell Simmons and Andre Harrell May Well Be Popular Culture Arena. Challenge: A Journal of Research Determining the Flavor of the Decade, Each in His Own on African American Men, 9, 25–56. In this work, the Way. GQ, p. 168. Haylin takes a look at the music

moguls author explains the relationship between rap and African who commercially control the hip-hop phenomenon.

communication styles.

I-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 269

I

PHASES OF IMPERIALISM

IMPERIALISM

The first phase of imperialism began in 1440 with the arrival of the first shipment of enslaved African people. Imperialism is the process by which a nation extends and gains territory by imposing its authority and thus gaining 1870 when the colonial phase began, involved political and economic control of other areas. Here the investment in human flesh, unknown in scale and term is being used to refer specifically to the process scope before this time. These shipments of African by which European nations achieved world hegemony people to other lands might be called the first experience through an aggressive system of exploitation accompanied by enormous violence and inhumanity against the trade of enslaved Africans, Asians, and Native Americans. Imperialism made imperialism, as a whole, possible. The modern wreaked havoc on the African continent, and the global economy, which Europeans once dominated mark it left on Africa helped to define the meaning and now European Americans dominate, was created of imperialism to the world.

by the inhumane exploitation of African people.

African people and their resources were plundered. The enslavement of Africans by Europeans is not and exploited from the 15th century on into the 20th properly considered trade—it is accurately defined as a century. It is usual to take an economic perspective on a holocaust, meaning the destruction of a people. The imperialism, but a concentration on economics alone rise of and support for the enslavement of Africans diminishes the

reality of the utter devastation of many may have led directly to what African American people and nations. Furthermore, such a view ratioscholars see as the moral decay of the modern world.

nalizes degeneracy. It is estimated that millions of From the 15th through the 20th centuries Europeans lives were lost during the height of Europe's hege-developed a network of international trade and fought mony. Indeed, as a consequence of the destruction and for its control. The trade of enslaved Africans was the exploitation of African and Asian nations, Europe single most important element of this effort. Portugal gained hundreds of millions of dollars in wealth dur-established a strong foothold early, establishing a ing the most intense period of imperialism. In 1914, at trading monopoly in the East. Once Portugal united its the height of Europe's imperial period, more than four political ambitions with those of Spain, attention was fifths of the world was under the control of one or turned to establishing colonies in the Americas.

the other of the European powers. Although most The Dutch replaced the Portuguese in the East and colonized nations won independence in the decades carried the technique and institutions of commercial following World War II, the phase of imperialism empire building to their furthest development. The referred to in the literature as neo-colonialism and Dutch efforts were supported by their role in supply-globalization continues to plague most of the world.

ing enslaved Africans to the colonies in the Americas.

269

I-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 270

270———**Imperialism**

The Dutch established the Dutch United East India The third and contemporary phase of imperialism, Company in 1602, an early example of the modern-given the name neocolonialism by Kwame Nkrumah, day multinational corporations that promote globalis now referred to as "globalization" by contemporary ization. The British ultimately seized the

Dutch scholars. African and African American scholars see monopoly in the East, making its British East India globalization as an extension of the two previous phases Company the formal ruler of Bengal in 1764. This of imperialism, with the hegemony of the European and presaged the efforts of imperialism as a whole to European American self-proclaimed elites more fully erode national sovereignty and establish multinational entrenched than in the past. Consistent with imperial-corporations as international governing bodies.

ism as a whole, globalization seeks to oppress Africa Having acquired the legal "right" to supply Spain with and Africans more than other peoples.

enslaved Africans, the British gained enough capital Globalization, also referred to in some literature as and power to begin the industrial revolution. They

"The New World Order," is viewed by African and then made the trading of enslaved Africans illegal, to African American scholars as an attempt to rob the limit challenges to their ascendance as the dominant world of its humanity and dignity and to enslave the European power. The stage was thus set for the creation world to the demands of a small group of corporate, of the British empire.

banking, and political leaders. The intent of this group Colonialism, the second phase of imperialism, is to further establish centralized worldwide economic began in Africa in 1870 and lasted until most management, including international institutions for African nations won their independence in the 1960s.

banking and trade, with multinational corporations as European merchants and institutions accumulated the glue that holds the various components in power.

huge sums in profit from shipping along the infamous Thus, imperialism, in its phase as globalization, is triangular trade routes connecting the colonies, the the process by which all nations are forced to pursue West Indies, and Africa or England, with the trade a common set of economic policies, so that commer-based primarily on the exploitation of African

people's interests supersede all other interests, including and their resources. This accumulation of wealth was health care, education, and food production. Due to invested in establishing European financial institutions, free trade legislation and the establishment of corporations, including the stock exchange and large banking financial institutions, multinational corporations institutions. The resulting economic system was used freely exploit the planet, dominate social systems, to expand and deepen the exploitation of peoples of and deploy the most powerful and dangerous technologies and their land and natural resources, with an emphasis in history, superseding national government emphasis on Africa. Increasing profits and increasing power; state power often slips away, overwhelmed by systematization of the economic infrastructure led to corporate dominance.

increased competition among those European nations Of primary importance to the understanding of that were vying for power. The competition and greed the ongoing process of imperialism and, hence, to of Europeans in turn resulted in a global devastation the understanding of the process by which it will be and inhumanity that was never before seen in human history, is an appreciation of its dependence on history.

optimal consent and minimal resistance from the European colonialism was an integrated system majority of the world's people. From its very inception that sought to eradicate African economic, political, social, and cultural autonomy. Through imperialism, in which a tiny minority benefits from increasingly violent and oppressive measures, exploiting the majority, has required the implicit or European powers established a system of absolute explicit consent of the majority of the voting public of exploitation; every gain, profit, and benefit realized the imperial nations to maintain its power. In order by Europeans was realized at African expense. King to gain support and consent for immoral, inhumane Leopold of Belgium personified the European foreign and domestic policy, a culture characterized colonial ethos: His exploitation of the people of the by inhumanity and immorality was created in the Congo and their resources earned his government exploiting nations and then spread to the petite bourgeoisie an estimated \$1,500,000 per year in profits. This geo-political exploitation of nations. Today, a similar effort is

exploitation cost the lives of approximately 11 million working toward creating a "One World" culture—

Congolese people between 1890 and 1920.

devoid of traditional cultural ties through history,

I-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 271

Indigeniste Movement———271

devoid of human feeling, worshipping material gain.

Haitians, and blacks around the world, viewed The purpose of this culture, according to some, is to themselves and their culture. It was largely inspired grant consent for the continuation of exploitation.

by the ideas of Jean Price-Mars (1876–1969), consid-Throughout the period of imperialism, the greatest ered by many as the greatest Haitian intellectual of and strongest resistance has continually come from the first half of the 20th century. Price-Mars was a diasporic Africans. African resistance has also fueled multitalented man. Trained as a physician, he served global resistance; for example, Touissant L'Ouverture's as Minister of Foreign Affairs, as well as Haitian revolution fueled the French Revolution as the civil Ambassador to France and the Dominican Republic. He rights movement gave new life to world revolution. As was also a prolific and extremely influential writer.

Molefi Asante, Amilcar Cabral, Ngugi Wa Thiong'o, The Indigeniste movement, with which Price-Mars Maulana Karenga, and countless other African scholars is closely associated, is primarily identified as a liter-have acknowledged, resistance to cultural domina-ary movement. Haitian writers such as Carl Brouard, tion through the internalization of traditional African J. B. Cineas, and Jacques Roumain, author of the culture is the most powerful weapon against the famous Gouverneurs de la Rosée (Masters of the contemporary efforts of imperialism.

Dew), founded *La Revue Indigène* in 1927. *La Revue Indigène* regularly renounced slavish imitation of

— Kismet Beckman

French literature and looked to peasant culture for inspiration. It can be said, however, that these writers **FURTHER READING**

fell short of their goal, for they wrote in ultra modern Chinweizu. (1975). *The West and the Rest of Us*. Boston: Faber French instead of Creole, the language of the peasants and Faber. This book, which is a striking indictment of the that Price-Mars championed as the true language of Western world for its role in subverting the cultures of the Haitian people. Another Haitian literary group *Africa and Asia*, has risen to the status of a being a classic swept by the Indigeniste movement was the group of in the struggle for African liberation.

Fanon, Frantz. (1967) *The Wretched of the Earth*. New York: poets known as the Griot, which included François Grove Press. Written by a young Caribbean philosopher Duvalier—the future dictator of Haiti. Others, how- whose insights into the impact of imperialism and racism ever, took a nonliterary road in the call to return became the arguments of an entire generation of African to Africa and pursued the scientific exploration of scholars, this book is considered an essential text in Black African civilization and its presence in Haitian cul-Studies.

ture. In this pursuit, Jacques Roumain founded the Nkrumah, Kwame. (1965). *Neo-Colonialism: The Last Stage Bureau of Ethnology in 1941*, while Price-Mars him-of Imperialism. New York: International. This is one of the self founded the Institute of Ethnology and became best African books on the impact of imperialism on African nations.

chair of Africology and sociology there.

Roberts, J. M. (1993). *History of the World*. New York: Oxford The historical development that inspired the birth University Press. Roberts provides a general overview of the of the Indigeniste movement was the

U.S. occupation way Europe has operated in the world over the past 500 years.

of Haiti from 1915 to 1934. Resistance to the U.S.

Rodney, Walter. (1982). *How Europe Underdeveloped Africa*.

occupation by Haitian intellectuals was ambiguous Washington, DC: Howard University Press. This is a and modest, at best. Haiti's claim to be the first free Guyanese scholar's exceptional analysis of how Europe black republic in the Western Hemisphere had always robbed the African nations of their mineral and agricultural been a source of pride and shaped its national identity.

resources in order to create wealth in Europe.

However, this identity (for the elite in particular) was always circumscribed by an emotional attachment to France, Haiti's former colonial ruler. With the **INDIGENISTE MOVEMENT**

American occupation in full force, Haitians endured humiliating racism that undermined the glory and The Indigeniste movement, or *Mouvement Indigéniste*, principles of the founding of their republic. In addition, started in the 1920s as an attempt by Haitian intellectuals to properly define Haitian culture as African, the occupation failed to deliver what many intellectuals had secretly hoped it would—a dramatic rather than an extension of French culture, as it was change in the technology and material wealth of Haiti.

then commonly assumed to be. This movement was In a series of lectures and articles, as well as in the a catalyst for literary and social change in the way 1928 publication of *Ainsi Parla l'Oncle* (*So Spoke the*

I-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 272

272———**Institute of Positive Education** *Uncle*), Price-Mars identified the cause of Haitian systems of thought throughout history and the malaise as the Haitians' failure to embrace their own diaspora. Parents of New

Concept's students pay an traditions and their denial of the African origins of annual tuition of \$3,000, and the school's enrollment their culture. With his wide breadth of knowledge of was once as high as 150 students, before the estab-African culture, Price-Mars systematically identified lishment of the Betty Shabazz International Charter the African roots of Haitian culture and Vodou. He School, where parents can send their children for called for elevating the pride of Haitians and for for-free to receive an African-centered education from tifying their resistance to the American occupation preschool through eighth grade. The charter school through the glorification of the Haitian peasants. He has an enrollment of approximately 300 students.

believed that in their ways was the source of Haitian New Concept is one of only three such schools in the strength and national pride. Price-Mars devoted five United States that date back at least 20 years. About chapters of his book to the assertion of the African New Concept, Haki Madhubuti says, "We're not talking roots of Haitian culture: Chapter II, "Popular Beliefs"; about words on paper but creating a world in which Chapter III, "Africa, Its Races and Its Civilization"; children are being anchored properly. I see our mis-Chapter IV, "Africa and the External World"; Chapter V, sion as nothing less than providing the necessary

"African Animism"; and Chapter VI, "The Religious foundation for a child to deal with the world from a Sentiments of the Haitian Masses."

secure and self-aware position."

Price-Mars's message that we can be ourselves only if we do not reject our ancestral heritage res-THE SCHOOLS THE INSTITUTE SPONSORS

onated in the hearts of many. Indeed, the Indigeniste movement inspired many other similar movements Safisha Madhubuti served for 16 years as principal around the world, such as the Négritude movement in and a teacher at New Concept before leaving the France and the Harlem Renaissance and Afrocentricity school to finish her doctoral degree at the University in the United States.

of Chicago. Today, she teaches in the School of Education at Northwestern University under the name

— *Garvey F. Lundy*

of Carol Lee. She says, “Students who graduated from New Concept have grown to be lovers of black people **FURTHER READING**

and contributors to the world. They are well man-Antoine, Jacques C. (1981). *Jean Price-Mars and Haiti*.

nered, not into gangs, not into drugs.” The parents of Washington, DC: Three Continents Press. Antoine provides New Concept’s students have been doctors, lawyers, insight into Price-Mars’s life and philosophy.

plumbers, secretaries, and welfare recipients. Some Price-Mars, Jean. (1983). *So Spoke the Uncle* (Magdaline parents volunteered in lieu of paying the annual W. Shannon, Trans.). Washington, DC: Three Continents Press. This is indispensable reading on the subject.

tuition. Most of the parents, however, have been public school teachers. Safisha Madhubuti provides insight into this, saying, “The average dropout rate in the Chicago public schools is around 50%. There are **INSTITUTE OF**

high schools in Chicago where the dropout rate is 75%. I personally cannot name a single child who **POSITIVE EDUCATION**

attended New Concept for even a year who did not go on to graduate from high school. Not one.”

The Institute of Positive Education was founded in Mornings at New Concept and Betty Shabazz start 1969 in Chicago, Illinois, by Haki Madhubuti and with the “unity circle,” just before 9:00. The children his wife Safisha. It sponsors African-centered learning and staff gather around a large white circle painted on for youngsters and adults. The institute served as the the gymnasium floor. The children recite the “Black legal entity for the establishment of the New Concept National Pledge” developed by the

Council of School in 1972 and it leases space to the Betty Independent Black Institutions. Using call-and-Shabazz International Charter School founded by the response, the teacher begins by saying “We are African Madhubuti in 1998. Annually, New Concept instructs people.” The children respond with “We are African about 35 school-age youngsters in an environment people. Struggling for national liberation. We are that fosters pride in and knowledge about African preparing leaders and workers to bring about a positive

I-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 273

Institute of Positive Education———273

change for our people. We stress the development of at a poetry reading in 1968, she was teaching African our bodies, minds, souls, and consciousness. Our com-American literature at the school that would later mitment is to self-determination, self-defense, and self come to be called Kennedy-King College. From her respect for our race. We extend the right hand out teaching she knew that black students needed to be for the fruition of Black power, for the triumph of Black reached much earlier than college. Thus Safisha con-nationhood. I pledge to my African nation to the build-vinced Haki Madhubuti of the importance of starting ing of a better people and a better world. My total devo-a school for African American children.

tion, my total resources, and my total power of my mortal life.”

EDUCATION FOR A BETTER FUTURE

New Concept and the Betty Shabazz International Charter School aim to teach black children a narrative Haki Madhubuti, whose book of poetry *Don't Cry* populated by African and African American heroes *Scream* had sold about 500,000 copies in 1969 and and African rituals, fables, and values. On the walls of 1970, was obsessed with the question “What hap-both schools are works of art that express the aesthet-pened to us? Why is it that most peoples are in charge ics of African and African American people and of their own destiny but not us?” He had been profiled inspirational quotes from black luminaries. On the in *Ebony* and was drawing the attention of scholars landings between floors, the space is artfully deco-at

Cornell and other universities, but instead of simply rated with African prints, tables and chairs, and edu-basking in his newfound fame, Haki Madhubuti cational passages printed large enough for display. On joined Safisha Madhubuti in creating a school for one landing are the words of Zora Neale Hurston, on African American children in an abandoned storefront another landing is an African mathematical system.

they rented on Ellis Street. Teaching a Saturdays-only This use of space invites visitors and perhaps teachers enrichment program, they instructed children ages 2

to rest and relax with inspirations from the African to 12. At the urging of parents, by 1974 the school was and African American experience. For drapes, the offering a full-time program for preschool through classrooms have a variety of colorful kente prints at the third grade. Even though the school never adver-each window. Rows of lockers are against the walls, tised, from the beginning the Madhubutis had to turn and children's projects, such as those on the solar people away. In 1991, New Concept moved to its pre-system and planets, proudly hang along the hallways.

sent location, a spacious building bought along with At recess the children sometimes play a game called the adjoining rectory from the Catholic diocese for

“The Underground Railroad” where girls clamor to roughly \$1.4 million. Since then the school has added be Harriet Tubman. The children learn Spanish and the fourth through eighth grades. Haki Madhubuti has Kiswahili.

remained the school's main benefactor. Profits from The teachers are referred to as *Mama* and *Baba*, his publishing company, Third World Press, support which mean “mother” and “father” in Kiswahili.

the Institute of Positive Education.

Addressing their teachers in this way gives the The Institute of Positive Education was built not on children a profound sense of family as it reinforces the grants or foundations but from the sweat of labor. Haki

instructors' commitment to familial values. New Madhubuti proudly admits that in all of his years oper-Concept now has 4 teachers, and the Betty Shabazz ating the Institute of Positive Education and the Third International school has 19 teachers and 11 classes.

World Press, he has never missed a payroll. Graduates At both schools, the children learn art, music, music from the school say that they are rooted in their iden-theory, science, reading, writing, math, social studies, tity, which allows them to get along with those who are and history. The teachers and the principal at the not black. In the curriculum, Africa is the starting schools are committed to the success of each student.

point, not the closing point. Students also learn about Safisha Madhubuti survived the advice of a guid-the Chinese, Mayans, Native Americans, and others.

ance counselor who told her that graduate school and Safisha Madhubuti says, "We teach about African teaching at the college level were beyond her, values and what is useful today—critical thinking.

although she was an honor student, because they were We are realistic about how the world operates."

beyond the abilities of the black child. This was one of The Institute of Positive Education provides the the events that inspired Safisha Madhubuti to start space not only for the New Concept School and the New Concept School. When she met Haki Madhubuti Betty Shabazz International Charter School but also

I-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 274

274———**Institute of the Black World** for programs that are African centered. It houses assassination but also to economic conditions within functions for students before and after school, as well those urban areas, and a growing black middle class, as the Mary McLeod Bethune Teachers Training among other phenomena. These events were changing Center headed by Safisha Madhubuti.

the way African Americans viewed themselves, their communities, and America as a whole.

— *Regina Jennings*

The W.E.B. Du Bois Institute for Advanced Afro-American Studies soon became known as the Institute **FURTHER READING**

of the Black World. The first governing board of the Hall, Corey. (2002, May 21). African-centered Charter School new endeavor, called the Advisory Council, consisted Displays Methods During Tour: Betty Shabazz International of prominent members of the African American com-Charter School Toured During National Charter Schools munity. These individuals represented diverse areas, Week. *Citizen Newspaper*, p. 3.

such as academia, the arts, and various community Rivlin, Gary. (1997, May 23). Eyes on the Prize: Over More Than Two Decades, Haki and Safisha Madhubuti Have groups. Members of the council included its chair, Proved That African-centered Education Can Amount to C.T. Vivian, Walter F. Anderson, Margaret Alexander, More Than a Black Version of History. It Can Also Be a Lerone Bennett, Horace Mann Bond, Robert Browne, Springboard to a Bright Future. *The Chicago Reader*, John Henrik Clarke, Dorothy Cotton, Ossie Davis, 26(33), 6.

St. Claire Drake, Katherine Dunham, Vivian Henderson, Tobe Johnson, Julius Lester, Frances Lucas, Jesse Noel, Rene Piquion, Eleo Pomare, Pearl Primus, Benjamin Quarles, Bernice Reagon, William **INSTITUTE OF THE BLACK WORLD**

Strickland, Council Taylor, E.U. Essien-Udom, Charles White, and Hosea Williams.

The Institute of the Black World (IBW) was an As a research institution designed to create solu-Atlanta-based, African American think tank founded tions to challenges faced by African people, the IBW

and directed by African American intellectuals from staff was comprised of scholars who could interrogate 1969 to 1983. Its primary objective was to

conduct the past, and the present, in an effort to shape the research that would positively impact the lives of future through in-depth analysis of the people, places, African people worldwide; its initial emphasis was on and events that impacted African people globally. The addressing concerns relevant to African Americans.

research that they conducted was not done solely for The IBW as an institution began its life as a part of the benefit of academia. All the research had to have the Martin Luther King, Jr. Memorial Center and also practical implications both inside and outside of the had ties with the Atlanta University Graduate Center.

academy. The cadre of scholars involved in the initial One of the IBW's cofounders, Vincent Harding, a project represented various academic disciplines and historian at Spelman College and friend of the King interests. All, however, shared a sincere desire to family, was asked by Martin Luther King Jr.'s widow, better the overall condition and status of African Coretta Scott King, to direct the work of the Martin people. The first full-time research staff members Luther King Library Documentation Project. Her were Lerone Bennett, Christine Coleman, Chester offer, made shortly after her husband's assassination in Davis, Lonetta Gaines, Vincent Harding, Stephen 1968, was accepted by Harding, but he recommended Henderson, Joyce Ladner, Daulton Lewis, William an independent research project that would support the Strickland, Sterling Stuckey, and Robert Browne.

spirit of the slain civil rights leader. Coretta Scott King Associate scholars and lecturers closely associated agreed to support the project and subsequently what with the work and mission of the IBW included was then known as the W.E.B. Du Bois Institute for C.L.R. James, Amiri Baraka, St. Clair Drake, Walter Advanced Afro-American Studies was born.

Rodney, Stokely Carmichael, Ella Baker, Alvin Harding's idea was shaped by the times in which F. Poussaint, and Haywood Burns.

it was devised. Major events were taking place in The work being done at the IBW headquarters in the late 1960s, events that had a direct and powerful Atlanta was augmented by other institutions and impact on the

African American community: the groups, which helped to form a cooperative network black power movement, the Vietnam War, student of scholars who agreed with and fully supported the demands for Black Studies curriculums in education of the IBW. Among these were the African Union, urban uprisings in response not only to the King Heritage Studies Association (AHS), Congress of

I-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 275

Institute of the Black World———275

African People (CAP), the Black Academy of Arts and the Martin Luther King Jr. Memorial Center where Letters, Fisk University, Shaw University, Howard it was housed. The IBW's critics claimed that the University, Dartmouth College, Wesleyan University, organization, which had only hired black staff members, Brooklyn College, and Cornell University.

was too separatist; did not espouse nonviolence as The goals listed below specify the actions through King had; and did not uplift King's memory enough which the IBW planned to carry out its mission to for it to be an appropriate part of a memorial center for provide research to support the struggle of African the civil rights leader. Many in the Advisory Council people worldwide. The IBW endeavored put pressure on the IBW to change its direction, so in an effort to preserve its initial purpose, the IBW

1. to assist in the design and implementation of decided to separate from the King center in the fall Black Studies curriculums

of 1970. Thus the Martin Luther King Jr. Memorial 2. to create cooperative relationships with institu-Center and the IBW became two separate entities. The tions of higher learning, including both histori-King center then became a place where the work of cally black colleges and predominately white King was studied exclusively. The IBW, in accordance colleges supportive of the aims of the IBW

with its stated mission, became a center of new ideas—

ideas as diverse as the staff that created them. The 3. to conduct original research at the IBW head-work of the institute was in the study of ideas, quarters and to teach courses that support the not people and personalities. The strand that connected institute's mission

all the research at the institute was that it had to be 4. to support African American artists, particularly designed to liberate African people worldwide. The those with an artistic vision tied to liberation, research took the form of papers, conferences, and and expose their work both inside and outside lectures from scholars both inside and outside of the of the academy

IBW research staff. Some examples are as follows: 5. to develop curriculums aimed at positively

- “Beyond Chaos: Black History and the Search impacting the lives of African American children for the New Land”

6. to create a center for social analysis of African

- “The Black Family and Social Policy”

American communities nationwide

- “Black Radicals in America”
- “Black Repression in the Cities: An Analysis of 7. to create connections with African intellectuals Institutional Racism in the 70's”

and activists worldwide

- “The Challenge of Blackness”

8. to train scholars to commit themselves not only

- “A Critical Anthology of Blues Poetry”

to academic excellence within Black Studies but

- “On the Need for a Black Revolutionary Theory”

also to improving the communities represented

- “The Search for a Religion of Blackness”

in their research, as well as to give these scholars

- “Toward a Theory of Black Political Economy”

the techniques necessary to properly teach students both inside and outside of the academy The research conducted at the IBW was disseminated on site, through tape recordings of lectures 9. to sponsor conferences where the results of made available to interested parties, through shared directed research could be shared with the manuscript copies, and through the widely distributed African American community, and to encourage

“Black-World-View” column that tackled current individuals and groups with interests similar to events relevant to African Americans.

the IBW’s to participate in such events All the research conducted by the black scholars 10. to create an independent means of publishing affiliated with the institute was to be used for the the findings of its research

purpose of empowering the African community, and although it initially concentrated on the American These goals were the driving force behind the experience, the research team eventually reflected the research conducted at the IBW from 1969 through IBW’s global perspective and reached out to people of 1983. Soon after the creation of the IBW, however, a color worldwide.

review panel and many of the members of the council After separating from the Martin Luther King Jr.

questioned whether its mission fit within the aims of Memorial Center in 1970, the IBW struggled financially,

I-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 276

lacking the big money donors of its former partner.

promotes racial pride. It helps teachers and students to Although never financially prosperous, the IBW

understand that Black Studies as a discipline is impor-nevertheless created a research environment where tant because it focuses on the black contribution to the scholars of African descent were able to focus on such social fabric of society.

areas as education, the economy, and government, Karenga understood that to close the historical gap among others, in an effort to address pressing chal-created by years of denial and neglect of Africans'

lenges faced by the African American communities contribution to society, there had to be a model that that it served. In 1983 the IBW faced a financial short-identified and introduced the basic social, intellectual, fall that it could not overcome, resulting in the closing and philosophical elements in the Black Studies cur-of its doors.

riculum. To rescue blacks' place in history and set the record straight on black thought and practice, and in

— *Christopher K. Johnson*

answer to the demands of college students during the black social movement of the 1960s and 1970s, there **FURTHER READING**

had to be a fundamental process of information gather-Bennett, Lerone . (1970). *The Challenge of Blackness* ing and reporting. The voices of protest and challenge

[Pamphlet]. Atlanta, GA: Institute of the Black World. This heard across the country from blacks of all ages were is the first pamphlet released in the IBW's Black Paper clamoring for affirmation of their African identity, and series, and it provides information regarding the range of it was imperative that Afrocentric intellectuals respond.

research interests held by the scholars at the IBW and how those interests were all connected to black liberation.

Karenga's *Introduction to Black Studies* answered that Institute of the Black World. (1969). *Institute of the Black* call with legitimate evidence that both delineated the *World: Statement of Purpose and Program*. Atlanta, GA: territory of Black Studies and introduced a plan of Author. This document provides invaluable information action for extended research and inquiry.

regarding both the mission and research plan of the IBW.

The book is organized in order of historical rele-Marable, Manning (Ed.). (2000). *Dispatches from the Ebony vance*, with the events of black civilization accompa-Tower: Intellectuals Confront the African American nished by evidence of their historical, social, political, *Experience*. New York: Columbia University Press. This and intellectual credibility. It begins with a summary of collection of essays provides a look into the field of Black Studies, touching on many of the ideals that drove the black history that covers the basic definition of black research of the IBW.

studies, followed by its origins, relevance, and scope.

Karenga describes seven basic areas of the black experience—history, religion, social organization, politics, economics, creative production, and psychology—

INTRODUCTION

and includes study questions and references for further exploration of each area. He also explores the

TO BLACK STUDIES

challenges and possibilities inherent in the black experience.

Introduction to Black Studies, which was first published *Introduction to Black Studies* is a fundamental in 1982 and subsequently revised, is a textbook written textbook and a prerequisite for intercultural, inter-by noteworthy black scholar Maulana Karenga. The disciplinary, and multidisciplinary curriculum design book is an Afrocentric investigation and validation of in many academic areas. Scholars may resist Black the social, intellectual, and sociological claims of his-Studies as a separate discipline, but they can no longer torical relevance to Western civilization by people of deny the importance of black contributions not only African descent. The question in academic settings was to Western civilization but to civilization as a whole.

always, “Can you prove that Black Studies is relevant Historically, blacks either were excluded from text-for curriculum inclusion?” *Introduction to Black* books or represented in a way that was rooted in mis-Studies answers this question not only by proving the information and prejudice. This book challenges such relevance of Black Studies but also by addressing many practices by providing evidence of significant black related questions with intellectual authority. This text-thought and practice. It is thus understandable that the book is thought provoking and presented in a way that chapter outlining black history is the largest chapter enables teachers at high school and college levels to in Karenga’s book. After an introduction that includes begin an extended dialogue with their students that historical background and definitions, the book covers

the vast sweep of Africans' history from 800 B.C.E.

his many tribulations, he is never complete or able to to the present, including sections such as "African live up to the social standards that people place on Background," "European Slave Trade," "Africans in him. The invisible man, which is the only name by America," and "Civil Rights of the 70s and 80s."

which the narrator allows readers to know him, is Areas of both Black Studies and Africana Studies are throughout the novel searching for a place in society, interwoven in the contents of this book. Maulana and every search leads to disappointment.

Karenga is to be applauded for his profound intellect, In the prologue, a young black man from the South courage, and forethought, as his *Introduction to Black* begins telling his story. In one of the most important *Studies* dispels all speculations about Black Studies as sections of the book, Chapter 1: Battle Royal, the nara relevant discipline of study.

rator explains his quest to find something. He speaks to his grandfather, an ex-slave who tells him not to be

— Gloria Grant Roberson

the traitor to blacks that he has been. His grandfather implies that he has lived a quiet life but also a life of **FURTHER READING**

submissiveness, thus representing an aspect of the narrator. The narrator recalls his high school gradua-Alkalimat, Abdul. (Ed.). (1990). *Paradigms in Black Studies*: tion speech, in which he promoted submissiveness as *Essays*. Chicago: Twenty-First Century Books. This is a radical examination of various theories and models of the way for blacks to succeed, mentioning Booker Black Studies.

T. Washington, who shares this belief. He is asked to Asante, Molefi Kete, and Abarry, Abu. (Eds.). (1996). *African* read his high school speech at a

banquet for the white *Intellectual Heritage*. Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This is the most comprehensive volume of African American theoretical and philosophical writers .

friends are to brawl with the other black boys of the Mazama, Ama. (Ed.). (2003). *The Afrocentric Paradigm*.

community for the entertainment of the town's big Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is the most complete book of Afrocentric theory essays published to date.

Articles by Maulana Karenga are included in the very fine into looking at a stripper, to fight with one another collection of pieces in this book.

with blindfolds on, and to scramble over fake money Mumford, Clarence. (1978). *Production Relations, Class and on an electric mat*. The narrator has a dream that night *Black Liberation: A Marxist Perspective in Afro-American* that his diploma and life mean nothing; this is just one *Studies*. Amsterdam: B.R. Gruner. This is one of the best example of Ellison's irony. Just as the white men have works by a socialist on the issues confronting African these young black men fighting in an environment that people in the Western world.

will never allow them to win, the narrator soon finds that his environment in contemporary America will not allow him to win as a black man because it fails to notice him. This first chapter sets the tone of the

INVISIBLE MAN

novel, the tone that then follows the narrator to college and his life in a hole in Harlem.

Ralph Ellison's 1952 novel *Invisible Man* deals with When the narrator goes to Harlem, he is able to see the inability of the people around the protagonist to the unworthiness that accompanies being black, and see him

as a black man, thus failing to respect himself how many people behave unethically in order to gain and his humanity. The protagonist takes readers on a power. One character in the novel, Tod Clifton, is a journey of truths as he tells his tale, starting with his member of the Brotherhood, a political organization home in the South and moving on to his current living in Harlem that works for blacks in the community and quarters in a hole in the North—in Harlem. Ellison that the Invisible Man is a part of. Clifton leaves the uses symbolism to give life to every detail from the organization and begins selling Sambo dolls, which lyrics of a song to the name of a preacher. Ellison's represent lazy black men. The narrator is unhappy narrator persuades readers that America's failure to about his friend's new career and frustrated that notice him has led him to a life of invisibility. The key Clifton thinks nothing of it. It is irony like this that motifs in the book are blindness, invisibility, and Ellison fills the novel with, people who in the midst of masks. The major conflict is the character's search for confusion do not see their confusion and are blind to a place of his own and his own identity—throughout the situation that they are in.

I-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 278

278——Islam

It is truly a voyage of self, this book that was written understanding between the Arabic and African as a memoir of a fictional character—an invisible communities in New York. He established and served black man—and that, when it appeared in 1952, had as director of the Jabul Arabiyya, a Muslim community a strong effect on the world of literature. *Invisible* ruled by Islamic law in West Valley, New York. His *Man* was very well written and expressed the frustra-followers started groups in Jacksonville, Florida; tion of black men in America as no author had. Highly Rochester, New York; Philadelphia, Pennsylvania; criticized at the height of its publication, the novel still and Detroit, Michigan.

broke barriers, winning the National Book Award in The Sunni First Cleveland Movement in Islam 1953 and becoming one of the greatest books in was established when the immigrant leaders of the African American literature.

Ahmadiyya Movement could not control the African Americans who wanted a more activist agenda for

— *Thysha M. Shabazz*

Islam. Imam Wali Akram founded the First Cleveland Movement in 1936, at about the time Nasir Ahmad **FURTHER READING**

and Said Akmal founded the First Muslim Mosque of Pittsburgh. Wali Akram and his wife Kareema learned Kinnamon, Kenneth. (1997). *Critical Essays on Richard Wright's Native Son*. New York: Twayne. These are useful Arabic and became the major teachers of the religion essays dealing with the role of Richard Wright's powerful in Cleveland.

book.

After World War II, many African American O'Meally, Robert G. (Ed.). (1988). *New Essays on Invisible* artists and musicians found Islam sympathetic. *Dizzy Man*. Cambridge, UK: Cambridge University Press. In five Gillespie, who became a Bahai, influenced many critical essays on Ralph Ellison's novel, the authors uncover musicians who became Muslims. He visited Turkey, the richness of Ellison's vision and fictional strategies.

Egypt, and Syria in 1956, and his band was influ-Wright, Richard. (1995). *Shadow and Act*. New York: Random House. This book is Wright's approach to many literary enced by the cultures of those lands. By the 1950s, and cultural issues.

there was a growing awareness of Islam brought about by such people as Talib Dawud, Mahmoud Alwan, and J.A. Rogers, who taught at the Islamic and African Institute in Philadelphia that was established by Dawud in 1957. In the late 1960s, many of the **ISLAM**

students influenced by this school supported the establishment at Temple University of the Afro-Asian Islam is the religion of Muslims, who believe in Institute, which later became the Department of Pan Allah as the supreme deity and Muhammad as his African Studies and then the Department of African prophet. Among African Americans, Islam has American Studies.

become a vibrant religious expression that has its Soon many African American Muslims sought origins in the Moorish Science Temple, the Nation closer relations with Islamic leaders from the Arab of Islam, Ahmadiyya Movement in Islam, Jabul world. Akbar Muhammad, the son of the Honorable Arabiyya, the First Cleveland Mosque, Darul Islam, Elijah Muhammad of the Nation of Islam, was among the Muslim American Society, and the Islamic those who attended Al-Azhar University in Cairo. He Mission of America. The Islamic Mission, later left the Nation of Islam to become a traditional Sunni named the State Street Mosque, was founded in 1924

Muslim. In 1972, Yusef Muzaffarudin Hamid founded and included immigrant people from Somalia, Yemen, the Islamic Party in North America, which is run by and Madagascar. Many of these people had come to Egyptian Muslims. By 1980, the Islamic Party in New York City as sailors. They soon found local North America had left the mainland to carry on its African American converts.

work in St. Croix. Soon thereafter the organization Muhammad Ezaldeen was a school principal in the opened branches in many of the islands of the 1920s in Newark, New Jersey, who went to Egypt to Caribbean, including Grenada and Dominica. In addi-study Arabic and the Koran. When he returned to the tion, a few of Hamid's followers founded a commu-United States he became one of the biggest promoters nity in Tate, Georgia, in the 1980s.

of the religion of Islam. As a member of the Moorish Perhaps the evolution of the Islamic movement Science Temple, Ezaldeen sought to bring about an is best illustrated by the fact that Warith Deen

I-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 279

Islam———279

Muhammad, a son of Elijah Muhammad, tried to **FURTHER READING**

re-Islamicize and re-African Americanize the movement Blyden, Edward Wilmot. (1967). *Christianity, Islam and the* that his father founded. This

was not very successful *Negro Race*. Edinburgh: University of Edinburgh Press.

because many of the followers of Elijah Muhammad (Original work published 1888). Written by the greatest were black nationalists first and Muslims second. By African scholar of the late 19th century, this book demon-2003, Warith Deen Muhammad had relinquished his strates the interrelationships of Africa, Islam, and drive to bring about a more authentic Islam among his Christianity and the results of those relationships.

followers. The leaders of the movement ended their Essien-Udom, Esien Udosen. (1962). *Black Nationalism: A long-term feud and decided to work together to make Search for Identity in America*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press. Essien-Udom's book is a classic in the Islam more important among African Americans. The discourse on the changing ideologies that impinge upon path to mainstream Islam seems to be the current African American identity.

direction of the various African American Muslim Turner, Richard Brent. (2003). *Islam in the African American communities*.

Experience. Bloomington: Indiana University Press. This remains the most authoritative work on Islam among

— *Adisa A. Alkebulan*

African Americans.

J-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 281

J

accented, while the usually accented parts of the beat **JAZZ**

are left unstressed. Bent pitches, vocal embellish-ments, and other special vocal effects associated with Jazz is the classical musical tradition created by emotional expressions typify the *blues*. It is the fusion Africans in America beginning in the late 19th century.

of the rhythms, phrasing, and sound productions of The term *jazz* came into common usage by 1918 with ragtime and the blues with the instrumentations, numerous theories posed as to its etymology, all of melodies, and harmonies of brass bands and dance which were associated in some way with African or orchestras, that jazz first began to evolve.

African American men. Despite the obscurity around The vast array of styles that comprised the jazz the term, jazz epitomizes the highest developed art tradition is most often identified in terms of geo-form produced in the United States and, as a musical graphical locations, chronological periods, and key tradition, encompasses many diverse and continually musicians of the style. One of the prime locations for changing styles.

the incubation of the earliest styles of jazz was New Throughout the development of jazz, African Orleans, Louisiana. During the late 1800s up through musical sensibilities are central. The technique of *call-the first two decades of the 1900s, the popularity and-response found in much of African music has of military bands, the influences of the music and remained prominent in jazz. The concept of participa-dances performed by Africans in Congo Square, along tory music-making that is at the core of African music, with the appearance of individual performers such whereby all members of the group take part in the as pianist Jelly Roll Morton, led to the formation of creation of the music, is evidenced in the prevalence of musical ensembles that performed at parades, funer-polyphonic ensemble playing in jazz. Improvisation—*

als, and for other various occasions. These performers composing and performing simultaneously, the most developed what came to be known as New Orleans important feature of jazz—can be traced to African jazz, a distinctively instrumental style performed on antecedents. It was, however, the encounter of the three or four wind instruments, drums, piano, guitar African with his new environment in America that or banjo, and tuba.

allowed for the development of jazz, which has Chicago is considered to have been the center of become one of the world's most vibrant art forms.

jazz activities in the 1920s. Many musicians from New Orleans migrated to Chicago with the first recordings of African American musical genres—ragtime and the blues. Ragtime, made popular by groups such as the New Orleans Rhythm Club. Ragtime, made popular by pianist Scott Joplin, and Louis Armstrong's Hot Five and Hot Seven, was intended to accompany dance with its highly syncopated rhythmic patterns. Syncopation is a rhythm-and 1940s, New York came into the spotlight with the mic technique derived from African music in which a emphasis of the jazz style known as swing. With the part of the beat that is usually unaccented is instead emphasis on music for dancing, the swing bands or big band

J-Asante.qxd 11/3/2004 3:12 PM Page 282

282———Jim Crow

bands—ten or more musicians consisting of a brass section, a reed section and a rhythm section—were led influential music in the world today. As an artistic and by bandleaders such as Fletcher Henderson and Duke Ellington. Kansas City Jazz also became popular with Americans and in all of its manifestations captures the bandleader Count Basie at this time.

“spirit” of life in America.

During the 1940s, a group of jazz musicians in

—Mawusi Renee Simmons

*New York City began experimenting with new musical ideas which developed into a style that came to **FURTHER READING***

be known as bop, bebop, or rebop. This new style of jazz emphasized intense and elaborate improvisations, Conyers, James L., Jr. (Ed.). (2001). African American Jazz and was developed by musicians such as saxophonist and Rap: Social and Philosophical Examination of Black Charlie Parker, trumpeter Dizzy Gillespie, and pianist Expressive Behavior.

Jefferson, NC: MacFarland. Relates music to social and political consciousness.

Thelonious Monk. Hard bop became associated with Martin, Henry. (1986). Enjoying Jazz. New York: Schirmer.

saxophonists such as Cannonball Adderly and John Givens give a brief survey of various jazz styles.

Coltrane.

Megill, Donald D., & Demoy, Richard S. (2004). Introduction Jazz vocalists have also been instrumental in the to Jazz History. Upper Saddle River, NJ: Prentice Hall.

development of jazz styles. Most often, the jazz vocal-Highlights some musicians and jazz styles.

ist uses the voice as a musical instrument blending Ramsey, Guthrie P., Jr. (2003). Race Music: Black Cultures in with the rest of the ensemble. Some prominent jazz from Bebop to Hip-Hop. Berkeley: University of California Press. Provides contemporary comments on social realities vocalists in the history of jazz have included Billie in relation to jazz.

Holiday, Ella Fitzgerald, and Jimmy Rushing.

*Although many jazz styles continued to coexist, the 1950s brought in the development of cool jazz epitomized, by trumpeter Miles Davis, and the genesis of **JIM CROW***

free jazz, first associated with saxophonist Ornette Coleman. In the 1960s and 1970s, many jazz musi-Jim Crow was a set of ideas, social norms, life ways, cians returned to the roots of jazz and began perform-mythoforms, role-play symbols, sanctions, and devas-ing styles known as jazz funk and gospel jazz. During tations created after the Civil War by white politicians the 1980s and 1990s, electric jazz and jazz/rock fusion intent on maintaining a system of oppressive control became popular with musicians such as bassist Stanley over African American life and economics. With the

Clarke, saxophonist Grover Washington Jr., and pianist support of the U.S. Supreme Court, whose decision of Herbie Hancock. The catch-all term contemporary 1883 declared the Civil Rights Act of 1875 unconstitutional, Jim Crow laws includes many new styles that are being developed tutional, Jim Crow laws aimed their invasive enter-currently. Latin jazz/Cuban jazz has also developed as prise at the level of social reality and psychological a distinct style with such artists as drummer Poncho manifestation in order to reestablish a stratified social Sanchez and pianist Chucho Valdez.

hierarchy based on white subjugation of African While the many styles of jazz reflect the life-American people.

styles and culture of African Americans during the various historical periods, jazz can categorically be **HISTORICAL AND POLITICAL ANTECEDENTS**

described as music having a) a vitality, originality and spontaneity in which improvisation is an essen-There were many precursors to the enthronement of tial element; b) a distinctive relationship to time in Jim Crow as a living institution, such as the exploita-which the music is played a little ahead of, or a little tive and bondage-centered sharecropping farming behind, the main beats, referred to as “swing” and system; the “benign” neglect of President Andrew enhanced with syncopation; and c) pitch and tonal Johnson to enforce Reconstruction laws; the rise of the inflections along with phrasing that reflect the ability of white rebel soldiers to gain political positions creativity and musicianship of the performer. These in state and national government; the intimidation, characteristics are present in varying degrees in the terrorizing, and murder of African Americans by wide range of jazz styles and various stages of jazz former Confederate general Nathan B. Forrest and his development.

Ku Klux Klan; and the deaths of radical Republicans,

J-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 283

Jim Crow———283

like Thaddeus Stevens of Georgia and Charles Sumner laws of Louisiana. Plessy argued that he had a mixture of Massachusetts, who were committed to full rights of African American and European blood and that due for African Americans. Then, in 1877, Rutherford B.

to his white-skinned appearance, he had a right to use Hayes became president and removed all federal the same accommodations used by whites. The court troops from the South. This act ensured and perma-decided in favor of the state and wrote a decision that nently established the national attack on African stated that if Plessy had one drop of African blood, Americans in the South and the North. The anti-then he was African and therefore had to comply with African rhetoric of white supremacist congressmen the Jim Crow laws of Louisiana. The ultimate impact like James Vardaman of Mississippi and Carter Glass of this decision was that the “separate but equal” doc-of Virginia helped other white supremacists to write trine was applied to all aspects of American life. Since and enforce anti-African social conduct rules and dis-African people were considered different and inferior, criminatory practices. These dehumanizing codes of when African people attempted to retain their dignity behavior and rules for discriminatory treatment against and assert their equality with others, they were often African Americans were called “Jim Crow” laws.

attacked. Thus, due to the *Plessy* decision, African The tacit agreement between the Republican Party Americans were subjected to an onslaught and night-and the Southern Dixicrats (Southern Democrats), mare of verbal and physical attacks, police brutality, which returned full control over the Southern states lynching, murders, several decades of situational and to the rebel white supremacists who had become politi-institutional discriminatory mistreatment, inhumane cians, encouraged local, state, and national movements living and working conditions, and a total erosion of all to create and enact Jim Crow laws and customs to rob, of their economic, educational, civil, and human rights.

steal, and deny African Americans their civil rights and money, as well as to prevent African Americans **THE FINAL OVERTHROW OF JIM CROW**

from owning land, resigning from jobs, voting, renting land—in short, doing anything without the control of In the face of this systemic oppression, it took a white supremacist male. This peonage process set numerous African American leaders and their sup-the stage for a national challenge to the Civil Rights porters many decades to successfully navigate and Act of 1875 that had ensured African Americans civil fight against this institutionalized subordination of rights in every aspect of American society. The 1883

their race. Their efforts in protest against racism were Supreme Court decision against the Civil Rights ultimately manifested in the Supreme Court decision Act then justified Americans' overt displays of white in the 1954 *Brown v. Board of Education*, the Civil supremacist thinking, values, ideas, practices, and Rights Acts of 1964 and 1967, the 1960s civil rights iconic symbols in every educational, legal, scientific, activism, the 1960s and 1970s militant activism, and religious, economic, and social institution.

the Black Studies movements, which were able to pro-The Civil Rights Act of 1875 had safeguarded gressively break down and decimate many vestiges of African Americans from being denied use of and the Jim Crow laws. In the final analysis, the lingering access to parks, public restaurants, post offices, retentions of Jim Crow and their potential negative churches, beaches, playgrounds, hotels, movies, impacts will need to be anticipated, identified, banks, swimming pools, hospitals, colleges, public analyzed, and eradicated such that the horrors of this schools, and other open public accommodations. The system of discrimination used against African hostile, pro-white supremacy decision by the U.S.

Americans and other cultural groups will not continue Supreme Court eliminated this ban on segregation.

or reappear.

Thus, Southern legislators at local, state, and national

— *Leophus Taharka King*

levels rushed to set up Jim Crow rules of conduct that created a system of legal separated accommodations for blacks and whites.

FURTHER READING

Asante, Molefi Kete. (1995). *African American History: THE PLESSY CHALLENGE*

A Journey of Liberation. Maywood, NJ: The Peoples Publishing Group. This comprehensive history of African In 1896, in a Supreme Court case, Homer Plessy Americans discusses, among other things, the resistance to challenged his conviction for violating the Jim Crow Jim Crowism among African Americans.

J-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 284

284———**Johnson Publishing Company**

DaSilva, Benjamin, Finkelstein, Milton, and Loshin, Arlene.

reporting that would inform and energize blacks (1969). *The Afro-American in United States History*.

politically. Johnson maintains, however, that his goal New York: Globe Book Company. This is one of the key was to get into and win in the game of magazine pub-resources on the historical and social issues confronting lishing, not to challenge the status quo of capitalism.

contemporary African Americans.

In Johnson's view, *Ebony* presents blacks in a posi-Newby, I. A. (1965). *Jim Crow's Defense: Anti-Negro Thought in America, 1900–1930*. Baton Rouge: Louisiana State tive light, which is rarely seen in white-dominated University Press. Newby's book is a study of Jim Crowism media. Many in the world of black business agree with and its roots in the doctrine of white supremacy.

his standpoint, maintaining that black success is in and of itself a contribution to black communities. In addition, many people have lauded

Ebony for consistently tracking important black political issues in the United **JOHNSON PUBLISHING COMPANY**

States, particularly since the 1960s, and Johnson counts himself as one of Martin Luther King, Jr.'s early supporters. The Johnson Publishing Company was founded in 1942 in Chicago, Illinois.

To date, the company is the most successful African American-owned magazine publisher in the United States. The Johnson Publishing Company proved to the publishing world that glossy, high production value magazines targeted at black consumers can make money.

The success of *Ebony* gave rise to a host of new titles, best known for the magazines *Ebony* and *Jet* (and its some black-owned and many not, catering to African American cosmetics line), but the publication that launched the company was *Negro Digest*, which (formerly *Emerge*), and *Heart and Soul* may not have Johnson began in 1942 with a loan taken against his gained space on the newsstands had it not been for mother's furniture. *Negro Digest* was modeled on Johnson Publishing Company's pioneering efforts.

Reader's Digest and contained reprinted as well as

— Catherine Squires

commissioned articles from some of the most celebrated minds in the black and white communities.

FURTHER READING

Langston Hughes, Eleanor Roosevelt, Walter White, and Zora Neale Hurston, among others, wrote for Hall, James C. (2000). *On Sale at Your Favorite Newsstand: Negro Digest in the 1940s*. Johnson stopped publishing *Negro Digest/Black World* and the 1960s. In Todd Vogel's edition of the magazine in 1951, but brought it back (Ed.), *The Black Press: New Literary and Historical Essays*. New Brunswick, NJ: Rutgers University Press.

in 1961. Under the leadership of editor Hoyt Fuller, Hall provides an insightful history of *Negro Digest*, with a *Negro Digest* became an outstanding record of the focus on editor Hoyt Fuller's efforts to make the magazine explosion of black political and artistic thought in culturally and politically relevant.

the 1960s. The magazine was renamed *Black World* Wolsely, Roland. (1990). *The Black Press, U.S.A.* (2nd ed.).

in 1970, but it never achieved the consistently high Ames: Iowa State University Press. Wolsely's book con-circulation numbers of what became the company's tains two chapters on black-owned magazines and features flagship publication, *Ebony*.

an introduction by John H. Johnson.

Frazier, E. Franklin. (1965). *The Black Bourgeoisie*. Glencoe, *Ebony* was first published in 1947 and was mod-IL: Free Press. This book contains a harsh critique of eled on *Life* magazine. At first, Johnson had a hard middle-class-oriented black publications in Part VII, "The time convincing major advertisers that such a maga-Negro Press and Wish Fulfillment."

zine would sell, but with an initial advertising contract with Zenith, the magazine was launched. Featuring glossy pictures, advertising for consumer goods, and features on famous African Americans, *Ebony* and *Jet*
JOINT CENTER FOR POLITICAL

have drawn criticism for being focused on celebrity, material gain, and the dream of middle-class status.

AND ECONOMIC STUDIES

Following the lead of E. Franklin Frazier in critiquing black newspapers, some scholars and activists believe The Joint Center for Political and Economic Studies that magazines like *Ebony* present unrealistic ideals (JCPES) is a national public policy institute that of a wealthy, leisurely lifestyle at the expense of conducts research on the political and socioeconomic

Joint Center for Political and Economic Studies———285

plight of African Americans and their communities.

of public hospitals, black trends in Medicaid and Founded in 1970, their mission is “to improve the managed care use, and HIV/AIDS data on African socio-economic status of African Americans, increase people (both in America and in Africa).

their political participation and build constructive Finally, JCPES has an International Affairs relationships across racial and ethnic lines.” JCPES is component. Since the late 1980s, the organization has widely recognized as one of the nation’s leading think conducted research and analysis in southern Africa tanks, especially with regard to policy issues concern-

(primarily South Africa, Swaziland, and Zambia).

ing African Americans, and it also has an international The mission of the International Affairs division is focus on the political, socioeconomic, public health, to strengthen African democracy and governance, and educational conditions in the southern region of enhance African economic growth and productivity, Africa.

and include the voices of African Americans in the In the context of Black Studies, JCPES demon-formation and implementation of U.S. foreign policy.

strates the role that research plays in the public policy-The Joint Center has researched the HIV/AIDS epi-making process. Since its inception, the think tank has demic in South Africa and its socioeconomic impact, provided policy-relevant data and analyses to policy as well as the southern African political economy and makers, black public officials, community leaders, economic and educational advancement. In addition journalists, and scholars. Though its audience is wide, to research, JCPES has also engaged in capacity JCPES’s primary constituency has always been black building

in the region, provided election support, and elected officials. The research and data that is generated through gender-empowerment trainings.

ated from the Joint Center has ultimately enabled While conducting the research is the primary feedback policy makers with sound arguments and justice of the institute, dissemination of the research is a function to either support or oppose public policies a key element in fulfilling the organization's mission.

that impact African Americans.

The Joint Center issued its first publication, *Black Elected Officials: A National Roster*, in 1970. Since then, JCPES publications have grown in number and **FIVE RESEARCH AREAS OF JCPES**

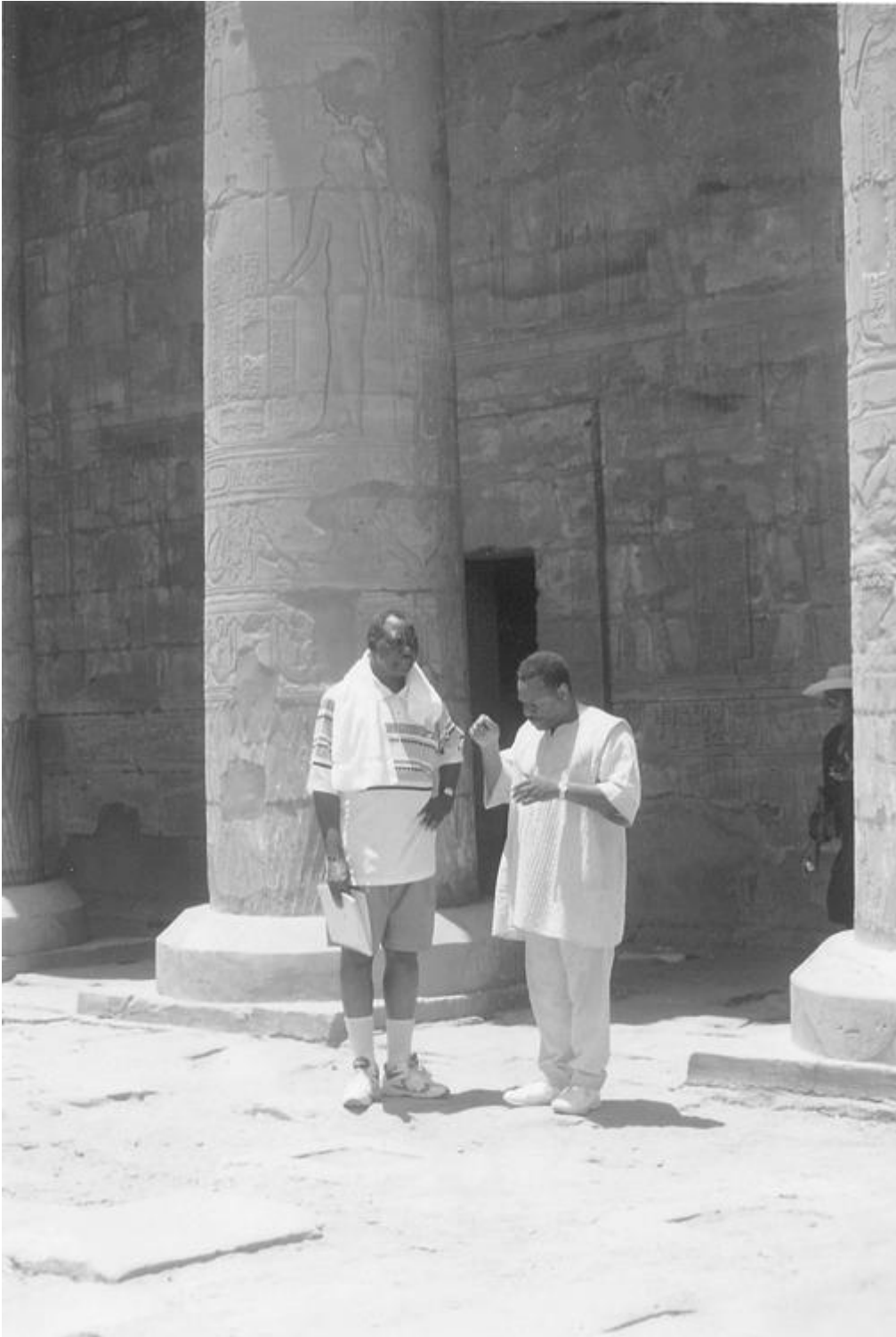
in scope. Recent publications include: *The Future of JCPES* has five main areas of research focus on *Urban Public Hospitals* (1998); *The Big Picture: African Americans: Economic Policy, Social Policy, Public Policy and Long-term Economic Outlook for Political Studies*, Health Policy, and International *African Americans* (2000); *Economic Impact of Affairs*. Within the area of Economic Policy, the Joint *HIV/AIDS on South Africa and Implications for Center* has conducted research and analyzed trends *Governance* (2000); *Welfare Reform, Devolution*, in job and labor markets, income differences between *and the Expansion of Charitable Choice* (2000); *The racial groups, the (in)effectiveness of affirmative Transformation of African American Policy Views* action, and data on the development of black-owned (2001); *From Talk to Action: An Online Community businesses*. JCPES has also disseminated valuable *Response to Racial Profiling* (2002); and *Building information on labor market education and training*.

Cultural Competence: A Tool Kit for Workforce In Social Policy, JCPES has produced research on *Development* (2003). The official public policy magazine; welfare reform and its effects on African Americans; and the perceptions, trends, and problems provides monthly coverage on a broad range of public of black youth; as well as a wealth of information on policy issues concerning African Americans.

the black family. The Political Studies area has focused on data concerning black elected officials; issues cen-PROJECTS AND INITIATIVES OF JCPES

tered around race, ethnicity, and governance; shifting partisanship and new coalitions; attitudes of black JCPES also has several programs and initiatives geared voters; black congressional districts; and planning for toward empowering various areas of the African urban revitalization and development. In the field American community. In economics, the organization of Health Policy, JCPES has made research contri-sponsors the Minority Business Roundtable (MBRT).

butions on the following: the connections between MBRT is a membership organization for CEOs of health care and the economic well-being of African large businesses owned by persons of color. It is Americans, barriers to health-care access, the future a vehicle for its members to collaborate, analyze



public policy issues, and help formulate effective public policies that affect businesspeople of color. The Black Leadership Information Exchange (BLIE) is another initiative of the Joint Center. BLIE is specifically geared toward black leaders (from both elected offices and community organizations) concerned with how public policy impacts the black community. This network is designed to provide members with information on numerous policy sectors. Finally, JCPES has a program called NABRE (or Network of Alliances Bridging Race and Ethnicity). NABRE is a national network of community-based organizations working to bridge racial and ethnic divisions.

— *Rico X*

FURTHER READING

Dawson, Michael. (2002). *Black Visions*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press. Dawson has done an exceptional job of identifying the political contours of the African American community.

www.jointcenter.org This is the Joint Center for Political and Economic Studies (JCPES) Web site.

www.nul.org This is the National Urban League Web site.

www.transafricaforum.org This is the TransAfrica Web site.

JOURNAL OF

AFRICAN CIVILIZATIONS

Professors Theophile Obenga and Molefi Kete Asante at the Sacred Temple of Heru in Edfu, Egypt, 1996.

The *Journal of African Civilizations* was founded in 1979 by historian, archeologist, linguist, and literary critic Ivan Van Sertima (b. 1935 in Guyana) and was such as Na'im Akbar and Asa Hilliard, as well as such immediately hailed by St. Claire Drake as "one of the varied voices as Charles Finch, Leonard

Jefferies, most important events in the development of research Rosalind Jefferies, Mamadou Chinyelu, and Cheikh and publication from the perspective of Pan-African Anta Diop. The *Journal of African Civilizations* was scholarship.” The journal has been a forum for posi-designed to correct the damage done by the myth-tive, proactive images of African genius and contribu-makers in the racist tradition. The journal therefore tion to world civilization. Using the monograph affirmed Africa’s significance in the history of world format, the *Journal of African Civilizations* has civilizations. In this regard, the journal is in the com-published the following volumes: Black Women in pany of *Journal of Black Studies*, *Western Journal of Antiquity* (Vol. VI, No. 1), Nile Valley Civilizations *Black Studies*, *Journal of Black Psychology*, and (Vol. VI, No. 2), Great Black Thinkers (Vol. VIII), *Imhotep*.

Golden Age of the Moors (Vol. XI), Egypt: Child of Africa (Vol. XX), and Great Black Leaders: Ancient

— Geoffrey “Jahwara” Giddings

and Modern (Vol. XIV).

Ivan Van Sertima’s book *They Came Before* **FURTHER READING**

Columbus exemplifies the sort of scholarship the jour-Drake, S. (1987). *Black Folk Here and There: An Essay in* nal has encouraged and inspired. In fact, the journal *History and Anthropology*. Los Angeles: UCLA Center for

J-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 287

***Journal of Negro History*———287**

Afro-American Studies. This is a comprehensive study of The *Journal of Black Studies* is published six times the African world by one of the major African American per year. It is open to a wide discourse on the nature scholars of the 20th century.

of Black Studies as a discipline, publishing articles
www.cwo.com/~lucumi/vansertima.html This Web site from various
perspectives and interests, while main- includes a very informative tribute to
Dr. Ivan Van Sertima taining a strong disciplinary focus on Africans every-
by Runoko Rashidi.

where as agents and subjects as opposed to victims, problems, and objects.

— *Cynthia Lehman*

JOURNAL OF BLACK STUDIES

FURTHER READING

The *Journal of Black Studies* was founded in 1968, at Asante, Molefi Kete,
and Karenga, Maulana. (Eds.). (2003).

the beginning of the Black Studies revolution, by two *Handbook of Black
Studies*. Thousand Oaks, CA: Sage.

former UCLA graduate students, Robert Singleton This is the first
comprehensive collection of works by key and Molefi Kete Asante (who
changed his name in Black Studies scholars, many of whom were chosen
1973 from Arthur L. Smith, Jr.). Singleton and Asante because of their work
in the *Journal of Black Studies*, the took their idea to the budding social
science publisher *Black Scholar*, or the *Western Journal of Black Studies*.

Mazama, Ama. (Ed.). (2002). *The Afrocentric Paradigm*.

Sara Miller, who was developing social science jour-Trenton, NJ: Africa
World Press. The editor of this volume nals at Sage Publications. Sage
agreed to publish the has collected the most important essays in the field of
journal and give editorial control to a board selected Black Studies in a
single volume. Several of the works by the founding editor, Molefi Kete
Asante.

included here were originally published in the *Journal of* Some of the
leading scholars in the African world *Black Studies*.

have served as referees and authors for the *Journal of Black Studies*. In the first issue, published in 1969, the monumental African scholar, Kofi Asare Opoku, wrote an article on the mind of Africa that was to set the tone

JOURNAL OF NEGRO HISTORY

for the succeeding volumes of the journal. Among the international group of scholars who have been involved Prior to the First World War, Africology, despite the with the journal are Boniface Obichere, Harold Cruse, impressive works of George Washington Williams, Gary Nash, Maulana Karenga, Marimba Ani, St. Clair W.E.B. Du Bois, and others, largely languished in the Drake, Martin Kilson, Cornel West, Kariamu Welsh, disrespect that racist scholars in the United States had Jan Carew, Gilbert Gwassa, Abdias do Nascimento, placed upon it. A major breakthrough in combating Hanes Walton, E. U. Essien-Udom, Robert Addo-this racially imposed exile occurred when the Harvard-Fenig, Ewart Guinier, Ronald Takaki, Price Cobbs, trained black scholar Carter G. Woodson met with a Irving Bernstein, Lee Rainwater, Charles Hamilton, group of his associates in Chicago in 1915 to found the Lerone Bennett, Clyde Taylor, Vincent Harding, Association for the Study of Negro (later African-Katherine Bankole, Mekada Graham, Clarence American) Life and History (ASNLH). Woodson and Munford, Ji Yuan, Tony Martin, Ama Mazama, Thomas his cohorts sought to counter prevailing notions that Kochman, FeFe Dunham, Ronald Walters, Keith Baird, Africans and people of African descent elsewhere had Atukwei Okai, and Dorthy Pennington.

no past that was worthy of serious scholarly study.

The *Journal of Black Studies* set the standard for They believed that a scientific presentation of the true Black Studies research from its beginning by develop-versions of the African and the African diasporan past ing a strong system of peer review, insuring that arti-would not only win respect for the race in academia cles are well edited, and securing editors who but also serve as an inducement to better race relations encourage the best minds to publish in the journal.

generally. They thought that such a presentation of the Indeed, it remains the most prestigious journal in its historical record of people of African

descent in the field. In 2003, the journal had a readership of more United States would raise the self-esteem of African than 3,500 in North America, Africa, South America, Americans as well. They knew that the achievement Europe, Asia, and Australia, and it has maintained a of this latter goal could have important cultural as well loyal subscription base over time.

as political and economic consequences.

J-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:00 PM Page 288

288——— *Journal of Negro History*

Within a few months after the founding of the essays began to appear in the early issues of the jour-ASNLH, Woodson moved ahead with the idea of nal, many by Euro-American scholars, the organ's disseminating studies of the black past as widely as favorable reputation was quickly established.

possible. Thus, on January 1, 1916, the first issue of After Woodson's death in 1950, several African the ASNLH's scholarly organ, *the Journal of Negro American* scholars who served as editors continued *History* (JNH), appeared. This revolutionary develop-the traditions that the founder had established and ment was made possible by Woodson's borrowing solidified the JNH's international reputation as the \$400 against his \$2,000 New England Mutual Life leading scholarly organ in Africology. Notable among Insurance policy to pay for the original printing costs.

these were Lorraine Williams, the first female editor, Woodson had wanted the inaugural issues of the JNH

and Alton Hornsby, Jr., the first editor based at a to be published by a black printer, but when black historically black undergraduate college.

printers' bids proved too high, he turned to the New The contributions of the JNH have been celebrated Era Printers of Lancaster, Pennsylvania, who, internationally—in 1991 in Washington, D.C., where the estingly and ironically, were also the publishers of the journal was cited as both a chronicler of history and leading historical journal by whites, the *American* a maker of history, and in 2001 in Atlanta, Georgia, *Historical Review*.

where scholars, including Molefi Asante, lauded the From this beginning, the journal was published journal as a foundation for Africana Studies. But quarterly, without missing an issue, until the 1980s.

ultimately the contributions of the JNH are not only in But the struggle to finance publication of the journal the pathbreaking studies it has published but also in plagued the ASNLH throughout Woodson's tenure the doors it has opened to black and white scholars, and continued to plague the ASNLH, and its succes-particularly junior professors and those on the Left; sor, the ASALH (Association for the Study of scholars at historically black colleges and universities; African-American Life and History) thereafter. These and women. Even in recent times, the JNH's major con-financial difficulties led to a brief suspension of tributors remain those who were exiled and dispos-publication in the early 1980s.

sessed by the academic mainstream.

While Woodson knew that the JNH might never

— *Alton Hornsby, Jr.*

be a financial success, he also knew that in order to achieve its larger objective of presenting a scholarly **FURTHER REFERENCES**

chronicle of the African and African diasporan experiences, particularly to skeptics in the "white world," he Asante, Molefi Kete. (2002). *African American History: A Journey of Liberation*. Saddle Creek, NJ: Peoples would have to establish and maintain the scholarly Publishing Group. This is one of the most recent works on integrity of the publication. Thus, he sought out some the history of the African American.

of the most prominent African American and Euro-Woodson, Carter G. (1933). *The Mis-education of the Negro*.

American scholars and named them to his editorial Washington, DC: Associated Publishers. This is the classic staff and editorial board. As impressive, research-based work by the founder of the *Journal of Negro History*.

K

playwrights. In the late 1920s, the Karamu House was **THE KARAMU HOUSE**

the only theatre producing plays written and performed by African Americans. The theatre group did not have The oldest existing African cultural institution in far to look for serious African American playwrights, America, the Karamu House, is located in the heart as it was around the corner from the childhood home of the African American community in Cleveland, of the future poet laureate Langston Hughes, who took Ohio. It was founded in 1915 by Russell and Rowena part in the early activities of the Karamu House.

Jelliffe and known as the Neighborhood Association Hughes was among the first children to participate in Settlement House until 1939, when it was renamed the arts program at the Karamu House, and he and the the Karamu House. *Karamu* is a Kiswahili word Jelliffes came to know each other well. When Hughes that means, among other things, “a place of joyful returned to Cleveland as an adult, their association meeting.” Since its inception, the Karamu House has enhanced his career as well as the reputation of the been committed to offering children the opportunity Karamu House. The years between 1936 and 1939

to engage with one another and participate in cultural came to be called the “Hughes era,” as the Gilpin performances enhancing experiences of their own Players performed six Hughes plays at the Karamu culture. One of the Karamu House’s most successful House: *Mulatto* (1935), *Troubled Island* (1936), *Little* activities has been its Children’s Theatre.

Ham (1937), *Soul Gone Home* (1937), *Don’t You Want* The success of its Children’s Theatre inspired the *to Be Free?* (1938), and *Front Porch* (1938).

Karamu House to create the Dumas Dramatic Club for Over the decades, the Karamu House has expanded, adults in 1920. Then, in 1922, a major dramatic actor and it now offers the community such programs as of the

time, Charles Gilpin, met with the group and children's storytelling; family activities; theatrical suggested that they take themselves seriously and productions on the main stage; improvisation sessions; make the Karamu House the best "Negro" theatre in costume and set design workshops; writing classes, the world. Gilpin began his career as a singer and including scriptwriting; speech and diction lessons; dancer in minstrel and vaudeville shows and then an after school cultural arts and education program; moved on to work in the legitimate theater. He is best classes in African drumming, African dance, tap, and known for his performance from 1920 to 1924 in modeling; and other cultural activities.

the title role in *Emperor Jones*, for which he won

— *Adisa Alkebulan*

the Drama League Award and the Springarn Medal (NAACP). He also was honored with being named *Crisis* magazine's Man of the Year in 1921.

FURTHER READING

The drama club accepted the challenge of this Karamu House. (1991). *75th Anniversary Souvenir Book*.

accomplished thespian and renamed themselves the Cleveland, OH: Author. This is both a historical analysis Gilpin Players. The Gilpin Players then sought real-life and a commemoration of one of the oldest African American dramas written by African American American cultural institutions.

289

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 290

290———**Kawaida**

Mitchell, Loftin. (1975). *Voices of the Black Theatre*. Clifton, a just and good society and a good and sustainable NJ: James T. White. This text identifies some of the world.

leading figures and major players in the creation and development of the Karamu House.

Selby, John. (1966). *Beyond Civil Rights*. Cleveland, OH:
INTELLECTUAL HERITAGE

World. This is one of the most comprehensive texts on the early history of the Karamu House.

To construct his system, Karenga borrowed from and Williams, Mance. (1985). *Black Theatre in the 1960s and builds on a wide range of continental and diasporic 1970s: A Historical-Critical Analysis of the Movement*.

African thinkers. Among the most significant thinkers Westport, CT: Greenwood Press. Williams provides invaluable concepts Karenga evolved, redeveloped, and able insights on the black theatre movement of the 1960s reshaped as essential elements in Kawaida philosophy and 1970s.

are Sekou Toure, Julius Nyerere, Kwame Nkrumah, W.E.B. Du Bois, Léopold Senghor, Malcolm X, Robert Williams, Frantz Fanon, Marcus Garvey, and later Amilcar Cabral. Kawaida incorporates all these
KAWAIDA

thinkers' emphasis on the centrality of culture and cultural revolution in the liberation struggle and the Kawaida is a communitarian African philosophy overall life of the people. Later, Kawaida incorporates developed by Maulana Karenga, an activist-scholar the womanist writings of Anna Julia Cooper; Mary and chair of the organization Us, one of the major McLeod Bethune's concept of the educated and black power organizations in the 1960s. The phi-socially conscious vanguard; Ida B. Wells's idea of the philosophy evolved in the context of the black freedom right and responsibility of self-defense; as well as movement, especially the black power period, thus it texts in the *Husia* and *Odu Ifa* that reflect its concern engages the movement's central themes of freedom, with an egalitarian complementarity and partnership justice, struggle, self-determination, unity, commu-of men and women in the ongoing project for human nity, black power and presence in the world, and espe-freedom and human flourishing.

cially the role and relevance of culture in the life and struggle of African people. *Kawaida* is a Swahili word **FOCUS ON CULTURE AND COMMUNITY**

that means “tradition,” but the term has come to mean a synthesis of tradition and reason informed by and As a self-consciously cultural and communitarian developed in practice. Indeed, the focus on tradition is philosophy and practice, Kawaida focuses on culture a recognition and reaffirmation of the essentiality of and community as the twin pillars of its intellectual culture, the central idea in Kawaida philosophy, while and practical foundation, framework, and focus.

the attention to reason is a necessary mode of measur-Here Kawaida draws heavily on Toure’s concept of ing the desirability and acceptability of an element in full re-Africanization, the self-conscious thrust to tradition and in Kawaida itself.

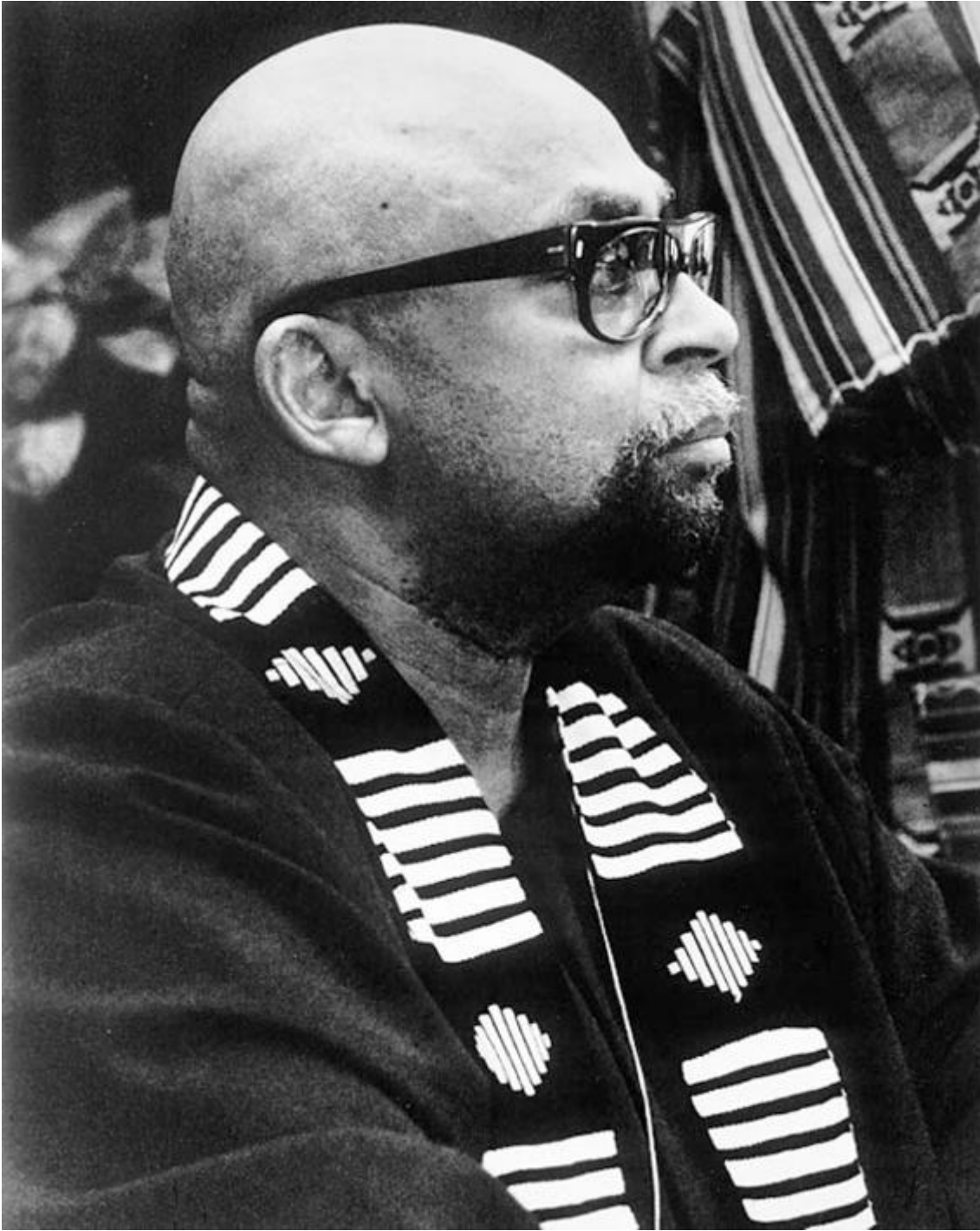
“recreate, create, and circulate” African culture—on the Practice, then, is the necessary test of both tradi-continent and in the diaspora, ancient and modern—

tion and reason. Thus, Karenga—currently a profes-and use it to constantly bring forth the best of what it sor of Black Studies at California State University, means to be African. This re-Africanization supports Long Beach, and still the chair of Us and the chair of and advances the liberation struggle and improves and the National Association of Kawaida Organizations enriches the present and future. As Karenga put it, (NAKO)—understands Kawaida as an open-textured

“Culture provides the basis for revolution and recov-and continually developing project. In Karenga’s ery.” In fact, people’s recovery of their Africanness words, Kawaida is an “ongoing synthesis of the best in the fullest and most progressive sense aids and of African thought and practice in constant exchange insures revolutionary practice. Thus, at the heart of the with the world.” Moreover, Kawaida is a cultural and Kawaida project is the thrust to inspire, inform, and social change philosophy that has as its central aims sustain cultural revolution and national or communal developing a logic and language of liberation, con-liberation, as well as new

paradigms of being African stantly linking theory and practice, empowering and human in the world.

people to change the quality and conditions of their Kawaïda argues that African Americans are above all lives, and making a contribution to the creation of a cultural community, a cultural nation. And Africans'



K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 291

Kawaida———291

struggle for liberation is first and at its foundation problem of liberation. Kawaïda maintains that without a struggle to free themselves culturally in the fullest a cultural revolution, there can be no real liberation of sense. Toure and Fanon had argued a similar concept—the people. But following Frantz Fanon, it argues that, and Amílcar Cabral in *Return to the Source* pro- without the struggle for total liberation, a dynamic, provides a reaffirmation and expansion of this concept, self-affirming, self-developing, past-and-future-facing which is so central to Kawaïda. Kawaïda defines *culture cannot be created. Moreover, following Amílcar Cabral, Kawaïda contends that, in fact, the struggle for people creates itself; celebrates, sustains, and develops national existence as a people is a cultural struggle and itself; and introduces itself to history and humanity.*

the struggle to defend, maintain, and develop African This occurs in at least the following seven basic areas: culture is in the final analysis a struggle for national ethics and spirituality or religion; history; social organization (i.e., the right and responsibility of Africans to exist as a people, to speak their own special truth to the world and make their own unique contribution to dance); and ethos—the collective psychology shaped the forward flow of human history).

by activities in the other six areas. It is in the context This concern for and understanding of the relation-of culture that people engage in the search for models ship between culture, community, and liberation of excellence and paradigms of possibilities in every struggle is at the heart of Kawaïda's cultural national-aspect of their lives and over time. Moreover, Kawaïda ism. And Kawaïda rejects what it calls the “theoretical philosophy involves creating a language and logic of clumsiness” of those who make a distinction between liberation, one of both opposition and affirmation and cultural nationalism and so-called revolutionary a corresponding liberational practice directed toward nationalism. For in Kawaïda philosophy, there are creating a just and good society and a good and sustainable world. At the same time, the philosophy poses focus—political, religious, economic, and cultural.

a paradigm of mutually beneficial human relations and Terms like progressive, reactionary, reformist, and cooperation for the common good.

revolutionary speak to an assumed quality of social In Kawaïda, the problem of unfreedom is first a practice and may apply to political, religious, economic, problem of cultural hegemony by the dominant or cultural thought and practice. So-called revolution-society. For the dominant society rules not simply any nationalists are thus confusing areas of social by force of arms but also by force of ideas, that is, focus with qualities of social practice. And, further-by an established definition of reality that even the more, they have given themselves and their allies oppressed often accept. For the oppressed, a key challenge-self-congratulatory titles without defining revolutionary struggle is to wage cultural revolution to break this hold and to pose, pursue, and flourish with a new paradigm of society and what it means to be African and human and to struggle for freedom. Thus, cultural struggle or revolution is essential to the preparation and process of any other struggle or revolution. Karenga defines cultural revolution as "the ideological and practical struggle to rescue and reconstruct African culture, break the cultural hegemony of the oppressor over the people, transform persons so that they become self-conscious agents of their own liberation, and aid in the preparation and support of the larger struggle for liberation and a higher level of human life." Thus, the cultural revolution is tied to and part of all forms of struggle for liberation, especially the political and economic ones.

The problem of liberation of the national community or nation, then, is understood in Kawaïda as a problem of culture and the problem of culture is a Dr. Maulana Karenga, philosopher and scholar

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 292

292——Kawaïda

or even nationalism, which is thought and practice directed toward creating a just and good society and dedicated to the defense and development of a people posing an effective paradigm of mutually beneficial with a common history, culture, life conditions, and human relations and human possibility.

self-understanding—a nation.

*In Kawaida philosophy, culture is understood as a **RECONSTRUCTION***

uniquely human way of being in the world, and each culture is considered equal in value to every other culture. In the area of history, Kawaida begins with a self-ture. Thus, each people has the right and responsibility conscious emphasis on the principle of recovery and to speak its own special cultural truth and make its own reconstruction of African culture. This return to unique contribution to the forward flow of human African history, Kawaida stipulates, is necessary first history. Thus African people are called to express and because colonialism and enslavement lifted Africans share their culture as both a requirement of their strug-out of their own history and made them a footnote and gle and an indispensable method of enriching and forgotten casualty in European history; and second, expanding their lives. Within this overarching frame-as a matter of agency, as Africans must return to their work, culture is the fundamental context within which history and culture so they may ground themselves, people understand and assert themselves, as well as and thus pursue projects in their own image and inter-the fundamental source of their identity, purpose, ests. In this s ankofa initiative, Kawaida emphasizes the and direction. Therefore, African self-understanding recovery of models of excellence and possibility from shapes African self-assertion in the world, and it is ancient and recent African history and culture and their essential that this self-understanding and self-assertion use to improve the present and enhance the future.

be founded on the best of African thought and practice In the areas of ethics and spirituality, Kawaida in constant exchange with the world.

*builds especially on the legacy of the Maatian (ancient Egyptian) and Ifa (Yoruba) ethical and spiritual traditions. It stresses five fundamental ancient and ongoing **DIALOGUE WITH CULTURE***

African concerns and commitments: profound appre-Here Kawaida calls for and poses its own project as a ciation for the transcendent and sacred; the dignity continuous dialogue with African culture. To dialogue and rights of the human person; the well-being and with African culture is to ask it

questions and seek flourishing of family and community; the integrity from it answers to the fundamental and enduring and value of the environment; and the reciprocal concerns of the African and human community. These solidarity and cooperation of humanity for mutual include questions of identity, purpose and direction, benefit. Inherent in this ethical project is the central meaning and mission in human life, the grounds for Maatian idea of *serudj ta*, the moral obligation to a just and good society, our obligations to others, a constantly repair, heal, and restore the world making framework for a rightful relationship with the envi-it more beautiful and beneficial than before. This ronment, and the basis of human freedom and human central idea is interrelated with and reinforces the flourishing and its role in the liberation struggle itself.

Ifa concept that humans are divinely chosen to bring Again, at the heart of this conversation with African good into the world and that this is the fundamental culture is the continuing quest to define and become mission and meaning of human life.

the best of what it means to be African and human in In the area of social organization, Kawaida the fullest sense.

concerns itself with the central question of quality This involves an ongoing search for models of relations, as well as the principles and practices that excellence and paradigms of possibilities in every area cultivate these and reflect the best of African culture.

of human life, but especially in the fundamental seven Key to this concern is the embrace and practice of the areas of culture: history, ethics and spirituality or *Nguzo Saba* (Seven Principles), which are standards religion, social organization, economic organization, of personal and social excellence directed toward political organization, creative production (e.g., art, building and sustaining moral community and rein-music, literature, dance), and ethos. Moreover, fol-forcing the community's capacity to define, defend, lowing Malcolm X, it involves creating a language and develop its interest in the most positive and pro-and logic of liberation, one of both opposition and ductive sense. These principles are *Umoja* (Unity); affirmation and a corresponding liberational practice *Kujichagulia* (Self-Determination); *Ujima* (Collective

Kawaida——293

Work and Responsibility); Ujamaa (Cooperative free themselves, start a new history of humankind, and Economics); Nia (Purpose); Kuumba (Creativity); and pose a new paradigm of how humans ought to relate Imani (Faith).

and live. Following Kwame Nkrumah, Frantz Fanon, In addition, Kawaida has expanded to include a and others, Kawaida also places emphasis on the self-conscious concern with the issues of the quality of political education and organization of the masses in male-female relations and the development of a wom-order to make them self-conscious agents of their own anist thrust within the Kawaida project, incorporating life and liberation. Kawaida also borrows from and the thoughts of Maria Stewart and Ana Julia Cooper, builds on Sekou Toure's and Frederick Douglass's as well as the stress of the ancient African sacred texts, understanding of the indispensability and enduring the Husia and Odu Ifa, on the indispensability and equal character of struggle to expand the realm of human status, presence, and power of women in all things good freedom and human flourishing.

and of value. Under the initiative of Tiamoyo Karenga and Chimbuko Tembo, and through the internal dis-ECONOMIC DISCOURSE

cussions of the women and men in the organization Us, Kawaida womanism has emerged as a constitutive The central category in Kawaida economic discourse is element of Kawaida philosophy. Kawaida womanism Ujamaa (cooperative economics), an African concept of defines itself as thought and practice directed toward shared work and wealth introduced by Julius Nyerere, enabling African women to achieve equality with and which also means African socialism. The root of the African men in personal and public relations and in the word ujamaa is jamaa, meaning "family," which sug-context of a free and equal black community. Kawaida gests kinship as the basis of the production, distribution, has several defining commitments and practices with and consumption of goods. In the Kawaida African respect to this project: cultural grounding, ethical framework, this kinship

extends to nature and every-grounding, self-definition, the partnership of women thing and everyone in it, and thus supports an economic and men, rootedness in family, rootedness in commu-ethic that demonstrates a profound respect for the nity, service, and social action and struggle.

integrity and value of the environment and approaches the world as a shared heritage not to be monopolized or privatized by a few. Thus, it also resists economic and **PAN-AFRICAN TRADITION**

other practices that promote the plunder, pollution, and Although the Kawaïda approach to politics recognizes depletion of the earth. Moreover, Ujamaa as the princi-the practice, as it is commonly understood, to be a ple and practice of shared work and wealth seeks to process of gaining, maintaining, and using power; it encourage a just and equitable distribution of resources also expands its meaning. In this expanded definition, of the world to enable everyone to live a life of dignity politics is, in the ancient Egyptian tradition of gover-and decency. It also supports the rights and interests of nance, an ongoing quest to create the Maatian society workers, care for the vulnerable, and the historical and and world—or in modern terms, a just and good ongoing effort to aid the poor in their struggle to end society and a good and sustainable world. In the poverty and live full and meaningful lives.

pan-Africanist tradition of Marcus Garvey, Kawaïda stresses its central concern for Africans everywhere **INFLUENCE ON THE BLACK ARTS MOVEMENT**

and the unity and common struggle for freedom, self-determination, power over individual and collective One of Kawaïda's most significant areas of influence destiny and daily life, and meaningful and effective in the 1960s was the black arts movement and its participation in all decisions that affect African people contribution to the discourse on a black aesthetic.

in significant ways. Here Kawaïda focuses on the In his influential article, "Black Art: Mute Matter interrelatedness of freedom, justice, power of people Given Force and Feeling," which appears in The over their destinies and daily lives, and peace in the Norton Anthology of African American Literature, world. It argues that the struggles for these and other

Karenga outlines aspects of the Kawaïda aesthetic. He essential goods are the motive force of history. And in argues that art in the African tradition supported by the tradition of Malcolm X and his model of Bandung, Kawaïda is never art for art's sake but always art Kawaïda argues also for the unity and common struggle for humans' sake. Building on Léopold Senghor's for people of color and other progressive people to writings, he contends that art must have three basic

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 294

294——Kawaïda

characteristics—it must be functional, collective, and the Kawaïda Institute of Pan-African Studies committing. It must be functional—of use and value (KIPAS); and the international impact of his ideas—

of the people; collective—rooted in and reflective of especially through the pan-African holiday of the beauty and good of the people; and committing
—

Kwanzaa and its Seven Principles, the Nguzo Saba, directed toward an emancipating and enhanced sense which are grounded in and grow out of Kawaïda phi-of humanity and human possibility, especially in the losophy—Kawaïda has become an influential founda-context of the struggle for human freedom and tion and framework for black intellectual discourse flourishing.

and social practice. Its influence is evident in the In addition, Kawaïda argues that the ethos of a black arts movement and the discourse on the black people is its self-understanding derived from its self-aesthetic; in Black Studies, where Karenga's book, assertion in the world in the other six areas of culture.

Introduction to Black Studies, is the most widely used Furthermore, it contends that there are three modal introductory text in the discipline; and in the black periods in African history that have shaped the lives power movement and its major conferences, where of Africans and thus informed their self-conception: Karenga was the major theorist. It was in the context

The classical period in the Nile Valley civilizations, of the black power movement that he developed the especially Egypt; the holocaust of enslavement; and the concept of operational unity and a definition of black reaffirmation that occurred in the 1960s (i.e., the reaf-power and the collective struggle for self-determina-firmation of their Africanness and social justice tradition (cultural, political, and economic), self-respect tion). Thus, Africans are the Fathers and Mothers of (reaffirmation of dignity), and self-defense (protection humanity and human civilization, the sons and daugh-of black life and achievement of freedom by any ters of the Holocaust of enslavement and the authors means necessary, including armed defense).

and heirs of the reaffirmation of the 60s. Each context In addition, Kawaida also is evident in the dis-reveals not only an identity but an obligation of contin-course and documents in the Black Student Union ued practice, so that the people may know and intro-movement, the rites of passage movement, African duce themselves to history and humanity in ways that life-cycle ceremonies, and naming practices in the represent the best of what it means to be African and spread of the model of Us organization's youth move-human in the fullest sense. Thus, the classical period ment, the Simba Wachanga (Young Lions). A signifi-presents a paradigm of spiritual and ethical grounding cant voice in the 1960s discourse on the relevance and and intellectual achievement; the holocaust of enslave-role of religion and the need for an African-rooted ment presents a model of human durability and adap-sacred literature and theology, Kawaida continues to tive vitality, as well as an unquenchable commitment to offer new insights into African ethical and spiritual human freedom and human dignity; and the reaffirma-tradition with Karenga's translation of and commen-tion that occurred in the 1960s presents a model of and taries on the Husia, the sacred text of ancient Egypt, profound commitment to African cultural integrity, the and the Odu Ifa, the sacred text of ancient Yorubaland.

ancient and ongoing African social justice tradition, Moreover, Kawaida and the Nguzo Saba have had an and the parallel struggle for human freedom and human impact on the international black community and are flourishing. To this is added the ancient conception of being used by groups as diverse as the black con-humans in the Ifa tradition as chosen ones,

divinely sciousness movement, the student union in South chosen to bring good into the world and not let any Africa in their mission statements, and churches in good be lost. In Kawaïda philosophy, this therefore Trinidad, in addition to being used widely as a cultural becomes the fundamental mission and meaning of and philosophical framework.

human life and the transcendent way Africans under-Recently Kawaïda was evident in the Million Man stand themselves within their cultural context.

March in Karenga's "Day of Absence Mission Statement" and "Ethics of Sharing" policy, which defined the meaning and goals of the march.

Kawaïda is also present in the reparations movement—especially in its

BROAD INFLUENCE OF KAWAIDA

discourse around the ethics of reparations and the use Through Karenga's lectures and writings; his activist-of the ancient Egyptian concept of serudj ta, meaning intellectual works with his organization Us, NAKO

to repair and restore the world, as a central way to (National Association of Kawaïda Organizations) and understand the project. Kawaïda and Us also have

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 295

Kemet, Afrocentricity and Knowledge———295

made a well-known contribution to the founding of earliest African responses to the moral and cultural questions the classical African studies movement, with its confronting humans, provides a thorough discussion of the special focus on the study of ancient Egypt (Maat) and philosophical and ethical bases for the reconstructive functions of Kawaïda.

ancient Yoruba (Ifa) and the framing of its discourse.

Us initiated and hosted the first annual Ancient Egyptian Studies Conference in 1984, which was the occasion of the founding of the Association for the

KEMET, AFROCENTRICITY

Study of Classical African Civilizations (ASCAC) and the release of Karenga's Selections From the Husia:

AND KNOWLEDGE

Sacred Wisdom of Ancient Egypt, which offered a framework for both discourse and research on the Kemet, Afrocentricity and Knowledge is the third Maatian moral and spiritual imagination. Likewise, of Molefi Kete Asante's three books explicating in 1999, Us held the International Conference of his theoretical ideas on Afrocentricity. Asante's first Yoruba Culture and Ethics, where Karenga's newly groundbreaking text, Afrocentricity: A Theory of released translation of the Odu Ifa: The Ethical Social Knowledge (1980), points toward a new para-Teachings also became a model and framework for digm of knowledge and social theory. His next book, discourse and research in this area of inquiry and The Afrocentric Idea (1987), outlines the dimensions practice. In addition, the Nguzo Saba and concepts of the Afrocentric project. In Kemet, Afrocentricity and of Kawaida are used as an African-centered value Knowledge (1990), Asante not only reasserts the per-orientation and vision grounding in various cultural, spective that Africans ought to be viewed as subjects educational, political, economic, and religious pro-and agents acting in their own image and interest, but jects, including student retention in schools, psycho-he continues his critique of the Eurocentric construc-logical counseling, and political caucuses.

tions of history, race, and culture, especially where The essential texts by Karenga, which offer critical they intersect. What is missing in this book, however, treatment and expression of Kawaida philosophy, are is the strong gender analysis that Asante undertakes *The Quotable Karenga* (1967); *Essays on Struggle*: elsewhere in various articles and book chapters.

Position and Analysis (1978), a collection of essays Asante strategically divides *Kemet, Afrocentricity* that originally appeared in the *Black Scholar*; *Kawaida and Knowledge* into three sections—interiors, anteri-Theory: An Introductory Outline (1980); and ors, and exteriors—each with a different set of themes *Kawaida: A Communitarian African Philosophy* and

problematics. Informed by a Diopian perspective, (2000); as well as *Selections From the Husia: Sacred* Asante scrutinizes the problematic assumptions, four-Wisdom of Ancient Egypt (1984); *Odu Ifa: The Ethical* dation, core, and contours of disciplines other than *Teachings* (1999); and his magnum opus, *Maat, the Black Studies* that claim to study African people and *Moral Ideal in Ancient Egypt: A Study in Classical* those who have taken up the question of Africa.

African Ethics (2004), which originated in his second Moreover, he asserts the significance of an African doctoral dissertation. As the texts demonstrate, the understanding of human relationship as fundamental Kawaida philosophy initially focused on race, commu-to revising the text for human interaction, while at the nity, and culture, and later expanded to include con-same time always challenging Europe to forgo hege-cerns for other critical issues—such as class, gender, mony for a view of sharing the world on equal footing environmental justice, multiculturalism, and ethics

with a plurality of perspectives. Most important, in without abandoning its original and central concerns.

this text Asante builds on his work in *The Afrocentric Idea*, introducing a new element—the Afrocentric

— *Maulana Karenga*

paradigm.

See also Us

AFRICAN INTERIORS

FURTHER READING

The concept of interior is linked to that of place, Karenga, Maulana. (2004). *Maat, the Moral Ideal in Ancient* which refers to a person's location in time and space, *Egypt: A Study in Classical African Ethics*. New York: no matter

where that person is. The idea of place, as Routledge. This book, which is an investigation into the Asante sees it, is fundamental to any intellectual

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 296

296——— *Kemet, Afrocentricity and Knowledge*

pursuit, as a person always begins speaking from self-conscious, placing events in relation to African some psychological, cultural, economic, social, or history and culture while constantly asking the ques-moral place. This person is not without a location, and tion, What else do I need to do to center this on African therefore any discourse on intellectual issues is a state-terms? There are three areas within Africology that ment of the speaker's place. A corollary idea Asante Asante identifies for the examination of phenomena: sets forth is the idea of centeredness. The centrality of cultural/aesthetic, social/behavioral, and policy issues.

African ideals takes a presumptive position over the In addition, Asante delineates the following three form or constitution of African ideals. In this context, important functions of Africologists' research in the Asante explores the idea of place as location, chal-context of the Afrocentric paradigm: lenging Afrocentric researchers to locate and root themselves in African ideas and values while daring to 1. to logically explain African experiences establish the perspective as a legitimate response to 2. to develop holistic approaches to analyzing the the human condition. Asante's definition of location role of Africans in world culture

involves the purposive placement of a person's self or 3. to explain, interpret, and analyze African behav-position rather than the mere factor of place as a neu-ior from an Afrocentric perspective

tral idea. Thus, a person has to have a place, but that person can definitely choose a location, that is, choose **AFRICAN ANTERIORS**

to be located in some place. For Asante, the advantage of the Afrocentric perspective is that it gives scholars Kemet, or ancient Egypt, is a fitting starting point for an intellectual tradition other than that of the Greeks addressing African culture in its classical form. Asante to root themselves

in, which may lead to new kinds of underscores the legitimacy of Kemetic high culture as valid knowledge.

the proper source of many African knowledge systems Asante also undertakes an analysis of what may be in the section of the book called Anteriors. His study called the European study of Africa. He concludes that of classical African societies involves a process he char-African Studies demonstrates that where neither race acterizes as reconfirming and delinking. Asante uses nor biology is problematic, perspective on data may historical data in reconfirming Kemet not only as an be. African Studies rarely employs an African method-anterior African society and as interior within Africa but ology or philosophical outlook. In fact, historically, also as undeniable, based on the abundant documenta-it tends to atomize African people. In contrast, Asante tion of its history. He also dispels much unscientific mis-positis Africology to counter the Eurocentric pers-information on Kemet by delinking Eurocentric pective represented in that discipline. Africology, he dating schemes and chronology from it and offering explains, is not merely a collection of courses on an alternative chronology.

African subjects but a methodological discipline with For Asante, Kemet is the beginning point for any a definite African location. It unifies the concerns of real discussion about Africa, as well as a rich resource social science with those of the humanities using a of ideals and concepts that can provide the basis methodology rooted in Afrocentricity. Also important for new Afrocentric theories on phenomena. Thus he is the fact that it presupposes that science is an attitude restores Kemet to its rightful place by exposing the toward imagination and creation, not simply a series of misconstruction of Kemet as an oriental culture by methodical steps.

early Egyptologists. By scrutinizing most of the essential texts written on classical Africa by Europeans and Eurocentric scholars, Asante reveals that Europeans **The Afrocentric Paradigm**

had no real interest in linking Africa to Kemet, nor The Afrocentric paradigm is concerned with cos-did they see African societies as interconnected and mological, epistemological, axiological, and aesthetic interrelated. On this account, he proffers a Diopian problematics and issues.

It gives researchers functional orientation to replace the European perspective in traditional, categorical, and etymological approaches to order to draw different interpretations and conclusions knowledge construction, offering a resource of questions than the traditional European ones that always cast questions and concepts that distinguishes Africology from Africa and Africans in the most negative light.

disciplines such as history, psychology, and sociology.

Perhaps because of his training in languages and This framework compels the Africologist to remain communication, Asante offers a more comprehensive

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 297

Kiswahili Movement———297

discussion than Diop did of the importance of addresses a reoccurring theme throughout the text: language in reorienting the images, ideas, and inter-knowledge. Asante sums up this topic with the resolutions of the African world. Therefore, language function that the approach to human knowledge in the in its oral script and its polysemic symbolic form Afrocentric project cannot end in critique but must become another topic of his section on anteniors.

end in concrete action that leads to harmony, under-Asante addresses the interrelatedness of the rhetoric standing, justice, and, in a word, Maat.

and the power of Maat to the creation of the good

— *Khonsura J. Wilson*

society, resolving that the rightness of speech depends on a person's ability to maintain a correspondence of **FURTHER READING**

heart and tongue. Maat, for Asante, not only is the foundation for African society but also becomes a Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). The Future of African American method of textual analysis that incorporates unity,

Rhetoric. In Ronald Jackson and Elaine Richardson (Eds.), *elimination of chaos, elevation of peace, and the cre-Understanding African American Rhetoric: Classical Origins to Contemporary Innovations*.

New York:

ation of harmony and balance.

Routledge. In this essay, Asante argues for an Afrocentric perspective on the future of African cultural expression.

AFRICAN EXTERIORS

Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). L'idéologie de la supériorité raciale comme fondement de la déportation d'Africains The final section of *Kemet, Afrocentricity and* par les Européens. In Isabel Castro Henriques and Louis Knowledge addresses six topics relating to being exte-Sala-Molins, *Déraison, esclavage, et droit: Les fondements rior or viewing one's self as exterior to Africa: Carter idéologiques et juridiques de la traite Négrière et de l'esclavage*. Paris: Editions UNESCO. This is an applica-G. Woodson's notion of miseducation; Ralph Ellison's tion of the principles outlined in *Kemet, Afrocentricity and Invisible Man*; Marxism; psychology; sociobiology; *Knowledge* to the historical problem of the enslavement of and the last but most important and reoccurring topic, Africans.

knowledge.

Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). Racism, Consciousness, and Asante recognizes the timelessness and relevance Afrocentricity. In William Banks (Ed.), *The Anthology of* of Woodson's assertion that Western education does *African American Social and Political Thought*. New York: more damage to the psyche of African people than Oxford University Press. This is a restatement of the cen-good. Asante notes that this indictment of education tral idea in *Kemet, Afrocentricity and Knowledge*, in the sense that Asante is concerned with the relationship also applies to historically black colleges, whose between culture and consciousness in the African person.

educational framework reflects the orientation of the dominant culture. Next, Asante demonstrates how the theme of miseducation became the theme of Ellison's *Invisible Man*. He ultimately concludes that Ellison is **KISWAHILI MOVEMENT**

himself a victim of dislocation and that his book was written not for African descendants but for Europeans. In Africa, Kiswahili is widely spoken in Tanzania, so that they can see the so-called invisibility of the Kenya, Democratic Republic of Congo, Uganda, African.

Burundi, Rwanda, and the islands of Zanzibar, Asante then revisits Marxism and argues that Karl Madagascar, and the Comoros. Prior to the colonial Marx was unable to understand the interrelatedness of era, before European nations carved up Africa among culture and economics, and that this misunderstanding themselves at the Berlin Conference near the end of of the context of African economic systems caused the 19th century, European missionaries learned Marx to assign them the lowest step in his hierarchy.

African languages for the purpose of converting He also notes the inadequacy of Western psychology Africans to Christianity or for "spreading the gospel."

to deal with problems of race and racism in the minds In East Africa, Kiswahili was widely used for mar-and imaginations of white and black people. With itime trade dating back hundreds of years. As a result sociobiology, Asante expresses concern not with the of this trade along the coast of East Africa, the total data generated, as he recognizes some legitimacy in number of Kiswahili speakers far exceeded the the nexus of social construction and biology, but with number of native speakers of Kiswahili. Therefore, the misconstruction and appropriation of theory for Kiswahili was a logical choice for the European mis-social or political engineering purposes. Finally, he sionaries. After learning Kiswahili, the missionaries

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 298

transcribed Kiswahili according to the Latin script and began advocating the use of Kiswahili as a pan-African language. In 1966, activist Maulana Karenga created Kiswahili grammar books, dictionaries, and other books in the African holiday Kwanzaa and its accompanying language. The missionaries also helped spread principles, the Nguzo Saba, using Kiswahili words.

Kiswahili to other African ethnic groups that they Every year, Kwanzaa is celebrated by millions of were attempting to convert.

Africans all over the world. In 1977, the Kiswahili The missionaries' work assisted the colonial admin-movement continued at the Second World Black and istrators, who followed the missionaries in forming poli-African Festival of Arts and Culture (FESTAC) held in cies with regard to language: During the colonial era, Lagos, Nigeria. Heading the African American delega-German and British colonial language policies specified tion, the Us organization, led by Karenga, promoted the use of Kiswahili in the lower levels of administration the adoption of Kiswahili by Africans everywhere.

and education. The introduction of Kiswahili in colonial Karenga and others believe that Kiswahili is a logical and missionary schools contributed to the spread of choice for a pan-African language because it is not Kiswahili. Some believe that the German language attached to a large ethnic group and is similar in struc-policy, which strongly supported the use of Kiswahili, ture to many other African languages, and not a tonal led to the expansion and eventual adoption of Kiswahili language, making it easier to learn. By the beginning as a national language in former colonies.

of the 21st century, Kiswahili was the first choice of language instructors in Afrocentric schools, suggesting that a new generation of youth will be exposed **THE NATIONAL LANGUAGE OF TANZANIA** to the popular language.

In 1962, Julius Nyerere, president of the newly inde-

— *Adisa A. Alkebulan*

pendent Republic of Tanganyika (later named the United Republic of Tanzania), delivered his Republic Day speech in Kiswahili. He then declared Kiswahili **FURTHER READING**

the national language. Kiswahili would be used in all Mazrui, Alamin M., and Shariff, Ibrahim Noor. (1994). *The spheres of educational, economic, and political activ-Swahili: Idiom and Identity of an African People*. Trenton, ities. In 1967, Kiswahili was declared the official lan-NJ: Africa World Press. The authors argue the importance guage and the policy of Ujamaa was adopted, which, of Kiswahili from an African cultural perspective.

in part, maintained that the resurgence of Africa and Nurse, Derek, and Spears, Thomas. (1985). *The Swahili: her people must be rooted in the values and traditions Reconstructing the History and Language of an African of African people*. Kiswahili was to be used as the sole *Society, 800–1500*. Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Press. This text documents the early history of the language language of instruction in primary schools, and most and its African roots.

government documents, forms, labels, and so on were Roy-Campbell, Zaline Makini. (2001). *Empowerment to be translated into Kiswahili*. There were several gov-Through Language: The African Experience: Tanzania and ernmental agencies created to implement Tanzania's *Beyond*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. In this book, new language policy. Tanzania became the lone model Roy-Campbell discusses the significance of Kiswahili as a for instituting African language policy in newly inde-pan-African language.

pendent African nations, while the rest of the former colonies were maintaining European colonial language policies. In fact, a significant debate rages in Tanzania today, which is echoed throughout Africa, between **KU KLUX KLAN**

advocates of colonial languages and advocates of African languages. As a result, many of the policies The Ku Klux Klan (KKK) is a white supremacist implemented by Nyerere have since been modified

organization created to harass, intimidate, and murder and English has been accommodated.

black men and women in order to maintain white power. The Klan has historically targeted blacks who were willing to stand up for their rights, such **THE INTERNATIONAL LANGUAGE OF AFRICA** as those who expressed their desire to vote and to In the mid-1960s, some African scholars, notably achieve legal equality. After 244 years of slavery, the Kenyans Ayi Kwei Armah and Ngugi Wa Thiong'o, Civil War, backed by the Thirteenth Amendment to

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 299

Ku Klux Klan———299

the Constitution, ended the nightmare for millions of disinformation, believed themselves superior to and enslaved African descendants. After the war, Recon-more godlike than blacks. From 1890 to 1900, the struction, which lasted from 1865 to 1877, was a move white Southern leaders of the Klan looked away as to create a more inclusive democracy in the country by these misinformed, mostly poor and working-class bringing within the protection of the laws millions of Klan members used lynching as a means of racial con-newly liberated Africans. This protection was guaran-trol. Lynching was so prevalent across the South that teed through two constitutional amendments—the it was a “happening” to which people traveled from Fourteenth Amendment, which made Africans citizens, far and wide. In the decade from 1889 to 1899 alone, and the Fifteenth Amendment, which gave African the yearly average lynching rate (i.e., the number of males the right to vote. These social changes were not lynchings counted) was 188. There was then a lull in without some negative ramifications, however.

Klan activity, but although the political pressure from the African American community was vehement, the organization did not disappear altogether.

MURDER AND BRUTALIZATION

OF AFRICANS IN THE SOUTH

GEOGRAPHICAL EXPANSION

There were whites in the South who sought a return to the status quo that existed before the Civil War, in During the period of World War I and into the 1920s, which whites ruled over blacks. In 1865 and 1866, in the Klan appeared, not just in the South and border Pulaski, Tennessee, a core of these Southern whites, states but with *klaverns*, or chapters, that stretched veterans of the Confederate Army, formed what was from Maine to Oregon. The Klan became urban and initially thought to be a social club. They called it the very active in politics in key states, helping to elect Ku Klux Klan, a name partially derived from the one of its own, Earl Mayfield, to the U.S. Senate. In Greek word *kuklos* meaning “circle.” Their ultimate 1915, the Klan was given a boost nationwide with the goal was the overthrow of the liberal republican state release of the D. W. Griffith film *Birth of a Nation*, in governments. Between 1866 and 1875, under the which the organization is depicted as saving the South leadership of the Grand Wizard, Nathan Bedford and white womanhood. The film is believed to have Forrest, the Ku Klux Klan killed an estimated 3,500

contributed to the lynching of 76 African American African Americans and brutalized many more in the uniformed soldiers who fought in World War I as well areas where they were most active—the upland and as to the riots of the period in Atlanta, Georgia. The piedmont areas of the deep South and border states.

aura of white supremacy was the driving force behind By 1873, as a result of the federal Ku Klux Klan both the cross burning by the Invisible Empire of the Act, which allowed the president to suspend habeas Ku Klux Klan on Stone Mountain, Georgia, in 1915, corpus in order to protect the Fourteenth and Fifteenth and the blatant parade of robed Klansmen down Amendments to the Constitution, the Klan retreated to Pennsylvania Avenue in the nation’s capital in 1925.

watch the effects of its societal violence against what In the 1920s, the Klan’s membership was estimated to they called “black republicanism.” The effects were be between 3 and 5 million paid subscribers. Between so systemic that by 1877, the conservative democrats 1930 and 1954, the Klan remained in a protracted had gained control of all Southern state

governments state of dormancy, but it made its anticomunist, and were using legal means to reconstitute society as anti-union organizing, and anti-Roosevelt positions it existed prior to the war. This agenda was helped felt across the nation.

along by the collapse of Reconstruction and the From 1954 to about the late 1960s, the resurfacing Klan-backed conservative Rutherford B. Hayes's of the Klan coincided with the rise of what some have

“selection” by the House of Representatives. In fact, it characterized as the second Reconstruction—the civil can be argued that Hayes's subsequent ascent to the rights movement. Calling itself the “United Klan of presidency set the stage for the 1896 Supreme Court America,” and with Robert M. Shelton as the Grand decision in *Plessy v. Ferguson* that blacks and whites Wizard, the Klan used intimidation, coercion, and were “separate but equal,” which gave legal support violence in the hope of halting the legislative process to the color line.

aimed at creating an even more inclusive American The Klan's retreat was a regrouping and recruit-democracy. In addition to lynching, the Klan used ment of new members who, through ignorance and bombings (of 30 black churches) and assassinations

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 300

300———**Ku Klux Klan**

to stem the tide of change sweeping the country.

and has found itself being mimicked by white While the United States was in the throes of the civil supremacist groups like the Skinheads, White Aryan rights movement, the Klan perpetrated a number of Resistance, Church of the Creator, and others. But the heinous crimes against not just individuals but existence of the Klan has been threatened by an inno-humanity itself.

vative legal challenge issued by the Southern Poverty One such crime was the 1962 assassination of Law Center in Montgomery, Alabama, headed by

the Medgar W. Evers, the field secretary of the NAACP

lawyer Morris Dees. In a series of litigations, Dees (National Association for the Advancement of and his colleagues have successfully sued the Klan Colored People) in Mississippi. Another was the and won in court. One of the first such cases was the 1963 bombing of the Sixteenth Street Baptist Church murder trial of Mobile teenager Michael Donald in in Birmingham, Alabama, in which four young 1981. Members of the United Klans of America who churchgoers were killed. Then there were the 1964

were involved in the murder were convicted, and the Philadelphia, Mississippi, murders of three civil Alabama court ordered the Klan and each defendant rights workers, James Chaney, Andrew Goodman, and to pay the \$17 million in damages the court awarded Michael Schwerner. The former was black and the to the victim's mother. In Georgia, the center sued the latter two white. When the bodies were recovered Klan because of its mob action against civil rights pro-from a gravel pit, Chaney had been beaten so badly testers in Forsyth County in 1987. The case ended in that every bone in his body was broken.

a multimillion dollar judgment against the Klan ringIn 1968, Martin Luther King, Jr., was assassinated leaders.

in Memphis, Tennessee, where he appeared in support As a result of court actions by the Southern Poverty of striking sanitation workers. Although the Klan was Law Center against both the Klan and other white not charged with the murder of Martin Luther King, supremacist groups (e.g., the White Aryan Resistance the spirit of racial hatred and outright violent attacks in Portland, Oregon), by the mid-1990s Klan mem-on blacks inspired by the examples of the Ku Klux bership had begun to drop off. In both Mississippi and Klan increased the possibility of such an attack. Once Alabama, the continuing efforts of government offi-again, a period of protracted dormancy set in for the cials at the state and national levels to imprison Klan Klan. It was not until 1979 that a new faction of members have since resulted in the indictments and the organization appeared. Under the leadership of convictions of the perpetrators of the murders of the clean-shaven Louisiana college graduate, David Medgar W. Evers and the four churchgoers killed at Duke, the Knights of the Ku Klux Klan initially touted

Sixteenth Street Baptist Church in Birmingham. But itself as antigay, anti-welfare, and antiestablishment.

the subtle and overt violence that hatred produces But eventually its true, old Klan white supremacist continues, as evidenced by the brutal murder of James cause became evident. In 1975, a splinter group of the Byrd by white men in Jasper, Texas; by the fires set in Knights, the Invisible Empire, Knights of the Ku Klux black churches; and by other acts of violence against Klan, established itself under the leadership of Bill African Americans.

Wilkinson. Both factions had limited memberships

— *A. J. Williams-Myers*

but wide support from many whites across the nation. In fact, what was most disturbing about the new Klan was its ability to enter the mainstream, as **FURTHER READING**

evidenced by David Duke's successful run for the Du Bois, W. E. B. (1999). *Black Reconstruction*. New York: Louisiana State Legislature and his shockingly close Free Press. (Original work published 1935). Considered by run for the U.S. Senate, as well as by the moral many critics to be Du Bois's most scholarly book, *Black* support he received from many whites.

Reconstruction presents the period after the Civil War as an opportunity for the American nation to choose freedom and equality. The reactions of the white racists in the South rendered this choice nearly impossible.

THE 21ST-CENTURY KLAN

Wood, Forrest. (1968). *Black Scare: The Racist Response to Emancipation and Reconstruction*. Berkeley: University of From the 1980s into the 21st century, there were no California Press. The Ku Klux Klan and other groups of cyclical resurgences or protracted periods of dor-whites responded to the emancipation of Africans with mancy for the Klan. The Klan has continued to exist bitter resentment. This book chronicles that history.

Kush——301

The 25th dynasty, which was known as the Kushite **KUSH**

Rejuvenation Dynasty, lasted from 747 to 656 B.C.E.

and was one of the most beloved dynasties in Kemetic Kush is the name given to a period of Nubian history. It was a period in which the Pharaohs of Kush during which there were two successive capitals, also ruled Kemet and restored many of the monu-Napata and Meroe. It is generally agreed that Kush re-introduced cultural rituals, and expanded extended from about 656 B.C.E. to about 642 C.E.

agriculture.

Kush was located south of Egypt from Aswan to Piankhi (or Piye) came to the throne in about 747

below Khartoum. Many Eurocentric scholars erro-B.C.E. He was the first Pharaoh from Kush to conquer neously locate Kush culturally and racially outside of Kemet, and he established the foundation for the 25th Africa, when it was in fact an African civilization with Dynasty of Kemet of 747 to 656 B.C.E. Piankhi also commonalties with other African cultures, such as left a thorough, well-known historical document, divine kingship, matriarchy, and cosmology.

known as *The Victory Stele*. Initially, Piankhi ruled southern Kemet from Kush. He was asked to come to Kemet in about 734 B.C.E. to help the Kemetians **THE NAPATAN AND MEROITIC PERIODS**

subdue a local ruler of Delta, Tefnakht, who wanted to conquer Kemet. Piankhi's narrative describes in The Napatan period lasted from 1000 to 250 B.C.E.

detail how he came to rule the entire Nile Valley.

The exact location of the administrative center of Throughout *The Victory Stele*, Piankhi demonstrated Napata is unknown, but it is known that Napata was impeccable piety, courage, and an unwavering belief associated with the area surrounding the Gebel Barkal that he was restoring Maat, order and balance, to Mountain. The Kushite people referred to it as the *Dw Kemet*. After each of his military conquests, he made *w'b*, meaning “holy mountain,” and it was there that contributions to the treasury and granary of the god they dedicated a temple to their primary deity, Amun.

Amun. This was to demonstrate his gratitude for The location of the city near the sacred mountain must divine assistance and to restore Amun’s temples have been very significant because royal personages throughout Kemet. After helping to liberate Kemet were still being buried there even after the capital was from Tefnakhte, Piankhi returned to rule from Kush.

moved.

He had a fondness for horses, and when he died, The Meroitic period is dated from 250 to 350 C.E.

Piankhi was buried with his beloved horses.

Incorrectly called an island, Meroe was a center of Taharqa was the biological son of Piankhi. He trade and one of several settlements located between began his reign at the age of 20, in about 690 B.C.E., the second and first cataracts of the Butanna Steepe, a when he was beckoned by the Pharaoh Shebitku to triangular area formed by the confluence of the Atbara come to Egypt. Taharqa is one of the most well-known and Nile rivers. The first historical record of Meroe kings of antiquity. He is mentioned in the Bible was when it was at the height of its power. It is suras an ally of the people of Israel in a war against mised that some event of political significance precip-the Assyrians (Isaiah 37:9). His mother, Abar, played itated the transfer of the capital of Kush from Napata a significant role during his reign. The relationship to Meroe. This transfer marked the beginning of a cul-between King Taharqa and his mother demonstrated tural, economic, and artistic “Imhotepean” period in the honored and revered position of motherhood in the history of Kush, that is, a rebirth of

artistic and Kush and other African cultures. In an African con-political excellence.

text, matriarchy denotes that kingship was determined within a matrilineal system, and while matriarchy does not imply rule of women over men (even though **KUSHITE RULERS**

this is not precluded), women such as queens and The Kushite Pharaohs were regarded as divine.

queen mothers had political and economic power in Pharaohs were viewed as divine because they were matriarchies.

indispensable to the sacred order of the universe. The In the sixth year of Taharqa's stele, he explained coronation of a Kushite Pharaoh was not considered how for 20 years his mother nurtured and prepared to be an apotheosis; it was an epiphany. The divine him for kingship. In this text, he associates himself creator was maintaining Maatian balance and order.

with divinity. In Kemetic cosmology, for example,

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 302

302———**Kush**

the goddess Auset (or Isis), through immaculate a value-laden, socially constructed cultural term.

conception, conceived a son, Heru (or Horus), and Traditional African culture must be viewed through then raised him to defeat the enemies of Kemet and the lens of spirituality. Based on the value system of rule as the pharaoh. Similarly, in Taharqa's stele, Abar many African cultures, the large size of the Kandakes raised him to defeat the enemies and to become king.

probably represented productivity, motherhood, In the stele, the respect and adoration that Taharqa has material wealth, and a powerful nation. The text and for his mother is unquestionable.

iconography suggest that the Kandakes were also One of Taharqa's projects as pharaoh was to considered divine rulers, as they are positioned at the continue Piankhi's restoration projects. He further same height as and next to the primary deity of elevated the status of Amun-Ra's temples. Taharqa Meroe, the lion god Apedemak. The fame of the referred to himself as the divine son of Amun-Ra.

Kandakes is also evident in the Kings James Version Like other kings, Taharqa was portrayed as the slayer of the Bible. In the story of the conversion of the of enemies, maintainer of Maat and the epiphany of Ethiopian eunuch to Christianity, his importance is divine order.

affirmed by his authority under the Queen Kandake (Acts 8:26–39).

Kandake Amanishakheto ruled Meroe from about **Kandakes, Ruling Queens of Ancient Meroe** 40 to 20 B.C.E. She was buried in Pyramid N6 in One of the unique features of Kush was that it Meroe, which contains one of the most remarkable had a series of ruling queens, known as Kandakes finds from antiquity. The treasure of her magnificent or Candaces. The name Kandake was a title and not golden jewelry is now in museums in Berlin and a specific name. The appearance of Kandakes was a Munich. Kandake Amanishakheto's lofty pyramid is natural component of the elevated position of women gilded in gold, well preserved, and about 70 feet at the in the Kushite culture, especially that of the queen base. On one of the temple walls, she is shown as a mother. The first, second, and fifth rulers of the Meroe commanding woman, holding prisoners by a cord and were Kandakes.

piercing the neck of one with a javelin.

The Kandake queens were well known in the Another female ruler, Amanitere, differs from European classical world. During the tenure of Gaius other Kandakes in that she was always associated with Pertonius, the Roman prefect of Kemet, from 25 to her husband, Natak-Amani. Their spiritual connection 21 B.C.E., the Romans conquered Meroe, which was and right to rule were evident in their names, which ruled by a Kandake queen. The evidence is not con-are both amalgamations of Amun. The political and clusive as to which Kandake it was, because Strabo cultural

connection of Meroe with Kemet can also be (a Greek historian who left an otherwise detailed account of the battle) described the Kandake as blind to her Meroitic name, which means “Daughter of in one eye but did not name her. She was probably the Sun, Lady of Diadems, Amanitere,” she had an Kandake Amanirenas or Amanishakheto. Strabo Egyptian name “The Queen of Upper Egypt, Lady of detailed how the Kandake and her generals led an the Two Lands, Mer-Ke-Re.” Amanitere was a large inadequately prepared and scantily equipped army woman who was equated with celestial beings and to counterattack the Romans. During the attack, her associated with divine order, or Maat.

army pulled down statues of Roman rulers. A bronze There is not much historical data about the head of the Roman Emperor Augustus, who ruled Kandake known as Nawidemak. However, because from 27 B.C.E. to 14 C.E., was probably taken during African culture has a spiritual foundation, her position this attack, as it was found in the area that was for-can be determined by interpreting the symbols that merly Meroe. The Kandake and her people lost the surround her. She was portrayed on the pyramid near battle. However, in negotiations afterwards, she won the holy mountain of Gebel Barkal as being protected back much of their land and possessions.

by Auset, who stood with her wings outstretched On the temple walls, the Kandakes are usually around the queen, who was holding a lotus flower.

pictured as large women with long, pointed finger-The lotus was a symbol of rebirth and resurrection.

nails and beautiful sacred jewelry. Eurocentric schol-Wings have been a symbol of protection from at least ars have described Kandake Amanishakheto and the time of the Old Kingdom in Kemet. In her picture other Kandakes as obese women. However *obese* is there was also a male figure, probably her eldest son

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 303

or another heir, who held a palm branch in his hand.

The palm branch, like most symbols in African culture, **KWANZAA**

has a multiplicity of meanings. It has been shown to represent time, Auset worship, and eternity. Thus, in Kwanzaa is a 7-day African American and pan-African many ways, she was shown through the symbolic holiday that celebrates family, community, and cul-meaning to be a ruling Kandake who was divinely ture. The holiday begins on December 26 and contin-

connected to the sacred universal order.

ues through January 1, and its name comes from the Swahili words *matunda ya kwanza*, which mean “first fruits” and indicates the holiday’s roots in the first **MEROITIC WRITING**

harvest celebrations recorded in African history.

The Meroitic language of Kush had a written script.

These harvest festivals bear various names, which The inscriptions were in a cursivelike script and in reflect the language of the society in which each is hieroglyphic writing. Most of the signs can be inter-celebrated. Some of these are: *Pert-en-Min* in ancient preted phonetically, but their meaning has not been Egypt, *Umkhosi* in Zululand, *Incwala* in Swaziland, interpreted. Unless a Rosetta stone can be found that *Odwira* in Asanteland, and *Odu Ijesu* in Yorubaland.

contains script in Meroitic and the same words in a As a harvest festival, then, Kwanzaa’s central deciphered language such as Greek, it will probably message expresses the ancient African model and be a long time until the language is fully under-practice of producing, harvesting, and sharing good in stood. Due to the synthesis of Kemetic and Kushite the world. Key to this commitment to bringing and culture, its notable pharaohs, and the unique posi-sustaining good in the world is practicing the *Nguzo* tion of ruling women, Kush is a civilization that is *Saba* (Seven Principles).

vitaly important to the reconstruction of African history, at the heart of the meaning and activities history.

of this 7-day holiday are the Nguzo Saba, which are aimed at reaffirming and strengthening family, com-

— *Miriam Maat Ka Re Monges*

munity, and culture. Thus, each day of Kwanzaa is dedicated to one of the principles and is organized **FURTHER READING**

around activities and discussion to emphasize each principle. These principles are *Umoja* (Unity)—to Adams, William. (1977). *Nubia: Corridor to Africa*.

strive for and maintain unity in the family, community, Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press. This book is nation, and race; *Kujichagulia* (Self-Determination)—

one of the key works on Nubia. Its focus, however, is on to define ourselves, name ourselves, create for our-Nubia as a corridor between Africa and Egypt, which the selves, and speak for ourselves; *Ujima* (Collective author obviously does not see as a part of Africa, thus the subtitle of his book, “Corridor to Africa.” Nubia, however, Work and Responsibility)—to build and maintain our is Africa.

community together and to make our brother’s and Emery, Walter. (1965). *Egypt in Nubia*. London: Hutchinson.

sister’s problems our problems and solve them This remains one of the most cited works on the Nubians.

together; *Ujamaa* (Cooperative Economics)—to build It deals, however, with the influence of Egypt on Nubia and maintain our own stores, shops, and other busi-and not with the significant impact that Nubia had on nesses and to profit from them together; *Nia* Egypt.

(Purpose)—to make our collective vocation the build-Monges, Miriam. (1997). *Kush, the Jewel of Nubia: Reconnecting the Root System of African Civilization*.

ing and developing of our community in order to Trenton, NJ: African World Press. Monges's book is one of restore our people to their traditional greatness; the first Afrocentric analyses of the history and place of *Kuumba* (Creativity)—to do always as much as we Nubia in the context of Black Studies.

can, in the way we can, in order to leave our commu-Shaw, I., and Nicholson, P. (1995). *The Dictionary of Ancient* nity more beautiful and beneficial than we inherited *Egypt*. London: British Museum Press. This is a reference it; *Imani* (Faith)—to believe with all our heart in our work that contains information on Kush.

people, our parents, our teachers, our leaders, and the Strabo. (1982). *The Geography of Strabo* (Vols. I, VII, VIII; righteousness and victory of our struggle.

C. L. Sherman, Trans.). Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press. (Original work published 1932). Strabo's Although it is rooted in an ancient African history geography is one of the earliest works to treat the role of and culture, Kwanzaa was developed in 1966 in the Nubia in the Nile Valley.

modern context of African American life and struggle

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 304

304———**Kwanzaa**

as a reconstructed and expanded African tradition are urged to live by to enrich and expand their lives; by Maulana Karenga, an activist scholar, who is cur-muhindi (corn), symbolic of children and the future of rently professor of Black Studies at California State African people that they embody; *kikombe cha umoja* University, Long Beach. Having emerged during the (unity cup), symbolic of the foundational principle and black

freedom movement of the 1960s, Kwanzaa practice of unity that makes all else possible; and reflects the movement's stress on self-determination, *zawadi* (gifts), symbolic of the labor and love of parents

“return to the source,” and the recovery and reaffirmation and the commitments made and kept by children. There is a reconnection of African identity and culture. Moreover, there are also two supplemental symbols: a representation of Kwanzaa is founded and framed in Kwanzaa philosophy of the Nguzo Saba and the *bendera* (flag), containing philosophy, which stresses cultural grounding, a values orientation—the three colors black, red, and green, symbolic respectation, and an ongoing dialogue with continental and history of African people, the struggle, and the promise of African culture in pursuit of paradigms of a future that come from the struggle.

human excellence and human possibility. First Within the framework of the five overarching principles celebrated by members and friends of the organization and general activities of Kwanzaa mentioned above, the Nguzo Saba (meaning us African people), which Karenga several specific practices are central to its celebration and in which the holiday developed, Kwanzaa is a celebration. These include the Umoja night (or daytime) is currently celebrated by an estimated 26 million gatherings at home or in the community to mark the beginning of the holiday throughout the world African community and beginning of the holiday, to pay homage to the ancestors on every continent in the world.

celebrations by pouring libations and sharing the lessons of Kwanzaa, as explained by Karenga in his 1997

their lives and teachings, and to commit to the practice of Kwanzaa: *A Celebration of Family, Community and Culture* and promotion of the Nguzo Saba. This commitment and Culture, is organized around five fundamental principles to the Nguzo Saba (and other fundamental kinds of activities that originated in ancient African values) is done on Umoja night, as well as on harvest or first fruit celebrations. These activities are each of the 7 nights of Kwanzaa, especially at home.

(1) the gathering of the people to reinforce the At the evening meal, family members light one of the bonds between them, especially those of family, community—seven candles each night to focus on the principles in community,

and culture; (2) special reverence for the a ritual called “lifting up the light that lasts,” that is Creator and creation in gratitude for the bountifulness to say, upholding the *Nguzo Saba* and all the other and goodness of the earth and in commitment to pre-life-affirming and enduring principles that affirm the serving and protecting it; (3) commemoration of the good of life, enrich human relations, and support past, to fulfill the obligation to remember and honor human flourishing.

the ancestors, and to teach and reaffirm the mission Also, a central and culminating event is the gather-and meaning of African history; (4) commitment to ing of the community on December 31 for an African the highest African cultural values—the ethical and *karamu* (feast) featuring libations and ceremonies spiritual values that bring forth the best of what it honoring the ancestors, as well as narratives, poetry, means to be African and human in the fullest sense; music, dance, and other performances to celebrate the and (5) celebration of the good—the good of life and goodness of life, relationships, and cultural grounding.

the world, of family, community, and culture, of rela-Finally, central to the celebration of Kwanzaa is tionships, and of cultivating, harvesting, and sharing the practice of pausing and turning inward as persons good in the world.

and a people and thinking deeply about the wonder Kwanzaa has seven basic symbols that represent its and obligation of being African in the world. This origins and cultural views and values. These are the is done on January 1, *Siku ya Taamuli* (The Day of *mazao* (crops), symbolic of African harvest celebra-Meditation), which is the last day of Kwanzaa and the tions and of the rewards of productive and collective first day of the new year. At the heart of this process labor; *mkeka* (mat), symbolic of tradition and history is the obligation of Africans everywhere to sit down in and therefore the foundation on which to build; *kinara* sober assessment, measure themselves in the mirror (candleholder), symbolic of ancestral roots, the parent of the best of African culture and history, and ask people, continental Africans; *mishumaa* (candles), themselves where they stand in relationship to the symbolic of the *Nguzo Saba*, the Seven Principles, highest of African

and human standards. To do this, which form a central value system that African people each person must ask himself or herself three basic

K-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 4:30 PM Page 305

Kwanzaa———305

questions: Who am I? Am I really who I am? and **FURTHER READING**

Am I all I ought to be? The person then commits or Karenga, Maulana. (1997). *Kwanzaa: A Celebration of Family, Community and Culture*. Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This is the authoritative work on Kwanzaa, forth the best of what it means to be African and Kwanzaa, and the Nguzo Saba.

human in the world.

www.officialkwanzaawebsite.org This is the main Web site for

— *Maulana Karenga*

information about Kwanzaa.

www.us-organization.org This is the Web site for the organiza-

See also Kwanzaa; Nguzo Saba tion Us.

L-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 307

L

in particular, the racism that continued to enslave **LAST POETS**

black Americans, and a burgeoning black nationalism.

The music of the Last Poets was a clarion call to The Last Poets were poet-musicians whose music those mired in complacency. It echoed the ethos of mirrored the social climate of the turbulent late 1960s 1960s and 1970s

social activists—particularly those, and early 1970s. Best known for their provocative and like the Black Panthers and the radical faction of the politically charged messages that sometimes reflected Student Non-violent Coordinating Committee, who the rhetoric of the Black Panthers, the Last Poets advocated self-sufficiency—and challenged black exhorted their listeners to become social and political people to shun resignation and to think seriously activists by heeding the words in their music.

about social revolution as an ideological construct.

Although members of the group continued to record The use of language to provoke is a hallmark of through the late 1990s, the importance of the Last the Last Poets. The word *nigger*, which is ubiquitous Poets lies primarily with their first recording, the landin the group's music, appears as neither an egregious mark *Last Poets* (1970).

nor an empty gesture; rather, it is calculated to address The group was born in May of 1968 at a fete held black people's self-perceptions. In "Run Nigger,"

in Marcus Garvey Park in honor of the birthday of written at the height of the civil rights movement, the late Malcolm X. Their name, the Last Poets, was the Last Poets ridiculed the passive tactics of the taken from a poem by a South African poet. Abiodun movement's leaders—"time is running out of talks, Oyewole, David Nelson, Gylan Kain, and Felipe marches, tunes, chants, and prayers," as they berated Luciano were among the founders; other original black people for the meaninglessness of their lives—

Last Poets were Umar Bin Hassan, Suliaman El Hadi,

"run, Nigger; run like you run when the liquor store is and Jalal Nurridin. Of the seven, Oyewole and Bin closing and it's Saturday night." "Niggers Are Scared Hassan have sustained careers in the spirit of their first of Revolution" is a message to those whose words are recordings.

grander than their actions, as well as a poem about From *Last Poets* (1970) to *Time Has Come* (1997), self-love and social responsibility: "Niggers are lovers.

the Last Poets embodied the spirit of the griot, or Niggers love to hear Malcolm but they didn't love African storyteller. In fact, their early music is mod-Malcolm. Niggers love everything but themselves. . . .

eled after West African practices, with its minimalist I love niggers because niggers are me. And I should drumming and half-spoken, half-sung vocal delivery only love that which is part of me.”

intended to accentuate the importance of the words.

“When the Revolution Comes” parodies the life-The group’s harsh texts were meant to inform, anger, style in which blacks would rather eat chicken and and incite and are themselves a triptych of black watch TV than acknowledge a social revolution in full issues in the late 1960s: the class distinctions that swing. It applauds the actions of those committed to divided all Americans but ostracized black Americans aggressive resistance as it denounces the acquiescence 307

L-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 308

308——— *Letter From the Birmingham Jail*

of those who prefer peaceful dialogue—“guns and **THE REASON FOR THE LETTER**

rifles will be taking the place of poems and essays.”

On April 16, 1963, Martin Luther King, a vital and

“Two Little Boys” is a poignant tale in two parts: lost determined African American civil rights leader, and a youth and black love. In this poem, we witness a fellow activist, Ralph Abernathy, were arrested and day in the life of two young drug addicts who steal, detained in the Jefferson County jail in Birmingham get high, and eat ravenously at Sylvia’s Restaurant in for violating a state court order to stop participating Harlem. The concluding lines “oh beautiful black in civil rights protests. City Commissioner T. E. “Bull”

minds create a world where children can play with Connor ordered that King and Abernathy be placed life, not death” and “oh beautiful black brothers and in isolation, supposedly “for their own safety.” In sisters come together to create life, to create love, to reality, this was a failed attempt to break their spirits; create, and to create” underscore the urgency of their the challenge of isolation, in fact, strengthened King’s desire for something better.

determination.

Given their uncompromising style, it is not surprisIn that same year, in response to the demand for ing that the Last Poets inspired younger musicians.

civil rights, eight clergymen—Bishop N. B. Harmon, The messages espoused and the traditions embraced Jr.; Bishop C.C.J. Carpenter; Bishop G. Murray; by this maverick prerap group were adopted by a host Bishop J. A. Durick; and P. Hardin, Jr.; Rabbi M.

of rappers and adapted to the issues of the 1980s, Grafman; Edward V. Ramage; and E. Stallings—

1990s, and 21st century. Many rappers—from KRS-issued two statements in Birmingham newspapers, One and Dead Prez to Ice-T and Tupac—are drawn one in January and one in April on the very day of especially to the teaching aspect of the Last Poets and King’s arrest, in which they accused “outsiders” of have infused their music with similarly bold social and

“unwise and untimely” protests that “incite violence.”

political statements meant to be heard and heeded.

These clergymen believed the fight against injustice

— *Gail Hilson Woldu*

should be waged exclusively in the courts.

From an isolated, cold cell King wrote an eloquent **FURTHER READING**

letter in response to the clergymen's criticism. This letter was published in *Last Poets*. (1992). *Vibes from the Scribes: Selected Poems*.

ter, though worthy of a pharaoh's papyrus, was written in Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This was one of the first on toilet paper and the edges of newspaper and "smug-works to present the Last Poets to a wide continental audience" out of the jailhouse a few sheets at a time to African audience.

Wyatt Tee Walker, SCLC's executive director, and his Oyewole, Abiodun, and Hassan, Umar Bin, with Kim Green.

secretary, Willie Pearl Mackey, who edited and published

(1996). *On a Mission: Selected Poems and a History of the* cized its content. Excerpts of the text were published *Last Poets*. New York: Henry Holt. This is a very useful on May 19 (when King was no longer in jail) in the work on the Last Poets.

New York Post Sunday Magazine. In May, the *Crisis* and many other newspapers published the whole text.

LETTER FROM

The publication improved national support for the Birmingham campaign against segregation.

THE BIRMINGHAM JAIL

In the letter, King responded to the SCLC's being called "outsiders" who promoted "unwise and untimely"

Letter From the Birmingham Jail by Reverend Martin protests that led to violence, expressed his disappointment-Luther King, Jr., was provoked by a major demonstration in white moderates and the white church, and tension in Birmingham. In the summer of 1962, Fred made clear his own position in the African American Shuttlesworth attempted to desegregate local business scene. King refuted the charge that he was a meddling nigger in Birmingham, Alabama. When he was not some outsider, since he was invited to

Birmingham successful, he contacted Martin Luther King, president because of the injustices in the city; he saw himself as a member of the Southern Christian Leadership Conference as an apostle carrying the news of freedom to (SCLC) in Atlanta, Georgia, for support. In April of Birmingham. This intervention was not an overly hasty 1963, a large group of activists was assembled to decision, as the four basic steps of all nonviolent campaigns in Birmingham. The aim of this march, one of the campaigns were followed in Birmingham. First, the group their most ambitious campaigns, was to end segregation determined by the facts that local bombings and racism by fighting a bastion of Southern racism.

acts meant that the march was necessary. Second, the

L-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 309

“Lift Every Voice and Sing”———309

black community had tried to negotiate with the white an appeal and a request for a blessing for the future of community to support putting a stop to the attacks, but America. This was his eloquence and his dignity.

the promises the white community made were not kept.

The effects of the letter were multifaceted. Though Third, “self-purification,” as a mental and psychological—some of King’s fellow clergymen were left untouched, calm preparation for direct action, had been an ongoing others dedicated the rest of their lives to the nonviolent process in the previous months and had finally led to the struggle for the rights of African Americans.

to the decision to take direct action. And fourth, the There is a general consensus, however, that the letter protest was planned and staged.

was meant for a much larger public—the African American community and American society; in fact, the letter was never directly sent to the clergymen. In **THE EFFECT OF THE LETTER**

this view, the impact of King’s irresolute action and philosophy of dignity have not ended.

Martin Luther King was not looking to bring tension into the situation; the tension already existed because

— *Rita S. Fierro*

of the racist nature of the South. Moreover, direct action is always premature in the minds of those who **FURTHER READING**

do not accept its relevance. King's letter was meant to Abernathy, Ralph. D. (1989). *And the Walls Came Tumbling* free both the segregationist and the African American.

Down. New York: HarperCollins. This book is a personal He recognized, however, that freedom is never given memoir about the struggle for freedom, justice, and equal-up voluntarily by the oppressor; it must be demanded ity by one of the men at the center of the fight.

Bass, S. J. (2001). *Blessed Are the Peacemakers*. Baton Rouge: by the oppressed. King had no illusions about the new Louisiana State University Press. This is a good work on the political administration, as he had experienced white activist tradition and the efforts by the preacher-influenced moderates as a weak, unreliable ally.

movement for social transformation to bring about civil In fact, throughout King's 10-year experience in rights.

the nonviolent civil rights movement, white moderates Harding, Vincent. (1981). *There Is a River*. New York: did not provide the level of support that he expected.

Harcourt Brace. This book, by a scholar who knew Martin King said that white allies used time as an excuse for Luther King, Jr., is remarkable for its treatment of King's life and actions, as well as one of the best works demon-inaction, while the church was a supporter of the sta-strating the African American community's long history of tus quo. Instead, the Birmingham protests took on the resistance to oppression.

immediacy of the movement of the sixties.

Washington, J. M. (Ed.). (1986). *A Testament of Hope*.

King's letter revealed his understanding that the New York: HarperCollins. Washington provides the reader violation of segregation statutes was not morally with a collection of personal testimonies about the civil wrong, that the violation of unjust laws was a mea-rights period that are very revealing.

sure in which good people must take pride. He compared his extremism to that of Jesus, and he harshly criticized the white church. He thought that

“LIFT EVERY VOICE AND SING”

Birmingham's religious leaders would join him in a righteous cause. Instead, King asserted, the days In the United States, millions of schoolchildren begin when Christians were ready to suffer for justice were their mornings with a ritual of reciting the Pledge no more, and a weak, ineffectual voice had taken its of Allegiance, and singing the national anthem, “The place; too few had broken away from the conformity Star Spangled Banner.” However, millions of African of the majority. This criticism was all the more harsh American schoolchildren who grew up during the era coming from King, himself a minister. In this letter of Jim Crow practiced an alternative morning ritual.

he showed his disappointment with other ministers Instead of singing the traditional national anthem, and white moderates.

they sang “Lift Every Voice and Sing.” This song King was well aware of his position as a moderate became known as the “Negro National Anthem.”

in the African American community. He saw himself as being in the middle —between the extremists and **THE JOHNSON BROTHERS AND THEIR SONG**

the forces of complacency. King dealt with the objections raised by the white ministers in Birmingham, and Written in 1900 by the brothers James Weldon when he had addressed them, he closed the letter with Johnson (1871–1938) and J. Rosamond Johnson

310———**“Lift Every Voice and Sing”**

(1873–1954), the Negro National Anthem has to New York shortly after the Lincoln celebration and endured the test of time and has continued to be one set out to become Broadway playwrights. Much to of the most influential African American cultural James and Rosamond’s surprise, their lyrical tribute to icons. The history of the Negro National Anthem African American determination developed a life of its begins in Jacksonville, Florida, at the turn of the 20th own after they departed Jacksonville. Schoolchildren century. At the time that “Lift Every Voice and Sing”

continued singing and teaching “Lift Every Voice and was composed, James Weldon Johnson was principal Sing” to others in Southern black churches, schools, of Stanton Public School in Jacksonville, Florida, and and civic clubs. Soon, the song became quite popular in J. Rosamond Johnson was a public school teacher.

this region. It was so highly favored that the words and Both men possessed artistic flair, great poise, and an score were often hand copied and pasted into the backs appreciation for culture, history, and politics. James of existing church hymnals and choir books. The received a bachelor’s degree in 1894 and a master’s Johnsons had the composition published and copy-degree in 1904 from Atlanta University. It was there righted, but it is likely that the song was most widely that he began to explore his love for poetry and was disseminated by these communally driven methods.

exposed to the impact of organized political activism.

The Negro National Anthem is, in fact, complex—

His brother John was a gifted musician, who honed especially when one considers that it was initially his craft at Atlanta University and at the New England written as a children’s choir song. It has resonant and Conservatory of Music. He dreamed of writing and haunting lyrics that speak frankly of the harsh realities producing musical scores on Broadway. In the close-of

African American life. James Weldon Johnson's knit Jacksonville community, the Johnson brothers'

prose does not avoid delicate subject matter, and talent did not go without recognition. Accordingly, the lyrics often allude to physical and psychological when Jacksonville city leaders decided to plan a celebration. He mentions the "chastening rod" and the bration commemorating the birthday of former presi-

"blood of the slaughtered" to honor the sacrificial dent Abraham Lincoln, James Weldon Johnson was death of African American ancestors who toiled and asked to make a special contribution to the program, prayed for their children to have a bright future.

which was held on February 12, 1900.

Rosamond Johnson added an intricate melody to the In his autobiography, James Weldon Johnson difficult subject matter of "Lift Every Voice and Sing."

recounts the circumstances surrounding the composi-The composition has a varied tempo and wide-ranging tion of "Lift Every Voice and Sing." He was asked to pitch, and it lacks the chorus that makes hymns easier give an address at Jacksonville's planned celebration to recall. Yet, it was originally written for and per-of Lincoln. He intended to also write a poem as an formed by a group of children, and children's choirs additional honor to Lincoln. However, as the time for are credited with spreading the song throughout the the program drew nearer, James found he could not South and eventually the North by the 1920s.

gather the inspiration to write the poem. In a final attempt to produce a fitting tribute to the former president, James recruited his brother Rosamond to col-THE JOHNSON BROTHERS

laborate with him in writing an original song for the **CONTINUE TO CONTRIBUTE**

assembly. They wrote “Lift Every Voice and Sing” in one night. As James called out and wrote down prose, In 1920, James Weldon Johnson was appointed as the his brother set the words to music. The brothers first black Executive Secretary of the National immediately sent the manuscript to their New York Association for the Advancement of Colored People publishers, where it was copied. The Johnsons then (NAACP). He served in this capacity until 1930.

taught the song to a choir of 500 African American Johnson’s influence led “Lift Every Voice and Sing”

children who had been gathered especially for the to be adopted as the official song of the NAACP

celebration of Lincoln’s birthday.

sometime in the 1920s. By then, “Lift Every Voice and Sing” had become a popularized tune that was familiar to millions of African Americans. It proved to **THE SONG GOES NATIONAL**

be a fitting clarion call for the civil rights organiza-Although they were moved by the passionate experi-tion, thus solidifying its role as a freedom and protest ence of writing this song, the Johnsons did not realize song sung during marches, demonstrations, and the composition’s potential for endurance. They moved protests for civil rights.

L-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 311

“Lift Every Voice and Sing”——311

James Weldon Johnson went on to become a Sing a song full of the faith that the dark past has consummate teacher, lawyer, writer, and activist. He taught us,

was the first African American to pass the bar in the Sing a song full of the hope that the present has state of Florida, and the first African American profes-brought us;

sor at New York University. He also served as a diplomat, becoming the American consul in Puerto Cabello, Facing the rising sun of our new day begun, Venezuela, in 1906. In 1909, he secured another post in Let us march on till victory is won.

foreign affairs and was appointed as consul in Corinto, Nicaragua. He was a major influence during the Harlem Renaissance, and in all his endeavors, he cham-Stony the road we trod, bitter the chastening rod, pioned the African American struggle for freedom.

Felt in the days when hope unborn had died; Some of his most famous works include *The Books* Yet with a steady beat, have not our weary feet, *of American Negro Spirituals* (1925, 1926), *God's* Come to the place for which our fathers sighed?

Trombones: Seven Negro Sermons in Verse (1927), and *The Autobiography of an Ex-Colored Man* (1912).

We have come over a way that with tears has been His brother Rosamond fulfilled his dream of becom-watered,

ing a successful songwriter. In New York, he and James We have come, treading our path through the formed a dynamic songwriting team with the African blood of the slaughtered;

American composer Bob Cole. Together Cole and the Out from the gloomy past, till now we stand at last Johnson brothers wrote over 200 songs. Rosamond Johnson went on to write the music and conduct the Where the white gleam of our bright star is cast.

orchestra for the 1911 revue *Hello Paris*. This marked the first time an African American had ever conducted a God of our weary years, God of our silent tears, white orchestra for a performance with a white cast in a New York theater. Rosamond Johnson edited numerous Thou Who hast brought us thus far on the way; collections of African American music. His goal was to Thou Who hast by Thy might, led us into the light, elevate the standards of black music, an aspiration Keep us forever in the path, we pray.

which “Lift Every Voice and Sing” certainly fulfills.

Lest our feet stray from the places, our God, where we met Thee.

THE SONG BECOMES CULTURE

Lest our hearts, drunk with the wine of the world, The practice of singing the Negro National Anthem we forget Thee.

continues today. It is part of the official repertoire of Shadowed beneath Thy hand, may we forever stand, any gospel choir, and it can now be found as a standard selection in many church hymnals. This anthem True to our God, true to our native land.

has endured because it honestly reflects a bleak past,

— *Aisha Francis*

yet remains hopeful for a triumphant future. Thus, whether it is being sung by a choir of a thousand or **FURTHER READING**

recited as a poem by one person, “Lift Every Voice Bond, Julian, and Wilson, Sondra Kathryn. (Eds.). (2000). *Lift and Sing*” is a tradition that has had a lasting histori-Every Voice and Sing, A Celebration of the Negro National cal and cultural influence on the state of race relations *Anthem: 100 Years, 100 Voices*. New York: Random House.

in this nation.

This is a precious account, among other things, of the circumstances leading to the writing of the black national anthem.

LYRICS TO THE NEGRO NATIONAL

Johnson, James Weldon. (1933). *Along This Way: The ANTHEM, “LIFT EVERY VOICE AND SING”*

Autobiography of James Weldon Johnson. New York: Viking Press. This book contains valuable insights into the Lift every voice and sing, till earth

and heaven ring, Johnson brothers' writing of the song.

Ring with the harmonies of liberty;

Levy, Eugene. (1973). *James Weldon Johnson: Black Leader, Black Voice*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press. Levy Let our rejoicing rise, high as the listening skies, provides important biographical information about James Let it resound loud as the rolling sea.

Weldon Johnson.

L-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 312

312——**Lucumi Tradition**

affected the modern day expression of the Yoruba **LUCUMI TRADITION**

tradition, researchers now claim that Cuba holds an older expression of the religion in the Lucumi tradition.

The word *Lucumi* refers to the Afro-Cuban manifesta-There also are many similarities to Yoruba found in tion of Yoruba in Cuba and on the North American con-the Xango tradition of Trinidad, the Candomble of tinent, as well as to the practitioners of Yoruba in those Brazil, and the Santeria of Puerto Rico. In addition, the regions. During the latter half of the 18th century, a large Lucumi tradition itself has spread outside Cuba to number of enslaved Africans were taken to Cuba from Venezuela, Panama Colombia, Dominican Republic, the home of the Yoruba in southwestern Nigeria. These Puerto Rico, Mexico, Spain, Virgin Islands, Curaçao, Africans were indigenous to the Yoruba kingdoms of Canada, Costa Rica, France, Germany, Sweden, and Oyo, Egbado, and Ijesha and brought the beliefs, tradi-Great Britain. Today the Lucumi tradition is the most tions, and philosophies of Yoruba to Cuba.

widely practiced form of Yoruba. In fact, in the United There was diversity to the traditions of Yoruba. In States, 90% of the orisha worship originated with the Africa this diversity was seen in the regional variations Lucumi tradition in Cuba.

among the Oyo, Egbado, and Ijesha. However, due to

— *Tyrene Wright*

the European slave trade, and many years of interaction between the diverse groups, the groups merged in **FURTHER READING**

the Americas to form one common tradition. The result of this unity was the religious practice of *La Regla de Babatunde*, Emmanuel. (1992). *A Critical Study of Bini and Osha Lucumi* (which translates as “The Rule of the Yoruba Values Systems of Nigeria in Change. Lewiston, Lucumi Orishas,” or the rule of the Lucumi deities).

NY: Mellen. This is a scholarly presentation of the culture of the Bini and Yoruba people.

This unification of various Yoruba traditions in Cuba Curry, Mary Cuthrell. (1997). *The Making of Gods in New York*.

did not in any way affect the theology and metaphysics New York: Garland. This book is based on a dissertation of Yoruba-speaking people in southwestern Nigeria or about the nature of African religion in New York City.

the regional variations in their traditions.

Murphy, Joseph. (1988). *Santeria: An African Religion in America*. Boston: Beacon Press. Although the elders of this community were enslaved, they still managed to organize and standard-to Santeria and various forms of Lucumi.

ize the ceremony and ritual of the present Lucumi tradition. This organized effort addressed the new geographical and social realities that practitioners of the religion faced in the Western hemisphere. Because **LYNCHING**

of the favorable climate for African social and political integration in Cuba, the Yoruba in Cuba were able White mobs are known to have lynched 3,386 African to maintain much of the ritual and ceremonial Americans during the

period between Reconstruction integrity of the religion. However, on the continent and the passage of the civil rights acts. *Lynching* is of Africa, British colonialism fostered Christianity, defined as execution without due process of law, Islam sent jihadists into West Africa, and internal usually by hanging. In fact, the practice of lynching conflicts decimated the Old Oyo Empire of ancient is more accurately described as a manifestation of the Yorubaland. Thus, while the fundamental principles depravity and inhumanity of those Southern whites of the Yoruba tradition are adhered to by all practi-who participated in or condoned the vile practice and tioners throughout the African world, including conti-of the Northern whites who responded to the travesty nental Africa and the diaspora in South America and of justice with apathy. Lynch mobs typically com-elsewhere, there are some rituals and ceremonies that prised members of all classes of a given Southern have disappeared over time.

white community, including women, children, and Yet Lucumi remains a strong tradition in Cuba.

prominent business and government and religious Analysis and comparison of the Yoruba chants, initia-leaders, as well as the working class men with whom tions, rites, and aesthetics show that Lucumi manifesta-the savagery is traditionally associated. These mobs tions are the preserved form of the traditions of Old took part in the castration, burning alive, gouging of Yoruba. Because the social and political changes that eyes, and hanging of anyone who was charged with a have taken place on the continent of Africa have crime against whites, whether or not the accused was

L-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 313

Lynching——313

guilty of what was charged. The majority of the explain lynching resulted in what appears justification lynching victims were male; however, some African for the brutality. The compartmentalized views of American women were lynched as well. The reported the various disciplines further dislocated scholarship figure of 3,386 people lynched excludes the countless from concern with injustice, immorality, and murder.

cases that went unreported.

Lynching may be understood as a scapegoating ritual. Antilynching activism was, by necessity, an effort in which white communities projected their fears, of persuasion. Popular belief, influenced by the white repression, and evil onto innocent black men to purge press, held that lynching was a justified response to themselves of sin and guilt. This insight directs attention to the rape of white women by black men. But the cry of attention to the essential question: How were Southern rape was meant to stifle the cry for liberation and free-whites capable of such depravity in their action and domination among blacks. Black activists worked diligently. Northern whites capable of such inaction? The to redress this misconception and mobilize opposition obvious answer is that the enslavement of African to the injustice of lynching. Their empirical studies Americans dehumanized white Americans.

revealed that rape was not the most common charge

— *Kismet Beckman*

against those who were lynched and that the justification for lynching—to protect the virtue of Southern white women—veiled its actual motivation, which **FURTHER READING**

was to crush black economic success, halt black Barnett, Ida B. Wells. (1993). *On Lynching: Southern Horrors*, activism, and perpetuate white dominance. Rape was *A Red Record, Mob Rule in New Orleans*. Salem, NH: Ayer.

charged in about a third of the cases, and those accusations were specious. In an appeal, Frederick of the first campaigners against racist violence in the South.

Douglass asked how it was possible that men who had Brundage, W. Fitzugh (Ed.). (1997). *Under Sentence of Death*: traditionally been left alone with white women and *Lynching in the South*. Chapel Hill: University of North Carolina Press. This book demonstrates in vivid detail the nature of lynch law in the South.

asserted that black men convicted of crimes were sure Harris, Trudier. (1984). *Exorcising Blackness: Historical and to receive swift justice through due process of law, Literary Lynching and Burning Rituals*. Bloomington: making the supposed need for “mob justice” unneces-Indiana University Press. Harris has developed an impor-sary. For nearly 100 years, the tireless efforts of tant thesis in this book dealing with the nature of the white African Americans to persuade white Americans to mind in its attempt to exorcise blackness through the help pass antilynching legislation were met primarily process of lynching.

with opposition and apathy.

Raper, Arthur F. (1933). *The Tragedy of Lynching*. Chapel Hill: University of North Carolina Press. This is a description of While activists continued in their efforts to eradi-the brutality of lynch law.

cate lynching, the emerging discipline of American Zangrando, Robert L. (1980). *NAACP Crusade Against social science cast its light on lynching and turned Lynching 1909–1950*. Philadelphia: Temple University tragedy into a popular topic of research. The intent of Press. This is one of the best histories of the NAACP’s sociological, economic, and psychological theories to campaign against lynching.

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 316

316———**Maat**

African life, many have embraced Maat as principle represents a concept of the interrelatedness of moral and practice for achieving this. In his major work on worthiness in every area of life. Thus, to stand worthy the subject, *Maat, the Moral Ideal in Ancient Egypt*: before God means and requires a worthiness in rela-A Study in Classical African Ethics (2004), Maulana tion to and before nature and other humans. This is Karenga discusses the evolution and essential tenets based again on the concept of Maat as an interrelated of this ancient and renewed tradition. Furthermore, he order of rightness. In King Unas’s text in the *Husia*, has translated and edited ancient Egyptian sacred texts Unas says that he comes before God, standing worthy, and compiled them in a sacred text called *The Husia*: bearing Maat,

free of accusation by any divine being, *Sacred Wisdom of Ancient Egypt*. The text takes its bird, beast, or human—living or dead. Thus, he seeks name from the ancient Egyptian for the two divine to justify his quest for immortality by worthiness powers by which the creator conceived and called the before God, nature, and humans.

world into being. They are *Hu*—“authoritative utter-Worthiness before humans and nature is achieved ance” and *Sia*—“exceptional insight.” Thus, the name by practice of the Seven Cardinal Virtues and other *Husia* means “authoritative utterance of exceptional virtues in the Declaration of Virtues and the Decla-insight.” For in the creation process, Ra conceives the rations of Innocence in the *Husia*, which leads to the world in his heart-mind and calls it into being with the development of character. In addition, worthiness word. In the renewed Maatian tradition, the name before nature requires practice based on the concept reaffirms the authoritative, deeply insightful, and of *srwd t3*, *serudj ta*—the moral obligation to sacred character of the text.

constantly repair, heal, and restore the world—

Some of the basic concepts in the Maatian tradition making it more beautiful and beneficial than it was are addressed in the *Husia*, such as the human as the when it was inherited. More expansively, it means to image of God; the dignity of the human; the require-raise up that which is in ruins, to repair that which is ment of standing worthy before God, nature, and damaged, to rejoin that which is severed, to replenish others; the necessity of moral and social excellence, that which is lacking, to set right that which is wrong, to especially as expressed in the Seven Cardinal Virtues, strengthen that which is weakened, and to make flourish the Declarations of Virtue, and the Declarations of that which is fragile and undeveloped. Thus, REDIU Innocence; the essentiality of service; the cultivation Khnum in the *Husia* says, “I restored what I found of the sedjem person; and the concepts of judgment, ruined. I rejoined what I found severed and I replenished justification, and immortality.

what I found depleted (or lacking).” Likewise, Petosiris The renewed Maatian tradition takes as its funda-says, “I made magnificent what I found ruined in its mental point of departure the concept that humans are place. I

restored what was damaged.” And Ramses III bearers of *divinity* and *dignity*. These two terms are asserts, “I restored the whole land.”

interlocked as they evolve from the oldest recorded Service, especially to the most vulnerable in the evidence of moral and spiritual teachings that humans community and society, is a central tenet of Maatian are in the image of God. This concept was first ethics. Here, other directedness is seen as central to our advanced in 2140 B.C.E. in the Book of Kheti in the moral and spiritual grounding as humans and to creat-Husia, which says “humans are the images of God”

ing and sustaining the good society and world. It is this (*snn ntr*, *senen netcher*) and came from his very ancient tradition which argued that one can measure the person. From this evolved the concept of the inherent moral quality of a society by how it treats its most vul-worthiness or dignity (*špsw*, *shepesu*) of human nerable members. Therefore, the *Husia* says we should beings. It is a transcendental and equal worthiness that give “bread to the hungry, water to the thirsty, clothes cannot be denied or diminished by social status or any to the naked and a boat to crossover for the boatless; be other external condition or attribute. This concept of a father to the orphan, a mother to the timid, a help to human dignity is clearly stressed in the Husitic text, in the widow, a shelter for the battered, a staff of support the Narrative of Djedi, in which the sage Djedi tells for those of old age, a refuge for the wretched, a raft for the king he can neither experiment on nor kill a name-the drowning and a ladder for those in the pit [of less prisoner. For the prisoner, in spite of his dishon-despair].” Moreover, in the *Husia*, Seba Ankhsheshonqi ored status, is still a noble (*shepes*) image of God.

says: “Serve God that he may protect you. Serve your Worthiness (*im3h*, *imakh*) before God, nature, and brothers and sisters that you may enjoy a good reputa-others is essential to the Maatian moral project. It tion. Serve a wise person that s/he may serve you. Serve

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 317

anyone who serves you. Serve any person that you may to humanity. The concept of judgment after death, benefit from it and serve your mother and father that as moral theorists have argued, represented a major you may go forward and prosper.”

development in the moral thought of humanity and acted as a counterweight and check on the excesses of holders of absolute power on earth. As early as the **A CULTIVATION OF**

Book of Unas in the *Husia*, the pharaoh recognizes **THE SEDJEMIC PERSONALITY**

that he is subject to the demands of Maat and says he The Maatian moral tradition also seeks to cultivate the comes before the creator after death, wishing to be *sedjemic* or hearing person, as opposed to the *sekhetic* judged by what he has done and given eternal life in or nonhearing person. The expansive meaning of the reward for his righteousness.

word *sdm*, *sedjem*—“to hear, listen”—is to be responsive and responsible. Thus, a sedjemic person is responsive to and responsible toward the divine, **A PROCESS OF JUDGMENT**

nature, and others, in contrast to the sekhetic person, The definitive text for the judgment, justification, and who is unresponsive and irresponsible. Seba granting of eternal life is The Book of Coming Forth Ptahhotep teaches that “hearing is better than every-By Day, especially Chapter 125. In it, the day of judg-thing,” for “it creates good will.” Moreover, in the ment is called the “Day of Assessing Characters” and Declarations of Innocence, one asserts as part of her the “Day of Great Reckoning.” This again reveals a or his justification, “I have not been deaf to truth stress on virtue and character as expressed in the

[Maat],” which is a parallel claim to the declaration Declarations of Virtue and the Declarations of

“I have not been blind to injustice.” This deafness to Innocence. In the process of judgment, the resurrected truth is another way of saying being unresponsive person must declare himself or herself innocent of to the

demands and requirements of Maat. And the offenses against God, nature, and others. These declarations called for are deeds that respond to human need, sensitivity to the needs of the environment and are mainly declarations of innocence of offenses committed, and deference to the will of the divine.

against other humans. In fact, the first declaration Both deafness to Maat and what the Book of is “I have not done evil to humans.” But, as noted Khunanpu calls “blind[ness] to what one should see”

above, these offenses, like the realms of existence and (i.e., *isfet*, meaning “wrongness, injustice”) are obligation—the divine, nature, and society, are inter-metaphors for moral insensitivity and ethical unre-related and thus offenses in any realm have implications and irresponsibility to others. Thus violations in the others.

Maatian ethics argues that persons with such blind-In conclusion, the quest for immortality is a desire that is disabled in their humanity and vitiates moral not only to live in the afterlife of the spirit world but community. This ethics of responsiveness is rooted also to continue as a powerful presence on earth in a deep appreciation for the virtue of reciprocity. A through a legacy of work and service, and thus to locus classicus of this stress on the reciprocal nature endure in the minds of the people. This is succinctly of good is found in the text of Lady Ta-Aset, who stated in the *Husia* in the text of Satephu, which says, says, “doing good is not difficult. In fact, just speak-

“A glorious spirit in heaven, a continuing power on doing good is a monument for those who do it. [Indeed]

earth, justification in God’s domain, resurrection after those who do good for others are actually doing it for death. These are the rewards of the righteous person themselves.” They are in fact building the moral community and a righteous person is one who receives them. He and all others want and will be counted among the ancestors. His name will deserve to live in.

endure as a monument. And what he has done on earth Finally, the renewed Maatian ethical tradition shall never perish or pass away.” It is within this embraces the ancient concept of judgment that carries framework that practitioners who follow the Way of with it two other interrelated concepts, justification Maat cultivate character, serve the people, and leave a and immortality. These three concepts, along with the legacy worthy of an enduring presence and praise both idea of humans as bearers of divinity and dignity, rep-in heaven and on earth.

resent some of ancient Egypt’s and thus Africa’s most significant and enduring ethical and spiritual legacies

— *Maulana Karenga*

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 318

318———**Mali Empire**

FURTHER READING

SUNDIATA KEITA’S REIGN

Assman, Jan. (2002). *The Mind of Egypt: History and The historical founder of the Mali Empire was the Meaning in the Time of the Pharaohs*. New York: magician Sundiata Keita (also known as Sundjata Metropolitan Books. This is one of the best works on the or Mari Diata), one of the most legendary figures in nature of Egyptian civilization in the time of the pharaohs.

African history. He is also referred to as the cultural Karenga, Maulana. (1987). *The Husia: Sacred Wisdom of Ancient Egypt*. Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press.

hero and ancestor of the Mande (also known as the This is the first English translation and interpretation of the Mandinka, Malinke, or Manding) people. Born in fundamental ethical principles in the ancient Egyptian text.

approximately 1210, Sundiata was the son of Nare Karenga, Maulana. (2004). *Maat, the Moral Ideal in Ancient Maghan*, the ruler of Kangaba, a small state situated *Egypt: A Study in Classical African Ethics*. New York: on the upper Niger River. He may have left Kangaba Routledge. This book seeks to establish the intellectual as a measure of voluntary exile to avoid a jealous half basis for the rediscovery of African moral ideals .

brother, or he may have been exiled by Sumanguru Kante, king of the Soso, who killed Sundiata's father and took over the kingdom.

Sundiata responded to the yearnings of his people **MALI EMPIRE**

to return to Kangaba to help them regain their independence. He assembled a coalition of Mande chiefs The Mali Empire, located around the upper bound-and, in 1235, he led them to victory in the Battle of aries of the Senegal and the Niger rivers, was the sec-Kirina. According to legend, Sundiata triumphed ond and vastest of the three great empires in West because he was a stronger magician than his opponent Africa. The empire lasted from 1235 until about 1468

Sumanguru was. This victory marked the beginning of and was responsible for uniting the vast interior of the Mali Empire. After overpowering the Soso, West Africa—a mostly inhospitable region of forests, Sundiata merged his authority with the Mande people mountains, savanna, and desert—and home to a rich and established a strong centralized monarchy.

diversity of peoples, including nomads, traders, farm-Sundiata was both a real historical personage and a ers, fishermen, and cattle herders. Mali surpassed the cultural hero, and his rise to power is still celebrated earlier Empire of Ghana in both wealth and influence.

in the Mande-speaking world by *jalis* (often translated Whereas Ghana had flourished by trading West as “griots”). *Jalis* are individuals who inherited and African gold with the Arabs across the Sahara, Mali acquired special knowledge about history, genealo-controlled both the trade and the mining of that gold.

gies, and music and have historically performed a The region had never known such unity and prosper-variety of social and political roles that they continue ity. To understand the history of Africa, an undert to perform today.

standing of Mali is essential. Though the topic of state Sundiata expanded the state by adding to it the for-formation has been a subject of debate in African mer Ghana Empire, with its West African gold fields.

Studies, it is undeniable that Mali became one of He built his capital at Niani, which was his home the huge states of premodern Africa, with a complex region. Under Sundiata, Mali gained fame and eco-governmental structure headed by the king and other nomic strength by controlling the region's trade routes bureaucrats.

and gold fields. Although he was a Muslim, Sundiata At the peak of its existence, the Mali Empire allowed the people to practice their traditional reli-extended across West Africa to the Atlantic Ocean and gions. Thus, the territory controlled by Mali com-included over 50 million people.

Administering such a prised three distinct regions: the Senegal region with vast territory was a formidable task that its founders people speaking Niger-Kongo languages, the central managed by establishing a government sensitive to the Mande states occupied by Soninke and Mande, and diversity of the land, population, and cultures and the region of Gao that was occupied by people who accepting the indigenous rulers and their customs. In spoke Songhay.

essence, Mali was distinguished by its ability to cen-Gold was not Mali's only mainstay, though it was tralize political and military power while allowing the one of the most lucrative. Mali also profited from the local rulers to maintain their identities alongside salt trade over which it had established control. Its Islam.

capital, Niani, was situated on the agriculturally rich

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 319

floodplain of the upper Niger River, with good grazing Mossi kingdom to the south took over a sizable part land farther north. Thus a class of traders emerged in of southern Mali. Also, the kingdom of Gao, which Mali, some of whom were of Mande origin, while had been under the authority of Mali under the rule of others were Bambara, Soninke, and Dyula. In the 14th Mansa Musa, gave rise to a Songhay kingdom that century, cowrie shells were established in Mali as a eventually eclipsed the renowned power of Mali.

form of currency for trading and taxation purposes as The memory of the ancient Mali Empire still Mali continued to prosper. The Mali Empire was built echoes today in the activities of the griots—the pro-from its monopolization of the trade routes from fessional historians, praise singers, and musical enter-western and southern Africa to eastern and northern tainers among the Mande people. Today, the Mande Africa. Though located farther south than Ghana, the are spread over the modern West African states of Malians lived in an agriculturally fertile land.

Mali, Cote d'Ivoire, Guinea, Guinea Bissau, Senegal, However, the bulk of the gold trade proceeded up the Burkina Faso, and the Gambia. They do not enjoy the Niger River, and this gave Mali a firm grip on this level of political unity they experienced under the lucrative monopoly.

historical Mali Empire, but they have maintained a remarkably unified culture. This is perhaps due to the **MANSA KANKAN MUSA'S REIGN**

Mali people's great admiration of their past, and the griots on whom they rely to remind them about their Although Mali flourished in economic wealth and glorious place in history. Of all the griot histories, the influence under Sundiata, it was under Mansa Kankan most revered is that which tells the story of Sundiata Musa that the empire attained the peak of its pros-Keita, the founder and first king of the Mali Empire.

perity. His reign from 1307 to 1337 has often been viewed as the “golden age” of Mali, in both literal and

— *David Shachia Agum*

figurative terms. Mansa Musa, the most significant of the Mali kings, expanded Mali's influence over the **FURTHER READING**

large Niger city-states of Timbuktu, Gao, and Djenne.

Davidson, Basil. (1991). *African Civilization Revisited: From Under him, Timbuktu became one of the major cul-Antiquity to Modern Times*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World tural centers not only of Africa but also of the entire Press. Davidson illustrates the challenge and achievement world. Also, under his patronage, vast libraries were of humankind in Africa's long history through the detailed built and Islamic universities were endowed. Thus, description of the ancient African civilization that is Timbuktu became a meeting place of the finest poets, unmatched by any other civilization in world history.

Niane, D. T. (2000). *Sundiata: An Epic of Old Mali*. London: scholars, and artists of Africa and the Middle East.

Longman. This book captures the oral tradition of the Mali Mansa Musa's wealth became legendary, sup-Empire as told by the griot Mamadou Kouyate. Since the ported by a gold trade with exports that placed Mali at 13th century, Malian griots have told the story of Sundiata, the center of world history. He was a devout Muslim the lion king, who first regained his throne by defeating his who built magnificent mosques all throughout the opponent and uniting the scattered kingdoms of West Mali sphere of influence, and his gold-laden pilgrim-Africa into one strong Mali Empire.

age to Mecca made him a historical figure as West Africa came to be regarded in the whole wide world as a fabled land of riches. Mansa Musa extended the Mali Empire over an area larger than Western Europe

MARCH ON WASHINGTON

during his reign.

In Washington, D.C., on August 28, 1963, more than 250,000 people gathered for a march that to this day **THE DECLINE OF THE EMPIRE**

is said to be the largest gathering on the Lincoln After the death of Mansa Musa, the Mali Empire Memorial and the largest demonstration for human began to decline. A combination of weak and ineffi-rights in U.S. history. People gathered for the March cient rulers and increasingly aggressive raids from its on Washington in the name of freedom. The march, neighbors greatly reduced its powers. In 1430, the which included all people from all walks of life, Tuareg Berbers in the north seized some of Mali's was organized for jobs and civil rights for African cities, including Timbuktu. Barely a decade later, the Americans. This nonviolent event included prayer,

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 320

320——**March on Washington**

song, and one of the most influential speeches of this volunteers managed to pull together a well-organized nation's history—Reverend Martin Luther King Jr.'s march. The official budget for the march was only

“I Have a Dream” speech. Organized by what the \$120,000. Buttons were sold for 25 cents each and press called “the big six,” A. Phillip Randolph, contributions came in from around the country to fund President of the Brotherhood of Sleeping Car Porters; the march. A portfolio-style memento was also sold, Whitney Young, President of the National Urban with *Life* magazine photographs of dog attacks, homes League (NUL); Roy Wilkins, President of the destroyed by fire, and other civil rights movement National Association for the Advancement of Colored pictures; the book was sold for \$1 and 40,000 were People (NAACP); James Farmer, Founder and printed. Celebrities also participated in the cause to President of the Congress of Racial Equality (CORE); raise money. The Friday prior to the march a fundraiser John Lewis, President of the Student Nonviolent concert was put on at the Apollo Theatre in Harlem Coordinating Committee (SNCC); and Martin Luther and well-known artists participated—Josephine Baker, King, Jr., Founder and President of the Southern Thelonious Monk, Herbie Mann, Quincy Jones, and Christian Leadership Conference (SCLC).

Tony Bennet. James Baldwin and Burt Lancaster led a march in Paris in support of the March in Washington.

President Kennedy tried to persuade the leaders of the **THE MOVING SPIRIT**

event to cancel the march, saying, “We want success in **OF A. PHILLIP RANDOLPH**

Congress, not just a big show at the Capitol. . . . Yes, March originator A. Phillip Randolph, whose interest I’m for the bill, but I am damned if I will vote for it at was jobs for African Americans, had attempted to plan the point of a gun.” When he was unable to stop the a mass march on Washington in 1941. In response, march, he publicly supported it.

President Franklin D. Roosevelt, who was fearful of such a massive march, intervened by quickly signing **SECURITY CONCERNS**

an executive order banning discrimination in the defense industries and creating the Fair Employee Police officers were put on high alert, as officials in Practice Committee. Randolph’s vision would not be Washington, D.C., were concerned about violence signed away that easily, however. In 1962, Randolph erupting during the march. Local police and suburban met with Bayard Rustin, who would become the officers were all given riot control training in prepara-deputy director of the march, and they decided that the tion for the event and then called to duty on the day of focus of the march should be economic equality. At the march. Due to the recent events in Birmingham, the time, the country was still feeling the ripple effects where blacks had been attacked by police with water of the recession of 1959, and over a million African hoses, batons, and violent dogs, police dogs were pro-Americans were looking for work. In fact, the black hibited, as was the sale of alcohol for the entire day—

unemployment rate was twice as high as the white for the first time since Prohibition. Officials studied unemployment rate.

70 different emergency patterns and placed nearly However, with the mass violence in Birmingham, 15,000 paratroopers on standby. The police secretly Alabama, and President John F. Kennedy’s civil rights rigged the sound system to enable them to pull the bill still stuck in limbo in Congress, the scope of the plug on it—in case of any violence, they said. In addi-

march changed to equality in regard to civil rights tion, FBI director J. Edgar Hoover and other officials as well as jobs. On June 11, 1963, the same day that tried to sabotage the march numerous times by tap-Kennedy made his civil rights speech, and a day ping the phones of both King and march organizer before the murder of civil rights leader Medgar Evers, Rustin in the months before the event and, on the King announced plans for the march to the press.

morning of the march, by tapping the phones of Some NAACP and NUL members were leery of celebrities in a last minute attempt to force them to getting involved in the march, fearing it would be a withdraw from participating in the march.

violent and controversial event, while groups like But no matter how many wished defeat on the SNCC and CORE, who were a little more radical, March on Washington, through determination and insisted on controversy. But by June all six organiza-by their sheer number, the people triumphed. They tions had agreed to participate. With just 2 months arrived on August 28 in cars, freedom buses, and free-to plan the event, Rustin and his team of CORE

dom trains. A man from Chicago rollerskated the

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 321

Marie Laveau———321

entire trip to Washington, D.C. Media attention to the for the occasion, but halfway into the speech King march was larger than it had ever been for a demon-raised his head up from his notes and begin to impro-stration. All the major networks were present at the vise a new speech, what is said to be one of the great-march, and the media spent over \$300,000 to broadcast speeches in American history. He told the crowd of cast the event. It was also the first of its kind his dream that his children could one day live in a to be televised all over the world. New York's Penn nation where they would be judged not on the color of Station reported the largest early morning crowd since their skin but on the content of their character. He the end of World War II. CORE members from said, "When we allow freedom to ring,

when we let it Brooklyn walked 230 miles over a span of 13 days. By ring from every village and every hamlet, from every 11:00 that morning, more than 200,000 people were at state and every city, we will be able to speed up that the Washington Monument. There a stage was set up day when all God's children, black men and white for the performances of artists such as Bob Dylan, men, Jews and Gentiles, Protestants and Catholics, Odetta, and Peter, Paul, and Mary. By noon, restless will be able to join hands and sing in the words of the demonstrators had begun to march toward the Lincoln old Negro spiritual: Free at last! Free at last! Thank Memorial. March organizers rushed to the front of the God Almighty, we are free at last!"

thrilled demonstrators to lead. The marchers were It is an understatement to say that demonstrators walking and swaying side-to-side singing "We Shall just protested on that day; they made history. No other Overcome." At the Lincoln Memorial Mall, people speech made during the civil rights movement is as wore signs that read "We march for first class citizens famous as King's, and no other demonstration for rights now" and "We march for jobs for all now!"

peace in U.S. history has been larger than the March Archbishop Patrick O'Boyle presented the invoca-on Washington. In his speech and advocacy for equal-tion and then the speeches began. The irony in what ity and peace, King delivered a message that was felt was said that day was that even though the march was from the demonstrators who sat on Lincoln's Mall all partially endorsed by President John F. Kennedy's Civil the way to Capitol Hill. It is said that after King spoke, Rights Bill, some speakers spoke out against the bill, the crowd dispersed and A. Phillip Randolph stood on criticizing it as incomplete. NAACP president Roy the platform alone. As Rustin looked on, he told his Wilkins cried out to President Kennedy to be more friend that it looked like *his* dream came true and active in working for the civil rights of African Randolph replied that it was the most beautiful and Americans; he also spoke about past NAACP president glorious day of his life.

W.E.B Du Bois who had died that morning in Ghana.

— *Thysha M. Shabazz*

Whitney Young spoke about underdeveloped black schools and the role that the students must take to fight **FURTHER READING**

for their education. One of the most controversial speeches of that day was made by 23-year-old John Harding, Vincent. (1981). *There is a River: The Black Struggle* Lewis. He said that if blacks did not receive “meaning-for Freedom in America. New York: Harcourt. Harding ful legislation,” they would march through the South provides a masterful account of the struggle for liberation.

King, Martin Luther, Jr. (2000). *Why We Can't Wait*.

(Randolph replaced “the heart of the Dixie” in the orig-New York: New American Library. (Original work pub-inal speech with “through the South”). Lewis’s speech lished 1963). This is King’s powerful treatise on why was interrupted 4 times by the energetic crowd—

African Americans could not wait for freedom. It is a people stood on their feet in support of what Lewis was poignant and powerful appeal to conscience.

saying. Speakers spoke all day about the inequalities of Saunders, Doris E. (1963). *The Day They Marched*. Chicago: the South and the North and the injustice that African Johnson Publishing Co. This is a very useful examination of Americans experience in America.

demonstrations used to protest discrimination and injustice.

MORAL LEADERSHIP OF THE MARCH

After Mahalia Jackson sang “I’ve Been Buked and **MARIE LAVEAU**

I’ve Been Scorned,” Randolph introduced King as the moral leader of a nation. Martin Luther King stepped Marie Laveau was a 19th-century spiritual figure to the podium to deliver a speech he had prepared just of immense power and prestige in New Orleans,

Louisiana. She appeared to transcend restrictions practitioner to maintain her or his spiritual balance.

based on class, gender, race, and status under enslave-Power in Vodou is marked by spirituality and knowl-ment conditions via an African spiritual system called edge, and not by controlling people or the elements.

Vodou (which is also spelled Vodou and Voodoo).

Vodou operates in all aspects of people's lives, such as Marie Laveau was born in 1801 in New Orleans.

economics, ethics, health, interpersonal relationships, Her mother, Marguerite Darcantel, was a healer of and safety.

African and Native American heritage. Her father, Africans who were brought to New Orleans origi-Charles Laveau, was a plantation owner who served in nally came from a number of African ethnic groups, the state legislature. Her grandmother, Marguerite and so Vodou developed in a unique way as it mixed Semard, was from the Congo. In 1819, she married practices from many African ethnic groups from all Jacques Paris, a freedman, who disappeared shortly parts of Africa. Ironically, enslavers who were threat-after their marriage. She later enjoyed a common law ened by Vodou actually encouraged its globalization.

marriage to Louis Christophe Duminy de Glapion, African spirituality was transplanted with Africans in also a freedman. In 1826, she became a hairdresser America, and the cruel treatment they received under whose clients included the wives and mistresses of chattel enslavement encouraged even stronger spiri-New Orleans's wealthiest men. In 1830, Laveau had tual faith. In New Orleans, Vodou was spiritual resis-become an established Vodou spiritual leader. Using tance to enslavement in its promotion of African knowledge passed down to her within Vodou, she was a identity.

healer, herbalist, diviner, and doctor until her death on Vodou rituals were held secretly at Bayou St. John, June 15, 1881.

at Lake Pontchartrain, and in private homes rather Vodou is a powerful form of ancient African spirit—than publicly. Congo Square was the only place in the city where a significant population of enslaved Africans could legally be brought with them when they came to New Orleans.

gather, and this was permissible only intermittently. Legislative attempts to suppress Vodou appear throughout the history of the city. As consistent historical records from before the Louisiana Purchase reveal, Vodou was not conducive to the esoteric nature of the religion until after Reconstruction. Vodou was feared and thus, Africans practiced Vodou clandestinely and came vilified by officials in New Orleans, and people of African descent suspected of practicing it were persecuted through dances such as the Bamboula and the closely monitored Calinda. Vodou adherents were imprisoned,

tortured, whipped, and murdered. Laws such as the black codes were passed to regulate the behavior of **MARIE LAVEAU'S VODOU PRACTICE**

Africans and prevent them from building altars, congregating for spiritual purposes, making ritual drums, Marie Laveau conducted rituals in the backyard of her house and speaking any African languages. Enslaved house on St. Ann Street, as well as at Maison Blanche, Africans were encouraged to report one another to her home on the shore of Lake Pontchartrain. In addition to authorities. Many Africans feigned a superficial conversion to Christianity to preside over Vodou rituals, Laveau offered Christian conversion and continued to practice Vodou relief to those who came to her privately. Clients in secret.

consulted her about all sorts of problems relating to the spiritual system. The system takes its name from the fertility, finances, health, legal matters, love, luck, African word *vodu*, which translates as “god,” “spirit,”

and protection. She supplied guidance and spiritual

“serving or following the spirits,” or “the snake under amulets—called gris-gris, ju-ju, or mojo—which whose auspices gather all who share the faith.” The were used to ask for the intervention of certain spirits. A snake represents balance, clairvoyance, life force, and to cause certain events to occur or as

protection. She wisdom. According to Vodou, events are causal, linked also enlisted the use of altars, anointing oils, baths, to one another through an intricate network of cosmo-brick dust, candles, colognes, dolls, floor washes, logical interdependence. An omnipresent creator is incense, powders, seals, soaps, statues, and talismans manifested through myriad intermediary ancestral and in her practice. Through her practice of Vodou, and her nature spirits. These spirits can bring good or harm, prescriptions requiring patients' willing participation, and they must be honored in rituals that recognize Laveau taught people that they were agents in their these sacred interrelationships in order for the Vodou own well-being.

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 323

Maroon Societies——323

Vodou recognizes the interconnectedness of nature living in New Orleans who were denied and distrustful and spirit, so in Vodou herbs play a significant role in of basic medical care depended on African healers sustaining good health. Laveau used her medicinal like Laveau to treat their physical, mental, emotional, skill and herbal knowledge to tend to those wounded and spiritual ailments. Marie Laveau centered Vodou as in the Battle of New Orleans. She was asked by the an intricate part of life at a time in history when many city of New Orleans to help with those stricken by the outsiders sought to annihilate African culture. Her epidemics rampant during the 1850s, which infected autonomous actions maintained Vodou's centrality of people with yellow fever, cholera, malaria, and small-ancient African spirituality in daily life.

pox. Marie Laveau was an intelligent businesswoman.

— *Wendy Carmen Trott*

She was given gifts and paid money for her successful assistance with the problems people brought to her.

FURTHER READING

Her home on St. Anne Street was reputedly one of those payments. Laveau altruistically shared this Gandolfo, Charles. (1992). *Marie Laveau of New Orleans*.

wealth; she supported her children, grandchildren, and New Orleans: New Orleans Historic Voodoo Museum. This great-grandchildren. She also took people in need of is an excellent introduction to the life of Marie Laveau.

Haskins, Jim. (1990). *Voodoo and Hoodoo*. New York: assistance into her home. She visited prisoners, those Scarborough House. Haskins has the ability to translate who were sick as well as those who were awaiting important ideas in ways that can be understood by the lay execution, and brought them food and helped them reader.

build altars in their cells.

Klein, Victor. (1999). *New Orleans Ghosts II*. Metairie, LA: People of African descent, whether enslaved or Lycanthrope Press. This book delves into the legend of the free, were considered insignificant in New Orleans great Marie Laveau and other figures of New Orleans.

and thus often were privy to the personal affairs of the city's most prominent citizens. Enslaved and free Africans informed Marie Laveau of what they learned, and, as a hairdresser, she herself learned **MAROON SOCIETIES**

much firsthand from her white clientele's gossip.

Laveau used this knowledge of the power structure in During the 17th and 18th centuries, particularly in the New Orleans, as well as her talent as a Vodou practi-West Indies and Guyana, enslaved Africans who man-tioner, to protect and maintain Vodou. People of aged to escape and become fugitives were known as European descent were among Laveau's clients and Maroons and formed Maroon societies. The spirit in ritual participants. Her expertise and knowledge these fugitives that desired to be free was the basis of earned her friendship and acceptance, and she used the system of these societies. In fact, the tension her social position to encourage continuation of between the desire of enslaved Africans to be human African spirituality.

and free and the obsession of Europeans to degrade Neither Marie Laveau's predecessors—Sanite Dede, and enslave them is reflected in the historical clash Carlos, John Montenet, and Dr. Yah Yah—nor her representing race relations in the Americas. Africans contemporaries—among them Malvina Latour, James who were enslaved never lost their desire to be free.

Alexander, and even Laveau's own daughter, Marie Maroon societies were established throughout the Philomene Laveau Glapion—attained the unification of African diaspora. Across the Americas—North, the Vodou community in New Orleans that Laveau had Central, and South—whenever and wherever the expertly accomplished. Marie Laveau was entombed in opportunity to be free presented itself, Africans St. Louis Cemetery, and although it has been more than suffering the brutality of involuntary servitude would a century since her passing, gifts and offerings including seek to get away from those they believed to be alcohol (red anisette liqueur and rum), bags, beads, evil and obsessed with exploiting African people.

bones, candles, candy, cigarettes, cigars, coins, flowers, Communities of freedom seekers were located in food, herbs, money, and various other items are still left swamps, bayous, heavily wooded areas, mountainous for Marie Laveau by those paying reverence and seek-terrains, and other isolated areas hidden away from ing her intervention as an ancestor.

mainstream populations.

Marie Laveau was influential throughout the social Some of the well-known Maroon societies were strata of New Orleans. People of African heritage located in Brazil, Jamaica, Ecuador, and Haiti.

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 324

324——**Maroon Societies**

Maroon societies were also founded in the United grammatical structures from their primary languages States in such places as Louisiana, Virginia, North to the languages of the oppressive groups within the Carolina, South Carolina, Kentucky, and Tennessee.

new lands, creating Creoles, Ebonics, Gullah, Brazilian These societies were also in place in Surinam, Panama, Portuguese, and other Africanized forms of language.

Mexico, Honduras, Venezuela, and Colombia. In these The African ancestors of diasporic Africans placed societies, men, women, and children from various identifiable linguistic markings on the languages they African cultural groups were armed and prepared to were forced to adopt in the new lands. Contemporary defend themselves against intruders who threatened archaeologists, in studying and examining African their liberty.

burial sites and plantations, are finding numerous The constant driving force and irresistible goal of artifacts that attest to the continuation of African the Maroons was to be free and African. Wherever culture within the new lands. In the name of being bondage existed, resistance emerged. Technically, human and African, men and women from various Maroon societies (called Quilombo by Afro-Brazilians African cultural groups armed themselves so that they and called Palenques, Cimarroneras, and Cumbes in were prepared to defend themselves against any act Spanish colonies) were communities established by or agent that threatened their liberty.

liberated Africans who fled the unnatural condition of The enslavers were equally determined and relent-chattel slavery. The term *Maroon* originates from the less in their efforts to prevent the loss of their prop-Spanish *Cimarron*, meaning “a run away or wild ani-erty. Africans were met with an insidious assault on mal.” During chattel slavery, the captured African was their psychological and physical value. In a shameful considered to be property and, therefore, the term attempt to justify the institution of slavery, the best *Maroon* or “run away animal” was misapplied to the minds in the fields of psychiatry and psychology, for African human being who resisted slavery and escaped instance, described Africans as mentally ill by nature, in order to live in the natural human condition of free-making it necessary for white people to control them.

dom. Maroon societies represented African resistance Samuel Cartwright identified two mental diseases to chattel slavery and dehumanization. They repre-that he claimed were symptomatic of black people and sented the

acceptance and recognition of their inalienable right to be African and free. One disease, *Drapetomania*, able right to be African and free.

he described as an ailment that caused enslaved The Maroons exhibited dauntless courage and deter-African people to have an uncontrollable urge to mination, allowing nothing to impede their claim to flee from their masters. The prescribed treatment for liberty. The Maroon communities provided a place to this illness was brutal beating. The other disease, establish, maintain, and defend their liberty on their *Dyaesthesia Aethiopsis*, was said to affect both the own cultural grounds. Obviously, the survival of these minds and bodies of Africans. The symptoms of this communities depended on the Maroons' raiding nearby ailment included being disobedient, answering dis-plantations for food, livestock, and clothing. The pur-respectfully, and refusing to perform labor. The pre-pose of these raids was also to liberate others from scribed remedy was to force patients to carry out bondage. The Europeans created a punitive system as a extremely difficult and rigorous chores that were deterrent to maroonage—if Africans were recaptured, believed to send vitalized blood to the brain to give they risked suffering severe, inhuman punishments liberty to the mind. These were considered to be legit-such as amputations, floggings, or even death.

imate psychological and therapeutic cures and interventions utilized to restrict running away.

THE SOCIETIES' PRESERVATION

OF AFRICAN CULTURE

THE EXTENT OF THE SOCIETIES

In spite of the bestiality and savagery of slavery, Knowledge of Maroon communities spread through-African culture was able to continue and expand in the out the plantations. The sites of these communities liberated territory. In freedom and in bondage, were most likely seen as African lands or places where Africans Africanized everything. African languages, the culture, traditions, and beliefs of African people for example, experienced the process of hybridization were free to be experienced. In the minds of the many as the different groups commingled and sought lin-Africans trapped

in bondage and oppression, Maroon guistic and cultural unity. Africans transferred the communities were more than safe havens—they were

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 325

Maroon Societies——325

icons of hope and freedom and a stimulus for **THE SOCIETIES'**

resistance. To these free places escaped and liberated **DETERMINATION TO**

Africans brought cultural templates from throughout **MAINTAIN INDEPENDENCE**

the African continent, including Nigeria, Dahomey, the Gold Coast (Ghana), Angola, the Congo, and The process of dehumanization and cultural destruc-Mozambique. These Africans were identified as tion fueled Africans' determination to transform their Ewe-Fon, Efik, Yoruba, the Fante-Asante, as well condition from enslavement to freedom and was the as Sudanese Muslims and Mandinkas. They spoke impetus to their engaging in their own salvation, Lingala, Manding, Yoruba, Twi, Ibo, and other lan-recreation, and reinvention. It was common for the guages. Groups and individuals finding their way to plantation owners to separate families—children and the communities brought their culture kits, which car-their parents, husbands and wives, and family ried patterns for beliefs, religious practices, traditions, members and members of their extended families.

mores, and festivals and enabled them to recreate the These and other cruel acts on the part of enslavers familiar societies they had known in Africa.

inspired entire families to seek refuge elsewhere.

The communities of Quilombos and Palenques are Fortunately, networking systems existed between the reputed to have become places where diverse popula-Maroon communities and captives in outlying areas tions were able to meld together with the common on farms and plantations; those who

were part of such goal of being African and, by so doing, perpetuate systems rescued enslaved Africans seeking freedom African culture. The African sense of agency and provided them with shelter.

responded to enslavement in three distinct ways: The indomitable African spirit in its quest to be free resistance, revolt, and recreation. Resistance against refuses to disappear or to rest until all Africans have slavery took many forms. The flight of African cap-been liberated and live within an equitable society.

tives was one form of resistance that may have begun This spirit resides in men, women, and children. It as early as the 1500s, during the formation of the continues to reincarnate throughout the generations.

Spanish colonies. Some of the captives escaped and Some of the Maroon communities are still operating found safe havens among Native American groups.

under the peace treaties that were established nearly However, it is the act of recreation that best describes 200 years ago. Many past and present Maroon leaders maroonage. The establishment of Maroon communi-can be named and have become part of pan-African ties indicated Africans' rebellion against the inhuman history: Queen Nanny in Jamaica; King Zumbi in conditions suffered while they were in bondage and, Palmares in Brazil; Diego de Guzman in the Dominican more important, their yearning for and achievement of Republic; Nyanga or Yanga, the Liberator in Mexico; freedom.

Loangos in Venezuela; Lorenza Smallwood, a conjure In the antebellum South, involuntary servitude was man, and Grace Sherwood, both of the Dismal Swamp the rule of the day. For the African captives forced into in the United States; and Toussaint L'Ouverture servitude, this meant demonstrating their discontent in in Haiti.

a remarkable variety of ways. The numerous forms The same indomitable spirit of the Maroon can be ranged from damaging equipment,

feigning

seen in African communities throughout the diaspora.

illness, and refusing to do certain work to outright vio-The struggle to recreate, transform, and promote lent confrontations. The institution of slavery was a societies that respect the rights to liberty and equality serious form of exploitation, which was accompanied of all people continues. Exemplary of this undying by the notion that the captive African was not a com-spirit are settlements and towns such as Allensworth, plete human being and thereby could be considered Rosewood, and Eatonville in the United States; Nanny property. Thus special laws were put in place to pro-Town and Accompong in Jamaica; the Republic of tect the farmers and plantation owners, while the Palmares in Brazil; the community of Yanga in enslaved Africans did not have human rights but were Mexico; and Haiti.

obligated to those who had purchased them. Like What must be clearly stated is that the act of estab-chattel, they could be bought and sold and forced to lishing a Maroon community was more than resisting reproduce to supply laborers for the benefit of the oppression or revolting against slavery. The establish-plantation owners and mining officials who had ment of Maroon societies was a conscious attempt on complete power over them.

the part of African ancestors of diasporic Africans to

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 326

326———Mdw Ntr

recreate Africa. The creation of Maroon societies The ancient Egyptians were well aware of the should be understood as an intentional act of location various uses and connotations of their language. They and agency of free African human beings. It is the made distinctions among the standard language they recreation of Africa. It is Africans' overwhelming used for official documents and standard texts and the desire and irresistible urge to be free and African, and language they used in casual conversation, common not just their need to escape from enslavement, that everyday writing, and literature. Literature was called must be understood as the basis for Maroon societies.

mdw nfrt, meaning “beautiful speech” or “beautiful words,” and the scribes or artists who could compose

— *Vera DeMoultrie Nobles*

them were called *nfr mdw*, meaning “beautiful of **FURTHER READING** speech.”

Carey, Bev. (1997). *The Maroon Story*. Kingston, Jamaica: Agouti Press. Carey, a Maroon and a descendant of Maroons, **RECENT DISCOVERIES**

provides an inside look into the Maroon heritage of Recent discoveries by Gunter Dreyer the director of Jamaica from 1490 to 1880 and clarifies that African values, traditions, and customs were in operation there.

the German Archaeological Institute suggest that Leaming, Hugo P. (1995). *Hidden Americans: Maroons of* Mdw Ntr is not only the oldest attested African lan-Virginia and the Carolinas. New York: Garland. This book guage but very well may be the oldest attested written makes visible the reestablishment of African communities script in the world. Using writing

samples from a as Maroon settlements within the United States. It is critical-cemetery area near Abydos, known as the “Mother of calligraphy important for an understanding of the weaving of Pots” because of the numerous amounts of pottery re-Africanization into the cloth of black nationalism.

discovered there, Dreyer has carbon dated with certainty these writings to between 3300 and 3200

B.C.E., which is some 5,300 years ago.

MDW NTR

Mdw Ntr first appeared in writing shortly before 4000 B.C.E. and remained in active use until the 11th century. *Kemet* (KMT) means “black country” or “black land,” making it the longest continually used word in the world. Beginning with the Muslim conquest of Egypt in 641 C.E., Arabic gradually replaced Greek encounter with it in 800 B.C.E. as ancient replaced Egyptian as the dominant language in Egypt.

Egypt. The word *Egypt* is derived from the Greek Like Latin, Egyptian is considered a dead language, *aegyptios*. The word *aegyptios* is derived from the and it can only be studied in writing, though it is still ancient Egyptian word *hwt-k3-ptḥ*, meaning “the sanctuary spoken in the rituals of the old Egyptian Christian community of Ptah.” *Pṯḥ*, or Ptah, was the indigenous name of the community called the Coptic Church and among members of Memphis, the capital of Kemet in the Old Kingdom.

of the Auset, a religious group begun by the The ancient Egyptians called their writing system Hieroglyphic Panamanian philosopher Shekem ur Shekhem.

Mdw Ntr (pronounced Medu Neter), which means

“god’s word” or “divine word.” Scholars in Black **THE HISTORY OF MDW NTR**

Studies often use the term *Mdw Ntr* to refer to the ancient Egyptian language in all periods, and they Most scholars classify Mdw Ntr history

into five therefore may use the term interchangeably with major phases.

hieroglyphics. However, many Western writers have come to use the term *hieroglyphics* to refer to the 1. Old Egyptian is the name given to the oldest Egyptian language and script. The term *hieroglyph* known phase of the language. While Egyptian comes from two Greek words meaning “sacred carv-writing existed before 3000 B.C.E., the early ings.” The system as a whole is called *hieroglyphic* inscriptions are only of labels and names. Old (not hieroglyphics). The hieroglyphic script gave birth Egyptian proper is dated from approximately to the Hieratic and Demotic scripts. In fact, the 2600 B.C.E., when the first connected texts Hieratic and Demotic scripts are merely simplified appeared. This phase of the language lasted cursive forms of the original hieroglyphic signs.

until around 2100 B.C.E.

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 327

Mdw Ntr———327

2. Middle Egyptian, sometimes called Classical The placement of Mdw Ntr into the Afro-Asiatic Egyptian, is closely related to the Old Egyptian.

family has been a surreptitious way of maintaining It first appeared in writing around 2100 B.C.E.

that the ancient Egyptians were at best Caucasians and and survived as a spoken language for some at least Semitic. The Afro-Asiatic linguistic classifica-500 years, but it has remained the standard tion is an attempt to separate ancient Kemeti lan-hieroglyphic language for the rest of Egyptian guage from its African context. The Afro-Asiatic history. Middle Egyptian is the phase of the lan-linguistic classification was rejected by the body of guage that is most often taught at universities Egyptologists who attended the International and in language programs.

Colloquium held in Cairo in 1974 on the Peopling of the Nile Valley. These scholars collectively agreed that 3. Late Egyptian began to replace Middle

Egyptian language could not be separated from its Egyptian as the spoken language after 1600

African context. In addition, most recent scholarship B.C.E., and it remained in use until about 600

has demonstrated that five of the six of the languages B.C.E. Though descended from Old and Middle grouped in the so-called Afro-Asiatic linguistic cate-Egyptian, Late Egyptian differed substantially gory have an African origin. Indeed, Ancient Egyptian from the earliest phase of the language, particu-is a branch of African languages spoken by black lar in grammar. Traces of Late Egyptian can be Africans in antiquity.

found in texts earlier than 1600 B.C.E., but it Middle Egyptian is the phase of Mdw Ntr most did not appear as a full written language until commonly studied in universities. Many of the after 1300 B.C.E.

sources needed to adequately study ancient Egyptian 4. Demotic developed out of late Egyptian. The are in French and German. In fact, most universities vernacular successor to Late Egyptian, it first require that students have a reading comprehension of appeared around 650 B.C.E. and survived until both French and German before they will accept them the 5th century C.E.

into advanced studies of the ancient Middle Egyptian 5. Coptic is the name given to the final phase of language Mdw Ntr.

Egyptian, which is closely related to Demotic. It

— *Troy D. Allen*

appeared at the end of the 1st century C.E., and it was spoken for nearly a thousand years. The last **FURTHER READING**

known texts written by native speakers of Coptic Allen, James P. (2000). *Middle Egyptian Grammar: An date to the 11th century*. This is the only stage of *Introduction to the Language and Culture of the the language in*

which the vocalic structure is *Hieroglyphs*. Cambridge, UK: Cambridge University known and distinct dialects are recognized.

Press. This is an excellent work that includes lessons on Mdw Ntr with answers in the back of the text, as well as When classifying ancient Kemetic language genet-information on the culture and history of ancient Egypt.

ically, most scholars adhere to the linguistic classifi-Buck, Adrian De. (1963). *Egyptian Reading Book*. Leiden: cation set forth by Joseph Greenberg in his work Nederlands Instituut voor het Nabije Oosten. This is one of *Studies in African Linguistic Classification*. It was the best small books published for those interested in beginning the study of the ancient Egyptian language.

Greenberg who suggested the name Afro-Asiatic to Faulkner, Raymond O. (1962) *Concise Dictionary of Middle* replace the entrenched and racially charged name *Egyptian*. Oxford, UK: Griffith Institute Ashmolean Hamito-Semitic. While the name Hamito-Semitic was Museum. This is the essential dictionary for students of the changed, the underlying racial theory that implied that language.

the original speakers of these languages were Gardiner, Alan H. (1994). *Egyptian Grammar* (3rd ed.).

Caucasian or black-skinned whites is still applied Oxford, UK: Griffith Institute Ashmolean Museum. This is erroneously to Afro-Asiatic. Currently, this linguistic the essential work in English for any student of the ancient Egyptian language Mdw Ntr.

family consists of six branches: Ancient Egyptian, Mohktar, G. (Ed.). (1978). *The General History of Africa: Akkadian-Hebrew-Arabic, Berber, Chadic, Cushitic, Studies and Documents, Proceedings of the Symposium* and Omotic. However, the science of historical lin-Held in Cairo from 28 January to 3 February 1974.

guistics has not yet been able to satisfactorily recon-Berkeley: University of California Press. This work pro-struct this language family.

vides a transcript and record of the topics debated by

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 328

328———**Melanin Theory**

Cheikh Anta Diop and Theophile Obenga during the Cairo distinct ethnic identity intact. What follows is the Colloquium on the Peopling of the Ancient Egypt.

victimization of African people, particularly males, Obenga, Theophile. (2002). *KMT Language Through Primary* within society. The tools used in the victimization *Texts: Original Data—Precise Examination—Comment*.

of African males are fashioned in many shapes and San Francisco: Ankh. This is a good introduction to ancient forms but are all for the singular purpose of European Egyptian language, culture, and history from an Afrocentric perspective.

genetic survival. African women are not primarily www.ankhonline.com This is an important Web site for those targeted, as it is believed that females are more sus-interested in the study of ancient African civilizations and ceptible to assimilation into Eurocentric society and cultures.

are less able to stage effective resistance to European www.agorafrica.com This Web site provides information on genetic domination.

many aspects of African culture, both ancient and modern.

The various forms in which attacks against African It is a useful guide to the contemporary discourses in males are carried out are institutionally ingrained into African Studies.

society. The systematic marginalization of African males is perpetuated in order to emasculate them. This emasculation process comes in the form of unemployment, imprisonment, political disenfranchisement, **MELANIN THEORY**

social marginalization, a depressed view of their African origins, and so on. The evidence that melanin theory holds that melanin controls people's theorists point to in making this case is the exponential responses to various social stimuli. The melanin content increase in African male incarceration rates, along with that of an individual is a hereditary trait that is passed with the expansion of the prison industrial complex; on from parents to offspring. Melanin is found in all the steadily rising African male unemployment levels; human beings, with the concentration being higher African homosexuality; African male unaccountability in people of African descent than it is in people of it; the lack of presence of the African adult male in European descent. Melanin has many qualities, and the home setting; increasing African male homicide contributes to many bodily functions and traits, such as rates; and so on.

as skin complexion and hair texture.

Melanin theory is associated with the writings of **MELANIN THEORY**

Richard King, Frances Cress Welsing, and to some **APPLIED TO SOCIAL ISSUES**

extent, Marimba Ani. There are several others who adhere to the idea that melanin influences an individual. The issue of homosexuality among Africans is given equal spiritual sensitivity. Frances Cress Welsing, a psychiatrist, great consideration as an indicator of the emasculation of the African male, in her book *The Isis Papers: The Keys to the Colors* of the African male. According to the melanists, the *Colors*, suggests that there is currently a color-conscious European worldview encourages homosexuality, in confrontation with the world resulting from the efforts of contrast to the traditional African worldview in which specific groups to perpetuate their own ethnicity. She homosexuality is taboo. Thus applicability of the writes that Europeans' struggle to perpetuate their scientific model of cause and effect is demonstrable ethnicity is a difficult one in that the genes that perpetuate African characteristics are dominant in the setting, and the dependent variable, sexual orientation, is determined by the recessive genes of Europeans. Therefore, are considered. This model is supportive of Frances Cress Welsing's theory of color confrontation. In the setting will bear distinctly African characteristics. The

color of modern-day color confrontational America, African confrontation delineated in melanin theory occurs males are taking on the contextually definable role of because of the Europeans' struggle to genetically being passively emasculated. According to the theory, survive as ethnicities intertwine.

this is indicated by homosexuality. The change in set-According to melanists, the color confrontation is ting that also produces a change in sexual orientation the result of insecurity in Europeans, particularly is explained by the color confrontation being in an males. The argument asserts that Europeans will stop active state of existence. Cress Welsing insinuates that at nothing in order to survive with their genetically the emasculation of the African male characterized by

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 329

Messianism——329

homosexuality is detrimental to the black community.

themes; however, it retains an enthusiastic following She goes even further by offering tactics to be in the lay community.

employed primarily by black women in order to avert

— *Gwinyai Muzorewa*

the current situation. She urges black women to rear their sons from an early age toward masculinity and accountability.

FURTHER READING

Cress Welsing also mandates that for the sake of Bynum, Edward Bruce. (1999). *The African Unconscious: Roots* genetic survival, black people should defer acquiring of *Ancient Mysticism and Modern Psychology*. New York: material goods and instead focus on protecting and sup-Teachers College Press. Bynum's book is a comprehensive porting their ethnic group, even at the cost of their lives.

discussion of the African roots of modern psychology.

Cress Welsing, Frances. (1991). *The Isis Papers: The Keys to the Colors*. Chicago: Third World Press. This would then halt the passive role African men *to the Colors*. This is Cress assume in the color confrontation. This tactic is sug-Welsing's major work on the theory of color and the gested in order to reverse the African American trend of confrontation between whites and blacks.

assimilating into the status quo of African extinction.

King, Richard D. (1990). *African Origin of Biological* Cress Welsing asserts that the color conflict is the basis *Psychiatry*. Germantown, TN: Seymour-Sith. This is one of for the racism practiced in the world. According to the key works by the pioneer of the melanin theory.

progenitors of the melanin theory, genetic survival is the basis for the practice of oppression.

Cress Welsing sees the symbolism of this oppression based on color exemplified in sports. The balls **MESSIANISM**

used in various sports are each of a particular color specific to a given sport. Cress Welsing contends that Messianism is, among other things, the belief in a sav-the balls used are an incessant reminder of the color ior. African American history has provided researchers confrontation. For example, the basketball and the and theorists with fertile ground for the discussion of football are typically brown. Scoring, which is a direct messianism among the oppressed. The term *messian-method of winning*, is characterized in basketball by ism is borrowed from Christian theology, but it is often the balls passing through the round white net, and in used in the context of the African American condition, football by kicking the brown ball through white, where suffering, pain, and degradation have under-upright posts. The correlations here are whites' repet-scored the need for a deliverer. Thus, the history of itive demonstrations of fear and schizophrenic fasci-African Americans may be written as the history of nation with the African male apparatus of procreation the many attempts to find someone who would answer and with European genetic domination. The African all of the questions surrounding the existence of an male phallus is denoted by the

brown balls used in the oppressed people. It is possible to look at the great respective sports, and the domination is emphasized deliverer tradition as producing the panoply of David by a white vaginallike net and two upright posts, which Walker, Nat Turner, Henry Highland Garnett, depict white women's legs. Cress Welsing goes further-Frederick Douglass, Sojourner Truth, Harriet Tubman, then to suggest that the greatest symbolism of white Booker T. Washington, Marcus Garvey, Martin Luther supremacy is of a European depiction of Jesus, as he King, Jr., and Malcolm X.

hangs from a brown wooden cross. The European Accompanying this tradition, which is basically image of Jesus is synonymous with European men secular, has been a religious tradition rooted in the dying because of the gigantic phallus of the African idea of spiritual deliverance. Thus, personalities such as man. The phallus of African men is connoted by the as Father Divine, Elijah Muhammad, Daddy Grace, brown wooden cross. Cress Welsing views this and Louis Farrakhan often appear larger than life removal of the cross from the body of Jesus, as in the because they seem to have the answers to the issues Bible story, as symbolically insinuating the castration confronting the community. Messianism is not simply of the black man, which would serve the purpose of the belief in a savior; it is sometimes also the accep-guaranteeing the survival of European genes. Melanin tance of that mantle by an individual who assumes theory is not widely adhered to and has been criticized that he or she has special or unique powers of deliver-for its seemingly heavy reliance on essentialist ance. The study of leadership in the African American

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 330

330——Middle Passage

community has revealed their tendency to believe in The tendency of 21st-century U.S. scholars has been messiahs who often are characterized by dogmatism, to focus on geography and consider the impact of the strict codes of conduct, and a sense of infallibility.

Middle Passage on the North American boundaries of Racial redemption seems to be an esoteric compo-the American state. In many ways, this has precluded nent of messianism. In effect, it is the role of the mes-examination

and analysis of the Middle Passage and its siah to defeat evil, to overcome racial exclusion, and repercussions in the Caribbean and Central and South to bring in a new day when equality and justice will America. Scholars' temporal assumptions revolve be the calling cards of society. Messianism's appeal around the year 1807, when the U.S. Constitution in the African American community is based on its called for the legal termination of the transatlantic slave logic of defiance and its magnetic character. The trade, and the year 1830, when both the United States messiah is automatically a person of charisma, one and Great Britain took naval action to proscribe it.

who believes that change can come, particularly if The Middle Passage and the transatlantic slave human beings would only listen to what the messiah trade are conventionally regarded as one event, an has to say.

event that was ended by the mid-19th-century activities of the British and American governments.

— Molefi Kete Asante

*However, this view fails to acknowledge that the Middle Passage continued to be used by the slave **FURTHER READING***

trade after legislation prohibited it in 1807 and 1830.

Essien-Udom, E. U. (1995). Black Nationalism: A Search for Slave traders continued throughout the 19th century to an Identity in America. Chicago: University of Chicago refine their methods for ever greater profits by sacri-Press. This book remains one of the most authoritative ficing the health and lives of the millions of Africans studies on the Nation of Islam.

who were brought to the Americas. The fact that Johnson, James Weldon. (1956). Black Manhattan. New York: Columbia University Press. In this book, one of the great-enslaved Africans had an enormous impact on con-est African American intellectuals gives his account of the structing the societies of the Americas until the close development of culture and organizational leadership and of the 19th century is obscured by the unanalyzed direction in the largest American city.

assumption that legislation ended the slave trade. This Smith, Robert, and Walters, Ronald. (1999). *African American assumption also misses the effect on Africans of the Leadership*. Albany: State University of New York Press.

ships themselves, which defined a group of people as Here two distinguished African American political scienc-African in the space between one shore and the next.

tists provide a panoramic view and comprehensive assess-The ships served as a crucible whose literal and figu-ment of the theory and praxis of leadership in the African American community.

rative heat gave birth to a new African person. Thus what follows here is a challenge to the conventional temporal assumptions that (1) the use of the Middle Passage for the transatlantic slave trade ended with the **MIDDLE PASSAGE**

legislation that prohibited it—it was not abolished, and (2) by the beginning of the U.S. Civil War, there was The Middle Passage was the dreadful passage across no Atlantic slave trade and therefore no Middle the Atlantic Ocean made by Africans—who were Passage. Both continued to the cusp of the 20th cen-forced into tight quarters with inadequate food and tury with serious ramifications and consequences.

water and the ill and dying among them—for several The horrors and the magnitude of the Middle weeks or even months en route to being sold into slav-Passage are irrefutable and inescapable. While there ery. The Middle Passage and the transatlantic slave might be debate over the number of Africans, debate trade are inextricably linked, with an examination of that sometimes reflects historiography and the role of the Middle Passage serving to illuminate one aspect history as rationale, it is clear that tens of millions of the incalculable tragedy of Africans' enslavement.

were dragged from their homes in the largest known Geographical and temporal factors contribute to our expatriation in history and that millions—possibly understanding of the Middle Passage, but considering tens of millions—lost their lives in the process. It is, only these factors is a

disservice to the scope and in fact, those conditions, the conditions of death, and impact of abominable human suffering of the Middle as important, survival that characterize the Middle Passage.

Passage and its implications.

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 331

Middle Passage——331

THE SLAVE TRADERS' CALCULUS

Hemisphere; in smaller slave ships, which were sometimes built for greater speed and maneuverability; and as a result of technological innovations to the and discourse on the Middle Passage has been ships, such as copper sheathing. These innovations reduced to “science,” by which is meant the science of were tied to an economic calculus of demographics.

today's cliometric historians. They attempt to measure The early trade and the consequent passage consisted the impact of the Middle Passage in its most quantifiable-predominately of young African males. The popularable terms. Interpreting the statistical data, the historical patterns on both sides of the Atlantic prompted and have come to various conclusions about the notions and debates that concerned the infinite supply Middle Passage. Some historians assert that the sheer of such a labor force and its expendability. This calculus underscores incalculable horrors, whereas lous disregard for Africans characterized discussions others, while never calling the slave trade humanitarian-associated with the Middle Passage. Such discussions can, argue that as it was refined, conditions improved centered on a population that could always be replenished-for those forced to endure the Middle Passage.

ished, no matter what the losses. Therefore, when the The numbers are these: From 10 to 20 million edicts and actions of 1807 and 1830 dictated that the Africans were shipped during a period of some 4 centuries-journey across the Middle Passage enter a new phase, centuries, over a distance of approximately 3,000 miles, one in keeping with the goal of maximization of

profit on a journey lasting anywhere from 3 weeks to its through stealth, speed, and tonnage, new demographic-3 months. The loss of African lives during the Middle Passage and new models of labor efficiency helped Passage ranged from 5% in the last quarter of the 18th century to maintain their profit margins and rationalize century to staggering rates estimated as high as 70%

risk.

for the entire process of the trade from capture The legal prohibition of and illicit trade in enslaved through seasoning. In addition, this was over the Africans actually may have helped to increase tonnage of the 19th century, during which mortality in voyage and profitability in three ways. First, from 1810

general increased.

on, and decidedly after 1850, children made up to This “scientific,” almost clinical enumeration and 40% of cargoes and women a further 15%. The pre-the analytical discourse that accompanies it are consequence of such a high percentage of children created a quences of the scientific age that also spawned the higher person per ton ratio, and their being young may modern concept of inequalities between the races and have been thought to add to their potential productivity-thus enabled one race to enslave another. It was these ity. Second, the additional concentration of women

“scientific” notions of race and racialized slavery that must have added significantly to the reproduction of provided the rationales for the “slave traders’ calculation-labor in this second phase of the Middle Passage’s loss” and the official policies that regulated the longevity. Third, the increase in both children and Africans’ journey through the Middle Passage. Thus women in the vessels making the Middle Passage in debates concerning the “tight packing” or “loose this period meant that the ratio of crew to enslaved packing” of captive Africans bound for the Americas Africans might be drastically reduced during the voyage-could be judged scientifically in regard to the number age, a clear reduction in the economy of labor.

of humans who might be inhumanely crammed into However, while those in the slave trade continued to vessels whose holds were filled with Africans nearly profit, captive Africans continued to experience to the point of suffocating them. "Packing" was regu-trauma, suffering, illness, and death during all phases lated by a "science" that matched ship tonnage with of the Middle Passage. In fact, as the illness and the possibilities of maximum profit. It was calculated death of Africans increased during the 19th century

that on average there should be "two and a half slaves particularly among children—so too must the trauma per ton," with ship tonnage calculated against the of psychic and cultural dislocation have increased.

length of the voyage. There were instances, however, in which the number of captives on a single vessel **THE AFRICANS' EXPERIENCE**

exceeded this ratio by almost 50%.

The voyage was shorter and more bearable in Some of the most potent history of diasporic Africans direct trips from the African coast to the American is in their resistance. The "Ibo Landing" of Daughters port in question in either the Southern or Northern of the Dust is simply one metaphor of that resistance;

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 332

332——**Middle Passage**

a metaphor that has been repeated time and time again those who survived. There were many Africans who as a paradigm of the ultimate act of resistance. Such found misery, suffering, and death on the Middle resistance emphasized the distinct philosophical Passage, but there were also many Africans who notions that undergirded the conceptualizations of showed incalculable strength and resilience as well liberty and freedom among Africans on the Middle as philosophical conviction. The story of the Middle Passage and the extremes to which they might go to Passage, from slave ships to mutinies to mass suicides secure it. In an age where property was deemed parato insurance policies, is not just a story of the enslave-mount,

and where they themselves were defined as ment of Africans but also a centuries-long story of property, Africans who resisted denied those who African survival and resistance at sea.

sought to reduce them to mere things, to property, the The holds of these ships, which contained the energy power to do so. The first phase of the Middle Passage, of resistance and survival in the Middle Passage, as the slave vessel lay off coast partially filled, was became the crucible in which captive Africans con-suffused with the constant threat of a slave mutiny.

structed a material, intellectual, and philosophical cul-Even within sight of Western shores, there was noth-ture, as well as what was to become African American ing to protect investors from an epidemic of African consciousness. This consciousness began in the Middle suicide at the last moment. As exceptional as accounts Passage with resistances to enslavement at sea, in an of mutiny and mass suicide may be, these and other incalculably cramped space, in a void that was thought accounts of resistance solidified a record of African to preclude any thought of or movement toward free-rebellion in the Middle Passage. This record provided dom, resistances that included onboard insurrections a preamble to the observation that the stretch of the and mass suicides.

transatlantic slave trade conscribed by the shores of In viewing the slave ships on the Middle Passage as Africa and the coasts of the Americas was the space a crucible of the consciousness of Africans in the where security was priority, a security that some Americas, scholars have had the tendency to focus on thought might be inherent in the conception of mod-the negative, viewing the "slave mentality" as a one-ern, racialized slavery from its inception, because the sided, monolithic consciousness. The traumatic con-process of restraining and constraining Africans sciousness attributed to all captive Africans who started at the beginning of the capture.

traveled the Middle Passage provides a dubious con-There are conservative reports of 55 mutinies struction of the consciousness of an entire race. Such between 1699 and 1845 and of 250 documented cases a construction must be erroneous because it does not of rebellion at sea. Clearly the insurance clauses that explore how the tenacity Africans showed in resis-protected

investors against such losses underscored tance and survival has shaped the consciousness of their occurrence, as well as investors' need to be pre-the diasporic African community.

scient in anticipation of African resistance even on the That captive Africans resisted enslavement at sea high seas. In many ways, insurance policies, policy and that so many Africans survived the Middle Passage debates, and laws like the 1799 Parliamentary Passenger is evidence of the resistance and survival incorporated Acts, told the resistors' tale, even if it did not fully con-into African bodies and minds and passed on through vey the immediate rhythms of the events. It is clear that generations of Africans in the Americas. African the resistors shaped history in ways we are only begin-sacrifice, resistance, and survival during the Middle ning to understand. Africans in shackles did this; Passage became part of African consciousness—a Africans in the Middle Passage forced change.

text of resistance and survival, and of freedom and liberty, that epitomizes the best modern philosophies of liberation.

THE AFRICANS' CHOICE TO SURVIVE

What could possibly be found in the history of the

— Maghan Keita

*Middle Passage that is uplifting or inspirational? What could be the possible object lesson of its resistors and **FURTHER READING***

survivors to their descendants and to the modern world Curtin, Philip. (1969). The Atlantic Slave Trade: A Census.

at large? In the holds of slave ships that made the Madison: Wisconsin University Press. This is one of the Middle Passage are the legacies and resonances of earliest quantitative studies of the slave trade, and its those who remained enslaved, those who resisted, and conservative estimates have been disputed.

Eltis, David. (1987). Economic Growth and the Ending of the African inferiority. As a result, he concluded that the Transatlantic Slaving Trade. New York: Cambridge Uni-African community must study African people in the versity Press. Eltis provides a useful analysis of the impact context of all disciplines. He also proposed that more of the slave trade on Europeans and Africans.

emphasis be placed on education with a practical ori-Mannix, Daniel. (1962). Black Cargoes: A History of the entation; for instance, he called for political education Atlantic Slave Trade, 1518–1865. New York: Viking Press.

This is a vivid and often revolting account of the conditions so that more Africans could understand the political that prevailed during the Middle Passage.

process. Woodson envisioned higher education as a Williams, Eric. (1944). Capitalism and Slavery. New York: tool that African people could use to help serve the Capricorn Books. This book views the Middle Passage masses of their people and especially to teach Africans within the broader context of the European-initiated trian-how to thrive economically.

gular trade routes.

The Mis-Education of the Negro stands as one of the most important early works in the Black Studies canon. By bringing to light the Europeanization of education, Woodson's work laid the theoretical foun-

THE MIS-EDUCATION

ation for the study of African people. The book was

OF THE NEGRO

clearly ahead of its time: Written over 30 years before the Black Studies movement, The Mis-Education of the Carter G. Woodson's Mis-Education

of the Negro can Negro raises the very issues that ultimately caused be considered one of earliest rationales for the impor-the profilation of Black Studies departments across tance of Black Studies. Written in 1933, Woodson's the country. Furthermore, Woodson's work remains book focuses on the Eurocentric education and indoc-deeply relevant as public school systems continue to trination of African people, and how it was systemati-miseducate the masses of young African students.

cally detrimental and damaging. Woodson, who is

— Rico X

*known as the "father of black history," discussed several key issues, but his primary contention was that **FURTHER READING***

African people were being miseducated by being indoctrinated with Eurocentrism through all levels of Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). Afrocentricity. Chicago: African the educational system. Throughout the book, American Images. This book follows in the tradition of Woodson's classic in pointing out the problems of Woodson gave examples of how, across all disciplines, Eurocentricity for African people.

the subject matter being taught to African students Williams, Chancellor. (1976). The Destruction of Black included little or no information about African or Civilization. Chicago: Third World Press. This book deals African American people. He also noted that the little with the reasons for the failure of Africans to retain their information that was taught only worked to reinforce culture in the face of the onslaught by outside forces.

white supremacist notions of African inferiority.

Woodson, Carter G. (1990). The Mis-Education of the Negro.

Woodson asserted that this miseducation had a seri-Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. (Original work published ous impact on African people, causing them to be 1933). This is Woodson's classic.

sociopolitically apathetic and uninterested in advancing their race. Comparing African resistance and uplift efforts in the 19th century to those in the early 20th **MISSISSIPPI FREEDOM**

century, Woodson noted that the educated Negro had lost moral courage because of compromise with white **DEMOCRATIC PARTY**

culture. In addition to delineating the problem of the miseducation of African people, Woodson also recom-The Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party (MFDP), mended solutions. Being a strong proponent of the which was also known as the Freedom Democratic study of black history, Woodson naturally called for Party (FDP), was active from 1964 to 1968 in endeav-more “study of self” by African people. In the 1930s, oring to obtain political power for Mississippians who when Woodson was writing his book, many African were kept disenfranchised by the racists of the people placed little value in studying and understand-Mississippi Democratic Party (MDP). The MFDP was ing themselves. Woodson, however, believed that such comprised of civil rights organizations and a consid-study was the only way of dismantling the belief of erable number of African residents of Mississippi, and

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 334

334——**Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party** their goals were to replace the MDP within the culminated in the Mississippi government joining the national Democratic Party, empower the black popu-Civil War effort on the side of the Confederacy.

lation in Mississippi, and expose the racist terror that prevented enfranchisement in the South. The tactics **THE ERA OF RECONSTRUCTION**

they used to achieve these goals included voter registration, voter education, Freedom schools, Freedom After suffering a loss in the Civil War; the proslavery Summer; negotiations, and protest within the government of Mississippi was replaced by a recon-Democratic National Conventions.

structed government with the help of the Union Army, which stood sentry over the transformation. Then the Fourteenth Amendment to the U.S. Constitution **THE BACKGROUND OF**

brought about another change in Mississippi by not **DEMOCRACY FOR BLACKS IN MISSISSIPPI** allowing political officers to refuse to pledge allegiance-During the first half of the 1800s, Mississippi was giance to the union. Blacks entered positions in state considered both an agrarian and a frontier society. It government and on school boards, and black children was populated with Native Americans, European set-entered schools in large numbers.

tlers, and enslaved and manumitted Africans. Of these Under military jurisdiction, Mississippi voter regis-populations, only the European men had full rights as tration in 1867 resulted in the enrollment of 60,167

U.S. citizens. By the middle of the 1830s, a movement blacks and 46,636 whites entitled to elect delegates was afoot to discourage the presence of free Africans to the state constitutional convention. Freedman's in Mississippi. A law passed by the Mississippi legis-Bureau schools in Mississippi enrolled 13,721 black lature in 1822 moved to limit emancipation in order to children, about 10% of school-age blacks. In addition, limit the size and proportions of the state's freed black 83 whites and 17 blacks were elected as state dele-population. This law gave the legislature authority to gates. The state constitutional convention met in 1868, decide on all emancipations in Mississippi. Eman-with the majority of delegates listed as Republicans, cipations sharply declined and the free black popula-the party that was seen at that time as the guardians of tion never exceeded 1,400.

liberty. This convention approved a moderate state constitution that met the requirements of the Fourteenth Amendment. The terrorism of the Democratic **MISSISSIPPI LAWS**

Party was still prevalent, however, and their threats and Mississippi was notorious for its official sanctioning of boycotts kept many people away from the polls, which racist relations. That there was such a small number

of in turn prevented ratification of the state constitution free blacks in Mississippi between 1810 and 1860 was by a majority of voters in 1868.

attributable to unjust laws and racist codes. Free blacks The Republican Party and “scalawags” elected were discouraged from moving into Mississippi, and Governor James Alcorn and changed the proposed free blacks who resided in the state suffered under laws state constitution to allow ex-Confederates to hold that assumed all blacks were slaves. Blacks within the office, covertly reversing the stipulations of the borders of Mississippi might be asked to prove their Fourteenth Amendment. New elections were held and free status at any time by showing a certificate with won by these Republicans. The voters in this election their name, color, physical stature, and other distin-ratified the modified state constitution. In the begin-guishing features. The certificate was to be renewed ning of 1870, a new state legislature met and ratified every 3 years at a cost that was high enough that many the Fifteenth Amendment. Congress accepted the blacks could not afford to renew it. Without proper doc-results and approved the readmission of Mississippi umentation presented in a timely fashion, free blacks in into the union in February 1870. During 1871, the Ku Mississippi were subject to enslavement and sale on the Klux Klan increased their violent terrorism of blacks auction block. The collusion of the state government in Mississippi. They targeted the black schools. The in this racism illustrates the tradition of hostility that lay state government only put up a feeble effort to defend at the cultural bedrock of the Democratic Party in the its citizens, and federal troops were required to sup-South, often called the Dixiecrat Party in reference to press the Klan.

the Southern conservatism displayed by it. Mississippi’s During the next 4 years, a legislature with 25% black resistance to black emancipation and citizenship membership initiated changes, which included reforming

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 335

Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party———335

public education, founding a black state university, and respectively. The league encouraged civic education reorganizing a judiciary financed by the

state, as well as and participation through motivation and literacy. The building new hospitals, asylums, and public buildings.

council advocated black voter education, registration, Notwithstanding the black minority in the legislature, and voting. It also campaigned against police brutality John R. Lynch, a 24-year-old formerly enslaved person, and for full citizenship rights for black Mississippians.

was chosen as speaker of the House in 1871 by the In 1955, when the National Association for the Republican majority in the legislature. As a result, Advancement of Colored People (NAACP), with Governor Alcorn resigned and led his Republican fol-Medgar Evers as its first field secretary in the state, lowers in unifying with the Democrats to form what was attempting to recruit adults to the organization, was called the new Republican Party of Mississippi.

they met with unexpected success with young people.

Ironically, in February of 1874, the Mississippi legisla-The NAACP Youth Councils were training youth to ture elected its first black senator, Blanche K. Bruce, to imagine the potential of political power. The Congress the U.S. Senate. Bruce served a full term but was the of Racial Equality (CORE) and the Southern Christian last of an era.

Leadership Conference (SCLC), and its spin-off the In 1876, a tightly run presidential race was Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee (SNCC), resolved in the famous compromise known as the participated in Freedom Rides that inspired the Tilden-Hayes compromise. Rutherford B. Hayes, the NAACP Youth Councils and fired their enthusiasm.

Republican candidate, agreed to remove Union Army CORE and SNCC began sending people into troops from the South in exchange for the uncontested Mississippi in 1961. As the action of the civil rights seat of the presidency. The compromise removed the groups in the area increased, the groups launched soldiers who were protecting the black populace in an effort to coordinate their activities. From 1962 to Mississippi from being terrorized by hate groups, 1965, an umbrella structure, the Council of Federated specifically the Dixiecrats. By 1876, the Democratic

Organizations (COFO), was formed as a confederation Party of Mississippi had come to power and overtly of the civil rights and citizenship education groups in enshrined white supremacy in government operations.

Mississippi. Its mission was to represent and promote Repression was on the rise and a new set of black the interests of all national, state, and local civil rights codes was created in Mississippi that forced blacks groups operating in Mississippi.

to live in designated areas, outlawed miscegenation, COFO, with a significant contribution from SNCC, forced labor on black citizens in the form of inden-worked with local populations to sponsor Freedom tured servitude, and gave courts the ability to “appren-Summer in Mississippi. They organized college tice” black minors to whites in indentured servitude.

students from Mississippi and other states to effec-In essence, these codes, along with the repression of tively conduct voter education, register voters, serve the Jim Crow social environment, created a new form as interviewers, teach in Freedom schools, and per-of slavery. These policies set the stage for an eco-form other duties that were needed. These activities nomic system of sharecropping that kept blacks poor were met with brutal repression from law enforcement in Mississippi while rebuilding the wealth of former agencies as well as hooded terrorists. After COFO

slaveowners. For close to a century, political, social, assisted local citizens in preparing to exercise their and economic power was out of reach for the blacks in political power, their next step was to help the local Mississippi.

population develop political machinery to represent them, as the MDP disallowed black participation in the political life of the state.

THE CIVIL RIGHTS

MOVEMENT IN MISSISSIPPI

THE TRAVESTY OF THE

*The 1950s through the 1960s brought a second recon-MISSISSIPPI
DEMOCRATIC PARTY*

struction era to Mississippi. Its prime agents were the African descendents residing in Mississippi, the In 1964, the MFDP challenged the MDP on its long civil rights movement, and the youth movement.

history of the systematic exclusion of blacks from The Mississippi Progressive Voter's League and equal participation in the political processes of the Regional Council of Negro Leadership emerged on state. The ideological force behind the MDP was the the Mississippi political landscape in 1947 and 1951, White Citizens' Council—an organization committed

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 336

336——Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party to white supremacy. The MDP, which controlled all Mississippi, on April 26, 1964. The approximately the branches of government in the state, gave white 300 delegates present elected a temporary state exec-supremacy state power. It passed laws and established utive committee, which was responsible for setting up regulations to discriminate against the potential black precinct and other state meetings. The meetings were electorate. Some of the petty tactics of the MDP

to parallel those of the Mississippi Democratic Party, included changing the location or time of a convention and the MFDP made efforts to comply with state laws to ensure black absence, blocking the entrance of that applied to the formation of political parties.

blacks to convention halls, and denying blacks who Registered voters in the MFDP had already attempted did attend opportunities to speak or vote. The 1963

to attend precinct and county meetings of the MDP

gubernatorial campaign blocked black participation.

but were rebuffed. In the summer of 1964, which State conventions were held in segregated facilities, became known as Freedom Summer, the MFDP

and dissent from whites and blacks was squelched in engaged in (1) Freedom registration drives, (2) pick-the manner of a dictatorship instead of a democracy.

ing Freedom candidates, (3) launching Freedom The MFDP also challenged the MDP's conclusive schools for literacy and political education, and (4) the demonstration of disloyalty to the national Democratic Democratic National Convention challenge.

Party. Citizens of Mississippi who supported the national Democratic Party's goals were denied mem-Freedom Registration Drives

bership in the MDP. The MDP had declared in public speeches and in printed tracts that it was not a part of In November of 1963, about 83,000 blacks voted the national Democratic Party. It claimed in a piece of in a mock gubernatorial election in which COFO

1963 campaign literature that it was entirely indepen-president Aaron Henry ran against Governor Paul B.

dent of the national Democratic Party. This was a clear Johnson. Official registration figures in 1964 showed indication of its conscious disloyalty to the national that only some 20,000 blacks were registered in parent organization.

Mississippi as compared to 500,000 whites. That In 1960, the MDP did not honor its pledge to figure represented less than 7% of the 435,000 blacks support the nominees of the Democratic National in the state who were at least 21 years of age. The Convention. The MDP intentionally voted against Freedom registration drives were designed to show candidates put up by the national body, and a majority that thousands of blacks wanted to become registered of its delegates at the 1964 Democratic National voters. By setting up registrars and deputy registrars Convention supported the Republican candidate, in counties across Mississippi, the MFDP registered

Barry Goldwater. Similar to the days before this sec-80,000 blacks in Mississippi in 1964. However, while on reconstruction, there was little difference between those 80,000 Mississippians were being registered, the Mississippi Democrats and the conservative 80 people were beaten, 35 churches were burned, Republicans when it came to black enfranchisement.

1,000 people were arrested, 30 homes and other build-Finally, the MFDP challenged the determination of ings were bombed, 35 shooting incidents involving the state's political power structure to keep Mississippi civil rights workers took place, and three civil rights as a closed society. Rather than being an open society workers were brutally murdered.

*that welcomed democratic debate, the MDP-led government passed five restrictive bills that prohibited **Freedom Candidates***

picketing, banned the distribution of boycott literature, restricted the movement of groups, established curIn June of 1964, before the Democratic National fews, authorized municipalities to pool police staff and Convention, the MDP excluded blacks from its process equipment, and increased the penalties assessed by for selecting delegates. In response to generally being city courts. This was all done to reduce dissent.

*locked out of MDP meetings, the MFDP held its own set of parallel precinct meetings, including county conventions in 26 of the state's 82 counties and a state **THE ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE OF THE***

*convention to select its own of delegates to challenge **MISSISSIPPI FREEDOM DEMOCRATIC PARTY***

the seating of the regular all-white delegation in The MFDP was open to all citizens regardless of race Atlantic City. The MFDP candidates, who planned to and was officially established at a meeting in Jackson, run in a mock election in November of 1964, were

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 337

***Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party**———337*

Mrs. Victoria Gray, opposing Senator John Stennis; MFDP, with the remainder of the seats going to the Mrs. Fannie Lou Hamer, opposing Representative MDP. However, thanks to Johnson's pressure tactics, Jamie L. Whitten; the Reverend John Cameron, oppos-the credentials committee denied the MFDP any seats.

ing Representative William M. Colmer; and Mr. James The MDP, staying true to their renegade nature, Houston, opposing Representative John Bell Williams.

announced after the convention that it would no longer The platform points of the candidates of the MFDP

permit seating delegations that were segregated.

included antipoverty programs, medicare, educational Though the MFDP was unable to break the MDP's aid, rural development, urban renewal, and the guaran-control over the convention, the challenge they posed tee of constitutional rights to all. This was in sharp in 1964 successfully forced the national Democratic contrast to the platform of the MDP.

Party to reform its rules for delegate selection. In 1964, Mississippi had no black officeholders, except in the all-black town of Mound Bayou. By 1994, it had 751

Freedom Schools

black elected officials, more than any other state.

In the summer of 1964, 41 Freedom schools opened throughout Mississippi in nonacademic set-THE STRUGGLE CONTINUES

tings such as church basements. SNCC was a major organizing force in these efforts. During 1964, 3,000

The MFDP presented Congress with documentation children enrolled in these schools. Freedom schools of the rejection of thousands of qualified blacks from were just the beginning of the improvement in educa-voter

registration and of the brutality against those who tried to register. One congressional presentation volunteers, set out to provide black students with the involved the MFDP's unsuccessful bid to stop the basic literacy and citizenship skills they would need to seating of the all-white Congressional delegation in organize for action and become a formidable voice of the U.S. House of Representatives in January of 1965.

the civil rights movement. The schools didn't have it The Voting Rights Act of 1965 struck down the easy. They were often targets for white mobs and were racially discriminatory voter registration tests used in consistently vandalized and burned.

Mississippi. Federal registrars were sent to Southern states to assist in the implementation of the act. A restrictive poll tax was also struck down in a **The Democratic National Convention Challenge** Department of Justice lawsuit in a federal district The MFDP attempted to seat 44 delegates and court in Mississippi. Within 2 years, the black voter 22 alternates at the Democratic National Convention.

registration went up ninefold, from 6.7% of It was the role of the credentials committee to deter-Mississippi's blacks voting to 60%. The Voting Rights mine if the MFDP would replace the MDP. Although Act was eclipsed in Mississippi, however, by a reign the MFDP was more loyal than the MDP to the national of segregationist terror that swept the South between Democratic Party, the efforts of the MFDP were stalled 1965 and 1969. The following 8 years saw two by the direct intervention of the Democratic nominee Democratic parties in Mississippi.

for president, Lyndon B. Johnson. Johnson was con-In an effort to ensure implementation of the promise cerned with offending the racist Southern Democrats of the 1964 Democratic National Convention, a bira—who were a powerful force within the party, and he cial coalition—consisting of the NAACP of used undercover intelligence to spy on the MFDP for Mississippi, the Freedom Democratic Party, the the MDP.

Prince Hall Masons, the Mississippi Teachers At the nationally televised credentials committee Association, the Mississippi AFL-CIO, and the

meeting, Fannie Lou Hamer, of SNCC and MFDP

Young Democrats—formed the Loyal Democrats of fame, described her experience as a sharecropper who Mississippi (LDM). The chair of the configuration was evicted for registering to vote. Aware of Hamer's was Aaron E. Henry. Some of the coordinators of the ability to inspire with her words, Johnson announced LDM were Charles Evers, Hodding Carter III, and a press conference during her testimony. Johnson's Lawrence Guyot. In 1968, the LDM protested the prospective running mate, Hubert H. Humphrey, nearly all-white Mississippi delegation at the conven-cajoled Johnson into setting up a process to urge a tion. The LDM was successful and was seated as the pseudocompromise: two "at large" seats for the representation from Mississippi, replacing the MFDP.

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 338

338——*Montgomery Bus Boycott*

The 1964 convention adopted a nondiscrimination requirement to be included in the call to the 1968

MONTGOMERY BUS BOYCOTT

Democratic National Convention. The LDM, which had subsumed the MFDP, included many who had In the 1950s, segregation laws and city ordinances participated in the 1964 challenge and who again deemed it a misdemeanor for blacks and whites to contested the seating of the racist Democratic Party intermingle in public transportation in Montgomery, delegation. This time they were victorious. The LDP

Alabama. This was the law across the South. Violators eventually functioned as the nationally recognized were promptly arrested and prosecuted under laws Democratic Party in Mississippi.

established to separate the races. A clear example of The segregationist group, called the Regulars, this is section 1413 of the Birmingham Racial included a mere 2 black delegates in their delegation, Segregation

Ordinance, which states that although the black portion of the Mississippi population was 40%. They were rejected by the 1968

Every owner or operator of any jitney, bus or Democratic National Convention but were recognized taxi cab in the city shall provide equal but separate by state officials, ran the state Democratic Party pre-rate accommodations for the white and colored many elections, and continued to mount political resistance-races by dividing separate vehicles or by clearly tance. Their new tactics included vote-dilution devices indicating or designating by visible markers the such as increased candidate filing requirements, at-area to be occupied by each race in any vehicle large elections, and racial gerrymandering. Blacks in which the two races are permitted to be car-were still prevented from electing candidates of their ried together and by confining each race to choice to office. In 1966, the MFDP had filed a suit in occupancy of the area of such vehicle so set federal district court to halt the discriminatory gerry-apart for it. It shall be unlawful for any person mandering of state legislative district boundaries. It to operate or cause or allow to be operated or to took 14 years, until 1979, for significant black repre-aid in operating for the carriage of white and sentation in the Mississippi state legislature to be colored passengers any vehicle not equipped as obtained.

provided in this section. And it shall be unlawful for any person, contrary to the provisions of

— Daryl Zizwe Poe

*this section providing for equal and separate accommodations for the white and colored **FURTHER READING***

races, to ride or attempt to ride in a vehicle or a division of a vehicle designated for the race to Fay, Robert. (n.d.). Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party.

which such person does not belong. Failure to Microsoft Encarta (3rd ed.) [Computer software]. This is comply with this section shall be deemed a a description of the MFDP and its role in Mississippi misdemeanor.

Democratic politics.

Henry, Aaron E. (1968, August 22). Mississippi Delegation

[Letter to the Editor]. The New York Review of Books, p. 1.

Knowing that the segregation laws were morally Henry's letter sets the record straight on the purpose, objec-unjust, several unknown and uncelebrated African tive, and success of the MFDP.

Americans challenged this legislation by refusing to Kelley, Robin D. G. (2002). Freedom Dreams: The Black collaborate with laws that oppressed their humanity.

Radical Imagination. Boston: Beacon Press. This book provides an introduction to the black radical tradition in the In most instances, violators of segregation laws were 20th century.

jailed without due process. Prior to December 1, Parker, F. R. (1994). Turning Point: The 1964 Mississippi 1955—the date of the Montgomery bus boycott—

Freedom Summer. Washington, DC: Joint Center for there had been several rebellions against the bus laws.

Political and Economic Studies. This is an authoritative The African American community in Montgomery narrative of the turning point in the civil rights struggle that was not passive and complacent about segregation occurred during Freedom Summer. It is a penetrating laws, but they were forced to endure many demeaning examination of the issues.

episodes before they were able to change the laws. In Robinson, Cedric. (1983). Black Marxism: The Making of the Black Radical Tradition. Chapel Hill: University of North 1943, Rosa Parks had paid her bus fare in the front of Carolina Press. Robinson provides an excellent overview the bus, exited, and then attempted to reenter through of the black radical tradition.

the rear door, only to watch the bus drive off, leaving

Montgomery Bus Boycott———339

her on the curb. In 1949, a black professor, Jo Ann segregation, and with her blessing he went to work.

Robinson, sat in the whites-only front section of an The next day, Nixon called the minister of the Dexter empty bus and was verbally assaulted by the driver Avenue Baptist Church, Reverend Martin Luther and then thrown off the bus. She commenced a strong King, Jr., as Coretta Scott King recalls in her intro-and silent protest campaign against the system includ-duction to The Words of Martin Luther King, “to ing several letters to Montgomery Mayor W. A. Gayle, describe the incident and to urge a boycott of the informing him of an impending citywide bus boycott.

buses. ‘It’s the only way to make the white folk see In 1950, Dr. Vernon Johns was forced to give up his that we would not take this sort of thing any longer,’

seat to a white passenger. These are just a few of the he said. Martin agreed and offered the Dexter Avenue protest actions of African Americans.

Baptist Church as a meeting place. Over forty leaders from all segments of the black community came to the meeting. They formed the Montgomery Improvement **THE NAACP AND ITS STRATEGY**

Association (MIA), elected Martin president, and With all these protest actions occurring, the NAACP

organized a boycott starting on December 5.”

(National Association for the Advancement of Colored People) was just waiting for the right **THE CAMPAIGN FOR**

“victim” and the right moment to galvanize public **FREEDOM AND RESPECT**

anger and sentiment against the bus segregation laws.

In 1955, 15-year-old Claudette Colvin was arrested. This was to be the beginning of a painful, year-long fight for refusing to give up her seat to a white passenger.

campaign to end bus segregation in Montgomery, NAACP officials thought they had found the perfect Alabama. The consequences were quite severe for the symbol, but then it turned out that she was pregnant.

African American community and the price costly.

Although her pregnancy was not relevant to the segregation issue, a focus on it might have jeopardized the freedom and dignity. In 1954, just a year prior to the NAACP's ability to win in their protest against the Rosa Parks incident, the U.S. Supreme Court had segregation laws.

handed down the decision in Brown v. Board of Education. On Thursday, December 1, 1955, Rosa Parks was arrested.

boarded a full bus and took her seat in the black section. However, most of the Southern states, and especially Alabama, refused to be in consonance with the nation of the bus were designated as the "whites only" section and remained adamant about maintaining segregated transportation. That section filled up very quickly, leaving a social structures.

white passenger standing. According to the law, and while the Montgomery authorities pressed on with the ordinance above, whites and blacks were forbidden the prosecution of Rosa Parks, the Women's Political Union to occupy the same row. So the bus driver asked Council, under the leadership of Professor JoAnn all African-Americans in the fifth row to vacate the Robinson, was taking steps to link strong political section. The other three people in the section came action to the trial. The group printed and distributed fliers, but Rosa Parks did not. She was summarily over 50,000 fliers asking Montgomery's African arrested.

American community to mount a one-day protest and Rosa Parks had been educated at Alabama State. Boycott the Montgomery bus company by

staying off College and became a seamstress. She had completed the buses on December 5—the day of Rosa Parks’s several workshops and courses in race relations and trial. The one-day protest was successful, as she was a seasoned NAACP secretary and worker who Montgomery buses with predominantly African had been active on the Claudette Colvin case. Above American routes were empty, but Rosa Parks and the all, her record was impeccable. E. D. Nixon, a leader NAACP lost their case. Parks was convicted of violatin the African American community, was quite famil-ing segregated seating laws, such as section 1413

iar with her and was sure that in Rosa Parks the above. Fresh from this defeat, the MIA met to chart NAACP had found its “poster figure” against public new strategies, including the extension of the bus boy-transport segregation laws. Nixon went to the jail and cott. That evening, over 8,000 people gathered at the posted bond for Rosa Parks. He solicited her permis-Holt Street Baptist Church to listen to the president of sion to commence a public campaign against bus the MIA and to resolve to continue with the boycott.

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 340

340——Montgomery Bus Boycott

On December 8, after almost 4 days of the continuing that the boycott was over. News of this trickery boycott, MIA officials met with attorneys from the reached King and the MIA officials in enough time for bus company and city commissioners to resolve their them to counter it by spreading the truth in the grass-differences. The MIA presented a case for established roots establishments of the community, such as local racial seatings with no mobile area, as well as the eateries, bars, and nightclubs.

employment of African American drivers to serve On January 26, when city officials made their African American neighborhoods. The attorneys and fourth attempt to force the African American commu-commissioners rejected the proposal completely.

nity to end the boycott, it was clear that the white The MIA returned to the boycott with strategies to establishment was getting desperate. While

conduct-sustain it. This was a serious challenge because of the ing a car pool, King was hawkishly tailed by a motor-nature of the community: It was one of the poorest cycle cop. The moment that he dropped off his communities in the nation and its members needed the passengers, the cop ordered him out of the car and income that going to work on the buses provided. The arrested him for driving 30 miles per hour in a 25 mile protesters had no choice—they still had to go to work, per hour zone. Following this, a less legal route was go to school, and carry on the activities necessary for used by some members of the white community to try survival, such as paying the rent or mortgage and to dissuade the MIA from continuing their protest. On putting food on the table. Most members of the com-January 30, Martin Luther King's Montgomery home munity were in service jobs and positions. They were was bombed while his wife and baby daughter and a nannies, cooks, maids, butlers, dishwashers, and friend were inside. Fortunately, no one was injured.

laborers. This was not a community in which owning On February 1, E. D. Nixon's home was also bombed.

an automobile was a basic rite of passage.

On February 21, King, along with 89 African American activists in the bus boycott, were charged with being a party to conspiracy. They were indicted **ORGANIZED DEFIANCE**

for hindering and preventing the operation of business The MIA turned to the 45,000 African American com-without any just or legal cause. King was ordered to munity members to organize car pools to get people to pay \$500 in fines in addition to another \$500 in court and from work. With family and community members costs. As the boycott continued, the business commu-volunteering their cars and services as drivers, local nity, especially the downtown store owners, began to insurance agents started canceling liability policies on feel the economic pressure of the protest. The boycott what were called the "MIA taxis." King's response to was costing them thousands of dollars because this was to seek out a black insurance agent in Atlanta African American patrons were less likely to take who provided policies covered by Lloyd's of London.

weekend shopping trips into the downtown district.

Thus the MIA had worked out a scheme and schedule The store owners formed a group called the Men of that enabled the African American community to Montgomery in reaction to the boycott. The aim of the successfully continue the boycott.

group was to negotiate a way to end the boycott—not Meanwhile, city officials were seeking ways to for moral reasons, not to end segregation, but to keep break the protest and the spirit of the boycott. They their profits from evaporating. Their negotiations tried several strategies. On December 10 they put their never really led to any outcomes.

first strategy into effect when they completely with-On June 4, 1956, the U.S. district court ruled 2 to 1

drew city buses from African American routes and that racial segregation on the Montgomery city bus neighborhoods. Their second strategy was to threaten lines is unconstitutional. A Southern judge cast the taxi drivers with prosecution if they charged African dissenting vote. The City of Montgomery resisted this American patrons less than the 45 cent minimum fare.

ruling and appealed it. Five months later, on Then, on January 21, 1956, they initiated their third November 13, the U.S. Supreme Court affirmed the strategy when the city commission met with three decision of the federal district court and declared black ministers who were not part of the MIA and unconstitutional Alabama's state and local segregation reported that a compromise had been reached and the laws. Even with this announcement, the MIA did not boycott ended. This news was leaked to the press, with immediately endorse patronage of city buses. They newspapers—especially the mainly white newspaper, waited patiently for the arrival of the mandate from the Montgomery Advertiser—encouraged to report the Supreme Court. On December 20, the federal

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 341

Moorish Science Temple of America———341

injunctions prohibiting segregation on buses were Canaanite Temple, then later it was reestablished as delivered to both the city of Montgomery and the bus the Moorish Holy Temple of Science, and finally, it company, and Alabama state officials were served was incorporated in 1928 in Chicago as the Moorish with injunctions.

Science Temple of America (MSTA). Its founder and December 21, 1956 saw the end of racial segrega-prophet, Noble Drew Ali (1886–1929), was born tion in Alabama. African Americans returned to the Timothy Drew in North Carolina. There is still some city buses, but not without a price and future anguish.

mystery surrounding Ali's early life and influences.

The city halted bus service at 5:00 that afternoon due But it is known that he spent a portion of his youth to several sniper attacks aimed at the buses. The on a Cherokee reservation, and that he was part of a Supreme Court decision to integrate the buses led to Freemasonic lodge as a young man. Both experiences a wave of countless bombings of African American evidently played some role in his decision to establish homes, churches, cab stands, and service stations. On the Canaanite Temple and eventually the Moorish January 27, 1957, an unexploded bomb was discov-Science Temple. Ali's stated purpose was to inform ered on the porch of the King residence. Just over a the people in the Americas who were labeled Negro, year later, in February of 1957, King and several min-colored, and black of their true nationality and origins isters who served in the MIA moved to Atlanta, where as Moors. The temple membership officially main-they formed the Southern Christian Leadership tains that they were born in the Americas but are the Conference and elected King as their president.

descendants of the peoples of the old Moroccan Yet Montgomery and Alabama remain the cradle of Empire. The word Moroccan, according to the temple, the civil rights movement, as they were the proving is the modern word for Moabite.

ground for King's nonviolent resistance techniques.

Coretta Scott King, in *My Life with Martin Luther* **POLITICAL PHILOSOPHY**

King Jr., wrote that “Montgomery was the soil in which the seed of a new theory of social action took As a nationalist organization, the temple membership root.” Rosa Parks, the bus boycott, the nameless places great emphasis on identifying themselves specif-45,000 African American citizens of Montgomery, the ically as Moors and Moorish. Although the members MIA, and the Women’s Political Council can best be reject the use of the word *black* to describe them, described as the droplets of water that would precede nothing in the official literature instructs them to the flood of the 1960s civil rights movement.

reject Africanity. They avoid describing themselves as black because they understand that the term *black* has

— *Adeniyi A. Coker*

no international recognition as an actual nationality connected to a nation and government. Moorish **FURTHER READING**

Americans also point to the negative meanings pri-King, Martin Luther, Jr. (1964). *Why We Can’t Wait*.

marily associated with the term *black* in the English New York: New American Library. King gives a remark-language. Although the membership does not directly able account of the civil rights struggle, explaining why it assert an understanding of the ancient Kemetic con-was impossible for the black population to wait for whites cept of Nommo (the power of the spoken word), they to end segregation and injustice.

Madhubuti, Haki. (1978). *Enemies: The Clash of Races*.

adhere to the concept’s basic principles by refusing Chicago: Third World Press. Madhubuti’s book is an explo-to identify with the pejorative Eurocentric designates ration of the difficult struggle blacks have had in the United of *black*, *Negro*, and *colored*. The temple membership States to gain equality and justice.

believes that in doing so they are spiritually, politically, and psychologically empowered.

MOORISH SCIENCE

TEACHINGS

TEMPLE OF AMERICA

The official teachings declare that Moorish Americans are to “propagate the faith . . . and to establish the faith The Moorish Science Temple of America, Inc. is a of Mohammed in America.” But Moorish Science nationalist and Islamic organization that was founded Temple Muslims do not practice religious orthodoxy.

in 1913 in Newark, New Jersey. It was first called the MSTA Islam submits to Allah via adherence to a

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 342

342———**Moorish Science Temple of America** simplified spiritual creed. Moorish Scientists, as they Moorish nationality and Islamic faith. Ali warned that call themselves, are taught to maintain love, truth, it would be legally and spiritually detrimental for peace, freedom, and justice. Temple members are them to describe themselves using “slave” designates taught to engage the world with these spiritual princi-such as *Negro*, *black*, and *colored*. In his essay “A ples in this order, with love being first and justice Warning From the Prophet in 1928,” Ali said that being last. Moorish Muslims are more concerned with through the adoption of their “free National name following the basic spiritual principles than they are

[Moor],” Moorish Americans would “receive their with following the more orthodox practices associated divine rights unmolested by other citizens.” Temple with the religion of Islam. In fact, Ali called Moorish adherents use the term *Asiatic* to refer to Africans and Science “Islamism” to distinguish it from the Islamic Asians collectively, and although MSTA members call religion.

the African continent Amexem, the Moorish Science Ali represents a homegrown teacher whose teach-literature still uses the terms *Africa* and *Africans* to ings are seen as having direct relevance to the refer to historical and cultural identity. Moorish African's peculiar conditions in the Americas, as evi-Americans are customarily identified by their use of denced by the fluid approach to the ritualized practice the surnames Bey and El.

of spiritual laws. Nevertheless, his teachings are closely related to Sufism and to the Marabout and Murid Islamic Orders of Africa, in that they follow the **ESSENTIAL BELIEFS**

basic elements of Islamic cosmology while remaining There are five essential beliefs that emerge from an regionally centered and drawing their key guides and examination of the temple teachings: (1) that the venerated ancestors from their own immediate Moors were an Africoid people with historical roots community and unique history.

in both Africa and Asia (which are viewed as holy The sacred (i.e., "official") literature of the lands), (2) that there was a pre-Columbian Moorish Moorish Science Temple of America includes *The* presence in the Americas, (3) that African Americans *Holy Koran of the Moorish Science Temple of* (i.e., blacks) are direct descendants of Moors, *America* (which is also known as *The Circle Seven*), (4) that the Moorish Science Temple interpretation *Koran Questions for Moorish Americans*, and of Islam has both historical and theological prece-Moorish Literature. The Moorish Koran is different dents that justify its credibility, (5) that the official from the orthodox Muslim *Holy Koran al-Sharif*.

declaration of Moorish nationality via the govern-Whereas the *Koran al-Sharif* (which is also known as ment-recognized MSTA results in greater political the *Koran of Mecca*) focuses on the revelations of the rights for temple members as full U.S. citizens under Arab Prophet Muhammed, the Moorish Koran focuses federal law.

on the life and teachings of the Prophet Issa (who is Presently there are several Moorish Science—

also known as Jesus). The Moorish Koran is much oriented groups that stem from the original Chicago-shorter in length than the voluminous *Koran of* based MSTA organization founded in 1928. Such *Mecca*, with the Moorish Koran consisting of only splinter groups go by various appellations, but they 63 pages. The *Koran Questions* is a kind of catechism generally utilize the Moorish name and use portions that addresses key issues and perspectives concerning of the original teachings. The groups are varied, with the Moorish worldview. An example of the 101 ques-some putting greater focus on the nationalist and tions asked is “What does the word colored mean?”

political element than others. The MSTA is now led Colored means anything which has been painted, by Brother R. Jones-Bey, who was voted its National stained, varnished or dyed.” This example illustrates Grand Sheik in September of 2002. The heads of the why Moorish Americans have rejected the nomencla-various temples are known as sheiks or sheikesses, ture of *colored*. The *Moorish Literature* is a collection and the heads of the various states are known as of essays and editorials authored by the prophet Noble grand governors or grand governesses. One of the Drew Ali that includes the essays “What is Islam?”

most unique aspects of the Islamic MSTA is its and “A Divine Warning by the Prophet for the history of having had women as the heads of temples Nations.”

and states.

When Ali established his temples, he instructed his membership to publicly and officially declare their

— *José Vittorio Pimienta-Bey*

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 343

Moynihan Report———343

FURTHER READING

American families were securely middle class and living according to the dominant culture's values, the Essien-Udom, E. U. (1965). *Black Nationalism: A Search For An Identity In America*. New York: Dell. This book remains other half were struggling in a pathological existence.

one of the most informative works done of the rise of black The committee concluded that much of the economic nationalism in the 1960s.

instability in the African American community was Pimienta-Bey, Jose V. (2002). *Othello's Children in the "New due to the legacy of 300 years of enslavement, which World": Moorish History and Identity in the African* led to drastic structural distortions in African *American Experience*. Bloomington, IN: 1st Books American lifestyles, specifically a deteriorating Library. This work describes and explains the nature of family structure. In particular, through the institution Moorish identity in the African American community. It is of slavery, the family structure of African Americans based on personal and historical accounts.

Wilson, Peter Lamborn. (1993). *Sacred Drift: In the Margins* had become matriarchal. This matriarchal structure *of Islam*. San Francisco: City Lights Books. This work had continued into the 1960s when the Moynihan examines the margins of Islam, claiming that there are Report was written. However, while this family struc-some groups that are not fully Islamic but have roots and ture was initially the result of enslavement and origins on the fringes of the religion.

oppression, the continuation of this structure after the removal of those conditions indicated that the pathology that plagued the black community had become self-perpetuating.

MOYNIHAN REPORT

MATRIARCHAL FAMILY

Published in 1965 and officially titled *The Negro* **STRUCTURE**
CONTROVERSY

Family: The Case for National Action, the Moynihan Report was the product of a federally funded study. By “matriarchal families” the committee meant a structure designed to pinpoint the reasons for African families that were headed by women and where Americans’ lagging economic growth and stability in women were the principle wage earners of the wake of significant civil rights legislation.

families. In this family structure, girls received more President Lyndon B. Johnson turned the government’s education than did boys, women secured better jobs attention to the noteworthy gap in wealth, employ- than men, and women were the primary transmitters ment, and income between whites and blacks.

of culture. The committee cited the matriarchal struc- Johnson recognized that due to recent legislation, ture as pathological not because it was inherently such as the Civil Rights Bill of 1964, legal barriers no pathological, but because it was not the predominant longer existed for African Americans, and he desired mode of family structure in the dominant culture. The to discover the root of this large discrepancy in order committee argued that matriarchal structure alienated to help African Americans achieve economic success.

African American men and made them feel inadequate. To this end, he appointed a committee headed by quate because they could not attain economic or Daniel Patrick Moynihan, a senator from New York, social status equal to that of either white males to study the reasons for the discrepancy.

or their African American female contemporaries.

The study was informed by research done by Further, African American women resented their African American sociologist E. Franklin Frazier.

spouses for not contributing more to the family eco- Frazier believed that enslavement, urbanization, nomicallly. As a result, many men abandoned their racism, and oppression inhibited African American families, and the divorce rate rose. As marriage sub-families from functioning properly. Moynihan, the sequently became less frequent, the number of ille-primary author of *The Negro Family: The Case for* gitimate births in the African

American community *National Action*, ended the report with a quote from rose significantly. These phenomena in turn perpetuated that described the detrimental impact of disoriented the matriarchal structure in African American organized family structure on the African American families.

community. Thus family structure was a central focus The Moynihan Report further outlined the problems of the Moynihan Report.

of female-headed households for the children reared After completing the study, the committee determined in this family structure. First, children who were found that while approximately half of all African American the products of such environments often suffered

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 344

344———**Moynihan Report**

from lower IQ scores, arguably because of limited inferiorities in African Americans' capabilities. It was opportunity rather than inherent intellectual deficiency—easy to overlook that qualifier in analyzing the extensive data. Male African American children from these data that shows African Americans had lower incomes, homes had a much more difficult time adjusting to the higher rates of illegitimate births and infant mortality, expectations of the dominant culture than did females.

more divorces, lower IQ scores, and higher delinquency They earned lower grades in school than African American rates, in addition to a pathological family structure.

African females, and engaged in delinquent behavior—Further, although the report also states that these data are more often.

are not reflective of all African Americans, generalization of the data was common because there were no data on the other half of African Americans, the African **Family Structure Labeled Pathological** Americans who were succeeding in America.

The report repeatedly indicates that the issues Civil rights leaders and intellectuals criticized the resulting from a pathological family structure only Moynihan Report for many reasons, not the least of applied to the half of the African American population which was its questionable methods in calculating with this structure. However, the pathology of this and reporting statistics. The Moynihan Report did lower class became problematic for all African not attempt to undertake the weighty task of examin-Americans due to segregated housing, which resulted ing contributing factors to each of the issues it from the increased African American population in raised, limiting itself to superficial explanations of urban centers and the subsequent exodus of white res-the phenomena. This left the public with misunder-idents to the suburbs. Middle-class African Americans standings as to the nature of the problems faced by could not move away from their lower-class neigh-the African American community. Thus social pro-bors, and they therefore could not escape the contam-gram development, one of the fundamental reasons inating influence of the pathological existence of that behind doing the report in the first place, would only segment of the African American population. This touch on the superficial aspects of the problems often resulted in African American families managing rather than solving the much more critical, structural only a short-term (i.e., one generation) escape from factors.

that pathology.

— *Jill Kissick*

THE INFLUENCE OF THE REPORT

FURTHER READING

The publication of *The Negro Family: The Case for FMC Program Segments 1960-2000: "The Moynihan Report"*: National Action thrust its principal author, Daniel *When Politics and Sociology Collide*. Retrieved November Patrick Moynihan, into a rather harsh spotlight, because 15, 2003, from <http://www.pbs.org/fmc/interviews/3seg2.htm> he had a reputation as a supporter of civil rights. He This is a transcript of an interview with Daniel Patrick said that he had undertaken this study to help develop Moynihan on the Public Broadcasting Systems Web site.

a plan to aid in the economic and social betterment The majority of the interview focuses on his perspective on of African Americans, with an eye to their achieving the now infamous Moynihan Report.

social and economic equality of opportunity with Rainwater, Lee, and Yancey, William A. (1967). *Moynihan Report and the Politics of Controversy*. Cambridge: MIT

members of the white majority culture. All of the issues Press. This work was contemporary with the publication of outlined in the Moynihan Report were deserving of the Moynihan Report. It includes the complete Moynihan the attention and action of the federal government.

Report, as well as analysis of the impetus for the study and And yet, there were no specific recommendations in the immediate public, governmental, and academic reper-the report, because the purpose of the Moynihan Report cussions of its contents.

was solely to articulate the problems.

www.dol.gov/asp/programs/history/webid-meynihan.htm This In addition, due to the time of its publication, the is the official Department of Labor's historical Web site. It not only offers the complete Moynihan Report broken down Moynihan Report contributed to the turmoil being by chapter (which is reliable considering the Department of expressed by the civil rights movement. Some sought Labor sponsored the original report), but it also has as an to use the report to prove the inherent inferiority of introduction President Lyndon B. Johnson's speech intro-African Americans. This was not difficult to do, though ducing the purpose and plan for the study that later became the report explicitly states that there are no inherent known as the Moynihan Report.

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 345

Multicultural Education—————345

the United States and other nations is highly stratified
MULTICULTURAL EDUCATION

by race, social class, and language. There are wide discrepancies in the academic achievement of middle-Multicultural education is an idea, an educational class white students and African American, Latino, reform movement, and a process. A major tenet of and Native American students. The racial, ethnic, and multicultural education is that all students, regardless class stratification in the larger American society is of their race, ethnic group, culture, or language, should reproduced in the schools and the nation's colleges be provided an equal opportunity to learn in schools, and universities.

colleges, and universities. Because multicultural edu-Multicultural education theorists and researchers cation focuses on providing equal educational oppor-have constructed various theories to explain why tunities for all students, it is consistent with the schools and universities have not been able to create democratic ideals and values that are expressed in equal educational opportunities for disempowered the founding documents of the United States, such groups such as African Americans, Latinos, and as the Declaration of Independence, the Constitution, Native Americans. Some of these theories focus on and the Bill of Rights. A major goal of multicultural the need for curriculum content that includes the education is to actualize for all the ideals that the history and cultures of various racial and ethnic founding fathers intended for a small elite. Multi-groups, the need for school reform that reflects the cultural education is a process because the goals cultural and learning styles of diverse groups, and the toward which it aims, such as educational equality and need for more African American and other teachers justice, are ideals toward which we must continually of color. Other theories and research focus on the work but may never totally achieve.

inequitable funding that is received by urban schools Multicultural education theorists and researchers attended by African Americans, Latinos, and other believe that an important part of a political democracy groups that are disproportionately low income. A is cultural democracy. When cultural democracy group of theorists who call themselves critical multi-exists within a political democracy, racial, ethnic, cul-culturalists argue that schools and universities are tural, and language groups are able to fully participate carrying out their latent function, which is to sort in the civic life

of the nation-state while maintaining various racial, ethnic, and income groups into their important aspects of their community cultures, identity-predetermined roles in adult society.

ties, and languages. The history of ethnic groups in the United States and other nations indicates that it is **THE AFRICAN AMERICAN ROOTS**

difficult for a political democracy to exist when cul-OF
MULTICULTURAL EDUCATION

tural democracy is denied to disempowered groups.

Ethnic and racial groups focus on cultural survival and Multicultural education emerged out of the civil empowerment rather than on the overarching issues of rights movement that began in the United States in the the mainstream society when they are denied full par-1960s and 1970s. An important consequence of the ticipation in the economic and political communities civil rights movement was the demand by African of a nation-state. They also focus on cultural survival Americans that school, college, and university cur-when the mainstream society does not reflect and riculums be reformed to reflect their history, culture, incorporate their histories, struggles, perspectives, and identity, and perspectives and that more black teachers dreams. The structural inclusion of ethnic, racial, cul-and professors be hired. In response to these demands, tural, and language groups is an essential requirement colleges and universities established Black Studies for justice and equality in pluralistic democratic courses and programs. The first response of the nation-states.

nation's schools to the civil rights movement was to implement black history courses at the high school level and to incorporate into elementary schools units **EDUCATIONAL REFORM**

and lessons on blacks who left a mark on history.

In their quest to attain equal educational opportunities African American scholars who were teacher edu-for students from diverse ethnic, racial, cultural, and cators and curriculum specialists were among the first language groups, multicultural educators have docu-educators to create

theories, curriculums, and materi-mented the ways in which educational achievement in als for the integration of black history into school

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 346

346——Multicultural Education

curriculums. Later, these teacher educators broadened (2) the knowledge construction process, (3) prejudice the scope of their work to include other ethnic groups reduction, (4) equity pedagogy, and (5) an empowering who were victims of institutional racism, such as school culture and social structure. Although each Native Americans, Mexican Americans, and Asian dimension is conceptually distinct, in practice they Americans. These African American teacher educa-overlap and are interrelated. Each of the dimensions is tors were among the first and major architects of mul-defined and discussed below.

ticultural education. They include James A. Banks, Carl A. Grant, Gwendolyn C. Baker, and Geneva Gay.

Content integration deals with the extent to which *Teaching Ethnic Studies: Concepts and Strategies*, teachers use examples and content from a variety of which was edited by Banks and published in 1973 by cultures and groups to illustrate key concepts, princi-the National Council for the Social Studies as its 43rd ples, generalizations, and theories in their subject area Yearbook, was one of the first educational publica-or discipline.

tions to use a comparative approach to the teaching of ethnic content. James A. Boyer, Asa Hilliard, and *The knowledge construction process* describes teach-Barbara A. Sizemore are other African American ing activities that help students to understand, investi-scholars who have influenced the multicultural educa-gate, and determine how the implicit cultural tion movement in significant ways through their assumptions, frames of reference, perspectives, and research, teaching, public lectures, and service.

biases of researchers and textbook writers influence The African American teacher educators who were the ways in which knowledge is constructed. The among the architects of multicultural education were knowledge

construction process helps teachers and heavily influenced by the early work of African students to understand why the cultural identities and American scholars and Black Studies scholarship.

social positions of researchers need to be taken into The historical works of W.E.B. Du Bois, Carter G.

account when assessing the validity of knowledge Woodson, John Hope Franklin, and Benjamin Quarles claims. Multicultural theories hold that the values, heavily influenced Banks and the other African personal histories, attitudes, and beliefs of researchers American constructors of multicultural education.

cannot be separated from the knowledge they create.

These teacher educators were working to incorporate black history into school curriculums prior to partici-The *prejudice reduction* dimension of multicultural pating in the formation of multicultural education.

education seeks to help students develop positive and Consequently, the current multicultural education democratic racial attitudes. It also helps students to movement is linked directly to the early study of understand how ethnic identity is influenced by the African Americans undertaken by scholars such as context of schooling and the attitudes and beliefs of George Washington Williams, W.E.B. Du Bois, Carter dominant social groups.

G. Woodson, Horace Mann Bond, and Charles H.

Wesley. The multicultural education movement is An *equity pedagogy* exists when teachers modify their linked in another important way to Black Studies in teaching in ways that will facilitate the academic that both have struggled for academic legitimacy since achievement of students from diverse racial, ethnic, their founding.

cultural, social class, and language groups. This includes using a variety of teaching styles and approaches that are consistent with the range of learn-
THE DIMENSIONS OF

ing styles within various racial, ethnic, and cultural **MULTICULTURAL
EDUCATION**

groups.

Since the multicultural education movement emerged, a number of theories have been developed to provide a An *empowering school culture* involves restructuring coherent overview of the field. James Banks's dimensions of multicultural culture and organization of the school so that students of multicultural education are cited frequently students from diverse racial, ethnic, social class, and by scholars and used widely by school districts to language groups experience equality. Members of the conceptualize and develop courses, programs, and school staff examine and change the culture and social projects. The five dimensions of multicultural education structure of the school. Grouping and labeling practices delineated by Banks are (1) content integration, participation, sports participation, gaps in achievement among

M-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 6:22 PM Page 347

Multicultural Education——347

groups, different rates of enrollment in gifted and force that supports multicultural education and its special education programs among groups, and the goals are the American democratic values embodied interaction of the staff and the students across ethnic in the Declaration of Independence, the Constitution, and racial lines are important variables that are and the Bill of Rights. Multicultural education's rein-examined and reformed.

forcement and perpetuation of American democratic values provides it with its greatest possibility for survival and for being on the right side of history.

MULTICULTURAL

EDUCATION AND THE FUTURE

— *James A. Banks*

The U.S. Census projects that people of color will make up 43% of the nation's population by 2050. In **FURTHER READING**

2002, students of color made up 40% of the population in the nation's public schools; they are projected to make up 60% of the school population by 2050. In *Contemporary Perspectives*. New York: Teachers College Press. This comprehensive book covers all spheres and bases in the multicultural education debate.

of immigrants. It is projected that one in three students will be a child of immigrants by 2040. As racial, ethnic, language, and religious diversity in the United States increases and the nation's need to respond to cultural education in the nation. It is a highly important collection of essays for educators.

become a powerful influence in the United States as Banks, James A., and Cherry A. McGee (Eds.). (2001).

well as in other Western nations.

Handbook of Research on Multicultural Education. San Francisco: Jossey-Bass. This handbook of the current research in the field of multicultural education seeks to provide the state of the art in the field.

ment to racial and ethnic diversity and promoting fear. Geneva. (2000). *Culturally Responsive Teaching: Theory, and concern about immigration to the United States*.

Research and Practice. New York: Teachers College Press.

The September 11, 2001 terrorist attacks on the United States have given impetus to and helped to synthesize much of the literature in the fields.

legitimize conservative sentiments in the nation.

Grant, Carl A., and Ladson-Billings, Gloria (Eds.). (1997).

Consequently, multicultural education exists today *Dictionary of Multicultural Education*. Phoenix, AZ: Oryx Press. This is a comprehensive dictionary of the words, within strong contradictory forces. Changing demo-concepts, and terms used in multicultural education.

graphics, which have been called the “demographic imperative,” are an important force prodding multi-Multicultural Learning Communities. New York: Teachers cultural education and equity. The conservative move-College Press. This is a penetrating inquiry into the ment exerts a counterforce. However, the greatest creation of multicultural learning environments.

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 349

N

With the rise of the antislavery movement in the **NARRATIVES OF THE ENSLAVED**

early 19th century came a demand for stories that would emphasize the harsh realities of slavery. These Narratives of the enslaved, which are also called slave began to appear in print in the late 1830s and early narratives, are autobiographical stories about life in 1840s. White abolitionists believed that testimony of slavery, recounted orally or in writing. They range from the earliest recorded narratives of the 1600s to the people in the North who were unaware of or apathetic thousands of oral histories collected from elderly about the situation of Africans in the South. These Africans in the 1930s by the U.S. Works Progress abolitionists would often add a preface or appendix to Administration. These narratives are rooted in the oral a narrative of the

enslaved that introduced the writer tradition of storytelling, which has been an explicitly as a person of good character and summarized what political tradition, combining both autobiography and the narrative would reveal about the horrors of social criticism. The narratives of the enslaved represent enslavement. The narratives of the enslaved of this sent one of the few indigenous literary forms, if not the period tell about passing from bondage in the South—

only one. Many themes commonly occur in the narrative—a kind of hell on earth—to freedom in the North. Most times: human suffering under the bondage of slavery; of the narratives reveal a common experience: The physical and spiritual abuse; the longing for freedom; enslaved person has a personal crisis, such as the sale the struggle to acquire literacy, which is associated with of a loved one by the slaveowner, that causes him or power and freedom; the importance of family and the her to decide to escape.

difficulty of maintaining family bonds when enslaved; the growing determination to escape; escape from **A MODEL FOR**

enslavement; and a new self-definition after freedom.

LITERATURE OF THE OPPRESSED

During the formative era of African-American autobiography, from 1760 to the end of the Civil War Narratives of the enslaved comprised most of the literature in the United States, approximately 70 narratives of literature written by blacks from 1861 to 1865. After the fugitive or former slaves were published as discrete Civil War and the abolishment of slavery in the United States in 1865, Africans continued to write about their sometimes multivolume texts. As the narratives of the experiences. From 1865 to 1930 at least 50 Africans enslaved evolved in the crisis years of the 1850s and wrote, or told to another person who then wrote down, early 1860s, they addressed the problem of enslaved book-length accounts of their lives. Most of the men with unprecedented candor, unmasking as never authors of African American literature before 1900, before the moral and social complexities of the including Frederick Douglass (1818–1895), William American caste

and class system in the North as well Wells Brown (1814–1884), Harriet Ann Jacobs as the South.

(1813–1897), and Booker T. Washington (1856–1915), 349

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 350

350——Narratives of the Enslaved

launched their writing careers through their narratives speech, as the narratives solicited by black interviewers of the enslaved. During the Great Depression of the clearly elicited a more straightforward response on the 1930s, the Federal Writer's Project gathered spoken part of former slaves. That ex-slaves dared to risk self-personal histories and testimony about slavery from exposure to share as much as they did with white 2,500 former slaves in 17 states, generating about interviewers about the horror of slavery and the 10,000 pages of interviews that were published in blacks' thirst for freedom is a tribute to the interview-18 volumes.

ers and, in many cases, a demonstration of the blacks'

The narrative of the enslaved reached a milestone courage and reluctance to conceal the most fiendish in 1845 with the publication of the *Narrative of the* examples of the antebellum South.

Life of Frederick Douglass, an American Slave, Written by Himself. Selling more than 30,000 copies **A LITERATURE OF TESTIMONIES**

in its first 5 years of publication, Douglass's book became an international best seller. Abolitionist In most post-emancipation narratives, slavery is leader William Lloyd Garrison (1805–1879) stressed depicted as a kind of crucible in which the resilience, that Douglass's narrative represented the usual expe-industry, and ingenuity of the enslaved person was rience of slavery, but he also noted that Douglass tested and ultimately validated. Thus the narrative of presented his story from the viewpoint of a former the enslaved asserted the readiness of the freedman slave who seeks mental as well as physical freedom.

and freedwoman for full participation in the post-Civil War view made Douglass's narrative stand out from War social and economic order. It has been estimated the rest.

that a grand total of all contributions to this genre, Harriet Ann Jacobs, the first African American including separately published texts, materials that woman to write her own narrative of the enslaved, appeared in periodicals, and oral histories and inter-showed how sexual control by white masters made views, numbers approximately 6,000, a significant slavery especially oppressive for black women. Her body of work for a people just out of enslavement.

autobiography, *Incidents in the Life of a Slave Girl* In addition to autobiographies, slave testimonies (1861), shows how she fought back against this appear in diaries; folklore; speeches; sermons; letters; oppression and gained freedom for herself and her pre-Civil War publications; church, legislative, and two children. The best-selling narrative of the judicial records; petitions; abolitionist newspapers; enslaved of the late 19th and early 20th centuries was major newspapers during that time, such as the Booker T. Washington's *Up from Slavery* (1901), a *New York Times*; scholarly journals; private printings; classic American success story. Because Washington's and broadsides. These are the primary sources that autobiography discussed black progress and interra-were corroborating witnesses to the enslavement, cial cooperation since the freeing of Southern slaves resistance, and freedom of African people in the in 1863, it received more acceptance from whites than United States.

did the autobiographies of former slaves who told of

— *Darrianna M. Proctor*

injustices to blacks in the post-Civil War South.

FURTHER READING

CRITICISM AND REFUTATION

Federal Writers' Project. (1936–1938). *Slave Narratives: A Folk History of Slavery in the United States From* Ulrich B. Phillips, a Georgia-born Yale professor, *Interviews with Former Slaves* (Vol. II, Pt. 1). New York: posed profound questions regarding the slave narra-Reprint Services Corporation. This is a first-person account tives' authenticity. Phillips, considered the "historian's of slave life told by former slaves in the form of interviews.

historian," dismissed the words of the formerly Hopkins, Dwight N., and Cummings, George C. L. (1991). *Cut* enslaved. Unfortunately, it took 40 years before schol-Loose Your Stammering Tongue: Black Theology in the arship began to refute the extremely biased, if not *Slave Narratives*. Maryknoll, NY: Orbis Books. The authors offer a theological approach to slave narratives and racist, research done by Phillips. However, some interviews with former slaves.

questions do linger about the legitimacy and reliabil-Rasmussen, R. Kent. (Ed.). (2001). *The African American* ity of the narratives of the enslaved. For instance, the *Encyclopedia* (2nd ed.). New York: Marshall Cavendish.

majority of the interviewers were white, and this may This encyclopedia provides brief descriptions of African have dampened the full force and truth of poor blacks'

American history and culture.

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 351

Nat Turner's Rebellion——351

that he was destined for some great mission on behalf **NAT TURNER'S REBELLION**

of God. He began preaching among the enslaved, inspiring them with tales of his communion with the In August of 1831, Nat Turner led the bloodiest slave spirit and gaining a reputation as a divinely ordained rebellion in U.S. history. Believing that he had been messenger.

ordained by God to free African Americans from Turner often wondered why he remained enslaved bondage, the slave preacher from Virginia killed on earth if God in heaven had chosen him for great-nearly 70 whites before militiamen stopped him and nass, and in 1821 he finally decided to run away. After his followers. Although his rebellion ultimately failed, hiding in the swamps for 3 weeks, however, he it forever affected slavery and race relations through-returned to the plantation, explaining that the spirit out the country and helped lead to the Civil War.

had ordered him to resubmit to his master. Turner may Nathaniel Turner was born the slave of a farmer have also been motivated by less spiritual concerns; named Benjamin Turner in Southampton County, according to some records, he married a woman Virginia, on October 2, 1800. According to local leg-named Cherry several months later. In 1822, the new end, Turner's African-born mother, Nancy, considered couple was separated when their master died suddenly killing him at birth so that he would not grow up in and his heirs sold Turner to prominent landowner bondage; the name of his father, who escaped from Thomas Moore and Cherry to a nearby farm. Like his slavery when Turner was a baby and was never heard birth, this prominent moment in Turner's life coin-from again, has been lost to history. Several months cided with a major insurrectionist scare. In July, before Turner's birth, an enslaved blacksmith named Charleston whites uncovered a planned uprising that Gabriel Prosser had planned a full-scale rebellion in may have included as many as 9,000 enslaved and free the state capital of Richmond but was betrayed by blacks and was led by two church leaders, a free cara fellow conspirator. Southampton suffered its own penter named Denmark Vesey and an Angolan-born minor insurrection scare around the same time, when

“conjurer” known as Gullah Jack.

Africans murdered three whites in a span of less than 18 months, but it was generally thought that most **TURNER'S VISION**

enslaved persons would not rebel against their condition in this isolated backwater.

Turner began experiencing visions again while in his mid-20s. He told other Africans that when he looked at the sky he saw the sun darkened; blood flowing in **NAT TURNER BECOMES A LEADER**

streams, representing the hands of Jesus on the cross; Turner showed exceptional intelligence from a young age, teaching himself to read and performing experiments in the fields he saw drops of blood; on leaves in the woods with paper, gunpowder, and earthen moulds. He saw blood-drawn numbers and images. He could recall events that had occurred before he was born, also instructed him, he later said, in the movements of planets and tides and the changing of the weather and seasons. This further convinced the African community that Turner was in direct communication with God that he would become a great leader.

with God, and he expanded his ministry through Many of his compatriots believed that he had supernatural powers. Some whites began to fear that natural powers, and even local whites agreed that he Turner might inspire the enslaved to rebel, but since he was uncommonly talented. The austere young man was a dutiful worker and his preaching had no overt devotion; he devoted himself to prayer and studying the Bible, racial message, Thomas Moore and his wife Sally focusing especially on the biblical idea that humans indulged him. For the most part, he was seen as a harmless to search for the kingdom of God before other less dreamer whose religion made him more docile, things. In Turner's mind, whatever the African people even after he ministered to and baptized a white man in required would be given to them if they sought first 1828. All of this activity proved an asset during the time which was pleasing to God. After weeks of reflection, when he would draw on not only his large fol-tion, he later recalled, a spirit twice spoke to him lowering but also his familiarity with the local geography while he worked in the fields. This convinced him and his connections with some of the most disgruntled

Africans in the county. Even if he did not know it at the time, Turner himself struck the first blow, but his sword was time, Turner was gathering intelligence for a war.

too dull to inflict a mortal wound, so others finished. By the late 1820s, tensions between North and the South over the issue of slavery had become so intense that some foresaw open war between the states. After securing several firearms and practicing military drills, the rebels swiftly moved through that some foresaw open war between the states.

the countryside, killing white families and gaining Antislavery sentiment was led by such activists as new recruits at each stop until their number swelled William Lloyd Garrison, Frederick Douglass, and to over 40 men. Among the victims were relatives of David Walker, whose controversial *Appeal to the Turner's first master*, although Cherry's master was *Colored Citizens of the World* argued that it was the will spared. Turner took only one life, a young woman of God that the enslaved should rise up against their named Catherine Whitehead whom he beat to death masters. It was during this period that Turner had his with a fence post. She and most of the more than 60

most apocalyptic vision. According to *The Confessions* white casualties were killed in the first hours of the *of Nat Turner*, on May 12, 1828, the spirit told him to rebellion while most people were sleeping. By early watch for a signal to "fight against the Serpent" and morning, however, frightened blacks and several

"slay my enemies with their own weapons," for "the whites who had narrowly escaped death fled to time was fast approaching when the first should be last Jerusalem with tales of a massive black uprising led and the last should be first." Thus Turner came to by a preacher named Turner. Some even thought that believe that God intended for him to lead his people in the enslaved had joined forces with an invading army armed rebellion against their masters.

from Great Britain or Haiti. Hundreds of militiamen He began waiting for a sign to begin, showing no headed toward Jerusalem to intercept Turner,

some outward sign of his plans except for an incident when attacking any enslaved or free blacks they could find.

he received what was probably the first whipping of In fact, the first black casualty was an innocent his life after he told Thomas Moore that the enslaved bystander who had drunk himself into a stupor after should be freed. Moore died soon after and his widow watching Turner's men kill his master.

married a carriage maker named Joseph Travis. By Turner's own admission, Travis was a relatively kind **THE CHAOS AFTER THE REBELLION**

master, but this did not change Turner's convictions.

When a solar eclipse occurred on February 12, 1831, The uprising essentially came to an end at noon Turner believed that he had finally received a divine when militiamen routed the exhausted rebels on the signal to begin his war. He told several trusted allies highway to Jerusalem. Although the rebels initially about his vision and they began recruiting other held off the militia's charge, the greater number of enslaved and free blacks. Turner also revealed his militia finally proved too much for the rebelling plans to Cherry, although neither she nor their blacks to fight, and Turner and his troops fled into the children took an active role in the rebellion. The upris-wilderness. Nearly all of them were captured or killed ing was scheduled to begin on July 4, but when the in the following few days, along with over 120 inno-day came, Turner fell sick from anxiety. His courage cent enslaved and free blacks who fell victim to a returned on August 13, however, after another solar reign of terror so brutal that even some whites found eclipse convinced him of the righteousness of his task.

it excessive. One crossroads on the Jerusalem high-Eight days later, Turner and his lieutenants met in the way was thereafter known as the Blackhead Sign Post woods near the Travis plantation and decided to begin because the head of a lynching victim was mounted their rebellion that very night while most of the local there. Many of the armed whites who began patrolling militia was away at a religious revival. They intended the countryside wanted to exact revenge on all the to head toward the county seat of Jerusalem, killing black people they saw, whether or not they had

been every white they encountered and recruiting more involved in the rebellion. By the end of the week, rebels from the African community along the way.

however, the violence had largely died down.

Over the next few months, more than 40 rebels were tried and executed for murder and inciting rebel-THE REBELLION

lion. Another 10 who had played lesser roles had their The insurrection began several hours after midnight death sentences commuted by the governor, provided with the murder of Joseph Travis and his family.

that they left the state immediately. One of the last to

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 353

Nat Turner's Rebellion——353

die was Turner himself, who remained free for Free blacks and black preachers also came under 2 months but was finally captured on October 30 by a fire after the rebellion. Most Southern legislatures farmer who saw him emerging from his hiding place banned or severely restricted both groups and made it near a local farm. He was taken to the courthouse in more difficult for masters to emancipate their slaves.

Jerusalem, where he gave a full confession describing This in turn contributed to the growth of black com-his religious visions and the details of the insurrec-munities elsewhere; many free blacks migrated to the tion. Even though he had been defeated, he still North and West after they found that they would no believed in the righteousness of his actions. When longer be tolerated in Southern cities. Over 200 of asked about cash that was allegedly stolen during the Southampton County's free blacks, for example, revolt, he turned to a free black and said, "You know migrated to the North or to Liberia within months of money was not my object."

the rebellion. Since Turner had been literate, many states created or strengthened prohibitions against teaching Africans to read. Ironically, the

rebellion **TURNER'S CONFESSION**

nearly brought an end to slavery in Virginia. Decades-On November 1, Turner gave a second confession, old debates about whether or not it would be safer to this time to local slaveholder and lawyer Thomas R.

expel all blacks, free and enslaved, finally came to a Gray (who contrary to popular belief was not Turner's head in the fall when the state assembly met. In the defense attorney). Later published as *The Confessions* end, however, Virginia planters were not willing to *of Nat Turner*, Gray's account shows a proslavery, give up the free labor that was the source of their anti-Turner bias and contains details that cannot be wealth, and slavery survived until the Civil War.

verified independently, but it also shows a grudging respect for Turner's intelligence, spirit, and religious **NAT TURNER BECOMES A LEGEND**

devotion. Most other whites, however, were not so generous. Turner's conviction and death sentence on In the years that followed, Nat Turner was remembered November 5 were a foregone conclusion, and he was by whites as one of the most hated figures in Southern hanged 6 days later, disappointing the huge crowd history, becoming a boogeyman whose name was used by not making a statement from the gallows. Local to scare small children. Many whites continued to whites skinned and dissected his body, making a purse believe that he was a mentally unbalanced fanatic, from his skin and keeping his skull as a souvenir.

influenced by abolitionists and free blacks, who had The effects of Nat Turner's rebellion were used false religion to take advantage of allegedly immense and far-reaching. Many Southampton simple-minded and superstitious enslaved Africans. It Africans who were guilty of nothing more than failing was unthinkable that his actions might have been a to resist the rebels were sold away to the Deep South.

calculated, understandable response to oppression.

Turner's wife and children seem to have escaped African Americans in Virginia and elsewhere took a reprisals, possibly because their connection

to the different view, however, calling him “General Nat”

preacher was not widely known. In an effort to pre-empt and referring to the rebellion as “Nat’s Fray” or “Old vent future uprisings, Virginia and other Southern Nat’s War.” Through folk stories, he was transformed states greatly expanded their slave patrols and mili-into a fierce general and a trickster hero who had tias; this large group of armed, well-trained white men defeated white men both in battle and with his mind.

would one day form the core of the Confederate Despised by the dominant culture, Turner was lionized Army. Although many Northern whites condemned by Southern blacks as one of the few Africans who the rebellion, sectional tensions increased as slave-successfully waged open war against slavery.

holders became further convinced that their way of

— *David Brodnax*

life was under attack. Northern abolitionists in particular were targeted for inspiring violence. Bounties **FURTHER READING**

were placed on William Lloyd Garrison’s head, and Greenberg, Kenneth S. (Ed.). (1996). *The Confessions of Nat* one jury in Raleigh even convicted him in absentia for *Turner and Related Documents*. Boston: Bedford Books.

inciting rebellion, although no evidence of a connec-The author provides the general context of Nat Turner’s tion between Turner and Garrison—or any other Rebellion, as well as Turner’s discussion of the rebellion abolitionist—has ever been found.

and related materials.

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 354

354———**Nation of Islam**

Greenberg, Kenneth S. (Ed.). (2003). *Nat Turner: A Slave Elijah Muhammad was that African Americans are Rebellion in History and*

Memory. New York: Oxford the original black nation of Asia known as the Tribe University Press. This is Greenberg's newest attempt to of Shabazz. This nation was said to have originated in place the rebellion in the American society's memory as a Africa when a great explosion divided the earth from moment of passion and vision.

the moon some 60 trillion years ago. The Tribe of Raboteau, Albert J. (1978). *Slave Religion: The "Invisible Institution" in the Antebellum South*. New York: Oxford Shabazz discovered that the rich land between the Nile Valley and Mecca was the best part of the earth on the religion of Africans during their enslavement, also is on which to live. But since the Tribe of Shabazz was a good introduction to the life of Nat Turner.

enslaved for 400 years, Fard Muhammad and his messenger Elijah Muhammad were sent by Allah to relocate the "lost-found nation" in an independent state. Therefore, since the so-called Negroes were **NATION OF ISLAM**

not and could not be American citizens by nature or race, they could be said to constitute a nation within The Nation of Islam is an indigenous African a nation. Hence, Elijah Muhammad renounced American socioreligious movement that was founded his U.S. citizenship and urged his followers to do in 1930 by W. D. Fard in Detroit, Michigan, and likewise.

developed by Elijah Muhammad. Though it began as Another core belief of the Nation of Islam is that it a socioreligious protest movement, its worldview is to is the religion of salvation and truth for black people, a large extent embedded in the Qur'an (which is also whereas Christianity is the religion of "evil white"

spelled Koran). It should not be confused with ortho-people. The theme "white devil" comes directly from dox Islam, which evolved in Mecca around 622 C.E.

the teachings of Noble Drew Ali, which identify white The Nation of Islam arose in the United States in people as the embodiment of the Satan in the Bible.

response to the crude, racist bigotry; socioeconomic The Nation of Islam also believes that Yacub, a injustices; lynching; and mob violence against African descendant of the Tribe of Shabazz, 6,800 years ago in Americans in the first decades of the 20th century.

Mecca, created a vengeful plot to enslave the tribe.

Another factor in the receptivity of the African Yacub was skillful in genetics and developed the American community to Islam was the failure of the white race through creating Adam and Eve by cross-Black Church to influence public policies in African breeding. Two thousand years later, Allah raised Americans' favor. Hence, the most despondent Moses to civilize the white race.

members of the African American community began The teachings of the Nation of Islam included to search for a new cultural and religious identity, images of the Armageddon by which the white race which they found in Islam.

would fall ignominiously into destruction, while in the East the black Muslims would rise triumphantly to rule the world and freedom, justice, and equality **ORIGINS AND EARLY TEACHINGS**

would prevail forever. The belief that Allah would The Nation of Islam evolved from the Moorish Science restore the New World Order after the final battle Temple founded by Noble Drew Ali in 1913 in Newark, against the "white devil" was preached in Elijah New Jersey. When the temple split into two factions, Muhammad's Mosque in Chicago. Images of Armaged- W. D. Fard moved to Detroit and trained several minis-don were also significant in the sermons of Malcolm X, ters to create a new group—the Nation of Islam. Among the national spokesman of the Nation of Islam, at them was Elijah Poole, later Elijah Muhammad, who at Harlem's Temple Number Seven in the late 1950s.

the time was an unemployed auto worker from the Elijah Muhammad turned the Nation of Islam into South. His knowledge of the Bible, as the son of a popular movement with a massive following. By Baptist minister, was what inspired W. D. Fard to make establishing mosques in poor inner-

city areas, the Elijah Muhammad the Supreme Minister of the Nation nation created several social and educational institu-of Islam. This explains why the Nation of Islam derives tions and activities in places where there had been its ideology from both the Bible and the Qur'an.

none. It reached into the poor, drug-infested neighbor-A core of the socioreligious teachings of both Fard hoods and the prisons with its message of a radical (who had become known as Fard Muhammad) and break with the past and a new beginning.

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 355

Nation of Islam———355

CURRENT TEACHINGS

enslavement, as well as providing a break with degradation, poverty, and the racial bigotry of the There is a continuation of some of these teachings in American establishment. For African Americans, Islam the contemporary Nation of Islam. Now the goals of symbolizes a rejection of white Christianity and its the Nation of Islam are to secure freedom, justice, and Eurocentric history and culture and offers a new way of equality under the law; equality of opportunity; and life based on complete submission to the will of Allah.

an end to police brutality and mob attacks against However, the Nation of Islam's claim that it consists African Americans. The Nation of Islam's other goals of the descendants of the original, great black Asiatic for those of African descent include employment nation is a fantasy of a glorious history of black Afro-opportunities, exemption from all taxation, prohibi-Asia. In addition, the notion of the Tribe of Shabazz tion of intermarriage or race mixing, knowledge of located between the Nile Valley and Mecca is without Islam, and a separate state for African Americans.

any historical reality. The idea of Islam as the religion The Nation of Islam believes it is important for its of nonwhites is also untrue and caused Malcolm X to members to be clean in spirit, mind, and body. This break away from the nation after his visit to Africa and belief is the source of the

group's prohibition of alcohol—the Holy City of Mecca in 1964. This visit transformed him, gambling, fornication before marriage, adultery, him from a black Muslim into a Muslim, as he met and dancing for its members. The members also have blond, blue-eyed men he could call his brothers.

dietary limitations—excluding pork, collard greens, corn bread, and neck bones from their diets because they are reminders of slavery, and including foods **CHANGES IN LEADERSHIP**

such as fish, chicken, and rice. Members are required In 1963, Elijah Muhammad's son, Wallace D.

to change their last names to X in order to rid them-Muhammad, and Malcolm X found themselves let selves of their “slave names.” The X is also said to down by Elijah Muhammad's infidelity within the represent the unknown identity associated with the *ummah* (i.e., the community of Muslims). By 1964, a African ancestry. In the Nation of Islam, men wear serious breakdown had occurred in the relationship suits and ties and are clean shaven and women cover between Elijah Muhammad and Malcolm. When their heads, wear long dresses that reach to their toes, Malcolm was assassinated, many people accused and wear no makeup. There is a separation between the Nation of Islam in the death of its most popular the sexes during prayers. Members are taught to spokesperson.

adhere to a strict moral and economic code that Wallace D. Muhammad (later known as Iman fosters thrift, capital gains, and self-respect.

Muhammad) succeeded his father, Elijah Muhammad, The economic development of the Nation of Islam as leader of the Nation of Islam after the latter's death has involved the establishment of farms, livestock in 1975. Iman Muhammad rapidly evolved the Nation and vegetable cultivation, rental housing, private home of Islam into the World Community of Islam in the construction, real estate purchases, food processing West. He accused his father of failing to give the centers, restaurants, Islamic schools, clothing factories,

“true” Islam to his community. He bestowed honor on banking, business league formations, import and export Bilal Ibn Ribah, a great person of

African heritage in businesses, health care, administrative offices, and men the history of early Islam, and changed the title of the and women's development and leadership training Nation of Islam's publication from *Muhammad* units. In 1972, the Honorable Elijah Muhammad *Speaks* to *Bilalian News*. But by 2003, Iman opened a \$2 million mosque and school in Chicago.

Muhammad had resigned his leadership, explaining This nation-building (*asabiya* in Arabic) program is an that the imams did not want to follow the strict Islam attempt at fostering the principle of self-determination that he taught. Elijah Muhammad's brother, John through collective ownership of business.

Muhammad, took over the World Community of Islam in the West when Iman Muhammad resigned.

CRITICISM OF THE TEACHINGS

THE NATION OF ISLAM UNDER FARRAKHAN

In many respects, the Nation of Islam has brought hope to disenchanted African Americans. It connects them The shift from the Nation of Islam's *asabiya* (nation to a religion not associated with the legacy of the building) to the purely *umann* (religious community)

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 356

356———**National Association for the Advancement of Colored People** of the World Community of Islam in the West had New York City by a group of black and white citizens left a void that Louis Farrakhan, a follower of Elijah committed to social justice and improving the quality Muhammad and the most popular preacher in the of life for African Americans. It was based on the Nation of Islam, sought to fill. Farrakhan succeeded in Niagara movement, a group of African American acquiring the major temple and residence of Elijah activists and scholars who opposed Booker Muhammad in Chicago. The temple was renamed T. Washington's Tuskegee Machine, which was a the Mosque Maryam and Muhammad's University political network and the dominant voice and inter-of Islam

School. It focuses on educating African preter of the African American people at the turn of Americans and other minority groups to arm them in the 20th century. Washington used his vast connec-their struggle against racism in the United States. The tions to influential whites and their financial support Nation of Islam under Louis Farrakhan has restored to gain prominence and position as well as to build the the worldview of Elijah Muhammad, including that of Tuskegee Institute. He also used his access to money Fard Muhammad as the long-awaited Messiah of the and influence to dictate the discussion about the future Christians and the Madhi of the Muslims. The Nation of the African American community.

of Islam also continues to uphold the December Fast In 1905 in Niagara Falls, Canada, 29 activists met to distinguish it from Ramadan, which is practiced by to discuss how to minimize Washington's influence orthodox Muslims. Under Minister Louis Farrakhan, and create a new class comprised of what W.E.B. Du the legacy of Elijah Muhammad continues and the Bois called the "talented tenth" of the black popula-Nation of Islam advances as an institution committed tion. The activists were educated men and women, to the transformation of the American society.

and they felt that the social, political, and economic situation of blacks demanded bold action. The group,

— *Kwame Botwe-Asamoah*

which included Ida B. Wells and Monroe Trotter, planned to move aggressively to gain full rights of **FURTHER READING**

citizenship for blacks.

Lee, Martha F. (1996). *The Nation of Islam*. Syracuse, NY: The Niagara movement agitated in the courts and Syracuse University Press. This work makes a contribution demonstrated a willingness to be defiant in its fight to the understanding of the organization as a contemporary against racism. It was with this spirit that the Niagara nationalist movement. Following lines laid down by earlier movement members led the 1909 founding of the scholars, this book goes into areas that are not discussed National Association for the Advancement of Colored in earlier works.

People, which has grown to include half a million Marsh, Clifton E. (1996). *From Black Muslims to Muslims: The Resurrection, Transformation, Change of the Lost-members and become the nation's most important Found Nation of Islam in America, 1930–1995*. London: civil rights group. There are 1,700 branch chapters Scarecrow Press. This is a very useful introduction to the and 450 college and youth chapters. The organization Nation of Islam, which includes answers to lots of ques-has had a powerful influence on the legal structure tions about its origins and programs.

of the country, and Thurgood Marshall and Charles McCloud, Amina Beverly. (1995). *African American Islam: An Houston, two of the most distinguished lawyers ever American Millenarian Movement*. New York: Routledge.

to serve in the organization, made legal history with This volume grew out of McCloud's doctoral dissertation their arguments before the Supreme Court.

on Islam in the African American community. It is one of the few works to seriously look at the movement since The NAACP has made bold investigations of mob Essien-Udom's massive Black Nationalism.

brutality and protested mass murders of blacks, segregation, and discrimination. The organization has also made testimony before congressional committees on the vicious tactics used to bar African Americans **NATIONAL ASSOCIATION**

from the ballot box. Many members of the NAACP

FOR THE ADVANCEMENT

legal staff participated in the battles between the white Southerners and the progressive forces to elim-OF COLORED PEOPLE

inate racial segregation. Among these pioneers for justice have been some who are well known, such as The National Association for the Advancement of W. E. B Du Bois, Thurgood Marshall, Walter White, Colored People

(NAACP) was founded in 1909 in James Weldon Johnson, Roy Wilkins, and others,

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 357

National Black Political Convention, Gary, Indiana———357

thousands of others, whose names may not be larger role in the decision making that affected their remembered but who placed their lives on the line for communities on a daily basis. They sought to continue civil rights and justice. This is what has given the and further develop the visions of such key figures as NAACP its noble history.

Martin Luther King and Malcolm X. The hope was that an agenda could be developed that would be rele-

— Mario Root

vant not merely to the delegates but, more important, to the people they served at home.

FURTHER READING

Among the issues and goals that were discussed Cruse, Harold. (1967). The Crisis of the Negro Intellectual.

during the course of the convention were the following: New York: William Morrow. This is an excellent look at the various tensions in the African American intellectual com-

- the education of African American children munity over civil rights, culture, and progress.*
- the creation of a program for black farmers and Lewis, David Levering. (1993). W.E.B. Du Bois: Biography of a Race, 1868–1919. New York: Henry Holt. Written by one rural development*

of the master historians of the contemporary era, this book

- *the institution of day care for all working parents shows the intimate way in which Du Bois led the discus-*

- *the creation of geriatric centers for the aged sions about race in the nation.*

- *the establishment of home rule for the District of Columbia*

- *the establishment of a national network of **NATIONAL BLACK POLITICAL***

community health centers

- *the elimination of capital punishment **CONVENTION, GARY, INDIANA***

- *the creation of a national health insurance program*

From March 10 to March 12 in 1972, the National

- *a government guarantee of a minimum annual Black Political Convention was held at the Westside income of \$5,200*

High School in Gary, Indiana. The convention was

- *a minimum wage guarantee of \$2.50 an hour cochaired by Gary mayor Richard G. Hatcher, U.S.*

- *the creation of a black united fund Representative Charles C. Diggs, and poet-activist Amiri Baraka of the Congress of African Peoples. The Agreeing on which issues were relevant to the convention was an all-African American gathering masses of African Americans proved to be a far easier that brought together both integrationist and national-task than coming up with viable solutions for the ist leadership in an effort to create a progressive polit-challenges raised. The ideologically diverse gathering ical agenda for the African American community.*

of delegates struggled to reach consensus regarding Of the 8,000 convention attendees, 3,300 were many issues raised during the course of the event. The delegates representing 42 states. The delegates claimed most

dramatic occurrence involved the Michigan membership in various civil rights, community, and delegation, led by Detroit mayor Coleman Young.

political groups and were selected via statewide politi-Fearing that the agenda was too separatist, the heavily cal caucuses. African American elected officials were unionized Michigan group walked out in protest of automatically given delegate status. Among the dele-what they viewed as a platform that if it was endorsed gates were Jesse Jackson, Louis Farrakhan, Bobby might jeopardize what they considered beneficial ties Seale, Julian Bond, Betty Shabazz, Coretta Scott with organized labor.

King, Barbara Jordan, Carl Stokes, Coleman Young, The work of the convention culminated with the Louis Stokes, Vincent Harding, Patricia Patterson, ratification of the “Action Agenda for Black People.”

Kim Weston, Walter E. Fauntroy, Ronald Dellums, This 55-page document touched on domestic and for-Richard Roundtree, Yvonne Braithwaite, and Patricia eign policy issues and articulated a plan for African Patterson.

American empowerment in the public and private The convention participants held diverse view-sectors of American life. After the convention, its dele-points regarding the best political direction for the gates pressured President Richard Nixon’s administra-African American community. The group addressed tion to create several policies in line with the aims of both local and national issues. What the attendees the National Black Political Convention. The Nixon shared was a desire for African Americans to play a Administration created business funding, affirmative

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 358

358——National Black United Fund

action, and welfare reform measures that mirrored would serve as founding members on the National recommendations offered by the delegates. In addition, Board of Directors. With grant support from the the Democratic Party created a platform that incorpo-Cummins Engine Foundation, NBUF was incorporated ideas first generated at the convention.

rated in New York and located its national headquar-Although some goals in the “Action Agenda for ters in Harlem. Walter Bremond served as the Black People” became reality, much of the agenda organization’s first executive director, and James was never implemented. One legacy of the convention Josephs,

president of the Cummins Engine

was the upsurge in the number of African American Foundation, became chairman of the board. Affiliate elected officials and African American community organizations immediately sprang up in major urban groups after this 1972 meeting.

centers such as New York, Detroit, Boston, San Francisco, Dallas, and Houston.

— Christopher K. Johnson

NBUF’s overall mission was to find ways for the black community to fund its own liberation struggle.

FURTHER READING

NBUF challenged social inequities and the unequal dis-Gibbs, Wilma L. (Ed.). (2002). *National Black Political tribution of power in American society. Most impor-Convention Collection, 1972–1973*. Indianapolis: Indiana tant, it created a viable, systematic, and cost-efficient Historical Society. This Indiana Historical Society docu-mechanism for black Americans to make charitable mentation contains a brief yet very useful biographical contributions to black organizations engaged in social sketch of the convention.

Hull, Mary. (1998). *Struggle and Love 1972–1997: From the change and the development of black human potential*.

Gary Convention to the Aftermath of the Million Man Funding programs that focused on human services, March. New York: Chelsea House. Hull provides an excel-community development, social policy development, lent

summary of the events leading up to the convention, social advocacy, and cooperative economics were given the event itself, and what it accomplished.

top priority.

During its initial stage of development, NBUF

relied primarily on foundation support and payroll deductions as a means to support the work of the **NATIONAL BLACK UNITED FUND**

organization. Workplace giving was viewed as an appropriate fund-raising strategy since most black In 1972, the National Black United Fund (NBUF) was income was derived from salaries. Being cognizant of founded as a black philanthropic institution whose the high percentage of African Americans employed purpose was to enhance the quality of life for black by the federal government (including in military ser-people and empower the African American community.

vice), NBUF recognized that the Combined Federal The genesis of the NBUF is linked directly to the Campaign (CFC) program, which permitted federal Brotherhood Crusade, which was created in Los Angeles in 1968 by a group of concerned black activists zations through payroll deductions, could provide a led by Walter Bremond of the Cummins Engine stable and reliable source of revenue for the organi-Foundation. These activists were inspired by the civil zation and its affiliates. However, NBUF was initially rights and social change movements of the era to cre-denied entrance to the CFC program. In response, in ate a group to promote charitable fund-raising in the 1976 NBUF legally challenged the unfair, discrimi-black community. The Brotherhood Crusade's mission natory practices of the CFC. In 1980, NBUF secured was to create a systematic and strategic model for the legal right to enter the CFC program when a fed-black fund-raising and black self-help.

eral court ruled that the organization's constitutional In 1972, some nationally recognized black leaders rights had been violated. This breakthrough allowed sought to establish a network that would link the

myriad other “alternative” charitable organizations to movement for social change with independent benefit from federal employee campaigns that had fund-raising efforts from around the country. Among previously been dominated by the United Way of these black leaders were the Reverend Negail Riley, America.

the Reverend Dr. Leon Sullivan, Quincy Jones, Walter Bremond continued to provide visionary Dr. Dorothy Height, Leroy Jones (later known as leadership for the organization until his death in 1982.

Amiri Baraka), and Lucius Walker, all of whom However, following his death, NBUF board members

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 359

National Council for Black Studies———359

engaged in a bitter and eventually destructive struggle **FURTHER READING**

over the control of the organization. As a result, many Bakewell, D. J. X. (1977). *The Brotherhood Crusade: A prominent board members departed, leaving NBUF in Conceptual Model. Black Scholar, 11, 22-26.* This is a state of disarray. It was several years before Dana study of the early movement that led to the creation of the Alston was selected as the permanent executive direc-National Black United Fund.

tor. Under Alston’s leadership (1985–1987), NBUF

Carson, Emmett D. (1993). *The National Black United Fund: continued to expand its mission, focusing on affiliate From Movement for Social Change to Social Change development, environmental concerns, and women’s Organization. In New Directions for Philanthropic Fund-issues as part of its overall program objectives.*

raising. Carson documents the development of the philosophy that informs the National Black United Fund.

In 1987, William T. Merritt assumed the position of King, Davis E. (1980). Fund Raising in the Black Community.

CEO and president of the organization. Under his Metuchen, NJ: Scarecrow Press. King analyses the leadership, NBUF incorporated the National Black promises as well as challenges of fundraising in the African United Federation of Charities (NBUFC)—a federa-American community.

*tion of over 45 national black nonprofit organizations engaged in social justice, policy advocacy, community development, and charitable services—and expanded **NATIONAL COUNCIL***

*its mission to include wealth and asset building for individuals, families, and nonprofit organizations in **FOR BLACK STUDIES***

the black community.

Throughout its over 30 years, NBUF and its affili-The National Council For Black Studies, Inc. (NCBS) ates have succeeded in generating millions of dollars was founded in 1975 by a group of academics, under in charitable revenue by participating in employee the leadership of Bertha Maxwell (later Bertha payroll deduction campaigns that have included fed-Maxwell Roddey), that pioneered some of the earliest eral, state, and local government employees as well as Black Studies programs on university campuses in the corporate employees. Through its local affiliates the United States. The purpose of the organization is to organization distributes grants to community-based promote and strengthen academic and community organizations and institutions serving the black com-programs in the area of Black Studies.

munity. However, NBUF's many accomplishments Bertha Maxwell Roddey, often referred to as the pale in comparison to the community's potential for

“Mother of the Black Studies Movement,” was the philanthropic development. Substantial funding, edu-person responsible for convening the group in 1975 in cational programs, marketing tools, and adequate Charlotte, North Carolina, from March 18 to March access to philanthropic dollars are still needed to 21. This group had as its goal to review and

analyze continue realizing the dream of black social and the structure and goals of Black Studies programs economic empowerment. Moreover, internal strife, across the nation. A follow-up meeting was held in resulting in legal battles between the national body July of that year at the Educational Testing Service and several of its local affiliates, has threatened to (ETS) in Princeton, New Jersey. It was at this meeting, divert the organization's resources and energies from convened by ETS's William Harris, that the organiza-its main purpose and mission.

tion was created, with Maxwell elected temporary NBUF strives to maintain its leadership role as the chairperson.

premier black fund-raising and philanthropic organi-From its inception, the organization viewed itself zation. By providing stable and ongoing support for as representing the academic discipline responsible for black nonprofit organizations, NBUF hopes to serve describing and analyzing the world from a black peras the anchor for a new vision of economic empower-spective. However, the term black perspective could ment and the social revitalization of the African not be sustained, as the organization's members came American community. The essence of its mission and from various disciplines and professions and held ongoing purpose is clearly stated in the organization's numerous perspectives. Over the years, the organiza-motto, as NBUF continues to be: "The Helping Hand tion matured, along with the discipline, placing the That Is Your Own."

highest value on curriculums and scholarship rooted in the history, culture, social realities, and worldview of

— Patricia Reid-Merritt

Africa. In 1985 the organization sharpened its statement

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 360

360——National Council for Black Studies of purpose, specifying that the National Council For those programs. NCBS dared to organize black Black Studies is a professional organization that teacher-scholar-activists

to defend their measured but defines, promotes, and enriches Black Studies as a essential victories.

vehicle to further the development of people of Early on, the council formed an Intervention African descent. The books Afrocentricity: The Committee, the primary function of which is to Theory of Social Change (1980) and The Afrocentric investigate complaints of institutional attacks on Idea (1987) by Molefi Kete Asante and Kawaida Black Studies programs or individual Black Studies Theory (1980) by Maulana Karenga contributed faculty. In fulfilling its charge, the committee has immeasurably to this evolution.

advocated for and defended Black Studies through In addition to its revised statement of purpose, the negotiating with university administrators, publish-organization needed a concise slogan or motto that ing editorials in local and national media, and filing would communicate its raison d'etr quickly and eas-amicus briefs with the court. In the mid-1980s, the ily. The NCBS found such a motto in a phrase coined attack on the discipline was widespread enough to for a very successful NCBS conference, which was prompt Delores P. Aldridge, then the president of organized in 1983 by Abdul Alkalimat (then known as NCBS, to issue a press release in July of 1986 to Gerald McWhorter) for the Illinois Council of Black urge public elected officials to hold public hearings Studies. The phrase "Academic Excellence and Social to address the issue of the destabilization of Black Responsibility" became and continues to be the motto Studies through the removal from chair positions of the organization because it so clearly reflects its of persons of strong Black Studies leadership. All commitment to scholarship for the betterment of its too often, poorly supported programs were being community.

exploited by administrators anxious to seize the moment to disrupt Black Studies. Citing specific cases at the State University of New York at Albany,
A RADICAL ORGANIZATION

the Ohio State University, San Jose State University, By its very nature, the National Council For Black and Portland State University, Aldridge related Studies was a radical organization at the time of its these attacks to the declining retention and gradua-founding. Black Studies programs were a logical tion rates of black students, who depended on the intellectual

extension of the civil rights movement of mentoring of individual black faculty and the sup-the 1960s that challenged the Eurocentric curriculum port of Black Studies programs for their academic and white supremacist philosophies of the American success.

academy. Maulana Karenga, in his Introduction to Black Studies (1982), indicated that one of the princi-CHANGES IN LEADERSHIP

pal roles of Black Studies scholars is to critique and correct the literature written by others. Black students Headquartered for the first 16 years of its existence at and other progressive students and community Indiana University in Bloomington, NCBS benefited activists demanded a comprehensive transformation greatly from the unequivocal support of Herman of higher education, requiring a rethinking of its cur-Hudson, then the dean of African American Affairs, riculum, the hiring of black faculty, and the kind of and Joseph Russell, who served as the executive direc-student support services that would enhance the like-tor of the organization from 1976 to 1991. Under the lihood of success for students who had been socially auspices of Russell, as the newly appointed vice and economically deprived. However, while these chancellor for Minority Affairs at the Ohio State goals for Black Studies programs were clear, the University, the national office moved to Columbus, establishment of the programs turned out to be for the Ohio. Shortly after its relocation there, the executive most part a political compromise rather than the out-director position was assumed by Jacqueline Wade, come of enlightened, rational decision making, and the former director of the Black Studies program at what was accomplished fell far short of what was the University of Pennsylvania. In 1994 the organi-envisioned. In fact, the old establishment did not zation's contract with the Ohio State University expect Black Studies programs to survive, and when-expired. Selase Williams, who was completing his ever possible, institutions found ways to undermine second term as president of NCBS and had accepted Black Studies programs and the faculty who taught in an appointment as dean of the College of Arts and

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 361

National Council for Black Studies———361

Sciences at California State University, Dominguez **SURVEYS OF BLACK STUDIES**

Hills, was able to negotiate a new contract for NCBS

on that campus. During its 8 years at Dominguez Between 1987 and 1988, Ford engaged noted Hills, the organization had a series of executive directors: Darlene Clark Hines to survey Black Studies, Hansonia Caldwell, Jossiah Cobbah, Tina Lee, faculty at various campuses to chronicle the achievements and Faye Edwards. In the spring of 2002, the national meetings of the discipline. One of those campuses was office was invited to relocate to Georgia State the University of Washington in Seattle, which had University, under the auspices of Charles Jones, only recently established the Department of Comparative American Studies, a consolidation of Afro-American Studies, and with a new executive director, American Studies, Asian American Studies, and Patricia Dixon.

Chicano Studies. Sela Williams, who was then the director of Afro-American Studies, invited Hines to meet with the executive board of NCBS. That meeting **DEDICATION TO ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE**

resulted in the development of an NCBS proposal to Because of the primary emphasis of Black Studies on the Ford Foundation and a 3-year, \$300,000 grant high quality, accurate, and complete educational experiences focused on three areas: (1) professional development, experiences for students, much of the council's attention (2) curriculum standards, and (3) program data has been devoted to curriculum development. This centralization. Delores P. Aldridge, president of the resulted in the publication of the Black Studies Core organization and the person who shepherded the pro-Curriculum (1981), which was developed by a committee, became the project director. The awarding of money chaired by Perry Hall and subsequently this grant constituted a major milestone in the history referred to as the Hall model. As an interdisciplinary of the organization.

model, it requires an introduction to Black Studies Professional development was a very important course and a series of three courses each in three component of the grant since many, if not most, faculty broad

subject areas: (1) social and behavioral studies, teaching in Black Studies programs were self-taught in (2) history, and (3) cultural studies. The culminating areas of the black experience. While a scholar's disser-course is a senior seminar in which students are tation research might have centered on some aspect of expected to synthesize their knowledge from other the black experience, his or her training was in a courses and apply that knowledge in ways useful to traditional discipline. The grant provided support for their community.

NCBS to enroll 15 to 20 scholars who recently gradu-In the 1980s, the Ford Foundation commissioned ated with their doctorates and newly appointed Black a series of studies on the discipline of Black Studies Studies faculty in the NCBS Summer Institute to study that were carried out by various African American with some of the most prominent scholars in the field.

scholars. Especially noteworthy among these studies Of equal importance were NCBS Administrative was *Afro-American Studies: A Report to the Ford Training Workshops for new and aspiring Black Foundation (1985)* by Nathan Huggins, the director Studies chairs and program coordinators.

of the W.E.B. Du Bois Institute for Afro-American The curriculum standards component of the grant Research at Harvard University. The report identified was assigned to the Curriculum and Accreditation institutions like Harvard and Yale as home to the pre-Committee, headed by William A. Little, in collabora-mier Black Studies programs in the country. NCBS

tion with Carolyn Leonard and Edward Crosby. The challenged this assessment on the basis that the study committee was charged with collecting data on exist-had used only traditional criteria for determining qual-ing curriculums and curriculum models, constructing ity. NCBS asserted that there were many programs model curriculums, and compiling curriculum devel-whose outreach efforts and development of student opment guidebooks. One of the products that resulted leadership had significantly impacted the black com-from this project was the *Holistic Afrocentric* munities around their respective institutions. They *Curriculum Development Model* (1990), which dif-also stated that these achievements were more conferred significantly from the curriculum in the Hall sistent

with the goals envisioned for Black Studies model and broke away from other curriculum models programs than were the purely academic achieve- that used Eurocentric disciplinary categories (e.g., ments measured by the study.

history, psychology, sociology, art). Use of traditional

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 362

362———**National Council for Black Studies** disciplinary categories had led Black Studies scholars Ghana, the Association of African Universities, and to define the African world experience in terms of the W. E. B. Du Bois Centre for Pan African Culture.

black history, black psychology, black music, black NCBS was successful in taking 350 African art, and the like, whereas the committee's holistic Americans to Ghana, in addition to participants from model reconceptualized and repackaged knowledge England, Germany, the Caribbean, and many other in ways that better reflect an African worldview and African countries.

transcend the artificial disciplinary boundaries With the annual conference being held in Ghana imposed on knowledge as if they were universal. The during the summer, the organization located the holistic Afrocentric model is also an alternative to the Summer Institute there, availing the institute fellows periodization model developed by Abdul Alkalimat of outstanding Ghanaian scholars, as well as those and Associates in their textbook *An Introduction to* from the United States, and giving institute fellows *Afro-American Studies: A People's College Primer* firsthand exposure to West Africa. Many of the insti-

(1986), which is organized chronologically, focusing tute fellows collaborated with Ghanaian scholars in on critical periods in the social development of the research projects, exchange programs, and other African American community.

scholarly activities. Because of the multiple benefits Delores Aldridge personally took on the task of that were gained from holding the institute in

Africa, collecting and analyzing baseline data on Black all subsequent institutes have been held in Ghana.

Studies programs across the country. While initially In addition to the success of its annual conferences, planning to survey only institutions with Black the council achieved a major milestone in 2002 when Studies programs, the project ended up designing a it joined the list of organizations that participate in the survey instrument that was administered to all 4-year National Black United Fund (NBUF). Patricia Reid-colleges and universities in the United States.

Merritt, a member of the executive board and author of *Sister Power* (1997, Wiley), spearheaded the application process for this honor. As a member of this **SUCCESS WITH FORD**

consortium, NCBS can solicit financial support **FOUNDATION SUPPORT**

through payroll deduction and ultimately build an The success of the projects funded by the Ford endowment to support its efforts in perpetuity.

Foundation inspired the foundation to award NCBS an Over the years NCBS has maintained special extension in funding for another 3 years. Thus, Ford relationships with organizations having similar mis-provided the organization \$600,000 over the 6-year sions. Among those organizations are the National period from 1988 to 1994. The second period of fund-Association of Black Cultural Centers, African ing coincided with the organization's interest in rekin-American Heritage Studies Association, Association dling and formalizing its links with Africa. Although for the Study of Classical African Civilizations, the early period in the development of Black Studies Association for the Study of Afro-American Life and witnessed the first introduction of students and many History, the Assault On Illiteracy, the National Black faculty to Africa, by the 1990s most Black Studies pro-Child Development Institute, National Society of grams focused primarily, if not exclusively, on the Black School Educators, and the Association of Black African American experience. In response to this situ-Psychologists.

ation, in 1991 NCBS began planning a series of international conferences, the first to be held in Ghana, **LEADERSHIP AND EXPANSION**

West Africa, in the summer of 1993. Selase Williams, who was president of NCBS from 1990 to 1994, and While there are many prominent teacher-scholar-William Little, chair of the International Affairs activists who have played essential roles in the Committee, cochaired the Conference Planning development of the National Council For Black Committee. In this capacity, they traveled to Ghana in Studies—and an even larger number of those who 1991 and 1992 to lay the groundwork for NCBS's first have conducted the research, written the textbooks, international conference and to build relationships developed the courses, and published the books and with educational, governmental, and nongovernmental periodicals that serve as the foundation for the disci-organizations. As a consequence of these efforts, the pline—there are nine individuals who have provided conference was cosponsored with the Universities of leadership to the organization during the various

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 363

National Negro Congress——363

phases of its almost 30-year history. These people are Lexington, MA: Lexington Books. This is a critical work listed below in chronological order: by two women pioneers in the field of Africana Studies.

Alkalimat, Abdul, and Bailey, Ron. (1986). *An Introduction to Afro-American Studies: A People's College Primer*.

Bertha Maxwell Roddey, University of North Chicago: 21st Century. This book is a progressive interpre-Carolina at Charlotte, 1975–1978

tation of the field that has been criticized for being too biased toward socialism.

William King, University of Colorado at Boulder, Asante, Molefi Kete. (1980). *Afrocentricity: The Theory of 1978–1980*

Social Change. New York: Amulefi. Asante's book is one of the first attempts to state what the field could benefit William Nelson, Jr., The Ohio State University, most by studying.

1980–1982

Hall, Perry (Ed.). (1981). *Black Studies Core Curriculum*.

Carlene Young, San Jose State University, Bloomington, IN: National Council For Black Studies.

This was the first attempt by a scholar to develop a core 1982–1984 curriculum.

Delores P. Aldridge, Emory University, 1984–1988

Harris, Robert L., Hines, Darlene Clark, and McKay, Nellie.

(1990). *Three Essays: Black Studies in the United States*.

Charles Henry, University of California, Berkeley, New York: The Ford Foundation. This is an official report 1988–1990

for the Ford Foundation.

Huggins, Nathan. (1985). *Afro-American Studies: A Report to Selase W. Williams*, California State University, *the Ford Foundation*. New York: The Ford Foundation.

Northridge, 1990–1994

This was the first report on the subject for the Ford Foundation.

William A. Little, California State University-Little, William A. (Ed.). (1990). *Holistic Afrocentric Curriculum* Dominguez Hills, 1994–1998

Development Model. Los Angeles: National Council For Black Studies. This was the NCBS's answer to the call for a James Stewart, Pennsylvania

State University, curriculum model.

1998–2002

Shirley Weber, San Diego State University, 2002–2004

NATIONAL NEGRO CONGRESS

Thanks to the many individuals who have dedicated themselves to the NCBS, the organization continues to The National Negro Congress (NNC) had its begin-expand into new areas. The NCBS conducts an annual nings at the conference Economic Crisis and the student essay contest, administers program reviews, Negro, which was held in Washington, D.C., in May and publishes a newsletter, *The Voice of Black Studies*.

of 1935. The conference was sponsored by the Joint In 1992, the NCBS published its inaugural issue of Committee on National Recovery and Howard *The Afrocentric Scholar: The Journal of the National University's* Department of Political Economy. The *Council for Black Studies*, with partial support coming conference produced evidence that depression and initially from West Virginia University and more recovery trends were forcing African Americans into recently from Loyola Marymount University in Los an even lower economic and social position than they Angeles. With William Little as the editor, the journal had previously occupied. It decided to create a was renamed the *International Journal of Africana* national congress to educate African Americans in the *Studies* in 1998 to reflect the global perspective being techniques of group action and in developing an promoted by the National Council For Black Studies action plan.

and the integration of African, African American, and The organizing committee convened for the first diasporic studies in the evolving discipline.

time in November of 1935 in Washington, D.C.

The meeting included all types of African American

— *Selase W. Williams*

organizations and had as its goal developing a platform to unite them in a program addressing African **FURTHER READINGS**

Americans' economic, social, and civil security needs.

Aldridge, Delores P., and Young, Carlene. (2000). *Out of The National Negro Congress was structured to be the Revolution: The Development of Africana Studies*.

a federation of organizations, to include people of

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 364

364——**National Negro Congress**

different political parties and philosophies as well as approach. In his view, problem solving could occur those of different races, and to assume the responsi-through statesmanship, politics, and appealing to the bility of coordinating a national plan of action, which legislatures, and he saw no reason to continue the was to be developed the following year at the Chicago NNC practice of developing additional local units.

convention.

This argument was opposed by Edward E. Strong, for-At that first organizational meeting in 1935, temmer national executive secretary, who believed it to be porary national officers and organizers were elected a communist plot to weaken NNC influence and and appointed. After the Chicago convention in increase the sway of the Communist Party. He February of 1936, the temporary officers became per-remained adamant in his refusal to change the ideol-manent. The elected officers were A. Philip Randolph, ogy of the NNC to one that supported educational president; John P. Davis, executive secretary; Marion forum over developing affiliated groups.

Cuthbert, treasurer; and Joseph Evans, assistant treasurer. In the end, the executive committee's decision was reversed. The overall purpose of the NNC was to develop to become an educational forum contributed to the organized protest against Jim Crow laws and the demise of the NNC. The new policy reduced the tensions. Its agenda included ways to bring about social, impact of the NNC in the Black United Front movement, political, and economic advancement for African Americans and removed the most effective avenue the NNC

Americans.

had to reach African Americans. The NNC had always had participants at the Howard University conference. The participants at the conference agreed that African Americans were experiencing conditions adopted at its national conventions. With the economic crisis whose root was racism. American new focus, the NNC was losing touch with its affiliate industry and unions made it a practice to exclude organizations, which had the responsibility to transmit African Americans, thereby creating the crisis. It was these resolutions locally. To the organization's disbelief that African Americans needed options to the may, it soon became evident that the new policy of NAACP, and that the NNC could provide a viable writing papers and issuing press releases rather than alternative. Members of the NNC intended to prove to the old policy of confrontation was a failure.

their fellow Americans that African Americans are a Perceiving that there was no future in the NNC, valuable segment of the American economy, are an many of its executive officers resigned. Local affiliate-important resource in times of national emergency, and labor unions also began to leave the congress are only seeking what is rightfully theirs under the after it was branded by the House Un-American U.S. Constitution.

Activities Committee (HUAC) as a subversive organization. At the outset, the organization identified several zation. Losing members and influence, the NNC

immediate concerns. They were (1) to see that African Americans decided in November of 1947 to join forces with a Americans exercised their right to

seek and find mean-new organization called the Civil Rights Congress
ingful employment that provided a living wage; (2) to (CRC), which had
been formed in Detroit in 1946.

open the doors of trade unions to African American The program of the
latter organization was similar in membership; (3) to provide assistance to
African nature to that of the old NNC. It used protest to attract American
farmers who were in dire straits and losing attention to violence against
African Americans in their farms; (4) to stop vigilante violence, lynching,
and the form of lynchings, police brutality, and discrimi-police brutality; (5)
to help African Americans to be nation. The CRC, however, was also
denounced by able to use their voting rights and serve on juries; (6) to
HUAC as a communist front organization.

secure rights for African American women and youth; The NNC did serve a
useful purpose. During its (7) to oppose colonialism, fascism, and war.

first 4 years, it showed that it could deliver acceptable During the first few
years of its existence, the programs to its affiliates. For all of the years of its
personal philosophy of the NNC's first president, A.

existence, it continued to use its forum to agitate for Philip Randolph,
guided the organization. He believed full citizenship with all of its inherent
rights for that it was only through constant struggle that African African
Americans. By far, its most significant contri-Americans could hope to get
justice and freedom. In bution was its ability to keep in front of African
1945, the NNC instituted a basic change in its policy.

Americans, and the American public at large, the idea A view promoted by
board member Benjamin J.

that the guarantees of the Constitution are attainable, Davis argued that new
times called for a new if the populace in sufficient numbers would marshal

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 365

their forces to bring to bear the moral condemnation the North still provided opportunities unavailable in of the world.

the South.

— *Zetla K. Elvi*

ORIGINS

FURTHER READING

Philanthropic organizations funded initiatives to edu-Davis, John P. (1935). *Let Us Build a National Congress*.

cate and train the unskilled labor pool in the North.

Chicago: National Negro Congress. This states clearly the Organizations established with interracial boards—

need for African Americans to make a united effort to over-such as the Committee for the Improvement of come the political, economic, and social evils perpetrated Industrial Condition Among Negroes in New York against them.

Foner, Philip S., and Lewis, Ronald L. (Eds.). (1989). *Black* (founded in 1906), the National League for the *Workers: A Documentary History From Colonial Times to* Protection of Colored Women (founded in 1906), and *the Present*. Philadelphia: Temple University Press. The the Committee on Urban Conditions Among Negroes essays in this book outline the course of black labor from (founded in 1910)—provided housing and vocational the mid-19th century to the 1980s.

and educational training. These groups, led by Ruth Hughes, Cicero Alvin. (1982). *Toward a Black United Front*: Standish Baldwin and George Edmund Hays, later *The National Negro Congress Movement*. Ann Arbor, MI: consolidated to form the National League on Urban University Microfilms International. Hughes documents Conditions Among Negroes in 1911.

African American attempts to develop a Black United Front movement.

Baldwin, the wife of philanthropist and railroad Miller, Kelly. (1936). *Black Turns Red. The Christian Century*, magnate William H. Baldwin, was active in the 53. This is a report of the proceedings of the National National League for the Protection of Colored Women Negro Congress held in Chicago in 1936.

and spent much of her time as an advocate for social Streater, John B. (1981). *The National Negro Congress* justice, especially for the protection of women from 1936–47. Cincinnati, OH: University of Cincinnati Press.

mistreatment and manipulation. George Hayes, a soci-Streater provides an in-depth examination of National ologist who worked in New York for the Committee Negro Congress development.

for the Improvement of Industrial Condition Among Negroes, believed in training blacks as social workers.

Hayes approached Baldwin with his theory regarding **NATIONAL URBAN LEAGUE**

the importance of both research and training to prepare blacks for urban life and of educating blacks in The National Urban League is an organization that the social sciences. Together they worked to establish was founded on social work theory and research to the National League on Urban Conditions Among initiate and promote community-based programs to Negroes, which Baldwin insisted that Hayes lead to assist urban black America. The need for such an ensure the incorporation of his ideas into the frame-organization emerged from the history of blacks in the work of the organization.

United States after the end of the Civil War in 1865, The league provided programs that included coun-when emancipation promised a great deal but actually seling, education, employment, and housing for the offered little freedom to blacks in the South. Then migrants. Under Hays, the league also created a social *Plessy v. Ferguson* and Jim Crow laws increased service department at Fisk University, which created a oppression and legal

separation of the races. The 20th model for developing a vested interest in black col-century brought the industrial revolution to the North, leges serving urban communities. Due to the success which provided job opportunities for the wave of of its programs, by the end of World War I the league European immigrants to the United States. The avail-had grown to include 27 affiliates staffed by paid ability of social, cultural, and employment opportuni-professionals.

ties contributed to an exodus of blacks from the South The league had a pivotal year in 1918. The first of to Northern cities. Migrants new to the North encoun-the year's many changes involved the league's name.

tered limited access to anything but menial jobs and Many thought the name National League on Urban were offered little except the effects of urbanization—

Conditions Among Negroes was cumbersome, so the poor housing and limited access to education.

organization agreed to shorten its name to the Although discrimination was prevalent, urban life in National Urban League, with the change becoming

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 366

366——National Urban League

official in 1920. Also during this time, the New York The league also sporadically published the *Urban* office became an affiliate and plans were under way to *League Bulletin*, which reported the work and progress establish a national program that would reorganize of the organization. To broaden its audience, in 1923

and change the direction of the league. George Hayes the league started it own magazine, *Opportunity*: left the league to join the Department of Labor, and *Journal of Negro Life*. The magazine's purpose was to Eugene Kinckle Jones became the next to direct the create a forum for black authors and provide the public National Urban League.

with authoritative, scholarly articles pertaining to the issues and situation of blacks in the United States. It also chronicled current activities, providing information-**WORKS AND PROGRESS**

tion about people, programs, practical information, This era of the National Urban League, with its values, education, work, self-sufficiency, and recognition-national programming and leadership, became one of tion of black artists.

further expansion. League members, under the leadership of Eugene Kinckle Jones, expanded employment League's Department of Industrial Relations worked opportunities for blacks by creating personal relationships with business owners. In addition, the league who were losing jobs and consideration in favor of engaged in a continual struggle to get blacks into the white workforce. To understand the severity of unions by working with the American Federation of the situation, the league conducted two major studies, Labor and creating publicity campaigns urging blacks

"How Unemployment Affects Negroes" and "Unemployment Status of Negroes." To formalize this initiative, the National Urban League established a Department of Industrial Relations. It confirmed that the number of unemployed blacks was disproportionately high relative to their proportion of the population. Jones led petition drives and letter-writing campaigns. The National Urban League also sponsored a campaign to impress upon business leaders that the study to ascertain the veracity of the notion that the league could not economically support any establishments discriminated against blacks. The study, which meant that would not employ blacks. During this era, was conducted by Charles S. Johnson and Ira De A. Reid, the league also expanded its responsibilities by revealing that blacks were in fact being denied admission access to middle-class employment for blacks' admission to major labor unions.

through providing preparation that enabled them to Another initiative the National Urban League and pass civil service exams.

Kinckle embarked on was to persuade public agencies to adopt the organization's projects, which gave form to **CIVIL RIGHTS BATTLES**

the league's social service ideology. The league also provided vocational and educational programs for After World War I, the National Urban League began children. In addition, the league realized the need to its foray into the political spotlight and also began to get back to the theory and practice of social science address civil rights issues. In 1934, the National Urban research, so it established the Department of Research League approved a proposal of antilynching legislation and Investigations. The department collected and ana-and initiated letter-writing campaigns to senators. As lyzed data on the social and economic conditions of the federal government became the nation's chief blacks in cities, usually in the form of a survey. The employer, it became necessary for the league to involve surveys allowed the league to present its case with fac-itself in ensuring blacks a place in New Deal programs tual data. The league's Department of Research and set up by the U.S. government for the recovery of the Investigations also was responsible for getting the economy. By encouraging public protests and provid-Carnegie Corporation to finance the New York Public ing facts and recommendations, Jones and the National Library's acquisition of the Schomburg Collection, the Urban league played a significant role in ensuring that largest collection of research materials about the blacks were on the agenda of the New Deal.

African world, which had been founded by Arturo In 1941, Lester Granger succeeded Eugene Schomburg, an Afro-Puerto Rican. In addition, this Kinckle Jones and continued the crusade for the department of the league filled requests for information National Urban League. He took a more public stance about blacks for research and educational purposes.

than Jones had in fighting for civil rights and social

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 367

National Urban League———367

work programs. Granger continued the league's cause (Congress of Racial Equality), and the SNCC (Student of integrating trade unions. During this

period, the Non-violent Coordinating Committee). Young net-league also focused on housing issues in urban black worked and brought the civil rights movement to the communities. The National Urban League had had a government and corporate America, which created Housing Bureau for some time, but it was not until programs and funds to eradicate discrimination. He Granger's tenure that local league affiliates saw re-pushed for a domestic Marshall Plan in the book sentation of their city governments and organizations.

To Be Equal (1966), influencing President Lyndon B.

The league also supported the 1941 March on Johnson's War on Poverty policies. There was a need Washington for jobs and civil rights. Granger used for the government to understand the dimensions of pressure tactics to force the attention of the federal urban affairs, and they focused attention on Young government on the issue of discrimination by unions.

because of the expertise and leadership he'd shown The strategy worked, and he also represented the NUL

in this area. Consequently, he was appointed to deter-on government committees to investigate discrimi-mine the infrastructure for the U.S. government's nation in the defense work and armed services.

Department of Housing and Urban Development.

Consequently, Granger and the league played a sig-Under Young's direction, the league was able to nificant role in desegregation of the military forces.

expand its affiliates to new locations, including the The league also committed Fortune 500 companies to South, where programs to serve the black community recruit at historically black colleges and universities.

had never existed before its presence. Whitney Young In addition, the National Urban League Guild was took a stand, outside of his role as leader of the formed to provide volunteer assistance to any organi-league, to speak out against the Vietnam War.

zation that received support from the league.

Tragically, Young died in a drowning accident in In its next phase, from 1950 through 1972, the Lagos, Nigeria, in 1971.

National Urban League became a multifaceted advocate for the black community. The league's new execu-PUSH FOR CORPORATE REPRESENTATION

tive director, Whitney Young, Dean of the Atlanta University School of Social Work, was the catalyst for In 1972, under Vernon Jordan, the next leader of the this growth. Young transformed academic social work National Urban League, the boundaries of equality and urban studies theories into government and organi-and opportunity continued to expand. While many zational policy during his leadership of the league. He believed that the work of the civil rights movement expanded fund-raising twofold and brought the was over, the league moved to ensure its foothold in National Urban League back from a financial deficit.

the black community. The National Urban League The league revamped its board to reflect geographical, changed with the times and created programs that occupational, and racial balance and challenged the reflected the needs of the black community. Jordan infrastructure of the organization to be relevant to the pushed for black representation in corporate board-issues it was currently facing. With the additional fund-rooms and for minority business development. The ing, the league continued its efforts of recruiting blacks league became a resource for the government in coor-into the social work field by providing graduate degree dinating programs and giving aid to communities in and fellowship programs within the organization.

need. The league's other new initiatives included Young also created bold proposals to aid the disad-increasing the number of black voters, environmental vantaged. An example of this was the full commit-programs, and new job opportunities for women of ment of the National Urban League in the struggle for color. Under Jordan, the tradition of research contin-civil rights. Young coordinated the league's efforts ued by introducing the yearly report *The State of* with those of other organizations to forward the cause *Black America* in 1976. This report, under the direc-of

justice and equality for blacks. Young and the tion of Robert Hill, gave statistics and other relevant league contributed significantly to the 1963 March on information on blacks and the community.

Washington. Facilitating commonality and communications with other civil rights groups, like the United **GROWTH AND OUTREACH**

Negro College Fund, NAACP (National Association for the Advancement of Colored People), the SCLC

John E. Jacobs began his reign of leadership in 1982 and (Southern Christian Leadership Conference), CORE

sustained the growth of the league. He memorialized

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 368

368———**Négritude**

Whitney Young by establishing the Whitney Young Léon Gontran Damas (from Guyana), who in 1937

Training Center, the Whitney Young Race Relations published the first book of Négritude poetry, Program, and the Whitney Young Commemoration *Pigments*, which was quickly banned by the French Ceremony. Jacobs also established programs to pre-government because of its unapologetic challenge to vent teen pregnancy, assist single mothers, and curb French colonialism. The three poets, who came from crime in urban communities.

countries colonized by France, were then students in As the world became a global market, the National France. They had been influenced by the Haitian indi-Urban League again had to restructure its program-geniste movement of a few decades earlier, in which ming for outreach. Hugh B. Price, who was appointed Jean-Price Mars led the Haitians in resisting the president of the league in 1994, focused on economic American military occupation of Haiti.

empowerment, youth development, affirmative action, and the digital divide. Marc Morial, former mayor of **PAN-AFRICAN CONNECTIONS**

New Orleans and the youngest to hold the post, was elected league president in 2003. His challenge is to The Négritude poets were in close contact with the make a connection to the hip-hop generation and poets of the Harlem Renaissance, and the ideas of young professionals who have no connection with the Négritude are reminiscent of the early pan-Africanist civil rights era. His goal is to continue in bridging the thinker Edward Wilmot Blyden and his efforts to iden-gaps between blacks and whites in education, home tify the “African personality.” Présence Africaine, the ownership, health care, leadership development, and Paris-based publishing company created by Alioune voter participation.

Diop, played a major role in disseminating Négritude ideas and writings. In addition, two Martinican

— *Tiffeni Fontno*

women, the Nardal sisters, held literary salons in Paris, where Négritude was widely discussed.

FURTHER READING

The Négritude movement was very influential and Moore, Jesse Thomas, Jr. (1981). *A Search for Equality*.

truly pan-African, since in addition to the three major University Park: Pennsylvania State University Press.

poets mentioned above, it included scores of others Moore provides a chronology of the changes blacks expe-from all over the African world, such as Jacques rienced between 1830 and 1960.

Rabémananjara (from Madagascar), Jacques Roumain Weiss, Nancy J. (1974). *The National Urban League, 1910–1940*. New York: Oxford University Press. Weiss (from Haiti), Etienne Léro (from Martinique), Paul

details the early history of this organization, including its Niger (from Guadeloupe), Guy Tirolien (from research and publications.

Guadeloupe), and David Diop (from Sénégal), to Young, Whitney. (1966). *To Be Equal*. New York: McGraw-mention only a few. The writings of the pan-African Hill. This is one of the two books written by the most poets were gathered by Senghor in his famous prominent of all National Urban League leaders. Young *Anthologie de la Poésie Nègre et Malgache de langue* lays out his vision of an America free of racism.

Française (1969).

www.nul.org/ This is the National Urban League Web site, which provides comprehensive information on the organization, including its programs, publications, and resources.

RESISTANCE AND CRITIQUE OF SOCIETY

Négritude was primarily born out of resistance to assimilation and colonial alienation. The French offi-NÉGRITUDE

cial policy toward its colonial subjects worldwide was openly assimilationist. While an assimilationist policy Négritude is a literary, primarily poetic, movement seems to imply that the colonized can acquire the that emerged in Paris in the 1930s. Its main propo-colonial culture, it is nonetheless predicated upon a nents were Aimé Césaire (from Martinique), who deeper, more fundamental belief in the inferiority of coined the word *Négritude* and gave the movement the colonized. Indeed, if the colonized were not infe-its masterpiece, *Return to My Native Land* (1939); rior, why would they renounce their own cultural Léopold Sédar Senghor (from Senegal), who defined ways and adopt another culture? Therefore, Africans and theorized Négritude as the sum-total of the culin French colonies were viewed as culturally deficient tural values and expressions of the black world; and and forced to submit to French culture, supposedly

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 369

for their own good. The French language was, and contrast, they viewed the African universe as dominated continues to be, a crucial component of that precious by life and rhythm, spirituality and mystery, inno-French cultural package.

cence. Unfortunately, the integrity of the African Thus, to counter the African cultural deficiency world has been greatly jeopardized by Europe's sav-fabricated by the French and other Europeans in their age assaults on Africa. Hence, the necessity to retrieve attempt to rationalize their white supremacist plans, a precolonial consciousness, the true Négritude of Césaire, Senghor, and Damas elaborated the concept Africans everywhere.

of Négritude. As Senghor put it, Négritude is “ a certain way of being a man, especially of living as a man.

CONTRADICTIONS AND ISSUES

It is sensitivity, and as such, soul rather than thought.

African expressions such as ‘I want you to feel me’ as However, the Négritude movement was not without opposed to ‘I want you to understand me’ are signifi-some serious contradictions. It seems as though, cant in that regard.” The values and attitudes that char-indeed, the apostles of Négritude, in particular acterize and define African people, Senghor further Senghor and Césaire, never fully succeeded in remov-explained, constitute a specific black ontology, the ing themselves from the French cultural and intellec-African essence. All the black people in the world, tual matrix, despite their repeated assertions about the according to Senghor, have in common a particular beauty and worth of African culture. For example, physiopsychology that is unique to them and mani-Césaire, in his famous *Return to My Native Land*, did fests itself independently of where they find them-not hesitate to refer to the black man as “one who has selves in the world.

never invented anything,” while Senghor did not have any qualms identifying rational thinking as fundamentally European. There are at least two reasons for this.

DEDICATION TO AFRICAN CULTURE

First, there is the great influence of Eurocentric anthropology. The main characteristic of Négritude, as understood by Senghor, is an intimate, unmediated contact with the African continent. Second, there is Césaire and the cosmos and the life forces, resulting in an extreme Senghor's deep love and admiration for French culture sensitivity to rhythm, the pulse of life. Through this and language. In the end, Senghor in particular argued for a positive definition of African culture, Senghor and his that there was no contradiction between embracing the friends were attempting not only to deflate all claims of merits of Négritude and embracing French culture.

of African cultural inferiority but also to encourage. Indeed, in the name of humanism, Senghor developed African people to re-embrace what is theirs. In one of his concepts that since all cultures have only cultivated his poems, Damas demanded that his "black dolls" be fragments of humanity's potential, the best of each culture given back to him, while Senghor advocated "African culture should therefore be gathered and a "civilization socialism" as the ideal political and economic form of the universal" offered to tomorrow's humanity. The organization for African people.

main problem with the "civilization of the universal"

In fact, Senghor insisted that cultural independence construct is that it negates the self-sufficiency and was the indispensable requisite for economic, political, autonomy of African culture vis-à-vis European culture and other types of independence. Césaire also made culture, while locking African culture in a relationship of the case for the critical importance of a conscious dependency on and necessity with European culture, a return to African culture on the part of diasporic reflection of Senghor's own ambiguity.

Africans. Africans could expect regeneration only. Other issues have been raised as well. Some have come from Africa, and not from Europe, which could

only be cast doubt on the existence of a black essence, while expected to further their alienation and dislocation.

others have questioned the sincerity of the Négritude. Négritude and Western culture were presented as being poets, in particular that of Senghor, who supported the in dialectical opposition to each other. Indeed, the French neocolonial agenda in Africa. Césaire's vote in Négritude proponents made a critical assessment of favor of the total assimilation of Martinique into the Western culture and its many shortcomings and con- French republic in 1946 was not missed either. As cluded that it is materialistic, individualistic, hypocrit-Négritude was to be lived, not simply written about, it ical, and violent and has only succeeded in creating has been asked whether or not the primary audience of a world devoid of real life, joy, and imagination. In the Négritude movement was in fact African people.

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 370

370———**Negro**

Whatever the answer to these questions, though, it is the term was specifically applied to all African ethnic undeniable that the Négritude movement played a groups central and below the Sahara desert, particu- major role in raising the racial and cultural conscious-larly those persons of the Congo and Sudan. The term ness of many African people worldwide and that it was has also been used to describe enslaved persons (in responsible for inspiring numerous talented African North and South America as well as the Caribbean) writers.

whether they were directly descended from Africa or mixed with Europeans or Native Americans. The term

— *Ama Mazama*

was also expanded to *African Negro* to categorize and distinguish Africans born on the continent of Africa **FURTHER READING**

from Africans born in the diaspora.

Ba, Sylvia. (1973). *The Concept of Négritude in the Poetry of Negro* was further developed into the derogatory *Léopold Sédar Senghor*. Princeton, NJ: Princeton *nigger* and applied to all African peoples before and University Press. This is an excellent study of Senghor's since the period of enslavement. The concept was philosophy.

always imbued with notions of racial inferiority and Césaire, Aimé. (1970). *Return to My Native Land*. Middlesex, UK: Penguin Books. This remains one of the most beautiful—was made synonymous with the word *slave*. In socio-cultural literary pieces produced by an African person; it articulates in a powerful and poignant manner the feelings that a primitive subhuman being who embodied the negative have come to be associated with the Négritude movement.

tive and stereotypical beliefs and ideas that European Damas, Léon Gontran. (1972). Poems From *Pigments*. *Black Americans* applied to all African people. In the *expansion-World*, 21(3), 4–6. This is a selection of translated poems showing racial idealization of African people, the term from the first book of Négritude poetry. In the poems, and several derivatives of it and related words were Damas engages in a biting and uncompromising critique of applied to Africans by European Americans. The out-French colonialism and African assimilation.

Dépestre, René. (1982). *Bonjour et Adieu la Négritude*. Paris: growths of the word include terms such as *Negress* (an Laffont. Dépestre reviews the main tenets of Négritude and African female), *Negrillo* (a “bushman” on the also includes an informative interview with Aimé Césaire African continent), *Negrito* (a diminutive African about the origin and development of Négritude).

person), *negritic* (of black people), *negroid* (possess-Senghor, Léopold Sédar. (1969). *Anthologie de la Nouvelle* in African features and characteristics and, also, the *Poésie Nègre et Malgache de langue Française*. Paris: lowest category of human beings), *négritude* (an aesthetic, cultural, and intellectual movement of African culture to appreciate the literary and geographical scope of culture), *negrophile* (someone—usually Caucasian—

the Négritude movement.

Senghor, Léopold Sédar. (1988). *Ce que Je Crois*. Paris: who has a filial relationship with Africans or an Grasset. In this book, Senghor provides information about extreme interest in African history and culture), Négritude as a theory.

negrophobia (fear of African people and African material culture),
Negroness (the circumstance and/or quality of being Negro).

Before the interaction with Europeans, indigenous **NEGRO**

Africans and Africans born in the African diaspora had no words that identified them as black, nor did The term *Negro*, similar to *Nègre* in French and *Neger* they refer to themselves as such. U.S. postbellum in German, had its origins in the romance languages, Southern whites used the term *nigger* to refer to as it means “black” in Spanish, Portuguese, and Latin.

Africans in day-to-day interaction and in the popular Negro as a primary racial and/or color referent was media. In response, many blacks began to refer to not used to identify people of African descent until the themselves as Negroes as a social corrective, in order middle of the 15th century, with the initiation of the to challenge being called by the routine epithet *nigger*.

African Holocaust (i.e., the enslavement and genocide This was an attempt made by blacks to give the term of African people). By the 18th century, *Negro* had a different face. In this search for collective pride in become an Anglo-American term applied to all nomenclature, discussion also surrounded using a persons of African descent and used to designate them capital or lowercase *N* to refer to Negroes in print.

as the lowest division of humankind (with Caucasians In 1925, Alain Locke offered the idea of the “New first, Mongolians second, and Negroes third). Later Negro” in American society—the individual of

African descent striving for self-realization and Africans and other Africans designated with “honorary acceptance in white society.

white status” from references to all people of African By the 1950s, there was a concerted movement descent. While there remains discussion about the among people of African descent in North America to concept and term *Negro* in world society, most scholars cease using the term *Negro*. The terms used to supersede agree that its original designation was that of slave-plant it included *colored*, *black*, and later, *Afro-ery* and *servitude*. It should also be noted that the American. Because of the imprecision of the term, as expressed in many other languages, is *con-colored* and *Afro-American*, however, beginning in the 1960s and continuing into the 1980s, the terms pre-Negro is rooted in the imposed social condition of slavery and used by Africans born in the United States Africans. In addition, the term is usually not included *African American*, *African*, and *black*.

as an ideological concept in examinations of race, in Despite the negative denotations of the color black, the advanced study of racial formation among people the term *black* continued to be used to describe of African descent in the diaspora, or in understand-African Americans because the black power movement critical theories of the concept of race. The term of the 1960s used the term as a designation of *Negro* is still used as a research indicator for finding political protest against racism.

materials about African people before the 1960s.

One of the main criticisms of the terms *Negro* and

— Katherine Olukemi Bankole

colored was that they did not identify people of African descent with their ancestral homeland of **FURTHER READING**

Africa. In 1988, Jesse Jackson and other black leaders called for the uniform use of the term *African American*. (1998). *The*

Afrocentric Idea (rev. ed.).

American. In contemporary African world society, the Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This is an insightful term *Negro* is considered outmoded and offensive, and discussion of the power of naming and defining.

Bankole, Katherine Olukemi. (2000). *You Left Your Mind in* there are many critiques of the term. Richard B.

Africa: Journal Observations and Essays on Racism and Moore examined the term *Negro* as a function of nam-African American Self-Hatred. Morgantown, WV: Nation ing by either external forces to control blacks or as House. Bankole analyses the negative impact of racial self-identification and actualization (agency) by stereotypes on African people, especially as it relates to blacks. Malcolm X (also known as el Hajj Malik el name calling.

Shabazz) linked the term *Negro* to the system of Hare, Nathan. (1991). *The Black Anglo-Saxons*. Chicago: oppression that enslaved African people. Molefi Third World Press. This is a classic study of Negro psychopathology.

Asante analyzed the concept of Negro and concluded Malcolm X, with Alex Haley. (1965). *The Autobiography of* that it ignores the ancestral bond that people have to *Malcolm X*. New York: Grove Press. This book illustrates, the continent of Africa and is a “cryptoterm.” In con-among other things, the manufacture of Negroes.

temporary African American cultural, social, and Moore, Richard B. (1960). *The Name Negro: Its Origin and Evil* intellectual thought, the term is a pejorative applied to *Use*. New York: Argentina Press. Moore’s book is a fasci-Africans and African Americans perceived as sell-outs nating study of the origin and evolution of the term *Negro*.

by the black community (i.e., those who seek only to serve the status quo and who actively work against the interests and needs of African people). According to Nathan Hare and Katherine Bankole, those who **NEGRO CONVENTION MOVEMENT**

demonstrate “Negro” behavior seek only to fit in, serve, and emulate the dominating culture; they shun The Negro convention movement was a series of activism and reform and are often rewarded for their national, regional, and state meetings organized by unswerving anti-African attitudes and actions.

free blacks in the North in the three decades leading Racial and ethnic categories for Africans born in up to the Civil War. This period was at the height of North America continue to be used in the government the abolition movement, which was largely domi-and private sector. Such categories include “African nated by whites. The conventions were an attempt by American/Black” and sometimes “Black/Negro” as African American leaders to unite and formulate a a person having origins in any of the black racial national agenda. The first national convention was ini-groups of Africa. Scholars note the exclusion of North tiated by Hezekiah Grice of Maryland and assembled

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 372

372———**Neocolonialism**

in 1830 at the Bethel African Methodist Episcopal African American men. Although some women did Church in Philadelphia, with Bishop Richard Allen seek to participate, acceptance of female delegates presiding. This was shortly after the publication of varied. At the Rochester, New York, convention in David Walker’s *Appeal* and a year before Nat Turner’s 1848, a presentation was made by Mrs. Sanford and revolt. Subsequent national meetings were held each delegates extended three cheers for woman’s rights.

year through 1835, when the American Moral Reform Mary Ann Shadd Cary was accepted as a delegate to Society was founded with a similar spirit of defiance the 1855 convention in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, and resistance to slavery and racism. Delegates at after a spirited discussion resulted in a vote of 38 yeas these early conventions consistently voiced opposition to 23 nays. The last-known national convention met to the American Colonization Society and its scheme in 1864 in Syracuse, New York, to plan a course of to return Africans to Africa. They were adamant

that action following the Civil War. Delegates formed the the issue of slavery had to be settled in America and National Equal Rights League, which was short lived.

that if Africans wanted to return to Africa it had to be Although the convention movement ultimately failed on their own terms. However, they did consent to to produce a lasting organization, it was among the establish a black settlement in western Canada for earliest attempts at autonomous political organizing those who felt emigration was a last resort. This was in by African Americans in the United States.

response to the discriminatory laws or black codes

— *Michelle Rief*

established in Ohio and other Northern states that severely restricted black freedom. Convention dele-FURTHER READING

gates endorsed William Lloyd Garrison and the American Anti-Slavery Society. They expressed strong Bell, Howard Holman. (Ed.). (1969). *Minutes of the* support for temperance and sought to establish a vocation school for black youth. Proceedings of the National Negro Conventions, tional school for black youth.

1830–1864. New York: Arno Press. Bell documents the nature of the debates held within the Negro Convention The following national conventions were initiated Movement.

by the fervent abolitionist David Ruggles and took Yee, Shirley. (1992). *Black Women Abolitionists: A Study in place* in the early 1840s. The conventions continued to *Activism, 1828–1860*. Knoxville: University of Tennessee be comprised of leading businessmen, clergymen, and Press. Yee identifies and analyzes black women's contribu-abolitionists and grew increasingly radical over time.

tions to the struggle against slavery.

At the Buffalo, New York convention in 1843, Henry Highland Garnet called for a slave insurrection and Frederick Douglass opposed the suggestion. At the Troy, New York convention in 1847, delegates called **NEOCOLONIALISM**

on all freed persons to “agitate! *Agitate!!* AGITATE!!!” against the institution of slavery. While Neocolonialism is a complex system of economic William Lloyd Garrison continued to utilize a strategy domination of a politically independent country by a of moral persuasion, black convention delegates were former colonial power and/or the capitalist world. It more inclined to support political parties calling for operates not only in the economic field but also in the abolition. This trend continued into the 1850s, when political, religious, ideological, and cultural spheres.

convention delegates rejected Garrison’s notion that The word *neo* is Greek for “new” or “modern.” Thus, the Constitution was a proslavery document. Many neocolonialism is new colonialism. A neocolonial attendees insisted that the United States was their state is a client-state, meaning the entrapment of a home, although emigration garnered substantial sup-state in the claws of a former colonial power or impe-port following passage of the fugitive slave law in rialist powers. Thus the necessary condition exists for 1850 that allowed white enslavers to pursue escaping the establishment of client-states by imperialist Africans across state borders.

nations for the continual hegemony of Africa, Asia, The 1840s and 1850s also witnessed a proliferation and Latin America (including the Caribbean region).

of state conventions, which achieved greater success Neocolonialism, therefore, is the highest stage of than national conventions had in compelling state imperialism.

governments to revoke discriminatory legal measures.

Kwame Nkrumah, the first president of the The convention movement was largely dominated by Republic of Ghana, coined the term *neocolonialism*

during the All African Peoples Conference in Ghana secure favorable political and economic policies via in 1958. But it was in Cairo in 1961, during the Third remote control. This was accomplished by various All African Peoples Conference, that the term gained means, such as the propping up of puppet govern-international currency. At this conference, speaker ments, systematic propaganda, and psychological after speaker denounced neocolonialism. They saw warfare against or physical assassination of indepen-neocolonialism as posing the greatest danger to the dent-minded political leaders like Patrice Lumumba political and economic independence of the African of the Congo, Walter Rodney of Guyana, and Almicar countries. One such danger is the policy of balkaniza-Cabral of Guinea-Bissau. In some cases, it was tion of African states for manipulation by the capital-attained by sponsoring military overthrow of govern-ist world. This can be more insidious with regard to ments pursuing noncapitalist paths of economic the legitimate aspirations of African states for political development, as was the case of Kwame Nkrumah's stability and economic freedom than is the outright government in Ghana.

political control of colonialism. Neocolonialism was similarly denounced at the first Tri-Continental **THE NATURE OF THE NEOCOLONIAL STATE**

Conference of Asia, Africa, and Latin America, which took place in Cuba from December of 1965 to January A nation becomes neocolonial or a client-state if it is of 1966. The delegates at this conference set out the independent *de jure* and dependent *de facto*. Such a characteristics of neocolonialism and the necessity to state is one in which political power lies in the intran-struggle against it; they also endorsed a comprehen-sigent forces of the former colony, while economic sive resolution to fight neocolonialism.

power remains under the control of international During the colonial epoch, the nature of economic finance capital. In this case, the country continues to and political domination of Africa, Asia, and Latin be economically exploited in the interest of foreign America (including the Caribbean region) was trans-investors. The primary objective of neocolonialism is

parent. In Africa, there were colonial governors, offi-the maximizing of superprofits for the capitalist cials, police, and missionary schools. Colonialism nations, which accomplished this by using puppet and permitted the European colonial powers to exploit corrupt regimes in the client-states.

African peoples in a variety of ways. They settled In a neocolonial state, the state in theory has its and/or seized fertile lands, controlled natural political independence and all the outward accou-resources, and secured cheap labor. They imposed a trements of sovereignty, such as national flags, system of low-priced payments for the peasants' cash national anthems, and a seat at the United Nations. In crops and established a monopoly-controlled market spite of that, its economic system and political poli-for the importation of the manufactured goods from cials are directed by outside powers. Neocolonial the metropolis, thus securing profits through invest-states thus become pawns of the very former colonial ment. The result of the imposition of unfavorable powers that are supposed to have granted them terms of trade on the colonies is that it obliged the national independence. In this case, the client-states peasants to sell their cash crops cheaply and pay become enmeshed in the net of foreign financial and higher prices for the manufactured goods imported diplomatic dependence. Thus, such states are inde-from the capitalist world. Also, the colonies were pendent only in name, since their ability to pursue an turned into bases for producing primary products independent course of action is usurped by those who such as minerals and single agricultural products control international finance capital.

for export. Often an entire country was turned into a one- or two-commodity producer country. For **Political Operatives Within the Government** example, Ghana concentrated on cocoa, India on cotton, Tanzania on sisal and coffee, Zambia on copper, Neocolonialism operates covertly by manipulating Senegal on peanuts, Jamaica on sugar and bananas, politicians, military generals, business moguls, and and Chad on cotton.

intellectuals into maintaining and preserving the eco-This unbalanced, monoeconomic culture was to nomic, political, administrative, and cultural

ideas and serve as a colonial legacy in the newly independent policies of the former colonial government. These were countries. In postindependence Africa, the former the phenomena that had been entrenched in the neocolonial rulers and the capitalist world sought to colonial state before the transfer of power from

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 374

374——**Neocolonialism**

colonialism to independence. The client-state was left in the defense of neocolonialism, but it also serves as with economic, political, administrative, and educa-the basic component in protecting and enforcing the tional systems based on European models and designed adherence to the imperialist policies. Neocolonialism to perpetuate the colonial relationship. Thus political maintains various contacts with the military personnel leaders became culpable for their lack of enthusiasm of the developing countries. This situation is perfected for formulating and pursuing an independent course of by arms procurement and military training by foreign action, one that may have involved losing contributions personnel in the client-states and military academies offered in exchange for their continued conformity to in the imperialist countries.

the policies of the colonial and imperialist powers.

Such leaders are strongly dependent on foreign contri-
NEOCOLONIALISM AS

butions to maintain the machinery of their government.

A THREAT TO WORLD PEACE

Neocolonialism poses a serious threat to world peace.

Economic Dependence

Contrary to the views held by the corporate media's The imperialist forces employ every means possible commentators and the ruling classes in the

capitalist to undermine the national, political, and cultural values world, this danger does not come from those who seek of the independent country. In addition, they form an its demise. It comes from the puppet regimes, grafters, apparatus of domination, including armed forces that self-seeking technocrats, elite class, nonmanufacturing are docile with regard to imperialist policy. Likewise, business communities, and intellectuals who champion the imperialist powers resort to a policy of containment the course of foreign privatization of public corpora-by employing their arsenal of alliances; network of tions, institutions, utilities, social services, and natural military bases; and economic devices such as aid, cor-resources, as well as from superpower nations that use ruption, sabotage, and blackmail; they employ psycho-military might to ensure the entrenchment of neocolo-logical weapons of propaganda with a view to nialism in “third world” countries. Neocolonialism cre-indoctrinating the masses with the imperialist ideolog-ates a situation whereby the masses of the people ical dogmas. Western democracy and the parliamen-become systematically exploited beyond what Nkrumah tary system are singled out as the only valid forms of described as “safe” limits of exploitation. Hence, governance. Hence, the slightest departure from the masses of the third world people frantically migrate to Western notion of democracy by a political leader in a the capitalist countries seeking economic haven.

developing country deems the leader a totalitarian, dic-For social and political activists, the prerequisite for tator, or communist. Capitalism, the free market com-creating the correct internal and global strategies to petition, and laissez-faire theory are put forward as defeat neocolonialism lies in their capacity to dissect constituting the only economic system capable of pro-and expose to others the means by which a neocolonial moting development. In the economic field, imperial-state is made and sustained. The eradication of neo-ist forces resort to the deception of using groups such colonialism in Africa, Asia, the Caribbean, and Latin as Food for Peace, Alliance for Progress, Economic America can be accomplished through revolutionary Recovery and Structural Adjustment Programs, and policies and independent action springing from a non-New Partnership Development, which are linked to violent direct confrontation with the imperialists that international financial institutions like the World Bank

draws its strength from the exploited and disinherited and International Monetary Fund.

masses. In the case of Africa, an African-centered curriculum at all centers of learning must be recognized as fundamental to the defeat of neocolonialism.

Military Dependence

Furthermore, the imperialist powers force military

— *Kwame Botwe-Asamoah*

and defense pacts and treaties on the client-states, thereby subjecting the states' foreign policies to the **FURTHER READING**

intentions of the imperialist powers. In some cases, Amin, Samir. (1973). *Neocolonialism in West Africa*.

the treaties lead to securing military bases and stand-New York: Monthly Review Press. This is a powerful ing armies of the imperialist powers in the neocolonial analysis of the function of neocolonialism in Africa by one states. Not only does this serve as an essential weapon of the leading Marxist theorists on the African continent.

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 375

New Deal———375

Nkrumah, Kwame. (1965). *Neocolonialism: The Highest Exchange Commission*. The Federal Securities Act *Stage of Imperialism*. London, Ibadan Nairobi: Heinemann required the disclosure of information on stocks that Educational Books. The leading philosopher of neocolo-were being sold, while the SEC's function was, and nialism explains in detail how neocolonialism keeps continues to be, to ensure that the laws were being fol-African nations enslaved economically.

lowed. These innovations leveled the stock market Smith, Stewart. (1974). *U.S. Neocolonialism in Africa*.

New York: International. In this volume, Smith explores playing field so that those interested in investing in the how the United States engages in its own brand of neo-stock market could do so as informed consumers.

colonialism, even though it does not have a record of major The second aspect of the New Deal, the commit-colonial interests on the African continent.

ment of federal money to relief agencies, was significant in that up to this point in history, America had not committed itself to the aid of the needy. However, as the majority of the country fell into the category of “the **NEW DEAL**

needy,” it was clear that action was required by the government. Therefore, the Social Securities Commission, The New Deal was a federally funded initiative imple-which was dedicated to providing pensions for retired mented by Franklin Delano Roosevelt that was designed workers and those who had been victims of work acci-to reverse the impact of the Great Depression of the dents, was established. Also, the Federal Emergency 1930s. Roosevelt became president of the United States Relief Administration (FERA) was founded to admin-in 1933, at the height of the greatest economic disaster ister funds to a variety of relief agencies.

that has ever devastated the nation. He recognized that the hands-off policy adopted by his predecessor, Herbert **FOCUS ON EMPLOYMENT**

Hoover, was not helping to revitalize the economy, provide jobs, or boost morale of the American people.

While these changes were significant, the New Deal Because of this, he saw the necessity of federal interis mostly remembered for its creation and regulation vention in the economy on an unprecedented scale.

of employment through a large number of agencies.

Roosevelt kept the American public informed of his The Civil Works Administration (CWA), Civilian goals, objectives, and progress through his now-famous Conservation Corps (CCC), National Industrial Fireside Chats.

These informative messages were delivered via the radio and helped to keep up people's morale (PWA), Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA), and Farm and maintain their trust in their president.

Security Administration (FSA) provided jobs for men and women throughout the country. The New Deal was three-pronged: It focused on enacting regulatory legislation for banking practices to work beautifying parks and beaches, building and the stock market, it dedicated significant monies to dams, and planting crops, among many other projects.

relief agencies and securing fair labor practices, and it These programs provided work for many who had sought to boost the economy by creating employment.

been unemployed for years, pumped money back into Roosevelt was not timid in his approach to any of these the people's pockets, and helped to revitalize the spheres, and within 2 months of taking office, he shut economy, if even just temporarily. And the New Deal down all of the banks in the United States through the also created legislation that regulated employment Emergency Banking Act. He took this step to deter-practices. The National Industrial Recovery Act, the mine how all of the banks in the country were faring.

National Labor Relations Act, and the Fair Labor This drastic step led to the creation of the Federal Standards Act all sought to establish safe, amicable Deposit Insurance Corporation, or FDIC, which working environments by setting a minimum wage insured the deposits of participating banks for up to and child labor laws, encouraging unionization, and \$5,000. For the first time since the rush on the banks in regulating working conditions.

1929, which had left many without their life savings and contributed to the Great Depression, Americans **FAILURE OF THE INITIATIVE**

again entrusted their money to banks.

Another major piece of regulatory legislation was However, the New Deal did not pull America out of the the Federal Securities Act of May 1933,

which was Great Depression. It left the government with a huge accompanied by the establishment of the Securities deficit and did not provide nearly enough jobs to put all

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 376

376——— *The New Negro*

the unemployed Americans back to work. Further, the Mid-Hudson Regional Information Center Web site, on rapid influx of money into the economy led to swift which Franklin Delano Roosevelt's Fireside Chats, a staple inflation. It was not until World War II, which of his presidency and the New Deal, are available in their entirety. The speeches are from 1933 to 1944, the duration Roosevelt hesitated to enter due to the state of the of Roosevelt's presidency, and on a wide variety of topics domestic economy, that America finally came out of including the New Deal and World War II.

the Great Depression. Also, Roosevelt seized an Gupta, Pranav, and Lee, Jonathan. Retrieved November unprecedented amount of authority in the name of 15, 2003, from <http://www.bergen.org/AAST/Projects/>

bettering the economy, which threatened the balance of depression/successes.html This is the Bergen Technical power established by the U.S. Constitution. Ultimately, Schools Web site, which was created by the school's the Supreme Court rendered some of Roosevelt's poli-students as a class project and is user-friendly. In chart cies unconstitutional in that they overstepped the form, it very generally outlines the programs created during the New Deal, as well as the programs' successes and administrative boundaries of the U.S. government. In failures.

essence, the New Deal's greatest achievement was not Powell, Jim. (2003). *FDR's Folly: How Roosevelt and His New* in improving the American economy but instead in *Deal Prolonged the Great Depression*. New York: Crown boosting the morale of the American people.

Forum. Powell's book outlines the New Deal and the many The New Deal was of particular interest to African ways in which it failed in its objective to end the Great Americans, who during times of economic difficulty

Depression. It sheds light on Roosevelt's faulty reasoning are often the first to lose their jobs, remain unemployed when devising programs meant to benefit the economy and the longest, and encounter the most difficulty in securing highlights the people who suffered for longer periods of time due to the New Deal programs.

ing new positions due to the increased competition for even the lowest paying, least skilled positions. African Americans were thus especially hard hit during the Great Depression; however, rather than reaping any of

THE NEW NEGRO

the financial benefits of the many programs of the New Deal, African Americans found themselves on the out-The New Negro: An Interpretation is a collection of side of economic development. Like many programs essays by various authors that was edited by Alain designed to help Americans, the New Deal really only Locke and published in 1925. Locke theorized the benefitted white Americans. Roosevelt focused very concept of the New Negro to identify members of strongly on unionization, and unions routinely a community emerging from hundreds of years of excluded African Americans, thus making finding jobs enslavement and beginning to develop mechanisms to virtually impossible for African Americans. Further, live their lives on their own terms. The book was programs such as Social Security largely favored inspired by "Harlem: Mecca of the New Negro," a whites. Therefore, it was not until the United States 1925 issue of the *Survey Graphic Harlem Number*, entered World War II that African Americans were able which was the monthly illustrated number of the to find steady gainful employment.

social work journal *Survey Magazine*. *The New Negro* The New Deal was innovative and ambitious, to addresses the themes of African American culture and say the least. It sought to bring the United States out identity, as well as the socioeconomic, political, and of the largest economic depression ever encountered educational issues pertaining to African Americans.

in this country. Unprecedented amounts of govern-The New Negro was a critical text in the initial ment money were spent to regulate banking and the development and articulation of black thought and stock market, as well as

to provide relief and jobs for thus is an ancestor of Black Studies. Locke organized Americans. However, these efforts were only superficial—a cadre of artists and scholars from all disciplines who were especially helpful to Americans in general, and they were challenging the perceptions of black people that were decidedly unhelpful to African Americans.

were articulated by outsiders and interpreted as fact.

Locke provided a rationale in *The New Negro* for

— *Jill Kissick*

developing the text, which included the issue of too much being written by people who did not know the **FURTHER READING**

African. His inspiration to establish in a text the *Fireside Chats of Franklin D. Roosevelt*. Retrieved November 15, 2003, from www.mhrc.org/fdr/fdr.html This is the trial, and highlight blacks' achievements provided

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 377

The New Negro———377

some of the earliest documentation of the production Two essays that illustrate this situation are James of many of the 20th century's greatest black artists Weldon Johnson's "Harlem: The Culture Capital" and and scholars early on in their careers, as well as Elise Johnson McDougald's "The Task of Negro recording the birth of the Harlem Renaissance.

Womanhood." In his introduction to *The New Negro*, The work of Bavarian artist Winold Reiss largely Johnson questioned the future of Harlem as well as its dominates the visual art in *The New Negro*. He did the potential . He wondered if blacks were going to be cover illustrations, the book decorations, and many of able to hold onto Harlem or if it would become just the portraits in the text. This begs the question, why a famous ghetto. The prophetic nature of Johnson's would an author whose rationale for a text is African inquiries is amazing, as these are some of the very

Americans' lack of ownership over their community same questions still being debated in the 21st century.

then select an artist outside that community to illustrate McDougald's statements are equally penetrating.

trate the faces of the New Negro? This question was In her essay, she attempted to enumerate the contributions of Negro women to society, while simultaneously addressing and dismantling stereotypes. She first value of Winold Reiss's illustrations to new African located black women in the center of her community, American artists, many of whom still lacked sufficient then she battled misconstrued perceptions head on, outlets for their own works, while Reiss, a white artist, arguing that sexual promiscuity was a matter not of was featured prominently. Still, this is not a major race but of socioeconomic conditions. McDougald's criticism of a book that contributed so much to black essay is an important resource that demonstrates the thought.

snail-like pace at which black women's issues are *The New Negro* is divided into two parts: "The being dealt with today.

Negro Renaissance," which addresses the diversity of Melville J. Herskovits's essay in this section, "The blacks' creative expression, and "The New Negro in Negro's Americanism," embarked on a mission to the New World," which outlines the many people and find out whether there is an African genius that is institutions contributing to the emerging black world.

peculiar to America. He thus attempted to discover a Both parts of the book begin with an essay written by black culture that was not purely imitative of white a scholar in the field to provide the context. This essay culture by undertaking an anthropological journey in is followed by first-person essays that delve more Harlem. Herskovits determined, however, that it was deeply into the themes the scholar addressed.

the same cultural pattern in a different shade. For him In the case of the arts explored in "The Negro to have suggested that no culture exists beyond

white Renaissance,” in addition to essays, Locke has taken American culture and that black people are perhaps the bold step of letting artists’ works speak for them-only colored-in white people is a serious indictment selves. The literary contributions include poetry, and smacks against the very progressive and proac-plays, essays, and critiques, as well as fiction such as tive position of the rest of the essays’ authors.

Zora Neale Hurston’s *Spunk* and *Negro Dancers* by Although the impetus for the inclusion of this ques-Claude McKay. The inclusion of nonfiction and fictionable essay in *The New Negro* is unclear, the position in this section allowed, for example, for William tion taken by Herskovits has adherents in this century Stanley Braithwaite in “The Negro in American as well.

Literature” to discuss the burgeoning field of black *The New Negro: An Interpretation* should be literary expression and for the following pages to required reading for any serious scholar of Black invite the reader to sample the works themselves.

Studies. The creative work and theories presented in Whereas “The Negro Renaissance” addressed the the text provide a view of the past that serves as a issues of education, community, gender, and econom-measuring stick of African Americans’ potential and ics from the perspective of the arts, “The New Negro progress. W.E.B. Du Bois said it well in the final line in the New World” dealt with those same topics in a of the final essay in the text, “The Negro Mind more direct and formulaic way. What is most interest-Reaches Out,” when he reminded his readers in 1924

ing about this second section is that many of the disas he had done in 1899 that he saw the problem of the courses presented in it are still relevant and are color line as the problem of the century.

currently being taken up by scholars and by the communities dealing with the challenges under discussion.

— *Kheli R. Willetts*

FURTHER READING

Ujamaa (Cooperative Economics)—to build and maintain our own stores, shops, and other businesses Alex-Assensoh, Yette, and Hanks, Lawrence. (2000). *Black and Multiracial Politics in America*. New York: New York and to profit from them together; *Nia* (Purpose)—to University Press. This is an excellent collection of contemporary essays on the political nature of the social and building and developing of our community in order to restore our people's cultural relationships in America.

to their traditional greatness; *Kuumba* (Creativity)—

Dyson, Michael Eric. (1996). *Race Rules: Navigating the* to do always as much as we can, in the way we can, in *Color Line*. Reading, MA: Addison-Wesley. This is a collection of essays that deal with the problem of racial inequality that we inherited it; *Imani* (Faith)—to believe divisions in America and among blacks.

with all our hearts in our people, our parents, our Locke, A. L (Ed.). (1925). *The New Negro: An Interpretation*.

New York: Albert and Charles Boni. This is the classic teachers, our leaders, and the righteousness and work on the subject.

victory of our struggle.”

Since their introduction in the sixties, the Nguzo Saba have become the basis for cultural grounding and value orientation of many independent schools, **NGUZO SABA**

rites of passage programs, cooperatives, Black Student Unions, educational programs, and various Although most widely known as the Seven Principles other community and professional organizations, of Kwanzaa, the *Nguzo Saba* (pronounced En-goo’-

institutions, and programs in the United States. The *zôh Sah'-bah*) are the core values of Kwaaida philos-Nguzo Saba have also spread throughout the world ophy, a philosophy of cultural and social change out African community through educational and cultural of which Kwanzaa and the Nguzo Saba were created.

exchanges and through the practice of Kwanzaa, a Evolving in the midst of the black freedom movement pan-African holiday that celebrates family, commu-of the sixties, the Nguzo Saba reflect central themes nity, and culture. In fact, one of the reasons Karenga from it as well as from communitarian African culture created Kwanzaa was to introduce and affirm the and philosophy. Developed in 1965 by Maulana importance of the Nguzo Saba and other communitar-Karenga, an activist scholar, chair of the organization ian African values (i.e., values that stress family, com-Us, and currently a professor of Black Studies at munity, and culture). Thus, Kwanzaa is a 7-day California State University, Long Beach, the Nguzo holiday in which each day is organized around the dis-Saba were put forth as a communitarian African value cussion and practice of each of the Seven Principles.

system essential to building and developing commu-As Kwaaida and the Nguzo Saba have developed nity, strengthening the African liberation struggle, and over the years, the original interpretation of the princi-cultivating and expanding social practice rooted in ples has expanded to reflect both a reaffirmation of the African culture.

original message of cultural grounding and struggle As originally introduced by Maulana Karenga and and extended meanings to address current concerns the organization Us, the Nguzo Saba were given in and issues. Thus, in Karenga's Annual Founder's Swahili and English to affirm their rootedness in Kwanzaa Message, 2000, on the official Kwanzaa Web African culture and to capture their communitarian site, he explains the following particular and the uni-character, that is, their emphasis on family, commu-versal meaning of the principles.

nity, and culture. The words *nguzo saba* are Swahili words for principles and seven, respectively. Karenga *Umoja* (Unity) calls for a commitment "to work for provided the Seven Principles with their original a continued and

heightened unity of African people meanings as follows: “*Umoja* (Unity)—to strive for in their families and communities through the and maintain unity in the family, community, nation, world and to continue to forge their future in the and race; *Kujichagulia* (Self-Determination)—to historic struggle to expand the realm of freedom define ourselves, name ourselves, create for ourselves, and increase shared good in the world.” And it is and speak for ourselves; *Ujima* (Collective Work and also a call “to work for an increased unity for com-Responsibility)—to build and maintain our commu-mon good among the peoples of the world based on nity together and to make our brother’s and sister’s mutual respect for each person, people and culture; problems our problems and solve them together; liberation for the oppressed, justice for the

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 379

Nommo———379

wronged, power for the people and a just peace at possible in people and in the world, and in our every site of conflict and war in the world.”

capacity to create good, to find it, cultivate and harvest it and share it in an unlimited number of mean-Kujichagulia (Self-Determination) calls for a com-ingful and mutually beneficial ways.”

mitment to “work for the right of every person and people to determine their own destiny and daily Finally, the Nguzo Saba continue to be viable and lives, to speak their own special cultural truth and dynamic responses to historical and cultural chal-make their own unique contribution to the forward lenges to the African community. The principles are flow of human history.”

incorporated into every institutional form, including *Ujima* (Collective Work and Responsibility) calls family, churches, corporations, schools, committees, for a commitment “to work for the good world we and so forth, that now exist in the African American all want and deserve to live in, a world, as the *Odu* community, making the Nguzo Saba the most ubiqui-Ifa of ancient Yorubaland says, where there is full tous symbols of the cultural revolution of the 1960s.

knowledge of things, happiness everywhere, peace,

— *Tiamoyo Karenga*

well-being, security of person and where everyone can live lives of dignity and decency in a context of

See also Kwanzaa; Kawaida maximum human freedom and human flourishing.”

Ujamaa (Cooperative Economics) calls for a **FURTHER READING**

commitment “to work for the strengthening of Karenga, Maulana. (2001). *Introduction to Black Studies*. Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This is the explanation of shared wealth in society and the world . . . and . . .

tion of the Nguzo Saba by the creator of the principles.

for economic practices that reflect due respect for www.officialkwanzaawebsite.org On this Web site, Karenga the dignity of work and the rights of the worker, explains the full meaning of the principles.

that link a right to a life of dignity with a right to a decent life, and that demonstrate appropriate care for the poor, responsibility for the ill, disabled and aged, and a right relationship with our environment.”

abled and aged, and a right relationship with our environment.”

In West Africa, the Dogon people of Mali believe that *Nia* (Purpose) calls for a commitment “to work for the African concept of *Nommo*, the power of the spoken word, carries a life force that produces all life and things in the world and of daring greatness through the spoken word, human beings can invoke a kind of the amassing and using of knowledge to serve and spiritual power. *Nommo* is a force that gives life to do good in the world.”

every thing. It is present everywhere and it causes everything. Furthermore, humans have power over the *Kuumba* (Creativity) calls for a commitment “to word and direct the life force. Thus all of human cre-work for a world which is better and more beauti-ation and natural phenomena emanate from the pro-ful than we inherited it . . . [and to] reaffirm the ductive power of the word—Nommo, which is itself a ancient African ethical commitment to constantly life force. For the Dogon, all magic is ultimately word heal and restore the world, a practice called *serudj* magic whether the word is manifested in incantations, *ta* in ancient Egyptian. This moral obligation calls blessings, or curses. In fact, if the word did not exist, on us, everywhere and at all times, in society and all forces would be suspended, there would be no pro-in nature, to raise up what is in ruins; to repair what creation, and therefore no life. For the ancient is damaged; to rejoin what is severed; to replenish Egyptians, Nommo, or the power of the spoken word, what is depleted; to strengthen what is weakened; was linked to their ethical principle, *Maat* (meaning to set right what is wrong; and to make flourish that

“truth, harmony, balance, reciprocity”). *Maat* pro-which is fragile and undeveloped.”

vided the ancient Egyptians with a value system to *Imani* (Faith) calls for a commitment “to work for live by. The ancient Egyptians believed that the nature a sustained and steadfast belief in the good and the of *Maat* was expressed by the living person, indeed,

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 380

380———**Nommo**

its essential quality related to the life sustaining power relationship. This relationship is imperative wherever of speech itself. The Dogon’s conception of the word Nommo exists.

and its life sustaining power is no different from that The African’s preference for the spoken word over of the ancient Egyptians.

the written word speaks to the word being viewed as a The power of the word is different from one indi-life force. The written word does not have the trans-vidual to the next. The word power of the creator is formative powers of the spoken word. Only the word more powerful than that of any other being. In African that is spoken can engage the human being and put philosophy, individuals have, by the power of their him or her on the path of harmony. Furthermore, words, dominion over things, which they can command Nommo creates a relationship between the speaker and change and make work for their purposes. The and listener. The written word cannot facilitate human Dogon believe that to command things with words is to interaction and is therefore lifeless. The spoken word practice magic. The power of the speaker will deter-permits us to experience life in the most significant of mine how fascinated the audience will be. Nommo is ways. The effective African orator understands the derived not only from the spiritual nature of words but transformative power of the word. Africans every-also from the spirituality of the presentation. However, where know that words have power when they walk morality is the prime consideration for African oratory away from events invigorated, ready for revolution, or or public discourse. The power of words, Nommo, is in

“praisin’ the Lawd.”

proportion to the moral character of the speaker as well In African culture, naming is also an area in which as the oratorical skill he or she possesses. It is impera-the concept of Nommo or the power of the word is tive for the speaker to guide his or her creativity in the ever present. Naming is an essential characteristic in direction of a higher level of consciousness.

the philosophy and religion of peoples throughout Ultimately, cosmic harmony is the objective of Africa. Understanding Nommo, the power of the human utterance within the African worldview. The word, is primary to an understanding of the universe.

attainment of harmony is the aim of all participants Naming is a creative act. What we cannot conceive when the community is called together for a common does not exist. And every human thought that is cause. Nommo, through the spoken word, is a power-expressed becomes reality, that is, is spoken into ful instrument that is evident in numerous ways. It being. Once

a person names it, it moves into existence-addresses profound life circumstances. Furthermore, hence. The power of Nommo through naming creates the spoken word creates human relationships that bring life. In addition, without naming, life would be static; about social transformations. The word, in an African there would be no possibility of social development or sense, is the sacred force of life and creates reality for growth and no integration into human society.

African people. The preeminence of Nommo is a defining-Naming is significant for Africans because it identifies cultural characteristic of African people.

defines who they are and where they hope to ascend.

The contemporary African preacher in the Black African naming ceremonies are sacred, and each time Church is an ideal example of the power of Nommo.

parents name a child they are commenting on the life The nature of African communication can best be path of that child, how that child will see himself or appreciated by understanding that Nommo flows herself, and their hope for what the future of African through the African's existence in the United States.

people will be. The name goes with the child as a Most Africans, given the nature of American history of symbol as he or she navigates through life.

slavery and the subsequent racism and oppression, can In Africa and in all other places where Africans are immediately recognize the transforming power of vocal present, every boy and girl is given a name with some expression. It is clear when someone says, "Man, that significance. Many Africans believe that names are cat can rap," and also when someone leaving a Baptist important because a child's name has a psychological church says, "I didn't understand all those words the effect and may affect his or her behavior. A name is a preacher was using, but they sure sounded good."

description for the totality of a person, and is thus tied Although Africans revere the spoken word, there is an to a person's behavior, attitude, and feelings of self-extensive literary tradition in Africa. However, the writ-esteem and importance. Therefore, it is important to ten word is, to a large degree, without life. It creates make the right choice when naming.

distance between the writer and the reader, who may never have a chance to interact or build a human

— *Adisa A. Alkebulan*

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 381

North Star——381

FURTHER READING

sustained him until the paper became self-sustaining.

A British woman named Julia Griffiths became most Alkebulan, Adisa A. (2002). *The Essence of Spoken Soul: Language and Spirituality for Africans in the United States*.

instrumental in rescuing Douglass from financial dis-Unpublished doctoral dissertation, Temple University. This aster and preserving the *North Star*. Griffiths moved to research discusses the spiritual elements essential within Rochester from Newcastle-on-Tyne, England, and the African oral tradition.

became the paper's financial manager and journalism Asante, Molefi Kete. (1998). *The Afrocentric Idea* (rev. ed.).

supervisor, as well as an advisor to Douglass. Her Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This work is the efforts enabled Douglass to become financially secure definitive text on Afrocentricity and African oral expression.

and afforded him the opportunity to focus primarily Jahn, Janheinz. (1990). *Muntu: African Culture and the on producing the paper*.

Western World. New York: Grove Press. This is the definitive text on Dogon cosmology and their belief in the African Americans provided little financial assistance-concept of Nommo.

tance to the *North Star*. During its initial year of publication, the paper acquired five white subscribers. An Exercise in Self-Glorification. *Journal of Black Studies*, to each black subscriber. Whites possessed greater wealth than blacks did and could afford to purchase common Eurocentric myths about the spoken word.

subscriptions. However, the financial limitations of African Americans only partially explained the dearth of black support for Douglass's newspaper.

Abolitionists functioned on the periphery of American

NORTH STAR

society, and Douglass may have been viewed as a curiosity or even a pariah. Cautious blacks therefore The first edition of Frederick Douglass's *North Star* eschewed abolition to ingratiate themselves with the newspaper was published in Rochester, New York, on larger white society. Less than 20% of the African American population supported the abolitionist cause.

Bedford, Massachusetts, to Rochester so that the underlying factors involving the *North Star*'s pro-circulation of his paper would not interfere with that function carried equal significance to the antislavery of the *Liberator* or the *Anti-Slavery Standard*, papers message it conveyed in print. As a man who had been heavily influenced by William Lloyd Garrison and a slave and never received a formal education, Douglass determined Douglass, as publisher, represented a 19th-century to publish the *North Star* after tiring of Garrison's style-anomaly. The crisp, lucid prose and clarity of thought flung influence and returning from a successful anti-slavery speaking tour of the United Kingdom with both awe and recrimination. A self-taught man gifted \$2,175. Thus, to free

himself from white abolitionists, with the writing elegance and elocution of a Harvard Douglass joined fellow black activist Martin R.

graduate, Douglass undermined the erroneous concept Delany and published his own newspaper.

of black inferiority. Douglass's abolitionist "friends"

Dedicated to hastening the demise of slavery, extolled his virtues as long as Douglass remained Douglass mortgaged his house and incurred significant dependent on white largess and functioned as a non-cant debt to present his views about slavery, the voting abolitionist. However, when Douglass sought

"peculiar institution." It was Douglass's indefatigable equal stature with his benefactors, including as a vot-perseverance that enabled the fledgling newspaper ing abolitionist, whites withdrew their support and to survive. Douglass had Delany travel throughout limited the *North Star's* financial success.

the nation to raise subscriptions, while he remained The hostility white abolitionists displayed toward in Rochester to edit the newspaper. After 6 months, Douglass's enterprise proved mild compared to the Delany had unfortunately failed to generate sufficient venom of those who recommended that he should be funds to enable the paper to achieve solvency.

exiled to Canada and have his publishing equipment Delany's inability to garner funds contributed to a rift thrown into Lake Ontario. Fortunately for Douglass, between the two men that resulted in Delany's quit-the printers and publishers of Rochester supported his ting the enterprise and leaving the paper entirely in literary enterprise, which they viewed as publishing Douglass's care. After Delany's departure, Douglass business that would bring revenue to their community.

enlisted the support of prominent white patrons, who Rochester's business leaders proved clairvoyant.

Douglass estimated that in the 16 years his newspaper principles were inconsistent with their practice with existed, white men in the city earned approximately regard to those of African ancestry.

\$100,000 from it.

— *H. V. Nelson*

Published weekly at a cost of \$80 for the 4 pages and 6-column spread, and boasting an average circu-FURTHER READING

lation of 3,000, the *North Star* enabled Douglass to be an extremely proud man. As the first newspaper facil-Douglass, Frederick. (1962). *Life and Times of Frederick* ity and printing establishment owned by an African Douglass: *Written By Himself*. New York: Collier Books.

American, the *North Star* served as an exemplary rep-This is Douglass's account of his life revealing his struggles and achievements. It is one of the three autobiograph-resentation of black achievement. The paper ran fea-ical works by Douglass.

tures on the Fugitive Slave law, freedom conventions, Quarles, Benjamin. (1968). *Frederick Douglass*. New York: and the inhumanity of slavery and provided informa-Atheneum Press. Quarles, an important black historian tion on myriad additional topics related to race, who uses his vast knowledge to bring Douglass's chal-racism, and the failure of American democracy.

lenges to life, has written the best study to date of Frederick By 1851 the *North Star* had become *Frederick Douglass*.

Douglass' Paper, a name that remained with the paper until its publication ceased in 1860. Douglass stated in a self-deprecating manner that since so many newspapers used the word *star*, as a neophyte his publication **NUBIA**

should drop the term. In reality, Douglass acted out of economic self-interest. He believed that his name and Ancient Nubia is vitally important to the reconstruction of African history. The Nubian pharaohs of the 25th Dynasty revitalized the glory of Kemet (Ancient Egypt). Nubia was the nucleus of trading between a candidate of the Political Abolition Party).

Kemet and other parts of Africa. Thus Nubia not only As the new organ for the Liberty Party, *Frederick Douglass' Paper* affected the course of the civilization of Kemet but *Douglass' Paper* engaged in political abolitionism.

actually donated its own intellectual and material It published antislavery speeches in their entirety, infrastructure to its junior. The concept of divine king-presented debates on the Constitution, apprised its ship was born in Nubia, which was indeed the readership of antislavery meetings, and reprinted anti-

“Mother of Kemet.”

slavery features from other abolitionist newspapers.

Douglass also acquired a list of contributors who **LOCATION AND NAMES**

spoke with authority about the antislavery movement in the local and national context and revealed the Nubia was located south of Kemet in the area that is breadth of the unrelenting attack against slavery.

now the Sudan and parts of Egypt. This area has been Perhaps one of the most unique aspects of known by several names. Ancient Greek historians

Frederick Douglass' Paper was Douglass's demand contemporaries of the Nubians—wrote that Nubia that it be high quality. Douglass had no tolerance for was a land inhabited by black people and named it typographical and grammatical errors. Thus black *Ethiopia*, which means “the Land of the Blacks.”

contributors, without exception, wrote extremely well.

Another of the early names for Nubia was *Ta-Seti*. Like Douglass, they endeavored to show their erudi-meaning “the Land of the Bow,” so called because the tion and mental acuity and refute charges of Negro Nubian warriors were renowned for their skill with inferiority.

bows. Nubia was also referred to as Yam. Yam was Although Douglass spent 20 years in servitude and considered to be an affluent land. Official letters lacked any formal education, his paper had an enor-reveal that the 6th Dynasty Pharaoh Merenra mous impact in furthering the abolitionist cause—

(2287–2278 B.C.E.) dispatched his official Harkhuf to enlightening whites about the injustices and Yam to trade and to obtain soldiers. Harkhuf, one of immorality of slavery and revealing the humanity of Kemet’s most esteemed ambassadors, was an adven-blacks. His work revealed that blacks could speak turer and a noble diplomat. On Harkhuf’s first journey ardently on behalf of their race and that Americans’

to Yam, he returned with an array of gifts. He brought

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 383

Nubia———383

back even more gifts on his second voyage, which to the satisfaction of all. The primary point of contention took 8 months. On Harkhuf’s third journey, he is the southern boundary and how far into Africa it reported that the cargo from Yam included multiple extended.

grains, unusual animals, extraordinary incenses, and remarkable woods. However, it was on his fourth expedition to Yam, for the 6th Dynasty Pharaoh Pepi **EARLY NUBIAN CULTURE**

II (2278–2184 B.C.E.), that Harkhuf brought back the **A Group**

most prized item, an African of very small stature who was a dancer. Pepi II was extremely delighted because There is evidence of an early Nubian culture of the he believed that this small person was the embodiment mid-4th to early 3rd millennium B.C.E. This cultural of powerful spiritual forces. Yet another name for group is commonly referred to as the *A group*, a term Lower Nubia was Wawat. The time period when the that was coined by archaeologist George Reisner. He name Wawat was in use is unclear. There is, however, believed that the people were culturally similar to the a textual reference from the 6th Dynasty in which ancient Kemites, but that they were unable to form ancient Egyptians obtained the help of the Chief of their own culture. His influence is key to understand-Wawat in building wooden barges. Thus Wawat is one ing the low respect accorded early Nubian culture by of the many names by which the area that is now the Eurocentric historians, for he laid the foundation for Sudan had been known during ancient times.

archaeological excavation as it is practiced today.

There is no book written about Nubian culture that does not refer to his work. Although the quality of his **ORIENTATION**

excavations cannot be denied, all material remains Whatever the boundaries of Nubia may have been, it must be interpreted, and Reisner's interpretations is clear that the Africans of the Nile Valley looked "up asserted the superiority of a Eurocentric worldview.

south" and "down north." African-centered scholar Cheikh Anta Diop gave us insight into the significance **The A Group and Divine Kingship**

of this orientation by analyzing the word *king*, which in the ancient language Mdw Ntr is *nswt*. The origin Archaeologist Bruce Williams of the University of of this word is *swt*, meaning "the sedge plant," which Chicago's Oriental Institute challenged the view that was indigenous to upper Egypt, the area closest to the early Nubians, the A group, were unable to form Nubia. *Biti*, meaning "lower Egypt," was never a syn-an advanced culture. Williams argued that a stone onym for king, as was proposed by those who argued incense burner found during excavations conducted that

the kings came from the north. The word for by the University of Chicago during UNESCO's

"west" in Mdw Ntr is *imnt*, which is a variation of International Salvage Campaign of 1963 and 1964

wnmi, meaning "right hand" side. The word for "east"

showed clearly that Nubia preceded Kemet in royal is *i3bt*, a variation of *i3bi*, meaning "left hand" side.

inscriptions. The incense burner depicts a king in a Using the orientation of the original African people royal boat, wearing the white crown of Kemet, a of the Nile Valley, what is currently called the "sixth"

serekh (a representation of the palace facade) , and cataract, located in the heart of Africa, near the a representation of the falcon god, Heru. This is the Butanna Steepe, is actually the beginning of the Nile, most ancient depiction of a king in the Nile Valley or the first cataract. The "fifth" is the second; the anywhere in history. This artifact was found in one of

"fourth," the third; the "third," the fourth; the "second,"

the richest and earliest tombs in Cemetery I in ancient the fifth; and finally, the "first" will be the sixth. Diop Nubia. Through the context in which it was found, the posited that this "southern" orientation of the ancient quality and quantity of the wealth of the cemetery, and Africans is related to the south to north flow of the the style and composition of the incense burner, the Nile, the origin of the Nile being in Central Africa, and date of this item was determined to be about six or the Nubian origin of the concept of divine kingship.

seven generations before the dynastic era in Kemet.

However, scholars have never been in complete agree-This would place it with the so-called A group.

ment on the boundaries of Nubia. This is not to say that Divine kingship and the origins of Kemet are inex-the Africans did not know where the boundaries lay; tricably intertwined. The placement of the monarchy however, no one in modern times has determined them in Nubia before it appears in Kemet could also place

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 384

384———**Nubia**

the origins of the people of ancient Egypt in the south.

cataracts of the Butanna Steepe, a triangular area This leads to the conclusion that the Kemites were formed by the confluence of the Atbara and Nile rivers.

black. Furthermore, the matriarchal essence of the The transfer of the center of rule to Meroe marked Egyptian royalty reflects the role of the queen mother the beginning of a cultural, economic, and artistic of Nubia. Indeed, the notion of divine kingship and

“Imhotepean” period in the history of Kush, that is, the Kemetic word for royalty (*nsw* in hieroglyphics) there was a rebirth of artistic and political excellence.

means “the one who came from the south.” This clar-

(Imhotep was the chief advisor to the Pharaoh Djoser, ifies why the people of Kemet always turned toward a king of the 3rd Dynasty. He was an architect, a priest, the south during rituals, just as Muslims turn toward a physician, a writer of proverbs, and the builder of Mecca. It also helps to explain why when foreigners the first pyramid—the Step Pyramid. After his death, from the north invaded and conquered Kemet during the ancient Egyptians worshipped him as a demigod.

the 24th Dynasty, the people turned to the south once Furthermore, his fame was widespread, as the ancient again and the Nubian Pharaoh Piye

(Piankhi) Greeks and the Phoenicians also worshipped him.) answered their call.

THE 25TH DYNASTY OF KEMET

KUSH

The 25th Dynasty of Kemet was a union of Kemet and The most well-known name given to Nubia was Kush.

Kush and one of the most beloved and respected It was the name given to a period of Nubian history dynasties remembered by the Kemetic people. It was during which there were two successive capitals, launched when the Kushite King Piankhi saved Kemet Napata and Meroe. The name Kush has been identi-from foreign invaders. He wrote about his triumphs in fied in Pharaonic texts from 2000 B.C.E.

the famous *Victory Stele*, which is one of the most thorough and well-known documents from the Nile Valley. When Piankhi saved Thebes in 740 B.C.E., he **Napata**

installed his sister, Amenirdis I, as divine wife of It is generally agreed that Kush extended from 900

Amun. The female in this position played a major part to 350 B.C.E. The exact location of the administrative in the sacred ceremonies in Amun worship. She center of Napata is unknown, but it was associated owned a large amount of property and supervised with the area surrounding the Jebel Barkal Mountain, large numbers of temple officials, and thus was polit-named by the ancients the “Holy Mountain.” The ically and spiritually powerful. In this way, Piankhi location of the city near the sacred mountain must established a solid power base, which allowed him to have been very significant because royalty were still rule Kemet and Kush.

being buried there even after the capital was moved.

The power that the divine wife of Amun held can be gauged by a description of Karnak during the reign of Ramses III of the 20th Dynasty.

There were 81,322

Meroe

people in the service of the Amun, working in 125 dif-The Meroitic period is generally agreed to extend ferent categories of labor. There were also 421,262

from the 6th century B.C.E. to the beginning of the animals, 433 gardens, and 83 ships. All of this was 4th century C.E. The origin of the city of Meroe is contained within 2,395 square kilometers of field, unknown. It is known that by 538 B.C.E. royalty who including 46 work sites and 65 villages. These data were being buried at Napata had ruled from Meroe. An about the temple come from an inscription made unknown event of political significance must have during the reign of Ramses III.

brought about the transfer of the capital of Kush from There is not as detailed a description of Karnak as Napata to Meroe. It may have been the result of the that left during the 25th Dynasty. However, the kings increase of trade routes to Meroe or it might have been of the 25th Dynasty enhanced Karnak, and the wor-because the Kushite rulers wanted to move away from ship of Amun became more extensive; thus we can the powerful priests at Amun temple in Jebel Barkal.

safely assume that Karnak was considerably grander.

The first historical mention of Meroe occurred when The divine wives of Amun wielded so much power it was at the height of its power. Incorrectly called that they were treated as queens and addressed as an island, it was a center of trade and one of several

“Your Majesty”; their names were written inside of settlements located between the second and first cartouches.

N-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:00 PM Page 385

The Candaces, Queens of Kush

THE CHRISTIAN PERIOD

The position of divine wife of Amun was not the During the time of the Roman emperor Justinian, from only source of power over spiritual and material 550 to 1400 C.E., Nubia became a Christian nation.

realms that women had in Kush. Women had enjoyed Tradition has it that the Byzantine Empress Theodora a long-standing tradition of respect and elevated posi-sent a missionary to Nobatia and that was the begin-tion in Kushite culture. Kushite kings Taharqua, ning of the conversion process. The Nubians, similar to Piankhi, and Anlamani all emphasized the impor-the Egyptians of the time, practiced monophysite tance of their mothers and wives in their coronation Christianity. They recognized the spiritual supremacy ceremonies and during their reigns. The appearance of the Coptic patriarch of Alexandria. Royal and reli-of a series of queen regents in Meroe, commonly gious leaders held concurrent power. The queen called Candaces, was a natural development of the mother still played a major role and the succession to elevated position of women in the Kushite culture.

the throne was determined by birth or marriage to a This could hardly have happened in Greece, where royal woman. Christian Nubia lasted for many cen-women neither owned property nor made decisions turies. It was at its height in the 9th and 10th centuries.

concerning the election of kings. This phenomenon is still not completely understood, partly because even **ISLAM**

though there was a Meroitic script, it is not been fully translated.

Muslim Arabs conquered Egypt in 640 C.E. and made several unsuccessful endeavors to conquer Nubia almost immediately afterwards. By the 12th century, **Candace Queen Who**

they were successful. All that is left of the Christian **Fought the Roman Emperor and Won**

period are beautiful paintings on the walls of the One of the Candaces was famous for her military cathedral at Faras. By the 15th century, the majority of valor. The Greek writer Strabo tells the story of how Nubians had converted to Islam. Currently it is called the Candace, believed to be Amanirenas, led an attack the Sudan and most of the people are Islamic.

against the Romans. The Romans were distracted

— *Miriam Ma'at-Ka-Re Monges*

with fighting the Arabians. The Africans were not as fully equipped as the Romans, but they felt that they **FURTHER READING**

had been maltreated, so they waited until the Romans Adams, William Y. (1977). *Nubia: Corridor to Africa*.

were vulnerable and then they struck. Some of them Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press. This is one of were captured, and they went into negotiations.

the basic books on Nubia.

During negotiations, the Candace obtained every-Emery, Walter. (1965). *Egypt in Nubia*. London: Hutchinson.

thing for which she had negotiated. The Roman This is an account of the relationship between Nubia and Emperor even cancelled taxes. She lost the battle but Egypt.

won the war.

Gardiner, Sir Arthur. (1992). *Egyptian Grammar*. Oxford, UK: Strabo describes this Candace as “a masculine Ashmolean. (Original work published 1927). This is the standard work on middle Egyptian language.

wo-man, and blind in one eye.” The iconography Monges, Miriam Ma'at-Ka-Re. (1997). *Kush: The Jewel of* generally shows the Candaces to be large women *Nubia*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is the first with long, pointed fingernails and very sophisticated book about Kush by an

African American scholar. It incor-jewelry. Scholars have referred to these queens as porates past and recent scholarship and provides a strong large, fat, obese, or very obese. There is a distinct basis for further study.

possibility that the large size of the Candaces repre-Olson, Stacie, and Wegne, J. (1992). *Ancient Nubia: Egypt's sented fertility and maternity.* African culture must *Rival in Africa*. Philadelphia: University Museum of Archeology and Anthropology, University of Pennsylvania.

be viewed through the lens of spirituality. Fertility This is an outstanding work that includes recent information.

and motherhood have always had significance to Williams, Bruce. (1980). *The Lost Pharaohs of Nubia*.

African people. The Candaces were divine rulers and *Archeology*, 33(5), 12–21. This has become a classic essay thus represented the spiritual and material wealth of in the field of Nubian studies because of its exploration of the people.

Nubian antecedents to Kemet.

O-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 387

O

regarded with both deference and fear in their **OBEAH**

respective communities.

In fact, since the days of slavery, Obeah priests Obeah is an African belief system and set of practices and priestesses have been greatly feared. Indeed, as in present in many former British Caribbean colonies, many other places, African spirituality, and in this case, such as Jamaica, Barbados, and Guyana, where it was Obeah, was used by enslaved Africans as a source of introduced during slavery. The word *Obeah* is of Akan unity and as an effective weapon against their white (West African) origin. Originally, it referred to a oppressors. It is a well-established historical fact that spiritual

force that can act for anyone, provided that Obeahmen and Obeahwomen were often responsible proper rituals have been observed. From an Obeah for leading insurrections to destroy slavery and the plan-point of view, and consistent with African spirituality, tation system. Among other things, they were known to there is present in the universe a cosmic force that poison whites and to administer oaths of secrecy. It is permeates all that is. That energy can be harnessed because of this strong link between Obeah and resis-through different procedures, commonly referred to as tance, and in a futile attempt to break it, that Obeah was magic. Cosmic manipulation can take place for good banned by the Europeans. For example, in Jamaica, the or bad purposes. The world itself is inhabited by spir-practice of Obeah became a capital offense after the for-its, who are particular forms of energy readily avail-midable Tacky Rebellion of 1760; and in Guyana, in able for guidance and protection but also for mischief.

1855, the punishment for practicing Obeah was impris-Obeah operates in all aspects of life. It may be used onment and public floggings. But not only was Obeah to cast a spell to protect oneself and one's property, outlawed, it was also vilified, as it became equated with family, and friends; to neutralize or destroy one's witchcraft and sorcery. Unfortunately, many Africans enemies; to amass wealth; to gain employment, love, have internalized this negative view of Obeah and reject and so on. It may also be used for healing purposes, it. However, for many others, Obeah remains an impor-through the use of herbs and other natural remedies. It tant and intricate part of their culture and of their life, as is the responsibility of the *Obeahman* or *Obeahwoman* they deal with the multiple challenges that life presents to bring about the desired result through the perfor-them as African people.

mance of appropriate rituals, such as services for particular spirits; the making of protective guards

— *Ama Mazama*

or cleansing baths; the sacrificing of animals (often chickens); or others. Thus, Obeah practitioners are **FURTHER READING**

expected to help solve a great variety of problems, Alleyne, Mervyn. (1988). *The Roots of Jamaican Culture*.

such as those associated with marriage, children, London: Pluto Press. This is indispensable reading on health, work, money, the police, the court, and so African culture and, more specifically, African religion in on. In that respect, Obeah priests and priestesses are Jamaica.

387

O-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 388

388——— ***Odu Ifa***

Gibson, Kean. (2001). *Comfa Religion and Creole Language* and analysis, are by Wande Abimbola, who is *Awise in a Caribbean Community*. Albany: State University of Agbaye or International Spokesperson for the Ifa New York Press. Gibson provides an excellent overview of tradition. These works include *Sixteen Great Poems Obeah* in Guyana.

of Ifa (1975), *Ifa: An Exposition of the Ifa Literary* Olmos, Margarite Fernandez, and Paravisini-Gebert, Lizabeth.

Corpus (1976), *Ifá Divination Poetry* (1977), and *Ifa* (Eds). (2000). *Sacred Possessions: Vodou, Santeria, Obeah, and the Caribbean*. New Brunswick, NJ: Rutgers *Will Mend Our Broken World* (1997).

University Press. This collection of essays includes some In addition, there are also important works of trans-interesting historical and literary analyses of Obeah.

lation of the *Odu Ifa* by others, including William Bascom's *Ifa Divination* (1969) and *Sixteen Cowries* (1980), Afolabi A. Epega and Philip Niemark's *The Sacred Ifa Oracle* (1995), and Solagbade Popoola's

ODU IFA

Practical Ifa (1997). Although the Ifa tradition is usually focused on divination and ritual sacrifice, The *Odu Ifa* is the sacred text of the spiritual

and eth-within the *Odu Ifa* there is a rich corpus of ethical ical tradition of Ifa and one of the great sacred texts of teachings that I have collected and translated in the the world. The Ifa tradition has its origins in ancient text *Odu Ifa: The Ethical Teachings* (1999) and from Yorubaland, but it holds a unique position among which I will extract and discuss core concepts of the African religions as the only African religion which Ifa tradition here.

has continuously survived and developed on an inter-Although Ifa has other names, Orunmila is the national level. The religion appears in numerous most often used to represent him as the teacher of countries under various names and forms—Lekumí the Ifa texts. Orunmila is an *orisha*, a divine being or (Santeria) in Cuba, Puerto Rico, and the United divinity, who is an assistant to Olodumare, who cre-States; Voudun in Haiti; Shango in Cuba; Candomblé ated heaven and earth. According to the sacred narra-in Brazil; and Ifa in Nigeria and the United States. But tive of creation, Orunmila was present at creation and regardless of its various names and forms, it is the mastered knowledge of the world. He thus is regarded same tradition, rooted in the ancient teachings found in Ifa tradition as the wisest of counselors and the cusin the same text, the *Odu Ifa*. Also, Ifa shares a unique todian of divine or sacred wisdom. And it is the *Odu* status with Maat, the spiritual and ethical tradition of that is the central source of this sacred wisdom of Ifa ancient Egypt, in their being the only two ancient or Orunmila.

African religions that have organized bodies of texts in which the tradition is rooted and developed.

A SCRIPT FOR ETHICAL LIVING

The meaning of the word *odu* is open to various interpretations, whereas the word *Ifa* clearly refers to The teachings of the *Odu* are rooted first in the con-both the teachings in the text as well as the divine sage cept of the essential goodness of the world. The *Odu* who taught them. In the Kawaída tradition, *odu* is states that at the time of creation, Olodumare, the cre-translated as “baskets of sacred wisdom.” Thus, the ator, sent orisha and humans in the world to finish the *Odu Ifa* contains the “baskets of sacred wisdom of world and make it good (*dara*) (*Odu Ifa* 10:2). And he Ifa.” This reading is based on the Ifa creation narrative gave them the power and

authority (*ase*) to accom-in which Olodumare, God, gives divine and human plish this task. Thus, the world is endowed with an beings baskets of sacred wisdom to make the world inherent goodness at the time of creation and this good. Thus, each *odu*, or chapter, is a container of good, the *Odu* teaches, must be increased and sus-sacred wisdom that humans are to use to make their tained. Moreover, although the world is essentially lives and the world good.

good, it is constantly in need of being renewed, The *Odu Ifa* is composed of 256 chapters (*odu*) repaired, and enriched with good. For there are nega-and innumerable verses (*ese*). Like other great sacred tive forces that threaten to undo the good. Five major texts, it contains a wide range of literary forms and threats to human good are death, disease, conflict, subjects, including poetry, proverbs, songs, chants, loss, and ignorance. But there are other vices that and sacred narratives, as well as prescriptions for threaten not only human good but the good of the divination and moral instructions for life. The seminal world—greed, selfishness, lying, injustice, cruelty, works on the *Odu Ifa* in translation, with commentary and others. Thus the *Odu* speaks of the need to “stop

O-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 389

***Odu Ifa*———389**

making sacrifices for wealth and instead make criteria for achieving a good world. Thus, the text sacrifices that would protect the earth from its (*Odu Ifa* 78:1) says the first criterion for achieving enemies,” which in modern Ifa ethics are plunder, the good world is “wisdom adequate to govern the pollution, and depletion (*Odu Ifa* 10:5).

world.” This wisdom is obviously multifaceted—

Tied to this concept of the goodness of the world is representing the full range of bodies of knowledge or a second pillar of *Odu* teachings that “humans are disciplines. But none is more important than *moral* divinely chosen to bring good into the world” (*Odu Ifa wisdom*. For even with mathematic, scientific, techno-78:1). In fact, the very word for human is

èniyàn, logical, sociological, and other forms of knowledge, which literally means “one chosen” or “chosen one.”

only with moral grounding can one serve the world Now the implication of this is of enormous moral significance. Thus, the *Odu* says, “Those whose turn it is to significance, for unlike other chosen people concepts in take care of the world should do good for the world”

which there is only one chosen people, the Ifa concept (*Odu Ifa* 33:2). This calls for a morally grounded wisdom-gives all humans this special divine status. And it is a domain that conceives and approaches the world in its chosenness based not on an ethnic or religious identity interrelated wholeness, respects its integrity, and takes but on a divine assignment— *the task of bringing good* seriously the divine assignment of humans to come into the world. And this ongoing moral obligation constantly bring good into the world. Therefore, the *Odu* and task of bringing good into the world is the says, “Speak truth, do justice, be kind and do not do fundamental mission and meaning of human life. This evil” (*Odu Ifa* 3:1).

status of divine *chosenness* is interlocked with its The *Odu* also places great emphasis on sacrifice companion concept of humans as the offspring (*omo*) as both ritual performance and moral practice. In the of Olodumare. And these provide the philosophical Kawaiida interpretation and tradition, sacrifice is and ethical grounds for the concept of human dignity approached as essentially a moral practice of self-or the inherent, transcendent, and equal worth of giving, as distinct from ritual sacrifice as object giving.

human beings.

Nevertheless, it is recognized that the two also can be Another important concept of *Odu* teachings and engaged at the same time. This stress on the morality the Ifa tradition is the right of everyone to a good life, of sacrifice calls for great effort to master oneself, to and the personal and collective responsibility of all to cultivate character and do good in the world.

create this. Again, the *Odu* says that Olodumare has The central moral quest in developing the Ifa ordained a good life for everyone and each of us is

person is to cultivate character. This is called *iwapele*, morally obligated to work to achieve the good world a gentle character, or *iwarere*, a good character, and in which a good life can be established and flourish thus these are interchangeable concepts. Character is for everyone (*Odu Ifa* 78:1). The *Odu* cautions against not only the basis of a long life in this world and eter-selfish conceptions of good when it says that “doing nal life in the next, it is also the basis of a good life on good worldwide is the best expression of character”

earth. Indeed, the *Odu* says, “All the good things we (*Odu Ifa* 166:2), and that “anyone who restricts good-have, if we don’t have character, the good things ness to one’s house will not find goodness outside the belong to someone else. And so it is character, *iwa*, we house” (*Odu Ifa* 124:2).

are looking for” (*Odu Ifa* 39:1). The word *character* is Orunmila, the sage and master teacher, describes used to mean a relatively stable disposition toward the good world as a world with several essential doing good (*ire*). And again, the text says “No one aspects: full knowledge of things; happiness every-needs to have a bad destiny, character is all that is where; freedom from anxiety and fear of hostile required” (*Odu Ifa* 31:3).

others; the end of antagonism with other beings on The *Odu Ifa* also places stress on the love of doing earth (i.e., animals and reptiles, etc.); well-being and good in the world. This is a moral practice rooted in the end of forces that threaten it, especially death, dis-the *Odu* teaching that one should do things with joy, ease, loss, and ignorance; and finally, freedom from knowing that humans are chosen to bring good into poverty and misery (*Odu Ifa* 78:1).

the world (*Odu Ifa* 78:1). By this stress on loving to Key to the *Odu* teaching is also the respect for do good, the *Odu* seeks to build a moral community knowledge (*ìmo*) and its higher form, wisdom based not simply on a sense of duty and obligation but (*ogbón*). Knowledge and wisdom are seen not only as also on a profound sense of joy in doing good, rooted the first criteria for a good world but also as the first in the benefit it has and brings for both giver and

recipient. And this love of doing good must be for everyone, but especially the most vulnerable and

OPPORTUNITY:

needy, as well as those who seek our help. Thus, the

A JOURNAL OF NEGRO LIFE

Odu states that creation of the good world requires

“love of doing good for everyone, especially for those *Opportunity: A Journal of Negro Life* was published who are in need and those who seek assistance from from 1923 to 1949 as the official organ of the National us” (*Odu Ifa* 78:1).

Urban League, a civil rights organization dedicated to Finally, the *Odu* teaches the importance of eager-the assimilation of blacks into mainstream America ness (*itara*) and struggle (*sisá ipa*) in order to bring and noted for its research on blacks in the United good in the world as a requirement to create a good States. The monthly journal is most frequently cited world. This reinforces the stress on moral feeling, a for the major role it played in formalizing and sus-sense of joy and urgency in doing good, and a pro-taining the arts movement known as the Harlem found commitment to struggle. The theme of struggle Renaissance; however, it was most consistent in pub-permeates the *Odu* and includes struggle to master lishing book reviews, editorials, and several articles oneself, cultivate character, build quality relation-each issue based on studies by the League’s depart-ships, create and sustain moral community, and insure ment of research and development.

good in the world. Indeed, the *Odu* speaks of the These articles typically took about two thirds of the struggle for good in the world in three basic ways publication and addressed crime, labor, housing, intel-

(*Odu Ifa* 78:1). These include the struggle to bring lightness testing, education, interracial relations, and so (*mu—lo, ko—wa*) good into the world, to increase on. The journal's name was taken from the League's (*kun*) good in the world, and to sustain good in the motto "Not Alms, but Opportunity," and its stated mis-world (*laijeki ire eyikeyii ti a ti ni lo—* literally, "not let sion was to report objectively on black life to "provide any good be lost"). Thus, it is in the constant waging a basis of understanding" and to "encourage interracial of these struggles to bring, increase, and sustain good co-operation." Specifically, it published information in the world that we honor our status as chosen ones, that would refute and discredit racial stereotypes then *èniyàn*; achieve the good world; and realize the held about blacks in the Americas and Africa.

fundamental mission and meaning of human life.

Charles S. Johnson, the journal's founder and edi-

— *Maulana Karenga*

tor from 1923 to 1928, graduated from Virginia Union University and the University of Chicago, where he was trained as a sociologist. It was Johnson's scien-FURTHER READING

tific training in Chicago that would shape much of his Abimbola, Wande. (1997). *Ifa Will Mend Our Broken World*: writing and the research published in the journal.

Thoughts on Yoruba Religion and Culture in Africa and Typical of his interest in analyzing the complexity of the Diaspora. Roxbury, MA: Aim Books. This is an analy-popular beliefs was his August 1923 essay on Marcus sis by a key figure in the Yoruba world of Yoruba mythol-Garvey. While his contemporaries at *The Crisis* and ogy as it relates to Ifa and the Yoruba people and their *The Messenger* had joined mainstream pundits in descendants.

Bascom, William. (1969). *Ifa Divination: Communication* denouncing Garvey and calling for his imprisonment *Between Gods and Men in West Africa*. Bloomington: and deportation, Johnson insisted that Garvey could

Indiana University Press. This is one of the earliest scholarly treatises on the Yoruba religion. Instead, he drew analogies

between Garvey's African nationalism with the Epega, Afolabi. (2003). *Ifa: The Ancient Wisdom*. New York: nationalistic movements elsewhere in the world sup-Athelia Henrietta Press. Epega's book is a concise and ported by downtrodden peoples. Garvey wanted for useful summary of Ifa's major tenets.

Africans what the Irish wanted for Ireland and the Karenga, Maulana. (1999). *Odu Ifa: The Ethical Teachings*—

Indians for India.

An Analysis of the Moral Implications and Dimensions of Ifa. Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This is the Johnson also thought it equally important to foster only English translation and interpretation of these sacred among blacks and influential whites an understanding writings.

and appreciation for black contributions to the "classical" arts. *Opportunity* regularly included poems,

See also Maat

literary criticism, essays, and photos of sculpture and art

O-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 391

Oral Tradition——391

by black artists, as well as artifacts from African Wilson, Sondra Kathryn. (Ed.). (1999). *The Opportunity* countries. Johnson is most often praised, however, *Reader*. New York: Random House. This is a collection of for his orchestration of the now-famous March 1924

poetry, fiction, plays, reviews, and essays—primarily by now-famous blacks—published in the journal during its

“coming out” dinner at New York’s Civic Club for Harlem Renaissance heyday of 1923 to 1931.

Harlem’s literary giants to meet mainstream publishing brokers. Attendees included editors at *Century*, *Survey*, *The Nation*, and Harper Brothers, as well as the black writers Alain Locke, W.E.B. Du Bois, James **ORAL TRADITION**

Weldon Johnson, Langston Hughes, Countee Cullen, Gwendolyn Bennett, and Jessie Fauset. This was The oral tradition, also termed *oral literature* or *ora-followed in Opportunity’s September issue with the ture, refers to a wide body of oral discourse encom-announcement of what would be the first of three passing every subject and in every type of expression literary contests that paid modest cash prizes to winners.*

created by a people. The oral tradition is an art form These efforts are frequently credited with being the cat-that can be analyzed in accordance with an approved alysts for the formalization of the Harlem Renaissance, and recognized set of traditional standards. The nature where black artists were published and patronized by of the African oral tradition is drawn from African wealthy, influential whites. The journal, however, would belief systems and traditions.

continue until 1949 with the publication of statistics-The oral tradition is the complex corpus of verbal driven research about blacks in the United States.

or spoken art created for the purpose of remembering

— Harry Amana

*the past based on the people’s ideas, beliefs, symbols, assumptions, attitude, and sentiments. There are three main categories of orature—literary, historical, and **FURTHER READING***

erudite knowledge. The literary includes poetic Gilpin, Patrick J. (1972). Charles S. Johnson: Entrepreneur genres, divination poems, and songs. It also includes of the Harlem Renaissance. In Arna Bontemps (Ed.), The

proverbs, parables, and incantations. The historical Harlem Renaissance Remembered. New York: Dodd, includes narratives based on myths, legends, and Mead. Gilpin examines the role Johnson played in historical plays or epics. The erudite knowledge Opportunity and behind the scenes in exposing black artists includes specialized, and often secret knowledge, to white patrons in the publishing world.

such as initiation formulas, herbal recipes, and so on.

Hutchinson, George. (1995). Toward a New Negro Aesthetic.

The poet serves many functions in traditional In The Harlem Renaissance in Black and White.

Cambridge, MA: Belknap Press of Harvard University African society. The griot or court poet for the Press. Hutchison argues that, contrary to the opinion of Mandika of West Africa was charged not only with many modern critics, Opportunity critics and reviewers singing the ruler's praises but also with documenting (some of them white) espoused a dynamic, holistic aes-through songs the historical events surrounding the thetic approach to African and African American art that royal or ruling family. He is also the linguist or generally rejected the narrow "exotic" and racially "primitivist" notions embraced by many renaissance patrons.

Central Africa, the imbongi of the Zulu in Southern Ikonne, Chidi. (1996). Opportunity and Black Literature, Africa, and poets in other ethnic groups all serve the 1923–1933. In Cary D. Wintz (Ed.), The Harlem Renaissance 1920– 1940: Analysis and Assessment same purpose.

1940– 1979. New York: Garland. This short study examines Ever present in traditional African orature is the in significant detail the important role played by productive power of Nommo—the Word. The African Opportunity in the "modification and intensification of poet commands things by using words according what other magazines had been doing . . . before its to traditional African philosophy. Not only are these establishment."

“magical” poets used at the discretion of royalty, but Stroman, Carolyn A. (1990). Charles S. Johnson. In Sam others consult them as well. For example, goldsmiths G . Riley (Ed.), Dictionary of Literary Biography (Vol. 91).

often call upon poets to work their “word-magic” for Detroit, MI: Gale Research. This essay describes Johnson’s career as researcher, writer, and editor, with an emphasis on the creation of their art.

his tenure as Opportunity editor from its founding in 1923

While at the same time appreciating the oral skill through 1928.

of the poet, Africans recognize their orature and its

O-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 392

*392——**Organization of Afro-American Unity** performance (again, you cannot have one without the Aesthetic: Keeper of the Traditions (pp. 1–20). Westport, other) as a functional part of society. The purpose of CT: Greenwood Press. Welsh-Asante explains that aesthetics orature is not merely to entertain, or to appeal to some in an African context operate in tandem with functional aspects of artistic expression.*

romantic sensation, but to enlighten and stir the audience into some productive action or initiate or facilitate spiritual action.

*African orature does not departmentalize literature into poetry, prose, and drama; orature is just language **ORGANIZATION OF***

*used by the speaker or poet. Examples of the use of **AFRO-AMERICAN UNITY***

language rooted in the indigenous African culture are copious. This is important because it demonstrates The creation of the Organization of Afro-American that there is no line drawn between a speech act and a Unity (OAAU) was announced on April 28, 1964 in performance in African communities. They are one New York City by Malcolm X, who is also known

as and the same. To speak is to perform. Traditional El-Hajj Malik El-Shabazz and as Omowale (“the child African literature, or African orature, exists alongside has come” in Yoruba). The OAAU was founded and or within African languages. It is not compartmental-modeled after the Organization of African Unity ized into separate and distinct categories. Therefore, (OAU). The OAU was the union of African states when discussing the African oral tradition, one is that came into being in order to overcome common speaking of artistic verbal expressions—and its per-obstacles faced by member states. Malcolm X, as a formance in the form of poems, songs, proverbs, spokesperson for his people who were being myths, legends, incantations, sermonizing, lecturing, oppressed in the United States, had been warmly testifying, signifying, and other modes—based on a received in Africa. He had taken his case before the complex worldview designed to elevate and transform collective OAU as well as individual statesmen to society. In Africa and the diaspora, past and present, petition for the assistance of newly independent the spoken word dominates communication culture.

African nations in securing freedom for Africans in This is part of the continuity with the ancient African America.

past.

This underscores the profound pan-African orientation of the OAAU from the start. Indeed, although

— Adisa A. Alkebulan

*the OAAU was created in the United States of America, the vision was clear: The Organization of **FURTHER READING***

Afro-American Unity was established to unite the Bodunde, Charles A. (1992). Oral Traditions & Modern struggles of all the people of African descent, in the Poetry: Okot p ‘Bitek’s Song of Lawino and Okigbo’s diaspora and in Africa. Their stated aim was to con-Labyrinths. In Eldred Durosimi Jones (Ed.), Orature in solidate the ideas, skills, and resources of all Africans African Literature Today (pp. 24–34). Trenton, NJ: Africa for the cause of freedom from oppression. Their World Press. In this article,

Bodunde discusses the African underlying aim was to transform the civil rights move-oral tradition from a cultural and historical standpoint.

ment into a human rights movement.

Mazama, Ama. (2001). An Analysis of Discourse on the The primary goals of the OAAU were as follows: Spoken and Written Words: A Historical Comparison of European and African Views. In Virginia Milhouse, Molefi Kete Asante, and Peter O. Nwosu (Eds.), Transcultural 1. to establish organized resistance to oppression; Realities: Interdisciplinary Perspectives on Cross-Cultural Relations. Thousand Oaks, CA: Sage. This essay highlights 2. to secure freedom through action; the cultural and historical significance of the African oral tradition.

3. to foster African unity and pan-Africanism Okpewho, Isidore. (1985). The Heritage of African Poetry.

through the nurturing of philosophical and Burnt Mill, Essex, UK: Longman Group. This text reveals cultural ties.

the functional aspect of the African oral tradition. It focuses on how verbal art is used to teach history and how the poet is used as the spokesperson for a nation's leaders.

The OAAU envisioned freedom being achieved in Welsh-Asante, Kariamuu. (1994). The Aesthetic Conceptualiza-this way: First, two primary mechanisms would be tion of Nzuri. In Kariamuu Welsh-Asante (Ed.), The African employed—self-determination and national unity.

O-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 393

Oyo Empire———393

Self-determination is best understood here as the OAAU would never realize its potential. Omowale ability of African people to pursue economic, political, Malcolm X Shabazz, the revolutionary, was killed, social, and cultural enterprises that promote their right and for all intents and

purposes the institution of the to shape their history, present and future, according to OAAU died with him.

their best interests. National unity refers to Africans

— Daryl Zizwe Poe

*everywhere overcoming the divisions that obstruct the progress of people of African descent, as well as **FURTHER READING***

strengthening the bonds that unite all Africans. The OAAU proposed that obstructive divisions be elimi-Brotz, Howard. (Ed.). (1992). African-American Social and nated in order to allow the fusion and convergence of Political Thought 1850–1920. New Brunswick, NJ: talents, skills, resources, and ideas toward the com-Transaction. The essays in this book provide a variety of vantage points on and solutions to America's social ills.

mon goal of freedom. In that respect, divisive agen-Haley, Alex, and X, Malcolm. (1964). The Autobiography of das, which were encouraged by oppressors, would be Malcolm X, as Told to Alex Haley. New York: Ballantine.

set aside. Another important factor in the process of This is a firsthand account of the man who envisioned the national unification would be the reconnection of Organization of Afro-American Unity (OAAU).

African Americans with their African roots. Indeed, Sales, William W., Jr. (1994). From Civil Rights to Black the rediscovery and reexperiencing of the true African Liberation: Malcolm X and the Organization of Afro-culture and history, deliberately distorted and misrep-American Unity. Boston: South End Press. This is a very useful study of the developments leading to the creation of resented by oppressive non-African groups, was also the OAAU, as well as an analysis of the organization's an important tenet of the OAAU. In this rediscovery major tenets.

process, Africans from the continent and the diaspora www.malcolm-x.org/docs/ This Web site offers many docu-would become aware of their common heritage and ments and timelines that reveal Malcolm Little's

transfor-identity. In the spirit of efficiently pursuing freedom, mation into Omowale Malcolm X el-Hajj Malik el-Shabazz, the OAAU developed three key concepts for national as well as his thoughts toward the end of his life.

unity: pledging unity, promoting truth and justice, and transcending compromise.

*The OAAU was made up of many branches, which would each specialize in specific issues. In this way, **OYO EMPIRE***

the many fronts on which oppression existed would be simultaneously engaged. Chapters of the OAAU were Oyo came to power under the reign of Alafin Ajagbo begun by African Americans residing in African in 1670. The Oyo Empire then lasted until the middle countries, so that they could better contribute to the of the 19th century, when an internal civil war pitted cause of freedom in America. The short-lived OAAU

the Oyo Muslims and Islamic traders against the would, however, start with the human rights issue in traditional ruling house of Alafin Afonja, ultimately the United States.

leaving a vacuum of power in Oyo. The people of A distinctive feature of the OAAU was that any ide-Ibadan then conquered the territory that had once been ology was acceptable in its midst, as long as it aimed under the power of Oyo.

at securing African freedom. Pluralism was thus Oyo is one of the oldest sites of the Yoruba peoples encouraged: The OAAU was inclusive with regard to of southwestern Nigeria. During its imperial days, religious differences, class differences, citizenship dif-Oyo conquered Dahomey and controlled a territory ferences, as well as any other divisive constructs that larger than France. Oyo sold manufactured goods to would hinder unified action for the cause of freedom.

Hausa and Fulani traders, who eventually had a large While common grounds for action were the OAAU's presence in the capital city of Oyo.

primary focus, this pragmatic flexibility regarding dif-Oyo imported horses from the north, which were fering ideologies and methods was a built-in feature of used in the kingdom of Oyo for military purposes, fes-the OAAU.

tivals, and state ceremonies and as status symbols.

Major OAAU rallies were held and planning activ-The horse appears early in Yoruba culture, but it is not ities were created from the start of the OAAU in the entirely clear who introduced the animal to West spring of 1964 until February 21, 1965, the day that Africa. However, the royal house of Oyo had an Omowale Malcolm X Shabazz was assassinated. The ancient practice of keeping horses long before Hausa

O-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:01 PM Page 394

394———**Oyo Empire**

traders came with horses from the north. Oranmiyan, **FURTHER READING**

an Ife prince, is said to have founded the royal Adepegba, Cornelius O. (1986). *The Descent from Oduduwa: dynasties of both Oyo and Benin and been the first to Claims of Superiority Among Some Yoruba Traditional introduce horses to Oyo society.*

Rulers and the Arts of Ancient Ife. International Journal of Horses may have been used earlier for nonmilitary African Historical Studies, 19(1), 77–92. This is a signifi-purposes, but evidence suggests that the the Oyo army cant discussion of descent claims in Yoruba generally, with may have begun using horses only during the 16th reference to Oyo particularly.

century. By the 17th century, Oyo had become a pow-Law, Robin. (1975). *A West African Cavalry State: The erful military state under leaders such as Oranmiyan, Kingdom of Oyo. Journal of African History, 16(1), 1–15.*

This is a good work on the presence of the horse in Oyo.

Sango, Orompoto, Abiodun, and Awole. However, by Law, Robin. (1986). How Many Times Can History Repeat 1836 the kingdom had spent its best days and would Itself? Some Problems in the Traditional History of Oyo.

be succeeded by the vigorous government of Ibadan.

International Journal of African Historical Studies, 18(1), 33–51. Law attempts to make chronological order out of sev-

— Willie L. Brown

eral facts and narratives that seem to recur in Oyo tradition.

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 395

P

*matrilineal system of the ancient southern societies, **PATRIARCHY***

as barbaric and sexually promiscuous. This pervasive notion on which patriarchy has based its assumption Patriarchy is an authoritative male system that is of superiority has left an undeniable curse on women both oppressive and discriminatory. It is oppressive in and it has always been and still is the ultimate reason social, political, economic, and cultural environments.

for the oppression of women in society.

It is discriminatory in its control of access to power, management of resources and benefits, and manipula-QUESTIONING THE PATRIARCHAL MODEL

tion of public and private power structures. Patriarchy is grounded in the assumption that the individual Whether considered from a sex or gender perspective, European male is a universal reference point and the in terms of male control of women's reproduction, or source of defining visions of the cosmos, society, cit-from a materialistic perspective where class relations izenship, and the individual self within hierarchical and the sexual division of labor in the marketplace as concepts of gender, race, and class relations.

economic and social extensions of male and female Although some authors contend that matriarchy roles in the family are mutually self-reinforcing, patri-precended patriarchy, patriarchy did not replace matriarchy always stands for the totality of oppressive and archy. The two social systems originated in different exploitative relations that affect women in both the parts of the world, and they are antithetical systems in capitalist and the socialist systems. Patriarchy is, that they are based on very different principles. In the therefore, an all-encompassing oppressive paradigm African conception, a matriarchy is a society in which whose transformation doesn't seem possible without a maternal energy and mother love are socially cohesive revolutionary questioning of every concept involved, forces. Thus matriarchy is not, like patriarchy, a dom-beginning with the evolutionary model proposed by inating ruling system—it is a social organization the classical theory of 19th-century Western writers.

focused on the power of women as mothers and on the Questioning the Western model is precisely what matrilineal ownership of the home and wealth.

Cheikh Anta Diop committed himself to, and he suc-Patriarchy is an authoritative system, in a broad ceeded in fully scientifically demonstrating its inva-sense, that resulted from the Western European histor-lidity when he established a link between patterns of ical and sociological approaches to the development survival and systems of social organization geograph-of social and family structures as addressed by ically separated by the Mediterranean in a northern Western scholars. Thus, the paradigm that underlies and a southern cradle. Diop clearly demonstrates the modern assumptions of patriarchy may have that rather than a universal evolution, where one could emerged from the insight of specific European authors speak of a transition from an inferior to a superior drawing on the patriarchal basis of Greek and Roman state, the two systems, with matriarchy favored philosophies. These authors saw matriarchy, and the by the agricultural societies of the southern cradle 395

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 396

and patriarchy favored by the nomadic people in pattern, the black men could not, would not, or were the northern cradle, encountered one another and unable to affirm themselves as the alternative male even disputed with each other as different human model that black women would legitimately have societies. Furthermore, at certain places and times, the expected to join in the consolidation of a cohesive two cradles were superimposed on each other or even African tradition of respectful communal values.

coexisted.

The Afrocentric paradigm as a holistic philosophy-Cheikh Anta Diop's presentation of matriarchy cal approach to the reality of the Africans in the dias-from an African perspective appears more complete pora contains, in its essence, the germ of a generating than the Western male-centered discourse that shapes creative power that pursues a much more humanistic the Western patriarchal construction with its emphasis society than the prevailing Western patriarchal on the male as a universal point of departure in con-society. A genuine Afrocentricity seeks to examine the ceptualizing human existence. Thus Diop provides an ancient continental African cultures for patterns of opening for criticizing the ideas based on the assump-matriarchal social organization, family bonds, and tion of a universal male referent (i.e., representation of human relations in an attempt to find a basis for a the white male as the standard model for all ideologi-global revolutionary paradigm of female-male rela-cal and theoretical positions), ideas that are rooted in tionships in the 21st century.

biological differences and that account for much of

— Ana Monteiro Ferreira

*the current hierarchical distribution and attribution of resources and power. This contrasting of matriarchy **FURTHER READING***

and patriarchy is a true revolutionary approach that places African cultural patterns at the center of the Asante, Molefi Kete. (1994). Malcolm X as Cultural Hero and exploration of a distinctive concept of degrees of Other Afrocentric Essays. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press.

importance assigned to male and female subjects in Asante's chapter on gender here is especially relevant to discussion of patriarchy.

African societies.

Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1978). Cultural Unity of Black Africa.

This revolutionary approach initiated by Diop, and Chicago: Third World Press. In this book, Diop exposes the developed by Afrocentric scholars such as Molefi commonalities among different African cultures before the Asante and Ama Mazama, defines the basis of the presence of Europeans in Africa.

quest for an ideology of nonoppression. These schol-Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1991). Civilization or Barbarism.

ars have based their views on ideas that derive from New York: Lawrence Hill. Here Diop puts forth the idea African holistic thought, which stresses collective-that there are two cradles of world civilization, one matriarchal, the other patriarchal.

ness, relativism, nonhierarchicality, egalitarianism, Dove, Nah. (1998). Afrikan Mothers. Albany: State University and a balanced construction of life. Their intellectual of New York Press. This is an examination of the role of idea is to confront patriarchy as an oppressive politi-women in society, with special emphasis on how women cal and cultural system in order to eradicate it.

and men participate in certain rituals.

Indeed, such an Afrocentric task is in line with the harmonizing of the world, a central feature of Afrocentric thought. When one considers the fact that the enslaved African men and women brought to

THE PHILADELPHIA NEGRO

the Americas by Europeans were deprived of family bonds and faced the deepest destruction of family In 1896, white aristocrat and reformer Susan

P.

unity, order, and harmony from the 16th century on, it Wharton, in conjunction with the University of is possible to understand Africans' urgency in working Pennsylvania and the College Settlement Association, to reclaim balance in society. In addition, slavehold-commissioned William Edward Burghardt (W.E.B.) ers' sexual harassment, violation, and rape of the Du Bois to undertake a study on Negroes in enslaved African girls and women could not but leave Philadelphia. Since Philadelphia contained the largest burning psychological marks in every black female.

black population north of the Mason-Dixon Line (of When the time came for Reconstruction, however, all U.S. cities, only New Orleans, Washington, D.C., black men and women in America often built their and Baltimore had larger populations), African family and social ties in the image of the European Americans residing in the City of Brotherly Love models of white America. By imitating the white male became a logical group for examination. The genesis

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 397

The Philadelphia Negro——397

of the study originated in late 19th-century reform The Philadelphia Negro contained information movements, comprising New Social Science, Social about African Americans never previously presented to Gospel, and College Settlement House Associations, interested readers. Conscious of the need to make his which were designed to investigate the debased condi-work comprehensible to readers, Du Bois divided his tion of downtrodden urbanites and offer problem-solving study into four parts. The first part describes the history suggestions to ameliorate life for the urban poor.

of the black people in the city, their present condition Those who instituted the study held more than as individuals, their behavior as a social group, and altruistic thoughts toward the black community, how-the physical and social confines of their community.

ever, as their ulterior motive for the investigation was The second part is devoted to “the general condition self-serving and pertained to politics. Elite reformers of Negroes” and contains information on age, gender, became disgruntled by the behavior of the corrupt education, and means of earning a living. The third part political machine that derived support from the black focuses on the group life of the black community, electorate. They therefore sought to document the including the number of blacks in Philadelphia and moral and social condition of local blacks. Du Bois, their family situations and secular and religious organi-who had studied in Berlin and recently graduated with zations. Here, Du Bois also presents information on his doctorate from Harvard, became the ideal social maladjustment and individual deprivation char-researcher for the project. Du Bois’s extensive study acterized by crime, pauperism, and alcoholism. Finally, on research methodology, which he had learned in Du Bois assesses the physical and social environment, Germany, and publication of his *Suppression of the references and analyzes interracial relationships, and Atlantic Slave Trade*, the first monograph published in offers advice and suggestions for social reform.

the Harvard Historical Studies, demonstrated he pos-Throughout the study, maps, statistical tables, sessed the acumen and preparation for the task at charts, and graphs provide convincing testimony to hand. Thus Du Bois easily complied with the stated the accuracy of the work. The ecological map detail-goals of the benefactors of the research project, who ing the distribution of the black population by socio-sought to understand the “Negro problem” by focus-economic class garnered special interest. Du Bois ing on the Seventh Ward, the largest and most diverse divided the black population into four categories: black ward in the city.

(1) the “middle classes” and those above, (2) the working people—fair to comfortable, (3) the poor, and (4) the vicious and criminal classes. Du Bois’s **DU BOIS’S FIELD RESEARCH FOR THE STUDY**

study made it clear that African Americans can best be Du Bois’s extensive field research and writing con-studied and understood within the context of class, conducted on black Philadelphians was completed within sequently, ever since publication of *The Philadelphia* the short time span of 15 months

*and achieved a series of firsts. Indeed, when Du Bois's *The Philadelphia Negro* devoted attention to social stratification.*

Negro was published in 1967, it became the first book Du Bois intended to do far more than present evidence of modern sociology. As members of a fledgling academic about the black situation. Prior to any previous academic discipline, sociologists traditionally read books, scholars, Du Bois presented an assessment and expected reflected on the information presented, and offered ideas of the black elite. He excoriated the black aristocracy without conducting investigative research. Therefore, a line between themselves and the interviews Du Bois conducted with Seventh Ward masses, and he chided the elite for being unprepared to residents broke new ground in scientific inquiry. A lead their race. While the Harvard-trained Du Bois disavowed second novel contribution inherent in Du Bois's work played aloofness and aristocratic tendencies himself, pertained to the original analysis that evolved from he nevertheless believed unequivocally that the better the format and methodology of his work. After con-classes should recognize their duty to the masses.

*ducting house-to-house interviews with all the black families in the Seventh Ward, Du Bois acquired can-***DU BOIS'S EMERGENCE**

did information from 9,675 subjects. Through these **AS A MAJOR SOCIAL SCIENTIST**

investigations, Du Bois gained insight on the condition, aspirations, trials, and tribulations of the black Unwittingly, those who contracted Du Bois to community.

perform research on black Philadelphians created

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 398

398—— The Pittsburgh Courier

an intellectual activist who never forgot the racism he experienced. Although the University of Pennsyl-

THE PITTSBURGH COURIER

vanian listed Du Bois as an assistant professor in the sociology department, it never considered offering him a teaching position. Du Bois never forgot the slight. He in an H. J. Heinz food-packing plant, The Pittsburgh later complained that the university never placed his Courier gained national prominence after attorney name in the catalogue, and he believed the university's Robert Lee Vann became the newspaper's editor and invitation had not been cordial. For most of his life, publisher, treasurer, and legal counsel in 1910. By the Du Bois would serve his race by galvanizing and 1930s and 1940s, it was one of the top-selling black encouraging blacks of higher station to fight relent-newspapers in the country. In fact, with a circulation lessly against racial discrimination. Du Bois and others of almost 200,000, The Pittsburgh Courier was once with talent and ambition bristled at the "color line" that the most widely circulated black newspaper, and prevented them from acquiring the social and occupa-on a par with The Chicago Defender and the Afro-tional positions worthy of their station.

American in Baltimore.

The scholarly brilliance Du Bois displayed in The A network of Pullman Porters who worked for the Philadelphia Negro was immediately recognized as railroad companies helped with the distribution of a credit to American scholarship. Reviewers praised the paper, especially in the South. Because the paper Du Bois's objectivity and willingly accepted his con-advocated equal rights and campaigned against clusions. And yet, few could have predicted that this lynching and discrimination, sheriffs in the Jim Crow seminal work on black Philadelphians would have South tried to ban the paper's distribution and fre-far-reaching consequences that continued throughout quently destroyed and burned stacks that made their the 20th century. The genesis of Du Bois's most way into town. The Pittsburgh Courier launched its important contributions to the black community

"stop and drop" program in 1936 and continued it appeared in The Philadelphia Negro—his demands through the mid-1940s. During that time, railroad for leadership emanating from the black elite, his porters helped to

get 100,000 papers a week into the condemnation of intraracial dissension caused by South. The porters were trusted because they worked class differences, and his persistent expectations that under the strong leadership of A. Philip Randolph, a those he termed the “talented tenth” (the 10% of labor and civil rights activist who was the founder blacks capable of leading the rest) receive proper and president of the Brotherhood of Sleeping Car respect from their white peers and the black masses.

Porters. Every week the black newspaper would be Throughout his career, Du Bois engaged in research smuggled in small bundles to the Pittsburgh railroad and writing with a clear focus in mind: He sought station, and porters would hide them aboard or under freedom, justice, and equal opportunity for all the trains. Once the papers arrived in the South, the African Americans. One may argue that the research porters dropped the papers 2 miles outside major skills he honed and shaped as he worked on The cities and black ministers gathered the papers and Philadelphia Negro served as motivating tools that held them until Sunday, distributing them to the culminated in the civil rights movement of the children in their congregations who served as news-1960s.

boys and newsgirls.

From its inception, The Pittsburgh Courier sought

— H. V. Nelson

to empower African Americans economically and politically. It called for improvements in housing, health, and education; protested the slum conditions **FURTHER READING**

in which black people were forced to live in Du Bois, W. E. B. (1967). The Philadelphia Negro. New York: Pittsburgh and throughout the nation; and encouraged Schocken Books. Du Bois’s report on his study of the the black community to support black organizations black condition in Philadelphia is one of the first urban such as the National Urban League and the National studies.

Association for the Advancement of Colored People.

Lewis, David Levering. (1993). W.E.B. Du Bois: Biography of a Race 1968–1919. New York: Henry Holt. This remains In 1932, Vann helped influence black voters to support one of the most comprehensive portraits of W.E.B. Du the Democratic presidential candidate Franklin D.

Bois.

Roosevelt; for blacks this was a major political shift

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 399

***Plessy v. Ferguson*———399**

from their prior allegiance to the Republican Party, Dyer, Ervin. (2002, February 24). Porters' "Underground which had been thought of as Lincoln's party.

Railroad" Carried Pittsburgh Courier into the South.

The Pittsburgh Courier was the first black news-Pittsburgh Post Gazette. Retrieved September 1, 2004, from <http://post-gazette.com> Dyer discusses how a network paper to publish both national and local editions. At of porters carried the newspaper by train to all areas and one time, there were as many as 14 editions circulated helped The Courier to become one of the nation's most in states in the North and the South including Texas, widely distributed and respected newspapers.

Louisiana, Pennsylvania, Ohio, and New York. Many Washburn, Patrick S. (1986). A Question of Sedition: The of the 20th century's well-known and influential Federal Government's Investigation of the Black Press black journalists and intellectuals contributed to the During World War II. New York: Oxford University Press.

paper, such as George Schuyler, Marcus Garvey, In this book, Washburn discusses and documents the pres-W.E.B. Du Bois, James Weldon Johnson, Elijah sure applied to the justice department and the White House to indict some black newspapers for sedition until President Muhammed, and Zora Neale Hurston. It was also one Franklin D. Roosevelt put an end to it.

of the few black newspapers to provide coverage of news in Africa as the countries on the continent moved toward independence.

The paper, which was often known simply as The Courier, protested misrepresentations of African

PLESSY V. FERGUSON

Americans in the media and in sports. Thus, in the early 1930s, the paper began a nationwide protest against the Abraham Lincoln's success in the Civil War and the Amos 'n' Andy daily radio serial, attempting to have the end of slavery signaled the beginning of a new era program removed from the air. The Courier, which for blacks in America. However, in an attempt to wielded much influence, came out strongly against seg-restrict the freedom of newly freed blacks, many regation in professional sports. Wendell Smith, the Southern states passed "black codes" that limited paper's sportswriter starting in 1938, used his column blacks' right to vote, to engage in certain occupa-to denounce segregation in the major leagues, and his tions, and to participate in the judicial system. In efforts contributed to Jackie Robinson's signing with response, the "radical Republicans" in Congress the Brooklyn Dodgers in 1947.

passed a civil rights bill and Reconstruction acts to Ira Lewis, a sportswriter himself, became editor of limit the impact of the black codes and guarantee the paper after Vann's death in 1940. The Courier blacks their rights. But lawmakers intimidated by reached its highest circulation under Lewis because of such organizations as the Ku Klux Klan passed laws the "Double V" Campaign, which from 1942 through that segregated blacks from whites. While the 1943 demanded that African Americans who were Fourteenth Amendment ended slavery, it still left risking their lives abroad receive full citizenship rights many questions about the relations between blacks at home. But in 1948 Ira Lewis died, and without his and whites unanswered. These questions became a leadership The Pittsburgh Courier's circulation began significant factor in the case of Plessy v. Ferguson to decline—especially in the 1950s and 1960s. In (1896), in which the U.S. Supreme Court decided 1965, the paper was sold to John Sengstacke, owner that a Louisiana law mandating "separate but equal"

and publisher of The Chicago Defender. Today the accommodations for blacks and whites on intrastate paper, as The New Pittsburgh Courier, continues to be railroads was constitutional. This decision provided an active, responsible voice for the African American the legal foundation to justify many other actions community.

by state and local governments to socially separate blacks and whites.

— Deborah F. Atwater

A LEGAL CHALLENGE TO SEGREGATION

FURTHER READING

The arrest of Homer Adolph Plessy (1862–1925) on Buni, Andrew. (1974). Robert L. Vann of the Pittsburg June 7, 1892 was part of a planned challenge to the Courier: Politics and Black Journalism. Pittsburgh, PA: University of Pittsburgh Press. Buni offers a detailed constitutionality of the 1890 Louisiana Separate Car account of Vann's life and the origin and evolution of The Act by the Citizens' Committee, a small group of black Pittsburgh Courier.

professionals in New Orleans. The committee hired the

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 400

400——— **Plessy v. Ferguson**

*white lawyer and novelist Albion Winegar Tourgée, **THE SUPREME COURT VERDICT***

who had begun calling attention to separate-car laws On May 18, 1896, the Supreme Court rendered its in his newspaper column in August of 1891. After decision. Eight of the nine justices were unconvinced the committee successfully led a test case in State by Tourgée's arguments, and they ruled that neither v. Desdunes, in which the Louisiana district court the Thirteenth nor Fourteenth Amendment was applic-declared forced segregation in railroad cars traveling able in this case. The majority

opinion delivered by between states to be unconstitutional, the committee Henry Billings Brown attacked the Thirteenth was anxious for a case to test the constitutionality of Amendment claims by distinguishing between political segregation on railroad cars operating solely within a state and social equality. According to this distinction, a single state. Part of Tourgée's strategy was to have blacks and whites were politically equal (in the sense someone of mixed blood violate the law, since to that they had the same political rights) but socially do so would allow him to question the arbitrariness unequal (blacks were not as socially advanced as by which people were classified "colored." Plessy, a whites). In effect, Brown believed that legislation was Louisiana Creole of Haitian descent who was a mix powerless to remove racial differences and that to of seven-eighths white and one-eighth black, agreed attempt to do so would only accentuate those differences to be the test case.

ences: If the civil and political rights of the races were The committee arranged with the railroad company, one race could not be inferior to the other and with a private detective to detain Plessy civilly or politically. If one race were inferior to the other until he was arrested. This challenge received some other support, the Constitution of the United States silent support from railroad companies, which did not put them on the same plane. The majority not like the added expense of providing separate also attacked Tourgée's Fourteenth Amendment claims. A month after his arrest, Plessy came before a claims by arguing that enforced separation does not Louisiana district court presided over by Justice John

"stamp" blacks with a badge of inferiority, because Howard Ferguson. A native of Massachusetts, blacks and whites were treated equally under the Ferguson had ruled earlier in the *States v. Desdunes* law—in the sense that just as blacks were barred from case that the separate car act was unconstitutional on white accommodations on trains, whites were forbidden interstate trains because of the federal government's denial to sit in railroad cars designated for blacks.

power to regulate interstate commerce. When Plessy appeared before the Louisiana district court, the court ruled that a state had the constitutional power **THE VOICE OF THE LONE DISSENTER**

to regulate railroad companies operating solely The single dissenter who argued in favor of Plessy's within its borders and concluded that the Louisiana case, and seemed to be the only one with a real under-Separate Car Act was indeed constitutional. The standing of equality, was Justice John Harlan, the only decision was appealed to the state supreme court in Southerner on the Supreme Court at the time and a for-1893 and was appealed again to the U.S. Supreme mer slaveholder. Inspired by the infamous Dred Scott Court in 1896.

case, which denied citizenship to all blacks, he wrote his By the time Plessy v. Ferguson arrived at the own speech regarding the case and its decision. Harlan Supreme Court, Tourgée and his colleagues James asserted that the Constitution was color-blind and did C. Walker and Samuel F. Phillips had solidified their not know or tolerate classes among citizens, and that strategy. Tourgée argued that Plessy was denied his therefore the decision rendered by the Court would be as equal protection rights under the Fourteenth Amend-pernicious as the decision made in the Dred Scott case.

ment and that Louisiana had violated the Thirteenth Harlan further believed that the decision would stimu-Amendment by perpetuating the essential features of late aggression against blacks and encourage the belief slavery. Tourgée also exploited the fact that Plessy had that second-class citizenship of the black race was sup-only one-eighth African blood and argued that ported by the Constitution. Justice Harlan's words the reputation of belonging to one race or the other proved to be prophetic. It was not until the case of was a form of property, in that the financial benefits Brown v. Board of Education in 1954 that "separate but incurred from being labeled white, Tourgée claimed, equal" would no longer be the law of the land.

were a form of property that was being denied to his client.

— Garvey F. Lundy

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 401

Protest Pressure———401

FURTHER READING

to be imbued with the power to bring either good or evil. The term fetish—which is derived from the Lofgren, Charles A. (1987). The Plessy Case: A Legal-Historical Interpretation. New York: Oxford University Portuguese word feitiso and the French word fetiche, Press. This book provides a very thorough historical meaning “artificial or false”—does not begin to account of the Plessy case.

explain to Westerners the methods and significance of Olsen, Otto H. (1967). “The Thin Disguise: Turning Point in African religion. The Western conception of African Negro History.” In Otto H. Olsen (Ed.), Plessy v. Ferguson: religion was a misconception from the beginning, one A Documentary Presentation (1864–1896). New York: that added to a general misunderstanding of the nature Humanities Press. This 30-page introduction to the book of African ways of life. Such facile explanations of provides the essential information about Plessy v.

African religion do not deal with the ethical and moral Ferguson. The documentation that follows contains personal letters and legal briefs that are invaluable to an complexity of Africans’ beliefs about their relation-in-depth understanding of the case.

ship to the universe, the community, the living and Thomas, Brook. (1997). Plessy v. Ferguson: A Brief History dead, and the supernatural. Furthermore, there are with Documents. Boston: Bedford Books. This is an excel-numerous religious expressions that must be consid-lent source of information on the Plessy v. Ferguson case, ered as a part of the equation when trying to determine which provides both a concise historical overview of the the nature of African religion.

case and the nuances of the legal arguments.

*In fact, just as the Christians have several denominations, the Jews several expressions of Judaism, and the Muslims several types of Islam, Africans have **POPULAR TRADITIONAL AFRICAN***

*many expressions of PTARE. Although there are many forms of PTARE—such as those seen in Yoruba, **RELIGIONS EVERYWHERE (PTARE)***

Efik, Ibibio, Shona, Ga, Ewe, and so on—the religion is singular.

PTARE, the acronym for Popular Traditional African

— Molefi Kete Asante

*Religions Everywhere, expresses that all African traditional religions have similar conceptualizations and **FURTHER READING***

are fundamentally ways of life. PTARE was coined during the early 1990s in the writings of the Temple Blyden, Edward W. (1992). Christianity, Islam, and the Afrocentric Circle, which included Molefi Kete African Race. San Francisco: First African Arabian Press.

Asante, Kariamu Welsh, C. T. Keto, Ama Mazama, This is an enormous work by one of the great African thinkers and contains the best treatment of the role of two Nah Dove, and others. Since few words exist in any world religions and their interpenetration of Africa.

African language for religion, it was not possible to Kenyatta, Jomo. (1962). Facing Mt. Kenya. New York: discover one word for all the traditions; therefore Random House. No work has yet appeared to equal this scholars came up with PTARE to cover the common-straightforward presentation of the life of the Kikuyu in alities in all of the African religions.

Kenya. This is a standard work for understanding African Whether one is Yoruba, Ibo, Zulu, or Congo, one traditions.

has certain basic values that are seen throughout Mbiti, John. African Philosophy and Religion. (1990).

African experiences. For example, all African people London: Heinemann. This is the most quoted book on African religion in the contemporary era. Although Mbiti have a notion of a first deity, a creator deity, who is was a Christian minister when he wrote the book, it has beyond all other spirits

and ancestors. In addition, all maintained its position as a classic and has been translated African religions have a strong belief in reverence for into many languages.

*ancestors. Most African religions place emphasis on nature spirits and have prohibitions or taboos against certain violations of the natural order. There is no concept of guilt in PTARE, but there is a developed **PROTEST PRESSURE***

concept of shame, because instead of an individual emphasis most African religions have a group or com-Protest pressure refers to demonstrative, rhetorical, munal emphasis when it comes to values and morality.

physical, and political actions taken by Africans to Westerners conceptualize religion in Africa merely reject enslavement, discrimination, racism, and preju-as rituals involving “fetishes,” that is, objects believed dice. Protest pressure may be thought of as having

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 402

402—— The Psychopathic Racial Personality

started with the slave revolts prior to the Civil War and Protest pressure has most often been brought to continuing into the 21st century.

bear in the two directions of economics and culture.

In the field of Black Studies, scholars study protest Economic radicalism has been concerned with devel-pressure emanating from individual and collective oping boycotts and other forms of economic sabotage organizations. Articulated primarily through political on racist institutions. Cultural radicalism has directed and physical actions, protest pressure is meant to create its efforts to cultural institutions such as schools, tension within the social structures that support white churches, social agencies, and arts and cultural insti-racial domination of African people. Protest pressure tutions. In the end, the African American community evolved during the 17th century as African people has used protest pressure when necessary to demand began to protest against the abuse, disrespect, and

*Black Studies, women's rights, youth justice, and an violence of whites.
After the end of the Civil War and end to racial profiling of motorists.*

the brief period of the Reconstruction, Africans were

— Molefi Kete Asante

*viciously attacked by many white Southerners whose claim to racial
superiority had been called into question* **FURTHER READING**

*by the Civil War and the subsequent rise of African American legislators in
the South. The Ku Klux Klan Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). Erasing Racism:
The Survival of (KKK) was founded in the late 19th century as the reac-the
American Nation. Buffalo, NY: Prometheus Books.*

This book seeks to outline the main contours of the march tionary arm of
the proponents of white supremacy.

toward African American freedom by showing the long dis-It was not long
after the creation of the KKK that the tance that has already been traveled
and suggesting how African American community began organizing against
protest pressure might bring about a renewal of energy the racist group. In
1909, the National Association for toward reparations.

the Advancement of Colored People (NAACP) was Hilliard, Asa. (1998).
SBA: The Reawakening of the African formed and quickly became one of
the dominant orga-Mind. Gainesville, FL: Makare. This book demonstrates
nizations to bring protest pressure against racism. Soon that African
Americans can achieve greater satisfaction after World War I, the African
population began to use with struggles against racism by arriving at greater
consciousness through African cultural principles and values.

large street demonstrations to express censure of dis-Meier, August,
Rudwick, Elliott, and Broderick, Francis L.

crimination. By the end of World War II, this strategy (1965). *Black Protest
Thought in the Twentieth Century.*

had gained widespread use and the increase in the Indianapolis, IN: Bobbs-Merrill. This is one of the standard expertise of the organizers meant that a demonstration works in black protest thought. It is a compilation of the could be called immediately.

best works of the early part of the 20th century.

Protest pressure has two characteristics: (1) the threat of violence and (2) the moral legitimacy of free speech. It is because of these two qualities that

THE PSYCHOPATHIC

demonstrations such as those led by Martin Luther King, Jr., during the civil rights era were so success-

RACIAL PERSONALITY

ful. African Americans had learned from A. Philip Randolph, the founder of the Brotherhood of Sleeping Car Porters, that protest pressure could be a valuable of essays written by Bobby Wright, a University of asset to the struggle for full liberation.

Chicago psychologist, and published by Third World Active propaganda against racism appeared in Press in 1982, two years after Wright's death. Wright the early 20th century as a form of literate warfare.

used his training and skills in the best interest of black Writers like W.E.B. Du Bois, Ida B. Wells, and Carter people. He took a scientific approach in *The Psycho-G. Woodson made it their business to agitate for racial pathic Racial Personality by outlining the psychoso-equality and social justice. Soon direct action, a form cial characteristics of Western society in relation to of protest pressure that involved physical action such racism, methodically addressing the areas of governas sitting at counters that were ostensibly segregated, ment, military tactics, science, the medical commu-sitting in the front of buses that did not permit African nity, religion, and education.*

people to sit in front seats, and physically occupying Wright coined the term *mentacide*, which he offices and buildings, became the most prevalent way defined as the deliberate and systematic destruction of of bringing pressure on racist institutions.

a group's minds with the ultimate objective being the

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 403

Push———403

extirpation of the group. The solutions Wright offered for the African community included the creation of a **PUSH**

black social theory and the fulfillment of the obligation of African intellectuals to perform black scientific PUSH is the acronym used first for People United to inquiry (i.e., the study of white supremacy and cul-Save Humanity, and later for People United to Serve ture, not the oppressed of such culture). He believed in Humanity. As the founder and President of Operation: the necessity of reestablishing black culture, and that PUSH, Reverend Jesse Jackson began this national a black social theory would establish and institution-civil rights organization in Chicago on December 25, alize methods and a direction for the liberation of 1971. The main thrust of Operation PUSH was to African people.

enhance the living conditions of working and poor The essays in *The Psychopathic Racial Personality* black people by helping them obtain economic power.

include "Black Suicide," "Educating the Black Child,"

In March of 1972, a regional office was opened in and "The Black Child: A Destiny in Jeopardy." These New York, and later offices were opened in other essays reinforce the warning in the African proverb major cities.

Wright quotes: "If you don't know where you are The choice of December 25—with its religious going, any road will get you there." Wright's concern symbolism—for the inception of Operation PUSH

is that destruction will result for the black community was intentional and is characteristic of Jackson's lead-because it lacks direction and a black social theory: ership style, which is deeply rooted in his training as a

"Social theory determines the destiny of a people by Southern Baptist minister. It is impossible to separate establishing guidelines of life and Blacks should there-Jackson's charismatic and forceful personality from fore develop a Black Social Theory." The objective of Operation PUSH, as the two are deeply intertwined.

a black social theory is to recreate a black culture that Operation PUSH was Jackson's idea, and as a young will allow for the liberation of blacks as a people.

ambitious activist with the oratorical skills of a In the title essay of The Psychopathic Racial preacher and a belief in autocratic leadership, he Personality, Wright wrote that the answer to blacks'

became the main decision maker within the organiza-problems can be found in the works and lives of people tion. In the area of civil rights, he chose to change the like Chaka, Martin Delany, Marcus Garvey, H. Rap administrative strategy from nonviolence to militancy Brown, Malcolm X, Chancellor Williams, and others: for Operation PUSH. Less tolerant in his beliefs of

"For they all looked at the matador or psychopath for equality, Jackson leaned more toward social justice what he was and is, and moved against him."

and shared resources, in contrast to Martin Luther King Jr.'s philosophy of civil rights through nonviolent

— Ivory Achebe Toldson

demonstrations. Jackson publicly stated that under his direction, Operation: PUSH would embrace a philoso-FURTHER READING

phy of nonviolence if possible, but violence if needed.

*Akbar, Na'im. (1984). Chains and Images of Psychological Slavery. Jersey City, NJ: New Mind. This book demonstrates a distinct African American psychology originating **JESSE JACKSON'S LEADERSHIP***

in oppression.

Jackson was gifted at organizing boycotts and gained Ben-Jochannon, Yosef. (1972). Cultural Genocide in the Black national recognition as one of the top lieutenants within and African Studies Curriculum. New York: Alkebulan.

the Southern Christian Leadership Conference (SCLC).

This was one of the earliest attempts to discuss the nature of curricula prior to the Black Studies revolution; the book He had become the director of Operation Breadbasket brought attention to the issues of race, culture, and class in (1966–1971), an economic arm of the SCLC, and had the curriculum.

worked closely with King. Effecting change through Fanon, Frantz. (1967). Black Skin, White Masks. New York: boycotts, demonstrations, and controlled consumer Grove Press. This is Fanon's penetrating and provocative spending, Operation Breadbasket was an economic analysis of how Africans can be disoriented by white movement designed to lessen the grubstake and domi-supremacist culture.

nance that major corporations had on black and under-Woodson, Carter G. (1933). The Mis-Education of the Negro.

Washington, DC: Associated Publishers. This is the classic served communities. Ironically, the word breadbasket work on the destruction of African American people by the is slang for stomach, and this endeavor was aimed at educational system.

restricting or tightening corporate profits.

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 404

However, Jackson's life changed on April 4, 1968, Operation PUSH. The importance of having political when Martin Luther King was assassinated in relationships directly with presidents or top ranking Memphis. The tragic death of the most recognized presidential aides to monitor national social and eco-African American civil rights leader startled the nomic policy affecting the living conditions of poor world. The movement for racial equality needed a new and working people could not be underestimated.

leader and immediate supervision to safeguard the President Richard Nixon's administration was known newly won rights in the areas of politics, social status, to be callous and unsympathetic to African American and economics. When Ralph D. Abernathy, Vice issues. This served to galvanize black leaders to orga-President of the SCLC and one of its founding nize picketing demonstrations. Jackson put aside any members, as well as a close activist friend of King's, philosophical and personal differences with Abernathy became King's successor, Jackson returned to and other black leaders to contribute staff from Chicago and began to distance himself from the orga-Operation PUSH in many demonstrations against nization. Jackson's complete break from the SCLC

Nixon's programs on welfare, education, and came later, however, when Jackson worked with black children's rights. In March of 1972, there were over businessmen in the Chicago area to organize the 25,000 people (many of whom were children) at the fourth annual Black Expo under the auspices of demonstration in Washington, D.C., against Nixon's Operation PUSH instead of SCLC, its prior sponsor.

proposed \$2,400 a year supplement for a needy family In December of 1971 he was chastised by Abernathy of four—instead of the \$6,500 recommended by the with a 60-day suspension for “administrative impro-coalition of national black leaders. When President priety” and “repeated violation of organizational dis-Gerald R. Ford took office, he immediately arranged cipline.” He later resigned from SCLC to devote all of a series of meetings with black leaders to improve the his attention to Operation PUSH.

White House's communication with the black community. Strongly committed to the picketing and demonstration. Jackson's Operation PUSH was just one of the strategies so successful in Operation Breadbasket, civil rights groups encouraged by the optimism of Jackson used the same model for Operation PUSH

the new president. However, as top man at Operation with added divisions for housing, welfare, politics, PUSH, Jackson's defiant public image often hindered education, and youth affairs. He was aggressively per-his ability to be an effective political insider on a suasive at enlisting the support of major corporations national scale. On one occasion, he stood alone in his to hire African Americans and invest in black community charge of "callous neglect" against the administration nities by forewarning of possible boycotts and picket-of President Jimmy Carter in the area of full employing demonstrations. Burger King, 7-Up, Coca Cola, ment for all blacks. In direct contrast, other black Southland, Adolph Coors, Heublein, Avon, and leaders were more optimistic and agreed to be "mod-Montgomery Ward were some of the many corporate erate and reasonable" in their comments.

sponsors convinced by Jackson to take their corporate In 1985, Jackson broadened the scope of Operation responsibility within African American communities PUSH and turned his attention to problems in public seriously. However, later some of the corporate heads education by creating an affiliate group called Push complained that they had been coerced by Jackson for for Excellence (commonly called PUSH-EXCEL).

financial contributions. Yet, even with millions of The goal was to upgrade the quality of education on a dollars contributed to Operation PUSH in federal national scale, with an emphasis on building teenagers'

grants and corporate funding, there were still admin-self-esteem. Jackson was very active in visiting schools istrative problems that plagued the organization. The across the country and speaking to students to promote accusations of financial mismanagement and poor self-esteem and self-discipline. A campaign of getting bookkeeping resulted in federal audits and civil signed pledges of parental involvement was one of the claims being brought against the organization.

strategies employed by Jackson to increase students'

*commitment to learning. However, in spite of having the support of the media and the federal government, **THE POLITICAL AGENDA***

and of having been granted a 3-year funding grant Jackson was well aware that keeping a vigil on pro-from the National Institute of Education of the gram and policy development in the White House and Department of Health, Education and Welfare, PUSH-Congress was important to the economic goals of EXCEL did not sustain its luster. Racial tension,

P-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:01 PM Page 405

Push———405

neighborhood politics, mismanagement, and federal the merger of Operation PUSH and the National auditing problems rendered the program ineffective.

Rainbow Coalition into one organization called the When Jackson made a bid for the presidency in Rainbow PUSH Action Network, or the Network. He 1984 and in 1988, without the endorsement of many vowed that the merger would strengthen the ability to black political leaders and without adequate financial effect change in the lives of working and poor people resources, the political infrastructure of Operation on a local and national level.

PUSH became a vital component in his campaign.

— Gloria Grant Roberson

Voter registration drives gathered a large population of Jackson supporters. However, during the campaign, federal auditing of Operation PUSH and PUSH

FURTHER READING

EXCEL yielded profound inconsistencies in the Collins, Sheila D. (1986). From Melting Pot to Rainbow administrative structure of the organization,

and in Coalition: The Future of Race in American Politics.

newspaper interviews, PUSH officials were critical of New York: Monthly Review Press. This is a well-balanced Jackson. There was some concern that Jackson's assessment of Jackson within the political and social environment of the United States.

political aspirations could cripple the legitimacy of House, Ernest R. (1988). Jessie Jackson and the Politics of the organization.

Charisma: The Rise and Fall of the PUSH/Excel Program.

In 1985, Jackson announced the formation of the Boulder, CO: Westview Press. House gives a historical National Rainbow Coalition, and in 1996, 25 years overview of Reverend Jackson's Operation PUSH and its after the beginning of Operation PUSH, he announced evolution into PUSH/Excel.

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 407

R

*As avid readers of the Christian scriptures, **RASTAFARIANISM***

Rastafarians have reinterpreted the Bible in light of present-day Caribbean reality. The bitter experience Rastafarianism or Rastafari is an Africa-centered of the Israelites under Egyptian and later Babylonian religion in which the Emperor Haile Selassie captivity is, for example, understood as a metaphor for (1892–1975) is revered as the black messiah. The modern-day African slavery in the West. Babylon, in religion draws its name from the emperor's pre-Rastafarian parlance, therefore refers to the capitalist coronation name, Ras Tafari Makonnen. Ras literally West, while its opposite, the Promised Land or Zion, means "head" in Amharic and is equivalent to the alludes to the ancient African nation of Ethiopia.

*English title of duke, thus Ras Tafari Makonnen means Duke Tafari, the son of Makonnen. Followers of Rastafarianism are known as Rastafarians, Rastas, **CUSTOMS***

Sufferers, Locksmen, Dreads, or Dreadlocks, with As a religion, Rastafari has its own rituals and cus-the last three names referring to the unique braided toms, most of them derived from scripture, that gov-hairstyle with which the group is associated.

*ern the day-to-day life of its adherents. A strict dietary law, which is the basis of Ital cooking, prevents members from eating beef and pork and from using **REGGAE'S MESSAGE***

factory made preservatives, including salt. Alcohol is Rastafarianism emerged in Jamaica in the 1930s. With outlawed, while the consumption of tea and coffee is the advent of reggae music, which was popularized also discouraged since they are factory processed. On by Rastafarians in the 1960s and 1970s, the movement the other hand, Rastas invoke Psalm 104:14 to lend became an international phenomenon, especially legitimacy to the practice of smoking marijuana or among disaffected youth and disenfranchised groups.

ganja: "He causeth the grass to grow for the cattle, and The failure of mainstream church groups to address herb for the service of man that he may bring forth the fundamentals of modern-day racial and economic food out of the earth."

woes, the ever-increasing polarization of the world Because of the conventional perception of mari-between the haves and the have-nots, the pervasive juana as a mind-altering drug, Rastafarians are nature of Western neocolonialism, the violent urban maligned by mainstream media as indulgent cultists.

backlash against third world immigrants, and finally, According to defenders of the faith, however, Rasta-reggae musician Bob Marley's simple but powerful farians use marijuana not as a recreational drug but lyrics on behalf of the voiceless, can be cited as some only for religious purposes or as aid in their medita-of the reasons for the transformation of Rastafari into tional rituals. They hasten to add, moreover, that the a worldwide protest movement.

harm associated with ganja consumption is much less 407

408——**Rastafarianism**

than that of alcohol and cigarettes, both of which are at their lowest. Since the Berlin conference of 1884, multibillion dollar industries in the West despite their Africa had been partitioned among European powers well-known side effects.

and, given the latter's superior military force, few Rastafarians, many of whom are self-employed as expected colonialism to be a short-term affair. In the artists, musicians, peddlers, and so on, are generally United States, likewise, the 1890s marked the worst nonviolent and law abiding. But since most of them setback in the postbellum struggle for racial equality.

live in lower-class neighborhoods, and since the high In 1896, the same year in which the Adwan legend rate of unemployment in such neighborhoods gives was born, the Supreme Court used the infamous rise to a high level of crime and homicide, Rastafarians Plessy v. Ferguson case to defend the ideology of in their dreadlocks and green-gold-and-red tricolor white supremacy, or de jure segregation, in the name often become ideal targets for police harassment and of "separate but equal" philosophy.

undue search and seizure. Such treatment has in turn Against these backdrops of colonialism and second-reinforced Rastafarian suspicion of government author-class citizenship, Ethiopia's military triumph over a ities as well as bolstered their commitment to repatri-European foe signified an imminent racial resurgence, ation to Africa, especially Ethiopia.

*and the far off country became henceforth an icon of freedom and a source of racial self-reassurance for Africans everywhere. Adwan mythology rendered East **COSMOLOGY***

Africa a central place in modern black thought, and Ethiopia's importance in Rastafarian cosmology has Ethiopianism in this regard became the direct harbin-its roots in the concept of Ethiopianism. Ethiopianism ger of 20th-century nationalist expressions, among refers to ideas based on the reading of selected scrip-them Garveyism, pan-Africanism, and Rastafarianism.

tural texts and Western classics from which were forged a sense of collective historical consciousness.

*Scriptural and Homeric positive presentations of **JAMAICAN ROOTS***

Ethiopia, which sharply contrasted with the Euro-American perception of Africans as heathen and To understand why Rastafarianism first took root savage, provided the means for a celebratory self-in Jamaica, it is necessary to take into account the identification. In literary texts such as the King James history of Jamaica's defiant past. The maroon wars Bible and the Hellenic epics, Ethiopia is not just a of the 1700s, the Christmas uprising of enslaved generic name for Africa but conjures up a powerful Africans in 1831, and the Morant Bay Rebellion of mythology that became the basis of 19th-century 1865 are but a few landmark examples of the island's black liberation discourse.

heroic resistance to exploitation and second-class cit-The Ethiopian Baptist Church in Jamaica was izenship. In addition to this is Jamaica's rich history of founded in 1783 by George Liele, a formerly enslaved revivalism, most of it associated with enslavement and preacher from Savannah, Georgia. The first indepen-African influences. Many 19th-century Jamaican dent black churches in the Americas also identified revivalist groups synchronized Christianity with such themselves with the Ethiopian tradition by using African religious practices as spirit mounting and names that had direct reference to Africa. By the early trance dancing, as well as with their beliefs in sorcery 19th century, several independent churches, such as and the medicine man. Out of this fusion were born the Abyssinian Baptist Church of New York, were expressions of worship indigenous to Jamaica, includ-flourishing in the United States. By the second half ing Myalism, Pokumina, and Kumina.

of the 19th century, a separatist religious tradition, Some of the revivalist groups produced charismatic known as the Ethiopian Church movement, had sprung leaders of messianic proportions. In 1895, Alexander up in southern and western Africa, suggesting once Bedward, a 36-year-old Jamaican Baptist preacher, again the universalist appeal of Ethiopianism as an gained wide notoriety for his outspoken denounce-expression of pan-African nationalism.

ment of the white establishment. His incendiary racial Emperor Menelik's victory over Italy at Adwa in rhetoric, which pitted him against the authorities, 1896 further elevated the concept of Ethiopianism.

spread across the island, making Bedward a champion The news of the Adwan victory came at a time when of the downtrodden. Allegedly imbued with prophetic African and African American political fortunes were and healing powers, during the next two decades

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 409

Bedward became the most popular Baptist minister in claimed was a direct reference to Haile Selassie: “And Jamaica. However, when his supernatural powers I saw a strong angel proclaiming with a loud voice: failed to materialize, Bedward’s own growing ambi-

‘Who is worthy to open the scroll and break its seven tion resulted in his final undoing in 1920. This, how-seals?’ . . . Then one of the elders said unto me, ever, did not end the peasantry’s hunger for a

‘Weep not, lo, the lion of the tribe of Judah, the root messianic hero. In the 1930s, many ex-Bedwardites of David, has conquered so that he can open the scroll would find refuge for their eschatological beliefs in and its seven seals’” (Rev. 2:2–5). These verses were the fledgling religion of Rastafarianism.

juxtaposed with Psalm 87:4 as further proof that For Caribbean people in general, from 1910 into Ethiopia was the Holy Land and Haile Selassie the the early 1920s was a time of unprecedented popula-long-awaited redeemer: “I will make mention of tion shift, sparked by the economic boom in the Rahab and Babylon to them that know me: behold United States. A radical religious text that was intro-Philistia, and Tyre, with Ethiopia; this man was born duced to Jamaica during this period, together with the there.”

mass flow of goods and ideas from North America, Italy’s unprovoked aggression in Ethiopia in 1935, was the Holy Piby, a black supremacist version of the which instantly turned the far off country into a racial Bible. First appearing in the East Coast in the early cause célébré, provided the optimal environment for 1920s, the Holy Piby reached the English Caribbean the spread of Rastafari in the nearby islands.

by 1925. A year later it was followed by the Jamaican Similarly, Jamaican migration to New York and publication of the “Royal Parchment Scrolls of Black England after World War II resulted in the group’s Supremacy,” much

of whose millennial ethos would expansion overseas. In the mid-1950s, the Ethiopian became the basis of Rastafarianism.

government allocated several hundred acres of land near the southern town of Shashemene for would-be black settlers from the West. News of the land grant **ETHIOPIA'S SIGNIFICANCE TO RASTAFARIANS**

on the one hand, and the continuous persecution of the The first decades of the 20th century also saw the Dreads by the Jamaican police on the other, revived revival of the Back-to-Africa movement under the the theme of repatriation as the movement's top prior-leadership of the legendary Marcus Garvey. Contrary ity. In 1961, a sympathetic publication on the to popular folklore, there is no record of Garvey hav-Rastafarian plight by three university professors ing made a prophecy about the coming of a race lib-resulted in Prime Minister Norman Manley's decision erator in the form of an African monarch. In the late to launch a fact-finding mission to five African 1930s, in fact, Garvey published a series of articles countries. After visiting the countries in question, accusing Haile Selassie of cowardice for fleeing to including Ethiopia, the mission produced its report, England instead of fighting the Italians at home. In which showed the African governments' relative recep-November of 1930, however, the UNIA (Universal tivity to a process of selective migration. Alexander Negro Improvement Association) leader hailed the Bustamante, Manley's successor, showed no similar coronation of Haile Selassie as a historic moment. In social sensitivity, however, and the question of repatria tribute befitting the occasion, Garvey described ation never received serious attention again.

Haile Selassie as a visionary and progressive king, Hoping the occasion would provide an opportunity and summoned all blacks to work with him for the to dispel the myth of Haile Selassie's divinity, betterment of Ethiopia and the African race.

Jamaican officials welcomed with enthusiasm his Out of the synthesis of Bedwardism, Garveyism, 1966 visit to their country. Little did they expect that the Holy Piby, and Ethiopian symbolism thus grew the circumstances, such as the extensive coverage in the interpretation of the 1930 coronation of Ras Tafari media of the imperial pomp and circumstance, Makonnen—

henceforth Emperor Haile Selassie, King people's tumultuous outpouring of love and adulation, of Kings, Select of God, the Conquering Lion of the and incidents like the drastic weather change that Tribe of Judah—as the fulfillment of scriptural accompanied Haile Selassie's entry into Kingston, prophecy. To that effect, Rasta doctrinaires found in would help re-entrench the monarch's divine aura and, the Bible several verses that supposedly corroborated in so doing, give the movement its greatest momen-their perception of Haile Selassie as the messiah.

tum since the 1930s. Inspired in part by the 1966 royal Among them was what the Jamaican ideologues visit and in part by Bob Marley's rise to international

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 410

410——Rastafarianism

stardom, between the late 1960s and the mid-1970s, Rasta loyalists, for whom Haile Selassie's divinity Rastafarianism experienced its fastest growth, making is nonnegotiable, the church holds a positive meaning it a factor in the 1972 election of Michael Manley, the because of its image as a repository of ancient wisdom son of Norman Manley, into the office of prime and history. The offering of Amharic classes, the minister in Jamaica.

issuance of Ethiopian baptismal names, and the cele-Despite its unheralded cultural and artistic suc-bration of Ethiopian holidays such as the new year and cesses on the world stage, from the mid-1970s on, Epiphany, are but a few reasons why many Sufferers Rastafarianism found itself on the defensive regarding feel socially drawn to the apostolic church.

its belief in Haile Selassie's divinity and its commitment to repatriation. The ousting of Haile Selassie by **A CROSS-CULTURAL MOVEMENT**

a Marxist junta in the midst of a cataclysmic famine contradicted the Caribbean image of Ethiopia as the Despite the recent acceptance of whites into the move-Promised Land or the new Zion. Following the death ment, the centrality of racial themes remains in of the emperor while in prison, some Rastas con-Rastafari, since most of its members are, after all, cluded

that Haile Selassie represented not the second people of African stock. What this racial inclusion coming of Christ but only his human manifestation.

implies is the growing awareness among the younger With this, they rejected the eschatological preoccupa-generation of Rastafarians of the interconnectedness of tions of Rastafari and explained their loyalty to the the oppressed, whether their experience of oppression movement in terms of its pan-African dimension.

has been on account of race, class, or gender. A striking Similarly, the rhetoric of repatriation notwithstanding-development in the recent history of Rastafarianism ing, the number of those who have resettled in is therefore its ongoing transformation into a cross-Ethiopia has remained negligible, a couple hundred at cultural movement, in which reggae music has become most. Sectarianism, personality differences, divisive one of the most eloquent voices of protest not just politics, and logistical hurdles have prevented the land against white supremacy but also against the vices and grant project from becoming what its founders had excesses of the postindustrial world.

hoped for: a self-reliant model community. This set-

— Fikru Gebrekidan

back has prompted the reexamination and redefinition of certain Rastafarian beliefs. The mottoes “repatria-FURTHER READING

tion is a must” and “Babylon is foreign” are no longer taken literally. Travels through the African world have Barrett, Leonard E. (1988). The Rastafarians: Sounds of Cultural Dissonance. Boston: Beacon Press. Since the made Rastas aware that African countries, including completion of his dissertation on Rastafarianism in 1968, Ethiopia, are not immune to the types of social evils Leonard Barrett has been North America’s pioneering that have plagued the capitalist West. Moreover, since student of Rastafari. Although Barrett embraces a millenar-the Shashemene experiment where Rastafarians were ian-centered explanation, his extensive field work in repatriated to Ethiopia had shown the impracticality Kingston and his use

of local informants make this work of wholesale migration, repatriation is now seen as both authoritative and comprehensive.

a process of psychological transformation. Ethiopia Campbell, Horace. (1987). Rasta and Resistance: From is now as much a state of mind as it is a spot on the Marcus Garvey to Walter Rodney. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. In contrast to Barrett's religious-oriented map; it symbolizes a cultural reorientation, a spiritual analysis, Campbell presents a Marxist interpretation of reconnectedness with ancient roots.

Rastafarianism. He argues that Rastafarianism, although One means by which such psychological self-couched in religious and racial rhetoric, represents the redefinition has been made possible for individuals is Jamaican version of working-class consciousness, which through conversion to the Ethiopian Orthodox Church identifies itself in terms of Africa and African values in (EOC). It has been a half century since this indigenous opposition to the local aristocracy and its Western mode of African Church established branches throughout the thinking.

Murrell, Nathaniel S., Spencer, William David, and West Indies. The EOC is seen by the Sufferers as fill-McFarlane, Adrian Anthony (Eds.). (1998). Chanting in a cultural void created by centuries of slavery and Down Babylon: The Rastafari Reader. Philadelphia: forced separation from Africa and, as such, it provides Temple University Press. The essays in this book engage in a unique sociocultural and religious context for those a multifaceted interrogation of Rastafarianism. Included trying to reconnect with their ancestral past. Even to are sociological, historical, geographical, and gender-based

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 411

Red Summer———411

analyses of Rastafarianism that reveal the depth and breadth serving the interest of blacks in the South. Also, there of the movement.

were a number of blacks who were elected to the state Smith, M. G., Augier, Roi, and Nettleford, Rex. (1960). The legislatures, several who were elected

to the U.S.

Rastafari Movement in Kingston, Jamaica. Mona, Jamaica: House of Representatives, and two who were senators.

University College of the West Indies Institute of Social and Much has been written about the so-called domination Economic Research. Written by three university professors when the movement was still in its infancy, this classic work of African American politicians during Reconstruction.

not only places the movement in Jamaican sociohistorical Even the film The Birth of a Nation promoted this context but also recommends ameliorative measures to myth. In reality, there were only two African Americans improve the life of the working poor and diffuse the sim-who served in the Senate, Hiram Revels and Blanche mering urban tension that was thought to have given rise to K. Bruce. Both men, quite interestingly, were from the Rastafarian movement. The 1961 Jamaican mission to Mississippi. From 1868 to 1895, 23 African Americans Africa, in the effort to investigate the feasibility of migra-served in the House of Representatives. But the resis-tion, was inspired by the findings of this study.

tance to their presence in the House from white Southerners was fierce, and while many of the representatives had their property stolen and their lives threatened, several were in fact killed.

RECONSTRUCTION

The Reconstruction period lasted a shorter time than the civil rights era. It is heralded as a great moment in Reconstruction is the term given to the period after the American history, but it is also a period that was ripe for Civil War, from 1865 to 1877, when the U.S. govern-harvesting a better future for the nation. It did not suc-ment sought to reconstruct the lives and property of the ceed in this. After the Union troops were pulled out of people in the South. Africans who had served for 246

the South in 1877, there was wholesale terrorizing of years in bondage came out of the enslavement with blacks in the South. In addition, it was not until nearly optimism. Whites who had fought against the Union a hundred

years later, in the 1960s, that Congress revisited the struggle defeated and dejected. The idea of a law to protect the voting rights of African Americans was the aim of the reconstruction was to create a new Southern Americans. Indeed, the 1960s was the period that spirit, born out of patriotism and common goals.

advanced the African American agenda toward reconstruction. Supporters of Reconstruction in Congress wanted reconstruction. Thus, reconstruction is an ongoing process.

the military to have stronger powers to govern the

— Molefi Kete Asante

South. They wanted African Americans to have full citizenship rights. They were concerned with protecting **FURTHER READING**

the lives of blacks from Southern white vengeance. It was important to the progressive members of Congress Du Bois, W. E. B. (1996). *The Souls of Black Folk*. New York: that every newly freed African have all the assistance Modern Library. (Original work published 1903). This necessary to establish a reasonable life.

classic book detailed the life experiences of African Americans and made Du Bois one of the greatest inter-Of course, there was great resistance in Congress to the interests of the black population just after Reconstruction.

this idea, and few of the more liberal proposals were Du Bois, W. E. B. (1999). *Black Reconstruction in America*, passed. Those that did pass Congress often passed with 1860–1880. New York: Free Press. (Original work published 1934). This is the best book written on Reconstruction since Abraham Lincoln's vice president, was not considered and was Du Bois's major work on the era.

considered a friend of the African people. He proved to be Stampp, Kenneth M. (1967). *The Era of Reconstruction*, a thorn in the side of Reconstruction.

Johnson granted 1865– 1877. New York: Random House. This is the most popular history on the period of Reconstruction.

*early pardons to some of the worst Confederate offend-ers of African American rights. The Reconstructionists in Congress sought to introduce bills that removed certain provisions favoring white Southerners, but Johnson vetoed all of the bills containing those **RED SUMMER***

changes.

Nevertheless, the Freedmen's Bureau was estab-What became known as the Red Summer took place in lished and for 7 years was a very effective organization the summer and fall of 1919 when race riots erupted

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 412

*412——**Reggae***

between African Americans and European Americans incident quickly spread throughout the county and as in over 25 U.S. cities. The word red in Red Summer far as Mississippi. Hundreds of whites armed with refers to the blood shed throughout the United States guns began a shooting rampage with the order to kill during the riots. In every instance, the riots were the any black person in sight. By the end of the 3-day result of some form of violence inflicted on Africans riot, the official count of the dead was 5 whites by Europeans. The Red Summer epitomized blacks'

and 25 blacks; however, some reports say that as resistance to white supremacist violence against them.

many as 200 blacks were killed during the riot. During Lynchings and mob violence against Africans had the Red Summer, riots also occurred in Harlem, long been occurring (especially in the South).

New York; Washington, D.C.; Cleveland, Ohio; However, the Red Summer was different because Knoxville, Tennessee; Longview and Gregg counties Africans were fighting back in a more strong and in Texas; and several other Southern towns.

organized fashion. Claude McKay captured the

— Rico X

*African perspective on the Red Summer in his poem If We Must Die when he wrote, “Like men we’ll face **FURTHER READING***

the murderous, cowardly pack/Pressed to the wall, dying, but fighting back!”

Asante, Molefi Kete. (2003). Erasing Racism: The Survival of There were several factors that prompted the explo-the American Nation. Amherst, NY: Prometheus Books.

sion of race riots during the summer of 1919. First, the This book has an extensive section dealing with lynching in the American nation during the 20th century.

migration of large numbers of African people to Harding, Vincent. (1981). *There is a River: The Black Struggle* Northern cities caused racial tensions. Thousands of *for Freedom in America*. New York: Harcourt, Brace and black workers began to compete with white workers Jovanovich. This is a major work that chronicles the history for factory jobs. Second, since 1915 there had been of African American resistance to enslavement and perse-a sudden surge of lynchings (in both the North and cution.

South). Many attribute this to the influence of the Tuttle, William. (1970). *Race Riot: Chicago in the Red* movie *The Birth of a Nation*, which depicted Africans *Summer of 1919*. New York: Atheneum. This is a historical account of the riots of the Red Summer.

as uneducated savages and rapists of white women.

www.geocities.com/Hayesportfolio/Red_Summer.htm This Web After the movie opened, lynchings increased and Ku site gives a broad overview of the Red Summer.

Klux Klan memberships quadrupled. With the surge in racial violence, the call for African resistance and self-defense increased. Third, as blacks began to organize themselves and establish their own independent communities,

whites felt threatened and sought to suppress this growing power through mob violence.

Reggae is a unique, exceptional, and infectious music. The bloodiest incidents of the Red Summer can be traced to the creativity that developed out of the events that occurred in Chicago, Illinois, and Elaine, Arkansas.

African Americans during the early 1970s. It is a distinctive artistic musical style centered on its captive black youth who were drowned for mistakenly swimming in 2/4 downbeat syncopated rhythm pattern that is on the white side of a local beach. Fighting broke out created by a passionately played electric base guitar, between whites and blacks after the police refused to drums, and organ or electric piano. Also, the reggae arrested the men involved in the drowning. The Chicago riot stresses the offbeat, afterbeat, or back-to-front race riot lasted for 5 days. In its aftermath, some boogie, instead of the usual 1/3 in 4/4 time.

23 blacks and 15 whites were killed, more than 500

people were injured, and 1,000 black families were **ORIGINS AND EARLY DAYS**

left homeless. The riot in Elaine, Arkansas, occurred that same year during the first 3 days of October. On September 30, a group of black men and women met expression, was influenced and nurtured by earlier at a local church to organize a farmer's union. Some musical styles. The musical styles that directly influenced time during the meeting, two white police officers ended reggae were African American jazz of the interrupted the meeting and gunshots were exchanged.

1940s and 1950s and the rhythm and blues (R&B) As a result, one of the officers was killed. Word of this soul of the 1960s, developed by ingenious musicians

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 413

Reggae——413

such as Dizzy Gillespie, Sarah Vaughan, Nat King testament to their ingenuity and their will to survive Cole, Aretha Franklin, James Brown, Curtis Mayfield and achieve—to bare the worst and make something and the Impression, and the creators of the Motown good out of it. It has been said that some of the best sound. In addition, Jamaica's authentic musical musical and artistic expressions can come out of the sounds, in the Revival Zion Christianity, Mento, Ska, worst suffering. Many Jamaicans who suffered and and Rocksteady musical genres of the early 1950s into paid their dues were driven by their raw talent to the 1960s, gave reggae its offbeat 2/4 time, its swift become impressive reggae musicians. Some of those and easy dancing pace, and the synchronized artists were Jimmy Cliff, Joe Gibbs, Dennis Brown, polyrhythms that expressed its African Jamaican Abyssinians, U-Roy, Horace Andy, Bob Marley & the cultural identity. Examples of Mento, Ska, and Wailers, Gregory Isaacs, Big Youth, Sly Dunbar and Rocksteady musicians are Laurel Aitken, Jolly Boys, Robbie Shakespeare, Gladiators, and Beres Hammond.

Byron Lee, Don Drummond, Prince Buster, the Skatalites, Toots and the Maytals, the Heptones, **ON THE INTERNATIONAL MUSIC SCENE**

Ethiopians, Upsetters, Ken Boothe, Derrick Morgan, Marcia Griffith, the Wailers, and others.

In the 1970s, a critical turn was made to cause reggae The word *reggae* was first mentioned in a 1968

to expand outside the boundary of Jamaica and onto recording by Toots and The Maytals in a song called an influential and international scene, taking up a

“Do the Reggay.” Initially, reggae lyrics concentrated position in world music that it has maintained to this on romantic themes that were a direct reflection day. The increasing influence of the Rastafarian phi-of black Americans’ R&B soul top 20 recordings.

losophy, culture, and way of life on reggae initiated Eventually, reggae found its Jamaican creative music this critical turn. Rastafarians believe in the divinity of identity when Jamaican musicians started to write, Jah Ras Tafari (aka Haile Selassie), the philosophy of arrange, and produce their music. After Jamaicans won Marcus Mosiah Garvey, and their cultural connection their independence from the British on August 6, 1962, to the motherland Africa, especially Ethiopia.

they needed to express their freedom in an art form.

Rastafarianism gave reggae music the spiritual energy With the development of the reggae genre, they could to cover nearly every corner of the world. It is an listen to music on their outdoor sound systems and African diaspora music phenomenon for the reason radios that spoke in their vernacular and to the beat of that it can activate the listeners’ political awareness, their peculiar African Jamaican rhythm. However, the enhance their spiritual consciousness, and enlighten increasingly difficult political conditions in Jamaica, their African cultural perspective. Some of the artists and the developing black consciousness movement in who have performed the phenomenal music of Roots America that was spreading throughout the African Rasta Reggae are Ras Michael and the Sons of Negus, diaspora, spurred reggae musicians to sing fewer love Jacob Miller, Burning Spear, Black Uhuru, Aswad, songs and produce more gusty and socially conscious Steel Pulse, Third World, Culture, Augustus Pablo, lyrics that mirrored what was going on in the nexus of Mighty Diamonds, Rita Marley, Judy Mowatt, Bob their social and political environment.

Marley & the Wailers & the I-Three.

Coxsone Dodd’s Studio One and Lee “Scratch”

Perry’s Black Ark recording institutions allowed many **REGGAE’S
BRIGHTEST STARS**

of those progressive artists the freedom to have a political and spiritual voice that spoke to and for the down-The brightest international reggae star was Bob trodden and voiceless in Jamaica as well as globally.

Marley, with his fellow talented musical artists, the Relatively speaking, Jamaica's small Studio One and Wailers—Peter Tosh, Bunny Wailer, Aston "Family Black Ark were equal in spirit to Berry Gordy's Man" Barrett, Carlton Barrett, Tyrone Downie, Julian Motown in Detroit and Kenny Gamble and Leon

"Junior" Marvin, and Alvin "Seeco" Patterson—and Huff's Philly Soul Sound in Philadelphia, in terms of the I-Three—Marcia Griffith, Rita Marley, and Judy seeking, encouraging, and promoting young artists Mowatt. Marley's Roots and Conscious Reggae is from the rough countryside and tough streets who made up of sweet songs of black love, protest songs enhanced the world with their creativity, passion, and of black rebellion, powerful songs of black libera-talent for making exceptional music. Their creation tion, and sorrowful songs of black redemption, which of unique genres of black music is an outstanding use African Jamaican double entendre, metaphors,

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 414

414———**Reparations**

proverbs, parables, utterances, call-and-response, and Larkin, Colin. (1998). *The Virgin Encyclopedia of Reggae*.

biblical references to touch the spiritual and cultural London: Virgin Books. This is an excellent, complete, and ethos of people of African descent and others who can authoritative reference text that lists valuable data about musical artists who were responsible for the progress of feel what is in the music.

various forms of reggae music.

In the 1980s, other branches of reggae came www.bobmarley.com This is a mesmerizing and classic con-forward, including Dancehall, Lovers Rock,

Dub, cert by Bob Marley when he was at his creative apex inter-Smooth, and Contemporary. These styles were attrac-nationally. The musical event confirms his artistic status as tive to the new youth, but for many of the conscious the brightest morning and evening star of reggae—and black listeners, the new reggae styles lacked the spir-explains why he was crowned the king and a prophet of ituality, human depth, and the African centeredness reggae music.

of Roots Reggae. Rasta Renaissance artists and musicians—Ziggy Marley & the Melody Makers, Dean Frazier, Mutabaruka, Israel Vibration, Morgan Heritage Family, Luciano, Sizzla, Capleton, Anthony **REPARATIONS**

B., Buju Banton, Sister Carol, and others—answered the call for more political, cultural, and spiritual reg-The issue of reparations, historically considered a fringe gae. During the 1990s and into the 21st century, they issue in the American black nationalist community, is have performed with a political and spiritual mindset now the inspiration of a firmly established movement similar to that of their mentors by singing thought-among various constituencies in the United States as provoking and Rastafarian spirituality–inspired lyrics.

well as in African communities around the world. The Their music has a positive and uplifting message in ascendancy of the reparations movement as an impor-critical times. The music of brilliant African reggae tant social movement—clearly the most important since performers such as Lucky Dube from South Africa, the civil rights era—is confirmed by the amount of print Alpha Blondy from Cote d’Ivoire, Fela Kuti from space and airtime the media devote to it. Though the Nigeria (with his reggae-style Juju Afro-Beat), and movement is picking up speed, compensatory measures others reflects the fact that reggae has made a for Africans have been hard to institute because of the full circle by returning to the rhythms of the continent entrenchment of white supremacy in world politics that of Africa from its starting place of phenomenally provides legal sanction for the enslavement of Africans, creative Jamaicans in the African diaspora.

even though it was clearly a crime against humanity.

Africans around the world have watched groups such

— *Ibo Changa*

as the Japanese, Jews, and others receive reparations for government-sanctioned crimes against them, while **FURTHER READING**

eyebrows are raised and arguments dismissed as non-Barrow, Steve, and Dalton, Peter. (2001) . *The Rough Guide to* sensical when similar justice for Africans and their *Reggae*. London: Rough Guides. This is a comprehensive descendants is requested. It is clear that making repara-look at the musical recording industry in Jamaica from tions not only is a common occurrence but is firmly 1950 to 2000.

rooted in international law that the United States recog-Bradley, Lloyd. (2000). *This is Reggae Music—The Story of* nizes. It is also important to note that while many view *Jamaica's Music*. New York: Grove Press. Bradley pre-reparations as a radical solution to addressing a histori-sents an in-depth historical probe into reggae, which high-cal wrong, conservative heads of state (e.g., former pres-lights the factors that contributed to the development and ident Ronald Reagan) have endorsed reparations for intense energy of reggae.

Henzell, Perry (Writer/Director), and Rhone, Trevor D.

victims of crimes against humanity.

(Writer). (1973). *The Harder They Come* [Film]. United States, Jamaica: Criterion Collection. This is recognized as the first movie that placed reggae on a world musical stage.

THE STAGES OF THE

Jimmy Cliff became an international star because of its **REPARATIONS DISCOURSE**

wide popularity. Raw and dated by today standards, it is still Many people are unaware that the discussion of repa-a classic film for reggae fans and many movie critics.

rations for African people has a long history in the Keef, Hartley (Director), and Millaney, S. (Producer). (1991).

Bob Marley and the Wailers—Live at the Rainbow Theatre United States, with four distinct stages. In Stage I, *in London, 1977* [Film]. United States, London: Island from 1865 to 1920, the U.S. government attempted to Visual Arts.

compensate the 3 million Africans who had just been

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 415

Reparations——415

released from bondage by granting funds and thus provided research facilities and a place to discuss some relief to destitute Africans who could not find strategies for all of these groups when he established work. This period also saw Callie House's heroic the Race Relations Institute during the 1940s.

establishment of the Ex-slave Mutual Relief, Bounty The reparations movement has a comparable and Pension Association, through which she orga-history. Grassroots organizations such as the December nized hundreds of thousands of ex-slaves for payment 12th movement (D12), the National Council of Blacks from the government. In Stage II, from 1920 to 1968, for Reparations in America (N'COBRA), and the Marcus Garvey, Queen Mother Audley Moore, and National Black United Front (NBUF) worked closely numerous black nationalists pressed for reparations by in the mid-1980s with legislators such as John Conyers educating thousands of black people about the unpaid (D-MI). These organizations also collaborated with the debt owed to Africans in America. This was the period Reparations Coordinating Committing (RCC), consistin which the reparations movement was seen as a ing of attorneys such as Willie Gary, Randall Robinson, black nationalist endeavor, and civil rights organiza-and Johnnie Cochran and academics such as Manning tions saw its goals as being unrealistic and extreme.

Marable and Ron Walters. The groups conversed long Stage III began in 1968 and continues today. The and hard with each other, and their discussions were founding of several black nationalist groups—including often heated and difficult. What united them, however, the Republic of New Afrika in 1968 and the National was a common goal of pressing for reparations for Coalition of Blacks for Reparations in America in African people on a global level.

1987—and James Forman’s 1969 *Black Manifesto*, A fertile ground for nourishing the movement was which demanded \$5 billion from churches and syna-laid during the early 1990s by the December 12th gogues, served as catalysts for launching what some movement and other grassroots organizations when have called the “modern reparations movement.”

they successfully lobbied the United Nations to hold Randall Robinson’s 2000 book *The Debt* has aided in a World Conference Against Racism (WCAR). This moving the discussion into even wider circles, as have followed the tradition of Marcus Garvey during the the continuing attempts since 1989 by Congressman 1920s, W.E.B. Du Bois during the 1940s and 1950s, John Conyers, Jr. (D–MI) to appoint a committee to and Malcolm X during the 1960s, who all encouraged study the effects of slavery on the United States. Stage bringing international attention to the struggle of IV of the movement is the legal stage, which began in Africans in America. The 2001 World Conference earnest in the 21st century, having been temporarily Against Racism (WCAR) presented an opportunity discouraged by the 1995 Cato decision in which a to press the issues of reparations at the global level.

liberal federal court in California ruled that the suit for The three core issues adhered to consistently by the reparations was not valid because it was brought “too December 12th movement that helped unify the strug-long” after the incident (i.e., slavery) had happened. In gle in the late 1990s were as follows: 2002, several lawsuits were filed first against corporations and ultimately against the U.S. government.

1. the declaration of the transatlantic slave trade The convergence of four groups provides a and slavery as crimes against humanity conceptual framework for understanding the current 2. reparations for people on the

African continent discussion of reparations: (1) grassroots organizers, and in the *Maafa*, a term first used by Marimba (2) legislators, (3) attorneys, and (4) academics. A Ani to mean “the great disaster of capture and similar convergence of cooperation occurred during enslavement”

the late 1940s that resulted in what we now call the civil rights movement. A. Phillip Randolph’s 3. acknowledgment of the economic base of Brotherhood of Sleeping Car Porters (grassroots orga-

nizers) began conversations with Charles Hamilton Houston and Thurgood Marshall (legislators), who These issues were not arrived at haphazardly.

consulted with politicians such as Hubert Humphrey Rather, the organizers had a steady eye on international of Minnesota (a legislator), as well as with psy-law. Thus they added to this list the impact of chologists Kenneth and Mamie Clark (academics).

colonialism on the transatlantic slave trade, which Together they formed national networks that led to the allowed for even wider litigation efforts involving the birth of the civil rights movement. Pioneering black former European colonial powers that divided Africa sociologist Charles S. Johnson of Fisk University up at the 1884 Berlin Conference.

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 416

416———**Republic of New Afrika**

AMERICAN AND EUROPEAN

FURTHER READING

OPPOSITION TO REPARATIONS

America, Richard. (1993). *Paying the Social Debt: What White In retrospect, it appears that both Europe and the America Owes to Black America*. Westport, CT: Praeger.

United States, which opposed every discussion in the America is an economist and political scientist who in this insightful and scholarly book

takes on the issues surround-international arena on reparations, under-anticipated ing reparations.

how the movement would coalesce during the late Hacker, Andrew. (1992). *Two Nations: Black and White*, 1990s. Just as the governments targeted by the civil *Separate, Hostile, Unequal*. New York: Scribner. Hacker's rights movement in the United States and the anti-work is considered one of the most closely reasoned argu-apartheid movement in South Africa were taken by ments against the neo-conservative understanding of race surprise, the governments responsible for slavery and in America.

exploitation were unaware that in the 21st century the Robinson, Randall. (2000). *The Debt: What America Owes to first global dialogue on the past practices of slavery Blacks*. New York: Dutton. This book is one of the most popular works on the issue of reparations. Robinson details would be initiated by the reparations movement. The the history of the country from the earliest times to the pre-West, led by the United States, realized too late, in sent and demonstrates how America has systematically 2000, that the momentum of the discussion would undercut black progress.

accelerate at breakneck speed in 2001, as final plans for the WCAR began in earnest. A by-product of the meetings leading up to the WCAR was the extraordinary networking that took place among members of **REPUBLIC OF NEW AFRIKA**

the global African community as they shared similar stories about patchwork programs provided as a The Republic of New Afrika (RNA) was conceived panacea and to sidetrack discussion on the continuing to fulfill the long-cherished dream of many blacks impact of slavery and colonialism on Africans and to establish a black nation on American soil. Five their descendants around the world. Both the United Southern states—Mississippi, Louisiana, Alabama, States and Europe failed in their strong-armed Georgia, and South Carolina—have been specified by attempts at removing reparations from the agenda in the RNA as the future black homeland in North Geneva and Durban, and the non-governmental orga-America. This RNA effort is part of the history of nizations (NGOs) participating in the conference were black people in North America, who since back before encouraged to press the issue in the world arena.

the Civil War have been working to gain their freedom from enslavement and discrimination in order to govern themselves. When the Spanish government **NEW ENERGY IN THE MOVEMENT**

ordered on April 12, 1731 that thereafter Africans In 2002, there were several legal victories that aided escaping from slavery in the English colonies would reparations advocates in their struggle for justice for no longer be either returned to the English or enslaved Africans. California passed a law that required all in Spanish Florida, the result was Africans' creation of insurance companies to reveal their participation or the town near St. Augustine called Gracia Real de lack of in the enslavement of Africans in America.

Santa Theresa de Mose, which was governed semiau-Lawsuits were filed against over two dozen corpora-tonomously by Africans.

tions in New York, Louisiana, New Jersey, California, and Illinois that argued that "unjust enrichment" had been experienced by these companies due to their enor-THE SPIRIT OF SELF-GOVERNMENT

mous dependence on slave labor for the accumulation The establishment of this town, though important, of their wealth. Although the tobacco, insurance, and was only one of the many efforts of blacks to govern railroad industries were the primary recipients of these themselves, and there were and are many battles suits, reparations advocates will surely expand their to be fought to achieve this independence. When scope and target other corporations, as well as uli-Gabriel Prosser's army of 1,000 enslaved African mately suing local, state, and federal government agen-men advanced on Richmond, Virginia, in 1800, the cies for their complicity in the enslavement of Africans.

Haitians whose revolution had inspired Prosser were

— *Raymond A. Winbush*

still in the midst of their battle for political control.

Although Prosser's determined strike was defeated Three years later, his followers in Detroit, in the by a violent storm that tore down bridges and swept Malcolm X Society and the civil rights organization away roads, the Haitians won their fight for indepen-known as GOAL (Group on Advanced Leadership), dence 4 years later, burying 10,000 of Napoleon's called a "Black Government Conference" in that city.

best troops. Some time later, in 1816, free Africans in It was led by attorney Milton R. Henry, accountant Florida joined with the Creeks to form the Afro-Indian (and later, attorney) Raymond Willis, artist Umbaji Seminole state, fighting resourcefully against Andrew Adefunmi (formerly Henri King), political activist Jackson's army and, in 1835, defending their freedom Charles Enoch, and others. During deliberations at the against another U.S. army. In 1822, Denmark Vesey's conference, those assembled rejected the name brilliant plan to seize Charleston, South Carolina, by

"Songhay Republic" and settled on "Republic of New military might was undermined by a small but crucial Afrika" for an independent country created by and intelligence leak.

for Africans in the United States. A "Provisional Still, as the Civil War moved toward its close in Government" was then formed to carry out the basic January of 1865, the black men who met with General aim of the revolution to "Free the Land!" This was to Sherman and Secretary of War Stanton responded to be done by organizing independence plebiscites, votes these officers' inquiry about what they wanted by of the oppressed people, in five states in the deep asserting, "[We] would prefer to live by ourselves, for South—Louisiana, Mississippi, Alabama, Georgia, there is a prejudice against us in the South that will and South Carolina—to create an independent country take years to get over." Sherman then issued his at least as free and powerful as Canada. The process Special Field Order 15, allotting 40 acres and a boat of the plebiscite, to enable colonized people to to each black family so that people could travel from achieve independence peacefully, had become part of the mainland to the islands off the Georgia coast.

the new international law regime with the 1960 pas-Tunis Campbell, who would later become a Georgia sage by the United Nations' General Assembly of state senator, then built an independent black commu-Resolution 1514, the Declaration on the Granting of nity on Sapelo and St. Catherine Islands.

Independence to Colonial Countries and Peoples.

These events are early evidence of Africans At the Black Government Conference, Robert enslaved in North America seeking independence Williams was named the first President of the and self-governance, which is one of the three major Provisional Government of the Republic of New strategies for freedom followed by African people Afrika. Williams, a former U.S. Marine, had returned in the United States and its predecessor English home to North Carolina as the picketing and sit-ins of colonies. Between the time of Gabriel Prosser and the black liberation movement were taking place in his Denmark Vesey, another of the three major strategic state. He had become president of the NAACP in goals—the “return” to Africa—was exemplified in the Monroe, North Carolina, but when he armed men in his plan of wealthy merchant seaman Paul Cuffe. Cuffe chapter, he was expelled by the NAACP national lead-wanted to bring talented black people to Sierra Leone ership. Escaping a U.S. government plot to arrest him in West Africa, and he had received Britain's approval for “kidnapping” a white couple he had assisted when to do so, but the war of 1812 interfered with his plans.

they stumbled into a neighborhood in which many The third major strategic goal, which was initiated by blacks carried weapons, Williams went into exile in Reverend Richard Allen of Philadelphia at about the Cuba. From there, by publications and radio, he time of Gabriel Prosser, involves attempting to change encouraged black people who were waging the fight for the United States and make it a good place for every-freedom in the United States to arm themselves and one. This is the strategy pursued by Reverend Martin strike back at whites who sought to kill them. At the Luther King and by most people today.

time of the Black Government Conference, Williams had relocated to the People's Republic of China.

The participants in the Black Government **LEADERS CHOSEN AT THE**
Conference elected as vice president Milton Henry **BLACK**
GOVERNMENT CONFERENCE

(also known as Brother Gaidi Obadele) of Detroit, and During the black revolution of the 1960s, in February as second vice president Betty Shabazz, the widow of of 1965, Malcolm X (also known as el-Hajj Malik el Malcolm X, who was then living in suburban Shabazz and Brother Omowale) was assassinated.

New York. The Ministers of Defense elected at the

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 418

418———**Republic of New Afrika**

convention were “Rap” Brown, former chairman **HEADQUARTERS**

of “SNCC” (the Student Non-Violent Coordinating **ESTABLISHED IN**
MISSISSIPPI

Committee), and John Taylor of Dayton, Ohio, who The first organized RNA cadre of six young men from later became General Mwesi Chui. As Minister of Detroit and New Orleans arrived in Mississippi, in the Justice, the group elected Joan Franklin, an attorney small town of Edwards outside of Jackson, in the who worked for the NAACP’s distinguished legal spring of 1971. Police descended on the young men counsel Robert Carter and who assured those at the there. Two escaped and traveled many miles through convention that they had no need to renounce U.S. cit-the woods to Jackson. There was no shooting, but izenship. She explained that the United States ended there were brief arrests. The new RNA president, Imari slavery with the 1865 Thirteenth Amendment but for Obadele, arrived in Jackson with other RNA officers well over 2 years failed to offer U.S. citizenship to the and citizens shortly afterward and began the purchase freed people. Then the U.S. never asked these people of land for the RNA headquarters. At the RNA’s first or their descendants for their acceptance of the offer Land Celebration, in March of 1971, on 20 acres of U.S. citizenship made

by the 1868 Fourteenth being purchased from a black farmer near Edwards, Amendment. Consequently, Franklin explained, black Mississippi, the FBI and state and local police made a people had no U.S. citizenship to renounce.

large armed showing but were met with a determined The Black Government Conference elected Wilbur armed showing led by Alajo Adegbalola and Chokwe Gratton of Ohio as Minister of Foreign Relations; Lumumba (who became a celebrated Mississippi Obaboa Olowa of California as Treasurer; Imamu lawyer) and RNA Minister of Justice William Miller, Baraka, Maulana Karenga, and Oserjeman Adefunmi a lawyer and Mississippian. The *Jackson Daily News* as joint Ministers of Culture. Imari Obadele, author of wrote that the RNA had declared independence and the book *War In America: The Malcolm X Doctrine* had established “a Black Nation.” (Actually, there had was named Minister of Information. This book was the been no plebiscite, only the beginning of a headquar-theoretical basis for the founding of the Provisional ters location.)

Government. Queen Mother Audley Moore, a grand and electrifying leader of the movement for independence and reparations, was the first to sign the Declaration of Independence of the Republic of New **RNA MEMBERS UNDER ATTACK**

Afrika, and 100 of the 500 conferees followed her in The Mississippi attorney general publicly accused signing the document.

RNA leaders of “treason,” and local and state officials At the first anniversary meeting of the Provisional promised to wipe out the Provisional Government of Government of the RNA (PG-RNA), held in Detroit at the RNA and its armed military. The FBI was con-New Bethel Church and pastored by Reverend C. L.

ducting a secret campaign (known as the counterin-Franklin, a spiritual and civil rights leader and the telligence program or COINTELPRO) to destroy the father of singer Aretha Franklin, Detroit police appar-Black Panthers, the organization Us, and other black ently attempted to kill Vice President Gaidi Obadele, extremists and organizations. The agency convinced the Provisional Government’s highest officer in the the Jackson police

department to attack the official United States. The two policemen initially involved residence of the PG-RNA on a quiet Jackson street. They were out shot by the black legionnaires who were attack came at 6:30 in the morning of Wednesday, accompanying the vice president, and he was driven August 18, 1971. A military force of about 60 police off to safety. Police on rooftops and in other locations and FBI agents fired into the PG-RNA but lost the gun then opened fire through the glass front doors of the battle, with one police lieutenant suffering fatal wounds church, wounding several people and forcing over 100

and a policeman and an FBI agent also being wounded.

others to take shelter in the large basement. This was No RNA personnel were wounded. President Obadele the last Saturday in March in 1969. And when Sunday and three others were arrested at the PG-RNA's new morning dawned, the brilliant, defiant, black Judge office, blocks away, where there had been no shooting.

George Crockett, who by rotation had become Chief All 11 of those in the PG-RNA residence at the Judge of Records Court, opened court in the police time of the armed attack were charged with state and station and began one by one bringing the captives federal "crimes" based on having defended them-before him and releasing them.

selves, not with working to create an independent

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 419

Revolutionary Action Movement——419

country. Interior Minister Offoga Quaddus and Vice to a Marxist philosophy of political and economic President Hekima Ana (who was visiting the resi-empowerment as a means of self-determination. It dence with his wife, Tamu) were sentenced to life sought reparations for the descendants of enslaved by the state and to 12 consecutive years by the U.S.

Africans, as well as an end to imperialism.

government. Karim Njabafudi, a 15-year-old boy, was RAM's initial purpose was to convert the civil sentenced to life by the state, and Addis Ababa served rights movement into a nationwide black revolution.

a 7-year state sentence. Obadele served almost 5 years The influence of RAM in the early 1960s helped in state and federal prisons, as did Chumaimari and to intensify the existing wave of black nationalist Tawwab Nkrumah. The black community in Mississippi organizations, which adhered to the tenets of self-and nationwide, as well as several lawyers, worked dili-determination and self-defense, as well as political gently for the freedom of those who became known as and economic organization. RAM also intended to the RNA-11. By early 1981, they had all been released displace the assimilationist thrust of the civil rights from prison except Nkrumah, who had escaped.

movement. The cadres or individually operating cells of RAM had the following objectives: **THE SPIRIT LIVES ON**

1. to assist in local community organizing Imari Obadele served as president of the RNA for 20
2. to build civil momentum by achieving immedi-years. Dara Abubakari (aka Virginia Collins) of New ate victories in the community, such as solving Orleans served as president while Imari was in federal people's day-to-day problems with issues that prison. Mathematician Kwame Afoh of Washington, were not nationally recognized

D.C., and Fort Lauderdale, Florida, served as president for 6 years; Mississippi physician Demetri 3. to eventually build a base for a mass resistance Marshall of Port Gibson, Mississippi, served as presi-to American imperialism

dent for 2 years; and Brother Ukali Mwendo began a 3-year term as president in December of 2002. The To advance its agenda, RAM incorporated the Provisional Government of the New Republic of militant tactics of self-defense through the use of Afrika declared in 2002 that the independence arms, civil disobedience, and community mass action.

plebiscite would be held in portions of the five states. The tactics of urban guerrilla warfare, such as selected by the year 2012.

boycotts, sit-ins, work slow downs, and strikes were employed against companies, schools, institutions,

— *Imari A. Obadele*

and offices that used discriminatory hiring practices and committed civil rights abuses. Multiple marches **FURTHER READING**

and mass demonstrations by as many as 100,000

Obadele, Imari A., and Henry, Laurence. (1998). *America, the people occurred up and down the East Coast and in Nation State: The Politics of the United States from a State-the Midwest as a result of the efforts of RAM and Building Perspective*. Detroit, MI: Malcolm. This is an other black nationalist organizations. The police authoritative work on nation building in a racist state.

*covertly attempted to take over by encouraging demonstrations by organizations not aligned with RAM that would turn their protests against RAM, thus **REVOLUTIONARY***

*degenerating the protests into street riots. These demonstrations, which often began peacefully, would **ACTION MOVEMENT***

also turn violent as clashes with local authorities occurred. Thus, agents provocateurs were used to The Revolutionary Action Movement (RAM), a black destabilize the movement.

nationalist and pan-African organization, first The dissemination of information to the masses of appeared on the black political activist scene in people within any city in which RAM operated was Philadelphia in 1963, in the midst of the social and achieved through the distribution of literature, such as political revolution of the black power and civil rights flyers and the biweekly newsletter Black America.

movements. Its founder was Max Stanford, who was This literature was generated and distributed by later known as A. Muhammad Ahmad. RAM adhered RAM's members to inform the masses about ongoing

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 420

420——**Ring Shout**

and planned activities in other cities and around the felonies, Ahmad ordered the members of RAM

world. RAM's members were primarily the dispostio shelve all activities. Governmental intervention sessed black youths of the inner cities, prisoners, and had effectively suspended the activities of the ex-convicts, but they were also intellectuals and indi-organization.

viduals from various other walks of life. The structure

— Imari A. Obadele

of RAM was a collective of cells or cadres connected by a unifying revolutionary orientation and guided by **FURTHER READING**

the central planning committee directives. RAM was an underground movement that primarily dispersed Stanford, Max C. (1986). Revolutionary Action Movement initiatives to the various cadres by word of mouth at (RAM): A Case Study of an Urban Revolutionary Movement committee meetings among the leaders of the central in Western Capitalist Society. This is virtually a firsthand account of RAM.

planning committees.

The Autobiography of Malcolm X (New York: Ballantine In articulating his organization's Marxist ideology, Books, 1965), as told to Alex Haley, Malcolm X's memoir as well as in expressing his demand for reparations gives insight into his transformation and continued dedica-from the U.S. government, Amhad was influenced by tion to work on behalf of his people.

Queen Mother Audley Moore. The militant and self-The Militant. This is a monthly newspaper that was born out of defense aspects of the organization came from the RAM. It is currently in circulation and offers its readers then-exiled Robert F. Williams, who advocated the insights into the struggles of black people in America and around the world.

use of force by way of arms and urban guerilla tactics Williams, Robert. (1973). *Negroes With Guns*. Chicago: Third as a method of ensuring black personal and collective World Press. Williams recounts the self-defense ideology security in America.

of many organizations, including RAM.

Malcolm X's self-determination orientation also deeply influenced the formulation of the goals of RAM, as Malcolm X had a close relationship with Ahmad prior to RAM's formation. Malcolm X would **RING SHOUT**

later join RAM as an officer, before his separation from the Nation of Islam and the formation of the The ring shout is a sacred group dance that originated Organization of Afro-American Unity.

in West Africa. When Africans from various ethnic It is also clear that RAM had a great impact on backgrounds came to America, they found that they other organizations. For example, Huey P. Newton were not able to communicate immediately but shared was influenced by the tenets of this organization when a common ancestral dance that was performed during he cofounded the Black Panther Party in the San sacred ceremonies. Enslaved Africans, including the Francisco Bay area. When Malcolm X founded the Ibo, Akan, Bakongo, and Asante, then took to per-Organization of Afro-American Unity, it is likely that forming the ring shout during their religious cere-it was supported and staffed by RAM members. Other monies and services. The ring shout became a national organizations such as the Students Non-synthesized version of African ancestral dance and Violent Coordinating Committee (SNCC), headed by a pan-African practice that predates the concept of Kwame Toure, adopted some of RAM's tactics and pan-Africanism. The dance created a cultural oneness ideologies. Organizations that were loosely affiliated among the different groups, as it suggests a spirit with RAM, such as CORE and the NAACP, distanced of

community and solidarity. The ring shout, which themselves from RAM because their ideologies con-typically took place during sacred ceremonies and cerning separation and assimilation were at odds with consisted of ancestor worship and “possession” (in RAM’s.

which an individual receives a spirit), enabled However, RAM’s efforts were seriously under-enslaved Africans to retain an aspect of their tradi- mined by federal and local law enforcement agencies tional religious practice.

such as the FBI’s counterintelligence program The ring shout is the oldest surviving dance from (COINTELPRO) and local police departments. In the European slave trade. It is considered the closest 1996, due to a series of imprisonments, assassina-remnant of Africa belonging to the African American tions, and exiles of the leaders of RAM, as well as culture. The ring shout is a process in which the body the implication of members in cases involving is believed to communicate with the soul. African

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 421

Ring Shout——421

people through their cosmological beliefs were mounted. Many slaveholders would watch the dance always able to transmit feelings, ideas, and prayers from afar and misconstrue what they saw as a practice through chants and rhythmic patterns associated with that was sexual and sinful in nature. White Christians the soul. This concept was brought to the United depicted the sacred dance as barbaric and unholy States as one of this country’s earliest forms of native according to their own limited beliefs.

African phenomena.

The ring shout was later accompanied with spiri-Call-and-response is part of the ring shout that took tuals and it was eventually looked upon with con- place in the United States. The leader of the shout is tempt and loathing by slaveholders. The Africans referred to as the songster. This person is responsible would dance despite possible punishment as a way to for calling out the leading lines of the shout. Within restore their body’s spiritual

strength and physical this group is also the person referred to as the sticker, prowess. There were accounts where the slaveholders who replaced the drummer when the Catholic faith attempted to ban the ring shout, but African attacked outlawed the Africans' use of the drum. The sticker then and the performance would continue. When a slave sits next to the songster and carries out a complex slaveholder brought a large posse to subdue the shout, number of rhythms. The rhythms in the shout were it often took the congregation several minutes to quite created for the ancestors and are directed toward them down and gain consciousness. The ring shout was as the dancers begin to move in a counterclockwise common during the era of slavery, and it remained ring. The lyrics of the ring shout speak of escape from popular far into the 20th century. It served as a means the trials and tribulations endured by many enslaved of emotional and physical release during religious Africans. The singers in the background sing out the worship. Today the ring shout is performed as an art responses to the songster. The shouters (who were from and still used in the sacred realm of some generally women) dance to the music in a counter-Pentecostal churches, but it is not a part of black clockwise circle while clapping their hands and church services throughout the country. Still, many of intensely moving their bodies in synchrony with the the elements are still a part of the black church ser-rhythm. The spirituals, songs that were firmly rooted vice. The actual ring dance is not performed, but the in African cultural tradition, eventually were added to African tradition is still alive. You can go into any and associated with the shout.

black Christian church in this country today and find As the dance survived throughout three genera-subtle remnants of the shout such as the call-and-tions of enslavement, it took on different forms.

response between the pastor and congregation and There were also several rules established in an effort the possession of the holy ghost. There is also a to keep the ring shout a part of African American cul-praise dance that is performed that resembles the ture. The ring shout could be danced in two forms—

solo shout. These are all African in nature and in one form was performed in Georgia and South practice.

Carolina and the other in North Carolina and Virginia. The latter type was performed as a solo

— *Kristy Holmes*

dance with onlookers doing verbal call-and-response, whereas the first form was performed as a group **FURTHER READING**

dance. Very early on the rules were established for the Defrantz,

Thomas. (2001). *Dancing Many Drums: dance*. One of the more important rules was the rule *Excavations in African American Dance* (Studies in Dance against the dancers' crossing their legs or feet. The History).

Madison: University of Wisconsin Press. This is a enslaved Africans believed that slaveholders would wonderful introduction to the varieties of dance experi-not label the ring shout a dance and prohibit it, as ences in the African American community.

they prohibited dancing in their own Catholic and Fauley-Emery, L. (1988). *Black Dance From 1619 to Today* Protestant faiths, if the feet or legs of those in motion (2nd rev. ed.). Princeton, NJ: Princeton Book Company.

never crossed.

This is one of the best books on African American dance history.

Many slaveholders would hide in the woods and Rosenbaum, Art. (1998). *Shout Because You're Free: The watch the ring shout performance*. Since they were *African American Ring Shout Traditions in Coastal* unfamiliar with the spirit of African culture, they dis-Georgia. Athens: University of Georgia Press. This work torted what they witnessed during these ceremonies.

underscores the retentions of Africanisms on the coast of Typically during the ring shout the body is seized and Georgia.

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 422

African American folk magic can be broken down **ROOT DOCTOR**

into two types of practices, the “light roots” (good roots) and the “dark roots” (bad roots). The light roots Root doctors are herbalists who use various plants and practice often includes herbs or plant substances, gun animal parts to cure or create ailments. Root doctors powder, sulfur, salts, candles, and incense. Dark roots are also called conjurers, herb doctors, root workers, may include animal parts such as crow feathers and healers, spiritualists, and two-headed doctors. Root salamander feet. Those who practiced root work were work is an African American form of shamanism viewed as medical doctors because roots were the pri-using herbs, stones, rocks, and other organic material mary ingredients for making medicines for physical as to heal the body, heal the mind, or solve a problem.

opposed to spiritual illness, whereas conjurers used Plants and animal parts are rarely administered in raw the same ingredients for both “good” and “bad” magic forms but instead are ground into powders or liquids or spirit work. In root work, nature is seen to play a and combined with other plants to make concoctions.

role in the way the body operates: Illness can either be Root doctors believe that they can use unseen forces a natural event or an unnatural event. Natural illnesses of nature to manipulate people and objects throughout can be treated by natural means; however, unnatural the world.

illnesses can only by treated by supernatural practices.

In the southern part of the United States, root work It is important to note that Hoodoo or root work is is commonly known as Hoodoo. *Hoodoo* is the term not a religion. Unlike Vodou (or Voodoo), to which it is used to refer to African-based systems of magical, sometimes compared, it has no pantheon or priesthood.

spiritual, and medicinal healing, but within Hoodoo, There is no formal initiation or consecration to any there is a slight distinction made between the root divinity required to become a root worker. Practitioners doctors (i.e., medicine folk) and the conjurers. The may practice any religion they

choose. Root work word *hoodoo* is probably derived from the African refers only to the set of healing and spell practices.

word *juju*, meaning magic. Africans when taken from Root work served many purposes. Blacks in the their homeland of Africa some 400 years ago brought South used conjuring for everything. The conjurers with them more than their words. They also brought even created potions to help someone gain love. Root their experience working with herbs, and they trans-doctors would plant crops used to chart a person's life mitted their botanical knowledge to their children.

by the phases of the moon. Conjurers helped Africans Most of this information was passed down orally and cope with their lives of servitude. They created roots used to cure the sick and ailing. Because of the terri-that they believed prevented whippings. The conjurers ble combination of slavery, discrimination, religious designed powders that would give the enslaved con-persecution, the inability to pass knowledge to suc-trol over their masters. Africans could even buy poi-cessive generations, and the unavailability of some sons that promised to sicken or kill their owners.

traditional African plants, African American folk Spells were provided to sway judges and juries. Root remedies are a combination of some Native American doctors acted in many roles in the black community, and European folk remedies and the already extensive ranging from medical doctors to spiritual healers.

African knowledge of medicinal root use. However, The practice of root work is both feared and the art and practice of conjuring has remained African respected in the black community. It is because of this in its philosophy, purpose, techniques, and lore.

that root doctors, spiritualists, and conjurers are not The most common ailments treated by root doctors easy to find. They usually hide themselves and live were smallpox and digestive disorders. The root doc-apart from the "common folk" in remote areas. Root tors treated each ailment by boiling down specific doctors, spiritualists, and conjurers live as an invisible herbs and making them into a tonic for the client to culture. It is because of this invisible culture that many drink for the disorder. Almost all blacks in the

South people believed that after the period of the enslavement had to have some knowledge of traditional herbal the practice of root work disappeared, when in fact it remedies because as slaves they could not afford the did not. The select few who have had the opportunity to expense of traditional health care. In fact, because study the art of root work or its practitioners understand many whites also could not afford or did not want the its African origin and its value in the black community.

enslaved to see traditional doctors, they would often advise their slaves to see root doctors.

— *Natalie Lewis*

R-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 423

Root Doctor———423

FURTHER READING

at African American philosophy and culture in relationship to ordinary life.

Ashanti, Kwabena. (1992). *Root Doctor*. Durham, NC:
www.napa.ufl.edu/2003news/blackmagic.htm This Web site is Sarafina Books. This book has an excellent history of root an excellent source for information on African American doctors.

folk magic.

Thompson, Robert Farris. (1983). *Flash of the Spirit*. New York:
www.fouye.com This Web site contains information on the Random House. Thompson presents a comprehensive look history of Hoodoo and Vodun.

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 425

S

on a plantation. Each character in *Sankofa* represents

SANKOFA

aspects of personalities that exist within the African community, and the film contains many symbolic representations of the African experience with slavery, ever made on the enslavement of Africans. The word exploitation, resistance, and victory.

Sankofa is an Akan word that literally means “go back to fetch it.” It refers to the process of going back to the **THE ENSLAVEMENT BEGINS**

past in order to build for the future. *Sankofa* suggests that Africans must return to the source for inspiration. *Sankofa* begins in Africa, in Cape Coast Castle in and direction for the future. The term is used as a concept in many discourses in Black Studies and has come a photo shoot, is being photographed by a white to represent much of the intellectual fervor for return-photographer. During the shoot, Mona is confronted by an African elder who claims to be the guardian of and culture. A popular symbol of *Sankofa* is the image of the Cape Coast Castle. He insists that the castle was of a mythic bird that flies forward looking backward sacred and that the lives of African people were stolen while holding an egg in its mouth. *Sankofa* may also be sold at the castle. He tells Mona and the photographer to be represented as a heartlike symbol.

photographer to leave and shouts to Mona, “*Sankofa!*” The symbolic meanings of *Sankofa* appear police come and order the old man out of the castle.

throughout the film *Sankofa*, which opens in contemporary times then travels back to the era of African the castle, Mona enters the castle dungeons and finds enslavement. The film shows Mona, a woman of African descent, returning to (or fetching) her past so taken captive by Europeans in control of the castle. As that she can use it to make sense of her future. *Sankofa* she is taken to the dungeon, Mona cries out that she illustrates the transformation of the consciousness and not an African.

identity of its main character, Mona, who can be seen The film then begins to trace the process of Sankofa.

as a representation of the African world community.

Mona is taken back to the African experience of slav-The film connects enslaved Africans with their ery: She is transformed into the character Shola, an African past and culture, and it empowers African enslaved African on the Lafayette sugarcane plantation people by showing how Africans' aspiration for freein Louisiana who is assigned duties in the house. Shola dom made them resist their enslavers. *Sankofa* also is referred to as a house slave who does not involve her-shows the collective past and experiences of Africans self in any forms of resistance. But she is in love with through Mona when she is taken back to her ancestral Shango, who resists being in bondage and argues that experience and becomes Shola, a woman who works all Africans held captive should resist. Shango and 425

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 426

426———**Santería**

Nunu, an African woman who was born in Africa and this rebellion, a newly transformed Shola kills her brought directly into slavery on the plantation, teach rapist. The rebellion is successful in that many of the Shola how to develop her African consciousness.

Africans realize the importance of resistance and These are the two people Shola looks to for strength several of the headmasters and headmen are killed.

to survive her condition. Shola has been sexually Although all of the rebels are captured and eventually abused by the plantation owner, Mr. Lafayette, and killed, the victory of consciousness was won by the recalls being raped and tortured. She wishes she had enslaved Africans. Shola articulates being free by Nunu's strength.

describing herself being lifted up and carried by The film then shows captured runaways being a buzzard that brings her spirit home, just like

whipped by two headmen—Joe, a half-white head-in the African American folktale of the “Flying man who adopts the values and norms of whites, and Africans.”

Noble Ali, a headman who is in conflict over his The story then shifts back to the present, where responsibilities as a headman but still does the whip-Shola as Mona is now conscious. She ignores the pho-ping he has been commanded to do. When Kutu, a tographer who seeks to exploit her beauty and goes to pregnant runaway, dies as a result of being whipped, participate in an African chant being performed by Nunu performs a caesarean to save Kutu’s child.

Sankofa. Mona is now able to appreciate this traditional chant due to her new awareness of her rich **THE RESISTANCE ENSUES**

African history.

At this point, Shola begins to learn the importance of

— *Justin Gammage*

resisting. The horrible experience of being raped by Mr. Lafayette, followed by her receiving no relief from **FURTHER READING**

Providence in answer to her prayers, jolts her into begin-Armah, Ayi Kwei. (2000). *Two Thousand Seasons*.

ning to recognize the value in her own resistance. After Popenguine, Senegal: PER ANKH. This novel dramatizes being severely beaten, Mona is consoled by Shango and the history of the enslavement of African people, and is given a Sankofa bird. This act, she claims, turns her clearly describes the role of the various participants in the into a rebel. She is then transformed and becomes con-enslavement.

Gerima, Haile, and Aina, Shirikiana (Producers) and Gerima, scious of her responsibility to resist enslavement.

Haile (Writer/Director).(1992). *Sankofa*. Washington, DC: The story then shifts to Joe being poisoned by Gerima.

Shango. Joe's mother, Nunu, tries to save him, but Joe Karenga, Maulana. (2002). *Introduction to Black Studies* (3rd is convinced by a priest, Father Rafael, that Nunu ed.). Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This is a is the devil, and he perceives her help as her carrying good introduction to the discipline, and it includes a section out the devil's work. In a rage, Joe kills his mother.

that breaks down the many layers of what is being called Afterward, when Joe recognizes the value of his the "Holocaust of African Enslavement."

mother, he brings her corpse to the church. It is then that he realizes his betrayal of his people and of his own mother, who had given birth to him after being **SANTERÍA**

raped by a white man. From this event, Joe is transformed and sees the disorientation that caused him to Santería (also known as regla de ocha, orisha, or follow white norms and values. He then kills Father Lucumi) is a transatlantic extension of Yoruba reli-Rafael, the priest who taught him that the ways of gion into the Caribbean. The homeland of the Yoruba whites were the ways of God and that those who people is in southwestern Nigeria, but they have also resisted were devils. Joe, confused by his feelings of settled in Togo and the Republic of Benin and have betrayal, locks himself in the church. The whites then spread to those areas an ancient religious system that burn the church down in order to kill Joe.

now also has thousands of devotees in the Americas.

Just as there are regional and doctrinal variants within **AFRICANS ARE UNITED IN REBELLION**

the Christian, Buddhist, and Islamic religions, The final scene of the film shows a rebellion that Santeria is simply the Cuban variant of this older, unites all the Africans on the Lafayette plantation. In more extensive Yoruba religious tradition.

ORIGINS

the results of positive investigations of the spirit world that others could also carry through mediumistic. Before the eighteenth century, only a small number of séances, and he preached an ethic emphasizing suffer-Yorubas were enslaved and brought into Cuba. But ing, charity, and spiritual development. All this had during the eighteenth-century boom in sugar produc-been dictated to him by spirits.

tion and at the height of the slave trade, the number of Kardecian spiritism, or *Espiritismo* as it came to be Yorubas brought into Cuba increased dramatically.

called, first took hold among literate, highly placed. Between 1840 and 1870, the last period of Cuba's Cuban Creoles who wanted independence from Spain involvement in slave trading, more than one third of and were alienated from the Spanish-dominated all the Africans brought there were Yorubas.

Catholic Church, but it eventually worked its way. Because Cuba's Catholic church was closely allied down to the urban masses and out into the country-with the national government and because Catholicism side. Even though Santería had been transmitted pri-was the only religion that was legal while Cuba marily by oral tradition since at least the 18th century, remained a Spanish colony, once Africans were in and even though Rivail's books had to be smuggled Cuba, they all—including the Yorubas—came under into Cuba because they were illegal, his writings still pressure to convert to Catholicism and abandon their had an impact on the development of Santería. Some traditional religions. The Catholic Church's strategy Santería priests came to view apprenticeship as a was to guide Africans gradually toward a complete spiritist medium as a necessary prerequisite for the conversion to Christianity but to tolerate some mixing practice of their religion. They became adept in both of African and Catholic practices along the way. To systems and adopted some of *Espiritismo*'s healing this end, the

Catholic Church founded Afro-Catholic techniques. By the twentieth century, Santería had fraternities in cities with sizable African populations.

spread beyond Yorubas and Yoruba descendants and The fraternities, called *cabildos*, where mutual aid was being practiced by Creoles and Whites as well.

societies for people from the same African ethnic Both Catholicism and Espiritismo have affected the background. The Yoruba-based cabildos were an insti-development of Santería. Nonetheless, Santería's ritual tutiional basis for what would later become known as system and cosmology remain essentially African in Santería (Spanish for *worship of the saints*).

character with a strong fidelity to Yoruba traditions.

At the same time as they preserved African tradi-Among the aspects of Yoruba religion faithfully pre-tions, the cabildos also promoted Catholic instruction served in Santería are the names and personalities of and participation in the church's public festivals. In the the deities, divination procedures, ceremonial spirit late nineteenth century, however, when it became clear possession and trance, Yoruba liturgical music and that the cabildos' African religious traditions—even in musical instruments, dance as a medium of worship, their mixed and modified forms—were not about to Yoruba language prayers and incantations, beliefs in disappear, the Catholic Church and the colonial gov-ancestor veneration and reincarnation, and sacrificial ernment joined hands to try and stamp them out. The practices. Santería contains a vast compendium of Catholic Church cut its ties to the cabildos, the gov-herbal medicine and healing ritual, much of which also ernment passed oppressive legislation against them, has African analogues.

and the police clamped down on them, too, treating involvement in the Afro-Cuban religions as a criminal activity. In response, the cabildos went underground, **BELIEFS**

and Santería worship became clandestine.

During this era of suppression, Santería was influenced by Santería theology recognizes a Supreme Being, called on by the spiritist doctrines of Hippolyte Rivail.

by various Yoruba names, such as Olodumare, Olorun, Rivail's books had begun appearing in Cuba as early as 1850 and Olofin, or simply Dios (God in Spanish).

as the 1850s, but between 1870 and 1880, his writings Olodumare created the universe and all things in it, spread like a tidal wave throughout the French and including the orisha, who are the main focus of Spanish Caribbean and into Central and South Santería worship. The orisha (also called *santos*) are America. Writing under the pen name Allan Kardec, powerful spiritual beings—at once forces of nature, this French engineer proclaimed the revelation of an guardians of particular facets of human life, and magickal, scientific spiritualism. His books described unified human personality types—sent by Olodumare

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 428

428———**Santería**

to populate and civilize the earth and endow it with might best be described as instrumental, that is, “If the powers essential for the harmonious existence of it works for you, believe it.” In spite of Santería's all living things. While there are innumerable orishas history of religious persecution, its priests and devotees throughout the world and the number known among teens are generally tolerant of other religions. Many African Yorubas is very large, only a few have special regard themselves as Catholics, while others fluidly prominence in Santería, and each of these corresponds slip between the worlds of the Catholic mass, the to a saint also known and venerated in Cuba's spiritists' white table, and Santería drum-dance with Catholic churches.

little deliberation or anxiety.

The spirits of people who have died are also important. The ancestral Dead are closer to human beings **WORSHIP**

than they are to Olodumare or the orisha, and deceased family members continue to have an inti-Santería is not congregational and so does not depend on a connection to their descendants. The ancestral upon the existence of a temple or church building.

Dead are capable of intervening in the affairs of their Worship is both individual and communal. Devotees living relatives and can be called upon to intercede carry out a round of private offerings to the santos in with the orisha. Although they are less powerful than their homes; priests and priestesses perform rituals the orisha (and less attention is given to them), ances-and provide herbal medicine, counseling, and symptoms still receive respect and veneration, and every bodily healing to devotees and the general public. There devotee has a small altar dedicated to them.

is also a cycle of annual festivals coordinated with the An encompassing energy, *ashe*, flows through saints' feast days of Cuba's Catholic Church.

and envelops the entire hierarchy of beings from Most individual worship takes place in front of the Olodumare: through the orisha, the ancestral Dead altars that devotees keep in their homes or outside in and other spirits, plants, animals and the entire natural natural settings such as a riverside, near the sea, or in world. This energy can be manipulated through rituals a forest or park. Much individual worship consists of and can be made to manifest itself in different forms.

offerings to the orisha and the Dead. These offerings Each orisha has its own divine power, or *ashe*, through generally have two purposes: The first is to allow the which it is sustained, and through which it acts on the devotee to influence the orisha and gain access to its aspects of the world over which Olodumare gave it *ashe* to help solve personal problems. The second dominion. When the orisha first formed human purpose is to help the devotee develop a bond of beings, they also taught them how to access each reciprocity and mutual respect with the orisha, a bond orisha's power. This knowledge is the basis of the thought to be beneficial, not only for the human rituals and doctrines of the different priesthoods.

devotee, but for the orisha as well. Offerings can take Through these rituals, devotees expect to achieve an many forms including cooked or raw food,

liquor, active harmony with the Supreme Being, a closer relationship with the orisha and the natural world, and the blood of sacrificed animals.

increased control over the forces affecting their lives Communal worship is highly participatory and personal fortunes.

features ritual dance; call-and-response chants per-Santería is neither a salvation religion that rejects formed in Yoruba and accompanied by drums; cere-the world nor a revealed religion with an authoritative monial spirit possession; ancestor veneration; and, on founder or holy book. For Santería devotees, spiritual occasion, animal sacrifices. The most characteristic beings and religious truths do not exist in a world form of communal worship in Santería is the *bembe*.

apart from the natural and social world known to our Bembes are great feasts and celebrations often corresponds; instead, they reside within it. Santería has an affinity with the feast days of those Catholic saints who intensely hierarchical, human-centered, and this have orisha associated with them, or coincident with worldly cosmology that does not draw a hard-and-fast the initiation of a priest or priestess, the anniversary line between either the human and the divine or the of priests' initiation, or the fulfillment of some other living and the dead. Since Santería is primarily non-religious obligation to the orisha that a priestess concerned with the self and with achieving ritual mastery may have.

of the natural, social, and spiritual forces affecting Spirit mediumship is at the core of the bembe, so daily life, the religious attitude of priests and devotees these ceremonies usually fall into two parts: invocation

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 429

Schomburg Center for Research in Black Culture——429

of the ancestral Dead and the orisha, and, then, the **FURTHER READING**

presence of the orisha among their devotees. The invocation, William. (1972). *Shango in the New World*. Austin: invocations are libations and prayers

made before an University of Texas and Afro-American Research Institute.

orisha altar in Lucumi (the Cuban variant of the One of the earliest attempts to analyze the meaning of Yoruba language and the liturgical tongue for all reli-Shango in the Western world.

gious observances in Santería) followed by music Brandon, George. (1993) . *Santería from Africa to the New* directed at the altar by an ensemble of drummers who *World: The Dead Sell Memories*. Bloomington, IN: Indiana lead call-and-response chants sung with a motionless University Press. One of the best and most comprehensive group of standing devotees. In the second part of the works to date on the emergence of Santería.

Sandoval, Mercedes. (1975) . *La Religion Afrocubana*. Madrid: ceremony, devotees perform dances imitating the per-Playor. Represents a major examination of the African sonalities, attributes, and attitudes of each of the orisha Cuban religion on the Island of Cuba.

while singing their chants to attract the orisha, compel them to come take over the bodies of their priests and priestesses, and manifest themselves in visible human form. When possession occurs, the possessed priests

SCHOMBURG CENTER FOR

and priestesses are garbed in the colors and clothing appropriate to the orisha who has mounted them, and **RESEARCH IN BLACK CULTURE**

they interact with the community of believers: talking to them, confronting them, consoling them, healing The Schomburg Center for Research in Black Culture them, making prophecies, or recommending that they is arguably the premier collection of Africana data in carry out certain rituals. Eventually the orisha return the world. This gem of the New York Public Library is to their invisible realm, leaving behind a group of the fruit of the lifelong toil of Arthur (formerly Arturo) exhausted priests who have no memory of what their Alfonso Schomburg (1874–1938), an Afro-Puerto bodies did while the orisha possessed them. A purifi-Rican bibliophile, patron of the arts, law clerk, lec-cation rite ends this part of the ceremony, a communal turer, writer, curator, exhibitor, translator, educator, meal follows, then a general distribution of the fruits activist, revolutionary, and

pioneer in microfilm and desserts that have surrounded the altar throughout preservation. Schomburg dedicated his existence to the the events.

documentation and reclamation of African achievement and greatness after being told as a young child that the “Negro” has no history. Very early on, he **THE SPREAD OF SANTERÍA OUTSIDE OF CUBA** began collecting historical literature and documents in the languages that he spoke and read: Spanish, Santería began to spread outside of Cuba after the French, and English, among others. He believed that Cuban Revolution of 1959. The Cuban exiles who history must restore what enslavement has stolen and brought it to Miami and New York at that time were that Africans must make history yield the same value followed by another major exodus from the port of that any people’s treasured past affords.

Mariel in 1980. Santería began to spread to other Hispanic communities and then to African American, White, and Asian communities. From these contacts **ORIGIN OF THE CENTER**

in the United States, Santería has made its way back **IN THE BLACK COMMUNITY**

into the Caribbean to Puerto Rico and the Dominican Republic. Cubans transplanted the religion to Mexico The origin of Schomburg’s far-reaching brainchild and also to Venezuela, where the santos/orishas have began in 1924 when the Citizens Committee of the already begun to win new devotees and exert an influ-135th Street Branch Library in Harlem met to discuss ence on Venezuelan popular religions. A small the organization and location of Africana materials, number of exiled Cuban Santería priests made their which were then underrepresented in the branch. This way to Spain and, through them, Santería became little-known group, which was chaired by Arthur established there and spread to other European Schomburg, included Ernestine Rose, the Branch countries.

Librarian, James Weldon Johnson, Hubert Harrison, John E. Bruce, Louise Latimer, and John Nail. The

—*George Brandon*

committee's stated mission, which would come to

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 430

430———**Schomburg Center for Research in Black Culture** be known as the “Schomburg Tradition” in library when it was set apart as one of the research libraries service, delineated two primary focuses: (1) the of the New York Public Library. Also in 1972, the collection, exhibition, and accessibility to the general Schomburg received a grant from the National public and scholarly researchers of documents chron-Endowment for the Humanities (NEH) that aug-icling the global black experience, and (2) using mented the archival preservation program made possi-research for educating the public through the use of ble by a 1967 Ford Foundation grant. In 1981, the old lectures, forums, and publications.

Schomburg building was named an official New York The collection had its auspicious beginning when it City landmark.

opened for public viewing at the 135th Street Branch Currently, the center has a constituency that spans of the New York Public Library on January 14, 1927

the globe, and it boasts a catalogue of well over at the height of the Harlem Renaissance. Arthur 5,000,000 items. The ultramodern Schomburg com-Schomburg's personal collection, which included over plex includes the 350-seat Langston Hughes Audi-5,000 volumes, 3,000 manuscripts, 2,000 etchings and torium, the refurbished American Negro Theatre, an paintings, thousands of pamphlets, newspapers, prints, exhibition hall, the Latimer/Edison Gallery, and a and other materials, had been purchased by the library gift shop. Adjacent to the center and completing the with the proceeds of a grant from the Carnegie complex is the Countee Cullen Regional Branch Corporation in May of 1926, becoming the major part Library on West 136th Street. In addition to its General of its Division of Negro Literature, History and Prints.

Research and Reference Division, it is comprised of Schomburg was curator of his beloved collected four special collections, including the Manuscripts, works from 1932 until the time of his death in 1938.

Archives, and Rare Books Division; the Arts and The collection, which has grown by historic proper-Artifacts Collection; the Photograph and Prints tions through the years, was renamed in his honor in Collection; and the Moving Image and Recorded 1939, becoming the Arthur A. Schomburg Collection, Sound Collection.

under the curatorship of the noted historian Lawrence Among the rare manuscripts and books housed in D. Reddick.

the collection are a book of poetry by Juan Latino, the With the independence movements that were occur-full-blooded African who occupied the chair of poetry ring in Africa and the Caribbean during the 1950s, the at the University of Granada during the sovereign rule Schomburg Collection soon became the epicenter of of Philip V; the autobiography of Gustavus Vassa; the research conducted on people in the African diaspora original manuscript of Richard Wright's *Native Son*; who were writing new chapters in African history.

the Harry A. Williamson Collection, which chronicles Between 1960 and 1966, during the civil rights and the history of blacks in Freemasonry; and records of the black power movements, the number of annual users Civil Rights Congress, the National Negro Congress, of the collection doubled and by 1972, the number had and the Negro Writers Project. In 2003, the Shabazz quadrupled.

family estate placed the Malcolm X papers on loan there for 75 years.

The Schomburg has also amassed considerable **THE SCHOMBURG COMPLEX:**

artistic holdings. The Blondiau-Theatre Arts Collec-AN
INTERNATIONAL RESOURCE

tion, with its Luba wooden artifacts, Fang brass work, In spite of perennial funding problems, the Pende masks, and ivory, among other pieces, is the Schomburg, as it is commonly known, has evolved core of the Schomburg's African art collection. There and expanded with the passage of time and the growth is also the Eric de Kolb Collection of African Arms, of the

collection. Perhaps the most comprehensive of which includes spears, shields, axes, and knives from its expansions was developed in 1969 with the Roger South and West African peoples, such as the Songhay, Glasgow architectural plan to replace the original struc-Kuba, Zande, Zulu, Maasai, and Fang. Yoruba artwork ture, which had been built in 1905, with a modern is also extensively displayed in the collection.

multimillion-dollar facility to span 135th and 136th Several prominent painters of the Harlem Streets and Lenox Avenue (now Malcolm X

Renaissance, such as Aaron Douglas and Palmer Boulevard). The new building was completed in 1980.

Hayden, are featured in the collection. Pieces by major In 1972 it received its present name, the painters such as Norman Lewis, Jacob Lawrence, and Schomburg Center for Research in Black Culture, Romare Bearden. Augusta Savage, Meta Warrick

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 431

Scottsboro Case——431

Fuller, Lois Mailou Jones, Richmond Barthe, Charles of history, and he also documents many early Africana Alston, Henry O. Tanner, Edward Mitchell Bannister, historical milestones.

and others are also represented. James VanDerZee, *The Schomburg Center for Research in Black Culture*

[Pamphlet]. New York: The New York Public Library. This Gordon Parks, and Edward Steichen are some of the pamphlet details the major holdings of each of the center's master photographers whose works are housed there.

divisions and also provides a brief historical overview.

Among its recorded resources are early radio broadcasts and speeches of the likes of Marcus Garvey, Booker T. Washington, and George Washington Carver.

The collection also holds over 5,000 hours of spoken **SCOTTSBORO CASE**

arts recordings ranging from interviews and lectures to conference proceedings.

The Scottsboro Case refers to the trials and appeals. The Schomburg remains, to this day, strictly a arising from the March 25, 1931 arrest of nine African noncirculating reference collection. It is accessible American males for the gang rape of two white for walk-in use, in addition to being part of several females in Alabama. The charges, later shown to be on line bibliographic resources, including the New York specious, divided the American political left and Public Library's Research Libraries on line public sparked the incipient civil rights movement in the catalog (CATNYP), the On-Line Computer Library American South. Organizations that first gained Center (OCLC), the Research Libraries Information national and international prominence for their part in Network (RLIN), and the Internet. It is directed by the defending the accused became prime movers in the able Howard Dodson.

legal battles of the civil rights movement.

The center publishes the *Schomburg Center*. The accused—Olen Montgomery, Clarence Norris, *Journal*, which is a quarterly newsletter that is avail-Haywood Patterson, Ozzie Powell, Willie Roberson, able to all donors who join the Schomburg Society for Charles Weems, Eugene Williams, Andy Wright, and the Preservation of Black Culture. The *Schomburg* Roy Wright—who became known as the “Scottsboro *Clipping File*, which includes newspaper and maga-Boys”—were arrested by an Alabama deputy sheriff's zine clippings, pamphlets, and collectibles dating posse in Paint Rock and taken to the Jackson County from 1925 to 1981, is published on microfiche by Jail in Scottsboro. The Scottsboro Boys, who ranged Chadwyck-Healey. Finally, the center maintains the in age from 12 to 20, had been traveling on a freight Schomburg Tradition of public education, which takes train with other migrants from Chattanooga, the form of educational conferences, lectures, and Tennessee. Two of the migrants, Victoria Price and exhibitions, ranging from the academic to the artistic.

Ruby Bates, told the deputies that they had been gang-raped by them. At the 1933 retrial, Ruby Bates admit-

— *Pamela Yaa Asantewaa Reed*

ted that she and Victoria Price had made up the charges because they feared that the posse would arrest them for violation of the Mann Act, which prohibited crossing state lines for “immoral” purposes.

FURTHER READING

Bates said that she and Price had had sex on the Deacon, D. (1981). The Art and Artifacts Collection of the train—with two white men.

Schomburg Center in Black Culture: A Preliminary Catalogue. *Bulletin of Research in the Humanities*, 84(2), 137–167. This work catalogues the Schomburg’s African **A QUICK TRIAL AND SENTENCING**

Art and Artifacts collection.

Dodson, Howard. (1986). Introduction. In *The Legacy of The women’s allegations caused an immediate Arthur A. Schomburg: A Celebration of the Past, A Vision* firestorm in Scottsboro. On the night of the arrests, *For the Future* [Publication for an Exhibition]. New York: 300 whites formed a mob outside the jail where the Schomburg Center for Research in Black Culture. This Scottsboro Boys were held, hoping to lynch them publication provides a detailed history of the Schomburg before a trial could take place. The governor of from the time of its founding through 1986.

Alabama was forced to send in the National Guard to Schomburg, Arthur. (1994). The Negro Digs Up His Past. In D.

L. Lewis (Ed.), *The Portable Harlem Renaissance Reader* protect the defendants. Despite the presence of the (pp. 61–67). New York: Penguin. In this essay, Schomburg National Guard, some 10,000 people descended on states his philosophy regarding the study of preservation Scottsboro as the first of the trials in the case began.

432——**Scottsboro Case**

The Scottsboro Boys were at first defended by government officials, including the governor of Stephen Roddy, a Chattanooga attorney with little Alabama and U.S. President Franklin Roosevelt, knowledge of Alabama law, and local attorney Milo received seemingly endless telegrams and mail from Moody, a 70-year-old man who had last tried a case across the world on behalf of the Scottsboro Boys.

over a decade before. Roddy and Moody, who were Just 3 days before their death sentence was to be given less than half an hour to meet with their clients carried out in July of 1931, the defendants learned before the trial, quickly put on a perfunctory defense.

that the court had issued a stay of execution in the Key witnesses—including Price and Bates—were case. By January of 1932, the ILD had appealed their barely cross-examined by Moody and Roddy, and case to the Alabama Supreme Court, arguing that the Roddy was drunk in court. The Scottsboro Boys were Scottsboro Boys had received an unfair trial due to tried in small groups, with the authorities pitting the inadequate counsel and the constant presence of a defendants against each other, making guilty verdicts mob outside the courthouse intimidating the jury.

all but inevitable. Ultimately three of the accused—

However, in a 6–1 vote, the Alabama Supreme Court who later said that they had been beaten and threatened rejected the appeal for most of the defendants, only into giving their testimony—blamed the others for the reducing the sentence of Eugene Williams, who at rapes. The defense rested without any closing argu-13 years old was deemed too young to have been tried ments in the first trial—the all-white, all-male jury as an adult. The ILD appealed to the U.S. Supreme needed less than 2 hours to sentence the Scottsboro Court, which issued the first of its two landmark Boys to death. Only 12-year-old Roy Wright was rulings relating to the Scottsboro case.

spared, as a mistrial was declared for him after 11

In *Powell v. Alabama*, the Supreme Court, in a 7–2

jurors held out for the death penalty, even though the vote, threw out the convictions. The high court argued, prosecution asked only for a life sentence for the boy.

in a momentous decision for both black and white defendants across the United States, that it is the responsibility of the state, under the due process
NATIONAL RESPONSE TO THE CASE

clause of the Fourteenth Amendment of the U.S.

The National Association for the Advancement of Constitution, to provide adequate counsel for defen-Colored People (NAACP) initially refused to involve dants in capital cases. The Supreme Court noted that itself in the appeals of the case. The rape of white it was not until the morning of the trial that the defen-women, as seen by the gathering mobs in Scottsboro, dants had been named counsel, providing little time, was an inflammatory charge in the South. The NAACP

even if the defense attorneys wished to do so, for the feared that its involvement in the case would injure its provision of an adequate defense. “It is hardly neces-ability to pursue the larger cause of gaining improved sary to say that the right to counsel being conceded, a legal status for African Americans in the United States.

defendant should be afforded a fair opportunity to It was the International Labor Defense (ILD), the legal secure counsel of his own choice,” the Court ruled.

arm of the U.S. Communist Party, that stepped into this

“The defendants . . . were thus put in peril of their legal vacuum. After gaining the trust of the defendants lives” with no worthy defense to protect them. The and their families, the ILD initiated a wide legal and first set of trials, the Court argued, went “forward with political campaign for the Scottsboro Boys’ release, the haste of the mob.”

opening itself up to accusations from the NAACP that its interest was less in getting justice for the accused **A NEW DEFENSE**

than in gaining publicity for its cause. The NAACP

then made an attempt to represent the defendants, but With this victory in hand, the ILD hired New York the defendants rebuffed the organization.

attorney Samuel Leibowitz—a political moderate The ILD’s media campaign was successful in bring-with no previous Communist Party affiliations—to ing pressure to bear on Alabama’s judicial system.

defend the Scottsboro Boys in the retrials. These retri-Protests were held all over the United States and the als were moved from Scottsboro to another city in world, including Paris, Moscow, and South Africa; Alabama, Decatur, and were presided over by Judge violent protests erupted in Berlin in 1933 in front of James Horton. From the beginning, Leibowitz laid the a U.S. Consulate office. Throughout the subsequent groundwork for subsequent appeals, arguing that jury trials and appeals, the judges in the cases and high selection in the cases was unconstitutional since

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 433

Scottsboro Case——433

African American citizens were systematically defense motions—including another Leibowitz excluded from the jury pool. Horton refused this and motion relating to the exclusion of African Americans a number of other defense motions. Despite these from the jury pool—and had to be reminded by setbacks, Leibowitz’s defense cast doubt on much of Leibowitz to give the jury the option of a “not guilty”

the prosecution’s case. When Victoria Price took the verdict at the end of the trial. Unsurprisingly, another stand, Leibowitz introduced medical evidence sug-guilty verdict was returned.

gesting that Price and Bates had spent the night before As the defense prepared for its appeals, Nashville the alleged rapes with two men. (Lester

Carter, one of police arrested two ILD lawyers for allegedly having the two men, later testified at the trial that this was attempted to bribe Price to change her testimony.

indeed the case.) Leibowitz also introduced evidence Angered by the allegations, Leibowitz parted with the that contradicted her account of where she had been ILD and formed a coalition, the Scottsboro Defense on the days leading up to the alleged rapes. The defense Committee (SDC), with the participation of the attorney also sought to prove that Price was both a NAACP, the ACLU (American Civil Liberties Union), bootlegger and a prostitute.

and the U.S. Communist Party. In January of 1935, the The most startling moment in the retrials came U.S. Supreme Court heard the SDC's appeal. In a rare with the appearance of Leibowitz's surprise witness, unanimous decision for such a contentious case, the Ruby Bates, who had been missing for some months Court held that Alabama's system of jury selection was leading up to the retrials. Under direct examination unconstitutional because of its systematic exclusion of from Leibowitz, Bates said that she and Price were African Americans from its jury rolls.

never touched or even talked to by the defendants.

Despite its second win in the Supreme Court, the When asked why she and Price had made up the story SDC failed to win the defendants' release in the subse-of the rapes, Bates said that Price had told her to go quent retrials. African Americans were still excluded along with the story in order to avoid morals charges.

from sitting on the juries, though a number were now Despite the new testimony and evidence, the jurors—

included in the jury pool. With appeals of these cases after being told in closing arguments by the assistant in the offing, and after an exhausting and costly 6 years prosecutor not to let Alabama justice “be bought with of retrials and appeals, the SDC agreed to a series of Jew money from New York” and after only a few min-plea bargains that led to the release of four

of the utes of deliberation—convicted and sentenced the defendants: Olen Montgomery, Willie Roberson, defendants.

Eugene Williams, and Roy Wright. The prosecution dropped the rape charges against Ozzie Powell, instead convicting him for an assault on a sheriff's deputy that **RETRIALS**

occurred during the lead-up to the last set of trials. He There was one last surprise, however, in this set of and the other Scottsboro Boys who remained in jail retrials. On June 22, 1933, Judge Horton set aside the served lengthy sentences. Charles Weems was paroled jury verdict, arguing that the evidence presented at in 1943, Ozzie Powell and Clarence Norris were trial made clear that Bates had not been raped by the paroled in 1946, and Andy Wright was finally paroled Scottsboro Boys. A year later, Horton revealed that he in 1950. In 1948, Haywood Patterson escaped from had been told by one of the doctors who had examined prison and was arrested 2 years later in Michigan after the women that there were no signs of rape on the the publication of his memoir, *Scottsboro Boy*.

night of the arrests. Horton said that the doctor, who Michigan, however, refused to extradite him to had a practice in Scottsboro, was afraid to testify to Alabama and Patterson remained free. Only Norris this on the stand.

ever returned to Alabama. In 1976, he accepted a par-With trials set to begin yet again, a wave of lynch-don on behalf of all nine of the Scottsboro Boys from ing spread across the South. The new judge in the Alabama governor George Wallace.

cases, William Callahan, however, refused to grant the defendants the protection of the National Guard.

RUINED LIVES

In this atmosphere, Bates, who had attended pro-Scottsboro Boys rallies across the United States, Free of Alabama, the Scottsboro Boys were never free declined to return to Alabama for the next set of trials, of their ordeals in the 1930s and 1940s. Sodomized in fearing for her life. Callahan refused a number of prisons deemed too miserable to house white prisoners,

434———**Slave Route**

and after their release, stigmatized as rapists by many Scientific, and Cultural Organization) based on a whites, the Scottsboro Boys went on to lives of mixed proposal made to the organization by Haiti. The project success, with some marrying and otherwise coming to was adopted in 1993 (Resolution 27C/3.13) and offi-terms with the horrors of the trials and imprisonment cially started in September of 1994 in Ouidah, and others succumbing to alcohol, disease, and suicide.

Republic of Benin. The choice of Ouidah, one of the The influence of the Scottsboro case on the civil rights most active West African ports during the European movement had an equally mixed record. The South's slave trade, is consistent with the purpose of the Slave oppressive Jim Crow laws remained in effect for some Route. Indeed, the objective of the UNESCO project 30 years after the trials and, as the exclusion of African is twofold: on the one hand, it aims at breaking the American jurors in the last set of retrials proved, civil silence that surrounds the transatlantic European slave rights victories in the judicial system often had little trade and slavery in the Indian Ocean and the effect on the plight of African Americans.

Mediterranean Sea; on the other hand, it seeks to Nevertheless, the Scottsboro case laid the ground-objectively assess, through scientific studies, the inter-work for later gains by the civil rights movement, such actions among all the people involved, as well as the as when the ILD's use of mass campaigning was consequences of the slave trade and slavery for each copied in the 1950s and 1960s by Martin Luther King, party, whether in Europe, Africa, or the Americas.

Jr.'s Southern Christian Leadership Conference. The UNESCO envisions that this should be done in three trials also called into question the strategy of accom-main ways: (1) through a survey and preservation of modation by political liberals, given the obstinacy of all national and religious archival resources on the the Alabama legal system, even in the face of higher issue of the European slave trade and the African court rulings. In the end, the legal lynch mob that con-diaspora, as well as a reliance on the African oral

tra-victed and reconvicted the innocent Scottsboro Boys dition; (2) through the constitution of a data bank; came to represent the racism and injustice of a politi-and (3) through a broad range of scientific research cal and legal system inimical to the rights of African projects with the purpose of a better understanding Americans; through the work of the U.S. Communist from the perspectives of archaeology, history, lin-Party, the NAACP, and other groups, the case also guistics, and other disciplines of the slave trade and came to symbolize the collective action needed to slavery.

bring about this system's downfall.

The findings of such research should lead to the development and implementation of educational pro-

— *Peter Gratton*

grams on the European slave trade and the African diaspora. Thus the proceedings of the Ouidah confer-FURTHER READING

ence were published in 1998 by UNESCO under the Carter, Dan T. (1969). *Scottsboro: A Tragedy of the American title La chaine et le lien: Une vision de la traite South*. Oxford, UK: Oxford University Press. This book is *Négrière*. The Ouidah conference was followed by a good introduction to the Scottsboro case.

a conference in Guadeloupe, Eastern Caribbean, in Kinshasa, Kwando Mbiassi. (1997). *The Man from Scottsboro*: 1998, and by another in Lisbon, Portugal, in 1999.

Clarence Norris and the Infamous 1931 Alabama Rape The proceedings from these conferences were *Trial, in His Own Words*. Jefferson, NC: McFarland. This is also published by UNESCO. Furthermore, in 1998, one of the best works describing one of the central figures August 23 was designated as the International Day in the case.

Patterson, Haywood, and Conrad, Earl. (1950). *Scottsboro* for Commemoration of the Slave Trade. It was first *Boy*. Garden City, NY: Doubleday. This book introduces observed in Haiti in 1998, and then in

Gorée, Senegal, the reader to the entire case by dealing with the example of in 1999. The purpose of such a commemoration is to one of the boys, Haywood Patterson.

ensure that the tragedy experienced by African people, as a result of the slave trade and subsequent African enslavement, will not be forgotten. August 23 was selected because it was on that day in 1791 that the **SLAVE ROUTE**

war Africans in Haiti waged and won against their French enslavers began.

The Slave Route is an ambitious project that was The ultimate goal of the Slave Route project is launched by UNESCO (United Nations Educational, through a scientific investigation and ethical questioning

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 435

Songhay Empire————435

of the past to shed light on all societies and facilitate followers of Islam, Sunni Ali Ber took on a Muslim the advent of genuine cultural pluralism, based on name. And while he was a proponent of traditional true respect for historical, geographical, and cultural customs and religions, he did not exclude or margin-diversity.

alize followers of Islam. Sunni Ali Ber's ability to expand a once vassal state to a position of promi-

— *Ama Mazama*

nence, while maintaining peace among his diverse followers, was a great example of his political savvy. The **FURTHER READING**

Islamic expansion, however, was leaving an undeni-Henriques, Castro Isabel (Ed.). (2003). *Déraison, Esclavage, et* able imprint on the region and, despite Sunni Ali Ber's *Droit: Les Fondements Idéologiques et Juridiques de la* astute leadership, an orthodox Muslim named Askia *Traite Négrière et de L'esclavage*. Paris: Editions UNESCO.

Mohammed overthrew him.

These are the proceedings of the third Slave Route conference-Askia Mohammed reigned from 1493 to 1529.

ence, held in Lisbon, Portugal. The volume provides a useful delineation of the scope of the project and of some Although Askia Mohammed's religious beliefs were of the findings of the researchers.

different from Sunni Ali Ber's, his abilities as a leader www.unesco.org/culture/dialogue/slave/html_fr/index.shtml were similar to those of his predecessor. Under the This is a resourceful site on the Slave Route project. It rule of Askia Mohammed, the Songhay Empire was should be consulted for further and updated information.

expanded and became the largest empire in the history of West Africa. In addition, Askia Mohammed used his Islamic faith to converse with various nations on how to improve the administration of his government.

SONGHAY EMPIRE

Specifically, Askia Mohammed undertook a pilgrimage to Mecca, a religious obligation of all Muslims, Songhay was the third great West African empire after but his pilgrimage was for more than a religious experience. He and his fleet conversed with scholars, math-Songhay rose and declined in power. The Malian ematicians, and scientists. As a result of these contacts, Empire ruled Songhay, once a small kingdom known Askia instituted various learned strategies to strengthen as Gao, during the reign of Mansa Musa. By 1355, the empire.

however, Songhay became a sovereign state, and John Hope Franklin and Alfred Moss wrote that under the leadership of Sunni Ali Ber (1464–1492) as a ruler, Askia Mohammed “devoted his energies Songhay conquered key cities such as Timbuktu and to strengthening his empire, making people prosperous Djenné. This established Songhay as a dominant and encouraging learning.” Askia Mohammed power in West Africa.

achieved his goal of a strengthened empire through Songhay and its rise to prominence were the result decentralization. He instituted a series of cabinet-level of effective leaders with great ingenuity, a respect for positions while also establishing local governmental traditional customs, and strict governmental organiza-control as a way to stay abreast of the happenings in tion. The most noteworthy leaders during the reign of the far regions of his empire. While the Songhay the Songhay Empire were Sunni Ali Ber and Askia Empire predated the United States by over 200 years, Mohammed. Sunni Ali Ber ruled with a great respect the organization of the government of the two is very for traditional customs and resisted the influence of similar. In fact, in the book *Classical Africa*, Molefi Islam on African culture. He expanded the kingdom Asante illustrates the comparison with a display of the and promoted education, the arts, and commerce.

cabinet positions. Commerce was also enhanced dur-During his reign, Songhay became home to the great ing Askia Mohammed's reign, with traders traveling universities of Timbuktu and Djenne, where tradi-from as far as Europe and Asia to trade with the tional African scholarship was advanced.

Songhay Empire. A banking system was in place that The expansion of Songhay during the reign of provided credit and used a uniform system of weights Sunni Ali Ber was the result of his having built a naval and measures.

fleet to control the Niger River. This fleet enabled When Askia Mohammed overthrew Sunni Ali Ber, Sunni Ali Ber to capture Timbuktu, Djenne, and Mali.

the empire boasted great intellectual centers such as Shrewd and keenly aware of the need to unite the Timbuktu, Djenne, and Gao. West African scholars people of the kingdom, many of whom had become were known to study at the universities. Askia

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 436

Mohammed continued this tradition of intellectual attuned to the nuances and symbolism of a piece of expansion, but from a strict Islamic perspective.

music, they might say that the music has soul. People Whereas Sunni Ali Ber held to traditional African can also experience soul when they see and hear a culture, Askia Mohammed maintained his devotion to public speaker: The listener or observer can quite eas-Islam. This was most prevalent in the educational ily tell if an orator has soul or not by paying attention system, where the universities were reorganized to to the gestures, linguistic slides, and mannerisms of emphasize an Islamic model and way of thinking.

the orator's voice and body, as well as to his or her Askia Mohammed, in declining health, was eventu-general appearance. Soul is the experience of a per-ally overthrown by his two sons. His sons proved not formance rather than the experience of a text, as it to possess the political savvy and organization of the engages more than the mind. Soul is the expression of Songhay Empire's previous rulers. The empire became all the most intimate secrets of a people.

fragmented, with each son attempting to rule a part of In Black Studies, the idea of soul carries with it the region. Eventually, Askia Mohammed's youngest the idea of that which possesses meaning. Sometimes son, Daoud Mohammed, took over and ruled from events, personalities, and situations conspire to create 1549 to 1582. Nevertheless, the period following Askia an atmosphere for soul to emerge. When soul emerges, Mohammed's death marked the decline of the empire.

everyone who has participated or participates in the Eventually the Moroccans took over the region and historical reality of African people knows that it has ruled for over 100 peaceless years. The people of come. To some degree, soul is a psychological fact—

Songhay resisted the Moroccans, and while they were a feeling, a mood, and an attitude. How individuals ultimately defeated, they never revealed the location of mediate their lives when confronted with the power of the empire's vast gold mines to their conquerors.

the concept in music, art, dance, or a sermon is a sep- The reigns of Sunni Ali Ber and Askia Mohammed are a arena for discussion. Soul is the evidence of an encompassed the height of the Songhay Empire. Each instantiation of African American culture, history, and ruler possessed the characteristics and desires of tra-experiences. People evoke soul through epic memo-ditional African leaders: prosperity for the people, ries of ancestors' names, ritual performances that education, and peace. While Sunni Ali Ber and Askia simulate victories over obstacles, and appeals to com-Mohammed differed greatly over religion, their lead-monalties that are historically grounded, whether in a ership catapulted the Songhay Empire to worldwide particular jazz riff or in a Martin Luther King-style acclaim.

sermon.

— *Mario Root*

— *Daryl Zizwe Poe*

FURTHER READING

FURTHER READING

Asante, Molefi Kete. (1994). *Classical Africa*. Saddlecreek, Davis, Gerald. (1985). *I Got the Word in Me and I Can Sing It*, NJ: Peoples Publishing Group. This book details in text-You Know: A Study of the Performed African American book fashion the empires of classical Africa.

Sermon. Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Press.

Franklin, John Hope, and Moss, Alfred A., Jr. (1988). *From This study demonstrates how the African American Slavery to Freedom*. New York: McGraw-Hill. This is an preacher used the sermon to reach levels of communion in-depth chronicle of the history of blacks in America, with the audience that could not have been reached without beginning with a discussion of the states in Africa where performance, the essence of which is soul.

many blacks in America trace their ancestry.

Jones, Leroi (now Amiri Baraka). (1963). *Black Music*.

New York: William Morrow. This book, by one of the most brilliant writers in African American history, demonstrates the role that music plays in developing the philosophical **SOUL**

and ethical grounds of the African American culture. The book is based on the author's personal experiences and academic inquiry and is a penetrating and interpretative. The idea of soul in African American culture is a qualitative account of black music in America.

ity of consciousness that puts people in direct contact Jones, Leroi (now Amiri Baraka). (1963). *Black People*.

with history, culture, and religion. *Soul* is an expressive New York: William Morrow. Here the author explores the consciousness that takes into consideration all aspects special qualities of soul that are based on the nature of oratory, music, dance, and art. When people are African experience in America.

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 437

Southern Christian Leadership Conference——437

Walker, Sheila S. (1972). Ceremonial Spirit Possession in the bonds of enslavement. After the end of slavery, Africa and Afro-American: Forms, Meanings, and Functions. Blacks in the United States believed that the key to ritual Significance for Individuals and Social Groups.

their equality was having the right to vote. However, Leiden, The Netherlands: E. J. Brill. This is one of the ear-gaining the power of the ballot did not give blacks. Liest works on ceremonial spirit possession in both the freedom, self-pride, and assurance, and Du Bois uses African and the African American contexts.

this as evidence of the constant struggle and trials that Africans in America must endure. What is most important about these struggles, however, is the

THE SOULS OF BLACK FOLK

resilience and resistance they show to exist in the African spirit. Du Bois says this resilience has been *The Souls of Black Folk* is a compilation of essays by instrumental in creating the souls of black folk and is W.E.B. (William Edward Burghardt) Du Bois that was at their foundation.

published in 1903. Part social documentary, part W.E.B. Du Bois's *The Souls of Black Folk* has had history, part autobiography, part anthropological field a significant impact on Black Studies. The fact that it report, *The Souls of Black Folk* remains unparalleled is used at least once as a basic text in most Black in its scope. In *The Souls of Black Folk*, Du Bois Studies students' careers is evidence of its importance describes the effect that living in segregation has on and contribution to the discipline. Most work done on the soul, spirit, and consciousness of black people African people has not been written by or from the being held in its grasp. He shows the creation and perspective of African people. *The Souls of Black Folk* maintaining of the racial divide from slavery until was written by Du Bois in way that allows black after the Reconstruction period.

people to speak for themselves and promotes an Du Bois opens *The Souls of Black Folk* with a understanding of black ontology.

description of life under "the veil." The veil is

— *Natalie Lewis*

described as the curtain that has been drawn between the black and white races, the curtain that keeps the **FURTHER READING**

two races separate and unequal. This curtain forced blacks into enslavement, which enabled the South to Chinweizu. (1987). *Decolonizing the African Mind*. Lagos, benefit from free and forced labor. This curtain also Nigeria: Sundoor. This is an excellent book on the prob-allowed the Northern part of the United States to go lems that confront African people

because of racism, slavery, and discrimination. According to Chenweizu, what on with its daily routine, acting as if nothing was out the African can do to eliminate the condition of coloniza-of place. The veil, as Du Bois saw it, created the prin-tion is to remove all the vestiges of colonization in the ciple and practice of the system of the color line in the mind.

United States.

Cruse, Harold. (1967). *The Crisis of the Negro Intellectual*.

The veil Du Bois describes is said to force black New York: William Morrow. This is perhaps one of the most people to have a double consciousness in which they important works on the culture of the African American see themselves as both black and American. This is intellectual since Du Bois's *The Souls of Black Folk*.

one of the most important concepts Du Bois explores Woodson, Carter G. (1977). *The Mis-Education of the Negro*.

Washington, DC: Associated Publishers. (Original work in *The Souls of Black Folk*. He admits in the book that published 1933). This is the classic work by a major histo-he himself struggles with just such a double con-rian, in which he discusses the educational situation of sciousness. There have been many discussions and African Americans.

debates about the double consciousness concept, with some people arguing that it reflects only Du Bois's personal crisis with being rejected by the majority white society, and others contending that double con-SOUTHERN CHRISTIAN

sciousness is a universal state of blacks dwelling in the United States of America.

LEADERSHIP CONFERENCE

The Souls of Black Folk is an exemplary examination of the ontology of black people. In it, Du Bois The Southern Christian Leadership Conference discusses the struggle within blacks over time. First, (SCLC) was formed

soon after the Montgomery Bus this struggle came from their wanting to be free from Boycott, which began on December 5, 1955 in

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 438

438———**Spirituals**

response to the arrest of a black woman named **FURTHER READING**

Rosa Parks for refusing to give up her seat to a white man on the bus. The boycott was maintained for 381 days, until December 21, 1956, when it ended on the role women played in the civil rights movement, with the desegregation of the Montgomery bus including SCLC, SNCC, and NAACP.

system. The leaders of the boycott were officers of the Grant, Joanne (Ed.). (1968). *Black Protest*. New York: Fawcett Montgomery Improvement Association (MIA)—its World Library. This is a documentary history of the president, Martin Luther King, Jr., and program direct-movement.

tor, Ralph David Abernathy. When the boycott was King, Coretta Scott. (1993). *My Life with Martin Luther King Jr.* New York: Henry Holt. This personal memoir adds context, a new phase had begun in the civil rights movement—text to the lives of those actively involved in the struggle.

ment—the phase of direct struggle to end segregation.

Soon bus boycotts spread across the South, and it was important for the leaders of the MIA and other protest groups to meet in January of 1957 to form a regional **SPIRITUALS**

organization and coordinate protest activities across the South.

Spirituals are the musical expressions created by Abernathy's home and church were bombed during enslaved Africans to maintain their spiritual and cultural meeting, where 60 persons from 10 states assembled while Southern slaveowners were killed and announced the founding of the

Southern attempting to Christianize them. The songs demon-Leadership Conference on Transportation and strate the human spirit in resistance to bondage with Nonviolent Integration. They issued a document an overarching theme of freedom, both spiritual and declaring that civil rights are essential to democracy, physical. Enslaved Africans relied on their faith in the that segregation must end, and that all black people divine to help them endure the harsh and cruel condi-should reject segregation absolutely and nonviolently.

tions of slavery. Two vital elements of the cultural tra-The group held a second meeting in New Orleans, dition of their ancestors express this faith and the Louisiana, on February 14, 1957. The organization resilience it inspired—the African oral tradition and shortened its name to Southern Leadership Conference, African music. The sacred songs that came to be established an executive board of directors, and known as spirituals affirmed an African worldview elected officers, including Martin Luther King as and were a critical vehicle for group unity in which president; Ralph David Abernathy as financial secre-the enslaved Africans could all take part. The spiritu-tary-treasurer; C. K. Steele of Tallahassee, Florida, als articulated directly and indirectly the enslaved as vice president; T. J. Jemison of Baton Rouge, Africans’ collective discontent with the injustices and Louisiana, as secretary; and I. M. Augustine of New inhumanities of the slave system and their hope and Orleans, Louisiana, as general counsel.

assurance of liberation.

At its first convention, in Montgomery in August of 1957, the Southern Leadership Conference adopted the current name, the Southern Christian Leadership **GROWTH AND DEVELOPMENT**

Conference. The basic decisions made by the founders **OF THE SONGS**

of the organization at this early meeting included the By the late 18th century, the spiritual had begun, in a adoption of nonviolent mass action as the cornerstone small way, to distinguish itself from other music per-of strategy, the affiliation of local community organi-formed by enslaved Africans primarily by the context zations with SCLC across the South, and a determina-in which it was performed. However, it was in the mid-tion to

make the SCLC movement open to all, despite of the 19th century that the spiritual reached its full regardless of race, religion, or background. Now, development. Although other forms of African nearly 50 years later, the SCLC is a nationwide organization of chapters and affiliates with style (e.g., the blues), the spiritual had its impetus and programs throughout the nation, and it has become growth as a musical form in the clandestine gatherings international in its scope and activities.

of Africans in religious ceremonies and rituals.

— *Mario Root*

Plantation owners' effort to Christianize enslaved

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 439

Spirituals——439

Africans was a covert tactic to subjugate and control Call-and-response patterns are typical in all the them, and enslaved Africans recognized the insincerity types of spirituals, whether in the form of solo and of the Christian proselytizers. Africans' predilection group responses, variable solo calls and repeated to spirituality, however, allowed them to transform the refrains, or solo and solo alternating responses.

newly introduced religious concepts and ideas into Many of the melodies of the spirituals are replicas of their cosmology, which led to the formulation of re-African melodies extracted from cultural memory, religious practices based on their African past. It was in while other melodies are the spontaneous creations these religious practices that the spiritual was born.

of talented individuals who used African concepts in The spirituals are a classic example of the creative the arrangement of melodic tones and drew upon and dynamic communicative possibilities of music musical scales common in Africa. Improvisation in African cultures that continued to be explored by takes place on several levels in the performance Africans in the Americas. The songs were used for of spirituals: Songs are created

spontaneously with multiple purposes: to teach, to inspire, to signal, to the text improvised as the song progresses and comment, to inform, and to tell stories. They not only melodic lines improvised with repetitions that vary were used for religious expressions but also covered slightly.

the history, thoughts, and aspirations of enslaved Africans and contextualized their lives and affairs **POPULAR RECOGNITION**

under the oppression and religious hypocrisy of the slave system. Most important, the spirituals were The spirituals first became recognized nationally and practical tools that served as coded communications internationally in the 1870s through the performances for emotional and physical escape as well as rebellion.

of the Fisk Jubilee Singers, a group of college musi-The texts of the spirituals are full of allusion and cians from Fisk University in Nashville, Tennessee.

imagery with hidden and double meanings. Many of Their concert-arranged versions of the spirituals the texts include biblical words like *Savior*, suggesting helped preserve the orally transmitted songs of their God, ancestor spirits, or Harriet Tubman and *Canaan* ancestors. H. T. Burleigh, the first African American referring to heaven, a better life in a Northern state, or composer to gain national recognition as a composer, freedom after emancipation. The phrase *my home* indi-arranger, and singer, transcribed and arranged spiritu-cated Africa and *steal away to Jesus* implied escape to als for solo voice. Internationally renowned African the North. A few of the most well-known spirituals are American musicians such as Marian Anderson,

“Go Down Moses,” “O Mary Don’t You Weep, Don’t Roland Hayes, and Paul Robeson performed You Mourn,” “Walk Together Children,” “Wade in the Burleigh’s solo arrangements on the concert stage.

Water,” “Roll Jordan Roll,” and “Deep River.”

James Weldon and J. Rosamond Johnson, John Work III, and Nathaniel Dett have provided other major **TYPES OF SPIRITUALS**

collections of the spirituals.

Musically, the spiritual represents the persistence of The spiritual is of paramount significance because African identity in the United States, with musical of its role as an authentic African American cultural continuances in African rhythms, call-and-response, artifact and for its widespread musical influence. It melody, and improvisation. The older spirituals were has been at the crux of all African American sacred of three basic types: ring shouts, sorrow songs, and music and has influenced every form of American jubilees. The ring shout was derived from West African popular music. The intensity and power of the spiri-rituals and ceremonies and involved singing the spiritual is evidenced in its universality and enduring tual, shouting, dancing, and drumming produced by message of triumph.

hand clapping, foot stomping, and tapping with sticks.

— *Mawusi Renee Simmons*

The rhythm of this type of spiritual is strongly influenced by the rhythms of the dance and percussion. The **FURTHER READING**

sorrow song has a slow tempo, is intensely poignant, Cone, James H. (1992). *The Spirituals and the Blues: An* and speaks directly to the conditions of slavery. *The Interpretation*. New York: Seebury Press. (Original work jubilee has a faster tempo and expresses the hopeful published 1972). This is Cone's penetrating theological expectation and joys of freedom.

interpretation and analysis of the spirituals.

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 440

440——— *Stolen Legacy*

Jones, Arthur C. (1993). *Wade in the Water: The Wisdom of the* on the contents and expansiveness of his writings, is *Spirituals*. Maryknoll, NY: Orbis Books. This book shows suspect. Pythagoras was expelled from Italy, Socrates the wisdom and teachings of the spirituals.

was executed, Plato was sold into slavery, and Lovell, John L. (1972). *Black Song: The Forge and the Flame*.

Aristotle was indicted and exiled. If the knowledge New York: Paragon House. This has been the authoritative and wisdom they were credited with was indigenous work on black song for more than 25 years.

Walker, Wyatt Tee. (1982). *Somebody's Calling My Name: to the Greek paradigm, why then would they have Black Sacred Music and Social Change*. Valley Forge, PA: been punished and ostracized by their societies?

Judson Press. Walker is a giant in the music, oratorical, and Furthermore, James asks, how could Plato, a philoso-civil rights fields, and he has given us a great book.

pher, instruct Aristotle, a scientist? According to James, it is physically impossible for Aristotle to have researched and published the works he is credited with in a single lifetime.

STOLEN LEGACY

Stolen Legacy has become one of the most frequently discussed books in Black Studies. It has cap-The author of *Stolen Legacy*, George Granville Monah tivated the minds of classicists like Mary Lefkowitz, James, was born in Guyana to Reverend Linch B.

been the topic of discussion for educators like Asa James and Margaret E. James. He earned his bache-Hilliard and Tony Martin, and been used by scholars lor's and master's degrees from Durham University in such as Martin Bernal and Molefi Kete Asante to England, then proceeded to earn his doctorate at make points about the valuable contributions of Columbia University in New York. James served as a Africans to world culture . *Stolen Legacy* is undoubt-professor of Greek and Logic at Livingston College edly one of the most fascinating books in the field of in Salisbury, North Carolina, and then taught at the Black Studies.

University of Arkansas, Pine Bluff. Shortly after the

— Gwinyai Muzorewa

publication of *Stolen Legacy*, which he completed while at the University of Arkansas, James died under **FURTHER READING**

mysterious circumstances. Popular rumors suggested he might have been killed because he exposed anti-Asante, Molefi Kete. (1999). *The Painful Demise of* mate knowledge related to the Masonic tradition.

Eurocentrism. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This work is Asante's response to Mary Lefkowitz's controversial *Not Others* believe that James died because his work *Out of Africa*. Asante demonstrates the relevance of challenged the idea of white racial supremacy by con-Egyptian ideas and philosophies to the making of the tending that the Greeks got their information from ancient world.

Africans, especially ancient Egyptians.

Bernal, Martin. (1987). *Black Athena*. New Brunswick, NJ: James's seminal work, *Stolen Legacy*, was com-Rutgers University Press. This book created a strong argu-pleted in 1954 and exposed the Greek philosophers ment for rethinking the conventional ideas about the Greek Pythagoras, Socrates, Plato, and Aristotle as fraudulent origin of civilization.

in their claim to have originated the philosophies and Bynum, Edward Bruce. (1999). *The African Unconscious: Roots of Ancient Mysticism and Modern Psychology*.

equations with which they are credited. The uncovering New York: Teachers College Press. Bynum pulls together of this deception dissolves the myth of the primacy of an immense body of African knowledge into one volume.

ancient Greek intellectual, scientific, theological, and cosmological contributions to humanity. The notion of the absence of Africa's contribution to humanity is also dissolved in *Stolen Legacy*, which reveals where and **STONO REBELLION**

how the Greek philosophers took their information from the Africans. In order to show the connections between The Stono Rebellion was the first large-scale uprising the ancient Egyptians and Greeks, James delves into the of enslaved Africans in North America during the philosophical development of the most important Greek colonial period. In the 17th and the early 18th cen-philosophers and exposes their ideas as consistent with turies, because the white population was outnumbered the earlier ideas of African philosophers.

by a massive number of Africans imported from the According to *Stolen Legacy*, the perception of Congo-Angolan region, a series of laws was enacted Aristotle as the wisest man ever to live, which is based to repress enslaved Africans in the Carolina colony.

S-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 441

Stono Rebellion——441

The enslaved Africans took advantage of this situation Stono Rebellion ultimately failed; however, it did to plan and organize a massive uprising. They were demonstrate enslaved Africans' robust cultural and united in their determination for freedom, as well as in armed resistance to the appalling slave system, as well their similar kinship and linguistic ties, as the major-as their strong commitment to the establishment of an ity of enslaved Africans in South Carolina were newly independent African community such as the one they imported from Angola. The Africans used drums and planned to create in Florida.

chants of "liberty" to recruit and unite other enslaved The Stono Rebellion induced white colonists in the Africans to fight against the oppression of white South to establish strict legislation aimed at promptly planters, who were the minority in 18th-century South controlling enslaved Africans. The Negro Act was Carolina. Their goal was to flee to St. Augustine, enacted in 1740 to ensure total subordination of Florida, where the Spanish had promised protection enslaved Africans in South Carolina. The act required and freedom for all Africans enslaved by the British.

all white men to carry guns, and prohibited enslaved Africans from beating African drums during slave gatherings, from assembling and working on Sundays, from earning money, from growing their own food, from learning to read. The act also limited direct miles from Charleston, South Carolina. During church slave importation from Africa, which it was thought services, which most white planters attended, the group could encourage slave revolts.

broke into a firearms store by Stono Bridge, plundered the store's boxes of guns and ammunition, and killed the store's owners. The consequences of the rebellion were that whites were never able to eliminate their fear of revolts, and two owners when they returned unexpectedly, leaving enslaved Africans' commitment to freedom based on their heads on the porch. The group of Africans pro- their African heritage thrived with the legacy of this rebellion toward St. Augustine via Pon Pons Road, the large-scale revolt, as evidenced by successive conspiracies and revolts in later years.

the group swelled to more than 50, and subsequently

— *Suzuko Morikawa*

killed the innkeepers of a tavern, their neighbors, overseers, and other white men, women, and children, and **FURTHER READING**

burnt their houses to the ground. Late in the afternoon, after traveling more than 10 miles from Stono, the Wood, Peter. (1996). *Black Majority: Negroes in Colonial white militia launched a surprise attack and fired on the South Carolina from 1670 through the Stono Rebellion.*

group of enslaved Africans. The groups exchanged fire, New York: W. W. Norton. This book has a very detailed discussion of the obstacles Africans found in South Carolina in the 17th and early 18th centuries.

least 30 Africans escaped, though some were captured
www.pbs.org/wgbh/aia/part1/1p284.html This Web site is a south of the
incident and shot to death; most of useful source for information on the
Stono Rebellion, see the remainder of those who escaped were arrested
especially the article “Africans in America: Part 1. The and hanged over the
following 6 months. Thus the Stono Rebellion.”

T-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 443

T

and African American social and political philosophy.

TALENTED TENTH

What follows is a critical assessment of the contributions this theory has
made and continues to make to W.E.B. Du Bois’s theory of “the talented
tenth”

the discourse and debates surrounding African registers right along with his
concept of “double-American social development and cultural survival.

consciousness” as among his most celebrated and controversial
contributions to African American edu-THE TALENTED TENTH THESIS:

cational, social, and political thought traditions.

THE INITIAL ARTICULATION (1903)

However, unlike his concept of double consciousness, Du Bois returned to
and revised his theory of the tal-Du Bois initially articulated the talented
tenth in his ented tenth. Many scholars and critics have inter-essay by that
name in the edited volume *The Negro* preted Du Bois’s theory of the most
talented tenth of *Problem: A Series of Articles by Representative African*
Americans leading the rest as utterly elitist American Negroes of Today
(1903), which included and thoroughly shot through with European ideals

pieces by Booker T. Washington, Charles W. Chesnutt, from Enlightenment thought to European American Paul Laurence Dunbar, and T. Thomas Fortune, among aristocratic philosophy and political theory. But other others. The talented tenth is divided into three parts: scholars and critics have argued that Du Bois's much The first part provides a philosophy of history that mangled theory of the talented tenth is actually not highlights and accents African American achievements about the black bourgeoisie or African American aris-against all the odds that holocaust and enslavement tocracy leading the black masses and working classes entail. Du Bois's philosophy of history places female but, rather, about an assemblage of people of charac-freedom fighters right alongside their male counterter who are actively dedicated to black liberation and parts, invoking the names of Phillis Wheatley, David democratic social transformation.

Walker, Sojourner Truth, Henry Highland Garnett, The confusion and contradictory interpretations of Harriet Tubman, Alexander Crummell, and Frederick Du Bois's theory are partly the result of his vagueness Douglass. Though there has long been confusion and, in Du Bois's own words, his youth and idealism among Du Bois's critics concerning the line that opens in his initial articulation of the talented tenth theory in and closes the essay, which refers to race being saved 1903. It also did not help matters much that it took by its exceptional men, he actually meant (as he made him 45 years to respond to criticisms and revise the clear in his 1948 revision of the talented tenth thesis) theory, which he did in 1948. Taken together, Du that African American uplift rested squarely on the Bois's 1903 and 1948 versions of the talented tenth shoulders of both black men and black women of theory are seminal and highly significant contribu-character. These black men and black women, like the tions to African American leadership and liberation freedom fighters just mentioned, constantly seek self-thought; African American philosophy of education; knowledge, self-realization, and self-control, and they 443

T-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 444

444———**Talented Tenth**

possess a serious and sincere spirit of service and found out that the spirit of Jeffersonian individualism sacrifice. The first and last line of Du Bois's

essay has and simple-minded selfishness was not something also been interpreted as an unmitigated endorsement of plaguing whites alone, but that blacks were under its African American leadership and social development pernicious spell as well. It was with a sense of great under the auspices of the black bourgeoisie or African disillusionment and deep depression that in 1948 Du Bois returned to and revised his theory of the talented tenth of his more sympathetic interpreters, however, he was tenth into “the doctrine of the guiding hundredth.”

not calling for leadership by the African American upper class, but leadership via the African American **THE GUIDING HUNDREDTH**

educated class, which by his estimate of 1903

THESIS: REVISITING AND

amounted to 10% of the African American population, **REVISING THE TALENTED TENTH (1948)** thus comprising the talented tenth of African Americans. In the first part of this essay, then, Du Bois In 1948, The Talented Tenth Memorial Address was is at pains to predicate African American uplift on the delivered at the Nineteenth Grand Boulé Conclave African American intelligentsia using its knowledge of of Sigma Pi Phi fraternity. From the outset of the and access to crucial and critical resources in the best address, Du Bois made it known that he had come to interest of the black masses, as opposed to merely its criticize not simply others’ black leadership and liber-upper and/or middle classes.

ation thought but, in a rare self-reflexive moment, his The second part of the essay engages the issues own black social development discourse. He was baffled-surrounding African American education at the turn fled and bemoaned the fact that so many black leaders of the 20th century, issues at the heart of the debate and intellectuals aped the aristocratic attitudes of the between Du Bois and Booker T. Washington. Where white ruling race and class. He also chided himself Washington was firmly for industrial education and for being naïve and not clearly laying out in 1903 the trade training, Du Bois declared that college educa-basic qualities and characteristics of the talented tenth and culture training was a prerequisite for

black tenth—qualities and characteristics that ultimately leadership and black liberation. Du Bois did not deny revolved around the black intelligentsia's ethical that industrial education was extremely important to obligations to the youth, the aged, and the infirm, as black life. He, however, believed that blacks needed well as the poor and poverty stricken. It was no longer broadly cultured men and women in leadership position enough for the talented tenth to be talented, equipped to guard against the manipulations and machinations of the white ruling race and class and the gle, sacrifice, and serve in the best interests of the hundreds of half-trained black demagogues and black masses. Du Bois then charged the talented tenth opportunists. Without broadly cultured men and with the task of providing self-sacrificing leadership women, by which he meant men and women with an through honesty of character and purity of motive. He acute understanding of the historical and current life criticized his 1903 articulation of the talented tenth struggles of black people and an intense ethical obligation, observing that it allowed a few selfish, self-tion (almost fanatic devotion) to black liberation, Du indulgent, well-to-do men to control the process of Bois surmised that blacks were without a doubt surely African American leadership. Du Bois was upset doomed to a slow and painful sociocultural death at with himself for not clarifying the central elements of the hands of racism, capitalism, and colonialism.

the talented tenth thesis and, therefore, leaving his The third part of the essay takes a headfirst and thought open to charges of aristocratic and intellectual hardnosed look at the relationship and responsibility of elitism. He declared that money and advanced education-black leaders and intellectuals to the black liberation tion did not in the past and do not presently make struggle. From Du Bois's perspective, black leaders people fit to lead, that only those who constantly cou-and intellectuals have an ethical obligation to use their wealth with character and a commitment to black training and knowledge to improve the conditions of people's highest ideals and interests are fit to lead.

the black masses and working classes. In 1903, Du In the final analysis, it all came down to a question Bois unwittingly "assumed," as he put it in 1948, that of character. In the talented tenth thesis, Du Bois black leaders

and intellectuals would make the sacri-emphasized education and economics, but he fices necessary to serve the black masses. He quickly neglected to connect them to personal character and

T-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 445

Temple Circle——445

social ethics. The guiding hundredth thesis, however, of this group were scholars such as C. T. Keto, Ama was careful to couple black educational and economic Mazama, Aisha Blackshire-Belay, Kariamuwelsh, needs with social ethics, democratic socialism, and a Theophile Obenga, James Ravell, Charles Fuller, Nah dash of black nationalism. The new black leaders, the Dove, Thelma Ravell, and several others.

guiding hundredth, had to be “moral leaders” as well There were three main ideas that motivated the as social and political leaders. What is more, they Temple Circle. In the first place, the TC believe that were charged with the task of sidestepping the con-it was possible to create a discipline of African ventional elitism and the vulgarities of vanguardism American Studies based on theories and methods that often associated with leadership cadres, Du Bois’s were derived from the historical and lived experiences talented tenth included. Extending and expanding his of African people. Second, the members of the talented tenth theory, Du Bois conceived of the guid-Temple Circle felt that a school of thought originating ing hundredth as a dedicated group of leaders from in the intellectual works of an African scholar could any and/or all classes of black people devoted to radi-seriously empower African people to believe in their cal democratic group leadership and antiracist social own inherent capacity to define themselves. Third, the change. This means, then, that his 1903 talented tenth Temple Circle was an exercise in collec-tive intellec-thesis served more as a stepping-stone theory than a tual power, as the members accepted the idea that full-blown and finished social program. Du Bois what they created out of group consciousness and dis-developed the thesis to speak to the specific social and cussion could be advanced as a common front in the political problems confronting African Americans at Western academy. Thus, the implication of this idea, the turn of the 20th century. The guiding hundredth grounded in the concepts of *agency, location, cen-theory was a mid-century*

update and expansion of the tiredness, and orientation, was enormous. Starting talented tenth thesis that, though often overlooked, with the notion that Africans had been decentered by symbolizes an important development in Du Bois's the enslaving and colonizing force of Europe, the social, political, and educational thought.

Temple Circle chose to view the entirety of African history since the encounter with Europe as resistance

— Reiland Rabaka

to dislocation.

FURTHER READING

AFROCENTRIC

*Battle, Juan II, and Wright, Earl. (2002). W.E.B. Du Bois's Talented Tenth: A Quantitative Assessment. Journal of **CATEGORIZATION OF SOCIAL PRACTICE***

Black Studies, 32(6), 654–672. This is one of the best article in an attempt to establish categories for analysis, the clues on the importance of Du Bois's Talented Tenth idea.

Temple Circle argued that there were four classes of James, Joy. (1997). Transcending the Talented Tenth: Black Leaders and American Intellectuals. New York: Routledge.

social practice in the historical relationship between James critiques black leadership in terms of transcending those who held social and economic power and those the talented tenth idea.

who sought to free themselves from a position of Rabaka, Reiland. (2001). Africana Critical Theory: From powerlessness. They called these categories the W.E.B. Du Bois and C.L.R. James's Discourse on

“Afrocentric Categorization of Social Practice,” which Domination and Liberation to Frantz Fanon and Amilcar then became a basis for the

scientific interpretation of Cabral's Dialectics of Decolonization. Unpublished doc-African behavior in the face of white racial domination dissertation, Temple University. This is a comprehension. Seeking to reduce the level of analytical noise side examination of critical theory.

that existed in social relations, the Temple Circle suggested that the use of these categories would strengthen the conceptualization of the field of African American Studies. The four categories of social practice-TEMPLE CIRCLE

tice divide individuals into capitulationists, integrationists, separatists, and Afrocentrists.

The Temple Circle (TC) was a group of Afrocentric According to the Temple Circle, capitulationists are scholars gathered at Temple University in the late 1980s and early 1990s around the intellectual ideas psychological, economic, and/or historical agency to a paradigm articulated by Molefi Kete Asante. Among the leaders hostile culture for an illusory gain. Their aim is to

T-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 446

446—— *Their Eyes Were Watching God*

agree to the dominant society's perception that their culture is inferior and that there is no value to it. In Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This remains the effect, capitulationists are saying, "We can easily give best work on the general intellectual movements in Black Studies.

this up and go either way. One day we can be black, the Mazama, Ama. (Ed.). (2003). The Afrocentric Paradigm.

next day we can be white." Integrationists are those who seek to combine their social and political cultures with a collection of works supporting the Temple Circle ideas.

dominant society to create an atmosphere for accep-Smith, Robert C. (1996). We Have No Leaders: African tance by the dominant society. Their aim is to allay any Americans in the Post Civil Rights Era. Albany: State fears that they are threatening the established dominant University of New York Press. This is an outstanding schol-society's right to dominate. Integrationists are saying, arly examination of African American political culture.

“We are the same, just different colors. We support your actions because we believe in your principles.”

Separatists are those who seek to isolate themselves

THEIR EYES

politically, culturally, and economically from the dominant society to establish their own society. Their aim is

WERE WATCHING GOD

to have no meaningful interaction with the dominant, often hostile, society. In effect, separatists are saying, Folklorist, anthropologist, novelist, playwright, and

“They do not have anything that we need. Involvement

“genius of the South” Zora Neale Hurston, wrote her with them is a sure way of destruction for us.”

third novel, Their Eyes Were Watching God, in 7 weeks Afrocentrists are those who accept their own agency as in 1937. Although the novel is a classic today, its early a way of interacting with the world and are unwilling to critics—Richard Wright, Langston Hughes, Alain relinquish their agency to the dominant, hostile society Locke, and others—gave it a mixed reception. That at any price. Their aim is to interact with others on the Hurston failed to effectively deal with the black expe-basis of mutual respect and equality. Afrocentrists are rience in the context of racism and oppression was a saying, “We are perfectly alright as we are, thank you.

frequent criticism. Hurston's critics accused her of "What can we do for you?"

inscribing minstrelsy in her depictions of black life to appeal to a white audience. Close reading, however, **THE AFROCENTRIC PARADIGM**

reveals that Hurston inscribed oppression and race matters but chose not to place these issues at the center. By 2002, over a decade after it began, the original ten of her story. She instead chose to foreground a Temple Circle that had dwindled to two members due to black women's challenging experiences during her transfers, university politics, and promotions. The TC

quest for freedom. Hurston chose to write not in a group of intellectuals who believed that response to but in spite of white benefactors and it was possible to establish a school of thought that detractors. Nevertheless, the book was thrust into would transform the nature of education by promoting obscurity for nearly 30 years due to a mixed critical reception of Afrocentricity as a paradigm. The book *The reception* expressing an overall lack of appreciation for Afrocentric Paradigm by Ama Mazama is considered the contributions of Hurston, a black woman writer the best statement of the ideas of the Temple Circle.

who used black cultural expressions. Fortunately,

— Molefi Kete Asante

later critics excavated the book during the early 1970s and, in doing so, demonstrated an appreciation for **FURTHER READING**

Hurston's literary contributions, her use of black culture—Asante, Molefi Kete. (1998). *The Afrocentric Idea* (2nd ed.).

tural expressions, and her authentic representations of Philadelphia: Temple University Press. This book provides black life. Alice Walker, in her efforts to memorialize a statement of the key concepts that constitute the Hurston, and Robert Hemenway, in his biographical Afrocentric idea.

work on Hurston, led this excavation effort.

Dawson, Michael. (2001). Black Visions: The Roots of A major theme of the novel is the protagonist's Contemporary African American Mass Political Ideology.

struggle to appropriate a voice that is alternately Chicago: University of Chicago Press. This is the best work to date on African American opinion. Dawson's data are muffled, ignored, or silenced due to the cacophony of used by most scholars who want to ferret out the male voices that compete with her own. Janie's thinking of African Americans on politics.

husbands, Logan Killicks, Joe Starks, and Vergible

T-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 447

Their Eyes Were Watching God———447

"Tea Cake" Woods, constitute the male chorus.

indictment of murder, and ultimately broadens Because of the challenges, Janie's voice becomes more Pheoby's horizon when Pheoby, as listener, grows 10

distinct as she progresses toward the freedom to live feet taller after figuratively consuming Janie's voice.

and love on her own terms. Interestingly, her husbands Janie strengthens her own internal resolve when she frequently produce voices eclipsed by their own strug-wins battles after exercising her rhetorical skill; gles to articulate inner thoughts. Each wrestles with however, she gains no power in her external world, as internal thoughts that often results in silence or inarticis evident in the community's response to her insulting ulation. For example, Killicks camouflages his fears Starks and killing Tea Cake.

with the repetitive complaint of sleep deprivation Throughout the novel, we witness the protagonist's when Janie invites him to contemplate the fact that quest for the freedom that permits a woman to experishe just might leave

him. In his struggle to respond, once life to the fullest. We witness Janie's desire for Killicks turns away from Janie to create a barrier to the freedom to love, and that freedom is impossible dialogue rather than toward Janie to facilitate communion within the confines of her marriages to elder Logan Killicks. He ultimately feigns exhaustion and silently Killicks and Mayor Joe Starks. Both men possess the agonizes over the suggestion that she might leave.

weight of prosperity that demands restrictive behavior. Similarly, at various periods in Janie's later life, prescribed by the dominant society. Janie walks away from Joe Starks and Tea Cake physically abuse Janie; how from Killicks and his plan to extend her domestic ever, neither articulates the perceived transgression in duties to field exercises, all for the sake of profit. With his own voice. Instead, the narrative voice mediates no regard for the legal ties that bind, Janie walks away the perceived transgressions. For example, Joe Starks from Killicks and toward Starks, only to be banished slaps Janie, but it is the narrator who communicates from the porch and imprisoned on the pedestal. Janie Starks's insult and departure. The reader knows that does not walk away from Starks but pushes Starks the slap is not in response to Janie's poorly prepared away with the rhetorical power of her voice.

meal but in response to Starks's recognition that after Voice, then, remains a textual matter, an authorial the first 7 years of their marriage, Janie still does not concern, and a critical issue in Zora Neale Hurston's wholly submit to his demands, nor does she cower timeless and authentically black novel, *Their Eyes Under the Weight of His Mounting Insults*. The narrator, *Were Watching God*.

not Starks, confirms that Starks would continue the

— Jacqueline Imani Bryant

abuse and the barrage of insults until Janie yielded.

Like Joe Starks, Tea Cake's voice is mediated through the narrative during his turn at physical abuse. Rather **FURTHER READING**

than articulating his fear, the narrator explains that Tea Penkava, Melinda. (2000, February 17). *Analysis: Finding Cake confesses his deed and purpose to his fellow Shades of Meaning in Zora Neale Hurston's Their Eyes workers in the muck. He slaps Janie in an effort to Were Watching God. Talk of the Nation [Radio broadcast].*

communicate his status of "boss." He struggles to Washington, DC: National Public Radio. This excellent communicate not with Janie but with people in the discussion includes the voices of scholar and literary critic community, specifically the Turners. Physical displace-Mary Helen Washington, Hurston biographer Valerie Boyd, and a wide range of callers that included high school ment and verbal indirection illustrate the struggle to teachers and students. Analyses of Hurston's novel range articulate those ever-present, innermost thoughts and from studied critical responses to affective reader responses feelings. Each man, then, exhibits male dominance but that resulted in precisely what the title suggests.

lacks a consistent, authentic voice.

Racine, Maria J. (1994). *Voice and Interiority in Zora Neale The generative power of Janie's voice emerges Hurston's Their Eyes Were Watching God. African even though the expected written conventions for American Review, 28(2), 283–292. The writer focuses on direct dialogue often do not appear in the text. Rather how voice and interiority apply to Janie, the protagonist, than present the conventions of direct speech, the and permeate the text in the male characterization, in the white community, and during the trial.*

narrative demonstrates the strength of Janie's voice.

Simmons, Ryan. (2002). 'The Hierarchy Itself': Hurston's Numerous examples abound. For instance, Janie's *Their Eyes Were Watching God* and the Sacrifice of rhetorical prowess banishes Joe Starks, the town's most Narrative Authority. *African American Review, 36(2)*, powerful figure, from his porch throne to his sickbed.

181–194. This essay considers the various levels of power Further, Janie's rhetorical skill releases her from the and authority inscribed in *Their Eyes Were Watching God*.

448—— ***They Came Before Columbus***

Central to the discussion is Hurston's attempt to dismantle analysis. One mean-spirited critique of Van Sertima's the traditional hierarchy of narrative forms, in which she work, "Robbing Native American Cultures: Van loses something in order to realize gain.

Sertima's Afrocentricity and the Olmecs" by Gabriel Haslip-Viera, Ortiz de Montellano, and Warren Barbour, was so venomous that it made the ignorant and unconscionable comment that the Indians would

THEY CAME BEFORE COLUMBUS

have eaten the Africans if they had come ashore. But Van Sertima's work has prevailed despite the opposi-When They Came Before Columbus was published tion of its critics. Van Sertima's reliance on an earlier in 1976 by the anthropologist Ivan Van Sertima, few work, Leo Wiener's Africa and the Discovery of people had ever taken seriously the possibility that America, and the support his theory received in a later Africans made it to the Western Hemisphere earlier work, Michael Bradley's Dawn Voyage: The Black than Europeans. In fact, the African "discovery" of African Discovery of America, have served to reinforce the Americas was thought to be impossible because the thesis he set out. Thus, They Came Before Africans were being enslaved by Europeans, and the Columbus maintains its position in the historical and propaganda about Africans tended to discount the like-cultural communities of African people as one of the lihood of Africans achieving anything of significance.

most referred to books on the subject.

As a Guyanese scholar, Van Sertima was familiar

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

with enough of the ancient record and the flora and fauna of Africa and South America to make an assess-FURTHER READING

ment of the information available to him. He had in fact amassed an array of information from previous Bradley, Michael. (1986). *Blacks in Discovery of America*.

attempts to demonstrate that Africans could have Toronto: Dorset. A Canadian author's popular book arrived in the Americas before Europeans. Such explaining the possibility of African presence in the Americas before the Europeans arrived.

attempts were based on the work of the 14th-century MacRitchie, David. (1985). *Ancient and Modern Britons*. Los Angeles: William Preston. This book delves into the nature emperor of Mali, had sent 2,000 long fishing boats of British origins suggesting the role of Africans in the across the Atlantic in 1311 to 1312. On the strength creation of modern Britons.

of this statement, numerous modern historians and Van Sertima, Ivan. (1976). *They Came Before Columbus*.

anthropologists have examined flora data, folklore New York: Random House. This is the classic book by Ivan and folktales, ocean currents, and language to deter-Van Sertima that reactivated the decades-old discussion of mine the plausibility of Africans landing in Mexico or whether Africans arrived in America before Europeans.

other parts of the Americas.

They Came Before Columbus was a major boost to those scholars and laypeople who claimed that Western scholars had hidden or suppressed informa-THIRD WORLD PRESS

tion about Africans coming to America long before the Europeans. Van Sertima's work must be seen as a pop-Third World Press (TWP), the oldest and longest ular version of the thesis. Neither Van Sertima nor his running black publishing house, celebrated its 35th supporters claimed that this was the authoritative work anniversary in 2002. Haki R. Madhubuti (formerly on the issue, but it was the most powerful intellectual Don L. Lee), with the assistance of Carolyn Rodgers statement of the thesis made before the

1980s. It meant and Johari Amini, founded Third World Press on that the author was in great demand as a speaker on September 20, 1967. In his small basement apartment college campuses and at conferences, where he near 63rd and Ada Streets on the South Side of Chicago, described the evidence that made his theory plausible.

Madhubuti started TWP with a used mimeograph His theory has had detractors, however. Several machine and \$400 earned from a poetry reading.

authors wrote pieces critical of the thesis of African As an artist-activist, Madhubuti knew that he would arrival in the Americas before the Europeans, and they compromise his artistry if he sought recognition and went so far as to deride the possibility that the thesis publication from white publishing houses. Before could be true—without engaging in any objective beginning TWP, he was already selling his work from

T-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 449

Third World Press———449

coast to coast and had established a substantial Gwendolyn Brooks (1917–2000), who, at the height following. In fact, mainstream publishing companies of her fame, generously switched to TWP from a approached him with offers, which he refused, decid-mainstream publishing house. When she got to know ing instead to enact the governing principle of the Madhubuti, she became his godmother in the tradition sixties—freedom—which demanded black autonomy.

of black female culture and humanity, standing in for The other major influences on Madhubuti's decision Madhubuti's mother, who had been brutally killed to create TWP included Adam Clayton Powell, who when he was 16 years old. As his relationship with said that black power is blacks building institutions Brooks developed, his poetry and ideology inspired of "splendid achievement," and Malcolm X, who her race consciousness when writing poetry, and she encouraged his listeners to construct institutions for entered his dream and labored with him to build the African Americans. At its founding, TWP institution-Third World Press. In the 1950s, Brooks

became the alized black power, the theme of 1960s activism and first black to receive the Pulitzer prize when she won of Madhubuti's black arts poetry from Think Black it for Annie Allen. In 2003, her final contribution to (1966) to Tough Notes (2002).

the arts, In Montgomery: New and Selected Poems, In the early years, Third World Press solely pub-was published by TWP.

lished poetry such as Don L. Lee's Think Black (1967) Third World Press followed the model of the and Black Pride (1968), Johari Amini's Black Essence defunct Broadside Press founded by Dudley Randall (1968), and Sterling Plumpp's Portable Souls (1968).

in 1965. Because of TWP's longevity, its achievement Through the 1970s and 1980s the press varied its now stands as a possibility for other similar publish-genres, publishing autobiography, fiction, nonfiction, ing houses. According to Paul Coates, creator of children's literature, psychology, history, inspiration, Black Classic Press in Baltimore, TWP "is without politics, and culture. Black intellectuals, such as precedent and one of the most significant things to Chancellor Williams, John Henrik Clarke, Amiri emerge out of the Black Arts Movement. For him Baraka, Woody King, Hoyt W. Fuller, Ruby Dee, Mari

[Madhubuti] to provide an outlet for black thinkers Evans, Nathan Hare, and Frances Cress Welsing, and a center where those black writers could come found a home at TWP. In the 1990s and currently, together—that has to be as significant as Motown."

TWP publishes Derrick Bell, Vivian Gordon, Lily Sixty percent of TWP's audience is African American.

Golden, Fred L. Hord, Kalamu ya Salaam, Useni E.

The books are used as textbooks all over the country Perkins, Diane D. Turner, George Kent, Keorapetse and purchased worldwide. TWP sells to independent Kegositsile, Geneva Smitherman, Asa G. Hilliard, and bookstores, booksellers, chains, superstores, educa-Acklyn Lynch. Haki Madhubuti has been continu-tional institutions, academic bookstores, and libraries.

ously published by TWP since its inception, and to Today, Third World Press employs 11 people. It is date he has authored 26 books. TWP's

bestsellers still located on Chicago's South Side, in the middle of include Frances Cress Welsing's The Isis Papers: The a working-class neighborhood, but now it is housed in Keys to the Colors; Chancellor Williams's The a million-dollar facility, an impressive complex that Destruction of Black Civilization: Great Issues of a was once a Catholic school and church. Wooden Race from 4500 BC to 2000 AD; Amiri Baraka's Wise, bookcases line the hallways and walls and fill the Why's, Y's; Gwendolyn Brooks's Blacks; Derrick libraries. In large and welcoming rooms, African Bell's Afrolantic Legacies; and Haki R. Madhubuti's American art, including paintings, hand-carved sculp-Black Men: Obsolete, Single, Dangerous? Each of tures, and framed prints, celebrate Paul Robeson, John these books has sold at least 50,000 copies.

Coltrane, W.E.B. Du Bois, Gwendolyn Brooks, and The press's 37 years have not been easy. Black Malcolm X. In a separate wing, Haki and Safisha banks have failed to support Madhubuti's efforts, Madhubuti founded two schools, New Concept placing him on the brink of failure at least five times.

Preschool in 1969 and the Betty Shabazz International Investing everything back into the press, Madhubuti Charter School in 2002, to teach children from an has never accepted royalty payments from his books.

African-centered curriculum.

His teaching assignments at universities, including In her foreword to Madhubuti's book *GroundWork* Howard University and Chicago State University, (1996), Gwendolyn Brooks wrote, "More than any have assisted him in keeping TWP afloat. Another other Black poet who became influential in the late important contributor was poet laureate of Illinois Sixties, he remained actively loyal to the richness of



T-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 450

450——Two Cradle Theory

his faith in and love for Black people.” Madhubuti’s Third World Press is a hallmark of the spirit of the 1960s black power and black arts movements, as well as a fulfillment of one of Malcolm X’s major dreams—that black people would build and control institutions within their own geographic space.

— *Regina Jennings*

FURTHER READING

Jennings, Regina. (2002). Cheikh Anta Diop, Malcolm X, and Haki Madhubuti Claiming and Containing Black Language and Institutions. *Journal of Black Studies*, 33, 126–144.

Jennings, Regina. (2004). *The Malcolm X Influence in the Poetic Vision of Haki Madhubuti: Issues of Maleness and Dr. John Henrik Clarke, one of*

the Elder Scholars, speaking on Memory. Chicago: Third World Press.

the Two Cradle Theory at City College, New York Mitchell, Mary A. (1997, September 14). Afrocentric Educators Practice What They Teach. *Chicago Sun Times*, pp. 2–3.

Reardon, Patrick T. (2000, August 10). Poetic Justice: Success civilization. Instead, he theorizes two distinct cradles Hasn't Diminished Haki Madhubuti's Passion for the of civilization existing side by side, one matriarchal,

“Struggle.” *Chicago Tribune*, pp. 12–13.

one patriarchal. The southern cradle, Africa, where humanity began, produced matriarchal societies. Over time, the migration of peoples to the colder climates of the northern cradle, Europe, produced patriarchal **TWO CRADLE THEORY**

societies. Diop attributes matriarchy to an agrarian lifestyle in a climate of abundance, and patriarchy to The Two Cradle Theory was advanced by the nomadic traditions arising from a harsh environment.

Senegalese scholar Cheikh Anta Diop to account for The cultural distinctions Diop draws between these African and European cultural characteristics. Diop's cradles is based on the arrangement of female-male knowledge of indigenous culture played an essential power relations. A matriarchy is nonhierarchical and role in shaping his analytical acumen and inspiring his expresses the complementary rather than competitive untiring devotion to investigative scholarship. His aca-aspect of the female-male relationship, as well as its demic training in Western sociology raised questions manifestation in all forms of institutional, spiritual, in Diop's mind about common assumptions regarding and social life. The union of the female and male in the human advancement and defining social structures like production of children represents the smallest unit of the family, society, and state. These questions, coupled the family and therefore society. Within the matriar-with Diop's inability to accept the inferiorization of chal family, the females and males seek reciprocal and African intellectual and

institutional development, harmonious relationships. From this family matrix a drove Diop to create new theories and concepts. For

“pacifistic morality” arose, underpinning societal Diop, culture naturally became the source for defining notions of “justice” and “democracy.” Most distinctive human realities. His Two Cradle Theory traces the in this family model is the critical significance of the cultural characteristics of African and European con-mother around whom the family gravitates, for she car-cepts, behaviors, values, and beliefs to their origins.

ries inside her the greatest wealth—future generations.

The theory thus provides a model that situates Africans In contrast, patriarchy involves the domination of in the context of their own cultural paradigm for male over female. The northern cradle family produces human development rather than the Western paradigm.

hierarchical personal relations as a result of this domi-Rectifying scholastic attempts to debase Africa and nation. Thus, as Nah Dove wrote in her 1998 essay her people, in his 1959 book *The Cultural Unity of*

“African Womanism,” hierarchical notions of inferior-Black Africa, Diop challenged European evolutionists ity and superiority rationalize woman’s subservience who argued that the transition of the world from to man. This unjust relationship is the core of conflict matriarchy to patriarchy marked the beginning of and aggression and is reflected in the greater society in

T-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:03 PM Page 451

Two Cradle Theory——451

beliefs about race and human inequality, characteris-reading on the origins and form of African civilization and tics of xenophobia. Diop considers the structure of the culture.

patriarchal family diametrically opposed to that of the Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1990). *The Cultural Unity of Black Africa*. Chicago: Third World Press. (Original work pub-matriarchal family.

lished 1959). This is Diop's fullest explanation of the cultural unity of black Africa. He lays the groundwork for an examination of the various dimensions of unity, from peoples can be traced historically. In this pursuit, Diop matrilineal families to the burial of the dead.

revealed the African origin of ancient Egypt. Thus, for Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1991). *Civilization or Barbarism*.

those of African descent globally, Diop left a living Chicago: Lawrence Hill. This is Diop's powerful anthropo-legacy of continuous discovery about the achievements logical and linguistic argument for the emergence of Africa. In light of this, the Two Cradle Theory is and African civilization.

Diop, Cheikh Anta. (1996). *Towards the African Renaissance*: has been pivotal to the development of culturally centered Essays in African Culture and Development, 1946–1960.

tered scholarship in the Afrocentric movement.

London: Karnak House. In this book, Diop contends that

— *Nah Dove*

Africa will have a rebirth only when African leaders and intellectuals put in place men and women who will work **FURTHER READING**

toward cultural development from Africa's own traditions.

Dove, Nah. (1998) African Womanism. *Journal of Black Studies*, 28(5), 515–539. In this essay, Dove applies Diop's Hill; Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is indispensable theory to the experiences of African women.

U-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 453

U

ideals have been incorporated into the dance. Thus **UMFUNDALAI**

Umfundalai resembles the traditional dances found on the African continent and in the Caribbean, but the *Umfundalai*, which means “essence” in Ebonics, is a movements within Umfundalai are not found in these polyrhythmic, multicultural African dance technique.

areas. Welsh Asante developed the technique while It was developed in 1970 by Kariamum Welsh Asante, traveling on the continent and in the islands, but a dance scholar and professor of dance at Temple University and Swarthmore College. Umfundalai is a synthesis of traditional dances with University and Swarthmore College. Umfundalai a contemporary flare. At the height of developing the came out of Welsh Asante’s quest to create a method dance technique, Welsh Asante was one of the leading that functionally and aesthetically mirrors certain members of the Afrocentric movement. Umfundalai aspects of African life and experiences. The dance was a way for her to create a pan-African technique that synthesizes movements and aesthetic characteristics added to the body of knowledge within the Afrocentric characteristics from continental Africans and African Americans paradigm. Through intense study of each ethnic group, in the diaspora; it was shaped by and responds to Welsh Asante has ensured that each dance movement the cultures of the various African ethnic groups.

represents the historical, mythical, and cultural context Umfundalai is considered a pan-African dance technique of the group from which it was derived.

technique because it draws from the various styles and Umfundalai is performed in educational, recre-movements from diasporic ethnic groups, including educational, and professional venues. The dance technique dance elements of African Americans. The pedagogy provides an introduction to African and African of the technique is twofold. First, it is centered on the American culture and has enhanced the relevance of belief that students of the dance must study the culture African dance techniques to other forms of dance, the dance comes from in order to fully understand and such as jazz, modern, and ballet. Students who are appreciate the dance. For example, when students knowledgeable about African and African American learn the Nigerian Stomp within Umfundalai, they culture have one advantage in

studying Umfundalai; are also given the social, political, and historic background. Experienced dance students have a different advantage of the Nigerian people and their culture.

stage. However, Umfundalai is a dance technique that Second, Umfundalai draws from the African cosmology—allows dancers to enter at their own level, and it can be the idea that universal perception should be taught to dancers at all levels at the same time. All harmonious interaction between the seen and unseen.

students of Umfundalai learn to understand and appreciate. Thus the student receives a holistic, personal text for its context of African values, spirituality, and the movement.

philosophical reflection while using their bodies as Umfundalai functions as an African cultural village.

vehicles of expression.

Before the start of the class, the dancers must pay respect to the drummer and the instructor, as these

— *Kristy Holmes*

453

U-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 454

454———**Underground Railroad**

FURTHER READING

daily reminders that as property without legal rights, all the decisions about their lives were made by the Ackerman, Robert. (1996). Traditions.

Retrieved June 16, 2004, from

<http://citypaper.net/articles/022296/article009>.

slaveholders who owned them. Being auctioned away.shtml

from family and friends at a human market for the Mills, G. R. (1994). Umfundalai—One Technique, Three master's profit was a constant threat. There was also Applications. *Journal of Physical Education, Recreation & the harsh reality that any act perceived by the slaveDance (JOPERD)*, 65(5), 36-38; 47. This is one of the first holder as disobedience brought physical abuse, public articles to deal with the technique.

humiliation, and savage beatings. However, although Welsh Asante, Kariamu. (1997). *Umfundalai: An African the bodies of Africans were enslaved, their minds Dance Technique*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This is longed for freedom. The mission of the Underground the key work on the subject.

Railroad was to help enslaved Africans escape the horrors of slavery into northern, free territories.

Below the Mason-Dixon line, enslavement of black **UNDERGROUND RAILROAD**

men, women, and children for whites' social and economic comfort was a way of life, and any haphazard The Underground Railroad was a secret order of attempts to alter or restrict the slaveholders' system of people, homes, and strategic routes, formed by a labor was dangerous. All phases of the Underground continuous network of sympathizers that ushered Railroad were carefully planned, because it had to be runaway slaves north toward Canada. This tunnel-like a well concealed and protected network of people, system was operated by three classes of people (both codes, and places—without flaws. All messaging black and white) who vehemently opposed slavery for within the Underground Railroad had to be of a seri-social, religious, and humanitarian reasons; they were ous nature, whereby the escapees could travel north the Presbyterians, Quakers (most of whom were abo-through a tunnel of trust and charity. Failure to follow litionists), and free people of color. These courageous instructions or any misinterpretation of directives men and women, with dissimilar incomes, educational along the way could mean hanging or some other backgrounds, and occupational means, worked in harsh punishment for the recaptured as well as for concert within the Underground Railroad to aid the those dedicated to helping.

fugitive slaves. United in purpose, they shared a pro-In the colonies, land was plentiful and cheap, but found commitment to the goals of the Underground labor was scarce. Consequently, slave labor was a Railroad and provided the resources necessary to vital element in agricultural development in Southern ensure runaway slaves safe passage from slaveholder states, and the slaveholders spared no expense in states to free northern territories. Compassionate but the employment of bounty hunters, bloodhounds, and realistic, they knew that their antislavery sentiments printed notices to hunt down runaways to maintain and meeting attendance were not enough to help the their economic development. However, the tenacious slaves, and that there had to be a distinct plan of action and inhumane treatment of the slaves by these slave-requiring networks of secrecy and extreme caution.

holders fueled the commitment of those sympathetic Ironically, it was the valor and commitment of those to the plight of enslaved Africans. Ironically, in the graced with freedom that gave hope and opportunity folklore of the time, the first use of the term *undertaken those oppressed by slavery*.

*ground railroad is attributed to a frustrated and embarrassed slaveholder whose slave, Tice Davids, vanished into thin air right under his master's nose; to save face, his master told everyone that Tice had **CONFRONTING THE DIFFICULTY***

escaped on a mysterious "underground railroad."

However, to comprehend the mission to aid fugitive slaves that was shared by participants in the Under-THE FUGITIVE SLAVE LAW

ground Railroad, as well as the true impact of their efforts, it is necessary to first know something of the The enactment of the Fugitive Slave Law in 1793 gave realities of slavery. In slavery, the enslaved experience slaveholders more authority to cross the Mason-Dixon how degrading it is for one race to be bound in servi-line, into Northern states where slavery was illegal, to tude to another. For enslaved Africans, there were capture their runaway slaves. However, at about the

Underground Railroad——455

same time, the legislature in the Upper Province of Slaveholders were stymied by the system of coded Canada, Ontario, enacted laws to abolish slavery. The places and people that shielded the Africans in secrecy Lower Province, Quebec, followed suit in 1803.

from station to station. Runaway Africans often trav-Before the Underground Railroad came into being, eled on foot in waist-high swamps, over mountains, escape was likely to end in capture for those who and through forests toward “the promised land.”

dared to run away from the horrors of human Within the Underground Railroad, Africans’ survival bondage. After 1793, there was a destination called en route to freedom came only through trust; the fugi-Canada where Africans would be free, outside of the tives put their lives in the hands of complete strangers United States. The awareness of Canada as a safe and complete strangers opened their homes to runaway haven was knowledge that came to enslaved Africans Africans. The slaveholder or slave catcher in pursuit of as a direct result of communication from within the runaway Africans became a common enemy of every-Underground Railroad.

one connected to the Underground Railroad.

The Ohio River was very important to the move-Providing aid to runaway Africans was morally but ment of runaway Africans, as it runs through Michigan not politically correct in the South and in some areas of to Detroit, where there were many Underground the North. The strong religious doctrine of the Quaker Railroad stations. Brave people of both races, often movement yielded many abolitionists who defied laws members of antislavery societies, were members of a by opening their homes to runaway Africans. As early secret society that provided information on check-as the late 1700s, committed and strong-willed people points, signals, and confidants who responded to the opposed to the legal exploitation of one race by another phrase “friend of a friend” as they invited desperate worked diligently to aid the fugitive Africans. Levi and frightened people of

color into their homes for Coffin, a Quaker from Cincinnati, was proud to be shelter. Denied schooling, most of the enslaved known as the "President of the Underground Railroad."

Africans were unable to read or decipher written language. However, the strengthening and refinement of language, thus they traveled north blindly and had to be the Underground Railroad and the migration north safeguarded within a system of coded signals (compatible into Canada was accelerated by President Millard Fillmore's signing of the Fugitive Slave Act of 1850, spirituality) and with maps marking natural elements which meant that any African escaping slavery could use such as trees, swamps, hills, and rivers as guides.

be recaptured and taken back into slavery even if he or she had crossed into a nonslave territory. In documenting the hopelessness of the enslaved, the **RIDING THE UNDERGROUND TRAIN**

restrictive legislation increased the sympathy of the The word railroad in Underground Railroad refers not abolitionists. Slaves had always attempted to escape, to masses of steel with locomotive power but to the but now the influx of those wanting freedom required courage and commitment of the tough-minded free-a systematic approach, and the Underground Railroad dominated fighters who helped the Africans escape. Grippled was further developed to accommodate the thousands by fear and traveling under the cloak of darkness, of Africans fleeing northward. Abolitionist William the Africans who dared to risk their lives in search of Lloyd Garrison used his newspaper, the Liberator, to freedom were hidden "underground" (i.e., away from denounce slavery and report on the effectiveness of the danger) in everything from secret rooms to handmade Underground Railroad after the passing of the Fugitive coffins. The word underground in Underground Slave Law . Canada was flooded with black people Railroad thus referred to the secretive manner of travel escaping lives of entrapment; the fugitive slaves often as well as the coded communication in language, had left the South with only the clothes on their backs songs, and signals necessary for the survival and without family or friends. Many Northern news-of runaway slaves being chased by ruthless bounty papers directly linked the enactment

of the Fugitive hunters with bloodhounds. Railroad terminology was Slave Act to the success of the Underground Railroad.

transformed into code words to encourage and relay In a Liberator report in October of 1852, Garrison messages to runaway travelers. A “station-master” was boldly bragged about the competence of the a keeper of safe house, “freedom train” and “gospel Underground Railroad conductors.

train” were code words for the Underground Rail-As news of the Underground Railroad spread road, and escaping slaves were called “baggage.”

throughout the plantations, slaves became optimistic

U-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 456

*456——**Universal Negro Improvement Association** about their chances of gaining freedom in Northern Africans the world over he began the organization cities. Harriet Tubman, who was affectionately called that he initially named the Universal Negro Improve-*

“Moses,” was an escaped slave from Maryland ment and Conservation Association and African who returned to the South to be a conductor and aid Communities (Imperial) League and later became many others to cross the Mason-Dixon Line on the the UNIA.

Underground Railroad.

— Gloria Grant Roberson

PRINCIPAL OBJECTIVES

*The objectives of the organization were subdivided by **FURTHER READING***

region into Jamaican and international sections. The Finkelman, Paul. (Ed.). (1997). Slavery and the Law. Madison, objectives for Jamaica included providing educational WI: Madison House. This is a compilation of essays that facilities, rehabilitating “the fallen and the degraded deal

with the legal ramifications of slave law and slavery (especially the criminal class),” stimulating industry itself.

and commerce, encouraging the “bonds of brother-Hagedorn, Ann. (2002). Beyond The River: The Untold Heroes of the Underground Railroad. New York: Simon and hood” among all people, and giving assistance to the Schuster. This is a well-researched, well-documented, and needy. In addition to aiding the needy and the “fallen”

clearly written accounting of the Underground Railroad and encouraging education and commerce, the interim the Southern Ohio and Northern Kentucky regions. Its national objectives sought to “establish a Universal includes detailed notes and bibliographical entries useful Confraternity among the race” and to “promote the for extended research on the Underground Railroad.

spirit of race pride and love.” The organization hoped Mitchell, William M. (1970). Underground Railroad.

in this way to strengthen the existing independent Westport, CT: Negro Universities Press. (Original work African states (Ethiopia, Liberia, and Haiti).

published 1860 as The Underground Railroad from Slavery to Freedom). Mitchell presents views of fugitive slaves The new organization busied itself feeding the from a Canadian perspective.

hungry, visiting hospitals, and recruiting members.

Preston, E. Delores, Jr. (1944). Genesis of the Underground It also functioned much like a literary and debating Railroad. Journal of Negro History, 18(2), 144–170. This society, with poetry and dramatic readings and elocu-essay provides a historical overview of the Underground tion contests. Garvey was greatly influenced by Railroad.

Booker T. Washington, founder of the Tuskegee Smedley, R. C. (1968). Underground Railroad. Westport, CT: Institute (now Tuskegee University) in Alabama. He Negro Universities Press. (Original work published 1883).

hoped in this early period to build an industrial school This book recounts the history of the Underground Railroad through the voices of many unsung abolitionist in Jamaica modeled after Tuskegee. In a letter of early heroes. Courageous in spirit and deed, their commitment 1916 to Robert R. Moton, principal of Tuskegee after to the cause of freedom and the Underground Railroad is Washington's death, Garvey confided his plans to documented here in many ways.

strengthen the organization by creating its own media.

ORIGIN AND DEVELOPMENT

UNIVERSAL NEGRO

*Garvey journeyed to Harlem, New York, in March of **IMPROVEMENT ASSOCIATION***

1916 in what was initially to be a fund-raising tour of a few months. He toured the United States and The Universal Negro Improvement Association Canada, then returned to Harlem, where he began to (UNIA) was the largest pan-African mass movement attract a following to his street meetings. He soon of all time. It was founded in 1914 by Marcus Mosiah rented a hall and moved indoors, and as his popularity Garvey (1887–1940) in Kingston, Jamaica. Garvey, a grew, his followers prevailed upon him to remain in printer, journalist, and political activist, had returned the United States. In 1918, the UNIA was incorpo-from 4 years of travel in Latin America and Europe rated in the United States. It developed with lightning determined to do something about the suffering he speed thereafter. Its official organ, The Negro World, saw being endured by African people everywhere.

appeared later in 1918. A series of auxiliaries and Garvey saw the power of organization as the key subsidiary ventures followed it in quick succession, to African advancement, so for the betterment of including the Negro Factories Corporation (1918) and

the Black Star Line Shipping Corporation (1919). The 700 branches in the United States alone, in 37 states Negro Factories Corporation ran restaurants, laun-and the District of Columbia. Of the 13 states with the dries, a printing press, a hotel, and other businesses, largest number of branches, 10 were in the South, and by the early 1920s it employed over 1,000 people though New York City had the largest single member in New York. The Black Star Line provided a hostel ship, estimated at between 35,000 and 40,000.

for seamen and a place where African international Louisiana had 74 branches, more than any other state travelers could escape the Jim Crow restrictions that and more than any country outside of the United were considered normal on carriers run by whites. The States. Cuba, Panama, Trinidad, and Costa Rica, auxiliaries included the Universal African Legions, respectively, led the rest of the world in terms of a paramilitary group, and the Juveniles for young number of branches. South Africa had more branches members of the organization. The Black Cross Nurses than any other country in Africa. There were branches and the paramilitary Universal African Motor Corps in Australia, England, Venezuela, and Brazil. This were for women only.

spread was mostly the result of a mixture of paid orga-The UNIA purchased its own meeting place, nizers, word of mouth, The Negro World (which Liberty Hall, in Harlem in 1918. By 1919 its meetings became the African world's most widely distributed were attracting crowds of as many as 5,000 people. It newspaper), and Garvey's powerful oratory and was now a major force to be reckoned with. The writing.

UNIA sent a delegate to the 1919 post-World War I The UNIA operated within a formal constitution.

Peace Conference in Paris. It began to expand over-Branches (called "divisions") each had a full slate of seas. By the time that Garvey convened his First officers, including a "lady president." More than one International Convention of the Negro Peoples of the division in the same city or district was discouraged.

World in New York in August 1920, the UNIA was Where more than one branch was allowed, however, already the most talked about African organization in the original was called a division and the second was the world. It was reported that 25,000 people attended referred to as a chapter. During the movement's the opening ceremonies of the convention at Madison heyday, the headquarters division was located in Square Garden. The convention parade was 10 miles Harlem, New York. The UNIA attracted the broad long and serviced by several brass bands. The con-masses of African people like no other organization. It clave opened on August 1 (Emancipation Day in the simultaneously attracted a good number of professional British empire) and continued in Liberty Hall for people, including lawyers, preachers, social workers, the rest of the month. Delegates attended from all over writers, and academics. Its circle of influence was far the African world, including South Africa, Nigeria, wider than its own paid-up membership. In some England, Panama, and many Caribbean territories.

countries, such as Dominica in the Caribbean, The The major conference document, the Declaration of Negro World was the largest newspaper in circulation.

Rights of the Negro Peoples of the World, cataloged The UNIA's popularity was facilitated by its the racist practices facing Africans everywhere and ideology of African nationalism, built around the demanded redress. It claimed for residents of the ideas of race first, self-reliance, and nationhood. Race African diaspora a right to African citizenship. It first projected the beauty of African features. It also demanded black history in schools, stipulated that an urged African people to write their own history, cri-uppercase N be used in the word Negro, and swore tique their own literature, control their own propa-to protect African womanhood. It declared red, black, ganda, and see their God in their own image and and green the colors of the African race.

likeness. This prompted a significant UNIA encour-Requests to purchase shares in the Black Star Line agement of the arts, resulting in a major Garveyite and for UNIA charters around the globe initially came input into the Harlem Renaissance. Self-reliance in faster than the fledgling UNIA

civil service could urged African people to “do for self” and was made process them. By the mid-1920s, the organization manifest in the Black Star Line and the Negro had peaked at a claimed 6 to 11 million members in Factories Corporation. Nationhood spoke to the need over 40 countries. The UNIA had become the largest for political power at all levels.

African American movement, the largest panThe many major pan-African personalities who Caribbean movement, and the largest pan-African were influenced by the UNIA in their formative years movement on the African continent. There were over include President Kwane Nkrumah of Ghana,

U-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 458

*458——**Universal Negro Improvement Association** Governor General Nnamdi Azikiwe of Nigeria, Jomo they were led by the National Association for the Kenyatta of Kenya, and the 1920s leadership of the Advancement of Colored People (NAACP), the flag-African National Congress (ANC) in South Africa.*

ship civil rights organization for black people that was The parents of Malcolm X were UNIA organizers.

led by Jewish and other white liberals. The NAACP

The Honorable Elijah Muhammad of the Nation resented Garvey’s black nationalism and ability to of Islam was a member of the Detroit division.

mobilize larger financial resources than they could, Practically the whole cohort of political and labor and without recourse to the liberals’ money. Judge leaders in the Anglophone Caribbean of the 1930s had Julian Mack, who imposed the maximum jail sentence some association with the UNIA. Garvey sent three and fine as well as court costs on Garvey, was a member delegations to Liberia between 1920 and 1924, hoping of the NAACP. Garvey’s organization also had internal to relocate his headquarters there. However, while the problems, as it was discovered that several employees Liberian government initially encouraged the idea, in and agents of the UNIA opportunistically stole from the end they reneged on their promises. This was the organization and helped sink the Black Star Line.

motivated partly by fear of a potential political challenge. In addition, private individuals and organizations longed for Garvey and by pressure from the imperial powers were supplementing the governments' anti-UNIAist governments of the United States, Great Britain, surveillance operations.

and France.

*In 1929, after Garvey's deportation, the UNIA held a massive Sixth International Convention of the Negro Peoples of the World in Jamaica. Garvey's forced **CHALLENGES***

absence from his U.S. base led, however, to schisms. Garvey's success was viewed with alarm by the U.S.

within the movement. A UNIA Inc. operated out of and European governments. The UNIA's core message—the United States, and Garvey's faction, the Universal Sage of Race First, self-reliance, and nationhood was Negro Improvement Association and African seen as a threat to continued Euro-American subjugation. Communities League of the World, which he founded in the African world. The movement was accordingly. August of 1929, had its headquarters in Jamaica.

ingly subjected to elaborate surveillance, infiltration, The split was not an African American versus and repression. J. Edgar Hoover, later legendary head of the Caribbean rupture as it is usually depicted, since many of the Federal Bureau of Investigation, directed anti-UNIA activities from 1919 on. The U.S. authorities themselves from UNIA activities from 1919 on. The U.S. authorities the Caribbean. Garvey's faction maintained the allegations brought several court charges against Garvey, the disgrace of many U.S.-based Garveyites and it was most important being for alleged mail fraud in controlled The Negro World, which continued to carry connection with the promotion and failure of the Black Garvey's pronouncements.

*Star Line. In an effort to present his ideas to a wider public, Garvey published the seminal two volumes of **A NEW BEGINNING FOR THE MOVEMENT***

Philosophy and Opinions of Marcus Garvey in 1923

and 1925. He was nevertheless convicted on the mail A seventh international convention was held in 1934

fraud charge in 1923 and spent 3 months in jail within Jamaica, and an eighth convention, the last in out bail. In 1925 Garvey lost his appeal and was Garvey's lifetime, took place in 1938 in Toronto, imprisoned in Atlanta Penitentiary. He spent almost Canada. Meanwhile, Garvey had relocated to London 3 years of his 5-year sentence there before President in 1935 in an attempt to return the movement to its Calvin Coolidge, bowing to international pressure, former preeminence. His death in London in 1940

commuted his sentence in 1927. He was deported to brought further disintegration to the association. The Jamaica immediately thereafter and arrived home to a base of the movement shifted once again to the United hero's welcome in December of that year.

States, where there were further splits. Groups loyal to Several other important entities mobilized against Garvey often changed their names to Garvey Clubs the UNIA. The world communist movement fought and the like. The organization nevertheless remained the UNIA on ideological grounds (class first versus an important factor in African American communities, race first) and resented the UNIA's grip on African though not the all-powerful force it once was. In 1945, workers and peasants worldwide. The integrationist the UNIA presented an important memorandum, establishment also opposed the UNIA. In this effort, drafted by Garvey's widow, Amy Jacques Garvey, to

U-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 459

Us———459

the founding conference of the United Nations in San Hill, Robert. (Ed.). (1995). Africa for the Africans: The Marcus Francisco. In that year, the Jamaica UNIA was repre-Garvey and Universal Negro Improvement Association sented at the Fifth Pan-African Congress organized by Papers, 1920–1921 (Vols. 8 – 10). Berkeley: University of California Press. These volumes conveniently bring George Padmore and Kwame Nkrumah in Manchester, together in printed form many archival documents scattered

England. By the 1950s, the African Nationalist Pioneer in various locations, including many selections from *The Movement* of Carlos Cooks and the Universal African *Negro World*. Hill's long introduction erroneously ascribes Nationalist Movement of Benjamin Gibbon were the Garvey's major initiatives to white agency.

most prominent of the UNIA offshoots. Both were Martin, Tony. (1983). *Literary Garveyism: Garvey, Black Arts* based in Harlem. In 1971, surviving units of the UNIA *and the Harlem Renaissance*. Dover, MA: The Majority had a unifying conference in Youngstown, Ohio, to Press. This study established Garvey and the UNIA as return the various factions into one fold.

major initiators of the literary and cultural movement known as the Harlem Renaissance.

Several important new organizations were founded Martin, Tony. (1986). *Race First: The Ideological and* by former Garveyites after Garvey's death. Those in the *Organizational Struggles of Marcus Garvey and the United States* include the Peace Movement of Ethiopia, *Universal Negro Improvement Association*. Dover, MA: the National Movement for the Establishment of a The Majority Press. (Original work published 1976). This 49th State, and the Nation of Islam. In Jamaica, the is the "most thoroughly researched book on Garvey's Rastafarian movement was started by former Garveyites.

ideas" (*Choice*) and the UNIA.

Garveyites and the children of Garveyites have continued to lead political movements all over the pan-African world. These include Congresspeople Shirley Chisholm and Charles Diggs in the United States; Jomo Kenyatta, US

Kwame Nkrumah, and Nnamdi Azikiwe in Nigeria; and leaders of the African National Congress Youth Since the 1960s, the organization US has played a sig-Movement in South Africa.

nificant role in black political and intellectual culture.

The UNIA still enjoys a modest existence, with Founded in Los Angeles in 1965 by Maulana Karenga divisions in several North American cities and a few in and a group of fellow activists, Us defined itself as Central America, Africa, and the Caribbean. Garvey's a cultural and social change organization. Its name—

son, Marcus Garvey, Jr., became president general in Us, which simply means us African people—was 1992 at a convention in Washington, D.C.. He was re-chosen to stress its communitarian character and elected for 4-year terms in Philadelphia in 1996 and collective focus on African people. The organization Montreal in 2000. The success of the UNIA in its hey-emerged out of the flurry of community activities that day in the 1920s is still unmatched in pan-African followed the Watts revolt and participated in the history.

general thrust of the times to mobilize, organize, and politically educate the black community.

— *Tony Martin*

THE NATURE OF THE ORGANIZATION

FURTHER READING

From the start, Us has seen itself as a revolutionary Clarke, John Henrik. (1974). *Marcus Garvey and the Vision of vanguard party* striving to be not a mass organization *Africa*. New York: Random House. This is a pioneering and still useful anthology of analyses of Marcus Garvey and the but a highly disciplined, tightly organized, and philo-UNIA by authors with different perspectives. Amy Jacques sophically grounded organization able to program-Garvey collaborated with John Clarke on this project.

matically influence the black masses and the black Garvey, Amy Jacques. (1970). *Garvey and Garveyism*.

liberation movement. Thus, it defined the three pillars New York: Collier Books. (Original work published 1963).

of the group as the leadership, doctrine, and organization. The memoirs of Garvey's second wife and collaborator, Amy Jacques Garvey, remain an indispensable source.

Maulana Karenga, who at that time had left UCLA, Garvey, Amy Jacques. (Ed.). (1986). *The Philosophy and Opinions of Marcus Garvey, Or, Africa for the Africans*. Dover, MA: The Majority Press. (Original work published 1923). This work remains the preeminent compilation of his writings and speeches.

Karenga, is *Kwaidia*. Its organization is expressed

U-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 460

460———Us

in the tight-knit, disciplined, and philosophically Angeles, San Diego, Newark, and Dayton. Embracing grounded relations and practice of its advocates or Malcolm X's Bandung model, with its stress on the members. Kwaidia is the ongoing synthesis of the unity and common struggles of people of color, Us best of African thought and practice, and thus has began to build "third world" (i.e., people of color) drawn on concepts and ideas from several major dias-alliances and to work with groups such as the Brown poric and continental African thinkers—Sekou Toure, Berets, the Crusade for Justice, and Alianza Federal Julius Nyerere, Malcolm X, Kwame Nkrumah, de Pueblos Libres, as well as to support the organiz-Marcus Garvey, Amilcar Cabral, Frantz Fanon, and ing efforts and strikes of the United Farm Workers. In others. These intensely studied and reshaped ideas 1967 in Albuquerque, New Mexico, Us—along with include concepts of re-Africanization, self-defense, the Student Non-Violent Coordinating Committee and Ujamaa (cooperative economics and African social-the Black Panther Party of Northern California—

ism), cultural revolution, political education and orga-signed a peace treaty titled Treaty of Peace, Harmony nization of the masses, a vanguard

revolutionary and Mutual Assistance with the Alianza Federal de party, cultural nationalism, and pan-Africanism.

Pueblos Libres led by Reies Tijerina, the Crusade for Justice led by Rudolfo Corky Gonzales, and the Hopi Nation represented by the spiritual leader Thomas **AN ORGANIC**

Banyaca. Us also trained black and brown organizers **RELATIONSHIP TO COMMUNITY**

at the Social Action Training Center in Los Angeles, Focusing first on the Los Angeles community, Us taught Spanish classes, and established an Olmec soon established a national agenda and practice that Club dedicated to researching and building on African stressed cultural revolution, institution building, orga-and Mexican links using Olmec civilization as a point nization, service, and struggles. Thus, Us held political of departure.

education classes, initiated several organizing projects, Us also organized one of the most important youth and worked with various educational, welfare, eco-organizations in the 1960s, the *Simba Wachanga* nomic and political groups in black united-front (Swahili for the “young lions”), which became a efforts to improve education, end police abuse, build model for youth groups and rites of passage programs cooperative economic projects, increase political across the country. Active on campuses and in the participation, build affordable housing, and provide community, the Simba organized black student unions quality health care.

in high schools and colleges, provided community ser-The group’s first national initiative was coplanning vice, and served as a defense organization for the com-and cohosting the three National Black Power munity. Following Malcolm X, and also influenced Conferences in 1966, 1967, and 1968. Karenga became by Robert Williams and Frantz Fanon, Us affirmed the Black Power Conference movement’s chief theo-the right to self-defense and trained in self-defense rist, introducing his philosophy Kawaida in the process.

measures. Us also helped form the Community Alert Us, at its inception, had seen itself as heir to the legacy Patrol, which monitored police activity

as early as of Malcolm X and had early on incorporated his 1965. Although Us asserted the right to self-defense, thinking in Kawaïda. This is reflected in the Kawaïda like other radical and progressive organizations of the definition of the black power movement as a collective time, it resisted the Vietnam War and the draft. Like struggle of black people to achieve and affirm three Malcolm X, Us argued that blacks should not partici-things: self-determination, self-respect, and self-defense.

pate in colonial and imperialist wars, especially against Moreover, Karenga introduced at the first conference other people of color who had done no injury to black the concept of *operational unity*—that is, unity in people, and that it was irrational and unethical to fight diversity, unity without conformity—which he underin the interest of one’s oppressor.

stood as an essential idea and call in Malcolm’s classic speech “Message to the Grassroots.”

THE SINGULARITY OF CULTURE

Building on the stress on culture, cultural struggle, and **OPERATIONAL UNITY**

cultural revolution—advocated by Toure in *Toward* Based on this principle of operational unity, Us estab-Full Reafricanization, Fanon in *Wretched of the Earth*, lished black united fronts in several cities—Los and later Cabral in *Return to the Source*—and the

U-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 461

Us———461

indispensability of the education of the masses, chronicled in Us’s newspaper, *Harambee*, in an article Us defined itself as a cultural nationalist organization by the women of Us titled “View from the Woman’s and began a series of educational projects. Thus, in Side of the Circle.” It established the concept and addition to its own educational projects, Us played practice of equal partnership in love, work, and strug-an important role in the founding and building of the gle, using the principles of *Ujima* (collective

work and Black Studies movement, the black student movement, responsibility) and complementarity (a necessary and the black independent school movement. Also in interrelationship of mutual completion and fulfill-1965, Us established its own model of an independent ment) as grounds for this. This internal dialogue is school, the School of Afro-American Culture, which further developed and appears in the writings of is still operative as the Kawaïda School of African Maulana Karenga in the *Black Scholar* in the early American Culture. Us also established the African 1970s, especially in his article "Towards a Greater American Cultural Center in 1965, to hold political and Togetherness in Love and Struggle." In these articles, cultural education classes, seminars, institutes, and Karenga sums up the conclusions and lessons of this other forums and training sessions, as well as to provide exchange between men and women of Us and reaf-creative performances. Furthermore, Us significantly firms the indispensability of equality, mutual respect, influenced the black arts movement by providing it with and shared responsibility in love and struggle. In the a philosophical grounding in Kawaïda, participating in early 1970s, Us went underground, and in the mid-the defining of the black aesthetic of the 1960s and 1970s, it emerged publicly first as the New African influencing major figures in the black arts movement American Movement (NAAM) and then as the such as Amiri Baraka, Larry Neal, Haki Madhubuti, Val Kawaïda Groundwork Committee. It reinstituted its Gray Ward, and others.

forum series, worked with other groups in political Like many other organizations of the time, includ-projects, and published literature reflecting its ing the Nation of Islam, the Southern Christian reassessment and development. It also made interna-Leadership Conference, the Black Panther Party, the tional trips to Nigeria to the pan-African gathering the Republic of New Africa, and the Revolutionary Action Second World Black and African Festival of Arts and Movement, Us experienced government harassment Culture (FESTAC) and to Peoples Republic of China, and suppression from the FBI's Covert Intelligence building relationships and further defining and devel-Program (COINTELPRO) in collaboration with local oping its positions in critical issues. Karenga served as police. The COINTELPRO was designed to disrupt, chair of the African American delegation to FESTAC

discredit, destroy, and otherwise neutralize all real and and as spokesman for the Independent Black Schools potential black nationalist and activist leadership and Education Tour to China. His book *Essays on leadership groups*. This led to many of Us's members *Struggle: Position and analysis* and his articles in the being imprisoned on trumped up charges and driven nationalist periodicals *Black News*, *Nkombo*, *Black underground* and into exile in other countries. These *Books Bulletin*, and the *Black Scholar* and the left activities also fostered group rivalry and antagonism periodical *In These Times* presented and developed among the groups, especially between Us and the new positions, as well as reaffirming the fundamental Black Panther Party. As part of the COINTELPRO, principles and positions of Kawaida philosophy.

agents penetrated both groups and provoked deadly confrontation between the two groups, as reported in **POLITICAL EDUCATION**

the Church Senate Report and major articles on the subject in the *Los Angeles Times*.

In the 1980s, Us began to use its name again and As the men of Us were imprisoned and forced returned fully to its mobilizing, organizing, and polit-underground and into exile, an increased number of ical education projects. Especially important is its women of Us emerged in leadership roles and, like crucial role on the national level in the founding of other organizations, Us engaged in a sustained dialogue the National Black United Front, the Association for and transformation concerning male-female relations.

the Study of Classical African Civilizations, and the Women created a self-defense unit (the Matamba) as a Black Leadership Retreat group. Internationally, counterpart and ally of the Simba, and increased their Karenga has led an Us delegation to Cuba in an edu-roles as administrators and organizational representa-cational exchange on race relations, African American tives. This dialogue and transformation were first life and struggle, and Us's role in the black liberation

movement; to the International Festival of Pan-African programs, and other community and professional Arts in Dakar, Senegal; and to London to given an organizations and projects. And as the core values of inaugural lecture to initiate Black History Month in Kwanzaa, they are celebrated with Kwanzaa throughout England. In the 1990s, Us played a key role on the the world African community.

Million Man March/Day of Absence Organizing Us currently continues its organizing efforts in build-Committee, and Maulana Karenga wrote the *Million ing the National Association of Kawaida Organizations Man March/Day of Absence Mission Statement*, (NAKO) and the Nguzo Saba Association out of which reflected the collective thinking of the commit-numerous organizations, institutions, and groups that tee as well as Kawaida philosophy.

use Kawaida and the Nguzo Saba in their value orien-Also important was Us's founding of its Kawaida tation, philosophy, and practice. Us is also working in Institute of Pan-African Studies (KIPAS) in the late alliances and coalitions with other progressive groups 1970s. KIPAS does research, publishes literature, and within the community and larger society, such as the holds forums and conferences. Moreover, it holds a International Black Coalition for Peace and Justice summer institute in leadership, social theory, and (IBCPJ), of which Us is a founding organization.

practice that draws a wide range of participants such Moreover, Us continues its pan-African activities by as teachers, college students, community activists, and developing a support committee for Haiti and the various kinds of professionals from around the Committee for Equitable and Sustainable Development country who come to learn Kawaida philosophy and in Africa, holding an annual African Liberation Day Afrocentric ways of engaging their studies and prac-rally, and participating in other joint activities with con-tice. In addition to teaching Kawaida philosophy, the tinenta and diasporic groups. Us also works in the institute also provides African-centered analysis of reparations movement as a member of the National selected current and past literature on black people, Coalition of Blacks for Reparations in America (N'CO-current event

analysis, issue analysis, and leadership BRA), provides literature and assistance to prisoners, training.

and maintains the African American Cultural Center Maulana Karenga and Us are most well known for and the Kawaida School of African American Culture, their work in cultural revolution and cultural recovery, Majando (rites of passage programs for boys and girls), as expressed in the development of Kawaida philosophy—the Timbuktu Book Circle, the Taifa Dance Troupe, the phy, the pan-African holiday *Kwanzaa*, and the *Nguzo Senu* Sisterhood of African Women, and the Senu *Saba* (Seven Principles). Created by Karenga in 1966, Brotherhood of African Men.

Kwanzaa is a pan-African celebration of family, com-

— *Maulana Karenga*

munity, and culture and seeks to introduce and reinforce communitarian African views and values that represent the best of what it means to be African and human in the

See also Kawaida; Nguzo Saba fullest sense. At the heart of the celebration of this 7-day holiday (December 26–January 1) are the *Nguzo Saba*

FURTHER READING

(Seven Principles). These principles in Swahili are *Umoja* (Unity), *Kujichagulia* (Self-Determination), Bankole, Katherine. (2001). *You Left Your Mind in Africa*.

Dellslow, WV: Nation House Foundation. This penetrating *Ujima* (Collective Work and Responsibility), *Ujamaa* examination of the cultural thesis alluded to in the title is (Cooperative Economics), *Nia* (Purpose), *Kuumba* made in light of African American development and (Creativity), and *Imani* (Faith). Put forth by Us as a advancement.

communitarian African value system necessary to build Karenga, Maulana. (1983). *Introduction to Black Studies*. Los and strengthen community and aid in the black freedom Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This is the most sig-struggle, the Nguzo Saba have become a central pillar in nificant

academic work to emerge from the philosophy numerous organizations and families throughout the behind Us, as Karenga's work is based on his extensive understanding of culture, organization, and economics.

world African community. Since their introduction in Terrell, Francis, Terrell, Sandra, and Taylor, Jerome. (1988).

1965, the Nguzo Saba have been used as essential cul-The Development of an Inventory to Measure Aspects of tural grounding and value orientation in many indepen-Black Nationalist Ideology. *Psycholog y* , 15(4), 31–33. This dent schools, rites of passage programs, economic is a useful article about the fundamental principles that cooperatives, black student unions, school retention undergird nationalist cultural movements .



U.S. CONSTITUTION,

THIRTEENTH AMENDMENT

Ratified December 18,
1865,

the Thirteenth

Amendment to the U.S. Constitution abolished slavery in all areas of the United States, freeing 4 million Africans from hundreds of years of bondage.

The amendment had initially failed to receive the two-thirds vote necessary in the House of Representatives, but it finally passed in February of 1865, 2 months before the official end of the Civil War in April.

The passage of the amendment put to rest debates within the Union over the validity of President Abraham Lincoln's 1863 Emancipation Proclamation.

Lincoln's proclamation had made ending slavery an explicit aim of the Union's fight in the Civil War, though it left slavery in place in a number of loyalist states and territories fighting on the Union's side, as well as in parts of the South under Union control.

Some questioned whether such a declaration could be made by the president or even the Congress, if either chose to do so. Thus abolitionists sought a constitutional amendment. Many backers of the amendment, however, were less concerned with the savagery of the

"peculiar institution" of slavery than with removing Douglass from the political discussion in the country.

they could only have expressed dismay at the new situation. After the ratification of the amendment, most abolitionists were disappointed that the rights of blacks.

newly freed Africans worked under conditions not unlike those that existed before the Civil War. Over time, many of the more egregious aspects of the black codes were repealed under pressure from the Johnson administration, who took over as president after Lincoln's assassination. Nevertheless, legal discrimination continued. When the Supreme Court first visited the issue of the Thirteenth Amendment and the black codes in 1883, it refused to intervene. As the Court noted, it appointed proslavery governors to a number of

“it would be running the slavery argument into the Southern states. These governors oversaw the passage of laws meant to ensure that every act of discrimination of *black codes*, which were laws meant to ensure the which a person may see fit to make.”

de facto enslavement of African Americans. One such law passed in Louisiana, for example, stipulated that

— *Peter Gratton*

adult men and women failing to “furnish themselves with a comfortable home and visible means of **FURTHER READING**

support”—an unlikely prospect for recently freed Africans—were subject to arrest. These prisoners were then hired out to work on plantations in order to support themselves. Horton, James, and Horton, Lois. (2001). *Hard Road to Freedom*. New Brunswick, NJ: Rutgers University Press.

This is an accessible history of the political and social pay their fines. Other laws forbade the owning or rent-upheavals in the pursuit of equality.

ing of property by African Americans, and many Pease, Jane H., and Pease, William H. (1996). *They Who Would Be Free*. Urbana: University of Illinois Press. This is an insightful history of the struggle for true freedom. Had pioneers like Sojourner Truth, Harriet Tubman, and Frederick

464———**U.S. Constitution, Fifteenth Amendment** police and giving states the right to control their own **U.S. CONSTITUTION,**

police. This was to be a major blow to the equal pro-FOURTEENTH AMENDMENT

tection clause.

The Five Sections of the Amendment are as follows: **CONTEXT**

The Fourteenth Amendment of the Constitution was Section 1. All persons born or naturalized in the one of the most contested pieces of legislation ever United States, and subject to the jurisdiction passed by the United States Congress. It represented a thereof, are citizens of the United States and of the challenge to the philosophy responsible for the idea state wherein they reside. No state shall make or that Africans were not human. The amendment even-enforce any law which shall abridge the privileges tually passed by both houses on June13, 1866.

or immunities of citizens of the United States; nor What should have been a simple idea became one of shall any state deprive any person of life, liberty, or the most fractious in the legislative chambers. Africans property, without due process of law; nor deny to were to be accepted as citizens inasmuch as they were any person within its jurisdiction the equal protec-born in the United States. The amendment sought to tion of the laws.

grant citizenship and protection to the Africans who had been freed from bondage. States were prohibited Section 2. Representatives shall be apportioned from denying or abridging the privileges or immunities among the several states according to their respec-of citizens of the United States. There had been distive numbers, counting the whole number of cussion about giving Africans limited rights, certainly persons in each state, excluding Indians not taxed.

not the same rights as whites. The southern whites But when the right to vote at any election for the sought every opportunity to deprive the African

of all choice of electors for President and Vice President privileges of life, liberty, and property, often without of the United States, Representatives in Congress, due process of law. Now the law would dictate that the the executive and judicial officers of a state, or the African had to have the same rights as anyone else members of the legislature thereof, is denied to any within the jurisdiction of the state.

of the male inhabitants of such state, being twenty-The majority of the southern states refused to ratify one years of age, and citizens of the United States, the law. It took the intervention of men such as or in any way abridged, except for participation in Thaddeus Stevens, Charles Sumner, Benjamin Wade, rebellion, or other crime, the basis of representa-Henry Winter Davies, and Benjamin Butler, called tion therein shall be reduced in the proportion Radical Republicans, to force the passing of addi-which the number of such male citizens shall bear tional legislation that would impose the measures on to the whole number of male citizens twenty-one the states in the former Confederacy. The result was years of age in such state.

the 1867 Reconstruction Act that divided the South Section 3. No person shall be a Senator or into five military districts controlled by martial law Representative in Congress, or elector of President from Washington. Thus universal manhood suffrage and Vice President, or hold any office, civil or mil-was established, and the new constitutions in the old itary, under the United States, or under any state, Confederacy had to honor the rights of Africans to be who, having previously taken an oath, as a member citizens.

of Congress, or as an officer of the United States, Because many whites refused to accept this law, or as a member of any state legislature, or as an the federal government had to step in and protect the executive or judicial officer of any state, to support African's right to citizenship and to due process.

the Constitution of the United States, shall have Ratification of the document was in doubt for a engaged in insurrection or rebellion against the considerable period of time, but the Amendment was same, or given aid or comfort to the enemies eventually ratified by the states July 28, 1868. Old thereof. But Congress may by a vote of two-thirds Confederate states were required to ratify it in order to of each House, remove such disability.

be readmitted into the Union . The Supreme Court's ruling in the 1873 Slaughterhouse cases weakened the Section 4. The validity of the public debt of the amendment, taking federal control away from state United States, authorized by law, including debts

U-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 465

U.S. Constitution, Fifteenth Amendment——465

incurred for payment of pensions and bounties for citizen's right to vote based on "race, color, or previous services in suppressing insurrection or rebellion, condition of servitude." This amendment symbolized shall not be questioned. But neither the United the beginning of a new era for Africans in America States nor any state shall assume or pay any debt or through suffrage for every African American male.

obligation incurred in aid of insurrection or rebel-However, this was the last of three so-called lion against the United States, or any claim for the Reconstruction amendments that were ratified during loss or emancipation of any slave; but all such the post-Civil War era.

debts, obligations and claims shall be held illegal The Fifteenth Amendment was ratified by the fed-and void.

eral government to legislate qualifications for voting, a right formerly left up to each state. However, for Section 5. The Congress shall have power to almost a century this amendment had a small impact enforce, by appropriate legislation, the provisions in the country as a whole, and its most limited effect of this article.

in the South, where a number of racist methods—

terrorism, the poll tax, and the grandfather clause—

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

were still employed to keep blacks from voting.

In the era after the Civil War (1866–1891), many **FURTHER READING**

blacks were still treated as less than human. Where the Thirteenth and Fourteenth Amendments failed to Bond, James E. (1997). *No Easy Walk to Freedom: Reconstruction and the Ratification of the 14th* assure equal protection under the law, federal legisla-Amendment. Westport, CT.: Praeger. This is one of the clas-tion was ratified to assure this protection. However, sic books on the subject of the 14th Amendment. It is well the Fifteenth Amendment was used by some politi-researched and well written.

cians as a Trojan horse in order to win favoritism from McWhirter, Darien A. (1995). *Equal Protection*. Phoenix, AZ: soon-to-be black voters. Maryland is a good example Oryx Press. This book is excellent for anyone wanting to of a state where this was the case, where there were have an introduction to the provisions of the 14th heated party tensions over whether or not to ratify or Amendment.

Nieman, Donal. (1991). *Promises to Keep: African American deny the application of the Fifteenth Amendment in and the Constitutional Order, 1776 to the Present*. New the state.

York: Oxford University Press. This is one of the best The political machines of the Democratic and works to date dealing with the difficult road African Republican parties dominated the agenda for the Americans have had under the laws of the United States of Fifteenth Amendment in the state of Maryland.

America. Nieman shows how almost every law that was These parties' political motivations obscured the created to protect the rights of African Americans was con-goals and aims of the Fifteenth Amendment. Power-tested by the reactionary elements in the society.

hungry Republicans worked against Democrats in the state to assure the successful ratification of the Fifteenth Amendment, so that almost 40,000 blacks **U.S. CONSTITUTION**,

in the state would be able to vote for them. The offer for black voter suffrage did not come without a price.

FIFTEENTH AMENDMENT

In return for black suffrage, blacks were lured into voting for the Maryland state political machine, Section 1. The right of citizens of the United States which still seemed to support old Southern unionist States to vote shall not be denied or abridged by hegemony.

the United States or by any State on account of African American men in Maryland celebrated race, color, or previous condition of servitude.

their new civil rights and the opportunity to vote for the first time. Blacks celebrated from Boston to Chicago, but it was recorded in the May 19, 1870

enforce this article by appropriate legislation.

issue of the *Baltimore Sun* newspaper that the celebration in Baltimore was by far the largest, with over 22,000 people participating. Baltimore was chosen as was ratified in 1870. This amendment prohibits federal or state governments from infringing on a most important being that it was the home state of

U-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:02 PM Page 466

466———**U.S. Constitution, Fifteenth Amendment** some of the most popular activists and political **FURTHER READING**

figures of that time. Hugh Lennox Bond, Senator Banfield, Susan. (1998). *The Fifteenth Amendment: African American Men's Right to Vote*. Enslow, CA: Enslow of Maryland's most outspoken political figures during this Reconstruction and post-Civil War era.

Fifteenth Amendment for the student of American history.

Frederick Douglass, Martin Delany, and Hiram Matthews, John M. (1971). *Legislative and Judicial History of the Fifteenth Amendment*. New York: Da Capo Press. This

legacy in Baltimore following the ratification of the work follows the legal path of the Fifteenth Amendment Fifteenth Amendment in the state of Maryland.

through history.

Wade, Linda R. (1998). *Reconstruction: The Year's Following the Civil War*. Edina, MN: Abdo and Daughters. This work

— *York Williams*

is a useful introduction to Reconstruction.

V-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:04 PM Page 467

V

of the slaving South. What was as amazing about **VESEY'S CONSPIRACY**

Vesey's group was that they collected money to purchase guns, recruited blacksmiths and a priest who In 1822, Denmark Vesey led an insurrection against was deeply involved in the African traditions, and the slaveholders of Charleston, South Carolina. Vesey schemed to take over the arsenal in the city. The upris-was an educated man from Saint Domingue, and one ing was planned for July of 1822, when most of the of the advantages that he had over other Africans was whites would be taking their vacations.

that he spoke two European languages, French and Vesey's plot is considered the best planned rebel-English.

lion and attack on enslavement in the history of the When Vesey came to Charleston with his owner, he United States. But an enslaved African heard about came with ideas of freedom. He did not believe that he the plot and went and told his owner. The whites were could remain a slave, and in 1800 he purchased himself stunned that blacks had made such extensive plans from his owner with money that he had won in a lottery.

to attack them and immediately went and arrested the He became a carpenter, and in the process of establish-leaders, including Denmark Vesey, Peter Poyas, Ned ing a place for himself in society, he amassed a fortune Bennett, Rolla Bennett, Balleau Bennett, Gullah Jack, that included property worth more than \$8,000.

the priest, and 35 others. They were all hanged, and Having purchased his own freedom, Vesey wanted 43 others were banished. In the end, Denmark Vesey to also free his brothers and sisters from bondage. So and his cohorts had demonstrated that the system in the rarefied and free air of the African community of enslavement could be challenged by Africans.

of Charleston, Vesey met with other free Africans to Unfortunately for the strategists, their plot had been plot an assault on racism and slavery. They met in a reported to the whites by an enslaved African whose church at Hampstead, a suburb of Charleston, to talk freedom they would have claimed.

and to strategize.

— *Molefi Kete Asante*

They were committed to debating the Missouri Compromise and any other issue in the national discussion dealing with Africans. At the meetings, they
FURTHER READING

passed information about fighting for liberty, talked openly about liberation in Saint Domingue, and Aptheker, Herbert. (1961). *Slave Revolts*. New York: shared their anger at the system of enslavement in the International Publishers . In this very important work, Aptheker identifies the major revolts by enslaved Africans South. Then, in December of 1821, they began to in America.

recruit blacks from areas as far as 80 miles from Asante, Molefi Kete. (2001). *African American History*: Charleston. Vesey's people drew up a list of thousands *A Journey of Liberation*. Saddle Creek, NJ: Peoples of recruits who were willing to oppose the institution Publishing Group. This

book provides a general history of of slavery. This was a massive movement in the heart resistance and liberation.

467

V-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:04 PM Page 468

468———**Vodu**

make any strict distinction between life and death: **VODU**

Indeed, life is infinite by virtue of the supreme cosmic force, and death is simply another mode of life. Thus, Vodou (also spelled vodoun, voodoo, voodoo, vodou, and quite consistently, there is also no waterproof sep-vodun, voodoo, voodoo) is a powerful religion and, aration between the world of the spirits and the world more important, a way of life driven by a quest for of the living. The two worlds are easily accessible to cosmic harmony and oneness with God.

each other via the manipulation of the cosmic energy.

ORIGINS OF VODU

The Loas

Vodu originated in Africa, where it is still practiced, Vodouists believe that the spiritual world is densely and in particular in Benin, where it is practiced in populated. In addition to restless and purely malevo-its original form. Vodou, however, crossed the African lent spirits, one finds two major categories of spirits: (Atlantic) Ocean during the 17th, 18th, and 19th cen-the living-dead and, above them, the Loas. Although turies, at the time of the European-organized deporta-the living-dead play an important role in the lives of tion of millions of Africans to different parts of the Vodouists, the Loas are nonetheless the most important Americas as part of the Triangular Trade.

spiritual entities in the world of Vodou. Although some Vodou is commonly associated with Haiti, where of them may be of human origin, the Loas, it is

said, it is the religion of the vast majority of the people.

were created by the supreme God, Gran-Mèt, in order While it is primarily indebted to the Fon belief to manage human affairs. Each Loa is associated with system, Vodou in Haiti also integrated elements from a particular aspect of life, for which it has become a other African people, such as the Yoruba (Nago), metaphor. As such, Loas are neither good nor bad.

Ibo, Congo, Hausa, Caplaou, Mandigo, Mondong, However, they can be called upon by human beings and many others. It also includes some aspects of the for good deeds, such as restoring balance and har-religion of the Arawaks (the indigenous inhabitants mony in one's life; or bad deeds, such as hurting of Haiti), of Freemasonry, and of Catholicism. The another unprotected human being. Vodouists associate influence of the latter primarily takes the form of the latter not with Vodou but with sorcery, the two dates of celebration, pictures of saints, prayers, and so being distinct. There is a strong ethical dimension on. However, it must be recognized that those saints to Vodou that is antithetical to doing evil. Those who and prayers are made to participate in a liturgy which engage in reprehensible actions must live with their is, at its core, African, not Catholic. The presence of

“konsyans” (i.e., conscience) and face the conse-Catholic symbols in Vodou in Haiti is attributable to the quences of their immoral choices. There are literally harassment to which African people were subjected hundreds of Loas, usually distributed among three by Europeans during (and even after) slavery while major pantheons: the Rada (Fon) pantheon, the Petro practicing religion; hence, the need to hide Vodou (Creole) pantheon, and the Congo pantheon. What behind European (i.e., “acceptable”) symbols.

distinguishes those pantheons, in addition to their geographical origin, is the nature of the energy they summon, the Rada energy being “cool,” and the Petro **VODU PHILOSOPHY**

and Congo energy being “hot.” Thus, depending on Vodou is a manifestation of the African spiritual sys-the nature of the call that was placed, the same Loa tem. As such, it rests on the very ancient African may come as a Rada Loa (i.e., as a rather cool type of assumption that the whole cosmos is animated by a energy) or as a Petro Loa (i.e., as a rather hot type of vital

force of divine origin that permeates all that energy). This is the distinction, for example, between exists—human beings, animals, plants, minerals, and Ezili Freda and her Petro correspondence, Ezili-objects, as well as phenomena. As a result, Africans Zyéwouj (Red Eyes). On the other hand, some Loas in general, and Vodouists in particular, think of them as not so versatile and belong exclusively to the human self as separated or distinct from the cosmos but energy category. These are the Loas usually called as an intricate part of a whole that is greater than upon by those involved in mischief. Loas respond by themselves. Similarly, Vodou metaphysics does not mount or possessing particular people, through

V-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:04 PM Page 469

Vodu——469

whom they communicate with the living. While being serious personal risks, such as sickness, repeated mounted by a Loa, one may find oneself capable of misfortunes, and even death.

acts that defy common physical laws, such as climb-The main functions and responsibilities of a ing a tree feet up or walking on fire or glass without Mambo and Houngan Assongwe are therefore primar-incurring any injury. Generally speaking, the Rada ily (but not exclusively) spiritual. Mambos and pantheon is the one most closely associated with Houngans Assongwe are expected to be capable of Vodou. Its main actors are Loas such as Papa Legba, performing operations that will meet the spiritual the one who opens the doors to the spiritual world, needs of the people, such as the diagnosis of the pre-and without whose permission no ceremony can take cise nature of an ill condition and the prescription of a place; Papa Loko, the “Father” of the Loas, guardian cure. The diagnosis usually takes place through div-of the trees; the Marassa, the sacred twins; Papa ination, with the priestess or priest making contact Dambala, the sacred snake, symbol of life; Metrès with the Loa with whom she or he “works” and ask-Ezili, the Loa of reproduction and sexuality; Papa ing for information about the condition of the person Ogu, the Loa of fire, thunder, and war; Papa Agwe and who came for consultation. If the problem is spiritual, La Sirène, masters of the ocean; and others. The then a remedy will also be suggested at that time. It

words Papa (“Father”) and Metrès (“Mistress”) are could take the form of a sacrifice, a bath, a protection terms of respect and endearment.

with a talisman, prayers, observation of certain taboos, or something else. A person may also be recommended to “marry” a particular Loa for protection; **VODU PRIESTS AND PRIESTESSES:**

this marriage takes place in an elaborate ceremony **HOUNGANS AND MAMBOS ASSONGWE**

similar to a wedding between two human beings.

Houngans and Mambos Assongwe are also called In any case, the performance of rituals will then be Papa and Manman (“Mother”), for they occupy the necessary.

highest level in the Vodou religious hierarchy (as far as human beings are concerned) and, as such, enjoy the **VODU RITUALS**

greatest respect among Vodou followers. Indeed, only they have gone before Papa Loko to be consecrated by Vodou rituals, whose main goal is to restore or keep him as dignitaries of the Vodou religion. From Papa in balance the web of energies around a person, are Loko, Mambos and Houngans Assongwe received very numerous and often quite complex. However, their *asson*, a calabash covered with special beads, they seem always to be based on the principle of and to which a bell has been tied. However, more the existence of cosmic correspondences between the important, the asson has been charged with a particu-physical and the spiritual worlds. Thus, each form of lar energy and power, the power to summon and direct spiritual energy (in this case, the Loas) is associated the Loas. Only to Houngans and Mambos Assongwe with specific aspects of the physical realm, such as have certain secrets been revealed. They also each foods, drinks, music, drawings (also called *vèvè*), received a spiritual name, which allows them to be colors, days, trees, scents, and dances. The activation identified by other priests and priestesses. There are of those physical aspects, the Vodouists believe, will two common ways through which one becomes a greatly facilitate the coming forth of a particular Houngan or Mambo Assongwe. One may be called by spiritual energy and its response to their call for help

the Loas themselves to serve them, or one may inherit and protection. Papa Ogu's day, for example, is from one's family line, especially from one's mother Wednesday; his favorite drink is rum, his color is red, or father, the charge of the priesthood. It is often after his favorite food is pork, and he likes to have certain a period of great difficulty, such as a recurrent illness, songs sung to him. Papa Dambala's day, on the other a series of misfortunes, loss of loved ones, that one hand, is Thursday and his color white; he likes white becomes aware of having been chosen by the Loas. To *sirop d'orgeat* and enjoys raw eggs. He too has songs be a Houngan or Mambo Assongwe means that one that he particularly likes. Similarly, each Loa has his has accepted the responsibility of serving the Loas in or her own *vèvè*, a drawing, often a very complex one, order to serve the people. While one may refuse to that is made on the ground, usually with cornmeal or respond to the calling, such a decision always entails flour. The *vèvè* always include symbols associated

V-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:04 PM Page 470

470———**Vodu**

with the Loa in question. Thus, the main element of several days. It is also where the *pé*, the Vodu shrine, Ezili Fréda's *vèvè* is a heart, while in Dambala's *vèvè*, is located. Important items of the Vodu cult are placed the main element is a snake. Drumming also plays a on the *pé*, such as the *colliers* (sacred necklaces), role of paramount importance in Vodu ceremonies.

flags, *govi* (jars that contain spiritual elements), Indeed, drums are held sacred since they are believed books, and so on.

to host spirits. Rada ceremonies involve three drums—

In addition to being places where spiritual cere-the largest one is called *Manman*; the medium one is monies are held, hounforts also function as com-Segon; and the smallest one is *Boula*. Petro and Congo munes. Indeed, attached to the Mambo or Houngan ceremonies, on the other hand, require two drums.

are a number of persons, called Hounsies, who were Another critical set of rituals performed by initiated by her or him. They owe respect and devotion Houngan and Mambo Assongwe are those associated to their Papa or Manman. They usually spend a sig-with the initiation into Vodou. In fact, so important and nificant amount of time at the hounfort, may even complex are those rituals that they require the pres-sleep there at times, and certainly must come when ence of several Houngans and Mambos Assongwe.

called for help, especially during ceremonies when The Vodou initiation is a very stringent process referred dancers and singers are needed. In return for the to as *kouche kanzo*. This process follows closely the loyalty of their initiates, the Mambo or Houngan is African pattern of separation, location in a sacred ultimately responsible for the needs of the Hounsies place, symbolic death, testing, revelation, resurrec-and must feed them and help pay their hospital bills or tion, and reincorporation of the initiate into the larger children's school tuition if necessary. In other words, community after several days of strict isolation from the hounfort is an important place of comfort and impure persons, that is, noninitiates. Aside from support for all attached to it.

Houngans and Mambos, *Hounsies* make up the largest portion of Vodou initiates. They have undergone the **VODU IN HAITIAN HISTORY**

first level of the *kouche kanzo* initiation and thus may assist a Houngan or Mambo during ceremonies and Since the very beginning of the French occupation of diverse rituals.

Haiti, Vodou was seen with great suspicion and therefore vilified by the French. Thus the French made every attempt to eradicate Vodou by subjecting Vodou **THE VODU TEMPLE**

practitioners to the harshest treatments, such as hang-Rituals usually take place within the confines of a ing, flogging, imprisonment, and live skinning, and by Vodou temple, a *houmfort*. A hounfort is made up of destroying Vodou-related objects, particularly drums.

several parts. The first one, the *péristyle*, is located at This harassment went on for 300 years. However, it the entrance of the hounfort. Its size may

vary from failed to suppress Vodou, which remained very much hounfort to hounfort, but it is usually a rather large, alive. In fact, it is Vodou, it is said, that successfully semi-open space where ceremonies take place. It is protected and guided the African struggle for freedom typically decorated with mystic paintings on the walls and independence. The most prestigious leaders of and colorful decorations hanging from the ceiling.

the Haitian War, Boukman, Dessalines, Makandal, The most important part of the péristyle, however, is Christophe, and Toussaint L'Ouverture, to cite only the *potomitan*, a pillar located in the center, usually a few, were all involved in Vodou. Makandal and decorated with a beautiful snake, and connecting the Boukman were Houngans, while Dessalines and ground to the ceiling. The Loas are believed to ascend Toussaint served Papa Ogu-Fè. However, while what or descend through the *potomitan*, which is therefore the Europeans feared—that Vodou had the power to seen as a magical passage. Given this, the *potomitan* undermine their authority in Haiti—had come true, plays a critical role during Vodou ceremonies. In addi-this did not necessarily mean an end to the war against tion to the péristyle, the hounfort also includes a Vodou. Indeed, several successive Haitian presidents, number of small rooms, which are sanctuaries dedi-often highly encouraged and assisted by the Vatican, cated to the Loas honored in that particular hounfort.

attempted to annihilate Vodou, thus causing the sys-One of the rooms, the *djèvo*, which represents sym-tematic destruction of many important items associ-bolic death, is where new initiates are secluded for ated with Vodou, such as drums, clothes, assons, flags,

V-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:04 PM Page 471

Vodou———471

and so on. Today, however, Vodou is still widely provides a useful survey of Vodou's origins and main practiced by a great number of Haitians. In addition, principles.

efforts are underway, on the part of several Houngans Deren, Maya. (1953). *Divine Horsemen: The Living Gods of Haiti*. Kingston, NY: McPherson.

This was written by a and Mambos throughout the country, to codify Vodou European woman who was initiated into Vodou. Its main and make it the official religion of Haiti.

merit is Deren's vivid descriptions of Vodou rituals and the

— *Ama Mazama*

general atmosphere in which they take place.

Gersi, Douchan. (1991). *Faces in the Smoke*. Los Angeles: **FURTHER READING**

Jeremy P. Tarcher. This is a fascinating account of the author's experiences with Vodou in Haiti, which describes *Angels in the Mirror: Vodou Music of Haiti* [CD]. (1997).

the power of Vodouists to alter reality.

New York: Ellipsis Arts Recordings.

Métraux, Alfred. (1972). *Voodoo in Haiti*. New York: Schocken Cheriza, Pierre. (1998). *Tambour Mystère—Haiti: Music of the Books*. This remains probably the most accessible and *Voodoo Cult* [CD]. Paris: Buda Musique Recordings.

reliable source of information on Vodou for noninitiates.

Crosley, Reginald. (2000). *The Vodun Quantum Leap*: Rigaud, Milo. (1953). *La Tradition Voodoo et le Voodoo Alternate Realities, Power and Mysticism*. St. Paul, MN: *Haitien*. Paris: Editions Niclaus. Rigaud provides an Llewellyn. Although unsympathetic to Vodou, Crosley insider's look into Vodou.

W-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:03 PM Page 473

W

construction of a social dynamic aimed at creating **WATTS PROPHETS**

understanding through words and rhythms inspires an African method of observing data and methodology. The Watts Prophets were a group of inspired poets who for interpreting the data. This particular kind of data were products of the accumulated economic, social, relocations of the African personality at the center of shape and political conditions of a community in South Central Los Angeles, shifting the discourse around African agency.

Central Los Angeles. Otis O'Solomon, Anthony

“Amde” Hamilton, and Richard Dedeaux, long-time **SOCIAL AND CULTURAL RELEVANCE**

area residents and community activists, were the original soul of the Watts Prophets. The poetic works of the pro-black stance expressed by the trio in the 1960s these men, and of other cultural activist-artists across articulated the connection between the pressing the nation in the 1960s, were the roots of many expressive-macrosocial realities of racism, poverty, and oppressions that are now part of our spoken language and, a recognition that the poor and working-class black community more important, the precursor of much of the intellectual in South Central Los Angeles experienced in their mutual expansion of African thought within the academy, everyday lives and the global context of that reality.

around African agency. *African agency*, as it is. This articulation is apparent in the title and substance expressed in the framework of Africology, is the study of their first album, *Rappin' Black in a White World*.

of African phenomena through the eyes of Africans, Today that expression, though not encased in the who are living the experience with specific ideas symbolic ideals of the black power movement, still regarding the interpretation of that experience.

reveals the pressing issues for the poor and working-Prior to the 1960s, many African Americans did not class black community. The focus today is more often see themselves as the center of their artistic and cultural at the microsocial levels, speaking to such issues as experience. They were still performing for white audiences, illiteracy, child abuse, neglect, rejection, HIV/AIDS, violence and for white interests, although they would and suicide.

The challenges facing the black commu-write about African American conditions. The Watts nity are the subject of the Watts Prophets' 1997 CD, Prophets changed this reality: Their words, music, and *When the 90's Came*, in which their words reflect the performances engaged audiences in a new aesthetic fire, love, and hope that drove them in the 1990s and of expression. The Watts Prophets presented poetry as continues to punctuate their messages today. In a an expression of African call-and-response. The call poignant analysis of the global economic and political was in the deliberate gestures, poses, eye contact, and co-optation of cultural icons and power agendas in rhythmic movement that characterized the perfor-their title track, they highlight how "Malcolm had been mances, and the response was the audience's engage-reduced to a commercial X, the Panthers to a movie, ment in those performances. This multidimensional the world psyched into an ethnic fight, while gun 473

W-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:03 PM Page 474

474——Watts Prophets

runners grow in economic might." The exploitation workshop to give people hope and freedom to express of black people by a powerful white majority—out of a growing global culture of power became a target greed, for economic and political gain—is what drove of the federal government. The resident videographer the revolutionary fervor of the 1960s and resulted in admitted that he had worked as an FBI informant, many rebellions across the United States. This long-which confirmed the artists' suspicions of a govern-term exploitative relationship with the black commu-ment conspiracy in the destruction of the project.

nity was a catalyst for the Watts Rebellion of 1965.

The rebellion in Watts focused attention on the **POLITICAL IMPACT**

inhumane living conditions in South Central Los Angeles, which brought millions of dollars of funding But it was the formation of African American cultural for housing, hospitals, and youth programs to the expression through the lived experiences of artists like area. Not only did it bring in government funding, the Watts Prophets, with the Watts Writers Workshop

but private liberal philanthropists also added their own as their lab, that made possible the African ideological gestures to assuage their guilt for neglecting the stance that continues to grow in the academy. The black community. One such outpouring resulted in Watts Prophets' music and message in the sixties and the creation of the Watts Writers Workshop, started by seventies was, in addition to being rhythmic and Budd Schulberg, screenwriter of *On the Waterfront*.

inspiring, also critical, political, and cultural, even This workshop became an outlet for a community though they were not aligned with any particular of creative people to express the myriad experiences cause or group. They considered themselves "the nestled on the margins of European discourse.

community's poets"; they became the prescient voice Hamilton, O'Solomon, and Dedeaux, then in their of the scholars investigating the subjective voice of twenties, were all participants in the Watts Writers Africans as agents. The expressions of cultural and Workshop. Cassius Weatherby recommended that artistic workers often become the forerunners to social they come together because of the possible synergy of consciousness and change. O'Solomon's poetic work their works. When they won second place in a talent *Hey World* was ahead of the curve in voicing for earth show at the legendary Maverick's Flat, they caught the sustainability before Greenpeace's environmental attention of the public as well as of other popular per-messages or a concept called *ecology* became preva-formers of the time. They subsequently appeared lent. The Watts Prophets represent the integrity of between concert sets of Earth, Wind and Fire, George a transgenerational interpretation of African experi-Clinton, and Richard Pryor. In the 1970s the Watts ences in South Central Los Angeles that are similar to Prophets recorded two legendary albums, *Black in a many other African experiences in the continental White World* and *In the Streets of Watts*. They were United States.

also guest artists on Stevie Wonder's *Songs in the Key*

— *Fatima Hafiz*

of Life and Quincy Jones's *Mellow Madness*.

The Watts Writers Workshop became a prestigious forum for people from all over the world to come and **FURTHER READING**

find a safe space for expression. The Watts Prophets Asante, Molefi Kete. (2002). *Afrocentricity*. Trenton, NJ: and other poets of the people knew long before the Africa Word Press. The idea behind this book is that discourse of postmodernism that the word was the African people are subjects and agents who are participat-source for deconstruction of the realities established ing in their own cultural revolution. Thus the book uses the by oppressive powers and conditions. As Dedeaux power and eloquence of the young poets of New York and expressed it, in the beginning, “there was nothing but Los Angeles as ways to influence youth.

a workshop, some railroad tracks, and a tree across the Ba, Sylvia. (1973). *The Concept of Negritude in the Poetry of street*, which we called the Freedom Tree.” In the end, *Léopold Sédar Senghor*. Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press. This is an excellent discussion of the with funding from area celebrities, film studios, and poetry of Négritude.

philanthropists, the workshop had grown to include a Karenga, Maulana. (2002). *Introduction to Black Studies*.

main building, a piano donated by Sammy Davis, Jr., Los Angeles: University of Sankore Press. This is the and a 350-seat, \$250,000 theater. These were all standard work on the development of Black Studies as burned to the ground in 1975 when the power of the a field of study.

W-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:03 PM Page 475

Watts Rebellion of 1965———475

As this was taking place, community residents and **WATTS REBELLION OF 1965**

pedestrians began to observe the ensuing situation.

Initially, Marquette remained calm and jovial; how-The Watts Rebellion of 1965 was the first of a series of ever, when it became clear that he was

being arrested violent confrontations between African Americans and his vehicle was being impounded, he became com-the white power structure that took place in the 1960s bative. When Officer Minikus, and several other offi-in the United States. The decade of the 1960s, as a cers who came onto the scene for backup, attempted to whole, on one level saw the failure of the American handcuff Marquette, he resisted. Meanwhile, a throng dream vis-à-vis integration; on another level, it of people had begun to form. A neighbor of the Fries witnessed the insurgence of black nationalist fervor ran to the Frye residence to alert Rena Frye, Marquette's and agency that was sweeping America's inner cities.

mother, that her son was having some trouble with the Watts, a section of South Central Los Angeles that police. When she arrived on the scene, it aggravated was named after land developer Charles A. Watts, ini-Marquette even more. Rena Frye attempted to calm tially was a multicultural community inhabited by her son, but to no avail. As the situation escalated and European, Asian, and Latino immigrants. Then, in the police backup arrived, Joyce Anne Gaines, a student at mid 1800s, African peoples began to move west to Compton Junior College, was mistakenly identified as California in search of better employment and, by someone who had spit on one of the police officers on 1950, African Americans were entrenched in Watts.

the scene. In their attempt to quell an already tense Like many urban areas with large African American situation, a few officers restrained and handcuffed populations during this time, Watts represented the Joyce and placed her into a police vehicle. Rena Frye growing disparities between African Americans and was also assaulted by police as she tried to intervene others. In the 1950s and 1960s, African Americans when her son Ronald was being jabbed with a police suffered from disproportionate unemployment rates, nightstick. Naturally, this added fuel to an already dilapidated housing, police brutality, and substandard tense situation.

education. They were largely excluded from the eco-The violence and mayhem that is now known as the nomic prosperity of America. Furthermore, many of Watts Rebellion lasted 6 days.

the political gains made by the civil rights movement Though just a catalyst, the stopping and subsequent of the 1950s and 1960s were lost.

arrest of Marquette Frye ignited the underlying vitriolic sentiments that had been simmering in the African American community in Watts.

THE REBELLION

In the end, 34 people died, 1,032 were injured, and The Watts Rebellion began on August 11, 1965, when 3,952 were arrested. There was over \$100 million in Marquette Frye, a young African American male, property damage. When the smoke cleared, many along with his stepbrother Ronald, was stopped on African Americans were targeted for the various a “routine” traffic stop on Avalon Blvd. in South crimes, primarily theft, committed during the rebel-Central Los Angeles. Ironically, it turned out that Frye lion. Local citizens were encouraged to provide tips to was pulled over because an African American truck aid in the process of convicting the guilty parties driver had flagged down California Highway Patrol (which led to a plethora of bogus tips). Citizens were officer Lee Minikus to describe a vehicle he had just also told that they could place stolen goods on their observed being driven erratically.

lawns and, by doing so, would avoid prosecution.

When officer Minikus finally caught up to the vehicle Marquette was driving, Marquette told Officer **THE AFTERMATH**

Minikus that he had lost his driver’s license not long ago, which was true. Nevertheless, Minikus became Many factors led to what has been labeled the Watts skeptical of Marquette’s story and asked Marquette to Rebellion of 1965. Although identifying all these step out of his vehicle. Though he had in fact been factors is very complex, some of the more obvious drinking, as he readily admitted, Marquette stated that factors can be identified as follows: (1) the radical he was not drunk. With this information, Officer posturing and rhetoric of many black nationalist orga- Minikus asked Marquette to take a sobriety test.

nizations such as the Black Panther Party, Us, the

476———**Westernization**

Student Non-Violent Coordinating Committee (SNCC), and the Nation of Islam; (2) Malcolm X's **WESTERNIZATION**

assassination in 1965; and (3) the substandard living conditions of African Americans in Watts (including Westernization refers to the spread of the culture of but not limited to unemployment and police Western Europe to other parts of the world, such as brutality).

(but not limited to) Africa. Westernization is closely After the rebellion, politicians, including President associated with Western modernity, as it emerged dur-Lyndon B. Johnson, scrambled to address the condi- ing the European Enlightenment period. Succinctly tions that led to the Watts rebellion. President Johnson defined, European modernity rests on an elevation offered a "25 year plan," which sought—at least of rationalism and empiricism; the assertion of the epis-superficially—to alter living conditions in Watts.

temological superiority of science; the adoption and Moreover, California governor Pat Brown nominated holding of individualistic and materialistic values; and John McCone to head a commission to study the a hostile stance toward nature as a supreme value. This rebellion. The findings of the McCone Commission resulted in the understanding and promotion of capital-revealed what was already painfully obvious to ism, bureaucracy, and science as existential ideals.

African Americans in Watts: The rebellion was not However, these ideals were believed by many incited by a small group of rogue African Americans, Europeans to be not simply valid but, in fact, the or riffraff; to the contrary, the causes of the rebellion best possible cultural norms. They were therefore were directly related to living conditions in Watts—

to be shared by all human beings, that is, made uni-the high jobless rates, poor housing, and substandard versal through their adoption by people around the schools.

world, hence Westernization. Thus, as a process, Though the study was considered useful from a Westernization entails that the targeted culture take on theoretical perspective, no serious attempt was made deep cultural changes; the acquisition of new skills; to use the information it contained to remedy the deep, the acceptance of new ideas about the nature of the underlying problems in Watts and similar areas. Thus world and human relationships; new values; new atti-the Watts Rebellion was a precursor to rebellions tudes; and the redirecting of their human energies.

that took place in the subsequent years in numerous The ultimate goal of Westernization is the establish-cities throughout America, most notably in Detroit, ment of a single standard of value based on the Michigan, and Newark, New Jersey, in the summer Western model.

of 1967. Nonetheless, the Watts Rebellion of 1965

Typically, three main mechanisms have been marked a turning point in American history. It could used to facilitate Westernization: the construction of no longer be assumed that integration was a success Western European culture as universal, violence, and and that African Americans were content with their misrepresentation. One method consistently used by place in American society.

Western Europeans to spread their culture has been an implicit refusal to relate their culture to its own

— *William Boone*

historical, social, and physical base, thus creating the illusion of cultural neutrality and normalcy, in other **FURTHER READING**

words, of Western European cultural universality.

Bullock, Paul. (1969). *Watts: The Aftermath; An Inside View* New names, such as *international* and *classical*, have of *the Ghetto*. New York: Grove Press. This is a useful become misnomers when applied, as they are apt to account of the actions of the police and citizens during the be, to cultural realities that are in fact specifically Watts uprising.

Western European. Violence, the second technique Crump, Spencer. (1966). *Black Riot in Los Angeles: The Story* employed, has manifested itself in different manners, *of the Watts Tragedy*. Los Angeles: Trans-Anglo. Crump's often as the exercise of physical brutality, but also as book is one of the best accounts of the day-to-day happen-the denial of the existence of indigenous cultures, ings during the violence.

which then became invisible. For example, it was Governor's Commission on the Los Angeles Riots. (1965).

Violence in the City: An End or a Beginning? Los Angeles: assumed that Africans had never developed any con-Author. This is the official report by the Governor's cept of God or any philosophy, and that only Western Commission.

Europeans had. Finally, the misrepresentation of

W-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:03 PM Page 477

The World Conference Against Racism, Racial Discrimination, Xenophobia——477

indigenous cultures came about as a result of their was attempted during the period of colonialism in Africa, being branded inferior, invalid, primitive, archaic, especially as it relates to religion.

limited, and so on, while Western European culture Sachs, Wolfgang. (Ed.). (1991). *The Development Dictionary*.

A Guide to Knowledge as Power. London: Zed Books. This was supposed to be just the opposite.

is an excellent study of most of the concepts imposed on It is therefore clear that Westernization, when it people of the world as part of the Westernization enterprise.

occurred, was based not on genuine cultural exchanges The book locates those concepts within their own cultural and respect, but on domination,

submission, injustice, matrix.

and destruction. Western culture must be correctly perceived as a local tradition that has been spread by force.

The first push toward Westernization was arguably the 12th-century Christian Crusades, shortly followed **THE WORLD CONFERENCE**

by colonialism and imperialism, which marked the **AGAINST RACISM, RACIAL**

beginning of the reign of Western European military, **DISCRIMINATION, XENOPHOBIA**

merchants, and missionaries. Westernization is rooted in the concept of the “white man’s burden” or the **AND RELATED INTOLERANCE**

“civilizing mission” of Western Europeans.

The extent to which the world has been Westernized The World Conference Against Racism, Racial remains a matter of debate. Some believe that Western-Discrimination, Xenophobia and Related Intolerance ization has been extensive, while others see it as a (WCAR) was convened by the United Nations (UN) rather superficial and already receding phenomenon.

in Durban, South Africa, from August 31 through However, most agree that Westernization has had a neg-September 8, 2001. Reportedly, approximately 12,000

ative impact on the world in general, and on Africans in people, representing over 153 countries of the world, particular, by undermining the fabric of many commu-were in attendance. In the weeks leading up to the nities as it created an increasing impoverishment and gathering, three highly charged issues were expected homogenization of life and a sterile aping of the West.

to top the conference agenda: (1) the fight to recog-In addition, many have questioned the validity of the nize the Holocaust of African Enslavement

(HAE) as Western model by pointing out its failure, as eloquently a crime against humanity; (2) the reparations due to be demonstrated by the massive social decay experienced paid to the descendants of the Africans against whom by many Western societies, as well as the unprecedented the said criminal acts were perpetrated, and (3) the ecological disaster created by the adoption of Western push to denounce the Israeli occupation of the cultural norms and practices. The Westernization enter-Palestinian homeland in the Middle East as racism.

prise therefore must be questioned and critiqued on A new nongovernmental organization (NGO), the both moral and practical grounds.

Africa and African Descendants Caucus, composed of over 500 continental and diasporan Africans,

— *Ama Mazama*

emerged during the preparatory meetings, with the goal of bringing to the WCAR the matter of repara-FURTHER READING

tions for the descendants of Africans enslaved during the “Trans-Atlantic slave trade.” In so doing, the cau-Asante, Molefi Kete. (1992). *Kemet, Afrocentricity and Knowledge*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press. This book cus, led by Adjoa Artis Aiyetoro, a founding member probes deeply into the issue of the African cultural disloca-of the National Coalition of Blacks for Reparations in tion brought about by Westernization.

America (N’COBRA), and Umberto Brown, sought Huntington, Samuel. (1996). *The Clash of Civilizations*: to raise not only the material aspects of the repara-Remaking of World Order. New York: Simon and Schuster.

tions question but also the issue of spiritual and This book must be read for further understanding of the political restitution. The caucus held daily strategy Western hegemonic project. Huntington is one of those sessions, during one of which Cuban president Fidel who believe that Westernization has been only relatively Castro made a surprise appearance and spoke of the superficial.

Mudimbe, Valentin. (1988). *The Invention of Africa*.

racism directed at his country, which is overwhelm-Bloomington: Indiana University Press. Mudimbe's book ingly populated by the descendants of enslaved remains a classic study of the cultural conversion that Africans.

W-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:03 PM Page 478

478——— *The Wretched of the Earth*

A 50-member contingent representing Black peoples gathered at the WCAR to shine a light on Leadership Forum (BLF)/Africa African American racism and oppression around the world: “We just Renaissance was hailed as the “official” U.S. delega-want the right to be human.”

tion by the South African government. Among their

— *Pamela Yaa Asantewaa Reed*

many preconference activities was a “Climate Justice Summit” that dealt with the question of environmental racism. Two days later, they hosted a town hall **FURTHER READING**

meeting to present the case of American racism within Burkes, Betty. (2001, October). *The World Conference on the international context and to lobby for continued Racism, Without Us*. Retrieved September 1, 2004, from attention to the problems post-WCAR and to call <http://www.afsc.org/pwork/0110/011018.htm> Burkes rep-for concrete action. In attendance, among others, were resented the Women's International League for Peace and Dr. Dorothy Height, National Council on Negro Women; Freedom at the WCAR.

Report of the World Conference against Racism, Racial Elaine Jones, Esq., NAACP Legal Defense Fund; and Discrimination, Xenophobia and Related Intolerance, Jesse Jackson, Rainbow/PUSH. In addition, several *Durban, South Africa, 31 August–8 September 2001*.

members of the Congressional Black Caucus (CBC) Retrieved June 21, 2004, from <http://www.un.org/WCAR/>

participated: CBC Chair Eddie Bernice Johnson coverage.htm. This document is the official report of the (D–TX), John Conyers (D–MI), Cynthia McKinney United Nations.

(D–GA), Shelia Jackson Lee (D–TX), Barbara Lee *Slavery Row Stalls Racism*. (2001, May 22). Retrieved June 21, (D–CA), Diane Watson (D–CA), and Donna 2004, from <http://www.news.bbc.co.uk/1/hi/world/Africa> This is a summary of the difference in the views of African Christian-Christiansen (D–VI).

and European nations over the question of reparations.

Even so, the issue that was most contentious, and that *UN Racism Conference Ends in Compromise*. (2001, certainly garnered the lion’s share of press coverage at September 9). Retrieved June 21, 2004, from [http://www the WCAR](http://www.theWCAR.org), was that of the Israel-Palestinian conflict.

[.abc.net.au/news/2001/09/item20010909100531_1.htm](http://www.abc.net.au/news/2001/09/item20010909100531_1.htm) The matter of the Holocaust of African Enslavement This story on the conference ran on both the *ABC Evening* received scant attention. In the days preceding the *News* and *ABC News Online*.

conference, however, several African nations offered apologies for the enslavement of fellow Africans.

Unconscionably, the overwhelming role of Western Europeans—including their practice of enslaving

THE WRETCHED OF THE EARTH

Africans like chattel in the Americas, not to mention colonialism—was ignored. The text of the final *The Wretched of the Earth* is arguably the most resolution called on those who participated in the famous of the many books written by Frantz Fanon enslavement of Africans to “take appropriate and (1926–1961). It was originally published in Paris in effective measures

to halt and reverse the lasting con-1961 under the title *Les Damnés de la Terre*. In this sequences of those practices.” Any language declaring book, the wretched of the earth are precisely those the so-called slave trade a crime against humanity was who have been unfortunate enough to experience effectively blocked. As a concession of sorts, UN High Western European colonization. At the time of its Commissioner for Human Rights Mary Robinson writing and publication, Africans were still for the announced the formation of an antidiscrimination unit most part under the European colonial yoke, although to address the final WCAR recommendations.

there were clear signs of major changes to come.

Although the WCAR did not quite live up to its Fanon, a psychiatrist born in Martinique, did not live billing, in the estimate of many, it was successful in to witness the total end of European colonial rule in bringing to the fore matters of centuries-old racial Africa; however, in many ways, his book can be read oppression that are far too often swept under the rug.

as both a prophecy and a warning.

For instance, over 200 Dalits, the so-called untouchIn *The Wretched of the Earth*, Fanon is indeed most ables of India, were present to protest the exclusion of concerned about the conditions required for an the oppressive caste system employed in their country authentic decolonization and the true regaining of from the WCAR agenda. A deceptively simple state-agency by African people. Colonization, as Fanon ment by a member of the Dalit delegation aptly sum-sees it, is foremost a violent process of dehumaniza-marizes the overriding message of the thousands of tion and economic exploitation. It is in the *Wretched*

W-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:03 PM Page 479

***The Wretched of the Earth*———479**

of the Earth that Fanon made his most famous, and play in a liberated Africa. Obviously inspired by a often misunderstood, claim about the necessity for Marxist perspective, Fanon denied this class, created the

colonized to engage in violence themselves. This, by the European colonizers, any positive function in a Fanon argued, was psychologically necessary for the new Africa. Much to the contrary, he saw those in the colonized, so that they would be empowered to destroy African middle class as parasites incapable of fulfill-the colonizers physically and, at least as important, ing their class function (i.e., to amass and invest eradicate the image of the colonizers as supermen or wealth in their country) and believed it to be in the demigods.

best interest of Africa to do away with the African Indeed, colonization created discursive categories bourgeoisie.

through which the European colonizers presented Fanon also made a poignant analysis of the cultural themselves as intrinsically superior beings, and colo-alienation experienced by many African intellectuals, nization as a burden, a civilizing mission assigned to due to their prolonged exposure to Western culture white people by God. The internalization of such dis-during the colonial period. Fanon describes their course led many colonized people to believe in their many attempts to revive African traditions that had, own inferiority, thus accepting the legitimacy of the however, been fossilized by colonization. All this, in colonial social order. By dictating the existential con-Fanon's eyes, is in vain and ultimately unnecessary, ditions of the colonized, and thus attempting to con-since it is through struggle that one forges one's fine them to particular roles while denying them culture, and not, as he would put it, through the others and exploiting them, the colonizers imposed singing of old songs.

their own will on the colonized, depriving the latter of

— *Ama Mazama*

their ability to make their own choices and determine their own destiny. This was a most serious crime in **FURTHER READING**

Fanon's eyes. Having been heavily influenced by Sartre's existentialism, Fanon asserts that it is the Fanon, Frantz. (1965). *The Wretched of the Earth, A Dying* human's defining characteristic to be free through

Colonialism. New York: Grove Press. This is the original the making of choices. Therefore, the killing of the

“handbook for the black revolution.”

Fanon, Frantz. (1967). *Black Skin, White Masks*. New York: European colonizers by the African colonized was to Grove Press. This is Fanon’s famous analysis of the psy-serve not only as a necessary therapy but also to chological impact of racism on the colonized and the colo-redeem the Africans’ humanity by giving them the nizers. Fanon argues in particular that blackness and ability to make choices again, that is, to realize their whiteness are colonial categories that must be discarded in own humanity. Fanon’s message did not go unheard, order to bring racism and colonialism to an end.

especially in the United States, where it had a great Fanon, Frantz. (1967). *Toward the African Revolution*.

influence on the black power movement and, more New York: Penguin. In this book, Fanon announces the African revolution and outlines the requirements necessary particularly, on the Black Panthers. Many hailed *The* for its success.

Wretched of the Earth as “the handbook for the black Hansen, William W. (1996). *A Frantz Fanon Study Guide*.

revolution.”

New York: Grove Press. This useful book contains an However, Fanon addressed other important issues, extensive list of the countless books and articles on Fanon’s such as the role that the African bourgeoisie could not philosophy, as well as an insightful overview of his ideas.

Y-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:04 PM Page 481

Y

The Yoruba speak a standard Yoruba language that **YORUBA TRADITION**

is intelligible to all in spite of the dialectal variations noticeable among the subgroups. The historical con-It is interesting that those who claim to be Yoruba sciousness of the Yoruba started at Ile Ife, the cradle of do not, strictly speaking, have a generally accepted the Yoruba race and civilization. The Yoruba claim meaning for the name. The Yoruba country lies descent from Oduduwa, who according to traditions is roughly between latitudes 6o and 9o north and longi-the eponymous father and cultural hero of all Yoruba.

tudes 2o30' and 6o30' east, with a total land area of Two major factors are important in the crystallization about 181,300 square kilometers in what is now of the salient aspects of Yoruba civilization. The first southwestern Nigeria. The Yoruba culture area, is the language, in that virtually all the indigenous however, is not coterminous with this geographical inhabitants of Yorubaland belonged to the same lin-delimitation, as it spreads from the present Edo State guistic stock. It is generally agreed that language is in Nigeria, over the whole of the southwest and the first basic element of Yoruba civilization. The sec-across, to the Republics of Benin and Togo on the ond factor is the environment, which, to a large extent, West African coast.

influenced the historical development of Yoruba civi-Significant aspects of Yoruba culture are also found lization. The geographical features of the Yoruba in such places as Sierra Leone, the Gambia, Brazil, country made it well suited for agriculture, metal tech-Cuba, Trinidad, Puerto Rico, and the United States of nology, industry, and commerce. Each of these factors America. It is precisely this open expression of Yoruba is essential for urbanization and, unsurprisingly, the culture in the Americas that has generated great inter-Yoruba became one of the most urbanized ethnic est in the Yoruba tradition, especially its religious and groups in Africa.

spiritual dimension, among Black Studies scholars.

The emergence of Oduduwa as prime cultural hero Indeed, large segments of the Yoruba religious pan-and the process of state formation in

Yorubaland con-theon have been preserved, with Yoruba deities called stitute the central themes of Yoruba tradition, and two *orishas*—like Shango, Yemoja, Ogun, and others — still major explanations have historically tried to account guiding the lives of many diasporic Africans.

for these traditional themes. The first one speaks of Ile Worldwide, it is estimated that the Yorubas number Ife as the original birthplace of the prehistoric human over 40 million. The major subethnic groups include and the center of all creation. According to this expla-the Oyo, Ibarapa, Ife, Ijesa, Igbomina, Egba, Egbado, nation, Oludamare appeared with the first 16 human Owu, Awori, Egun, Ijebu, Ekiti, Ilaje, Ikale, Owo, elders and their followers. One major conclusion Akoko, Ondo, Yagba, Owe, Bunu, Idaisa, Ajase, Ketu, from this is the claim that Ile Ife was not just the and Sabe. In Brazil and Cuba the major Yoruba sub-source for the Yoruba people but also the cradle of all groups are known as Nago and Lucumi, respectively.

humankind through the process of creation. Indeed, in 481

Y-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:04 PM Page 482

482——**Yoruba Tradition**

a common fashion, the Yoruba people believe that kingship eventually became the most significant they were the first human beings created on earth.

attribute of Yoruba monarchy. Oduduwa was assisted According to the second explanation, following in state administration by a council of elders called the a political crisis, Oduduwa led the Yoruba in their *Iwarefa*, who constituted the cabinet. The dispersal migration to Yorubaland from somewhere in the Nile from Ile Ife into the Yoruba forest took place in Valley, presumably from the area that came to be three major waves, as indicated in the conferences of known as Arabia. It is said that Oduduwa was the son Ijero, Ijamo, and Marun. The founders of Oyo, Owu, of Lamurudu, a king in Mecca, and was forced to leave Igbomina (Ila), Sabe, Popo, Benin, and Ketu all his homeland because of his idolatrous practices. He belonged to the same and possibly the first wave.

eventually came to Yorubaland, where the original The beaded crown with fringes became the symbol inhabitants accepted him as the purveyor of a new and of divine kingship as instituted by Oduduwa at Ile Ife.

better culture. Recent studies have exposed the many It is the crowning of an Oba that transforms him, weakness in this explanation. First, there is not a shred giving him the status of an orisha and giving ritual val-of evidence in the history of the Nile Valley that idation to his authority. When and where the Oba puts supports these wild claims. Second, linguistic studies on the crown, he incarnates divine power. The endur-have not discovered any link between the Yoruba lan-ing legacy or success of the Oduduwa experiment is guage and any language in the Nile Valley. If there was best illustrated by the fact that the chieftaincy institu-any relationship between the peoples as recent as after tion based on divine kingship, in spite of debilitating the rise of Islam, such a link would not be obscure. The external influences, is the most characteristic and proponents of this explanation probably relied on dubi-most developed feature of Yoruba civilization.

ous historical evidence, derived from sources outside

— *Akin Alao*

Yorubaland, with the intent of providing what was perceived by some as a prestigious ancestry for the Yoruba.

The emergence of Ile Ife as a focus of power and **FURTHER READING**

civic authority could, perhaps, be regarded as the most Akinjogbin, I. A. (Ed.). (1992). *The Cradle of a Race: Ile-Ife* notable event in pre-1500 Yorubaland. Recent studies *From the Beginning to 1980*. Port Harcourt: Sunray. This propose that a trenchant reconstruction of what is book examines the place of Ile Ife in the crystallization of known suggests a new direction in the search for an Yoruba civilization from divergent viewpoints.

Ayandele, E. A., and Akinjogbin, I. A. (1980). Yorubaland up explanation of the major themes of Yoruba tradition.

to 1800. In O. Ikime (Ed.), *Groundwork of Nigerian* Oduduwa probably migrated to Ile Ife as the leader of a *History*. London: Heinemann. This essay presents a powerful group that subdued the aboriginal inhabi-detailed description of Yorubaland up to the 19th century.

tants of this fertile lowland. The preexisting semiau-Johnson, Samuel. (1921). *History of the Yorubas*. London: tonomous settlements of Omoloogun, Parakin, Iwinrin, Routledge and Kegan Paul. Johnson's book is the most Oke-Awo, Ijugbe, Iraye, Imojubi, Oke-oja, Odin, Ideta, authoritative anthology of Yoruba traditions and thus pro-Oloromu, Ido, and Iloran submitted to the exclusive and vides a reference point of agreement or disagreement for contemporary writings on the Yoruba past.

widespread political leadership of the Oduduwa group.

Ogunremi, Deji, and Adediran, Biodun. (1998). *Culture and* The process of state formation has also been recon-Society in Yorubaland. Ibadan, Oyo State, Nigeria: Rex structured recently. It is said that Oduduwa was the Charles Publications in association with Connel Publications.

architect of a representative system of government The authors examine the various aspects of Yoruba culture that emphasized the primacy of the monarch. Divine from a critical and multidisciplinary perspective.

Appendix-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:05 PM Page 483

Appendix I

Chronology of the Most Notable

Books, Scholars, and Events in Black Studies 1967

1970

Students at San Francisco State demand Black John Jackson's *Introduction to African Civilization* Studies

is published

Nathan Hare organizes the first Black Studies Toni Morrison's *The Bluest Eye* is published department at San Francisco State University Maya Angelou's *I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings* is published

1968

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA), 1971

creates the Institutes for American Cultures, which Shirley Graham Du Bois publishes a memoir of includes the Center for Afro American Studies W.E.B. Du Bois, *His Day is Marching On* Frantz Fanon's *The Wretched of the Earth* is Addison Gayle, Jr.'s *The Black Aesthetic* is published in the United States

published

Eldridge Cleaver's *Soul on Ice* is published Two young men are killed in the struggle for Black Studies at UCLA

1972

The Black Scholar is started by Robert Chrisman and Nathan Hare

Yusef Ben-Jochannon's *Black Man of the Nile* is Martin Luther King is slain

published

Shirley Chisholm is elected to the House of Richard Barksdale and Kenneth Kinnamon's *Black Representatives*

Writers of America is published Gil Scott-Heron records "The Revolution Will Not Be Televised"

1969

Paul Carter Harrison's *The Drama of Nommo* is *The Journal of Black Studies* is founded by Robert published

Singleton and Molefi Kete Asante

The National Black Political Convention takes Clarence Majors edits the *New Black Poetry* place in Gary, Indiana

Molefi Kete Asante's *The Rhetoric of Black Revolution* is published

1973

Amy Jacques Garvey's *Philosophy and Opinions of Marcus Garvey* is reissued Stephen Henderson's *Understanding the New* Molefi Kete Asante heads UCLA Center for Afro *Black Poetry* is published

American Studies and publishes his essay "The Black Nathan Huggins's *Harlem Renaissance* is Perspective"

published

483

Appendix-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:05 PM Page 484

484———**Encyclopedia of Black Studies 1974**

1981

Chancellor Williams's *The Destruction of Black* Vincent Harding's *There is a River* is published *Civilization* is published

Death of Larry Neal, a major black arts movement Cheikh Anta Diop's *The African Origin of figure*

Civilization is published in English **1982**

1975

Charles Fuller receives the Pulitzer Prize for *A* Quincy Troupe's *Giant Talk: An Anthology of Third Soldier's Play*

World Writing is published

The National Council of Black Studies is founded **1983**

1976

John Henrik Clarke gives a major speech at City Asa Hilliard gets George James's *Stolen Legacy* College, "The Black Man's History in a White Man's" republished

World"

Callaloo magazine is founded in Baton Rouge, Alice Walker wins the Pulitzer Prize for *The Color Purple*

Louisiana

Alex Haley receives the Pulitzer Prize for *Roots* President Ronald Reagan signs the Martin Luther King Jr. Day bill, making King's birthday a federal holiday published

to be celebrated on the third Monday of each January **1977**

1984

Geneva Smitherman's *Talkin' and Testifyin': The Maulana Karenga's Selections from the Husia: Language of Black America* is published *Sacred Wisdom of Ancient Egypt* is published Wallace Terry's *Blood* is published

1978

Mari Evans's edited volume *Black Women Writers 1950-1980: A Critical Evaluation* is published Cheikh Anta Diop's *Cultural Unity of Black Africa* is published

Abdias do Nascimento's *Mixture or Massacre: The* **1986**

Genocide of a People is published Wole Soyinka wins the Nobel Prize for literature James Alan McPherson receives the Pulitzer Prize Molefi Kete Asante begins the campaign to create for *Elbow Room*

the first Ph.D. program in African American Studies at Maulana Karenga's *Essays in Struggle* is published Temple University

Haki Madhubuti's *Enemies: The Clash of Races* is published

1987

Kariamuwelsh's *Textured Women, Beetle Sticks, Cow Bells, and Cowrie Shells* is published August Wilson wins the Pulitzer Prize for *Fences* Rita Dove receives the Pulitzer Prize for *Thomas* **1979**

and Beulah

Winston van Horne of the University of Wisconsin-The African American Studies program becomes a Milwaukee proposes the term *Africology* department at the State University of New York at The University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee African Buffalo

American Studies department changes its name to Department of Africology

1980

Molefi Kete Asante's *The Afrocentric Idea* is Molefi Kete Asante's *Afrocentricity* is published published

Theophile Obenga's *Pour une Nouvelle Histoire* is Horace Campbell's *Rasta and Resistance* is published

published

Appendix-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:05 PM Page 485

Appendix I——485

1988

Cornel West's *Race Matters* is published John Gwaltney's *Drylongso* is published Toni Morrison receives the Pulitzer Prize for *Beloved*

Temple University accepts the first class of **1994**

doctoral students in African American Studies Marimba Ani's major analysis of European thought Wade Nobles's *African and African American* and behavior, *Yurugu*, is published *Cultural Blueprint/Framework for Black Family Pilot* Tricia Rose's *Black Noise* is published is published

Linda James Myers's *Understanding the* **1995**

Afrocentric Worldview is published The Cheikh Anta Diop International Conference is Theophile Obenga's *A Lost Tradition: African* founded in Philadelphia

Philosophy in World History is published Herb Boyd and Robert Allen's edited volume **1989**

Brotherman is published

More than a million black men march on C. Tsehloane Keto's *The Africa Centered* Washington, D.C., to raise awareness about the plight *Perspective of History* is published of black men and foster black men's consciousness of Darlene Clark Hine's *Black Women in White:* and commitment to self

Racial Conflict and Cooperation in the Nursing Na'im Akbar's *Natural Psychology and Human Profession 1890–1950* is published *Transformation* is published Henry Louis Gates's *Colored People* is published **1990**

Clenora Hudson-Weems's *Africana Womanism:* Maulana Karenga's *Introduction to Black Studies Reclaiming Ourselves* is published is published

Adeniyi Coker, a Nigerian student at Temple **1996**

University, becomes the first person to receive a Ph.D.

Molefi Kete Asante and Abu Abarry's edited from an African American Studies department volume *The African Intellectual Heritage* is published Mark Hyman is the first African American gradu-Theophile Obenga's *Icons of Maat* is published ate with a Ph.D. in African American Studies The

University of Massachusetts at Amherst cre-Molefi Kete Asante's *Kemet, Afrocentricity and* ates the second U.S. Ph.D. program in African *Knowledge* is published as a signature for the first American Studies

Ph.D. program in African American Studies **1997**

1991

Phile Chionesu organizes a million black women on Clarence Thomas is confirmed for the Supreme the Benjamin Franklin Mall in Philadelphia to bring Court in the closest vote in the Court's history and about changes in the life conditions of black women despite the objections of many African American Henry Louis Gates's edited volume *The Norton* scholars

Anthology of African American Literature is published Henry Louis Gates begins to assemble the "Dream The University of California, Berkeley announces Team" of scholars at Harvard University plans for a Ph.D. program in African American Studies J. E. Holloway's *Africanisms in American Culture* Kariamu Welsh Asante's *African Dance* is published is published

1998

1993

Tennessee State University becomes the first Toni Morrison wins the Nobel Prize for literature predominantly black institution in more than 25 years Yusef Komunyakaa wins the Pulitzer Prize for poetry to develop a program in African American Studies Maya Angelou reads poetry at Bill Clinton's presi-Manning Marable and Leith Mullings's edited dential inauguration

volume *Let Nobody Turn Us Around* is published

Appendix-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:05 PM Page 486

486———**Encyclopedia of Black Studies** Manning Marable's *Black Leadership* is published **2003**

Katherine Bankole's *Slavery and Medicine: Ama Mazama's The Afrocentric Paradigm is Enslavement and Medical Practices in Antebellum* published

Louisiana is published

Molefi Kete Asante's *Erasing Racism: The Survival of the American Nation* is published **1999**

Ray Winbush's edited volume *Should America The Cheikh Anta Diop Conference becomes an Pay?* is published

international event, with attendees and participants Maulana Karenga's *Maat: The Moral Ideal in* from four continents

Ancient Egypt is published

Zizwe Poe's *Kwame Nkrumah's Contribution to* **2000**

Pan Africanism is published Jawara Giddings's *Contemporary Afrocentric* Randall Robinson publishes *The Debt: What Scholarship* is published

America Owes to Blacks

James L. Conyers's *Afrocentricity and the Academy* is published

2002

Molefi Kete Asante publishes *The Egyptian* **2004**

Philosophers

Michigan State University announces a Ph.D.

Publication of the comprehensive *Encyclopedia* program in African American Studies

of Black Studies, the first such encyclopedia in the Mark Christian's *Black Identity in the 20th Century* field's history, edited by Molefi Kete Asante and Ama is published

Mazama

Appendix-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:05 PM Page 487

Appendix II

Advanced Degree–Granting Programs **DOCTORAL-GRANTING**

Michigan State University

PROGRAMS IN BLACK STUDIES

African American Studies

Morrill Hall, Room 1

Departmental or Disciplinary Degrees East Lansing, MI 48824

Temple University

Yale University

College of Liberal Arts

Graduate School of Arts and Sciences African American Studies

African American Studies

8th floor, Gladfelter Hall

Box 208323

1115 W. Berks

New Haven, CT 06520-8323

Philadelphia, PA 19122

University of California, Berkeley

Ethnic Studies

M.A.-GRANTING DEPARTMENTS

Afro American Studies

506 Barrows Hall #2570

Boston University

Berkeley, CA 94720

African American Studies

705 Commonwealth Avenue

University of Massachusetts Amherst

Boston, MA 02215

W.E.B. Du Bois Department of Afro-American Studies

Clark Atlanta University

Afro-American Studies

School of Arts and Sciences

323 New Africa House

African and African American Studies Amherst, MA 01003-6210

Office of Admissions

J. P. Brawley Drive at Fair Street SW

Atlanta, GA 30314-4385

Interdepartmental or

Interdisciplinary Degrees

Columbia University

Graduate School of Arts and Sciences Emory University

Institute for Research in African-American Graduate Institute of the Liberal Arts Studies

American and African-American Studies African American Studies

S415 Callaway Building

Columbia University-IRAAS

Atlanta, GA 30322

1200 Amsterdam Avenue, Mailcode #5512

Harvard University

New York, NY 10027

Department of Afro-American Studies

Cornell University

Barker Center

Africana Studies and Research Center 12 Quincy Street

310 Triphammer Road

Cambridge, MA 02138

Ithaca, NY 14850

487

488———**Encyclopedia of Black Studies** Florida International University

University of California, Berkeley

College of Arts and Sciences

Ethnic Studies

African-New World Studies Certificate Program Afro American Studies

PC 236 University Park Campus

506 Barrows Hall #2570

Miami, FL 33199

Berkeley, CA 94720

Morgan State University

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) School of Graduate Studies

Department of African American Studies African American Studies

Afro-American Studies

1700 East Cold Spring Lane

Center for African American Studies

Baltimore, MD 21251

160 Haines Hall, Box 951545

Los Angeles, CA 90095-1545

The Ohio State University

Department of Black Studies

University of Iowa

African-American and African Studies African-American World Studies

486 University Hall

303 English-Philosophy Building

230 N. Oval Mall

Iowa City, IA 52242-1408

Columbus, OH 43210-1319

University of Massachusetts Amherst

State University of New York at Albany W.E.B. Du Bois Department of
Afro-American Africana Studies

Studies

Office of Graduate Admissions

Afro-American Studies

1400 Washington Avenue

323 New Africa House

Albany, NY 12222

Amherst, MA 01003-6210

Temple University

College of Liberal Arts

University of Wisconsin - Madison

African American Studies

Afro-American Studies

8th floor, Gladfelter Hall

4141 Helen C. White Hall

1115 W. Berks

600 North Park Street

Philadelphia, PA 19122

Madison, WI 53706

Appendix-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 1:05 PM Page 489

Appendix III

Major Journals in Black Studies

African American Review

Western Journal of Black Studies Saint Louis University

70 C Cleveland Hall

Shannon Hall 119

Pullman, WA 99164

220 N. Grand Boulevard

Publisher: Board of Regents, Washington State St. Louis, MO 63103

University Press

Publisher: St. Louis University

Journal of Black Psychology

The Black Scholar

Department of Psychology

P.O. Box 22869

Mail Location #376

Oakland, CA 94618

University of Cincinnati

Publisher: University of Nebraska Press Cincinnati, OH 45221

Publisher: Association of Black Psychologists *Journal of Black Studies*

Department of African American Studies *Research in African Literatures*

Temple University

601 N. Morton Street

1115 W. Berks

Bloomington, IN 47404

Philadelphia, PA 19122

Publisher: Indiana University Press

Publisher: Sage Publications

International Journal of Africana Studies Center for Interdisciplinary
Studies 124 Lane Hall

Virginia Tech University

Blacksburg, VA 24061-0227

Publisher: National Council for Black Studies 489

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Resources-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:04 PM Page 506

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Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 507

Index

Ababa, Addis, 419

African Americans, 8-14

Abernathy, Ralph David, 308, 404, 438

benevolent and malevolent negroes, 221

Abimbola, Wande, 388

Black Anglo-Saxons, 113-114

Abolition movement, 232

cultural and linguistic orientation, 9-10

American Anti-Slavery Society (AASS), 79-80

cultural patterns and customs, 11-12

American Colonization Society and, 84

economic situation, 11

American Missionary Association and, 85-86

political participation, 13

black women and, 80

population, 9

Caribbean and, 180

socialization, 12

David Walker's Appeal, 88-89, 131, 232, 352

religious practice, 13

John Brown, 81

African Blood Brotherhood (ABB), 14-15, 132, 308

narratives of the enslaved and, 349-350

African bourgeoisie, 479

Negro convention movement, 371-372

African Burial Ground Project, 33

North Star and, 381-382

African-centered psychology, 103

Underground Railroad, 454-456

African Communities League, 109

Abraham, Willie, xxvii

African Community Theatre (ACT), 158

Abu-Jamal, Mumia, 135

African cosmology, 33-35

Abubakari, Dara, 419

African dance, 36-37

Accommodationism, 1-3

African demographics, 37-39

black nationalism and, 131, 133

African diaspora, xxvi, 216-218

Achebe, Chinua, 48

Black Atlantic, 116-117

Adams, Carolyn, 21

black power movement and, 146

Adams, Henry, 237

Caribbean, 178-182

Adderley, Julian “Cannonball,” 85

Indian Dalits and, 216

Adegbalola, Alajo, 418

population estimate, 217

Afer, Amo Guinea, 47, 49

resistance to imperialism, 271

Affirmative action, 3-5

African epistemology, 39-44

Afoh, Kwame, 419

divination, 41-42

Africa, human origins in, 37

main characteristics of, 42-44

Africa and African Descendants Caucus, 477

rationality, 40, 41-42

Africa World Press, 5

African ethnic groups, 9, 44

African aesthetic, 6-8, See also Arts African Heritage Studies Association (AHSA), xxvii, African agency, 473

55, 150, 163

African American journalists, as

African history

“Black Anglo-Saxons,” 114

ancient Egyptian studies movement, 93-97

African American oratory, 19-20

Axum, 106-108

African American soldiers, 82, 194

cavalry state, 393-394

desegregation, 367

The Destruction of Black Civilization, 214-215, 226

African American Studies

Diopian historiography, 219-220

Indian perspectives, 31-32

Egyptian/Kemetic influence on Greek philosophy, 440

Temple Circle, 445-446

Elder Scholars and, 226-229

Temple University, 20-24

Ghana, 256-257

Temple University, postgraduate

Journal of African Civilizations, 286

programs, xx, 24-28

Kawaida philosophy and, 292

See also Black studies

Kush, 301-303

507

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 508

508——***Encyclopedia of Black Studies Mali Empire, 318-319***

Africological enterprise, 58-59

Nubia, 382-385

opposition and critique, 59, 61

Oyo Empire, 393-394

“Afro-American,” 30, 371

pre-Columbian Africans and America, 448

Afro-Asian Institute, 24

prehistoric art, 6

Afro-Asiatic language classification, 327

Songhay Empire, 435-436

Afrocentric Creed, 62

African history, Eurocentric versus Afrocentric Afrocentric criticism, 62-63

perspectives, xxx, See also African philosophy; Afrocentric education, 63-65

Afrocentricity; Diop, Cheikh Anta; Egypt, ancient Afrocentric schools, 65, 69-70

(Kemet); Yoruba

See also African American Studies; Education African Liberation Day, 45

The Afrocentric Idea (Asante), 65-67, 68, 74, 360

African Methodist Episcopal (AME) Church, 119

The Afrocentric Paradigm (Mazama), 5, 67-68, 446

African National Congress (ANC), 458

The Afrocentric Scholar, 69

African Nationalist Pioneer Movement, 459

Afrocentric social work, 71-72

African personality, 196

Afrocentricity, xxvii, 28-29, 52, 65

African philosophy, 45-52

African Renaissance and, 53

American context, 52

Africana womanism, 57-58

Asante's Afrocentricity and, 52

Africological paradigm, 58-61

discourse, 47-48

Afrology, 64

epistemology, 39-44

agency and liberation theory, 67

Ethiopian tradition, 49

ancient Egyptian studies movement, 94

existentialism, 123-126

antecedents, 67

feminism and, 51

*Asante's **Kemet, Afrocentricity and***

Greek philosophy and, xxx, 47, 115-116, 138, 440

Knowledge, 295-297

Kemetetic tradition, 47, 48

Asante's paradigm, 20-25, 28-31, 150-151, 296

metaphysics, 50-51

categorization of social practice, 445-446

politics, 51

centering and location theory, 66-67

postcolonial era, 50

critique of Eurocentrism, 73

science and, 51

cultural wars and, xxix-xxx

slavery and, 48, 49

developments in Black Studies, 150-151

Western philosophy and, 47

dislocation, 220-221

worldview theory, 56-57

epistemology, 40

See also Afrocentricity; Black philosophy; Maat; fight for, 23-24

Négritude; Religion and spirituality gender issues, xxxi

African Psychology Institute, 103

holistic curriculum development model, 361-362

African rationality, 41-42

Négritude and, 67

African Renaissance, 53

struggle for, 29

African retentions view of family, 242

Temple Circle, 445-446

African socialism, 293, 369

***Temple University African American Studies African Studies Association
Convention (Montreal, 1969), programs, xx, 20-28***

African Studies Association (ASA), 54-56

See also Africology; Asante, Molefi Kete; Black African Union, 45

*Studies; Kawaïda; Kwanzaa; Mazama, Ama; African worldview theory,
56-57*

Us organization

Africana, collections and libraries

***Afrocentricity: The Theory of Social Change (Asante), Blockson
collection, 182-183***

xxvii, 5, 72-74, 360

education and, 64

*Afrocentrism, African history and, See African history Martin Luther King
Library*

Afrocentrists, 446

Documentation Project, 274

Afro-cultural theory, 74-75

Schomburg collection, 366, 429-431

Afrology, 58, 64

Africana Studies, 159

Afronography, 75-77

Africana womanism, xxxi, 57-58, 127

Agency, in Afrocentric theory, 67

Africanisms, 224

Ahmad, A. Muhammad, 419-420

Africanity, 74

Ailey, Alvin, 36

Africology, 29, 59-61, 150, 296

Aiyetoro, Adjoa Artis, 477

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 509

Index———509

Akan, 44, 91

Animism, 196

cosmology, 34, 35

ANKH, 53

metaphysics, 197

ANKH (Association for Kemetic Nubian Heritage), 184

Ofamfa-Matemasie epistemology, 49

Antef inscription, 42

Al-Amin, Jamil Abdullah, See Brown, H. Rap Anti-Semitism, alleged at Wellesley College, 163-165

Al-Omari, 448

Antigua-Barbuda, 180

Aldridge, Delores P., 360

Antilles, 178

Alexander, 215

Antilynching campaign, 97-98

Alfonja, Alafin, 393

Antiracist philosophy, 98-100

Ali, Noble Drew, 341-342, 354

Apollo Theatre, 101, 320

Alianza Federal de Pueblos Libres, 460

Appiah, Kwame Anthony, 30, 61, 138, 221, 222

Alkalimat, Abdul, xxix, 188, 360

Arab slave trade, 236

All African Peoples Conference, 373

Arawaks, 178

All-African People's Revolutionary Party Aristotle, 138, 440

(A-APRP), 77-79

Ark of the Covenant, 106, 107

Allen, Richard, 119, 417

Armah, Ayi Kwei, 298

Allen, Robert, 146

Armstrong, Samuel Chapman, 2

Alston, Dana, 359

Arts

Amanirenas, 385

African aesthetic, 6-8

Amanishakheto, 302

Amistad Research Center, 86

Amanitere, 302

Apollo Theatre, 100-101

Ambedkar, Bhim Rhao, 32

black arts movement, 114-115

Amen I, Ra Un Nefer, 104-105

commemorative functions, 7

American and Foreign Anti-Slavery Society, 80

The Crisis and, 207

American Anti-Slavery Society (AASS), 79-80, 372

hip-hop graffiti and fashion, 266-267

American Civil War, 81-83

Karamu House, 289

African American soldiers, 82, 194

Kawaida philosophy and, 293-294

Emancipation Proclamation, 229

Opportunity: A Journal of Negro Life, 390-391

Freedman's Bureau, 172-173, 249-250

Schomburg collection, 430-431

See also Reconstruction

type motifs, 7-8

American Colonization Society (ACS), 79, 83-84

Watts Prophets, 473-474

American Committee on Africa, 86

See also Dance; Film; Literature; Music American Federation of Labor (AFL), 366

Asante, Kariamu Welsh, 453

American Indian Movement (AIM), 136

Asante, Molefi Kete, xxiii, 137, 287

American Missionary Association (AMA), 85-86, Afrocentric Creed of, 62

173, 247, 248

***The Afrocentric Idea*, 65-67, 74, 360**

American Moral Reform Society, 372

Afrocentric paradigm and African American Studies ***American Negro Academy (ANA)*, 84-85**

programs, xxviii, 20-25, 28-31, 150-151

American Negro Labor Congress (ANLC), 15, 16

Afrocentricity, xxvii, 5, 72-74

Amini, Johari, 448

Afro-cultural theory, 74

***Amistad Research Center*, 85-87**

Afrology and, 58, 64

Amo, Anthony William, 49

Amistad Research Center, 86

Amos n'Andy, 399

ancient Egyptian studies movement and, 94

***Amsterdam News*, 87-88**

Cheikh Anta Diop International Conference and, 183

***An Appeal to the Colored Citizens of the World*, 88-89**, contribution to
Azama's The Afrocentric Paradigm, 67

131, 232, 352

“Curse of the Door of No Return,” 211

Ana, Hekima, 419

dislocation theory, 220-221

Ancestors, 34, 89-93, 428

James’ Stolen Legacy and, 440

Ancient Egyptian Studies Conference, 295

Journal of Black Studies, 287

Ancient Egyptian studies movement, 93-97,

Kemet, Afrocentricity and Knowledge, 295-297

See also Egypt, ancient

Temple Circle, 445-446

Anderson, James H., 87

See also Afrocentricity; Kawaida; Kwanzaa Andrews, Marcellus, 164

Asante people, 92

Ani, Marimba, xxvii, 328

Ashanti, 241

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 510

510——Encyclopedia of Black Studies Askia Muhammad, 435-436

Ber, Sunni Ali, 435-436

Assimilation

Bernal, Martin, 48, 115-116, 440

cultural genocide, 210

Bernasconi, Robert, 48

Négritude and resistance to French policy, 368-369

Bethune, Mary McLeod, 290

See also Accommodation

Betty Shabazz International Charter School, 272-273

Associated Publishers, 102

Big bands, 282

Association for Kemetic Nubian Heritage (ANKH), 184

Biko, Stephen, 121-123, 142

Association for the Study of Classical African

The Birth of A Nation, 111-113, 299, 411, 412

Civilizations (ASCAC), 96, 295, 461

Birth rate, 37, 38

*Association for the Study of Negro Life and History Black Academy of Arts
and Letters (BAAL), 85*

(ASNLH), 287-288

Black aesthetics, 293

Association of Black Psychologists, 103-104

Black Anglo-Saxons, 113-114

Atlanta Compromise address, 1

Black arts movement, 114-115

Ausar Auset Society, 13, 104-105, 326

Black Athena, xxx, 115-116

The Autobiography of Malcolm X, 105-106

Black Atlantic, 116-117

Axum empire, 106-108

Black Britannia, 227

Ayaga, Odeyo, 24-25, 26

Black Caucus, 54

Azibo, Daudi, 64

Black Church, 118-119

Azikiwe, Nnamdi, 458, 459

Black Code (Code Noir), 188-190, 260

Black Codes, 120-121, 335, 372, 399, 463

Baba, Ahmad, xxvi, 48

Black Commentator, 207

Baby talk theory, 203, 204

Black consciousness movement, 121-123, 142

Back-to-Africa movement, 83-84, 109-110, 417

Afro-cultural theory and, 74

black nationalism and, 131

soul, 436

diaspora and, 216

See also Black power movement Garvey and, 409

Black Cross Nurses, 457

opposition to, 372

Black elected officials, 139, 140, 194, 334-335, 411

Rastafarianism and, 409, 410

Black English, 223, 224

Bahai, 278

Black existentialism, 123-126

Bahamas, 180

Black Expo, 404

Bailey, Ronald, xxix

Black Feminist Thought (Collins), 126-127

Baldwin, James, 85, 124

Black Government Conference, 417-418

Baldwin, Ruth Standish, 365

Black History Month, 102

Baluba, 41, 47, 49

Black Indians, 246

Bambaataa, Afrika, 263

The Black Jacobins (James), 127-128

Bambara, 35

Black Leadership Forum (BLF), 478

Bandung model, 460

Black Leadership Information Exchange (BLIE), 286

Bankole, Katherine, xxx

Black Leadership Retreat, 461

Banks, Samuel, 102

The Black Manifesto, 128-130

Bantu-Congo philosophy of consciousness, 197-198

Black National Pledge, 272-273

Bantu Philosophy, 47

Black nationalism, 130-134

Banyaca, Thomas, 460

currents in Black Studies, 159

Baraka, Amiri, 142-143, 164-165

Du Bois and, 132

Congress of African Peoples, 191

incoherence and fragmentation, 133-134

1972 National Black Political Convention, 357-358

political parties, 134

Barbados, 180

Revolutionary Action Movement, 419-420

Bates, Ruby, 431, 433

See also Black power movement; Pan-African Bedward, Alexander, 408

nationalism

Before the Mayflower (Bennett), 110-111

Black Panther Party, 135-137, 144

Belafonte, Harry, 85

Black Manifesto and, 129

Ben-Jochannan, Yosef, 24, 151, 228-229

black power movement and, 144-145

Benevolent negroes, 221

Black Studies and, 161

Benin, 91

community service programs, 135-136

Bennett, Lerone, 85, 110-111, 168

FBI counterintelligence and, 136-137, 144, 418

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 511

***Index*——511**

legacy of, 137

Dalit perspectives, 31-32

peace treaty, 460

dimensions in, xix-xx

police harassment, 136

disciplinary field, xxvii-xxviii, 30-31

political philosophy, 136, 145

doctoral program, xx

Revolutionary Action Movement and, 420

education and, 225-226

Us and, 461

established departments, xix-xx

Black philosophy, 137-139

Eurocentric and anti-Afrocentric academics, 22, 29-30

case against, 138

Kent State University, 153-158

epistemology, 39-44

gender and, xxxi

existentialism, 123-126

graduate studies, 28-31

great thinkers in, 138

graduate studies, Temple University, 24-28

See also African philosophy; Afrocentricity; Kawaiida Hall model, 361

Black politics, 139-141

holistic Afrocentric model, 361-362

African philosophy and, 51

initial development, 148

black opponents and, 141

intellectual advances, 150-151

Booker Washington's accommodationism, 1-2

internal developmental dynamics, 150

campaign messages, 141

Introduction to Black Studies (Karenga), ideology and public policy, 140-141

276-277, 294, 360

Nyerere's Ujamaa, 51

Journal of Black Studies, 287

See also Civil rights movement; specific Marxism and, xxix, 59

movements, organizations, persons mission-oriented discipline, 149-150

Black Power Conference of Newark, multicultural education and, 346

New Jersey, 142-143

names controversy, 158-160

Black Power Manifesto, 143

National Council for Black Studies, 359-363

Black power movement, 144-146

nationalist currents, 159

black consciousness movement and, 121

origins of, xxv

Black Studies and, 149, 161

political aspects, xxvi

black theology and, 166

professional development, 361

Conference movement, 460

social responsibility, 150

Congress of African Peoples, 191, 201

surveys of, 361-362

independent black schools and, 200

theoretical evolution and development of, xxviii legacy of, 146

Temple University, 20-24

political cleavages, 145-146

Temple University, postgraduate and first doctoral Third World Press and, 449

programs, 24-28, 29

The Black Scholar, xx, 146-147, 461

Us and, 460

Black skin, children of the sun and, 215

Wellesley College, 160-165

Black Skin, White Masks (Fanon), 125, 147-148

Black studies, Asante's Afrocentricity paradigm, Black Star Line, 109, 457, 458

20-25, 28-31, 150-151, See also Afrocentricity; Black Star Publications, 130

Asante, Molefi Kete

Black Student Union movement, 294

Black studies, research centers, xx

Black Studies, xxi, 148-151

Amistad Research Center, 85-87

activist tradition, 148-149

Institute of the Black World, 274-276

African Studies and, xxviii-xxvix

Joint Center for Political and Economic Africological enterprise, 58-59

Studies, 284-286

Africology, 29, 160

Black Studies Core Curriculum, 361

aims of the Encyclopedia of Black Studies, xxv-xxvii ***Black theology, 165-166***

alleged anti-Semitism, 163-164

Black United Students (BUS), 153, 156

Black Panthers and, 161

Black World, 284

black power movement and, 149, 161

Blackshire-Belay, Aisha, 445

City College of New York, 151-152

Blakey, Michael, 33

civil rights movement and, 149

Blaut, J. M., xxx

Congress of African Peoples program, 191

Blaxploitation films, 166-169

The Crisis and, 207

Blockson, Charles L., 182

cultural wars and, xxix-xxxi

Blues, 124, 169-170

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 512

512——***Encyclopedia of Black Studies*** Blyden, Edward Wilmot, 19, 49, 84, 131, 219

Capitulationists, 445

Boni, Tanella, 51

Capoeira, 175-178

Booker, Cory, 207

Caribbean, 178-182

Bop, 282

arrival of Europeans, 178-179

Boucaux, Jean, 189

carnival in, 245-246

Boycott, Montgomery bus, 338-341

economy, 181-182

Brazil

enslavement, 179

Capoeira, 175-178

independence and nationhood, 180-181

Carnival, 247

indigenous people, 178

diaspora studies, 218

Obeah, 387

Break dancing, 264, 265

resistance to slavery, 179-180

Bremond, Walter, 358

Caribbean Basin Initiative (CBI), 182

Briggs, Cyril V., 14-16, 132

Caribbean Community and Common Market British East India Company, 269

(CARICOM), 181

Broadside Press, 170-171, 449

Caribbean Free Trade Association (CARIFTA), 181

Brooklyn Labor Day Carnival, 246

Carmichael, Stokely, See Ture, Kwame Brooks, Gwendolyn, 449

Carnival, 244-247

Brotherhood Crusade, 358

Carruthers, Jacob, 95

Brotherhood of Sleeping Car Porters, 398, 402, 415

Caste, Dalits (“untouchables”) and, 31-32, 478

Brouard, Carl, 271

Caste and class analysis, 185-187

Browder, Earl, 17

Castro, Fidel, 477

Brown, Elaine, 135

Catholic Church

*Brown, H. Rap (Jamil Abdullah Al-Amin), African colonization and, 185
144, 135, 418*

Santería and, 427

Brown, Jim, 167

Vodu and, 466

Brown, John, 81

Centeredness, 66, 296

Brown, Umberto, 477

Césaire, Aimé, 50, 51, 67, 368, 369

Brown, William Wells, 349

Chaney, James, 253, 300

Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka,

Charles L. Blockson Afro-American 171-172, 200, 213, 283, 339

Collection, 182-183

Brownies Book, 207

Chavez, Cesar, 136

Bruce, Blanche K., 335, 411

Checole, Kassahun, 5

Bureau of Refugees, Freedmen, and Cheikh Anta Diop International

Abandoned Lands (Freedmen's Bureau), Conference, 22, 183-184

172-173, 249-250, 334, 411

Children, socialization of, 12

Burial Ground Project, 33

Children's Theatre, 289

Burleigh, H. T., 439

Chisholm, Shirley, 194, 459

Bus boycott, 18, 338-341, 437-438

Chokwe, 44

Bush, G. H. W., 141

Christianity, 13, 184-185

Bush, G. W., 5, 140

Africanization of, 50

Bwino epistemology, 40, 41-42, 49

Axum, 106

Byrd, James, 300

Black Church, 118-119

black theology, 165-166

Cabral, Amilcar, 290, 291

civil rights movement and, 119

Calendar, 13

cultural genocide, 210

Calhoun, John, 190

education of African children, 225

Call-and-response, 281, 421, 439, 473

Ethiopian Orthodox Church, 107-108, 410

Campbell, Leslie (Jitu Weusi), 200

Ethiopianism, 233-234

Campbell, Tunis, 417

Jamaican revivalism, 408

Canaanite Temple, 341

missionaries and Kiswahili, 297-298

Canboulay, 245

Nation of Islam and, 354

Candaces, Queens of Nubia, 215, 302, 385

Nubia and, 385

Candomblé, 312, 388

slave trade and, 185

Capitein, Jacobus, 49

slavery and racism, 118-119

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 513

***Index*——513**

Chrisman, Robert, 146-147

Classical African studies, 151, 295, See African history; Christophe, Henri, 127

Egypt, ancient; Nubia

Chui, Mwesi, 418

Classical Egyptian, 327

Ciboneys, 178

Clay, Bill, 194

Cineas, J. B., 271

Clay, Henry, 190

Cinque, 85

Cleaver, Eldridge, 135, 136, 137

City College of New York, 151-152

Cleaver, Kathleen, 135

City University of New York (CUNY), 152

Clinton, Bill, affirmative action and, 4

Civil disobedience, 192

Clothing styles, hip-hop influences, 266-267

Civil Rights Act of 1875, 282, 283

Coates, Paul, 449

Civil Rights Act of 1964, 153, 172, 343

Code Noir, 188-190

Civil Rights Congress (CRC), 17, 364

Coffin, Levi, 455

Civil rights movement, 10-11

COINTELPRO, 136-137, 144, 418, 420, 461

antilynching campaign, 97-98

Coker, Adeniyi, xx

Black Church and, 119

Coker, Daniel, 233

Black Power Conference of Newark, Cold War, 18

New Jersey, 142-143

Collectivism, 197

Black Studies and, 149

Collins, George, 194

Communist Party and, 18

Collins, Patricia Hill, 126-127

Congress of Racial Equality, 192-193

Colonialism, 270

Congressional Black Caucus and, 194

neocolonialism, 243-244, 270, 372-374

Freedom Rides, 335

See also Imperialism

freedom songs, 250-252

Color confrontation theory, 328-329

Freedom Summer, 193, 252-253, 335, 336

“Colored,” 371

Highlander Folk School, 262-263

Colored Methodist Episcopal (CME) Church, 119

Jackson’s Operation: PUSH, 403-405

Columbus, Christopher, 178, 259

King’s “Letter from the Birmingham Jail,” 308-309

Colvin, Claudette, 339

Ku Klux Klan and, 299-300

Communism, 14-19

martyrs, 253, 300

Cruse's critique of, 208

March on Washington, 193, 319-321

Jim Crow and, 17

Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party, 254, 333-338

Langston Hughes and, 16

Montgomery bus boycott, 18, 338-341, 437-438

racism and, 16

multicultural education and, 345

repression of, 18

National Urban League and, 366-367

Universal Negro Improvement Association ***Revolutionary Action Movement (RAM), 419-420***

and, 458

sit-ins against segregation, 193

See also Marxism and Marxism-Leninism victims of white reactionary violence, 253

Communist Party (CP), 14

Wellesley college and, 161

civil rights movement and, 18

See also Southern Christian Leadership Conference racism within, 16

Civil War, See American Civil War Scottsboro case and, 432

Clark, Kenneth Bancroft, 213

Communist Political Association, 17

Clark, Mark, 136

Community Alert Patrol, 460

Clarke, John Henrik, xxvii, 55, 151, 227-228

Community committees of elders, 12

Class, xxix, 185-187

Community control schools movement, 200

carnival and, 245

Community Education Program, 25

caste and racialized social stratification, 185-187

Community service programs, Black Panther Du Bois on, 397

Party, 135-136

economic analysis of racist exploitation, 186

Compromise of 1850, 190-191

Haitian revolution and, 128

Cone, James, 165-166

racism of white working class, 122

Conflict resolution, 13

white workers, 188

Congo people, 44

*See also Marxism and Marxism-Leninism Congress, African American members, 139, 194, **Class struggle, 186, 187-188***

334-335, 411

Classic blues, 170

Congress of African Peoples, 191-192

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 514

*514——**Encyclopedia of Black Studies Congress of Racial Equality (CORE), 192-193***

Cultural nationalism, 133, 145, 291

CORE Singers, 251

Cultural relativity, 242

Freedom Rides, 335

Cultural revolution, 291

Freedom Summer, 252

Cultural wars, xxix-xxxi

March on Washington, 320

Curry, George E., 114

Congressional Black Caucus, 192, 193-195

“Curse of the Door of No Return,” 211

Congressional Black Caucus Foundation, Inc. (CBCF), 195

Dalits, 31-32, 216, 478

Congressional districts, 139

Dance, 35-37

Conjuring, 422

hip-hop, 265-266

Consciencism, xxvii, 195-197

ring shout, 420-421, 439

Consciousness, 197-200, See also Black consciousness Umfundalai, 453

black consciousness movement, 121-123, 142

Dark Ghetto (Clark) , 213

Contemporary jazz, 282

Davidson, Basil, 48

Conyers, James L., Jr., 86

Davis, Angela, 18, 20, 135

Conyers, John, Jr., 194, 415

Davis, Arthur, 141

Cook, Carlos, 132-133, 459

Davis, Jefferson, 82, 194

Cool jazz, 282

Davis, Ossie, 85

“Coon” stereotypes, 235

Dawson, William, 194

Cooper, Anna Julia, 290, 293

Deacons for Defense and Justice, 153

Coptic Church, 326

Death rates, 38

Coptic language, 327

Death traditions, 13, 91, 92

Cornell University, 30

December 12th movement, 415

Corporate responsibility, 404

Declaration of Human Rights, 260

Cosmology, 33-35

Declaration of Rights of the Negro Peoples of the Cosmotheandricity, 50-51

World, 457

Council of Federated Organizations (COFO), 335

Dedeaux, Richard, 473-474

Council of Independent Black Institutions Dees, Morris, 300

(CIBI), 200-202

Delany, Martin R., 19, 84, 131-132, 142, 381

Country blues, 170

Democracy, cultural, 345

Cox, Oliver Cromwell, 186

Democratic National Convention of 1964, 337

Creole, 147, 202-204

Democratic National Convention of 1968, 136, 338

Indigeniste movement, 271-272

Democratic Party, 13, 140

Creolization, 204-205

Loyal Democrats of Mississippi, 337-338

Cress Welsing, Frances, 328-329

Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party, 333-338

The Crisis, 205-208

Mississippi racism, 253, 333-336

The Crisis of the Negro Intellectual (Cruse), 208-209

Democratic Select Committee, 194

Criticism, Afrocentric, 62-63

Demographics, African, 37-39

Crockett, George, 418

Demotic, 327

Crosby, Edward W., 153-154

Deposition of liberation, 189-190

Crummell, Alexander, 19, 84-85, 131

Desegregation

Crusade for Justice, 460

armed forces, 367

The Crusader, 14

Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka, 171-172, Cruse, Harold, 145, 208-209

200, 213, 283, 339

Cuba

See also Civil rights movement abolition of slavery, 180

Dessalines, Jean-Jacque, 127-128, 261-262

Lucumi tradition, 312

The Destruction of Black Civilization (Williams), Santería, 426-429

214-215, 226

Cudjoe, Selwyn, 164

Diaspora, 216-218, See also African diaspora Cuffee, Paul, 84, 417, 131

Diggs, Charles, 194, 459

Cultural community, Kawaiida philosophy, 290-295, Dignity, Maat tradition and, 316

See also Kawaiida

Dill, Augustus, 205

Cultural democracy, 345

Dinh, Tran Van, 25, 26

Cultural genocide, 209-210

Diop, Birago, 50

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 515

***Index*——515**

Diop, Cheikh Anta, 219

Encyclopedia Africana project, 54

African Renaissance and, 53

Ethiopian renaissance theme, 233

Afrocentricity antecedents, 67

existentialism, 125

ancient Egyptian studies and, 94-95

Karenga's Kawaiida philosophy and, 290

Garvey and, 219

The New Negro and, 377

Nubia studies, 383

on education, 444

on ancient Egypt as black civilization, xxx oratory, 19

on matriarchy and patriarchy, 395-396, 450

The Philadelphia Negro, 396-398

overthrow of Eurocentric philosophic The Pittsburgh Courier and, 399

paradigm, 47

repression by U.S. government, 18

Two Cradle Theory, 450-451

The Souls of Black Folk, 437

Diop, Cheikh M'Backe, 53

“talented tenth” theory, 1, 443-445

Diopian historiography, 219-220

Wellesley college and, 160

Discrimination, in clubs and organizations, 12

Dukakis, Michael, 141

Dislocation, 220-221, 297

Duke, David, 300

Divination, 41

Dutch imperialism, 179, 269-270

Dixon, Patricia, xxxi, 360

Duvalier, François, 271

Djehuti, 197

Dyaesthesia Aethiops, 324

Djelis, 169

Djenne, 435

Eboh, Marie Pauline, 51

Dobson, Tamara, 168

Ebonics, 9-10, 223-224

Dodd, Coksone, 413

Ebony, 284

Dogon, 35, 197, 379

Economic nationalism, 133

Doll tests, 213

Economics

Dominica, 180

analysis of racist exploitation, 186

Donald, Michael, 300

Asante's critique, 297

Dorsey, Francis, xxvii

Booker Washington's theory, 2

Double consciousness, 443

Caribbean economy, 181

Douglass, Frederick, 80, 232, 349

colonialism, 270

American Colonization Society and, 84

contemporary African Americans' status, 11

black nationalism and, 131, 132

globalization, 270

Civil War and, 82

imperialism, 269

existentialism, 124

Kawaida philosophy and, 293

lynching and, 313

neocolonialism, 372-374

Narrative of the Life of, 350

slave trade, 331

Negro convention movement and, 372

Education

North Star and, 381-382

African worldview and, 64

oratory tradition, 20

Afrocentric, 63-65, 69-70

southern black migrations and, 238

American Negro Academy (ANA), 84-85

Dove, Nah, 68, 445, 451

antiracist philosophy, 99-100

Drake, St. Clair, 234

Black Studies and, 225-226

Drapetomania, 324

Booker Washington's philosophy, 2-3, 44

Dream Team, 30, 221-222

Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka, 171-172, Dredd Scott case, 81, 400

200, 213, 283, 339

Drumming

Christian missionaries and, 225

carnival music, 244-245

Council of Independent Black Institutions Last Poets, 307

(CIBI), 200-202

Vodu ceremonies, 470

The Crisis and, 207

Du Bois, W. E. B., 402

defining African-centered education, 202

American Negro Academy and, 85

Du Bois on, 444

Black Church and, 119

Freedom schools, 253, 335, 337

black nationalism and, 131, 132

Institute of Positive Education, 272-274

The Crisis, 205-207

miseducation, 297, 333

critique of Booker Washington, 1

multicultural education, 345-347

Index-Asante.qxd 11/3/2004 3:25 PM Page 516

516——Encyclopedia of Black Studies Push for Excellence, 404

Ethiopia

rites-of-passage initiations, 225

African diaspora and, 216

tenets of the centered school, 69

African Zion, 233

Us and, 461

Axum empire, 106-108

See also Black Studies; Independent schools; Italian aggression, 233, 234, 408, 409

School desegregation

philosophical tradition, 49

Egalitarianism, 197

Rastafarianism and, 408, 409-410

Egypt, ancient (Kemet), 93-97, 296

Ethiopian Baptist Church, 408

A.F.K. calendar, 13

Ethiopian Church movement, 408

African epistemology, 39-40

Ethiopian Orthodox Church, 107-108, 410

African philosophical tradition, 47, 48

Ethiopianism, 233-234, 408

African Renaissance and, 53

Ethnic groups, African, 44

alternative (non-Eurocentric) chronology, 296

Ethnic Notions, 234-235

ancient Egyptian studies movement, 93-97

Ethnocentrism, European, See Eurocentrism arks, 107

Ethnography, Afronography and, 75

Asante and Afrocentric initiative, 94

Eurocentrism, 235-236

Asante's Kemet, Afrocentricity and

Asante's Afrocentric critique, 66, 73, 296

Knowledge, 295-297

conceptual incarceration, 66

ben-Jochannan's work, 229

cultural genocide, 209-210

black and Afro-Asian people, 214-215

cultural wars and, xxix-xxx

commemorative sculpture, 7

feminism and, 57-58

consciousness philosophy, 198, 199

ideological function of, 64

Diopian historiography, xxx, 94-95, 220

in Black Studies programs, 22, 29-30

epistemology, 41-42

Négritude and, 369

Greek and Western philosophy and, xxx, 47, Westernization, 476-477

115-116, 138, 440

Woodson's *Mis-Education of the Negro*, 333

Husia, 96, 290, 293, 294, 315, 316

European slave trade, 236-237, See *Slave trade intellectual initiatives*, 95

Evers, Medgar W., 300

Kushite Rejuvenation Dynasty, 301-302

Existentialism, black, 123-126

language and script, *Mdw Ntr*, 29, 326-327

Exodusters, 237-239

Nubia's influence, 382, 383-384

Ezaldeen, Muhammad, 278

spiritual and ethical tradition (*Maat*), 96, 315-317, 379-380

Fabian, Johannes, 48

Victory Stele, 301, 384

Family, 241-242

Vulture Glyph, 115-116

Afrocentric education and, 63

See also *Maat*

cultural relativity, 242

El Hadi, Suliaman, 307

enslavement and diaspora and, 241-242

Elbert, Ella Smith, 160

matriarchal structure controversy, 343-344

Elder Scholars, 226-229

Moynihan Report, 343-344

Elders, community committees of, 12

pathological deficit view, 242

Electric jazz, 282

Fanon, Frantz, xxvii, 50, 125, 290

Ellison, Ralph, 124, 277-278, 297

Afrocentricity antecedents, 67

Emancipation Proclamation, 82, 229, 463

Black Skin, White Masks, 147-148

Encarta Africana, 222

Karenga's Kawaiida philosophy and, 290, 291

Encyclopedia Africana, 54

Négritude and, 147

Engels, F., 187

on violence, 243-244

Enslavement abolition movement, See Abolition

The Wretched of the Earth, 243-244, movement

478-479

Enslavement of Africans, See *Slave trade*; *Slavery Fard*, W. D., 354

***Enslavement resistance*, 230-232**, See also *Farmer, James*, 193, 320

Resistance and revolution

Farrakhan, Louis, 20, 355

***Epistemology, African*, 39-44**

Fascism, communists versus, 17

Equiano, Olaudah, 49

Fauset, Jessie Redmon, 207

Espiritismo, 427

Fautroy, Walter E., 194

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 517

***Index*——517**

Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) Freedom Summer, 193, 252-253, 335, 336

counterintelligence program (COINTELPRO), *Freedom's Journal*, 232

136-137, 144, 418, 420, 461

Freyre, Gilberto, 177

March on Washington and, 320

Fugitive slave laws, 80, 372, 454-455

Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC), 375

Fuller, Charles, 445

Federal Securities Act, 375

Funerals, 13

Feminism

African philosophy and, 51

Ga, 90

Africana womanism, xxxi, 57-58

Gangs, 12

Black Feminist Thought, 126-127

Ganja, 407

Eurocentrism and racism of, 57-58

Gao, 319, 435

Fertility rate, 37

Garnet, Henry Highland, 20, 131, 133, 372

Festivals and celebrations, 12, 13, 244-247

Garrison, William Lloyd

African Liberation Day, 44-45

American Anti-Slavery Society and, 79-80

Santería tradition, 428

American Colonization Society and, 84

See also Kwanzaa

David Walker's Appeal and, 89

Fetish, 401

Douglass's narrative and, 350

Fifteenth Amendment, 194, 299, 334, 465

Nat Turner's rebellion and, 353

Film

Negro convention movement and, 372

The Birth of A Nation, 111-113, 299, 411, 412

Underground Railroad and, 455

black female stars, 168

Garvey, Marcus, 142

blaxploitation films, 166-169

Afrocentricity antecedents, 67

Ethnic Notions, 234-235

Back-to-Africa movement, 109, 409

NAACP and, 167

black nationalism and, 131

new black directors, 167-168

Booker Washington and, 132, 456

Sankofa, 425-426

Charles Johnson and, 390

Finley, Robert, 83

communism and, 15

First Cleveland Movement, 278

Cruse's critique of, 208

Fisk Jubilee Singers, 247-249, 439

Diop and, 219

Flasch, Kurt, 51

Ethiopian millennialism and, 234

Fon, 91

government persecution of, 458

Ford, Gerald, 404

Karenga's Kawaida philosophy and, 290, 293

Ford Foundation, 21, 361, 362

oratory, 19

Forman, James, 128-129, 415

The Pittsburgh Courier and, 399

Forrest, Nathan B., 282, 299

posthumous Garveyite movement, 459

“Forty Acres and A Mule,” 249-250

reparations movement and, 415

Fourteenth Amendment, 194, 299, 334, 464

social workers and, 71

France

Universal Negro Improvement Association, assimilationist policy, 368-369

15, 456-459

Code Noir, 188-190, 260

Garvey, Marcus, Jr., 459

French Revolution, 260

Gates, Henry Louis, Jr., 30, 221-222

Haitian Revolution and, 259-262

Gender issues

Franklin, John Hope, 85, 102, 418

Black Studies and, xxxi

Frazier, E. Franklin, 242, 343

Diop’s Two Cradle Theory, 450-451

Frederick Douglass’ Paper, 382

Kawaida philosophy and, 293

Free jazz, 282

matriarchy, 343-344, 395-396, 450

Free speech movement, 149

See also Women's issues

*Freedmen's Bureau (**Bureau of Refugees, Geneonymy, 90***

Freedmen, and Abandoned Lands),

Genocide, Caribbean indigenous peoples, 178

172-173, 249-250, 334, 411

Genocide, cultural, 209-210

Freedom clinics, 253

Gerrymandering, 338

Freedom Rides, 193, 335

Ghana Empire, 256-257, 318

Freedom schools, 253, 335, 337

NCBS conferences, 362

Freedom songs, 250-252

Ghetto, 213

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 518

*518——**Encyclopedia of Black Studies** Gibbon, Benjamin, 459*

Hamito-Semitic language classification, 327

Gillespie, Dizzy, 278

Hammon, Jupiter, 233

Gilpin, Charles, 289

Hampton, Fred, 136

Gilroy, Paul, 117

Handy, W. C., 169

Globalization, 270

Harambee House, 162

creolization, 205

Harding, Vincent, 274

Godboldt, Catherine, xxvi

Hare, Julia, 113

Goldwater, Barry, 336

Hare, Nathan, xxv, 113, 143, 149, 225

Gone With the Wind, 17

Harkhuf, 382-383

Gonzales, Rudolfo Corky, 460

Harlan, John, 400

Goodman, Andrew, 253, 300

Harlem

Gordon, Lewis, 125, 137

Amsterdam News, 87-88

Gospel jazz, 282

Apollo Theatre, 100-101, 320

Gracia Real de Santa Theresa de Mose, 416

The New Negro and, 377

Graduate programs, 24-31

Harlem Renaissance, 132, 144, 390, 391

Grafitti, 266

Universal Negro Improvement Association and, 457

Granger, Lester, 366-367

Harper, Frances Ellen Watkins, 80

Gray, Cecil, xxviii

Harrison, Hubert, 132

Gray, Thomas R., 353

Harvard University, Black Studies program, 30

Great Depression, New Deal and, 375-376

Dream Team, 221-222

Greek language, African influences on, 115-116

Hassan, Umar Bin, 307

*Greek philosophy, African influences on, xxx, Hatata (Yacob), 40, 41, 49
47, 115-116, 138, 440*

Hausa, 41, 44

Greenberg, Joseph, 327

Hawkins, Augustus, 194

Grenada, 180

Hayes, George Edmund, 365

Grice, Hezekiah, 371

Hayes, Rutherford B., 299, 335

Grier, Pam, 168

Hayford, J. E. Casely, 234

Griffith, D. W., 111, 299

Haymes, Stephen, 126

Grimke, Francis J., 85

Hayward, Henry, 191

Griot, 271, 307, 318, 391

Haywood, Harry, 15

Guadeloupe, 180

Headley, Clevis, 126

Guyana, 180

Healers

Guzman, Diego de, 325

African epistemology and, 43

Gyekye, Kwame, 47, 137, 138

root doctor, 422

Health, African birth and death rates and, 38

Haile Selassie, 234, 407, 409-410

Health care, Freedom clinics, 253

Haiti, 128

Hegel, G. W. F., 47

Carnival in, 246

Henry, Milton, 417

diaspora studies, 218

Henry, Paget, 125, 137

emigration to U.S., 132

Herndon, Angelo, 16

enslavement and social hierarchy, 260

Herskovits, Melville, 54, 377

French Code Noir, 189

Heywat, Walda, 43

Indigeniste movement, 271-272

Hieroglyphic, 326-327

*L'Ouverture and **Revolution**, 127-128, Higginbotham, Evelyn, 221, 222*

*180, **259-262**, 417*

Higgins, Chester, 198

U.S. occupation, 271

Highlander Folk School, 262-263

Vodu, 210, 466, 470-471

Hilliard, Asa, 68, 440

Haley, Alex, 105

Hilliard, David, 135

Hall, Gus, 18

Hilliard, Earl, 141

Hall, Perry, xxix, 361

Hip-hop and rap, 263-267

Hamer, Fannie Lou, 20, 337

art and fashion, 266

Hamid, Yusef Muzaffarudin, 278

commercialization, 264

Hamilton, Anthony "Amde," 473-474

dancing, 265-266

Hamilton, Charles V., 144

DJs and MCs, 264, 265

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 519

***Index*————519**

Historically black colleges, miseducation Independent black communities, maroon, critique, 297

See Maroon communities

Historiography, Diopian, 219-220

Independent black communities, Republic of History of Africa, See African history New Afrika (RNA), 416-419

HIV/AIDS pandemic, 38-39

Independent Black Institutions (IBI), Holidays, See Festivals and celebrations See Independent schools

Holistic Afrocentric Curriculum Development Model, Independent schools, 12, 65, 461

361-362

Council of Independent Black Institutions Holocaust of African Enslavement (HAE), 269, 477, (CIBI), 200-202

See also Slavery

Institute of Positive Education, 272-274

Holy Piby, 409

India, caste system, 186

Homestead Act, 238

*India, **Dalits**, 31-32, 216, 478*

Homosexuality, melanin theory, 328-329

Indigeniste movement, 271-272

Hoodoo, 422

Ingram, Rosa Lee, 17

Hoover, J. Edgar, 144, 320, 458

Institute for African American Affairs (IAAA), 153

Hopi Nation, 460

Institute of Positive Education, 272-274

Hornsby, Alton, Jr., 288

Institute of the Black World, 274-276

Horses, 393-394

Integrationists, 446

Horton, Myles, 262-263

black nationalism versus, 131

Horton, Willie, 141

International Black Coalition for Peace and Houngans, 469

Justice (IBCPJ), 462

Hountondji, Paul, 50, 138

International Cheikh Anta Diop Conference, 96, 150

House, Callie, 414

International Festival of Pan-African Arts, 462

House Un-American Activities Committee International Journal of Africana Studies, 69

(HUAC), 18, 364

International Labor Defense (ILD), 16, 432

Housing issues, 367

International Monetary Fund (IMF), 374

Houston, Charles, 356, 415

Introduction to Black Studies (Karenga), Howard University, 160

276-277, 294, 360

Howe, Stephen, 61

Invisibility, 124

Hudson, Herman, 360

Invisible Man (Ellison), 277-278, 297

Hudson-Weems, Clenora, xxxi, 57-58, 68

Islam, 13, 278-279

Huggins, Nathan, 361

Axum, 106

Hughes, Langston, 16, 289

Moorish Science Temple, 341-342, 354

Human origins, 37

Nubia and, 385

Humanism, 138

polygamy, 11

consciencism, 197

Songhay, 435-436

Humphrey, Hubert H., 337, 415

See also Nation of Islam

Hurston, Zora Neale, 399, 446-447

Islamic Party, 278

Husia, 96, 290, 293, 294, 315, 316

Israel, September 11 attacks and, 165

Hutton, Bobby, 136

Israel-Palestinian conflict, 478

Hutu, 44

Italy, aggression against Ethiopia, 233, Hyman, Mark, xx

2324, 408, 409

Ivy, James W., 208

Ibo, 44, 90, 241

Ifa, 43, 148, 388-390, See also Odu Ifa Jabul Arabiyya, 278

Ijaw, 44

Jackson, Jesse, 20, 119, 371

Ile Ife, 481, 482

National Rainbow Coalition, 405

Imani, 303, 378, 379, 462

PUSH, 403-405

Imhotep, 384

Jacobs, Harriet Ann, 349

Imperialism, 269-270

Jacobs, John E., 367-368

neocolonialism and globalization, 243-244, Jamaica, 408-409

270, 372-374

Haile Selassie's visit, 409

phases of, 269-270

independence, 180

resistance to, 271

Obeah, 387

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 520

520———*Encyclopedia of Black Studies* Rastafarianism, 234, 407, 408-409

Kagame, Alexis, 50

reggae and, 413

Kain, Gylan, 307

Universal Negro Improvement Association, Kansas City jazz, 282

456, 458

Kansas Fever Exodus, 237-239

James, Cyril Lionel Robert, 127

Kansas-Nebraska Act, 81, 191

James, George Granville Monah, xxx, 440

Kant, I., 47

***Jazz*, 281-282**

Kaoze, Stefano, 50

Jazz funk, 282

***Karamu House*, 289**

Jeffries, Leonard, 151, 152

Kardecan spiritism, 427

Jet, 284

Karenga, Maulana

Jewish-African American relations, 11

Afrocentricity discourse, 67, 68

Wellesley College and, 163-165

black power movement and, 145

Ji, Yuan, xx

*Black Studies discipline and, xxviii **Jim Crow, 282-283***

Introduction to Black Studies, 276-277, 294, 360

Black Codes, 120-121, 335, 372, 399, 463

Kawaida and, 290, 295, 459-460

Christianity and, 119

Kawaida Institute of Pan-African Studies, 95-96

communism versus, 17

Kwanzaa and, 13, 146, 298, 304, 378, 462

effect on family relations, 241

Million Man March and, 294

Journey of Reconciliation and, 193

Nguzo Saba and, 201, 298, 378

Mississippi society, 335

on Maat, 316

See also Civil rights movement on racism and class struggle, 186

Johnson, Andrew, 120, 282, 411, 463

oratory, 20

Johnson, Charles S., 390-391, 415

race and class analysis, 188

Johnson, Clifton H., 86

Republic of New Afrika and, 418

Johnson, J. Rosamond, 310-311

Us and, 459

Johnson, James Weldon, 310-311, 377, 399

See also Kawaida; Kwanzaa; Nguzo Saba; Johnson, John Harold, 284

Us organization

Johnson, Lyndon B., 253, 337, 343, 476

Karenga, Tiamoyo, 293

affirmative action and, 3

Karibs, 178

Johnson Publishing Company, 284

Karnak, 384

Joint Center for Political and Economic Kawaida, 290-295, 459-460

Studies, 284-286

black arts movement, 293-294

Jones, Audrea, 135

Black Studies and, 294

Jones, Charles, 360

influence of, 294

Jones, Eugene Kinckle, 366

Nguzo Saba, 378

Jones, Leroy, See Baraka, Amiri pan-African tradition, 293

Jones, William R., 125, 137

See also Karenga, Maulana; Kwanzaa; Nguzo Saba; Jordan, Vernon, 367

Odu Ifa

Journal of African Civilizations, 286

Kawaida Groundwork Committee, 461

Journal of Black Studies, xx, 184, 287

Kawaida Institute of Pan-African Studies (KIPAS),

Journal of Negro History, 102, 287-288

95-96, 462

Journals and magazines

Kawaida School of African American Culture, 461

The Afrocentric Scholar, 69

Kawaida womanism, 293

Amsterdam News, 87-88

Kebra Nagast, 107

The Crisis, 205-208

Kelley, Abby, 80

Johnson Publishing Company publications, 284

Kemet, See Egypt, ancient (Kemet) The Negro World, 109

Kemet, Afrocentricity and Knowledge (Asante), 295-297

North Star, 381-382

Kemetic-centered spiritual group, Ausar Auset Society,

Opportunity: A Journal of Negro Life, 390-391

13, 104-105, 326

The Pittsburgh Courier, 398-399

Kemetic Institute, 95

See also specific publications

Kennedy, John F., 3, 321

Journey of Reconciliation, 192-193

Kent State University, 153-158

Joyce, Joyce, 21-24, 29

Kenyatta, Jomo, 458, 459

Juries, African Americans in, 433

Kershaw, Terry, xxix

***Index*————521**

Keto, C. T., 445

Language and linguistics

Kikuyu, 44

African influences on Greek, 115-116

King, Coretta Scott, 341

African rationality and, 41

King, Martin Luther, Jr., 10, 119

Africanisms, 224

assassination and its consequences, xxv, Africanization, 324

153, 161, 300, 404

Afro-Asiatic and Hamito-Semitic classifications, 327

birthday, 13

Afrocentric location theory, 66

black nationalism and, 131

ancient Egyptian, Mdw Ntr, 29, 326-327, 383

“Letter from the Birmingham Jail,” 308-309

baby talk theory, 203, 204

March on Washington, 320, 321

Creole, 147, 202-204

Montgomery bus boycott and, 18, 339-341

creolization, 204-205

Newark 1967 rebellion and, 142

cultural genocide, 210

oratory, 20

Ebonics, 9-10, 223-224

*Southern Christian Leadership Conference **Kiswahili movement, 297-298***

and, 438

Kushite script, 303

King, Richard, 328

Maat, 297

Kiswahili movement, 297-298

substratist approach, 204

Knowledge

Yoruba, 481

African epistemology, 39-44

Lapzansky, Emma, 26

Afronography, 76-77

Last Poets, 307-308

Odu Ifa, 389

Late Egyptian, 327

Koran, 342

Latin jazz, 282

*Ku Klux Klan, 120, 171, 207, 282, **298-300, Laveau, Marie, 321-322***

334, 402, 412

League of Revolutionary Black Workers, 129

The Birth of A Nation and, 112

League of Struggle for Negro Rights (LSNR), 16

Kujichagulia, 292, 303, 378, 379, 462

Leclerc, Charles, 261

Kumbi Saleh, 256

Lee, Carol, 272

Kunjufu, Jawanza, 102

Lee, Jonathan Scott, 138

Kush, 301-303, 384

Lefkowitz, Mary, xxx, 61, 163-164, 440

Candaces, Queens of Nubia, 215, 302, 385

Lehman, Cynthia, xx

Meroe, 301-303, 384

Lekumí (or Lucumi), 312, 388, 429

See also Nubia

Lenin, V. I., 15

Kuumba, 293, 303, 378, 379, 462

Leopold of Belgium, 270

*Kwanzaa, 13, 146, 298, **303-305**, 378, 462, Les Ballet Africains, 36*

See also Kawaida

Les Noires, 260

Temple University Department of African American

“Letter from the Birmingham Jail,” 308-309

Studies and, 21

Lewis, Ira, 399

Lewis, John, 320, 321

L’Ouverture, Toussaint, 127-128, 260-261, 325, 470

Liberator, 455

La Amistad, 85

Liberia, 83-84, 109, 458

La Revue Indigène, 271

Liele, George, 408

Labor movement

Life-cycle development programs, 72

black alliance, 16

“Lift Every Voice and Sing,” 309-311

black alliance, Black Panthers, 136

Lincoln, Abraham, 81-82, 229, 463

communists and, 15, 16

racism of, 194

Highlander Folk School, 262-263

Literature

National Urban League and, 366

Afrocentric criticism, 62-63

protest songs, 251

black existentialism, 124-125

racist tendencies, 188

Broadside Press and, 170-171

strikes, 15

Haitian Indigeniste movement, 271-272

See also Unions

Last Poets, 307-308

LaFollette, Robert, 207

narratives of the enslaved, 349-350

Lamming, George, 124

See also Publishers

Langston, John Mercer, 85

Little, William, 362

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 522

522——***Encyclopedia of Black Studies*** Loangos, 325

Marxism and Marxism-Leninism, 14, 15

Loas, 468-469

analysis of Haitian revolution, 127

Location theory, 66-67, 295-296

Asante's critique of, 297

Locke, Alain, 85, 370, 376

Black Studies and, xxix, 59

Long, Charles, 165

class and caste analysis, 185-187

Long, Huey, 206

class struggle, 187-188

Louis XIV, 188, 260

Congress of African Peoples and, 191

Louisiana Purchase, 261

Revolutionary Action Movement, 419-420

Love, Monifa, 124

See also Communism

Lovedu, 92

Masking, 244

Loyal Democrats of Mississippi, 337-338

Matriarchy, 343-344, 395-396, 450

Luciano, Felipe, 307

Matrilineal system, 89-90, 301

Lucumi tradition, 312, 388, 429

Maxwell, Bertha, 359

Lumumba, Chokwe, 418

Mayfield, Earl, 299

Lumumba, Patrice, 51

Mazama, Ama, xxiii

Lundy, Benjamin, 89

The Afrocentric Paradigm, 5, 67-68, 446

Lynch, John R., 335

Black Studies disciplinary perspective, xxviii ***Lynching, 299, 312-313***

malevolent/benevolent negroes theory, 221

antilynching campaign, 97-98

Temple Circle, 445-446

The Birth of a Nation and, 412

*Temple University African American Studies National Urban League
proposed*

programs and, 21, 23-24

legislation, 366

Mbiti, John, 50, 137

Scottsboro case and, 433

McCone, John, 476

McGee, Willie, 17

Maat, 96, 297, 315-317

McKay, Claude, 412

judgment, 317

McKissick, Floyd, 193

revived tradition, 315-316

Mdw Ntr, 29, 326-327, 383

sedjemic personality, 317

Melanin theory, 61, 328-329

Machado, Manoel dos Reis (Mestre Bimbo), 177

Mentacide, 402-403

Madhubuti, Haki, 102, 272-273, 448-449

Mental health services, Association of Black Madhubuti, Safisha, 272-274

Psychologists, 102-104

Magazines, See Journals and magazines Meroe, 301-303, 384

Majority-minority districts, 139

Merritt, William T., 359

Makeda, Queen of Sheba, 106, 107

Merritt College, 161

Malcolm X Society, 417

Messianism, 329-330

Malevolent negroes, 221

Mestico, 177

Mali Empire, 318-319, 448

Metaphysics, See Religion and spirituality Mambos Assongwe, 469

Mezepo, Salomon, 53

Mande, 318

Middle Egyptian language, 327

Mandinka, 44

Middle Passage, 330-332

Mansa Musa, 318, 435

Migration patterns, 37

Marable, Manning, xxix, 187

Military desegregation, 367

March on Washington, 193, 319-321

Miller, Sara, 287

Mardi Gras, 246

Miller, William, 418

Marijuana, 407

Million Man March and, 294, 462

Marley, Bob, 407

Minority Business Roundtable, 285

Maroon communities, 180, 232, 323-326

Mis-Education of the Negro (Woodson), xix , 333

Marriage and kinship patterns, 11

Mississippi

Marshall, Demetri, 419

antebellum, free blacks in, 334

Marshall, Thurgood, 5, 12, 356, 415

civil rights movement in, 335

Martin, Tony, 164, 440

Democratic Party racism, 253, 333-337

Martin Luther King Jr. Memorial Center, 274, 275

Freedom Summer, 252-253

Martinique, 147-148, 180

Republic of New Afrika headquarters, 418

Marx, Karl, 187

Mississippi Council of Federated Organizations, 252

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 523

Index———523

Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party National Association for the Advancement of Colored (MFDP), 253, 333-338

People (NAACP), 12, 356-357

Missouri Compromise, 81

The Birth of A Nation and, 111-112

Mitchell, Parren, 194

Brown v. Board of Education and, 171-172, 213

Modupe, Danjuma Sinue, 68

Congress of African Peoples, 191

Moleah, Alfred, 25, 26

Congress of Racial Equality and, 192-193

Monges, Miriam, xxx

consciousness, 199

Montgomery, Olen, 431, 433

The Crisis, 205-208

Montgomery bus boycott, 18, 338-341, 437-438

film industry and, 167

Moore, Queen Mother Audley, 418, 420

freedom songs, 251

Moore, Richard B., 132, 371

Freedom Summer campaign, 193, 252

Moorish Science Temple of America, 341-342, 354

“Lift Every Voice and Sing,” 310

Morial, Marc, 368

March on Washington and, 320

Morikawa, Suzuko, xx

Montgomery bus boycott, 339

Morrison, Toni, 124

origins, 356

Moynihan, Daniel P., 242, 343

political pressure against racism, 402

Moynihan Report, 343-344

Robert Williams and, 417

Mudimbe, V. Y., 48, 50

Scottsboro case and, 16, 432, 433

Muhammad, Akbar, 278

Universal Negro Improvement Association and, 458

Muhammad, Elijah, 106, 142, 279, 354, Youth Councils, 335

355, 399, 458

National Association of Kawaida Organizations Muhammad, John, 355

(NAKO), 462

Muhammad, Wallace D., 355

National Ballet of Senegal, 36

Muhammad, Warith Deen, 278-279

National Black Economic Development Conference Mulago, Vincent, 50

(NBEDC), 129

Multicultural education, 345-347

National Black Political Convention, Gary, Indiana, Multicultural studies, 151

192, 357-358

Music

National Black Power Conferences, 460

African aesthetic in, 8

National Black United Fund (NBUF), African dance and, 36

358-359, 362, 461

blues, 124, 169-170, 281

National Coalition of Blacks for Reparations carnival, 244-245

in America (N'COBRA), 462, 477

existentialism, 124

National Council for Black Studies (NCBS), 69, 150, freedom songs, 250-252

163, 359-363

hip-hop and rap, 263-267

National Council of Churches (NCC), 129

Last Poets, 307-308

The National Dance Ensemble of Ghana, 36

reggae, 407, 412-414

National League for the Protection of spirituals, 13, 438-439

Colored Women, 365

spirituals, Fisk Jubilee Singers, 247-249

National Movement for the Establishment Mwendo, Ukali, 419

of a 49th State, 459

Myal, 13

National Negro Congress (NNC), 16-17, 363-365

Myers, Linda James, xxvii

National Rainbow Coalition, 405

Myrdal, Gunnar, 186

National Urban League (NUL), 12, 365-368, 390

Nationalism, 130-134, See also Black nationalism; Names and naming, 12, 30

Pan-African nationalism

Christianity and, 210

Nationhood, 457

controversies in Black Studies, 158-160

Nawidemak, 302

Nommo and, 380

Négritude, 368-370

Nanny, Queen, 325

African culture and, 369

Napata, 301, 384

Afrocentricity theory and, 67

Napoléon Bonaparte, 261

Eurocentric anthropology and, 369

Narratives of the enslaved, 349-350

Fanon and, 147

Nation building, 202, 355

resistance to French assimilationist policy, 368-369

Nation of Islam, 105-106, 164, 278, 354-356, 459

“Negro,” 133, 370-371

Index-Asante.qxd 11/3/2004 3:25 PM Page 524

524——***Encyclopedia of Black Studies Negro convention movement, 371-372***

Nubia, 382-385

Negro Digest, 284

black ancient Egyptians, 214-215

Negro Factories Corporation, 456-457

Christianity and Islam, 385

The Negro Family: The Case for National Action, 343-344

commemorative sculpture, 7

Negro History Week, 102

Kush, 301-303, 384

“Negro National Anthem,” 199, 310

location and names, 382-383

Negro National Congress, 17

Napata, 384

The Negro World, 109, 456 , 457, 458

Nuer, 90

Neighborhood Association Settlement House, 289

Nupe, 41

Nelson, David, 307

Nurridin, Jalal, 307

Nelson, William, 117

Nyanga, 325

Neocolonialism, 243-244, 270, 372-374

Nyerere, Julius, 290

Westernization, 476-477

Kawaida philosophy and, 293

New African American Movement (NAAM), 461

Kiswahili movement and, 298

New Concept School, 272-273

Ujamaa, 51

New Deal, 375-376

New England Journal of Black Studies, 163

Obadele, Gaidi, 417

The New Negro: An Interpretation, 376-377

Obadeli, Imari, 418, 419

New Negro movement, 234, 370, 376-377

Obeah, 387

New Orleans, Louisiana

Obenga, Theophile, 47, 53, 95, 445

Carnival in, 246

O'Boyle, Patrick, 321

jazz, 281

Odu Ifa, 290, 293, 294, 295, 388-390

Marie Laveau and Vodou, 321-322

Oduduwa, 481-482

New York Public Library, Schomburg

Oduyoye, Mercy Amba, 51

collection, 429-431

Ofamfa-Matemasie epistemology, 40, 41, 49

Newron, 168

Ohio State University, African American Newton, Huey, 20, 135, 136, 137, 420

Studies program, 30

Nguzo Saba, 72, 200-201, 292-293, 295, 298, 303, Okpara, Mzee Lasana, 138

304, 378-379, 462

Old Egyptian language, 326

Nia, 303, 378, 379, 462

Old Freedom, 251

“Nigger,” 307, 370

Oluwole, Sophie, 51

Nihilism, 125-126

Omotunde, Jean Philippe, 53

Nix, Robert, 194

Ongonza, Maisha, 25

Nixon, E. D., 339

Onyewuenyi, Innocent, xxx

Nixon, Richard, 404

Operation PUSH, 403-405

affirmative action and, 3

Opoku, Albert Mawere, 36

black power and, 145

Opoku, Kofi Asare, 287

Njabafudi, Karim, 419

***Opportunity: A Journal of Negro Life*, 390-391**

Nketia, Kwabena, 36

*Oral histories, **narratives of the enslaved**, Nkrumah, Kwame, xxvii, 44-45, 50, 290*

349-350

All-African People's Revolutionary Party, 77-78

Oral tradition, 391-392

consciencism philosophy, xxvii, 195-197

Oratory, 19-20

neocolonialism and, 270, 372-373

Afro-cultural theory and, 74

Universal Negro Improvement Association and, 457

Nommo, 20

Nkrumah, Tawwab, 419

See also Nommo

Nobles, Wade, xxvii

Organization of African Unity (OAU), 45, 392

Nommo, 20, 341, 379-380, 391

Organization of Afro-American Unity, Nommo organization, 23

392-393, 420

Nonviolence, 192

Orishas, 312, 388, 481

Norment, Nathaniel, 22, 24

Oromo, 44

Norris, Clarence, 431, 433

O'Solomon, Otis, 473-474

North Star, 381-382

Outlaw, Lucius T., 47, 125

Norton Anthology of African American Literature, 222

Oyewole, Abiodun, 307

Notting Hill Gate Carnival, 247

Oyo Empire, 393-394

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 525

***Index*———525**

Pacifism, Congress of Racial Equality and, 192

Popular Traditional African Religions Paleolithic art, 6, 7

Everywhere (PTARE), 401

Pan-African Congresses, 459

Population

Pan-African nationalism, 130-134

African diaspora, 217

Congress of African Peoples, 192

African demographics, 37-39

Council of Independent Black Institutions and, Portugal, slave trade and,
236-237

201-202

Portuguese imperialism, 269

currents in Black Studies, 159

Positionalities, 75

David Walker's Appeal, 88-89

Powell, Adam Clayton, 20, 142, 143, 449

diaspora issues, 218

Powell, Adam Clayton, Jr., 194

Diopian historiography, 219-220

Powell, Colin, 140

Kawaida philosophy and, 293

Powell, Ozzie, 431, 433

Kiswahili movement and, 298

Powell vs. Alabama, 432

Nkrumah's All-African People's Revolutionary Party, Pragmatism, 125
77-79

Présence Africaine, 47, 50

*Nkrumah's **consciencism**, 195-197*

Presidential election campaigns, 141

socialism, 196

Price, Hugh B., 368

See also Afrocentricity; Kawaida Price, Victoria, 431, 433

Parks, Rosa, 10, 338-339, 438

Price-Mars, Jean, 271-272

Patriarchy, 395-396, 450

Professional associations, Association of Black Patterson, Haywood, 431, 433

Psychologists, 102-104

Patterson, William L., 17

Professional development in Black Studies, 361

P'Bitek, Okot, 50

Prosser, Gabriel, 255-256, 231, 416

Peace Movement of Ethiopia, 459

Protest pressure, 401-402

Pearce, J. C., 198

Protest songs (freedom songs), 250-252

Pennington, J. W. C., 233

Psychology

People United to Serve Humanity (PUSH), 403-405

African-centered, 103

Perry, Lee “Scratch,” 413

Asante’s critique, 297

Personality, African, 196

Association of Black Psychologists, 102-104

The Psychopathic Racial Personality, 402-403

Drapetomania and Dyaesthesia Aethiops, 324

Phenomenology, 125-126

*Wright’s **The Psychopathic Racial Personality,***

The Philadelphia Negro, 396-398

402-403

*Philanthropic institute, **National Black United Fund Ptahhotep, 42-43,***
138, 315

(NBUF), 358-359

Public Broadcasting Service (PBS), 156

Phillips, Ulrich B., 350

Publishers

Philosophy, African, See African philosophy; Africa World Press, 5

*Black philosophy; Religion and spirituality **Associated Publishers, 101-102***

*Philosophy, **antiracist, 98-100***

Black Star Publications, 130

Piankhi, 301, 384

Broadside Press, 170-171

Piano blues, 170

Johnson Publishing Company, 284

The Pittsburgh Courier, 398-399

Third World Press, 448-450

Plato, 138, 440

Puerto Rico, 180

Plessy, Homer, 283, 399

Pullman, George, 248

Plessy v. Ferguson, 171, 283, 299, 408, 399-400

PUSH, 403-405

Poetry

Push for Excellence, 404

oral tradition, 391-392

Pythagoras, 440

Third World Press and, 449

Watts Prophets, 473-474

Quaddus, Offoga, 419

Poitier, Sidney, 167

Quakers, 454, 455

Police harassment and brutality, 136, 143

Politics, black, See Black politics Race, class struggle and, 187-188

Polygamy, 11

Race, in black philosophy, 138

Popular culture, See Arts; Music Race-conscious districting, 139

Popular Front, 16

Race first, 457

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 526

*526——**Encyclopedia of Black Studies** Race Relations Institute, 415*

Kawaida and, 292

“Race riots”

*Kemetic-centered **Ausar Auset Society, 104-105***

Red Summer, 411-412

Messianism, 329-330

Watts Rebellion of 1965, 475-476

Obeah, 387

See also Resistance and revolution

Odu Ifa, 290, 293, 294, 295, 388-390

Racial consciousness, 198

Nommo, 379-380

Racism, antiracist philosophy, 98-100

Popular Traditional African Religions Ragtime, 281

Everywhere, 401

Rainey, Joseph H., 194

Rastafarianism, 407-410

Randall, Dudley Felker, 170, 449

Santería, 426-429

Randolph, A. Philip, 132, 320, 321, 364, 398, 402, 415

socialization, 12

Rangel, Charles, 194

spirit and reality, 34-35

Rap and hip-hop, 263-267

See also Christianity; Islam; Nation of Islam; Vodun Rara, 246

Religious nationalism, 133

Rashidi, Runoko, 86

Relocation, 221

Rastafarianism, 234, 407-410, 413, 459

Remond, Charles, 20, 80

Rationality, African, 40, 41-42

Remond, Sarah Parker, 80

Ravell, James, 445

Reparations movement, 414-416, 462

Ravell, Thelma, 445

African Burial Ground Project and, 33

Reactionary nationalism, 133

The Black Manifesto, 128-130

Reagan, Ronald, affirmative action and, 4

“Forty Acres and A Mule,” 250

Reapportionment, 139

Kawaida and, 294

Reconstruction, 411

Repatriation movement, See Back-to-Africa movement The Birth of A Nation, 111-112

Republic of New Afrika (RNA), 129, 416-419

Black codes, 120, 399

Republican Party, 13, 140, 335

Freedmen’s Bureau, 411

Resistance and revolution, 230-232, 325

Ku Klux Klan and, 299

aftermath of rebellions, 231-232, 353

troop withdrawal, 238, 283, 411

Black Power Conference of Newark, voter registration, 334

New Jersey, 142-143

Red Record, 97

Caribbean, 179-180

Red Sea Press, 5

day-to-day, 230

Red Summer, 411-412

deposition of liberation, 189-190

Regents of California v. Bakke, 4

Drapetomania and Dyaesthesia Aethiops, 324

Reggae, 407, 412-414

freedom songs, 250-252

Reid-Merrit, Patricia, 362

Gabriel Prosser revolt, 231, 255-256, 416

Reincarnation beliefs, 93, 198

Haitian Revolution, 180, 259-262

Reisner, George, 383

Kent State protests and massacre, 153

Reiss, Winold, 377

Nat Turner's rebellion, 118, 231, 351-353

Religion and spirituality, 13

Négritude and French assimilationist policy, 368-369

African aesthetic, 6-7

Obeah, 387

African American oratory tradition, 20

protest pressure, 401-402

African cosmology, 33-35

Red Summer, 411-412

African epistemology, 40

Revolutionary Action Movement (RAM), 419-420

African philosophy, 50-51

on slave ships, 331-332

Afro-Cuban Lucumi tradition, 312, 388, 429

Stono Rebellion, 440-441

ancient Egyptian/Kemetic tradition (Maat), Vesey's conspiracy, 231, 351, 417, 465

96, 315-317, 379-380

Watts Rebellion of 1965, 475-476

ancestor veneration, 89-93

*See also Abolition movement; Civil rights movement; **Black Church, 118-119***

*Maroon communities; specific movements, **black theology, 165-166***

organizations, persons

cosmotheandricity, 50-51

Revels, Rhoades Hiram, 194, 411

cultural genocide, 210

Reverse discrimination, 4

divination, 40-41

Revolutionary Action Movement (RAM), 129, 419-420

existential beliefs, 123

Revolutionary Communist League (RCL), 191

function of rituals and myths, 34-35

Revolutionary nationalism, 133, 291

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 527

***Index**———527*

Ribah, Bilal Ibn, 355

Sedjemic personality, 317

Rice, Condoleeza, 140

Segregation

Rigaud, André, 260-261

Black Codes, 120-121

Riggs, Marlon, 234-235

Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka, 171-172, Ring shout, 420-421, 439

200, 213, 283, 339

Rites of Ancestral Return, 33

in sports, 399

Rites of passage, 12, 72, 225

Plessy v. Ferguson, 171, 283, 299, 408, 399-400

Rituals and myths, function of, 34-35

“separate but equal” doctrine, 171, 283, Rivail, Hippolyte, 427

299, 399-400

Rivers, Freya, 69

See also Civil rights movement; Jim Crow Roberson, Willie, 431, 433

Selassie, Haile, 234, 407, 409-410

Robeson, Paul, 18, 19, 132, 183

Self-determination, 392-393

Robinson, Jackie, 18, 399

Marxist-Leninist critique, 15-16

Robinson, Jo Ann, 339

nationalism and, 130

Robinson, Randall, 415

Self-hatred, 213

Rodgers, Carolyn, 448

dislocation theory, 220

Rodney, Walter, 144

Self-reliance, 457

Roman Empire, 302, 385

Seminoles, 417

Roosevelt, Franklin D., 320, 375, 398

Senghor, Léopold Sédar, 47, 48, 67, 290, 368-369

Root doctor, 422

Separate but equal doctrine, 171, 283, 299, 399-400

Roumain, Jacques, 271

Separatists, 446

Ruggles, David, 372

September 11 attacks, 165

Russell, Joseph, 360

Serequeberhan, Tsenay, 126

Russwurm, John, 84

Service, in Maatian ethics, 316

Rustin, Bayard, 320

*Sexuality, **melanin theory** and, 328-329*

*Sexuality, portrayal in *The Birth of A Nation*, 112*

Sage Publications, 287

Shabazz, Betty, 417

Sales, William, xxix

Shabazz, el Hajj Malik el, See X, Malcolm Sambo, 234-235

Shaft, 168

Sanchez, Sonia, 21, 23, 24

Share Croppers' Union, 16

Sankofa (film), 425-426

Sharpton, Al, 20, 163-164

Sankofa (cultural movement), 94, 292

Shekem ur Shekhem, 104, 326

Sankore, University of, 48

Shelton, Robert M., 299

Santería, 13, 312, 388, 426-429

Shepherd, Ella, 248

Sartre, Jean-Paul, 48, 243

Sherman, General W. T., 249, 417

Schiele, Jerome H., 68

Sherwood, Grace, 325

Schomburg, Arthur, 227, 366, 429, 430

Shona, 41, 44, 90

Schomburg Center for Research in Black Shujuaa, Mwalimu, 68

Culture, 366, 429-431

Sierra Leone, 83, 131, 417

School desegregation, 200

Simba Wachanga, 294, 460

Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka, 171-172, Simmons, Russell, 266

200, 213, 283, 339

Simone, Nina, 85

The Crisis and, 206

Singleton, Benjamin "Pap," 132, 238

School of Afro-American Culture, 461

Singleton, Robert, 287

Schools, See Education

Slave narratives (narratives of the enslaved), 349-350

Schulberg, Budd, 474

Slave revolts and resistance, See Resistance Schuyler, George, 399

and revolution

Schwerner, Michael, 253, 300

Slave Route, 434-435

Science and African philosophy, 51

Slave trade, 10, 236-237

Science EXPO, 202

Asante's "Curse of the Door of No Return," 211

Scientific socialism, 78

Christianity and, 185

Scobie, Edward V., 227

economic calculus, 331

Scottsboro case, 16, 431-434

estimates, 237

Seale, Bobby, 135, 136, 137, 145

Jewish role in, 164

Securities Exchange Commission (SEC), 375

Middle Passage, 330-332

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 528

528——***Encyclopedia of Black Studies*** *mutinies of the enslaved, 331-332*

Southern Negro Youth Congress (SNYC), 17

prohibition of, 237, 330, 331

Southern Poverty Law Center, 300

Slave Route, 434-435

Soyinka, Wole, 48

Slavery, 10

Spain, slave trade and, 236

abolished, Thirteenth Amendment,

Spirit, consciousness and, 199

80, 82, 194, 298, 463

Spirit House, 142

African philosophy and, 48, 49

Spirituals, 13, 438-439

as holocaust, 269, 477

Sports

Caribbean plantations, 179

Capoeira, 175-178

Christianity and the racial order, 118-119

melanin theory of black emasculation, 329

Civil War and, 81

segregation in, 399

Compromise of 1850, 190-191

Stereotypes of racial minorities, 141

Drapetomania and Dyaesthesia Aethiops, 324

Ethnic Notions, 234-235

enslaved population, 10

Stevens, Thaddeus, 282

French Code Noir, 188-190

Stewart, James, xxvii-xxviii

Emancipation Proclamation, 229

Stewart, Maria, 20, 133, 293

Missouri Compromise, 190

Stokes, Louis, 194

narratives of the enslaved, 349-350

Stolen Legacy (James), 440

Sankofa (film), 425-426

Stono Rebellion, 440-441

See also African diaspora; Maroon communities; Strong, Edward E., 364

Slave trade

Structural Adjustment Programs, 374

Slavery abolition movement, See Abolition movement Student Non-Violent Coordinating Committee (SNCC), Smalls, James, 152

136, 144

Smallwood, Lorenza, 325

Freedom Rides, 335

Smith, Arthur L., Jr., See Asante, Molefi Kete Freedom Summer campaign, 193, 252

Smith, Gerrit, 382

March on Washington, 320

Smith, Wendell, 399

peace treaty, 460

Smitherman, Geneva, 224

Revolutionary Action Movement and, 420

Social Action Training Center, 460

songbook, 251

*Social welfare, **New Deal, 375-376***

Student protests, Kent State University, 153

Social work

Substratist approach, 204

Afrocentric, 71-72

Summer Institute (in Ghana), 362

National Urban League and, 365-368

Sumner, Charles, 283

Socialism, 78

Sun God, 215

African, 293, 369

Sundiata Keita, 318

See also Communism

Superfly, 168

Socialization, 12

Swahili (Kiswahili movement), 297-298

Sociology

Swazis, 92

Dark Ghetto, 213

Sweet, Sweetback's Baadasssss Song, 167

Du Bois and The Philadelphia Negro, 396-398

Swing bands, 281-282

Soldiers, African American, 82, 194, 367

Songhay Empire, 319, 435-436

Tacky Rebellion, 387

Sonthonax, Léger Félicité, 260

Taharqa, 301-302, 385

Soul, 436

“Talented tenth” theory, 1, 443-445

Soul food, 93

Tallensi, 91

The Souls of Black Folk (Du Bois), 119, 125, 437

Tanzania, Kiswahili movement and, 298

South Africa

Tappan, Lewis, 80

Black consciousness movement, 121-123

Tatum, Elinor, 88

HIV/AIDS in, 39

Tatum, Wilbert, 88

Southern Christian Leadership Conference (SCLC), Taylor, John, 418

119, 341, 437-438

Tempels, Placide, 47

Freedom Rides, 335

Temple University

Jesse Jackson and, 403-404

African American Studies programs, 20-24

Montgomery Bus Boycott and, 437-438

Charles L. Blockson Afro-American Collection, Southern Conference for Human Welfare, 17

182-183

Index-Asante.qxd 11/3/2004 3:25 PM Page 529

***Index*———529**

Cheikh Anta Diop International Conference, Ujamaa, 51, 145, 293, 293, 298, 303, 378, 379, 462

22, 183-184

Ujima, 292, 303, 378, 379, 462

fight for Afrocentricity, 23-24

Umfundalai, 453

postgraduate program, xx, 24-28, 29

Umoja, 292, 303, 378, 462

racism, 25

Underground Railroad, 454-456

struggle for Afrocentricity, 23-24, 29

Unemployment studies, 366

Temple Circle, xxviii, 401, 445-446

Unions

Terrell, Mary Church, 97-98

American Negro Labor Congress (ANLC), 15

Territorial nationalism, 133

racist tendencies, 188

Texas Black Codes, 120-121

Us alliance, 460

Theatre programs, 158, 163

*See also Labor movement; specific organizations **Karamu House, 289***

United Farm Workers, 460

Their Eyes Were Watching God (Hurstons), 446-447

United Nations (UN)

Theology, Black, 165-166

Declaration on Granting Independence to Colonial

They Came Before Columbus (Van Sertima), 448

Countries and Peoples, 417

Thiam, Awa, 51

*UNESCO's **Slave Route** project, 434-435*

Thiong'o, Ngugi Wa, 5, 48, 298

World Conference Against Racism (WCAR), Third World Press (TWP), 448-450

415, 477-478

Thirteenth Amendment, 80, 82, 194, 298, 463

Unity circle, 272

Thomas, Clarence, 221

Universal African Legions, 457

Tijerina, Reies, 460

Universal African Motor Corps, 457

Tilden-Hayes Compromise, 335

Universal African Nationalist Movement, 459

Timbuktu, 48, 319, 435

Universal Negro Improvement Association (UNIA), Tiv, 8

*15, 109, 132, 199, 208, 234, **456-459***

Toppin, Edgar Allen, 102

University of California, Berkeley, Black Studies Toronto Caribana, 246

program, 30

Toure, Kwame, See Ture, Kwame University of Michigan, race-sensitive admission Toure, Sekou, 290

program, 5

Tourgée, Albion Winegar, 84, 400

Up from Slavery (Washington), 350

Tourism, 181

Urban blues, 170

Towa, Marcien, 50

Urban guerrilla warfare tactics, 419

*Trades unions, See Labor movement; Unions **U.S. Constitution, Thirteenth Amendment, Traditional medicine, root doctor, 422***

80, 82, 194, 298, **463**

*Transatlantic slave trade, **Middle Passage**, 330-332, U.S. Constitution, **Fourteenth Amendment**, See also Slave trade*

194, 299, 334, **464**

Treaty of Guadalupe Hidalgo, 190

***U.S. Constitution, Fifteenth Amendment**, Treaty of Peace, Harmony and Mutual Assistance, 460*

194, 299, 334, **465**

Trenton Six, 17-18

U.S. League for Revolutionary Struggle, 192

Tribe of Shabazz, 354

U.S. Works Progress Administration, 349

Trinidad, 180, 245

***Us organization**, 95, 96, 290, 295, 298, Trotter, Monroe, 356*

304, **459-462**

Truth, Sojourner, 20, 80, 232

culture, 460-461

Tubman, Harriet, 456

operational unity, 461

Ture, Kwame (formerly Stokley Carmichael), political education, 461-462

19, 20, 135, 420

reparations movement and, 462

All-African People's Revolutionary Party, 78-79

Simba Wachanga, 294, 460

Black Panthers and, 145

black power movement and, 142, 144

Vagrancy laws, 121

Wellesley College and, 161

Valentine, Victoria, 207

Turner, Henry McNeal, 19, 84, 131

Van Horne, Winston, 58

Turner, Nat, 118, 231, 351-353

Van Peebles, Melvin, 167-168

Tuskegee Institute, 356, 456

Van Sertima, Ivan, 96, 448

Tuskegee Machine, 1, 2, 356

Vesey's Conspiracy, 231, 351, 417, 467

Tutsi, 44

Victory Stele, 301, 384

Two Cradle Theory, 450-451

Vietnam War opposition, 149

530——*Encyclopedia of Black Studies* *Violence*

Wesley, Charles H., 102

Fanonian concept of, 243-244

West, Cornel, 30, 125, 137, 221, 222

Ku Klux Klan and, 299-300

West Indian-American Day Carnival, 246

martyrs of the civil rights movement, 253, 300

Western Journal of Black Studies, xx See also Ku Klux Klan; Lynching; Resistance ***Westernization, 476-477***

and revolution; Slave trade

Weusi, Jitu, 200

Virgin Islands, 180

Wharton, Susan P., 396

Vodu (Voudun), 13, 322-323, 388, 468-471

Wheatley, Phillis, 124, 233

Haitian history, 470-471

White Citizen's Council, 335-336

Marie Laveau, 321-322

*White supremacist film, **The Birth of A Nation, 111-113***

repression of, 210

White supremacist organization, See Ku Klux Klan rituals, 469

White working class, 122, 188

temple, 470

Wilcox, Preston, 201

Voting rights, 140, 193, 252

Wilkins, Roy, 206, 320, 321

Fifteenth Amendment, 194, 299, 334, 464

Wilkinson, Bill, 300

Reconstruction era Mississippi, 334

Williams, Bert, 235

*registration movement, **Freedom Summer**, Williams, Chancellor, 214-215, 226-227*

252-253, 336

Williams, Eugene, 431, 432, 433

Voting Rights Act of 1965, 337

Williams, Henry Sylvester, 132

Vulture Glyph, 115-116

Williams, Leon, 23-24

Williams, Lorraine, 288

Wade, Jacqueline, 360

Williams, Peter, Jr., 233

Walker, Alice, 161

Williams, Robert F., 20, 223, 290, 417, 420

Walker, David, 19-20, 88-89, 131, 133, 142, 232, 352

Williams, Selase, 360, 362

Walker, Margaret, 85

Wilmore, Gayraud, 165

Walker, Wyatt Tee, 119, 308

Wilmot, David, 190

Wallace, George, 433

Wilson, Amos, 134

Wallace, Henry, 18

Wilson, Milton E., 153

War, African philosophy and, 51

Wilson, William Julius, 186, 221, 222

Washington, Booker T.

Wiredu, Kwasi, 138

accommodationism, 1-2

Wolof, 44

Du Bois and other critics of, 1

Women and abolition, 80

economic theory, 2

Women's issues

educational philosophy, 2-3

African philosophy and, 51

Garvey and, 132, 456

Africana womanism, xxxi, 57-58

in Ellison's Invisible Man, 277

Black Feminist Thought, 126-127

NAACP origins and, 356

Kawaida philosophy and, 293

on education, 444

The New Negro and, 377

oratory, 19

See also Feminism; Gender issues Tuskegee Machine, 1, 2

Woodard, Komozi, 133

Up from Slavery, 350

Woodson, Carter G., xix, 85, 101-102, 287-288, Watts, J. C., 140

297, 333, 402

Watts Prophets, 473-474

Work

Watts Rebellion of 1965, 475-476

contemporary African Americans' status, 11

Watts Writers Workshop, 474

Black codes and, 120-121

We Shall Overcome, 251

New Deal and, 375-376

Weatherby, Cassius, 474

unemployment studies, 366

W.E.B. Du Bois Institute for Afro-American white workers, 122

Research, 221

See also Labor movement

Weems, Charles, 431, 433

World Bank, 374

Wellesley College, 160-165

World Community of Islam in the West, 355

Wells, Ida B., 97, 142, 290, 356, 402

The World Conference Against Racism, Racial Wells-Barnett, Ida B., 20

Discrimination, Xenophobia, and Related Welsh, Kariam, 26, 68, 445

Intolerance, 415, 477-478

Index-Asante.qxd 11/2/2004 5:06 PM Page 531

Index———531

Worldview theory, 56-57, 64

Third World Press and, 449

The Wretched of the Earth (Fanon), Wellesley College and, 161

243-244, 478-479

Xango, 312

Wright, Andy, 431, 433

Xhosa, 44

Wright, Bobby, 402-403

Wright, Richard, 32, 124

Yacob, Zera, 40, 41, 49

Wright, Roy, 431, 432, 433

Yale University, Black Studies program, 30

Yoruba, 44, 92, 481-482

X, Malcolm, 11

*Afro-Cuban **Lucumi** tradition, 312*

assassination and its consequences,

cosmology, 34, 35

153, 392, 417

family structure, 241

autobiography, 105-106

masking traditions, 244

Bandung model, 460

Oyo Empire, 393-394

birthday, 13

Santería religious tradition, 426-427

black nationalism and, 131

Young, Whitney, 320, 321, 367

Black Panthers and, 136

Youth groups, 12

breaks from Nation of Islam, 355

Simba Wachanga, 294, 460

Harlem Renaissance and, 144

Southern Negro Youth Congress, 17

images of Armageddon in sermons, 354

Karenga's Kawaida philosophy and, 290, 293

Zion, 107-108

on term "Negro," 371

African, 233

oratory, 19, 20

Rastafarianism, 407

Organization of Afro-American Unity and, 392-393

Zulu, 35, 44

Revolutionary Action Movement and, 420

Zumbi, King, 325